The Ramayana of Valmiki

Introduction

Western culture is only just beginning to look beyond the Roman and Greek civilizations for new inspiration. Even so, it is a little surprising that, although the mighty epics of the Iliad and the Odyssey are widely known and loved, only a few scholars have studied their Hindu counterparts known as the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. In fact no good complete modern English translation of the Ramayana exists, and the best of those made in the last half of the 19th century are unobtainable outside the larger libraries.

The Ramayana is a work of great antiquity attributed to the illustrious Sage Valmiki. Its date of composition cannot be fixed with any certainty, particularly as, in common with other Sanskrit classics, it was not at first committed to writing, but was passed on from singer to singer. This process also accounts for the fact that the various versions (Sakhas) of the poem that have come down to us differ slightly in context. The interesting fact is that the scholars are agreed that the Ramayana is the grandly conceived and executed masterpiece of one poet, and not a collection of stories from many sources, loosely gathered together.

Unfortunately we know very little about the Rishi Valmiki, whose title ‘Adikavi’ (First Poet) and pre-eminence in Sanskrit verse has never been seriously challenged to this day. He was a robber chief in a forest in Northern India and on one occasion waylaid two ascetics for the purpose of plundering them. The travellers, however, spoke to him with kindness, and offered him the spiritual truth in lieu of the gold and silver which they did not possess. Convinced of their sincerity and on their advice, Valmiki changed his mode of life and became a devotee of Shri Ramachandra, the Seventh Incarnation of God (Vishnu) on earth. After a long period of meditation on the form and virtues of Shri Rama, it is said

that he was granted a vision of Rama's life from beginning to end.

He gave expression to this unique experience, in Sanskrit verse, in the 24,000 slokas (48,000 lines) known as the Ramayana. The sloka is a specific metre which the poet himself discovered, as is told in a beautiful passage in the first book.

The poem is divided into seven books (Kandas) of unequal length, which may be very briefly summarised as follows:

Book I (Bala-Kanda). King Dasaratha of Ayodhya (Oudh) performs a sacrifice in the hope of obtaining a son. At this time the Gods (Devas) are alarmed at the power acquired by the mighty Titan named Ravana, who, by the practice of black magic, had conquered almost all of the known world. King Dasaratha's prayer is answered and his three wives bear four sons, Rama, Bharata and the twins Lakshmana and Shatrughna, who are all partial incarnations of Shri Vishnu. Vishnu, however, manifests himself more fully in Shri Rama than in the other brothers. The boys grow up and Shri Rama wins as his bride, Sita, the daughter of King Janaka of the neighbouring kingdom of Videha.

Book II (Ayodhya-Kanda). King Dasaratha intends to proclaim Shri Rama heir-apparent, but the jealousy of his second queen, Kaikeyi, is aroused and she holds the king to a promise made formerly, that he would grant her two boons. The boons she now secures are the banishment of Shri Rama to the forest for fourteen years, and the installation of her own son Bharata as Yuvaraja. According to the law of righteousness (dharma) a vow must be honoured, and Shri Rama calmly accepts the sentence of exile. He travels south to Chitrakuta in the Dandaka Forest with his wife Sita and his brother Lakshmana. King Dasaratha dies of grief and Bharata implores Shri Rama to return to the throne, but the latter adheres firmly to the vindication of his father's honour and the fulfilment of his vow.

Book III (Aranya-Kanda). After about ten years in the forest with her husband, Princess Sita is kidnapped by the Titan Ravana, and taken by him to his capital, Lanka (the modern Ceylon).

Book IV (Kishkindha-Kanda). Rama and Lakshmana in pursuit of Ravana and to rescue Sita, enlist the aid of King Sugriva, leader of the monkey tribe, whose chief minister Hanuman becomes the foremost devotee and servant of Shri Rama. Help also comes from Vibhishana, brother of Ravana, who has openly disapproved of the Titan king's conduct, and warned him of the retribution he may expect for his unrighteous actions.

Book V (Sundara-Kanda). The monkey armies reach the south coast of India, and, bridging the straits, gain entry into Lanka.

Book VI (Yuddha-Kanda). After a series of pitched battles, Lanka is captured and Ravana is slain by Shri Rama. Sita demonstrates her purity and faithfulness to her husband, by successfully undergoing the ordeal by fire. The period of fourteen years' exile is by now completed, and Shri Rama returns with his consort, his brothers and allies, to the capital Ayodhya, where he begins a long and glorious reign.

Book VII (Uttara-Kanda). This 'later section' or epilogue describes the doubts raised in the minds of the citizens concerning the purity of Sita, and how they compel Shri Rama to send her to Valmiki's hermitage in the forest where she gives birth to twin sons, Kusha and Lava. When these boys grow up, they return to Ayodhya and are recognized by Shri Rama, who subsequently brings Sita back to share the ruling of the kingdom with him.

This in outline is the story of the Ramayana, which, in the poetic grandeur of the original, as well as in the later Hindi work on the same theme by Goswami Tulsidas, has exerted a tremendous influence on the men and women of India. It is not only poetry of unsurpassed dramatic power and brilliance, it is a treasure-house of information on rhetoric,

medicine, geology, botany, geography and every facet of the ancient civilization, with which learned scholars may interest themselves. For every Hindu, Shri Rama and Sita are the ideal man and woman, the model husband and wife. Shri Rama is an incarnation of God, the One all-pervading Principle of Truth and Intelligence, and what higher pattern for one's life could be chosen than this man of perfect virtue, a lover of truth, compassionate, just, benevolent, valorous and chivalrous?

The story may also be taken as an allegory. Symbolically Rama and Ravana represent the forces of light and darkness operating in the human heart, as well as in the world. Truth, benevolence, mercy and righteousness are the forces of Light which are opposed by greed, lust, love of pleasure and power, anger and egoity. The real triumph of man means conquest of the forces of darkness. In India a festival is celebrated each year on the day traditionally held to be that on which Ravana fell and the rule of tyranny, injustice, savagery and unrighteousness ended.

Mention has already been made of Tulsidas' later Hindi epic on the life of Shri Rama, which is probably the most widely read of all in the present day. One version of the story also forms an episode in the Mahabharata and another comparatively modern treatment of it is the Adhyatma Ramayana ascribed to the Sage Vyasa.

The Sage Valmiki himself wrote a long metaphysical classic known as the Maharamayana or Yoga Vasishtha, which deals with the inner development of Shri Rama as opposed to his outer deeds and which remains one of the most authoritative and respected philosophical treatises of Vedanta.

The life of Shri Rama has entered into the consciousness of the Indian people, and much art and literature, such as Bhavabhuti's dramas, draw their inspiration from it. The words of Brahma in the Ramayana have proved so far to be no idle boast: "So long as mountains and rivers have place on the earth, the story of the Ramayana will be told in the

world.”

The aim of the translator is to make the story known to English readers in a complete form. Although it is not possible to reproduce the beauty of the original poetic form, the true spirit of Valmiki’s masterpiece is here preserved and for those who have vision, the whole significance of its spiritual purpose will be apparent.

BOOK I

Bala Kanda

King Dasaratha of Ayodhya performs a sacrifice in the hope of a son. The Devas, alarmed at the power of the Titan Ravana, prevail upon Vishnu to incarnate. Four sons are born — Rama, Bharata, Lakshmana, Shatrughna — and the boys grow to manhood. Rama, accompanying the sage Vishwamitra, slays the demons of the forest, breaks the bow of Shiva at the court of Janaka, and wins Sita as his bride.



CHAPTER 1

Shri Narada relates to Valmiki the story of Rama

CHAPTER Sltri Narada r614ta to V almiki tM rtory of **RAMA** THE Sage **VALMIKI**, chief among the *munis*' and the most eloquent of men, coastantly engaged in the practice of self· control and the study of the holy scriptures, enquired of Shri Narada:" "Who is there in the world to-day, endowed with excellent and heroic qualities, who is versed in all the duties of life, grstcful, truthful, firm in his vows, an actor of many parts, benevolent to all beiDgs, learned, eloquent, handsome, patient, slow anger, oae who is truly great ; who is free from envy and when excited to wrath can strike into the hearts of celestial beings ? O Sage, I would hear of such a man from thee, who art able to describe him to me." Narada, aequainted with the past, the present and the future, pleased with the words of the Sage **VALMIKI**, answered him saying: " Rare indeed are those, endowed with the qualities thou hast enumerated, yet I can tell thee of such a oae. Born in the liunily of Ikshwaku,' he is named **RAMA** ;' one renowned, fully self-controlled, valorous and illustrious, the Lord of All. Wise, conversant with the ethics! code, eloquent, fortunste, a slayet of his foes, broad-shouldered, long-armed, possessing a conch-shaped neck and prominent chin, eminent in archery, with a muscular body, arms extending to the knees, and a noble head and brow ; of mighty prowess ; possessing well-proportioned limbs and skin of bluish tint,' one l'CDOwned for his virtue ; of prominent eyes, deep-chested, bearing auspicious marks ; one who those who take refuge in him and is ever-mindful of the good of those dependent on him ; true to his promises, benevolent to his subjects, omniscient, for his good deeds, pure, and ever responsive to devotion ; med itating on his own

essence. " Equal to **BRAHMA**, the Protector of his people, pleasing to look upon ; supporting the universe ; the destroyer of those who contravene the moral code ; the inspirer of virtue ; the giver of special to his devotees and to those who duly observe sacrilicial rites and are charitable ; conversant with the essence of the Vedic pbilnsophy; an adept in the science of warfare ; skilled in the scriptural law ; of infallible memory ; beloved of all ; of courteous disposition ; incapable of cowardice; acquainted with the laws of this world as also of the other worlds. “As the rivers hasten to the ocean, so do men of virtue ever approach him. " Equal to Vishou in valour ; grateful to the sight as the full moon ; when stirred to righteous anger, resembling all consuming death ; in patience like the earth, in generosity like Kuvera ;” in truthfulness the personification of virtue. Such are his great qualities-Ram, the beloved heir of King Dasar atha, possessing every ecellent attribute, benevolent to all, devoted to the welfare of every living being.” His father, King **DASARATHA**, made preparations to install him as his regent, but the Queen **KAIKEYI**, the boons formerly promised to her, demanded the of **RAMA** and the enthrone ment of her own son **BHARATA**. The king held by his promise and bY the ties of honour, sent his son **RAMA**, whom he loved as his own life, into exile. Obeying the command of his royal sire, and in order to gratify **KAIKEYI**, **SHRI RAMA** went to the forest. The son of Queen **SUMITRA**, Prince **LAKSHMANA**, inspired by affection and humility, followed his brother **RAMA** into exile. ·-The daughter of King Janab, an incarnation of Lakshmi, endowed with the highest feminine virtues, seeing Prince Laksbmans accompanying **RAMA**, obedient to her lord, followed him as Venus follows the moon. Accompanied for some leagues by King **DASARATHA** and his people, **RAMA** dismissed the chariot on reaching the town of Shringavera on the banks of the Ganges, and commanded

the minister Sumantta to to the capital. Here the prince met his beloved Guha, the chief of the Cbandslas, accompanied by whom, with Laksbmans and **SITA**, he crossed the river Ganges and entered the forest, arriving at length at the Chittrakuta mountain described by the Sage Bhsradwaja. **RAMA**, Laksbmans and **SITA** dwelt hsppily in the forest like *devas*' or gandhsrvas. Overwhelmed with grief at the separation from his sons and lamenting their absence, the king departed this life, while **RAMA** was dwelling on the Chittrakuta mountain. The holy sages offered the throne, left vacant on the desth of King **DASARATHA**, to Prince **BHARATA**, who declined it, not desiring the kingdom. Setting forth to the forest where **SHRI RAMA** dwelt, in order to propitiate him, he approached that hero of truth with humility and directing his attention to the code of justice with which he was ccmversant, requested **RAMA** to return and govern the kingdom. The magnanimous, handsome and mighty **RAMA** reftlsed to accept the throne, preferring to carry out the command of his sire and, presenting Prince **BHARATA** with his sandals as a symbol of authority, repeatedly eahorted him to return to the capital. Shri **BHARATA**, touching the feet of **RAMA** in submission. departed and began to rule the dominion from the town of Nandigrama, while esgerly awaiting the return of his brother. The sages and hermits, who dwelt in the forest, constantly harassed by *asuras*,' approached Shri **RAMACHANDRA** to ask for his protection-**SHRI RAMA** agreed to slay the evil *asuras* in order to preserve the Sages who had sought his help. The holy men, whose appearance equalled the fire in lustre, heard of **SHRI RAMA**'s resolve and were assured by him of his pro tection. The female *asura* Shurpanakha, who could assume various forms at will, was overpowered and disfigured by **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. All the wicked rakshasascame led by Khara, Dushane and Trishira, to eugage in combat with **SHRI RAMA**, and were slain by him. **SHRI RAMA** slew

fourteen thousand *rakshasas* who dwelt in that forest. Hearing of the slaughter of the *rakshasas*, King Ravaua transpOrted with rage, took with him Marieha, a demon like himself. Marieha, knowing the superior strength of **RAMA**, sought to dissuade Ravaua from entering into combat with him, but Ravaua who was marked down by destiny, disregarded the advice and went with Marieha to **SHRI RAMA**'s abode. There, Marieha lured **SHRI RAMA** and Laksh mana away from the hermitaeo and **RAVANA**, having slain the vulture **JATAYU**, carried **SITA** away. Learning from the dying **JATAYU** of the abduction of the daughter of the King of Mithila, **SHRI RAMA** was overwhelmed with grief and began to mourn. Having performed the funeral rites of the vulture, while wandering in search of **SITA**, he encountered an *asura* named Kabandha whose form was menacing and terrible. **SHRI RAMA** slew him and then performed the funeral riteS whereupon his soul ascended to heaven. While passing to the cclestial sphere, Kabandha spoke to **RAMA** of Shabari, a female ucetic, and entreated him to visit her. **SHRI RAMA**, the ever resplendent Desttoyer of his foes, came to where Shabari dwelt \'nd was duly worshipped by her. On the banks of the Lalre Pampa, **SHRI RAMA** met the monkey **HANUMAN** who presented **SUGRIVA** to him. The mighty **RAMA** related the whole of his story to him as far as the abduction of Shri **SITA**. **SUGRIVA** having listened to **SHRI RAMA** entered into the rite of :liiendship with him, witnessed by the fire. With full faith in **RAMA**, **SUGRIVA** then recounted to him all the sutrerings he had endured through his enmity with Bali' slay Bali, but **SUGRIVA**, uncatain ofRama's prowess and desiring to test him, showed him the bones of the body of Dundbubi, forming a heap as high as a mountain. With bis foot. **RAMA** kicked the heap to a distance of ten yojanas and, discharging an arrow,pienedseven palmyra trees, cleaving a mountain and with the shaft penetrating to the centre of the earth. Having

witnessed this exploit. **SUGRIVA** was satisfied, and thereafter trusted **RAMA** implicitly. In his aJmpany he passed through deep valleys to the town of Kishkindbya ; thete, the yellow-eyed **SUGRIVA** roared like thunder. At tbis terrible sound, the powerfUl and valiant monkey chief, Bali, issued forth, disregarding the waming of bis wife Tara, and engaged in aJmbat with **SUGRIVA**. As desired by **SUGRIVA**, **SHRI RAMA** slew Bali with a single arrow ; then he entrusted the government of Kishkindhya to **SUGRIVA** who now, as king of the monkey tribe, gathered his forces together and dispatched them to every quarter in search of **SITA**. The vulture chief, the courageous Sampati, informed Manu man where **SITA** was, whereupon the monkey leapt over the sea tbat lies between Bharatvarshand Lanka, a distance of five hundred miles. Entering the city of Lanka that was protected by **RAVANA**, **HANUMAN** beheld **SITA**, meditating on **RAMA** in the ashoka garden. He there delivered Ranta's ring to her and acquainted her with the welre of her lord. Having rtvived the courage of **SITA**, he shattered the gate of the garden and slew seven sons of the counsellors of **RAVANA**, five great captains and levelled Akshya kumara, the son of **RAVANA**, to the dust. Then he sulfered himself to be taken captive. Knowing he could not be subdued by the weapon granted by **BRAHMA** to **RAVANA**, yet acknowledging the power of its blessing, **HANUMAN** allowed himself to be imprisoned, sufl"ering many indignities. Subsequently he burnt the whole of Lanka, only sparing the place where **SITA** dwelt. :=-=. oivon-.-... Returning to deliver his welcome tidings, he respectfully circumambulated the mighty **RAMA** and recounted in detail how he bad found **SITA**. Setting out in the company of **SUGRIVA** and others, **RAMA** reached the sea. There he created a tempest by his shining arrows and the Lord of the waters, Sumudra, appeared before bim. Under his direction, NaJa threw a bridge over the sea. Crosaing the sea by of tbis

bridge, **SHRI RAMA** entered gave much gold, and hundreds of thousands of cows in eharity, thus preparing for themselves a place in the divine regions. **SHRI RAMA** added incalculably to the prosperity of the dynasty, and bestowed immense wealth on the *brahmins*. He employed his subjects in the duties of their respectives castes and ruled for eleven thousand years, after which he returned to his celestial abode, Vaikuntha. He who reads the stoty of **RAMA**, which imports merit and purity, is freed from all sin. He who reads it with faith and devotion is ultimately worshipped together with his sons, grandsons and servants at his death. A *brahmin*' reading this becomes proficient in the Vedas, and philosophy; a *kshatriya*' becomes a king; a vaishyagrows prosperous in trade; a shudra,on reading this will become great in his caste. CHAPTER Sage V almiki creates tlr4 metrical form far the story THE wise and eloquent **VALMIKI** with his disciple, Bharadwaja, having listened to the words of Narads, was filled with wonder and worshipped **RAMA** in his heart. He olfered obeisance to Shri Narada, who craved permission to deport and on his request being granted he ascended through space to the heavens. Narada, having deported, the great *Muni* **VALMIKI** proceeded to the banks of the river Tamasa, which was close to the Ganges. Reaching that place and seeing the pure and limpid waters, **VALMIKI** said to his disciple : " O Bharadwaja, behold how pure is the water of the holy river, verily it is clear and pleasant like the mind of a good man. O Oilld, set down the waterpot and fetch me my hark robe from the hermitage. I wish to bathe in the sacred stream, delay not." Obedient to the command of his Guru, the disciple brought

CHAPTER 2

Valmiki creates the metrical form for the story

gave much gold, and hundreds of thousands of cows in eharity, thus preparing for themselves a place in the divine regions. **SHRI RAMA** added incalculably to the prosperity of the dynasty, and bestowed immense wealth on the *brahmins*. He employed his subjects in the duties of their respectives castes and ruled for eleven thousand years, after which he returned to his celestial abode, Vaikuntha. He who reads the stoty of **RAMA**, which imports merit and purity, is freed from all sin. He who reads it with faith and devotion is ultimately worshipped together with his sons, grandsons and servants at his death. A *brahmin*' reading this becomes proficient in the Vedas, and philosophy; a *kshatriya*' becomes a king; a vaishyagrows prosperous in trade; a shudra,on reading this will become great in his caste. CHAPTER Sage V almiki creates tlr4 metrical form far the story THE wise and eloquent **VALMIKI** with his disciple, Bharadwaja, having listened to the words of Narads, was filled with wonder and worshipped **RAMA** in his heart. He olfered obeisance to Shri Narada, who craved permission to deport and on his request being granted he ascended through space to the heavens. Narada, having deported, the great *Muni* **VALMIKI** proceeded to the banks of the river Tamasa, which was close to the Ganges. Reaching that place and seeing the pure and limpid waters, **VALMIKI** said to his disciple : " O Bharadwaja, behold how pure is the water of the holy river, verily it is clear and pleasant like the mind of a good man. O Oilld, set down the waterpot and fetch me my hark robe from the hermitage. I wish to bathe in the sacred stream, delay not." Obedient to the command of his Guru, the disciple brought the l8iment from the Sage's hermitage and returning speedily, olfered it to him. Receiving the robe of bark from the hands of his disciple. the sage, with his senses fully controlled, girded it about him and while bathing repeated the traditional prayers, olfering libations of water to his ancestors and the gods. Then he wandered about in the

forest enjoying the beauties of nature. Now the auguat sage, Shri **VALMIKI**, beheld a psir of Krauncha hirds fearlessly disporting themselves in love. Soon after, a fowler stealing up unobserved, slew the male bird in the presence of the sage. The female bird, deprived of her yellow crested companino, who but now had been spreading his wings in the act of love to please her, perceiving him bleeding and crying out in distress, began to mourn. The heart of the sage was filled with pity on seeing the bird struck down by the fowler. Touched by the lament of the female krauncba and incensed by the cruel act of the fowler, the sage said : " O Fowler, having killed the bird in the midst of the enjoyment of love with its mate, thou shalt never attain prosperity. Do not visit the forest for many years lest evil overtake thee." Refteeting on the words he bad addressed to the fowler and realising their implication, the sage said to himself: " What worda are these that I have uttered, inspired by my compassion for the dying hird ? " The wise and learned sage reflected a moment, and then said to his disciple : " Grieving for the dying bird, I have recited this verse of four feet, each of equal syllables, which can be and performed other rituals and having instructed his disciple in the tradition and the sacred history, passed into deep meditation. The Creator of the world, the Self-born, the four filced and glorious Btahma at length appesrcd before the holy sage. **VALMIKI** rose hastily, filled with astonishment, and welcoming the Deity in great humility, offered obeisance to Him. Leading Him to a seat, in profound reverence he poured forth h"bations of water as enjoined in the tradition, making enquiries as to His welfare. The Blessed Lord accepted the homage offered to Him and commanded the sage to be seated. Shri **VALMIKI** occupied the place designated by **BRAHMA** and once more reco1lected his grief over the incident of the wicked fowler, who ruthlessly slew the bird that was so happy and cooing with delight. He recalled the grief of

the female bird and read and re-read the lines : " By the ignorant and wicked fowler, grief is born For he has wantonly slain the melodious krauncha.” Shri **BRAHMA**, seeing the sage aftlicted and sorrowful, said to him : " O Great Sage, let these words spontaneously uttered by thee, inspired by the death of the krauncha, be poetry. Do thou describe the whole story of **RAMA**, who is the essence of virtue and fu1J of the highest attributes, in accordance with what thou hast heatd from Shri Natada. Do thou narrate all the known and hitherto unknown deeds of **SHRI RAMA**, **SITA** and I .akshmn and the *asuras*. Whatever relates to King **DASARATHA**, his wives, city, palace, sayings, condUct and what he accomplished, will be revcsled to thee by my favour. None of thy words will prove false. Do thou render into verse the sacred and delightful deeds of **RAMA**. O Sage, as long as the mountains and rivers remain on the earth, so long will the story of **SHRI RAMA** endure. So long as the story of **RAMA** endures, so long shalt thou abide in the higher regions.” Having uttered these words, Shri **BRAHMA** pondered awhile within Himself and then vanished from sight. The great sage and his disciple were filled with amazement at this event, and reading the stanza again and again, their delighr grew. Repeatedly reciting the couplet, compoaed by **VALMIKI**, they realised that the holy sage had expressed his sorrow THE RAMAYANA’OF VALMIKI in poetic furm, Then Shri **VALMIKI** meditated on the Lord witbin his soul and it occurred to him to relate the stacy of Rsma in sinWar verse. For the good nf the world, the illustrious and holy sage, thetefote, began composing the life of Shri Rsma in verse ; that Rsma, worthy nf world-wide renown, who is both generous and charming. Shri **VALMIKI** composed the story of the life nf Rsma and of the slaying nf **RAVANA** in beautiful and measuted stanzas, a work nf infinite merit.

CHAPTER 3

The deeds of Rama that will be described in the sacred poem

Concerning the sacred theme. Washing his hands and feet and drinking a little pure water, placing himself acing the east on a sest nfkusha grsss, with joined pslms, he passed into profound meditation and in a vision beheld the history of Rsma. Through the grsce of Shri Brahms, the holy sage saw all that Rsma, **SITA** and Lakshmans had experienced, observed and done. He witnessed in detail the life of Rsma, who was truth incarnate and all that he had accomplished in the forest and other places. By the power nf spiritual meditation and *yoga*, the Sage **VALMIKI** saw the whole past as clearly as if it were a fruit placed on the pslm nf his hand. Thus, having witnessed all, the most enlightened sage began to describe the life nf Shri Rams in verse. Tbe history nf Shri Rsma, which confers righteousness, worldly prosperity and delight on the reader, which does not degrsde the mind and grants release from sorrow, that story which charms the heart and is as twl nflovely gems as is theses, was rendered by Shri **VALMIKI**, in the form in which Shri Narada had related it to him. Tbe birth of Rsma, his valour, his benevolence to all men, his lllliversal goodwill, his clemency, his pleasing looks, his s\veet disposition, his love of truth, his humility, his helpful services to the Sage Vtshwamitra, the instruction given by the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** to him and his patient hearing of it ; his breaking of the bow ; his marriage to Princess **SITA** ; his controversy with Parasurama ; the preparations for his coronation ; a description of his great qualities ; the opposi tion otfcred by Queen Kailreyi to the coronation ; his departure to the forest ;

the lament and death of King **DASARATHA**, the grief of the people of Ayodhya ; **RAMA**'s speech with the ferryman ; his farewell to Samantra ; his crossing of the Ganges ; his visit to the holy Sage Bharadwaja ; his departure for Chittrakuta on the instance of the sage ; his dwelling in the leaf-thatched hut on Mount Chittrakuta ; the grief of the king on Sumantra's return and the monarch's departure to heaven ; the arrival of Shri **BHARATA** at Chittrakuta to persuade **RAMA** to return to his kingdom ; his stay at the hermitage ; his interview with **RAMA** ; the funeral rites of his sire ; **RAMA**'s refusal to rerum ; the receiving of **RAMA**'s sandals by **BHARATA** as a symbol of authority ; **BHARATA**'s installation of the symbol and his ruling of Ayodhya from Nandigrama ; **SHRI RAMA**'s visit to the Dandaka forest ; his slaying of the wicked Vll'Odha ;his interview with the Sage Sharabhanga ; his arrival at the hermitage of Sutikshna ; the meeting of Anasuya with Shri **SITA** and the imparting of teachings to her ; the visit of the Sage Agastya ; his residence at Panchavati ; the meeting with **JATAYU** ; the appearance of Shurpamakha ; the conversation of **RAMA** and Lakahmana with her ; Shupamakha's mutilation ; the slaying of Khara, Dusana and Trishira ; the arrival of **RAVANA** ; the slaying of Maricha ; the abduction of **SITA** ; **RAMA**'s lament on his separation from **SITA** ; the slaying of **JATAYU** by **RAVANA** ; the meeting with Kabandha ; the arrival at Lake Pampa ; **RAMA**'s interview with Shabati ; his arrival at the Rishyamukha mountain ; his meeting with **HANUMAN** ; **RAMA**'s seal of friendship with **SUGRIVA** ; his promise to destroy Bali ; the combat between Bali and **SUGRIVA** ; the slaying of Bali ; the mourning of Tara ; the installation of **SUGRIVA** ; **SHRI RAMA**'s sojourn on the mountain in the rainy season ; **SUGRIVA**'s exceeding of the stated time for his mission, **RAMA**'s anger against him ; Lakahmana's delivery of the message to **SUGRIVA** ; **SUGRIVA**'s visit to **RAMA** ; his propitiation of **RAMA** ; the

organising of the monkey army ; the dispatch of the monkeys to find **SITA**'s abode ; the description of the esrth given to them ; the giving of **RAMA**'s ring to **HANUMAN** ; the monkeys entry into the dark cave ; their fasting on the seashore in pteparation for death ; their interview with Ssmpati, the king of the vultures ; his information respecting Lsnb ; **HANUMAN**'s leap and his crossing of the ses ; the emergence of the Minaks hill from the ocesn ; the slaying of the wicked female demon Singhika who imprisoned her victims by capturing their shadow ; the appear ance of Lsnb by night ; the entry of **HANUMAN** into Lsnb and his lonely reftections ; his seeing of the wicked Ravans and his aerial chsriot Pushpab; **HANUMAN**'s entry into the inner apartments, where Ravans is drinking surrounded by women ; **HANUMAN**'s search for **SITA** and his beholding of the princess in the ashoka garden; Ravans's entry into the garden and his solicitation of **SITA** ; her reproaches ; the threatening of **SITA** by the female uuras ; **TRIJATA**'s description of her dteam concerning the delivery of **SHRI RAMA**'s ring to **SITA** by **HANUMAN** ; the conversation on this matter ; the gift of the jewel to **HANUMAN** by **SITA** ; the destrUCtion of the grove by **HANUMAN** ; the Oight of the women uuras ; the slaying of Ravans's guards by **HANUMAN** ; the captore of **HANUMAN** and the burning of Lsnb by him ; the re-crossing of the sea ; the eating of the fruits of the Madhu forest ; the words of consolation offered to **SHRI RAMA** by **HANUMAN** and the delivery of Shri **SITA**'s jewel to him ; the arrival of **SHRI RAMA** at the seuhore and the bridging of the ses by Nsla and Nila ; the siege of Lsnb ; the arrival of Ravans's brother Vibishana to take refuge with **SHRI RAMA** and the disclosure by him of the design to destroy Ravans ; the slaying of Kumbhabma and Meghanads ; the destrUCtion of Ravans ; the reunion with **SITA** ; the crowning of Vibisbana, King of Lsnb ; the offer of the aerial chsriot Pushpab by Vibishana to **RAMA** ; the retnm of **SHRI RAMA**

to Ayodhya; the reunion with Prince Bbatata; the crowning of **SHRI RAMA** u king ; the farewell to the monkey army ; the rejoicings ot'his subjects at the coronation; the repudiation ofSita; these and all the other deeds of **RAMA** onesrthhave been described in the sacred poem written by the blessed **VALMIKI** himlelf.

CHAPTER 4

Shri Rama's sons chant the poem

WHILE **SHRI RAMA** was still King of Ayodhya, the great Sage **VALMIKI** composed this beautiful classic. The holy *rishi* composed twenty-four thousand verses and divided them into five hundred chapters and six books. In addition, he composed the epilogue. The work being completed, he retlected thus : " To whom shall I tescb tbis classic ? " While the sage was reflecting on the matter, the two princes, Kusba and Lava, the offspring of **RAMA** and **SITA** approacbed bim and toucbed bis feet in reverence. The great sage studied these two virtuous princes of mellifluous speecb, who dwelt with bim in bis hermitage at tbat time. Knowing them to be wise and foil of faith in the tescbings of the Vedss, the great sage, who had expounded the meaning of the scriptures in bis verses, taught the classic to them. The **VALMIKI** taught them the classic describing the deeds of **RAMA** and **SITA** and all that relates to the inciden!B lesding to the slaying of **RAVANA** named "The Slaying of the Grandson of Poulastya ". Tbis historical classic is pleasant to sing and adopted to the three measures of time,' it is contained within the seven notes and can be sung to the vina. It expresses the various moods of love, courage, disgust, anget, terror, compassion, wonder,laughllr and serenity. The two princes were skilled musicians, proficient in rhythm

and melody and had sweet voices ; they were as comely to look at as Gandbarvas. Endowed with god-like beauty, the two sweet singers, the retlected images of **SHRI RAMA** himself, constandy repeabd the holy classic and commitbd it to memory. The two adorable and charming princes skilfully recibd the holy classic, the Ramayana, wbicb extols virtue, before the sages, the learned *brahmins* and the ascetics, as they had been instructed to do. On a particular occasion, the two princes, great-souled, fottunate, and equipped with all good qualities, chanted the great epic in **SHRI RAMA**'s assembly. The listening sages were visibly moved and shed of delight. Being overcome with wonder, they cried " Excellent ! Excellent ", and ptaisiag the two siagets, the virtue-loving sages experienced great joy. Showetiag ptaises on the brothers, they cried, "How melodiously you sing I How exquisite is the divine poetn, the story of Ramal" Being pleased with the sweet singers, one sage presented them with loshtas, another with delicious fruits, a third with robes of bark and another with antelope skins ; some gave sacrificial thread, some vessels for collecting alms, others gave loin cloths, kusba grass, garments of yellow cloth, scarves and thread for binding the bair, sacrificial vessels, rosaries and axes. Others bestowed their blessings upon thetn, saying " May you live long " and all acclaimed the aothnr of the marvellous poem. **THEY** *said*: " This metre will be the foundation of the verse of future poets ; it is composed according to specific rules ; the two ptinces bave sung this wonderful poem with great art ; it will ptomote wisdom in those who listen to it and them longevity and health ; it is truly able to charm the heart." While the sages were thus ptaising the two princes, Shri Ramacbandra, passing that way, took them to his royal palace. Occupying his golden throne, **SHRI RAMA**, the destroyer of his foes, offered hospitslity and reverence to the two worthy ptinces. In the assembly, surrounded by his ministers and brothers, **SHRI RAMA**

looked approvingly on those handsome and learned youths, and addressed the Princes I .akshmana, Sbatrughna and Bharsta saying : " Hear the historical poetn, whieh these two celestial and brilliant minatrels sing, this poem whieh portrays incidents of wonderful meaning." Then **SHRI RAMA** commanded the two musicians to sing and the ptinces tuned their vinas and chanted the poem they had learned, sweetly and clearly. The whole asaembly listened to the music whieh was wholly gratifying to the mind and heart. **SHRI RAMA** *said*: " I 8dmire the music and the verse sung by these two minattels who appear to be endowed with royal attributes." J6 In this way, praised and eocouraged by Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, the two brotbeJs demonsll'llting their skill in music, sang on. Listeniug to them in the royal assembly, Shri Ramscbandra was charmed. CBAPTBB S DasGf'atha's kilwdom fJIId capital Till! esrtb eonsisting of seven islands bas been under one ruler since the time of those kings descended from Manu,' who were ever victorious. Among those mighty monarchs was Sagara followed by his sixty thousand sons who hollowed out the ocean. This classic Ramsyana contains the history of the House of Sagara, founded by Ikshwaku. This Rams-Katha' will be recited from beginning to end-let all listen to it with faith. On the banks of the river Sarayu, there was a great and prosperous country named Koshala, inhabited by contented people. In it was the city of Ayodhya, famous in the three worlds, founded by the renowned Manu, a lotd among men. The city's tborougbtilres eztended for sixty miles ; its beauty was enhanced by admirably planned, the principsl highways being sprinkled with water and strewn with flowers. King **DASARATHA** protected the city as Maghavan proteCts Amaravati. He dwelt there in splendour, as **INDRA** in heaven. The city had beautiful and massive gates and eharming markets; its fortifialtions were planned by sliJful engineers and

artificers. There were batds, ballad singers and public musicians in the city ; the inhabitants were weslthy and had spacious houses with high arched porticos, decorated with flags and banners. It was alied with eztensive buildings and beautiful gatdens, u.m c::r!:;, :S:CU: man··. '" ... or

CHAPTER 5

King Dasaratha's kingdom and capital

In this way, praised and eocouraged by Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, the two brotbeJs demonsll'llting their skill in music, sang on. Listeniug to them in the royal assembly, Shri Ramscbandra was charmed. CBAPTBB S DasGf'atha's kilwdom fJIId capital Till! esrtb eonsisting of seven islands bas been under one ruler since the time of those kings descended from Manu,' who were ever victorious. Among those mighty monarchs was Sagara followed by his sixty thousand sons who hollowed out the ocean. This classic Ramsyana contains the history of the House of Sagara, founded by Ikshwaku. This Rams-Katha' will be recited from beginning to end-let all listen to it with faith. On the banks of the river Sarayu, there was a great and prosperous country named Koshala, inhabited by contented people. In it was the city of Ayodhya, famous in the three worlds, founded by the renowned Manu, a lotd among men. The city's tborougbtilres eztended for sixty miles ; its beauty was enhanced by admirably planned, the principsl highways being sprinkled with water and strewn with flowers. King **DASARATHA** protected the city as Maghavan proteCts Amaravati. He dwelt there in splendour, as **INDRA** in heaven. The city had beautiful and massive gates and eharming markets; its fortifialtions were planned by sliJful engineers

and artificers. There were batds, ballad singers and public musicians in the city ; the inhabitants were weslthy and had spacious houses with high arched porticos, decorated with flags and banners. It was alied with eztensive buildings and beautiful gatdens, u.m c::r!:;, :S:CU: man··. '" ... or THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI and surrounded by mango groves, tall enhancing the outskirts of the city, giving it the appearance of a beautiful girl wearing a girdle of greenery. The city was enclosed by Strollg fortificatiODS and a deep moat which DO erumy, by any expedient whatsoever, could penetrate. Countless elephants, horses, cattle, camels and mules were to be seen in the city. Inn=ble ambassadors and merchants dwelt there and people from many lands traded peacefully within its walls. Ayodbya, like Indta's Amaravati, was resplendent with gilded palsces, the walls of which were set with precious stones, the

CHAPTER 6

The city of Ayodhya

THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI and surrounded by mango groves, tall enhancing the outskirts of the city, giving it the appearance of a beautiful girl wearing a girdle of greenery. The city was enclosed by Strollg fortificatiODS and a deep moat which DO erumy, by any expedient whatsoever, could penetrate. Countless elephants, horses, cattle, camels and mules were to be seen in the city. Inn=ble ambassadors and merchants dwelt there and people from many lands traded peacefully within its walls. Ayodbya, like Indta's Amaravati, was resplendent with gilded palsces, the walls of which were set with precious stones, the pre-emineruc in uuth and virtue ; he was one who

never broke his word, who was ever prudent, majestic and bdoved of his subjects, a great chariotEer, a worthy descendant of the dynasty of Ikshwaku, an observer of many sacrifices, one who ever delighted in the practice of righteousness ; in full authority over his people, equal to a great sage ; a royal seer, renowned in the three worlds, triumphing over his enemies, a friend to all ; having perfect control of his senses and appetites ; in prosperity equal to **INDRA** ; in wealth equal to Kuvera. That uuth-loving monarch, striving to acquire perfection in virtue, worldly prosperity and happiness, ruled the city as the cdestial monarch **INDRA** rules Amaravati. The people in that city were happy, virtuous, learned, ezperienced, each satisfied with his state, practising his own calling, without avarice and of uuthful speech. None was indigent or dwdt in a mean habitation ; all lived happily with their families, possessing wealth, grain, cattle and horses. In that city of Ayodhya, none was a miser or a swindler, none was mean-spirited, proud, rash, worthless or an atheist. Men and women were of righteous conduct, fully sdf-controUed, and in their pure and chaste behaviour they equalled the great sages. None 1acked earrings, coroneta and necldaces. They bathed daily and rubbed their bodies with oil, using artar of roses and sandal paste. None ate impure food, none allowed his neighbour to sulfer hunger. An possessed ornaments and gold, and there was none who had not learnt to subdue his mind. No one in the city neglected to olfer butter and fragrant objects in the sacrificial fire. No one was mean, impious or failed to discharge his duties ; there were no thieves and none were bom of mixed castes. The *brahmins* were devoted to their respective duties, firm in sdf-control and authorized to accept gifts. None denied the existence of God, none uttered fillsehood or were enamoured of worldly pleasure and none was guilty of slander. No *brahmin* was unversed in the six systems of philosophy nor did any

neglect to fast at the full moon, or on other appointed days ; there were none who sulfered from mental or physical infirmities and none were unhappy in that city. Among the inhabitants, there were no revolutionaries and none who were not loyal to lWig and state. Those who dwdt 19 there, worshipped the gods and the llllinvited guest ; they were both magnanimm.Jll and cbaritable. All attained a ripe age as vittuous and truth-loving people ; their homes were filled with children, grandchildren and vittuous women. The warriors were subject to the learned brabmins and the mercbants to the warrior caste ; in aceordance with their caste the people served the brabmins, the warriors and the menbants. In the administration of the empire, the Emperor **DASARATHA** followed the example of the tint ruler Manu who was supreme in wisdom and a god among men. Ayodbya abounded in warriors, undefeated in battle, fearless and skilful in the use of arms, resembling lions guarding their mountain caves. There were horses in the city from Kamroja, Vanaya, Nudi and Vahli,andelepbantsfrom the regions of Vindhuand Himavat. The city of Ayodbya was full of courageous and noble men belouging to the races of Bhadra, Mulla and Mriga, inhabitants of the regions of Binchyacbala and the Himalayan ranges. The city possessed mighty depbants like great hills. That capital was auly worthy of the name 'Ayodhya,' which means " The city none can cballenge in warfsre ". Dwdling there, the Emperor **DASARATHA**, ruling the kingdom, resembled the moon in the midst of countless stars. That great king. equal to Indta himself, reigned over the city, guarded by fortifications and ramparts, a city which contained innumerable dwdlings of many kinds and thousands nf prosper ous inhabitants.

CHAPTER 7

The administration of the kingdom

TM adminhtradon of tlulrilw4om EVER devoted to the welfare of King **DASARATHA**, the ministers of the House of Ikshwaku were possessed of all the virtues ; their counsds were based on truth and they underatood the import of the royal commands immediatdy. 20 Eight of the kiug's counsellors were famed ; untiringly employed in the affairs of state, they were honest and devoted to the cultivation of virtue. Their were Dhristi, Jayanta, Vljaja, Siddbartha, Atyartha-Sadaka, Aaboka, *Mantra*-pala and Sumantra. The great and holy sages, **VASISHTHA** and Vamadeva assisted the king in his observance of spiritual duties and also acted as his advisers. All the ministers were virtuous, scorning to do wrong, benevolent, versed in the moral law, of wide eaperience, dis interested, magnanimous, acquainted with the spirit of the scriptures, forbearing, patient, obedient to the king, true to their word. cheerful, free from avarice and well acquainted with the alfairs of their fellow subjects and with those of the subjects of other monarchs. They were efficient, firm in friendship, and even passed judgment on their own sons if they broke the law. These counsellors were eapert in the science of economics and warfare, and never inflicted unmerited punishment on an enemy. They were brave and unambitious. Conversant with every branch of political life, they protected all those who lived in the state. Adding to the royal treasury without burdening the learned and the warriors, they inflicted penalties on wrongdoers with due regard to their capacity for hearing it. These ministers were pure of heart and of chaste conduct. None consorted with his neighbour's wife, none were wicked and all lived together peaceably. Cultivating every good quality and prac

tising the various arts, they were renowned for their courage, their fair name was published abroad and their lives were guided by reason. Skilled in the laws of the country and blessed with wealth, they issued wise edicts and exercised their minds in philosophical debate. Acquainted with the moral code, they conversed affectionately with each other ; such were King **DASARATHA**'s ministers who, informed by their agents of the needs of the people, satisied them and governed with prudence. In the administration of his kingdom, the king never permitted unrighteousness to cause dissension, and became known through out the world as an ocean of truth. That lion among men THE RA.MAYANA OF VAL.MIKI King Dasaratba, reigning over the earth, had none superior or equal to himseJ£ Honoured by his feudal lords, surrounded by friends. King **DASARATHA**, like **INDRA**, reigned in majesty. Benevolent, powerful, accomplished and gracious, King Dasaratba protected Ayodhya and shone in splendour like the sun illumining the wodd.

CHAPTER 8

The king decides to perform a sacrifice for the birth of a Son

KING DASARATBA, that glorious and righteous king, though performing great austerities, was without an heir to the thtone. Then the wise and great-souled monarch said to himself: " I will perform the honc-saaificc (*Aswa-medha*)' in order to have a son." Having thus decided, the supremely sagacious sovereign convened a meeting of his counsellors and addressing his chief minister, Sumantra, commanded him as follows : " Send speedily for the spiritual preceptors and priests."

Quick to act, Sumantra at once summoned those highly learned preceptors and brought thither Suyagna, Vamadeva, Javali, Kasyapa and **VASISHTHA** together with other eminent priests and *brahmins*. Having offered salutations to these holy men, King **DASARATHA**, speaking in gracious accents, uttered words full of truth and purpose : He said, “O Sages, 1 have practised virtue and yet I have not had the good fortune to be blessed with a son ; it is therefore my intention to perform the hone-sacrifice. I The learned bnhmins, led by Shri **VASISHTHA**, praised the king’s intention and said : " Thou hast decided on the ptoper coune, O King.” Highly pleased, they commanded those things requisite for the sacrifice to be assembled and the horse loosed. They said, " O King, let a place of saaifice be chosen on the north bank of the rivet Sarayu. O King, this holy resolve formed by thee, for the sake of an heir, will assuredly bring the fulfilment of thy desire ". Hearing the words of the brabmins, the monarch rejoiced and commanded his ministets to bring the sactificial appointments and release the horse undet the protection of the warriors ; they were also directed to erect a sactificial pavilion on the bank of the river Sarayu. He further decteed the adoption of those measures which would diminish the possibility of hindrance to the sactifice, for even for kings, the horse-sactifice was not easily petformed. The king said : " Let it be remembered that during the observance of the sactifice, no sulfeting must be inllicted on any, lest some pervetae and crafty *brahmin* should cause obstruction in the proceedings. By cartying through the ritual without regard for scriptural injunctions, it comes to nought ; therefore, bring the sactifice to a successftd conclusion. I depend on you, and expect you to carry the sactifice through to a successful issue.” The counsellors replied, saying, " O King, be it so ". Blessing the monarch, the learned *brahmins* retired, and the king addressed his ministets saying : " Prepare the sacrifice as

the officiating priests have instructed you and aecept responsibil ity for its final success.” Then the illustrious sovereign left the court and enteted his ptivate apartments where the queens dwelt, who loved the king from the depths of their hearts. King Dasaratba addressed them, saying : " I intend to obsetve a sactifice for the sake of obraining a son, do you all follow the preacribed discipline.” The queens rejoiced to hear these words from the lips of the king and their lotus-like faces brightened like flowers on the departure of the cold season.

CHAPTER 9

Sumantra relates a tradition that a son will be born through the help of Rishyasringa

Obtained a private audience with his sovereign and said : " I have beard of a tradition, formerly related to me by the august *brahmins*. O KiDg, in ancient days, the blessed Sanatkumara predicted to the holy sages around him that a son would be born to thee. It was prophesied that a son of Kasyapa, named Vibhandaka would have a son called Riahyasringa and that he should dwcll in the forest alone with his saintly father, unknown to any other man or woman. This sage would keep the twofold vow of brahmacharya enjoined by the sages. In this way he would pass a long time worahipping God through the fire-sacrifice and the service of his sire. In the country named Anga, a famous king named Lomapada, would oppress the people by his evil way of life and thus cause a drought. On account of this, the king would sulfcr great allliction and S1IJI1IIl01Iing the *brahmins* would say to tbem : " O Wise Men, acquainted as you are with the customs of the world and also the divine laws, tcll me what ritual of purification and repentance I can adopt to

expiate my evil deeds, which have brougltt about this drought.” Then the *brahmins*, learned in the Veda, would answer the king thus : " O KiDg, exert thyaelf by every means to bring the son of the Sage Vibhandaka hither. Having with due reverence conveyed him hither, do thou confer thy daughter Shanta on him in marriage.” The king having listened to their words and reflected on how he should bring that excllcnt sage to the court, would then request his ministers and priests to approach the sage, but they would declare their unwillingness to undertake the mission, being afraid of the *rishi*’s power. In order to avoid the monarch’s displeasure, however, after 24 delibcratiDg on the method by which the sage could be brought to the court, they would make the following proposal : " By the can the 811” be persuaded to come to the king’s court, the rains will then follow and the drought will be at an end. Then will the king join his daughtet in marriage to the sage. By pouring oblations into the sacrificial fire the illustrious sage, Risbyasringa, will, by his grace, obtain the desired for King **DASARATHA**.” " Thus spoke the illustrious Sanatkumara, in the midst of the sages, and I have now recounted it to thee.” King **DASARATHA** was delighted to hesr these words, and requested the minister to describe further how King Lomapada brought the sage to his court. CHAPTER Hs tksaiba 1wrD Rishyasringa brought to Kitw lAmaptula’s court Tuvs requested, Sumantra began to narrate the story in detail and said : " O Great King, hesr how the ministers brought the Sage Risbyasringa to the court. " The ministers addressed King Lomapada saying : ' We have a plan whereby the young sage may be conveyed hither successfully. He resides in the forest, devoted to holy study, spiritual practice; and asceticism, and is wholly unacquainted with the pursuit of pleasure. " ' By the means of those things gratifying to the senses, we shall most cenainly be able to bring the sage to the court.

CHAPTER 10

He describes how Rishyasringa was brought to King Lomapada's court

delibcratiDg on the method by which the sage could be brought to the court, they would make the following proposal : " By the can the 811" be persuaded to come to the king's court, the rains will then follow and the drought will be at an end. Then will the king join his daughtet in marriage to the sage. By pouring oblations into the sacrificial fire the illustrious sage, Risbyasringa, will, by his grace, obtain the desired for King **DASARATHA**." " Thus spoke the illustrious Sanatkumara, in the midst of the sages, and I have now recounted it to thee." King **DASARATHA** was delighted to hesr these words, and requested the minister to describe further how King Lomapada brought the sage to his court. CHAPTER Hs tksaiba 1wrD Rishyasringa brought to Kitw lAmaptula's court Tuvs requested, Sumantra began to narrate the story in detail and said : " O Great King, hesr how the ministers brought the Sage Risbyasringa to the court. " The ministers addressed King Lomapada saying : ' We have a plan whereby the young sage may be conveyed hither successfully. He resides in the forest, devoted to holy study, spiritual practice; and asceticism, and is wholly unacquainted with the pursuit of pleasure. " ' By the means of those things gratifying to the senses, we shall most cenainly be able to bring the sage to the court. passed the boundaries of the hermitage, nor had he seen any man or woman beyond its precincts. One clay, impcllcd by destiny, the youth went forth from the hermitage and beheld the graceful and beautiful women, attired in many-coloured robea of exquisite design, singing

sweetly. They approscbed the son of *Rishi* Vibhanclaka and addressed him. aaying : " Who art thou ? Whose son art thou ? What is thy name ? Why dost thou dwell in the darll: forest?" Never having beheld women of beauty and charm before, Rishyasringa wss captivated and answered them, saying : " My father is the great Sage Vibhanclaka of the fiunily of Kasyapa and I am his son, my name is Risbyasringa. O Beautiful Beings of charming mien, my hermitage is near at hand, please come thither and allow me to offer you hospitality there." The accepted the invitation and accompanied the sage who received them in the traditional manner, placing before them to wssh their feet and delicious roots and fruits. Fearing the father's return and anxious to depart with all haste, the courtesans plied the young aage with tasty confeetions which they had brought with them, saying : " Be pleased to accept these dainties which we have hrought for thee to enjoy on this occasion." They then caressed the youth, feeding him with sweets and other delicacies. The resplendent sage partook of the offerings, thinking them to be fruits, never having tasted any other food. The courtesans, fearing the father's return, pretended to be fasting and left the hermitage. At their departure, the youth ful aage felt dejected and restless. The following clay, the courtesans, charmingly attired, again went to the hermitage and smiled on perceiving the young sage appear so disconsolate. They then approached him and aaid : " O Handsome Youth, to-day please grace our hermitage with thy presence. O Auspicious One, we can entertain thee better there than here." The young aage agreed to accompany them and went with them to their abode. As the aage entered the city, **INDRA** showered rain on the domain of King Lomapada and the people rejoiced. Wbm the rain began to fall, King Lomapada, realising that the holy sage had entered the city, went out to meet him. Offering him humble and loving salutations, he presented him with the traditional gifts (*arghya*)'

of water and food, and entreated him to grant the boon that his father Vibbandska sbould not visit his displessure on him. The king then took the youth to the inner apartments and united him in marriage to his daughter Sbanta. Deeply revered by the king, Rishyasringa lived happily in the capital with his bride, the Princess Sbanta. CHAPTER II Kitl8 **DASARATHA** goes to Lomapada, by fJJMse permission

CHAPTER 11

King Dasaratha goes to King Lomapada, by whose permission Rishyasringa comes to Ayodhya

Wbm the rain began to fall, King Lomapada, realising that the holy sage had entered the city, went out to meet him. Offering him humble and loving salutations, he presented him with the traditional gifts (*arghya*)' of water and food, and entreated him to grant the boon that his father Vibbandska sbould not visit his displessure on him. The king then took the youth to the inner apartments and united him in marriage to his daughter Sbanta. Deeply revered by the king, Rishyasringa lived happily in the capital with his bride, the Princess Sbanta. CHAPTER II Kitl8 **DASARATHA** goes to Lomapada, by fJJMse permission THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI " This story was urrated by the Sage Sanatkumara in the fint quarter of Satya-*Yuga*.0 Great King I Thou shouldat approach Rishyasringa with a worthy chariot and retinue, and bring him with cetemony to thy capital." Having beard the good counsel of his minister Sumantra, the King commanded him to inform his Guru **VASISHTHA** of this matter, and the holy Vasiahtha acquiesced in the plan. Then the king, with firm resolve, attended by his queens, COUD8ellon and priests, ptepated to set fotth fot the city where

Rishyasringa dwelt. Passing through various forests and traversing many rivers, the king arrived at Lomapada's capital. There he beheld the resplendent sage, in lustre like a glowing fire, seated near King Lomapada. Inspired by friendship, the great monarch Lomapada offered respectful salutations to King Dassratha and informed Rishyas ringa of his alliance with this king, whereupon the sage expressed his approval in Wotds of praise. Having enjoyed the hospitality of King Lomapada for seven days, King **DASARATHA** addressed him thus : " O King, I desire to enter upon an important undertaking, be gracious enough to allow tby daughter Shanta and her lord to rerum to my capital to aasist me." Hearing these Wotds, **KING LOMAPADA** *replied*: " Be it so," and turning to the sage said : " Be pleased to go with thy wife to the capital of King Dassratha." The youth1iJI sage assented to the command of King Loma pada, and he, in company with his spouse, departed with King **DASARATHA**. Having taken leave of his liieod, King **DASARATHA** despatched speedy messengers to go before him to instruct his ministers to prepare for their arrival. The people of Ayodhya carried out all as they had been commanded and overjoyed at the monarch's rerum, fulfilled the instructions of his messengers. The citizens were delighted to behold the young sage entering the city and being honoured by the king, as **INDRA** in heaven pays tribute to Kasyapa. apartments, the king o1fered him the traditional welcome as enjoined in the scriptnres. The royal ladies also welcomed the wide-eyed Shanta with her lord to the private apartmeDIB, and expressed their pleasure and delight. Honoured and worshipped by the queens, no less than by King **DASARATHA** himself, the Princess Shanta and her husband, the sage, dwelt in the palace as Brihaspatiresides in the city of Mahendra. CHAPTER IWhyarrinca t1lf""U to tJSiist in the sacrifice TIME passed and the spring came again while the holy sage was at the court of King **DASARATHA**. On a

propitious day, the king decided to enter upon the sacrifice. He approached Riahyasringa and, bowing low, ofFered saluta tions to him, inviting that god-lilre sage to assist in the sacrifice he was observing, to preserve the dynssty. The sage agreed and requested the king to provide the necessary material for the sacrifice and to let loose the horse. The sovereign COII1IIIBI1ded his minister Sumantra to summon with all speed the priests acquainted with the philosophy of the Veda, and sent invitations to the sages Vamadeva, Javali, Kasyapa, the high priest **VASISHTHA** and other exalted and teamed btahmins. Sumantra, setting out in haste, approached the sages court eously and brought them to the king. The virtuous monarch, after paying respcaful homage to them, addressed them humbly, speaking words full of amdour and integrity. He Slid : " O Sages, despite my ardent desire to have an heir, I am without one. I have, therefore, decided to perform the horse sacrifice to that end. I desire the sacrifice to be observed according to the scriptnrallawa and through the grace of the Sage Rishyasrinp, I hope to attain my purpose."

CHAPTER 12

Rishyasringa agrees to assist in the sacrifice

apartments, the king o1fered him the traditional welcome as enjoined in the scriptnres. The royal ladies also welcomed the wide-eyed Shanta with her lord to the private apartmeDIB, and expressed their pleasure and delight. Honoured and worshipped by the queens, no less than by King **DASARATHA** himself, the Princess Shanta and her husband, the sage, dwelt in the palace as Brihaspatiresides in the city of Mahendra. CHAPTER IWhyarrinca t1lf""U to tJSiist in the sacrifice TIME passed

and the spring came again while the holy sage was at the court of King **DASARATHA**. On a propitious day, the king decided to enter upon the sacrifice. He approached Riahyasringa and, bowing low, ofFered saluta tions to him, inviting that god-lilre sage to assist in the sacrifice he was observing, to preserve the dynssty. The sage agreed and requested the king to provide the necessary material for the sacrifice and to let loose the horse. The sovereign COII1IIIBI1ded his minister Sumantra to summon with all speed the priests acquainted with the philosophy of the Veda, and sent invitations to the sages Vamadeva, Javali, Kasyapa, the high priest **VASISHTHA** and other exalted and teamed btahmins. Sumantra, setting out in haste, approached the sages court eously and brought them to the king. The virtuous monarch, after paying respcaful homage to them, addressed them humbly, speaking words full of amdour and integrity. He Slid : " O Sages, despite my ardent desire to have an heir, I am without one. I have, therefore, decided to perform the horse sacrifice to that end. I desire the sacrifice to be observed according to the scriptnrallawa and through the grace of the Sage Rishyasrinp, I hope to attain my purpose." THE. Tbe sages advised the king to gather together the sacrificial articles and to release the horse. **THEY** *said*: " Righteous is thy desire to be blessed with a son ; O King. thou shalt surely obtsin four illustrious sons of limitless valour." The brahmios' words convinced tbe king that heirs would be granted to him and be communicated bis satisfaction to his ministers. **HE** *said*: " O Counsellors, bring together four high priests and set the horse at liberty under the protection of four bundled wattiors. Let a sacrificial psvilion be set up on the bank of tbe river Sarayu, and let appropriate protective rites be observed lest obstructions arise." The king theo ordained that during tbe period of sacrifice neither priests nor other persons sbould be subject to any suffering whatsoever. **HE** *said*: "In such rites, others have

beeo impeded by sub-human beings, which has resulted in the annulment of tbe sacrifice. You should, therefore, employ every means to bring tbe sacrifice to a successful con clusion.” Hearing tbe words of the king, the ministers-highly gratified -began to act according to his instructions. Tben the *brahmins* assured the king that tbe sacrifice would be accomplisbed without hindrance and offering him obeisance, returned to their homes. Tbe *brahmin* having departed, tbe king bade farewell to bis ministers and enteled his private apartments. CHAPTBR 13

CHAPTER 13

The sacrifice is commenced

THE. Tbe sages advised the king to gather together the sacrificial articles and to release the horse. **THEY** *said*: " Righteous is thy desire to be blessed with a son ; O King. thou shalt surely obtsin four illustrious sons of limitless valour.” The brahmios’ words convinced tbe king that heirs would be granted to him and be communicated bis satisfaction to his ministers. **HE** *said*: " O Counsellors, bring together four high priests and set the horse at liberty under the protection of four bundled wattiors. Let a sacrificial psvilion be set up on the bank of tbe river Sarayu, and let appropriate protective rites be observed lest obstructions arise.” The king theo ordained that during tbe period of sacrifice neither priests nor other persons sbould be subject to any suffering whatsoever. **HE** *said*: “In such rites, others have beeo impeded by sub-human beings, which has resulted in the annulment of tbe sacrifice. You should, therefore, employ every means to bring tbe sacrifice to a successful con clusion.” Hearing tbe words of the king, the ministers-highly gratified -began to act according to his instructions. Tben the *brahmins* assured the king

that tbe sacrifice would be accomplisbed without hindrance and offering him obeisance, returned to their homes. Tbe *brahmin* having departed, tbe king bade farewell to bis ministers and enteled his private apartments. CHAPTBR 13 " O Great Sage, be pleased to complete the holy ceremony according to the sacred tradition. Let it be so undertaken that no interference may take place. Thou art compassionate and thy heart is inclined towards me. Thou art also my Guru, the burden of the sacrifice must be borne by thee." The most excellent sage replied, " Be it so. I will do as thou desirest." Hereafter, Shri **VASISHTHA** summoned those *brahmins*, ,able to perform the holy rituals and also artificers, architects, writers, actors and dancers. Addressing the learned priests, he said : "At tbe king's command, inaugurate the great sacrifice. Cause bricks in thousands to be brought hither with all speed and erect many kinds of dwellings, well arranged, furnished with food and every comfort to accommodate royal and other guests. Prepare hundreds of beautiful houses on suitable sites, together with provisions and all things needed by brabmins ; erect also large buildings for tbe people of other lands, and store food and articles of comfort where it is best to do so. Fine and well equipped houses should be built for villagers. Ensure that hospitality in the form of food and refreshment be given with courtesy and kindness. Those attending the sacrifice should be entertained with respect and consideration, being received in a becoming manner, according to their caste. Let no affront be offered to any through greed, anger or lust. Let craftsmen and servants be suitably regarded, so that their hearts be set on their task and let no one act disruptively. Treat all in a spirit of goodwill and courtesy, ,so that tbe work may be successfully accomplished." The people listened to the holy sage and answered, " We will act according to thy instructions, O Sage, nothing shall be omitted., Shri **VASISHTHA** then summoned tbe chief miuister

Sumantra and said : " Send out invitations to the sacrifice to all the righteous kings of the earth and also the brabmins, *kshatriyas*, vaishyas and shudras of every country, but go first to the great Sovereign of Mitbila, tbe heroic Jauaka, eminent in truth, the greatest of warriors and a koower of the Veda, since he is an ancient ally of King **DASARATHA**. Thereafter, bring the ever 3I trutbful King of Kasbi, of exemplary conduct, equal to a god ; and then the aged and virtuous King of Kaiteya, our sovereign's father-in-law, and invite his son also. Call the fortunate King Lomapada of Anga, the intimate friend of the King, and bring hither, with respect, Kosbala, the King of Magadba. " Thereafter, send messengers to the kings of the eastern countries of Sindbu, Souriva, and Sourashtta, and the monarchs of the south, with other great kings of the eatth ; let them come with their brothers, relations, retainers and servants." Having heard the wotds of Sbri **VASISHTHA**, Sumantta carried out the instructinns given by him, dispatching invitations by special messengers to the monarchs of many lands, himself going forth to escort some of the grest kings. Sumantta having departed, all the workers employed in the sacrifice informed the holy sage of their ptogress, and he advised them further saying : " Let nothing be ptesented to any without due respect, even in jest ; gifts given with contempt lesd to the destruction of the giver." A few days later, the kings from afar arrived at the sacrificial pavilion beating gifts of gems. Then Sbri Vasishtba, being plessed, said : " O King, at thy command, all the kings bave come and been received by me with due hospitality. The preparations for the sacrifice are now completed, be pleased to enter the sacrificial pavilion and inspect the articles needed for the ceremony. See how well thy servants bave furnished everything requisite and bave gratified thy every wish." On the recommendation of the Sage Vasishtba and Rishyas ringa, King Dasaratba went to the sacrificial ground at an

auspicious time, when a propitious star was in the ascendant. Then the learned *brahmin* and Sbri Vasishtba elected Rishyas rings as chief priest. The sacrifice began in accordance with the ancient ordinance and the king, with his queens, engaged in the preliminary illitiations. CBAPTB 14 The C...IIIIIDIIiu an pnfonned fllith tM appropriau rites HAVING I8IJied far and wiclc during a year, the horse returned and on the bank of the river Sarayu the sacrifice of King Duaratha continued. The chief priests, under Rishyasringa. us.isted the king in the observance of the rituals. *Brahmins* learned in the ancient science, also officiated and assisted the king according to the instrnctions laid down in the Kalpa Sutra. The two special portions of the sacrifice PrfJfJar1fYa and Upasada were duly observed ; then the brahmina worshipped the gods with joy. The illustrious sage performed certain rituals and oft'ered **INDRA** the part of the sacrifice due to him. There after aU partook of the *soma*-juice which destroys every sin. The high-souled king duly undertook the third portion of the ceremony with the assistance of the holy *brahmins*. In the sacrifice, no oblation was omitted and none wrongly ofl'ered in the sacred fire. All that was done was correctly carried under the supervision of the sages. During the perind of sacrifice, no *brahmin* experienced hunger or thirst. Countless priests were present and each was attended by hundreds of disciples. Workers, servants and other classes were feasted like the *brahmins*, and monks and ucetics were provided for abundantly. The aged, the children, and the women were served with aU they cared to eat, and those who attended on them were willing and pleasant. By the king's command, appud, money and other gifts were freely distributed with immeasurable generosity. Mountsins of cooked and uncooked foods were to be seen and each could have what he required. to suit his needs. Men and women ftom many lands were daily entertained with food and drink. From every side,

the king heard the ezclamations “How delicious is the food,-are wdl content". Servants and retainers gorgeously clad and wearing golden earrings, attended on the *brahmins*, while others adorned with jewels served other cutes.

CHAPTER 14

The ceremonies are performed with the appropriate rites

CBAPTB 14 The C...IIIIIDIIiu an pnfonned fllith tM appropriau rites HAVING I8IJied far and wiclc during a year, the horse returned and on the bank of the river Sarayu the sacrifice of King Duaratha continued. The chief priests, under Rishyasringa. us.isted the king in the observance of the rituals. *Brahmins* learned in the ancient science, also officiated and assisted the king according to the instrnctions laid down in the Kalpa Sutra. The two special portions of the sacrifice PrfJfJar1fYa and Upasada were duly observed ; then the brahmina worshipped the gods with joy. The illustrious sage performed certain rituals and oft’ered **INDRA** the part of the sacrifice due to him. There after aU partook of the *soma*-juice which destroys every sin. The high-souled king duly undertook the third portion of the ceremony with the assistance of the holy *brahmins*. In the sacrifice, no oblation was omitted and none wrongly ofl’ered in the sacred fire. All that was done was correctly carried under the supervision of the sages. During the perind of sacrifice, no *brahmin* experienced hunger or thirst. Countless priests were present and each was attended by hundreds of disciples. Workers, servants and other classes were feasted like the *brahmins*, and monks and ucetics were provided for abundantly. The aged, the children, and the women

were served with aU they cared to eat, and those who attended on them were willing and pleasant. By the king's command, appud, money and other gifts were freely distributed with immeasurable generosity. Mountsins of cooked and uncooked foods were to be seen and each could have what he required. to suit his needs. Men and women ftom many lands were daily entertained with food and drink. From every side, the king heard the ezclamations "How delicious is the food,-are wdl content". Servants and retainers gorgeously clad and wearing golden earrings, attended on the *brahmins*, while others adorned with jewels served other cutes. 33 In the interval between the two parlll of the sacrifice, eloquent and learned pundits debated metaphysical problems and vied with each other in the display of wisdom and acumen. Day by day, the sacrificial ceremonies were carried out by learned and holy priests. There were none assisting at the holy ritual who were illiterate or unacquainted with the Vedas. Each attendant of the king was inspired by exalted principles and all were highly eloquent and deeply veraed in the scriptures. Eighteen pillars of wood were set up in the place of sacrifice, each made of a dift'erent kind of timber. Priests, skilled in the art of sacrificial rites, overlaid them with gold. Each of the eighteen columns was twenty-one feet in height, polished and of octangular shape and all were firmly fixed in the earth and covered with embroidered cloths. In addition, they were adorned with sandalwood and tlowers and looked as beautiful as the constellation of the seven sages,' in the Skf. Sacrificial pits were constructed by master masons and the fire kindled by *brahmins*. The sacrificial pit prepared for King **DASARATHA** was formed like a great eagle in gold, its wings set with gems. The beasts to be sacrificed to each particulat deity were bound according to scriptural injunction. There were birds, anakes and horses, and according to tradition, the chief priest bound the aquatic animals, snch as turtles, in

the sacrificial pavilion. Three hundred beasts and the horse which had roamed over the earth were assembled. Queen **KAUSHALYA** joyfully paid reverence to the horse before making the sacrifice with three strokes of the sword. Prompted by righteous desire, Queen **KAUSHALYA** passed the night watching over the dead body of the horse, then the priests caused the king's serving women and the courtesans to approach it. The twice-born of subdued senses cooked the fat of the horse on the fire in the manner prescribed by the shastra. King **DASARATHA** inhaling the odour emitted by the fat, acknowledged and eqriated his sins. Sixteen assistant priests made ofFerings of parlll of the horse into the fire, in spoons fashinned of cane, plaksha wood being used in other sacrifices. At the hone sacrifice, three days of special rituals are observed : during the lint day the ApUtona is performed ; during the second day, the Uktha rite, during the third day the Atiratl'a rite. The great sacrificial acts named J:yotishtoma, ApUhtona, Atiratas, Ab!Ufit, Vislrnajit and Aptoryama are also observed. King **DASARATHA**, the promotet of his dynasty, on the conclu sion of the sacrifice, gave away four parts of his kingdom, as dakshinato the four priests. The king distributed alms following the great esample of Swayambhumanu of old. The sacrifice being conclnded, that great monarch gave large portions of the earth in charity, to the officiating priests, and finally that magnanimous sovereign bestowed the whole kingdom on the assisting priests. Then the holy *brahmins* addressed that sinless monarch, saying : " O Lord of Men, we are not able to protect, defend and administer this vast empire, for we have dedicated ourselves to holy study. Therefore, O Great King, we render back these lands to thee, grant us in some lesser gift. be it gems, gold or coins to help us in our hermitsges." Thus addressed by the learned *brahmins*, the king bestowed on them a hundred million pieces of gold, aod four hundred million silver coins.

Then the assisting priests placed all the king's gifts before the holy sages, **VASISHTHA** aod Rishyasringa and begged them to distribute them. Each one received his just share and the priests were highly pleased and well satisfied. The king gave away gold coins to those who had come to witness the sacrifice and ten million gold coins were bestowed on other *brahmins* present at that time. A needy mendicant begged for the diamond studded bracelet worn by the king himself and it was freely bestowed on him. Beholding the *brahmins* fully satisfied, King **DASARATHA** with great gladness msde obeisaoce to them again and again. The twice-born then bestowed their blessings on the king who was exceedingly liberal aod valorous aod who saluted them by prostrating himself on the earth. Thus ended the great sacrifice, the meaos of destroying sin and attaining heaven and scarcely to be accomplished by other monarchs. Then the king addressed Rishyasringa and said : " O Thou of great and virtuons resolve, tell me what further must be done by me to be blessed witb an heir ? " **TBE SAGE RISHYASRINGA** *replied*: " O King, tbou shalt be blessed witb four scms, wbo will perpetuate tbe royal line." CHAPTBR 15 Till! wise Rishyasringa, versed in tbe Scriptures, meditated for a while and tben spoke to King Dasaratba saying : " O King, I will perform the sacrifice Puttatresti,spoken of in tbe Atbarva Veda, wbich will assist tbee in tby endeavour to obtain a aon." Then tbe sage inaugurated the sacrifice and poured oblations into the sacred fire accompanied by the chant of Vedic mantras. The celestial beings, gandharvas, siddhas' and sages assembled to obtain their portion of tbe sacrifice. After the sacrifice, they all approached Shri Brahms, tbe Lord of mankind and witb joined palms addressed bim : **THEY** *said*: " O Blessed Lord, having been favoured by tbee, tbe *Asura* **RAVANA**, perpetUally troubles us who are helpless, since tbou hast granted great booWI to bim and we are forced to bear bis

fearful oppression. " This Lord of *Rakshasas* has persecuted tbe tbree worlds and having overthrown the guardians of tbe earth, he has even humbled **INDRA** himself. Provoking tbe sages, contemplatives, *brahmins* and the gods, he even controls the sun's rays and the wind's power, even the ocean in bis presence is still. At bis approach, O Blessed Lord, we are terrified. O Giver of Boons, be plessed to bring about bis destruction." Hearing tbese words, **BRAHMA** re1lected for a while and : ""tl::' .::Ura: die

CHAPTER 15

To destroy Ravana, Shri Vishnu resolves to incarnate

Then the king addressed Rishyasringa and said : " O Thou of great and virtuons resolve, tell me what further must be done by me to be blessed witb an heir ? " **TBE SAGE RISHYASRINGA** *replied*: " O King, tbou shalt be blessed witb four scms, wbo will perpetuate tbe royal line." CHAPTBR 15 Till! wise Rishyasringa, versed in tbe Scriptures, meditated for a while and tben spoke to King Dasaratba saying : " O King, I will perform the sacrifice Puttatresti,spoken of in tbe Atbarva Veda, wbich will assist tbee in tby endeavour to obtain a aon." Then tbe sage inaugurated the sacrifice and poured oblations into the sacred fire accompanied by the chant of Vedic mantras. The celestial beings, gandharvas, siddhas' and sages assembled to obtain their portion of tbe sacrifice. After the sacrifice, they all approached Shri Brahms, tbe Lord of mankind and witb joined palms addressed bim : **THEY** *said*: " O Blessed Lord, having been favoured by tbee, tbe *Asura* **RAVANA**, perpetUally troubles us who are helpless, since tbou hast granted great

booWI to bim and we are forced to bear bis fearful oppression. " This Lord of *Rakshasas* has persecuted tbe tbree worlds and having overthrown the guardians of tbe earth, he has even humbled **INDRA** himself. Provoking tbe sages, contemplatives, *brahmins* and the gods, he even controls the sun's rays and the wind's power, even the ocean in bis presence is still. At bis approach, O Blessed Lord, we are terrified. O Giver of Boons, be plessed to bring about bis destruction." Hearing tbese words, **BRAHMA** re1lected for a while and : ""tl::' .::Ura: die-answered : " I bave devised a plan for slaying this wicked tyrant. It was granted to Havana tbat no gandbarva, yaksba or *deva* should be able to slay him, bnt thinking man to be of no acaunt, he did not ask to be made invulnerable in regard to him ; therefore, none but man can destroy him." These words, uttered by Shri **BRAHMA** filled the celestial and nther beings with joy. At this time the immortsl **VISHNU**, with conch, disc and mace, the Overlord of the whole world, clad in a yellow robe, appeared at tbat place. Adored by the gods, he drew near and took his seat by Shri **BRAHMA**, then all the gods addressed him saying: " O Madhusudanafor the good of all beings, we entreat Thee, to be born as heir to the supremely righteous, charitable and illustrious Sage Dasaratba. Appear, O Lord, in the form of four sons to the three consorts of tbat great king. Descending into a human body, do thou slay Havana, the scourge of the universe, whom we are unable to desaoy. Tbat ignorant Havana, by his power, aftlicts the *devas*, siddbas and sages. O Lord, tbat wicked *asura*, sporting in the garden of **INDRA**, has slain countless nymphs and gandhsrvas. In company with the sages, we approach Thee so tbat we may be released from this oppression. We take refuge in Thee, Thou art our only asylum I O Lord, we beseech Thee to take birth as man in order to destroy the enemy of men and gods." Thus did the gods appeal to Shri **VISHNU** and He, adored by the world,

answered them who bad taken refuge in Him : " O *Devas,* fear no more, peace be with you. For your sake, I will desaoy Havana, together with his sons, grandsons, counsellors, friends and relatives. Having slain tbat cruel and wicked *asura,* the cause of fear to the divine sages, I will rule in the world of mortals for eleven thousand years." Thus did Shri **VISHNU** grant a boon to the gods, and then reflected as to where on the earth he should take birth as man. Then the lotus-eyed Lord resolved to become incarnate as the four sons of King **DASARATHA**. The celestial sages, the hesvenly musicians and the nymphs praioed the Lord saying : " O Univetsal Sovereign, destroy the wicked 8Sura, who is arrogant, powerful and vain, the enemy of **INDRA** and the SOUge of the 8Scetics and pious men, one wbostrikis terror into every heart, causing universal lamentation. " Destroy, O Lord, this mighty being, together with his army, generals, relatives, friends and followers, remove the cause of the world's woe and then to thy perfect abode."

CHAPTER 16

He decides to incarnate as the four sons of King Dasaratha

THE Omniscient Lord, Shri Narayana,' listened to the praise offered by the gods and honouring them, uttered words of pleasing impon to them. **HE** *said*: " O *Devas,* by what means may the King of the Asuru be slain, that tbom in the side of holy men ? " The gods with one accord answered the imperishable Lord, crying : " Do Thou become incarnate in the form of man and slay him in open fight. O Conqueror of Thy foes, **RAVANA** bas long practised austerities, by means of which he h8S won the favour of the world-revered Brahms. That deity bas granted him a boon, by

which he is rendered invulnerable to all but man. Considering man of no aCCOIIIlt, he does not fear him. The boon bestowed on him by Shri Brabma h8S made him arrogant and he is bringing destruction to the three worlds and canyiDg off women by violence. Therefore, O Lord, man alone can bring about his desth." Hearing the words of the gods, Shri VJS!mu resolved to choose King Duaratha 8S his sire. At that time, the illusaious King Duaratha, the slsyer of his foes, began to observe the sacri1ice in order to obtain an heir. Shri **VISHNU**, having formed his resolution to appear in human form and concluded his deliberations with Shri Brabma, vanished. Forthwith there issued from King Dasaratba's sacrificial fire to the sound resembling the beating of a drum, a great Being of limitless splendour, of glowing counteoance, clad in red and hairy as a lion. Bearing auspicious marks and adorned with beautiful ornaDJents, his height was equal to the peak of a mountain. Striding boldly lite a lion, his form shone as fire. In both hands he carried, as would a beloved spouse, a vessel of gold, with a silver cover, filled with payasa.t This great Being addressed the king saying : " O King, I come from Prajapati.The king bowing down with joined palms, answered : " Thou art welcome, O Lord, what orders hast thou for me ? " Theo the **BEING** *replied*: "Receive the fruit of thy sacrifice ! O Chief of Meo, accept this dish of payasa prepared by the gods, it will bring thee sons and increase thy power. Let it be eateo by thy consorts, they will theo preseot thee with the heirs for whose salrc thou hast performed the sacrifice." The king received the food contained in the goldeo vessel prepared by the gods and revereotly raised it to his forehead. Having received the divine repast, he rejoiced as a peoniless man on obtaining wealth. Forthwith that wonderful and resplendent being vanished, having offered the consecrated food to the king. The tidings of this event caused the consorts of King **DASARATHA** delight and they appeared as

radiant as the beams of the moon irradisting the autumns! sky. Entering the private apartments, the king addressed Queen **KAUSHALYA**, saying : " Receive this food and partake of it that thou maycst have a son." Tbcrcafter, the monarch gave half of the dish to Queen **KAUSHALYA** and onc-thitd to Queen **SUMITRA**. Theo he gave the eighth of the payasa to Queen Kaikcyi and, after rcllcction, the remainder to Queeo **SUMITRA**. In this way, the King divided THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI the queens soon became prepant. their wombs glowing like the fire in the sun.

CHAPTER 17

To assist Shri Vishnu, celestial beings incarnate as warriors of the monkey tribe

THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI the queens soon became prepant. their wombs glowing like the fire in the sun. The Aswini-Kumaraaproduced Minda and Dvivida ; **VARUNA**' begat Suchella ; Megba, was the father of Sharabha, the mighty ; Pavana' begat the warrior called **HANUMAN**, whose body was as hatd as a diamond and whose speed equalled an eagle's ; he excelled all the other warrion in wisdom and power. There were thousands of warriors bom in the monkey tribe ready to destroy Ravaoa. All the beats, monkeys and chimpan zees resembled the god that had produced them in characteristics, habits and prowess, and many were of outstanding valout. The female chimpanzees and beats gave birth to grest beioga of divine nature. They produced hundreds and thousands of heslthy progeny. These dwcllets of the forest were imposing in form and in strength and fearlessness resembled lions and tigers. .All were able to

clesve rocks and mouotsios and fight with their nails and teeth. Skilled in evety kind of weapon, they could shake grest peaks, uproot the stoutest and by their velocity even put the sea god to shame. Able to tear up the earth with their feet and cause the ocean to overftow, they could dy in the air and even seize the clouds. These beioga of the monkey tribe wandered in the woods, making captive the elephants, and by their shouts causing the birds in llight to fall to the ground. Thus were bom millions of moakeys, able to assume any form, together with hundreds and thousands of monkey chiefs. These chiefs begot other brave and powerful beioga, some of whom dwelt on the mouotsios while othets inhabited the valleys and forests. The two btothets, **SUGRIVA**, the olfspriog of **SURYA**,' and Bali, poisonous snakes. The powerful loog-armed Bali protected the DI.Oilkeys, bears and chimpanzees by his prowess. Tbese heroes, invincible as mountains and of immense size, born to assist Shri Rams, filled the earth. CHAPTBR IS IWtg Dtuaratha's are born and grorJJ to mtllluJod WHBN the sacrifice of King Dasaraths bad been brought to a successful conclusion, the gods, receiving their due portions, returned to their abode. The king also, having fu1611ed the obligations incurred by his initiation, returned the capital with his queens, servants, army and vehicles. The royal guests to whom due hospitality bad been shown, made obeisance to the Sase Vasishths and returned to their homes. When they departed, ornaments, appard and gifts were distributed to their armies who set out for their own cities with joy. King Dasaraths attended the departure of his guests and then re-entered the capital in a procession preceded by the holy *brahmins*. Rishyasrinsa with his wife Shanta then took leave of the monarch and departed to his own city, King Dasaraths accom panying him for aome distance. Then the king, expectins to be blessed with an heir, dwdt happily in Ayodhya. Six seasons after the completion of the

sacrifice, in the twelfth

CHAPTER 18

King Dasaratha's sons are born and grow to manhood

poisonous snakes. The powerful loog-armed Bali protected the DI.Oilkeys, bears and chimpanzees by his prowess. Tbese heroes, invincible as mountains and of immense size, born to assist Shri Rams, filled the earth. CHAPTBR IS IWtg Dtuaratha’s are born and grorJJ to mtllllluJod WHBN the sacrifice of King Dasaraths bad been brought to a successful conclusion, the gods, receiving their due portions, returned to their abode. The king also, having fu1611ed the obligations incurred by his initiation, returned the capital with his queens, servants, army and vehicles. The royal guests to whom due hospitality bad been shown, made obeisance to the Sase Vasishths and returned to their homes. When they departed, ornaments, appard and gifts were distributed to their armies who set out for their own cities with joy. King Dasaraths attended the departure of his guests and then re-entered the capital in a procession preceded by the holy *brahmins*. Rishyasrinsa with his wife Shanta then took leave of the monarch and departed to his own city, King Dasaraths accom panying him for aome distance. Then the king, expectins to be blessed with an heir, dwdt happily in Ayodhya. Six seasons after the completion of the sacrifice, in the twelfth The Promoter of the glory of the House of Ikshwaku, the blessed Lozd **VISHNU** was born as a son of Queen Kausbalya. When this cbi1d of limitless splendour was born, the queen looked most beautiful, like Aditi of old, favoured by **INDRA**. The hero of the realm of truth, **BHARATA**, was born

of Queen **KAIKEYI**. Possessed of every grace, he was endowed with a quarter of the glory of Shri **VISHNU**. **SUMITRA** gave birth to **LAKSHMANA** and **SHATRUGHNA**, heroes skilful in the wielding of weapons and also partaking of Shri **VISHNU**'s glory. **BHARATA** was born when the stat Pushya was in the ascendant in the Lagna Meena. During the ascendance of the stat Shlasa in the Lagna Karka, at the time of sunrise **SHATRUGHNA** was born. Each of the sous of the king had specisl attributes and were endowed with great qualities, they were as resplendent as the Purva, Uttata' and Bhadripata' stats. At that time gandhatvas played divine melodies, nymphs danced, celestial drums were heard and the gods showered Bowers from the sky. Everywhere in the capital, signs of rejoicing were apparent ; the streets were filled with acton and dancers and those who sang or played on various instruments. The king gave gifts to the batds and hallad singers and confetred wealth and cows on the *brahmins*. The four children were named on the twelfth day ; the eldest son received the name Ramachaudra, and the name given to the son of Queen **KAIKEYI** was **BHARATA**. The sons of Queen **SUMITRA** were called **LAKSHMANA** and **SHATRUGHNA**. The ceremony was performed by the holy Sage **VASISHTHA** with great joy. After this, the *brahmins* of the capital and the country were feasted and presented with gifts and precious gems. Resembling the deity Shri **BRAHMA**, the king showed universal "-" ___ _ THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI benevolence. The princes grew in the knowledge of the Veda, in courage and active goodwill to all. Though each was wise, learned and possessed of every virtue, yet Shri **RAMACHANDRA** exce1led them in truthfulness and energy, and was beloved of an. like the flawless orb of the moon. Expert in mounting the elephant, the horse and the chariot, be was skilful in archery and devoted to the service of his parents. Shri Laksbmana cherished an ezceeding love for his elder btother Shri

RAMACHANDRA, the delight of the world, and **SHRI RAMA** loved him also as his very self. Shri **RAMACHANDRA** loved Laksbmana who was endowed with every ecellent quality, as his own life, and neither slept nor partook of any nourishment without the other. When Rsghava mounted on borsebsck, engaged in the cbsse, Shri Laksbmana followed with bow and arrows to protect him. Emulating the c:J:ample of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, Bbsrata loved Sbstrughna and was loved by him with equal affection. Tbe monarch was as pleased and satisfied with his four sons as is Shri Brahms with the four Vedas. Observing the wisdom, prudence and modesty of his children, who were endowed with every great attribute, King **DASARATHA**.:lerived as great a delight from them as Brahms from the four guardians of the earth. The princes studied the Veda with perseverance, affectionately attended on the king and acquired proficiency in the use of arms. One day when the illustrious sovereign was in council with his relatives, ministers, and learned preceptors, delibetating on the marriage of his four sons, the great Sage **VISHWAMITRA** appeared in the capital. Seeking an audience with the king, he addnssed the doorkeeper, saying : " Inform the king speedily that the son of Gadhi of the mce of Kaushib is at the gate." The awe-stricken guard hastened to the royal apartment and conveyed the tidings with due respect to his majesty, wbo with his Guru **VASISHTHA** went forth to welcome the sage at the gate and bring him into the royal paisce. As Brahms welcomes **INDRA**, so did they greet the *muni*, and beholding that resplendent and mighty ascetic, the observer of great vows, of cheerful countenance, the king offered him arghya according to the prescribed tradition. 44 The virtuous **VISHWAMITRA** then enquired of the king concern ing the welfare of the empire, the prosperity of his people, relatives and friends and also as to the state of the royal treasury. Thereafter, the sage questioned the monarch further, saying: "Are thy

vassals obedient to thee ? Are thine enemies subdued ? Are the Vedic sacrifices duly observed in thy dominion? Are strangers entertained with fitting hospitslity ? " Then after enquiring as to the well-being of Shri **VASISHTHA** and other sages, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** entered the palace. Here the king once more paid him reverence and with delight addressed him saying : " O August Sage, thy coming hss caused me as great a joy as the acquisition of ambrosia or the advent of rain falling on the parched earth. O Sage, thy approach is as grateful to me as the birth of a son to one without an heir or the recovery of his wealth to one who imagined it to be irretrievably lost. O Mighty Sage, I welcome thee with my whole heart, say what commands thou hsst for me ? When thy glance doth fall upon me, O Sage, I become righteous and acquire merit ; to-day my life is rendered fruitful and the purpose of my birth is accomplished since thou hsst visited me. O Auspicious One, formerly thou a warrior sage, illustrious by virtue of thy sacred practices, but now thou art become a *brahmin*' and art worthy of supreme worship by me. Thine advent hss conferred purity and blessing on me, and by thy sacred presence both the kingdom and I have been putged of every oft'ence. Be pleased to tell us of the purpose of thy coming, I desire to manifest my gratitude to thee by rendering thee service. O Kaushib, do not hesitate to speak thy will, I am ready to do anything for thee ; thou art to me as a god. O *Brahman* Seer, by beholding thee, I have acquired the great merits of a pilgrimage." Hearing the words of King **DASARATHA**, sweet sounding and in accordance with the scriptural injunctions, the great sage, the repository of all excellent qualities, was highly gratified. CBAPTBR 19 Yishr.tlamitra's request HI!ARING the laudatory and admirable words of that Lion kings, **DASARATHA**, the great **SAGE VISHWAMITRA** *answered*: " O Great Ki.Dg, who in the world save one of the Houae of Ikshwaku, instructed by Shri **VASISHTHA**, could give

tongue to such utterances ? O Dlustrinus Monarch, I will now unfold my purpose, do thou fulfil it and prove the truth of thy words. " O Chief of Men. when I undertake the observance of sacred sacrifices to enhance my perfection, two *rakshasas*, adepts in magic, cnate great impediments. When, after long effort, the sacrifice approaches consummation, then these two *rakshasas*, Maricha and Suvahu destroy the rite and defile the altar with blood and flesh. My holy endeavours being thus frustrated, I become despondent and leave the place of sacrifice. O King, it is not permitted to me to show wrath when engaged in sacrifice, and I therefore refrain from cursing them. Do thou lend me the services of thy son, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, the truthful, the brave, that hero, whose locks fall on his cheeks. " Under my protection, he will destroy those mischievous *rakshasas* and I will confer great blessings on him. I will instruct him for his good in many sciences and he will become famous in the three worlds. The *rakshasas* will not be able to stand against **RAMA** and no one else can destroy them. They are proud and powerful, but now, owing to their sins, their destructinn is imminent, they will not be able to withstand Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, “Do not allow a father’s affection to overcome thee ; I assure thee that in the presence of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, the *rakshasas* are as good as slain. **RAMA**’s virtues are known to Shri **VASISHTHA** and other ascetics. O Ki.Dg, if thou seekest everlasting renown and merit in this world, then let **SHRI RAMA** go with me. Seek the advice of Shri **VASISHTHA** and thy counsellors and if they approve the project, give me **RAMACHANDRA**. Be pleased, O King, to give up thy beloved son for the space of ten days, so that I may complete the sacrifice. O King, help me in

CHAPTER 19

Vishwamitra's request

CBAPTBR 19 Yishr.tlamitra’s request HI!ARING the laudatory and admirable words of that Lion kings, **DASARATHA**, the great **SAGE VISHWAMITRA** *answered*: " O Great Ki.Dg, who in the world save one of the Houae of Ikshwaku, instructed by Shri **VASISHTHA**, could give tongue to such utterances ? O Dlustrinus Monarch, I will now unfold my purpose, do thou fulfil it and prove the truth of thy words. " O Chief of Men. when I undertake the observance of sacred sacrifices to enhance my perfection, two *rakshasas*, adepts in magic, cnate great impediments. When, after long effort, the sacrifice approaches consummation, then these two *rakshasas*, Maricha and Suvahu destroy the rite and defile the altar with blood and flesh. My holy endeavours being thus frustrated, I become despondent and leave the place of sacrifice. O King, it is not permitted to me to show wrath when engaged in sacrifice, and I therefore refrain from cursing them. Do thou lend me the services of thy son, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, the truthful, the brave, that hero, whose locks fall on his cheeks. " Under my protection, he will destroy those mischievous *rakshasas* and I will confer great blessings on him. I will instruct him for his good in many sciences and he will become famous in the three worlds. The *rakshasas* will not be able to stand against **RAMA** and no one else can destroy them. They are proud and powerful, but now, owing to their sins, their destructinn is imminent, they will not be able to withstand Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, “Do not allow a father’s affection to overcome thee ; I assure thee that in the presence of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, the *rakshasas* are as good as slain. **RAMA**’s virtues are known to Shri **VASISHTHA** and other ascetics. O Ki.Dg, if thou

seekest everlasting renown and merit in this world, then let **SHRI RAMA** go with me. Seek the advice of Shri **VASISHTHA** and thy counsellors and if they approve the project, give me **RAMACHANDRA**. Be pleased, O King, to give up thy beloved son for the space of ten days, so that I may complete the sacrifice. O King, help me in 46 furthering my sacrifice, and do not let the allotted time pass in vain. Do what is auspicious, do not grieve." The upright and resplendent Sage **VISHWAMITRA** having uttered these righteous words, became silent. The words of Shri **VISHWAMITRA** filled the king with anxiety and he became distraught. Because of these inezorable words, the DlOD8fCb trembled and fell unconscious from his overcome with grief.

CHAPTER 20

The king's reluctance to allow Shri Rama to contend with Maricha and Suvahu

he is my eldest son, thetcfote, do not take him from me. O Great Sage, how powerful arc these *rakshasas* ? Who arc their supporterS and how dost thou imsgine **SHRI RAMA** can destroy them ? O Blessed Lord, say if thou deemest that I and my army may successfully oppose those *rakshasas* who arc skilled in magic?" Shri Vishwamitta answeted : " O King, **RAVANA**, born of the great filmily of Poulastya, having heen favoured by **BRAHMA** with a boon, is oppresaing the three worlds. He is exceedingly powerful and supported hy many asuric followers. It is said that this great warrior **RAVANA** is the King of *Asuras*. He is the brother of Kuvcra and the son of the Sage Visbravas. He does not obstruct the lesser sacrifices in person, but two mighty *rakshasas* named Maricha and Suvahu, prompted by him, dis rupt the sacrificial rites." The king

listened to the *muni*’s words and then spoke : " I am not able to oppose that evil-souled *asura*. O Knower of the Law of Righteousness, I am but a wretched man and thou art worthy of my wonhip ; thou art verily a god and also my spiritual preceptor. Since the gods, the danavas, gand· harvas, yakshas, birds and snakes cannot destroy **RAVANA**, how can man do so ? In battle, **RAVANA** is able to defeat the mightiest warriors, it is certain thetcfore, that neither I nor my army can-">ntend with him. How can I then send my son, beautiful as a god, but inexperienced in war, to oppose **RAVANA** ? O Sage, I will not let my young child go. Lavana, the son of Madhu is among those who destroy the sacrifice. I will not give up my son. The sons of Sunda and Upasunda, Maricha and Suvahu, who resemble desth itself in battle, arc among those who impede the sacrifice. They are skilful and seasoned warriors, I dare not send my young son against them. Whoever thou chooseth, friends, relatives or even I myself will accompany thee to engage in the fight.” On hearing the Icing’s injudicinus words, the holy sage was enraged. As an oblation poured into the fire adds to the fiercenesa of the ftame, so did the words of King **DASARATHA** add to the fire. of anger kindled in the sage’s heart.

CHAPTER 21

On Vasishtha's advice the king acquiesces

" **O** King. recolleet that thou art hom in the house of Raghu, how can’st thou presume to break thy promise ? This action is unworthy of thy royal line and is also improper. If this be thy determined desire, I will take my lesve, do thou live at ease amidst thy relatives and friends, O Violater of thy Word I " At the wrath of the august sage, the whole esrth shook and

the gods began to tremble. Seeing the whole world shaken with terror, the wise and patient *muni* Shri **VASISHTHA** intervened, and thus addressed the king : " O King. thou art hom in the tlunily of Ikshwaku and art righteousness personified ! messed by fortune, filled with patience and endurance, thou hast cherished great vows and should'sr not, therefore, abandon dhartns.The three worlds know thee as virtuous, it is thy duty to maintain integrity and not to act in contradiction to it. O Chief of Men, if one making a promise does not honour it, he loses the merit of his good deeds. It is, therefore, for thee to be faithfiJI to thy word and let **RAMA** accompany this sage. Though Shri **RAMACHANDRA** is inexperienced in warfare, yet the *asuras* will not be able to overcome bim. Furthermore, he is under the protection of Shri **VISHWAMITRA** and no harm can come to him. How can one steal the nectar that is surrounded by fire ? The holy Vish wamitra is virtoe itself, his powers are unsurpsssed, and there is none living equal to him in wisdom and asceticism. In the whole world of men and other beings, none excels him in the use of weapons and none has fathomed the depth of his nature. Neither the celestials, nor the sages, nor the *asuras*, nor any other beings know the full glory of this sage. The god Krishasawa and his highly virtoous sons gave every variety of weapon to **VISHWAMITRA** when he was king. The two daughters ofDaksha, Jaya and Suprabha invented thousands of resplendent weapons. Shri **VISHWAMITRA** is not one, but many in one form ; he is illustrious, mighty and able to defeat any in battle. Jaya produced five hundred weapons supremely potent and capable of destroying a host of *asuras*. Suprabha also created five hundred weapons of war which no foe in the world could withstand. Shri **VISHWAMITRA** is an adept in the use of all these arms, O King, he is also able to create many new weapons and there is nothing in the three divisions of time which is not known to him.

Do not hesitate to send thy **RAMA** with this mighty and courageous sage, Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, and do not entertain any fears for his safety. The Sage **VISHWAMITRA** is well able to destroy the demons, but asks for the services of thy for his own good." The Guru **VASISHTHA** having thus exhorted the monarch, the king cheerfully acquiesced to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** accompanying the sage.

CHAPTER 22

Ramachandra and Lakshmana set forth with Vishwamitra

At the time of their departure, the Peace Chant was recited by the king, whilst the Guru **VASISHTHA** pronounced the benedic tion. The illustrious sovereign then smelt the heads' of his sons with joy and delivered them into the care of the sage. Shri **VISHWAMITRA** led the way followed by the most illustrious Ramacbandra, then came Shri **LAKSHMANA** of flowing locks, bearing a bow in his hand. The two handsome and powerful princes with quiven on their backs and bows in their hands, adding lustre to the ten cardinai points, followed the *muni* as if two three-beaded snakes' wete following Shri **VISHWAMITRA** or as the Aswinilrumaras and Kinneras follow **BRAHMA**. Shri Ramaehandta and **LAKSHMANA**, armed with their bows, adorned with precious jewels and wearing gloves made of deetskin, resplendent and beautiful, girt with swords, following the holy sage, looked like the two sons of **SHIVA**. Coming to the rivet Sarayu, nine miles to the south of the capital, the Sage VIShwamitra addressed **SHRI RAMA** in gentle accents, saying: " O Child, purify thy body with water. When thou hast done so, I will teach thee the use of Baia and Atibala. The application of these two

herbs will prevent thee from being fatigued or suffering from disease, nor will age affect thee. Even should'st thou retire to rest without performing the purification ceremony no demon will be able to alllict thee ; none in the world will equal thee in prowess. O **RAMA**, no one in the three worlds will rival thee in good fortune, skill, knowledge and practical wisdom. O Prince, when thou hast learnt these sciences, thou wilt be able to answer any question and thou wilt be unique in scholarship. These two sciences, O Rams, are the parents of all other sciences. Thou wilt be able to control hunger and thirst by their application. O Prince of the House of Raghu, by the mastery of this lore, Bala and Atibala, thou wilt attain renown throughout the whole world. These brilliant sciences are the dsughten of **BRAHMA**, I shall impart them to thee, O Prince, because thou art qualified to receive them. O Rams, all the fruits of this knowledge are already thy attributes, yet when thou hast mastered it, thou wilt be able to teach it to othetS." Shri **RAMACHANDRA** then poured the water over his body and with a cheerful countenance said to the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** : " O Great *Rishi*, I am thy servant, teach me these sciences." .. :e Possessed of the knowledge of these two sciences, the mighty **RAMA** resembled the sun in autumiJ. emitting a thousand rays. Then the two brothers massaged the feet of the boly Guru and passed the night pleasantly on the banks of the river Sarayu. **SHRI RAMA** being nnaccustomed to sleeping on the ground, the two sons of King **DASARATHA** made a bed of grass, then having listened to the gentle words of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, they passed the night in sleep. CHAPTBR 23 Tluy reach the hermitage uf Kama A before dawn, the great Mum **VISHWAMITRA**, reclining on his grassy couch, addressed the princes, saying : " O Son of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, O **RAMA**, the dawn is about to break, arise and perform thy morning devotions." The two princes, hesring the words of the most generous

sage, rose, performed their ablutions, offered ceremonial water to the rising sun, worshipped their ancestors and began to repeat the holy Gayatri. Their devotions completed, they offered salutations with great reverence to the distinguished ascetic and stood ready to proceed further. In their company, the holy sage reached the confluence of the rivers where the Ganges unites herself with the Sarayu. There they beheld the holy ascetics in their sacred hermitage, where for a long time they had pracrised *Yoga* assiduously. Seeing the peaceful hermitage, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and **LAKSHMANA** were filled with delight and said to the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** : " O Blessed Lord, whose boly hermitage is this ? Wbo dwells here? We are both eager to hear of this." The great sage smiled and answered **RAMA**, saying : " Hear,

CHAPTER 23

They reach the hermitage of Kama

Possessed of the knowledge of these two sciences, the mighty **RAMA** resembled the sun in autumiJ. emitting a thousand rays. Then the two brothers massaged the feet of the boly Guru and passed the night pleasantly on the banks of the river Sarayu. **SHRI RAMA** being nnaccustomed to sleeping on the ground, the two sons of King **DASARATHA** made a bed of grass, then having listened to the gentle words of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, they passed the night in sleep. CHAPTBR 23 Tluy reach the hermitage uf Kama A before dawn, the great Mum **VISHWAMITRA**, reclining on his grassy couch, addressed the princes, saying : " O Son of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, O **RAMA**, the dawn is about to break, arise and perform thy morning devotions." The two princes, hesring the words of the most generous sage, rose,

performed their ablutions, offered ceremonial water to the rising sun, worshipped their ancestors and began to repeat the holy Gayatri. Their devotions completed, they offered salutations with great reverence to the distinguished ascetic and stood ready to proceed further. In their company, the holy sage reached the confluence of the rivers where the Ganges unites herself with the Sarayu. There they beheld the holy ascetics in their sacred hermitage, where for a long time they had pracrised *Yoga* assiduously. Seeing the peaceful hermitage, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and **LAKSHMANA** were filled with delight and said to the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** : " O Blessed Lord, whose boly hermitage is this ? Wbo dwells here? We are both eager to hear of this." The great sage smiled and answered **RAMA**, saying : " Hear, whom the pundits called Kama once took human form and fixed in meditation, worshipped the Lord **SHIVA** here. When Shri **SHIVA** was passing with his newly-wedded bride, accom panied by celestial beings, Kama tried to agitate the mind of the Lord **SHIVA** and reaped the due punishment of his insolence. O Son of the House of Raghu, **SHIVA** in wrath opened his third eye and the members of Kama's hody were consumed. Since Kama was reduced to ashes by the God, he has been a dis embodied being. O **RAMA**, since that time, he has been known as Ansnga (*bodiless*) and the country where his limbs were strewn as he sought to ftee, is known as Anga. This hermit age belongs to the Lord **SHIVA** and the holy men who dwell here are his traditional devotees : they are both righteous and sinless. O **RAMA**, Thou of pleasing looks, this night I shall break my journey at this hermitage and to-morrow we shall cross the sacred river and proceed further. O **RAMA**, let us first purify ourselves by bathing and then recite the holy Gayatri silendy, offering oblations into the sacred fire, we will thereafter pass the night in the hermitage." While **SHRI RAMA** and the sage were conversing, the holy ascetics dwelling in

the hermitage, knew by the power of their *Yoga*, that these great beings were approaching and were highly gratified. Having presented arghya to Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, they then offered hospitality to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and **LAKSHMANA**. Entertained by those dwelling in the hermitage who regsled them with the holy traditions and philosophical discourses, they remsined there for their evening devotion and with great delight abode in the hermitage of Kama, the devout sages gathering round Shri **VISHWAMITRA** who engaged them in pleasing converse. S3 CHAPTBII 24 The pritret fllith Vislmlamitra behold t/u dark furett 11/Taraka WRBN the day dawned, the two princes performed their daily devotions and followed Shri **VISHWAMITRA** to the river. The keepers of sacred vows, the dwellers in the holy hermitage accompanied them to the river bank and arranged for an ezcellent boat to take them across ; they said to Shri **VISHWAMITRA** : " O Great *Rishi*, do not delay, please board the vessel with the royal princes, now, and thus avoid the heat of the day." Shri VIShwamitra paid reverence to the devout ssges and proceeded to cross the sacred river. When the craft was in mid-stream. the roar of the waters was heard by **SHRI RAMA** chandra and his younger brother. They questioned the holy sage, saying : " O Venerable Lord, what is the cause of this tumult?" In answer to Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** described the cause of the sound in the following manner : " O Prince, on Mount Kailasha, Shri **BRAHMA** created a lake by the power of his thought, on account of which it is called the Lake of the Mind (*Manasarovara*). The holy river Sarayu rises in the Manasa Lake and flows through the capital Ayodhya, here it joins the sacred stream Gunga, and this sound is pro duced when the two rivers unite. With concentrated mind, offer salutations to them." The two royal princes made obeisance to the rivers, and having reached the southern bank, left the boat and proceeded onward. Walking further,

the two princes beheld a dart and terrible forest and Shri **RAMACHANDRA** again addressed the Sage as follows : “O Great Sage, this forest looks dart and sinister ; above the ceaseless clamour of crickets and other insects, feartUI beasts can be heard roaring. The forest resounds with their dread cries while the harsh and discordant notes of birds echo

CHAPTER 24

The two princes with Vishwamitra behold the dark forest of Taraka

CHAPTBII 24 The pritret fllith Vislmlamitra behold t/u dark furett 11/Taraka WRBN the day dawned, the two princes performed their daily devotions and followed Shri **VISHWAMITRA** to the river. The keepers of sacred vows, the dwellers in the holy hermitage accompanied them to the river bank and arranged for an ezcellent boat to take them across ; they said to Shri **VISHWAMITRA** : " O Great *Rishi*, do not delay, please board the vessel with the royal princes, now, and thus avoid the heat of the day.” Shri VIShwamitra paid reverence to the devout ssges and proceeded to cross the sacred river. When the craft was in mid-stream. the roar of the waters was heard by **SHRI RAMA** chandra and his younger brother. They questioned the holy sage, saying : " O Venerable Lord, what is the cause of this tumult?” In answer to Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** described the cause of the sound in the following manner : " O Prince, on Mount Kailasha, Shri **BRAHMA** created a lake by the power of his thought, on account of which it is called the Lake of the Mind (*Manasarovara*). The holy river Sarayu rises in the Manasa Lake and flows through the capital Ayodhya,

here it joins the sacred stream Gunga, and this sound is pro duced when the two rivers unite. With concentrated mind, offer salutations to them." The two royal princes made obeisance to the rivers, and having reached the southern bank, left the boat and proceeded onward. Walking further, the two princes beheld a dart and terrible forest and Shri **RAMACHANDRA** again addressed the Sage as follows : "O Great Sage, this forest looks dart and sinister ; above the ceaseless clamour of crickets and other insects, feartUI beasts can be heard roaring. The forest resounds with their dread cries while the harsh and discordant notes of birds echo through it. See, O Sage ! Boars, lions, tigers and elephants abouud there, it is overgrown with dhara, asbwakarna, kujaja, patala, sillea and tioduka trees,' it is iudeed terrifying." The highly resplendent Sage Visbwsmitra beatiog these words, said : " My son, I will tell thee something of this dark forest. Formerly there were two cities named Malava and Karusba, they were both prosperous and resembled the cities built by the gods. O **RAMA**, iu ancieut times, lndra slew the wicked Vritrasura theu, beiug hungry and thirsty, he weut to an inauspicious and isolated place where he became distressed on account of the siu of having slaiu a *brahmin*. The gods and holy sages bathed lndra iu the sacred waters of the Ganges, and pwged away his siu by pouring jars of water chatged with mantrams over him. In this way, the remorse of lndra was appeased, the pollution caused by slayiug a *brahmin* was washed away and he was highly gratified. Purified and siuless, **INDRA** gladly conferred a boon on this land saying : ' These two cities will be knowu as Malava and Katusha and they will acquire great renowu, their prosperity will be famed throughout the earth.' " When lndra thus favoured these two cities, the celestial beiugs praised him and cried : Be it so.' These two places soon eujoyed great prosperity and fame. In the course of time, a perverse yaksbini was born here, poasessiug the

strength of a thousand elephants. Her name was Tarska, the wife of Sunda, and her son was the *rakshasa*, Maricha, who was equal iu strength to lndra himself. He poaaessed long arms, an enormous mouth, and a gigiantic body. This terrible *rakshasa* contioually destroys the people of these two lands. " O **RAMA**, the wicked Taraka constandy plunders and devastates these two countries. Obstructiog the road, she lives at two miles distance from here ; let us euter the forest of Taraka. By my command, O **RAMA**, do thou slay the wicked yakshini and set the country free. O **RAMA**, none dares to come hither for fear of Taraka ; save this land from the dangcrons demoness. This is why this forest is uninhabited, but thou can’st restore it. This wicked ysksbini is unceasingly bent on her evil designs.” : CHAPTBR 25 Villmlamilrtl ueks to convine auna that it is his duty to rlay Taraka HBAluNG the words of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, **SHRI RAMA** of limitless power and inlluence uttered the following auspicious words : " O Great Sage, it is said that the yakshinis have little power, then how is it that Taraka has come to possess the strength of a thousand elephants ? " The mahatma listened to **RAMA**’s words and said : " O Prince, I will relate the story to thee. This female demon has acquired her great strength by virtue of a boon which she received. In the past, a powerful yaksha by the name of Suketu, who was virtuous but childless, performed many yogic practices which pleased Shri **BRAHMA**, who promised him a daughter by name Taraka, and amferred on her the strength of a thousand elephants. But the most illustrious **BRAHMA** did not grant a son to that yaksha. When the daughter grew up and possessed both the charm of youth and great beauty, her father gave her in marriage to Sunda, the son of Jambha. After some time, the yakshini gave hirth to a son. His name was Maricha and he was very powerful ; though born ofyaksha parentage he became a *rakshasa* through a curse. O **RAMA**, when the Sage Agastya condemned

Sunda to death by cursing him, then Taraka and her son wished to devour the sage. Seeing her running towards him, the blessed Sage Agastya cursed Maricha and said ' Become a demon '. He also cursed that wicked woman so that she became a cannibal with a hideous countenance. **SHRI AGASTYA** *said*: ' May thy beauty vanish and mayest thou become a terrible *rakshasi*.' Then Taraka, transported with anger under this curse, began to destroy this sacred land because it was here that the Sage Agastya performed his yogic practices. " O **RAMA**, thou must slay this wicked and impious demon Taraka. who ravages the land. For the good of the *brahmins* and the king, O Raghava, accomplish this ; do not heaitate to destroy this vile yakshini. It is the duty of a warrior to protect those of the four castes. A prince must not eschew

CHAPTER 25

Vishwamitra seeks to convince Rama that it is his duty to slay Taraka

CHAPTBR 25 Villmlamilrtl ueks to convine auna that it is his duty to rlay Taraka HBAluNG the words of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, **SHRI RAMA** of limitless power and inlluence uttered the following auspicious words : " O Great Sage, it is said that the yakshinis have little power, then how is it that Taraka has come to possess the strength of a thousand elephants ? " The mahatma listened to **RAMA**'s words and said : " O Prince, I will relate the story to thee. This female demon has acquired her great strength by virtue of a boon which she received. In the past, a powerful yaksha by the name of Suketu, who was virtuous but childless, performed many yogic practices which pleased Shri **BRAHMA**, who promised him a daughter by name Taraka, and amferred on her the

strength of a thousand elephants. But the most illustrious **BRAHMA** did not grant a son to that yaksha. When the daughter grew up and possessed both the charm of youth and great beauty, her father gave her in marriage to Sunda, the son of Jambha. After some time, the yakshini gave hirth to a son. His name was Maricha and he was very powerful ; though born ofyaksha parentage he became a *rakshasa* through a curse. O **RAMA**, when the Sage Agastya condemned Sunda to death by cursing him, then Taraka and her son wished to devour the sage. Seeing her running towards him, the blessed Sage Agastya cursed Maricha and said ' Become a demon '. He also cursed that wicked woman so that she became a cannibal with a hideous countenance. **SHRI AGASTYA** *said*: ' May thy beauty vanish and mayest thou become a terrible *rakshasi*.' Then Taraka, transported with anger under this curse, began to destroy this sacred land because it was here that the Sage Agastya performed his yogic practices. " O **RAMA**, thou must slay this wicked and impious demon Taraka. who ravages the land. For the good of the *brahmins* and the king, O Raghava, accomplish this ; do not heaitate to destroy this vile yakshini. It is the duty of a warrior to protect those of the four castes. A prince must not eschew 56 deeds that are painful and difficult, for the preservation of his people. It is according to the Jaw of eternal *dharma*, O **RAMA**, that even deeds that appear ruthless, are permitted to those appointed to protect their subjects. O Raghava, Taraka is wholly evil, and therefore must be destroyed. It is said that in the past Mantbara, a daughtet of King Virochana, was slain by **INDRA** because she was the cause of the destruction of othets. The blessed Lotd VIShnu Himself slew the wife of the Sage Bhrigu, devoted to het husband, and the mother of Shukla because she was intent on tilling lndra. Many other great souled princes of old also condetnned wicked women to desth. Thetefore, it is for thee to fulfil thy duty and slay this yaksbini without

delay.”

CHAPTER 26

How the Yakshini Taraka was slain

THs son of **DASARATHA**, firm in his vows, listened to the inspiring words of the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, which lilled him with ardour, and with joined palms he humbly addressed him : " To fulfil the commands of my royal sire and to honour his promise, I deem it my duty to act according to thy instructions without hesitstion. My father, the emperor, at the time of my departure from Ayodhya bade me carry out thy injunctions -0 *Muni*, I shall honour them. I am prepared to execute thy commands, O *Rishi*, because it will lead to the benefit of the *brahmins* and the king, and will also bring happiness to the people of this land.” Having spoken thus, **SHRI RAMA** grasped his bow and, twanging the string, lilled Ell the cardinsl points with the sound. The deoizens of the forest were terrified, and Taraka was overcome with helpless rage. Full of wrath that yaksbini ran in the direction from which the sound came and **SHRI RAMA**· chandra beholding that gigantic and misshapen monstet was incensed and said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O Brother, behold this 57 fearful yabbini of formidable size, whose very aspect would strike terror into timozous hearts. See, O **LAKSHMANA**, how I shall cut off her ears and nose and put her to llight l She is horrible, versed in black magic and hard to subdue, but it is not proper to deprive a woman of her life. A woman is worthy of protection, therefore, I shall incapacitate her, by depriving her of the power of motion thus pceventing her from doing further mischief. .. Wbile **SHRI RAMA** was still speaking, the dteadf’u1 Tanh to wards him roaring with uplifted

arms. The Risbi Vishwamitta approaching her encouraged Rams, with a shout, crying, " J ai to the descendsnt of Raghu ". Notwithstanding, Tanh taised a thick cloud of dust and foe a while **SHRI RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** could see nothing. Then the yaksbini by the power of magic caused a shower of tOCks to min on the two brothers and **RAMA** was now filled with wrath. Partying the min of rocks and advancing towatds her, he cut off both her hands. Then Shri **LAKSHMANA** aevered the nose and ears of the asuri who had already been deprived of her hands. Assuming vsrious forms, she rried to deceive the princes by vanishing away. Then from het hiding place, she showered heavy rocks on them, and a rain of stones fell on every side. Shri Vishwamitta, who stood watching the combat, now ctied : " Bnough, she docs not desecve further mercy ; should'st thou spare her, she will gain sttength through het magic powers and will again bteak up our holy rites. The evening is approaching and in the evening *rakshasas* are overcome with di11iculty; slay her, thercfoce, without delay." Then Shri Vlshwamitta pointed out the concealed yaksbini to Rams, who drew from his quiver arrows capable of following sound and swrounded her with them. The powetful female demon, an adept in occult powers, encompassed by the min of arrows, advanced roaring, towatds the princes. With an arrow, **SHRI RAMA** pierced the heatt of the wicked yaksbini, who fell to the ground and expired. Seeing the tetrible yabbini slain, **INDRA** and other celestial beings WOtshipped **SHRI RAMA**, crying : " Well done, well done, O Holy **RAMA** l " All the gods filled with joy, said to Shri Vishwamitta : " O *Muni*, may prosperity attend thee, **INDRA** and the gods are grslified with ss Shri Ramacbandra's feat of arms, show thy special favour to him md deliver to him the two kinds of weapons, natural md super natural, belongiDg to Krisbssbws. Present Shri Ramschandra, who is worthy to receive them, with all the other mighty wespoos, he is wholly devoted to

thee; these two princes are destined to achieve great things." Having uttered these words, the gods bowed down to the Sage Vishwamitta and returned to their abode. Evening fell, and the holy sage gladdened by the slaying of the wicked Tarab by Shri Rams, smelt the head of the prince and addressed him thus : " O **RAMA**, this night we will remain here and to-morrow morning ptoceed to my hermitage." Shri Rams rejoiced to hear the *muni*'s words and rested happily during the night in the forest. On the day that Tarab was slain, the forest, freed from the curse, adorned with cbampaka,' ashoka,' mango and other trees, looked as charming as the forest of Chitraratha. Shri Ramscbandra, whom the siddhas praised for slaying Tarab, passed the night in the forest, awaiting the dawn.

CHAPTER 27

Shri Rama is given the celestial weapons

HAYING passed the night resting in the forest, the illustrious Sage **VISHWAMITRA** spoke to Rams smilingly, in sweet accents : " O Prince of Great Renown. I am entirely satisfied with thee and am happy to give thee these weapoos by means of which thou shalt be able to conquer and subdue all thine enemies, whether *devas, asuras* or nagas. Accept these divine wespoos, O Rams. Here is the great celestial disc and the Dunda weapon, the Disc of *Dharma*, the Kala weapon, the Disc of **VISHNU** and the irresistible Weapon of Indta. O Great Prince, here is the Mace and the Spear of Mahendta the **BRAHMA**-Shira and the Ishika. O Mighty-armed One, take the Shankara weapon and the two great maces Koumoduki and Lohitamukhi. O Great Prince receive also the mighty *Dharma*-pasha, the Kala-pasha and the **VARUNA**-pasha and two other maces called Shoshka and Ashani ; the Pinaka weapon, the Narayana

weapon and the fire-emitting weapon Agneya. “O **RAMA**, take this wind weapon, Vayuvya, and the horse headed weapon, Hayashira, also the Krauncha weapon. I give thee further two powers and the weapons called Kankala, Mushala, Rapala and Kinkini. O Mighty Prince, I confer on thee the two supernatural weapons named Vidyadhara and Nandana, useful in fighting the *Asuras*. " Take this jewel among swords, which I give to thee, O Mighty-armed One, and another supernatural weapon named Gandharva, and here, O **RAMA**, is one very dear to me called Manava. Here arc Prashaman, Soura, Praswaprana, Darpana and that which has the power of dtying up, and the pain inflicting weapon causing lamentation. I grant thee also the strength to bear the Madana-astra presented to me by Kandarpa which creates in man unbearable sexual desire so that he is unable to fight. Here also is the Paisha-astra and the Moban astra. " O ! Illustrious Prince, receive also the weapon that produces inertia, and the great Saumana weapon. O Great Prince, here are the Samvartta, Moushalya, Sattyastra and Mayadhara, and take the Tajaprabha by means of which the strength and courage of the foe are withdtawn, and also the Shishira which chills and the Somastra and Twashtra. " O **RAMA**, now thou an all-powerful and knowest the secrets of magic, yet take the Bava, Shitesu and Manava astra also. O Prince, receive the Paramodara-astra, take all these weapons from me.” Then the great VishwamitJ;a turned his face to the east and performed the purificatory rites with joy, conferring on **RAMA** in the methods unknown even to the gods. All these weapons did Shri **VISHWAMITRA** confer on **RAMA**, aod he, repeating the appropriate mmtrams, caused their presiding deities to appear before him. Approachiog with joined palms, they said : " O Prince of the House of Raghu, we are thy servaots md will obey thy bebests.” **SHRI RAMA**, having surveyed md blessed them, answered : " Come md serve me

when I summon you.” Thereafter, Shri Ramachmdra oft’eriDg salatatioos to the venerable Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, said: " Let us proceed further, my Lord.”

CHAPTER 28

He is instructed in their use

HAVING received the weapons aod instractioos for their ase, **SHRI RAMA** addressed the sage in cbarmiDg accents as they proceeded onward. **HE** *said*: " O Blessed One, by thy grace, I have received weapons which even the *devas* aod asaras caooot easily obtain. Be pleased to tell me fUrther, how I may withdraw these weapons when they are discharged ? " Then the supremely patient aod holy sage taught Shri Ramachmdra the method of withdrawing the *mantra*-propelled weapons aod gave him more by the name of Satya-VIDI, Satya-kirti, Dhrishta, Rapbasa, Pratibaratara, Parangmukha, Avaosmukha, Labhya, Alabhya, Drimabha md SODBbhaka, Dasharsba, Shatavaktra, Dasba-shirsba, Sbatodara, Dbarma oabha md Maba-oabba, Daoda-oabba aod SWIDBbhuka, Jyotisha aod Sbakuoa aod the two weapoos Nirashya md Vimala, also the Yogaodbara aod Vinidra, Ditya aod Pramm thmR, Shuchivahu, Mabavanu, Nishkali, Virucba, Sarchi-lllllli Dhriti aod Mali, Vrittimm aod Ruchira, Pitryia aod Soammas vidhata aod Mabra, Karavira with Rati, Dbaoa aod Dhmya. The holy sage said, " O **RAMA**, receive also Kamarapa, Kamarachi, Moba aod Avaraoa, also Jrim Bbala, Sarpa-1111tha 61 with SandhaDa and Varona. Rlceive from me, O **RAMA**, the Krisbashwa which assumes any form-0 Prince, mayest thou be triumphant, thou art worthy to possess these weapoas ". **SHRI RAMA** answered " May it be so, my Lord ". The holy *rishi*’ then placed the

divine weapons before **RAMA**, some of which shone like fire, others with the colour of smoke and yet others which resembled the sun and moon. With joined palms the deities presiding over them addressed **SHRI RAMA** with submission, saying : " O Prince, we are at thy service, what would'st thou have us accomplish ? " **SHRI RAMA** *answered*: " When called to mind in the time of need. grant me aid, now depart, all of you." Offering obeisance to Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, they replied : " Be it so, my Lord," and returned to their abode. **SHRI RAMA** then questioned the great *rishi*, saying : " O Spiritual Sovereign, what is this that resembles a dark cloud near the mountain ? It would seem to be a grove of trees, pleasing to the sight, filled with deer. I hear birda ainging sweetly, have we then passed the dangerous forest which was a cause of fear ? O Lord, ler us rest here at peace ; tell me, whose hermitage is this ? O Great *Muni*, are we now in thine own hermitage, where the wicked demons, the slayers of *brahmins* obstruct thy sacrifice ? O Blessed One, be pleased to show me the place of thy sacrifice. O Wise One, I will slay the meddlesome demons who hinder thy devotiODS. Be gracious enough to enlighten me in the matter, O Sage." CHAPTER Z!l Visltmamitra relata the story of his hermit411

CHAPTER 29

Vishwamitra relates the story of his hermitage and commences the sacrifice

With SandhaDa and Varona. Rlceive from me, O **RAMA**, the Krisbashwa which assumes any form-0 Prince, mayest thou be triumphant, thou art worthy to possess these weapoas ". **SHRI RAMA** answered " May it be so, my Lord ". The holy *rishi*' then placed the

divine weapons before **RAMA**, some of which shone like fire, others with the colour of smoke and yet others which resembled the sun and moon. With joined palms the deities presiding over them addressed **SHRI RAMA** with submission, saying : " O Prince, we are at thy service, what would'st thou have us accomplish ? " **SHRI RAMA** *answered*: " When called to mind in the time of need. grant me aid, now depart, all of you." Offering obeisance to Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, they replied : " Be it so, my Lord," and returned to their abode. **SHRI RAMA** then questioned the great *rishi*, saying : " O Spiritual Sovereign, what is this that resembles a dark cloud near the mountain ? It would seem to be a grove of trees, pleasing to the sight, filled with deer. I hear birda ainging sweetly, have we then passed the dangerous forest which was a cause of fear ? O Lord, ler us rest here at peace ; tell me, whose hermitage is this ? O Great *Muni*, are we now in thine own hermitage, where the wicked demons, the slayers of *brahmins* obstruct thy sacrifice ? O Blessed One, be pleased to show me the place of thy sacrifice. O Wise One, I will slay the meddlesome demons who hinder thy devotiODS. Be gracious enough to enlighten me in the matter, O Sage." CHAPTER Z!l Visltmamitra relata the story of his hermit411 " O **RAMA**, this is the place at which the Blessed Lord **VISHNU**, the first among the gods, dwelt, observing his yogic practices for immeasurable years and previous to that, it belonged to the glorious Vamana.' This spot is called Siddha-asbnma, for here, these great souls practised austerities with success. At that time, Bali the son of King Virochana, conquered **INDRA** aod other *devas*, together with the deities of the wiud and he ruled over the three worlds. Wheo Bali initiated a sacrifice, the *devas*, under the leadership of Agniapptoached Sbri **VISHNU** iu this hermitage aod said : ' O Lord, the son of Vuochana, King Bali is observing a great sacrifice ; while it is yet iucomplete, come to our aid. The Lord grants the requests

of those who seek His favour, therefore, by the power of Thy *Yoga* and for our own good, take the form of a dwarf (*Vamaoa*) and secure our welfare.' Meantime, O **RAMA**, the Sage Kashyapa, resplendent as fire, who wss endowed with supreme lustre by virtue of his yogic practices, with his spouse Aditi, having completed a thousand years' austerities, began to praise Madhusudaoa, the conferrer of boons, saying : ' O Supreme Purusha,Thou art adored through austerity and Thou dost grant the fruit of austerity, Thy nature is knowledge aod asceticism, it is by virtue of austerity that I behold Thee. O Lord, iu Thy body I see the whole world animate and iuanimate. In Thee Who art beginniugless and iudescribable, I take refuge.' " The blessed **VISHNU** was pleased with this prayer aod said to the sinless Sage : ' O Kashyapa, mayest thou see perfectioa, thou hast merited a booa, ask what thou desirest.' " Then Kashyapa, the son of Marichi, aoswered : ' O Blessed Lord, Aditi, the gnds and I beseech Thee to grant this boon -Become the son of my siuless wife aod myself. O Lord, become the younger brother of **INDRA** aod assist the sorrow stricken *devas*. This spot, by Thy grace, shall then be known as Sicldha-Asbnma.' (Hermitage of the Perfect Ones.) " Upon this, the resplendent **VISHNU** was born of the womb of Aditi as the iucarnation Vamaoa aod disguised as a mendicaot, he approached King Bali. Of him, he requested a piece of : =c groundthatcouldbe coveredbythrcestridcs,and having obtained what he asked. he covered the whole universe in thrce steps. " This restful hermitsge formerly belonging to Vamana, whose devotee I am, is enjoyed by me. Hete the *rakshasas* wreak destruction. O Lion among men, remain here and slay them. ORama,to-dayletuseoterthe Siddha-*Ashrama* togetber. O Friend, tbis hermitage is not only mine but tbine also." Accompanied by Shri Ramacbandrs and l.akshmana, the holy ssge entered the hermitage, which appesred as beautiful as the autumn moon attended by the planet

Punsrvasu.Wheo the sages dwelling in the Siddha-*Ashrama* perceived Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, they rose and saluted him with joy. Having duly honoured the respleodeot sage, tbey entertained the princes in a fitting manner. Having rested awhile, the two princes humbly and respectfully addressed the holy sage, saying : " O Great Sage, inaugurate thy sacrifice to-day, may it be attended with good fottune. This place is the Siddha-*Ashrama*, we wish tbee success in thy undertaking." Thereupon the great sage with due preparation, his mind subdued, began the sacrifice while the two princes kept vigil. Having passed the night in tbis manner, in accordance witb the prescribed rules, tbey performed their ablutions, repeating the mantram sileotly, tbey theo paid respect to Shri **VISHWAMITRA** and ocatpied their seats as do those perfotming a fire-sacrifice.

CHAPTER 30

Maricha and Suvahu obstruct the sacrifice and are slain by Rama

THB two princes, knowing what was appropriate in respect to time and place and skilled in the art of conquering their foes, uttered words fitting to the place and occasi.on. **THEY** *said*: " O Blessed One, we desire to hear at what moment in the course of the sacri1icc, the two demoas appear ? It is essential for us to be acquainted with the matter, to forestall their attack." The dwellers in the Siddha-asbrama, hearing the words of the princes, and finding them eager to fight the demons, praised them saying : " O Princes, from now on, keep watch over the sacrifice for six days ; the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** having begun the rite will observe a strict silence during that time." On this, the two illustrious

princes kept watch in the Tapovana forest continuously fot six days without sleeping. Armed with bow and arrows they guarded the *rishi* and his sacrifice with firm resolve. Five days passed without interruption and on the sixth day Shri **RAMACHANDRA** said to **LAKSHMANA** : " Brother, be prepared to-day." As **SHRI RAMA** uttered these words concerning the approaching conllict with the demons, the altar fire blazed up suddenly. The officiating *brahmin*, the priest and Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, who watching, beheld all the sacrificial implements aet on fire. The sacrifice of the holy sage still proceeding, a grest and fearful clamour resounded in the firmament. As in the rainy season, clouda cover the sky, ao the demons by the power of magic began to courae through the air. Maricha and Suvahu and other demons surrounding the altar, let fill torrents of blood. Seeing the altar deluged with blood, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and **LAKSHMANA** were filled with and ran to discover the cause. Then they saw Maricha and other demons in the sky. Raghava beholding the demoas rushing towards him, said to **LAKSHMANA**, " O **LAKSHMANA**, see these evU fiesh-eating demons, I shall destroy them with the Manava weapon, as the wind scatters the clouda ". So saying, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** hurled the shining Manava weapon at them and striking the breast of Maricha, inllicted a wound. Thus smitten, the demon was ftung into the sea, a distance of a hundred miles. Perceiving Maricha reeling, struck senaelcsa by the Manava weapon, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** addrcsaed I .aisbmana, saying : " Behold the power of this great weapon aested by the *muni* I Yet, though Maricha has been deprived of his aenaes, he is not desd; verily I shall now destroy ,, 1 those wicked, merciless and sinful blood-drinking demons who obstruct the holy sacrifice." So saying, he seized the fire weapon and discharged it at the breast of Suvahu, who sttaight way fell to the ground and expired. On this, **SHRI RAMA** destroyed the remaining demons with the

air-weapon (*Vayuvya*). Thus by slaying the obstructots of the sacrifice did Shri Ramachandta bring delight to the heatts of the sages and was wotshipped by them as was formerly the victorious Jndta. When the sacrifice had been successfWly completed, perceiving the world to be freed from the interference of the asatss, the *Rishi* Vishwamitts said to **RAMA** : " O Mighty-atmed Prince, to-day I have fulfilled my spiritual purpose, thou hast obeyed the commands of thy Guru perfectly, truly thou hast made the Siddha-*Ashrama* worthy of its name." CHAPTI!Il 3 Vilhrmmritra ltarts out r»ith th4 lfllo prinu1 to attend King Janakt/1 IIM:Tifics THI! great hero, the ever-cheerful **RAMA**, togethei with Labh mana having successfully assisted Shri Vishwamitts, passed the Dight in the hermitage. At dawn, aftei purifying themselves, they approached Shri Vishwamltts and otrexed obeisance to him and the othex sages. Bowing down before the great *muni*, who was as resplendent as a blazing fire, they addressed him in submissive tones, saying :

CHAPTER 31

Vishwamitra starts out with the two princes to attend King Janaka's sacrifice

1 those wicked, merciless and sinful blood-drinking demons who obstruct the holy sacrifice." So saying, he seized the fire weapon and discharged it at the breast of Suvahu, who sttaight way fell to the ground and expired. On this, **SHRI RAMA** destroyed the remaining demons with the air-weapon (*Vayuvya*). Thus by slaying the obstructots of the sacrifice did Shri Ramachandta bring delight to the heatts of the sages and was wotshipped by them as was formerly the victorious Jndta. When the sacrifice had been successfWly completed, perceiving the world to

be freed from the interference of the asatss, the *Rishi* Vishwamitts said to **RAMA** : " O Mighty-atmed Prince, to-day I have fulfilled my spiritual purpose, thou hast obeyed the commands of thy Guru perfectly, truly thou hast made the Siddha-*Ashrama* worthy of its name." CHAPTI!Il 3 Vilhrmmritra ltarts out r»ith th4 lfllo prinu1 to attend King Janakt/1 IIM:Tifics THI! great hero, the ever-cheerful **RAMA**, togethei with Labh mana having successfully assisted Shri Vishwamitts, passed the Dight in the hermitage. At dawn, aftei purifying themselves, they approached Shri Vishwamltts and otrexed obeisance to him and the othex sages. Bowing down before the great *muni*, who was as resplendent as a blazing fire, they addressed him in submissive tones, saying : **JANAKA**, it is exceedingly heavy and splendid. Neither gandharvas nor *asuras* can bend this great bow, how much less man ? To test their skill, great kings have come to the assembly of King J anaka, but none has succeeded in raising the bow and stringing it. O illustrious One, let us go and see the sacrifice of the King of Mithila and also that marvellous bow. In former days, King **JANAKA** performed a sacrifice and the fruit of it was the great bow which he obtained from the gods who instructed him saying : ' Place this bow in the sacrificial chamber and let it be worshipped with incense, perfume and lights'." Shri **VISHWAMITRA** having related these facts, started out accompauied by the two princes and other sages. Invoking the Vanadevata (*Forest Deity*) he said to him: "My sacrifice has come to a successful conclusion, may happiness be thine. I am leaving the Siddha-*Ashrama* for the banks of the sacred river Gunga on the slopes of the Himalayas, situated in the domain of King **JANAKA**." Then the sage reverently circumambulated the hermitage and turned northwards. As Shri **VISHWAMITRA** entered upon his journey, the sages skilled in the knowledge of the science of *Brahman,* accompanied him with their chattels placed on hundreds of waggons. The birds and beasts

of the hermitage also followed them for a long way until the holy *muni* requested them to tum back. The sages and the holy *muni* reached the banks of the river Shona at sunset and, having bathed and recited their evening prayers, performed the fire sacrifice. Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and Prince Lakshrnana then offered salutations to Shri **VISHWAMITRA** and the other *rishis*, and sat down before them. Thereafter **SHRI RAMA** cheerfully enquired : " O Lord, what country is this, covered with verdant groves ? Be gracious enough to relate everything conceruing it." The great ascetic of firm vows, was pleased to hear these words and, sitting amidst the sages, he described the country fully to them.

CHAPTER 32

Vishwamitra tells of his ancestors and the dynasty of King Kusha

" **O** lUMA, in times of yore, there was a king named Kusha, he was the son of a *brahmin*, a noted ascetic, mtbful to his vows, conversant with *dharma* and ever revered by the virtuous. He wedded a high-born woman of great beauty named Bhidharvi, and begat four sons, each resembling himself. Their names were Kushamba, Kushanabhs, Umurita-rajasa and Basu ; these four princes were mighty and active, and desirous of teaching them the duties of a *kshatriya*, the trutbful and righteous King Kusha addressed them as follows : " ' O My Sons, protect and nourish your subjects, this practice" is productive of great merit.' " In order to carry out the instructions of their sire, these princes founded four cities and named them after themselves. The mighty Kushamhs called his city Kaushambi, and the righteous Kushsnabhs founded the city of Mahodaya. O Rams, Prince Umurita-rajasa founded the city

Damed Dhar-maranya and the Prince Basu called his city Giribrat,also nsmed Basumati. This city was surrounded by five mountain peaks and the river Msgadhi or ShoDa meandering through the mountains resembled a lovely garland. O **RAMA**, this stream the Magadhi llows towards the east and irrigates the fruitful fields on either bank. " O Prince of Raghu, Kushanabhs took in wedlock a nymph Damed Ghritachi and by her hsd one hundred beautiful daughters, who on reaching maturity were delightful to look upon. One day, clad in lovely dresses, in beauty of form un paralleled they wandered in the garden like lightning amidst the clouds. Singing, dancing and playing on instruments they seemed to be divine forms which had materialised and des cended on the earth, or like the stars in the firmament. " Seeing those lovely and virtuous princesses, Vayu the wind god thus addressed them : ' I entreat you all to be wedded to me; sive up your mortal form, I will tender you immortal. Remember youth is passing and youth among mottsls passes even more swiftly ; wedded to me, you will be beautiful for ever.' " The damsels listened to the improper speech of the wind god and replied mockingly : ' O Deity of the Wind, thou knowest all that is passing in the hearts of men, but we know wbat ia passing in thy heart. Wby dost thou insult us, O Wind ? O Vayu, who art renowned for thy wisdom, we virgins by the power of our devotion and self-control can effect thy downfall, but because the merits of the righteous come to nougbt when they cause barto to others, we sball preserve our sacred vows inviolate. O Stupid One, heaven forfend that we choose husbands for ourselves without first seeking the approval of our honoured sire. He is as a god to us and our master, and we shall wed the husbands he chooses for us.' " The wind god was enraged and entering their bodies, twisted and distorted them. Thus afHicted, the princesses in tears, approached their father for assistance. " The king was grieved to sec his

daughters in this condition and BBid : 'O speak, what has occurred ? Wbo, disregarding justice, has deformed you ? Tell me all.' The monarch waa deeply moved by this event and his heart became heavy."

CHAPTER 33

King Kushanabha's hundred daughters

WHEN the hundred princesses were thus questioned by the king their father, they placed their heada at his feet and answered : " The wind god, who pervades all, has entered the evU path and desired us to forsake virtuous conduct. We told him we were not free to choose our way of life since our father was atilllivillg and that he should CODSult thee if he wished to wed us, but that sinfid god, disregarding our request has twisted and deformed our bodies in this manner." 69 The great king hearing the complaint of the hundred virgins, said to them: “You have acted nobly by practisiug forbearance towards the deity. It is meet that the generous-minded should exercise forbearance, you have added to the honout of out dynasty. Forbearance is the chief ornameot of both msn and womsn, you have achieved somethiug rare ; few are capable of such forbearance. O Virgins, forbesrance is charity, forbear ance is truth, forbesrance is sacrifice. A msn’s true glory is forbearance ; forbearance is *dharma*. The world is established in forbesrance.” Having spoken thus, the princesses were comforted, and the king dismissed them. Then the monarch, mighty like a god, summoned his ministers and coDSulted them regarding the alliance of his daughters to suitable filmilies at the proper time and place. Now a great *muni* IIIUiled Chuli full of glory derived ftom prolooged celibacy and highly virtuous, was engaged in sacred austerities for the purpose of spiritual liberation. At that place, the

virgin daughter of the nymph Urmila, IIIUiled Somada, began to minister to the *muni*. She attended on the great sage for a long time with undeviating faith and devotion and her Guru was pleased with her ; he said to her : " I am pleased with thee, what desire of thine shall I fulfil ? " Perceiving the *muni* to be highly pleased, that sweet-voiced nymph acqusinted with the art of conversation made answer to him : " O King of Kings, I desire to bear a son, resplendent with divine power, a worshipper of God and devoted to *dharma*. I have no husband, nor do I wish to be the wife of any, as I am a brahmacharini,' therefore, by virtue of thy *Yoga*, grant me a son produced by the power of thy thought." The divine Sage Chuli was pleased to hear these words and gtanted her a son IIIUiled Brahmadatta, by the power of his mind. Brahmadatta became King of Kampjla and was as prosperous as **INDRA** in heaven. King Kushanabha resolved to give his daughters in martisge to King Brahmadatta. Kushan· abha requested King Brahmadatta to visit him and joyfully gave him his daughters in marriage. O Ramaji, King Brahmadatta, who was equal to lndra in glory walded the princesses one by one by taking their hands in his. Through the touch of his hand, the princesses were freed from their deformity and teStoted to their Conner besuty. When King Kusbnabha bebeld his daughters relessed from their clillfigurement and teStoted to their former besuty he was filled with joy. Thus did the King Kushnabha give his daughters in marriage to King Brahmadatta and then commanded their preceptors to accompsny them to the court of his son-in-Jaw. Somada was delighted with the union of het son to the damsels and receiving them with great affection, commended the virtuous King Kushanabha.

CHAPTER 34

His son, Gadhi, is the father of Vishwamitra

" **O** RAMA.II, after the wedding of his daughters, the sinless King Kushanabha prepared to perform a sacrifice in ordet to obtain a son. “At the inauguration of the sacrifice, the munificent King Kusha, son of Shri Brahms, said to Kushanabha : ' O my Son, thou wilt obtain a son 1i1re thyself, he should be named Gadhi, he will bring thee immortal renown.' “After some time a son was born to the wise King Kushanabha who was a lover of virtue, and his name was Gadhi. This Gadhi, O **RAMA**, was my virtuous father’ and because I was horn in the family of Kusha I was called Kaushika. " I had, O Prince, an eldet sistet named Satyavati, who became the faithfbl spouse of Richika. When het lord died, she ascended to hesven and took the form of the Kaushild river. The river is sacred and beautiful, and its watets confet Inerit on men. To bless the world Satyavati became the river flowins near tbe Himalayas. THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIXI " O Prince, through love of my sister, I dwell on the baDb of the Kaushiki river near the Himalayas. " Established in truth. faithful to her lord, that sister of mine, named Satyavati is to-day the river Kaushiki, great among and highly fornmate. " O **RAMA**, in order to perform a sacrifice, I went to the Siddha asbrama, I have now accomplished my purpose. " O **RAMA**, at thy instance, I have told thee of my family and origin ; the night is fir spent in listening to this tale, now rest, so that, refreshed, we may resume our journey to-morrow. Peace he with thee I " The leaves of the are motionless, the birds and beasts are silent and darkness covers aU. How imperceptibly the evening has passed away. The sky is brilliant with stars, as if a thousand eyes gazed down on us. " The hrighr moon with its cool

beams, slowly rising higher and higher dispels the darkness. Nocturnal wanderers and the terrible fiesh-eating yakshas prowl about here and there.” Having uttered these words, the great Sage Vishwamitta became silent. The other *munis* prsised him saying: " Well spoken, well spoken, O Sage.” **THEY** *said*: " The dynssty of Kusha has ever practised righteousness and the kings of this line hsve been eminent in virtue. Of this dynasty, thou, O **VISHWAMITRA**, art the most illustrious, the fame of this royal line has been enhanced by the beautiful river Kaushiki.” Thus did the great sages praise the *Rishi* **VISHWAMITRA**, who then withdrew to rest, as the sun sets behind a mountain. Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and his brother **LAKSHMANA**, full of wonder also made obeisance to the holy sage and retired to sleep. CHAPTER 3S Yiiheamitra begins to th4 origin of th4 holy ri’llerGun,a HAVING passed the night with the other *munis* on the banks of the river Shona, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** said to Prince **RAMA** at daybreak: “Arise, O Prince, the day has dawned, may prosperity attend thee ! Perform thy morning devotions and let us prepare for our journey.” **SHRI RAMA** listened to the instructions of the holy sage, recited his morning prayers and prepared to leave, saying : " O Knower of God, the waters of the holy river Shona appear to be very shallow and rest on a sandy bed, be pleased to instruct us where we should cross over it.” The sage replied : " O Prince, I will show thee where the great *rishis* traversed it.” Thereafter they forded the river and journeyed on and on, enjoying the many beautiful wooda and forests through which they passed. After proceeding a great distance, late one afternoon, they reached the holy river Ganges, beloved of the sages. On beholding the lovely river rendered beautiful by the presence of swans and cranes, **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and the sages were filled with delight. They halted on the banks and bathed in the sacred river as prescribed by the holy ordinance,

then lighting their sacrificial fires they partook of the remains of the offerings. According

CHAPTER 35

Vishwamitra begins to narrate the origin of the holy river Ciunga

CHAPTER 3S Yiiheamitra begins to th4 origin of th4 holy ri'llerGun,a HAVING passed the night with the other *munis* on the banks of the river Shona, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** said to Prince **RAMA** at daybreak: "Arise, O Prince, the day has dawned, may prosperity attend thee ! Perform thy morning devotions and let us prepare for our journey." **SHRI RAMA** listened to the instructions of the holy sage, recited his morning prayers and prepared to leave, saying : " O Knower of God, the waters of the holy river Shona appear to be very shallow and rest on a sandy bed, be pleased to instruct us where we should cross over it." The sage replied : " O Prince, I will show thee where the great *rishis* traversed it." Thereafter they forded the river and journeyed on and on, enjoying the many beautiful wooda and forests through which they passed. After proceeding a great distance, late one afternoon, they reached the holy river Ganges, beloved of the sages. On beholding the lovely river rendered beautiful by the presence of swans and cranes, **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and the sages were filled with delight. They halted on the banks and bathed in the sacred river as prescribed by the holy ordinance, then lighting their sacrificial fires they partook of the remains of the offerings. According On tbis request, Shri VJShwamitra began to oarrate the origin and genesis of the sacred river. " O **RAMA**, the great Himavat, Lotd of the Himalayas, the treasury of all precious metals, had two

daughters, who wete in loveliness on eatth. Their mothet Mena, the wife of Himachala (*Himavat*) was the daughter of Mount Metu. Her elder daughter was ll8llled Gunga and the younger Uma. " The *devas* wishiDg to observe certain sacred rites, asked for Shri Gunga to promote the success of their undertaking and with the permission of her father, took her away with them. " Himachaia, mindfUl of the good of all beings, gave his daughter Gunga, the purifier of the whole world, to the gods, thinking it to be his duty to do so. The gods supremely gratified took his daughter Gunga and blessing all, left Himachala. " O Prince of the House of Raghu, the other daughter of Himachala, ll8llled Uma, practised great asceticism, considering it to be her chief wealth. Himachala gave tbis ascetic daughter Uma, who was venerated by the whole world, to Shri Mahadeva in marriage, thinking him to be a worthy consort. " O **RAMA**, now I have told thee of the two daughters of Himachala, revered by the whole world, the river Gunga and UmaDevi. " O my Son, O alief of Disciples, I have related to thee the story of Shri Gunga accompanying the *devas* to heaven. This beautiful daughter of the King of Himalaya, once resident in heaven, is the charming river Gunga, whose waters destroy all sin." CHAPTEil 36 HwNo the wonderful narrative, so eloquently related by Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, both the princes praised the holy sage and said : " O Divine Sage, thou hast tbld us a tale, by the hearing of

CHAPTER 36

The story of the King of Himalayas' younger daughter Uma

On tbis request, Shri VJShwamitra began to oarrate the origin and genesis of the sacred river. " O **RAMA**, the great Himavat, Lotd of the Himalayas, the treasury of all precious metals, had two daughters, who wete in loveliness on eatth. Their mothet Mena, the wife of Himachala (*Himavat*) was the daughter of Mount Metu. Her elder daughter was ll8llled Gunga and the younger Uma. " The *devas* wishiDg to observe certain sacred rites, asked for Shri Gunga to promote the success of their undertaking and with the permission of her father, took her away with them. " Himachaia, mindfUl of the good of all beings, gave his daughter Gunga, the purifier of the whole world, to the gods, thinking it to be his duty to do so. The gods supremely gratified took his daughter Gunga and blessing all, left Himachala. " O Prince of the House of Raghu, the other daughter of Himachala, ll8llled Uma, practised great asceticism, considering it to be her chief wealth. Himachala gave tbis ascetic daughter Uma, who was venerated by the whole world, to Shri Mahadeva in marriage, thinking him to be a worthy consort. " O **RAMA**, now I have told thee of the two daughters of Himachala, revered by the whole world, the river Gunga and UmaDevi. " O my Son, O alief of Disciples, I have related to thee the story of Shri Gunga accompanying the *devas* to heaven. This beautiful daughter of the King of Himalaya, once resident in heaven, is the charming river Gunga, whose waters destroy all sin." CHAPTEil 36 HwNo the wonderful narrative, so eloquently related by Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, both the princes praised the holy sage and said : " O Divine Sage, thou hast tbld us a tale, by the hearing of which great merit is acquired, be gracious enough to enlighten us funher regarding the elder daughter of the Kiog of Himalaya. Thou art omniscient, therefore describe to us fully, how the Gunga, the world purifying stream, came down from heaven to eanh. O Thou, versed in the science of *dharma*, why is this sacred river called

Tripathsga (the Traverser of the Three Worlds) and whence is this name derived?" Seated amidst tbe other sages, Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, whose only wealth was truth and austerity, spoke as follows, in answer to **SHRI RAMA**'s questioning : " O Prince, in ancient times, the holy Lord Mahadeva was wedded to Parvati' and being charmed with her beauty devoted himself to the delights of connubial bliss. According to the measure of time of tbe gods, the Lord Mahadeva passed a hundred years with thst devi' but remained without issue. In their anxiety, the gods approached Shri **BRAHMA** and said : " ' Who will be able to endure the power and glory of the offspring produced by these two mighty beings ? " They then took refuge with Shri Mahadeva, saying : ' O God of Gods, O Mahadeva, ever engaged in doing good to all beings, we offer salutations to thee, be gracious unto us ! Thy power, O First among the Gods, none can endure, therefore with this goddess engage in yogic penances. For the welfare of the three worlds, retain thine energy within thy body so thst the universe may be preserved and may not suffer destruction '." The Ruler of the World, Shri Mahadeva, listened to the words of the *devas* and said : " Be it so, O *Devas*, I will restrain my power so that all the regions including the earth may dwell in peace, but O *Devas*, should my vital fluid overflow, who shall receive it ? , The gods answered Shri Mahadeva, saying : " Let the eanh THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI with that creative power and thus was a white mountain created and later a hcaVCD!y forest as resplendent as the light of the sun. From this fiery light was born the glorious Swami Karttikeya. "All the gods and *rishis* were full of joy and adored the Lord **SHIVA** and the goddess Uma. As they worshipped them with gratefUl hearts, Uma was filled with wrath and said : ' O Dews, your action has filled me with displeasure, you shall not escape the consequences.' " Then Uma shining like the sun, took water in the palm of her hand and

pronounced a curse on the gods, aaying : ' O Dews, you have prevented me from bearing a son, may you be childless from this day, may your wives be without progeny.' " Still not appeased, Uma cursed the earth also and said : ' O Earth, thou shalt never remain in one form, thou shalt have many masters. O Witless One, thou shalt never bear a son, since thou hast prevented me from becoming a mother.' " Shri Mahadeva, seeing the dews discomfited, prepared to depart to the northern region of the Himalayas. There, on a peak named Himavatprabhava, he engaged in prolonged yogic practices together with Uma. " O **RAMA**, I have told thee of one of the two daughters of the Himalayas ; now with **LAKSHMANA**, listen to the tale of the other daughter of Himalaya, named Gunga."

CHAPTER 37

The king's elder daughter, Gunga

BRAHMA where, with lndra, they psid reverence to the Lord of the world, and said : " O Lord, at the beginning of creation thou did'st make Shri Mahadeva our leader, but he has now retired to the Himalayas and is engaged in the practice of austerity with Uma. O Thou who art desirous of the good of the world, do what thou considerest ought to be done, thou art our only refuge." Then Sbri Brahms encouraged the *devas*, with gende words, saying : " O *Devas*, the curse of Uma Devi, that you should remain without oft'spring is irrevocable, but the fire god Agoi will cause Gunga to bear a aon who will desttoy the enemies of the gods. The youngest daughter of Himanchala (*Uma*) will look upon her sister's son as her own and will inevitably lavish her affection on him." " O **RAMA**, the words of Shri Brahms filled the gods with satisfaction and

they offered obeisance to him. Then they all circumambulated Mount Kailasha, the repository of precious metals, and begged Agoi to beget a son. “Agoi acquiesced in their request and approaching Shri Gunga, said : ' O Devi, let us beget a son for it is the wish of the gods.' “Assuming the form of a celestial nymph, Gunga, inspired the fire god to plant his seed in her, her every vein being filled with splendour. After a time, she addressed Agoi, saying: ' O *Deva*, I am unable to bear the ever-increasing splendour which thou hast communicated to me. My body is burning like fire, my mind is agitated and I am filled with fear.' “**AGOI** *replied*: ' O Sinless One, place this foetus near the Himalayas.' " Then Gunga Devi expelled the resplendent being, shining like gold. This substance, falling on the earth, became the purest gold that can be found. All objects in its proximity became silver and the more distant areas exposed to its penetrating rays became copper, the baser parts becoming zinc and lead. In this way, its brilliance was transmuted into metals and spread abroad and the mountains and forests near by were changed to gold. O Rams, gold being produced in that dazzling form is called jatsrupa (*form-born*) and, O Hero, that is why gold shines like fire. The grass, the creepers, the shrubs, all were converted into gold, and from that splendour was bom Kumara. child and they regarded him as their own son. The gods named the cbi1d Karttikeya and said : ' He shall be our son and he will be renowned in the three worlds.' " The Krittitas bathed the cbi1d and as he grew, his form resembled the fire. Because the iufant was born premsturely, the *devas* called him Skanda. " The nurses began to nourish the child with milk and he shone like a flame. With six mouths he sucked the milt of six nurses at the same time. Soon he grew so powerful that while yet an iufant he challenged groups of demons to combat. Then all the gods appointed him their commander-in-chief. The *Devas* and **AGNI** paid afl’ectionate homage to

thia child. " O **RAMA**, thia is the inspiriog and merit-bestowing story of Sbri Gunga and Karttikeya. " O Raghava, on thia earth, those who read this narrative with faith and devotion shall have long lives, sons and grandsons and obtain the divine region of Skanda.”

CHAPTER 38

The story of King Sagara, Shri Rama's anccstor

thousand sons.' " When the queens heard of the boon granted by the *rishi*, they approached him saying : ' O Knower of God, we are certain that thy boon will bear fruit, please tell us therefore which of us will beget one son and which sixty thousand ? ' " Hearing their words, the highly virtuous **BHRIGU** *said*: ' That depends on your desires. Tell me, which of you would fain be the mother of the founder of the dynasty and which desires to beget sixty thousand illustrious sous ? ' " O **RAMA**, Queen Keshini desired to be favoured by one son only, but Sumati, the sister of Garudaobtained the boon of bearing sixty thousand powerful and illustrious sons. " O Prince, the king offered salutations to the *Rishi* Bhrigu and with his consorts returned to the capital. " When the time was ripe, the chief Queen Keshini gave birth to a son who was called Asamanjasa. " O Great One, a gourd was brought forth by Queen Sumati from which, when opened, sixty thousand male infants emerged. The nurses placed them in jars full of butter and tended them. After a long time they attained to the state of adolescence, and then grew to manhood. " O **RAMA**, the eldest son of King Sagara, Asamanjasa used to seize hold of children and throw them into the river Sarayu. When he saw them drowning, he rejoiced. This evil doer grew up to oppress the good by his conduct. “The citizens of King Sagara’s capital exiled the

prince, thus passing judgment on him. Asamanjasa became the father of a valiant prince named Anshuman, who was esteemed by everyone and addressed every man with courtesy. “After a long time, King Sagara resolved to perform a sacrifice. O **RAMA**, the king summoning the high priests began the initiatory rites.”

CHAPTER 39

The horse with which he performs a sacrifice is stolen

HAVING listened to this tale, Sbri **RAMA** addressed the *Muni* **VISHWAMITRA**, who resembled the fire in splendour, and slid: " O Wise One, may prosperity constantly attend thee I I desire to hear how my ancestor King Sagara performed tJie sacrifice.” Sbri **VISHWAMITRA**, highly gratified by Sbri **RAMA**’a eager enquiry, smilingly replied : " listen, O **RAMA**, to the history of the high-souled King Sagara. There is a country between the Himalayas and the Vindhya mountains, and it was there that King Sagara performed his sacrifice. That land is suitable for this purpose, O Great Prince. " The great archer and warrior Anshuman was appointed the ptotector of the horse released for the sacrifice. A *rakshasa* in disguise, stole the horse and when it was being borne away, the priests approsched the king, crying : ' See, someone is carrying off the horse, kill the thief and restore it.' The king called for his sixty thousand aons and said : 'A wicked demon has stolen the sacrificial steed, in what direction has he borne it away ? It has been consecrated by mantrams to avoid obstructions ; seek the horse, my aons, and may success attend you. Scour the earth surrounded by the seas, and excavate the earth at my command, till the sacred horse is

fonnd. Having taken the initiation, I cannot leave this place. Go Ye, My Sons ! I shall remain here with Anshuman and the *brahmins*.' " O **RAMA**. commanded by their father, those powcdW princes joyfully started in search of the horse. O Great One I they ranged the world in vain and began to dig the ground with their nails which were as sharp as diamonds. . " O Prince of the House ofRagbu, they used ploughs, apadea and other implements to excavate the ground and the earth shook with the sonnd. While ploughing up the earth, many snakes, demons and powcdW titans were slain and injured. " O Raghsva, those mighty ptinces pierced the earth to the depth of sixty thousand milea and reached the antipodes. Having 8o pierced the earth with its mountains, they searched for the horse in Jambudwipa. " The *devas*, gandharvas, uuras and nagas became agitated, and approached Shri **BRAHMA** ; bowing before him with their minds aftlicted and in great distress, they said : ' O Blessed Lord, the sons of the Maharajah Sagara are digging up the whole earth and they have brought about the death of many great beings. Whosoever opposes them is slain with the words, " Thou art a thief, thou hut stolen the sacrificial horse " '.”

CHAPTER 40

The king's sons search for the horse; they accuse Shri Kapila of stealing it and are reduced to ashes

" THE grandsire Shri **BRAHMA**, hearing the words of the gods regarding the sons of King Sagara, who were already doomed, said: .. ' O *Devas*, this whole world belongs to the glorious Vasu *deva*’ and he, in the form of the Sage Kapila, supportS it. These princes will fall victims to the wrath of holy Kapila ; the earth is eternal and cannot be

destroyed.' The gods, hearing these words, returned to their own regions, full of joy. " Meanwhile, the uproar caused by the sons of Sagara digging the earth resembled the craah of thunder. " Having encompassed the whole world, they returned to their father and said : 'We have traversed the whole world and have slain gods, demons and snakes, but we have found no trace of the sacrifi.cial horse nor of the thief. O Father, may prosperity attend thee, be pleucd to reftcct on the matter and give us fUrther instructions.' " The great monarch replied in anger : ' Go, dig the earth once more, capture the horse, accomplish your purpose, then return.' ! " In accordance with the command of their fOYal sire, the princes once more renewed their tunnelling and came upon the monstrous form of a great elephant which resembled a mountain. " O Prince of Raghu, the whole earth and the mountains of that quarter are supported by that elephant Vimpaksha, and whenever, from fatigue, he moves his feet to ease himself, the whole world trembles and quakes. “The princes bowed down to him and circumambulated him. They then continued digging deeper and deeper, first to the east, then to the west. To the south they saw the second great elephant whose name was Mahapadma. They beheld him supporting that quarter of the earth and were astonished ; they offered him salutations. " O Prince, the sons of King Sagara next dug the northern quarter of the earth and saw there a white elephant which resembled a heap of snow. His name was Hima-Pandara and his form was gigantic ; they worshipped him as he stood supporting that quarter of the earth. " Then with furious zeal, those mighty and valiant sons of Sagara dug the earth and proceeded to that renowned quarter where they saw Kapila the eternal Lord Vasudeva and the horse grazing near him. " O **RAMA**, they were glad, thinking that it was Shri Kapila who had stolen the horse. Full of wrath, seizing ploughs, trees, rocks and stones, they ran towards him, crying : Thou art

the stealer of the sacrificial horse, thou art the thief. O Wicked One, we, the sons of King Sagara, have found thee.' " O **RAMA**, Shri Kapila, hearing these words, filled with rage, uttered the sound H'm ' and instantly by his immeasurable power all the sons of Sagara were reduced to ashes."

CHAPTER 41

King Sagara's grandson, Anshuman, finds the horse and the ashes of his uncles. He is told the funeral rites must be performed with the waters of the holy river Ganga

" **O** RAMAciwmRA, perceiving tbat a long period had elapsed since the departure of his sons, King Sagara spoke to his powerful and resplendent grandson Anshuman : " ' O Olild, thou art valiant, learned and illustrious like thine ancestors, go and seek thine uncles and the stealer of the horse also. The interior of the earth is inhabited by the most mighty beings, arm thyself thetefore with sword, bow and arrows. Pay revereoce to those worthy to be worshipped whom thou dost encounter on the way and make obeisance to them ; slay those who obstruct thy purpose, then successful, return and ensure the completion of the sacrifice.' " Thus instructed by his grandfather, Prince Anshuman, arming himself with sword, bow and arrows, speedily departed. Honouted on the way by *devas*, danavas, *asuras* and nagas, pisachas, birds and serpents, he came to the mighty and resplendent elephant and worahipped him, enquiring as to his welfare. The elephant said in reply : ' O Prince Anshuman, thou wilt accomplish thy purpose and soon return to the capital.' " The prince ptoceeded further and enquired in the same

manner of each of the other grest elephants. They all advised the prince, who had psid due respect to them, to proceed further. As instructed by them, Anshuman came to the place where the heaped ashes of his uncles' bodies were lying. Overcome with grief, Anshuman wept to see tbat death had overtaken them. A11licted with distress and pain, he suddenly perceived the sacrificial horse grazing near by. Desirous of offering the rite of water for his departed relatives, he looked round bnt could find no water anywhere. Extending his gaze, he saw his maternal uncle, the holy eagle, who addressed the prince as follows: " O Lion among men, grieve not, these princes have met the death they deserved. They have been consumed to ashes 83 by the Mahatma Kapila of Ullimaginable glory. O Wise One, it is not meet to offer the usual rites for them. O Great One, perform the rites with the water of the boly river Gwiga, the Daughter of Himalaya. When the waters of tbe purifier of the world, the sacred Gunga ftow over their ashes, the ceremony will be crowned with success and tbe sixty thousand princes will be received into heaven'." The illustrious and mighty Prince Anshuman listened to the words of Sbri **GARUDA** and speedily returning with the borse, approached King Sagan, who still awaited the tompletion of the initiatory rites ; he related to him all that the eagle had said. The monarch tompleted the sacrifice and returned to his capital considering the means whereby he might cause Sbri Gunga to descend to earth ; but in vain. King Sagan, unable to devise any way to accomplish this matter, having ruled for thirty thousand years, departed hence. CHAPTEK 4Z Aruhumtzn' s son, Dilipa,fails and his son Bhagiratha peyforms austerities to induu the holy mer to descend .AFTEa his death, the ministers installed the virtuous Anshuman as king. O **RAMA**, glorious was the reign of K.iog Anshuman. He was succeeded by his son, the world-renowoed Dilipa. King Anshuman, leaving his kingdom to Dilipa,

retired to the top of a Himalayan peak and began to perform severe yogic austerities. Having passed thirty-two thousand years in this wise, without inducing the sacred river Guogs to descend on earth, he gave up his life. Acquainted with the filte of his great uncles, and overcome with grief. the mighty sovereign Dilipa found no means of bringing the sacred stream down to earth. Consumed with ansiety, he reftected daily on how he should accomplish the descent of the Gunga and perform the funeral rites for the deliverance of the souls of his ancestors. The righteous and

CHAPTER 42

Anshuman's son, Dilipa, fails and his son Bhagiratha performs austerities to induce the holy river to descend

by the Mahatma Kapila of Ullimaginable glory. O Wise One, it is not meet to offer the usual rites for them. O Great One, perform the rites with the water of the boly river Gwiga, the Daughter of Himalaya. When the waters of tbe purifier of the world, the sacred Gunga ftow over their ashes, the ceremony will be crowned with success and tbe sixty thousand princes will be received into heaven'." The illustrious and mighty Prince Anshuman listened to the words of Sbri **GARUDA** and speedily returning with the borse, approached King Sagan, who still awaited the tompletion of the initiatory rites ; he related to him all that the eagle had said. The monarch tompleted the sacrifice and returned to his capital considering the means whereby he might cause Sbri Gunga to descend to earth ; but in vain. King Sagan, unable to devise any way to accomplish this matter, having ruled for thirty thousand years, departed hence. CHAPTEK 4Z Aruhumtzn' s son, Dilipa,fails and his son

Bhagiratha peyforms austerities to induu the holy mer to descend .AFTEa his death, the ministers installed the virtuous Anshuman as king. O **RAMA**, glorious was the reign of K.iog Anshuman. He was succeeded by his son, the world-renowoed Dilipa. King Anshuman, leaving his kingdom to Dilipa, retired to the top of a Himalayan peak and began to perform severe yogic austerities. Having passed thirty-two thousand years in this wise, without inducing the sacred river Guogs to descend on earth, he gave up his life. Acquainted with the filte of his great uncles, and overcome with grief. the mighty sovereign Dilipa found no means of bringing the sacred stream down to earth. Consumed with ansiety, he reftected daily on how he should accomplish the descent of the Gunga and perform the funeral rites for the deliverance of the souls of his ancestors. The righteous and illustrious King Dilipa, constantly engaged in these reflections, was then blessed with the birth of a virtuous son, Bbagiratha. The renowned monarch Dilipa observing many sacrifices, ruled over his kingdom for rhirty thousand years ; his thoughts were ever devoted to the deliverance of the souls nf his forbears until stricken with disease, he was claimed by desth. Having bequeathed the kingdom to his son Bbagiratba, his spirit ascended to the region of **INDRA**. O **RAMA**, Bhagiratba was a virtuous and royal sage, but he had no heir and was desirous of obtaining a son. O Raghava, he entrusted the administration nf his kingdom to his ministers and proceeded to the holy place named Gokarna where he practised yogic penances to attract the descent of the holy Gunga. With arms uplifted and senses controlled, he stood in the midst of five fires in the hottest season, partaking of food once a month only, and continued thus for a thousand years. O Mighty Prince, after a thousand years, Shri **BRAHMA**, the Lord and Ruler of the wnrld, was pleased with Bhagiratba and, accompanied by the *devas*, approached the high-souled king and said: "

O Bhagiratba, thy virtuous yogic practices have elicited our admiration ; ask for a boon, O Fortunate One.” The highly resplendent Bhagiratha, with joined palms submissively addressed Shri **BRAHMA**, saying : " O Bleased Lord, if thou art pleased to confer the fruits nf mine austerities on me and grant me a boon, then allow me to deliver the souls of able to sustain bcr ; none but the Lord **SHIVA** can accomplish this!' Having uttered these words to King Bhagiratha and having spoken to Shri GuDga also, Shri Bmhma returned with the gods to his own region. CHAPTBR 43 Lord Shi’D4 lets loose the saered ri,.,. rJJhich follMDs JUne Bhagirat’lul’s celsstial cluiriot SHRI lhtAHMA having departed, the King Bhagiratha, standing on the tip of one toe, adored Shri Sbiva for a full year. O Mighty One, with arms uplifted, living on air, unsupported, fixed like a piiiar, day and night King Bhagiratha offered his adorations to the Lord. A full year having passed, the Lord of Uma, Shri Mahadeva, who is adored by the whole world, spoke to King Bhagiratha as follows : " O Great One, I am pleased with thee, I will accomplish what thou desirest, I will receive the descent of Gunga on my head.” Then the holy Gunga, the eldest daughter of Himalaya, the object of reverence to the whole world, assuming the form of a mighty river, descended with torrential force on to the head of Sbiva. The goddess re1bted within herself that she would bear down the Lord Mahadeva to the antipodes. Shri Sbiva, reading her thoughts, grew angry and determined to detain the

CHAPTER 43

Lord Shiva lets loose the sacred river which follows King Bhagiratha's celestial chariot

able to sustain bcr ; none but the Lord **SHIVA** can accomplish this!' Having uttered these words to King Bhagiratha and having spoken to Shri GuDga also, Shri Bmhma returned with the gods to his own region. CHAPTBR 43 Lord Shi'D4 lets loose the saered ri,.,. rJJhich follMDs JUne Bhagirat'lul's celsstial cluiriot SHRI lhtAHMA having departed, the King Bhagiratha, standing on the tip of one toe, adored Shri Sbiva for a full year. O Mighty One, with arms uplifted, living on air, unsupported, fixed like a piiiar, day and night King Bhagiratha offered his adorations to the Lord. A full year having passed, the Lord of Uma, Shri Mahadeva, who is adored by the whole world, spoke to King Bhagiratha as follows : " O Great One, I am pleased with thee, I will accomplish what thou desirest, I will receive the descent of Gunga on my head." Then the holy Gunga, the eldest daughter of Himalaya, the object of reverence to the whole world, assuming the form of a mighty river, descended with torrential force on to the head of Sbiva. The goddess re1bted within herself that she would bear down the Lord Mahadeva to the antipodes. Shri Sbiva, reading her thoughts, grew angry and determined to detain the IIALA *KANDA* and as it fell it divided itself into seven streams. The three branches conferring prosperity, Hladini, Pavani and Nalini, flowed towards the east from the hesd of holy **SHIVA**. Then the saaed Gunga of pure and delightful water was divided into three further branches, Suchakshu, **SITA** and Sindhav, all flowing towards the west. The seventh of these streams followed the chariot of the Maharajah Bhagiratha. The rnyal sage, riding in a beautiful chariot, went forward and the sacred river Gunga followed him. Thus did the holy river descend from heaven on to the forehead nf Shri Mahadeva and from thence came to the surface of the eatth. The fall nf the saaed sueam =ated a mighty reverberation, her waters flowing through beautiful ways. Riding their aerial chariots as large as cities,

containing elephants and horses, the gods, sages, celestial musicians, yakshas and siddhas in great numbers, came to wimess the holy Ganges falling from heaven to earth. In their aerial chariots named Pariplava, the gods came to see this wonderful event of the holy river ftowing on the earth, and as they descended from the skies, the splendour nf their celestial ornaments irradiated the cloudless canopy nf heaven as if a thousand suns had risen there. The mercurial fishes and aquatic creatures leaping from the sueam thrown up by the force nfthe current, shone like lighming in the sky, whilst the foam and spray scattered on all sides resembled ftocb of swans in ftight or clouds in winter. The waters of the holy Gunga snmetimes rose high in the air, sometimes ftowed tortuously, sometimes broadened out, some times dashed against the rocks and sometimes spouted upwards afterwards falling to the ground ; that pure water cspable nf removingsinlookld delightful flowing on the surface of the earth. Then the celestial sages and heavenly musicians and the denizens nf the earth, reverently touched that sacred sueam falling from the lncks of **SHIVA**. Those beings, who through a curse, had fallen from the heavenly regions and been made to dwell on earth, were cleansed of their uansgressions by bathing in the holy Gunga. Purlfted and freed from their sins, those resplendent beings teturned to the heavenly reginns, passing through the sky. 87 Wherevez the sacred Ganges flowed, people were cleansed of their sins by bathing in its waters. King Bbagiratha, riding a celestial ebariot, drove on and Sbri Gunga followed after bim. O **RAMA**, the gods, the sages, *rakshasas*, *asuras*, yakshas, the chief serpents and nymphs following King Bhagiratha, together with the aquatic beings and swans, attended the sacred river. Whichever course King Bhagiratha took, that mighty river Gungs, the Destroyer of all sin, followed. Flowing on and on, Sbri Gunga arrived where the Sage Jahnu, worker of miracles, was

performing a sacrifice. Then the sacred river swept over the sacrificial pavilion and all it contained. The *Rishi* Jahnu perceiving the pride of Gungaji, grew angry and drank up the whole of the water of that river, verily a grcst miracle! The dcvas, gandharvas and sages were astonished and began to worship that Mahatma Jahnu, saying, " From to-day the holy river shall be called thy daughter". The mighty Jahnu being plcssed, let loose the river through his csrs. From thence Shri Gunga is called Jahnavi (*the daughter ofJahnu*). Thereafter sbe once again flowed behind the chariot of King Bhagiratha. Finally, the holy Gunga reached the sea and entered the lower regions to fuJfiJ the purpose of the king. The royal Sage Bbagiratha attended by the sacred river, gazed with grief on the ashes of his ancestors. O Prince of the House of Raghu, as soon as the holy stream touched the ashes, the sons of King Sagara were resuscitated, freed from sin, and attained the celestiaJ region.

CHAPTER 44

King Bhagiratha completes the funeral rites for his ancestors

WHEN the king attended by the holy Gunga, rcschcd the seashore, he entered the subterranean region where the sons of King Sagara had been burnt to ashes. 88 " O **RAMA**, as the holy water flowed over the ashes, Shri **BRAHMA** the Lord of all the worlds, addressed King Bhagintha as follows : ' O Great King, thou hast redeemed the sixty thousand sons of King Sagara, who now dwell in the heavenly region. O King, as long as the waters of the sea continue on earth, so long shall the sons of King Sagara in celestial form enjoy heaven. Henceforth, O Great Sovereign, Shri Gunga shall be thy eldest daughter and be known by thy name

throughout the earth. This sacred river shall be named Shri Gunga, Tripathaga' and Bhagirathi. " ' O King, perform the funeral rites of thine ancestors and fulfil thy prescribed duty. The mighty King Sagara was not able to accomplish this purpose and King Anshuman of limitless prowess also failed to obtain the fulfilment of his devout desire. Thy father Dilipa, equal to ourselves in merit and a warrior fully established in the duties of his caste, that illustrious Dilipa besought the holy Gunga to descend to earth in vain. This great design has been accomplished by thee alone. Thou hast acquired undying renown throughout the world. " ' By achieving this, thou art possessed of the highest *dharma*. O Great Sovereign, now do thou bathe in the holy stream also. O Lion among men, purify thyself and acquire merit, then perform the fimerai rites of thine ancestors. O King, may prosperity attend thee, retutn to thy capital, I shall now ascend to my own abode.' " The mighty and illustrious **BRAHMA** then ascended to heaven and the royal Sage Bhagiratha, having performed the obsequies of the sons of King Sagara, with the water of the sacred Ganges, rctutned to his capital. " Enjoying every felicity, King Bbagintha began to govern once more and his people rejoiced that be had again assumed rulcrsbip. All were freed from suffering and anxiety and they increased in wealth and prosperity. " O **RAMA**, I have narrated the story of the descent of Shri Gunga fuiiy to thee. May prosperity attend thee I Dusk has fallen and the hour of the evening prayer has come. This story gives wealth, prosperity, fame, longevity, sons, and residence in heaven to the reader. He who causes it to be heard by others whether he be a *brahmin* or a bhauiya, brings joy to his ancestors and the gods. " O ltsmachandta, he who with fixed attcotion listcos to this story, shall obtain all he desires, his sins will be remitted and he will obtain long life and renown." CHAPTER 4S Vishrllamitra begim to relate tlu story of tlu city of VisluJ/a and tlu

churnittt: of tlu ocean, fJJhich leads

CHAPTER 45

Vishwamitra begins to relate the story of the city of Vishala and the churning of the ocean, which leads to the combat between the Devas and the Titans

in heaven to the reader. He who causes it to be heard by others whether he be a *brahmin* or a bhauiya, brings joy to his ancestors and the gods. " O ltsmachandta, he who with fixed attcotion listcos to this story, shall obtain all he desires, his sins will be remitted and he will obtain long life and renown." CHAPTER 4S Vishrllamitra begim to relate tlu story of tlu city of VisluJ/a and tlu churnittt: of tlu ocean, fJJhich leads humbly made enquiry concerning the city. **HE** *said*: " O Great Sage. what roysl and illustrious house rules here ? I desire to hesr." At these words of **RAMA**, the holy sage began to relate the story of the city as follows : " O **RAMA**, attend! I will tell thee the story of this city, which I hesrd from lndra. "In the golden age (*Satya Yuga*) Ditigave birth to a powerful son Daitya, an *asura*, and Aditi' gave binh to the highly fonunate and exceedingly righteous son Devata, a celestial being. These two sagacious beings sought to become immortal, incorruptible and free from disease, old age and other ills. After reftecting on this matter, they resolved to churn Ksbiroda (*the ocean of milk*) and obtain from it the water of inunortality. Using the mighty snake Vasuki as a rope and the Mandara mountain as the churn, they began to chum the ocean. When they had done so for a thousand years, the snake Vasuki bit the rocks with its teeth and threw up venom. From this was produced the great poison which began to consume men, gods, demons and the whole

world. " The gods took refuge with the Lord **SHIVA** and worshipped him crying ' Protect us, protect us '. Attracted hy the moumful cry of the gods, Shri Mahadeva and Shri Hari' appeared there with conch and disc. " Shri **VISHNU**' smilingly addressed the bearer of the trident, Shri Mahadeva, and said : O Lord, thou an the chief of the gods and should'st, therefore, accept whatever is first produced hy the churning of the ocean. Receive the poison as thy gift, the first tribute.' " Having spoken thus, Shri **VISHNU** disappeared, and the Blessed Lord **SHIVA**, moved by the distress of the gods and the words of Shri VIShnu, drank the dreadful poison, as if it were nectar, and returned to Kailasha. " O Prince ofRaghu, the *devas* and the daityas began churning once more, but the churning sta1f began to sink. Then the *devas* and gandbarvas praised the Lord **VISHNU**, aaying : O tl THE B.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI Bles8ecl Lord, Thou art the Master of all beings, thou art the asylum of the gods-protect us all, O Grmt Lord, and support the sinking Mandara mountain.' " Shri **VISHNU**, assuming the form of a tortoise, entered the ocesn and supported the mountain on his back. Taking hold

CHAPTER 46

Diti undergoes severe austerities for the birth of a son

" **O** RAMA, learniDg that her children had been slain, Diti was much atllicted and approached her husband Kasyapa with the words : ' O Lord, by thy powetful sons, am I bereft of my children. I desire a son who will be able to destroy Indta, though to this end I must undergo great penance. Such austerities I will perform, if thou wilt grant me a son that is mighty, valorous, strong-willed and firm of purpose.' " The holy sage

answered the afllicted Diti saying : ' Be it so ! Remain chaste for a thousand years, thou shalt then bear a son capable of destroying Indta. By my grace, thy child shall be the ruler of the three worlds.' " Thus did the sage console Diti, and blessing her, departed to practise penance. Diti retired contentedly to the forest of Kushaplava and began to undergo severe austerities. " **INDRA** then, coming there, paid reverence to her and began to serve her with humility, supplying her with fire, kusha grass and other necessities, massaging her body when she became weak from the severity of ascetic practices. O **RAMA**, lndra served Diti for a thousand years less ten days. " Then Diti joyfully addressed lndra saying : ' O lndra, thy father has promised to grant me a son after a thousand years penance. Thou shalt soon behold thy brother, whom I desire shall overcome thee. With him thou shalt share the three worlds and be happy, have no IUIXiety.' " By this time the afternoon had come. Diti overcome with sleep, placing her feet where her head had lain, carelessly assumed an impure posture. " **INDRA** rejoiced and laughed aloud. Entering her body, he cut the fbetus into seven pieces with his great mace. Diti’s slumber was interrUpted by the cry of the child in her womb. x—evodic: . Inclra said to it ' Do not weep’, 'Do not weep ', and again divided the child with his mace, despite Diti’s cries, 'Do not destroy it, do not destroy it '. " Then **INDRA** pansed in his murderous assault and with humility addressed Diti saying ' O Diti, thou wast impure through sleeping with thy feet towards the head of the couch, thou clid’st thus occupy an imptopet posture. I have, thetefore, severed thine unborn child into seven parts, since he was to be the cause of my destruction. O Devi, pardon me '.”

CHAPTER 47

The holy sage and the princes arrive at Vishala and are welcomed by King Pramati

gready petturhed and said to **INDRA** : " Thtongh my fault has this come to pass; O **INDRA**, thou att in no wise guilty. This child being divided, for thy good and mine own, I declare that these seven shall become the protectors of the forty-nine winds. These seven sons of divine appearance shall be known as the BaJa-*kanda* winds. Let one wander about in the region of **BRAHMA**, anothet in the region of **INDRA**, and the third in space. Let the remaining four winds go anywhere undet thy instructions ; may they all be known by the name of Maruts, confetred on them by thee." With joined palms, the thousand-eyed god **INDRA** said in reply to Diti : " O Devi, it will assuredly come to pass as thou deaireth. Thy sons shall wandet about in the form of dcvas in the Tapovana forest." Thus reconciled and fully satisfied the mothet and son ascended to heaven. Thus have I heard, O **RAMA** I This is that Tapovana fOrest in which **INDRA** formerly served his mothet Diti. O IJon among Men, here a great city was founded by the righteous Prince Viahala, the son of King Ibwaku and Alambusa. !14 O **RAMA**, the mighty son of Vishala was named Hemachandra, and his son was the renowned Sucbandra. O **RAMA**, the son of Sucbandra was Dhumrashwa and his son was Srinjaya. The glorious Sabadeva was the son of Srinjaya and the son of Sabadeva was the highly vinuous Krisbashwa. The son of Krisbashwa was Somadatta and his son was Kakusrba. The most illustrious and invincible of warriors King Pramati the son of Kakustba, is the present ruler of Visbala. By the grace of King Ikswaku all the

rulers of Visbala are long lived, virtuous and mighty. O **RAMA**, let us pass the night here, and to-morrow we will wait upon King **JANAKA**. When the powerful King Pramati heard of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**'s arrival in his kingdom, he went with his spiritual preceptor and relatives to welcome him. With joined palms, they offered him due worship and enquired as to his welfare. The king said : " O *Muni*, to-day I am indeed fortunate rbat thou bast been gracious enough to visit my kingdom. None is more blessed rban I."

CHAPTER 48

They come to Gautama's hermitage and Vishwamitra relates its story

KING PRAMAn having enquired as to the well-being of Shti **VISHWAMITRA**, said : " O Holy Sage, may the Lord protect those two youths ; be gracious enough to tell me who they may be. These princes, equal to the gods in power, walking with the gait of an elephant, fearless as lions or bulls in combat, whose eyes resemble lotuSes, who are armed with swords, bows and quivers, who rival the heavenly Aswins' in beauty and who, in the flower of their yoatb, appear like gods, visiting the earth. Why ue they uavdling on foot ? Whose ue they ? Why ue they come ? Enhancing the earth as the sun and moon illumine the sky ; their manner of address and bearing showing them to be kinsmen, why ue these two heroes of high descent, bearing mighty weapons, found on this hatd path ? I long to hear." Sbri **VISHWAMITRA** related to the king the whole story of the visit to the Siddha Asbrama and the slaying of the unraa. The king was highly gratified to meet the princes, and perceiving them to be virtuous, entertained them with the greatest respect. Sbri

RAMACHANDRA and **LAKSHMANA** having received hospitality from King Pramati, pused the night there. The following day they left for Mithilapuri, the capital of King **JANAKA**. When they beheld the city at a distance, they cried out : " How beautiful, how beautiful it is ! " Thereafter, finding a charming hermitage which was uninhabited, **RAMA** enquired of the *Rishi* **VISHWAMITRA** u foUowa : " O Sage, how can it be that this beautiful hermitage is unfrequented ? O Lord, teD ns whose hu been this hermitage ? " Sbri **VISHWAMITRA**, chief among the eloquent, answered **RAMA**, saying : " O Prince, hear the true story of this hermitage, I will relate to thee who was its author and how he cursed it in anger. " O **RAMA**, this place, a source of wonder even to the gods, belonged to the *Rishi* Gautama and resembled the abode of the celestials. Here with Ahalya. the sage practised *Yoga* for thousands of yeats. " O **RAMA**, one day, the sage having gone to a distant place, **INDRA**, finding Ahalya alone, usumed his form, and said to her : ' O Fair One, I am overcome by desire, let us carry out onr conjugal duty.' " O Raghava, though Ahalya recognized **INDRA** disguiaed u her lord, yet she acceded to his request. Then Ahalya addressed **INDRA** aaying : ' O **INDRA**, I am highly gratified, now depart quickly, unobserved. O Chief of the gods, preserve me and thyaelf fiom Gautama.' " **INDRA** laughed and answered : ' O Thou of beautiful waist, !J6 to-day I rejoice, I will now depart for my own region.' On this, he sought to leave the hut of Ahalya. " O **RAMA**, at that instant he observed the *Rishi* Gautama entering the hut and he became agitated and anxious. Seeing the holy sage unconquered by *devas* or dauavas, eodowcd with the power of *Yoga*, drenched with holy water, shining like fire, holding the sacred fuel and kusha grass in his hands, **INDRA** was terrified and grew pale. " Shri Gautama perceiving **INDRA** in his own guise and judging by his guilty looks that he was leaving his spouse having committed ain with her, cuned him

saying : " ' O Wicked Wretch, assuming my form, thou hast committed this sinful act. Be thou impotent.' Cursed by the *Rishi* Gautama, **INDRA** was instantly deprived of his manhood. Then the Sage Gautama cuned Ahalya also saying : Thou shalt remain immovable in this place for thousands of years, thy food the wiod alone. Thou shalt be as dust, invisible to all creatureS. When **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA** visits this forest, then shalt thou be cleansed from thy sin. Haviog served him, O Deluded One without desire for personal gain, thou shalt be restored to me in thy present body.' " Thus did the illustrious Gautama cunc the wicked Ahalya and, abandoning the hermitage, began his yogic penances, on the beautiful peak of Himalaya, inhabited by siddhss."

CHAPTER 49

Shri Rama liberates Ahalya from Gautama's curse and departs for Mithila

DBnmD nf his virility, **INDRA** grew melancholy, and Eddresaing **AGNI** and the other gods, said : " By obstructing the ascetic practices nf the Mahatma Gautama, who sought to usurp my power, I have verily served the purpose nf the gods. Evoking his wrath, by causing him to cunc me and denounce Ahalya. 97 I bave robbed the *rishi* ofhis spiritual power, therefore, O *Devas*, O Divine Beings, help me now to recover my msnbood.” Then the gods with **AGNI** at their hcsd, approached the pittris, kavyavabanas and other beings and said to them : " **INDRA** bas been deprived of his virility ; this ram of yours is in full possession of its powers, allow us to graft the testicles of the ram on to **INDRA**, we can compensate the ram in this wise-from to-day, let those who desire to propitiate you, offer the sacrifice of a castrated ram and receive the

reward of great merit at your bands." The pittris did as requested by **AGNI** and grafted the testicles of the ram on to **INDRA**. From tbat time, O **RAMA**, they bave accepted the sacrifice of a gelded ram. This event proves the immeasurable power of the practices of the holy sage. Now let us enter his hermitage. O **RAMA**, do thou liberate the unfortunate Abalya, so tbat she msy once more resume her nymph-like form." Shri Rams accepted the command and entered the hermitage, preceded by the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**. There they beheld Abalya, by virtue of her yogic practices. Unperceived by *devas*, *asuras* or men, it seemed as if Brahms bad created her with his own bands as a great mistress of occult powers. Resembling the full moon veiled in mist or the rellection of the sun in water or a bright fire wreathed in smoke, by the curse of the *Rishi* Gautams she rcmsined invisible and thus it was ordained she should remain till she bchcld Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and till that hour, none in the three worlds should look on her. With the deepest reverence did **SHRI RAMA** and Lakshmsna touch the feet of Abalya and she, remembering the words of the *Rishi* Gautams fell down in devotion before them. There after, she entertained them with dne hospitality, as enjoined in the scriptures, while the two princes acknowledged the honour paid to them. At this moment a rain of flowers fell from the sky, scattered by the gods ; heavenly musicians sang and celestial nympha danced whilst all rejoiced and paid homse to Abalya. The illustrious Sage Gautams becoming aware of the msttcr through his divine powers, repaired to the hermitage and rejoiced to behold Abalya restored to her former state. Re-united, they 98 both worshipped the glorious **RAMA** and then resumed their spiritual life together. **SHRI RAMA**, having accepted the homage offered to him, departed thence for Mithila.

CHAPTER 50

They are welcomed at the place of sacrifice by King Janaka

Beholding the sacrificial pavilion, they said to the holy sage : " How well has the great **JANAKA** prepared for the sacrifice! O August *Rishi*, thousands of brahrnins learned in the Vedas, from many lands, with hundreds of bullock transporting their possessions, can be seen here. O Holy Father, let us choose a place where thou mayest rest/ The Sage thereupon selected a place which was secluded and supplied with water. Hearing of the arrival of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, King J anaka, accompanied by his illustrious priest, Shri Shatananda, and many others, hastened to that place and humbly offered obeisance to the holy sage. Then the king placed the traditional gifts of water sweetened with honey' before him and he, accepting the gifts, enquired as to the king's welfare and further whether the sacrifice was proceeding without hindrance ; he then duly inquired concerning the welfare of Shri Shatananda and other holy men in attendance on their sovereign. The king received all with a cheerful countenance and with joined palms said to Shri **VISHWAMITRA** : " O August Lord, please be seated with the other great sages." Thus requested, they sat down, after which **JANAKA** with his family priest, *brahmins* and counsellors occupied their places, the king seated in the midst of his ministers. Having attended to tbe due placing ofhis guests, tbe illustrious sovercign said : " O Lord, to-day, by the grace of the gods, an the for the sacrifice have been carried out, by thine advent here I have acquired merit equal to the fruit of my sacrifice. Blessed am I that thou hast honoured the place of sacrifice with thy

prescoce. O Divine Sage, the high priests have informed me that tbe sacrifice will be completed io the course of twelve dsys, the gods will then come to take their shate ; Thou, O Dlustrious Lord, shalt behold them.” Having thus addressed tbe sage, the king again earnestly eoquired of him, saying : " May prosperity attend thee I O Sage, who are these two illustrious princes, equalliog the gods io power, whose bearing resembles the majesty of an elephant, or a lion, who are valiaot and whose eyes are like loruses, who are armed with swords, bows and quivers and whose beauty rivals tbe Aswioi-Kumara, who are youthful and appear to have desceoded from heaveo to earth like tbe gods ? Have they come here oo foot ? Whose sons are they ? They, whose eyes are wide set and who are armed with sacred weapons, who wear their hair like Karttikeys’ and who captivate tbe hearts of meo by their magnanimous and virtuous qualities ? Surely they are come hither to exalt our hearts and add to the fame of our dynasty ? Adoruiog tbe earth as the suo or moon adorn the sky, io stature and bearing resembliog each other, O Great Sage, whose soos are they ? Please tell me an I " Heariog tbe words of King Jaoab, **SHRI VISHWAMITRA** *said*: " These are the sons of King **DASARATHA**.” He then told the king of their resideoce io tbe Siddha-Asrama and of the slaying of tbe demons, of their visit to Vishala and the rescue of Ahalya, also of their meeting with the Sage CHAPTER S Gautams’s son, Shatanatula, relates more of the story uf the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** heard the words of the wise Vishwamitta, Shri Shat ananda, the eldest son of the Sage Gautama, resplendent by virtue of his practice of *Yoga*, was filled with wonder and delight and, beholding **SHRI RAMA** was astonished. Seeing the two princes sitting at their ease, Shri Shatananda said to the Sage Vishwamitta: " O Holy Sage, was my mother, so long involved in the practice of austerity, shown by thee to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** ? O Illustrious One, did my

mother enter tain these two heroes WOithy of adoration with fruits and those things she was able to obtain in the hermitage ? " O Holy *Rishi*, didst thou relate the story of the improper behaviour of **INDRA** to my mother in bygone days, to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** ? O Holy One, by virtue of the advent of **SHRI RAMA**, did my mother obtain my father's favour once more ? O Kaushika, did my father duly honour **SHRI RAMA** chandra and is this Illustrious One, having received the hospitaliry of my parents, really come hither ? O Holy Sage, please tell me ; when my tranquil-minded sire entered the hermitage, was he honoured by **SHRI RAMA** ? " Shri Vishwamitta, skilled in the art of converse and acquainted with the laws of rhetoric, answered Shri Shatananda saying : " O Great *Muni*, I did that which should be done, by speaking that which was proper to the occasiou, and patiently listening to that which was spoken, recollecting my duty. As Jamadagni, who first cursed Renuka and was then reconciled to her, so has thy father shown favour to thy mother and received her again." Hearing the words of Shri Vishwamitta, the great Shatananda addressed Shri Ramachandn, saying : " O Great One, may

CHAPTER 51

Gautama's son Shatananda relates more of the story of the Sage Vishwamitra

CHAPTER S Gautams's son, Shatanatula, relates more of the story uf the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** heard the words of the wise Vishwamitta, Shri Shat ananda, the eldest son of the Sage Gautama, resplendent by virtue of his practice of *Yoga*, was filled with wonder and delight and, beholding **SHRI RAMA** was astonished. Seeing the two princes sitting at

their ease, Shri Shatananda said to the Sage Vishwamitta: " O Holy Sage, was my mother, so long involved in the practice of austerity, shown by thee to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** ? O Illustrious One, did my mother enter tain these two heroes WOithy of adoration with fruits and those things she was able to obtain in the hermitage ? " O Holy *Rishi*, didst thou relate the story of the improper behaviour of **INDRA** to my mother in bygone days, to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** ? O Holy One, by virtue of the advent of **SHRI RAMA**, did my mother obtain my father's favour once more ? O Kaushika, did my father duly honour **SHRI RAMA** chandra and is this Illustrious One, having received the hospitaliry of my parents, really come hither ? O Holy Sage, please tell me ; when my tranquil-minded sire entered the hermitage, was he honoured by **SHRI RAMA** ? " Shri Vishwamitta, skilled in the art of converse and acquainted with the laws of rhetoric, answered Shri Shatananda saying : " O Great *Muni*, I did that which should be done, by speaking that which was proper to the occasiou, and patiently listening to that which was spoken, recollecting my duty. As Jamadagni, who first cursed Renuka and was then reconciled to her, so has thy father shown favour to thy mother and received her again." Hearing the words of Shri Vishwamitta, the great Shatananda addressed Shri Ramachandn, saying : " O Great One, may ' holy practices he bas become a brahmarishi' though previously a royal sage. Among brahmarishis he is unique, he is known to me as one who is ever concerned with the good of all. **RAMA**, none is equal to thee on earth, since thou art protected by so a sage as VIBhwamilra. Hear while I relate the story of the Kaushib' to thee: .. In the past, this holy sage was a virtuous monarch, versed in all branches of learning, delighting in the welfare of his subjects and the destroyer of his foes. " Kusha, the righteous and powerful king, was the son of Prajapsti, and his son was Gadhi, and the great and illustrious Sage

VISHWAMITRA is the son of Gadhi. “On ascending the throne, King **VISHWAMITRA** ruled the earth for many thousands of years. At a certain time, King Vish wamitra, assembling his army, set out to range the earth. O **RAMA**, he passed through many cities and kingdoms and crossed innumerable rivers, mountains and forests, visiting many hermitages till he came to the one belonging to Shri **VASISHTHA**. This hermitage was thickly planted with many-branched trees with dense folisge in which birds of every kind dwelt. Many species of beasts frequented that place, and the siddbas also " Many retired householders pmctising *Yoga*, dwelt there with their wives. Verily that hermitage resembled the abode of Brabma, and the and powerful King **VISHWAMITRA** rejoiced to behold it.” CHAPTER S:Z

CHAPTER 52

How King Vishwamitra visits Vasishtha's hermitage and accepts hospitality provided by the wish-fulfilling cow, Shabata

" **M**any retired householders pmctising *Yoga*, dwelt there with their wives. Verily that hermitage resembled the abode of Brabma, and the and powerful King **VISHWAMITRA** rejoiced to behold it.” CHAPTER S:Z the ancient ttaditions to each othet, they thus promoted their mutual de6ght. O Prince of the House of Raghu, when King **VISHWAMITRA** paused, Shri **VASISHTHA** said to him smilingly : " O King, although thou hast with thee a large rctiouc, yet it is my desire to offer thee hospitality, together with thine army. Be pleased to accept it. Since thou art a distinguished guest, it is meet that I should do aU within my power to entertain thee, therefore, be gtacious enough to receive the little I have

to offer.” **KING VISHWAMITRA** *answered*: " O Lord, thy gentle and pleasing words arc sufficient entertainment. Moreover, thou hast already presented me with fruits and the clear water of thy hcrmitsge. By mcctiog with thee alone, am I sufficiently honoured. O Supremely Wise One, it was proper that I should o1fer obeisance to thee ; now thou hast entertained me, allow me to offer thee salutations and depart.” The great sage declined to accept the king’s refusal of his o1fer, and still insisted that he should entertain him. **THEN VISHWAMITRA** *said*: " Be it according to thy pleasure, my Lord, I will do as thou desirest.” At these words, Shri **VASISHTHA** sent for his favourite spotted cow Kamadhenu and said to her : " O Shabala, draw ncar and listen to me, I desire to o1fer hospitality to the king and his army. O Dear One, thou art the wish-ful1illing cow and can accomplish anything, therefore, now prepare splendid dishes which will be pleasing to them, of the six kinds of taste.' Produce speedily whatever food can be eaten, drunk, licked or sucked.”

CHAPTER 53

The king desires to possess Shabala but Vasishtha win not give her up

THE cow Shabala provided for the needs of aU according to the instruction of Shri **VASISHTHA**. Sugar cane, sweets of varions kinds, honey, crushed harley, wine and other excellent drinks, 1bc. nlt, hot rice in heaps as high as mounwns, milk, curry and other fare combining the six tastes and countless other dishes with sweets made of jagari’ were distributed. Each was wholly satisfied and delighted with the hospitality of Shri **VASISHTHA**, who accorded to all the companions and retainers

of King **VISHWAMITRA** the fuJI extent of their desires. The king with his family priests, ministers and attendants, partaking of the feast o1Fered with generosity and respect by the great sage, was highly gratified. When all the counscllors and personal attendants and the army had received fuJI hospitality, the king, wholly satisfied, said to Shri **VASISHTHA**: “O Holy Sage, thou hast cntettained me royally, please hear what I have to say O Eloquent One! O Lord, give me the cow Shabala in exchange for a hundted thousand excellcnt cows. Shabala is a jewel and by a king should jewels be cnjoyed-eccording to the natural law, this ttcasure should therefOre be mine.” Shri **VASISHTHA** answered, saying : " O King, I will not part with Shabala in exchange for ten million cows, still less for a hundred thousand. If thou did’st offer me mountains of silver yet would I refuse to give thee Shabala for she must remain in my hermitage. " O King, as a righteous man cares for his good name, so do I for Shabala. She helps me to satisfy the *devas*, the pittris and other beings. My sacred fire sacrifice and other Vedic rites, besides the various branchea of learning depend on Shabala. O Great Ruler, indeed I relinquish this cow, she is my all and she fWlils all my needs-for these and numerous other reasons do I refuse to yield the cow to thee. O King, verily I will not part with Shabala.” The words of Shri **VASISHTHA** merely increased the king’s desire and he, under great emotion, declared with psssion : " O Grcst *Muni*, I will give thee fourteen thousand elephants adorned with golden trappings, ornaments and goads and, in addition, I will give thee a hundted and eight chariots made of solid gold, each driven by four milk white horses. At the same time, I offer thee eleven thousand well-trained honea, each with a golden harness and further ten million cows of J.,..._._... made-polm-varied colours, that are young and healthy. O give me Shabala, and I will give thee in achange as much gold as thou desirest. Grant me Shabala, I

implore thee, and accept my gifts, O Sage." Then the wise **VASISHTHA** *said*: " Under no condition can I part with Shabala, O King, sbe is my jewel and my wealth. She is my very life, my all-in-all, and she furnishes me with alms and all I require for sacrifice. In brief, O King, Shabala is the source of my spiritual life and I will never give her up."

CHAPTER 54

King Vishwamitra attempts to carry her away by force

O RAMA, perceiving that Shri **VASISHTHA** would not willingly consent to part with the cow, **VISHWAMITRA** resolved to carry her away by force. O Raghava, while Shabala was being forcibly carried off, distracted with grief, she began to reflect thus : " Why has the holy **VASISHTHA** abandoned me? In what way have I offended the holy sage ? Why are the servants of the king draggiog me away from the hermitage ? I am innocent and docile, the holy *muni* is dear to me ; what fault have I committed that the Mahatma **VASISHTHA** should abandon me ? " Sighing again and again, Shabala, shaking off the hands of the king's attendants, swiftly ran and placed her head at the feet Shabala, who was skilled in argument, listened to the words of Shri **VASISHTHA** and said : " O Holy Sage, the power of a warrior is as nought ampared to that of a holy sage. O Illustrious Lord, the strength of a sage is divine and based on the exercise of spiritual practices and discipline, it is therefore limitless ; thou art, O Lord, immeasurably stronger than a *kshatriya*. The power of that mighty king **VISHWAMITRA**, is great, but he cannot equal thy strength and splendour. O Lord, through thy strength and energy suffer me to destroy the power and pride of this wicked wretch." **SHRI**

VASISHTHA *answered*: " Be it so I Create an army by thy spiritual energy, that will destroy the forces of the king." Lowing loudly, Sbabsla, in obedience to the sage, instantly produced bundreds of foreign soldiers, who began to destroy the army of **VISHWAMITRA** while he was looking on. Perceiving his army about to be ovcrthtown, King **VISHWAMITRA** became enraged and, monnting his chariot, bis eyes red with anger, he advanced to the attack. With various weapons, he began to slay thousands of men, and Shabala, seeing the army created by her, annihilated, now produced sttan,se beings called shakas in such numbers, that they filled the whole earth. Highly valorous, their skins shiniog like gold, clad in yellow armour, furnished with scimitarS and maces, they started to consume the army of **VISHWAMITRA** like a raging fire. Then the great **VISHWAMITRA**, with the aid of yogic weapons, began to create disorder in the ranks of the forces produced by Sbabala. CHAPTER SS

CHAPTER 55

Shabala creates an army which annihilates Vishwamitra's force

Shabala, who was skilled in argument, listened to the words of Shri **VASISHTHA** and said : " O Holy Sage, the power of a warrior is as nought ampared to that of a holy sage. O Illustrious Lord, the strength of a sage is divine and based on the exercise of spiritual practices and discipline, it is therefore limitless ; thou art, O Lord, immeasurably stronger than a *kshatriya*. The power of that mighty king **VISHWAMITRA**, is great, but he cannot equal thy strength and splendour. O Lord, through thy strength and energy suffer me to destroy

the power and pride of this wicked wretch." **SHRI VASISHTHA** *answered*: " Be it so I Create an army by thy spiritual energy, that will destroy the forces of the king." Lowing loudly, Sbabsla, in obedience to the sage, instantly produced bundreds of foreign soldiers, who began to destroy the army of **VISHWAMITRA** while he was looking on. Perceiving his army about to be ovcrthtown, King **VISHWAMITRA** became enraged and, monnting his chariot, bis eyes red with anger, he advanced to the attack. With various weapons, he began to slay thousands of men, and Shabala, seeing the army created by her, annihilated, now produced sttan,se beings called shakas in such numbers, that they filled the whole earth. Highly valorous, their skins shiniog like gold, clad in yellow armour, furnished with scimitarS and maces, they started to consume the army of **VISHWAMITRA** like a raging fire. Then the great **VISHWAMITRA**, with the aid of yogic weapons, began to create disorder in the ranks of the forces produced by Sbabala. CHAPTER SS Sbabala, IowiDg loudly, produced well-armed soldiers from her feet and udders, and from her hair and thighs were born the extraordinary warriors Harita and Kirata. By these, the whole army of **VISHWAMITRA** consisting of elephants, horses and chariots, was instantly destroyed. Beholding their entire army exterminared by the power of Shri **VASISHTHA**, King Vishwami tra's hundred sons bearing mighty arms and with various thought-propelled weapons rushed angrily at the holy Sage Vasishtba. Shri Vasishtba merely uttered the sound" H'm I" and they were all immediately consumed. By the great Sage Vasishtba, the infimtry, cavalry and chariots, together with the sons of King **VISHWAMITRA**, were instantly burned to ashes. Then the illustrious monarch **VISHWAMITRA** whose sons and army had been annihilated, was filled with shame and dismay. Deprived of his glory, he resembled a waveless ocean or a snake bereft of its fangs or the sun

under eclipse. Like a bird without wings, his confidence shatrercd, his pride humbled, he became filled with anxiety. Bestowing the kingdom on his only remain ing son, he cxhorred him to rule according to *dharma* and then himself retired to the forest to practise asceticism. After some time, he found favour with Shri Mahadcva' the magnanimous granrer of boons, and he, appearing before **VISHWAMITRA**, addressed him saying : " O King, why art thou undergoing penance ? What is thy desire ? I will grant thee whatsoever thou asketh ? " Shri **VISHWAMITRA** making obeisance to Shri Mahadcva said to him : " O Great Gnd, if I have found favour with thee, then instruct me in the Upanishads and other branches of learning, reach me also the mysteries and the science of archery. Whatever weapons arc known to the danavas, yakshas, *asuras* and other beings, let them be rcvcalcd to me by thy grace." On bearing the request of the king, Shri **SHIVA** answered, " Be it so " and returned to his abode. King **VISHWAMITRA**, having acquired the various weapons from Mahadeva, became as happy as the sea at the time of the full moon. He now resolved to subdue the Sage Vasishtba and regarded him as his captive already. Proceeding to his hermitage he discharged his great weapons like rain, setting the forest ofTapovm ablaze. Alfticted by these dreadful weapons, all the sages began to ftee to the four quarters in terror; even the disciples of Shri **VASISHTHA**, together with innumerable birds and beasts, escaped hastily in every direction. The hermitage of Shri **VASISHTHA** hecame deserted and a deep silence fell upon it, causing it to resemble a barren field. Shri **VASISHTHA** repeatedly called out: "Fear not, fear not, I will destroy **VISHWAMITRA** as the sun dispels the morning mist." Then the great Sage **VASISHTHA**, foremost among those who practise silent prayer, angrily addressed **VISHWAMITRA** saying : " Thou hast destroyed my ancient and auspicious hermitage, O Wicked and Deluded Wretch, thou thyself shalt be destroyed."

Snatching up his staff equal to the rod of **YAMA**, he advanced like a naked flame.

CHAPTER 56

Shri Vasishtha by his spiritual strength conquers Vishwamitra who then engages in penances

tra raising the fire weapon, cried : " Stay I Beware ! " Then Shri **VASISHTHA**, lifting up his **BRAHMA** staff in wrath, exclaimed : " O Vilest of Warriors, here I stand, let loose all thy weapons, not excepting those propelled by thought which thou hast obtained from the Lord Sbiva. O Son of Gadbi, to-day I will deprive thee of all these weapons. How can thy power as a warrior compare with that of a divine sage ? O Stupid Wretch, behold my divine energy I " So saying, Shri **VASISHTHA** quenched the dangerous fire weapon hurled at him by **VISHWAMITRA** as water quenches fire. Then the son of Gsdhi let fty other dangerous weapons upon the holy sage, the **VARUNA**, the Rudra, the **INDRA**, the Pasbupata and Ishib weapons together with the Manava, Mohans, Gsndharva, Swapana, Jrimbhana, Viadans, Santapana, 109 and Vilapana ; the Shosbana, Darana and the terrible Vatra ; the **BRAHMA**-pasha and Kalapasha, the **VARUNA**-pasha and the priceless PiDaka and also the missiles Shusbka and Ardra, the Danda weapon and the Pisacha, the Krouncha and the *Dharma* discus, the Kala discus and the discus of **VISHNU**, also the weapon Vayuvya. Mathana and Haya-shira did he discharge upon the gteat sage with the two Shaktis, the Kankala, Mushala, Vidyadhara, Kala, the trident Kapala and the Kankana. All these did he hurl at the holy sage. Then Shri **VASISHTHA** accomplished a gteat marvel and by means ofhis staff alone destroyed all the weapons

ofVishwamitra. Seeing these weapons rendered ineffectual, **VISHWAMITRA** raised the *Brahman*-astra. At this, **AGNI**, the divine sages and the celestial beings were seized with terror and the three worlds shook with fear. But by means of his spiritual power and the study and practice of *Brahman*-Vidya, Shri **VASISHTHA** subdued the *Brahman*-astra. As Shri **VASISHTHA** consumed this tremen dous weapon, his charming and pleasing mien became terrible and from each pore of his body shafts of light shot forth while the staff of the holy sage, shining like fire, burst into ftame. All the sages now began to praise Shri **VASISHTHA**, saying : " Thy power is without equal and ever productive of good, by the power of thy *Yoga*, pacify the *Brahman*-astra. O Holy Sage, thou hast humbled the pride of Vuhwamitra. O Great Ascetic, be pacified, that we also may be delivered from fear." Thus addressed, Shri **VASISHTHA** assumed his accustomed mien and **VISHWAMITRA**, being defeated, sighing heavily, exclaimed : " Woe, woe to the might of a warrior I The real power is the spiritual power. Shri **VASISHTHA** by his spiritual strength has fully conquered mine. I will, therefore, abandon my warlike nature and seek to obtain brahmanhood." no

CHAPTER 57

Shri Vasishtha refuses to help King Trishanku enter heaven in his physical state

THE bean ofVishwamitra was heavy, remembering his disgrace, and he was filled with remorse at having borne enmity to Shri **VASISHTHA**. O **RAMA**, with his queen he went to the southern quarter and began his great ascetic penance there. Mter a long time four sons were born to him, each a devotee of truth, who were virtuous and of great militaty prowess.

Their names were Havisyanda, Madhusyanda, Drirha-netra and Maharatha. Having practised severe austerities for a thousand years, the Grandsire of the world, Shri **BRAHMA** appeared before Vishwami tra and said : " O Son of Kaushika, thou hast surpassed the royal sages in thy great asceticism, thou shalt, therefore, be numbered among them." Having thus spoken, Shri **BRAHMA** with the gods went to Brahmaloka. **VISHWAMITRA** was filled with shame and with bowed head, overcome with grief, thus spoke : "Alas I In spite of prolonged austerities, the gods still hold me to be a .royal sage.' I deem this state no reward for the penance I have undergone." O **RAMA**, with renewed resolve, **VISHWAMITRA**, pre-eminent in the field of endeavour began his life of mortification anew. At this time, the great King Trishanku of the House of Ikswaku, fully self-subdued and a lover of truth, resolved to initiate a sacrifice in order to enter heaven in his physical body. Summoning the holy Sage **VASISHTHA**, he communicated his intention to him, but the Mahatma **VASISHTHA**, having duly considered the matter, said : " O King, this cannot be." Discouraged by Shri **VASISHTHA** and for the purpose of fulfilling his design, the monarch went southwards to where the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** abode, leading lives of purity and ascetism. When King Trishanku beheld the sons of his own Guru, that great and illustrious sage, he was full of shame, and with bowed head offered salutation to them, addressing them in great humility saying, " O Protectors of those who seek refuge in you, I come to seek your aid. O Holy Ones, I besought your sire to assist me in the observance of a sacrifice and he discouraged me. I have, therefore, come to seek your help in the matter. O Sons of my Holy Guru, I offer salutations to you. Again and again, I bow down to you, O Holy Ones, and beseech you to officiate at the proposed sacrifice, which I desire to undertake for the fulfilment of my design, namely that I may ascend to heaven in my

embodied state. Discouraged by the holy teacher **VASISHTHA**, I considet that you alone are able to assist me. Should you refuse me, there is none in whom I may take refuge. The kings of the House of lkshwaku have always sought guidance of their spiritual preceptor in time of need, and the holy and learned Sage **VASISHTHA** has ever upheld the dynasty and, following him, you alone are my instructors ".

CHAPTER 58

The king apeals to Shri Vasishtha's sons to conduct the sacrifice. They curse him and he appeals to Vishwamitra

TM kin8 aJIPM/s tD Shri Vasishth4’11011$ to cotrd1111t the saerifoe. They him atullre app.als to VishrDamitra O RAM.!., hearing the words of the king, the hundred sons of Sbri **VASISHTHA** were filled with wrath and said : " O Thou Evil-minded Wretch, discouraged by thy spiritual preceptor, how dost thou dare to seek our aid ? O King, we know thee to be an ignorant man. Shri **VASISHTHA** is able to advance the sacrifices of the three worlds, verily thou art no true disciple of such a sage. Shall we render void the utterance of our great sire ? " Hearing these harsh words, the king replied : " Discouraged by my Guru and now by you, I shall seek elsewhere for aid ; may aU be well with you.” The sons of the great sage were enraged on heariDg these worda spoken in defiance, and cursed the Jdns, sayina : " Mayest na thou become one of the fallen caste.” Having thus cursed him, they returned to their hermitage. When the Dight was over, the king was transformed into a low-hom being. his complexion dark, his body emaciated, his head shaven, his whole frame besmeared with ashes from the crematorium, his golden ornaments

changed to lead. When the people of the capital beheld the king in this condition they fled from that place, and Trisbanku departed, full of anguish. Sunk in grief day and night, he finally sought refuge with Shri **VISHWAMITRA**. That sage sccing the monarch deprived of his kingdom and condemned to assume the form of a low-caste being, was moved with compassion, and addressed him saying : " O Mighty Prince, msyest thou be prosperous ! Why hast thou come hither? I know thee to be the Sovereign nf Ayodhya that through a curse art come to this state." The doquent King Trislw)kn, with joined palms, replied in tones of submission : " O Great One, discouraged by my Guru and his sons in my desire to enter heaven in the physical body, I have been transformed by them into a chandala.' Now, for shame, I msy not show myadf to any. O Lord, I have failed to obtain the fruit of countless sacrifices, an untruth has never been uttered by me, I have governed my people with righteous ness and by my conduct have satisfied my spiritual preceptor and holy men. I desired to undertake a further meritorious sacrifice, but O Great Sage, my Guru has withheld his aid. O Lord, destiny is irrevocable, destiny is inexorable, none can withatand it. All arc ruled by destiny. O Divine Sage, be favourable to me, who am fallen into distress ! Besides thee, there is none in whom I can take refuge. O Holy One, by thy spiritual energy, avert this evil fate." Cl2and8la-u ouu.t. 113 CHAPTI!R S9 Vislm!amitra seeks the help of the smu of V tuishtha Mahodefa ; they refuse are CW"sed SHRI VISHWAMITIIA heard the appeal of the fallen sovereign and in sweet accents spoke words of comfort, saying : " O King, thou an welcome, I know thee to be wholly virtuous, I will be thy refuge, fear not. I shaU invite hither the learned and pious brahmans who will assist thee in the performance of thy sacrifice. This thou shalt accomplish and obtain heaven in the form imposed on thee by thy Guru. O King, having taken refuge in me, consider thy purpose already

accomplished.” Having uttered these words, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** commanded his sons to prepare aU things for the sacrifice. Summoning his disciples, he said to them : " Bring hither the pious and learned *brahmins* and the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** also. May they come with their disciples, their friends, the learned and the priests. If any disregard my word, let it be reported to me.” In obedience to the sage, the disciples set out to every quaner, summoning the sages and learned men from many lands. Returning, they approached **VISHWAMITRA**, and said : " O Lord, at thy command the holy sages are coming hither, some are already come, Mahodeva excepted ; but the sons of holy **VASISHTHA**, transported with rage uttered harsh words of which we will tcU thee.” **THEY** *said*: " How shall divine sages panakc of that sacrifice undertaken by a chandala, at which a *kshatriya* officiates ? And how shall those *brahmins*, con strained by **VISHWAMITRA**, panaking of the food offered by a chandala, enter heaven ? " O Great Sage, these are the words of the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** . **VISHWAMITRA**, his eyes red with anger, answered : " Why should the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** disregard me, who am engaged in severe ascetic practices and without guilt ? By my power, these evil-minded men shaU this day be consumed to ashee and enter the abode of death. By my curse they shaU become

CHAPTER 59

Vishwamitra seeks the help of the sons of Vasishtha and Mahodeva; they refuse and are cursed

CHAPTI!R S9 Vislm!amitra seeks the help of the smu of V tuishtha Mahodefa ; they refuse are CW"sed SHRI VISHWAMITIIA heard the

appeal of the fallen sovereign and in sweet accents spoke words of comfort, saying : " O King, thou an welcome, I know thee to be wholly virtuous, I will be thy refuge, fear not. I shaU invite hither the learned and pious brahmans who will assist thee in the performance of thy sacrifice. This thou shalt accomplish and obtain heaven in the form imposed on thee by thy Guru. O King, having taken refuge in me, consider thy purpose already accomplished." Having uttered these words, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** commanded his sons to prepare aU things for the sacrifice. Summoning his disciples, he said to them : " Bring hither the pious and learned *brahmins* and the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** also. May they come with their disciples, their friends, the learned and the priests. If any disregard my word, let it be reported to me." In obedience to the sage, the disciples set out to every quaner, summoning the sages and learned men from many lands. Returning, they approached **VISHWAMITRA**, and said : " O Lord, at thy command the holy sages are coming hither, some are already come, Mahodeva excepted ; but the sons of holy **VASISHTHA**, transported with rage uttered harsh words of which we will tcU thee." **THEY** *said*: " How shall divine sages panakc of that sacrifice undertaken by a chandala, at which a *kshatriya* officiates ? And how shall those *brahmins*, con strained by **VISHWAMITRA**, panaking of the food offered by a chandala, enter heaven ? " O Great Sage, these are the words of the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** . **VISHWAMITRA**, his eyes red with anger, answered : " Why should the sons of Shri **VASISHTHA** disregard me, who am engaged in severe ascetic practices and without guilt ? By my power, these evil-minded men shaU this day be consumed to ashee and enter the abode of death. By my curse they shaU become 114 of those who subsist on the dead for a hundred incarnations. They shall eat the flesh of dogs and be called ' Musthika '. Despised by all, they shall wander about among men and

may the wicked Mahodeva also, having imputed blame to me, be born as a fowler, for a long time becoming the pitiless destroyer nf other's lives and by my wrath may he sink to a miserable and abject state." Sitting amid the sages, the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** having pro nounced this curse, became silent.

CHAPTER 60

Through fear of Vishwamitra, the sages assist in the sacrifice and King Trishanku ascends to a specially created heaven

his asceticism, **VISHWAMITRA**, seated amidst the sages, spoke: " The renowned monarch Trishanku of the dynasty of Ikshwaku, who is both magnanimous and virtuous, has taken refuge with me. He is desirous of entering heaven in his embodied state, it is for me to accomplish it. O Sages, do you unitedly assist him in this sacrifice., The sages hearing the words of **VISHWAMITRA** and being acquainted with the tradition, consulted together saying : " The son of Kaushika, the *Rishi* **VISHWAMITRA**, is given to wrath. If we do not fullil his desire, like a consuming fire he will pour out his curse upon us. Let us, therefore, assist him in the sacrifice so that the king may enter heaven in his physical body. Now let us inaugurate the rites., Then the rites begsn, as prescribed by ancient tradition, **VISHWAMITRA** acting as the chief priest and the learned *brahmins* becoming the sacrificing priests subordinate to him. Observing numerous ritusls, the sacrifice continued for a long time. Then Shri **VISHWAMITRA** called thither the gods for their share of the aacrifice, but none of these celestial beings appeared. At this us the great sage grew sceedingly wroth and lifting up the sacrificial vessel, aaid to

the King Triahanku : " O King, behold the power of my asceticism by virtue of which I now send thee to heaven ill thy embodied slate. O King, though it is deemed impossible to accomplish this, by the power acquired by me I now say to thee ; ascend to heaven in thy physical form.' " Having uttered these words, King Trishanku, in the presence of the sages instantly ascendcd to the hesvens. Seeing Trishanku there, Inclra and all the other gods exclaimed : " O Trishanku, thou hast no place in heaven. Cursed by thy Guru, O Stupid Wretch, do thou fiol1 headlong to the earth." Trishankn accordingly inslantly began to fiol1 towards the earth crying out to Shri Vishwamitta, " Protect me ", " Protect me". Shri Vishwamitta, hearing the cry, grew angry, and called out," Slay, Slay". At that moment, slanding amidst the sages, the great *rishi* resembled Prajapati. Thereafter he crested seven planets in the southern quarter called the Seven *Rishis*, and then he crested the Ashwini and twenty-seven other stars. Scsted amidst the sages, filled with wrath, Vishwamitts reflected in himself: " I will creste another Inclra or I willlcsve this heaven without an Inclra. Nay, I will mskc Trishanku Lord of this hcsven," and he began to creste a new circle of gods. Upon this, the sages, gods and celestial beings, bewildered and perturbed, approached Vishwamitts and aaid with humility : " O Great Sage, this king has been cursed by his spiritual preceptor and is not worthy of hesven." Shri Vishwamitta answered them, saying : " Hcsr, O ye Gods, I have vowed that this king shonld enter heaven in his embodied state, this pledge must be fulfilled. To this end, I have crested the Pole Slar and other planets and this hcsven will abide as long as the former hcsvcn endures, as also the gods crested by me, it becomes you, therefore, to confirm what I have promised." The gods in awe, having hcsrd these words, answered : " Be it so, O IDustrious *Rishi*, the heaven crested by thee shall endure beyond the Path of Vishwanara, and let

Trishanku, suspended head downwards, remain as if immorlal among these shinina: u6 stars. As the stars attend on famous and successful men, so let these brilliant luminaries, created by thee, attend on King Trishanku." Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, extoHed by the gods, acquiesced in their proposal. After this, O **RAMA**, the gods and the ascetics who bad attended the sacrifice, returned to their own regions.

CHAPTER 61

King Ambarisha's sacrificial horse is lost and he seeks a human victim

O RAMA, when Vishwaiuitra saw the sages departing, he said to the dweHers of the Tapovana forest : " In the southern region, great obstructions have hindered my penances, I shall therefore go to another quarter to perform austerity. To the west of this place, at the sacred spot named Pushkara, there is a large and beautiful forest where I shall continue my practices un disturbed." Reaching tbat place, the great sage engaging in occult practices, subsisted on fruit and roots. Meanwhile, King Ambarisha of Ayodhya inaugurated the horse sacrifice, but the horse was carried away by **INDRA**, on which the priest addressed the monarch, saying : " O King, it is for thee to protect the sacrificial steed, the horse has been stolen away owing to thy negligence, therefore, provide another or seek a human victim, so tbat the sacrifice may be accomplished without further hindrance." Hearing these words, the renowned monarch offered thousands of cows to whosoever should find either a horse, or human being. Seeking the sacrificial beast, the illustrious sovereign passed through many countries, cities and forests, and entered hermit ages and sacred places. At length, the King

Amharisba beheld Ricbika the Sage, with bia sons and wife dwening on the mountain Bhrigutunga. II7 Mding obeisance to him. the .king honoured him in various nys and enquired as to his welre. He then said to him : " H it be agreeable to thee, grant me one of thy sons in exchange for a hundred thousand cows. After searching many countries, I have not found either a horse or a human victim for the sacrilice. O Lord, do thou, therefore, deliver thy son to me and accede to my request." **RICHIB** *answered*: " O King, I will never bestow my eldest son on any." His wife then said: " My Lord does not wish to part with the eldest son, but the youngest son Shunalta is dearest to me, I shall not part with him. O Great *Muni*, the eldest son is beloved of his father and the youngest is dear to his mother, therefore, these two should not be taken away." O **RAMA**, the middle son, whose name was Shunashepha, hearing these words, spoke thus : " My father does not wish to part with his eldest son, nor my mother with her youngest, therefore, take me, O King." O **RAMA**, the Iring gave the Sage Richilta a hundted thousand cows in exchange for Shunashepha and, mounting his chariot, started with him on his home'll'llrd journey. CHAPTBR 62 ShuntJsh4pluz, the htmum fliltim, s11/u Gild obtains help from Vuhrmmritra O RAMA, the illustrious King Ambarisha, accompanied by Shunashepha, having in the afternoon reached Pushkara, rested there. While the Iring rested, Shunashepha, going to a certain spot, beheld Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, his maternal uncle, engaged with other sages in the performance of spiritual practices and he, sorrowful, thirsty and fatigued, fell at the feet of the sage, and said: "O Lord, for me there is neither father, mother, relative nor caste. O Peaceful Sage, O Sovereign among asatics, I take refUge in thee ; in the name of *dharma*, deliver me. Thou can'st protect the whole world, how much more one so insignlfi· uS

CHAPTER 62

Shunashepha, the human victim, seeks and obtains help from Vishwamitra

Mding obeisance to him. the .king honoured him in various nys and enquired as to his welre. He then said to him : " H it be agreeable to thee, grant me one of thy sons in exchange for a hundred thousand cows. After searching many countries, I have not found either a horse or a human victim for the sacrilice. O Lord, do thou, therefore, deliver thy son to me and accede to my request." **RICHIB** *answered*: " O King, I will never bestow my eldest son on any." His wife then said: " My Lord does not wish to part with the eldest son, but the youngest son Shunalta is dearest to me, I shall not part with him. O Great *Muni,* the eldest son is beloved of his father and the youngest is dear to his mother, therefore, these two should not be taken away." O **RAMA**, the middle son, whose name was Shunashepha, hearing these words, spoke thus : " My father does not wish to part with his eldest son, nor my mother with her youngest, therefore, take me, O King." O **RAMA**, the Iring gave the Sage Richilta a hundted thousand cows in exchange for Shunashepha and, mounting his chariot, started with him on his home'll'llrd journey. CHAPTBR 62 ShuntJsh4pluz, the htmum fliltim, s11/u Gild obtains help from Vuhrmmritra O RAMA, the illustrious King Ambarisha, accompanied by Shunashepha, having in the afternoon reached Pushkara, rested there. While the Iring rested, Shunashepha, going to a certain spot, beheld Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, his maternal uncle, engaged with other sages in the performance of spiritual practices and he, sorrowful, thirsty and fatigued, fell at the feet of the sage, and said: "O

Lord, for me there is neither father, mother, relative nor caste. O Peaceful Sage, O Sovereign among asatics, I take refUge in thee ; in the name of *dharma*, deliver me. Thou can’st protect the whole world, how much more one so insignlfi· uS cant as mysel£ Do thou assist the king in the completion of his sacrifice that it may be accomplished without hindrance, and may I live and by means of my spiritual practices obtain heaven. Thou art my master who am masterless. Protect me, wretched as I am, as a father protects his child.” Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, hearing the piteous words of Shunashepha addressed his own sons, saying: " O My SoDS, that world for which fathers beget their children is at hand,' this child is the son of the Sage Richib and has taken refuge in me, let us protect his life. You are all virtuous and charitable, let one of you take the place of the sacrificial victim at the king’s sacrifice, and thus satisfy the God **AGNI**. In this way, we can rescue Shunashepha. Assist me in the completion of the king’s sacrifice, propitiate the gods, and enable me to be true to my word.” Hearing these words, Madhusyanda and the other sons sullenly replied to **VISHWAMITRA**, saying : " O King of Kings, would’st thou abandon thine own sons and protect another’s ? Such an action resembles the relinquishing of a tasty dish to partake of the flesh of a dog.” Hearing this reply, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** grew angry and, his eyes inflamed with wrath, he said : " Your speech is arrogant and contrary to *dharma*, it is a violation of filial affection. I regard yon all as insubordinate, therefore, I now curse you. Like the sons of Shri Vasisbtha, may you fall from your high csste and, eating the flesh of dogs, wander about in the world during the period of a thousand years ! " Having thns cuned his sons, the *muni*, off!""ing Shunashepha his protection, thus instructed him : " O Son of a Sage, at King Ambarisha’s sacrifice, allow thyself to be bound, adorned with the red garland, besmeared with sandalwood paste and tied to the sacrificial post. I will

impart to thee two mantrams, which when repeated, will deliver thee." The holy sage then carefully instrUcted him in the sacred formulas. Thereafter, Shunashepha approached the king and said : " O ruustrious Monarch, now enter upon the initiation without delay and accomplish the performance of thy sacrifice." The king, filled with joy, went without delay to the sacrificial pavilion. With the consent of the officiating priest, the king now dressed Shunasbepha in red attire and tied him to the post as the consecrated victim. Being bound, Shunashepha began to praise Upendraby reciting the mantrams he had been given by **VISHWAMITRA**. Indta, pleased with the worship of Shunasbepha, bestowed the blessing of long life on him. O Rams, then did the king complete his sacrifice and obtain the desired fruit from **INDRA**. Thereafter, the righteous **VISHWAMITRA** renewed his yogic penance in Pushlwa and petformed it there for a thousand years.

CHAPTER 63

After more austerities Vishwamitra is proclaimed a Maharishi

SIIIU VISHWAMITKA passed a thousand years in the practice of mortification, then the gods came to bestow on him the fruits of his asceticism. The supreme **BRAHMA** addressed him in plessing accents, saying : " O Holy One, mayest thou be prosperous, thou art now become a *rishi* by virtue of thy great austerities." Having said this, Shri **BRAHMA** and the other celestial beings returned to their own spheres. **VISHWAMITRA** again engaged in severe austerity and in this way passed many more years. While thus employed, the celestial nymph Menaka came to bathe in the Pushkara lake. Resembling lightoing

illumining a cloud, her beauty stirred the passion of **VISHWAMITRA** and he said to her : " Be gracious to me for I am filled with a great love for thee." Then that beautiful one agreed to take up her abode in the hermitage of the rishl. The penances ofVishwamitra were thus rendered void by the ·presence of Menaka in the hermitage. O Rams, that nymph paed ten years in that place. After this time, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** perceiving himself to have been deluded, was filled with shame and he reflected on the cause of his infatuation. Then he adjudged the gods to have devised this plan to bring his ascetism to nought and he cried out : " What, have I passed ten years with this woman, as it were a night. Alaa I My austerities are deatroyed by this passion. Sighing heavily and filled with remorse, he beheld Menaka trembling with fear, standing near, but **VISHWAMITRA** addreasing her in reassuring words, hade her farewell. Having controlled his passions, Shri **VISHWAMITRA** went to the northern mountains and began to perform penance in the Himalayas on the hank of the Kaushiki river. Then, O Ramo, the gods were filled with fear by the austeritiea practised by the *rishi* on the Himalayan mountains, and approach ing **SHRI BRAHMA** *said*: " O Grandsire, now grant the tide of maharishi to Shri **VISHWAMITRA**." Shri **BRAHMA** then appeared before **VISHWAMITRA** and in gende accents said to bim : " Hail to Thee, O *Rishi*, I am pleased with thine austerity. I name thee chief among the *rishis*." Then **VISHWAMITRA**, making obeisance to Shri Brahms, spoke submissively saying : " O Lord, these penances have been undertaken by me that I might become a brahmarishi. Since thou still namest me maharishi, I regard myself as not yet fully self-subdued." Shri **BRAHMA** answered, saying : " So it is, thou hast not yet approached the nymph Rambha and begged her to promote his interest and cause harm to **VISHWAMITRA**.

CHAPTER 64

Indra is perturbed and sends Rambha to disturb the further austerities of the sage

INDRA thus addressed Rambha saying : " O Rambha, it is for thee to accomplish this great work and stimulate the passions of the great Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, so that his spiritual practices may be rendered void." O **RAMA**, Rambha, filled with apprehension on hearing the words of **INDRA**, said in humility : " O **INDRA**, the *Rishi* **VISHWAMITRA** is easily moved to wrath, he will certainly curse me if I approach him. I fear to enter his presence, do not therefore ask me to undertake this task." To Rambha, trembling with fear, standing with joined palms, in token of submission, **INDRA** made answer : " O Rambha, fear not, accomplish my desire, may success attend thee I In the spring season, assuming the form of a cuckoo calling sweetly, accompanied by the god of love, I will take my place on a blossoming tree not far from thee. O Rambha, attired in beautiful and charming appsrel do thou divert the mind of the *muni* from his spiritual practices." At the instance of **INDRA**, that lovely nymph clad in enchanting raiment, faintly smiling, went forth to allure the heart of Shri VIShwamitra. At that moment, the liquid notes of the cuckoo began to delight the *rishi* and he then beheld the nymph Rambha. Stirred by the cuckoo's note and the ravishing sound of the beautiful Rambha's scmg, Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, recollecting his former fall, was filled with misgiving and recognizing the design of the god **INDRA**, transported with rage, cursed Rambha, saying: " O Rambha, O Unfortunate One, thou hast come hither to lure me from my penance, I, who have conquered lust and anger. Mayest thou become petrified and take the

form of a rock for ten thousand years. A *brahmin* perfected in the power of *Yoga* shall one day deliver thee from this curse." Having pronounced this curse on Rambha, the *rishi* became a prey to remorse, for, giving way to wrath he lost the fruit of all his yogic ptactices. Ramhha having been instantly turned to stone, **INDRA** and Kama, perceiving the sage filled with wrath, fled in terror. Shti **VISHWAMITRA** having lost the merit of his penances could obtain no peace ; his passions remaining unsubdued, he resolved to speak no word to any and never give way to anger ; he said : " For a thousand years, I will not breathe. Reducing my body to the last extremity, mastering my senses, I will obtain brahmanhood by the power of my penance. Measurdess years, shall I remain standing, neither breathing nor eating, even should my limbs become atrophied." O **RAMA**, **VISHWAMITRA** resolved to perform this mortification for the space of a thousand years. CHAPTBII 65 VishrDamitra peif""""" anDihlr thtnutllld ysars' austeritin tUid he aqrlires brahmanlrtJod APTIII this the great *Rishi* **VISHWAMITRA**, leaving the northern quarter, went eastward and engaged in a most severe course of austerities. Observing silence for a thousand years, he performed incomparable ascetic practices, hardly able to be accomplished. After a thousand years, his form reduced to the semblance of wood, the royal sage, under the greatest provocation, was not incited to anger. O **RAMA**, when **VISHWAMITRA** was persuaded that he had conquered anger, his vow of a thousand years' mortification heing terminated, he sat down to eat. At that time, IDdra appeared in the guise of a *brahmin* and

Vishwamitra performs another thousand years' austerities and acquires brahmanhood

to lure me from my penance, I, who have conquered lust and anger. Mayest thou become petrified and take the form of a rock for ten thousand years. A *brahmin* perfected in the power of *Yoga* shall one day deliver thee from this curse." Having pronounced this curse on Rambha, the *rishi* became a prey to remorse, for, giving way to wrath he lost the fruit of all his yogic ptactices. Ramhha having been instantly turned to stone, **INDRA** and Kama, perceiving the sage filled with wrath, fled in terror. Shti **VISHWAMITRA** having lost the merit of his penances could obtain no peace ; his passions remaining unsubdued, he resolved to speak no word to any and never give way to anger ; he said : " For a thousand years, I will not breathe. Reducing my body to the last extremity, mastering my senses, I will obtain brahmanhood by the power of my penance. Measurdess years, shall I remain standing, neither breathing nor eating, even should my limbs become atrophied." O **RAMA**, **VISHWAMITRA** resolved to perform this mortification for the space of a thousand years. CHAPTBII 65 VishrDamitra peif""" anDihlr thtnutllld ysars' austeritin tUid he aqrlires brahmanlrtJod APTIII this the great *Rishi* **VISHWAMITRA**, leaving the northern quarter, went eastward and engaged in a most severe course of austerities. Observing silence for a thousand years, he performed incomparable ascetic practices, hardly able to be accomplished. After a thousand years, his form reduced to the semblance of wood, the royal sage, under the greatest provocation, was not incited to anger. O **RAMA**, when **VISHWAMITRA** was persuaded that he had conquered anger, his vow of a thousand years' mortification heing terminated, he sat down to eat. At that time, IDdra appeared in the guise of a *brahmin* and THE li.AMAYANA OP VALMIKI requested the food set before the *muni*, upon which VJSbwamitra, belieriDg him to be a sage, gave him the whole which he had prepared for himself aud still observing the vow of silence, uttered no word. ' The chief of the

sages, suspending his breath for a tiurher thousand years, continued his penance, then there issued from his head a smoke which terrified the beings of the three worlds. By the power of his mortification, the *devas*, gandhsrvas, and other beings were deprived of their glory aud lost conscious ness. In distress, they addressed Shri **BRAHMA** saying : " O Lord, by every means in our power, we have sought to distract the great sage from his penances aud provoke him to anger, but he has persisted in his practices aud is free from desire and aversion. If thou dost not grant him brahmanhood, verily the three worlds will be destroyed. None can find rest anywhere, the seas are drying up and the mountains are riven by the power of his austerities; the sun is deprived of its splendour, the earth is agitated and the wind stirs not. O Lord, we cannot move him from his resolve. On account of this peril, men like atheists have given up the performance of charitable deeds. Nowhere is peace to be found. O Divine Being, lest the mighty **VISHWAMITRA**, resplendent as lire, determine to destroy the universe, deign to grant him his desire. As Time, in the form of lire, at the dissolution of the world, consumes the whole universe, so also will the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**. Grant him, therefore, lndrahood, if he so desire it, for if Thou withhold brahmanhood which he has sought to acquire, then only the sovereignty of **INDRA**'s region, will content him." Thus approached, Shri Brahms, accompanied by the gods, appeared before Shri **VISHWAMITRA** aud in pleasing aCCentS addressed him, saying : " O Brahmarishi, reverence to thee, we are pleased with thine austerity. O Holy **VISHWAMITRA**, by the power of thy penance, thou hast acquired brahmanhood. The gods bless thee, may prosperity attend thee, may longe9ity loagevity upon me, grant me instruction in the holy syllable and the Vedas also, and further invest me with the authority to officiate at the sacrifice. O Y e Gods, let the son of **BRAHMA**, Shri Vasishtba, fully acqusinted with the Vedic

science, acknowledge me as a brahmarishi. If this desire of mine be fulfilled, ye may all depart." Thereupon the gods appeared before Shri Vasishtba, who having acquiesced in their wish and sealed his friendship with **VISHWAMITRA**, said to him: "Verily thou art now a brahmarishi and as such I acknowledge thee." Thereafter the gods returned to their own region. Thus did the illustrious Sage **VISHWAMITRA** acquire brahmanhood. Tbe divine sage then psid homage the great Vasishtba and, his purpose accomplished, wandered about the earth engaged in charitable deeds. **SHRI SHATANANDA** *said*: " O **RAMA**, this is the story of Shri **VISHWAMITRA** and how he obtained brahmanhood. O Raghava, verily he is the chief of sages and the personification of *Yoga*. Constantly engaged in acts of virtue, he still performs rigorous penances." Having uttered these words, Shri Shatanands becsme silent. When this excellent sage had ended his narrative, King **JANAKA** in the presence of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** humbly addressed Shri **VISHWAMITRA** saying : " O Chief of Ssges, blessed am I, that thou art come with **SHRI RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** my sacrifice. O *Muni*, thou hast, by thy presence, done us great honour. O Brahmarishi, thou hast added to our renown. Shri Rams, my counsellors and I have heard the story of thy wonderful austerities and also of thine excellent qualities. O Great Sage, immense is thy power, unimaginable thy penances, incalculable thy virtues, nor does one ever tire of hearing of thy marvellous deeds. O illustrious Lord, the sun has set and the time of evening devotion is near, graciously grant us leave to depsrt ; in the morning we shall see thee again." Shri **VISHWAMITRA** gratified by the king's words, praised him and granted him permission to depsrt, upon which King **JANAKA** rose and circumambu1atin the great sage took his departure, accompanied by his spiritual preceptor and relatives. Honoured by the sages, the great VIShwamitra with **SHRI RAMA**

CHAPTBR 66 Kine Jatlllka relatu the tory of the griHJt boUt and the birth of **SITA** THB day dawned peacefully and King **JANAKA**, having performed his morning devotions, called for the two princes and Vish wamitra. Having honoured the sage and the two descendants of the House of Raghu, he said : " O Blessed Lord, peace he with thee, what service can I render thee, I am wholly thine." Thus addressed by the king, the **SAGE** *replied*: " These two princes are the sons of King **DASARATHA**, they are renowned in the warrior caste and exalted throughout the earth. They desire to see the great how, which is deposited with thee, be gracious enough to permit them to view it and having thus accomplished their purpose, they will to their own capital." Thus addressed, King **JANAKA** replied to the sage : " O Holy *Rishi*, hear from me for what reason this bow is deposited with me. There was a king named Devarata in the sixth generation of the monarch Nimi who obtained this bow as a trust. In ancient days, Shri Mahadeva at the destruction of Daksha's sacrifice, lifting up his bow in sport said to the gods : ' O Devos, ye have failed to give me my share in the sacrifice, therefore, by means of this bow I shall destroy you all.' "O Great Sage, the *devas* overwhelmed with fear, making supplication to the god, succeeded in propitiating Shri Maha *deva*. Then he delivered the bow to the gods and they bestowed it on King Devarata. This is the how. " Thereafter, while I was ploughing the earth for a sacrifice, a virgin issued therefrom. Being uncovered by the edge of the plough, I named her **SITA**' and she became my daughter. This earth-hom virgin has grown up under my prorection. For the marriage of my daughter, it was established by me and made known to the kings coming to seek her hand, that I should not bestow her on any prince whose strength had not been fully tried. O Renowned Sage, these kings have come to test

CHAPTER 66

King Janaka relates the story of the great bow and the birth of Sita

CHAPTBR 66 Kine Jatlllka relatu the tory of the griHJt boUt and the birth of **SITA** THB day dawned peacefully and King **JANAKA**, having performed his morning devotions, called for the two princes and Vish wamitra. Having honoured the sage and the two descendants of the House of Raghu, he said : " O Blessed Lord, peace he with thee, what service can I render thee, I am wholly thine." Thus addressed by the king, the **SAGE** *replied*: " These two princes are the sons of King **DASARATHA**, they are renowned in the warrior caste and exalted throughout the earth. They desire to see the great how, which is deposited with thee, be gracious enough to permit them to view it and having thus accomplished their purpose, they will to their own capital." Thus addressed, King **JANAKA** replied to the sage : " O Holy *Rishi*, hear from me for what reason this bow is deposited with me. There was a king named Devarata in the sixth generation of the monarch Nimi who obtained this bow as a trust. In ancient days, Shri Mahadeva at the destruction of Daksha's sacrifice, lifting up his bow in sport said to the gods : ' O Devos, ye have failed to give me my share in the sacrifice, therefore, by means of this bow I shall destroy you all.' "O Great Sage, the *devas* overwhelmed with fear, making supplication to the god, succeeded in propitiating Shri Maha *deva*. Then he delivered the bow to the gods and they bestowed it on King Devarata. This is the how. " Thereafter, while I was ploughing the earth for a sacrifice, a virgin issued therefrom. Being uncovered by the edge of the plough, I named

her **SITA**' and she became my daughter. This earth-hom virgin has grown up under my prorection. For the marriage of my daughter, it was established by me and made known to the kings coming to seek her hand, that I should not bestow her on any prince whose strength had not been fully tried. O Renowned Sage, these kings have come to test their prowess and I have placed the bow before them and requested them to string it, but none as yet has been able to do so. Perceiving them to be deficient in strength, I have refused to bestow my daughter on any of them. These kings, inflamed with anger, considering their failure to string the bow had brought them into disrepute, surrounded my capital, and inflicted great hardship on my people. This siege endured a full year and immeasurably reduced my treasury. Undergoing severe penances, I propitiated the gods, who granted me a large army with which I have defeated those kings who have retreated, bereft of courage, yet still smarting under imagined injury. " O Great Sage, this is that bow and I will show it to these two princes. O *Rishi*, should Shri **RAMACHANDRA** be able to string the bow, I will give my daughter **SITA** to him in marriage."

CHAPTER 67

The illustrious Rama breaks the bow and is given the Princess Sita in marriage

HEARING the .,vords of King **JANAKA**, **SHRI VISHWAMITRA** *said*: " O King, let the bow be shown to **SHRI RAMA**." Then the monarch addressed his ministers, saying : " Go, bring the bow adorned with flowers and sandalwood, hither." The counsellors commanded by **JANAKA** went to the capital and brought hack the bow. Five hundred

men, of great strength, brought the eight-wheeled cart on which the bow was placed. Having brought the chest fashioned of iron containing the bow, the ministers addressed their divine sovereign, saying : " O Chief of Men, here is the bow worshipped by former kings, O Sovereign of Mithila, it is at thy disposal." Then, with palms joined in humility, King **JANAKA** spoke to the holy Sage **VISHWAMITRA** standing with **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** : " O Holy Lord, this is the bow which has been the object of worship to the kings of the Nimi dynasty and which the monarchs of the earth coming hither have sought to string. Even the gods have not been able to raise, bend or string tbis bow. How, therefore, shonld mortals have the power to do so if the gods have failed ? O Great Risbi, behold the bow, let the two princes eumineit." The righteous Sage Visbwamitra, hearing the words of the king, said to **RAMA**: " O Child, view tbis divine bow." Then **SHRI RAMA**, approaching the casket in which the bow lay, opened it and gazed upon it. **HE** *said*: " O Divine Lord, taking it in my hand and raising it up, I shall endeavour to string the bow." Then the king and the sage answeted : " Be it so," and Shri **RAMACHANDRA** with a slight elfort, seizing the centre of the bow, lifted it up in the presence of tbonssnds of people and without exertion drew it. By the unparalleled strength of the illustrious **RAMA**, the bow broke into two parts and a sound resembling the fall of a thunderbolt rang forth cleaving the mountains asunder and causing the earth to shake, and on tbis the people on every side fell insensible, save only Vishwamitta, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. After a while, the people being somewhat restored, and the king's misgivings set at reat, he addressed the excellent Sage with humility, saying : " O Blessed Lord, I have witnessed the unpanlleled. wonderful and incontestsble feat of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. My daughter, the Princess Sits, shall obtain Prince **RAMA** as her lord and add to the gloty of my dynasty. O Great Sage,

to-day my pledge to subject the prospective wooer of my daughter to a trial of strength has been redeetned. Now I shall bestow on **RAMA**, **SITA**, who is dearer to me than my life. With thy permission, O Sage, my messengers in swift chariots shall drive in all haste to Ayodhya and respectfully relating tbis event to King **DASARATHA** invite him to my capital. They shall fimher inform bim regarding the well-being of the two princes protected by thee and with due honour, convey the great king hither." The Sage **VISHWAMITRA** acquiescing to the proposal, the king communicated the mauer to bis masengers and entruSting thetn with a personal missive to King **DASARATHA**, sent thetn forth on their deputation. 128 CHAPTER 6 8 King JIDIIllul muls meumgm to invite King **DASARATHA** to tlu! capital by King Jomaka, the messengers in swift chariots, passing three nights on the way, their horses greatly fatigued, arrived at Ayodhya. Entering the gates of the palace, they addressed the sentries, saying : " Please inform the king that we have come from King Jomaka and desire an audience." King **DASARATHA** being informed, caused the messengers to be brought before him. Entering the royal palace, they beheld the aged king who resembled a god. His benigu and gracious presence putting them at their ease, they addressed him in gentle and submissive accents saying : " O Illustrious Sovereign, the Lord nfthe kingdom nf Mithila, the performer of great sacrifices, King Janab, enquires with affection as to thy well-being and also concerning the welfare of thy subjects. With the consent of the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** he sends you the following good tidings. His daughter who has been wooed by many kings unable to pass the requisite trial of strengrh, who have thereupon returned home discomfited, has been won by thy higbly fortunate and princely son. He, in the company of the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, coming hither, broke the sacred how in the presence of a grest assembly, therefore, King Jomaka desiring to see his daughter

wedded to thy son, Shri Ramachandrs, sends thee the following message : " O Great Sovcreigu be gracious enough to visit my kingdom with all speed, together with thy preceptors, thy family and attendants and be united with thy sons. Accept the love I bear for thee. Do thou come hither and witness the nuptials of thy children. " O King, these are the words nf King Jomaka which we bring to thee approved by the Sage VISbwamitra and the priest Shri Shatananda ... Having 1Jttere!1 these words, the mesaengers, overawed by the aovereigu's presence, became silent. On recei"fing these tidings, King **DASARATHA** fWl of joy, said

CHAPTER 68

King Janaka sends messengers to invite King Dasaratha to the capital

CHAPTER 6 8 King JIDIIllul muls meumgm to invite King **DASARATHA** to tlu! capital by King Jomaka, the messengers in swift chariots, passing three nights on the way, their horses greatly fatigued, arrived at Ayodhya. Entering the gates of the palace, they addressed the sentries, saying : " Please inform the king that we have come from King Jomaka and desire an audience." King **DASARATHA** being informed, caused the messengers to be brought before him. Entering the royal palace, they beheld the aged king who resembled a god. His benigu and gracious presence putting them at their ease, they addressed him in gentle and submissive accents saying : " O Illustrious Sovereign, the Lord nfthe kingdom nf Mithila, the performer of great sacrifices, King Janab, enquires with affection as to thy well-being and also concerning the welfare of thy subjects. With the consent of the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** he sends you the following good tidings. His daughter

who has been wooed by many kings unable to pass the requisite trial of strengrh, who have thereupon returned home discomfited, has been won by thy higbly fortunate and princely son. He, in the company of the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, coming hither, broke the sacred how in the presence of a grest assembly, therefore, King Jomaka desiring to see his daughter wedded to thy son, Shri Ramachandrs, sends thee the following message : " O Great Sovcreigu be gracious enough to visit my kingdom with all speed, together with thy preceptors, thy family and attendants and be united with thy sons. Accept the love I bear for thee. Do thou come hither and witness the nuptials of thy children. " O King, these are the words nf King Jomaka which we bring to thee approved by the Sage VISbwamitra and the priest Shri Shatananda ... Having 1Jttere!1 these words, the mesaengers, overawed by the aovereigu's presence, became silent. On recei"fing these tidings, King **DASARATHA** fWl of joy, said 129 to the holy Sage Vasishtba, Shri Vamadeva and his ministers : " Protected by Shri Vuhwamitra, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and Prince Lakshmaua are now in the city of Mithila. The renowned Janab bas witnessed the prowess of Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and desires to give his daughter in marriage to him. If this union is looked upon with favour by you, let us start for Mithila immediately, ao that we may reach it with all speed." The sages and ministers there present, answered : " It is well," whereupon the king, highly pleased, said: " Let us set out to-morrow." King Dasaratba with his counsellors entertained King Janab's messengers with great respect, and they passed the night there in comfort.

CHAPTER 69

King Dasaratha sets out with his spiritual preceptor, relations and ministers

THE night being over, King **DASARATHA**, glad in heart, accom panied by his spiritual precepror and relations, summoned his chief minister, Sumantra, and said : " Let the officers of the treasury take with them wealth and jewels in abundance and precede us in good order. Let the four divisions of my army hold themselves in readiness and let chariots and palanquins be prepared. Let my commands be carried out with promptitude. Suffer Shri **VASISHTHA**, Vamadeva, Javali, Kashyapa, Bhrign, Markandeya and Katya yana with other learned and holy men to lead the procession. Make ready the royal chariot, let there be no delay, King Janab's messengers are eager to return." Then the mighty King **DASARATHA** attended by the holy sages Bet out on the journey followed by his army. Passing four nights on the road, they enrered the capital of King **JANAKA**, who, having commanded the city to be decorated, advanced to pay honour to hia royal guests, Approaching the aged 130 sovereign **DASARATHA**, King **JANAKA** was filled with joy, and addressed him with cheerful words, saying : " O Great King, I bid thee welcome, fortunate indeed am I that thou hast been gtacious CDougb to honour me with thy presence. Now sbalt thou bave the felicity of looking on thy two sons. Twice blessed am I that Shri Vasisbtba, attended by other learned sages, has come bither also, as it were lndta in the midst of the gods. Every impediment to the wedding ceremony has been withdrawn and this ancient dynasty, by the alliance with the House ofRagbu, will acquite new lustre. O IUustrious

Sovereign, to-morrow at the completion of the sacri1ice, baving consulted with the sages, be gtacious CDouglt to celebrate the nuptials." The eloquent IIIOII8llb, **DASARATHA**, seated amidst the sages, answered : " I bave ever heard that those who receive charity are subject to the cooferrer of that charity I O Thou acquainted with virtue, it is ours to defer to thee in aU things." Hearing the speech of the truthful sovereign, King **DASARATHA**, King **JANAKA** was filled with aatonishment. AU the sages thCD coming together, passed the night in converse, mutuaUy delighting each other. King **DASARATHA**, being united with bis sons was filled with bappinesa and surrendered bimself whoUy to King **JANAKA**'s hospitality. The magnanimous sovereign of Mithila, baving completed the orders for the preparations of the wedding ceremony, retired to rest.

CHAPTER 70

The king, Vishwamitra and the princes are invited to King Janaka's com where Vishwamitra relates the descent of the dynasty

desire to sec that Excellent One, who, with liberality, has assisted me in the act of sacrifice ; it is meet that he should attend the marriage ceremony." Having spoken thus to Shri Shatananda, certain attendants stsnding near, were commanded by the king to set out thither. At his command, the messengers, like gods riding out on the behest of **INDRA**, went forth on swift horses to bring back the royal guest. Arriving at Sankanshya, and being received by the King Kushadwaja, they acquainted him with King **JANAKA**'s proposal. The great king acquiescing to his request, came to the capital of the sovereign of

MithiJa and beholding the virruous great souled]onaka, aogether with Shri Shatananda, bowed down to them in salutation. Having occupied a royal seat in the assembly, the two illusttious brothers commanded their chief minister, Sudamana, saying : " O Chief of Counsellors, speedily approach the great sovereign, **DASARATHA**, of limitless glory, and bring that Excellent One to my court, together with the two princes and his ministers." Sudamana, going to the encampment of King **DASARATHA**, and bowing down to him, said : " O Great Hero, O Lord of Ayodhya, the sovereign of Mithila humbly invites thee with thy spiritual preceptor, thy priests and thy two sons to his assembly." Then King **DASARATHA** attended by his friends and kinsmen came to the place where King **JANAKA** sat amidst the sages and ministers. And he, the wise and eloquent monarch addressed King **JANAKA**, saying : " O Great King, it is known to thee that the chief priest of the House of lltshwaku is Shri **VASISHTHA** and my spokesman in all matters. Therefore, with the approval of Shri **VISHWAMITRA** he will relate the descent of our dynasty to thee." Having spoken, **DASARATHA** became silent and Shri **VASISHTHA** then addressed King **JANAKA** and Shri Shatsnanda : " From Btahman, the Unmanifeat, the Eternal and lmperish· able **BRAHMA** came forth. From him was produced Maricha, Maricha begot Kashyapa ; Kashyapa begot **SURYA**, **SURYA** begot Vivaswat, arul Vivaswat begot Manu. Manu was the father of lbwaku who was the first king of Ayodhya. The son of Ikswaku was Kukshi and his son was Vikukshi ; the illustrious Vana was the son of Vikuksbi arul Vans's son was the mighty Anranya ; his son was Prithu and the son of Prithu was Trishanku ; the Dhundhumara was the son of Trishanku and his son was the hero Yuvanashwa. The renowned Mand hata was hom of Yuvanashwa arul Mandhata's son was named Susarulbi. Susandbi had two sons Dbruva-sandbi and Prasen ajit. **BHARATA** was the son of

Dbruva-sandbi and the renowned Asit was the son of **BHARATA**. The three sons of Asit were Hihaxas, Talajanghas arul Shashavindus, great Kings, who, hostile to their site, waged war against him and sent him into exile. Then King Asit, with his two consorts, going to the Himalayas, there laid down his life, leaving the queens pregnant, whereat one of them, to destroy the fruit of the other's womb, gave her poison. "At that time, a sage of the family of Bhrigu dwelt on the heights of Himalaya, by name Chyavana practising penance there. Then the lotus-eyed Queen Kalindi, desirous of bearing an ezcellent son approached the sage who resembled a god arul bowed before him. The *brahmin* addressed the queen saying : O Fortunate One, thou bearest in thy womb, a hero, soon to be hom together with the poison ; have no anxiety.' " The queen, faithful to her deceased lord, overcome with sorrow, fearing the death of her child, paid homage to the *muni*. Thereafter she bore a hom with the poison administered by the other wife arul he was named Sagara. " The son of Sagara was Asumanjas, and his son was Anshuman. The son of Anshuman was Dilipa, and Dilipa's son was Bhagiratha. The son of Bhagiratha was Kakustha and his son was Ragbu. The son of Raghu, Prabradha became a demon, and was subsequently called Kalamashapada arul his son was Shangana. The son of Shangana was Sudarsbana, and his son was **AGNI**-varna. Sbigbraga was the son of **AGNI**-varna arul the son of Sbighraga was Manu. Manu's son was Prashu ahrub arul his son was Amharisha. Ambarisha's son was named Nahusha arul his son was Yayati. The son of Yayati was Nabhaga. 133 " The son of Nabhaga was Aja, and the son of Aja was King **DASARATHA** ; the two sons of King **DASARATHA** are **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. " O KiDg, I have recounted the genealogy of King Ikswaku to thee. All these kinga were noble, virtuous and distinguisbed in their love of truth. " King **DASARATHA** requests the

bands of thy daoghrers in marriage for his two sons, who are in every way worthy to be thy kinsmen. O Chief of Men, beatow thy daughters on them.”

CHAPTER 71

King Janaka gives an account of the succession and his dynasty

KING]ANAXA, paying homage to the Sage **VASISHTHA**, said : " O Maharishi, be peace with thee, hear the account of the succession of our dynRSty. At the time of beatowing a daughter in marriage, it is customary for the father to recite the pedigree of his race, be graeinus enough to hear me, O Lord. " In ancient times, renowned in the three worlds was the King Nimi, eminent in virtue, a lover of truth and foremost kinga of that era. Nimi begot Mithi whose son was the first Janab and he begor Udavasu. His sln was Nandi vardbana and he begot Sutetu. Suketu begot the righteous Devarata and the son of Devarata was the royal Sage Briha dratha. He begot the great hero Mahavirya whose son was Dhratiman and his son was the truthful Sudhriti. He begot Dhrishta-Ketu and his son was the royal Sage Harysshwa. Haryashwa begor Maru. Then followed Prasidhaka, Kirtti ratha, Devamirha, Bibudha, Mahidhraka, Kirtivaja and Maha roma. Maharoma begor Swamaroma and his son was Hraswa roma. Hraswaroma had two aons of whom I, myself, am the elder, and this is my younger brother Kushadwaja. My father, bequeathing the kingdom to me and chargillg me with the care of Kushadwaja, retired to the forest. My aged aire, havins pasaed from this world, I began to rule accordin to *dharma*, 134 supporting my brother with the utmost affection. After some time, tbe

King Sudhanwa besieged tbe capitsl of Mitbila, tberesfter he sent me offen of pesce on condition I sutrendered my dsugbter, Sits, and also tbe sacred bow of **SHIVA** to him. O Brahmsrishi. on rejecting his offer a battle ensued between us in which Sudhanwa was slain. O Great Sage, King Sud hanwa being dead, I gave tbe kingdom of Sankasya to my well-beloved brotber Kushadwaja. This is my well-beloved brotber. O Sages, we submit outSelves in love, to tbee. " O Ragbava, to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** I give my daughter Sits, and Prince **LAKSHMANA** will receive tbe Princess Urmila. **SITA**, resembling a dsugbter of the gods, I bestow on **RAMA** ; verily witb my whole heart do I yield tbese two dsughters of mine to tby sons. O King, now be pleased to inaugurate the traditional distribution of kine in charity. Perform the Nandi Mukha' ceremony so that the nuptials may be celebrated. " To-day the Magds star is in the ascendant and in tbree dsys the Uttara Phalguni will have risen ; tbe marriage should take place in that conjunction. "For tbe purpose of ensuting their felicity, let **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** now distribute cows, land, sesamum seed and otber requisite offerings." CHAPTER 7' The 1tlflt'riae of the /0111' of Kittg **DASARATHA** is arranged

CHAPTER 72

The marriage of the four sons of King Dasaratha is arranged and preparations commence

Supporting my brother with the utmost affection. After some time, tbe King Sudhanwa besieged tbe capitsl of Mitbila, tberesfter he sent me offen of pesce on condition I sutrendered my dsugbter, Sits, and also tbe sacred bow of **SHIVA** to him. O Brahmsrishi. on rejecting his offer a

battle ensued between us in which Sudhanwa was slain. O Great Sage, King Sud hanwa being dead, I gave tbe kingdom of Sankasya to my well-beloved brotber Kushadwaja. This is my well-beloved brotber. O Sages, we submit outSelves in love, to tbee. " O Ragbava, to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** I give my daughter Sits, and Prince **LAKSHMANA** will receive tbe Princess Urmila. **SITA**, resembling a dsugbter of the gods, I bestow on **RAMA** ; verily witb my whole heart do I yield tbese two dsughters of mine to tby sons. O King, now be pleased to inaugurate the traditional distribution of kine in charity. Perform the Nandi Mukha' ceremony so that the nuptials may be celebrated. " To-day the Magds star is in the ascendant and in tbree dsys the Uttara Phalguni will have risen ; tbe marriage should take place in that conjunction. "For tbe purpose of ensuting their felicity, let **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** now distribute cows, land, sesamum seed and otber requisite offerings." CHAPTER 7' The 1tlflt'riae of the /0111' of Kittg **DASARATHA** is arranged say, hear me. Thy younger brother, King Kusbadwaja, unexcelled in virtue, bas two daughters of incomparable beauty, these two I request for the sagacious **BHARATA** and the pious Sbatrughna. The four sons of King **DASARATHA** are youthful, handsome, resembling the gods, equal to the (*four*) gusrdians of the world. O Great King, bestow these two damsels on the younger aons of King **DASARATHA**. Thou an unequalled in virtue and the House of lkswalcu is without a peer." Hearing the magnanimous words of Shri **VISHWAMITRA** echoed by Shri **VASISHTHA**, King Janaks with joined palms humbly addressed the two august sages : " O Holy Ones, I am proud that you have approved the alliance of my House with the House of Ikshwaku. Your commands shall be accomplished. The daughters of King Kushadwaja shall be given to the Princes **BHARATA** and **SHATRUGHNA** in marriage. Let the four great sons of King **DASARATHA** be united with the four princesses

on the same day. O Divine Sage, to-morrow the constcllation Phalguni presided over by the deity Bhag' is in the ascendant. The wise consider this season aa auspicious for the nuptials." Shri **VASISHTHA** answering" Be it ao ",King **JANAKA**, in great humility, addressed the holy sages, saying: " O Spiritual Kings, it is by your favour that I am able to olfer my daughten in marriage. Regard me as your servant. Ye arc wonhy of these seats prepared for you. Let my kingdom now belong to the King **DASARATHA** and my affections extend to the kingdom of Ayodhya. I have spoken truth. O Holy Ones, do what is considered necessary." King **DASARATHA** hearing with attention the words uttered by King Janak was pleased and replied, saying : " O Brothers, possessing ionumerable excellent qualities, ye have honoured the holy *rishis* and kings with abundant hospitality. May you be blessed I May happiness be youn ! With your leave I shall now withdraw to my own aparrments to inaugurate the prelim· inary rites." Having taken leave of the King of Mithila, Shri **DASARATHA**, preceded by the holy sage, went away. tJ: The following day, baving fulfilled the traditional rites, King **DASARATHA** gave away innumerable cows in charity. On behalf of each of his sons, be bestowed on the *brahmins* thousands of cows whose horns were covered with gold, yielding rich milk, together with their calves. With every cow the king gave away a metal milking vessel. On that day, four hundred thousand cows were given away by him. That mighty king holding his sons supremely dear, gave incalculable wealth in their name. King **DASARATHA**, performing these deeds of charity, surrounded by his sons, resembled **BRAHMA** attended by the Regents of the world.

CHAPTER 73

The marriage ceremonies are completed

ON tbe day on which King **DASARATHA** distributed the cows in charity, the grest bero Yudbajit, the son of the King Kaikeya and the maternal uncle of Bbarata, also came to **JANAKA**'s capital. Seeing King **DASARATHA**, he made enquiries as to his welfare and said : " O King, the Lord of Kaikeya, through a1fection, sends tidings of his well-being to thee, and seeks to know if it be well with thy friends. O Great King, my father desired to see Prince Bbarata, and for this purpose I went to Ayodhya. There, hearing that thou badst gone to Mithila with thy sons, for their nuptials, I came hither in baste to see the son of my sister.'" King **DASARATHA** thereupon duly honoured his kinsman who spent the night happily in company with the princes. The following day, rising early, King **DASARATHA** performing his customary devotions, proceeded to the sacrificial pavilion, escorted by the sages. At an auspicious hour in the presence of Shri Vaaishtha and other sages, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and his brothers adorned with every ornament being present, the preliminary ceremonia were performed. Then Shri Vasishtba addressed King J anaka saying : " O King, King Dasaratba has inaugurated the preliminary cere mouies, he now awaits thy pleasure. The sacred rite is com pleted when host and guests come together. Be pleased, therefore, to perform the principal nuptial rites." King **JANAKA** listened to the worda of the great-souled Vasishtba and answered : " What guard detains King Dasaratba at the gate ? Whose sanction does his royal majesty seek ? Is not this bis house ? Let the king enter I O Chief of Sages, my daughters, in readiness, stand at the altar, bright as the clear flame. I, standing near, await you all. There is no need for

delay. Let the king cause the ceremony to take place without further hindrance.” Then King Dasaratba with his sons and the holy sages entered the marriage pavilion. Thereafter, King **JANAKA** addressed Shri Vasishtba, saying : " O Virtuous Sage, with the other sages perform the wedding ceremony.” Then Shri Vasishtba igDited the sacrificial fire in the centre of the pavilion. Shri **VISHWAMITRA** and Shri Sbatananda standing before him, sprinkled the altar with perfume, and decorated it with ftowers. Then he set out the golden vessels and the sacred kusba grass, filling many with incense and arranging them in the form of a concbshell. Dishes filled with parched corn and rice were placed there, and durbba grass spread about, the sacred formulas being pronounced over them. The holy *rishis* now lit a fire pronouncing the Vedic mantrams and offered oblations into it. Shri **SITA**, adorned with jewels, took her seat by the sacred fire opposite Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. King **JANAKA**, addteasing the Son of Raghu, said : " O **RAMA**, from to-day my daughter **SITA** will be thy companion in virtue. Accept her, O Prince, and take her band in thine. This fortunate princess, faithful and tender, will constantly attend thee, following thee like a shadow, in loving obedience. May you both be happy.” Saying this, King **JANAKA** sprinkled on them water purified Then King JIUI8b said to Shri .LakshmaDa : " O Labbmana, come hither, peace be with thee I Take in thy hand the hand of my daughter Urmila, lllrl’y DOt, O Prince.” Having thus spoken, JIUI8b likewise addressed Prince Bbarata, saying : " O Son of Raghu, accept the hand of the Princess Mandavi " and to Prince Shatrugbna, he said : " O Great Prince, accept the hand of Shrura-kirtti. O Princes of the House of Raghu, be gentle and faithfil1 to your wives as they will be to you, receive them now, let there be no delay.” Tbus instructed by King **JANAKA**, the four princes, taking the banda of the four princesses as directed by the Sage Vasisbtba,

circumambulated the fire, King **JANAKA** and the sages performing the rites as ordained by the sacred ordinance. As the nuptial ceremony of the four princes of the House of Raghu with the four princesses terminated, a rain of fiowers fell on them tiom the sky. Divine music sounded, nymphs danced and the celestial lingers broke into paeons of praise. All these marvellous events marked the wedding of the sons of King Dasaratba while the princes, circumambulating the fire, were united with their brides. Thereafter with their wives, they returned to their apartments and KingJ11118b with his relatives and friends, with a joyful heart having taken part in the festivitiea, also withdrew.

CHAPTER 74

Parasurama appears amidst inauspicious signs

THE night being past, the great Sage **VISHWAMITRA** took leave of King Dasaratba and King J11118b and, blessing the princes and tbcir sire, departed for the Himalayas to meditate there. The holy risbi being gone, King Dasaratba begged the permission of the Lord of Mitbila to return to his capital. Bidding farewell to the pious king, JIUI8b escorted him for some distance on his way. To the King of Ayodhya, on behalf of his daughter, King 139 Jllllaka gave a hundred thousand cows, woollen cloths, countless silken robes and richly decorated elephants, horses and chariots. He also bestowed on him male and female attendants, numberless golden coins with quantities of pearls and coral. All these and many other gifts King Jllllaka gave with a joyful mind, and having taken leave of King **DASARATHA**, returned to Mithila, whereupon King Dasaratba with bis illustrious sons, preceded by the sages, started on the homeward journey, accompanied by bis army. As the sages, with Shri

RAMACHANDRA, advanced in company with the king, the screeching of strange and terrible birds was heard, wbile frightened deer lied across their path. Perceiving these inauspicious signs, the king addressed Shri Vasishtbs, saying : " O Holy Guru, why do the birds cry thus ominously, and the deer traverse our path? What do these omens portend ? My mind is filled with anxiety, O Divine Lord." The Maharishi Vasishtba, in gentle tones, replied: " O King, the fearful crying of the birds betokens some great danger, but the crossing of the deer from left to rigbt indicates a speedy end to thy fears." While they were yet speaking, the earth began to quake and and giant trees fell down, darkness covered the earth and clouds of dust veiled the sun, nor could the cardinal points be discerned. In the great dust storm that followed, the army was overwhelmed with terror and all became paralysed, save Shri Vasishtba, King Dasaratba and the princes alone. When the dust was allayed and the army somewhat recovered, Shri **VASISHTHA** beheld the snn of Yamadagni of dreadful aspect. With matted hait, Parasurama, the humbler of the pride of kings and emperors, drew near. The appearance of the *muni* resembling the splendour of Mount Kaiiasha or the fires of dissolution at the end of the world-period was hardly to be borne by human eyes. With bis hattie axe nn bis shoulder, bearing a mighty bow, brilliant as has Paraswama come again to desuoy the warrior caste ? " Was not bis anger appeased when he formerly destroyed the whole warrior caste ? Has he come again to take bis revenge onus?" Reflecting thus, they approached Parasurama with traditional offerings, saying : " O **RAMA**, accept this arghya." Shri Parasurama accepting the offering, then addressed **SHRI RAMA**.

CHAPTER 75

He challenges Rama to combat

" **O** RAMA, O illustrious Hero, I have heard of thy great prowess. I have also heen acquainted with thy heroic deed, the breaking of the bow at Janakapura, verily a feat exciting wonder and surpassing imagination. Having heard of thine achievement, I, taking tbis other bow, have come bither. With tbis terrible bow named Yamadagni, show thy strength, O **RAMA**, and placing an arrow in it, discharge it. Should'st thou be able to accomplish this, I will engage in honourable comhat with thee." Hearing these words, King **DASARATHA**, became dejected and humbly addressed the risbi, saying : " O Holy Paraswama, thou art a great *brahmin* sage, it becomes thee not to show anger to warriors ; be gracious unto my son, who is still a child. Thou art bom in the family of Bhrign and hast pledged thyself to **INDRA** to bear arms no more. Having given the dominion of the world to Kashyapa and retired to the Mahendra mountain to practise asceticism, why hast thou now come bither to destroy us ? O Sage, if **RAMA** is slain, none of us will survive." The great son ofJamadagni, disregarding the entreaty of King Duaratha, again addresaed **RAMA**, saying : " O **RAMA**, these two bows of exquisite design, famed throughout the world, exceedingly powerfUl, were forged by Vishwabrma.' One of them, wielded by Shri Sbiva in comhat with Tripura, was broken by thee. The other, held by me, of inexpressible power, was given to **VISHNU** by the gods and is known to give victory over the foe ; it is equal iu moment to that which thou hast broken. " Formerly the gods asked **BRAHMA** wbich of the two excelled the other and Shri **BRAHMA**, acquainted with their intention, invoked a quarrel between **VISHNU** aud Mabadeva. They entered iuto combat one with the

other. By the shout raised by Shri **VISHNU**, Shri Mabadeva was struck motionless and his bow unstrung. Tbeo the gods and *rishis* came to that place aud caused the two gods to be recouciled. Tberesfter the gods esteemed the bow of **VISHNU** to be the more powerful and Sbti **SHIVA** surreudered his bow to the King of Mithila, together with all its arrows. " This bow, belonging to **VISHNU**, was given in ancient times by that god to Ricbilat and be gave it to his soo Jamadsgni, my father. He having renounced the besriog of weapons, retired to practise austerity, when the rash and foolish monarch Sahasravaku slew him. Heariog of the cruel death of my sire, I successively destroyed the warrior caste, from generation to generation, thus acquiriog domiuion over the earth. I conferred this great domiuion as a gift on the Sage Kashyapa at the completion of a aacrifice, and retired to the Mahendra mountain, cbeerfully observing the practice of *Yoga*. To-day, O Valiant Prince, acquainted with thy great achievement, I have come hither to behold thee. Receive this bow, bestowed on my ancestors by Shri VIShnu and in the spirit of a warrior, place an arrow on it. If thou succeed in drawing the bow, I will challenge thee to fight."

CHAPTER 76

Parasurama is vanquished and deprived of his glory and power

HBAIIING these words, **SHRI RAMA** having regard for the presence of his sire, answered with restraint, aaying : " O Parasurama, thy deeds are known to me, as also the avenging of thy fathen' murderers. Methinb thou dost deem me lacking in valour, l,P I, a *kshatriya*, and a descendant of the Solar race. O *Rishi*, witness my prowess." Having spoken thus,

Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, incensed, seized the bow and from the *rishi*'s hands and stringing it, placed an arrow on it. While drawing the mighty bow, the son of **DASARATHA** addressed the *rishi* with defiance, saying : " O Sage, thou art a brabmin and as such do I honour thee ; thou art furthet a kinsman of Shri **VISHWAMITRA**, thetefure I shall not slay thee with this arrow, but by this shsft I will rob thee of the power of motion so that thou shalt no longer be able to travel through space, or I will banish thee from those high regions to which thou hast attained by the practice of penance. Say, what is thy desire ? This divine arrow of **VISHNU**, possessing the power of vanquishing the strength and pride of the foe, may not be restored by me to the quiver, till it has accomplished its great purpose." When **RAMA** placed the arrow in the sacred bow, **BRAHMA**, with the gods, assembled to behold that glorious deed, followed by the gandhsrvas, apsaras, yabhas and other beings. Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, having taken up the mighty bow, the three worlds began to tremble and Parasurama, bereft of his divine power, stood aghast. Deprived of his glory and powerless, Shri Parasurama with humble entreaty, addressed the lotua-eyed **RAMA**: " When the dominion of the earth was given by me to the sage Kashyapa, he said ' Thou must not inhabit this kingdom '. Thetefure, O Ramo, in obedience to the sage, I do not stay on the earth by nighL This world is no longer mine, but belongs to Kashyapa. O Ramo, do not deprive me of the power of movement, but allow me speedily to return to the beautiful Mahendra mountain. Thou can'st deprive me of the merits earned by the practice of *Yoga*. I know Thee to be the Imperishable, Tbou art verily **VISHNU** Himself, none but Thou could'st wield this bow. O Son of Ragbu, the gods have assembled to behold Thee ; Thou art pre-eminent in combat, and the conqueror of Thine enemies. O Virtuous Prince, to be defeated by Thee is no ignominy ; discharge Thy matchless arrow and I will

return to the Mahendra mountain." THB R.AMAYANA OF VALMJKJ Thereupon Shri **RAMACHANDRA** discharged the arrow and the merit of Parasurama was rendered void, whereupon he speedily departed to the Mahendra mountain. The darkness being dispelled and the whole world once more filled with light, **RAMA** was worshipped by the gods and *rishis*, and Shri Parasurama having circumambulated the son of **DASARATHA**, returned to his own hermitage.

CHAPTER 77

King Dasaratha with his army, the princes and their brides, return to Ayodhya

SJnu PARASURAMA having departed, Shri R.ama delivered the bow and arrows as a trust to the god **VARUNA**. Having offered salutations to Shri **VASISHTHA** and the other sages he, seeing his father filled with apprehension, addressed him, saying : " Sire, Shri Parasurama has now gone, do thou command thine army to proceed towards Ayodhya." King **DASARATHA**, hearing **RAMA**'s words, embraced him and rellected that his son was botn to him a second time. Then summoning his army to advance, he in a chariot, adorned with banners, to the fanfare of trumpets ptoclaiming victory, entered Ayodhya. The streets of the city sprinkled with water and llowen, appeared beautiful, and the citizens rejoicing at the return of their sovereign, greeted him with shouts of welcoll1e. Met by the *brahmins* inhabiting the city, the king with his friends and relatives, followed by the princes and their brides, entered the royal palace which was white as snow. There, the kindred of the king welcomed him with garlands and sandalwood. The Queena **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA** and Kaiteyi received the brides and conducted

the fortunate **SITA**, the illustrious Urmila, and the two daughters of Kushadwaj to their palace, with auspicious rites. Arrayed in sumptUouS aUken robes, and botne to the temple to wonhip the holy images, the I# brides then offend respectful salutations to their mother-in-laws, and others worthy of honour. Thereafter, each began to live with her lord in her own palace. Shri **RAMACHANDRA** with the other princes, possessing the knowledge of the use of weapons and the science of defence, passed the time with their friends in attendance on their aged sire. After some time, King **DASARATHA** said to his son **BHARATA** : " O my Son, thy maternal uncle, who came for the purpose of taking thee to his home, still tarries in the capital, therefore, go with him to see thy grandfather." Prince **BHARATA** and Prince **SHATRUGHNA** prepared to start on their journey and took leave of their father and their highly compassionate brother Ramo. **BHARATA** being gone, Shri Ramo and Latshmana ministered to the aged king as if he were a god and in his name performed charitable deeds among the people of the city. **RAMA** also ministered to his mother with deep affection, and served his Guru with single-minded devotion. His noble behaviour gratified the king, the *brahmin*, merchants and other castes ; his sweet disposition and pious amduct charmed the people of the capital. Ramo, wholly devoted to truth was renowned for his virtue, and endowed with evety excellent quality lite Swayambhu-**BRAHMA** himself. For a long time did Shri Ramo enjoy a life of content with Sits. To him, she was dear beyond all things and he surrendered his whole heart to her. Love is enhanced by beanty, virtue and gentleness, and Sits possessed all these in an equal degree with Ramo. Lovely as a goddess, Shri Sits was able to disccrn the thoughts of her lord before he expressed them. The beautiful Sits with Shri **RAMACHANDRA** wholly satisfied, resembled Latshmi, the consort of the incomparable **VISHNU**. ..... King DIWII'atha tksires to 1u

Prince **RAMA** mmie ...,,,, tmtliU1IfiiiOfiS a t:Drmcil THB great souled Bbarata af£ectionately requested the pious Shattuglma to accompany him, on the journey to his matemal grandfather. Enjoying abundant bospitality and held by their uncle Ashwapati in all affection, the two brothers dwelt there happily. Satisfied with the love and entertainment bestowed on them, they daily remembered their royal sire, the aged monateh, and the king also thought of his sons, now in a distant countty. Tbe four sons of the aged king were as dear to him as his own four arms issuing from his body, yet **RAMA** resembling Brahms, endowed with every good attribute, was dearest to his sire. **SHRI RAMA**, the eternal Purusha,the Lord **VISHNU** himself, descended on earth on the entresty of the gods, to slay **RAVANA**, the enemy of the whole world. Tbe charming Queen **KAUSHALYA**, glowing with matemallove for her son **RAMACHANDRA**, resembled Adili at the birth of **INDRA**. Unequalled in beauty, brave and chivalrous, never speaking ill of others, **RAMA** inherited the virtues of his illustrious father ; of a cheerful disposition, speaking soft words to all, never returning a barah answer when trested with contumely ; when injured, pardoning thi offender and remembering the ofl'ence no more ; showing gratitude for the least of favours and devoting his leisure fromaflilin of state to seeking the friendship of those eminent in wisdom, learning, age and conduct. Wise and generous, be was foremost in addressing others, speaking with afl'ection ; supremely courageous yet not rendered vain glorious by his own powers ; never nttering falsehood, honouring the leamed and the aged. showing regard for his people who

BOOK II

Ayodhya Kanda

Dasaratha intends to crown Rama heir-apparent, but Queen Kaikeyi, moved by the maid Manthara, holds the king to two old boons: Rama's fourteen-year exile and Bharata's coronation. Faithful to dharma, Rama goes calmly into the forest with Sita and Lakshmana. Dasaratha dies of grief; Bharata pleads with Rama to return, but Rama remains true to his father's vow.

CHAPTER 1

King Dasaratha is inclined to resign his throne to Prince Rama and summons a council

CBAPTBR King DIWII'atha tksires to 1u Prince **RAMA** mmie ...,,,, tmtliU1IfiiiOfiS a t:Drmcil THB great souled Bbarata af£ectionately requested the pious Shattuglma to accompany him, on the journey to his matemal grandfather. Enjoying abundant bospitality and held by their uncle Ashwapati in all affection, the two brothers dwelt there happily. Satisfied with the love and entertainment bestowed on them, they daily remembered their royal sire, the aged monateh, and the king also thought of his sons, now in a distant countty. Tbe four sons of the aged king were as dear to him as his own four arms issuing from his body, yet **RAMA** resembling Brahms, endowed with every good attribute, was dearest to his sire. **SHRI RAMA**, the eternal Purusha,the Lord **VISHNU** himself, descended on earth on the entresty of the gods, to slay **RAVANA**, the enemy of the whole world. Tbe charming Queen **KAUSHALYA**, glowing with matemallove for her son **RAMACHANDRA**, resembled Adili at the birth of **INDRA**. Unequalled in beauty, brave and chivalrous, never speaking ill of others, **RAMA** inherited the virtues of his illustrious father ; of a cheerful disposition, speaking soft words to all, never returning a barah answer when trested with contumely ; when injured, pardoning thi offender and remembering the ofl'ence no more ; showing gratitude for the least of favours and devoting his leisure fromaflilin of state to seeking the friendship of those eminent in wisdom, learning, age and conduct. Wise and generous, be was foremost in addressing others, speaking with afl'ection ; supremely courageous yet

not rendered vain glorious by his own powers ; never nttering falsehood, honouring the leamed and the aged. showing regard for his people who were devoted to bim ; having overcome wrath ; surpassingly compassiouate, venerating the btahmins ; showing pity for the poor ; well-versed in public and individual responsibili ties, fulfilling his domestic duties, not only to add lustre to the dynasty but also to attain an exalted state in the other world. Wise in the discbarge of his obligations ; as a Scion of the House of Ikshwaku, proving himself tender and loving to those who sought his protection ; restraining the evil-doer ; ever seeking the weal of his subjectS ; eschewing frivolous pursuits and shsllow talk ; neither hearing nor speaking aught against *dharma* ; in debate equal in eloquence to Brihsspati ; free from infirmities ; youthful, handsome, having knowledge of time and space and being able to divine the contents of a man's heart at a single glance ; verily a great sage and for his marvellous qualities as dear the people as life itself. Profoundly learned in the science and the philosophy of the Veda, which he had studied with his spiritual preceptor, he even excelled his father in the art of warfare. The repositoty of all auspiciousness, virtuous, cheerful, truthful and guileless ; having received full instruction from the learned *brahmins* in sacred and secular policy, knowing the significance of virtue, material prosperity and enjoyment ; of prodigious memory, conversant with worldly wisdom, possessing a pleasing disposition, gentle, able to conceal his thoughts ; recognizing when to refuse and when to accept material gifts ; winning many friends, firm in his devotion to his Guru and to God, countenancing no sin ; never uttering a bitter word or one which would agitate the hearts of others ; energetic, deploring his own faults whilst excusing those of others ; a great advocate, grateful, lending support to those he held in affection ; in all circumstances true to his word ; capable of protecting the interests of his

family and friends ; knowing how to meet out retribution to the wicked. Acquiring wealth by just means, and appreciating how to distribute it with discrimination. Proficient in the Veda, following the literary and dramatic arts with enthusiasm, endowed with the gift: of oratoty in Sanskrita and hia own native tongue ; depending on right alone for felicity and prosperity ; prudent, accomplished in sport, music and painting ; an incomparable rider whether mounted on horse or elephant ; stilled in archery, renowned AYODHYA IC.ANDA in the field, forestlllling the enemy in attack and knowing how to destroy his defences ; fired with righteous wrath when engaging in comhat, so that neither god nor titan could withstand him ; speaking nought against any ; free from pride and envy ; ever submissive, overruled in his resolve by none ; pre eminent among his people ; renowned in the three worlds ; in forbearance resembling the earth, in wisdom equal to Brihas pati, in courage like unto **INDRA**. Shining resplendent like the full moon in the love of his people and his sire, worshipped for his acellent qualities, his matchless valour and his integrity, the earth desired to make him her lord. Seeing his illustrious son manifesting these qualities, King **DASARATHA** began to rellect in this wise : " I have become old and have ruled a full measure of yesrs. I desire to see Rams crowned while I yet live ! " This inelination grew in the mind of the king, and he waited eagerly for the time when he might resign his throne in favour of Rams. He rellected : " **RAMA**, resembling a cloud, rsining compassion on all ; beloved far beyond myself; in valour equal to **YAMA** and Indrs, in understanding like Brihaapati, in endurance like unto a mountain, exceeding myself in acellent attributes ; on him do I desire to confer the dominion of the earth ; this will be my heaven.” Theo that great sovereign summoning his ministers communi cated to them his resolve to proclaim **RAMA**, endowed with those powers, rare even in a king. and

a mine of surpassing virtues, as heir-apparent. THE RA.MAYANA OP VAL.MIKI informed of the occasion siDI:e they would hear of it thereafter. Seated io the assembly, the king resembled Prajapati io the midst of his subjects. The kings of the earth coming together io council, King **DASARATHA** occupyiog the throne and they taking the places prepated for them, reverently faced the royal dais, observing the uaditions of the court. Surrounded by his feudal lords aod the elders, the king appeated like **INDRA** sittiog among the gods. CHAPTER The elders and C01111dllors fllillingly **SHRI RAMA** as regem IN ringing tones, Kiog **DASARATHA** addressed the leaders of the people seated before him, ntteriog words delightiog their hearts. When the aged llllldIUCb began to speak, his words resembled the beat of dsums, or the crashing of thunder, yet they were lilled with great sweetness withal and uttered io the manner of a king. **HE** *said*: " It is well known to you tbat this vast empire was upbeld by my predecesson and their fathen before them. To promote the prosperity aod felicity of the ltiogdom, formerly protected by the Kiogs of Ibhwaku, I, walking io the path trodden by my forbears, bave preserved it to the utmoSt. Haviog passed sixty thousand yean under the royal canopy, my body bas become old and feeble and seeks repose. The

CHAPTER 2

The elders and councillors willingly accept Shri Rama as regent

THE RA.MAYANA OP VAL.MIKI informed of the occasion siDI:e they would hear of it thereafter. Seated io the assembly, the king resembled Prajapati io the midst of his subjects. The kings of the earth

coming together io council, King **DASARATHA** occupyiog the throne and they taking the places prepated for them, reverently faced the royal dais, observing the uaditions of the court. Surrounded by his feudal lords aod the elders, the king appeated like **INDRA** sittiog among the gods. CHAPTER The elders and C01111dllors fllillingly **SHRI RAMA** as regem IN ringing tones, Kiog **DASARATHA** addressed the leaders of the people seated before him, ntteriog words delightiog their hearts. When the aged llllIDIUCb began to speak, his words resembled the beat of dsums, or the crashing of thunder, yet they were lilled with great sweetness withal and uttered io the manner of a king. **HE** *said*: " It is well known to you tbat this vast empire was upbeld by my predecesson and their fathen before them. To promote the prosperity aod felicity of the ltiogdom, formerly protected by the Kiogs of Ibhwaku, I, walking io the path trodden by my forbears, bave preserved it to the utmoSt. Haviog passed sixty thousand yean under the royal canopy, my body bas become old and feeble and seeks repose. The " I desire to install as regent, **RAMA**, eulted among men, elder brother of Labhmana, worthy to be your protector. In truth, I verily believe that not only the earth, but the three worlds will regard him as their lord. Desiring the joy of the universe, I shall lay upon him the weight of government and thus be freed from amiety concerning the ldngdom. " If tbis seems proper to you, give me your counsel or say what should otherwise be dooe. Though this be my decree, yet should you judge aught else to be a better way, then speak that I may know of it. The best course is well known to be determined after carefu1 deliberation." Hearing the words of King **DASARATHA**, the other monsrcha and elders cried in unison, " Exeellent, Exeellent ! " Upon tbis, a sound like distant thunder, pleasant to hear, or like the cry of peacocks delighting in the storm, arose. Thereafter, the purpose of the sovereign being communicated to all,

acclamations burst forth that shook the foundations of the palace. Then the learned btahmins, the ministers, !dugs and the elders of the city assembled for consultatinn with those who had come from afar, and being of one mind, after due deliberstino, thus addtessed the ldng : " O Mighty Sovereign, thou hast ruled for thousands of years and have now become old, do thou, therefore, appoint **RAMA** as regent. It is our chetished desire that the glorious Prince **RAMA** should be seen by us, riding on an elephant beneath the royal canopy." The ldng, wishing to fathntn their true motives, teplied with candour, saying : "Acting on my suggestion, you have all expressed your willingness to see **RAMA** appointed regent, yet thete is still some uncettainty in my mind ; tell me frankly why you desire to see **RAMA** crowned. Have I etted ? Have I failed to govern righteously ? " Then the elders of the people and the counsellors answered the sapcious sovereign **DASARATHA** in tbis wise : " O King, thy son is endowed with excellent attributes. Heat of the divine and amiable qualities of the wise and perfect **RAMACHANDRA**, qualities endearing him to aU and pleasing to teeord. 'rHll li.A.MAYANA OF VALMIKI " In his love and zeal for truth, he is equal to **INDRA**. Thou, O King, art exalted above all in the House of Ikshwaku, yet none in the world practises righteousness as does **SHRI RAMA**. "By his conduct, he has added lustre to virtue and prosperity. Di1fusiDg happiness among his people, he resembles the moon delighting the earth. Inforbesrance,heis like the earth, in wisdom like Brihaspati, in valour like lndra. With a deep regard for truth, free from envy and jealousy, his disposition is excellent. " Forgiving every injury, a comforrer of the a111icted and the distt'esled. he addresses all with gentleness. Acknowledging every favour recdved in :full measure, self-conttolled, uue to his word whatever betide, speaking no ill of others, of candid utterance, :full of wisdom he ever reveres the aged. "

Of immeasurable renown, **SHRI RAMA**, whose glory and splendour constantly inrease, who in the science of archery is superior even to the gods, asnras and men, who has studied all the branches of learning and the Veda, is also unequalled in the art of music. The abode of peace and prosperity, ever courteous, humble and wise, and who, having recdved the highest instruction from the *brahmins*, is skilful in expounding the meaning of the Veda. " When in company with Latshmana, he goes to the attack, storming towns and villages, he never withdraws without wholly defeating the enemy. 1l.etumiDg triumphant, he enquires after the welfare of his subjects as if they were his own sons, and gives special thought to the well-being of women, servants and his disciples as a father regards the needs of his family. " O Sire, **SHRI RAMA** gracioualy enquires respecting our own disciples whether they render us proper service and hospitality and forther discharge their duties faithfully. " He suffers with the a111icted and rejoices like a parent when his people hold a festival. That mighty archer, the observer of truth, the servant of the aged, who blesses all those who seek his protection, is wholly righteous. Performing noble deeds, he will not hear or utter words that create discord. Possessing a charming brow and large eyes, in this resembling **VISHNU** himself, **RAMA**, by the procesa of deduction, is able to converse with eloquence. By his courage, prowess, self-rcliance and patience, he has become the delight of his people. 154 " Ever ready tu serve his subjects, scorning sensual plessures, he is able to rule the three worlds, bow much more this tiny eanh? " His joy and anger are never excited without cause. He destroys those meriting death, but shows mercy to the innocent. " Liberal to those who have found favour with him ; willing to suffer in the exercise of self-control ; beloved of his subjects, he evokes devotion in every virtuous hesrt. " Brilliant as the moon by reason of his excellent attributes, the eanh

claims him as her lord. " O King, thou art fortunate in possessing this great son who resembles Kashyapa, the son of Marichi. The people of Ayodhya and the citizens of the kingdom ofKoshala continually pray for Rams's life and well-being. " Men, women, the aged and those from far and ncar, at dawn and eventide, unitedly pray to all the gods that **SHRI RAMA** may ever be attended by prosperity. O Great King, graciously accede to our request. O Giver of boons, beg thee to install **SHRI RAMA** as without delay. Thy son, resembling Shri **VISHNU** himself, is benevolent and generous to all. O King, do this with a cheerful mind." CHAPTIR 3 TM 11i1!1 ruolws Sltri Rllln4 shall be instalkd To those who with joined palms were making this petition, King **DASARATHA** answered courteously :

CHAPTER 3

The king resolves Shri Rama shall be installed

" **E**ver ready tu serve his subjects, scorning sensual plessures, he is able to rule the three worlds, bow much more this tiny eanh? " His joy and anger are never excited without cause. He destroys those meriting death, but shows mercy to the innocent. " Liberal to those who have found favour with him ; willing to suffer in the exercise of self-control ; beloved of his subjects, he evokes devotion in every virtuous hesrt. " Brilliant as the moon by reason of his excellent attributes, the eanh claims him as her lord. " O King, thou art fortunate in possessing this great son who resembles Kashyapa, the son of Marichi. The people of Ayodhya and the citizens of the kingdom ofKoshala continually pray for Rams's life and well-being. " Men, women, the aged and those from far and ncar, at dawn and eventide, unitedly pray to all the gods that **SHRI**

RAMA may ever be attended by prosperity. O Great King, graciously accede to our request. O Giver of boons, beg thee to install **SHRI RAMA** as without delay. Thy son, resembling Shri **VISHNU** himself, is benevolent and generous to all. O King, do this with a cheerful mind." CHAPTIR 3 TM 11i1!1 ruolws Sltri Rllln4 shall be instalkd To those who with joined palms were making this petition, King **DASARATHA** answered courteously : THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI After the king had spoken, the people applsuded, and when the shouts of acclamation had died away, the monarch addressed the mighty Sage Vasishtba, saying : " O messed Lord, it is meet that thou ahouldest order those things needful for the coronation ceremony." Then Shri Vaaiahtha commanded the ministers in attendance to provide gold, gems, unguents, garlsnds of white flowers, parched rice, honey and clarified butter in separate vessels, also new cloths, chariots, weapons of all kinds, a complete army, elephants free from any imperfection, white flags, a white canopy, chamaras,' a hundred vessels of gold shining like fire, bulls with pded horns, lion skins and other requisites. Then the Sage Vaaiahtha commanded them, saying : " Plsce all these in the !ling's sacred psvilion. Let every gate in the capital and the private apartments of the pslace be decorated with garlsnds and sandalwood, and let fragrant incense be kindled everywhere. "O Ye Accompliahed Ministers, provide sweet and health givingfoods, milks and curds in attractive dishes sufficient to feed a hundred thousand *brahmins*. To-morrow the holy *brahmins* should be respectfully served with butter, curdled milk and parched rice, and presented with as much dakshina as will preserve them from want for the remainder of their lives. "To-morrow, early in the morning, the Peace Chant should be recited, therefore, let the holy *brahmins* be invited and their seats prepared. Let banners and arches of flowers be displsyed everywhere, and the roads

sprinkled with water. Let beautifully attired singing girls with their attendants wait at the gates of the psisce ; let food and cooliog drinks be provided at all the principal aossroads, also gifts of money and ritual objects that are considered sacred ; let fruit and flowers be sent separately ; let armed warriors clothed in clean raiment and armed with scimitars, wait in the courtyard of the king." In this manner, Shri Vaaiahtha and Sbri Vamadeva performed allthathadbeenrequiredbythekingand,everythingbeingcarried out to their aatisfaction, they informed the p-eat monarch accord ingly. Then the illustrious sovereign aaid to the ptime minister SUIIIIDUII : " Let the accompiiahed Prince **RAMA** be bfouPt here with all speed." Acquiescing in the royal command, Sumantra brought thither in a royal chariot that great warrior, **SHRI RAMA**. Surrounded by the rulers of the earth, the east, the west, the north and the south, the kings of aryan and non-aryan descent and those from the forests and the hills, King **DASARATHA** looked like Iudra in the midst of the gods. He beheld his son Shri Ramachaudra, handsome, valorous, of mighty length of arm, fearless, walking like au intoxicated elephant, his couuteuauce resembling the moon, fair to look upon, captivating the hearts of all by his virtue and generosity, refreshing his subjects as clouds refresh thoae atllicted with the heat. The monarch could not gaze sulliciently on his beloved son as he, attended by Sumantra who followed him with reverence, alighted fiQm his chariot and ascended the sreps of the royal palace which resembled Mount Kailasha. Approaching the king he announced his name and made profound obeisance at his feet. Seeing the prince standing respectfully at his side, the king embraced him and asked him to occupy the golden throne set with jewels and gold. Raghava thus seated looked like the sun rising on the Sumeru mountain. The whole assembly was illumined by the presence of **SHRI RAMA** who resembled

the moon riding in the autumn sty filled with innumerable stars. As a man adorned with many ornaments is overjoyed with delight to see his own image rellected in a mirror, so was King **DASARATHA** filled with ineffable delight when beholding the glory of his son ; and like Kashyapa addressing Iudra, the mighty sovereign smilingly spoke to **RAMA** : " O My Sou, thou art the offspring of my ehief queen and do resemble her, thou art exceediugly dear to me, endowed as thou art with all the great attributes, thou hast imbued thy people as though they took place before thine eyes. Give pleasure to thy people by filling the various storehouses and arsenals. O Prince, that sovereign who rules his subjects with due regard to their happiness causes his friends to rejoice like the gods who have drunk the nectar of immortality. Wherefore, O my Child, conduct thyself with a mind fully subdued." Then, the friends of Rams acquainted Queen **KAUSHALYA** of the king's resolve and she rewarded the messengers of these good tidings with many cows and gems. Shri Rams, bearing the Icing's words, answered: " So be it," and, bowing to the grest monareb, left the palace in his chariot, the people greeting him with joy as be passed by. Satisfied with the sovereign's decree, they acclaimed him with salutations and returning to their homes worshipped their gods, propitiating them so that no impediment shol!,ld arise in the installation of Sbri Rams as regent.

CHAPTER 4

Shri Rama and Princess Sita prepare for the ceremony

in the ascendant, I decree, therefore, that the lotus-eyed Rams sball then be installed as my successor." Dismissing his counsellors, the king,

entering the inner apartment, commanded Sumantra to bring Rams to him once more. In obedience to the command of his royal master, Sumantra repsired to the palace of **RAMA**, to bring him thither. **RAMA**, bearing the doorkeeper announce the second visit of the minister, became anxious and seading fur him with all baste inquired ofhim the purport ofhis coming. Sumantra answered, saying : " The king desires to see thee." **SHRI RAMA** thereupon hastily repsired to the palace of his royal parent. King **DASARATHA** retiring to the private apartment, isaued instructiona that Rams should be brousbt thither. The prince, 158 entering his ather's palace, bowed low, with joined palms, from a distance, and contemplated his sire. The king, raising him up, embraced him and, giving him a seat, again addressed him : " O Prince, I have now grown old and have ruled long, enjoying all the pleasures of the heart. I have also performed hundreds of sacrifices and distributed great quantities of food and lavish gifts as alms to the *brahmins*. O Great One, a son such as thou art, is the fruit of much charity and study of the Veda. O Most Excellent One, what I desired to give in charity, I have given, and I have studied the Veda and offered up many sacrifices. My desire for pleasure is past ; I have discharged every obligation to the gods, the sages, my ancestors and the learned brabmins, nothing remains to be accomplished by me but thine installation. O My Son, heat me, it is the will of my people that thou become their sovereign ; I shall, therefore, install thee as my successor. Nevertheless, O **RAMA**, fearful dreams have visited me at night, attended by the roar of thunder and the falling of meteors, signs betokening opposition. O Ramo, the star of my birth is surrounded by the sun, Mars and Rahu ; those versed in divination speak of it as of evil augury, that portends either the desth of a king or the visitation of some grave calamity. O Prince of Raghu, I desire to see thee crowned before my senses fail. Verily, the mind of man is inconstant.

To-day, the astrologers announce that Purnavasu is in the ascendant, but to-morrow it will be the Pushya star, auspicious to thy coronation. I desire thee, therefore, to be proclaimed regent to-morrow. Do thou, from now on, lilst with thy spouse, passing the night on a bed of kusha grass, with a stone for thy pillow. It is the duty of the friends surrounding thee to guard thee. In such undertakings many obstructions arise. " Prince **BHARATA** is in the city of his grandsire, it is my will that thou be installed in his absence. Thy btotber, Bbarata. is virtuous, compassionate, master of his senses and obedient to thee, yet, O Prince, I know the mind of man to be fickle, even the mind of a righteous and devout man may be subject to inconstancy. To-morrow, thy coronation shall take place, therefore, now return to thy abode." King **DASARATHA** having thus spoken, **SHRI RAMA** left for his palace. Entering his own abode, anxious to acquaint Janaki with the king's proposal and not finding the princess in bet own aparunent, **RAMA** repaired to the palace of his mothet. Thete he beheld the Queen **KAUSHALYA**, seated in the temple, obsetving the vow of silence and praying for bet son's welfare. Acquainted with the sovereign's decree, Shri **LAKSHMANA** and Sumitta wete already in the palace of the chief queen, and **SITA** also having been summoned thither was sitting at bet side. Queen **KAUSHALYA** attended by Queen **SUMITRA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA**, having heard that **SHRI RAMA** would be installed when the Pushya star was in the ascendant, was meditating on Narayana, with closed eyes and controlled breathing. **SHRI RAMA**, approaching his mother, paid revetence to bet and joyfully exclaimed: " O Mothet, my fathet has commanded me to SetVe the people and to-morrow I am to take up the burden of govetnment. Shri **VASISHTHA**, my preceptor, and othet sages have ordained that the Princess **SITA** should, tbis night, fast with me. At dawn, the Princess **SITA** and I will carry out those prayers and rites proper to the occasion."

Queen **KAUSHALYA**, long desirous of this event, with tean of joy llowing from bet eyes, answered : " O My Beloved Son **RAMA**, mayest thou live long and may all thine enemies perish. Acquiring the throne, mayest thou bring joy to thy friends, relatives and also Queen **SUMITRA**. O Child, surely thou wert born under an auspicious star since thou hast won favour with thy royal sire by thine ""ccllent attributes. The putpose of my devotion and austerity, undertaken to please the lotus-eyed Narayana, has been fullilled to-day inasmuch as thou art about to obrain the kingdom of the dynasty of Raghu." Sbri **RAMA** listening to his mother's words, smilingly addressed Shri **LAKSHMANA**, he who ever paid honout to his fathet, and said : " O **LAKSHMANA**, share with me the government of the kingdom, thou art my second self, the dominion is equally thine. O Brother, I desire life and a kingdom for thy sake." Thereaftet, **SHRI RAMA**, bowing to the two queens, with their permission withdtew with **SITA** to his own aparunent. CHAPTER S On Vasirllth4's adrJice they obmve afaJt KING DASARATRA, having acquainted his son Rams with the knowledge of his approaching regency, now called his spiritual preceptor, Shri **VASISHTHA**, and addressed him, saying: " O Sage, whose only wealth is ansterity, gracionsly approach Shri Rams and canse him to observe a fast with Princeas **SITA** in prepatation for his coronation." Shri **VASISHTHA** answering, " Be it so ", went himself to Shri Rams's palace. Ascending a chariot drawn by two horses, he drove to the palace, and entering by the three gates, approached the abode of Raghava, white as a cloud. Shri Rams hearing of the arrival of his preceptor, speedily went forth to welcome him and offer him due obeisance. Taking him by the hand, he assisted him to alight from the chariot and, studying his mood, made enquiries as to his well-being. The venerable **VASISHTHA** *said*: "O Rams, thy royal parent is gracions to thee, to-morrow thou shalt be

proclaimed ruler of the kingdom, do thou observe a fast to-day. To-morrow, King **DASARATHA** will install thee as regent, as Nahnsha of old made over his kingdom to Yayati." ' ' Having uttered these words, the knower of truth, the sovereign of *munis*, requested Rams and **SITA** to observe a fast that night. Then Shri **RAMACHANDRA** respectfully saluted Shri **VASISHTHA**, and the royal preceptor accepting his salutation departed for his abode. Conversing delightfnlly with his friends, Shri Rams, when requested by them, retired to the inner apartments. The palace of Raghava waa crowded with joyful men and women, and resembled a lake filled with lotuses visited by innumerable birds. Leaving the palace, Shri **VASISHTHA** perceived the streets to be filled with people. All the roads entering Ayodhya were so crowded with spectatOrs eager to wimeas Shri Rams's coronation that none could pass to and fro without difticulty. The sound of the multitudes shouting with joy, filling the highways, resembled die l'lllring of the sea.

CHAPTER 5

On Vasishtha's advice they observe a fast

CHAPTER S On Vasirllth4's adrJice they obmve afaJt KING DASARATRA, having acquainted his son Rams with the knowledge of his approaching regency, now called his spiritual preceptor, Shri **VASISHTHA**, and addressed him, saying: " O Sage, whose only wealth is ansterity, gracionsly approach Shri Rams and canse him to observe a fast with Princeas **SITA** in prepatation for his coronation." Shri **VASISHTHA** answering, " Be it so ", went himself to Shri Rams's palace. Ascending a chariot drawn by two horses, he drove to the palace, and entering by the three gates, approached the abode of Raghava, white as a cloud. Shri

Rams hearing of the arrival of his preceptor, speedily went forth to welcome him and offer him due obeisance. Taking him by the hand, he assisted him to alight from the chariot and, studying his mood, made enquiries as to his well-being. The venerable **VASISHTHA** *said*: “O Rams, thy royal parent is gracions to thee, to-morrow thou shalt be proclaimed ruler of the kingdom, do thou observe a fast to-day. To-morrow, King **DASARATHA** will install thee as regent, as Nahnsha of old made over his kingdom to Yayati.” ' ' Having uttered these words, the knower of truth, the sovereign of *munis*, requested Rams and **SITA** to observe a fast that night. Then Shri **RAMACHANDRA** respectfully saluted Shri **VASISHTHA**, and the royal preceptor accepting his salutation departed for his abode. Conversing delightfnlly with his friends, Shri Rams, when requested by them, retired to the inner apartments. The palace of Raghava waa crowded with joyful men and women, and resembled a lake filled with lotuses visited by innumerable birds. Leaving the palace, Shri **VASISHTHA** perceived the streets to be filled with people. All the roads entering Ayodhya were so crowded with spectatOrs eager to wimeas Shri Rams’s coronation that none could pass to and fro without difticulty. The sound of the multitudes shouting with joy, filling the highways, resembled die l’lllring of the sea. All the streets of the capital were swept and sprinkled with water ; on either side, llower garlands were banging, and every house was decorsted with flags and banners. Men and women, children and the aged, all anxiously awaiting the dawn, so thst they might witness the sacred ceremony, looked forward with eagerness to the great festival thst would promote their bappiness. The priest Shri Vasishths, avoiding the crowded streets, at length reaehed the royal palace. Ascending the balcony which resembled a white cloud, he greeted the king as Bribaspati pays homage to lndrs. Seeing the sage approaching, the king rose and enquired as to

what **SHRI RAMA** had said. Shri Vasishths answered, “All is prepared ". Ao the king rose from his throne, the whole assembly stood up to honour the venerable sage. Having heard his spiritual preceptor’s report, the king, dismissing the court, withdrew to the inner apartment, as a lion enters its cave. Entering those gorgeous and richly ornamented apartments equal to one of Indrs’s palaces, he resembled the moon gliding through the heavens. CBAPTBR 6 Th4 city of Ayod/lyt1 is deeortlled for the proclamation

CHAPTER 6

The city of Ayodhya is decorated for the proclamation

All the streets of the capital were swept and sprinkled with water ; on either side, llower garlands were banging, and every house was decorsted with flags and banners. Men and women, children and the aged, all anxiously awaiting the dawn, so thst they might witness the sacred ceremony, looked forward with eagerness to the great festival thst would promote their bappiness. The priest Shri Vasishths, avoiding the crowded streets, at length reaehed the royal palace. Ascending the balcony which resembled a white cloud, he greeted the king as Bribaspati pays homage to lndrs. Seeing the sage approaching, the king rose and enquired as to what **SHRI RAMA** had said. Shri Vasishths answered, “All is prepared ". Ao the king rose from his throne, the whole assembly stood up to honour the venerable sage. Having heard his spiritual preceptor’s report, the king, dismissing the court, withdrew to the inner apartment, as a lion enters its cave. Entering those gorgeous and richly ornamented apartments equal to one of Indrs’s palaces, he

resembled the moon gliding through the heavens. CBAPTBR 6 Th4 city of Ayod/lyt1 is deeortlled for the proclamation devotions and silently repeated the Gayatri. As the sun rose, clad in silken garmentB, they saluted Shri Narayana abiding in the golden orb and then insrructed the learned *brahmins* to recite the Peace Chant and other prayers. The deep and melodious sound of the Peace Chant, recited by the *brahmins*, mingling with the beat of drums, filled the capital of Ayodhya. The inhabitants of the city, knowing that **RAMA** and **SITA** were observing a fast and offering devotion to the Lord, were filled with joy. On the dawning of day, the citizens brought banyan trees, setting them up as pillars to adorn the city for the coming coronation. The high temples resembling the Himalayan peaks, the stately houses, the highways, the crcscentB and strcetB, the shops filled with merchandise, the mansions where members of the royal family dwelt, the public assembly halls and the taU trees were an hung with Oags of different colours which fiutrcred in the breeze. Here and there, companies of actors and dancers gave pleasure to the people by singiog sweetly and playing melodiously on their instrumentB. In the market, in the houses, at home and abroad, an spoke only of the coming proclamation of **SHRI RAMA** as ruler. Children playing in front of their homes also chattered about this matter. In honour of the occasion, the roads were atrcwn with fiowcrs, and rendered fragrant with incense and pleasant odours ; lamps were placed here and there lest the royal procession should psss through at night. Having decorated the city, the inbabitantB awaiting the proclamation, came together in public assemblies or stood on raised tribunes. Praising King **DASARATHA**, they said : " That mighty King **DASARATHA** of the dynaaty of Ikswaku is indeed a pious man. Realising he has grown old, he, himself, is installing **RAMA** as ruler. How gracious is our king that he is placing us under the rule of Shri Ramacbandra. May the Lord long

protect the prince as our ruler. **SHRI RAMA** is simple, highly 1carncd. devoted to righteousness and affectionate to hia brothers. Virtuous and wise, **SHRI RAMA** loves ua as his own brethren. May the righteous and sinlcas King **DASARATHA** live long, by whoae grace, we see **RAMA** enthroned to-day." Hearing the praisca of King Daaaratha by the people, those 163 living fitt distant were attracted to the holy ceremony and flocked to see the royal procession, filling the city of Ayodha Purl. On the day of the full moon, the tumult of the multitude was like the roar of the ocean. People coming from fitt and nesr to Ayodhya which resembled the city of Amaravati, enhanced the beauty of the capital as aquatic creatures add to the beauty of the sea.

CHAPTER 7

The hunchback maid, Manthara, informs Queen Kaikeyi of Shri Rama's coming installation

AT this time, Queen **KAIKEYI** had a female servant who had accompanied her from the abode of her royal parent and was ever in attendance on the queen. Her name was **MANTHARA**. By chance, ascending the balcony of the palace which resembled the full moon, she perceived lhe capital of Ayodhya adomed with garlands of lotuses and the principal streetS sprinkled with water. Flags were fluttering from the tops of the tall houses, the roads levclled, and the wide crowded with people. Holy *brahmin* carrying auspicious gifts were waiting to offer them to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** ; the temples were painted white and strains of musical instruments resounded everywhere. Elated by the festivities, joyful crowds were singing the Vedic mantras and not only men but elephants, horses and cattle demonstrated their joy in their own

peculiar fashion. Large flags bound with flowers were being carried by joyous citizens wandering here and there. **MANTHARA** was amazed to see these unusual activities and, meeting **SHRI RAMA**'s royal nurse gaily dressed in a white silken robe, she enquired of her, aaying: "Why is the wealthy Queen **KAUSHALYA**, mother of Shri Rams, distributing immense ricllea in charity to-day ? Why are the people of the capital so joyous ? What is the happy king about to accomplish ? " The royal nurse, overcome with joy at that time, told the 164 hunchbacked Mantbara of **RAMA**'s enthronement. **SHE** *said*: " To-morrow, at dawn, under the Pushya star, King **DASARATHA** will install the sinless **RAMA**, the subduer of anger, as *Yuvaraja*." The words of the nurse filled the hunchbacked woman with jealous wrath. Speedily descending from the high palace which resembled Mt. Kailasa, that sinful woman, consumed with malice, entered the bedchamber of Queen **KAIKEYI** and, waking her, thus addressed her: " Why art thou sleeping, O Deluded One ? Thou art in imminent peril ; art thou blind to future suffering ? O Fair One, the good fortune which thou vauntest is about to pass away, like a river that is dried up in the summer season." Queen **KAIKEYI**, pained by the bitter words of the sinful hunchbacked maid, answered her saying : " O **MANTHARA**, is all well ? Why do I behold thee with a gloomy mien, what is the cause of thy distress ? " Hearing the gentle accents of Queen **KAIKEYI**, Mantbara, who was full of cunning, assuming a sorrowful mien and feigning friendship for the queen, spoke bitterly, "O Devi, a great calamity bas befallen thee. Hear me ! King **DASARATHA** is about to proclaim Shri **RAMACHANDRA** as regent. I am immersed in the bottomless sea of fear ; I am afflicted with pain and sorrow ; I am as if scorched by fire, and for thy good I have come hither. O **KAIKEYI**, thy woes are my woes, thy sorrows my sorrows, of this I am certain. Hearken ! Thou art the daughter of a great royal House and thou art the

favourite of King **DASARATHA**. Why art thou deceived by his crafty ways ? Outwardly, thy husband appears to be a speaker of truth, but, inwardly, he is a deceitful man. His speech is fair, but his heart is hard. Thy honesty is the cause of thy suffering. Prevailing on thee .by specious words, the king visits thee and speaks insincere words to thee. By delivering the kingdom to Kausl)alya's son, be seeks to make her mistress of all. Like an a1fectionate mother, thou hast nourished in thy lap the enemy that is called thy lord. Thou resemblest the one who pressed a serpent to her bosom deeming it, through illusion, to be her infant. As a snake or an enemy harms the one who bas spared him, so has King **DASARATHA** to-day dealt with thee and thy son. 165 This sinful, deceitful monarch will destroy thee, thy son and thy relatives, who are worthy of happiness, by enthroning Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. O Thou of Deluded Intellect, ever indifferent to thine own good, hear me, there is yet time. Whatever thou can'st do for thine own advantage perform and thus protect thy son and me." Hearing the worda of Mantbara, the beautiful queen rose from her couch, like the autumnal moon. Filled with wonder and delight, she took from her person a precious ornament and presented it to the hunchback woman. That lovely one, unequalled in beauty among youthful women, said to Mantbara : " O **MANTHARA**, thou hast brought me joyful tidings. Tell me, what I can offer thee in return for these pleasing worda ? I find no difference between **RAMA** and Bbarata. I am, therefore, fully sstisfied if the king installs Shri Ramachandrs. O Dear One, nothing is more pleasing to me than the news of **SHRI RAMA**'s enthronement. Ask for whatever pleases thee, and I will confer it on thee."

CHAPTER 8

Manthara persuades the queen that Bharata should be regent and Prince Rama banished

SHRI RAMA is well-versed in affairs of state, and acts promptly in his own interests. Knowing the dsnger threatening **BHARATA** from **RAMA**, I am filled with dread. “To-day, Queen Kausbalys is fonunate indeed ; her son will be enthroned by the holy *brahmins* at dswn, when the Pushys star is in the ascendant. Thereafter, thou sbalt have to stand in complete submission lilte a stone, before Queen Kausbalys whose enemies will be subdued. Thus, not only thou, but the virtuous Prince **BHARATA** will become a servant and dependent on the Queen Kausbalya. The women of **SHRI RAMA**’s householcl will be filled with joy, but thy daughters in-law, having no status, will suffer great anxiety and sorrow.” Queen **KAIKEYI** believing **MANTHARA** really be benevolently disposed to her, began to extol the great vittues of **RAMACHANDRA**, saying : " **SHRI RAMA** instructed by his holy Guru is truly righteous, grateful, truthful and pious ; he, the eldest son of the king, assuredly deserves to be made regent. May he live long ! He will ever proteCt his brothers and servants as a father protects his chilclren. O Kubija, why thou jealous ofRama’s coronation ? After a hundred years, **BHARATA** will inherit the throne of his illustrious ancestors. Why thou sad on such a joyful occasion, O **MANTHARA** ? Shri **RAMACHANDRA** is as dear to me as is **BHARATA**, he serves me with greater zeal even than he does Queen Kausbalys. If **SHRI RAMA** ascends the throne, it is as if **BHARATA** ruled the land ; **SHRI RAMA** regards his brother as himself.” Hearing the Queen’s words, **MANTHARA** intensely provoked, sighed deeply and said : " O

Stupid One, thou deemest adversity to be prosperity, thou art sinking in an ocean of suffering and THB RA.M.AYANA OF VAL.M.IKI of all comfon, will be ast forth from the royal dynasty to suffer. I have come to tell thee this for thy good and thou dost not comprehend it. If thou wen wise, thou wouldst not reward me with this jewel on account of the increased prosperity of thy rival. Assuredly when **RAMA** assumes the regency, he will either banish Prince **BHARATA** or have him put to death. Through proximity people acquire affection even for inanimste objects, but thou didst send thy son in his childhood to thy fathet's house. " Prince Shatruglma bas accompanied **BHARATA** ; **LAKSHMANA** follows **RAMA** as Sbatruglma follows **BHARATA**. It is said that a tree marked down for felling by the dwellers of the forest is preserved by the prozimity of the thorny ishika bushes. Thus will **LAKSHMANA** ever protect **RAMA**, and **RAMA** in return will preserve **LAKSHMANA**. These two brothers love each other as do the Aswins ; this is well known. **RAMA** will, therefore, seek to harm **BHARATA** though he will ever protect **LAKSHMANA**. I, therefore, consider it were best for **BHARATA** to escape to the forest. If **RAMA** succeed to his father's kingdom, how may thy welfare and that of thy relatives be assured ? To thee **BHARATA** is a child worthy of happiness but to **RAMA** he is a rival. When **RAMA** is king, Bbarata will not live long. It becomes thee, therefore, O Queen, to protect Prince **BHARATA**, as the leader of a herd of elepbanta protects it from the lion's spring. Prompted by pride, thou bast in the past slighted Queen Kaushalys ; dost thou think she will spare thee when she is chief queen ? O Beautiful One, note well when **RAMA** obtains the kingdom togethet with its mountains, seas and valleys, then thou and thy son, Prince **BHARATA**, will suffer ignominy. Assuredly, when Rams is king, Prince **BHARATA** will be deprived of life, therefore, act so that **RAMA** may be exiled to the forest and **BHARATA** obtain the kingdom."

CHAPTER 9

Queen Kaikeyi is resolved upon her evil design

TBB face of Queen **KAIKEYI** ftushed with anger, and sighing deeply, she said to Manthsra : " To-day, I shall indeed banish **RAMA** and CDSure thst Bhsrata be proclaimed regent. O Manthsra, how may Bhsrata become regent, and **RAMA** be deprived of the kingdom ? " Hesring these words, the sinful Mantbara, bent upon the complete destruction of Shri Rams, said to the queen : " Hear, O **KAIKEYI**, I will unfold to thee the only course which willlesd to the coronation of Prince Bhsrata. O **KAIKEYI**, hsst thou forgotten thst which thou hsst often relsted to me ? O Lover of Poesy, if it be thy desire to hear the tale from my lips, listen and then take action." Thus addressed, Queen **KAIKEYI**, rising from her couch, replied : " O Mantbara, relste by what means **BHARATA** may acquire the throne and **SHRI RAMA** suffer eclipse." Then the wicked Manthsra, desirous of doing injury to Rams, said : " Formerly when thy husband was engaged in a war between the *devas* and *asuras*, he supported the cause of lndra. He took thee with him and I accompanied thee. O Kaikeyj, to the south, in the Dandaka forest, there ruled a king named Timidwaja in his capital Bijayanta. He was versed in the magic named Shambara, and he was unconquerable by the gods. He waged war on **INDRA** and in the great conllict the *asuras*, at night, carried off the wounded from their beds and slew them. King Dasaraths fought great battles with these *asuras* who pierced his body many times with their weapons. He, failing un conscious, thou, O Devi, brought him from the battlefield and when they stili asaailed him, didst skiifully preserve him. O Beautiful One, then the king, thy lord, well pleased with thee, prolfered thee two boons, and thou didst answer : ' I shall elsim

thetn when the need arises.' " I was not then acquainted with this matter, but thou didat later relste it to me. Prompted by my love for thee, I have I6f treasured all this in my memory. Now, demand the cessation of preparations for Shri Rams's enthronement. For the first boon ask for the proclamation of **BHARATA** as regent, and for the second the banishment of **RAMA** for fourteen years. During the period of his ezile, men will grow to love thy son and his rule will be assured. " O, Danghter of a Mighty King, entering the cbamber of wrath, clad in soiled raiment, east thyself on the bare ground. On the entrance of the king, neither look at nor speak to him but, rolling on the ground, continue to weep. Doubdess thou art very dear to thy lord who, for thy aske, would enter a raging fire. The king would never provoke thee nor can he bear to see thee weep. He would sacrifice life itaelf for thy sake. The king cannot be indifferent to thy requests. O Indolent One, test the power of thy besuty to-day ; but have a care lest the king offer thee diamonds, pearls, gu1d and other gems, and be not caught in the snare of greed. " O Fortunate One, remind the king of the two boons promised to thee on the hatdefield ; strive hard for the success of thine undertaking. If the king would lift thee up, let him on oath renew his promise. Do thou say to him : ' O Grest King, send **RAMA** into ezile for fourteen years and mate **BHARATA** ruler of the kingdom.' " Whilst **RAMA** is absent, the rule ofBharata will be established and he will reign forever. O Beautiful One, demand the ezile of **RAMA**, from King **DASARATHA**, and all will be wcll with thy son. Men will forget their love for **RAMA** and will cease to care for him, and **BHARATA** will have no enemy anywhere. When **SHRI RAMA** returns, the supremacy of **BHARATA** will be firmly estab lished ; ruling with love, he will inspire affection and many friends will support him. Therefore, O Queen, questioned by the king, fearlessly and firmly demand thst the preparations for Rams's enthronement be terminsted."

KAIKEYI, thus prevailed upon to execute the evil design of **MANTHARA** and fully prepared to comply with it, followed her counsel as a young chicken follows iu mother. The besutiful queen, aggrieved thst the king had not consulted her concerning wisest. O Kubija, as yet. I fail to comprehend the king's real intention. Deformed women arc usually sinfbl and perverse, but thou, O Kubija, art unique, resembling a lotus bending to the brcczc. In spite of thy physical defect, thou art not to be despised. It would seem that thy slender waist, bashfUl of thy full rounded bosom, had withdrawn itself. O Manthata, thy face is like the fuJI moon, thou art indeed lovely, thy body is smooth, thy waist decorated with a girdle, thy thighs arc long, thy limbs slender. O **MANTHARA**, when thou walkest before me, clad in a silken sari, reaching to thy ankles, thou art as graceful as a swan. "Acquainted with every grace and blandishment, thy hump protruding like the hub of a wheel is surely filled with wisdom, diplomacy and understanding. I, therefore, present thee with" a gold chain to adorn it. "O Lovely Woman, whco **BHARATA** becomes king and **RAMA** goes into exile, I will cover thy hump with beaten gold. When I am certain of tbc success of my undertaking, I will apply sandalwood paste to thy hump, and to thy forehead a diadem of gold and gems. " O Kubija, I will give thee ornaments of pure gold ; thus attired and adorned thou shalt be free to Jive as thou pleaseth. Thou shalt put my sister queens to shame and precede them with pride. O Thou whose face is incomparably beautiful, thou art a rival of tbc fuJI moon. O Defurmcd One, many huoch backcd women wearing golden ornaments shall attend thee as thy handmaids." Thus flattctcd, **MANTHARA** reclining on a white couch, glowing like an altar flame, spoke : " O Fortuoate One, it is useless to construct a dam whco the water has run away, therefore, enter on thine undertaking immediately. Go wait upon tbc king in the chsmbcr of wrath." Thus

prompted by Kubija, tbc beautiful-eyed Queen Ksikeyi, filled with ambition, entered the chsmbcr of wrath with **MANTHARA**. There, inspitcd by tbc huochbsckcd woman, casting her pearl nccldace of itnmcasurable value on tbc ground, the queen rnlling on tbc floor, addressed her : " O Kubija, either **RAMA** shall go into cxiJc and **BHARATA** obtain the kingdom, or King **DASARATHA** will have news of my death. I shall neither put on ornamcna, nor parblke of delicious dishes ; if **RAMA** is installcd, it sball be the end of my life." **MANTHARA** continued to instruct Kaikcyi in the most cracl manner, uttering words hostile to **RAMA**. " Know wcll, O Fortunate One, should **RAMA** become ruler, it will mean encllcss sulfcring for thee and thy son. Therefore exert thyself to overthrow him., The queen, wonnded by the shaftS of Manthsra's words, placing both hands on her heart, replied angrily : " O Kubija, either thou shalt bear the news of my dcsth to the king, or **RAMA** sball be exiled and Bbarata enthroned. If **RAMA** be not exiled, then I sball neither sleep on a bed not wear flowing garmcna, nor apply sandalwood paste nor antimony to my person. Except Bbarata be enthroned, I sball neither est nor drink. If this is not accomplished, I do not desire to live." Having fumly resolved this, casting her ornaments to the ground, she, herself, lay down like a fallen kinnari.' Her face vci1ccl in wrath, her body stripped of its garlands and jewels, the queen resembled the sky bereft of sun and starS.

CHAPTER 10

The king is deeply afflicted at the sight of the weeping queen

INCITBD by **MANTHARA**, **KAIKEYI**, like a kinnari, continued to roll on the ground as if wounded by a poisoned arrow. Tbe artful queen, devising a plan, gradually unfolded her design to **MANTHARA**. Hcsving deep sighs, like a python, **MANTHARA** was filled with satisfilction, perceiving her favourite, Kaikcyi, resolved on her evil coune of action. Rcllecting on the matter, torn with jcalousy, the queen, pluck· attired in soiled raiment with her hair dishevelled, she resembled a nymph fallen from heaven. The king, having given his instructions for the installation of **SHRI RAMA**, dismissed the court and entered the inner apartments of the queens to inform them of the great occasion. Anxious to impart the good tidings to his bclovcd consorts, the illustrious King **DASARATHA** entered the inner apartment, first going to the beautiful abode of **KAIKEYI**. As the moon sails into a clear sky after eclipse, so did the king enter the apartment of Queen **KAIKEYI**. He passed through the garden made beautiful by parrots, peacocks, swans and cranes. Music was softly playing, while dwarfed and hunchbacked maids passed to and fro. There were leafy bowers and alcoves on whose walls were painted beautiful pictures. Everywhere champaka' and asoka enhanced the view, whilst other trees were laden with blossom and fruit. AltarS of ivory, silver and gold with springs of water ftowing by seats inlaid with precious metals and costly jewels, where delicious food and drink was constantly served, transformed the palace into paradise itself. The king entered the inner apartments, but did not perceive the queen on the couch where desire had caused him to seek her. Calling loudly and receiving no answer, he grew sad; never before had **KAIKEYI** missed the time of dalliance, never before had the king found the apartment deserted. The monarch desiring to know where the queen was, questioned a maidservant, who replied with fear and submission : " O Sire, she has entered the chamber of wrath." On hearing these words, the

heart of the sovereign was exceedingly troubled. Restless and agitated in mind, the king bowed with sorrow entered the chamber of wrath and found the queen lying on the ground in an unseemly manner. The king who, in his old age, loved the young queen as dearly as his own life, was deeply alllictcd at the sight. That sinless monarch beheld the ambitious **KAIKEYI** lying on the earth like a branch torn from a tree, or a nymph thrust forth from heaven. She lay like an apaara fallen on the earth when her merit is csbausted, or like a snapped garland, or a doe casoarcd by the hunter, or like a young elephant wounded by a poisonous arrow. Standing over her like an immense tusker, the monarch regarded her with affection. Gcndy caressing her, apprchcasive yet propelled by desire, the king addressed his lotus-eyed queen : " O Dcvi, I know not why thou art displeased, by whom hast thou been insulted. O tell me I O Auspicious One, I am grieved to sec thee lying in the dust, why art thou, ever benevolent towards me, lying on the earth ? Thou art as dear to me as my own life, why dost thou act as one possessed by an evil spirit ? Art thou siek ? If so, I have many eminent physicians who can cure thy malady, who being satisfied with the gifts and honours bestowed on thcro, arc ready to obey my will. In an instant they shall restore thee to health. O Beautiful One, tell me the symptoms of thy complaint. Or dost thou desire to reward or punish any man ? Do not let the charm of thy face be marred by grief. " In order to please thee, I will put to death one who docs not deserve the penalty, or will pardon one who merits death. I will reduce a rich man to poverty, or ·cause a pauper to be made wealthy. I and all those who belong to me arc thy obedient servants. I shall never oppose thy will, O Queen. If I can please thee even at the cost of my life, thou hast but to speak. Well dost thou know how much I love thee, now tell me what I may do for thee. " I swear to accomplish whatever thou desircth. Know me to be monarch of a kingdom on which

the sun never sets. The lands of Drivira, Sindhu, Souvira, Sourashtra, Dakshinaputha, Vanga, Anga, Maghandha, Matsha, Kashi and Koshala together with their abundant produce and wealth arc ruled by me. If thou desircst any of these, tell me. · " O Frail One, why dost thou cause thyself suft'cring ? Rise, rise, O Dearest, what dost thou fear ? O Kaikcyi, as the sun dispels the mist, I will dispel thy fears." Thus flattered by the king, Kaikcyi appeared somewhat pacified, yet in order to aftlict her lord, began to utter bitter and harsh words. 174 CHAPTER II

CHAPTER 11

She asks for the two boons promised her by the king

CHAPTER II THB RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI how in the war between the gods and *asuras*; thou didst fall wounded like one dead, and I rescued thee by applying the appropriate means ? On thy recovery, thou didst promise me two boons. O Truthful Monarch, I now earnestly desire these two boons which arc in thy power to grant. Shouldst thou, despite thy promises given, not fUlfil these desires, then I will relinquish my life, dishonoured by thee." The queen, holding the king's mind subject by her sweet words, resembled a hunter who, intending to slay a deer, lays a snare for it. Then addressing the king infatuated with passion and willing to grant any boon, she said : " O *Deva*, hear me, I now claim these boons. Employing the preparations made for **RAMA**'s installation, let my son **BHARATA** be proclaimed regent, this is the first boon. The second plcdgc granted me on the battlefield is now also due to be fulfilled. Let **RAMACHANDRA** be esilcd to the forest for fourteen years,

wearing a dress of bark, with matted locks like a hermit, while my son, Prince **BHARATA**, rules without hindrance. This is my earnest desire. Let me, this dsy, behold the exile of **RAMA**. O King, Protector of Truth, prcscrvc thy integrity and the traditions of thy birth. The *rishis* declare that the observance of truth is the most cxcellcnt means of attaining heaven." CHAPTER I2 Th4 kittg 111/Jtm bitf8rly at th4 tltonght 11/ surding PrW4 **RAMA** into exile THB harsh words of Queen Kaiteyi caused intense sulfering and agitation to the heart of the king. He began to rc1lect -"Am I scciDg a dream by day, is my mind unhinged, am I possessed by an evil spirit, is an inauspicious star causing me distress or is this disturbance the result of some malady ? " Pondering awhile, the king grew calm, but his mind was still troubled, and, recollecting the demands of Queen **KAIKEYI**, he I'Tfi

CHAPTER 12

The king suffers bitter agony at the thought of sending Prince Rama into exile

THB RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI how in the war between the gods and *asuras*; thou didst fall wounded like one dead, and I rescued thee by applying the appropriate means ? On thy recovery, thou didst promise me two boons. O Truthful Monarch, I now earnestly desire these two boons which arc in thy power to grant. Shouldst thou, despite thy promises given, not fUlfil these desires, then I will relinquish my life, dishonoured by thee." The queen, holding the king's mind subject by her sweet words, resembled a hunter who, intending to slay a deer, lays a snare for it. Then addressing the king infatuated with passion and willing to grant any boon, she said : " O *Deva*, hear me, I now claim these

boons. Employing the preparations made for **RAMA**'s installation, let my son **BHARATA** be proclaimed regent, this is the first boon. The second plcdgc granted me on the battlefield is now also due to be fulfilled. Let **RAMACHANDRA** be esilcd to the forest for fourteen years, wearing a dress of bark, with matted locks like a hermit, while my son, Prince **BHARATA**, rules without hindrance. This is my earnest desire. Let me, this dsy, behold the exile of **RAMA**. O King, Protector of Truth, prcscrvc thy integrity and the traditions of thy birth. The *rishis* declare that the observance of truth is the most cxcellcnt means of attaining heaven." CHAPTER I2 Th4 kittg 111/Jtm bitf8rly at th4 tltonght 11/ surding PrW4 **RAMA** into exile THB harsh words of Queen Kaiteyi caused intense sulfering and agitation to the heart of the king. He began to rc1lect -"Am I scciDg a dream by day, is my mind unhinged, am I possessed by an evil spirit, is an inauspicious star causing me distress or is this disturbance the result of some malady ? " Pondering awhile, the king grew calm, but his mind was still troubled, and, recollecting the demands of Queen **KAIKEYI**, he I'Tfi again became restless and agitated like a deer in the presence of a lioness. Heaving deep sighs, seated on the ground, he resembled a highly venomous snake hypnotized by the power of a mantram. He cried out in anger, "Woe unto me" and fell senseless. After a long time, he remvered consciousness, and suffenng great distress, full of wrath, answered **KAIKEYI**, while his glance seemed as if it would consume her. " O Thou of Evil Disposition, O Destroyer of my Dynasty, what harm have Shri **RAMACHANDRA** or I done to thee ? **RAMA** has ever treated thee as his own mother. Why hast thou determined thus? Alas I I brought thee to my honse for the destruction of my home. I deemed thee to he the daughter of a king and thou hast shown thyself to he a venomous serpent. All my people unite in pmise of **RAMA**. For what fault sball I abandon him ? It were possible

for me to part with Queen **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA**, my kingdom, even life itself, but I cannot abandon **SHRI RAMA**. To behold the heir-apparent causes delight to my heart; when not contemplating him, my mind loses its capacity to act. The world may continue to exist without the sun, crops may grow without water, but I cannot live even for a little while without Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. " Therefore, O Sinful One, give up thine arrogance. See, I put my head at thy feet, be gracious to me. Why hast thou determined on this cruelty, O Wicked Oae ? If thou desireth to test my love for Prince **BHARATA**, then do so. When thou didat say betimes that **RAMA**, my eldest sou, was entitled to the kingdom on account of his virtues, didat thou utter these worda in flattery to gratify me or to .,.ct some service of **RAMA** ? " The tidings of **RAMA**'s installation is causing thee a burning discontent. Possessed by an evil spirit, thou art not thyself, I wean. O Devi, it is a great calamity that the House of Ibhwaku, famed for its probity, should fall into disrepute. " Hadst thou not been aftlicted by an evil spirit or inftueneed by an inauspicious planet, thou wouldst never have spoken to the detriment of others. It is certain that thou art possessed by a malignant entity. O Child, thou hast often said that thou didat love Shri Rainaehandra, even as **BHARATA** himself. O Devi, bow dolt thou dare to seek the banishment of RlmadlaDdra 177 for fourteen years ? How amst thou demand the exile of the virtuous and tender **RAMACHANDRA** for fourteen long years ? O Thou of beautiful eyes, how canst thou think of sending **RAMA** into exile, who ever honours thee ? **RAMA** has paid thee greater respect tbsn **BHARATA**. I fail to comprehend how thou canst desire his exile. Refiect well, none in the world will offer thee greater service, respect and obedience tbsn **RAMA**. " Among the thousands of women and maid-servants in my private apartments, none ever speaks ill of **RAMA**, and he with a pure heart offers protection to every living

being, while his subjects ever love and obey him. He has won the hearts of all beings by protecting the interests of the needy and the affiicted. Generosity, filithful service to his preceptor, valour in the field of hattie, skill in archery, have all contributed to his renown. Truth, austerity, friendship, purity, simplicity of life, knowledge of philosophy and service of his teacher are well known qualities of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. " O Devi, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** ever acting in the highest interests of all, equal to the maharishis and the gods in enlightenment, must not suffer the ills of exile. **SHRI RAMA** has never speken a harsh word to any, how shall I then, at thy instigstion, give him this pitiless message ? What shall befiill me bereft of **RAMA** who is endnwed with forgiveness, gratitude, self-control, renunciation, truth and virtue, and who never inflicts pain on any human being ? " O **KAIKEYI**, I have grown old and my end is near. In this wretched state I beseech thee to show mercy on me. The esrth girdled by the sea, and all that is contained therein, shall be thine. Why dost thou drive me to the brink of death's dark abyss? " O **KAIKEYI**, I toUch thy feet in supplication. Protect Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and save me from dishonouring my word." King **DASARATHA**, stricken with grief, fell senseless, his whole frame convulsed and agitated. Again and again be entreated the queen to take him beyond the sea of suffering, but that cruel one growing each instant more adamant, replied : " O King, if thou repent of the two boons given to me, none in the world will call thee righteous. When other kings questinn thee regarding thy promises, O Righteous One, what will be J78 thine answer ? Wilt thou say that she to whom thou owcst thy life and by whose grace thou yet livest, who rcndctcd tbcc great sctvice at the time of misfortune and to whom thou didst promise two boons, bas now been refused these blessings ? "Assuredly thou shalt become a stigma on the illusttious dynasty of Iksbwaku, having given promises

from which thou now wouldst fain withdraw. Recollect King Shivya, who gave the ftcsb of his own body, to redeem a pledge, was of thy royal house. King Alarka,likcwise of thy dynasty, plucked out his eyes that the sight of an aged and learned *brahmin* might be restored, and thus obtained the highest state. Not only man is bound by his word, the ocean whose boundaries are fixed, does not pass beyund the shore. Therefore, recollecting thy pledge, do not relinquish it. O King, art thou bereft of thy senses ? Abandoning truth, thou wouldst grant **RAMA** the kingdom so that thou mayest enjoy the embraces of Queen Kausbalya. Be it in accord with *dharma* or not, be it truth or falscbood, thou must fulfil the promise made to me, it sball never be revoked. " Sbouldst thou withdraw thy pledge and grant **RAMACHANDRA** the kingdom, I will give up my life by drinking deadly poison. Were I to see Queen Kausbalya receiving salutations as chief queen, I should not be able to endure it. " O Great Sovereign, I swear by Bbarata and my own life that nothing save the exile of **RAMA** sball satisfy me." After speaking these words, **KAIKEYI** became silent, disregard ing the supplications of the alllictcd monarch. Understanding the full portent of the harsh words of **KAIKEYI**, implying **RAMA**'s exile and the rulership of Bbarata, the king remained silent for a long time. His senses numbed, be gazed steadfasdy at the face of his beloved queen, speaking thus bitterly. Maharajah **DASARATHA**, alllicted on bearing the threatening speccb of **KAIKEYI** resembling a thunderbolt, inspiring pain and grief, knowing she bad resolved to banish **RAMA**, cried out: " O **RAMA** I **RAMA** I " and heaving deep sighs fell to the earth like a felled tree. Like a madman bereft of sense or as one in delirium or a anake hypnotized by incantations, be fell, deprived of his glory. In abject tones, be addressed **KAIKEYI**, saying : " Who bas inatructed tbcc in this evil design, cloaked in specious 179 garb ? Art thou not asbamed to address me as one posscsacd ? Formerly, I did not deem thee capable

of such conduct ; in youth, thy disposition was otherwise. What has overpowered thee that thou scekest such a boon ? Stay these unjust words that **RAMA** should go to the forest and Bhatata occupy the throne. O Sinful One, O Cruel-hearted One, O Evil Doer, relinquish the insistence on thy resolve, for thine own sake and for the sake of thy subjects and thy son. Bither **RAMA** Ot I must have offended thee. How have we done so, that thou spcakcst thus ? Assuredly Prince Bbarata will never wisb to occupy the throne while **RAMA** lives. I deem **BHARATA** no less virtuous than **RAMACHANDRA**. When instructing **RAMA** to go to the forest, seeing him stricken, how can I look on him ? How can I look upon his face darkened like the moon in eclipse ? How can I revoke that decision made in consultation with my ministers and friends desiring my welfare, causing confusion, as the sudden smiting of an anny by the enemy. What will the kings of other lands say when they hear the breaking of my resolve which was reached by common consent ? Will they not say : ' King **DASARATHA** of the House of Ikshwaku is like a child. We matVel that he has ruled so long.' When the aged, wise and learned *brahmins* enquite for **RAMA**, shall I answer them that, coerced by Kaikcyi, I have sent him into cxilc ? If I say this in truth, it will be accounted falsehood since I have already instructed my Guru to install **SHRI RAMA** as regent. What will his mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA**, say, if I banish **RAMA** ? How shall I explain this cruel deed to Queen **KAUSHALYA** ? She is ever dutiful, a friend, serving me as a handmaid, keeping my scacts as a trusted companinn, practising virtue like a woman and iu artending on my welfare resembling a sistet, serving me with delicious food like a mother, ever speaking sweetly to me, ever desiring my good ; her son is dearest to me. How can I fail to accord ber due respect ? Fearing thy displcasurc, how great would be my suhaequent repentance and remorse ? “As one partaking of delicious

food, really injurious to him, is latet filled with regret, so knowing **RAMA** cxi1cd at my command, the terrified **SUMITRA** will place no further faith in me. Oh I how unfortunate is this, that **SITA** hearing thcae evil JBo tidiugs of my death and Shri **RAMACHANDRA**'s banishment, will yield up her life, as a uymph dies deprived of her mate in a Himalayan valley. " I shall uot long survive the exile of **RAMA** and the grief of **SITA**. Enjoy thou the kingdom with thy son, but as a widow I Know well, O Dcvi, there is no happiness for me in life if **RAMA** is exiled. As men infatuated by the colour of wine, drink it thinking ill of it the while and knowing its harmful consequences, so did I, charmed by thee, enter into union with thee, believing thee true and faithful. Y ct now I kuow thy disposition to be incomparably vile. Thou bast deluded me with alluring deceits. "As a hunter decoys a deer by sweet music, so alas ! will the pcoplc of the capital think of me, as my son's executioner. They will ahrink from me as from a *brahmin* who drinks intoxicating liquor. Alas I that I should hear such bitter words. Now I am suffering deep allliction as men who consume the fruit of their former iniquities. O Sinful One, having long protected thee, it is I who have erred, like the man who carcfully preserves the rope with which he is eventually banged. "As a child, in a solitary place, plays with a blacl< snake not knowing it will be the cause of his death, so am I. Who is more wic1cd than myself, who, during my lifetime causes my saintly son to become an orphan ? The whole world will despise me saying : King Dasaratba is overcome by lust and at the prompting of a woman bas sent his son into exile.' " **SHRI RAMA** in his childhood abstained from 1lcsh, honey' and wine, and faithful to his brahmacharya vow, was reduced to a skeleton by the observance of scvcrc austerities, much study and the firm service of his preceptor. Now, a householder, the time bas come that he should enjoy health and prosperity, yet now he is condemned to undergo great

physical privation. It is certain when I command him to go to the forest, he will reply Be it so, O Sire'. Alas I how much better if it could be otherwise. My bclovcd child will assuredly not disobey me. Not knowing my aue reason, and bclicving the command to apting from the sincerity of my heart, he will acquiesce and willingly depart; yet all will execrate me if **RAMA** leaves us. " Death, who spares none, will take me to the region of **YAMA** while Shri **RAMACHANDRA** has gone to the forest, then O **KAIKEYI**, what grievous injustice wilt thou inflict on thy remaining relatives and Queen **KAUSHALYA** ? She, deprived of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, will no longer be able to endure her grief and will yield up her life. " O **KAIKEYI**, having cast me, **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA** and my three sons into the pit of death, canst thou be happy ? Wilt thou be able to protect the dynasty of Ikshwaku, which for long ages has been ruled without disturbance, when **RAMA** and I are gone? Will **BHARATA** approve the banishment of **RAMA**, if it be so, let him not perform my obsequies. O Enemy, may thine ambitions be fulfilled. When I am dead and **RAMA** banished, then wilt thou, a widow, govern the kingdom with thy son. " O Thou dwelliog in our midst as the pretended daughter of a king, wert thou truly a princess, thine incomparable renown would not have been tarnished, nor would I have been set at nought by thee. " Now my son, accustomed to ride on chariots, horses and elephants will have to walk barefoot in the forest. He, who formerly was served at table by attendants in jewelled livery, each vying with the other, saying: 'My dish is sweeter, O Lord,' how shall that **RAMA** henceforth live on the bitter and insipid fruits of the forest ? How shall he pass his life depen dent on fruit and roots ? How shall Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, accustomed to costly apparel and a luxurious couch, sleep on the bare ground, clothed in the yellow robe of a mendicant? I know not why an evil-minded woman should issue this

cruel decree that **RAMA** should be exiled and **BHARATA** be insralled as regent. " Woe unto those women seeking material gain, skilful in accomplishing their own purpose ! I do not condemn all women, but those like the mother of **BHARATA**. O **KAIKEYI**, versed in wrong doing, ever meanly disposed and seeking thine own advantage, didst thou enter my house to cause me affiiction ? What fault hast thou seen in me or in **RAMACHANDRA**, the friend of all the world ? O **KAIKEYI**, on seeing **RAMA** suffering in the forest at thy request, fathers will abandon their sons, faithful wives their husbands, and the whole world will condemn thee. " When I behold Shri **RAMACHANDRA** adorned and handsome as a god, approaching me, my eyes are delighted ; seeing him thus, I am filled with joy and courage. The affairs of the world may continue in the absence of the dawn, and the earth exist without rain, evoked by lndra, but none in the capital will enjoy happiness beholding **RAMA** going into exile. “Alas I To-day, I am about to perish for long nuning thee in my arms, O Iaikeyi, a venomous snake bent on my destruction. Thou art my real enemy. Now do thou, **RAMA** and Lakshmans perform my funeral ceremonies, then govern the kingdom with thy son, Bhanta. Destroy my relatives and friends, depopulate my and country, and live in accord with mine enemies, O Thou Cruel Wretch ! Why do thy teeth not break into a thousand fragments, seeing thou hast spoken improperly before thy lord, and uttered vain boasts. Never did my **RAMA** speak an unkind word to thee. He knows uot how to speak uokindly. Thou chatgest **RAMA** with baseness, who ever was of gentle speech and who is endowed with every excellent quality. " O Thou Ddiuner of the Kingdom of Iaikeya, I shall not grant thy request whether thou be angered or sorrowful or takes! thy life by swallowing poison or dasheth thy head against a rock, or even sinkest into the earth. Thou utterest words keen as the edge of a rszor, deceitful and heartrending, veiling them in gentle accents, thy nature is

perverse, thou art the destroyer of thine own family. Thou hast inflicted bitter agony on me. Though charming in looks, thou art a dangerous woman. I do not desire to consort with one so surpassingly wicked. " What use to speak of love and joy, I cannot live without **RAMACHANDRA**. O Devi, abstain from destroying me. · I touch thy feet, be gracious to me." Finding her heart unmoved by his appeal, King **DASARATHA** like an orphan, fawning and abject, fell unconscious at the feet of lC.aikeyi as one about to die. CHAPTBR 3 Ksfke;yi disregtmh tM kirtg'J imnt4tmlf'able distress DASARATHA lying on the ground in utter ignominy, =embled King Yayati fallen from heaven. The cruel queen, seeing her purpose yet unacxomplished, herself fearless yet inspiring teitOr in the heart of the king, again demanded the boons, saying : " O King, thou didst ever deem thyself a msn of truth and one faithful to his vows, why dost thou then withhold the boons promised to me ? " After some time, the monarch exceedingly disquieted, replied in anger: "O Sinful Woman, after my death when **RAMACHANDRA**, the chief of men, has gone into exile, thou msyest acxomplish thy purpose. In heaven, the gods will enquire concerning the welfare of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. If I reply that I have sent Rams into exile to please **KAIKEYI**, it will be looked upon as a falsehood, and none will believe it. Having passed innumerable years without a son, how should I, after long suft'ering and anxiety, being blessed with an heir, forsake the long-armed Rams ? " How can Rams, valorous, learned, tolerant and forbearing, whose eyes are like lotuses, be driven into exile by me ? How should I send the beautiful Rams, whose complexion is like the blue lotuS, to the Dandaka fo=t ? Shri Rams, meriting every comfort and pleasure, undeserving of sorrow, how can I behold that wise **RAMACHANDRA** in distress ? " Had I died without seeing Rams a111icted, who merits no suffering whatsoever, my spirit would have

experienced joy in heaven. O Pitiless, O Sinful **KAIKEYI**, why, why dost thou compel me to send my dear and truthful son, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, to the fo=t ? I shall incur dishonour throughout the whole world.” Thus lamenting and distracted, evening having fallen and the night creeping on apace, King Dasarstha a111ictcd and in grest anguish, experienced no delight on beholding the moon. 114

CHAPTER 13

Kaikeyi disregards the king's immeasurable distress

CHAPTBR 3 Ksfke;yi disregtmh tM kirtg’J imnt4tmlf’able distress DASARATHA lying on the ground in utter ignominy, =embled King Yayati fallen from heaven. The cruel queen, seeing her purpose yet unacxomplished, herself fearless yet inspiring teitOr in the heart of the king, again demanded the boons, saying : " O King, thou didst ever deem thyself a msn of truth and one faithful to his vows, why dost thou then withhold the boons promised to me ? " After some time, the monarch exceedingly disquieted, replied in anger: “O Sinful Woman, after my death when **RAMACHANDRA**, the chief of men, has gone into exile, thou msyest acxomplish thy purpose. In heaven, the gods will enquire concerning the welfare of Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. If I reply that I have sent Rams into exile to please **KAIKEYI**, it will be looked upon as a falsehood, and none will believe it. Having passed innumerable years without a son, how should I, after long suft’ering and anxiety, being blessed with an heir, forsake the long-armed Rams ? " How can Rams, valorous, learned, tolerant and forbearing, whose eyes are like lotuses, be driven into exile by me ? How should I send the beautiful Rams,

whose complexion is like the blue lotuS, to the Dandaka fo=t ? Shri Rams, meriting every comfort and pleasure, undeserving of sorrow, how can I behold that wise **RAMACHANDRA** in distress ? " Had I died without seeing Rams a111icted, who merits no suffering whatsoever, my spirit would have experienced joy in heaven. O Pitiless, O Sinful **KAIKEYI**, why, why dost thou compel me to send my dear and truthful son, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, to the fo=t ? I shall incur dishonour throughout the whole world." Thus lamenting and distracted, evening having fallen and the night creeping on apace, King Dasarstha a111ictcd and in grest anguish, experienced no delight on beholding the moon. 114 The old king, sighing heavily, continued to lament, and gazing at the starry sky cried : " O Night, adorned with stars, do not pass into the dswn. O Auspicious Night, with grest humility, I supplicate thee, have pity on me and do not pass away. I have no desire to behold the face of this cruel '**KAIKEYI**, who has caused me immeasurable distress." Then the monarch again entreated **KAIKEYI** saying : "A virtuous man and yet wretched, I take refuge in thee, for I have only a short while to live. O Auspicious One I Know this ; I am a king and not alone but in the royal assembly have I proclaimed **RAMA** as regent. Be gracious unto me, O **KAIKEYI**, O Child, O Giver of Delight I Grant imperishable rulership to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and endear thyself to me. O **KAIKEYI**, thus shalt thou obtain grest renown. " O Thou of besutiful face, let **RAMA** he installed, so shalt thou cause pleasure to Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, to **BHARATA**, to the court, nay to the whole world." Then the pure-hearted sovereign, his eyes reddened in his distress burst into a flood of tears, but the wicked **KAIKEYI** disregarded both his flattery and his weeping. The king, realising the ezile of **SHRI RAMA** could not be avoided, fell senseless to the earth. Sighing deeply at evety moment, King **DASARATHA** passed the night in grest anguish. At dswn, the royal

musicians striking up to awaken the grest monsreb, were ordered by him to be ailent.

CHAPTER 14

The king is overcome by grief, the queen summons Sri Ram

TM 1ri1w u by grief; tJu 1J11U11"""""""" **SHRI RAMA** own good. O King, in amient times, thy forbear, King Shivya fulfillcd a promise given, by yielding up his body to a hawk and thus sequim! a high spiritual Thus also the illustri ous Alarlra gladly takiJJg out his own eyes gave them to a blind *brahmin* vcracd in the Veda. The Lord of Waters, the ocean, paying due rcgsrd to truth, docs not pass beyond its boundaries at the time of the full moon. Truth is *Brahman*. Truth is the crown of righteOusness. The imperishable Veda proclaims the glory of truth. When the heart is purified by the practice of truth, Brahmsn is realised. O King, if thou boldest truth to be the fruit of virtue, then following truth grant me the two boons, O Bestower of Boons. For the sake of safeguarding thy future happiness, send Rams into exile I Send **RAMA** into exile at my rcquesL Thrice I repeat my desire. If thou failest to exile Rams, I sball not survive the dishonour and sball yield up my life in thy prcscncc." Hearing the words of **KAIKEYI**, King **DASARATHA** found himself bound and unable to escape, like King Bali of old in the prcscncc of Vamana.' Distraught, his mind agitated, his countenance pallid, the king resembled a bullock tottering between the yoke and the wheel. Anxiety and grief overwhelmed the king ; with a supreme effort, mustering his courage and controlling his senses, his eyes distended, he addressed **KAIKEYI** ; " O Sinful Woman, at the time

of our nuptials, in the presence of the sacred ftamc, I took thy hand in mine, but tCH!ay, I reject thee and the son born of thee, Prince **BHARATA**. O Dcvi, the night is nearly passed and the sun about to rise. My Guru and the elders will urge me to perform the instsllation ceremony. Let the preparations made for the instsllation be used for my funeral rites. Let no part therein be taken by thee, O **KAIKEYI**, as thou dost oppose the instsllation of **SHRI RAMA**. How sball I look upon the faces of these people now filled with joy in anticipation of Rams's enthrollCIIICDt, that will soon become overcast and melancholy ? " The night illumined by the moon and stars paased away as the King was speaking, and day dawned. Then **KAIKEYI**, eloquent in speech but full of iniquity, transported with anger, spoke passionately :-" O King, why dost thou speak like one affected by a grave disease ? Send for thy son **RAMACHANDRA** to come hither. Install my son on the throne and send **RAMA** into exile. Then sbalt thou have accomplished thy duty." The king, like a well-bred hotse smarting under the lash, replied : " I am caught in the of *dharma*, I am bereft of understanding, let me behold my eldest son, **SHRI RAMA**." The morning had now dawned, and the night had fled ; the sun had risen and an auspicious planet was in the ascendant. The blessed Lord **VASISHTHA** endowed with every acellent quslity, surrounded by his disciples, holding the sacred articles required for the installation, came to the great door. Passing through the capital, Shri **VASISHTHA** observed the streets swept and watered. Flags were fluttering everywhere in the breeze, flowers of many kinds were strewn on the roads and garlands hung here and there. All the inhabitants looked happy ; shops and stalls displayed a variety of menhandise, while incense mixed with ambergris and sandalwood perfumed the air. Every where people were celebrating the festival and eagerly awaiting the coronation of Ramaehandrs. Having paased through the city of

Ayodhya, which resembled Amaravati, Shri **VASISHTHA** came to the royal palace, and beheld at the gate an assembly of *brahmins* and teachers who enhanced the scene. Innumerable priests, skilled in the ritual of sacrifice, courtiers and leaders of the warrior class, as well as merchants were gathered there. Shri **VASISHTHA** penetrated to the private apartments and delightedly entered there. At the door he beheld the charioteer Snmantra of pleasing looks and the holy sage begged him to announce his arrival to the king I!Ild inform his majesty that he had brought the sacred water of the Gunga in golden vessels, and various seeds, fragrant herbs and gems of different kinds. There was also honey, curds, clarified butter, parched rice, kusha grass, flowers and mllk, together with eight beautitul virgins and a white elephant. A chariot drawn by four horses, an acellent sword and bow, a palanquin with besren and a canopy resembling the moon in purity. Two white chamaraa, a narrow-necked jar of gold, white heifers, a lion with great teeth, a fine steed, a lion throne, a tiger skin, sacrificial tue1 and fire. Musicians of every kind, bealltifully 187 adorned women Bingen, teachers, priests, cows, deer and birds ; representatives of the people and metchants with their :6unilies wete gatheted thete. These and many people inspired by affection and of gentle speech, had come with their leadetS to see the coronation of **RAMA**. Sbri **VASISHTHA** ordeted Sumantra to inform the king with all haste that **RAMA** should be installed when the Pushya star was in the ascendant. Sumantra instructed by the royal Sage **VASISHTHA**, and having access to the petaon of the king, enteted the palace crying “Jai I Jai! to his majesty". The guards permitted him to entet without hindtancc, and Sumantra, approaching the king, ignorant of his condition, began to praise his royal mastet, according to the prevailing custom. With great humility he addtessed him, saying : " O Gracious Sovet eign, as the sun at the bresking of dsy

gives pleasute to the sea, so do thou give us joy by thy radiant countenance. Add to our delight, O Mighty Lord ! As in the morning **INDRA** was adored by his charioteet, whereaftet he defeated the *asuras*, so do I salute thee. 1 come wake thee as the Vidyas and Vedss waken **BRAHMA**. As sun and moon stimulate the earth which supports all men and life, so do 1 come to waken thee, O Great Rulet. Awake, O Maharaj and rejoice the hearts of the people by thy sight. Don thy royal robes and adorn thyself with the great gems, resplendent like the sun on the crest of Mount MetU. O Sire, may the Moon, the Sun, **SHIVA** and Kuvera be auspicious to thee. May Vanma, **AGNI** and lndra grant thee success. The lovely night has passed and the auspicious day has dawned. O Royal Sage, arise and petform thy duties ; preparations for the installation of **RAMA** are completed, the leading citizens and the inhabitants of the capital are waiting in revetence at the gate ; the blessed Sage **VASISHTHA**, with his disciples, is at the door. Command us, O King, to inaugurate the coronation of **RAMA** immediately ; as cattle without a keepet, an army without a general, night without the moon, cows without a bull, so is thy kingdom without a king to-day." The king hesring the peacetbl words of Sumantra wu once more submerged in the sea of sorrow ; thoush over come with grief, his eyes red with wrath, he llllwered him : 188 " O Sumantra, thy words of praise in1lict great pain on me." Sumantra, beholding the miserable condition of bis master, and hearing bis anguished words, joining bis palms in submission, stepped backwards, tongUe-tied. Then **KAIKEYI**, skilled in achieving her own purpose, addressed Sumantra : " O Snmantra, being overjoyed on account of the installation of bis son, the king has not slept this night. Being fatigued, he is now overcome with sleep. Go thou, therefore, and bring the illustrious **RAMACHANDRA** hither ; this matter requires no deliberation." Sumantra rdlected that the arrival of Shri

RAMACHANDRA would pacify the mind of the king : he speedily went to summon him and on the way rdlected, " Why has Queen **KAIKEYI** summoned **RAMA** in haste ? " The charioteer believed the eagerness of the king had prompted him to summon Shri **RAMACHANDRA** for the purpose of bis installation. Sumantra, happily came to the beautiful palace of **SHRI RAMA** which resembled a small island in the sea, and beheld there many people standing at the gate. He beheld many kings and great chieftains assembled in their allotted places. CHAPTER IS WHI!N night had given way to the dawn, *brahmins* wcll-versed in the Veda, together with the king's priests, came to the pslacc gate. With them came the counscllors, the chiefs of the army and leading merchants to witness the installation of **RAMA**. The sun having risen and the Pushya planet with Karrata' being auspicinus,' it being the time at which **RAMA** was born, *brahmins* bronght vcasels of gold filled with water, a finely

CHAPTER 15

Sumantra hurries to Prince Rama's palace

" **O** Sumantra, thy words of praise in1lict great pain on me." Sumantra, beholding the miserable condition of bis master, and hearing bis anguished words, joining bis palms in submission, stepped backwards, tongUe-tied. Then **KAIKEYI**, skilled in achieving her own purpose, addressed Sumantra : " O Snmantra, being overjoyed on account of the installation of bis son, the king has not slept this night. Being fatigued, he is now overcome with sleep. Go thou, therefore, and bring the illustrious **RAMACHANDRA** hither ; this matter requires no deliberation." Sumantra rdlected that the arrival of Shri

RAMACHANDRA would pacify the mind of the king : he speedily went to summon him and on the way rdlected, " Why has Queen **KAIKEYI** summoned **RAMA** in haste ? " The charioteer believed the eagerness of the king had prompted him to summon Shri **RAMACHANDRA** for the purpose of bis installation. Sumantra, happily came to the beautiful palace of **SHRI RAMA** which resembled a small island in the sea, and beheld there many people standing at the gate. He beheld many kings and great chieftains assembled in their allotted places. CHAPTER IS WHI!N night had given way to the dawn, *brahmins* wcll-versed in the Veda, together with the king's priests, came to the pslacc gate. With them came the counscllors, the chiefs of the army and leading merchants to witness the installation of **RAMA**. The sun having risen and the Pushya planet with Karrata' being auspicinus,' it being the time at which **RAMA** was born, *brahmins* bronght vcasels of gold filled with water, a finely decoratcd throne and a resplendent chariot with a seat spread with a tiger skin. Water was brought from the confluence of the Gunga and Yamuna and from the holy rivers, lakes and wells, from the westward flowing streams and those descending from grcst heights and flowing through the plains. From the seas also water was provided and stoted in shining vessels of gold and silver, wherein lotus blooms floated and on whose surface sticks of Gular' and banyan were sprinkled. Honey, curds, clarified butter, kusha grass, and flowers were also provided. Beautifully adomed singing women were like wise present. Chamaras with handles of gold set with jewels, a beautiful canopy, scintillating and round as the moon, were furnished for the ceremony, also a white caparisoned steed, a young elephant of grcst size, and eight virgins gracefully attitcd. Musicians with vinas, bards and those who proclaim the king's praise ; everything required for the installation of a sovereign of the dynasty of Ikshwaku was furnished by command of the king. Not

beholding King **DASARATHA** at the appointed time, those present said : " Who will announce our arrival to the monarch ? The sun has riaen, but the king has not come forth ; every preparation for the installation of **RAMA** is now complete." While they were thus speaking, Sumantra, honoured servant of the state, addrcsaed the royal guests, and maharajahs, saying : "As commanded by the king, I purpose to bring **SHRI RAMA** before him. On my return, I will ask his majesty for you who are worthy of honour, the reason for the delay." The aged Sumantra came to the door of the inner apartment and entered, unannounced. Praising the royal dyoasty ofRaghu, he reached the chamber where the king was lying on the ground. Pouring forth his praise, he approached the arras hanging before the king's chamber, and said : " O Sovereign, may **SURYA**, Kuvera, **VARUNA**, **AGNI** and **INDRA** grant thee victory. The Goddess Night, has departed, dawn has come, arise O Lion among Kings I *Brahmins*, ambassadors and chiefs of the forces have assembled and are desirous of seeing thee." The king, rousing himself, said to his chief minister, Suman tra: "Bring Shri **RAMACHANDRA** hither speedily. Why dost GuW-Twipafaqnat-treo. J!IO thou delay ? I do not sleep, go bring **SHRI RAMA** with all haste." Sumantra, !lowing to the king, went forth to execute his commands. Thinking the installation of **RAMA** to be near, he set out for the palace, passing joyfully along the royal route gay with flags and banners. Hearing on all sides, people conversing of the coming event, he mingled with the happy throng and after walking some distance, saw **SHRI RAMA**'s palace, white as the peak of Mount Kailasha and filir as lndra's abode. The turrets, adorned with golden images, studded with coral and jewels, rendered the palace resplendent, like the winter clouds on the caverns of Mount Sumeru. The main gateway, decorated with wreaths of gema and pearls, was fragrant with sandslwood and ambergris, sweet-scented like the Malaygiri mountain

and abounding with cranes and pea cocks. The doors and walls of the inner apartments were decorated with paintings of lions, tigers and wolves, pleasing to the eye and mind. The palace of **RAMA**, resplendent as the sun and moon, furnished like the palace of Kuvera and equalling the abode of **INDRA**, was surrounded by many kinds of bitds who sported there. Men from distant lands in bejewelled apparel waited bearing gifts in theit hands, eager to behold **RAMA**. The spacious palace was sumptuously furnished and the attendants serving there were men of small stature. Shri Sumantra, delighting the people, in his chariot drawn by horses, came to the door of the palace which was filled with untold wealth and surrounded by deer and peacocks gladdening the heart. Entering the gates and greeting those dear to **RAMA**, Sumantra reached the door of the inner apartment. There also he heard everyone conversing of **SHRI RAMA** and he rejoiced to hear them speaking of his glory. He beheld the inner inclosure, resplen dent and lofty as Mount Meru, which was rendered charmiDg by the presence of many deer and birds. There, too, he beheld those from various lands, descending from theit chariots, bearing gifts. He observed an elephant equal to a hill in height, resembling a dark cloud, who had never known the touch of a goad and whose forehead was dripping with sweat. Its name wss Shatrunja, and it stood prepared to carry **RAMA**. Proceeding further, Sumantta beheld many charioteers and horsemen ready with theit caparisoned horses. Continuing on his wsy, Shti Rams's chief minister saw countless artists and poets gathered there. Passing through the multitude, he came to the private apltt ment of Shti **RAMA**. Unchallenged, the great Sumantta, resembling a cloud, entered the aplttment as a ctOCOdile enters the gem-filled ocean. CHAPTER Slrri **RAMA** in his chariot tlriws SVJiftly to the king through a further dooiway, thronged with people, Sumantta came to another gate where no

guard stood. He beheld there many young men, alert, vigilant, and devoted to their master, armed with bows and axes, and wearing beautiful CBI-rings. Beyond these, Sumantta saw aged men, clad in red, gorgeously attired, holding staves in theit hands, guarding the apSttments of the Queens. Seeing the virtuous Sumantta approaching with others, they stood respectfully at attention. Sumantra, addressing these humble and experienced attend· ants, said : " Be pleased to inform Shti **RAMACHANDRA** that Sumantta waits at the door." They, ever desiring the good of **RAMA**, informed the prince and **SITA** of the arrival of Sumantra. Knowing Sumantra to be in the confidence of his royal father, Shti **RAMA** affectionately caused him to be summoned. The charioteer, entering thete, perceived Shti **RAMACHANDRA** rcaembling Kuvers himself, seated on a golden couch, spread with soft cushions and richly ornamented. His btow wsa anointed with pure and fragrant sandalwood-paste, the colour of the blood of a wild boar. By his side the Princess **SITA**, as beautiful as the moon attended l!JZ

CHAPTER 16

Shri Rama in his chariot drives swiftly to the king

Whose forehead was dripping with sweat. Its name wss Shatrunja, and it stood prepared to carry **RAMA**. Proceeding further, Sumantta beheld many charioteers and horsemen ready with theit caparisoned horses. Continuing on his wsy, Shti Rams's chief minister saw countless artists and poets gathered there. Passing through the multitude, he came to the private apltt ment of Shti **RAMA**. Unchallenged, the great Sumantta, resembling a cloud, entered the aplttment as a ctOCOdile enters the gem-filled ocean. CHAPTER Slrri **RAMA** in his chariot tlriws SVJiftly

to the king through a further dooiway, thronged with people, Sumantta came to another gate where no guard stood. He beheld there many young men, alert, vigilant, and devoted to their master, armed with bows and axes, and wearing beautiful CBI-rings. Beyond these, Sumantta saw aged men, clad in red, gorgeously attired, holding staves in theit hands, guarding the apSttments of the Queens. Seeing the virtuous Sumantta approaching with others, they stood respectfully at attention. Sumantra, addressing these humble and experienced attend· ants, said : " Be pleased to inform Shti **RAMACHANDRA** that Sumantta waits at the door." They, ever desiring the good of **RAMA**, informed the prince and **SITA** of the arrival of Sumantra. Knowing Sumantra to be in the confidence of his royal father, Shti **RAMA** affectionately caused him to be summoned. The charioteer, entering thete, perceived Shti **RAMACHANDRA** rcaembling Kuvers himself, seated on a golden couch, spread with soft cushions and richly ornamented. His btow wsa anointed with pure and fragrant sandalwood-paste, the colour of the blood of a wild boar. By his side the Princess **SITA**, as beautiful as the moon attended l!JZ by the Cbittaplanet, was seated, holding a chamara in her hand. Summtra, versed in the customs of the court, offered respectful salutations to **SHRI RAMA** who appeared as resplendent as the noonday sun. With joined palms, Summtra humbly enquired as to the prince's welfare and addressed him who was thus seated on the couch, saying : " O Bicellent Son of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the king desires to see thee in the apartment of Queen **KAIKEYI**, be pleased to go thithet without delay." Thus addtessed, that Lion among men, the most illustrious Ramachandta, filled with joy, on receiving the summons, replied: "Be it so, I will go thithet with all speed." Then turning to **SITA**, he asid : " O Devi, my mothet **KAIKEYI**, and my fathet have consulted each othet concerning those matters relative to my installation. O Princess of

Beautiful Eyes, my mothet **KAIKEYI**, evet benevolent and accomplished, knowing the king's desire, is influencing him for my good ! That daughtet of the great King of Kaikeya, evet obedient to my royal father desires my welfare. He, with his beloved queen, has sent for me through Summtra, who is evet well-disposed to me, and desires what is pleasing to me, as does the king, my sire, and the queen, my mothet. Assuredly, to-day the king will proclaim me regent. I shall go to my royal fathet in all haste, do thou convetSe happily with thy maids of honour." Hearing these courteous words, spoken by het lord, the lotus-eyed Princess **SITA** reciting the Peace Chant, followed Shri **RAMACHANDRA** to the door. She asid: "O Maharaj, the kingdom has many learned *brahmins* who will crown thee, as Indta was crowned by **BRAHMA**. When the preliminary initiation is completed and thou dost perform the Rajasuya' sacrifice and I behold thee dteased in an antelope skin with the d='s horns in thy hand, do thou then allow me to pay thee homage. May **INDRA** in the east protect thee, may **YAMA** in the south proteCt thee, may **VARUNA** in the west proteCt thee, may Kuvera in the north protect thee." Having taken leave of **SITA**, Shri Rams left his palace with Sumantta. **SHRI RAMA**, going forth from his palace, as a lion : issues from his cave, beheld Shri **LAKSHMANA** humbly waiting at the door. At the middle gate, **SHRI RAMA** encountered his friends and honoured those who had gathered there to witness his coronation. Then that Lion among men, the son of King **DASARATHA**, mounted his chariot resplendent as llame, spread with tiger skins and which, on its course, made a noise like thunder. Inlaid with gold and gems, it dazzled the beholders as does the brightness of the sun. Tbe horses yoked to the chariot, equalling young elephants, galloped as swiftly as the steeds of **INDRA**. **SHRI RAMA**, seated in his resplendent chariot moving rapidly with a sound as of thunder issuing from the clouds, appeared like the

moon coursing in the heavens. His younger brother, Prince **LAKSHMANA** attended him standing behind him in the chariot, with a chamara in his hand. On every side, shouts of “Jail Jail” arose, while the multitude followed **SHRI RAMA**’s chariot with its cavalcade of mounted horsemen and mountain-like elephants. Warriors whose brows were anointed with sandalwood paste and amber gris, preceded the royal charint bearing naked swords in their hands. Then followed the musicians and bards singing their praises and the shouts of warriors resembling the roaring of lions. Tbe chariot went forward amid a rain offtowers showered down from the balconies and windows by beautifully adorned women, of faultless limbs, who thus offered salutations to **RAMA** and desirous of his welfare chanted hymns of adoration, saying : " O Deligbt of Thy Mother, whose heart to-dsy is raised in exultation because of thee ; to-day thy royal mother will see thee in possession of the throne. “The Princess **SITA**, exceedingly dear to **RAMA** is esteemed the most fortunate woman in the world by womankind who, believing her to have practised a high degree of virtue and ascetism in aaid : " TCHiay, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, our lord, will acquire limitless wealth and power through the favour of his royal sire. Those people over whom he holds sway, will obtain their heart’s desire and the fulfilment of their ambitions. Should he enjoy the kingdom for long, it will be our gaio, since no distress will visit the kingdom while be is king.” Thus preceded by neighing horses and the praises of his dynasty by chroniclers and bards, **RAMA** advanced like the god Kuvea, while on every side be beheld the decorated high· ways filled with male and female elephants, chariots, horses and people and stslls overflowiDg with gems and merchandise. He adrlanus to tlr4 palae amidst tlu pi4udjts uf his friends SIATI!J) in his cbariot, the prince beheld his delighted friends and the city, white as a clond, adorned with ftags and banners

ftuttering here and there, fragrant with the perfume of incense, filled with a multitude of men and enriched by stately buildings. Passing through the scented highways where heaps of sandal· wood were burning, and rare perfumes, wool and silken cloths, unpierced pearls, and innumemble gems being exposed to view, with sts11s replete with anicles of food and drink and merchandise of every kind, be beheld the royal highway sdomed like the pstbway of the gods in heaven, with every auspicious msrk, such as curds, rice, sandalwood, parched grain and milk. Traversing the cross-roads gay with ftowers and fragrant objects, amidst the blessinp and salutations of his friends, be acknow· ledged their praise with humility. Those advanced in years,

CHAPTER 17

He advances to the palace amidst the eulogy of his friends

aaid : " TCHiay, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, our lord, will acquire limitless wealth and power through the favour of his royal sire. Those people over whom he holds sway, will obtain their heart’s desire and the fulfilment of their ambitions. Should he enjoy the kingdom for long, it will be our gaio, since no distress will visit the kingdom while be is king.” Thus preceded by neighing horses and the praises of his dynasty by chroniclers and bards, **RAMA** advanced like the god Kuvea, while on every side be beheld the decorated high· ways filled with male and female elephants, chariots, horses and people and stslls overflowiDg with gems and merchandise. He adrlanus to tlr4 palae amidst tlu pi4udjts uf his friends SIATI!J) in his cbariot, the prince beheld his delighted friends and the city, white as a clond, adorned with ftags and banners

ftuttering here and there, fragrant with the perfume of incense, filled with a multitude of men and enriched by stately buildings. Passing through the scented highways where heaps of sandal· wood were burning, and rare perfumes, wool and silken cloths, unpierced pearls, and innumemble gems being exposed to view, with sts11s replete with anicles of food and drink and merchandise of every kind, be beheld the royal highway sdomed like the pstbway of the gods in heaven, with every auspicious msrk, such as curds, rice, sandalwood, parched grain and milk. Traversing the cross-roads gay with ftowers and fragrant objects, amidst the blessinp and salutations of his friends, be acknow· ledged their praise with humility. Those advanced in years, THE RAMAYANA OF VALMJKI our delight will exceed all else. Nothing is dearer to us than the installation of Shri Ramacbandra of limitless glory." Thus did Raghava advance, amidst the eulogies of his friends the focus of every eye and heart, senne and imperturbable. Those who were unable to behold him or were unnoticed by him, became objects of contempt to others, nay, they were a reproach to themselves. The all-compassionate **RAMACHANDRA** looked on each of the four castes with equal condescension. Each loved him according to his capacity. Passing the temples, the sacred groves and pavilions, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** circumambulated them in reverence. He now beheld the royal palace, resembling a white cloud, its towers like the snow-capped peaks of Mount Kailasa, its balconies seeming almost to reach the skies like the fire chariots of the gods ; the pleasure houses set with precious gems, caused the whole palace to excel all those on earth and rival even the abode oflndra. Approaching his father's palace, Sbri Rams passed through the three gateways guarded by archers, and proceeded on foot through the fourth and fifth enclosures. There, leaving his attendants, he entered the private apartments of the king. The

multitude seeing Rams enter the palace were filled with joy and awaited his coming forth as the sea awaits the coming of the full moon.

CHAPTER 18

He sees the king full of anguish and speechless; Kaikeyi utters the cruel words

feet of hia royal sire, he then respect1Wly olt'ered aalutatiolla to Mother **KAIKEYI**. The kine. hia eyes filled with tears, his throat choked with 196 emotion, could only utter the word " **RAMA** " and nothing more. As the heart of a man who accidentally touches a serpent is filled with fear, so was the heart of **RAMA** on beholding the king's misery. The king agitated by grief and remorse, sighjng bitterly, filled with anguish, resembled the ocean which, calm by nature, is agitated by a mighty storm, or Rahu' causing the sun's eclipse, or the soul of a sage stirred by the utterance of falsehoods. Without knowing the cause of the king's distress, **SHRI RAMA** became agitated like the sea on the day of the full moon. Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, ever engaged in seeking his father's welfare, re11ected : " Why is my father not happy to see me to-day ? Formerly, when displeased, on beholding me he was pscified, but to-day, behu1ding me, he is troubled. Why is he overcome with grief aod bereft of his glory ? " Making obeisance to **KAIKEYI**, he said : " If by an involuntary offence, I have caused my farber displeasure, then O Mother, propitiate him for me. Erstwhile, even when displeased, my father showed favour to me, but to-day, I behold him pale of countenance, and deeply distressed, nor does he speak to me. Is my revered father suffering any physical or mental distress ? It is rare indeed for a man to be consistently happy. Has his majesty seen any grievous

fault in the amisble Prince **BHARATA** or the valorous **SHATRUGHNA**, or in my mothers or in me ? I do not desire to live a aing1e instant if his majesty is not satisfied with me, or is displeased or if I have disobeyed him. Why should not man obey his parents, who are the source of his birth and who are living gods ? Hast thou spoken harsh words, in vanity, to the king, on hearing which his heart is lacerated ? O Devi, answer my question truly. Tell me the cause of this unprecedented grief in my aire." **KAIKEYI** thus addressed by **SHRI RAMA**, dead to all shame and skilful in defence of her selfish purpose, spoke arrogantly : " O **RAMA**, the king is not angry nor is he suffering physical pain. he has something on his mind which he fears to disclose to thee. He loves thee dearly and so heaitates to tell thee this unpleasant matter. It is for thee to fulfil what he has promised to me aod to act in aamdance with it. Having formerly granted me a boon, he now repents it like a common man. To promise a boon and then seek to evade it, is like the setting up of a dam when the watet has gone. O **RAMA**, have a lest the king abandon truth for thy sake. Among holy men, truth is said be the root of *dharma*. Should the king command thee and thou fulfil his command without futther deliberation, then will I reveal the whole truth to thee. The king may not communicate with thee directly, therefore, be ready to execute what I command on his behalf." Sbri **RAMA**, highly agitated, replied to **KAIKEYI** in the presence of the king : " For shame, O Devi, to speak thus to me. At the command of my father I am willing to do anything, even to casting myself into the :tire. At the bidding of the king my parent and author of my welfare, I will gladly drink deadly poison or throw myself into the sea. O Devi, disclose to me his will, I vow to fulfil his command. Be assured, O Mother, **RAMA** does nor utter falsehood." To the ever truthful **RAMA**, **KAIKEYI** answered in these wound ing words : " O Ramschandra, long ago the Maharajah fought against the *asuras* and

fell wounded on the field. I then preserved him and he promised me two boons. For these I ask the installation of Prince **BHARATA** and thy exile to the Dandaka forest. O Great One, if thou desirest that thou and thy father should uphold truth, then hear me. In obedience to thy father, now go into exile for fourteen years. Let the preparations made for thine installation be used for the enthronement of **BHARATA**. Giving up thy claims to the kingdom, do thou with matted hair, wesring a deer skin, live in the Dandaka forest for seven and again seven years. Let the esrth be ruled by Prince **BHARATA**. This kingdom filled with an abundance of gems, horses and CHAPTER 9 Shri Rattuzclumdra betrays sign of distress and prepares fur exile THE slayer of his foes, Shri Ramacbandra, hearing the words of **KAIKEYI**, keen as the pangs of death, was in no way moved by them, and answered : " Be it so ! To honour the promise made by the king, I will leave fOI the forest immediately, with matted locks, attired in raiment made of bark, but I desire to know why the illustrious sovereign does not address me ? O Devi, fear not, I vow, in thy presence that I shall dwell in the fOiest, dressed in bark with matted locks ; rejoice, there fore ! Whatever command the benevolent monarch, ever mindful of my welfare, shall lay upon me, I will gladly execute to please him. There is nothing I would not do for him without hesitation, but one painful thought srill lingers in my mind. Why does the king not speak to me himself of **BHARATA**'s enthronement ? O Mother, by thine order, I am willing to surrender to my brother **BHARATA**, not only the kingdom, but also Sits, together with every object of desire, my wealth and my life. How much mOie would I do for my father, that he may preserve the vow of truth and serve thy purpose. Render this matter clear to the king. How is it that I behold my tither with bowed head, shedding tears ? Let messengers on swift horses summon Prince **BHARATA** immediately from his uncle's house, while I,

without considering the merit or demerit of my sire’s injunctions, enter the Dandaka forest forfourteenyears." Queen **KAIKEYI** highly pleased by the words uttered by Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and assured of his exile, urged him to depart, saying : " So be it ; messengers on swift footed horses will summon **BHARATA** immediately from his uncle’s home. O **RAMA**, being ready to enter the forest, do not delay : depart, therefore, with all speed. Overcome with shame, the king dare not ask thee to depart, but do thou disregard this. O **RAMACHANDRA**, the king will neither bathe nor partake of food till thou hast elltered upon thine ezile.” The king, hearing the words of **KAIKEYI**, cried “Woe ",

CHAPTER 19

Shri Ramachandra betrays no sign of distress and prepares for exile

Shri Rattuzclumdra betrays sign of distress and prepares fur exile THE slayer of his foes, Shri Ramacbandra, hearing the words of **KAIKEYI**, keen as the pangs of death, was in no way moved by them, and answered : " Be it so ! To honour the promise made by the king, I will leave fOI the forest immediately, with matted locks, attired in raiment made of bark, but I desire to know why the illustrious sovereign does not address me ? O Devi, fear not, I vow, in thy presence that I shall dwell in the fOiest, dressed in bark with matted locks ; rejoice, there fore ! Whatever command the benevolent monarch, ever mindful of my welfare, shall lay upon me, I will gladly execute to please him. There is nothing I would not do for him without hesitation, but one painful thought srill lingers in my mind. Why does the king not speak to me himself of **BHARATA**’s enthronement ? O Mother, by thine order, I am willing to surrender to

my brother **BHARATA**, not only the kingdom, but also Sits, together with every object of desire, my wealth and my life. How much mOie would I do for my father, that he may preserve the vow of truth and serve thy purpose. Render this matter clear to the king. How is it that I behold my tither with bowed head, shedding tears ? Let messengers on swift horses summon Prince **BHARATA** immediately from his uncle's house, while I, without considering the merit or demerit of my sire's injunctions, enter the Dandaka forest forfourteenyears." Queen **KAIKEYI** highly pleased by the words uttered by Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and assured of his exile, urged him to depart, saying : " So be it ; messengers on swift footed horses will summon **BHARATA** immediately from his uncle's home. O **RAMA**, being ready to enter the forest, do not delay : depart, therefore, with all speed. Overcome with shame, the king dare not ask thee to depart, but do thou disregard this. O **RAMACHANDRA**, the king will neither bathe nor partake of food till thou hast elltered upon thine ezile." The king, hearing the words of **KAIKEYI**, cried "Woe ", 199 "Woe", and, stricken with grief, fell senseless on the golden couch. Rsising up the king, Shri Rsmachsndra, urged on by the words of **KAIKEYI** as a horse under the lash, prepsted to enter the forest in all baste. His heart unmoved by the queen's cruel words, he replied : " O Devi, I did not desire the kingdom to acquire wealth and power, but becoming regent, I wished to preserve *dharma*. Know me, like the sages, to be a prorector of *dharma*. If I can render any service to my father at the cost of my life, it is as if already accomplished. There is no greater good in this world than service to one's sire by thought, word and deed. On this command, not issued by the king but by thee, I will dwell for fourteen years in the uninhabited forest. O Sati, thou bast been my mother and yet art unacquainted with my oature. If thou had'st known me, no need would have arisen to consult my father on so insignificant a matter. Now I go to

take leave of my mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA**, and offer consolation to my Sits. Let **BHARATA** rule the kingdom according to *dharma* and serve our royal father faithfully. This is a son's abiding duty." Hearing the words of Shri Rsmachandra, the king, speechless and overcome with grief, wept aloud, shedding bitter tears. The most illustrious Rsma made obeisance to his father lying pitifUlly there and, then bowing to the feet of **KAIKEYI**, left the apartment. Having cireumambulated the King and Queen **KAIKEYI** with extreme reverence, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** came forth from the inner chamber and beheld his friends standing at the door. Shri Labhmana lUll of wrath, his eyes suffused with tears, followed Rsma. Shri Rsma citcamambulated the saeted articles prepared for the installstion ceremony in great reverence, and prayed that they should be dedicated to the installstion of Prince **BHARATA**. Then turning from them, without a backward glance he slowly withdrew. The abandoning of the ceremony failed to impsir the serenity of Shri Rsmachsndra, the splendour of his counteoance remained unchanged as the moon suffers no diminution of its beauty in the waning period. On renouncing the kingdom and departing for ezile, Shri Rsmachandra resembled a great yogi and none observed any change of mood in him. Relinquishing the royal canopy, the beautiful chamara and bidding a respectful and a1fectiooate farewell to his friends and the people's delegates and guests, remembering the sorrow occasioned to them, and restraining his senses, the prince went to the apartments of his mother, to break the distressing tidings to her. Those about him found no change in him, neither in the adornments of his body, donned in preparation for the royal ceremony, nor in the cheerfulness of his countenance. Such was the truthful Ramacbandra. As the autumnal moon does not lose its splendour, so the cheerfulness of the mighty armed **RAMA** did not diminish. Addressing those standing near with sweetness and respect, he

approached his mother Kausbalya. The valorous Prince T.aksbmana, the sharer of his brother's joya and griefs, followed him. Aware of the great distress that would arise in the hearts of his friends, **SHRI RAMA** for his mother's aake entered the palace in a serene and cheerful mood. CHAPTBII 20 Quem KtJulluJlya is ajJiicted and Mlpk11 fllith that Lion among men, Shri Ramacbandra, his palms joined in a gesture of farewell, coming forth from his father's apartments, the ladies of the inner chamber begsn to lament loudly, saying: "ShaU **SHRI RAMA**, who fulfiJled all our desires without awaiting the injunctinn of his royal sire and who is our sole refuge, to-day go into exile ? " From his birth he has honouied and respected us as his own mother, Queen Kausbalya. When we have spoken harah words to him, he was never angry, nor did he ever give any cause for displeasure. That prince who ever reconciled those who were affronted, is to-day going into exile. Our king, acting like an ignorant man, is delermined to destroy his subjects and is sending **RAMA**, who is the sole support of all beings, into exile." Thill, weepiDg bitterly, all the maids of honour and maid·

CHAPTER 20

Queen Kaushalya is afflicted and helpless with sorrow

Relinquishing the royal canopy, the beautiful chamara and bidding a respectful and a1fectiooate farewell to his friends and the people's delegates and guests, remembering the sorrow occasioned to them, and restraining his senses, the prince went to the apartments of his mother, to break the distressing tidings to her. Those about him found no change in him, neither in the adornments of his body, donned in preparation for the

royal ceremony, nor in the cheerfulness of his countenance. Such was the truthful Ramacbandra. As the autumnal moon does not lose its splendour, so the cheerfulness of the mighty armed **RAMA** did not diminish. Addressing those standing near with sweetness and respect, he approached his mother Kausbalya. The valorous Prince T.aksbmana, the sharer of his brother's joya and griefs, followed him. Aware of the great distress that would arise in the hearts of his friends, **SHRI RAMA** for his mother's aake entered the palace in a serene and cheerful mood. CHAPTBII 20 Quem KtJulluJlya is ajJiicted and Mlpk11 fllith that Lion among men, Shri Ramacbandra, his palms joined in a gesture of farewell, coming forth from his father's apartments, the ladies of the inner chamber begsn to lament loudly, saying: "ShaU **SHRI RAMA**, who fulfiJled all our desires without awaiting the injunctinn of his royal sire and who is our sole refuge, to-day go into exile ? " From his birth he has honouied and respected us as his own mother, Queen Kausbalya. When we have spoken harah words to him, he was never angry, nor did he ever give any cause for displeasure. That prince who ever reconciled those who were affronted, is to-day going into exile. Our king, acting like an ignorant man, is delermined to destroy his subjects and is sending **RAMA**, who is the sole support of all beings, into exile." Thill, weepiDg bitterly, all the maids of honour and maid· THE RAM.AYANA OF VALMIKI come to seek thy sanction. It is the season of sorrow for thee, **SITA** and Labhmana. Now, entering the forest, my seat will be of kusha grass and there, residing for fourteen years, I shall live on honey, and fruits. The king has conferred the regency on Prince **BHARATA** and I, giving up royal fare, must enter the forest to eat the food of ascetics there. By the king's command, **BHARATA** will be installed as regent. For fourteen years, it is ordained that I shall live in the forest, practising asceticism far from the haunts of men. The forest from henceforth will

be my home ; roots and berries will be my food!” Hearing these words, the queen fell to the ground like the bough of a fir tree severed from the trunk, by an axe I Resembling a nymph fallen from heaven or a phantom tree struck down, she fell. Shri **RAMACHANDRA** raised her to her couch, her body soiled with dust, like a steed that has rolled on the earth and gently brushed awsy the dust with his own hands. The queen, worthy of every happiness, seated by her son, filled with distress, addressed him in the presence of Shri **LAKSHMANA** : " O Child, O **RAMA**, hadst thou not been born of my womb, I shonld have su1feted the distress of being childless, but I should have been spared this sorrow. O My Son, were I a barren woman, I should not have been thus alfticted, for a barren woman has but one grief, that of being childless. The fortune that befalls a wife, alas ! wss not to be enjoyed by me for long ! Having a son, I looked for happiness, but now, though chief queen, I must bear the piercing words of my rival consorts, no longer showing me deference. What greater calamity can befall a woman ? The insults that will be heaped upon me, without thee, will prove unendurable. Alas ! This is the season of unfathomable grief and alftiction I O My Son, when thou art gone, I shall cease to Jive. As chief queen, I have already borne great provocatinn ; now, serving **KAIKEYI**, I shall be deemed lower than her maidservant, indeed some say I am already her slave. Those who attend me, will desert me on beholding **BHARATA** made regent.” Then Queen **KAUSHALYA** growing angry, began to ntter bitter THE RAM.AYANA OF VALM.IKI words, saying : " How shall I, thus aftlicted, look on the face of **KAIKEYI** ? O **RAMA**, sevemeen years have passed sinee thou didst receive the holy thread.' Since then, I have lived in expectation of thine installation and the tetmination of my sorrows, but now I su1fer furthet. I shall not be able to endure this. O **RAMA**, I shall not be able to suffet the contumely of the othet queens in my old age. O Child, not

beholding thy countenance resembling the full moon, how shall I beat this miserable life ? I have kept innumerable fasts, worshipped the gods and nourished thee till now, yet un fortunate as I am, it has proved to be in vain. Surely my heart is made of stone that it has not btoken to-day, it resembles a rivet in the tainy season that does not ovetflow undet continued tain. Surely death has forgotten me or there is no room in his abode. Had it not been so, he would have carried me hence to-day like a doe carried away by a lion. Assuredly my heart must be as hard as iron that it is not riven undet this afBiction. O why does not the ,earth open and engulf me ; it seems one cannot die before the time appointed. Those sacred austerities, fasts, meditation and penance undettaken for the prosperity of my child have proved vain, like seeds sown in a barren fidd. If at this time of sorrow, I might die, threatened with thy separation, I should embrace death as willingly as a cow deprived of its calf. O My Son, of what use is life now to me, robbed of the sight of thy face resembling the full moon? Nay, I will follow thee to the forest like a feeble cow following its calf." Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the mothet of **RAMA**, aftlicted and hdpleas, realising bet own unfortunate position, and her son to be bound in the service of truth, lamented like a kinnari whose ofl"spring has been made captive. :,:;r;

CHAPTER 21

Shri Rama, in spite of the laments of the queen and Shri Lakshmana, prepares for departure

SHRI overcome with grief, addressed Mother Kausbalyainwordssuitedtotheoccasion. **HE** *said*: "OMother, it cannot be pleasing to thee that Rams, at the command of the king, who is subject

to a woman, and oblivious of the prosperity of the kingdom, should go to the forest. Old age has impaired the intellect of the IIIOII8lCb who, impelled by desire, is no ioDgei master of his senses ; what words will he not utter ? I see no fault in **RAMACHANDRA** for which he should be exiled and deprived of his kingdom. I know no man whether friend or foe who can find fault with **RAMA** even in absence. Like a god, he is guileless, self-controlled and forbearing even to his foes ; what righteous king would abandon such a without cause ? What versed in the discharge of a sovereign's duties would give obedience to so puerile a king ? " Addiessing **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** *continued*: " O Brother, befoe the multitude become acqusinted with these tidings, assume the Ieins of the kingdom, I will assist thee in the DDdertaking. O Raghava, who will dale oppose thee, when like death itself, I stand by thy side, armed with my bow ? If rwo or three, nay if all the people of Ayodhya resist thee in thine undertaking, I will destroy them. If all the supporters of **BHARATA** oppose I am **SHRI RAMA**'s williDg servant. O Devi, should **RAMA** enter the blazing lire or the dart forest, know I shall have preceded him. O Goddess, do thou and Shri Ramacbandrs behold my prowess by wbicb I shall destroy all your sufferings, as the sun destroys darkness. I will also slay the king enslaved by **KAIKEYI**, who is aged, contemptible, of unsubdued mind and in bis second chlldhood." Hearing the words of the noble Latshmana, Queen Kausbalya was overcome with grief and said to Shri **RAMACHANDRA** : " O Child, thou knowest the content of thy brother's heart, now act as thou considerest meet. It does not befit thee to abandon thy sorrow-stricken mother at the unjust words of her rival. O Righteous One, if thou art established in *dharma*, then remain here, serve me and acquire virtue. There is no bigher duty than service of the mother. I am, with the king, equally an object of thy reverence, and I command thee not to go to the forest. In thy separation, there is no

occasion for rejoicing, neither do I desire to live, but with thee I will gladly live, sustaining myself on herbs alone. If thou, leaving me alllicted with grief, go to the forest, then shall I refuse food and yield up my life. Then, O My Son, being responsible for my death thou wilt, lite Samudra,' unmindful of thy mother, enter hell." Seeing bis mother, the Queen Kausbalya, thus lamenting, the righteous Ramacbandra spoke to her dutifully, saying : " O Goddess, I cannot disregard my father's commands, therefore I bow before thee and entreat thy favour and sanction to enter the forest. Know that the Sage Kandu, a great pundit, acquainted with bis yogic duty, slew a cow in obedience to bis father's commands, knowing it to be a sin, wbicb was thereafter not cbarged against him. " In ancient times, likewise, in our own dynasty, the sons of King Sagara, digging the earth, sacrificed their lives at their father's behest. At the command of bis father, the son of Jamadagnya, Parasurama, with bis ue, cut off the head of bis mother Renuka. O Devi, these and other godlike men have obeyed theit father resolutely. I, too, without hesitation, shall perform that wbicb benefits my father. O Mother, not I lllone obey my father bnt all those virtuous men, mentioned by me, have been obedient to their father's will. I follow no new law, nor one conuary to the traditions of the royal dynasty, but tread the patb of my illustrious ancestors. I am accomplishing nought whieb has not already been accomplished in this world. He who acts in accordance witb his father's commands does not fall from virtue." Having spoken tbus to his motber, **SHRI RAMA** addressed **LAKSHMANA**, saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, I am acquainted witb thine immeasurable love for me, tby valour and tby prowess ; none can witbstand tbcc. O **LAKSHMANA**, my motber endowed witb every good quality is now subject to misery and grief through ignorance of *dharma* and laek of resignation. O Brotber, *dharma* is the highest good on earth,

Trutb and *dharma* arc one. My father's command is founded on *dharma*, hence it is superior to my mother's ruling. O Hero, it is unwortby in one seeking tbe supreme fruit of *dharma*, not to fullil the promise made to his fatber, motber or a learned *brahmin*, I cannot, tberefore, disregsrd my fatber's command. O Hero, inspired by my fatber, Mother **KAIKEYI** has urged me to tbis course, thercforc, O **LAKSHMANA**, relinquish tbe idea of bloodshed and embracing tbe state of virtue, follow me." Thus lovingly addressing **LAKSHMANA**, witb bowed head and in great humility **RAMA** turned to Queen **KAUSHALYA** and said : " O Goddess, now grant me permission to go into exile. In my absence pray for me. Having honoured my vow, I shall rcruru, like King Yayati who falling to cartb from hcaveu, again ascended thither. O Motber, comfort my unhappy fatber. Have no anxiety, O Mother, I ahall rerum after fourteen years as desired by my father. Do thou, **SITA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SUMITRA** obey my royal sire. This is the ancient tradition. O Mother, disregarding tbe preparations made for mine installatiou, let tby mind be freed from grief and allow me to go into exile as ordained by *dharma*." Hearing the words of **RAMA**, inspired by righteous motives, spoken witb courage and equanimity, Queen **KAUSHALYA** as one restored to life, gazed stcsdfastly at **RAMA** and said : " O My Sou, if tbou art versed in *dharma* and art mindful of tbe good done to tbcc by tby parents, tben am I as wottby oftby respeet as tby father. O My Sou, do not abandon thine unfortunate mother and enter the forest. O My Child, of what use is my life without thee ? The earth, the region of the pitais, heaven and the region of Mabaloka, which are the abodes of highest bliss, for me are all void without thee. An hour with thee is my greatest delight O My Son." **SHRI RAMA**, heariDg his mother's lament, was agitated, like a king who is pertUrbed, when on a dark night his totch·bearen are assailed on the way. Then the dutiful Ram again addressed his mother rendered almost

senseless with grief and **LAKSHMANA** distressed and disquieted, and spoke to them for their good, in words that were full of integrity: " O Labhmana, I know of thy prowess and the intensity of thy devotion to me, but now in opposition to my purpose, thou dost increase my mother's misery. O Brother, there are three means to happiness in this world, they are righteousness, prosperity and pleasure. Those who Jove righteousness should pursue it as a wife acquires merit by being obedient to her husband, and pleasure by endearing herself to him and prosperity by becoming a mother. That undertaking which does not ensure these three, should be given up and that by which they are secured should be canied out. He who pursues prosperity alone, is without friends and has many enemies, and he who is devoted to pleasure, which is not based on righteousness, is an object of contempt. O Brother, the king is fintly our preceptor, secondly our father and thirdly he is an aged man. From the point of view of *dharma*, I must obey his commands, whether they are inspired by anger or desire. As a righteous msn, I must fulfil his behests. Rare is the son so ruthless as to disobey his father. How can I evade the behests of my sire, who is my parent and has full authority over me as a king, and further is the consort of my dear mother **KAUSHALYA** ? How, therefore, should the queen, abandoning the virtuous king, her lord, follow me like a widowed woman ? O Goddess, grant me permissioA to leave for the forest whilst thou dost recite the Peace Chant, that my vow may be accomplished. " Like King Yayati of old who returned to heaven, inspired by his love of truth, I, toO, shaD retum. O Mother, I dare Dot 2011 disobey my father for the sake of a mere kingdom ! Life is brief and I have no desire for the rulership of the world through the sacrifice of virtue." The mighty **RAMA** thus acquainting his mother with his intention of entering the forest as demanded by **KAIKEYI**, circum ambulated the Queen

KAUSHALYA, fixing his heart on his departure. CHAPTER He appeals to Shri La/ulmuzna not to grkrJe SBRI RAMAclwmRA then turned to Shri **LAKSHMANA**, who unable to endure his distreSs, fUll of wrath against Kaikcyi, his eyes distorted, was breathing heavily like a mighty elephant. Address ing him in terms of af£ection as a beloved brother and friend, patiendy calming his fears, **RAMA** *said*: " O Brother, give up grief and anger and arm thyself with patience, forgetting the preparations made for mine installation, make thyself ready for my departure to the forest. O Labhmana, prepare with the same zeal as thou didst prepare for my coronation. The mind of my mother, **KAIKEYI**, is clouded with suspicion on account of my proposed enthronement, therefore, O **LAKSHMANA**, act so that her suspicions may be allayed. O Brother, Mother Kaikcyi believes thou wilt use force to place me on the throne. This I cannot endure, nor can I suffer her to experience anxiety. At no time, do I recollect that I have voluntarily given cause for olfencc to my parents. O **LAKSHMANA**, let us relieve the apprehensions of onr royal father, ever truthful and valiant hut now r-tW lest his future life be jeopardized. If I do not abandon the desire for the crown, the distress caused to the heart nf the king, at the violation of his vow, will be mine also. O lbhmana, because nf this, I desire to enter the forest without delay, abandoning the project nf mine installation. Thinking her purpose accomplished, Queen **KAIKEYI** will to-day, if I depatt for the forest. cause her son **BHARATA** to be sUIIIIIIIIned

CHAPTER 22

He appeals to Sbri Lakshmana not to grieve

disobey my father for the sake of a mere kingdom ! Life is brief and I have no desire for the rulership of the world through the sacrifice of virtue." The mighty **RAMA** thus acquainting his mother with his intention of entering the forest as demanded by **KAIKEYI**, circum ambulated the Queen **KAUSHALYA**, fixing his heart on his departure. CHAPTER He appeals to Shri La/ulmuzna not to grkrJe SBRI RAMAclwmRA then turned to Shri **LAKSHMANA**, who unable to endure his distreSs, fUll of wrath against Kaikcyi, his eyes distorted, was breathing heavily like a mighty elephant. Address ing him in terms of af£ection as a beloved brother and friend, patiendy calming his fears, **RAMA** *said*: " O Brother, give up grief and anger and arm thyself with patience, forgetting the preparations made for mine installation, make thyself ready for my departure to the forest. O Labhmana, prepare with the same zeal as thou didst prepare for my coronation. The mind of my mother, **KAIKEYI**, is clouded with suspicion on account of my proposed enthronement, therefore, O **LAKSHMANA**, act so that her suspicions may be allayed. O Brother, Mother Kaikcyi believes thou wilt use force to place me on the throne. This I cannot endure, nor can I suffer her to experience anxiety. At no time, do I recollect that I have voluntarily given cause for olfencc to my parents. O **LAKSHMANA**, let us relieve the apprehensions of onr royal father, ever truthful and valiant hut now r-tW lest his future life be jeopardized. If I do not abandon the desire for the crown, the distress caused to the heart nf the king, at the violation of his vow, will be mine also. O lbhmana, because nf this, I desire to enter the forest without delay, abandoning the project nf mine installation. Thinking her purpose accomplished, Queen **KAIKEYI** will to-day, if I depatt for the forest. cause her son **BHARATA** to be sUIIIIIIIIned and will make over the kingdom to him with joy. The heart of **KAIKEYI** will find no till I, dressed in a deer skin, with matted locks, entor the forest. I

cannot grieve her, who has urged me to go to the forest and contributed to my resolution, therefore, I will depart without delay. O **LAKSHMANA**, the acquisition of the kingdom is not part of my destioy. If provideoce had favouted me, **KAIKEYI** would not have desired to seod me to the forest. O Dear One, thou knowest no distinction was made by me between my three mothers, nor has **KAIKEYI** looked on me as di1ferent from Prince **BHARATA**, but to-day to frustrate my coronation and seod me into exile, she has uttered cruel and pitiless words. This is the will of God and nought else. Had it not been so, how should **KAIKEYI** the daughter of a king, of gentle disposition and noble nature, speak thus like a vulgar woman in the presence of her husband ? Whatever is inscrutable to man should be known to be the decree of providence ; even **BRAHMA** cannot evade the conse quences of *karma*.' It is this unalterable and fixed decree that has created the dissension between **KAIKEYI** and me, not to be understood by man. " Pleasure, pain, fear, anger, profit and loss, life and death, and similar matters come into being as a result of our *karma*. Even the sages practising great austerities, prompted by their *karma*, abandoning asceticism have been swept away by concupiscence and avarice. This sudden happening, never apprehended, this frustration of a well-devised plan is the work of brma. Therefore, I in no wise regret my resolve nor the cancellation of my coronation. Do thou also abandon grief and following me forget the preparations for the coronation. O IJ!kshmana, with these vessels of water brought hither for mine installation, let my dedication to the ascetic life, be made. Yet what use have I now for these sacred waters ? From now on, I shall draw water with mine own hands for every ritual. " O I.aksbmana, do not grieve that the installation ceremony remains unperformed. We know by reason and discernment that there is little di1ference between ruling a kingdom and liviag in a forest. O J.abhmna,

do not for an instant blame Queen AYODHYA KAND:A **KAIKEYI** for obstrmting my coronation ; prompted by *karma*, men say wbat is unlawful." CHAPTEil 23 Shri IAiulunana offers to defeat all those filM obllruct Shri Rmna's installation INSTilUCTED by his brother, Laksbmana, his head bowed, was filled with distress on account of **SHRI RAMA**'s impending departure, yet glad to learn the secret of dbarma. Remaining in the cave of anger awhile, breathing like a snake provoked in its hole, his frowning mien resembling an enraged lion, swaying like the trunk of an dephant, with quivering limbs, avertiog his gaze, he addressed his dder brother, saying: "O Brother, in this evil hour, thou art subject to a ddusion. m-timed is this assertion that disobedience to a parent is contrary to dbarma. It does not become one virtoous as thou art to speak thus. Thou, a leader warriors, canst control thy fate, yet like a weak man thou speakest of it as irrevocable. Dost thou respect these wicked beings,' O Virtuous One? Dost thou not know how many deceivers appear as righteous men ? Take note how the king and **KAIKEYI** for sdfish ends deceive thee and send thee into exile. If this matter of the boons granted to **KAIKEYI** were true, then why was it not revealed 'ere the preparations for thy inataUation were made ? If it can be said it was done in error, then that error is a calamity. It will cause

CHAPTER 23

Shri Lakshmana offers to defeat all those who obstruct Shri Rama's installation

AYODHYA KAND:A **KAIKEYI** for obstrmting my coronation ; prompted by *karma*, men say wbat is unlawful." CHAPTEil 23 Shri IAiulunana offers to defeat all those filM obllruct Shri Rmna's

installation INSTilUCTED by his brother, Laksbmana, his head bowed, was filled with distress on account of **SHRI RAMA**'s impending departure, yet glad to learn the secret of dbarma. Remaining in the cave of anger awhile, breathing like a snake provoked in its hole, his frowning mien resembling an enraged lion, swaying like the trunk of an dephant, with quivering limbs, avertiog his gaze, he addressed his dder brother, saying: "O Brother, in this evil hour, thou art subject to a ddusion. m-timed is this assertion that disobedience to a parent is contrary to dbarma. It does not become one virtoous as thou art to speak thus. Thou, a leader warriors, canst control thy fate, yet like a weak man thou speakest of it as irrevocable. Dost thou respect these wicked beings,' O Virtuous One? Dost thou not know how many deceivers appear as righteous men ? Take note how the king and **KAIKEYI** for sdfish ends deceive thee and send thee into exile. If this matter of the boons granted to **KAIKEYI** were true, then why was it not revealed 'ere the preparations for thy inataUation were made ? If it can be said it was done in error, then that error is a calamity. It will cause I consider the punuit of such a course to be worthy of condemnation. This is the reason for my distress. Though our parents, the King and **KAIKEYI**, desire to harm thee and are swayed by passion, who, except thee, would countenance their design ? Yet thou attributest this matter to the deaee of fate. This action is unpleasing to me. Let the wesk and the cowardly trust in so uncertain a fate, heroes and men of patient resolve, do not accept the dictates of *karma*. He, who by his own endeavours, conquers fate, never suffers. Let it be seen to-day whether fate or exertion prevail. " That destiny' which prevents thine instsllation, which resembles an elephant refusing to respond to the goad, and having broken its fetters, is wandering about unchecked, that decree will I conquer by my prowess. " Neither the guardians of the four quarters, nor all the dwellers in the

Three Worlds, united as one, can prevent thine installstion, how much less then, my father ? Those who have planned thine exile, shall themselves pass fourteen years in exile. I will frustrate the hopes of my father and **KAIKEYI**, who, depriving thee of the kingdom, seek to enthrone **BHARATA**. The power of *karma* will not bring such adversity to those opposed to us as my valour shall inflict on them I After ruling a thousand years, do thou retire to the forest, leaving thy sons to govern the kingdom, then, like our ancestors, who, becoming aged, withdrew to a hermitage, do thou continue to live in the forest. Formerly, kings in their declining years, giving over their subjects to the governance of their sons and gtandsons, used to retire to the forest as ascetics. If, O **RAMA**, thou fearest to rule against the behests of the king, thinking the administration would be insecure, I will protect thy kingdom as the shore protects the earth from the inroads of the sea. If I fall, may I never be called a hero I Now fix thy mind on thine enthronement with these auspicious preparations ; singlehanded I can e1fect the defeat of the kings who obstruct thine installstion. Theae two arms of mine are not for show, nor is my bow a mere decoration. My sword was never meant to dangle at my side, nor are my arrows designed to be kept in the quiver I All these are dedicated to the task of destroying the enemy. I will not brook the emunce of my foes. With my teen bright sword, I willbewtheirbodies to pieces, even ifit be **INDRA** himself. I will cut to pieces elephants, horses and men with my sword, creating large heaps and rendering advance impossible. To-day, my enemies sball fall like clouds rent by lightning. Domrlng the godha, lifting up my bow, I sball strike the enemy with many shafts and large numbers of them with a single arrow. I sball destroy innumerable soldiers, horses and elephants by piercing their most vulnerable parts with my shafts. To-day I sball demonstrate the power of my weapons and establish thy sovereignty.

To-day these two arms accustomed to be adorned with ornaments and aandalpaste and used to distributing charity and to protecting friends, sball prove their prowess by opposing those who obstruct thine installation. O **RAMACHANDRA**, I am thy servant, tell me who is thy foe and command me to oppose him so that severing them from their fame and friends, the kingdom be placed in thy hands." Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, hearing the words of **LAKSHMANA**, wiping away his tears, consoled him, saying : " O Dear One, know my chief valour to be obedience to the will of my father ; it behoves the virtuous to fiillil their father's command."

CHAPTER 24

The queen realises she has no power to restrain Shri Rama's resolution

SweetmestS and butter, how will that Roms of mine be able to live on roots and fruit? Who will not feel insecurity, knowing King **DASARATHA** to hsve banished his illustrious and virtuous son ? If he acts thus to such a son, whst of myself? If Rsmschsndra, beloved of all, is compelled to enter the forest, then undoubtedly destiny (*psst karms*) rules our joys and sorrows. O Child, the fire of grief in my heart, fanned by the wind of thine absence, fed on lamentstion and aftliction ; stimulated by tears, emitting the smoke of anxiety, will utterly consume and destroy me, like a forest fire at the end of winter reduces the bushes, creepers and grass to ashes. O Child, as a cow runs after its calf, so shsll I follow thee wheresoever thou goest." Rams, listening to the sorrowful speech of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, replied : " O Mother, the king is sorely distressed by the deceit of **KAIKEYI**, and I also must leave him when I

go to the forest. The Maharajah will not survive if thou also come with me. No more cruel act can a woman perform than to leave her hushsnd ; it is not to be countenanced. As long as my father lives, it is for thee to serve him. This eteroal *dharma* must be followed by thee." The virtuous maharani listening to the advice of Shri Rsmschandra, he who overcame dilliculties with ease, replied submissively to him: "O My Son, thy words are true." Shri Roms then addressed her who was suffering deep distress, saying: " O Goddess, both thou and I must obey my father. He is first my preceptor, secondly my father, thirdly thy hushsnd and finally the proteCtor, master and lord of us all. Having cheerfully passed fourteen years in the forest, I will return and do thy bidding." Queen **KAUSHALYA**, her eyes brimming with tears, she who did not merit suffering, answered Shri Ramachsndra, saying : " O My Son. how shsll I endure dwelling with my rivals ? If thou art resolved to enter the forest at the command of thy father, then like a wild doe take me with thee." .To his weeping mother, **SHRI RAMS** *replied*: "As long as a woman lives, she should consider her hushsnd as her master and her lord. The king is our master, how should we be masterless while the king lives ? Bbarata also is virtuous, humble and devoted to the good of all. He will undoubtedly treat thee with respect and oot oppose thee. When I am gone, let not the king suffer on account of my separation, and let him not be overcome by this great grief. The king is now aged, it becomes thee to serve him with every care. Even a virtuous woman, devoted to piety and fasting, if negligent towards her consort, comes to a sinner's state, but she who is devoted to her lord attains heaven. The woman who is ever devoted to her husband and ever ready to seek his welfare, attains heaven, even if she bas not worshipped any god. Service of the husband is a duty sanctioned by ancient tradition, by the Veda and by the scriptutallaw. O Mother, undertake those rituals promoting universal

peace and serve the gods with lloral offerings. For my sake, give hospitality to pious and learned *brahmins* and await my return. Performing the discipline of daily purification, give up savoury foods, and existing on simple fare, serve the king. Should the king still be living when I return, truly it shall be well." The queen, her eyes suffused with tears, distressed on account of the impending separation from her son, replied to Shri Ramacbandra : " O Child, thy resolution to enter the forest being fixed, I have no power to restrain thee. O Hero, fate is irrevocable, therefore, enter the forest without anxiety, mayest thou be happy. On thy retum, my sulferings will cease. O Auspicious One, when thou returnest on the fulfilment of thy vow, rendering back the debt thou owest to thy father, my joy will be complete. None can comprehend the warp of fate.' It is fate that urges thee to oppose me. O Prince, now depart and return safely, promoting my delight with a pure heart. O Child; I pray that thou wilt return soon, and that I shall behold thee in robes of bark with matted locks." Queen **KAUSHALYA**, knowing that Ramacbandra was eager to enter the forest, reverently gave him her blessings, uttering auspicious words CHAPTBR 2S Ths quem giws ,.,. blaring and ths *brahmins* pronounce tM bmstlictitm REsniAINING her grief, sipping a few drops of pure water from her band, Queen **KAUSHALYA**, purifying herself, performed the benedictory rites for the well-being of **RAMA**. **SHE** *said*: " O Prince of the House of Raghu, I may not restrain thee, therefore now depart. and on thy return, tread the path of the virtuous. O Great Raghu, may that *dharma* which thou hast practised with courage, preserve thee. May the gods thou hast worshipped in the temples and on the highways and the great sages protect thee. May the weapons given thee by the wise **VISHWAMITRA** protect thee. O Mighty One, preserved by this service rendered by thee to thy father, mother and the truth, mayest thou live long. May the

sacrificial kusha grass, sacred grass rings, altars, temples, sacred places, mountains, trees of every kind, lakes, rivers, birds, snakes and lions ever protect thee ! May **BRAHMA**, Pusha,Atyama, **INDRA** and Lobpalaall be auspicious to thee I May the seasons, the months, the weeks, the years, the day and night favour thee I O My Son, may holy meditation, concentration and *dharma*, together with the injunctions, ordained in the Veda protect thee I May the Lord Sanat Kumara, Mahadevawith Uma,' Brihaspati, the seven holy *Rishis*' and Shri Narada bless thee I May all the perfect beings adored by me, ever protect thee ! May the mountain ranges, the seas as also **VARUNA** their lord, space, the earth, the rivers and the stars with their deities, the planeta and the day and night protect thee in the forest I May the six seasons, the twelve months, the whole year and the divisions of the hour promote thy happiness I May the *devas*, the adhityas and the *asuras*, wandering in the forest in the guise of hermits, protect thee I

CHAPTER 25

The queen gives her blessing and the brahmins their benedicnon

CHAPTBR 2S Ths quem giws ,.,. blaring and ths *brahmins* pronounce tM bmstlictitm REsniAINING her grief, sipping a few drops of pure water from her band, Queen **KAUSHALYA**, purifying herself, performed the benedictory rites for the well-being of **RAMA**. **SHE** *said*: " O Prince of the House of Raghu, I may not restrain thee, therefore now depart. and on thy return, tread the path of the virtuous. O Great Raghu, may that *dharma* which thou hast practised with courage, preserve thee. May the gods thou hast worshipped in the temples and on the highways and

the great sages protect thee. May the weapons given thee by the wise **VISHWAMITRA** protect thee. O Mighty One, preserved by this service rendered by thee to thy father, mother and the truth, mayest thou live long. May the sacrificial kusha grass, sacred grass rings, altars, temples, sacred places, mountains, trees of every kind, lakes, rivers, birds, snakes and lions ever protect thee ! May **BRAHMA**, Pusha,Atyama, **INDRA** and Lobpalaall be auspicious to thee I May the seasons, the months, the weeks, the years, the day and night favour thee I O My Son, may holy meditation, concentration and *dharma*, together with the injunctions, ordained in the Veda protect thee I May the Lord Sanat Kumara, Mahadevawith Uma,' Brihaspati, the seven holy *Rishis*' and Shri Narada bless thee I May all the perfect beings adored by me, ever protect thee ! May the mountain ranges, the seas as also **VARUNA** their lord, space, the earth, the rivers and the stars with their deities, the planeta and the day and night protect thee in the forest I May the six seasons, the twelve months, the whole year and the divisions of the hour promote thy happiness I May the *devas*, the adhityas and the *asuras*, wandering in the forest in the guise of hermits, protect thee I "May no rabhasas,' pisachas,those who practise cruelty, that which is ill-omened and the eaters of flesh, ever cause thee injury ! May no monlteys, scorpions, gadfties, serpents or reptiles approach thee ! O My Son, may no elephant, lion, tiger, bear or beast with awful jaws, or bu1faloes and those with dangerous horns, be hostile to thee ; propitiated by me, may they not cause thee injury in the forest I May thy way be blessed, may thine undertsking be crowned with success I O My Son, mayest thou ever find fruits, roots and the means of subsistence I Mayest thou ever tread the forest unhindered I May all things between heaven and earth protect thee at all times I May **INDRA**, the Moon, the Sun, Kuvera and **YAMA** worshipped by thee, protect thee from thy foes I May **AGNI**,

Vayu, Dhuma,' and the sacred formulas, taugbt by the *Rishis*, protect thee when inadvertently contacting the untouchables I May the Lord of the world, **BRAHMA**, **VISHNU** and the gods not mentioned by me, protect thee in the forest ! " Then the illustrious **KAUSHALYA** worshipped the gods with ftowers and sandalwood, offering oblations and kindling the sacred fire for the health and peace of Shri **RAMACHANDRA** with the aid of the pious *brahmins*, learned in rituals. With butter, white flowers, sacrificial fuel and mustard seed prepared for the oblation by Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the learned and pious *brahmins* performed the Hawan ceremony for the welfare of **RAMA**. Then the mother of **RAMA** asked the btahmins to pronounce the benediction and present the oblations to the Lokopalas, the priests receiving the remainder. With honey, curds, rice and clarified butter, the btahmins pronounced their blessings and the queen having offered them abundant alms and whatsoever they desired, addressed **RAMA**, saying : " O Rams, may the same blessing bestowed on **INDRA** on the destruction of Bratra-worship of Vmata.' May the blessiug attendant on **INDRA**, the bearer of the mace, at the time of the raising of the amrita from the ocean at the instance of his motber, Aditi, be thine. O My Son, may the good fortune attendant on the blessed Trivikrama' wben measnring the world in tbree strides, be tbine also. O **RAMA**, may the seasons, the ocean, the islands, the Vedas and the eardinal points contribute to thy happiness." Thus, scattering rice over the head of her scm, the large-eyed Queen **KAUSHALYA**, applying sandal paste to his forehead, bestowed on **RAMA** the healing wood ' Vishalya Karina '. For his protection, the queen silently repeated the mantrams, and tbough her hearr was filled with distress, appeared as one contenr. Embracing her son, and kissing his head, she laid : "O My Son, now go in peace. Mayest tbou, having fulfilled the commands of the king, return in health to Ayodhya. O

Child, my joy will be complete, wben I behold thee at thy coronation. My troubles ended and my ambitions fulfilled, on thy return from exile, beholding thee occupying the throne, I shall know supreme happiness. Having fulfilled the injunc tions of thy fatber, thou wilt rerum, and I, beholding thee clad in royal apparel with innumerable gems, shall then find peace. O Prince, now depart and accomplish the desire of Princess **SITA** and me." The queen reciting the Peace Chant, her eyes su1fused with tears, embracing her son again and again, circumsmbulated him, gaaing on his face. Touching her feet repeatedly, the illustrious **RAMACHANDRA**,

CHAPTER 26

Shri Rama acquaints Princess Sita of his resolution

SHRI RAAIAcBANDRA, ever devoted to virtue, taking leave of his mother, ready to enter the forest, passed through the crowded sueets, by his excellent qualities inspiring peace in the hearts of the multitude. The ucetic Princess **SITA**, not being acqUBinted with what had happened, her mind full of joy in the thought of the coming coronation of her consort, worshipping the gods and proficient in every duty, awaited the approach ofher lord with a happy heart. Meantime, **RAMA** dressed in his customary appard, his head bowed in humility, entered the palace filled with joyful and richly attired persons. Seeing **RAMACHANDRA** unadorned, the princess was filled with consternation and fear, and rose uembling from her seat. **RAMA** beholding the princess, dearer than life to him, could not restrain his distress. **SITA**, seeing the countenance of **RAMA**, sad, pale and moist with anguish, addressed him : " O My Lord, what is this? To-day, the Pushya planet and the moon are in conjunction,

and Brihaspati in the ascendant, this is the time fixed for thy coronation by the holy *brahmins*, why art thou thus distressed? Why do I not behold the canopy, pnre as foam, set with a hundred stars over thy head ? Why are the chamaru, white u the moon or the swan, not waving to and fro over thee ? O Great One, why do I not hear the bards to-day eloquently voicing thy praise, or the pundits reciting the Chant of Peace ? " Why have the leamed *brahmins* not anointed thee with honey, and curds u a mark of thine enthronement ? Why art thou not attended by ministers, citizens and courtiers sumptu ously attired ? Why do four swift steeds with golden trsppings, fleet of foot, not precede thee ? I do not behold the great elephant resembling a cloud, pouessed of every auspicious mark,· in thy train ? Why dost thou appear downcut when the preparations for thy coronation are completed ? O My Lord, why does thy countenance manifest no signs of joy ? " Hearing the aorrowful words of the Princess Sits, **RAMA** *replied*: " O **SITA**, my honoured father has commanded me to go into exile. O Princess, born of an illustrious family, acquainted with the law of *dharma* and eminent in virtue, hear, while I tell thee what has befallen me. Long ago my father, a lover of truth, gtanted two boons to my mother **KAIKEYI**. Beholding the preparations for my coronation, **KAIKEYI** demanded the fulfilment of her boons and has now gained ascendency over his mind. In accordance with the two boons gtanted to her, it is mine to pass fourteen years in the Dandaka forest and Prince **BHARATA** to be installed as regent. I am now going into exile and have come to bid thee farewell. Let no words in praise of me be repeated to Prince **BHARATA**, lest he withhold his protection from thee. It is for thee to submit to his will for the sake of thy support. The king has conferred the regency on Prince **BHARATA** forever. It behoves thee to aet in such a way that he be not displeased with thee. O Wise One, now I go to the forest in obedience to my

father’s behest, remain here with a quiet heart. O Sinless One, when dressed as a hermit I leave for the forest, then do thou also cease to adorn thyself. Rising early, do thou worship the gods according to the prescribed rituals, then, approaching my father and mother, offer obeisance to them. My mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA**, having grown old, is aftlieted on account of my departure, it becomes thee to serve her with respect. My other mothers should be honoured and served by thee like Queen **KAUSHALYA**, their hearts are also full of love towards me. Like my own mother **KAUSHALYA**, they have also cherished me, therefore I deem them worthy of the same honour. My bmthers **BHARATA** and Shat· rughns should be regarded by thee as thy brothers or thy sons. It behoves thee never to provoke Prince **BHARATA**, from CHAPTBB. '-7

CHAPTER 27

She entreats Rama to allow her to accompany him

CHAPTBB. '-7 causing thee no IIDXiety. Under the protection of one as wise as thee, O Lord, I desire to enjoy the beauty of lakes, mountains and rivers without hindrance. O **RAMA**, I long with thee to see the beautiful lakes where swans and kavandava birds’ play and charming lotuses bloom. Thete will I bathe with thee, O My Lotus-eyed Lord, sporting thete with thee. Thus would I pass a thousand years with thee, the happiness eojoyed in thy company renders even the delights of heaven distasteful to me. O Prince, without thee, heaven itself would not please me. I long to enter the forest with thee where deet, monkeys and elephants roam. O Prince, setVing thy holy feet, I will pass the time there as happily as in my royal father’s house. Recognizing no other, in thee my mind finds its highest delight ; separated from thee, I shall

surely die. O Master, be gracious enough to take me with thee, assuredly I shall not burden thee." Shri **RAMACHANDRA** hearing the humble and piteous words of Shri **SITA**, unwilling to let the princess accompany him, sought to dissuade her by describing the hardships of a forest life.

CHAPTER 28

Shri Rams seeks to dissuade her

THE virtuous **RAMACHANDRA**, devoted to truth reflecting on the hardships to be borne in the forest, in spite of **SITA**'s entreaty was unwilling to grant her request. Once more, he addressed the weeping **SITA**, insisting she should not accompany him, saying : " O **SITA**, thou art nobly born and devoted to the practice of virtue ; remain here continuing to act righteously. O Frail Princess, act according to my will. Life in the forest is fraught with misety, O **SITA**, relinquish the thought of sharing my elile, many are the dangers thete. The forest is named Antara " meaning it is unlit for human habitation. For thine own well-being, I advise thee to remain here ; in the forest thete is no comfort. The rivers opec;.. ddwk. -issuing from the mountains are difficult to cross, the lions rosring in the mountain caves strike terror in the heart and render the forest perilous ; therefore, remain here. O **SITA**, many wild bessts wandering at will in the forest may assail thee, therefore life there is full of danger. The deep marshes and the rivers infested with crocodiJea are difficult to cross, even an elephant may find them impasssble. Many ssvage elephants wander here and there; assuredly the forest is replete with perils. Waterless are the paths covered with thorns and poisonous creepers, there the hoarse cry of wild fowl re-echoes ; the forest is a source of suffering. Wearied by

journeying the traveller finds no silken pillows nor a soft couch, but at night must sleep on the bare esrth, his bed the fallen lesves ; verily the forest is a source of suffering ! O **SITA**, in the forest, there is nought to est save the fruit that has fallen from the trees ; with this the traveller must be sstisfied day and night, therefore the forest is a source of suffering I O Daughter of Mitbila, fasting to the urmost extent, with matted locks, wearing robes of bark, one must constantly worship the *devas* and pittris and offer respectful hospitality to the unexpected guest. Thrice daily must ablutioas be performed by thoae who live according to the prescribed ordinance, therefore, the forest is a source of suffering. O Youthful Princess, it is necessaty to make offerings of tlowers on the altars, plucked by one's own hand, as ordained by the sages. A dweller in the forest must be satisfied with whatever food he can obtain, therefore the forest is a source of suffering. Great storms visit the forest, covering it with darkness by day ; constant hunger and many other perils prevail there, therefore is it a source of suffering. O Beautiful One, grest snakes and pythons dwell in the forest, serpents as tortuous as the currents of the river live in the waters and obstruct the traveller's path, therefore the forest is a source of suffering. O Delicate Princess, scorpioas, poisonous reptiles, hornets and mosquitoes aftlict one constantly in the forest ; therefore the forest is a source of suffering. O Charming Princess, the forest is filled with briars, harsh grass and gnarled trees obstrncting the way, it is therefore a source of suffering. Lite in the forest is full of conditions adverse to the body and manifold dangers, it is therefore a source of suffering. O **SITA**, n3 THE RAMAYANA OF VALMJKJ a dwdler in the forest must relinquish anger and avarice and practise severe penances, nor must fear visit him in the midst of alarms. " Do nor, tbetefote, CODSidet entering the forest which is not meant to be thy lot. Reftecting carefully, I see nought but

suffering in the forest fot thee." Thus **RAMA** disclosed his mind to **SITA** and sought to dissuade her from entering the forest, but the princess, sorely distressed, unable to CODSent to his counsel, then made answer.

CHAPTER 29

Sita continues her entreaties but the prince is unwilling to consent

SHRt StTA hearing **RAMA**'s words, greatly distressed and with tears coursing down her cheeks, ausweted in a low voice : " O **RAMA**, the sufferings of a life in the forest described by thee, wiU, through my Jove fot thee be tranamuted to joys. Deet, bear, lions, elephants, sarabhas,' birds, bulls and other woodland beasts, on beholding thy matchless countenance, wiU See away striclten with terror. All fear thee, O Lord ! Instructed by my elders to remain in thy company, it behoves me to go with thee ; separated from thee, I cannot live. Wheo near to thee, O **RAMA**, eveo lndra the King of the *Devas* dare not do me injury. O **RAMA**, thou hast taught me that a woman must not be parted from her lord. O Most Wise Lotd. long ago, in my father's house, I told by one fidelity, enjoined by my elders. The time for the fulfilment of the bnhmin's prophecy is at band. O Hero, I know all the miseries of life in the forest, but it is those of unsubdued mind who suffer them. While still living in my father's house, a pious and saintly woman predicted in the presence of my mother, that I should live in the forest. O My Lord, formerly I have begged thee to let me sport with thee in the woods. The time is now come, grant my prayer and let me go with thee I O Prince, may the undertaking be propitious. Glad am I to accompany thee to the forest, to serve thee there will be my great delight. O Lord, relinquishing

envy, accompanying thee in the forest, all my sins will be washed away through my devotion to thee. I have other god but thee, if death overtakes me I shall DOt experience happiness in the other world without thee. I have heard from the *brahmins* that a woman given by her father according to the sacred ordinance to a man, becomes his wife in this world and also in the other world. O Prince of Beautiful Locks, in perfect devotion to thee, filled with humility, regarding psin and pleasure as equal, sharing thy austerities, permit me to accompany thee. If thou art still unwilling to take me, a woman distressed, to the forest, then I will seek death by poison or drowning." In this wise, **SITA** entreated **RAMA** to let her accompany him, but still the great prince was unwilling to consent. Seeing **RAMA** disinclined to grant her request, **SITA** was filled with grief, and her hot fell, moistening the earth. **SHRI RAMA**, seeing the princesa flushed with amtiety and indignation still sought to divert her from her purpose. CBAPTBR 30 amr, 1wr fWd rUD1w Slrri Rlmla grantllwr ,_, SHiu RAMA again stressed the dangers of the forest and sought to persuade **SITA** Dot to accompany him ; but **SITA**, with fixed resolve, trembling with fear yer urged by love and pride, spoke as in jest : " O **RAMA**, if my father the Lord of Mithila, had

CHAPTER 30

Seeing her fixed resolve Shri Rama grants her request

fidelity, enjoined by my elders. The time for the fulfilment of the bnhmin's prophecy is at band. O Hero, I know all the miseries of life in the forest, but it is those of unsubdued mind who suffer them. While still living in my father's house, a pious and saintly woman predicted in the

presence of my mother, that I should live in the forest. O My Lord, formerly I have begged thee to let me sport with thee in the woods. The time is now come, grant my prayer and let me go with thee I O Prince, may the undertaking be propitious. Glad am I to accompany thee to the forest, to serve thee there will be my great delight. O Lord, relinquishing envy, accompanying thee in the forest, all my sins will be washed away through my devotion to thee. I have other god but thee, if death overtakes me I shall DOt experience happiness in the other world without thee. I have heard from the *brahmins* that a woman given by her father according to the sacred ordinance to a man, becomes his wife in this world and also in the other world. O Prince of Beautiful Locks, in perfect devotion to thee, filled with humility, regarding psin and pleasure as equal, sharing thy austerities, permit me to accompany thee. If thou art still unwilling to take me, a woman distressed, to the forest, then I will seek death by poison or drowning." In this wise, **SITA** entreated **RAMA** to let her accompany him, but still the great prince was unwilling to consent. Seeing **RAMA** disinclined to grant her request, **SITA** was filled with grief, and her hot fell, moistening the earth. **SHRI RAMA**, seeing the princesa flushed with amtiety and indignation still sought to divert her from her purpose. CBAPTBR 30 amr, 1wr fWd rUD1w Slrri Rlmla grantllwr ,_, SHiu RAMA again stressed the dangers of the forest and sought to persuade **SITA** Dot to accompany him ; but **SITA**, with fixed resolve, trembling with fear yer urged by love and pride, spoke as in jest : " O **RAMA**, if my father the Lord of Mithila, had known thee as a man in form only, but a woman at heart, he would never have united me to thee. Alas I that men in Thus **SITA**, lamenting and embracing **SHRI RAMA**, wept aloud. From her eyes, like a she elephant wounded by poisoned arrows, long-restrained tears issued, as fire is kindled by the friction of wood. Crystal drops fell from her eyes as water

slips from the petals of the lotus ftowers. The face of the princess resembling the full moon, withered by the fire of intense grief, looked like a lotus withdrawn from water. Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, taking **SITA**, aftlicted and fainting, in his arms, spoke to her in the following wise : " O Devi, I do not desire even to enter heaven if it causes thee pain I Nought do I fear I Lite Brahm, I am wholly fearless I Though able to protect thee in every way, yet not fully knowing thy mind, I declined to let thee share my exile. Seeing thou art destined to share my exile, I do not desire to abandon thee, as a man of virtuous conduct determines not to sacrifice his good name. O Beautiful One, following the example of the good of yore, I shall act in the same manner; do thou follow me as Suvarchala' follows the sun. O Daughter of King J onaka, I am not entering the forest by my own desire, but to obey the injunctions of my father. O Devi, it is the duty of a son to obey bis patents, I could not endure life if I failed to observe my father's command. Fate is invisible, who can control it, but the parents and the spiritual preceptor are visible deities and their orders must be obeyed. What in the world is so sacred as the worship of that which grants dharms, prosperity and pleasure ? By this worship, homage is paid to the three worlds. O **SITA**, observance of truth, charity and sacrifice accompanied by suitable offerings (*dakahina*) is of less avail in obtaining the spiritual realm than the service of parents and the Guru. Those who serve their parents and the spiritual preceptor obtain heaven, wealth, learning and progeny and nothing is impossible for them. Those who are devoted to their parents and their Guru obtain entranCe to heaven and the regions of the *devas*, the gandhsrvas and Brahm. This is eternal righteousness-to obey the command of thy parents, fixed in the practice of truth. O **SITA**, not knowing thy mind, I advised thee not to accompany me, but now seeing thy fixed resolve I desire to tate thee with me. O Princess, whose eyes sparkle like wine,

thou art destined s .. to be my companion, do thou assist me in the performance of my duty. It is well that thou didst desire to be with me in accordance with the custom of forbears. O **SITA**, prepare to go into exile without delay ; without thee, even heaven does not please me. Bestow thy jewels on the brabmins in cbarity and offer food to the poor ; hasten, make no delay. Give to the *brahmins*, jewels, ornaments, rich apparel, whatever thou possesses! or is employed for my entertainment, all that is mine and thine, couches, coverlets, and vehicles give in cbariry to the *brahmins* and what remains distribute among the servants." Shri **SITA**, happy at the acquiescence of Prince **RAMA** and knowing her departure to be fixed, began to distribute all her possessions. Free from anxiety, **SITA** bestowed on the pious *brahmins* her wealth and all her jewels. CBAPTI!R 3 Shri Lakshtnanl u resolwd to accompany them SBRI LAmlMANA being present. hearing the converse of **RAMA** and **SITA**, was a111icted and unable to restrain his grief, and weeping bitterly, spoke as follows : " If thou art resolved to enter the forest in wbich dwell many wild beasts and elephants, I will accompany thee with my bow and arrows. I will wander with thee in the beautiful forest to the delightful sounds of birds and deer abounding there. O **RAMACHANDRA**, without thee I do not care to dwell even in the region of the gods nor do I desire immonality or dominion over other abodes." Seeing Prince Labhmana determined to accompany him to the forest, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** sought to dissuade bini, but Shri Labhmana anawered : " O Brother, having already granted me permission to accompany thee, why dost thou now prohibit me ? O Sinless One, I would fain know what prevenn thee from takina me with thee ; my mind is clouded with fears." Shri **RAMACHANDRA** perceiving I .abhwna humbly standini before him ready to accompany bini, said: "O I-1bhmna, thou art most dear to me, virtuous, brave and constantly

engaged :az8

CHAPTER 31

Shri Lakshmana is resolved to accompany them

to be my companion, do thou assist me in the performance of my duty. It is well that thou didst desire to be with me in accordance with the custom of forbears. O **SITA**, prepare to go into exile without delay ; without thee, even heaven does not please me. Bestow thy jewels on the brabmins in cbarity and offer food to the poor ; hasten, make no delay. Give to the *brahmins*, jewels, ornaments, rich apparel, whatever thou possesses! or is employed for my entertainment, all that is mine and thine, couches, coverlets, and vehicles give in cbariry to the *brahmins* and what remains distribute among the servants." Shri **SITA**, happy at the acquiescence of Prince **RAMA** and knowing her departure to be fixed, began to distribute all her possessions. Free from anxiety, **SITA** bestowed on the pious *brahmins* her wealth and all her jewels. CBAPTI!R 3 Shri Lakshtnanl u resolwd to accompany them SBRI LAmlMANA being present. hearing the converse of **RAMA** and **SITA**, was a111icted and unable to restrain his grief, and weeping bitterly, spoke as follows : " If thou art resolved to enter the forest in wbich dwell many wild beasts and elephants, I will accompany thee with my bow and arrows. I will wander with thee in the beautiful forest to the delightful sounds of birds and deer abounding there. O **RAMACHANDRA**, without thee I do not care to dwell even in the region of the gods nor do I desire immonality or dominion over other abodes." Seeing Prince Labhmana determined to accompany him to the forest, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** sought to dissuade bini, but Shri Labhmana

anawered : " O Brother, having already granted me permission to accompany thee, why dost thou now prohibit me ? O Sinless One, I would fain know what prevenn thee from takina me with thee ; my mind is clouded with fears." Shri **RAMACHANDRA** perceiving I .abhwna humbly standini before him ready to accompany bini, said: "O I-1bhmna, thou art most dear to me, virtuous, brave and constantly engaged :az8 in righteous deeds, thou art as dear to me as my life. Thou art my younger brother, my servant and my friend. If I grant thy request, who will protect the reuowned **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA** in thine absence ? O Brother, the king who granted their desires, as a cloud responds to the need of the earth, is still under the bondage of pleasure desire. Wben **KAIKEYI**, the daughter of King Ashvapatti, becomes the queen mother, she will not treat her rival consorts well. She will not heed the needs and comforts of Queen **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**, nor will **BHARATA**, governed by his mother, respect them. Therefore, O Lakshmaoa, remaining here, winning the kiug's favour, render Queen **KAUSHALYA** happy. O Brother, heed my instruc tion. O Knower of *Dharma*, acting thus, thou wilt demonstrate thy great devotion to me and alao serve thy mother and thereby eam great merit. O I abhmana, reflecting on these words, follow my injunctinn. Bereft of us, our mothers cannot be happy." **RAMA** having uttered these words, the eloquent Lakshmaoa replied in gentle accents : " O Hero, **BHARATA** will assuredly have due regard for the Queens **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**. If **BHARATA**, having obtained this mighty kiugdom, through evil counsel and pride should not protect the queens, I will assuredly slay that wicked wretch. O Noble One, Mother **KAUSHALYA** can well command thousands like me. That illustrious queen can easily protect my mother and herself and countless others. Make me thy humble attendant, there is no wrong in this. Thus shall my highest desire be

accomplished and thou shalt also find satis1iactinn. Armed with my bow and anows, a spade and basket, gathering wild frnit and flowers, I shall precede thee, pointing out the way. Bach day, I shall provide thee with ascetic's food, leaves and other suitable ofl"erings. Do thou, with the daughter of the King of Vadeha, enjoy thyself on the mountain l1opes. Sleeping or waking, I shall do all for thee." Shri Ramachanc!R listened to the loving words of Shri hbhmana with delight and answered : " O Lakshmaoa, seek the permiasioo of thy mother **SUMITRA**, and other relativea to go with me. O I .abh-n, fetch, without delay, the dread bowl pvea by Vlnlll himaelf to Rajarisbi Janab at the time of the quivers, the two swords bright as the sun, decorated with gold, which King Jlllllllka presented to me at the time of my nuptials and which were deposited with care in the house of Shri asisht' Kno"lng his exile to be certain, Shri Lakshmsna bade farewell to his relatives and, bringing the weapons decorated with fresh ftowers from the home of Shri **VASISHTHA**, presented them to Ram.

CHAPTER 32

Shri Rama bestows his wealth upon the brahmins, his friends and servants

Quivers, the two swords bright as the sun, decorated with gold, which King Jlllllllka presented to me at the time of my nuptials and which were deposited with care in the house of Shri asisht' Kno"lng his exile to be certain, Shri Lakshmsna bade farewell to his relatives and, bringing the weapons decorated with fresh ftowers from the home of Shri **VASISHTHA**, presented them to Ram. golden thread, amulets 8lld other jewels, and at **SITA**'s instance, said : " O Peaceful *Rishi*, be gracious

enough to accept tbis necldace and gold whicb Sbri **SITA** offetS to thy spouse, also the bracelets 8lld rings of beaten gold and jewelled bangles ; about to entet tbe forest, Shri **SITA** offets them to thy wife. Accept also tbis soft pure coucb with a covetlet embroideted with precious stones, peatls 8lld tassels. This elephant also, named Shatranjaya, whicb my uncle gave me, I present to thee, O Great *Rishi*, togetbet with a thousand golden coins." Suyajna, tequested by Sbri **RAMA**, accepted all the gifts, 8lld gave his blessings to **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA**. Then **RAMA**, of sweet speech, addressed **LAKSHMANA** as Btabrna addresses Indta, saying : " O Laksbrnana, call hithet tbe two excellent sons of the *Rishi* Agastya and Sbri **VISHWAMITRA**, and honour them with gifts of gems. Give to each in abundance as a field of com is visited by tain, a tbouslllld cows, gold, silvet, jewels and ornaments. To that btahmin, vetSed in the Taittirya' who daily, with devotion, gives his blessing to Queen **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**, who is 1eamed in the Vedanta and experienced in all tnatters, give vehicles, silken robes 8lld women attendants, so that he tnay be wholly satisfied. To my confidential adviset, Chitaratha, who has SetVed me over a long petind, give precious jewels, cloths 8lld abundant wealth, and to tbe brahtnacharis, my fellow students who study tbe Veda and arc of excellent conduct, following no profession, living detached, enjoying good food, yet dependent on alms, give to each of these a thousand cows. O **LAKSHMANA**, bestow on tbem eighty camels apiece loaded with jewels, a thousand bullocks loaded with rice and two hundred bulls for tilling the ground. O Laksbruana, give tbem cows so that they tnay enjoy butter, milk and curds, and to each of the brahtnacharis attending on Queen **KAUSHALYA** give a thousand cows 8lld a thousand golden coins and give them abundant alms so that my mothet tnay be pleased with us." Obeying the comtnands of Prince **RAMA**, Sbri Laksbrnana offeted

hospitality to tbe *brahmins*. Like Kuvera, he gave to every *brahmin* abundant wealth as instructed by his brother. Then **SHRI RAMA**, seeing his semnts standing near him weeping, bestowed on them sutlicient wealth for their entire lives and said : “Until I from the forest, keep watch on the palace belonging to Shri Latshmana and myself.” Then all wept overcome at the thought of his departure, and **RAMA** turning to his treasurer said : " Bring hithet my wealth,” and they heaped quantities of gold and silver befote him, wonderfW to behold. Then **RAMA** with the aid of **LAKSHMANA** disuibuted it among the aged, the sick and the needy. Now, thcte was a certsin btahmin of the family of Garga, whose name was **TRIJATA**, whose complexion was psle on account of much privation. He, toiling honestly, went to the foteSt dsily with spade, axe and plough, maintaining his family on the fruits and llowers of the foteSt. His wife, wom down with much poverty, gathering her young children together, addteSsed her husband, saying: “Abandoning thy plough and spade, follow my instructions. Go with all speed and approach the virtuous Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, undoubtedly thou shalt obtain something there.” The btahmin, covering himself with a few wretched tags, set out for **SHRI RAMA**’s palace, his countenance, in lustre, teaembling that of the *Rishi* Bhrigu or Angiras. Entering the fifth gate unchallenged, he Came: to where the multitude were assembled and approaching Shri Ramachancha, said : " O Illustrious Prince, I am destitute of wealth and having many children, subsist on what I find in the foteat, look upon me with compassion.” **SHRI RAMA** answered jestingly : " I have still many thousand cows not yet bestowed on any. Casting thy staff from this spot. I will bestow on thee as many cows as can stand in the space berween thee and where the staff has fallen.” **TRIJATA**, hearing these words, binding his tags firmly about his waist. twirling his staff, thtew it away with all his might. The staff fell on the

futthet bank of the river Satayu where thousands of royal cows and bulla were grazing. **SHRI RAMA** ordered all these to be driven to the btahmin's hermitage and thus addteSsed him : " Be not displeased, O Brshmin, that I jested with thee ; I desired to test thy great powers. Now, the cattle will be driven to thine abode, ask further whatsoever thou desircst. O *Brahmin*, I will bestow anything thou askcth on thee; all my wealth is to be given to the btahmins. Nothing so plcascs me as the bestowal of my wealth on *brahmins* such as thou, bringing me renown." Then the *brahmin* **TRIJATA** highly gratified, taking the cows, departed with his wife, full of power, renown and devotion, blessing Shri Ramacbandra. Thereafter, **RAMA** bestowed the remainder of his wealth, acquired through virtue, upon his friends, honouring them with marb of respect. There was not a *brahmin*, servant, pauper or beggar that he did not honont with charity at that time.

CHAPTER 33

He goes, with Sita and Lakshmana, to King Dasaratha's Palace

SHRI RAMA, having with **SITA**, distributed riches in abundance to the btahmins in charity, went with **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** to sec King Dasatatha, followed by their servants bearing weapons adorned with llowers and sandalwood. The people of the capital mounting to the top of high buildings and the roofs of seven-storied houses to view them, were dispirited. **SOME** *said*: "Behold now **SHRI RAMA**, formerly attended by font divisions of the anny, is to-day only followed by **SITA** and Lakshman " Others answered, " **SHRI RAMA**, having tasted the delights of sovereignty and cxpericnced in all the joys of life, he who

amfers wealth on the needy, prompted by duty, desires to render fruitful the promise of his sire. To-day, **SITA** never beheld before even by the birds, is exposed to the view compassionate, learned, truthful, self-controlled and of subdued mind. His subjects are as distressed at tbe thought ofhis absence as the watet-fowl during tbe summer drought. Tbe sufferings of Rsma, Lotd of tbe world, afBict all, as does a tree uprooted from the earth. Tbe glorious Rsmaebandra, knower of dbarma, resembles tbe root of a tree of which tbe llowcrs, fruit, leaves and branches are the people. Let us, abandoning our gardens, fields and homes, sharing his woes, follow **SHRI RAMA**. Our houses deserted, their treasure removed, their courtyards neglected, without grain or stores, their beauty gone, will be buried in dust. Tbe *devas* will no longer visit them, but mice scurrying hither and thither will fill tbem with countless holes. Without water, covered with soot, uncleanscd, no daily rites will be performed there. Fallen in ruins, strewn with broken vessels, as if cursed by tbe king or by divine decree, all these, utterly forsaken by us, let **KAIKEYI** enjoy. " We pray tbst this city abandoned by Shri Rsma may be converted into a wilderness and the forest where **RAMA** dwells become a flourishing city. May tbe snakes forsake tbeir holes, the deer and birds abandon their abode in the mountains and valleys, and the lion and elephant leave tbe forest, in fear of us and come and dwell in tbe capital of Ayodhya. May the city abandoned by us, bereft of hay and grain having become the resort of serpents, deer and birds, be ruled by **KAIKEYI** and her son and may we, dwelling in tbe forest with **RAMA**, enjoy fully every happiness.” Shri Rsma passing by, hearing their converse, was not in any way disturbed, but proceeding slowly, like a young elephant, with majestic stride approached the palace of his father which resembled the Meru mountain. **SHRI RAMA** entering tbe royal palace guarded by seasoned troops, beheld Sumantra standing there

disconsolate. **SHRI RAMA**, with a smiling countenance, passing the people who were affticted and filled with grief, approached his father's apartment, desirous of serving him. Before entering tbe royal chamber, he requested Sumantra, dejected on account of **RAMA**'s departure, to inform tbe king of his arrival. Desirous of fulfilling tbe command of the virtuous monarch, Shri Rsma, determined to enter tbe forest, requested Sumantra to make known his presence to tbe king.

CHAPTER 34

The king gives his blessing while the whole palace is filled with lamentation

TM king gives his blessing while the whole palace is filled with lamentation THE dark-complexioned, lotus-eyed **RAMACHANDRA**, that peerless prince, instructed his minister to announce his arrival to the king. On this, Sumantra entering the royal apartment, beheld the king sorely distressed, lamenting bitterly, like the sun under eclipse or a fire buried in ashes or a lake without water. The learned Sumantra with joined palms, addressed the sorely grieving monarch by praising him in a fitting manner and offering obeisance, he said: "Jai to thee, O King." Then, falteringly, in low and gentle accents he added : " O King, thy son **RAMA**, that Lion among men, is at thy door, having distributed his whole wealth to the pious *brahmins* and servants ; now having tsken leave of his friends, he wishes to approach thee. Qothed with every excellent quality as the sun with its rays, he is about to depart for the forest, be pleased to receive him, O Sire." The virtuous monarch, the knower of *dharma*, profound as the sea, pure as the sky, spoke: " O Sumantra, summon the ladies of the court, I wish to see **RAMA** in their

presence.” Entering the private apartments of the queens, **SUMANTRA** *said*: " His majesty demands your presence, go to him without delay.” Thus addressed by Sumantra, in obedience to the wishes of their consort, they prepared to approach the king. Three hundted and fifty women, their eyes teddened with weeping on aaount of Rams’s departure, surrounding Queen **KAUSHALYA**, slowly advanced towards the king. They being present, the king commanded Sumantra to bring his son before him. Sumantra bringing **SHRI RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** with him, speedily entered the apartment of the king. The monarch beholding **SHRI RAMA** approaching, rose from his seat, and ran towards him in haste, with his consorts, but ere he reached him fell 8CD8eleaa to the earth. Then **SHRI RAMA** and LakshmaDa advancing, lifted up the king who had been rendered UDCOIIScious by grief and soft’ering. The palace resounded with the lamentations of a thousand women crying, " **RAMA**, **RAMA** ", “Alas ! Alas I " the tinkling of their ornaments, drowned in the tumult of their cries. **SHRI RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** supporting the king in their arms, conveyed him to the couch, and after a long time, he revived. Then Shri **RAMACHANDRA** addressed the monarch who was sinking in the ocean of grief, and said : " O Great King, Master of All, I am about to enter the Dandaka forest, be gracious enough to look on me with favour. Grant also that **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** acampany me, since they, setting aside my counsel that they ahould remain here, have with fixed purpose, resolved to follow me. O Sire, giving up grief, command us, as Prajapati commands his subjects.” His eyes filled with compaasion, fixing his gaze on his beloved son, the king, knowing him to be about to enter the forest with a serene heart, said : " O **RAMACHANDRA**, I have been deceived by Queen **KAIKEYI** by reason of a promise, do thou, setting me aside, seize the kingdom of Ayodhya by force.” Heariog the king’s words, **RAMA**, eminent in virtue,

spoke eloquently and humbly : " My Lord, may God grant thee yet a thousand years to live and rule the earth I Desirous of following truth, I shall assuredly enter the forest, dwelling there fourteen years. I shall then return to serve thee and offer thee homage." Held fast in the toils of trutb. the king, urged on by **KAIKEYI**, wept and full of distress, answered : " O Child, to attaio felicity in the other world and renown on earth and for the sake of thy return, enter the forest with a peaceful hesrt. May no fear from any source visit thee on the way. O **RAMACHANDRA**, firm in truth and in the performance of dUty, none can divert thee from the path of rightcousnest. O My Son. do not yet depart, stay one more night with thy mothet and me. Satisfied after the night, early in the III011Iing, do thou set out for the forest. My Child, for my sake, thou hast Ulldertaten that which none can accomplish. For my good and my future happiness, thou hast chosen to enter the forest. o Child, in truth, I cannor suffer thy departure but am helpless. Deceived by Kaibyi, 236 whose designs resemble a lire covered with ashes, I am caught in this snare, but why must thou also suffer ? O Child, what wonder that thou, my eldest son, should desire thy father to uphold the truth." Hearing the words of bis alllicted patent, Shti **RAMA**, deeply distressed, answered : " O Father, if to-day I should remain happily in the royal palace, what of to-morrow ? Therefore, with thy permission, I would fain leave at once. Let thy kingdom, filled with wealth and grain, inhabited by thy subjects, surrounded by tributary states, be given to Prince **BHARATA** I O Giver of Boons, my resolution to enter the forest is fixed. Thus hast thou ordained I I shall reside in the forest for fourteen years with the ascetics. Do thou, without delay, give the kingdom to **BHARATA** ! I desire nought, nor is happiness as dear to me as obedience to thy commands. O My Father, do not grieve, nor be distressed ; the mighty ocean, Lord of the Rivers, does not overstep its bounds. O SU:e, I desire neither

kingdom nor plessure, nor even Janaki, nor delight, nor heaven, nor life itself, but nnly wish to sec thee the votaty of truth. O My Father, thou art as a god to me, I vow by the truth and the merits acquired by me that my words arc free from the taint of hypocrisy. O My Father and Lord, I cannot remain here a motnent longer ; restrain thy grief, nothing can move me frotn my resolve. When **KAIKEYI** commanded me to enter the forest, I answered " I will go ", therefore, true to my word, I shall depatt. Do not be distressed, O My Lord, I shall live in the forest where pcaceful deer abound and birds sing their beautiful lays. O Father, a father is said to be the god of gods ; knowing thee to be a supreme deity, I am obedient to thy behests. O August King, I shall eaaily pass fourteen years in the forest and then rerum to thee. Now it becomes thee to pacify those alllicted and sorrowful. O Lion among men, tiillil thy duty and do not fall a victim to grief. I renounce the capital the kingdom and the earth ; let them be given to **BHARATA**. Without hesitation I shall follow thy command and enter the forest. Let this kingdom adorned by high mountains and deep forests, fillcd with cities and villages, be ruled by Prince **BHARATA** according to *dharma*. Let thy word be fuifilled. O King, my heart is not given to delights nor to any object of pleasure, all I desire is to carry out thy commands, approved by virtuous men. O King, give up all sorrow for my sake ; I neither desire happiness nor wealth, nor the earth, nor Janaki, nay not even life. I desire the world to know thee as the votary of truth. O My Lord, be happy. I, entering the forest filled with many kinds of trees, viewing the mountains and rivers, shall dwcll joyfidly, living on fruits and roots.” The king filled with anguish, embraced his son and fell senseless to the carrh. The queens all began to lament, save **KAIKEYI** alone. Then the aged Sumantra also fell unconscious and the whole palace was filled with lamentation.

CHAPTER 35

Sumantra arraigns Queen Kaikeyi

beating his head, his eyes growing red, his colour altered, showed every sign of distress. Perceiving the Queen **KAIKEYI** to have forfeited the king's regard, Sumantra pierced her heart with words as keen as arrows, causing her to tremble. Penetrating to the most vulnerable parts of her being, Sumantra exposed the hidden defects of the queen by his barbed words. **HE** *said*: " O Lady, thou hast abandoned thy husband the nourisher and supporter of the movable and immovable. There is nought nndesirable in the world that thou hast not accomplished. I consider thee the murderess of thy husband and the destroyer of thy family. By thy vile deeds, thou hast smitten King **DASARATHA**, who is unconquezable, who resembles **INDRA** and who is immovable as a mountain. O Kalkeyi, do not insult the aged king who has conferred these boons upon thee. Obedience to her husband should, in a woman, ar exceed the love of a thousand sons. It is the ancient tradition of this dynasty, that the eldest son succeed his lather, but thou seekest 338 to revoke it and make thy ruler while the aged king still Jives. Let thy **BHARATA** rule the kingdom, we will foJ!ow **RAMA** wheresoever he goes. No one of good report will remain to help thy in the administration, since thou seekest to repudiate the immemorial usage. I wonder the earth docs not open and swallow thee for thy misdeeds. Why do the holy sages not condemn thee utterly ? What fool cuts at the root of a sweet mango tree with his axe in order to plant a Dimba tree in its place, which docs not bear sweet fruit even if watered with milk. It is a common saying that honey does not fiow from the Dimba tree. I perceive thee to be as wicked as thy mother. The sins committed by thy mother are known to me, I bave heard of them on

trustworthy report. Thy father, by virtue of a boon granted to him by a Yogi, understood the language of all creatures ; of every bird, he understood the voice. Once, returning to the capital, he heard the converse between two ants and laughed, whereupon thy mother grew wrath and threatened to take her life, saying : ' I must know the cause of thy laughter.' The king replied, saying: 'O Lady, if I tell thee the cause of my laughter, it will undoubtedly lead to my death.' Then thy mother spoke to her husband, Kaikeya saying : ' I care not if thou livest or diest, tell me the cause of thy laughter. If thou wert dead, thou couldst not insult me with thy laughter '." The king approaching the Yogi, told him the whole story, and the **YOGI** *said*: " O King, let thy wife return to the house of her father or die, do not thou reveal the secret to her." Then King Kaikeya with a contented mind abandoned thy mother, and Jived free like Kuvera. O Sinful Queen, thou also followeth the cvU path, deceiving the king and urging him to cvU ways. to the fORSt, the whole world will speak ill of thee. Let thy mind be at peace and let **RAMA** be crowned. If any other than **RAMA** rule the kingdom, it will not profit thee. If **RAMA** becomes regent, then the king following the ancient tradition wjll doubtless retite to the fotest." Tbus did Sumantra with hatsb words arraign the queen in the assembly, but Ksikeyi wss in no wise moved, neither did sbe sbow any sign ofrepeutance, nor did her countcii8Dce change. CHAPTI!It 36 THEN King Dasaraths, deeply distressed on account of his vow, addressed the weeping Sumantra, saying : " O Sumantra, prepare four divisions of the army laden with wealth to accompany **SHRI RAMA**. Let beautitill and eloquent women and merchants follow in his train, together with rich traders who can set up stores stocked with those things necessary for the army of **SHRI RAMA**. Let those personal attendants pleasing to **RAMA**, baving received abundant wealth, accompany him. Let chosen citizens accompany

RAMA with instruments of war and vehicles, and those who know the fotest paths, go also. Sbri **RAMA** hunting the deer and elephants, drinking fresh honey and enjoying the beaury of the rivers will call those left behind to remembrance. Let all my wealth and grain be sent with Rams to the uninbabited forest. Observing sacrifices with the sages in sacred places, bestowing alms upon them, **SHRI RAMA** will dwell there bappily. Prince **BHARATA** will govern the people here and **RAMA** set out abundantly provided." Ksikeyi was seized with fear on hearing the words of the king, her mouth dried up and she was unable to speak. Trembling with agitation, she then said : " O Chief of men, Bbarata will not accept the kingdom stripped of its wealth and people, resembling unfermented wine." Tile eyes of the king reddened with uger at the cnJd and

CHAPTER 36

She disregards the words of the chief minister and the king

to the fORSt, the whole world will speak ill of thee. Let thy mind be at peace and let **RAMA** be crowned. If any other than **RAMA** rule the kingdom, it will not profit thee. If **RAMA** becomes regent, then the king following the ancient tradition wjll doubtless retite to the fotest." Tbus did Sumantra with hatsb words arraign the queen in the assembly, but Ksikeyi wss in no wise moved, neither did sbe sbow any sign ofrepeutance, nor did her countcii8Dce change. CHAPTI!It 36 THEN King Dasaraths, deeply distressed on account of his vow, addressed the weeping Sumantra, saying : " O Sumantra, prepare four divisions of the army laden with wealth to accompany **SHRI RAMA**. Let beautitill and

eloquent women and merchants follow in his train, together with rich traders who can set up stores stocked with those things necessary for the army of **SHRI RAMA**. Let those personal attendants pleasing to **RAMA**, baving received abundant wealth, accompany him. Let chosen citizens accompany **RAMA** with instruments of war and vehicles, and those who know the fotest paths, go also. Sbri **RAMA** hunting the deer and elephants, drinking fresh honey and enjoying the beaury of the rivers will call those left behind to remembrance. Let all my wealth and grain be sent with Rams to the uninbabited forest. Observing sacrifices with the sages in sacred places, bestowing alms upon them, **SHRI RAMA** will dwell there bappily. Prince **BHARATA** will govern the people here and **RAMA** set out abundantly provided." Ksikeyi was seized with fear on hearing the words of the king, her mouth dried up and she was unable to speak. Trembling with agitation, she then said : " O Chief of men, Bbarata will not accept the kingdom stripped of its wealth and people, resembling unfermented wine." Tile eyes of the king reddened with uger at the cnJd and shameless words of **KAIKEYI**, and he replied : " O Wicked Wrctch, why dost thou seek to crush me with this load of sorrow? When thou didst demand **RAMA**'s exile, thou didst not add he should go empty handed ? " At the king's words, the fury of **KAIKEYI** was redoubled, and she said : " Of thy dynasty, King Sagara sent his son Asumanjas into exile. Let **RAMA** depart in the same DliUlllel'., At these words, King **DASARATHA** cried, " Woe, alas I " and all the people felt ashamed, but **KAIKEYI** remained unmoved. Then the chief minister, Siddhartha by name, a virtuous man, much favoured by King **DASARATHA**, addressed **KAIKEYI**, saying: " O Lady, Asumanjas, seizing the children playing in the street, threw them into the river Sarayu, for this he was considered an exceedingly wicked man. The people of the city, disgusted with his cruel deeds, entreated King Sagara

to banish him, saying : ' Wilt thou preserve us or Prince Asumanjas in the city ? ' King Sagara enquired of them the cause of their fear and they said in reply : ' Prince Ansumanjas bas become insane, catching our children while at play and throwing them into the river ; he rejoices in this act.' King Sagara, therefore, abandoned his malevolent son and placing him on a carriage with his wife, clothing and other necessities, proclaimed : 'Asumanjas is banished for Ufe.' Asumanjas, armed with an axe and basket, wandered about in the forest and reaped the fruit of his evil deeds. The righteous Maharajah Sagara banished his son on account of his evil conduct bur. O Queen, what wrong bas **RAMA** done that he should be exiled by thee ? I see no ault in **RAMA**. It were as easy to find a taint in the moon I O Lady, if thou bast fuund any ault with **RAMA**, then declare it openly and he will be banished from the kingdom. O **KAIKEYI**, it is an unrighteous act to abandon one following the path of virtue, without substantial reason ; such an act would destroy the splendour of lndrs himself. O Lady of BeautiiUI Countenance, do not destroy the prosperity of Shri Rania chandra and become a source of ignominy to the people." Hearing the words of the minister Siddhartha, King Dasaratba, overcome with grief, spoke to **KAIKEYI**, in broken accents and said : " O Sinfal One, dost thou disregard the words of my 241 minister ? Art thou blind to thine own welfare and mine ? Art thou determined to follow the evil path ? Giving up my wealth and substance and the comforts of the palace, I will follow **RAMA**. Do thou rille at case with Bbarata for ever." CRAPTIR 37 Despite the ilutruetion tf V IUishtha, S'hri **SITA** rtill thnm ta the form HI!AJuNG the words of the chief minister Siddhartha and those of the king, the gentle prioce humbly made the following reply : " O King, having renounced all pleasures to live on the products of the forest, what need have I for wealth, an army or other requisites ? Who will concern bimaelf with the ropes binding

the howdah to the elephant when he has parted with the elephant ? O Great One, such am I, what occasion have I for an army in the forest ? Let it be given to Prince **BHARATA**. Bting me garments of bsrk. I go to pass fourteen yesrs in the forest, and need but a spade to dig for roots and fruit and a creel and basket. I wish to start without further delay." Hearing his words, Kaikcyi rose up and brought the robes of bart, and in the midst of the assembly without shame, addressed Prioce **RAMA** saying : " Put them on." Sbri Ramacbaudra receiving the raiment from Kaikcyi, discarding his rich apparel, put on the dress of bark. Sbri Laksbmana also putting off his beautiful robes, put on the dress of an ascetic in the presence of his father. Sbri **SITA** dressed in a lovely silken sari, seeing the robes of bart proffered her, was startled, lite a doe at the sight of the fowler's snare. The Princess Janati, endowed with excellent quslities, teceived the bart drcas, in shame and distress. Versed in the duties of a faithtul spouse, she, addrcasing her god-lite husband, her eyes suffused with tears, said : " How do the ascetica put on the robes of bart ? " Shri **SITA**, ipcmmt of the custom, remained confused,

CHAPTER 37

Despite the instruction of Vasishtha, Shri Sita still desires to enter the forest

minister ? Art thou blind to thine own welfare and mine ? Art thou determined to follow the evil path ? Giving up my wealth and substance and the comforts of the palace, I will follow **RAMA**. Do thou rille at case with Bbarata for ever." CRAPTIR 37 Despite the ilutruetion tf V IUishtha, S'hri **SITA** rtill thnm ta the form HI!AJuNG the words of the chief minister Siddhartha and those of the king, the gentle prioce humbly

made the following reply : " O King, having renounced all pleasures to live on the products of the forest, what need have I for wealth, an army or other requisites ? Who will concern bimaelf with the ropes binding the howdah to the elephant when he has parted with the elephant ? O Great One, such am I, what occasion have I for an army in the forest ? Let it be given to Prince **BHARATA**. Bting me garments of bsrk. I go to pass fourteen yesrs in the forest, and need but a spade to dig for roots and fruit and a creel and basket. I wish to start without further delay." Hearing his words, Kaikcyi rose up and brought the robes of bart, and in the midst of the assembly without shame, addressed Prioce **RAMA** saying : " Put them on." Sbri Ramacbaudra receiving the raiment from Kaikcyi, discarding his rich apparel, put on the dress of bark. Sbri Laksbmana also putting off his beautiful robes, put on the dress of an ascetic in the presence of his father. Sbri **SITA** dressed in a lovely silken sari, seeing the robes of bart proffered her, was startled, lite a doe at the sight of the fowler's snare. The Princess Janati, endowed with excellent quslities, teceived the bart drcas, in shame and distress. Versed in the duties of a faithtul spouse, she, addrcasing her god-lite husband, her eyes suffused with tears, said : " How do the ascetica put on the robes of bart ? " Shri **SITA**, ipcmmt of the custom, remained confused, 343 Unskilled in the art of wearing robes of bark, putting one end of the vestment round her neck and holding the other in her hands, she stood pcrplezcd. Then **RAMACHANDRA**, chief of the good, approaching the princess, fastened the robe of bark over her silken sari. All the ladies of the court, perceiving **RAMA** assisting **SITA** in putting on the dress of bark, began to weep and timidly addressed the illustrious **RAMA** : " O Beloved Prince, thy father has not granted Shri **SITA** permission to enter the forest. Do thou enter the forest in accordance with the king's behest, but let not Janaki go with thee. Let our life be fruitful beholding her face.

Let **LAKSHMANA** go with thee for thy protection, but the beautiful **SITA** is not fitted to dwell in the forest like an ascetic. O **RAMA**, prompted by *dharma*, go without delay as thou desirest but, we entreat thee, leave Princess **SITA** with us." **SHRI RAMA**, knowing that **SITA** was not willing to stay there in his absence, disregarding the request, helped **SITA** to don the bark raiment. Shri **VASISHTHA**, the king's preceptor, seeing **SITA** attired in the habit of an ascetic, was displeased, and said to **KAIKEYI** : " O Destroyer of thy Dynasty, O Evil-minded **KAIKEYI**, thou hast deceived the king and now exceed the boons granted to thee, thou art dead to all good sense. It is not for Princess **SITA** to enter the forest, let her rule in the place of **RAMA** till he return. The wife is, as it were, half of her spouse, thcrefote, what is his due is hers also. Shri **SITA** being the half of **SHRI RAMA** is in bis absence entitled to the throne. Should Shri **SITA** accompany **RAMA**, then I and all the people of Ayodhya will follow him. Where **RAMA** goes with **SITA**, there will follow the guards, the people of the kingdom and the citizens of the capital. Yea, even Prince Bhatata and Prince Shatraghuna, assuming the robes of ascetics will accom pany their elder brother. Then this kingdom abandoned by shouldst die, yet will Prince Bbarats, acquainted with the ancient Jaw, refuse to rule the kingdom as long as his elder btothet, Shri Ramacbandra lives. Thou, desiring the advance ment of thy son, Bbarata, seeking to make him king, art in teality bringing him to grief, since aU will follow Shri **RAMACHANDRA**. O **KAIKEYI**, thou ahalt aee beasts, SJI8kes, deet, birds and even trees, bend befote **RAMA**, swayed hy his love, not to speak of men. O Lady, remove the dress of bark and let Sits be attired in royal robes, the ascetic's garb ill befits her." The Guru **VASISHTHA** fotbade Sits to don the tobe of batk and said to the queen : " O Daughtet of the King Kaikeya, thou hast demanded the exile of :Ramo alone, let Sits be clad in royal robes when accompanying

RAMA. The boon exacted hy thee did not imply the exile of Shri Sits, thetefote, let the ptiDcess, besutifully atrayed and adorned, entet the foteSt in a royal chariot." Despite the instruCtion of the teaplendent sage, chief among the brahmiDs and the king's pteceptor, Shri Sits, not relinquish· ing the ascetic's dteSs, desired to entet the fOteSt, attired like her lord.

CHAPTER 38

Shri Rama requests the king to protect his mother during his absence

On the dress of a devoree. Let this princess enter the foresr attired in an auspicious manner, wirh all her ornaments. My death is not far clisrant and my mind is in confusion ; by promising these boons to thee, I have been brought to nought. This act is consutning me as is the bamboo by its flowering.' If it he said that **SHRI RAMA** has done thee injury, O Sinful One, what harm did J8118ki ever do to thee ? Of what dost thou accuse the daughter of King **JANAKA**, whose eyes resemble the gazeJle's and who is meek and gentle. " O Wicked One, by sending **RAMA** without reason to the forest, thou shalt assuredly enter hell ; what else will not befall thee on account of thy evil deeds ? " When **SHRI RAMA** approached me on the eve of his installs· tion, then didst thou fo.tbid him to inaugurate the ceremony and charged him to enter the forest with matted locks in an ascetic's garb. By my silence, I gave consent, but now, desirous of plunging thyself into hell thou requirest **SITA** to enter the fo.tesr robed in the habit of a recluse." King **DASARATHA**, lamenting, saw no end to his distress. At length, helpless and overcome with grief, on account of his son, he feU to the ground.

SHRI RAMA, his head bowed, ready to enter the forest, observing his father's distress, said : " O King, my mother **KAUSHALYA**, devoted to her lord, aged and of a generous disposition, who never speaks ill of any, bereft of me will be CRAPTBII 3 9

CHAPTER 39

As they prepare for departure the palace resounds with grief

CRAPTBII 3 9 Queen Kausbalya embraced the princess of virtuous conduct to ber bosom and blessing ber said : " The world is filled with undutiful wives, who cease to regard their lord when he has fallen into distress. Such is the lllllturc of those who having enjoyed great pleasures, on finding their consort involved in trouble, condemn and sometimes even abandon him. Many arc the women, untruthful, hesrtless, unchaste, devious' and vain, full of evil passions, the destroyers of long-honoured ties. Neither a worthy fiunily nor dury, nor the instruction of the Guru, nor gifts, sway them, nor do they honour the marriage ties, their minds being fickle. But those women devoted to their husbands, of virtuous conduct, honouring the tradition of their fiunily, truthful, following the instructions of their preceptor, regard their lord as the chief of men. Therefore, do not condemn my son, now ready to enter the forest, who should be regarded by thee rather as a deity, whether in poverty or prosperity." Shri **SITA**, understanding the import of these words, inspired by *dharma*, humbly replied: O Noble Lady, I will fulfil thy commands. It is known to me that a woman should serve ber lord, and my parents have instructed me in the matter. Do not deem me a false woman. I am as unable to forsake the path of virtue as the sun's light the

moon. As a lute is useless without strings, as a charint cannot move without wheels, so is a wife bereft of ber husband, even if she have a hundred sons. " Father, mother or son can give but a small measure of happiness, but a husband is the source of limitless joy. What woman is so unworthy that she will not obey ber husband ? I am acquainted with all the duties of a wife, being instructed by those eminent in virtue. A husband is as a god to his consort, never shall I not honour him." pass like a dream. Surrounded by my friends, tbou shalt behold me serving my sire." Speaking thus to his mother Kausbalya, **SHRI RAMA** reftccted how to address the three hundred and fifty other consorts of the king. To these who were bitterly lamenting, he spoke with humility. " While living you, if I have ever, in ignorance, olfcodcd you, be gracious enough to pardon me." These pious and humble wntds of **RAMA**, inspired by *dharma*,

CHAPTER 40

All Ayodhya is distressed to see Shri Rama's chariot depart

pass like a dream. Surrounded by my friends, tbou shalt behold me serving my sire." Speaking thus to his mother Kausbalya, **SHRI RAMA** reftccted how to address the three hundred and fifty other consorts of the king. To these who were bitterly lamenting, he spoke with humility. " While living you, if I have ever, in ignorance, olfcodcd you, be gracious enough to pardon me." These pious and humble wntds of **RAMA**, inspired by *dharma*, My Son, enter the forest with **RAMA**. O Child, have no auxiety, do not grieve eithet for thy finher, mothet, home or country, esteem **RAMA** to be **DASARATHA**, Janald as myself and the forest equal

to Ayodhya.” Sumantta now addressed **RAMA** with humility as Matali adchesses **INDRA** : " O illustrious Prince, be plessed to mount the chariot. I will take thee wheresoever thou desirest. Let the period of thine ezile enjoined by **KAIKEYI** begin to-day.” Then the beautiful daughter of King J anaka, adorned with the jewels, beatowed on her by the king, cheerfully mounted the waiting vehicle, which shone like the sun. **SHRI RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** also swiftly ascended the chariot enriched with gold and weapons. Having regard to the period of exile, King **DASARATHA** had bestowed on his daughter-in-law, robes and jewels and ordered arms and *mantra*-charged weapons, armour and shields to be placed on the chariot. Seeing that all were mounted, Sumantra set the chariot io motion guiding the horses swift as the wind. **RAMA** having started for the Dandaka forest, the whole city, young and old, men and women, soldiers, elephants and horses, distracted and full of iodigoation and distress, became as beiogs demented. The loosing of elephants, and the loud neighing of horses filled Ayodhya with tumult and ferment. Young and old, distraught. ran after the chariot ofRama as men overpowered by the sun plunge ioto water. Some runniog beside the royal car, some behiod looking up towards Rams, others weepiog and lamenting, cried to Sumantra : " O Charioteer, drive slowly, draw io thy steeds, so that we may see the face of **RAMA** so soon to be hidden from us. Surely the heart of his mothet must be made of steel that it did not break on seeiog the godlike prioce departing for the forest. GTeat iodeed is Shri **SITA**, who follows The chariot outstripping the king, caused him to halt with his household and mentally circumambulating **RAMA**, he returned to the palace. The courtiers now said to the king: “None follows a friend far, whom he wishes to see return.” King **DASARATHA** hearing this injunction, bathed in perspiration, utterly wretched, stood gazing at the receding chariot. CHAPTER 4I The whok world grieves for Prince

RAMA THAT Lion among men, Prince **RAMACHANDRA**, having in humility departed, a great cry of distress arose among the ladies of the inner apartment. **THEY** *cried*: " Where is **RAMACHANDRA**, the only asylum and refuge of the orphaned, the weak and the suffering ? Where is Prince **RAMA**, who when provoked, showed no anger, who caused no agitation to any heart, who appeased those who were wrathful, and considered others' distress as his own? Where is that **RAMA** now, who treated us with the same regard as he showed his illustrious mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA** ? Where is he wandering now, that **RAMA**, Protector of the World, who has gone to the forest, persecuted by **KAIKEYI**, and exiled by his father ? O, how insensible the king has grown, that he has sent the virtuous and truthful **RAMA**, the object of universal love, into exile." In this way, all the ladies of the court wept

CHAPTER 41

The whole world grieves for Prince Rama

The chariot outstripping the king, caused him to halt with his household and mentally circumambulating **RAMA**, he returned to the palace. The courtiers now said to the king: "None follows a friend far, whom he wishes to see return." King **DASARATHA** hearing this injunction, bathed in perspiration, utterly wretched, stood gazing at the receding chariot. CHAPTER 4I The whok world grieves for Prince **RAMA** THAT Lion among men, Prince **RAMACHANDRA**, having in humility departed, a great cry of distress arose among the ladies of the inner apartment. **THEY** *cried*: " Where is **RAMACHANDRA**, the only asylum and refuge of the orphaned, the weak and the suffering ? Where is Prince **RAMA**, who when provoked, showed no anger, who caused no

agitation to any heart, who appeased those who were wrathful, and considered others' distress as his own? Where is that **RAMA** now, who treated us with the same regard as he showed his illustrious mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA** ? Where is he wandering now, that **RAMA**, Protector of the World, who has gone to the forest, persecuted by **KAIKEYI**, and exiled by his father ? O, how insensible the king has grown, that he has sent the virtuous and truthful **RAMA**, the object of universal love, into exile." In this way, all the ladies of the court wept Vishab,t growing dim, was scarcely distinguishable iD the sky. The clouds, driven by a strong wind, overtaking each other, resembled waves rising iD the scs. When Sbri **RAMA** departed, an earthquake caused the city to tremble, the ten cardinal points were covered iD darkness, neither were the planets nor the stan visible. All the iDbabitsnts of the city were overwhelmed with misery, none partook of food that day or found pleasure iD any pastime. All the people of Ayodbya, sighing heavily, were filled with sorrow and grieved for the king. Those walking iD the streets wept and nowhere was there any sign of joy. No cool breezes blew, nor did the moon shine, the rays of the sun were weak and the whole world mourned for **RAMA**. Sons gave no thougltt to their parents, husbands were indifferent to their wives and brothers showed no affection to each other ; all were S1lllk in gric£ The friends of **RAMA**, unconscious of themselves and filled with distress, were bereft of sleep. Without **RAMA**, Ayodbya resembled the earth with all its mountains, suffering from drought. Every household was consumed with grief and the cries of elephants, horses and warriors filled the city.

CHAPTER 42

Without Rama the king's heart can find no rest

to thy lord, I now repudiate. Thy hsnd, accepted by me when circumambulating the sacred fire, I relinquish, and renounce the woridly and spiritual pledges given thee in the ceremony. If Bharats, receiving this kingdom, is satisfied, then let him not perform my obsequies." Queen Kaushslya, tom with grief, raised the king, soiled with dust, and conveyed him to his chariot. The king sorely a1Bicted, remembering his son in aseetie's garb, resembled one who hss murdered a *brahmin* or touches a blazing fire with his Daked hsnd. Turning again and again towards the path that the chariot had taken, the king's countenance resembled the sun in eclipse. Conceiving his son **RAMA** to hsve pasaed beyond the city boundary, and thinking of him, he again gave way to gri..C, crying : " I see the marks of the hoofs of the horses that were yoked to the chariot of my son, but him I do not see. Alas I My Son, who perfumed with sandslpaste, slept on soft pillows, fanned by beantiful women, to-day sleeps beneath a tree with wood or stone for his pillow. In the morning, he will awake on the hsrd ground, his mind oppressed, his body smeared with dust, sighing deeply like a bull rising from beside a spring. The dwellets in the forest will behold **RAMA** rising like orphan and wandering as one forlorn. Thst daughter of King Jaoaka worthy of every hsppiness, her feet pierced with thorns, hearing the roar of animals like tigers, will be struck with terror ; O **KAIKEYI**, thy ambition is fulfilled, now rule the kingdom as a THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIKl of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, tbe mother of **RAMA**, nowhere else can I obtain peace." The attendants carried tbe king to tbe apartments of Queen **KAUSHALYA** and placed him on a couch, but the king's bean could find no rest ; the palace without **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** appeared to him like the sky bereft of the moon. Finding no delight there, tbe king lifting up his hands, cried : " O My Son, O **RAMA**, an thou leaving me ? How bleased are they who seeing **RAMA** retum, will embrace him."

Finding tbe night dark, resembling tbe hour of death, tbe king at midnight thus addressed **KAUSHALYA** : " O **KAUSHALYA**, I do not see thee, my sight has followed **RAMA**, nor has it yet returned, therefore, reach forth thy hand and touch me, O Queen.” Seeing her royal consort merged in tbe remembrance ofRama, tbe queen, sighing, seated herself by tbe king and began to lament in sympathy with him.

CHAPTER 43

The lament of Queen Kaushalya

" **O** King, that evil **KAIKEYI** having dischatged her poison on **SHRI RAMA**, will wander about at will, like a snake that has cast its slough. That sinful woman, having accomplished her design and sent **RAMA** to tbe forest will ever inspire me with terror, like a venomous serpent in tbe home. If her demand bad been that **RAMA** should dwcll in tbe city on alms or had she condemned him to be her alave, it were better than exile. She has cast out **RAMA**, as tbe oblation offered to tbe *asuras* is cast away by thoae who tend the sacrificial fire. The loug armed **RAMA**, tbe wielder oftbe grest bow, walking like tbe king of elephants, must by now have reached tbe forest with **SITA** and Llkshmana. O King, consider how thy aon Ratna, who has never before ezperieneed suft"ering, is banished by thee, urged by **KAIKEYI** I O What fate 3S4 will befall them now ? Without wealth, exiled in his youth when a king’s happiness should have been his portion, how will he be able to live on and benies in the forest ? Will the time ever come when I shall see **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** return, putting an end to my sotrow ? When will that glad day dawn, when the illustrious capital filled with rejoicing crowds, decorated with flags, banners and garlands, welcomes **RAMA** ?

O will that auspicious hour ever strike, when the citizens hearing of his return will be filled with gladoess, like the sea at the time of the full moon ? When will **SHRI RAMA** with **SITA**, eoter the city, like the bull who, at dusk, preceding the herd of cows, returnS to the town. When will the people of the capital, waiting to scatter rice over him, gather in thousands on the highways to welcome **RAMA**, the subduer of his foes ? O, wheo shall I see my sons, respleodent as two mountain peaks, return to Ayodhya, adorned with earrings, bearing the sword and scimitar. When will the two princes, circumambulating the city with Janaki, receive gifts of flowers and fruit from the hands of virgins and *brahmins* ? When will the virtuous and sagacious **RAMA** run towards me, leaping like a child ? Surely my love pours forth for him, as the breasts of mothers when suckling their infimts. O Great King, because of this, **KAIKEYI** bas increased my love for my child ; bereft of him, I am like a cow whose calf has been forcibly carried away by a lion. My only son **RAMA** is versed in aU the classics and eodowed with every excelleot quality ; without such a son, I cannot live. O Great King, I cannot sustain life in the absence of my brave and beloved son ; the fire of grief caused by the separation from my son is consuming me, as the rays of the sun in summer consume the surfilce of the earth." CHAPTBR 44 S/16 fou/1 in t/16 cmuolatitm of Quun Srmritr« THB righteous Queen **SUMITRA** hearing the lament of Queeo **KAUSHALYA** addressed her in reasonable words : " O Queea, why dost thou weep in abject fashion, for thy son, the chief of men, endowed with every virtue ? O Noble Lady, **SHRI RAMA** has reaounced the throne and entered the forest to render his father illustrious, as the votary of truth. **SHRI RAMA**, honouring his father, has conducted himself as the best of men and secured the future glory of his sire. There is no cause for grief, since **RAMA** is treading the path of *dharma*, neither is there cause to grieve for Lakshmsna, ever

compassionate to all, sinless, serving **RAMA** and in every way worthy of the highest good. The tender-limbed Janaki, too, is following thy virtuous son. O Queen, the exile of **RAMA** is no cause for sorrow since he is the protector of all beings and the follower of virtue. O Queen, the banner of his good name waves over the three worlds. Consider the purity of **RAMA** ; even the sun dares not cause him suft'ering by its rays. In his presence, the hot winds of the forest in summer will grow cool and like the spring breeze bring him refreshment I When asleep in the forest at night, the moon, like a father, will succour him with its cool beams. That **RAMACHANDRA**, to whom the Brahmarishi Vishwamitrs gave celestial weapons on the death of his son Shambara, thst valorous son, thst lion among men, depending on the strength of his arms will dwell in the forest as fearlessly as in his own palace. That hero whose arrows destroy his foes, is certain to be snceouted by the estth. That **RAMA**, endowed with great prowess, power and courage, will soon retnm on the termination of his exile, to claim the kingdom. O Lady, **SHRI RAMA**, who illnmines the sun which gives light to the whole world, who gives splendour to the fire, who is the supreme ruler of rulers, who is the fame of fame and the essence of forgiveness, who is the chief of beings; wherever he dwells, in the forest or the city, all is one to him. **SHRI RAMA**, this great hero, will speedily regain his kingdom, together with **SITA**, the estth and every prosperity. 2$6

CHAPTER 44

She finds peace in the consolation of Queen Sumitra

CHAPTBR 44 S/16 fou/1 in t/16 cmuolatitm of Quun Srmritr« THB righteous Queen **SUMITRA** hearing the lament of Queeo **KAUSHALYA** addressed her in reasonable words : " O Queea, why dost thou weep in abject fashion, for thy son, the chief of men, endowed with every virtue ? O Noble Lady, **SHRI RAMA** has reaounced the throne and entered the forest to render his father illustrious, as the votary of truth. **SHRI RAMA**, honouring his father, has conducted himself as the best of men and secured the future glory of his sire. There is no cause for grief, since **RAMA** is treading the path of *dharma*, neither is there cause to grieve for Lakshmsna, ever compassionate to all, sinless, serving **RAMA** and in every way worthy of the highest good. The tender-limbed Janaki, too, is following thy virtuous son. O Queen, the exile of **RAMA** is no cause for sorrow since he is the protector of all beings and the follower of virtue. O Queen, the banner of his good name waves over the three worlds. Consider the purity of **RAMA** ; even the sun dares not cause him suft'ering by its rays. In his presence, the hot winds of the forest in summer will grow cool and like the spring breeze bring him refreshment I When asleep in the forest at night, the moon, like a father, will succour him with its cool beams. That **RAMACHANDRA**, to whom the Brahmarishi Vishwamitrs gave celestial weapons on the death of his son Shambara, thst valorous son, thst lion among men, depending on the strength of his arms will dwell in the forest as fearlessly as in his own palace. That hero whose arrows destroy his foes, is certain to be snceouted by the estth. That **RAMA**, endowed with great prowess, power and courage, will soon retnm on the termination of his exile, to claim the kingdom. O Lady, **SHRI RAMA**, who illnmines the sun which gives light to the whole world, who gives splendour to the fire, who is the supreme ruler of rulers, who is the fame of fame and the essence of forgiveness, who is the chief of beings; wherever he dwells, in the forest or the city,

all is one to him. **SHRI RAMA**, this great hero, will speedily regain his kingdom, together with **SITA**, the estth and every prosperity. 2$6 **SHRI RAMA** for whom, when departing for the forest, the people of Ayodhya filled with grief, shed rears, will soon regain the kingdom. Nought is difficult to obtain in the world by him, who, though invincible, entered the forest, dtessed like an ascetic, followed by **SITA**, who is Laksbmiin another form. " What should be dillicult for him, who, armed with bow and sword, is preceded on his way by Laksbmana? O Lady, abandon grief and infatuation, assuredly thou wilt behold **SHRI RAMA** retoming ftom his ezile. O Thou who art irreproacbable, O KalyaDi, O Auspicious One, thou wilt behold thy like the rising moon, placing his head at thy feet. Thou wilt shed rears of joy, seeing thy son installed on the throne and in possessinn of the king's treasury. O Lady, neither grieve nor let thy mind be troubled, I see nought that is inauspicious in respect of **RAMA**. Soon thou shalt behold thy with **SITA** and Laksbmana. O Sinless Queen, it becomes thee to encourage others, therefore, why dost thou now cause thy heart distress ? O Devi, do not grieve, there is none in the world more virtuous than **RAMA**. Seeing **RAMA** returning from the forest with his friends, making obeisance to thee, then wilt thou shed of joy, like the clouds in the rainy season. In briet; I tell thee, thy **SHRI RAMA**, retoming to the capital, will press thy feet to him with his tender hands. Seeing thy son bowing to thy feet thou wilt cover him with rears as the clouds cover the mountains with rain." Thus did the beautiful Sumiua, ever persuasive and benevo lent to all, oft"er words of consolation to the Queen **KAUSHALYA** and having spoken, became silent. The chief queen, the mother of **SHRI RAMA**, hearing the words of Queen Sumiua, found peace and forgot her grief which resembled the rain of the autumn clouds that swiftly disappesrs CHAPTER 4S The lmMnt of the flJlw folloflJ **SHRI RAMA**

CHAPTER 45

The lament of the brahmins who follow Shri Rama

CHAPTER 4S The lmMnt of the flJlw folloflJ **SHRI RAMA** the heart of our master to be simple and gentle, we know him to be a hero firm in his vows, therefore, return to Ayodhya, do not carry **RAMA** away from the city to the forest." Hearing the lament of the aged brahmios and perceiving their distress, **SHRI RAMA**. causing the chariot to halt, dismounted. With LabhmaDa and **SITA**, he walked towards the forest, Collowed by the multitude, proceeding slowly oo Coot. The ever virtuous and compassiooate **RAMA** was unable to endure the light of the aged brahmios walkiDg on Coot, Car behind the chariot. The brahmios seeing **RAMA** did not return, despite their supplications, but still proceeded towards the forest, were troubled and overcome with distresS, cried : " O **RAMA**, thou art a friend of the brahmios and the whole caste is following thee with the sacred fire home on their shoulders. See, we are carrying the holy canopies, like autumn clouds, obtained by us by observing the Vaja-peyaceremony. By covering thee with their shade, we will proteet thee from the rays of the sun. O Child, formerly thy mind was set on the study of the Veda, but now thou art determined to enter the forest. Our only wealth, the Veda, we have stored in our memory and our coosortll are at home, protected by their conjugal devotion. There is no cause for fUrther reflection, we are determined to go with thee I If thou dost not walk in the path of dhartna, who will follow it ?" " O **RAMA**. what more can be said? We, whose heads are white like swan's down, offer humble salutations to thee. Among us, some have entered opoo their sacrifices, O **RAMA**, their completion depends oo thee. Not we alone, but beasta, birds and trees, entreat thee to return ; have pity on

all these. Trees desiring to follow thee, prevented by their roots which penetrate deep into the earth, implore thee not to depart, their branches bending low in the wind. See the birds, forgetting to seek their food, sit motionless on the trees, supplicating thee who art compassionate to all." Thus lamenting, the brahmios beheld the river Tamaaa as If obstructing the path of **RAMA**. preventing his fUrther propss. TbeD Sumantra, loosiDg the tired horses, let them roll on the ground to relieve their filtigue and gave them to drink causing them to bathe in the river, and allowing them to graze on the banks of the Tamasa. · CHAPTBK 46 Shri auna, fllith **SITA** and Laluhnuma and th8 charioteer drifJI "" alone to th8 f,....t SHBI RAMA, reaching the beautiful banks of the river Tamasa, gazing on **SITA**, addressed his brother **LAKSHMANA** : " O Sou of Queen Sumitta, this is the first night of our exile, there is no cause for anxiety. The forest looks deserted and melancholy, the birds and beasts having mired to rest. Doubtless the capital of Ayodhya with its inhabilllnts and my royal sire are deeply distressed on aaount of our departure. The king, seeing in us many virtnes, looks on us with deep affection. O I -akshmaua, I fear lest my father and my illustrious mother become blind with incessant weeping. Yet Prince Bharats of uprigbt conduct, will assuredly offer consolation to my parents in dutiful and pious words. O Mighty-armed Prince, re1lectiug on the compassion of Prince **BHARATA**, I have no fear for my parents. O Hero, thou bast done well in accompanying me to the forest, bad it not been so, my solicitude for Sits would have been great. O Lakshmaua, there is au abundance of roots, fruits and berries here, but to-night I desire to partske of water alone." Having thus addressed Prince I -aksbmana, Sbri **RAMA** said to Sumantra : " O Gentle Friend, attend to the hones with

CHAPTER 46

Shri Rama, with Sita and Lakshmana and the charioteer, drive on alone to the forest

TbeD Sumantra, loosiDg the tired horses, let them roll on the ground to relieve their filtigue and gave them to drink causing them to bathe in the river, and allowing them to graze on the banks of the Tamasa. · CHAPTBK 46 Shri auna, fllith **SITA** and Laluhnuma and th8 charioteer drifJI "" alone to th8 f,....t SHBI RAMA, reaching the beautiful banks of the river Tamasa, gazing on **SITA**, addressed his brother **LAKSHMANA** : " O Sou of Queen Sumitta, this is the first night of our exile, there is no cause for anxiety. The forest looks deserted and melancholy, the birds and beasts having mired to rest. Doubtless the capital of Ayodhya with its inhabilllnts and my royal sire are deeply distressed on aaount of our departure. The king, seeing in us many virtnes, looks on us with deep affection. O I -akshmaua, I fear lest my father and my illustrious mother become blind with incessant weeping. Yet Prince Bharats of uprigbt conduct, will assuredly offer consolation to my parents in dutiful and pious words. O Mighty-armed Prince, re1lectiug on the compassion of Prince **BHARATA**, I have no fear for my parents. O Hero, thou bast done well in accompanying me to the forest, bad it not been so, my solicitude for Sits would have been great. O Lakshmaua, there is au abundance of roots, fruits and berries here, but to-night I desire to partske of water alone.” Having thus addressed Prince I -aksbmana, Sbri **RAMA** said to Sumantra : " O Gentle Friend, attend to the hones with for **RAMA**. Perceiving the bed made with tender leaves, on the banks of the Tamasa, **SHRI RAMA** with **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA** rested there. Finding **SHRI**

RAMA and **SITA** sleepiog, J.abbmana, leaving his scat, recounted the excellent virtues of **RAMA** to the charioteer. Laksbmana thus passed the whole night till the sun rose, conversing with Sumantra on the attributes of **RAMA**. In this manner, on the banks of the Tamasa, among herds of cattie, **SHRI RAMA** and those who bad followed bim, passed the night. At dawn, **SHRI RAMA** rose and seeing the people still asleep, said to his virtuous brothet Laksbmana : " O **LAKSHMANA**, see how these people, abandoning their homes and property, to follow us, are sleeping under the trees. It seems tbat they, vowing to bring us back, will give up their lives rather than be false to their determination. Let ua, therefore, O Brother, leave this place before they wake. When we bave crossed the Tamasa, there will be no further cause for amtiety. By our silent departure, the people of the capital of King Ikshwaku, will not, like us, be compelled to sleep under the trees. It is the duty of a prince to preserve them from auft"etillg and not make them the companions of his distress." Shri **LAKSHMANA** answeted Rmchandra, saying: "O Wise One, I aaept thy resolve, let us mount the chariot immedistely." **RAMA** then said to Sumantra : " Speedily prepare the chariot, I will proceed towards the forest, let us thetefore depart from hence without delay." The charioteer, bastily yoking the horses to the chariot, humbly addressed **RAMA**, saying : " O Great Prince, the chariot is now ready, please ascend with l.akshman and **SITA**; may prosperity attend thee." **SHRI RAMA** with his bow, quiver and othet weapons, mounted the chariot and passed over the swiftly flowing river. Crossing the Tamasa, at a short distance from the shore, they traversed a ruaeci path oversrown with briars, and then came to a wide road, where they could travel with ease and which wu safe from any daager. To elude the citizens, **SHRI RAMA** said to Sumantra: " O Charioteer, drive first toWatds the south. Having thus 261 driven for a space, rerum again, so that no of us may be

found." Shri Sumaotra, following the instructioos of **RAMA**, drove forward, thco rctaming, stood before **RAMA**. The soo of Dassraths, the augmentcr of the glory of the house of Raghu, spokefromthechsriot,saying: "Now drive towards Tapovaoa." Sumantrs, tumiDg the chsriot towsrds the north, procccdcd in the direction of the forest.

CHAPTER 47

Those who have followed Prince Rama find themselves alone

THE oight being over and the day having dswncd, the citizens awoke and not beholding **RAMA**, were overwhelmed with grief, not lmowing how to act. Seeking here and there, their eyes bathed in tearS, they were unable to discover by what path **SHRI RAMA** had dcpartcd. Wretched and pale with distreSs, with quivering hearts and utterly dispirited, they broke into piteous czclamations, saying : " Cursed be the sleep that veiled our pcrceptioos, now we shall not behold the full chested and large-eyed **RAMA**. How fruitless is our devotion, since **RAMA** has gone to the forest leaving us, his faithful friends, here. Why has **RAMA** who ever treated ns as his children, left us to enter the forest ? Bither we will find death here or go to the Himalayas and perish in the snow. What avails life without **RAMA** ? Here is dried wood, let us collect it and kindling a fire, perish in the flames. What shall we say oo our retutn ? Shall we tell others we have abandoned the mighty umcd **RAMA**, who is free from envy Thus lamenbng, with uplifted arms, filled with distress, they resembled cows bereft of their young. , Following the track of the chariot wheels, they pressed forward, till, losing their trace, they became

prostrate with grief. Finding no furtltcr path to follow, they turned back crying : “Alas I wbat shall we do ? Fate is against us I " Then, by the way by which they had come, they retraced their stcpa to Ayodhya. Shri Rams, failing to return, the people became restless, and seeing the capital cheerless, despondent and sorrow-stricken, they wept, murmuring to each other : " The city, bereft of **RAMA**, bas no beauty, it resembles a dried-up river, divested of its snakes by an csglc.” As the sky without the moon or the sea without water, so did the city appcsr to the people, causing their hearts to faint within them. Sadly entering their magnificent dwellings, a1Hicted and distraught, they were unable to distinguish one of their own relatives from a stranger.

CHAPTER 48

Ayodhya without Shri Ramachandra is bereft of beauty

Thus lamenbng, with uplifted arms, filled with distress, they resembled cows bereft of their young. , Following the track of the chariot wheels, they pressed forward, till, losing their trace, they became prostrate with grief. Finding no furtltcr path to follow, they turned back crying : “Alas I wbat shall we do ? Fate is against us I " Then, by the way by which they had come, they retraced their stcpa to Ayodhya. Shri Rams, failing to return, the people became restless, and seeing the capital cheerless, despondent and sorrow-stricken, they wept, murmuring to each other : " The city, bereft of **RAMA**, bas no beauty, it resembles a dried-up river, divested of its snakes by an csglc.” As the sky without the moon or the sea without water, so did the city appcsr to the people, causing their hearts to faint within them. Sadly entering their magnificent dwellings,

a1Hicted and distraught, they were unable to distinguish one of their own relatives from a stranger. homes, womea, wealth, SODS or pleasure ? There is only one who is truly virtuous and it is Lakshmalla, who bas followed **RAMA** and **SITA** to the folat ! How fortunate are those lakes and rivers filled with lotuses, whose Rams, eotering to bathe, doth purify I Beautiful forests, rivers with verdant banks, lakes and mouullliDs will be adoroed by the presence of Shri Ramacbandra. Those mouullliDs visited by **RAMA**, recognizing their beloved guest, will honour him with due hospitality. " The also, their brancha laden with ftowers and buds, in which the bees are humming and murmuring, will o1l'er their besury to **RAMA**. The hills will send forth ftowers out of season and yield fruit and blossom in his honour. The crystal wsterfiills of varied beauty will gush forth from the mouutsins to give delight to him. The trees, growing on the slope of the mouullliDs, will eocbant him. Where **RAMA** is, fear and danger are banished. The beroic SODS of King **DASARATHA**, even now, are but a little distance from us ; come let us follow them. There is no bappineas save in the service of the holy Feet of that illumined One. Verily he is the only Lord of the world, the Absolute, the Highest State and our sole support." The women of the city, overcome with grief, addressing their husbands said : " Let us follow **RAMA**, we will serve Shri **SITA**, you attend on **SHRI RAMA**. Remember, **RAMA** will preserve and maintain you in the forest. while Shri **SITA** will grant support to us. Of what use is life where the heart is restless and the mind bereft of purpose? If **KAIKEYI** rule the kingdom setting aside the moral law, what delight can we have in childreo and possessiODS ; even our lives will become valueless. Will **KAIKEYI** be solicitous on our account, she, who bas abandoned King **DASARATHA** and her son ShriRamachandra, for the sake of power? We swear by our sons that while we live, we will never be slaves to **KAIKEYI**. Who can live happily under the rule of that

ahameless and evil woman who pitilessly exiled the sun of the king ? W'nhout a ruler the defenccless kingdom will become a prey to every misfortune and perish on account of **KAIKEYI**'a evil deeds. The king will not long survive the exile of **RAMA** and without him the kingdom will be destroyed. Our good *karma* being ahaulted we are miserable ; let us either have .... live there unknown. By ezi1ing Rams, **SITA** and I .aksbmana, through false we have been made subject to **BHARATA**'s governance as beasts are lead to the slaughter. Shri Rams, a source of delight resembliug the full moon, the destroyer of bis foes, mighty-armed, Labhmana's elder brother, wbose eyes are lite lotuses, who spesks in geode acxents, wbo is brave, guileless and beloved of the people, will assuredly adorn the forest wheresoever he roams." ThewomenofthecitydistressedbytheirseparatioofromRama, wept and mourned as do the friends of a dying man. Lameoting thus, the sun set and the night fell, no sacrificial fires wera visible, did the brabmins, devoted to the study of the Veda, intone the sacred tenS, or recite the Puranas, and in no dwelliDg was any lamp kindled. The city of Ayodbya, stricken and destitute, the stalls of merchandise forsaken, was bereft of beauty like the sky divested of stars. The women of Ayodbya, filled with sorrow as if their own sons or brothers bad been banished, wept bitterly, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** being desrer to them than their own children. In the city, no songs or music was heard, not was there dancing or any sign of rejoicing. The mercbant ceased to expose their merchandise and sat sunk in dejection. Thus Ayodbya, without joy or activity, appeared as desolate as an ocean without water. CHAPTBit 49 Tlte duzriot CI'OIIa ths baundary of Km1ulla SHiti RAMA, remembering bis father's command, bad travelled far through the night. Day dawned while he was still journey ing; oft'ering up bis morning prayer, he cootinued on bis way, soon reaching the southern boundary of

Koshala. Enjoying the cultivated fields, the forests, and trees laden with blossom, he dlovc on, drawn by swift horses. Aa he pused, he heard the people of the villages and hamlets coovcrsing th111 : " Woe IIDIO ICing **DASARATHA** enslaved by concupiscence.

CHAPTER 49

The chariot crosses the boundary of Kosala

live there unknown. By ezi1ing Rams, **SITA** and I .aksbmana, through false we have been made subject to **BHARATA**'s governance as beasts are lead to the slaughter. Shri Rams, a source of delight resembliug the full moon, the destroyer of bis foes, mighty-armed, Labhmana's elder brother, wbose eyes are lite lotuses, who spesks in geode acxents, wbo is brave, guileless and beloved of the people, will assuredly adorn the forest wheresoever he roams." ThewomenofthecitydistressedbytheirseparatioofromRama, wept and mourned as do the friends of a dying man. Lameoting thus, the sun set and the night fell, no sacrificial fires wera visible, did the brabmins, devoted to the study of the Veda, intone the sacred tenS, or recite the Puranas, and in no dwelliDg was any lamp kindled. The city of Ayodbya, stricken and destitute, the stalls of merchandise forsaken, was bereft of beauty like the sky divested of stars. The women of Ayodbya, filled with sorrow as if their own sons or brothers bad been banished, wept bitterly, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** being desrer to them than their own children. In the city, no songs or music was heard, not was there dancing or any sign of rejoicing. The mercbant ceased to expose their merchandise and sat sunk in dejection. Thus Ayodbya, without joy or activity, appeared as desolate as an ocean without water. CHAPTBit 49

Tlte duzriot CI'OIIa ths baundary of Km1ulla SHiti RAMA, remembering bis father's command, bad travelled far through the night. Day dawned while he was still journey ing; oft'ering up bis morning prayer, he cootinued on bis way, soon reaching the southern boundary of Koshala. Enjoying the cultivated fields, the forests, and trees laden with blossom, he dlovc on, drawn by swift horses. Aa he pused, he heard the people of the villages and hamlets coovcrsing th111 : " Woe IIDIO ICing **DASARATHA** enslaved by concupiscence. 365 Ah I how bard is the heart of the wicked Kaikcyi, how cruel her disposition ; violating the ancient tradition, she hss performed this evil deed, she who hss banished the Prince of Light, who is erudite, compassionate and self-controlled. How will the daughter of King **JANAKA**, brought up in ease, endure the hatdships of the forest ? Alas I The king has no love for his son or he would not have abandoned one so perfect, who is devoted to the welfare of all." Hcsring the words of the villagers, Shri 1tama pressed on quicldy and crossed the boundary of Koshala. Then fording the river Vedasruti, a pure stresm, he proceeded south. After traversing a great distance, he csme to the cool of the Gaumati dowing towsrds the ses, with many cows grazing on its banks. The swift steeds, restrained by **RAMA**, crossed this river and then the Syandika, on whose banks pescocks and ducks were heard. 1tama here showed Sits the land formerly given by Manu to Ikshwaku, a spacious and open country of many principalities. Then **SHRI RAMA**, whose voice resembled an enchanted swan, addressed Sumantra, saying : " O Charioteer, when will the dsy come, when I, returning from the forest in company with my parents, will spurt in the ftowering woods of Sarayu? To hunt in the forest is the prerogative of royal sages. It is the favourite pursuit of kings and others also incline to it. I do not deem it evil and desite to engage in it when the season of my austerities is over." Thus firm in his purpose, Shri

RAMACHANDRA continued to converse sweetly with Sumantra. CHAPTBII SO HAVING crossed the boundary of Koshala, ltama, turning his ace towsrds Ayodhys, with joined palms, addressed the city :

CHAPTER 50

They reach the river Gunga and meet the chief of ferrymen, Guha

Ah I how bard is the heart of the wicked Kaikcyi, how cruel her disposition ; violating the ancient tradition, she hss performed this evil deed, she who hss banished the Prince of Light, who is erudite, compassionate and self-controlled. How will the daughter of King **JANAKA**, brought up in ease, endure the hatdships of the forest ? Alas I The king has no love for his son or he would not have abandoned one so perfect, who is devoted to the welfare of all." Hcsring the words of the villagers, Shri 1tama pressed on quicldy and crossed the boundary of Koshala. Then fording the river Vedasruti, a pure stresm, he proceeded south. After traversing a great distance, he csme to the cool of the Gaumati dowing towsrds the ses, with many cows grazing on its banks. The swift steeds, restrained by **RAMA**, crossed this river and then the Syandika, on whose banks pescocks and ducks were heard. 1tama here showed Sits the land formerly given by Manu to Ikshwaku, a spacious and open country of many principalities. Then **SHRI RAMA**, whose voice resembled an enchanted swan, addressed Sumantra, saying : " O Charioteer, when will the dsy come, when I, returning from the forest in company with my parents, will spurt in the ftowering woods of Sarayu? To hunt in the forest is the prerogative of royal sages. It is the favourite pursuit of kings and others also incline to it. I do not deem it evil and

desite to engage in it when the season of my austerities is over." Thus firm in his purpose, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** continued to converse sweetly with Sumantra. CHAPTBII SO HAVING crossed the boundary of Koshala, ltama, turning his ace towsrds Ayodhys, with joined palms, addressed the city : 266 " O Ayodhya, Cbicf of Cities, protected by the kings of the House of Ikshwaku, I take leave of thee and of the gods thy who dwell with thee. Having fulfilled the command of the king, I shall, retumiDg from the forest, again behold thee and my pareots." Then lifting up his arms, **SHRI RAMA**, the tears falling from his eyes, addressed the citizens of his father's kingdom : "O Ye Who have treated me with the respect and affection due to a master, it is not meet that you remain with me, now return to your homes and discharge the duties of your households." Bowing down to **SHRI RAMA**, the people circumambulated him with reverence and turned homewards, frequendy halting, weepiog and lamenting. **SHRI RAMA**, seeing them weepiog and not yet satisfied with beholdiog him, told the charioteer to drive on speedily and passed beyond their sight as the sun sinks our of view at the time of eveniog. Proceeding on his way, **SHRI RAMA** beheld prosperous towns and villages full of men of charitable, righteous and fearless disposition evidenced by the abundance of temples and sacrificial pillars of their cities. The gardens filled with mango were enriched by pools of translucent water with carefully tended highways and herds of carde grazing here and there. Everywhere the recitation of the Veda could be heard. From his chariot, **SHRI RAMA** surveyed the Kiogdom of Koshals and passed beyond its confines. The sagacious **RAMA**, proceeding through the extensive land inhabited by happy and prosperous people, enriched by pleasant gardens, came to the southern boundary of Koshals and beheld the holy Gunga, adorned by the presence THE li.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI ud lillliDg from the heights on the rocks

below, resembles a maiden's plaited locks ; sometimes made beautiful by whirlpools, here dark 8Dd deep, there with the roar of waterS, proclaiming the presence of Sbri Gunga herself; those sacred waterS wherein the celestial beings plunge ud swim, where white lotuses float, bordered by high banks or shelving SIDds ; there, where swans, cranes, ud chakut birds are heard, where trees adom the banlrs ud waterlilies float or fields of lotus flowers whose buds re vcsl their tender beauty carper the tide. Sometimes the waters, reddened by the petals of lotuses, make the river appear like a lovely attired in a crimson sari ; those sparkling waterS, green as emerald, where mighty tuskers sport ud also the great guardian elephonts of the earth's four quarters, or those bearing the gods, where the sound of Hara ! Hara ! resounds forever. Sbri Gunga, beautiful as a tastefully adorned with brilliant gems ; Sbri Gunga, enriched with fruit, flowers 8Dd birds of every hue, abounding in porpoises, crocodiles 8Dd serpents ; that sacred stream, lillling from the feet of the Blessed **VISHNU**, divine 8Dd spotless, the destroyer of others' sin, having sported in the loeb of Sbri **SHIVA**, thereafter descending on earth, through the power of the penance of Bhagiratha. Shri ltsma, proceeding towards the city of Shringavera, seeing the queen of the the holy Gunga, where the songs of the krauncha bird are heard, watching wave on wave rising on the sacred stream, that mighty warrior, **RAMA**, said to Sumantra : " O Charioteer, let us lodge here. There, under the Ingudi tree,' laden with vcrdiDt leaves ud blossom, let us rest. O Benevolent One, let us linger by the mighty river, whose auspicious waterS are worshipped by the gods, the duavas, serpents, beasts ud birds, ud let us ofl'er homage there." Sumantra 8Dd LabhmiDa IDSwering " Be it so ", stayed the chariot under the Ingudi tree. Arriving there, Shri ltsma 8Dd Labhmaaa descended from the chariot 8Dd Sumantra, unyoking the horses, respectfully seated himself filcing

RAMA, at the foot of the tree. amoag men, Shri Rams, bad come to his territory, he to gether with his aged miDister and relatives went forth to meet the prince. Shri Rams, seeing the chief of ferrymen, from a distance, went with **LAKSHMANA** to meet and welcome him. Perceiving Shri Rams to be in ascetic's garb, Guha, distressed, bowing before him, said : " O Prince, let this small kingdom be as Ayodhya to thee, please issue thy commands, I am at thy service. O Mighty-armed One. it is rare to receive a guest so deeply beloved I " Guha then brought exceUent dishes of delicious foods, together with the arghya and said: "We are thy servants and thou art our lord, aecept this kingdom and rule it as thine own. Here are dishes of various kinds, desserts, liquids, spices, exceUent beds on which to rest and provender for the horses, all at thy disposal." **SHRI RAMS** *answered*: " O Guha, thou hast come to welcome me on foot out of affection, by this I am duly honoured, I am pleased with thee." Then taking him in his strong arms and embracing him, Shri Rams addressed him in cheerful accents, saying : "O Guha, through my good fortune I behold thee and thy friends in good health. Is all well amoag thy people and with thy possessions ? O Friend, having renounced the accept ance of gifts, I am not able to partake of what thou hast offered me with love; know that having assumed the robe ofkusha grass and the antelope skin, I live on fruit and roots ; I am the pro tector of *dharma* and my father's servant. Being an ascetic, I may only aecept a little grass for the horses and nothing beside by this alone. I am fully welcomed. These horses of my father **DASARATHA** are dear to him, they having received oats, grass and pure water, I am honoured in full measure." On this, Guha commanded his servants to provide drink and provender for the horses. Then Rams assuming a dress of bark performed his evening devotions, drinking the water brought" by Shrii.abhmana Thenl.abhman washed thefeetofRama and **SITA** who bad

laid themselves down beneath the Ingudi tree and seated himself respectfully near them. Guha with Sumantra seated near Shri I .abhmn who, armed with bow and arrow, carefidly guarded Rams, spent the night in holy convene. every comfort and who now, lying on the ground, suft'ered adversity, passed the night undisturbed in deep sleep. CHAPTER SI T1u night is ljlent the bank of the rim

CHAPTER 51

They pass the night on the bank of the sacred river

every comfort and who now, lying on the ground, suft'ered adversity, passed the night undisturbed in deep sleep. CHAPTER SI T1u night is ljlent the bank of the rim-will surely yield up her life without **RAMA**. Alas I Ayodhya, the repository of wealth and illhabited by those who love **RAMA**, will perish through the distress caused by the king's death. How can the king live without beholding his beloved and virtuous eldest sou ? Queen Kaushslya also will perish, nor can my mother long survive Kaushslya's death. Alas I The whole structure of theking's purpose hss fallen in ruins; desiring to appoint **RAMA** as his regent, he will leave this world still cherishiDg this hope. He is fortunate who, attending the last

CHAPTER 52

Sumantra is ordered to return; Shri Rama, Sita and Lakshmana cross the holy river

Will surely yield up her life without **RAMA**. Alas I Ayodhya, the repository of wealth and illhabited by those who love **RAMA**, will perish

through the distress caused by the king's death. How can the king live without beholding his beloved and virtuous eldest sou ? Queen Kaushslya also will perish, nor can my mother long survive Kaushslya's death. Alas I The whole structure of theking's purpose hss fallen in ruins; desiring to appoint **RAMA** as his regent, he will leave this world still cherishiDg this hope. He is fortunate who, attending the last THB RAMAYANA OF VALMJKJ Shri aksbmana, hearing **SHRI RAMA**'s command, lltllldiDg before his brother, called Gulla and Sumantra. Gulla diviDing **SHRI RAMA**'s pmpose, summoned his ministers and said to them : " Speedily bring a good boat, stout and strong, capable of taking **SHRI RAMA** across." The minister according to Gulla's instruction brought an ezcellent boat and said: " Sir, the boat is ready." Then Gulla, with joined palms, approaching **SHRI RAMA** thus addressed him : " O Lord, thy boat is at band, what fUrther dost thou require of me ? O Lion men, O Prince, O Thou observer of great vows, the boat capable of crossing the river 11owing towards the sea, is bere, please enter it." Tbe glorious Prince **RAMA** answered Guba saying : " Thou hast supplied me with all I could desire, now place the baggage on the boat." Tbe princes donning their quivers, and beating their bows, came to the place where the boat was waiting. Then Sumantra approaching the righteous **RAMA** with bowed hesd and joined palms, said : " What commands hast thou for me, O Lord ? " Touching Sumantra with his right band, **SHRI RAMA** *replied*: " O Virtuous Sumantra, now return to the king and serve him with vigilance, I no longer need thee. O Friend, leaving the chsriot, I will enter the forest on foot." Sumantra receiving the order to return, imagined himself already separated from **RAMA** and full of grief eKC1aimed : " O Lord, none in the kingdom desires thee to enter the forest with **SITA** and Laksbmana like a common man. When I behold thee, mmpassionate and guileless, fitcing great adversity, I regatd

as vain, mmpasaion, simplicity, the brahmacharya vow and the study of the Veda! O Prince, dwelling in the forest with **SITA** and Laksbmana will bring thee renown equal to one who conquers the three worlds ; but we, separated from thee, O **RAMA**, are doomed and will 11 under the sway of the sinful **KAIKEYI**." The wise Sumantra, certain of **RAMA**'s departure, filled with distress, wept lang and bitterly. At length, restraining hia teara he purified himself with water, and was then addressed by **RAMA** who spoke to him in gentle aaenta, laYing: "Among the ministers nf the house of Ibhwatu, is ao kind a friend. WUt thou, therefore, ICt in such wise that the king be freed from grief? The Lord of the earth is aged, his mind CODfused and he is tormented with desire, therefore I ask thee to minister unto him. Whatever the king commands, through a1fection for Queen **KAIKEYI**, do thou perform. Kings tule to fulfil their THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI chariot, their sorrow wiD be increased a thousandfold. On retumiDg to Ayodhya, with what words sball I address thy mother ? Sball I say ' I have left tby son at the home of thy brother, do grieve.' ? How can I utter such a falsehood, yet how ·can I relate the truth to her ? Those noble steeds that have drawn the chariot bearing thee, Lakshmaoa and **SITA**, how sball they be driven without thee ? O Sioless Prince, I cannot retUrD to Ayodhya without thee, therefore let me remain with thee in the forest. If in spite of my prayer, thou still reoouruest me, I wiD, with the ch)lriot enter a blazing fire. Prince, whatever beings seek to frustrate thy life of devotion in the forest, I wiD repel with my chariot. Through thee, I am enabled to drive the chariot, now be gracious enough to let me enter the forest with thee. Accept me, therefore, as thy protector and let me enter the forest, I ask thee with exceeding love. O Hero, should these excellent steeds serve thee in the forest, they wiD acquire a high spiritual state. O Prince, by whatever means I may serve thee in the forest, I would esteem it more

than residence in heaven or in Ayodhya. Without thee, I am unable to re!UrD to the capital, as the sinful Iodra was unable to enter Amaravati. It is my highest desire when thy period of exile sball be over to convey thee to the capital once more. O R.ama, fourteen years with thee wiD pass like a moment, while without thee, they wiD seem like a thousand years. O Friend of those devoted to thee, I have resolved to stay in the forest with the son of my lord. How cao'st thou abandon thy devoted friend, who only seeks to do his duty? " Thus repeatedly besought by the minister Sumantra, Shri R.ama answered him saying : " O Lover of thy Master, I know of thy devotion to me, but hear the reasons which prompt me to send thee hence to Ayodhya. " Seeing thee return to the capital, my mother **KAIKEYI**, convinced I have entered the forest wiD be sarisfied and wiD no louger reproach the king, chargiog him with tilsehood and unrighteousness. I desire that my mother **KAIKEYI** should enjoy words of reason and encouragement to Guha, saying : " O Guha, it is not proper for me to dwell in the forest in which my friends reside, therefore, constructing a hut ofleaves and twigs elsewhere I will live as an ascetic. For the spiritual welfilre of my father, I, **SITA** and Labhniana, with matted hair following the ascetic discipline, will reside in the forest. Bring me, therefore, the milt of the Bhurja tree.' Guha obeyed the instruction of the prince, whereupon **RAMA** poured the viscous liquid on his own head and also on the head of **LAKSHMANA** I Thus **SHRI RAMA**, that Lion among men, and his brother **LAKSHMANA** appeared as ascetics and in their robes of hark with matted locks looked charming. Taking the vow of brahmacharya, the two brothers addressed Guha saying : " O Guha, do not neglect thine armies, thy treasury, thy forces of defence and thy people. A kingdom is governed through diligence and exertion." Taking leave of Guha, **SHRI RAMA** with **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA** went quickly towards the Ganges. Seeing the boat near

the bank of the swiftly flowing river and desirous of crosaing over it, **RAMA** said to Laksbmana : .. O Lion among men, hold the boat firm and aid the gentle **SITA** to board it, then you, too, enter it." Acting on his brother's command, Shri **LAKSHMANA** fint assisted the daughter of the King of Mithila and then boarded the boat himself. Then the resplendent **RAMA** followed, being the last to enter and Guha ordered his jervants to row them over the sacred river. Occupying his seat in the boat, Prince **RAMA** began to recire the Vedic *mantra* for the safe conduct of all. Performing the THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIKJ Gunga, returning with them, I wiD worship thee. O Gunga, thou art the fulfiller of pious desires. O Thou Tripartite Goddess, reaching to the abode of **BRAHMA**, and appearing in the mortal realm as the consort of the ocean king, O Beautiful One, I bow down to thee and adore thee. When, returning safely from the forest, **SHRI RAMA** occupies the throoe, theo I, desiring to gratifY thee, wiD give a hundred thousand cows, abundant grain and beautiful apparel to the *brahmins* in charity. Returning to Ayodhya, I wiD offer a sacrifice of a hundred jars of wine and rice to thee. I wiD wonhip all the gods dwelling on thy banks and all the sacred places such as Prayaga and Kashi. O Sinless Ooe, grant that **RAMA** and I .abhmaoa, free from sin, completing the term of their eme, return again to Ayodhya." Thus worshipping the Gunga, the Promoter of delight, they reached the further bank. Then **RAMA**, chief of men, leaving the boat on the southern shore, proceeded to the forest with Lakshmaoa and Janaki, and addressed Shri Lakshmaoa, saying : " O Sou of **SUMITRA**, do thou carefully protect Shri **SITA** in the lonely and also the frequented areas of the forest. We must guard her in this uokoown and uninhabited plsce, therefore, O I .abhmaoa, do thou go before and let **SITA** follow thee, I wiD walk behind to safeguard you both, let us defend each other, O Prince. So far, Shri **SITA** has not made trial of her strength, but from

to-day she must endure the hardships of a forest life. To-dsy, the daughter of King **JANAKA** will enter the forest where no man dwells, nor are there fields or gardens there, but hard and arid ground with yawning chasms everywhere." Shri I abhmaoa, thus instructed, went ahead with **SITA** following him, **SHRI RAMA** coming after. Meantime, Sumantra, on the further bank, followed Raghava with his eyes, and overcome with grief, wept bitterly. **SHRI RAMA**, respleodeot as the earth's guardiaos, giver of boons, having crossed the river Gunga, came to the land of Batsya. Thereafter, the two brothers hunted the deer and wild bou, and other beasts and growing huogey, fed on roots and berries, as ordained, resting at eventide beneath a tree. CHAPTBR 53 Tim Delighter of the World, **SHRI RAMA**, sitting beneath a tree performed his eveniDg devotion (*Sandbya*) and then addressed Shri **LAKSHMANA** thus : " O Brother, this is our first night in the forest without Sumantra, do not be dispirited. From now on at night but one of us shall sleep, since the protection of Shri Sits is our core. O **LAKSHMANA**, gatbeting leaves and gnss, let us prepare a bed and lay ourselves down." **SHRI RAMA**, accustomed to a sumptuOUS and princely couch, lay thst night on the bare earth. Conversing with Shri Laksh mana, he said : " O **LAKSHMANA**, it may be that King Dasaraths slept fitfully this day, bur **KAIKEYI** having realised her ambition, is surely satisfied. I fear thst she, avid for the kingdom, will slay the king 'ere Bharats returnS. The aged monarch is defenceless, a slave to **KAIKEYI** and subject to desire ; bereft of me, how will the wretChed king safeguard himself? Viewing the king's downll and his subjection in matters of desire, it would seem thst concupiscence is more powerful than wealth or virtue. O Brother, what foolish man, swayed by a woman, would abandon an obedient son like me ? Bharsts alone is fortunate, who, with his consort, having acquired Ayodbya, will enjoy the kingdom. " Prince Bharats will become the

ruler of the whole empire aince the life of the king is drawing to its close and I have entered the forest. He who gives up righteousness and dis regarding prosperity, seeks to gratify his desires, like King **DASARATHA**, alis a prey to sorrow. O Handsome Prince, I deem thst **KAIKEYI** entered our house to destroy the king, to send me into ezile and to install Bharsts as ruler of the kingdom. O Brother, I fear that **KAIKEYI**. blinded by power, may persecute **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**, they being our mothers. Do thou, lest **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA** sufFer, go to Ayodbya, for my sake. I, with Sits, will enter the Dandab foRst. Go thou to Ayodbya and become the protector of the defenceless Queen Kausbalya. The evilly-disposed **KAIKEYI**. through enmity to us, may cause a77

CHAPTER 53

Determined to follow their destiny they enter upon exile

CHAPTBR 53 Tim Delighter of the World, **SHRI RAMA**, sitting beneath a tree performed his eveniDg devotion (*Sandbya*) and then addressed Shri **LAKSHMANA** thus : " O Brother, this is our first night in the forest without Sumantra, do not be dispirited. From now on at night but one of us shall sleep, since the protection of Shri Sits is our core. O **LAKSHMANA**, gatbeting leaves and gnss, let us prepare a bed and lay ourselves down." **SHRI RAMA**, accustomed to a sumptuOUS and princely couch, lay thst night on the bare earth. Conversing with Shri Laksh mana, he said : " O **LAKSHMANA**, it may be that King Dasaraths slept fitfully this day, bur **KAIKEYI** having realised her ambition, is surely satisfied. I fear thst she, avid for the kingdom, will slay the king

'ere Bharats returnS. The aged monarch is defenceless, a slave to **KAIKEYI** and subject to desire ; bereft of me, how will the wretChed king safeguard himself? Viewing the king's downll and his subjection in matters of desire, it would seem thst concupiscence is more powerful than wealth or virtue. O Brother, what foolish man, swayed by a woman, would abandon an obedient son like me ? Bharsts alone is fortunate, who, with his consort, having acquired Ayodbya, will enjoy the kingdom. " Prince Bharats will become the ruler of the whole empire aince the life of the king is drawing to its close and I have entered the forest. He who gives up righteousness and dis regarding prosperity, seeks to gratify his desires, like King **DASARATHA**, alis a prey to sorrow. O Handsome Prince, I deem thst **KAIKEYI** entered our house to destroy the king, to send me into ezile and to install Bharsts as ruler of the kingdom. O Brother, I fear that **KAIKEYI**. blinded by power, may persecute **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**, they being our mothers. Do thou, lest **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA** sufFer, go to Ayodbya, for my sake. I, with Sits, will enter the Dandab foRst. Go thou to Ayodbya and become the protector of the defenceless Queen Kausbalya. The evilly-disposed **KAIKEYI**. through enmity to us, may cause a77 mJury to our mothers. O **LAKSHMANA**, assuredly in some previous birth, my mother bas deprived other women of their sons and is reaping the fruit of tbat action in this life. Woe unto me, tbat I should have to abandon my mother who nurtured me with exceeding love and should now enjoy felicity. O **LAKSHMANA**, may no woman give bUth to a son like me, who am the sowce of infinite disttess to my mother. O Brother, a maiDa' taught by me, cried in the hearing of mY mother, ' Bite the enemy's f-while you are in his mouth .0 **LAKSHMANA**, my unfortunate mother is to-day sunk in an ocean of grief and I am not able to succour her. Better it were tbat she had had no son ! Assuredly she is an object of

compassion, mourning in my separation. Alas ! what exttemity of grief is hers to-day ! O I .akshmn, should I give way to wrath, I were able to subdue the world not to speak of Ayodhya, but for the upholding of righteousness, I may not demonstrate my power. Should I do so, I should incnr ain and endanger the life hereafter ; never will I take the kingdom by force." Thus lamenting in the lonely forest. Ramo. abandoning restraint. passed the night in tears. When, ceasing to lament. **LAKSHMANA** beheld **RAMA** like an extinguished fire or a calm sea, he thus addressed him : " O Great Hero, deprived of thee, Ayodhya is without splendour, as the night, at the setting of the sun, bur. O **RAMA**, it is unworthy of thee to grieve, sapping the courage of **SITA** and myself. Like fish without water, we aumot live an installt without thee. O Great One, I do not desire to see my father, my brother Shatruglma or my mother Sutnitra, nor even heaven itself." Hearing the words of I a!rsJnnana, full of good counsel, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** arose and seated himself by **SITA** on the bed of leaves. Determined to fullow his deatiny, **SHRI RAMA** entered upon the period of ezile. From tbat day, the two great princes of the house of Raghu dwelt in the londy furesr. serene and fearless like two lions dwelling on the summit of a mountain.

CHAPTER 54

They spend the night at Prayaga in the hermitage of the Sage Bharadwaja

undet a banyan ttee, they set out from thence and proceeded to where the Gunga and the Yamuna meet, Bowing through the vast fomt. The two illustrious brothers journeying onwards beheld beautiful vistas in the forest, hitherto unseen by them, and they, sometimes reclining at

ease, delighted in the blossoming trees. The day being nearly over, Sbri **RAMA** said to the son of Sumiaa : " O Laksbmana, look towards Prayaga, smoke is Tising like the fire-god's banner ; undoubt edly, it is a sign that the hermitage of holy Bharadwaja is near. We have assuredly reached the junction of the Gunga and Yamuna, the sound of these mighty rivers clashing together is clearly heard. Wood-cutters have bewn the logs from mighty trees and many are cut down in the hermitage of the holy sage." Conversing thus, as the sun was setting, the two great archers reached the confluence of the Gunga and Y amana, and the hermitage of Bharadwaja. Desiring to look upon the holy sage, they halted respectfally at some little distance from the place. Then **RAMA** slowly and reverently entered the hermitage, beholding there the omniscient Sage Bharadwaja of mighty vows, the conqueror of time by sacred discipline. Surrounded by bia disciples, offering oblations into the holy fire, they beheld the *rishi*, and **RAMA** with Sits and **LAKSHMANA** paid obeisance to him. **RAMA** *said*: " O messed and Mighty Sage, we are **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, the sons of King Dasatatha, and this, my wife, is the daughter of Videha's King, this fortunate one is following me to the lonely Tapovana. My royal sire has sent me into ezi1e and the son of **SUMITRA**, my younger brother, ever dear to me, mking the brabmacharya vow, has followed me. IDessed Lord, fidfilling the behests of our father, we shall enter THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI The virtuous sage, Jlharadwaja, hearing the words of Prince llama, oJferiDg them madhuparbtogether with the arghya, and water wherewith to wash their feet, thereafter gave them various and aails. Then the holy sage prepared a resti.og place for them. The Maharishi Bharadwaja, seated amidst the deer and birds, thus honoured llama, enquiring as to his welfare. llama receivillg the wonhip of the great *rishi*, reflected on the wotds spoken to him : " O Prince, I

behold thee after a long time, I have heard that thou exiled without cause. Remain hete at ease and in peace, at this sacred and pleasant place whete the two rivers meet." Shri llama, devoted to the good of all, answered : " O Lord, thy hermitage is close to the abodes of men and many will come hithet to gaze on **SITA** and myself. I thetefore do not deem it wise to linger here. O Blessed One, do thou iuform me of a lonely pJace, where **SITA**, the daughter of Janab, may live in happiness." In gentle accents **SHRI BHARADWAJA** *replied*: " O Child, ten miles from here, there is a mountain, purified by the presence of many sages who dwell there, beautiful and pleasing to the aight, there do thou abide. Monkeys, bears and chimpanaees wander there freely. That mountain is Chittrakuta, delighttUI as Gmdhamdana. Those beholding the peaks of Chittrakuta, obtain spiritual merit, their minds admit no sin and, livillg there, they win divine rewatds. Many sages, performing austerities there for thousands of years, have entered heaven in their embodied state. O llama, this lovely place is a fit residence for thee, I deem, if thou will not remain hete with me until the period of thine exile be past. Thus Bhatadwaja honoured llama with **SITA** and Labhmana offering them every mark of hospitality due to their royal state. So in the hermitage of we have passed the night at ease in thy hermitage now grant us leave to depart to the place appointed by thee." Shri Bbaradwaja then made answer. " O **RAMA**, aet out for the mountain Cbittrabta abounding in honey, roots and fruit, worthy to be thy dwelling, covered with trees and the abode of heavealy beings ; there, peacocks cry and mighty tuskers roam. Go then to that sacred place, which is pleasant and filled with fruit and flowers, and where elephants and deer wander through the woods. There, lingering with **SITA** by the springs and waterfiiJJs, the mountain slopes and peaceful caves, thy mind will find ddigbt. O **RAMA**, do thou depart to dwell on that high and lovely mountain thronged with

elephants and various beasts, where the tittibhaand the kokilasing." CHAPTEK SS Tluy 1M y""""""" and trafiS/ "" SHRI RAMA and **LAKSHMANA**, the conquerors of their foes, having passed the night in Prayaga, offered obeisance to the sage and proceeded towards Olittrakuta. On their departure, Sbri Bharadwaja pvc them his blessing as a father blesses his son and addressing **RAMA**, that hero of the region of truth, said : " O Great One, proceeding west of the junction of the rivers, on the bank of the YIIIDUIJll, which flows into the swiftly-moving Gunga, thou wilt find a worn-out ferryboat. Do thou pass over the stream by means of a rod to which, at either end, an uprumed pitcher is hung. On the opposite shore, thou wilt behold a mighty green-leaved fig-tree surrounded by many others. The leaves of this tree arc of a dark green hue and it is tiequcntcd by siddhas. Reaching that place, do thou, with Janaki pray for the accomplishment of thy legitimate desires. Rest there awhile, then paas beyond it ; reaching NUvan at a mUe's distance, there many sala, jamnu and badri' trees arc seen. .... bodri-..... _...

CHAPTER 55

They cross the Yamuna and travel on

We have passed the night at ease in thy hermitage now grant us leave to depart to the place appointed by thee." Shri Bbaradwaja then made answer. " O **RAMA**, aet out for the mountain Cbittrabta abounding in honey, roots and fruit, worthy to be thy dwelling, covered with trees and the abode of heavealy beings ; there, peacocks cry and mighty tuskers roam. Go then to that sacred place, which is pleasant and filled with fruit and flowers, and where elephants and deer wander through the woods.

There, lingering with **SITA** by the springs and waterfiiJJs, the mountain slopes and peaceful caves, thy mind will find ddigbt. O **RAMA**, do thou depart to dwell on that high and lovely mountain thronged with elephants and various beasts, where the tittibhaand the kokilasing." CHAPTEK SS Tluy 1M y""""""" and trafiS/ "" SHRI RAMA and **LAKSHMANA**, the conquerors of their foes, having passed the night in Prayaga, offered obeisance to the sage and proceeded towards Olittrakuta. On their departure, Sbri Bharadwaja pvc them his blessing as a father blesses his son and addressing **RAMA**, that hero of the region of truth, said : " O Great One, proceeding west of the junction of the rivers, on the bank of the YIIIDUIJll, which flows into the swiftly-moving Gunga, thou wilt find a worn-out ferryboat. Do thou pass over the stream by means of a rod to which, at either end, an uprumed pitcher is hung. On the opposite shore, thou wilt behold a mighty green-leaved fig-tree surrounded by many others. The leaves of this tree arc of a dark green hue and it is tiequcntcd by siddhas. Reaching that place, do thou, with Janaki pray for the accomplishment of thy legitimate desires. Rest there awhile, then paas beyond it ; reaching NUvan at a mUe's distance, there many sala, jamnu and badri' trees arc seen. .... bodri-..... _... that is the way to Chitttakuta and often have I journeyed on that path. Beautiful it is and free from thorns and there is no danger there of a forest fire." After pointing out the way to Sbri **RAMA**, the sage turned back to his own hermitage. Offering salutations to the saint, Sbri **RAMA**, having taken his leave, said to Lakshmsna : " O **LAKSHMANA**, surely we are fortunate in that the holy *Rishi* has treated us so graciously." Conversing thus, the two princes proceeded onwards, Sbri **SITA** walking before them, and came to the bank of the swiftly-t!owing Yamuna. Then they began to consider how they should pass over it, and collecting some wood constructed a raft, tying together

lengths of dried bamboo and filling the interstices with kusha grass. Then **LAKSHMANA**, spreading the branches of jambu and verras rrees, made **SITA** a comfortable seat. Shri **SITA** shyly holding the hand of her lord, **SHRI RAMA** placed his Beloved on the raft with her clothing and ornaments beside her. Thereafter placing the axes and the chest covered with deerskins, containing their weapons there, the two brothers began to sail. Arriving in mid-stream, Sbri **SITA**, bowing low, prayed to the holy river saying : " O Devi, forgive us for passing over thee, grant that my lord may fulfil his vow without obstructions. When I return, to please thee I will offer a thousand cows in charity." Then with joined palms, she said : " May the Lord of the House of Ikshwaku return in peace to the capital." Having crossed the rippling Yamuna, the swift daughter of the sun, they reached its southern bank; there abandoning the raft, they entered the woods and the river bank and came to the heavily shadowed fig rree. Sbri **SITA** solid : " O Mighty Tree, I make obeisance to thee, may my lord fulfil his vow, so that I may again behold Sbri **KAUSHALYA** and Queen **SUMITRA**." Then **SITA** circumambulated the tree with reverence and **RAMA** beholding the lovely **SITA** praying for his welfare, said to **LAKSHMANA** : " Do thou go forward with **SITA** of whom no ill word has ever been uttered, who is ever obedient to me and is dearer than life itself. O Chief of Men, I, with my weapons will follow after. Whatever fruit or ftower the daughter of **JANAKA** may desire in the fonst, do thou gather for her, so that her mind may fiDd delight." Shri **SITA**, between the two princes, walked like a female elephant guarded by two tuskers ; the daughter of **JANAKA**, beholding many things, formerly llllknown to her, questioned **RAMA** concerning every tree, sbrub and climbing plant. Seeing many beautiful covered with blossom, Shri Laksbmana brought the princess all she desired. Viewing the river and its sandy banks caressed by the waves, where swans and

cranes called, Shri **SITA** was filled with happiness. Having travelled some distance, the two valiant brothers slew many deer for food, then, with **SITA**, passed through the pleasant wooda, ringing with the cries of peacocks and frequented by clcphaots and mookeys. Perceiving a delightful and sbcltered place which found favour with **SITA**, they lodged there free from fear. CBAPTBil S6 T/uy rsodl ths tiiiJIIIltain Cltittrakuta and buil4 a hut THB night being past, **SHRI RAMA**, slowly waking, roused the sleeping Laksbmana and addressed him, saying : " O Laksh mana, how beautiful are the parrots, cuckoos, mainas and other

CHAPTER 56

They reach the mountain Chitttakuta and build a hermitage

JANAKA may desire in the fonst, do thou gather for her, so that her mind may fiDd delight." Shri **SITA**, between the two princes, walked like a female elephant guarded by two tuskers ; the daughter of **JANAKA**, beholding many things, formerly llllknown to her, questioned **RAMA** concerning every tree, sbrub and climbing plant. Seeing many beautiful covered with blossom, Shri Laksbmana brought the princess all she desired. Viewing the river and its sandy banks caressed by the waves, where swans and cranes called, Shri **SITA** was filled with happiness. Having travelled some distance, the two valiant brothers slew many deer for food, then, with **SITA**, passed through the pleasant wooda, ringing with the cries of peacocks and frequented by clcphaots and mookeys. Perceiving a delightful and sbcltered place which found favour with **SITA**, they lodged there free from fear. CBAPTBil S6 T/uy rsodl ths tiiiJIIIltain Cltittrakuta and buil4 a hut THB night being past,

SHRI RAMA, slowly waking, roused the sleeping Laksbmana and addressed him, saying : " O Laksh mana, how beautiful are the parrots, cuckoos, mainas and other THB RAMAYANA OF VALMIKJ crimson flowers glowing like fire and the branches decked with 8owers as if adorned with garlands. How rich in bloom are the bilwatrees untouched by man who is not able to approach them. Here we can easily gathet food. See, O **LAKSHMANA**, buging on the trees, the honeycombs at least a dtona' in size, coveted with bees. How charmingly the waterbird is singing and the peacock answering with ill call, and look I the earth is half concealed with aowen. Here are the lofty peaks of Chittrakuta where countless birds aing and herds of elephants wandet. Somewhere on Chittrakuta a level field must lie midst groves of trees, a and stainless place. whete we will dwell." The two btothets, in company with **SITA**, convetsing thus, reached the pleasant and captivating mountain of Chittrakuta. Coming to that place. on which thete wete birds of many kinds, abounding in various rootB and plessant fruitB and clear transparent pools, Rams said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O Gentle Brothet, how plessant is this hill coveted with sbsdy trees, creepers and fruitB of many kinds, appearing delightful and whete we may abide nnmolested. Within the fotest, many sages dwell, this place is to he our hetmitage." Thus resolving, Rams, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** came to the hermitage of the Sage **VALMIKI** and, with reverence. ofFered obeisance to him. The virtuous sage, full of joy, paid homage to them, asking them to he seated saying : " You are welcome I" Shri Rams, ptesenting himself tOgCthet with his brothet and **SITA**, related the cause of his exile to the sage and then addressed **LAKSHMANA**, saying : " O Brothet, bring strong wood and let us build a hut in this place. O Excellent Prince, here do I wish to dwelL" Shri **LAKSHMANA** thetenpon brought many pieces of wood, hewn from the trees, and eteered a hut thatched with leaves. When Shri

Rams beheld that firm and pleasant hut fUrnished ki1lcd a black deer, bring it here speedily. Let us follow the scriptural ordinance in this matter.” Shri I .akshmana, having obeyed his brother’s command, **RAMA** *said*: " Now dress the meat and we will offer it as a sacrifice. Hasten, O Brother, this is an auspicious hour.” The illustrious son of **SUMITRA** slew a black antelope and roasted it in the flames. When it was dressed and the blood drained from it, **LAKSHMANA** addressed Raghava, saying : " O Godlike One, I have prepated the flesh of the black deer, oft"et up the sacri1ice to propitiate the god.” The devout and resplendent **RAMA**, skilled in silent prayer and sacrifice, having bathed, recited the holy tests, oft"ering homage to the gods, then enteted the hut, his heart filled with joy. Having adored Rudra and **VISHNU** for the purification of the dwelling, he read the Peace Cbant and other propitiatory prayers. Repeating the *japa*’ and bsthing in the rivet, he oft"eted oblations for the expiation of sins. He then erected altars in the eight directions for the worship of dift’erent gods and gratifying the deities presiding over the clements with oft"erings of flowers, garlands, fruits, cooted meats and the recitstion of Vedie mamrans, he, together with **SITA**, enteted the delighttbl hut, thatched with leaves, set up in a suitable place, shelteted from the wind. **SHRI RAMA**, of subdued senses, dwelt happily in that habita tion, built in the forest, the abode ofbeasts and birds, abounding in and flowers, where elephants wandered and the cries of wild bessts re-echoed. Living on the pleasant mountain, Chittrakuta, by the banb of the river Malati, **RAMA** forgot the capital and remembered his reQIJIICiation no more.

CHAPTER 57

Sumantra returns to the stricken city of Ayodhya

Versing long with the cbariotcer, he perceived **RAMA** reach the southern shore, and turned homewards. Sumantra heariDg fully from the men of Shrangvcrpira of **RAMA**'s arrival at Praysga, his meeting and residence with the *Rishi* Bbaradwaja and his journey towards Chittrakuta, bade farewell to G1lha and yoking his horses to the chariot, with a sorrowful heart, started for Ayodhya. Speedily passing through Bower-laden forem and viewing the rivetS, pools, villages and towns, he reached the stricken city of Ayodhya on the evening of the thitd day. Seeing the silent city, he rellected : " Has the city with its sovereign, men, elephants and horses been consumed by the fire of grief, caused by the separation from **RAMA**?" Poodeting thus, in his swiftly borne chariot, Sumantra reached the gate of the inner city and entered it. There innumerable people rushed towards the chariot and surrounding it, cried : " Where is Shri Rams ? " " Where is **SHRI RAMA** ? " and **SUMANTRA** *answered*: " Having reached the banks of the Gunga, the virtuous **RAMA** ordered me to return, therefore, I bave come." Then the people, finding Rams had crossed the sacred river, their eyes filled with tears, sighing heavily, cried : " O **RAMA**, O **RAMA** ! " and all exclaimed with one voice, " Alas I We are deprived of the sight ofRama, we are destroyed! We shall no more behold Rams, the distributor of gifts and performer of sacrifices, who sat in onr assemblies and who resembled the beautifully adorned Metu mountain I Alas I Where is Shri Rams, onr protector, acquainted with the need of each and the happiness of alii .. Then Sumantra, proceeding ftuther, heard on every side, through the lattices of the honses the wailing of women mourning for Rams and heariDg their lamentations on the royal Descending with all speed from his chariot, he passed beyond the seven gates and entered the royal residence. Seeing Sumantra return alone, the women, seated at the balconies and windows of the palace, seven-stnries high, languishing in **RAMA**'s separation,

broke into loud lamentations. Exchanging glances, their eyes streaming with tears, in broken accents they gave ezpression to their grief. He heard, too, the feeble wailing of the queens ofKing **DASARATHA**, saying: " What will Sumantra, who went forth with **RAMA** and has returned alone, say to the stricken Queen Kausbalya ? Surely the human soul suffers pain and anxiety more readily than joy, since Queen Kausbalya still lives separated from **RAMA**." Hearing the words of the queens and weighed down with sorrow, Sumantra entered the residence of the king and passing through the eighth door beheld in the white chamber, the wretched king, disconsolate and wasted with grief on account of his son. Approaching the king seated there, Sumantra making obeisance to him delivered the message entrusted to him by **SHRI RAMA**. The king heard it in silence, his mind agitated with pain and grief and fell unamscious to the earth. The queens, seeing the king alien in a swoon, lifted him in their arms and covered him with tears. Kausha1ya and **SUMITRA** raising the fallen monarch from the ground addressed him, saying : " O Thou Fortunate One, why dost thou not answer the messenger ofRama who has aaomplished his arduous task ? O King, having exiled **RAMA**, why art thou now full of shame ? Arise, there is no cause for this distress. O Lord, Queen **KAIKEYI** is not here, in fear of whotn thou dost not dare address Sumantra. Speak without fear." Thus exhorting the king, Queen **KAUSHALYA** fell insensible, her throat choked on account of her grief. The ladies of the court and the other queens, perceiving **KAUSHALYA** lying on the ground lamenting, began to weep aloud. Then all the people of Ayodhya, old and young, hearing the wailing from the inner apartments of the palace, broke into lamentation, as on the day when **RAMA** had left the city. THB R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI CHAPTER S8 H deliwn Slni **RAMA**'s to the king THE king, recovering consciousness after a while, summoned

the royal charioteer and turned his gaze upon him. Sumantra reverently approached the aged monarch who was grievmg and restless, and sighing heavily like a newly-captured elephant. Then the alllicted sovereign spoke to Sumantra who was most miserable, his body covered with dust, his eyes suffused with tears, and said : " O Charioteer, that virtuous one, wotthy of evety comfort and happiness will now be seeking refuge under a tree. O ! What will be his food ? How will R.ama, the son of King **DASARATHA**, who merits no suffering, who is wotthy of resting on a royal couch, sleep as one orphaned, on the hare earth ? How can that prince, formerly accompanied by soldiers and elephants, and whose chariot was drawn by matchless steeds, now sleep in the lonely forest ? How will R.ama and **SITA** be able to dwell in the forest abounding with pythons and other wild beasts ? O Snmantra, how can the tender and sorrow stricken **SITA** with the two ptinces, abandoning the chariot, walt barefooted in the forest ? O Charioteer, thou an fortunate in that thou hast seen the two ptinces wandering in the forest like the Ashwini Kumaras on the mountain Mandara. O Sumantra, when they entered the forest, what did R.ama say ? What did Labhmans say ? What did **SITA** say ? O O!arioteer, tell me fully of Rams's dwelling, his sleeping and his eating. thus shall I live a little longer,like King Yayati of old, on heating the words of the sadhus." Thus questioned by his royal master, Sumantra, his throat choked, his speech broken by sobs, replied : " O Great King, Shri R.ama, the Upholder of righteousness, reverently joining his palms and bowing his hosd, said : On my command, offer salutations again and again to the mnst praiseworthy sovereign, renowned far and wide in the world as highly virtunus, and to all the men and women of the inner apanment, carry tldiDgs of my welfare with salutations befitting their nllk. Convey the news of my welfare to my mother **KAUSHALYA**, with my

CHAPTER 58

He delivers Shri Rama's message to the king

THB R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI CHAPTER S8 H deliwn Slni **RAMA**’s to the king THE king, recovering consciousness after a while, summoned the royal charioteer and turned his gaze upon him. Sumantra reverently approached the aged monarch who was grievmg and restless, and sighing heavily like a newly-captured elephant. Then the alllicted sovereign spoke to Sumantra who was most miserable, his body covered with dust, his eyes suffused with tears, and said : " O Charioteer, that virtuous one, wotthy of evety comfort and happiness will now be seeking refuge under a tree. O ! What will be his food ? How will R.ama, the son of King **DASARATHA**, who merits no suffering, who is wotthy of resting on a royal couch, sleep as one orphaned, on the hare earth ? How can that prince, formerly accompanied by soldiers and elephants, and whose chariot was drawn by matchless steeds, now sleep in the lonely forest ? How will R.ama and **SITA** be able to dwell in the forest abounding with pythons and other wild beasts ? O Snmantra, how can the tender and sorrow stricken **SITA** with the two ptinces, abandoning the chariot, walt barefooted in the forest ? O Charioteer, thou an fortunate in that thou hast seen the two ptinces wandering in the forest like the Ashwini Kumaras on the mountain Mandara. O Sumantra, when they entered the forest, what did R.ama say ? What did Labhmans say ? What did **SITA** say ? O O!arioteer, tell me fully of Rams’s dwelling, his sleeping and his eating. thus shall I live a little longer,like King Yayati of old, on heating the words of the sadhus.” Thus questioned by his royal master, Sumantra, his throat choked, his speech broken by sobs, replied : " O Great King, Shri R.ama, the Upholder of

righteousness, reverently joining his palms and bowing his hosd, said : On my command, offer salutations again and again to the mnst praiseworthy sovereign, renowned far and wide in the world as highly virtunus, and to all the men and women of the inner apanment, carry tldiDgs of my welfare with salutations befitting their nllk. Convey the news of my welfare to my mother **KAUSHALYA**, with my deepest respect aDd admonish her not to neglect her duty. Let her practise *dharma* aDd tend the sacrificial pavilion. Say to her : O Goddess, honour the king, my father, as thou wou!dst a God. AhSDdoning fiunily pride and royal prerogative, serve my other mothers attentively. **KAIKEYI** is the king's favourill:, do thou attend to her as to the king himself.' " " O King, **SHRI RAMA** has instructed Prince **BHARATA** thus : Let it be known to the prince, that I am well and instruet him to treat all his mothers with justice. Tell the illustrious Prince **BHARATA** that, though regent, he must continue in obedience to his royal father. The king is far advanced in years, let not Prince **BHARATA** proclaim himself king. Let him obey the king and aet as co-adjutor."' "**SHRI RAMA** charged me with tears, saying : Let **BHARATA** look upon my beloved mother as his own.' The mighty armed and highly illustrious **RAMA** of lotus eyes addressing me thus, wept aloud. "Then Shri **LAKSHMANA** growing wrath and sighing heavily, ssid : What fault has this noble prince committed to be exiled ? Assuredly the king has agreed to the foolish desire of Queen **KAIKEYI**, granting her boons without considering if they were proper or improper, through which we are all involved in misery. If **RAMA** has suft'ered exile to satisfy the stupidity of Queen **KAIKEYI**, then assuredly it is an evil aet. Even if the gods decreed the exile of **RAMA**, I see no reason for it. Aeting with imperfect understanding the king regardless of consequences has banished **RAMA** which will surely cause him untold sufl'ering. I see no parental affection

in the king; to me Shri **RAMACHANDRA** is brother, master, relative and father. The darling of the whole world, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, devoted to the good of all, has been banished, how can the people approve this aet ? Having, in opposition to the will of the people, exiled Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, who is virtuous aDd beloved, how can he claim to he a king? “The sagacions Janaki, O King, stood mute, her eyes fixed aDd vacant, like one possessed by a spirit. That illustrious daughter of Janab, unacquainted with suft’ering, wept with grief aDd was unable to speak. Seeing the countenance of her lord wet with tears, her mouth became parched, aDd gazing at me, the wept bitterly. Thus **SHRI RAMA**, his face drawn with 289 grid, supported by Labbmana, addressed me, seated in the royal cbariot. while the ascetic **SITA** fixed her gaze on me in silence.”

CHAPTER 59

The king bewailing the absence of Rama is drowning in a sea of sorrow

TM kirtg berNiling tlu absenel of Rsma u drttrimittg itt ofrDITt1rll **SUMANTRA** *said*: " O King,!when Sbri!**RAMA** entered the forest, I returned and the weary horses halting, stood still, showing signs of distress. Offering obeisance to the two princes, I mounted the cbariot and restraining my grief, went forward, remaining a few days with Guha, in the hope that **SHRI RAMA** might call me again and take me with him. " O King, tuming homewards, I behold the very filled with distress, their tender shoots, buds and flowers being withered ! The water in the pools and rivers was slowly ebbing away, the leaves in the woods were til11ing and the beasts were motionless, the resdess

elephants no longer wandered here and there. Alllicted by **RAMA**'s separation, the forest had become silent. O King, the waters in the ponds had grown turbid and the lotuses had submerged themselves, being unable to besr the severance from **RAMA**. The fishes and water fowl had deserted their accustomed haunts and the aquatic plants and those that grew on land no longer gave forth their fragrant scents, while their fruits were devoid of taste. Gardens were bereft ofbesuty and birds sat motionless in the woods. " Entering Ayodhya, none appeared to be happy and the citizens beholding the royal cbariot without **RAMA** were perpetu· ally sighing. O Lord, seeing. from a distance, the cbariot retuming without **RAMA**, all were plunged in grief: The womea of the city, from their windows, baiCODies and roo1i, seeing the cbariot without **RAMA**, broke into lamentation. With tears fa11ins from their unpainted eyes, fUll of distress, they withdrew their ., owing to grief. All men together with elephants and horses, join in the suffering and mourning, all are aftlicted in **RAMA**'s separstion I The city of Ayodhya, neglected and wretched, resembles Queen Ksusbalya berd't of her son ! " Hearing these words, the king became agitated and in trembl ing accents addresaed the charioteer : " O Sumantra, deeply penitent am I, that without deliberating with my able counsellors and elders, I granted the boons to the evil-minded Kai1teyi, under the sway of **MANTHARA**. This unpremeditated act was performed by me, inspired by my desire for **KAIKEYI**, without consultation with my friends and ministers. O Sumantra, this great calamity is the result of fate and will destroy the House of Ikshwaku. O Charioteer ! If I have ever done any good to thee, then take me to Shri Ramachandrs soon ; my life is fast ebbing from my body, or do thou go to the forest and cause **RAMA** to return, if he be still obedient to me. If that Mighty One be gone far from here, then take me in the chariot and drive there speedily ; I desire to look on him but once

more. Where is **RAMA**, the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**, whose teeth resemble the water lilies and who is a mighty warrior? If I am to live, I must see that virtuous one. If I do not behold **RAMA** with reddened eyes, wearing beautiful earrings, set with jewels, I shall assuredly perish. O I What can exceed my pain, that, at the moment of death, I am unable to see **RAMA**, the hero of the House of Ikshwaku ? O **RAMA**, O I abbmana, O Patient **SITA**, you do not know that I am dying in bitter anguish." The king, his mind drowned in the sea of sorrow, cried : " O Ksusbalya, that ocean of misery caused by Ramo's separation is fathomlesa, severance from **SITA** arc its shores, deep sighs arc the whirlpools rendered turbid by my tears, the stretching of the arms arc its restless motion, lamentations are the sound of its thunder, dishevelled hair are the weeds, the words of **MANTHARA** arc the crocodiles and Kaileyi is the lire in its deptha, the unscalesble cliffs arc the boons which sent **RAMA** to the foresL Without **RAMA**, I am sinking in this bottomless sea, living, I am mooarcb, bewailing the absence of **RAMA**, swooned away. Hear· ing the king's words, the mOI:I= of **RAMA**, Queen Kausbalya, was seized with fear.

CHAPTER 60

The charioteer attempts to console Queen Kaushalya

QVEBN lying trembling on the ground like one dead or possessed by an evil spirit, now said to the charioteer : " O Sumantra, take me to the place where **RAMA**, Laksbmana and Janaki dwell I Life without them, even for a moment, is vain. Speedily there in thy chariot, either I must follow them or enter the region of death." Shri Sumantra, weeping and

distressed, respectfully sougbt to console the Queen, saying : " O Lady, abandon disquiet, infatuation and anxiety born of grief! **SHRI RAMA** will Jive happily in the forest I Prince Laksbmana, self-subdued, serving **RAMA** and living in accordance with virtue will fashion for himself an auspicious future. In the solitary forest, Shri **SITA**, her mind wholly centered on **RAMA** in devotion, will live without fear, as in her own home. I see no lack of courage in Princess **SITA**, it would appear that she was bom to reside in a land. As in former daya, she enjoyed the parks and gardens, so does she now enjoy the uninhabited forest. **SITA**, whose countenance resembles the full moon, her mind absorbed in **RAMA**, depending on him, sports in the forest ; with her heart and mind centred on him, she would hold this great capital no better than a wilderness without **RAMA**. Walking in the forest, seeing the. villages, rivers, towns and various kinds of trees, she enquires of **RAMA** conceming their history and origin. To her, the forest is a pleasure garden in the Deighbourhood of Ayodhya. This I remember of **SITA**, but what she said of Kaikcyi now slips my mind." Sumantra, cardully withholding the refera1ce to Kaikcyi which had escaped from him througb inadvertence and in order to propitiate Queen Kausbalya, addressed her further, saying : " The lustre of the filce of JBDBki is not marred by the fatigue of the journey or the winds or through fear of dangerous beasts or through the heat of the sun. The countenance of the Princess, resembliug the full moon is not impaired by residence in the forest. Her feet, no longer painted with vermilion, appear as fresh as lotuses. The princess ever exceedingly devoted to **RAMA**, has not put oft' her ornaments, but with her tinkling anklets trips happily along, causing the very swans to envy her. Depending on the power of **SHRI RAMA**, she suffers no fear at the sight of a lion or tiger in the forest. O Lady, there is no cause for grief fur these three or fur the king or thyself. The self-imposed exile of

SHRI RAMA, in obedieJU:e to his father's command, will remain a subject fur veneration to the whole world, as long as the sun aod moon abide. Having baoished sorrow, **SHRI RAMA** pursuing the psth trodden by the sages, living on fruits and berries, ful1ils the beheat of his sire." Though consoled by the charioteer, Queen Kausbalya, torn with grief, in the separation from her son, cried out : " O My Darling, O My Son, O **RAMA**," and continued to weep.

CHAPTER 61

Queen Kaushalya reproaches the king

TRB ¥irtuous **RAMA**, the upholder of *dharma*, having depsrted, Queen Kausbalya weeping bitterly, addressed her royal consort : " O King, Thy fair name is known throughout the three worlds ; thou art esteemed compassionate, charitable and of gentle speech. Yet, O Great One, tell me, how will thy two sons, brought up in ease together with **SITA**, be able to endure the forest life ? How will the young and tender **SITA**, worthy of happiness, endure heat and cold ? How will that large-eyed primess, who lived on dishes prepared by skilful cooks, sustain life on the wild lentils of the forest ? How will she, accustomed 293 to the sweet strains of music, be able to bear the roaring of man-eating lions ? How will the two mighty princes, whose arms resemble the rainbow, sleep on the ground, pillowing their heads on their arms. O When will I again behold the lotus filce of **RAMA**, framed in beautiful locks, whose eyes are like the water-lily and whose breath is fragrant as the nymphoea ? Surely my heart must be as hard as a diamond that it does not break into a thousand pieces, beteft of **RAMA**. O King, in banishing thy children, thou hast been merciless. Worthy of every comfort, they are

now wandering aimlessly in the forest. Should **RAMA** return, after fuutteen years, will Prince **BHARATA** the kingdom and the treasure to him ? If those inviting the pious and learned *brahmins* to the funeral sacrifice, first serve their poor and deserving relations and subsequently the *brahmins* these will not accept the food of that sacrifice, renouncing it like wine. The learned *brahmins* regard it as a mark of disrespect to be served even with that in which other *brahmins* have already participated, which is like a bull shorn of its horns, of lesser worth. O Master of thy People, will not **RAMA** even thus disdain the kingdom enjoyed by his younger and un deserving brother ? A lion will not eat the food killed by another, neither will **RAMA** accept that which has already been enjoyed by others. As the libations, butter, kusha grass and pillars employed in the sacrifice, are not used again, so will **RAMA** not accept a kingdom which resembles a sacrifice without *soma*. **SHRI RAMA** will never su1fer this indignity, as a lion will not sulfer the twisting of its tail. Do not all fear **RAMA** as he appears on the battlefield ? He, himself; is righteous, indicating the path of virtue to others, never will he seize the kingdom by force I Is not the mighty-armed **RAMA** with his golden shafts, able to destroy all living beings and dry up the sea ? Yet to-day, that **RAMA**, powerfUl as a lion, is rendered impotent at the king's command, as the spawn of fishes is devoured by their parents ? O King, hadst thou regarded the scriptures and the eternal laws, observed and inculcated by the learned sages, thy virtuous son had not been csiled by thee. O Lord, the first support of a woman is her husband, the ICCDDd is her son, the third her relatives, but a fourth she has not I Thou hast ceased to regard me as thine, thou hast banished my son **RAMA**, and I may not follow him and leave thee desolate. O Lord, thou hast destroyed me utterly ! O King, thou hast brought disaster on thy counsellors, the whole kingdom, the ministers and thyself, and I with my son and all the citizens of

Ayodhya are utterly ruined.” Hearing the bitter reproaches ofhis consort, the king, reftecting on the cause of this calamity, overwhelmed with grief, fell senseless, drowned in the aea of sorrow.

CHAPTER 62

The king is overcome with grief

Regaining consciousness, he sighed heavily and began to ponder within himsel£ He then remembered how, formerly, he had slain a young ascetic inadvertently by a sound-directed artow, in the forest. The monarch was now subject to a dual cause of grief, the recollection ofbis former evil deed and his banishment of **RAMA**. Thus a111icted, with bowed head, the king addressed the queen in faltering tones : " O **KAUSHALYA**, ever compassionate to thine enemies, I entreat thee, with joined palms, not to look on me with hostility. O Lady, to the wife, the husband is a deity be he virtuous or worthless, this is the eternal law. I know thee to be wise and acquainted with what is proper and improper, it is not meet that thou shouldst utter these wounding words.” Hearing this plaintive speech, tesrs welled from the eyes of the queen like falling rain and taking his hands in hers, she addressed the king, saying : " O Lord, do not grieve, be at peace, see, I lay my head at thy feet, do not entreat me, it is as death to me I I have spoken what ought not to be uttered, pardon my transgression I Thar woman is not nobly bred, who eKpect8 THB li.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI her lord to solicit her with humble words. O Sire, I am acquainted with a woman’s duty and I know thee to be a lover of virtue. What I have said was uttered involuntarily through distress on account of my son. Grief destroys patience, grief destroys the understanding, there is nothing more destructive than grief I

The blow of an unknown enemy may be endured but the distress arising from grief is not easily borne, even with resigllation. This is only the fifth night since the exile of llama but to me they are as live years. Sorrow has driven away every joy from my breast and because of llama my pain increases, agitating my heart as the of a swiftly ftowing river disturb the ocean.” Wbile the queen was yet speaking, the sun declined and the night fell. Consoled by the words of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the king, wearied with grief, sank into slumber. CBAPTBR 63 He rllllh jtmflll’ svil tlud rDhicJJ is the of hit preunt distress A hour ba-ring passed, the king awoke and was overcome with distress. He began to ponder deeply, but his mind was clouded with grief and though equal to lndra, death threatened to seize him as Rahu’ seizes the sun. The sixth night after llama’s exile, the king again remembered his former evil deed and agitated by the recollection of his sin, he addressed the Queen **KAUSHALYA** : " O Kalyani, O Auspicinus One, whatever man does, be it good or evil, he gathers the fruit thereof. He is deemed ignorant who does not consider the merit or demerit of his actions before performing them. O Queen, he, who, enjoying the red flowers of the palass tree, cuts down

CHAPTER 63

He recalls a former evil deed which is the cause of his present distress

THB li.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI her lord to solicit her with humble words. O Sire, I am acquainted with a woman’s duty and I know thee to be a lover of virtue. What I have said was uttered involuntarily through distress on account of my son. Grief destroys patience, grief destroys the

understanding, there is nothing more destructive than grief I The blow of an unknown enemy may be endured but the distress arising from grief is not easily borne, even with resigllation. This is only the fifth night since the exile of llama but to me they are as live years. Sorrow has driven away every joy from my breast and because of llama my pain increases, agitating my heart as the of a swiftly ftowing river disturb the ocean." Wbile the queen was yet speaking, the sun declined and the night fell. Consoled by the words of Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the king, wearied with grief, sank into slumber. CBAPTBR 63 He rllllh jtmflll' svil tlud rDhicJJ is the of hit preunt distress A hour ba-ring passed, the king awoke and was overcome with distress. He began to ponder deeply, but his mind was clouded with grief and though equal to lndra, death threatened to seize him as Rahu' seizes the sun. The sixth night after llama's exile, the king again remembered his former evil deed and agitated by the recollection of his sin, he addressed the Queen **KAUSHALYA** : " O Kalyani, O Auspicinus One, whatever man does, be it good or evil, he gathers the fruit thereof. He is deemed ignorant who does not consider the merit or demerit of his actions before performing them. O Queen, he, who, enjoying the red flowers of the palass tree, cuts down who, heedless of the coosequences, enters into action, will in the end repent like the man who waters the palasa tree. "O Lady, I have cut down the mango ttee and wateted the palasa tree, now, when the fruit is ripe, I too, having banished **RAMA**, repent bitterly. O **KAUSHALYA**, in ordet to be esteemed as an archer, in my youth, I directed my arrows by sound alone, and a grievous deed was committed by me. I am the cause of this present distress. O Queen, as a child swallows poison in ignotance, so have I destroyed my happiness by this deed fotmetly committed in ignorance. As one beguiled by the beauty of the palasa llower, waters it in ezpectation of the sweet fruit (*of the mango*) so did I

cultivate the fruit I reap, by shooting at a sound. O Lady, in those days we were not united in marriage and I was heir-apparent. “At that time, the rainy season being near, the increase of desire having come, the sun drying up the earth, scorching the world with its rays, enteted the southern path. Then the heat subsided and refreshing clouds covered the sky, delighting the pescocks, the frogs and the swallows. The birds drenched with the rain, passed the night in disttess, tossed to and fro on the ttees by the humid winds. The limpid watet in the stteams dark and turgid from deposits of the mountain soD, llowed onwards sluggishly. " In that delightfUl season, taking my bow and arrows in my chariot, I came to the hank of the river Sarayu, desiring to hunt. Taking my stand at a ford, where bulFaloes, elephants and tigers came at night to drink, I heard the sound as of a pitcher being filled with watet in the darknesa. Seeing nought and deeming it to be the sound of an elephant. I took from my quiver an arrow dipped in the poison of a snake and discharged it whence the sound came. Having discharged the keen and poisoned shaft, I heard the voice of a youth crying out, and he, pierced in the side, fcll exclaimiDg ' Who has shot an ascetic who has no enemy in the whole world ? Desirous of drawing water, I came here in the dead of night. What harm had I done to him who has amitten me ? Why should I, who live on the amch of his Guru is considered an abandoned pers011, so he who has wnmgfully smitten me, cannot be a virtuous man. I do not grieve for the loss of my own life, but for wbat will befall my parents, when I die I To what condition will they be brought on my death, that aged pair so long supported by me ? My mother, my father and I have been killed by a single artow I By what foolish man have we all been slain ? ' " O **KAUSHALYA**, I, ever desirous of acquiring virtue and eschewing what was evil, hearing this sad complaint, became exceedingly distressed and the bow fell from my hands. The lament of

the sage caused me the deepest affiiction and over whelmed with grief I advanced to where he lay, wounded by my There I beheld him lying on the ground, his hair dishevelled, his body besmeared with blood and dust, the water flowing from his loshtawhich lay at some distance from him. Seeing me standing there dismayed, he fixed me with his gaze as if he would consume me, and said : ' O King, what harm have I, a dwellcr in the forest, done to thee, that thou hast wounded me while fetching water from the river for my aged parents ? Thou hast infiicted a mortal wouod by thine arrow and have in this wise slain my mother and father also, who weak. aged and blind and the victims of exceeding thirst, await my return. AlBicted with thirst, they are watching for my rerum. Alas ! what fruit have I earned by the practice of penance and the hearing of the Veda and Puranas' since my father does not know that I am lying mortally wounded here ? Yet if he knew, what could he do, since he is blind and a cripple ? As a tree cut down cannot support another, so my parents blind and crippled cannot assist me. O King, go speedily to my father and inform him of my plight. I fear lest he curse thee and consume thee as a lire bums np wood I O King, the path beheld by thee leads to my parents' hut. Do thou go there and propitiate them. O King, that they may not wax wrath and curse thee. O King, free my side from this shaft ; this arrow penetrating my body resembles a river that washes away the long and aandy bank. " O Lady, I ldlected that as long as the arrow remained fixed he would not die, though suffering great paiD. but should I extract it, he would certainly perish. The son of the *muni*, seeiog me atllicted and reading my thoughts addressed me in great agony and said: ' O King, though in anguish and confused, my body quivering with pain and about to die, yet I am able to control my diatress and am at peace. Dismiss thy fears, O King, though thy sin is grievous, thou hast not slain a *brahmin*. O King, I am bom of a shndra

mother and a vaishya father.' “As he was speaking, his eyes rolling, his face blanched, struggling and quivering on the earth, I withdrew the arrow and he, looking up in agony, yielded up his breath. " O Queen, deeply atllicted, I beheld that treasury of truth, lamenting, his body bathed in sweat, in the act of giving up his life.”

CHAPTER 64

Overcome by grief the king yields up his life

" **O KAUSHALYA**, having unwittingly committed this impious deed, I, deeply distressed, ldlected what could now be done and decided to seek out the parents and propitiate them. Taking the pitcher, 1illed with water, I bore it to the ascetic’s hermitage and there beheld his mother and father, aged and feeble, seated together, like two birds bereft of their wings. Motionless, deprived by me of their support, they sat, conversing of their son and awaiting the water. My mind was clouded with grief and I was smitten with fear, but seeing the aged pair, my anguish was increased a thousandfold. " Hearing the sound of my steps, the father spoke : ' O My .. Son, why hast thou delayed so long ? Give me water speedily, O Child, why hast thou been diverting thyself in the water ? Come quicldy into the hermitage, thy mother is exceedingly anxious. O My Son, if aught thy mother has done has displeased thee, it behoves thee to forget it. Thou art our only support who are blind and crippled ; thou an our very eyes, our lives are depeudent on thee, why dost thou not speak to us ? " Beholding the *muni*, and as one sorely dismayed, I uttered inarticulate Wotds, then by force of will, cootrolling my speech, I related to him the whole misfonune. Slowly, I narrated to the sage the distressing fate that had befallen his son and said : O Mahatma, I am not

thy son, my name is Dasarstha and I am a kshattiya. A sinful act has been committed by me of wbich I now repent. O Lord, armed with bow and arrow I came to the bank of the Sarayu to hunt the elephant, tiger or lion, that might come there to drink. Heating the sound of a pitcher being filled with water and supposing it to be an elephant, I discharged an arrow and coming to the bank of the river beheld an ascetic lying on the ground pierced to the heart by my weapon. O Lord, having mistaken thy son, who had gone to seek water, for an elephant, I slew him by an arrow discharged on heating that sound On his entresty I extracted the arrow from his heart causing him pain and he left this life lamenting for his blind parents. Thy son was suddenly and unknowingly slain by me without design ; what was to happen, has been accomplished Thou art a sage, now do what thou cnnsiderest proper. " Heating the tale of my evil deed from my own lips, the sage reftained from pronouncing a curse on me. His eyes suffused with tears and his heart distressed, he addressed me who supplicated him with joined palms, saying : O King, if thou thyself had’st not coofessed this evil deed to me, thy head had instantly split into a thousand pieces by my curse. O King, the killing of one dwelling in the forest by a *kshatriya* causes him to lose his status, even if he be Indrs. If anyone knowingly anacks a sage or spiritual preceptor with a weapon, his head is severed into seven pieces. Thou livest still, since the deed was done by thee without design, else hadst thou and the whole House of Raghu perished.' " O **KAUSHALYA**, the sage said : ' Take me to the place where the body of my son is lying, I wish to acquaint myself with his final state. Alas ! Under the decree of destiny he is lying lifeless on the earth. his body besmeared with blood, stripped of the deerskin formerly worn by him.' " O **KAUSHALYA**, taking the deeply distressed sage and his wife to that place, they, with their fingers touched the lifeless body of their son. Approaching the place, they

embraced the dead body of their child, the father crying : ' O Child, thou art to-day not bidding us welcome, nor dost thou speak to me. Why art thou lyiug on the earth. art thou displeased? O My Son, if thou art angry with me, regard thy virtuous mother. Why dost thou not embrace me and speak tender words to me ? Now that balf the night has gone, who will read the Scriptures and Puranas in gende accents to me ? O My Son, who will perform our morning ablutions and after offering up his morning devotions, serve and console us? Helpless and destitute, who will gather roots, berries and fruits for me in the forest, and feed me, like a beloved guest ? O My Son, how shall I nourish and support thy mother, blind, ascetic and devoted to her son? O My Child, stay, stay, do not yet enter the abode of **YAMA**. To-morrowthymotherandlwill accompany thee. Without thee we are distressed, helpless and bereft of support, we will accom pany thee to the abode ofYama. Beholding the Lord of Death, we shall say to him, “Forgive our transgressions of the past which have caused us to be separated from our son and let him yet be our support. Grant us this blessing, O Lord of Death, and make us free from fear. Thou art just and the renowned protector of thy res1m? O My Son, thou art innocent and hast been slain by a sinful man, therefore, by the power of truth, enter thon the abode of heroes. Go, my son to that high state attained by those who follow truth and suffer death at the hands of their foes, without retreating. Go to that high region Dhundhumara.Thatslate attained by those versed in the Veda and practising austerity, be thine. That slate, O My Son, of those who attend the sacred fire, of those highly generous persons who IDllklo gifts of land in charity, may that slate acquired by those who give thousands of cows in charity and serve theit Guru single mindedly, or those courting death by fire in medilation, be thine. None born of thy family has ever descended to a lower slate but he who has slain our son shall end in

misery ".' " Thus for a long time wsiling in distress, the aged parents began to offer ceremonial water for their dead son. The son of that sage by virtue of his meritorious deeds ascending to heaven in a celestial form, in the companyoflndra addresaed his parents with consoling words, saying : ' By virtue of my servicea to you, I have oblained this slate, you, too, will soon join me here.' Thereafter, that self-conrrolled ascetic ascended to heaven in an aerial chariot. O Lady, that great sage with his wife performing the water ritual, said to me slanding near with joined palms : ' O King, now put an end to my life also, I shall fed no grief in dying. This was my only son and by slaying him thou hast rendered me childless. As he was slain by thee, I pronounce a curse on thee. Mayest thou suffer the the same grief that thou hast caused to me, through separation from thy son, ending in thy death. O King, having slain the sage unknowingly, the guilt of killing a *brahmin* will not be thine. As the dispenser of charity receives the merit of those gifts, so wilt thou su1fer in the degree of the suffering thou hast caused me, putting an end to thy life.' " O Queen, having cursed me, they lamented for some time and then gathering wood, kindled a fire, and entering it, departed this life. O Lady, to-day recalling that evil deed, committed thoughtlessly in my youth, by discharging the arrow by sound, the fruit of my action has overtaken me, as illness follows the partaking of unwholesome food. O Noble Lady, the time of the fullilment of the sage's cnrse has come." Having said this, the king weeping and overcome with fear on the approach of death, spoke again : " O **KAUSHALYA**, I am tide KiuJ about to yield up my life through grief for my son, I am unable to see thee, do thou draw near and touch me. Those about to enter the abode of death distinguish nought. If **RAMA** could but touch me for an instant, or receive my wealth and the regency, I might yet live. O Auspicious Lady, I have not dealt justly with **RAMA**, but

what he has done to me is right. What thoughtful man would abandon even a sinfUl son ? But what son, sent into exile will not think ill of his father ? O **KAUSHALYA**, I no longer behold thee, my memory is also fading. O Queen, the messengers of death call on me to depart ; what aftliction is greater than this, that at the hour of death I do not behold the virtuous **RAMA**, the hero of troth ? The grief caused by the absence of my son, who never opposed my wishes, dries up my life as heat dries up water. They are not men, they are gods, who will look on that lovely countenance of lotus eyes and charming features after fourteen years ! Blessed are those who will behold the face ofRama resembling the full moon, returning to Ayodbya. Fortunate are they who will behold **RAMA** in the capital like the planet Shukra,' completing its course in the heavens. O **KAUSHALYA**, my heart is breaking, I have lost the sense of touch, taste and sound. When the mind apirea, the senses are atinguished as the llame of a lamp subsides when the oil is consumed. O Grief, thou art deatroying me and carrying away my life as a river bears away the banks by its force I O Prince, O Mighty Hero, O Sole Remover of my pain, O Darling of Thy Sire, O My Master, My Son, where art thou ? O Kauahalya, O V'lttUODI Snmitra, I depart ! O My Cruel Enemy **KAIKEYI**, destroyer of my family's felicity." Thus lamenting, the king died in the preaence of **RAMA**'s mother and the Queen Snmina. Overborne by the grief caused by the aile of his son, that generGIIS and mighty king, at midDight, yielded up his life.

CHAPTER 65

The palace is filled with the sound of distress

THE night having passed, at dawn, according to custom, the bards arrived at the palace of the king, the traditional singers, those versed in rhetoric and in the history of the dynasty, and skilled musicians acquainted with rhythm and melody, began to sing the praises of the king. The sound of their eulogies and their songs filled the whole palace. Others uttering tributes and clapping their bands recited the monarch's wonderful deeds. The birds in the trees near the palace and those confined in cages awoke and sang. Their notes mingled with the salutations of the *brahmins*, the music of the vinas, the chanting of the holy names of God and the praises of those describing the great deeds of the king. Eunuchs and servants stood near, ready to serve, as was their wont. Those who attended to the ablutions of the king, brought water scented with fragrant perfumes, in pitchers of gold. Charming and well-attired men and women came with oil, unguents, mirrors, combs, towels and other articles and all that was needed by the king was provided according to custom. Till sunrise, all awaited the king, then they addressed each other saying : " How is this, has his majesty not yet risen ? " Then the women, other than **KAUSHALYA**, who formerly attended on the king, began to waken their lord as was their usage. Having with affecrion and skill touched the body of the monarch, they found no sign of life in him. Then the women, knowing well the motion of the pulse and understanding the signs of sleep, began to tremble perceiving the king's condition. Fearing that the king no longer breathed, they shook like the narcai grass in the midst of a flowing stream, and slowly became aware that their sovereign had passed away. The Queens, **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**, overcome with grief on account of the depanurc of their sons, lay as if dead. Sutfering had rendered the chief queen pale and her body feeble. The two queens, their splendour dimmed by sorrow, resembled the stars hidden by clouds.

Seeing the two queeas lying insensible and the king dead. the women wept aloud in distress. At the loud wailing of the attendant women, like female elephants betcft: of their leadet, **KAUSHALYA** and Sumitta came to themselves. Touching the body of the king and finding it cold, they fell senseless, crying: " O, My Lord," " O, My Lord." Lying oo the earth, coveted with dust, Queen **KAUSHALYA** resembled a fallen from the skies. The king being dead, the ladies of the inner apartments beheld the queen lying oo the ground lib a female naga.' The other consorts of the king with Kaibyi, overcome with grief, fell uncooscious to the earth. The wailing of the women within, and those who now fOllowed them, filled the whole place. The royal dwelling, bereft of joy and filled with the sound of disttess, was thronged with a1l1icted relatives and friends mouming and weeping. The queens stricken with grief, lamenting piteously, lib orphans cleaving to their departed parent. clasped the arms of the mighty monarch. CHAPTBR 66 Ths inhabitimU 11/ AJIOIh.ya mourn for tMir lord placed the head of the dead king, resembling an extinguished fire or a waterless ocean or the sun without lustre, on her lap and oppresaed with grief, thus addressed Kaibyi : " O Kaibyi, thy ambition is fiillilled, now rule without further opposition. Having abanclooed the king, enjoy the kingdom with thy son, O Thon of Evil Conduct I **RAMA** having departed and the king also, I resemble a traveller on a dangerous and difllcult path betcft: of his companions. There is no further joy in life fur me I Alas I what woman betcft: of her lord. her deity, desires to continue to live ? Kaibyi alone is such a one, having ahandoned all virtue. The greedy disregard the con· sequences of their acts, like a hungry man devouring poisonous ... _. .....

CHAPTER 66

The inhabitants of Ayodhya mourn for their lord

Seeing the two queeas lying insensible and the king dead. the women wept aloud in distress. At the loud wailing of the attendant women, like female elephants betcft: of their leadet, **KAUSHALYA** and Sumitta came to themselves. Touching the body of the king and finding it cold, they fell senseless, crying: " O, My Lord," " O, My Lord." Lying oo the earth, coveted with dust, Queen **KAUSHALYA** resembled a fallen from the skies. The king being dead, the ladies of the inner apartments beheld the queen lying oo the ground lib a female naga.' The other consorts of the king with Kaibyi, overcome with grief, fell uncooscious to the earth. The wailing of the women within, and those who now fOllowed them, filled the whole place. The royal dwelling, bereft of joy and filled with the sound of disttess, was thronged with a1l1icted relatives and friends mouming and weeping. The queens stricken with grief, lamenting piteously, lib orphans cleaving to their departed parent. clasped the arms of the mighty monarch. CHAPTBR 66 Ths inhabitimU 11/ AJIOIh.ya mourn for tMir lord placed the head of the dead king, resembling an extinguished fire or a waterless ocean or the sun without lustre, on her lap and oppresaed with grief, thus addressed Kaibyi : " O Kaibyi, thy ambition is fiillilled, now rule without further opposition. Having abanclooed the king, enjoy the kingdom with thy son, O Thon of Evil Conduct I **RAMA** having departed and the king also, I resemble a traveller on a dangerous and difllcult path betcft: of his companions. There is no further joy in life fur me I Alas I what woman betcft: of her lord. her deity, desires to continue to live ? Kaibyi alone is such a one, having ahandoned all virtue. The greedy disregard the con· sequences of

their acts, like a hungry man devouring poisonous ... _. ..... food without consideriDg its elfects. Alas I **KAIKEYI** bas destroyed the dynasty of Raghu at the instigation of a hunch backed woman! How bitterly will King Janab mourn, on hearing that Kiog **DASARATHA**, urged by **KAIKEYI**, baa exiled **RAMA** The friends aDd relatives of the monarch taking COUIISel together, beiDg unwilling to cremate the body of the king, in the absence of his scm, laid it, therefore, in a vessel of oil. The king beiDg dead, the inhabitants of the city filled the streets aDd mouroiog for their lord, causing Ayodhya to resemble the JUght bereft of stars. Men and women gathered

CHAPTER 67

The elders recommend at a member of the house of Ikshwaku be appointed king

The friends aDd relatives of the monarch taking COUIISel together, beiDg unwilling to cremate the body of the king, in the absence of his scm, laid it, therefore, in a vessel of oil. The king beiDg dead, the inhabitants of the city filled the streets aDd mouroiog for their lord, causing Ayodhya to resemble the JUght bereft of stars. Men and women gathered are assemblies, nor do the people visit plessant parts and gardons or build temples and homes of rest. In such a land, the self-controlled *brahmins* offer sacrifice nor do those of pious vows, assist them in the sacred rite. In a rulerless land, the *brahmins* do not receive their due share of the aacrificial fees ; neither do actorS nor lesders of song or dance lind joy in such a land. The holy festivals promoting the land’s prosperity are no longer held, nor do those reciting the holy tradition give satisfiution to their hearers. In a rulerless land,

virgins adorned with golden ornaments, do not frequent the 1lower gardens at close of day, nor do the devotees of plessure, riding swift chariots in company with charming damsels, repair to the forest. In such a land, the weslthy are not protected, nor does the husbandman, the cowherd and the shepherd sleep at ease with open doors. In a rulerless land, grest elephants of sixty years of age do not wander on the royal highways adorned with tinliling bells. The twanging of the archer's bow is longer hesrd, nor do the merchants travelling the rosds in security bting their goods to sell from distant lands. In a rulerless land, the self-controlled ssge, fixing his mind, in contemplation, on his identity with the all-pervading spirit, receives no hospitality when night falls. Wealth is not unassailable, nor are man's needs supplied, the armies have no lesders, nor can they match the enemy in war. In a rulerless country, man, gorgeously apparelled, riding in an cxcellent chariot, drawn by swift steeds, can go forth without fear ; nor can the learned disputant propound his doctrines in the city or forest. In such a land, garlands and sweetmeats, alms or other gifts, are not ofFered by worshippers as a sacrifice, nor in the springtime, do the princes, like blossoming trees, adorned with sandalwood and ambergris, walk abroad. A kingdom without a sovereign is like a river without water, a forest without vegetation, or a cow without a keeper. As a chariot is known by its standard, as a fire is indicaud by BDillke, so the king, a light representing the kingdom, has been eztingoished. No man loves his own kind in a rulerless land, but each slays and devours the other. Atheists and materialists, exceeding the limits of their caste. assume dominion over others, there being no king to exercise control over them. As the eyes CODtinuously point out what 3o8 is dangerous to the body, promoting its welfare, so the king ever regards the advantage of his people, promoting truth and ethical conduct. The king leads his people

in the psth of righteousness and guides them in integrity, he is the parent of his subjects and the greatest of benefactors. In the psth

CHAPTER 68

Messengers are sent to Prince Bharata

is dangerous to the body, promoting its welfare, so the king ever regards the advantage of his people, promoting truth and ethical conduct. The king leads his people in the psth of righteousness and guides them in integrity, he is the parent of his subjects and the greatest of benefactors. In the psth The messengers received the commands of Shri **VASISHTHA** and taking provision for the journey went to their own houses. Then mounting swift horses, accustomed to prolonged travel, they started for the kingdom of Kaikeya. Having taken leave of the holy Guru, equipped with provisions, they departed in haste. Their counc, along the bank of the Maliui, lay south bctwccn the Uparathala mountain and north of Pralamba. They crossed the sscred Ganges st Hsstinapura and proceeded westward arriving in Panchals (*the Punjab*) by way of Kuru Jangula. On the way, they beheld many lakes filled with limpid water and translucent streams and passing speedily onwards, reached the river Sharadanda, full of pure water and frequented by many species of waterfowl. On the bank of that river grew the sacred ttcc Satyapayachan, to which the messengers made obeisance and then entered the city of Kalinga. Passing through the village of Abikala, they crossed the river lbhumati issuing from the mountsin Bodbi bhavana, a tcrritoryfonncrly belonging to the House ofiksbwaku. There themessengcrsd!ank the water of the river from the palms of their hands and CI1COUI1tcred certain *brahmins* versed in the Veda. Traversing the land of Vahlib, they

descried the mountain Sudamana which bore the marks of the Feet of **VISHNU**, and duly worshipped it. They beheld the riven Vipasha and Shalmali and many pools, lakes and reservoirs. Proceeding further on their journey, according to the instructions of their master, they saw lioDB, tigers, elephants and various other beasts. After a long period, the horses became fatigued, but the messengers pressed on to the town of Giribraja in the kingdom of Kaikeya. For the sake of performing the will of their lord and to preserve the royal dynasty and the honour of the House of Dassratha. without reluing their pace, the messengers entered the city at uightfilll.

CHAPTER 69

Prince Bharata's inauspicious dream

ON the night the messengers reached the city, Prince **BHARATA** had a most inauspicious dream. Seeing that evil dream, the son of the emperor, when the night ended, was much distressed. His intimate friends, the compaDions of his own age, seeing him in distress, spoke pleasing words in the assembly and related humorous traditions to distraCt his mind. Some played on vinas for his entertainment, others danced, acted and narrated stories. Despite the endeavours of his amiable companions, Prince **BHARATA** remained melancholy. At length, they addressed him, saying : " O Friend, we have tried in vain to entertain thee, why dost thou not smile ? " **BHARATA** *replied*: " Hear the cause of my sadness. In a dream, I saw my father in faded apparel, his hair dishevelled, falling from a mountain peak into a pit of cow dung. There, I saw that great king, wallowing lilte a frog and drinking oil from the palms of his hands ; afterwards, I behdd him eating rice mixed with sesamum seed, his body

besmeared with oil, he being immersed in it. Again, in that dream, I saw the sea dry up and the moon fall on the earth and the world plunged in darkness. The tusks of the royal dephants were broken in pieces and a blazing fire was suddenly extinguished. I saw the earth rent and the leaves of the trees wither and the mountains riven and emit smoke. I behdd the king on an iron seat, clad in black and women attired in black and yellow mocking him. That virtuous king, adorned with sandalwood paste, wearing garlands of red flowers, seated in a chariot drawn by asaes went southwards. I saw a female demon of monstrous shape clothed in red deriding the king. This fearful vision has been seen by me. Either mysdf or **RAMA** or the king or Lablunana will aurdy die. When, in a dream, one is seen riding in a chariot drawn by asses, the smoke of his funeta1 pyte will soon ascend. On this aaounr. I am distraught, nought gives me joy, my throat is choted and my mind confused. THE RA.M.AYANA OF VAL.M.IKI or breathe, my body has lost illl power, I am agitated and cannot control my distress. Never have I seen so threatening a dream I Reflecting on it. I am pertUrbed, fear has taken possession of my bean and I know not if I shall ever again bebold the king." CHAPTBB 70 TM msssag1 is tlidifJmd; Bluzrata and Shalrrl6hna l44fll the palace WEDLB **BHARATA** was !dating his dream, the messengers from Ayodhya, overcome with weariness, entered the city of *Raja* grahapura within the impassable moat. Having approached the KiDg of:Kaikeya and the heir-apparent, Prince Yudbajita, and being received by them with due bospital ity, they addressed Prince **BHARATA** saying : " The chief priest. Sbri **VASISHTHA** and his counsellors send their greetings I Return speedily to Ayodhya, an urgent matter awailll thy attention there. O Great Prince, taking these precious robes and jewelled sent to thee, present them to thy maternal uncle." Shri **BHARATA**, accepting the gifts offered them to his maternal uncle with

great affection, then making provision for the messengers and entertaiDing them duly, he afterwards said to them : " O .Messengers, is my father the king well ? Is the great **RAMACHANDRA** well, and my brother Prince Labhmana ? Is the Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the upholder of dhatma, in good heslth? She who is virtuous and a patron of *brahmins*, who is ever to be worshipped, who is wise and the ehief queen ? Is the second of my father's queens, **SUMITRA** the mother of Lakshmn and Shatrugbna, well ? And my mother :Kailreyi, self-willed, given to anger, arrogant and accounting herself wise, is it well with her ? What message has she sent to me ? " The messengers thus addressed by Prince **BHARATA**, answered with respect : " O Lion among Men, those whose welfare is dear to thee, are well. Prosperity awaib thee, therefore, summon thy chariot."

CHAPTER 70

The message is delivered, Bharata and Shatrughna leave the palace

THE RA.M.AYANA OF VAL.M.IKI or breathe, my body has lost illl power, I am agitated and cannot control my distress. Never have I seen so threatening a dream I Reflecting on it. I am pertUrbed, fear has taken possession of my bean and I know not if I shall ever again bebold the king." CHAPTBB 70 TM msssag1 is tlidifJmd; Bluzrata and Shalrrl6hna l44fll the palace WEDLB **BHARATA** was !dating his dream, the messengers from Ayodhya, overcome with weariness, entered the city of *Raja* grahapura within the impassable moat. Having approached the KiDg of:Kaikeya and the heir-apparent, Prince Yudbajita, and being received by them with due bospital ity, they addressed Prince **BHARATA**

saying : " The chief priest. Sbri **VASISHTHA** and his counsellors send their greetings I Return speedily to Ayodhya, an urgent matter awailll thy attention there. O Great Prince, taking these precious robes and jewelled sent to thee, present them to thy maternal uncle." Shri **BHARATA**, accepting the gifts offered them to his maternal uncle with great affection, then making provision for the messengers and entertaiDing them duly, he afterwards said to them : " O .Messengers, is my father the king well ? Is the great **RAMACHANDRA** well, and my brother Prince Labhmana ? Is the Queen **KAUSHALYA**, the upholder of dhatma, in good heslth? She who is virtuous and a patron of *brahmins*, who is ever to be worshipped, who is wise and the ehief queen ? Is the second of my father's queens, **SUMITRA** the mother of Lakshmn and Shatrugbna, well ? And my mother :Kailreyi, self-willed, given to anger, arrogant and accounting herself wise, is it well with her ? What message has she sent to me ? " The messengers thus addressed by Prince **BHARATA**, answered with respect : " O Lion among Men, those whose welfare is dear to thee, are well. Prosperity awaib thee, therefore, summon thy chariot." **PRINCE BHARATA** *said*: " I will seck permission of the king to depart and inform him I must go without delay." Thus, dismissing the messeogen, Prince **BHARATA** approached his grandtinbet and aaid : " Your MajetY, urged by the messcngas, I wish to return to my fathet in haste, I will come again, when thou m pleased to call me." King Kaikeya smeWng the head of the prince, addressed him in comfortable wotds, saying : " O **BHARATA**, **KAIKEYI** is blessed in thee, a virtuous son I Carry my greetings to thy mothet and father. Salute also the holy Sage Vasisbtha, and the wise and pious *brahmins* in my and greet the mighty warriors **RAMA** and Labhmana." King Kaikeya, thea, bidding **BHARATA** farewell, commending him, gave him great dephants and ptecious shawls, woollen cloths and deerskins. He gave him also

with great venera tion, much wealth, two thousand necklaces, coral and gold ornaments and sixteen hundred CKCdlent horses. He sent also wise and trustworthy counsellots to attend him. Then Ptince Yudhajita gave **BHARATA** two stately dephants named Itavata and Indtasibra and many mules to ttanspott his gifts. His uncle gave him also cettaiD fietce dogs, bted in the palsce with large teeth equalling tigers in strength. Shri **BHARATA** pnised the gifts CODferred on him and sought pennission to leave without dday. His heatt was heavy on account of his fearful dream and the urgency of the messengets. The ptince came forth from the inner aputments of the palsce and, surrounded by dephants and horses, stood on the royal highway. Entering the ldng's apartment. unchallenged, Shri **BHARATA** bade fatewdl to aD, then mounting his chariot with Prince Sbatrughna, he statted on his journey. Servants, horses, camds, bulls and mules followed the chstint of the ptince. Escorted by the private counsellots of the king, togethet with the army, the patient and highly valiant **BHARATA** togethet with SbatriJihna left the palsce fearlessly, as the perfected ones leave the recion of **INDRA**. THB RAM.AYANA OF VALM.IXI CBAPTBR 71 THAT valiant and resplendent prince. turning eastward, came to the river Suddsma, and passing over it. reached the broad Hladini and the Satali 8owiog westward. Having crossed over the river at 11adhana, he reached PBIVBta and the stream in which all objects thrown are petrified, then proceeding further he fOlded the Shalyakartana river. Then the righteous and truth loving pxince ascended the mountains and crossed the rivex Shilavaha the forest Chittaratha, arriving at the conftuence of the Ganges and Saraswati, and ttaversing the land of Viramatsya, entered the Bbarunda forest. At length, reaching the swift and joy-inspiring Xulinga river, which descends from the mountains, he crossed the Yamuna and allowed his army to rest. There, the weary horses were refreshed and his

followers bathed and drank, taking water with them for future use on the way. Thereafter, Prioce BbarBta entered the uninhabited forest on a great Bhadra elephaot, speedily travers ing it. Finding they were unable to cross the GungB at Unchudhaoa, they went to the place called Pragavata and crossing there passed over another river named Kutikoshtaka ; then with his army, be reached the village of DharmavardhaoB. Resting for a while at Varutha, the son ofDasaratha went towaids the east to the wood called Ujjihana which was filled with kedumbra' trees. Arriving at the groves of sala' and bhandub' trees, **BHARATA**, leaving his army to follow slowly, went forward with haste, halting at the village of SBIVatirtha. Then crossing the river Uttamib, he passed over several other streams with the help of mountain ponies. At Hastiprastaka, he crossed the river Kutika and at Lohitya, the Sultatavati. Arriving at the

CHAPTER 71

Prince Bharata sees Ayodhya filled with unhappy people

THB RAM.AYANA OF VALM.IXI CBAPTBR 71 THAT valiant and resplendent prince. turning eastward, came to the river Suddsma, and passing over it. reached the broad Hladini and the Satali 8owiog westward. Having crossed over the river at 11adhana, he reached PBIVBta and the stream in which all objects thrown are petrified, then proceeding further he fOlded the Shalyakartana river. Then the righteous and truth loving pxince ascended the mountains and crossed the rivex Shilavaha the forest Chittaratha, arriving at the conftuence of the Ganges and Saraswati, and ttaversing the land of Viramatsya, entered the

Bbarunda forest. At length, reaching the swift and joy-inspiring Xulinga river, which descends from the mountains, he crossed the Yamuna and allowed his army to rest. There, the weary horses were refreshed and his followers bathed and drank, taking water with them for future use on the way. Thereafter, Prioce BbarBta entered the uninhabited forest on a great Bhadra elephaot, speedily travers ing it. Finding they were unable to cross the GungB at Unchudhaoa, they went to the place called Pragavata and crossing there passed over another river named Kutikoshtaka ; then with his army, be reached the village of DharmavardhaoB. Resting for a while at Varutha, the son ofDasaratha went towaids the east to the wood called Ujjihana which was filled with kedumbra' trees. Arriving at the groves of sala' and bhandub' trees, **BHARATA**, leaving his army to follow slowly, went forward with haste, halting at the village of SBIVatirtha. Then crossing the river Uttamib, he passed over several other streams with the help of mountain ponies. At Hastiprastaka, he crossed the river Kutika and at Lohitya, the Sultatavati. Arriving at the , HaviDg spent seven Dights nn the way, seeing Ayodhya from a distance, the prince said to bis charioteer: "O Charioteer, this would appear to be the renowned and taintless city of Ayoclhya abounding in green lawns, but at a distance it resembles a heap of yellow dust ; formerly the sound of the recitation of the Veda was heard, intoned by the *brahmins*, and the city was frequented by royal sages. To-day, I do not hear the cheerlUI cries of men and women in pursuit of pleasure I The woods at eventide were formerly filled with people, running here and there in sport, but to-day they are deserted and sUent. O Charioteer, this is not like Ayoclhya to me, but seems to be a wilderness. None of the nobly born are seen coming and going in chariots or riding lin elephants and horses. The flower gardens were erstwbi1e filled with cheerful people and the orchards with those who

made merry there ! These gardens, once abounding in flowers and trees, with pleasant groves and arbours, to-day seem to mourn. I no longer hear the cry of deer or the birds singing with joy. O Friend, why do the breezes, redolent with the scent of sandalwood and ambergris, not blow as formerly, over the city ? In the past, the sound of drums and the music of the Vma was heard by us, now all is sUent I I see portentons signs and evil omens, my mind is heavy nn of these forehodings. O Charioteer, without apparent cause my heart beats fast and painfully, my mind is clouded, and apprehension freezes my senses." Entering the capital by the northern gate, his horses being overcome with wearineas, the guards, enquiring as to his welfare, sought to accompany him nn his way. But **BHARATA**, sick at heart, declined their company, though with due deference. **HE** *said*: " O Charioteer, I behold the houses with their doors set open, bereft of splendour and emitting no fragrance of incense or ncriftcisl o1fering ! Filled with unhappy people and those who are fasting, the houses are destitute of all splendour. No garllllds hang from any dwelling and the courtyards lie neglected THE RA.M.AYANA OF VAL.M.IKI trade. Birds in the sacred groves seem joyless and men and women in soiled attire, weeping and lamenting, wasted with grief, roam about the city." Speaking thus to the cbarioteer and seeing the city's distress, Prince **BHARATA** drove towards the palace. Beholding the capital once gay as **INDRA**'s city, with the roads and deserted and the houses covered with dust, he was overcome with anguish. Struck by these painful porteDI8 formerly IIDknown to him, **BHARATA**, with bowed head, his heart filled with dread, entered his father's palace.

CHAPTER 72

Queen Kaikeyi begins to relate what has occurred

her son after a long absence, with a joyous heart, rose from her golden couch. Observing the apartment of his mother, divested of splendour, **BHARATA** reverendy touched her feet. She, having kisaed the head of her son, embraciDg him again, seated him on her lap, and said : " O Child I How many days have passed since thou didst leave thy grandfather's abode ? Having jOIIl'llC)'ed in haste, I trust thou art not fatigued ? O Child, are thy grandfilther and uncle well ? Tell me, O Dear One, hast thou been in heslth since thou hast visited that other country?" Shri **BHARATA** thus questinned, by his mother, telated all that had happened. **HE** *said*: " O .Mother, seven days and seven nights have pasaed, since I ldl: my grandfather's home. Both he and my uncle are well. The parting gifts of weslth and gaoa which the King of Kaikeys gave me, I have ldl: on the way, to follow me, the beasts of burden being weary I The messengers who conveyed the orders of the king, hade me retarD with all speed. Now, O .Mother, answer what I would felp ask ? Why is this, thy golden couch, vacated by the ldq ? 316 "Why do the Jdng's subjects appear wretched ? The king was wont to dwell principally in thy palace, where is he to-day ? I have come hither to entCl' his august presence ! Where is my tam... now, I have come to oft'er salutations to his feet ? Is he in the apsrtment of my chief mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA** ? " **KAIKEYI**, knowing all that had taken place but filled with ambition, answered Prince **BHARATA**, as yet ignorant of the matt.... Imparting the unpleasant news in honeyed accents, she said : .. That fate, which inevitably overtakes all beings, has befilllen that great soul, that renowned and mighty monarch the support of his people, thy sire I " The guileless Prince **BHARATA**, born of a great family, hesring these words, overwhelmed by grief, instantly fell to the ground and alling striking his bands on the earth, cried : "Alas ! I am undone ! " That resplendent prince, deeply moved on learning of the death of his fathCI',

began to lament, crying : " On this couch, my tam... appes!Cd like the moon in autumn, to-day on account of his absence, this pleasant bed resembles the sky bereft of stars or the ocean without water ! " Heaving deep sighs, weeping bitterly and covering his face with a cloth, the prince continued to mourn. Queen **KAIKEYI**, seeing Bbarata lying on the ground, over whelmed with sorrow, like the branch of a shaia tree, seveted by the blows of an axe, raised him up and said to her godlike son who resembled the moon, the sun or the elephant in splendour : " O Son of a King ! O Moat illustrious One I Rise I Rise I Pious men like thee, do not thus yield to grief I O Wise One I Aa the radiance of the sun “is fixed in that orb, so must thou who art devoted to charity, sacrifice and good conduct and who follow the injunctions of the Vedas, be calm ! " Prince **BHARATA**, rolling on the earth, wept for a long time and then answered his mothCl’ sorrowfiJJiy, saying: " O Mother, thinking the king was undertaking a great sacrifice, having bestowed the throne on Shri Rima. I started for home with great joy, but now I see mattCl’S are otherwise and my mind is torn with anguish, aince I no longer behold my ever magnni!I!OIJB parent I O Mother, frotn what malady did the king auffer, that he was carried away in my absence ? How fortunate are my bzothers. **SHRI RAMA** and I.alrshmana, who THB ll.AMAYANA OP VALMIKI have pedormcd the IDOIIliiCb’s obsequies I If the great sovereign’ had been aware of my mum, would he not have bent his head and embraced me ? Alas I Whete is that royal hand, the touch of which filled me with delight and which cleansed my body from the dust ? O Mother, where is my sagacious brothet Rams, whose servant I am and who resembles my father ? Tell me quickly where he may be found ? Since my virtuous and enlightened brothet has now become as a father to me, I desire to tske refuge at his feet, he alone is my sole support I O Mother, what commands concerning me did the righteous and lesmed

king, the ever-truthful monarch of firm vows, give ? I desire to hear the last words of the great sovereign ? " Thus questioned, Queen **KAIKEYI** openly answered, ssying : " The king, at the time of death, did not speak thy name but cried ' O **RAMA**, O Sits, O Laksbmana' and thus gave up his life ! Thy fathet, bound by the ties of fate and duty, like a mighty dephant, caught in ambush, uttered these words at the end : ' Those who see ll.ama, **SITA** and Laksbmana, returning from the forest, will attain their desire '." As **KAIKEYI** revealed this unpleasant intelligence, the prince yet more distracted and enquired of his mother : " O Mother, where is the virtuous Rams, where is he now with **SITA** and his brothet Laksbmana ? " Thus questioned, the queen began to rdate what had occurred, supposing the news of the unpleasing event would be wdcome to her son. **SHE** *said*: " O Orild, that prince, clothed in robes of bark, has entered the great Dandab forest with **SITA** and Laksbmana." Hearing from his mothet that **RAMA** had entered the forest, Prince **BHARATA** was alarmed, filled with misgivings and concerned for the honour of his House. **HE** *said*: " O Mothet, how is *brahmin* of his wealth, nor has he slain any, rich or poor, without reason, neither has **RAMA** looked on another's wife with desire ! My Son, having heard that he was to be proclaimed regent, I requested thy father to banish **RAMA** and bestow the kingdom on thee ! Thy sire, in order to honour the promise made to me, fulfilled my request. He sent **RAMA**, togaher with **SITA** and LakshmaDa to the forest. Then that mighty monarch, unable to endure the separation from his son, died. O RighteouS Prince, now do thou rule the kingdom I For thy sake, I have contrived all this ! My Son, do not grieve, do not alllict thyself, the kingdom and the capital, being now without a ruler, depend on thee for support. Therefore, seeking advice from Shri **VASISHTHA** and the learned *brahmins*, perform the funeral rites of thy great sire and, without hesitation, accept the throne I "

CHAPTER 73

Prince Bharata reproaches his mother

" What will the throne avail me, since I am stricken by the death of my father and bereft of my brother, who was as a parent to me ? Thou hast destroyed the king, and banished **RAMA**, causing him to become an ascetic I Thou hast thus rubbed salt into the wounds which thou hast inflicted I Thou hast entered this royal House for its extinction, like the night of death I My father, unaware that thou wert an all-consuming fire, supported thee. O Sinful One, thou hast deprived the king of life I O Thou Destroyer of the Family, overpowered with avarice, thou hast shattered the peace of the hearth. Through uninn with thee, my father, a lover of truth, has suffered untold misery and grief I Wherefore hast thou slain my virtuous sire ? Wherefore haat thou exiled **RAMA** ? Hard indeed were it to live with such a mother I How will **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA** now endure life ? My elder brother, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, ever devoted to his duty and to the service of his Guru, treated thee T as his own mother. So also my elder mother, Queen **KAUSHALYA**, knowing what would befall, yet acted towards thee as a true sister, in a proper spirit. Thou hast sent her son to the forest in ascetic's garb and still thou dost not grieve ? What hast thou gained by sending that renowned hero, **RAMA**, to the forest, **RAMA**, who was nnscquainted with suffering ? Wert thou ignorant m my gteSt love for Raghava, that thou, possessed by avarice, committed this gteSt sin, O Mothet ? By whst power can I rule, deprived m Latshmana and that Lion among men, **SHRI RAMA** ? King **DASARATHA** ever depended on that mighty and vslorous **RAMA**, as the forest depends on Mount Meru ! How can I sustain the burden m the kingdom, without the suppott ofRama? How

should a calf sustain the load that taxes the strength of a full-grown bull ? Even if it were possible for me to rule through wisdom and sound policy, yet would I not allow thy evil intention in seeking the kingdom for thy son, to prevsil ! I should have abandoned thee, O Mother, did I not know that **RAMA** regards thee as his mother slso I O Thou Evil-minded One, thou hast btought disgrace on the dynasty m my ancestors ! How didst thou conceive such a purpose, bringing shame into our lives ? It is the immemorial custom of our House, that the eldest brother shsll occupy the throne and the younger brothets obey him. Thou art not acquainted with the duty m a king nor dost thou know the rules m government. In the House m Itshwaku, the succession m the eldest son is enjoined. To-day, thou hast cast into the dust the glory and integrity m the House of Itshwaku, that was enriched by the noble conduct of its kings ! Thou, too, wert bom of a renowned and royal House, how camest thou to entertain this evil intention ? O Mother, let it be known to thee that I will never fa11i1 thy evil desires, come what may, since thou hsst introduced that which is destructive m life into this royal House I I shsll now bring my sinless brother, Rams, back to the capital and thwart thee I Not only will I cause **RAMA** to return from the forest, but I will serve him with my whole heart I" Thus reproaching **KAIKEYI**, himself alllicted, with hsrsh words, **BHARATA** spoke once more, roaring like a lion in the caves m the Mandara mountain.

CHAPTER 74

He laments the death of his father and the exile of Shri Rama

SHRI Blw!ATA denounced his mother in great anger, saying : " O Cruel-hearted One, O Wicked Being, thou art without virtue, enter the forest, I am about to die l Weep for me; since thou hast deserted thy coosort, do not mourn for him. Tell me, what harm had the ting or the most virtuous **RAMA** dooe to thee, that thou hast slain the one and exiled the other ? O **KAIKEYI**, the sin by which thou hast destroyed the dynasty is equal to the murder of a *brahmin* l Do thou enter heU ! Thou hast no right to inhabit the regioo to which the ting has gone l Thy deed and guilt are infamous. In denouncing **RAMA**, who is beloved of aU the world, thou hast secured me a kingdom, but brought me igoominy. Thou art the cause of my father's death and the exile of **RAMA**, and also of my dishooour. Thy heart is adamant, thou art not my mother but an enemy in the form of a mother I O Slayer of thy husband, thou dost not merit that ooe should address thee I O Defamer of the fair name of this dynaSty, thou art the cause of distress to my mothers, Queen **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA** I Thou hast forfeited the title of daughter to the great King Ashwapati ; thou art surely a demon hom in that family to destroy my father's line l Thou hast banished **RAMA** to the forest, he, who ever delighted in virtue and thou hast deprived my illustrious father of his life I It is I who must bear the weight of thine iniquity, who am fatherless, bereft of my two brothers and an object of universal loathing I O Thou Sinner, O Traveller on the path of self-destruction, say what state shalt thou attain, who hast deprived the virtuous **KAUSHALYA** of her husband and her son ? O Evil One, didst thou not bow that **SHRI RAMA** was the chief asylum of his relatives, the son of **KAUSHALYA** and a father to me ? AU relatives are dear, but to a mother, the son is dearest, since he is hom of the body and heart of the filther. Hast thou forgotten this truth ? " In ancient times, the cow Kamadhenu, worshipped by the 321 gods, beholding two of her sons, weary with

ploughing, swooned away. At that time, the King of the Celestials, lndra, was wandering on the earth and the fragrant tears of Kamadhenu fell upon him. Experiencing the sweet odour issuing from the body of the sacred cow, lndra realised her superior worth and startled, looked upward ·and beheld, in the sky, the alllicred Kamadhenu, weeping piteously. The Bearer of the Mace, distressed on seeing the renowned Kamadhenu shedding tears, addressed her with humility and said : " O Benefactor of the World, why dost thou weep ? Is it the premonition of some future calamity which causes thee to lament thus ? " The wise Kamadhenu, patiently answered : " O Devaraj, thou hast no cause for fear, I am alllicted on account of the suffering of two of my sons. See, how wretched they are, how wasted and oppressed by the sun's best ! O Devaraj I The ploughman has struck them cruelly! Bom of my body, I am 1illed with grief to see them yoked to the hesvy plough ! Verily nothing is dearer to a mother than her son." **INDRA**, perceiving that the cow mourned over the wretched state of two of her innumerable sons, recognised that to a mother nothing is dearer than a son I " O Mother, Kamadhenu estends her blessings equally to an and has the power to fulfil the desires of others. If she, who is cons-tly producing thousands of offspring, 1i1led with maternal love, mourns thus for two sons, how then, O **KAIKEYI**, will **KAUSHALYA** bear the exile of her only son ? Thou hast brought about the separation ofRama from bis mother **KAUSHALYA** and for this thou shalt not know happiness in this or in the other world I I shan perform the last rites for my sire and then, with my heart and soul serve my brother and carefully promote bis honour. Having brought back **SHRI RAMA** to the capital. I, myself, shan inhabit the forest. O Thou, of evil intent, how shan I endure thine iniquity, when looked on by the people of the capital with sorrow-stricken gaze ? Now it befits thee to enter the fire or hang thyself in the Dandska forest, desth

alone is thy desert I Only when **RAMA** returns and that Prince of Truth is by my side, shan I finc1 peace and my purpose be accompliahed I " Bbarata, lamenting and breathing like a serpent, fell to the earth like an elephant tormented by the goad. His eyes ted with anger, his dtess loosened, his jewels cast aside, he fell like the banner of **INDRA**, uprooted at the close of a ceremony.

CHAPTER 75

He seeks to console Queen Kaushalya

TID valiant Bbarata, regaining consciousness, his eyes suffused with rears, pcrccived his mother filled with distress. Seated in the midst of his counsellots, he poured forth reproaches on his mother saying : " It was never my desire to rule, nor did I consult my mother in this matter ; I was not acquainted with the ldng's intention to cooler the crown on **RAMA**, being far from the capital with Shatrnghoa. I knew nought of the exile of **SHRI RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA**, nor how it came to pass. My heart is filled with anguish." **KAUSHALYA**, hearing the sound of **BHARATA**'s weeping, said to **SUMITRA** : " **BHARATA**, the son of the cruel **KAIKEYI**, has come, I wish to see the prudent **BHARATA**." The queen, pale and weak on acxount of her separation from **RAMA**, advanced trembling to where **BHARATA** was, while the prince with his brother **SHATRUGHNA** started likewise for the Queen **KAIKEYI** bas made thee sovereign of this country, replete with wealth, grain, horses, elephants and chariots." Hearing the bitter words of Queen Kausbalya, **BHARATA** was pained as a man who suffers when his wound is probed by a lancet. Agitated and coufused, he fell at the feet of the queen lamenting. Then growing composed, with joined palms, he addtessed the

sOlTOwing queen : " O Mother, thou knowest how great is my love for **RAMA** and also that I am innocent in this matter. Why dost thou reproach me ? May he, who is the cause of the exile of **RAMA**, forget the tmchiDgs of the Vedas and the holy tradition. May he, who bas given his consent to the exile of **RAMA**, become a slave of the lowest caste or incur the sin of killing a cow. May such a man be subject to the same punishment as one who withholds the wages of his labourers. May he who bas consented to the banishment of the holy prince, bear the same guilt as one rebelling against a king, who protects his subjects as his own offspring ! May the guilt of a king taking the sixth part of the revenue of his people and yet failing to protect them, be his, who exiled **RAMA**. “May the fruits of the sin incurred by one who, well-equipped with elephants, horses and chariots and all weapons, does not fight according to the law of righteousness, be his l May he, who agreed to the exile of **RAMA**, forget the teachiogs of Vedanta which ensure happiness, and all the secrets obtained from his spiritual preceptor by serving him I May such a one not live to see the coronation of Prince **RAMA** whose countenance equals the sun and moon in splendour. May that wretch incur the sin of one, who, partaking of milk and rice, does not make an offering to his ancestors and guests or to the gods. May he be guilty of not honouring his spiritual preceptor by offering salutations to him in a fitting manner. " May that wretch, who gave conaent to the exile of **RAMA**, bear the same guilt as one who strikes a cow, reviles his Guru or betrays his friends l May he incur the guilt of one who forswears his trust. May he, who participated in the exile of **RAMA**, reap the sin of one who does not do good to others. " May the wretch, who ordered the exile of **RAMA**, bear the guilt of one, who, partaking of sweetmeats, fails to share them AYODHYA KA,NDA or one who, living on cxccllent food, gives to his inferiors that which is raw and ill-cooked. May he, by whom

RAMA was sent into exile, die without marrying a woman of his own caste or producing oflilpring or performing the fire ritual ! May he not behold the oflilpring born of his spouse ! May his years be brief I May he be slain in battle, retreating from a superior foe in fear, or may he be as one who slays a fleeing enemy. May he, like one dressed in rags, demented, carrying a skull in his hand, wander about begging from door to door ! May he who has conspired to send **RAMA** to the forest be given over to wine, women and gambling and become an object of contempt on account of his concupiscence and anger. May he ever indulge in the practice of unrighteousness and forget his duty and distribute immense weslth in charicy to the undeserving ! May the accumulated wealth and extensive possessions of the one who has furthered the exile of **RAMA**, be stolen away by thieves. May the sin of him who sleeps at sunrise or sunset be his ! May the sin of him who is guilcy of arson or looks with desire on the wife of his spiritual preceptor or who betrays his friend, be his, who has advocated the exile of **SHRI RAMA** ! May he, who acquiesced in the exile of **RAMA** be deprived of the worship of his ancestors and parents as also of the funeral rites ! May such a one, even now, be driven from the society of good people and lose the renown and merit of companionship with the virtuous I May his mind never be devoted to such deeds as are undertaken by the righteous I May that man who sought to exile **RAMA**, fail to obey his mother and ever be employed n evil deeds I May he maintain a large family in extreme poverty I May he, ever restless, be consumed with fever ! May he be guilcy of that sin incurred by one, who fails to satisfy a miserable suppliant who looks to him for succour ! May he be deceitful, slanderous, base, depraved and ever walk in fear of authority I May he incur the guilt of one who disregards his chaste and devoted wife, who approaches him in the season of her flowering I May he be dull-witted

and abandoning his lawful spouse, may he live in sin with other women I May the guilt of a *brahmin* who abandons his children, who are dying of hunger be his I May he be like one who defiles a reservoir or administers poison to another I May that man 3'"5 THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIKJ lose the power of his limbs, as he who seeks to impede the hospitality to be shown to a *brahmin*, by speaking ill of him I May his be the sin of ooe who drinks the milk of the cow that possesses unweaned calves ! May he incur the sin of him, who, having water in his dwelling, the thirsty man from his door I May he bear the guilt of him, who arbitrating between two learned disputants, grants victory to the ooe he favours I " With these words, Prince **BHARATA**, seeking to console Queen **KAUSHALYA** for the separation from her soo, fell to the ground, overcome with distress. The queen then addressed him, who, distraught and a11Jieted, seeking to establish his innocence, had fallen to the earth, and said : " My Soo, my pain is increased by the words thou hast uttered but fortunate it is that the hearts of **LAKSHMANA** and thyself are fixed in love of thy brother. Assuredly thou wilt enter the region attained by the blesL" Then the queen, taking the mighty-armed prince in her lap, wept aloud. The prince whose heart was rent with grief also wept in an excess of sorrow. Caressed by the queen, lamenting wildly, lying oo the earth and sighing heavily, he passed the night in this wise. CHAPTBll 76 Ths prince tM perfllmiiJ1Ie of tlu funeral rites

CHAPTER 76

The prince commences the performance of the funeral rites

 lose the power of his limbs, as he who seeks to impede the hospitality to be shown to a *brahmin*, by speaking ill of him I May his be the sin of ooe who drinks the milk of the cow that possesses unweaned calves ! May he incur the sin of him, who, having water in his dwelling, the thirsty man from his door I May he bear the guilt of him, who arbitrating between two learned disputants, grants victory to the ooe he favours I " With these words, Prince **BHARATA**, seeking to console Queen **KAUSHALYA** for the separation from her soo, fell to the ground, overcome with distress. The queen then addressed him, who, distraught and a11Jieted, seeking to establish his innocence, had fallen to the earth, and said : " My Soo, my pain is increased by the words thou hast uttered but fortunate it is that the hearts of **LAKSHMANA** and thyself are fixed in love of thy brother. Assuredly thou wilt enter the region attained by the blesL" Then the queen, taking the mighty-armed prince in her lap, wept aloud. The prince whose heart was rent with grief also wept in an excess of sorrow. Caressed by the queen, lamenting wildly, lying oo the earth and sighing heavily, he passed the night in this wise. CHAPTBll 76 Ths prince tM perfllmiiJ1Ie of tlu funeral rites had assumed a yellow hue through being immersed in oil for many days, yet it appeared as if the king slepL They then laid the king on a couch set with gems and Bhatata, overwhelmed with grief, began to lament. **HE** *said*: " O Great King. I know not why, in mine absence, thou didst send **RAMA** to the forest. Whithet art thou gone, leaving me bereft of **RAMA**, that Lion among men and the Doer of famous deeds ? O Great Soveteign, who with a constant mind is able to preserve his mighty kingdom ? Thou art dead and **SHRI RAMA** is banished. O Mighty Ruler, this earth is widowed and divested of all beauty without thee I Without thee, the capital resembles a moonless night." Shri **VASISHTHA** again addressed Shri Bhatata, perceiving him

still to be a ptey to grief and said : " O Mighty-armed Ptince this is no time for giving way to sorrow or procrastination, now perform the last rites for the king." Thus addressed, Shri Bbarata with the aid of the *brahmins* and the spiritus! preceptor of the monarch, inaugurated the funeral ceremonies. In the sacrificial hall, the priests performed the fire ritual. The servitors placed the body of the king on a litter and conveyed it thence, weeping and lamenting. Scattering golden coins, and silver ftowers and laying cloths before the bier, they proceeded on their way, while before the palace, sandalwood, ambergris and incense were kindled. On the banks of the river Sarayu, a funeral pyre of devadaru,' sandal and othet fragrant woods, was raised. Aromatic herbs were thrown on the pyre and the body of the king laid upon it. The sactificing priests poured oblations on the funeral pile, to the end that the monarch should attain the beatific state, and intoned the traditional mantrams, whilst the *brahmins*, acqusinted with the Sama Veda, sang the Sama hymns. The qneens, carried in palanquins, attended by the royal and aged guards, approached the funeral pyre, weeping. Then they, overcome with grief, together with the priests circum· ambulated the blazing body of the king. The piteous wailing of the stricken Queens and the cries of distress of innumetable women following them, resembled the call of the krauncba birds in the mating season. Then the queens, abandoning their vebicles, approached the baDk of the river Sarayu and, together with Prince **BHARATA**, the counsellors and ministers, offered libations of water; thereafter, weeping bitterly, they returned to the capital, where for the period of ten days they slept on the bare earth.

CHAPTER 77

The ceremonies are continued

ON the eleventh day, Prince Bbarata purified himself and on the twelfth day he performed the Sapindi' ceremony, and distributed jewels, gold, silver, gorgeous apparel and other articles among the *brahmins*. He also gave in charity countless wbite goats and cows, male and female servants, chariots and horaes. On the thineenth day, the mighty-armed Bbarata, overcome with grief, went to collect the ashes of the king and, standing near the fimeral pyre, spoke in a voice choked with emotion. **HE** *said*: " O Lord, my brother, Ramacbandra, to whom thou hadat entrusted me, has entered the forest and thon, also, hast abandoned me, helpless and wretched as I am. O Father, where hast thou gone, abandoning Mother Kauahalya, whose son is now exiled ? " Seeing the white ashes of the king's bones and the body wholly consumed, Bbarata burst into fresh lamentation, and weeping, fell on the earth. The people tried to raise the prince who was lying on the ground like the banner of **INDRA**, Being somewhat RStorcd, they called to mind the excellent qualities of their illustrious father and **SHATRUGHNA** *cried*: " The boons exacted by **MANTHARA** are the ocean inhabited by the croaxlile **KAIKEYI**, in which we are submerged. O Father, where art thou gone, abandoning thy tender and beloved son **BHARATA** ? Why hast thou abjwed us, thou who wast wont to give us delicious food, fining gifts, robes and ornaments ? Who will now confer these favours on us ? Why is the earth not riven, thus deprived of an illustrious and pious sovereign ? Alas I My father has departed to heaven and **SHRI RAMA** has gone to the forest I How can I continue to live ? Bereft of my father and brother, I shall enter the fire. I shall not return to the capital, I shall go to Tapovana." The palace attendants hearing the prince grieving so bitterly, were aJIIicted and fell to the ground, tormented like bulls whose horns are broken. Then the excellent and wise **VASISHTHA**, their father's chief priest raising Bharatll up, addressed him, saying : " O Prince, thirteen

days have passed since the cremation of thy illustrious father's body. Do not delay longer, but collect the bones that remain. Every man sutrers the three pairs of opposites; hunger and thirst, pleasure and pain, life and death. Do not permit thyself to grieve for that which cannot be avoided." Then the wise Sumantra raised up **SHATRUGHNA** and consoling him explained the nature of birth and death that visits all beings. Standing erect, those two lions among men, their eyes red with much weeping, resembled the standards of **INDRA**, bereft of glory by the effi!cts of sun and rain. Then the counsellors approached the two princes and requested them to undertake the remaining ceremonies. CHAPTBR 78 Ths /umdJback, Mt1111lulra, i11Jtt's Prinu Shatruglma's disple4sur As llharata, still grieving, was considering how he should approach **SHRI RAMA** in the forest, **PRINCE SHATRUGHNA** *spoke*: " O Brother, how is it that **SHRI RAMA**, the support of an beings in distress and who is powerful, has been banished to the forest with his consort ? Bven if **SHRI RAMA** were bewildered, why did the mighty and courageous **LAKSHMANA** not defend him and restrain his father ? The king, falling under the sway of desire, forsook the preceptS of justice, Prince **LAKSHMANA** who was acquainted with what was right, should have restrained the king from this sinful aCL" While Prince Shattughna was conversing thus with **BHARATA**, the hunchback **MANTHARA**, attired in costly garments, adorned with precious gems, appeared at the east door. Painted thicldy with aandalwood paste, wearing a robe and ornaments befitting a queen, bestowed on her by **KAIKEYI**, her waist encircled by a jewelled girdle, her whole body covered with precious stones, she resembled a captive monkey. The guards seeing that wicked and deformed slave, seized her and said to Prince **SHATRUGHNA** : " This is the sinful wretch who has caused the exile of **SHRI RAMA** and the death of the king ; deal with her according to thy pleasure." On hearing the

words of the guards, the prince smarting with indignation, reflected on his duty and said to those in the pslace : " Let this woman, the cause of the grief of my brothers and the death of my father, suffer the consequence of her acts.” **SHATRUGHNA** then seized **MANTHARA** from amidst her companinns with such violence that her shrieks filled the palace I The women, perceiving Shattughna so enraged, dealing thus with the hunchback, ran away in an directions. They reflected among themselves, aaying : " The enraged prince will surely put an end to us an, let us therefore take refuge with the compassionate, liberal and illustrious Queen Kauahalya, she alone will protect us.”

CHAPTER 78

The hunchback, Manthara, incurs Prince Shatrughna's displeasure

CHAPTBR 78 Ths /umdJback, Mt1111lulra, i11Jtt’s Prinu Shatruglma’s disple4sur As llharata, still grieving, was considering how he should approach **SHRI RAMA** in the forest, **PRINCE SHATRUGHNA** *spoke*: " O Brother, how is it that **SHRI RAMA**, the support of an beings in distress and who is powerful, has been banished to the forest with his consort ? Bven if **SHRI RAMA** were bewildered, why did the mighty and courageous **LAKSHMANA** not defend him and restrain his father ? The king, falling under the sway of desire, forsook the preceptS of justice, Prince **LAKSHMANA** who was acquainted with what was right, should have restrained the king from this sinful aCL” While Prince Shattughna was conversing thus with **BHARATA**, the hunchback **MANTHARA**, attired in costly garments, adorned with precious gems, appeared at the east door. Painted thicldy with aandalwood paste, wearing a robe and

ornaments befitting a queen, bestowed on her by **KAIKEYI**, her waist encircled by a jewelled girdle, her whole body covered with precious stones, she resembled a captive monkey. The guards seeing that wicked and deformed slave, seized her and said to Prince **SHATRUGHNA** : " This is the sinful wretch who has caused the exile of **SHRI RAMA** and the death of the king ; deal with her according to thy pleasure." On hearing the words of the guards, the prince smarting with indignation, reflected on his duty and said to those in the pslace : " Let this woman, the cause of the grief of my brothers and the death of my father, suffer the consequence of her acts." **SHATRUGHNA** then seized **MANTHARA** from amidst her companinns with such violence that her shrieks filled the palace I The women, perceiving Shattughna so enraged, dealing thus with the hunchback, ran away in an directions. They reflected among themselves, aaying : " The enraged prince will surely put an end to us an, let us therefore take refuge with the compassionate, liberal and illustrious Queen Kauahalya, she alone will protect us." 330 Prince Sbatruglma, the conqueror of his foes, his eyes red with anger threw **MANTHARA** on the ground and forcibly dragged her hither and thither, while all her ornsments were scattered, causing the palace to look like the autumn sky, studded with stars ! Dragging **MANTHARA** in anger before Queen **KAIKEYI**, who sought to deliver her, the prince reproached his mother with bitter words. Pained by the harsh speech of Prince **SHATRUGHNA**, the terrified **KAIKEYI** 1led to Prince **BHARATA** for protection. Perceiving **SHATRUGHNA** overcome by anger, **BHARATA** addressed him saying : " O Brother, women are not to be slain by any living being, therefore pardon her and ser her free ! If women were subject to the law of retribution, and were it not that **RAMA** would forsake me as a matricide, I would have slain this sinful woman long since l If **SHRI RAMA** became acquainted with our treatment of this

deformed woman, he would never converse more with us.” Thus instructed by Prince **BHARATA**, **SHATRUGHNA** restrained his wrath and released **MANTHARA**, who fell at the feet of Queen **KAIKEYI**, pantiog and lamenting. Perceiving **MANTHARA** full of fear under **SHATRUGHNA**’s displeasure and trembling like an imprisoned krauncha bird, **KAIKEYI** gradually calmed her.

CHAPTER 79

Prince Bharata decides to go to the forest and bring back his brother

assembled, thus addressed Prince **BHARATA** : " Our Venerable Sovereign, King **DASARATHA**, having sent his eldest son, **SHRI RAMA** and the mighty Prince **LAKSHMANA**, into exile, has, himself, joined the circle of the gods. Thou art to-day our Lord, O Mighty Prince. The kingdom is now rulerleas and the king bequeathed it to thee, it is not improper for thee, therefore, to ascend the throne, nor will any censure thee on this ccount. 331 O Prince of the House ofRaghu, all the articles for thy coronation are made ready ; thy relatives, COUDSellors and ministers and the citizens look to thee. O Great Prince, accept the kingdom of thy paternal ancestors and cause thyself to be installed and protect us all.” The Speaket of Truth, the illustrious **BHARATA**, bearing these excellent WOtds, revetently citcumambulating the articles designed for the coronation ceremony, replied to those who thus addtessed him : " Hear, O My People, it is known to you that according to the ttadition of our Royal House the throne “is inherited by the eldest son of the deceased sovereign ; it is, therefore, improper for you to make this request to me. Shri Rams is my elder btothet and, therefore, should

be king. I shall enter the forest and reside there during fourteen years in his stead. Now order my whole army hold itself in readiness, I will go to the forest and bring my brother back, taking with me all the articles necessary for his installation. Rams will there be proclaimed king I I will restore him like the holy fire which is brought to the place of sacrifice. I will never suffer the ambitions of Queen **KAIKEYI** to be fulfilled. I will enter the forest, hard to penetrate, and shall make Rams king. Let the rough and uneven roads at once be repaired by skilled artisans ; let them be foDowed by mechanics and labourers." The people were gratified to hear the auspicious wotds of the prince and replied : " O Prince, may the Goddess of Prosperity' ever abide with thee ! Desirous of making Rams our king, thy words are timely."

CHAPTER 80

A royal highway is constructed for the prince

men able to perform all kinds of work, woodcutters, artisans skilled in the sinking of wells, labourers, hewers of wood, cooks and those acquainted with the way, set forth. The multitude of people advancing, appeared astonishing, like the sea under the full moon. Those proficient in various ways, equipped with axes and other implements, advanced in groups, cutting through trees, shrubs, bushes and rocks, levelling them and hewing out a path ; plantiug trees where these were needed, they cut back the branches of others that obstructed the way. Stroug men set fire to tree trunks and cleared the road, levelling the uneven places with clay and filling the ditches. Others bridged the small rivers and brooks and swept the road clear of pebbles and thorns, pulverizing the rocks that impeded the ftow of water. They speedily built barriers to dam the small

streams and deepened the ponds by digging in many places. They also sank wells where water was scarce, and built platforms on which men could rest. Lime was spread on the road, trees were planted where birds sang and the highway appeared as if adorned with banners. Sprinkled with the essence of sandalwood and decorated with flowering branches, it resembled the pathway of the Gods. Those skilled in building prepared dwellings on pleasant sites near fresh water and fruit trees. Camps were set up for the army in accordance with Prince **BHARATA**'s instructions and all that was needed was provided. Those acquainted with the auspicious planetary positions erected quarters for the illustrious **BHARATA**. Bordered by deep moats with intersecting roads, these camps were as lofty as the blue mountain. Stately white temples were set up, and rows of houses, bordering the roads, were adorned with flags. 333 The balconies on the buildings, elevated like dovecotes, resembled the abode of the gods, and the whole arena rivalled **INDRA**'s capital Tbe way prepared for Prince Bimrats, eztended to the banks of the Ganges in whose cool waters fishes glided, as it flowed between woods and forests, and tbat royal highway, erected by skilled artisans, appeared as beautiful as the night sky, adorned by moon and stars. CHAPTER 8I V asUhtluJ mmmom tM royal assembly YET a little of the enchanting night still remained, when the bards began to praise the prince ; three hours before the sun rose, the great drums were struck with golden sticks, while conches were blown and the sound of countless musical instru ments was heard. The music 1i1ling the heavens increased the grief of Prince Bharats, who commanded it to cease, saying : " I am not the king." Then addresaing Prince **SHATRUGHNA**, he said : " Hear, O Brother, how nnfitting are the praises now sung at the instance of Queen **KAIKEYI**. She has done us a great wrong. Tbe king has departed to the regions of the gods and left xne desolate. The future and the kingdom trembling in

uncertainty, resembles a ship without a pilot drifting on the ocean. My father is dead and my mother, abandoning the path of virtue, has sent **SHRI RAMA** into exile." The woxnen of the palace, hearing the great prince lamenting, began to weep aloud pitifully. At this tiine, the great and illustrious Sage **VASISHTHA**, versed in the science of government, appeared in the assembly hall, which was decorated with wrought gold, encrusted with gems. Attended by his followers, the spiritual preceptor of the royal dynasty, entered the council chamber, as **INDRA** enters the celestial hall nained Sudharma. Seated on a golden throne, which was covered with Ill excellent

CHAPTER 81

Vasishtha summons the royal assembly

The balconies on the buildings, elevated like dovecotes, resembled the abode of the gods, and the whole arena rivalled **INDRA**'s capital Tbe way prepared for Prince Bimrats, eztended to the banks of the Ganges in whose cool waters fishes glided, as it flowed between woods and forests, and tbat royal highway, erected by skilled artisans, appeared as beautiful as the night sky, adorned by moon and stars. CHAPTER 8I V asUhtluJ mmmom tM royal assembly YET a little of the enchanting night still remained, when the bards began to praise the prince ; three hours before the sun rose, the great drums were struck with golden sticks, while conches were blown and the sound of countless musical instru ments was heard. The music 1i1ling the heavens increased the grief of Prince Bharats, who commanded it to cease, saying : " I am not the king." Then addresaing Prince **SHATRUGHNA**, he said : " Hear, O Brother, how nnfitting are the praises now sung at the instance of Queen **KAIKEYI**.

She has done us a great wrong. Tbe king has departed to the regions of the gods and left xne desolate. The future and the kingdom trembling in uncertainty, resembles a ship without a pilot drifting on the ocean. My father is dead and my mother, abandoning the path of virtue, has sent **SHRI RAMA** into exile." The woxnen of the palace, hearing the great prince lamenting, began to weep aloud pitifully. At this tiine, the great and illustrious Sage **VASISHTHA**, versed in the science of government, appeared in the assembly hall, which was decorated with wrought gold, encrusted with gems. Attended by his followers, the spiritual preceptor of the royal dynasty, entered the council chamber, as **INDRA** enters the celestial hall nained Sudharma. Seated on a golden throne, which was covered with Ill excellent 334 carpet with the swastika design, Shri **VASISHTHA** said to the messengers : " Go speedily and summon the learned *brahmins*, the counscllors, the warriors and the lesders of the army; matters of gJeat importance await them I Bring also the royal princes together with thdr secretaries and ministers, Yudhajita and Sumantra I " A gJe8t tumult now arose from those invited, who approached in cbariots and on horses and depbants. The counscllors seeing Prince **BHARATA** dtawing near, were gladdened by his sight as though King Dasatatha himadf had entered the assembly. The presence of **BHARATA** added to the splendour of the court so that it appeared as when King **DASARATHA** was present, or as the clear waters of the ocean are enhanced by whales, alligators, shells and golden sand. CHAPTBR 82 TM chiefs af the """!Y prepare for de[>IJJ'tllre THB wise **BHARATA** behdd the royal assembly presided over by the great **VASISHTHA** and other venerable ssges, resembling the night made glorious by the full moon. Illumined by these excellent ones, who occupied theU seats, attired in splendid apparel, the amclave was of incomparable brilliance. The assembly of learned men resembled the beauty of the full moon on a

winter’s night. The virtuous priest, Shri **VASISHTHA**, beholding all the ministers and the chief counscllors, gendy addressed **BHARATA**, saying : .. O OWd, King **DASARATHA**, having practised virtue in his life, has bequeathed this rich and prosperous land to thee. Shri Rmacbandn observing the vow of truth, in obedience to his father and in conformity with the duty incumbent on him, to vindicate his parents, has not failed to accomplish his father’s ClODIIDand, as the moon does not abstain from shedding abroad its ndiance. Now enjoy the poaaession of this peaceful kingdom 33$ z

CHAPTER 82

The chiefs of the army prepare for departure

Carpet with the swastika design, Shri **VASISHTHA** said to the messengers : " Go speedily and summon the learned *brahmins*, the counscllors, the warriors and the lesders of the army; matters of gJeat importance await them I Bring also the royal princes together with thdr secretaries and ministers, Yudhajita and Sumantra I " A gJe8t tumult now arose from those invited, who approached in cbariots and on horses and depbants. The counscllors seeing Prince **BHARATA** dtawing near, were gladdened by his sight as though King Dasatatha himadf had entered the assembly. The presence of **BHARATA** added to the splendour of the court so that it appeared as when King **DASARATHA** was present, or as the clear waters of the ocean are enhanced by whales, alligators, shells and golden sand. CHAPTBR 82 TM chiefs af the """!Y prepare for de[>IJJ’tllre THB wise **BHARATA** behdd the royal assembly presided over by the great **VASISHTHA** and other venerable ssges, resembling the night made glorious by the full moon. Illumined by these excellent ones,

who occupied theU seats, attired in splendid apparel, the amclave was of incomparable brilliance. The assembly of learned men resembled the beauty of the full moon on a winter's night. The virtuous priest, Shri **VASISHTHA**, beholding all the ministers and the chief counscllors, gendy addressed **BHARATA**, saying : .. O OWd, King **DASARATHA**, having practised virtue in his life, has bequeathed this rich and prosperous land to thee. Shri Rmacbandn observing the vow of truth, in obedience to his father and in conformity with the duty incumbent on him, to vindicate his parents, has not failed to accomplish his father's ClODIIDand, as the moon does not abstain from shedding abroad its ndiance. Now enjoy the poaaession of this peaceful kingdom 33$ z given to thee by thy father and brother I To please thy coun· sellors, cause thyself to be iDstalled. The kings of the north, south and west, the peers and titular sovereigns of the western boundsry and the monarchs of many islands, will bring thee countless gems as offerings." Hearing the words of his spiritual preceptor, Prince **BHARATA** was distressed, knowing well that according to the ancient trscli tion of his dynasty, the eldest inherits the kingdom. Calling Rsma to remembrance, Shri **BHARATA** resolved to seek out his elder brother. The throat of the youthfUl prince was choked and in tones resembling the ay of the swan, he plaintively reproached the venerable Guru for the impropriety of his command. **BBARATA** *said*: " O Holy Lord, how can I usurp the legitimate possession of one, who, learned in the Vedas and sciences, acquired by dwelling as a servant in the house of his Guru, knows their meaning well and follows them in practice ? How can one, born of King **DASARATHA**, striving to fulfil the law of *dharma*, take possession of the kingdom of Rsma ? Not only does the kingdom belong to **RAMA**, but I also belong to him. O Holy One, may thy counsels accord with righteousness 1 King **DASARATHA** owned this kingdom as did King

Dilipa and Nahusha before him, so shonld the virtuous Prince **RAMA**, the eldesr and most excellent son, inherit the kingdom I " If, as iDstructed by thee, I it, it would be a great sin and worthy of an evil-doer, not in accordance with the way that leads to hesven and I should be adjudged the destroyer of the House of Ibhwaku. I abhor the wrong com mitted by my mother, and I offer salutations to Rsma residing in the forest ; I will follow him, he alone is king and worthy of ruling the three worlds I It were easy for him to administer this kingdom." All seated in the assembly, devoted to **RAMA**, having listened The lover of his brother, Shri Bbarata, turning to the royal counsellors, addressed the wise Sumantra seated near them and said : " Go speedily and summon the army in my name to accompany me to the forest and bring the leaders hete." Sumantra glsdly carried out the commands of Prince **BHARATA**. The military amunandets were filled with joy at the order of Prince Bbarata to proceed with the army to recall **SHRI RAMA**. In every home, wives joyfully urged their husbands to go with all speed and bring back **SHRI RAMA**. The leaders of the army riding their swift horses or in bullock carts and chariots gave the ordet to march. His preceptor the Guru **VASISHTHA** being near, Shri Bbarata said to Sumantra who was at his side, "Speedily prepare my chariot". Sumantra replied with revetence " Be it so " and highly pleased brought the chariot to which excellent horses were yoked. The Prince, filled with fortitude, illustrious, of fixed vows and a hero of the region of truth, resolving to recall **SHRI RAMA** from the forest, addressed Sumantra saying : " O Sumantra, mobilise the army and ordet my friends and the chiefs of the people to be prepared. I desire to recall **RAMA** for the good of the world." As instructed by the great prince, Sumantra speedily issued the command to the chiefs of the army and the friends ofBbarata. fully explaining its purpose. In every dwelling the *brahmins*, the warriors, the

merchants and the labourers brought together camels, chariots, mules, elephants and excellent horses.

CHAPTER 83

The whole army reaches the river Ganges

TM fi1IIDk """110’ Ntlhel tM riwr Glltllfu EARLY in the morning, the prince rose and mounting an excellent chariot, set out in haste, deairous of seeing **RAMA**. Shri Bbarata’s chariot was preceded by ministers on horseback and priests in coacbcs and shone lite the vehicle of the sun. Nine thousand richly bedecked clephanls and amy thousand carts 337 with archers, together with a hundred thousand troops, accom· panied the self-controlled prince, the devotee of truth. **KAIKEYI**, **SUMITRA** and the renowned **KAUSHALYA** riding in resplendent chariots, went forward to bring **RAMA** home. The multitude of the twice born proceeding from the capital, conversed solely of Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and listened only to that which related to bim. They aaid : " When shsll we behold **SHRI RAMA**, that cloud-complexioned, mighty armed one, of fixed purpose ; the destroyer of the grief of the world ? As the rising sun ends the darkness of the esrth, so by the mere beholding of **SHRI RAMA** will our grief diaappear.” Conversing thus of **RAMA** and embzacing each other, the citizens went forward, filled with gladness. The fOremost merchants of Ayodhya who had received permission from **BHARATA** to accompany bim, also those who had not been so favoured and others, went forward happily to meet **RAMA**. Skilful engravers, potters, weavers and workets in gems, those who made fans of peacocks’ feathers, woodcutters, plasterers, workets in glass and ivory, masons and perfumers, famous goldsmiths, makets of woollen cloth, washermen,

masseurs, appliers of unguents, physicians and those who fumigated the dwellings with incense, also retailers of wine were present. Fullers, tailors, chiefs of villages, cowherds, dancing men and women, fishermen, and countless Vedic scholars of subdued mind, devoted to **RAMA**, followed Prince **BHARATA** in carts drawn by bullocks. All apparelled in pure raiment. their bodies anointed with red sandalwood, mounted on vehicles of various kinds, followed in the wake of Prince **BHARATA**. The leaders of the army joyfully accompanied the prince, now going furth to bring Prince **RAMA** home. Mounted in chariots, palanquins, bullock carts or on horses and elephants, the people proceeded a considerable distance and reached the banks of the Ganges at Shrangaverapur, where the friend of **SHRI RAMA**, Guha, dwelt with bis people, guarding bis country with vigilance. Arriving at the banks of Shri Gunga. the haunt of the chakravab' bird, those following the prince halted. The eloquent **BHARATA**, aeeing the beautiful Ganges, reviewed bis troops and aaid to bis ministers :-" Let the whole army camp here to-night, to-morrow we will cross the river. Now I desire to offer a libation to the spirit of my lilther, the king I" His counsellors replied, " Be it so, O Prince ", and caused the people to halt there, each according to his rank. The saintly **BHARATA** alone in his tent, on the banks of the Ganges retlected anxiously how be might best bring **SHRI RAMA** home.

CHAPTER 84

Guha, the chief of ferrymen, is filled with apprehension

followers : " My Friends, this great army which is occupying the river banks, is not to be numbered even in imagination. Assuredly Prince

BHARATA bas come here with evil intent, since the ftag of his dynasty flies over his tent. Either he is come to bind and destroy me, or he is going to slay **RAMA** who is exiled by his father, and helpless I Perchance the son of **KAIKEYI** desires to slay **RAMA** in order to gain complete possession of the kingdom. But **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, is my Lord, my Supporter and my Friend, I command you, therefore, to don your armour and take up arms, lining the banks of the Ganges for the protection of **RAMA**. Let my servants and the troops and is fully acquainted with the forest. he is a friend of thy brother, **SHRI RAMA**. Therefore, O Prince, let him be admitted in audience to thee, he assuredly knows the place where **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** dwell." Hearing the WOlds of the sagacious Sumantra, **BHARATA** *said*: " Go and tell Guha that I desire to meet him." The sanction of Prince **BHARATA** being given, Guha with the chiefs of hia people approached the prince and thus addressed him : " O Lord, CODSider this country as thine own domain ; not being acquainted with thine intention, I am unable to offer thee a fitting welcome. Tliis inconsiderable kingdom is thine and we also thine I We entreat thee to abide in thy servant's house. I have brought roots, fruits and ftesh both fresh and dried for thee and other products of the forest for thy use. It is my hope that thine army remain here to-night as my guests ; may we have occasion to thee, O Prince ; to-morrow thou canst go forward with thine army." CHAPTBK 85 He u filkd fl1ith joy on he4rittt/ of Prinee BMI'ata' intention THE wise Bharats listened to the WOlds of the chief of ferrymen and revealed his purpose to him, stating his reasons thus : " O Friend of my elder brother, thy hospitality is great, since thou desirest to entertain so great an army as accompanies me." Prince Bharats then addressed Guha once more in gentle and well-chosen WOlds, and said : " O Chief of the Nishadas, by what way shall I proceed to the hermimge of the Sage

Bharadwaja ? The valley of the Ganges being ftooded is clifticult to cross.” Guha, acquainted with all the paths and inaccessible parts of the fOrest, replied with great humility : " O illustrious Prince, have no ansiety I These, my kinsmen, armed with bows and arrows, fully acquainted with the forest. shall accompany thee,

CHAPTER 85

He is filled with joy on hearing Prince Bharata's intention

and is fully acquainted with the forest. he is a friend of thy brother, **SHRI RAMA**. Therefore, O Prince, let him be admitted in audience to thee, he assuredly knows the place where **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** dwell.” Hearing the WOlds of the sagacious Sumantra, **BHARATA** *said*: " Go and tell Guha that I desire to meet him.” The sanction of Prince **BHARATA** being given, Guha with the chiefs of hia people approached the prince and thus addressed him : " O Lord, CODSider this country as thine own domain ; not being acquainted with thine intention, I am unable to offer thee a fitting welcome. Tliis inconsiderable kingdom is thine and we also thine I We entreat thee to abide in thy servant’s house. I have brought roots, fruits and ftesh both fresh and dried for thee and other products of the forest for thy use. It is my hope that thine army remain here to-night as my guests ; may we have occasion to thee, O Prince ; to-morrow thou canst go forward with thine army.” CHAPTBK 85 He u filkd fl1ith joy on he4rittt/ of Prinee BMI’ata’ intention THE wise Bharats listened to the WOlds of the chief of ferrymen and revealed his purpose to him, stating his reasons thus : " O Friend of my elder brother, thy hospitality is great, since thou desirest to entertain so great

an army as accompanies me.” Prince Bharats then addressed Guha once more in gentle and well-chosen WOlds, and said : " O Chief of the Nishadas, by what way shall I proceed to the hermimge of the Sage Bharadwaja ? The valley of the Ganges being ftooded is clifticult to cross.” Guha, acquainted with all the paths and inaccessible parts of the fOrest, replied with great humility : " O illustrious Prince, have no ansiety I These, my kinsmen, armed with bows and arrows, fully acquainted with the forest. shall accompany thee, army, I am filled with apprehension. Art thou going to approach **RAMA**, urged by some evil intent ? " Shri **BHARATA**, whose heart was pure u the stainless heavens, answered him in sweet accenlll, saying : " O Guha I May the time never come when I cause him distress. Do not look on me with fear O Friend ; **RAMA**, mY elder brother, is to me equal to my tllther himself I O Guha, I go to bring back **SHRI RAMA** from the forest. Do not impute any evil motive to me I O Friend, this is the truth and the truth alone.” Guha filled with joy on hearing the words of Prince **BHARATA** and again addressed him saying : " O **BHARATA**, blessed art thou. In the whole world, I see none equal to thee, since thou desirest to relinquish a empire that has fallen to thee without any effort of thine own. Thy tame in the world will live forever, since thou, suffering distress, didst go forth to bring back **SHRI RAMA**.” While Prince **BHARATA** and Guha were thus conversing, the sun set and the night dtew on. Gratified with the converse and hospitality of Guha, his army fully refreshed, Shri **BHARATA** entered his tent to rest. But the prince, whose heart formerly had been unacquainted with grief and who wu patient and free from sin, which is the chief cause of suffering, wu yet overcome by pain on aaount ofRama. Sorrow for Raghava consumed him inwardly, u a file consumes a withered and hollow tree in the forest. The perspiration caused by the fire of grief ran down his body, u the snow flows fiom the

Himalayan peaks melting under the heat of the sun. By the mountain, the peak of which was sorrow, the recollec tion of **RAMA** the rocks, his sighs the mineral charged streams, his desolation the forest, and weariness the promontories, his deep anxiety the wild beaslll, his restlessness the herbs, by

CHAPTER 86

Guha tells of Shri Rama's stay by the sacred river

THE dweller in that dense forest, Guha, began to console the virtuous and affectionate prince, whose love for the pious LakshmaDa and Shri Ramachand"' was unwavering, and said : " O Lord, when the valiant I ,akshmana, well armed, was keepins watch over the then sleepins **RAMA**, I said to him, ' O Friend. a soft couch is prepared for thee, sleep thereon at ease, O Prince ofRashu, those dwclling in the forest are accustomed to hardship but thou art worthy of comfort, we will keep guard over Shri Rams this night. O Prince, there is none in the world so dear to us as Rams. Be not anxious, we will keep watch over Shri Rams ; do thou rest. By the grace of Rams, I hope to acquire great renown and the limitless wealth of *dharma* in this world. Therefore, O Prince, I will protect my friend, Shri Rams who is reposing with Sits I My kinsmen will keep watch ; nothins in the forest is unknown to me, who constantly traverse it ; I could challenge a great army with success, should it venture to attack Shri Rams I " " O Lord. the illustrious **LAKSHMANA**, established in virtue, answered me sayms : ' O Guha, when the virtuous Rams and Sits are resting on the naked earth, how should I occupy an easy couch ? How can any of the comforts of life or life itself be mine if Shri Rams does not also enjoy them ? O Guha, behold Shri Rams,

capable of subduing the gods and demons, resting on a bed of grass. Through great austerity and penance was Shri **DASARATHA** blessed with a son, like unto himself. Assuredly, tbe king will not Ions survive the exile of Shri Rams, and tbe land will soon become widowed. The women will lament loudly and then grow silent. I fear lest my Father, Queen **KAUSHALYA** and my mother **SUMITRA** will not survive. Perchance my mother will continue to live in ezpectation of the return of **SHATRUGHNA**, but **KAUSHALYA**, the mother of that great hero will surely die I The kiDs desired to transfer the throne to Prince **BHARATA**, but this ambition will not be realised by him, A great and honourable duty will be fulfilled in performins 343 the funeral ceremonies for my sire. The capital of the king abounding with beautiful terraces and parks, pleasant highways and tall houses encrusted with gems, crowded with horses, elephants and chariots, resounding with music, furnished with pleasure grounds, where happy and healthy people gather, is hlessed by those who walt therein. O Guha, shall we, returning with **RAMA**, the fulfiller of firm vows, when the fourteen years of exile are over, joyfully enter Ayodhya in his company ? " **GUHA** *said*: " O Prince, thus keeping watch, the mighty **LAKSHMANA**, bearing his bow and arrows, passed the night. When the clear sun rose, the two princely brothers, on this selfsame bank of the sacred river caused their beautiful locks to be matted and were then conveyed by me, in safety, over the Ganges. The royal brothers, heroic, resplendent and the subduers of their enemies, their hair matted, attired in bark, armed with bow and quiver, departed with **SITA**, looking back at me, like mighty elephants." CHAP TBK 8 7 HDfiJ Shri RDma ljJS1It his firt night uf xil HAVING heard the moving tale related by Guha, Prince **BHARATA** began to re1lect on **RAMA**. That tender prince of powerful arms, whose shoulders resembled a linn's and whose eyes were like the lotus, who was patient, youthful and charming

in appearance yet sad at heart, at leDgth sank to the ground unconscious, like an elephant stricken to the heart by a goad. Prince Shatrugbna ever in attendance on **BHARATA**, deeply afBicted by his state, embracing his body, wept aloud. Then all the mothers of Prince **BHARATA**, emaciated with fasting and sorrow for their deceased lord, surrounded him. lying unconscious on the earth. The pinus Queen Kauahalya approaching, raised **BHARATA** up and pressed him to her breast. The aacetic queen,

CHAPTER 87

How Shri Rama spent his first night of exile

the funeral ceremonies for my sire. The capital of the king abounding with beautiful terraces and parks, pleasant highways and tall houses encrusted with gems, crowded with horses, elephants and chariots, resounding with music, furnished with pleasure grounds, where happy and healthy people gather, is hlessed by those who walt therein. O Guha, shall we, returning with **RAMA**, the fulfiller of firm vows, when the fourteen years of exile are over, joyfully enter Ayodhya in his company ? " **GUHA** *said*: " O Prince, thus keeping watch, the mighty **LAKSHMANA**, bearing his bow and arrows, passed the night. When the clear sun rose, the two princely brothers, on this selfsame bank of the sacred river caused their beautiful locks to be matted and were then conveyed by me, in safety, over the Ganges. The royal brothers, heroic, resplendent and the subduers of their enemies, their hair matted, attired in bark, armed with bow and quiver, departed with **SITA**, looking back at me, like mighty elephants.” CHAP TBK 8 7 HDfiJ Shri RDma ljJS1It his firt night uf xil HAVING heard the moving tale related by Guha, Prince **BHARATA** began to re1lect on **RAMA**. That tender prince of

powerful arms, whose shoulders resembled a linn's and whose eyes were like the lotus, who was patient, youthful and charming in appearance yet sad at heart, at leDgth sank to the ground unconscious, like an elephant stricken to the heart by a goad. Prince Shatrugbna ever in attendance on **BHARATA**, deeply afBicted by his state, embracing his body, wept aloud. Then all the mothers of Prince **BHARATA**, emaciated with fasting and sorrow for their deceased lord, surrounded him. lying unconscious on the earth. The pinus Queen Kauahalya approaching, raised **BHARATA** up and pressed him to her breast. The aacetic queen, THE RAM.AYANA OP VALM.IKI her own child, ...cpillg. enquired of him, saying : " O M.y Son, art thou a111icted by pain ? The life of tbis royal family wholly depends on thee I O Child, Sbri **RAMA** has gone to the forest with **LAKSHMANA**, I Jive only if I behold thy face. King **DASARATHA** being dead, thou alone art the protector of the people. O Child, hast thou heard aught against **LAKSHMANA** or my only son, who, with his wife is gone to the forest ? " The renowned **BHARATA** returning to his normal consciousness, consoled the weeping Kausbalya and then addressed Guha : " O Guha, where did my brother pass the night here ? What did he eat, on what couch did he rest ? Where did **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA** dwell ? " Guha, the King of Nishadas, glaclly related how he had eotertained his gracious guest, Sbri **RAMA**. He said, " O **BHARATA**, rice, other foods and fruit in abundance were placed by me, before Sbri **RAMA**. To please me, that hero of the res1m of truth, Sbri)l!amacbandra, aecepted the gifts, but recollecting his duty as a *kshatriya* did not partake of them. **HE** *said*: " O Frieod, we are warriors and it is our duty to give all to others, not accepting any gift for ourselves." That night, the great-hearted **RAMA**, having with **SITA** drunk the water brought by Sbri Labhmana, retired to rest, fasting. Sbri **LAKSHMANA** finishing the water that was left over, all observed sileoa: and performed

the eveoing devotion with con centration. Thereafter the son of **SUMITRA** brought kusha graas and spread it on the earth to serve as a couch for Ramo. As Sbri **RAMA** and **SITA** rested there, Sbri **LAKSHMANA** washed their feet in pure water and then moved to a distance to' mount guard over them. O Prince, here is that lngudi tree, and here is the couch of grass on which **RAMA** and **SITA** slept. That hero, Sbri **LAKSHMANA** with his quiver filled with arrows, bound to his body, donning gloves made of goha-skin, drawing the string of his bow, paced round and round at a distance, guarding the royal pair. I also, O Prince, surrounded by my kinsmen, armed with an excellent bow, kept watch through the llight, protectiDg Sbri **RAMACHANDRA**, who resembled lndra. 344

CHAPTER 88

Prince Bharau sleeps on the same spot where Shri Rama had rested

SHill with his counsellors reverently approached the Ingudi tree and looked with love on the grassy couch. He said to his mothers : " This grass was pressed by the royal frame of the illusuious Ramacbandra, who passed the first night of ode in this place. It ill became the great and wise son of King **DASARATHA** to sleep on the bate earth I How could Shri Ra,ma, who ever reposed on a soft couch, sleep on the naked ground ? **SHRI RAMA** who dwelt in a seven-storied palace, the ftoors of which were studded with gold and silver ftowers, overlaid with soft carpets of many a hue on which marvellous floral designs were woveo, the whole fragrant with the perfume of sandalwood and ambergris, and which resembled the clouds ; where the cries of parrots and mainas were

constantly heard and cool air ftowed uninterruptedly through shafts ; where the walls inlaid with gold and silver resembled the Meru mountain : in such a palace, **SHRI RAMA** was accustomed to rest, awakened each moming by the sweet music of the royal musicians and the gentle tinkling of women's BDldets, and duly praised by the batds, panegyrists and ministers, in verse and song. To-day, he sleeps on the naked earth and hears the cry of jacbls and other wild beasts. This matter is past belief, it resembles a dream I I consider nothing more powerful than the will of the Lord ; how otherwise should the son of King **DASARATHA** be seen sleepillg on the earth ? How could the daughter of King Janab, that beautiful princess, the beloved daughter-in law of King **DASARATHA**, sleep on the naked ground ? " O Mother, here is my brother's couch, on it he tossed, crushing the grass by the weight of his limbs. It would aeem that Shri **SITA** rested here also, weariDg her ornaments, since I perceive particles of gold lying here and there. O Mother, see **SITA**'s scarf became entangled here, for in this place I see threads of silk I Whether it be bard or soft, the couch of her lord is sweet to a woman I See I The young and tender **SITA**, 345 devoted to her husband, experienced no smart, resting here. Oh I I am undone ! What a merciless wretch am I ! On my account, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** and his spouse lay on this hard couch I Alas that **SHRI RAMA**, deprived of kingly felicity, though born of a royal line, dear to all and the cause of universal joy, whose complexion resembles the blue lotus, whose eyes are slightly red, charming to look upon, not meriting tribulation, should have to sleep on the naked earth. " messed and fortunate is **LAKSHMANA**, who followed his brother in the days of adversity ! Frnitful is the life of Princess **SITA** who, thus accompanied her lord to the forest. Wretched are we, bereft of **SHRI RAMA** ; nor are we certain that he will allow us to serve him. King **DASARATHA**, being dead, and

SHRI RAMA having entered the forest, the earth appears to me like a boat without a pilot. None desires to usurp the place spiritually reserved for him, who dwells in the forest. To-day the capital is empty and unproteCted, horses and elephants wander here and there unconfined, there being none to control them ; the gates of the city are left open and unguarded ; the army is melancholy and indifferent to the defence of the capital! Ayodhya externally without protection and bereft of purpose, is in a sorry state. Even its enemies turn from it, as men turn away ftom poisoned food ! " From to-day, assuming an ascetic garb, I will sleep on the earth and live on frnit and roots. I shall live in the forest for the remainder of the term which **RAMA** has to discharge, so that his vow may be fulfilJed. My brother **SHATRUGHNA** shall dwell with me in the forest, while **LAKSHMANA** returns with **RAMA** to protect the capital ! The learned *brahmins* will install **SHRI RAMA** in Ayodhya ! I entreat the gods to fulfil the desire of my heart. If Rams, however, will not grant my request, I will remain in the forest as his servant, but how should he reject my appeal ? Is he not compassionate towards his devotees ? "

CHAPTER 89

The army crosses the holy river

BHABATA having slept on the same spot where **SHRI RAMA** had lately rested, and the night being over, called **SHATRUGHNA**, and said to him : “Arise, O Brother, may good attend thee I The day has dawned, sleep no more ! Please summon G11ha, the ehief of the Nishadas, so that he may convey our army across the river!' **SHATRUGHNA** *answered*: " O Noble One, I am awake. I was not able to sleep, for like thee I have beeo meditating on **SHRI RAMA**!” As these two, the chiefs of men, stood

conversing together, Guha approaching, said with humility : " O Prince, didst thou rest at ease, on the river hank ? Did any disturbance visit thee or thine army ? " Heating these words of G1lha uttered with alfection, Shri **BHARATA** answered him, saying : " O King. we have passed this night in peace, having beeo highly honoured by thee. Now let thy servants convey our army over the river." G1lha hastily returned to his city and spake thus to his servants and relatives : " Brothers, arise, awake, may you ever be fortunate I Bring boats to the hank and convey the army over the river!" Thus addressed, the ferrymen arose and gathering five hundred boats together, brought them to the hank. A specisl barge that was seaworthy, named" Swastika", hung with large bells and flying banners with apertures for air, was also furnished, whereon white woollen ruga were spread like carpets, small bells tinkling melodioualy when it sailed. This barque was steered by G1lha himself. On it stepped the illustrious Princes **BHARATA** and **SHATRUGHNA** with the Queens **KAUSHALYA** and **SUMITRA**, and other ladies of high degree, preceded by their spiritual preceptors, the priests and learned *brahmins* ; finaJJy, the baggage was loaded. At the time of departure, the noise of those burning the residue left by the army, of those who plunged into the holy Ganges and the porters bearing the baggage, ascended to the sky. The 347 boats, crowded with attendants, guarded by picked ferrymen, sailing swiftly, conveyed them over the rivet. Many vessels contained women only, while otllers were filled with horses or bullocks, carts, cattle and mules. Reacbing the other bank of the river, the people disembarked, the ferrymen and Guha's relatives playing diverse games in the water as they returned. Some of the elepbants, resembling mountains as they moved, were driven across by their mahouts, others crosscd in boats, some on rafts and some swam. Guba's servants ferried the army over the river, before taking their

morning bath. During the period of Maitra, following on the swuise, the army crossed the sacred stream and entered the cbarming forest. Arriving at holy Prayags, the magnanimous **BHARATA** spoke encouraging words to the army and ordered them to camp at ease. Then the prince accompanied by the Guru Vasishtba and other priests, went to see the Sage Bharadwaja. Approaching the hermitage of that learned and illumined sage, the son of Brihaspati, they beheld in the dense and deligbtful forest, cbarming huts thatched with leaves. CHAPTBR 510

CHAPTER 90

Prince Bharata with Shri Vasishtha visit Bharadwaja's hermitage

boats, crowded with attendants, guarded by picked ferrymen, sailing swiftly, conveyed them over the rivet. Many vessels contained women only, while otllers were filled with horses or bullocks, carts, cattle and mules. Reacbing the other bank of the river, the people disembarked, the ferrymen and Guha’s relatives playing diverse games in the water as they returned. Some of the elepbants, resembling mountains as they moved, were driven across by their mahouts, others crosscd in boats, some on rafts and some swam. Guba’s servants ferried the army over the river, before taking their morning bath. During the period of Maitra, following on the swuise, the army crossed the sacred stream and entered the cbarming forest. Arriving at holy Prayags, the magnanimous **BHARATA** spoke encouraging words to the army and ordered them to camp at ease. Then the prince accompanied by the Guru Vasishtba and other priests, went to see the Sage Bharadwaja. Approaching the hermitage of that learned and illumined sage, the son of Brihaspati, they

beheld in the dense and deligbtful forest, cbarming huts thatched with leaves. CHAPTBR 510 for the ritual appointments presented them with the arghya, and refreshed them with fruits ; he then enquired respecting their welfare and if all were well in Ayodhya. Then he asked concerning the state treasury and the ministers, but, knowing the king to be dead, he made no enquiry concerning him. In return, Shri **VASISHTHA** and **BHARATA** enquired as to the health of the sage, the state of his body, the sacred fire, his disciples, the deer and the birds. The great ascetic Bharadwaja informed them respecting all these things and then, prompted by the affection he bote for **SHRI RAMA**, said to **BHARATA** : " O Prince, what occasinn has brought thee hither, who art now the ruler of the kingdom ? Tell me all. King **DASARATHA**, urged by hia consort, banished Prince **RAMA** to the forest, for the period of fourteen years. I trust that thou, desirous of enjoying the kingdom without reserve, art not the harbouter of ill-will to thy brother ? " Bitterly wounded by the *rishi*'s words, Prince **BHARATA**, his eyes suffused with tears, his throat choked with emotion, said : " O Lord, thou art all-knowing, if thou dost thus regard me, then my 6fe is vain. I am in no way implicated in the fate of **SHRI RAMA**. Such villainy would never proceed from me. O My Lord, why dost thou charge me thus ? That which my mother has done, on my aecount, is not approved by me, nor should I ever condone it. I go to gratify that gteat prince, by oft"ering salutations to him and with the intentinn of bringing him back to the capital. O Divine One, this is my purpose, be pleased to tell me whete **RAMA**, now the lord of the earth, is to be found ? " Requested likewise by Shri **VASISHTHA** and the other priests, Shri Bharadwaja, captivated by the words of **BHARATA**, answered: " O Great One, thou art born in the illustrious family of Raghu, and it is therefore not a source of wonder that dutiful regard for thy preceptor, self-control and the following of the path of the wise, are

all united in thee I By my yogic powers, the contenta of thy heart were known to me, but I questinned thee, that thy resolutinn might be established, and thy fame proclaimed throughout the whole world. It is known to me whete Shri THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI thither to-morrow. To-day, stay here with thy counsellors. O Wise One, do thou accede to my request." Then **BHARATA**, the prince of great renown, accepted the oft'er of the sage and remsined all thst night at his hermitage.

CHAPTER 91

Bbaradwaja entertains the whole army

Lord, thou hast already eniertained me with water, fruit and berries, I am wbolly satisfied." Shri Bharsdwsja smilingly answered : " I know thee to be pleased with whatever is lovingly offered thee, but, O Prince, I desire to entertain thy whole army, it is meet that thou accede to my request. O Gteat Prince, why art thou come, leaving thine army at a distance ? Why didst thou come unattended by thine army? " Hearing these words, Prince Bharsta answered with humility : " O Lord, I did not come attended by mine army, in deference to thee. It becomes a king or a king's son to protect the hermitages of his kingdom I O Lord I I am accompanied by many horses and wild elephants occupying a vast area. Fearing lest they should destroy the trees, the thatched huts and defile the water of the ponds and wells, I came alone, leaving them behind." Then the Maharishi Bharsdwsja aaid : " Bring thine army hither." Thus commanded, the prince brought his army thither. Entering the sacrificial pavilion. the *rishi* drank three times of the water there, and reciting a certain formula, sprinkled aome dwcllings for the army. I desire to olfer

Prince Bbarara hospitality, I therefore call upon the deities **YAMA**, Vlll1IDll, Kuvera and also **INDRA**. Let them assist me in providing the entertainment. I also summon all the rivers, ftowing above or below from east to west and from west to east. Let some of these prodnce the delicious wine nsmed Maireya' and thst nsmed Sours, and also cool, sweet water, like the juice of the sugar cane. I summon further the heavenly musicians called Haha and Hnhu, together with other divine beings and nymphs. I summon the dancing apsans, Ghritachi, Vishwachi, Mishra· keshi, Alambusha, Nagadanta, Hema and *Soma*, who dwell in the Himalayas. I call on the dancing nymphs attendant on **BRAHMA** and lndra ; let them attire themselves in beautiful apparel, bringing their instruments. I desire the celestial forest Chaitraraths to appear here, the leaves of whose trees are formed like beautiful damsels. I desire further foods of many kinds thst can be chewed, sucked or licked, and various drinks to be prepared by the deity presiding over the moon. Let garlands of fresh ftowers be made ready and beautiful goblets and dilferent dishes of ftesh be produced here instantaneOUsly I " By his yogic power and the proper recitation of the sacred mantras, the holy Sage Bharadwaja produced all thst was necessary. Facing the east in the posture of invitation, Shri Bharadwaja sat in meditation for a space. Then, one by one, the gods appeared before him. The cool, slow and fragrant breezes blowing from the Malaya and Dadura mountains, tempered the best. The clouds rained down ftowers and the sound of the divine dundubhis (*drums*) was heard ; delightful zephyrs began to blow, nymphs danced, the celestial musicians sang and the notes of the vina were heard everywhere. The earth and the sky were filled with sweet and harmonious sounds, heard by all living beings. As the divine music continued, Bhsrata's army beheld the wonderful structure wrought by VIBhwabrma. They perceived the whole area within a radius of four

miles, to be covered with a carpet of green and glistening grass sparkling like a green emerald. Its beauty was enhanced by sllwa,tapitba, amlakiand mmgo trees. A wood appeared wherein people could wander, also a divine flowing between banks adorned by various trees. Beautiful white mansions were erected, with stables for elephants and bones. Palaces with their balconies decorated with leaves and flowers were to be seen, and others adorned with green and flowery sprays and garlands of pure white blossoms sprinkled with scented water. Theae dwellings contained square courts serving as reception balls with space for palanquins, and coaches. Food of all kinds, rice, the juice of sugar cane and every variety of confection was to be found there, with curry puffs, pancakes and other delicious disbes served in clean vessels, while excellent catpets and seats were spread for relaxation, and coucl1es with spotless coverings and quilts. Entering these mansinns with the permission of the Sage Bharadwaja, Prince **BHARATA** was followed by his servants, ministers and priests who, perceiving all to be well furnished, were highly gratified. In one of the mansions, a room was set apart contsining a throne where retainers holding the canopy and chamara were in attendance. **BHARATA** with his ministers, circumambulated the royal dais as if it were occupied by Shri Rams and bowing it respectfUlly, Shri **BHARATA**, holding the chamara, occupied a lower seat, the counsellors, priests and army commsnders assuming positions in accordance with their respective rank. Now, at the commsnd of the holy sage, streams of milt, thickened with rice, flowed before **BHARATA**'s eyes. Beautiful houses, washed with quicklime, appeared on the river banb. Twenty thousand youthfUl women, enchantingly attired and wearing beautiful ornaments came there at the instance of Brahms. Kuvera also sent twenty thousand lovely damsels adorned with gold, gems and pearls. Further twenty tbousand nymphs from the region

oflndra appeared, whose beauty caused men to lose their reason. Narada, Gopha and other brilliant musicians began to sing and play before **BHARATA**, and the celestial nymphs to dance in the presence of the prince, at the *rishi*'s commsnd. All the flowers most highly esteemed in the celestial gardens among the gods, were seen at Prayaga, through the power of Bharadwaja. The trees applauded, the bahadur tree per formed on the cymbals and the pipal danced, through the influence of the sage, and those named devaparna, tala and lruraka assumed the form of dwarfs ! Plants by the name of sbingsapa, amaJaki and jambu, and twining creepers such as the jasmine and mallika, taking on the shape of womeo in the hermitage ofBbaradwaja, cried out: "O Wine-Bibbers, drink I O Hungry Ones, eat kbeeva ! Come, till yourselves with the various kinds of meat I " Each person was bathed in the cool river and attended by seven or eight beautiful msidens with Iuatroua eyes, who massaged their body with oil and unguents. Their bath completed, many women dried them with soft cloths and gave them sweetened water, tasting like ambrosia, to drink. The keepers attended carefully to the horses, elephants, mules, camels and bullocks. Those steeds belonging to the royal stables and ridden by great genetals, were fed by the grooms on bundles of sugar cane and parched and sweetened rice, their attendants and mahouts could hardly recognize their charges. The soldiery were now intoxicated with wine and indulging in every pleasure I Each was gratified in whatever be desired ; their bodies anointed with sandalwood paste and united with the nymphs in amorous dalliance, they exclaimed : " We will neither go to Ayodbya nor enter the Dandab forest I Let Bbarata live at ease and Sbri **RAMA** dwell in the forest!" Thus did the warrion and grooms express themselves in the state of inebriation, while thousands of soldiers, in emltation, shouted aloud : " Verily, this is heaven I " Running hither and thither with garlauds rouud their necks,

innumerable soldiers danced, sang and laughed. Though they bad partaken to the llllkempt, none was seen with an unclean countenance or uncombed hair I The men beheld countless dishes of mutton, pork, venison and other mests cooked in fruit-juices and fried in butter with cloves, csraway seeds and lentils simmering gently in them. Thousands of vessels were filled with spiced rice, garnished with fiowers and ftags. All were speechless with wonder on beholding them I Within a radius of five miles, the wells were filled with frumenty (*kheeva*) and cows like Kamadhenu fWfilled evety desire I The trees dripped honey and the lakes were filled with the spatlding wine Maireya, and banked with dressed viands sucb as deer, chickens and pescocks. Hundreds and thousands of disbes were provided, and myriads of vessels filled with cutds, mixed with csraway seeds, ginger and other fragrant spices, were served there. Lakes of yoghourt and milk, together with hesps of sugar, were to be seen on the river banks, as also fragraot crushed lesves and unguents with large pots of sandal wood paste, mirrors and towels ! An abundance of sandals and shoes were provided, whilst antimony, combs, brushes, parasols, bows and quivers, armour and ornamental sests were placed here and there I Tanks, full of liquid mixed with herbs to promote digestion, were taken to the banks of lakes where descent was essy, and where the people could bathe freely and drink when they plessed ! These lakes were filled with pure water, abounding in lotuses and fringed with tender grass of blue and emerald hue ; here, resting places for the beasts were also to be found. Prince **BHARATA**'s companions were astounded at the entertain ment provided by the Maharishi Bharadwaja. All passed the night in amusement, as in the garden of lndra ! At dawn, the rivers, celestial musicians and nymphs took lesve of the maharishi and returned to their own abode. But Prince **BHARATA**'s followers were still flushed and inebriated, their bodies painted with aandalwood, the flower

garlands in hespa like

CHAPTER 92

Prince Bharata with the army departs for Mount Chittrakuta

RAMA, approached the *muni*. With joined palms, he stood before the holy *rishi* who was engaged in the fire ritual. The Sage Bharadwaja enquired of him, saying : " O Sinless Prince, didst thou pass the night in my hermitage in peace ? Are all satisfied with the meagre entertainment provided by and trembling Kausbalya and **SUMITRA** touched the feet of the holy man. Then **KAIKEYI**, thwarted in her designs and despised by the whole world, touched the feet of the sage and circum ambulated him. Grief-stricken, she stood at a little distance from **BHARATA**, as the holy Bharadwaja addtessed the prince, saying : " O Prince, I desire to be acquainted with thy mothers." The ever eloquent **BHARATA** answered humbly : " O Holy Lord, here is my father's chief queen, wretched and weakened through fasting, yet resembling a goddess. She is the mother of that lion among men, the highly intrepid Prince **RAMA** ! Comparable to Aditi who brought forth Ptajapati, she has given birth to Raghava I She, who leaning on her arm, stands with a sorrowful heart, like the brsnch of the karnikara tree stripped of its flowers, is the Queen **SUMITRA**, the mother of those heroes of truth, Shri **LAKSHMANA** and **SHATRUGHNA**. O Great Sage, she who has brought great atlliction on these two chiefs of men and caused the death of King **DASARATHA** by separating him from his sons, who is given to anger and who is vain and shallow, esteeming herself favoured, who is highly ambitious and fickle and yet looks upon herself as free from imperfection, that cruel and

wicked **KAIKEYI**, is my mother ! O Great *Muni*, it is she who has caused my great misfortune ! " Unable to utter further, his throat choked with emotinn, the prince began to sigh heavily, his eyes in11amed, breathing like a provoked serpent. Then the holy sage, acquainted with what should come to pass, answered saying : " My Son, do not reproach Queen **KAIKEYI**, the exile of **SHRI RAMA** will be productive of great good and the gods and dauavas and the illustrious sages will gain great benefit from the presence of **SHRI RAMA** in the forest I " Hearing this, **BHARATA** bowed low to the *rishi* and receiving his blessing, circumambulated him with reverence. Then craving permission from the sage to depart, he ordered his army to prepare to march. The leaders of the forces mounted their horses, while others, ascending golden chariots, started on their joumey. Elephants with howdahs fixed by golden chaina and adomed with Buttering Bags went forward, the bells hanging from the male and female tuskers causing a sound like the thunder of the clouds at the end 356 of the rainy season I The other vehicles large and small, conveying members of the niyal family advanced also. Shri **BHARATA**, intent on seeing **RAMA**, riding in a resplendent palanquin shining like the sun or moon, with bis great army, moved towards the south, awering the earth like a vast cloud. The horses and elephants were all contented and the vast concourse inspiring the wild deer and birds with terror, looked splendid as it entered the deep forest. CHAPTER !13 They behold the hermitage af **SHRI RAMA** As the mighty army traversed the forest, the leaders of the herds of wild elephants with theit companions, ran away in alarm. Bears, leopards and other fierce beasts could be seen lleeing on the hilltops and by the banks of the river. Supremely gratified, Prince **BHARATA** proceeded in the midst of bis soldiers who shouted as they marched. The army of the illustrious **BHARATA**, resembled an ocean, whose waves spread over the earth or

like the clouds covering the sky during the rainy season. The ground for miles was covered with elephants and horses, so that no trace of it could be seen. Having marched a considerable distance, Shri **BHARATA**, perceiving bis aoimals to be fatigued, addressed the holy priest, Shri **VASISHTHA**, saying : " This country appears to be as beautiful as described to me, I deem that we have reached that place spoken of by the Sage Bharadwaja. This mountain is Cbittratuta, and this is the Mandaldni. river, and this is the forest which, from a distance, resembled a blue cloud. Theae are the glorious peab of Cbittratuta, which are being trodden by my great elephants I See, O Holy Guru, as the dart clouda pour down water in the rainy season, so do the elephants, whose trallka are scarred by the waving branches of the trees, acatter 1lowen on the hills. " O SJaatraahna, behold the lovely Chittratuta mountain

CHAPTER 93

They behold the hermitage of Shri Rama

Of the rainy season I The other vehicles large and small, conveying members of the niyal family advanced also. Shri **BHARATA**, intent on seeing **RAMA**, riding in a resplendent palanquin shining like the sun or moon, with bis great army, moved towards the south, awering the earth like a vast cloud. The horses and elephants were all contented and the vast concourse inspiring the wild deer and birds with terror, looked splendid as it entered the deep forest. CHAPTER !13 They behold the hermitage af **SHRI RAMA** As the mighty army traversed the forest, the leaders of the herds of wild elephants with theit companions, ran away in alarm. Bears, leopards and other fierce beasts could be seen lleeing on

the hilltops and by the banks of the river. Supremely gratified, Prince **BHARATA** proceeded in the midst of bis soldiers who shouted as they marched. The army of the illustrious **BHARATA**, resembled an ocean, whose waves spread over the earth or like the clouds covering the sky during the rainy season. The ground for miles was covered with elephants and horses, so that no trace of it could be seen. Having marched a considerable distance, Shri **BHARATA**, perceiving bis aoimals to be fatigued, addressed the holy priest, Shri **VASISHTHA**, saying : " This country appears to be as beautiful as described to me, I deem that we have reached that place spoken of by the Sage Bharadwaja. This mountain is Cbittratuta, and this is the Mandaldni. river, and this is the forest which, from a distance, resembled a blue cloud. Theae are the glorious peab of Cbittratuta, which are being trodden by my great elephants I See, O Holy Guru, as the dart clouda pour down water in the rainy season, so do the elephants, whose trallka are scarred by the waving branches of the trees, acatter 1lowen on the hills. " O SJaatraahna, behold the lovely Chittratuta mountain THB llAMAYANA OP VALMIKI sought after by the gods ; everywhere herds of deer wander about enhancing its beauty, like crocodiles swimming graccfully io the sea. As clouds driven by the wind io winter adorn the sky, so do these deer rwming before the army, render the forest delightful. " Out soldiers decorating their heads with flowers, resemble the people of the south wbo crown themsdves with blossoms. See, O Shatrugbna, the forest that appeared terrifying and seemed to breathe by beiog filled with men, resembles Ayodhya itself! " The dust risiog from the boofs of the bullocks ccwers the sky and settles there, till the wind quickly dispels it, as if those thiogs obstructing my viaion of Shri Rams were beiog removed from my eyes. O **SHATRUGHNA**, behold these horses yoked to the chariots with their charioteers, swiftly passing through the forest I

And see tbose beautiful peacocks with long feathers, rwming in fear towards their habitation on the mountain. O Sinless Brother, this place appears enchanting to me and a fit abode for ascetics. " How lovdy are the spotted deer wandering about with their hinds ; they appear if studded with ftowers. Let my leaders go forward and seek out the place where Shri Rams and Labhmana dwell." Hearing the words of Shri Bbarata, the warriors bearing weapons io their hands, entered the forest and there perceived a spot where smoke was ascendiog. On beholding this, they returned to Prince Bbarata and communicated him their belief, that the two royal brothers dwelt where the smoke arose. **THEY** *said*: " If ir be not Shri Rams and Laksbmana yonder, then surdy it is some devotee wbo can ioform us concerning the dwelliog place of llaghava I " Hearing this pleasing report, Shri Bbarata addressed the leaders of the army saying : " Do you remain here, do not proceed further, I, with the boly Guru **VASISHTHA** and Sllllll8lltla will go forward to that place." Thus commanded the warriors halted and Shri **BHARATA** looked towards the spot wbere the smoke was visible. Observing the smoke, the warriors, waiting at that place, rejoiced, bdieviog the time for the meedng with Shri llama was at hand. 3S8

CHAPTER 94

Shri Rama decides to spend his exile on the mountain

they themselves appearing as lovely as **INDRA** and his consort. **SHRI RAMA** *said*: " O Fortunate Ooe, beholding the beauty of this pleasant mountain, no longet does the separation from my friends or my country cause me pain I O Centre of Delight I behold the loveliness of these

peaks abounding in metals of various kinds, reaching the skies and frequented by birds of every species! These peaks, some of which shine like silver, some of which are ruddy, some yellow, some glittering with the splendour of the brilliant gems concealed in them ; some sparkling with sapphire and crystal, and some resembling quick silver and glittering like the stars I Though many lions and leopards abound in the forest, yer in11uenced by the pure nature of the ascetics dwelling here, they have ceased to follow their cruel instincts. Many varieties of birds have their nesiS on yonder hiD, laden with fruit and flowers afl'ording delightful abade, render the mountain enchanting I " Here are mango, jambu, asana, lohdra, piysla, panasa, dhuva, ankotha, bhavya, tinisha, hilwa, tindura, bamboo, kasanari, arista, varana, madhuca, tilaka, vadari, amlaka, nipa, vetra, dhanwaria, vijab and other trees. " O Auspicious Princess, behold the ravishing loveliness of these hills where the wise kinneras wander in pairs, their swords and coloured apparel hanging on the branches. See the dwell here with thee and **LAKSHMANA** for innumerable years, no grief or anxiety will visit me. O Lovely Lady, on the mountain of Cbittraknta, rendered pleasant by a profusion of dowers and fruits, whose delightful peaks echo with the sweet song of birds, I am content to dwell ! By residing here, two objects have been acbieved, the fulfilment of my father's vow and the satisfaction of Prince **BHARATA**. O Daughter of King Videha, behold this enchanting spot where self-control and asceticism are easily exercised. Say, art thou happy here ? The discipline of residence in the forest is declared by royal sages to be a means to liberation. Our ancestors such as Manu have held that residence in the forest is the means of acquiring the form of the gods. Behold, O Princess, yonder mountain, adorned by thousands of rocks blue, yellow, purple and white. At night, the hesling herbs shine like fire, lighting the crags with their radiance. See, O Princess, some of

the caves resemble houses, some appear like dower gardens, all enhancing the glory of the mountain. It would seem that Chittrakuta has sprung forth from the earth and from every side appears incomparably beautiful. Observe, O Auspicious One, how those devoted to pleasure, have spread couches here and there, and covered them with azure lotuses overlaid with coverings of bark. See the faded garlands cast aside by them and the rinds of many fruits of which they have partakeo. " This mountain Cbittraknta, in variety of dowers and trans parent has surpassed the capital of **INDRA** in loveliness. O Sits, I will pass the twelve years here with Prince **LAKSHMANA** and thee ; pursuing the highest virtue and discipline, I shall thus protect my kingdom and earn merit." CBAPTBR 95 H points out tho btauties of nature to **SITA**

CHAPTER 95

He points out the beauties of nature to Sita

dwell here with thee and **LAKSHMANA** for innumerable years, no grief or anxiety will visit me. O Lovely Lady, on the mountain of Cbittraknta, rendered pleasant by a profusion of dowers and fruits, whose delightful peaks echo with the sweet song of birds, I am content to dwell ! By residing here, two objects have been acbieved, the fulfilment of my father's vow and the satisfaction of Prince **BHARATA**. O Daughter of King Videha, behold this enchanting spot where self-control and asceticism are easily exercised. Say, art thou happy here ? The discipline of residence in the forest is declared by royal sages to be a means to liberation. Our ancestors such as Manu have held that residence in the forest is the means of acquiring the form of the gods. Behold, O Princess, yonder mountain, adorned by thousands of rocks blue, yellow,

purple and white. At night, the hesling herbs shine like fire, lighting the crags with their radiance. See, O Princess, some of the caves resemble houses, some appear like dower gardens, all enhancing the glory of the mountain. It would seem that Chittrakuta has sprung forth from the earth and from every side appears incomparably beautiful. Observe, O Auspicious One, how those devoted to pleasure, have spread couches here and there, and covered them with azure lotuses overlaid with coverings of bark. See the faded garlands cast aside by them and the rinds of many fruits of which they have partakeo. " This mountain Cbittraknta, in variety of dowers and trans parent has surpassed the capital of **INDRA** in loveliness. O Sits, I will pass the twelve years here with Prince **LAKSHMANA** and thee ; pursuing the highest virtue and discipline, I shall thus protect my kingdom and earn merit." CBAPTBR 95 H points out tho btauties of nature to **SITA** of King Janab, whose counii:DIDCe resembled the moon, saying : " O Princess, behold the river Mandakini with its delightful baDb frequented by sWliDS, cranes and other water fOwl, aboUDding in flowering of different kinds, which cause it to resemble the river Sangandhika in the region of Kuvera. Its pleasant fords, where I desire to bathe, the waters of which have been rendered muddy by the herds of deer who have come to drink and recently departed, all these attract the heart. O Dear One, the ascetics attired in robes of bark and deerskin, bathe at stated seasons in this river. O Princess of beautiful eyes, here the *munis* observing strict and austere vows, stand with uplifted arms, worshipping the sun. The agitated by the breeze, cause the hills to appear as if they were dancing. The blossoms scattered by the force of the wind make it seem as if Chittrakuta were offering dowers to the river. O Auspicious One, here the waters of Mandakini sparkle like gems and there they form a sandy beach. Groups of petfect beings fnquent the ballb. O Princess, behold the heaps of

flowers shaken down from the branches by the wind, and others floating through the air and falling into the river to be carried away by the water. O Kalyani, behold the wild geese standing in the shallows, uttering sweet cries to summon their mates or diverting themselves with them. O Lovely **SITA**, when I behold the Chittrakuta mountain and the river Mandakini in company with thee, I esteem it a greater joy than any Ayodhya could yield me. Come, O **SITA**, and let us two bathe in the river Mandakini, frequented by petfect beings who are endowed with inner and outer control and are devoted to the prsctice of austerity. O Princess, thou didst fOrmerly play with thy maids of honour in Ayodhya, to-day amuse thyself with me in the Mandakini river, pelting me with ted and white lotuses and splashing the waters over me. O Dear One, imagine those dwelling here to be the citizens of Ayodhya and the Mandakini to be the river Sarayu. O **SITA**, I am happy with thee, who art obedient to my command as is also Prince **LAKSHMANA** Beloved, bathing thrice a day with thee in the river and living on honey, fruits and berries, I feel no desire fur the comforts of the kingdom of Ayodhya. Who will not be happy, dwelling on tbe baDb of the river Mandakini, where herda of elephants 361 wander and lions and JDODkeys come to quench their thirst, and where flowers grow throughout the year ? " Thus Sbri **RAMA** amverscd on many wondrous things concerning the .Mandakini river with **SITA** and taking the hand of the princess, wandered with her over the blue and beautiful Chittrakuta mountain. CBAPTEit 96 Thsy see the llni!Y approaching tmd Lakslmuma to daiToy it shown **SITA** the beauties of the river Mandakini, Rsma and **SITA** seated themselves on a rock. Feasting Videhi' with venison, Sbri **RAMA**, in order to please her, spoke in this wise : " This meat is pure and is rendered delicious by being roasted in the fite." Wbile thus amversing with **SITA**, he observed the dust rising like a cloud, stirred up by the feet

of the approaching army of Bhasata and heard the tramp of marching warriors at the sound of which the leaders of the dephants with their herds, zan hither and thither in agitation. Seeing the herds of dephants fleeing at the tumult caused by the army, Sbri **RAMA** said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O I akshmana, Queen **SUMITRA** is fortunate indeed to be thy mother. Is this warlike clamout issuing from the clouds ? The herds of dephants dwdling in the dense forest, the wild butlilloes and the deer are fleeing away in terror I Has any king or prince come to hunt in the woods, or has some terrible and blooclthinty beast entered the forest ? Enquire into the matter, O **LAKSHMANA** I Bven the birds are not careftee in their llight ; it becomes thee to seek out the cause of this commotion."

CHAPTER 96

They see the army approaching and Lakshmana vows to destroy it

Wander and lions and JDODkeys come to quench their thirst, and where flowers grow throughout the year ? " Thus Sbri **RAMA** amverscd on many wondrous things concerning the .Mandakini river with **SITA** and taking the hand of the princess, wandered with her over the blue and beautiful Chittrakuta mountain. CBAPTEit 96 Thsy see the llni!Y approaching tmd Lakslmuma to daiToy it shown **SITA** the beauties of the river Mandakini, Rsma and **SITA** seated themselves on a rock. Feasting Videhi’ with venison, Sbri **RAMA**, in order to please her, spoke in this wise : " This meat is pure and is rendered delicious by being roasted in the fite.” Wbile thus amversing with **SITA**, he observed the dust rising like a cloud, stirred up by the feet of the approaching army of

Bhasata and heard the tramp of marching warriors at the sound of which the leaders of the dephants with their herds, zan hither and thither in agitation. Seeing the herds of dephants fleeing at the tumult caused by the army, Sbri **RAMA** said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O I akshmana, Queen **SUMITRA** is fortunate indeed to be thy mother. Is this warlike clamout issuing from the clouds ? The herds of dephants dwdling in the dense forest, the wild butlilloes and the deer are fleeing away in terror I Has any king or prince come to hunt in the woods, or has some terrible and blooclthinty beast entered the forest ? Enquire into the matter, O **LAKSHMANA** I Bven the birds are not careftee in their llight ; it becomes thee to seek out the cause of this commotion." towards the north and there he beheld a vast army compoaed of elephants, hones, cbariols and well-armed infantty ! Describing the approaching army with its elephants, horses, chariots and flags, Shri **LAKSHMANA** said to **RAMA** : " O Great One, put out the fire and let **SITA** enter the cave, do thou arm thyself and take up thy bow and arrow." **SHRI RAMA** answered **LAKSHMANA** saying : " O Child, ascertain by the symbols on the Oags to whom this army belongs." The prince listened to **RAMA**'s words and burning with anger desirous of consuming the army, replied : "Without doubt, **BHARATA**, having secured the throne has come to slay us both in order to enjoy rulership, unopposed I See, by that large and beautiful tree is a chariot with a white 6ag beating the sign of a pomegranate tree. The soldiers mounted on swift moving horses are coming towards me. I see the riders on elephants also. O Hero, let us both, armed with bows and arrows, climb the hill, or clad in battle array, stand here fully prepared. We shall surely defeat **BHARATA**. To-day, we shall subdue him on whose account all our sufferings have come to pass. O **RAMA**, that **BHARATA**, on whose account, thou, **SITA** and I, have been deprived of our kingdom and cast into tribulation, is approaching like an enemy.

He must certainly be slain, O Prince, I see no sin in destroying him. It were no sin to slsy one who seeks to injure thee. O Prince, he has already wronged thee ; by slaying **BHARATA**, thou canst acquire mastery over the whole earth. To-day, **KAIKEYI**, avid for the kingdom, will see her son slain in the field. Seeing **BHARATA** slain by me, like a tree uprooted by an elephant, **KAIKEYI** will suffer great anguish I I shall slay **KAIKEYI** alsn, and her friends and **MANTHARA** too. O llestower of Honour, I will free the world of the sinful **KAIKEYI** ; to-day I will let loose my long restrained wrath on the forces of mine enemy, as a fire consumes dried grass. To-day, I will drench the fields of Chittrskuta with the blood of mine enemies. To-day, those elephants, wounded by my sharp arrows and those men slain by me, will be dragged hither and thither by wild beasts. To-day, I will redeem my vow, by destroying **BHARATA** and his army with my bow and arrow." CHAPTBR 97 SUING **LAKSHMANA** overcome with anger and desire for ven geance, **SHRI RAMA** sought to pacify him saying : " O Labhmana, the learned warrior **BHARATA**, fully armed, is coming to see us in person, of what value is shield or sword ? What should I do with a kingdom obtained by slaying my brother Bharats, I having undertaken to fulfil my father's behests ? I will never riches obtained by the slaying of relatives and friends which would be as acceptable to me as food mixed with poison I O Labbmana, I promise thee, it is for the sake of my brothers that I desire to pursue virtue, legitimately acquired wealth, pleasures, and even the kingdom. O Labbmana, I speak the truth, by this sign, touching my arms, ' I desire a kingdom only for the aake of supporting my brothers and securing their good '. O Charming Prince ! Tbe acquisitiou of the kingdom is not di11icult to me, but O, My Brother, I do not even desire dominion of the celestial region if it can only be acquired by unrighteous means ! O Dear One I May the Deity of Fire consume all that giws me

joy, if it is not for thy good and to the advantage of Bharats and **SHATRUGHNA** I It seems to me that when my dearest brother, ever devoted to me, returned to Ayodbys from the home of his maternal uncle, after hcsring that we three, robed in bsrlt had enteml. the forest, he, overwhelmed by affection and grief, set out hither to seck us I I see no other purpose for his advent here. Or it may be that **BHARATA**, wroth with his mother has reproached her with bitter words and has come here to be reconciled with me. It is meet that **BHARATA** should see me and I cannot believe that he comes as an enemy. What harm has **BHARATA** ever done to us, O Brother, that to-day, thou assumest him to be against us ? It is improper for thee to speak ill or harshly of **BHARATA**. Those bitter things thou sayest of **BHARATA**, thou hast in fact said of me. O Son of **SUMITRA**, how should a father slay his son, or a brother alay his brother, whatever betide ? If thou hast aaid all this on account of the kingdom, then I will desire **BHARATA** to give thee

CHAPTER 97

Shri Rama cannot believe Prince Bharata comes as an enemy

CHAPTBR 97 SUING **LAKSHMANA** overcome with anger and desire for ven geance, **SHRI RAMA** sought to pacify him saying : " O Labhmana, the learned warrior **BHARATA**, fully armed, is coming to see us in person, of what value is shield or sword ? What should I do with a kingdom obtained by slaying my brother Bharats, I having undertaken to fulfil my father’s behests ? I will never riches obtained by the slaying of relatives and friends which would be as acceptable to me as food mixed with poison I O Labbmana, I promise thee, it is for the sake of my

brothers that I desire to pursue virtue, legitimately acquired wealth, pleasures, and even the kingdom. O Labbmana, I speak the truth, by this sign, touching my arms, ' I desire a kingdom only for the aake of supporting my brothers and securing their good '. O Charming Prince ! Tbe acquisitiou of the kingdom is not di11icult to me, but O, My Brother, I do not even desire dominion of the celestial region if it can only be acquired by unrighteous means ! O Dear One I May the Deity of Fire consume all that giws me joy, if it is not for thy good and to the advantage of Bharats and **SHATRUGHNA** I It seems to me that when my dearest brother, ever devoted to me, returned to Ayodbys from the home of his maternal uncle, after hcsring that we three, robed in bsrlt had enteml. the forest, he, overwhelmed by affection and grief, set out hither to seck us I I see no other purpose for his advent here. Or it may be that **BHARATA**, wroth with his mother has reproached her with bitter words and has come here to be reconciled with me. It is meet that **BHARATA** should see me and I cannot believe that he comes as an enemy. What harm has **BHARATA** ever done to us, O Brother, that to-day, thou assumest him to be against us ? It is improper for thee to speak ill or harshly of **BHARATA**. Those bitter things thou sayest of **BHARATA**, thou hast in fact said of me. O Son of **SUMITRA**, how should a father slay his son, or a brother alay his brother, whatever betide ? If thou hast aaid all this on account of the kingdom, then I will desire **BHARATA** to give thee 364 tbe killgdom. O I abbmana, if I say to **BHARATA** ' Give tbe crown to Labhmarut ', assuredly he will answer ' Be it so '.” Shri Labhmarut was profoundly humiliated by the words of **RAMA**, bis limbs and muscles contracted and he was sunk in shame. **HE** *said*: " It appears that the Mabaraja **DASARATHA** himself has come hither to see us.” Seeing Labhmarut abashed, **SHRI RAMA** *answered*: " I also believe my father is come to see us, and will seek to take us home to the capital, knowing

how grievously we suffer in the forest I " " It may he, too, that tbe king, knowing **SITA** to be worthy of every happiness, will take her home. See, O Brother, two escellent horses of noble breed, swift as tbe wind, appear in view I The grest and aged dephant Shatrunjaya that carries my illustrious father, marches before tbe army, but I fed apprehensive for I do not behold tbe white umbrdla of my renowned Lord ! O I afrsbmana, descend from the tree." The prince having descended in obedience to Sbri Rams, stood before him with joined palma. Shri **BHARATA** meanwhile commanded his army not to approach or disturb tbe hermitage of **RAMA**. The army with its dephants and horses occupied an area of seven miles and tbe prudent **BHARATA** who, to please Rams, had rid himsdf of all egoity and employed only virtuous means, caused it to take up its position at some distance from tbe Chittrakuta mountain.

CHAPTER 98

Prince Bharata goes on foot to meet Shri Rama

THAT Clalted one, Shri **BHARATA**, truly obedient to tbe behests of his Guru, perceiving bis umy wdllodged, proceeded on foot to meet **SHRI RAMA**. As soon as the army was encamped, he addressed Sbatrugbna in these words : " O Excellent One, thou with thy men and a few huntsmen, speedily search tbe forest and seek out **SHRI RAMA**'s hermitage. Let Guha attended by a thousand ofbis warrion, armed with bows, arrows and swords, 365 search for **SHRI RAMA** in the forest. I, myself, in the company of the counsellors, citizens, elders and *brahmins*, will go on foot through the forest. I shall not rest till I have beheld the saintly **RAMA**, the valiant Lakshrnana and the most auspicious **SITA**. I shall not seek repose till I have looked on the shining countenance of **SHRI**

RAMA, my elder brother. My mind will taste no peace till I have placed my forehead at the feet of **RAMA**, that bear the marks of royalty. My soul will find no delight till I have placed **SHRI RAMA** on the ancestral throne and beheld him anointed with the holy water at the time of his coronation ! Fortunate is Prince Lakshrnana, who looks on the moon-like, lotus-eyed resplendent face of **RAMA**, each day. Blessed is the daughter of King Janaks, who followW' Sbri **RAMA**, the Lord of earth and ocean! Blessed also is Chittrakuta, equal to the Himalayas, on which **SHRI RAMA** dwells, as Kuvera and Chittraratha dwell in the forest. Blessed is this forest to-day, abounding in poisonous serpents and difficult to penetrate, because the mighty warrior **RAMA** abides in it." Thus speaking, the valiant Prince **BHARATA** entered the forest on foot. The chief of eloquent persons, the pious **BHARATA**, reached the centre of the forest, where blossoming and fruitful trees adorned the mountain heights. Climbing a shala tree, be saw the smoke rising from the fire in **RAMA**'s hermitage. The prince with his friends rejoiced like those who have crossed the ocean, to find the dwelling place of **RAMA**. Finding that Shri Ramacbandra dwelt on the mountain frequented by ascetics, Shri **BHARATA**, leaving his army behind, in the company of Guba speedily started for the hermitage.

CHAPTER 99

The four brothers meet with tears of joy

SHRI BHARATA with great eagerness pointed out the indications of the position of **SHRI RAMA**'s hermitage to his brother **SHATRUGHNA**. He appealed to Shri Vasisbtha to bring his mothers AYODBYA *KANDA* there speedily, while he, devoted to his elder brother, hastily went on

before. Sumantra followed **SHATRUGHNA**, wbo walked behind Bbarata and wbo was equally anxious to behold **RAMA**. The prince, proceeding, at length descried the hut thatched with leaves in the midst of the hermitages of the ascetics, and beheld before it a heap of broken wood and flowers plucked for worship. To mark the site of the *ashrama*, **SHRI RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** had bound kusha grass and strips of cloth to the trees. He perceived also great heaps of the dung of deer and bulfaloe, dried for fuel, to be used in winter. The illustrious and mighty Bbarata going forward, spoke measuted words to his brother and counsellors, saying : " I deem we have reached the place spoken of by the Sage Bbaradwaja, and that the river Mandakini is not filr distant from here ! Prince **LAKSHMANA** has bound strips of cloth to the trees, so that when fetching water on a dark night, he may know the way back to the hermitage. This appears to be the road traversed by the great elephants who were roaring in the forest. I perceive the black smoke rising from the ascetics' sacrificial fire. Here, I shall behold that Lion among men, **SHRI RAMA**, the great preceptor, seated in majesty, like a resplendent sage." Proceeding a little further, Prince Bbarata reached the river Mandakini on Chittrakuta, and addressing his companions, said : " That chief of men, a very god among living beings, is seated in this lonely forest in the posture of an ascetic. Woe unto me, wretched is my life and birth, on account of which the most resplendent Lord of aU, Shri **RAMACHANDRA** is plunged in this aflliction and dwells in the forest deprived of aU joy I Despised by men because of this, I will now fall at the feet of **RAMA** and **SITA** in order to propitiate them." While still lamenting, Bbarata perceived the hut thatched with leaves, pure and pleasant, covered with the leafy bougha of sala, tala and other trees, resembling an altar covered with kusha grass. Here and there mighty bowa and shields covered with gold, river. There also were two

scimitars in scabbards of gold and two shields emblazoned with golden Bowers, also many deerskins and gloves with gold embroidered gauntlets. That habitation was impregnable as a cave and unassailable by the herds of wild deer. Bbarata discerned in this dwelling, **SHRI RAMA** seated near the altar, resplendent as fire. For a long time, Shri **BHARATA** gazed on the beauty of the scene. He saw **RAMA** sitting, his matted locks coiled on the crown of his head, shinillg Uke a ftame, his body clad in a robe of bark, covered with the skin of a black antelope, his shoulders resembling a Uon's, his arms were long, his eyes like lotuses, that ruler of earth and ocean, the sovereign of eremal decrees ! Sbri **BHARATA** beheld that righteous one with **LAKSHMANA** and Sits, seated on a platform with kusha grass, appearing like the eternal Brshma. Beholding him seated thus, the pious Bbarata was overpowered with sorrow and affection, and ran towards him, his throat choked with grief, weeping and lamenting. Though the pain was past restraining, he yet mastered it and spoke : "Alas ! my elder brother, wnrthy of a seat in the royal assembly, beloved of his counsellors, is to-day associating with wild beasts in the forest. He, deaerving of apparel adorned with thousands of golden coins, is sitting, clad in a deerskin, in order to practise the obligations of righteous Uving. Shri Rams, who was formerly adorned with garland of different Bowers, how can he endure the weight of his matted locks ? He, who should have acquired merit by the performance of sacrifices aided by the risbis, to-day increases his meritorious deeds by the practice **SHRI RAMA**, on which **RAMA** gathering them both in his arms, melted into tears. Then Sumantra and Guha approached **SHRI RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, and it appeated as if the Sun and Moon, Jupiter and Venus bad conjoined in the heavens. The inhabitants of the forest, beholding the four princes met together in their midst, shed tears of joy.

CHAPTER 100

Shri Rama enquires of Prince Bharata concerning the discharge of his royal duties

SHRI RAMAclwmliA saw Bbarata lying on the ground, clothed in ascetic's gIb, his hair coiled on the crown of his head, his palms joined in supplication, resembling the sun bereft of splendour, fallen to earth, at the time of the dissolution of the world. Taking hold of the bands of his brother, who was emaciated and weak, **SHRI RAMA** nised him up and smclling his head, embraced him, clasping him in his arms and tenderly enquiring of him : " O Child, where is thy father, that thou art come to the forest alone ? Had he lived, thou couldst not have come hither unaccompanied I Alas ! I grieve that I scasccly recoguize my brother, thin, weary and full of care. What briDgs thee to the forest ? O My Brother, is the king well and happy ? Or has grief brought about his end ? O Darling, thou art yet a child, tell me, is ought amiss in that eternal kingdom ? O Hero of Truth, hast thou served the king well ? Say, is that Sovereign of men, devoted to truth and to duty, the performer of the great sacri1ice, in good health ? Is that highly learned monarch, master of the ascetic *brahmins*, fully cherished ? O Child, ue Mother Kausbalya and Queen **SUMITRA**. mother of an illustrious son, well ? Is that highly eulted Queen Kausbalya, happy ? O Friend, dost thou IUIIiciently regard that humble, experienced, highborn, 36!1 maguanimous companion of mine, he who is skilled in action, the son of Shri **VASISHTHA** ? Does the royal priesr. highly versed in the Veda, who is wise and beneficent, inform thee of the time of sacrifice ? O Brother, dost thou offer full reverence to the Gods, father, mother, Guru, thine elders, the physicians

and *brahmins* ? O Friend, dost thou give due respect and honour to Sudhama, skilled in the science of arms and conversant with the *mantra*-driven weapons ? Hast thou made those thy counsellors, who are trustworthy, patienr. masters of ethics and who have transcended avarice ? O Prince, the good fortune of kings is consultation with those versed in the spiritual laws. My Son, hast thou overcome sleep ? Dost thou awaken betimes ? Dost thou in the late hours meditate on the methods of acquiring legitimate wealth ? Dost thou rdlect alone on matters of moment and consult with thy ministers in public ? Do other monarchs know of thy decisions before they are applied ? When thou hast determined upon what must and should be done, dost thou speedily accomplish it ? Are leaser kings acquainted with thy determined resolve after the event or before thou hast set it in motion ? Dost thou prefer the society and advice of a leatned pundit to that of countless fools ? In timea of adversity, it is of infinite advantage to have the proximity of a learned man. If a sovereign surround himself with ten thousand ignorant persons, he will receive no help from them, but should a king be attended by a wise minister, thoughtful. studious, versed in the moral laws and governmenr. he will reap a great advantage. O Brother, dost thou employ men of eulted character in affairs of moment and lesser ones in unimportant events ? Dost thou appoint ministers who are pure of hearr. full of integrity and of a noble disposition, whose ancestors have served the crown in positions of authority ? O Son of Queen **KAIKEYI**, do the arrogant and proud, when incensed, offer thee or thy ministers insult ? Aa a woman disregards one who has illicit counection with another's wife or the priests condemn that man who has sinned while ofl'ering the aacrifice, so is a king despised who levies harsh tues. That lllllliiUdl who does not condemn a man to death, who has through avarice and deluded by ambition, accuaed others who are virtuous, and

even threareaed the life of the king, is himself 310 destroyed I O Brother, art thou attended by such pcrs01!S ? Has a commandcMn-chief who is active, victorious over his enemies, skilled in arms, patient in adversity, devoted to thee and experienced, been appointed by thee ? Hast thou honouted with suitable rewards, those men who are valiant, distinguished, eminent in militaty sciences, resourceful and whose abilities have been tested ? Dost thou distribute remuneration and provisiOl!S in a fitting manner when they are due ? Servants who are not paid at the proper season, become incensed and disregard their master. Dissatisfied retainers are a source of danger. “Ate the liege warriors and chieftains devoted to thee ? In time of need, are they ready to lay down their lives for thy sake ? Hast thou appointed, as thine ambassadors, those who are citizens of thy kingdom, who can divine the motives of others, who are of sound judgment, eloquent, and able to overcome their opponents in debate ? Dost thou emploY three spies, each unacqusinted with the other to the secrets of the fifteen,' excluding thy ministers, priests and the heir-apparent ? Dost thou set a watch over enemies whom thou hast driven from thy kingdom and yet who have returned ? Dost thou deem them harmless ? Att thou atrended by *brahmins* of atheistic opinions ? Such persons deem themselves wise but, in fact, are fools, yet they may divert others from the path of virtue, being skilled in dispatching souls to the lower regions. They do not study the authorised treatises on the duties of men, but indulge in arguments against the Veda and becoming eminent in useless knowledge, discuss unworthy matters con tinually. " O Friend, dost thou csrefully preserve the capital Ayodhya, the seat of our ancestors and great men, justly termed 'Invincible’ having strong gates and being filled with elephants, horses and chariots, where *brahmins* eDg8ged in spiritual duties dwell, also warriors and merchants, and superior men who have subdued their

senses and are intent on various enterprises ; that progressive city which is replete with temples of many furms, frequented by learned men. O Brother, ours is a capital which bas been the site of many great sacrifices, which contains innumerable temples and lakes, frequented by chccrful men and women, where festive assemblies arc held, where no portion of the earth is uncultivated, where elephants, horses and cattle dwcii in large numbers, where no one lives in jeopardy, and which is irrigated by artificial means so that people need not depend solely on rain ; which is delightful and where no dangerous beasts like lions abound, which is free from wicked men, which improves daily and which is protected by the spirits of our ancestors, tell me is that city prosperous ? O Brother, art thou satisfied with the husbandmen and those who live by tending their cattle ? Dost thou provide whst they need and preserve them from harm ? Dost thou ever guard them and provide them with sustenance ? O Brother, a king should ever protect his subjects by righteous means. Dost thou propitiste the women of thy realm ? AJ:e they duly safeguarded by thee ? Dost thou put thy confidence in them ? Dost thou communicate thy to them ? O Prince, dost thou, well adorned, show thyself to thy people in the assembly hall 'ere noon? Do those who work for thee approach thee with assurance, or do they hold back on account of fear ? Both these stateS arc unprofit able. Dost thou treat thy subjects with moderation ? Arc thy forts well supplied with wealth, food, arms, water, armaments, and furnished with archers and bowmen ? O Prince, docs thy contain more than is needed for thine ""pcnditure ? Is thy wealth spent unprofitably on musicians and dancers ? A YODHY A *KANDA* by a monarch who lives at ease and is indifferent to justice being meted our. destroy his children and his herds ! O Prince, dost thou satisfy the aged, children and physicians by providing them with their needs, treating them with affection and

gmnting them the benefits of wise administration ? Dost thou offer salutations on meeting thy Guru or the aged, the ascetics, strangers, saaed objects, and the btahmins who are leamed and enlightened ? Dost thou use the time reserved for the performance of thy duty, for the acquisition of wealth, or dost thou waste the opportUnity of fWfilling thy duty and acquiring wealth by partiality to comfort and dissipation ? O Chief of Conquerors, O Knower of the significance of time, dost thou divide thine hours between the observance of thy duty, the acquisition of wealth and legitimate diversion ? O Wise One, do the learned pundits and the citizens pray daily for thy welfare ? O **BHARATA**, dost thou abjure the fourteen failings a sovereign must eschew ? Atheism, dissimulation, anger, in attention, procrastination, neglect of the wise, indolence, surrender of the senses to external objects, disregard of counsel, consulting those who advocate evil, the deferring of that which has been resolved upon, the concealment of counsel received, the abandoning of righteous conduct, the olfering of respect equally to the low and high born, and the ruthless conquest of other lands. " O King, art thou acquainted with the results of the following and dost thou constantly re1lect on them ? Hunting, gambling, sleeping during the day, slander, inordinate a1fection, vanity, concentration on dancing and music, lounging here and there to no purpose ; the five fortifications ; by moat. by high banks, by thickly planted trees, by waste land destitute of means of subsistence and by a waterless region ; the four means to success; concluding peace, liberality, punishment and sowing dissension in the ranks of the enemy ; the seven requisites of administration : the king, the ministers, government, treasury, territory, army and allies. The kinds of persons with whom one should not contract friendship; those who speak ill of others, the bold, the curious, the injurious, those who take other’s property, the abusive, the ruthless, and the eight objects

which wealth, suitable diversions, the study of the three Vedas, treaty, sttaragem, invasion, proper timing, and allying oneself with the powerful ? “Art thou acquainted with the five kinds of suffering caused by celestial beings ; by fire, water, disease, famine and plague ? Hast thou carefully considered the misfortunes occasioned by officials, thieves, enemies and the king’s favourites ? Dost thou reflect that it is not proper to be intimate with a child, one who is senile, one who has long been afllicted, one who has been excommunicated, a cowatd, a terrorist, one who is avaricious ot who excites covetousness, one who is despised by others, one who is voluptuous, one who consults everybody, one who speaks ill of the *brahmins*, one who ascribes all to fate, ot who is afllicted by famine, or who wanders from country to country without a purpose, one who has many adversaries, one who does not act at the proper season, one who is not devoted to auth, one who lives under foreign domination and one who is aggressive ? Hast thou given the following due consideration and found them to be in accord with thee : thy subjects, women, the kingdom, those who have lost their wealth, thine enemy, thy friend, those un· friendly to thine enemy ? " O Wise One, art thou acquainted with the preparations necessary fot a journey, the methods of punishment, the drawing up of treaties, and who is to be trusted ot distrusted ? O Prince, dost thou enter into consultation with thy counsellors collectively or separately, and dost thou treat each interview as private ? Dost thou conclude thy study of the Veda with charitable gifts ? Dost thou employ thy wealth in distribution of alms and legiti· mate diversions ? Do thy marriages become fruitful of progeny ? Dost thou ptactise what thou hast learned from the scriptureS ? Dost thou approve of acts of benevolence, duty, and worship and rcprd them u productive of fame and lcmgevity ? O Prince, dost thou foDow the path of thy predecessors, which promotes happiness and which all

applaud ? O **BHARATA**, dost thou partake of delicious dishes by thyself? When amcmgst thy companions, dost thou first present them with succulent food and then partake of it thyself? Know, O Brother, that monarcla who is acquainted with the law and also knows how 374 to administer justice and rules by righteous becomes Lord of the earth and enters heaven on his death."

CHAPTER 101

Shri Rama hears the account of his father's death

Virtue ? O Great One, according to the uadition of our line, the younger brother may not be king while the elder lives, therefore, O Raghava, return with me to the auspicious city of Ayodhya and fox the sake of our family, cause thyself to be installed as king. Some may consider the king a man, but I hold him to be a god. since his conduct differs from others, being inspired by duty and divine grace. When I was at the home of my matcmal uncle and thou exiled to the forest, king **DASARATHA**, adored by the good, the performer of spiritual sacrifices, departed to heaven. As soon as thou, with Site and Labhmana, hadst left the capital, the king overwhelmed by sorrow and aftliction, passed away. O Chief of Men, offer the uaditionallibations for thy father ; Shatrughns and I have already caiTied out this ritual. O Prince, it is said that the water and rice offered by a beloved son, grants imperishable bliss to one departed. O Raghava, thou wast indeed the beloved of thy royal father ; through grief on thy account and the desire to see thee, thy sire, his mind unceasingly fixed on thee, overcome by sorrow, departed to heaven."

CHAPTER 102

They ale all afflicted with grief

retainer of the royal line, wise, intelligent, tender-hearted, self-subdued, and humble, wholly devoted to **RAMA**, cotoforted the princes and led them to the river Mandakini whose waters were sacred and meritotinus. Deeply aftlicted, the illustrious ones approached the pleasant river that passed through blossoming woods, and descending into the pure, swift-flowing and un-muddied stream, they offered the ritual water in the name of their royal father, saying: “O Great King, may this water be thine.” Then **SHRI RAMA**,lilling his palms with water, turning to the south, wept and said : " O Mighty King, may this sacred water offered to-day by me, be thine for ever in the region of thine ancestors.” Thereafter, Raghava with his brothers offered balls of rice in mcmnty of the king on the shores of the river Mandakini. Having made a cake by mixing the juice of berries with the pulp of the lngudi fruit, **SHRI RAMA** spread it on kusha grsss and deeply aftlicted, weeping, said : " O Mighty King, be pleased to acccpt and partake of this food, for that which is man’s eustomary food, the gods approve.” Then ascending the hillside, **SHRI RAMA** returned by the way he had comc. The great Raghava, reaching the door of the thatched hut, took hold of the hands of **LAKSHMANA** and **BHARATA**, and wept. The sound of the weeping of the four princes and **SITA** re-echoed in the mountains like the roaring of a lion, and the army hearing it were greatly pertUrbed and said among themselves, " **SHRI RAMA** and **BHARATA** have met and they arc bewailing the death of the king, their sire.” Leaving their camp and turning their faces to where the sound of weeping arose, they went in haste to that spot. Some mounted horses and elephants, some rode in

gilded chariots, and others on foot hastened towards that place, for though **SHRI RAMA** had but lately left the capital, it appeared to them as if he had been long absent from them. Desirous of seeing **RAMA**, they proceeded to the hermitage of the illusttinus prince in vatinus kinds of vehicles and the sound of their advance and the rolling wheels created a noise like thunder. Blephants terrified by the tumult ran with their mates into other woods, perfuming the forest with their ichor. Boars, wolves, bu1faloes, lllllkes, tigers, wild cattle and deer of many kinds were li1led THB R.AMAY ANA OP VALMIKI with fear. Ducks, waterfowl, geese, cuckoos and herons fled in every direction. The air was filled with birds, and the earth with men, rendering both beautiful. At length, the anny reached the place where they perceived the illustrious and innocent **RAMA**, the chief of men, seated on the sacrificial seat, and seeing his condition they began to curse **KAIKEYI** and Manthata and, approaching closer, wept bittetly. Shri R.ama, observing them so afllicted, embraced them like a parent. Embracing those who wcte wotthy of his affection, offering salutations some, he treated those of his age and his relatives with the respect due tn each. The voice of their weeping filled the earth and sky, and tevetberated in the caves and in every quartet like the beat of a dtum.

CHAPTER 103

Shri Rama greets the queens

SHRI V preceded by the widowed queeDS of King **DASARATHA**, proceeding towards Shri Rams's hermitage, beheld the slow-moving Mandakini and the holy place frequented by **RAMA**. Alllicted with grief, Queen Kausbalya wept and then said to **SUMITRA** and the othet QueeDS

: " O see I here is the place whcte the defenceless R.ama, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA**, deprived by **KAIKEYI** of their kingdom, come to bathe. O **SUMITRA**, hete meseems thy son **LAKSHMANA** unwearyingly brings watet for my son. Though engaged in this menial service, a kind office petformed for an elder brothet is an honourable act I Though the widows of the departed kiug, saying : " See how this hss been offired by Raghsva in memory of the great king of the House of Ikshwsku. I do not consider this ftour ball mixed with the juice of the lngudi fruit to be worthy of the Mahstma **DASARATHA**, who was equal to a god ! How should the sovereign of the eatth enclosed between the four seas, find this cake of lngudi pulp acceptable ? Nothing is more paiDful to me than this, that the illustrious Rams should o1t"er this paltry 1iour ball to his deceased father I Why does my bean not break into a thousand fragments, seeing this poor offeriDg ? It is a common saying among men that the food eaten by a man is the food of his god and his ancesmrs." The consorts of the king consoled the chief queen and proceeding onwards, reached the hermitage where they beheld Shri Rams seated like a god descended from heaven. Seeing Sbri Rams withdrswn from every pleasure, they were deeply distressed and wept bitterly. Sbri Rams, the Devotee of Truth, rose up and IDUched the feet of his mothers, and the large-eyed queens with their tender hands took the dust from his feet. Sbri **LAKSHMANA**, distressed to sec their grief, offered salutations to them with deep affection and they, wiping the dust aom the feet of Sbri Rams, manifested the same love to Prince Lakshmano, since he, too, was the son of King **DASARATHA**. **SITA** also, Iiiii of grief, her eyes suffused with tears, stood before the queens mucbing their feet. **KAUSHALYA**, embracing Shri **SITA** who was cmacisted through the privations of her erllc, addressed her as a mother her daughter and said: "Alas I Alas! the daughter of King Videha, the daughter-in-law of King Dasarstha, and

the consort of Shri Ramachandrs, hss undergone great privations in the forest. O Janaki, I burn with the fire of grief when I behold feet. Having touched the feet of the great ascetic, who was as resplendent as fire, like **INDRA** offering salutations to the feet of Brihaspati, **SHRI RAMA** sat down near him. Then the pious Bbarata accompaoied by his counsellors, the chief people of the city, and his geoerals, approached **SHRI RAMA** and occupied a lower seat. The heroic **BHARATA**, with joined palms, seated by his elder brother who was attired in ascetic's garb, appeared like Prajapati seated before **BRAHMA** I At that moment, the principal citizens present were filled with curiosity to know what Shri **BHARATA** would say to Raghava. The ever-truthful and valiant **RAMA**, seated with Bbarata and **LAKSHMANA**, together resembled three ritual fires in the place of sacrifice.

CHAPTER 104

He requests Prince Bharata to ascend the throne

SHRI RAMA, together with Laksbmana, addressed Shri **BHARATA**, saying : " O Bbarata, say why thou art come hither to the forest in ascetic's garb, clothed in bark and deerskin ? For what purpose, O Prince, hast thou, abandoning thy throne, come to the forest, attired in the skin of the antelope ? " Thus questioned, Shri Bbarata conrrolling his grief, answered : " O Noble Sire, my filther, the king, by my mother acting in an improper manner, has died of grief througb separation from his son. O Migbty Prince, my mother has done an exceedingly evil deed and forfeited her filir name. Widowed and over whelmed with aftliction, she will filii into hell. Thougb the son of **KAIKEYI**, yet am I thy servant. Be gracious to me and allow thyself to be installed to-day and ascend the

throne like Indrs. The elders of the people and my widowed mother have come hither to entreat thee. Be pleased to grant our request, O Lord. " Q Thou who payest dne deference to all men, being the eldest son of the king, abouldst by right occupy the throne. 38o Accept the burden of kingship and gratify the desire of thy friends. The esrth, obtaining thee as her Lord, will rest satisfied as the winter night in the presence of the moon. Not only am I thy brother, but thy devoted follower and servant. I and my ministers salute thee and beg of thee to look with favour on our request. " O Chief of Men, let not these counsellors and those who have traditionally held office, plead in vain." Having spoken, Prince Bharats, his eyes suffused with tears, placed his head at the feet of **SHRI RAMA**. **SHRI RAMA** lifting him up embraced Prince Bharats who was sighing like one distraught, and said : " O Bharats, why shonld a virtuous and enlightened prince such as thou, act so that his elder brother commit sin ? O Hero, I see no fanlt in thee, but it behoves thee not to speak ill of thy mother. O Sinless One, the father or the spiritual preceptor can order his disciple, his servant or his wife as he will. Therefore, it must be known to thee, that a wise son or devotee shonld ever manifest obedience. I am, therefore, submissive to my sire. " O Lovely One, we are subject to the king and it is one if he send us to the forest, to the abode of ascetics, or retain us in his proximity. O Chief of the Virtuous, a mother shonld be revered even as the father. O Bharats, by the command of my pious mother ·and father, I was sent to the forest, how shonld I dare to disobey them ? " Do thou, O Prince, return to the capital and acclaimed by the people, ascend the throne, while I reside in the forest as an ascetic. Remember, thus did the king resolve in the presence of his people and now he has departed. The sovereign is the instructor of his people and of thee also, and it was meet he shonld do as he has done. O Bharats, do thou enjay the kingdom given thee by my father. " O Beautiful One, I

shall remain in the Dandaka forest for fourteen yean and enjay what my father has conferred on me. The illustrinus monarch, my aire, honoured by the w·hole world, has commanded me to come to the forest and tc obey him ia my happiness. " Meseema the sovereignty of the whole world is vain if it be mine in defiance efmy father's command." · 381 CHAPTER lOS Prince **BHARATA** apfJI4h to Shri R47na to return and ruk tlukingdom THE princes surrounded by relatives and friends passed the night sorrowing. The day having dawned, the brothers observed the fire sacrifice and performed the repetition of silent ptayer on the haob of the river Mandakini, then entering the hermitage of **RAMA**, they sat in profuund silence, no one uttering a wotd, a great peace prevailing over all. At length, Shri **BHARATA**, in the midst of his friends, broke the silence and thus addtessed **SHRI RAMA** : " O My Brother, our illustrious sovereign conferred the kingdom on me to satisfy my mother and fulfil the obligation of his former boons and my mother having given this kingdom to me, I now offer it to thee, enjoy it without hindtance. When the dam bursts in the tainy season, none can stem the tide, similarly none but thee can proteet this vast dominion. O King, as an ass cannot equal the pace of a horse, nor an ordinary bird's11ight that of an eagle, so am I unable to rule the kingdom without thee. " O **RAMA**, happy is the sovereign on whom others depend, but wretched is the one who depends on others. A tree planted and watered, though it grow and spread forth great btanches that no dwarf can scale, and be eovered with blossom, if it hear no fruit, the one who planted it suffers obloquy. O Mighty Hero, let this metaphor be understood by thee, that thou, being the Lord of all, mayst guide thy servants. O Lord, let us behold thee, the destroyer of thy foes, seated on the royal throne, shining resplendent like the sun. May these mighty tuskcn follow thy chariot and all the queens dwelling in the palace rejoice." The people hearing Shri **BHARATA**'s wotds applauded

them saying, “Well said I” " Well said I” Then the compassionate **RAMA** perceiving **BHARATA** a111icted

CHAPTER 105

Prince Bharata appeals to Shri Rama to return and rule the kingdom

CHAPTER lOS Prince **BHARATA** apfJI4h to Shri R47na to return and ruk tlukingdom THE princes surrounded by relatives and friends passed the night sorrowing. The day having dawned, the brothers observed the fire sacrifice and performed the repetition of silent ptayer on the haob of the river Mandakini, then entering the hermitage of **RAMA**, they sat in profuund silence, no one uttering a wotd, a great peace prevailing over all. At length, Shri **BHARATA**, in the midst of his friends, broke the silence and thus addtessed **SHRI RAMA** : " O My Brother, our illustrious sovereign conferred the kingdom on me to satisfy my mother and fulfil the obligation of his former boons and my mother having given this kingdom to me, I now offer it to thee, enjoy it without hindtance. When the dam bursts in the tainy season, none can stem the tide, similarly none but thee can proteet this vast dominion. O King, as an ass cannot equal the pace of a horse, nor an ordinary bird’s11ight that of an eagle, so am I unable to rule the kingdom without thee. " O **RAMA**, happy is the sovereign on whom others depend, but wretched is the one who depends on others. A tree planted and watered, though it grow and spread forth great btanches that no dwarf can scale, and be eovered with blossom, if it hear no fruit, the one who planted it suffers obloquy. O Mighty Hero, let this metaphor be understood by thee, that thou, being the Lord of all, mayst guide thy servants. O Lord, let us behold thee, the destroyer of thy

foes, seated on the royal throne, shining resplendent like the sun. May these mighty tuskcn follow thy chariot and all the queens dwelling in the palace rejoice.” The people hearing Shri **BHARATA**’s wotds applauded them saying, “Well said I” " Well said I” Then the compassionate **RAMA** perceiving **BHARATA** a111icted sons, friends, wives, all who live must die one day. Hoarding and spending, prosperity and destitution, meeting and parting, life and death ue all akin. When the ripe fruit falls, we ue not surprised, thus a man being born should not fear when death claims him. “As a building supported by stout piUan on becoming old, falls into ruins, so man subject to age, must one day meet with dissolution. O **BHARATA**, the night once past, does not come again ; so the watets of the Yamuna, Oowing to the sea, do not return. See I the days and nights are passing away, decreasing the period of our life’s span, as the rays of the sun in summer suck up the earth’s moisture. O Prince, grieve for thyself therefore, there is nought else worthy of grief ! Age withers all whether movable or immovable. Death is ever at our side, nor does it leave us when we travel to a distant place, and it is still present at our returning ! " What shall a man do when his skin is wrinkled and grey hair covers his head and he is stricken in years ? Man rejoices when the sun rises and sets, heedless of the waning of his powers. He welcomes the approsch of each season, such as the arrival of spring, yet the succession of the seasons devoun man’s days I As pieces of driftwood, floating on the sea, come together for a space, so wives, sons, relatives, wealth and property remain with us a while, but in the course of time, leave us. " One, sitting by the wayside, cries to a group of travellers passing by, ' Let me also go with you I ' why then should man grieve to mad the road, which has been trodden by his predecesson ? The life of man, like a river Oowing, does not return, thus our days diminish and we should perform those righteous acts that bring us to the knowledge of

Reality. " Practising virtue, man should enjoy worldly pleasures ; our father, the illusuious **DASARATHA**, having performed benevolent deeds and given firting charitable gifts, has departed, clothed in virtue. Having cherished his servants and nourished his people, having levied those taxes alone warranted by moral duty, having aet up watet tanb and created reservoin and performed many aacriflcia1 acts, he has passed away. Leaving the world after enjoying a variety of pleasures and oft'ering coundess sacrifices, the king, at a great age, has gone to heaven. THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI " O Brother, it is not meet to grieve for the king, who, full of years, having enjoyed the pleasures of the world, respected by the good, has given up his life. Having abandoned his worn-out frame, he has obtained the form of a celestial being. "A wise, learned and colightened man like thee, should not grieve for such a site. Exercising patience, thou shouldst cease to lament and giving up sorrow return to the capital. O Chief among the Eloquent, thy father has commanded thee to dwell in Ayodhya. I too will perform the behests of him who ever practised righteousness I " I cannot disregard the commands of my illustrious father, he is worthy to he obeyed by thee and me, being our parent and our ruler. O Son of R.sghu, I shall, therefore, obey his will and dwell in the forest. O Chief of Men, those who desite felicity in a future state, and who are virtuous and benevolent should obey their elders. O Great One, bear in mind the behests of our father, a lover of truth, and return to the capital to rule over the kingdom ! " The magnanimous R.ama, having uttered these sage words relative to the need for obedience to his father, heeame silent.

CHAPTER 106

In spite of entreaties Shri Ram remains steadfast in his vow

the pious **BHARATA** answered R.sma, putting forth persuasive arguments of righteous purport, saying : " O Lord, who is there in this world like thee ? Adversity does not move thee, nor does any agreeable tbiDg toueb thee. All look on thee as their superior, yet thou seekest counsel of thine elders I " The man to whom the living and dead are one and who is indilferent as to what he possesses or loses, for what reason should he grieve ? O Lord, those who like thee, know, as thou dost, what is the nature of the soul and its essence, are not IDOVed in the hour of disttess I 384 " O Prince of Raghu, like the gods, thou an magnanimous, thou an ever forbearing and faithful to thy vows. Thou an wise, thou knowest and seest all I Thou an aware of the motives of men's actions and the ause of their abandoning them, therefore, that distress which is insupportable to others, does nor. in any wise, disturb thee." Having spoken thus, **BHARATA** *continued*: " O Rams, be gracious to me, though during my absence in a strange land, my mother committed those sins which ause my allliction. I am bound by the ties of duty, else would I have slain my wicked mother. What is evil and what is good is known to me, descended as I am from the righteous King **DASARATHA**, therefure I am unable to act contrary to virtue. I annot speak evil in the assembly of my pious and aged father, who has passed away, and where is a man to be found so wholly acqusinted with the law of righteousness as was the king, yet what person familiar with the moral law, would commit so great a wrong prompted by the desire to please a woman ? There is an

ancient saying that. at the approach of death, man loses the power of judgment I The king has verily justified this adage to the whole world I Through fear of Queen .**KAIKEYI**'s wrath or her threat of self-imposed destruction, or through mentsl agitation, the king may have acted thus without consulting his subjects, but thou an not bound by such a deed. He who imputes the transgressions of his father to righteous motives is not considered a good son ; as heir to the king, reveal not the erron of thy sire, but conccal this unjust deed from the world " O Hero, it is thy duty to save my mother **KAIKEYI**, my father, my relatives and myself from the consequences of this action condemned by all. O Brother, remember thy duty as a warrior and re1lect on the outcome of thy sojourn in the forest as an ascetic, but do thou also consider the good of thy people. It becomes thee not to undertake this course of action. The fint duty of a warrior is to be installed so that he may be able to protect his people. Say, why should a man giving up that which is an established dUty, cmbJacc that which is wretched, cheerless, visionary and undefined ? It; O Blessed One, thou deaircst to undertake this mortification, why dost thou not aeek it through the arduous labour of ruling the four castes ? It is said that . 31S the duty of the householder is the highest *dharma*, then, why dost thou abandon it ? " O Lord, hear me ; I am but thy child in respect oflearning, age and state, how should I be able to govern the kingdom ? I, a child, void of undetstanding and virtue and in rank also thine inferior ; how should I be able to live without thee mueh less rule in thy stead ? Therefore, O Raghava, O Thou Virtuous One, do thou, with thy relatives govern the kingdom without opposition and acquire merit I The great sage, the Holy Vaaishtha, is here present with the ministers and priests, permit thyself to be crowned and return with us to Ayodhya I "As lndra, having conquered his foes, entered hesven attended by the Maruts, do thou enter Ayodhya, thereby

discharging thy duties to the gods, the sages, and thine ancestors, gratifYing the ambitions of thy friends ! Regard me as thy servant and command me ! O Noble One, let thy friends to-day rejoice at thine enthronement and let the evil doers flee to the uttermost ends of the earth ! O Chief of Men, wash away the tsint of my mother's guilt and deliver our great psrent from this heinous ain. With my head bent in submission, I entrest thee ; as Shri **VISHNU** shows his compsssion to aU beings, do thou show mercy to us. Shouldst ::hou however reject my prayer and go hence to some other forest. then will I follow thee there I " **SHRI RAMA**, thus entreated by Shri **BHARATA**, who had placed his head at the feet of his brother in humility, still remained steadfast in his vow and did not waver or consent to rerum to Ayodhya. Beholding the of **SHRI RAMA**, aU present rejoiced to aee him ao faithful to his vow, yet bewailed his determination not to return to the capital. The merchants, the learned *brahmins* and the priests filled with wonder, and the weeping matrons, praised **BHARATA** and UDitedly entreated **RAMA** to return. CHAPTBR 107 He instructs Prina Bharot4 to return and be installed SIIBI RAMA, worshipped by **BHARATA**, who sought to petition him fUrther, replied to his brother in the presence of the other warriors, saying : " O **BHARATA**, Son of Queen **KAIKEYI**, and the mighty Dasuatha, what thou hast aaid is meet and right. In ancient times when King Dasuatha, our sire, sought thy mother, Princess **KAIKEYI**, in marriage, he promised het father that he would be succeeded by a son of hers. Furthermore, in the wu between the gods and *asuras*, our sovereign made the promise of two boons to thy mother in for her great services, in consequence of which thy illustrious and charming mother asked two favours of the king, holding him to his word. " O lion among Men ! By one boon was my exile secured and by the other the kingdom was obtained for thee. O Chief of men, as a result of the boon granted by my father, I have consented to

live in the forest for fourteen years. " Determined to prove the trUth of my father’s word, I have entered the forest with **SITA** and Labhmana, regardless of heat and cold. O Great Ruler, it becomes thee also to prove thy father to be a votary of truth and allow thyself to be speedily instaUed. O **BHARATA**, honour this debr. thou owest it to the king, and thus protect his fait name. By occupying the throne, shalt thou succeed in pkasing me and rejoicing thy mother, Queen **KAIKEYI**. " O Friend, I have heard that formerly a great monarch nanted Gaya, when offering a sacrifice at Gaya, to the spirit of his anc;estors, aaid : 'A son is called " Puttra " because he aavca his father aom hell and protects the spiria of his anceston by enjoined aea of benevolence.' " To have many Jesrned and virtuous sons is greatly to be desired, for some of them may offer a sacrifice at Gaya and thua deliver the spiria of theit ancesaors. " O Son of:Raghu, all the royal sages have approved this tenet, thou llhouldst also, therefore, accept it. O **BHARATA**, do tbou

CHAPTER 107

He instructs Prince Bharata to return and be installed

CHAPTBR 107 He instructs Prina Bharot4 to return and be installed SIIBI RAMA, worshipped by **BHARATA**, who sought to petition him fUrther, replied to his brother in the presence of the other warriors, saying : " O **BHARATA**, Son of Queen **KAIKEYI**, and the mighty Dasuatha, what thou hast aaid is meet and right. In ancient times when King Dasuatha, our sire, sought thy mother, Princess **KAIKEYI**, in marriage, he promised het father that he would be succeeded by a son of hers. Furthermore, in the wu between the gods and *asuras*, our sovereign

made the promise of two boons to thy mother in for her great services, in consequence of which thy illustrious and charming mother asked two favours of the king, holding him to his word. " O lion among Men ! By one boon was my exile secured and by the other the kingdom was obtained for thee. O Chief of men, as a result of the boon granted by my father, I have consented to live in the forest for fourteen years. " Determined to prove the trUth of my father's word, I have entered the forest with **SITA** and Labhmana, regardless of heat and cold. O Great Ruler, it becomes thee also to prove thy father to be a votary of truth and allow thyself to be speedily instaUed. O **BHARATA**, honour this debr. thou owest it to the king, and thus protect his fait name. By occupying the throne, shalt thou succeed in pkasing me and rejoicing thy mother, Queen **KAIKEYI**. " O Friend, I have heard that formerly a great monarch nanted Gaya, when offering a sacrifice at Gaya, to the spirit of his anc;estors, aaid : 'A son is called " Puttra " because he aavca his father aom hell and protects the spiria of his anceston by enjoined aea of benevolence.' " To have many Jesrned and virtuous sons is greatly to be desired, for some of them may offer a sacrifice at Gaya and thua deliver the spiria of theit ancesaors. " O Son of:Raghu, all the royal sages have approved this tenet, thou llhouldst also, therefore, accept it. O **BHARATA**, do tbou 387 return to Ayodhya with Sbatruglma and thy people and promote the happiness of thy subjects there. " O King, I shall speedily retire to the Dandab forest with **SITA** and Iaksbmana O **BHARATA**, be thou king of men and I will be sovereign over the wild beasts. Do thou return joyfully to the capital and I will ebeerfully proceed to the forest. " May the royal canopy protect thee from the sun's heat, I shall seek shelter from its rsys in the dense shadows of the trees. O **BHARATA**, Sbatruglma of limitless understanding shall attend thee, and I shall be attended by the illustrious Prince **LAKSHMANA**. O

Brother, dn not be a prey to grief any longer, thus shall we, the four soos of the great King Dasarstha, establish his fame in the realm of uuth.”

CHAPTER 108

A brahmin utters words contrary to dharma

Raghava, but it is not for thee to think as common men, for thou art a man of understanding and also a philosopher. Coosider well, O Prince, a man has neither a real friend nor an enemy, he enters the world alone and leaves it alone also. He who thinks This is my father ' or This is my mother and becomes attached to this relationship is without sense. From the atandpoint of right reasoning, none belongs to any. As a man trsvelling from his own village to another, remains for the night somewhere on the way and leaves at dawn, so father, mother, wealth and fiunily remain with a man fur a brief space and the wise do not become attached to them. plcasurcs which befit a king and divert thyself in the capital as **INDRA** in Amaravati. **DASARATHA** is nought to thee nor thou to him, the king is one penon and thou another, therefore, foUow the advice I give thee. " The fitther’s seed is but the remote cause of man’s birth, since if it does not enter the mother’s womb, it cannot fructify ; the uue source of conception is the womb of the mother. The king has departed to the place destined for all mortals. Why dost thou claim this false relationship and distress thyself in vain, O **RAMA** ? I grieve for those who, abandoning the pleasures of the world, seek to acquire merit for felicity hereafter and sink to an untimely death, I do not grieve for others. Men waste food and other precious things by offering them up yearly, as sacrifices in honour of their departed ancestors. O **RAMA**, has a dead man ever partaken of food ? If food that is eaten by one,

nourishes another, then those who journey need never carry provision on the way. Relatives might feed a *brahmin*, in bis name, at home ! " O Ramaebandra, these scriptural injunctions were laid down by learned men, skilled in inducing others to give, and finding other means of obtaining wealth, thus subjugating the simple minded. Their doctrine is ' Sacrifice, give in charity, consecrate yourselves, undergo austerities and become ascetics '. O **RAMA**, be wise, there eaisll! no world but this, that is certain I Enjoy that wbich is present and cast behind thee that which is unpleasant ! Adopting the principle acceptBble to all, do thou receive the kingdom offered thee by **BHARATA**." CHAPTER IO!I **SHRI RAMA** rep1W in rtJDrt1s /JQied tm the V ltlat SHu RAMA, patiently giving ear to the utterance of Javali, replied with a due sense of jndgment and in words based on bis belief that thoae duties enjoined in the Vedas, should be twfi11ed. "" O Mnni. thai: which thou hast spoken with the desire to

CHAPTER 109

Shri Rama replies in words based on the Vedas

plcasurcs which befit a king and divert thyself in the capital as **INDRA** in Amaravati. **DASARATHA** is nought to thee nor thou to him, the king is one penon and thou another, therefore, foUow the advice I give thee. " The fitther's seed is but the remote cause of man's birth, since if it does not enter the mother's womb, it cannot fructify ; the uue source of conception is the womb of the mother. The king has departed to the place destined for all mortals. Why dost thou claim this false relationship and distress thyself in vain, O **RAMA** ? I grieve for those who, abandoning the pleasures of the world, seek to acquire merit for felicity hereafter and sink to an untimely death, I do not grieve for

others. Men waste food and other precious things by offering them up yearly, as sacrifices in honour of their departed ancestors. O **RAMA**, has a dead man ever partaken of food ? If food that is eaten by one, nourishes another, then those who journey need never carry provision on the way. Relatives might feed a *brahmin*, in bis name, at home ! " O Ramaebandra, these scriptural injunctions were laid down by learned men, skilled in inducing others to give, and finding other means of obtaining wealth, thus subjugating the simple minded. Their doctrine is ' Sacrifice, give in charity, consecrate yourselves, undergo austerities and become ascetics '. O **RAMA**, be wise, there eaisll! no world but this, that is certain I Enjoy that wbich is present and cast behind thee that which is unpleasant ! Adopting the principle acceptBble to all, do thou receive the kingdom offered thee by **BHARATA**." CHAPTER IO!I **SHRI RAMA** rep1W in rtJDrt1s /JQied tm the V ltlat SHu RAMA, patiently giving ear to the utterance of Javali, replied with a due sense of jndgment and in words based on bis belief that thoae duties enjoined in the Vedas, should be twfi11ed. "" O Mnni. thai: which thou hast spoken with the desire to please me, is not authorized, nor are thy admonitious just, since. even the most cursory analysis proves them to be false. O Sage, to reverence that truth upheld by men of old. Should I follow the duty of a warrior, I should be unjust. To do that which is false is worthy only of mean, covetous and depraved souls. Should I pursue that crooked path, indicated by thee, then I should perpetrate falsehood, through the mind, the body and the soul. Those who uphold truth acquire land, renown, fame, and heaven also ; therefore, let all men utter truth and act according to truth I " That which thou, after much deliberation, believest to be and recommendest to me is wholly improper. O how can I disregard the command of my sire, that I should reside in the forest ? When I pledged my word in the presence of my father, to enter the

forest, Queen **KAIKEYI** was rendered glad at heart, how should I now give her cause for distress ? " Giving up falsehood and deceit, differentiating between what should and should not be done, subduing the senses, possessed of full aith in the Vedic injunctinns, I shall devote myself to the fulfilment of my father's will ! " By sacrifice, one acquires the state of **INDRA** and enters heaven. The sages by virtue of sacrifice have gone thither." The illustrious and glorious **RAMACHANDRA**, highly displeased by the materialistic arguments of Javali spoke thus in terms of refUtation and reproof: " O Javali, by speaking the truth, by pursuing the duties of their caste and station, by manifesting their vslour in time of need, by gentle speech, by service of their spiritual preceptor, the gods and unexpected guests, men attain heaven I Therefore, those *brahmins* instructed in truth, pursue virtue with a single mind in accordance with their caste and station and eagerly await their entrance to Brahmaloka. O Javali, I perceive with regret the action of my illustrious patent in permitting one of atheistic ideas, who has fallen from the path of rectitude enjoined in the Vedas, to remain in his court. Those who preach the heretical doctrine of the Cbarvaka school, are not only in1idels, but have deviated from the path of truth. It Is the duty of a monarch to deal with such persons as with felons, nor should men of Ullderstanding and learaing stand in the preaence of such atheists. " O Javali, those versed in wisdom, who preceded thee, performed many holy by virtue of which they acquired eminence here and in the spiritual realm. Those sages have ever practised harmlessness, trutb, asceticism, charity, benevo lence and sacrifice. "O Javali, those who fulfil their spiritual duty, who are the foremost in deeds of charity, and who batm none, who frequent the assemblies of the good and are revered by all men, they are without sin, their name shall live for ever as that of our illustrious Guru, Shri Vasishtba." **RAMA**, having uttered these harsh

words to Javali, he, with humility addressed **RAMA** saying : " O **RAMA**, I am no atheist ; on this occasion, I assumed this atheistical disguise in order to turn thee from thy purpose and persuade thee to return to the capital!" CHAPTER IIO v tuiJhtlla the traditiotl uf the dynasty,

CHAPTER 110

Vasishtha proclaiming the tradition of the dynasty, calls upon Rama to return

performed many holy by virtue of which they acquired eminence here and in the spiritual realm. Those sages have ever practised harmlessness, trutb, asceticism, charity, benevo lence and sacrifice. "O Javali, those who fulfil their spiritual duty, who are the foremost in deeds of charity, and who batm none, who frequent the assemblies of the good and are revered by all men, they are without sin, their name shall live for ever as that of our illustrious Guru, Shri Vasishtba." **RAMA**, having uttered these harsh words to Javali, he, with humility addressed **RAMA** saying : " O **RAMA**, I am no atheist ; on this occasion, I assumed this atheistical disguise in order to turn thee from thy purpose and persuade thee to return to the capital!" CHAPTER IIO v tuiJhtlla the traditiotl uf the dynasty, Jkshwaku was named Kuksbi and his son was Vikukshi, whose son was the resplendent and illustrious King Vana and the great warrior Anavanya was his son. During the reign of the virtuous King Anavanya there was neither famine nor scarcity of rain nor any thief. The son of Anavanya was Prithu and his son was Trishanlru. So great was Trishanku's observance of truth thst he attsined heaven in his embodied ststе. His son was the mighty Dhundhumara. The son of Dhundhumara was Yuvanashwa and his son was Mandhsts. The illustrious Susandhi

was the son of Mandhsts and Dhruvasandhi and Prasenagits were the offspring of Susandhi. The renowned Bharsts was the son of Dhruvasandhi and from Bharats sprang Ajits, against whom the great kings, Himaya, Talagangbs and Shashavindu declared war. Ajits laid siege to them by building fortifications, but found their defeat beset with dilliculties. " Resigning his throne, he retired to the delightful Himalayas to devote himself to spiritusl practices. It is said thst one of his queens was pregnant and the other gave her poison to destroy the foetus. The Queen Kalindi approached the Sage Chyavana, the son of Bhrigu, who resided in the Himalayas at that time, and paid him respectful homage. He, gratified, knowing her to be desirous of a son, said : ' O Goddess, thou shalt bring forth a son who will be renowned, virtuous, magnanimous, of excellent conduct, a promoter of his race and a subduer of his files.' " The Queen hesring this, saluted the *rishi* with reverence ; she then returned home and brought forth a son, whose eyes resembled the lotus and who resembled **BRAHMA** in splendour. Being born with the poison that her fellow-consort had ad ministered to her, Kalindi's son was named Sagara. " Consecrated at a fitting season, King Sagara drained the ocean. His son was called Asamanjas, he oppressed the people THI! who rising to power, by a curse, was destroyed wth his whole army. The mighty hero Sudarshana was the son of Shankhaoa and his son was Agnivama and Agnivama's son was Shighraga. His son was named Meru, and Meru's son was Prashusvara, and his son was the great Sage Ambarisha. The son of Ambarisha was the truthful Prince Nahusha, whose son was the virtuous Nabhaga. Nabhaga had two sons, Aja and Suvrata, and the son of Aja was the illustrious sovereign **DASARATHA**. Thou art the son of the great IDOIIII1"Ch **DASARATHA** renowned all tbrough the world, who reigned over earth and heaven. " In the dynasty of lbhwaku, the eldest son suceeeds to the throne ; while the

eldest son lives, none else can become king. It is not meet fur thee to violate this sacred tradition of the House of Raghu. O Great One, reign over this esrth filled with treasures and those extensive dominions subjecr to thee, as did thy sire I " CHAPTEK Prinu **BHARATA** still mlrlllts **SHRI RAMA** rDho is resolwd to jollor» his father's command HAVING spoken thus, Shri **VASISHTHA** continued, uttering wotds of wisdom. " O **RAMA**, when a man is born, be must regard as his teachers, his ather, his mother and his spiritual preceptor. " O Chief of Men, the parents bestow on man the physical frame, but the spiritual preceptor confers wisdom on him, and hence he is called Guru. " I am the preceptor of thy filther and of thee, mark my C01IDSel and do not over-ride the way of the good. O My Son, here aie thy relatives, the leamed *brahmins* and the people of the capital, as also the warriors and merchants. Fulfil thy duty to tbem and do not emed the limits of morsl obligation. " Here is thy pious and aged mother, whom thou shouldst not disobey. That man is called virtuous who renders obedience to his IIMJ!her.

CHAPTER 111

Prince Bharata still entreats Shri Rama who is resolved to follow his father's command

THI! who rising to power, by a curse, was destroyed wth his whole army. The mighty hero Sudarshana was the son of Shankhaoa and his son was Agnivama and Agnivama's son was Shighraga. His son was named Meru, and Meru's son was Prashusvara, and his son was the great Sage Ambarisha. The son of Ambarisha was the truthful Prince Nahusha, whose son was the virtuous Nabhaga. Nabhaga had two sons,

Aja and Suvrata, and the son of Aja was the illustrious sovereign **DASARATHA**. Thou art the son of the great IDOIIII1"Ch **DASARATHA** renowned all tbrough the world, who reigned over earth and heaven. " In the dynasty of lbhwaku, the eldest son suceeeds to the throne ; while the eldest son lives, none else can become king. It is not meet fur thee to violate this sacred tradition of the House of Raghu. O Great One, reign over this esrth filled with treasures and those extensive dominions subjecr to thee, as did thy sire I " CHAPTEK Prinu **BHARATA** still mlrlllts **SHRI RAMA** rDho is resolwd to jollor» his father's command HAVING spoken thus, Shri **VASISHTHA** continued, uttering wotds of wisdom. " O **RAMA**, when a man is born, be must regard as his teachers, his ather, his mother and his spiritual preceptor. " O Chief of Men, the parents bestow on man the physical frame, but the spiritual preceptor confers wisdom on him, and hence he is called Guru. " I am the preceptor of thy filther and of thee, mark my C01IDSel and do not over-ride the way of the good. O My Son, here aie thy relatives, the leamed *brahmins* and the people of the capital, as also the warriors and merchants. Fulfil thy duty to tbem and do not emed the limits of morsl obligation. " Here is thy pious and aged mother, whom thou shouldst not disobey. That man is called virtuous who renders obedience to his IIMJ!her. " O Prince, thou shalt not have swerved from the path of righteous action by acceding to Bharats's request that thou shouldst occupy the throne." Thus, having addresaed **RAMA** with mildness, the holy Guru **VASISHTHA** resumed his seat. The mighty **RAMA** then made answer, saying : " The good that patents do to their son cannot easily be teCOIIlpensed. In childhood, they ptesent him with beautiful attire and delectable dishes, they put him to rest and tenderly rob his body with oil of sesamum seed and manifest alfection in gentle counsels ; further they strive aingle-mindedly fot his ultimate good. " The commands of my

sire, the authot of my being, shall not be set aside." The magnanimous Bhatata heating these wotds of Raina chandra, suffeted distress, and spoke to Sumantta, saying : "O Charioteer, ptepate a seat ofkusha grass on this trestle seat, I will place myself before **SHRI RAMA** till he be pleased to grant my request. Like a *brahmin*, who is destitute, I will lie at the dOot of this hut, tasting and covering my fiue, till **SHRI RAMA** consents to return to the capital." Sumantta looking towards **SHRI RAMA**, sptead the kusha grasa, and Prince **BHARATA**, full of grief, seated himself there, before his brother. Perceiving this, **SHRI RAMA**, chief of the royal sages, said to him : " O Beloved Bhatata, what wrong have I done that thou shouldst sit thus before me? A *brahmin* may adopt this measure towards his aggressor, but it is not meet that a crowned head should do so. O Lion among Men, rise, abandon this and weigh the matter carefully. Having reflected on their words with attention, arise, O Raghava, and undergo that whieb sball purifY thee for having enacted that which does not become a warrior. Do thou drink water and touch me also." **BHARATA** rising, said : " Hear, O *Brahmins*, Countrymen and Warriors ! I do not desire the kingdom of my father, I did not urge my mother to demand it. I knew naught of the exile of **SHRI RAMA**. If it be required that someone shall dwell in the forest in obedience to my father's command, then will I reside there for fourteen years in his stead." **SHRI RAMA**, astonished at his brother's resolution, addressed the people present, saying : " Friends, whatever was bought, pledged or sold by the king in his lifetime, can by no means be cancelled by me or **BHARATA**. Neither can I accept contumely and permit Bbarata to go as my representative to the forest. What **KAIKEYI** demanded was rightfully granted by the king. "I know **BHARATA** to be disinterested and a true disciple of his Guru, and that excellent one is a lover of truth. I herewith declare that on my return from the forest, I shall accept the kingdom and

with my virtuous brother govern the country with honour. " O **BHARATA**, I have discharged the boon granted to **KAIKEYI** by the king and vindicated his honour. Do thou liberate the king from the charge of falsehood and redeem the second boon."

CHAPTER 112

Following the advice of the celestial sages, Prince Bharata is reconciled to becoming Shri Rama's deputy

and weigh the matter carefully. Having reflected on their words with attention, arise, O Raghava, and undergo that whieb sball purifY thee for having enacted that which does not become a warrior. Do thou drink water and touch me also." **BHARATA** rising, said : " Hear, O *Brahmins*, Countrymen and Warriors ! I do not desire the kingdom of my father, I did not urge my mother to demand it. I knew naught of the exile of **SHRI RAMA**. If it be required that someone shall dwell in the forest in obedience to my father's command, then will I reside there for fourteen years in his stead." **SHRI RAMA**, astonished at his brother's resolution, addressed the people present, saying : " Friends, whatever was bought, pledged or sold by the king in his lifetime, can by no means be cancelled by me or **BHARATA**. Neither can I accept contumely and permit Bbarata to go as my representative to the forest. What **KAIKEYI** demanded was rightfully granted by the king. "I know **BHARATA** to be disinterested and a true disciple of his Guru, and that excellent one is a lover of truth. I herewith declare that on my return from the forest, I shall accept the kingdom and with my virtuous brother govern the country with honour. " O **BHARATA**, I have discharged the boon granted to **KAIKEYI** by the

king and vindicated his honour. Do thou liberate the king from the charge of falsehood and redeem the second boon." Desirous that the life and reign of **RAVANA** should e11d soon, certain sages approached Bhuata and unitedly addressed him, saying : " O Bhuata, O Highly Resolute Prince, O Pious and Renowned One, recollect that thou art born in a royal line, let not the word of **RAMA** be disregarded by thee, if thou art wishful to bring felicity to the spirit of thy parent. It is our desire that thy father who has entered heaven may be absolved from every debt, having discharged his obligations to Queen **KAIKEYI**." Having spoken thus, these celestial sages returned to their abode. **RAMA**, gratified by their words, said : " By you, have I been assisted in upholding virtoe." Prince Bhuata with trembling accents again entreated **RAMA**, saying : " O **RAMA**, he who is skilled in righteous governance and who is the eldest, ascends the throne. Do thou, observing the tradition, fulfil the desire of thy mother **KAUSHALYA**. I alone have neither the courage to administer so vast a dominion, nor should I be able to satisfy the people of the capital and kingdom. " Our relatives, friends, and warriors await thy conversion to sovereignty as the husbandman eagerly anticipates the rain clouds. Therefore, O Wise One, accept the ctown for thou alone art able to establish this kingdom." Having spoken thus, Bhuata fell at the feet of his brother and fervently entreated him, crying : " O **RAMA**, O **RAMA**." Sbri **RAMA**, raising up the young prince who, eloquent and lotus-eyed, resembled a wild swan embraced him, and said : " That genuine humility which thou hast demonstrated will furnish thee with suflicient courage to govern the kingdom. Do thou consult thy ministers, counsellors and friends in the great work of thy rule. The moon msy cease from shining, and the Himalaya abandon the snows, Mount Meru its splendour or the ocean exceed its boundary, but I shall not relinquish the vow made in the

presence of my sire. O Beloved One, it is not for thee to determine whether that which was brought about by thy mother was done through love of thee, or through ambition to thee made king, it is for thee to treat her as thy parent.” 1’lloD Prince Bhuata answered **RAMA** who resembled the in glory and the new moon in splendour, saying : " O Noble Ooe, place thy feet in re.e sandals adorned with gold, since soon they will furnish our only means of support and protection.” The illustrious **RAMA** having put on the sandals, took them off and returned them to Bbarata. He, bowing reverently to the sandals addressed **RAMA** thus : " From to-day I shall for fourteen years, assuming matted locks and a robe of bsrk, live on fruits and roots, awaiting thy return. Offering up the management of the kingdom to these sandals for fourteen years, if I do not see thee returning on the final dsy of thst period, I will enter the fire and be consumed I " **SHRI RAMA** embracing Bbarata with great reverence answered " Be it so.” Then he spoke further saying : " Cherish thy mother **KAIKEYI**, and be not angry with her. In my name and in the name of Shri **SITA**, I adjure thee to reverence and protect Queen **KAIKEYI** I " His eyes suffused with tears, **SHRI RAMA** then bade farewell to Shri **BHARATA** and **SHATRUGHNA**. Bbarata offering due reverence to the ornate and glittering sandals, circumambulated **SHRI RAMA** and placed them on the head of the migbry elephant belonging to King Dasaraths. Then **SHRI RAMA**, immoveable like the Himalayas, in the practice of virtue and the promoter of the honour of the House ofRaghu, made obeisance to his holy Guru, the ministers, citizens and his brothers, and diamissed them. His mothers, overcome with grief, were unable to utter a single word. To them also **SHRI RAMA** offered reverent salutations and sorrowfully entered his own dwelling.

CHAPTER 113

Prince Bharata commences the return journey

Sbri **BHARATA** with his army, went forward and at a short distance from Chittrakuta, perceived the hermitage in which the holy Bharadwaja and othet sages dwelt. Approaching the hermitage of the Sage Bharadwaja, Sbri **BHARATA** having dis mounted from his chariot, olfeted salutations to him. Bharadwaja, full of joy, said to **BHARATA** : " O Friend, hast thou beheld Sbri **RAMA** ? Is thy purpose accomplished ? " Sbri **BHARATA**, evet devoted to his brothet, aDSweted the sage, saying : " O Lord, I and the holy Guru **VASISHTHA** besought **RAMA** to but he cheetfully replied : ' My father's decree that I should reside in the fotest for fourteeo years, shall be faithfully obsetved by me '." Then the lesmed and eloquent Sbri **VASISHTHA**, skilled in wisdom, addresaed Sbri **RAMA** in this wise : " O Wise One, be pleased to bestow thy sandals, adorned with gems, on thy deputy. Do thou bear the good of the capital in thy heart. Sbri **RAMA**, in obedience to his holy Guru, turning towards the east, put on the sandals and thereafter deliveted them tome. "Now, frustrated in my design to bring back Sbri **RAMA**, I am returning to Ayodhya with these sandals." The Maharishi Bharadwaja, then uttered these auspicious words : " O Prince, vetaed in the knowledge of virtue, thine eKCellence is as litde a source of wondet, as water evet flowing towards a hollow. King **DASARATHA**, possessed of a righteous and duty-loving son, such as thou art, has surely found immortslity." Sbri **BHARATA**, touching the feet of the holy *rishi*, in great reverence, with joined palms, circumambulated bim and then, with his counsellon, proceeded to Ayodhya. The army following Prince **BHARATA**, some riding elephan18, some horses, and some in bullock cam, crosaed the

Yamuna with its singing waves and came to the sacred waters of the Gqea. Having crosaed the holy rivet Gunga, with his COIIIpiDions, Shri Bbarata entered the town of ShriDpvera and from there THB llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI passed on to Ayodhya. Beholding Ayodhya, a stricken city, deserted by his father, King **DASARATHA** and his brother Sbri Ramacharulra, Prince **BHARATA**, deeply distressed, said to his charioteer : " Behold the ruined capital bereft of its former glory, unadorned and Jacking all signs of festivity ! How silent, how wtetdled is tbis city, formerly fWl of life." THB prina:, in his chariot, which gave forth a thunderous sound as it roUed onward, entered Ayodhya. There he beheld the city where cats and owls ranged, and where the dooiS of the dwellings were closed, daikness and gloom reigning over all. The city resembling the planet Rohini,that has lost its splendour on the moon's eclipse, or a mountain stresm, whose waters have dried up in the sun's heat, deserted by the waterfOwl, the fishes all having perished. Sad and wtetdled, on aaount of its separation from Rams, Ayodhya resembled the sacrificial llame, which when the oblation is poured into it, shines like a golden mnc and then sinks into smoking ash, or like a mighty army divested of its weapons in battle, its horses, elephants, chariots and standards scattered abroad and its heroic warriniS slain. Tbat city which looked, as it were, like the waves of the sea whipped into foam by the storm, rolling and breaking and then sinkiDg into silena: with the dying out of the wind, or like the sacrificial pavilion deserted by the priests who go forth in search of alms after the sacrifice; or like kine bereft of the bull, who have aascd to graze in the pasrureand stand in the enclosure dispirited; orlikeancck· Jaa: stripped of its precious gems ; or like a meteor, its virtue ezhaustcd, faJJen to earth, deprived of its splendoUI ; or like a 1lowering branch, Josded with blossom in the Spring, visited Roblai-Tbe ..-.llatiaD g·-> -·

CHAPTER 114

He finds Ayodhya desolate

THB llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI passed on to Ayodhya. Beholding Ayodhya, a stricken city, deserted by his father, King **DASARATHA** and his brother Sbri Ramacharulra, Prince **BHARATA**, deeply distressed, said to his charioteer : " Behold the ruined capital bereft of its former glory, unadorned and Jacking all signs of festivity ! How silent, how wtetdled is tbis city, formerly fWl of life." THB prina:, in his chariot, which gave forth a thunderous sound as it roUed onward, entered Ayodhya. There he beheld the city where cats and owls ranged, and where the dooiS of the dwellings were closed, daikness and gloom reigning over all. The city resembling the planet Rohini,that has lost its splendour on the moon's eclipse, or a mountain stresm, whose waters have dried up in the sun's heat, deserted by the waterfOwl, the fishes all having perished. Sad and wtetdled, on aaount of its separation from Rams, Ayodhya resembled the sacrificial llame, which when the oblation is poured into it, shines like a golden mnc and then sinks into smoking ash, or like a mighty army divested of its weapons in battle, its horses, elephants, chariots and standards scattered abroad and its heroic warriniS slain. Tbat city which looked, as it were, like the waves of the sea whipped into foam by the storm, rolling and breaking and then sinkiDg into silena: with the dying out of the wind, or like the sacrificial pavilion deserted by the priests who go forth in search of alms after the sacrifice; or like kine bereft of the bull, who have aascd to graze in the pasrureand stand in the enclosure dispirited; orlikeancck· Jaa: stripped of its precious gems ; or like a meteor, its virtue ezhaustcd, faJJen to earth, deprived of its splendoUI ; or like a 1lowering branch, Josded with

blossom in the Spring, visited Roblai-Tbe ..-.llatiaD g·-> -· by a swarm of bees, that is suddeuly COJlS1IIIIed by a forest fire. The streets were deserted aod the fllirs and markel!l closed, and no merchandise was o1fcred for sale. Dark aod fearful, Ayodhya resembled the moon aod stars obscured by hesvy clouds in the rainy season, or a deserted mvem, its revellers departed, the liquor expended aod naught but fragments of broken glass aod pots in wild disorder scattered here aod there. Ayodhya appeared like a tank sunk into the earth, the water being spent, the fonndations having collapsed, the jars aod eatthen vessels lying scattered amidst the thitsty, standing there in despair ; or it resembled the string of a hero's bow that has been severed by the arrow of his adversary aod is lying on the eatth ; or an aged and ill-nourished mule, urged on by a soldier, slain in the battle aod left unheeded. VJ.CWiog the desolation, Prince Bharam, seated in his chariot, spoke to SUJD1111tta, who was driving the equipage : "Alas I How sad that this city, formerly so gay, to-day appears so melancholy, the intoJ:icating fragrance of ftoraJ garlands and the scent of incense, no longer filling it. O Sumantra, 1 do not hear, as formerly, the sound of clattering chariots, the ne.ighiog of horses aod the prolonged roaring of elephants. Alas I Since **RAMA** departed, the young men of Ayodhya have ceased to adorn themselves with garlands of fresh blossoms aod aandalwood and men no longer walk abroad decked with ftowen. No longer are festivals observed aod the people of the capital are merged in grief; it seems as if the glory of the city had departed with Rams. O ! Ayodbya is bereft of light, like the night overcast with clouds at the time of the waxing moon. When will my brother, **RAMACHANDRA**, rerum like a festival, diffusing joy in Ayodhya, as do the autumnal rains? Formerly, the royal highwaya of the capital were tiDed with riehly attired youths, but to-day they are aU deserted." Wailing aod Jameming. Prince Bharalll entered his father's

pl1ace, wllicb, bereft of the king. resembbl a cave without a Jiou. Seeing the inDer compartment in complete dsrlmesa, the prince wept aloud, like the gods, when warring with the titana, are alllicled when beholcling the darkening of the sun. 401 CHAPTER 5 Prinu BhartUa retiru to Nandigrama tmtl tM flirwdom from that dty TRB sorrowing Bbarata, firm in his resolve, having brought his mothers back to Ayodhya, said to the holy Guru Vasiahtha and the elders : " I aave your permission to retire to Nandigrama and there endure the woes occasioned by Sbri **RAMA**'s absence. The king has depatted and my elder brother has entered the forest. shall, thercfure, await the of Sbri **RAMA**, since verily he alone is Lord of Ayodhya." Sbri Vasiahtha and the counsellors, hearing the words of Prince Bbarata, answered him saying : " O Prince, thy words, inspired by devotion to thy brother, are worthy of praise. Verily, they do thee honour! Who will dare oppose thee, who art deeply attached to thy brother and who, in this land, has reached such an eulted state ? " Perceiving the counsellors reconciled to his purpose, the prince said to Sumantra : " Bring hither the chariot I " The chariot having come, Bbarata, after conversing with his mothers, mounted the equipage with his brother Shatrugbna. Accompanied by the priests and ministers, the two princes eheer1illly proceeded to Nandigrama, the Guru **VASISHTHA** and the pious brabmios leading the procession. Then the army, elephants, horses and chariots together with the people of the capital, fullowed him unbidden. The peerless Bbarata filled with fratemal love, carrying the sandals of **SHRI RAMA** on his head, at last reached Nandigrama. Dismounting from the chariot, he addreseed his spiritual preceptor and the elders, saying : " My brother, **SHRI RAMA**, gave this kindom to me, as a precious trust, verily these sandals, decorated with gold shaD zepresent him."

CHAPTER 115

Prince Bharata retires to Nandigrama and rules the kingdom from that city

Prinu BhartUa retiru to Nandigrama tmtl tM flirwdom from that dty TRB sorrowing Bbarata, firm in his resolve, having brought his mothers back to Ayodhya, said to the holy Guru Vasiahtha and the elders : " I aave your permission to retire to Nandigrama and there endure the woes occasioned by Sbri **RAMA**'s absence. The king has depatted and my elder brother has entered the forest. shall, thercfure, await the of Sbri **RAMA**, since verily he alone is Lord of Ayodhya." Sbri Vasiahtha and the counsellors, hearing the words of Prince Bbarata, answered him saying : " O Prince, thy words, inspired by devotion to thy brother, are worthy of praise. Verily, they do thee honour! Who will dare oppose thee, who art deeply attached to thy brother and who, in this land, has reached such an eulted state ? " Perceiving the counsellors reconciled to his purpose, the prince said to Sumantra : " Bring hither the chariot I " The chariot having come, Bbarata, after conversing with his mothers, mounted the equipage with his brother Shatrugbna. Accompanied by the priests and ministers, the two princes eheer1illly proceeded to Nandigrama, the Guru **VASISHTHA** and the pious brabmios leading the procession. Then the army, elephants, horses and chariots together with the people of the capital, fullowed him unbidden. The peerless Bbarata filled with fratemal love, carrying the sandals of **SHRI RAMA** on his head, at last reached Nandigrama. Dismounting from the chariot, he addreseed his spiritual preceptor and the elders, saying : " My brother, **SHRI RAMA**, gave this kindom to me, as a precious trust, verily these

sandals, decorated with gold shaD zepresent him.” **RAMA**. Let them rest beneath the royal canopy and wave the chamara over them. These are the sandals of our supreme Guru and by them will righteoumess be established in the kingdom. I shall preserve the trust lovingly reposed in me by **RAMA**, till his return. When he returns to Ayodhys, I, myself, will assist him to put on the sandals. Then I, united with him once more, will deliver the kingdom to him and like a son will I honour him. By restoring the capital and kingdom to **RAMA**, I shall wash away the stigma of dishonour brought on me by my mother. Sbri **RAMA** will be installed and his subjecb made happy; then shall ill-fame psss away, and I shaD

CHAPTER 116

The holy men of Chittrakuta depart, fearing the coming oppression of the asuras

RAMA. Let them rest beneath the royal canopy and wave the chamara over them. These are the sandals of our supreme Guru and by them will righteoumess be established in the kingdom. I shall preserve the trust lovingly reposed in me by **RAMA**, till his return. When he returns to Ayodhys, I, myself, will assist him to put on the sandals. Then I, united with him once more, will deliver the kingdom to him and like a son will I honour him. By restoring the capital and kingdom to **RAMA**, I shall wash away the stigma of dishonour brought on me by my mother. Sbri **RAMA** will be installed and his subjecb made happy; then shall ill-fame psss away, and I shaD departure. By the expression in their eyes and other signs, they manifested their misgivings and could be observed convers· ing secretly in low tones with one another. **SHRI RAMA**,

beholding their anxiety addressed them with humility, saying : " O Blessed Ones, bas my conduct towards you suffered a change ? For what resaon are your heartS filled with dread ? O Holy Ones, bas my younger brother involunt arily injnred you ? Or bas Shri **SITA**, ever devoted to my service, given you cause for offence ? Perchance she has done that which is not fitting for a woman ? " Thus questioned, a great sage, an aged ascetic, his frame emaciated by austerities, tremblingly answered the Ever Compassionate One, saying : " O Child, bounteous to all that lives, Shri **SITA** is innocent of any breach of the traditional attitude to any, least of all towards holy men. In truth, the reason is that the *asuras*, through enmity to thee, have begun to oppress the sages, and tb.ercfirc, they being terrified, seek how they may defend themselves in secret. " **RAVANA**'s yonnger brother Kara, who dwells hete, is casting out the ascetics from their hermitages. O Friend, he is in· exorable and he is a mighty warrior. He is brutal and cannot endure thy presence hete. Since thou bast come to dwell in this hermitage, the *asuras* have increased the persecution of the sages. Appearing in grotesque and terrible forms, they fill them with terror, then to do them further miscbiet; they fling unclean and inauspicious objects into the sacred precincts, finally when meeting with guileless and pure-hearted hermits, they slay them. Those evil-hearted *asuras* wander everywhete covertly, till perceiving a sage to be alone and defenceless, they put an end to his life. "At the time of sacrifice, when the sacred fire is kindled by the ascetics, then do the *asuras*, scattering the hallowed vessels and ladles,. quench the fire by discharging water over it and destroying the utensils. O Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, weary of these wicked *asuras*, the sages are urging us to abandon these hermitages and depart hence. " O **RAMA**, those terrible *asuras* threatell to slay us all, tb.ercfOrc, we are leaving this hermitage. Not far distant is the wonderfW Tapovana belonging to the Maharishi

Ashwa ; 404 it is ricll in fruits and roots, there we would dwell. O Friend, if it seem proper to thee, do thou come there, for thine oppression is also planned. " O Prince, though thou art able to defeod thyself, thy sojourn here with thy holy consort is fraught with peril." Hearing the words of Kulupati and perceiving their anxiety to be gone, Sbri **RAMA** sought to persuade them to stay, but in vain, and the sages departed. **SHRI RAMA** 81X01Dpanied them a short distance then, taking leave of them and offering obeisance to them, returned to his sacred dwelling. On leaving the holy men, they instrwted him lovingly in the path of duty and bade him farewell. **SHRI RAMA** did not then abandou the hennitage, which the

CHAPTER 117

Shri Rama decides to leave the hermitage and comes to the ashrama of the Sage Atri

it is ricll in fruits and roots, there we would dwell. O Friend, if it seem proper to thee, do thou come there, for thine oppression is also planned. " O Prince, though thou art able to defeod thyself, thy sojourn here with thy holy consort is fraught with peril." Hearing the words of Kulupati and perceiving their anxiety to be gone, Sbri **RAMA** sought to persuade them to stay, but in vain, and the sages departed. **SHRI RAMA** 81X01Dpanied them a short distance then, taking leave of them and offering obeisance to them, returned to his sacred dwelling. On leaving the holy men, they instrwted him lovingly in the path of duty and bade him farewell. **SHRI RAMA** did not then abandou the hennitage, which the THE RAMAYANA OF VALMlKl The virwous Sage Atri, ever devoted to the good of all, summoned his aged and pious wife Anasuya,

and respectfully asking her to be seated, addressed his worthy and excellent spouse. **HE** *said*: " Shri **SITA** has visited our hermitage, do thou take her with thee and receive her hospitably." Then the Sage Atri said to **RAMACHANDRA** : " Formerly when rain was withheld for a period of ten years and the earth dried up, this virtuous woman, Anasuya, by her great austerity, produced fruits and berries for the sages and caused the sacred Ganges to descend so that they might bathe therein ; thus by her atduous ascetic practices, did she dispel the impediments in the path of the sages. O Sinless **RAMA**, this is the same Anasuya, who at one time, to succour the sages, caused ten nights to be reduced to oue. This Anasuya is to be highly revered for her age's sake, and is the object of reverence of all beings. Do thou permit the Princess **SITA** to accompany the meek and aged Anasuya. By her great and noble deeds, she has acquired immeasurable fame. Let Janaki attend her." Then Shri **RAMACHANDRA** answered, " Be it so," and the illustrious ptince said to **SITA** : " O Princess, thou hast heard the words spoken by the sage ; for thine own good do thou wait on this aged ascetic." Tltereafur, Shri **SITA** went with Anasuya who was proficient in every virtue. On account of her age, her physical form was feeble and emaciated, her hair grey, whilat her body tRtnbled like a palm tree agitated by a strong wind. Uttering her name, Shri **SITA** made obeisance to her, the geode saint retuming her salutation with grest humility enquiring as to worship him as a god. O Princess, I have studied deeply and I do not think that a woman can have a better friend than her hnsband, for he, in all circumstances, ptotects her. " O Princess of Videha, those evil women who, enslaved by desite, do not regard what should or should not be done, O Princess of Mithila, they, imprudently commit unworthy acts and becoming abhorrent, fall from virtue. But women such as thou, acquainted with what is good or evil in the world, like pious men, attain

heaven. O Sati, thou hast ever been faithful to thy conjugal duty and through thy virtuous acts, undertaken in conjunction with thy husband, shalt attain merit and fame.”

CHAPTER 118

Princess Sita receives gifts of love from the sage's wife

THB blameless Anasuya having spoken, Shli **SITA**, approving her words, gently answeted : " O Noble Lady, the advice thou hast given me, is in no wise a source of wonder to me, for it is my conviction that the husband is in authority over his wife. Bven if the husband be poor and ignorant, yet women, such as I, should feel no aversion for him. " But the husband who is worthy of praise on account of his excellent qualities and who is compassionate, self-mntrolled, constant in his afl’ections, fully acquainted with his duty and who manifests the loving-kindness of a parent, ezcels all ezpectstion. " Whatwer love Shli **RAMACHANDRA** bears to his mother **KAUSHALYA**, he bestoWS equally on the other queens, and not this alone, but whoever the king has looked on with alfection, that woman he also regards as his own mother. " Whea departing for the feartbl forest, my mother-in-law, Queen Kanshalya, imparted certain instruction to me, and I inscribed her worda on the tablet of my heart. I call to mind also the advice given me by mine own mother at the time of my auptilla. " O Righteous One, the crowning discipline for a woman is the service of her lord. THiay, thou hast awakened in my memory the counsels formerly given to me by my relatives. “To-day, Savitri dwells in heaven through the service of her spouse, thou also shalt enter the supreme abode through service of thy

lord. Rohini, a pearl among women and a dweller in the celestial region, ever accompanies the moon. Thus many others who have followed virtue, with fixed resolve, enter heaven throngh their merits." Anasuya rejoiced to hear **SITA**'s words and kissing her head in benediction, said : " O **SITA**, much merit has accrued to me by prayer and fasting. O Princess, pure in heart, I desire to confer a boon on thee by virtue of these merits. Tell me what thou dost desire ? O Princess of Mithila, thy words have given me extreme satisfilction. Now say what good I may accomplish in thy name., Shri **SITA**, hearing the words of the pious Anasuya, versed in domestic duty, and being filled with astonishment, answered smilingly : "Thy loving kindness has already fulfilled my every desire.u Shri Anasuya heating these words was gratified in greater measure and said : " O **SITA**, fornmate am I to behold thee I Let my joy bear fruit, ask a boon. I can give thee celestial garlands, apparel and precious unguents to adorn thy person. O Daughter of Janska, my gifts would enhance thy beauty, they will never fade and they will become thee well. Apply this powder which I now give to thee ; thou shalt, by this, augment thy husband's beauty as Lakshmi increases the glory of the imperishable **VISHNU**." The princess accepted the robes, powder and ornaments, gifts of love, from the ascetic. The illustrious **SITA**, having received the symbols of affection from Anasuya, sat down near her with joined palms. Then Anasuya requested Shri **SITA** to relate something of moment, saying : " O **SITA**, I have heard a brief account of thy wedding, describe it to me now in detail." Shri **SITA** obediently answered : " Hear me, and I will relate it all to thee. The King of Mithila, that brave and virtuous monarch, Janska, the protector of his people as befits a warrior, 408 once, when ploughing the earth to establish sacrificial ground, bebeld me like a daughter emerging from the furrow. At that time, the king repeating the holy was scattering the seed of herbs aud, seeing my

body besmeared with dust, was astonished. Being without issue, he took me in his arms aud said, ' This shall be my daughter ', aud treated me with extreme Jove. Then a voice rang out from the heavens, saying : ' O King, verily she is thy daughter.' " The king rejoiced in my possession and since my birth his prosperity has increasecl. That sovereign, CODSIBnt in the performance of saaiftce, gave me into the care of his chief queen, she nourishing me with maternal atfection. When I came to maturity, my father grew anxious, like an indigent man who is berd't of all he possesses. " The fathet of a daughter, be he equal to Indta, must defer to his son-in-Jaw, whether in status he be his peer or his inferior. My father was willing to submit to this eventuality and was consumed with anxiety, as one desirous of crossing a river, who lincls himself without the means of transport. "After much seeking, he was unable to find a suitable bride groom and was beset with fears. On profuund reflection, he resolved to convene a meeting of princes, that I might elect a husband. " In ancient days, on the occasion of a sacrifice, one of our royal forbears received from **VARUNA**, a great bow with two quivers that should never Jack arrows. The bow was so heavy that many persons together amid not move it and no monarch could draw it, even in dream. " By his merit, my honoured sire had acquited the bow and he, summoning the kings in council, addressed them, saying : ' Ye Sovereigns of Men, I will give my daughter in marriage to him who is able to lift up and string this bow.' " The kiDgs, beholding the bow resembling a mountain in weigbt, unable to lift it up, made obeisance to it aud went theit way. "After a long time, the resplendent **RAMACHANDRA** came to my father's aacrifice in company with the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**. The king, my fathet, o1fered that truth-loving hero together with the Saae Vishwamiaa, abundant hoapitality. 40!1 " Then Sbri Vishwamitta said to the king : ' These are the two sons of

King **DASARATHA**, who desire to see the bow. Be gracious enough to allow these two princes to view it.' " King Jauab commanded the bow to be brought as requested by the Sage Vishwamitta. " In an iosllllt, Sbri **RAMACHANDRA**, lifting the bow, drew it. Having been heot by the thong, the bow broke in creating a sound like the crash of thunder. Thereafter, my honoured father caused water to be brought and oft'ered to Sbri **RAMA** chandra and prepared to bestow me on him, hut Shri **RAMACHANDRA** did not consent to accept my hand till the inten tions of his own father were known. " King Jauab then requested the aged King **DASARATHA** to come thither and he, acquiescing in the matter, did so. With his approval I was pledged to the great-souled **RAMACHANDRA** ; my younger sister, a guilekss girl, Urmila, being wedded to Sbri Labhmana. " O Great Ascetic, thus was I bestowed in marriage and since then have tsken delight in ministering to my Lord, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, as is my duty." CHAPTER I 19 1M lwly t.UUtics blm tM mles ...ur tM forest

CHAPTER 119

The holy ascetics bless the exiles who enter the forest

" Then Sbri Vishwamitta said to the king : ' These are the two sons of King **DASARATHA**, who desire to see the bow. Be gracious enough to allow these two princes to view it.' " King Jauab commanded the bow to be brought as requested by the Sage Vishwamitta. " In an iosllllt, Sbri **RAMACHANDRA**, lifting the bow, drew it. Having been heot by the thong, the bow broke in creating a sound like the crash of thunder. Thereafter, my honoured father caused water to be brought and oft'ered

to Sbri **RAMA** chandra and prepared to bestow me on him, hut Shri **RAMACHANDRA** did not consent to accept my hand till the inten tions of his own father were known. " King Jauab then requested the aged King **DASARATHA** to come thither and he, acquiescing in the matter, did so. With his approval I was pledged to the great-souled **RAMACHANDRA** ; my younger sister, a guilekss girl, Urmila, being wedded to Sbri Labhmana. " O Great Ascetic, thus was I bestowed in marriage and since then have tsken delight in ministering to my Lord, Shri **RAMACHANDRA**, as is my duty." CHAPTER I 19 1M lwly t.UUtics blm tM mles ...ur tM forest The smoke, in hue resembling a pigeon's neck, rising from the Sages' sacred fires is being driven by the wind here and there. The bare trees, scarcely seen in the distance, appear like dense clouds in the gathering darkness. The light is slowly fading in every quarter. See, the rangers of the night are

GLOSSARY (Note: For Flowers, Trees, and Weapons, see separate Glossaries.) ACHMANA ceremony-purificatory rite, at which water is taken in the palms of the hands, and poured on the head and breast. Aom. Mother of the Gods, space and infinity. GLOSSARY B A title of honour. IIALA and A mystical science or magic formulae uaed for tbe discharge of saaed weapoos. BALl or VALL Brother of **SUGRIVA**, tbe monlzy King. Bali was slain by Shri Ramo. BHAGIIIATHA. Deacendant of King Sagara, whoae austerities caused tbe sacred river to oome to earth. BHAGIIIATRI. A o(tbe river Ganges or Gunga after tbe Sage Bhagiratba. Brother of **SHRI RAMA** and of Queen **KAIKEYI** and Dasaratba. Ancient India. BHAIWlWAJA. A Vedic Sage, to whom many Vedic hymns are attributed. He received tbe sons of King Dasaratba in tbe foreat and entertained them there. BHUGV. A Vedic Sage, said be tbe son of Manu, tbe Progenitor of mankind. BBUVAB, SwAB. Lower, middle and upper worlds. BmiSHANA or VmiSHANA-Brotber of **RAVANA**, but a devotee of **SHRI RAMA**, wbo

conferred tbe Kingdom of Lanka on him after **RAVANA**'s death. BISHAKA or VISHAKA. A devotee of abstraction of mind, or tbe oonatant contemplation of tbe Deity. i!RAHMAN. The AbsOlute, The Highest Rulity, Attributelesa Being. IIRAHMA. The aeative aspect of Divinity, Shri V11hnu being tDe maintaining aspect as opposed to Shri **SHIVA** tbe destruc1ive DAITYAS. TitaDs. GLOSSARY D of Shri llrlhma; his daughter UMA was the ofShiva. DAESHINA. Traditiooal offering made after a sacred ceremony. DANAVAS. A race of_siants, enemies of the Gods. vast furest lying between the rivers Godavari snd Narmada, the scene of Shri Rams and **SITA**'s eaile. King of Koshala, father of Shri Rams, Lablunana GLOSSARY GullA. King of the Nisbadas, a moantain tribe, a great devOII:e of **SHRI RAMA**. Gtlllu. A tradiliooal Toacher, one wbo dispels ignorance. H HANuMAN. A lllliiRy chief, son of Pavana and Anjana. **HANUMAN** was the ideal devotee and servant of **SHRI RAMA**. HAiti. A name of the Lord meaning CaptivatiDJ ", Pleasing". HAW A particular ofl"ering to the Gods, an anaent fire ceremony. IJCSHWAJtu. Son of Manu, lbunder of the Solar race of Kinp, who reigned in Ayodhya. Tbe King of the Gods or *Devas*. TuB. Sacred fig tree. Coone brown Indisn sugar made from palm sap. The sage who d!ank up the saaed river Ganges. One of the continents of which the world was said to be composed. King of Mithila, father of **SITA**. name of **SITA**. Silent repetition of a prayer or saaed formula. King of the vultureS, wbo fought **RAVANA** when he abducting **SITA**. Producer of weapons. King **DASARATHA**'o couruellor. The matted loeb of a devotee. K KAIANDHA. An *asura* or demon. GLOSSARY ltAsYAPA or KAsliYAPA. The peat Vedic Sase, grandaoJI of **BRAHMA**, and father of Vivaswat. An ancient writer of peat celebrity, author of Dbarmasbaatra. KAUPIN. Loin cloth. Chief Queen of King **DASARATHA** and mother of Sbri R.ama. KA'OSJIIEA. Title of V1Shwamitra after his grandfather. K.\VSHW. A rioer, said to be the sister of Sbri **VISHWAMITRA**. KAUSTUIIIL\. Celebrated jewel, churned from the ocean and wom by Shri **VISHNU**. A species of duck. A

special c1sss of celestial beintl· Klsloo. Chief QUeea of King Sagara. KHAKA. A demon. KJovA or KIIBEVA. Frumenty: hulled wheat boiled in milk and sweetened. KINDs T See under " Six ". KJNNERAS. Celestial Beinga attendant on Kuoera. The country ruled over by Bali (*possibly Mysore*) given **SUGRIVA** by R.ama. KoSHALA. The kingdom ruled over by King Dasarstha. KIIAVNCBA. A species of heron, Ardea Jacularor. KluTTJKAS. The Pleisdcs, nunes of God of War. The ocean of milk, KUBIJA. Hunchback. IWMIIIIALWIA. Brother of R.avana, a great warrior killed by Sbri R.ama. KtiiiiA. One of of Shri R.ama and **SITA**. (See Lava.) KIIVBIIA. God of wesllh. l.AGNAS. The twelve signs of lhe Zodiac are considered as rising above horizoJ1 in coune of day. The J..aP.a has GLOSSARY One of the IODI of Sbri **RAMA** and **SITA**. {See Kusba.) l.AVANA. Son of Madhu, a demon. LoiUTANGA. Man. LoiW'ALAS. GuardiiDS oftbe four quarters. A vessel of coconut or metal used for begging or cere monial purposes. M A mixture of curds, butter, honey and tbe milk of a ttaditiooal oftirinJ. MADHUStlDANA. Name of Shr1 Vislmu, meaJiing Destroyer of Madhu, a demon.. GLOSSARY NADBAra.u. Tbe Hindus, bcoide the oommon division of the Zodiac into twelve sips, divided it into 27 Nabhalrll, al in ead1 sign. Bach Nabhatta bas its appropnate : Aawini. :a. Jlhanni. 3· Krittika. 4· Rohini. S· Mr'gu· iras. 6. Aldea. 7· Punarvasu. 8. Pusbya. 9· Alesba. Magna. u. Purva-pbalguni. Uttarapbalguni. Hasta. I+ Otitta. 15. Svati. 16. Vishaka. 17. Anuradb. GLOSSARY The of die 6th lllllllr IIWISion, also of CODJitelJalion of three PuTTIII!STI. O=mony for extmding die race by having sODS. Title of those the House ofRaghu wbich KiDg Dasaratba aod Sbri Rimi8 belooged. RARu. A mythical demon said to cause the eclipse of sun and saailice. A great aaailice petforniOd io ancient lima at the instsllation of a king. RAiwL\SAS. DemODS. llAMA or RAMAcHANDIIA. The Incarnation of Shri **VISHNU**, and the eldest son of King Dasaratba. It is round tbis great figure tbat the Ramayana is CODitructed. RAMA·KATHA. Tlie recitation of Ramayana which has been a tradition io Iodia for thousands

of years. RAMBHA. An apsara (q.v.) symbolising tbe perfection of female beauty from lodra's realm. King of Lanka, a tlll-headed demon wbo abducted **SITA**, **RAMA**'s consort. Rmu. An illumioed sage. Tbere are four classes of *Rishi* : Rajariahi-e ro,al *Rishi*, GLOSSARY The Dwapora or C'.oppu Ae· KaJi or IrOn Ae· Lirerally relating to the sun, a divine potion. SAvrru. DII1Jibtet of King Aswapati who rescued her husband Satyavanta from the God of death. The wish-fulfilliDg cow belonging to Shri Vasishths. or SBIBIII. A female ascetic, great devotee of Shri Ramo, whom 1iaited in the !brest. SILWIA. A name of the God Indrs. SILWIA-DHWAZA. A ceremony in honour of **INDRA**. Daughter of King Lomapoda, married to the Rishya S....=NGA. A hermit Sage 1iaited by Shri Rams and **SITA** in the Dandab Tedllhings of divine or recognised authority. of the Sage Gautama and spiritual preceptot at the Court of King **JANAKA**. !as!:!:t GLOSSARY Monkey King, a friend of Shri Roma who gave him the Kingdom of Kishki.ndhyo. Prime minister of King Dosoratho. Younger wife of King Sagara, who gave birth to a gourd containing thousand sons. One of the queens of King Dasoratho, mother of Laksh mana and Shatrugbna. A goddess who created divine weapons. A name of the Gods. A hermit sage who dwelt in the Dandaks forest. A spiritual director of King Dasaratho. The Self—existent, a name of the Creator, Shri **BRAHMA**. A furest much frequented by holy sages. The daughter of Brihaspati q.v. T A female demon. THiu!E WoRLDS, The-Bhur, Bhurah, Swah, Lower, middle and upper worlds. Traverser of the Three Worlds, a name of the river Ganges. A demon slain by **SHIVA**. A King of the Solar race who desired to enter heaven in his physical form and later became the planet of that nome GLOSSARY A Vedic *Rishi*, author of many hymos. V The Holy Dwarf, fifth divine Incarnation of Shri **VISHNU**. V Lord of the waters, the Indian VAIIUNI. Daughter ofVaruna, symbolises wine. VABISRTIL\. One of the seven great sages. He the spiritual precel'lor of the House of Rsghu. King of the Snalos. VAYll. God Of the winds. VBDA. The Holy Scriprutes of the Hindu religion. Fouotain of divine knowledge. Snn of the Sage

Kasyaps and fiother of Rishyasrin.a-. VmAIIIIHA. The country is probably Birar, whose capital Kundinapura. VINA. A stringed musical insttument. VINATA. The of **GARUDA**. VIROCHANA. A giant, fiother of llRli. VISHAEA. One Of the Nabhatras (q.v.), also a month of the Spring aeason. VISHNU. The divine Maintainer of the Universe. VISHWAMITRA. A great sage, whose story is told in the Ramayana. or VIIITRA. See YAKSHA, YABBINI. Supemstwal beings attendant on the God of wealth, Kuvera. The God of Death. YAYATI. A forbear of King **DASARATHA**, his story appears in several of the great classics, **VISHNU**-Purana, Mahabhaiilta, ete. *YOGA.* A school of philosophy of the most important il the Adwaita (*non-dualist*) system elaborated by Shri Shlnbracbarys. YOJANA. Approllimately eight miles. WEAPONS AGNEYA. The fiery weapon. AI.AxSHYA. That which ca'lllot be seen in its coune. ARDI!A. The web (*see Shuska*). AIIHANI. The thunderbolt. AVANGMUKHA. Weapon with head hanging. Weapon of Protection. B il.wiMA-PASHA. Net or noose of Bnbma. (Pasba meaaing a rope.) llaA!iMAsmRA. **BRAHMA**-beadcd. D DANDA or DUNDA. Lilaally staff. Rod of punishment. DARANA. To tear or split asunder. DARPANA. Drying-up weapon. DASHAXSIIA. The ten-eyed weapon. DASHA-SIIIIISIIA. The ten-headed weapon. DHANA. Weapon of wealth. g: GLOSSARY H HAYA-SlmA. The hone-headed. The weapon of **INDRA**. lsHJKA. The ardent woapon.]YOTISHMA. The luminous. K KALA Discus. See Disc of Kala. KALA-PASHA. Death KAMAIIUCID. Able ID do wbat it pleues. KAMAitvPA. Able ID assume any !Orm at will. Creating sex Weapon protecting the side (*possibly some kind of armour*). KAPALA. A helmet. Weapon of the valiant band. A small bell. Giving ID the eatth. Fmm the bird of that name, 9·"· Tbat which may he seen in its course. I.oJUTA MuiUu. Bloody monthed. M MAMA NABHA. Large navelled. MAMA V ABU. The great armed or banded. MAKARA. The sea M.w. The necldAced. MANAVA. Weapon of Manu. MATBANA. Weapon that hurts or injures. GLOSSARY p PAISHA AsniA. Tbe ghostly weapon, one

belonging the Pisachas, ghosts or demons. AsniA. Supreme cleari!'f weapon. Tbe weapon sa=d **SHIVA**. **SHIVA**'s bow. PISHACHA. Missile belonging the Pisachas. PlnYIA. Connected with the ancestors (*Pittris*). l'RAMA THANA. The chumer. Weapon of deatruction. hABwAPRANA. To do with inhaliog the vital airs. PaAnHAIUAitA. That which preveuts the effects of other wnpons. l'tJBANG MIJKHA. Haviog thO face a-..rted. The desolamr. Q R RAn. Weapon of eojopnent. The weapon. Weapon saaed (***SHIVA***). s The covaiog weapon. Tbe arm weapon. Ooe of the of Kamadeva, the God of l.cmo, a weapon scorches aoCI bums up. Thst which has furce. SAIIPA-NATHA. lmd of serpeots. SArYA-AsniA. Tbe existence weapon. SATYAltlltTI. The famed. Tbe heroic weapon. SJwms. Powen. SJIAKuNA. Tbe vultuie-sbaped. GLOSSARY T TIUMIIHAKA. The gaper. GLOSSARY B IIADu or VADIII. plant-Zisyphus Jujuba. BIL\NDUKA. Calosanthes lndica. A smaD fruit ttoe to tbe Magnolia-aillinia Speciosa. BILWA. A citrus fruit used in tbe manufacture of sherbet. BllRGAD. Banyan tree-Ficus bengalensis. L. CIIAMPAU. A species of mapolia. D DI!VA A variety of pine. DI!VA PARNA. MediciDal plant (*tbe Divine Leaf*). GLOSS AllY Simplocoo llaczmosa. The bark of this tree is used for dye. M Dlipi butll:< tree. Bossia Lstifolia. MADHURA. Perennial Jasmine. MAI.I.nA. Evening Jasmine. MANGO. Mangifcia Indica. N VADRI. (See Badri.) GLOSSARY u Sacred medicinal tree. CratctVa Tapia. VB"IRA. Otnamental palm. VBTTAS. Ra-.. cane. Calamus rotamg. L. VIJAIA. Citron tree. w y z 450 -TrtmSlated by HARI PRASAD SHASTRI Vol. II. SHANTI SADAN 2!1 CHBPSTOW VILLAS LONDON, W.11 1!157

liARI l'USAD SHAsTIII bcpn the translation of the 1tamayua of Risbi **VALMIKI** about 1945, and he completed the work ill I94fl. The task of editiag the translation, proof readiDg and compiling the Glouaries bas been entrusted to some of his studcnls, and the first of the thiee volwues published ill 1952 and was favourably received by the

critics. A generous recognition on the of the Government of India brought a grant towards the publication of the and third vo1wues which is hereby gratdW!y ackuowleclgcd. The volume of the Ramayana cloBely foUows the pattern of Volume except that it has been decided to dispease with fuotnotes so far as possible, and to ezpand the Glossaries. The BDglisb equivrolent of aU Sansait WOlds will be found ill these, although the of some have been ttaeed. The ptep11111tion of the manuscript of the third and last volume is well advanced and publication is planned for aat yeat. SIIANTl SADAN, I9S7· CONTENTS CONTENTS 36. Ravllllll reveals Project to him 37. Maricha seeks dissuade **RAVANA** from Design -38. Marich first Encounter with **RAMA** 39· Maricha again seeks to dissuade **RAVANA** ftom pursuing his Design **-RAVANA**'s 41. Further Counsels of Maricha to **RAVANA** 42· Muicha, assuming the form of a Deer, to **RAMA**'s Hermitage ————-43· **SITA** is enamoured of the Fawn 44· **RAMA** slays Maricha -45· Sits sends Labhmana to Rams's Assistance 46. **SITA** ——The Convenation of **RAVANA** and **SITA** 48. **SITA** defies **RAVANA** -49· Sits's Abduction by **RAVANA** -so. **JATAYU** attacks **RAVANA** -xos sx. The Combat between **JATAYU** and RavaDa I07 **JATAYU** Flight -53· **SITA** 54. **RAVANA** implores **SITA** to become his Conson -56. **SITA** is guarded by the Titan Women —-57· **RAMA** sees terrible Portents s8. **RAMA**'s Lament -59· **RAMA** reproaches **LAKSHMANA** -6o. The Search for **SITA** —**RAMA**'s Plaint -62. His Despair —-63. He connnues to lament -64. **RAMA**'s Wrath -65. **LAKSHMANA** seeks to pacify **RAMA** ——I37 66. **LAKSHMANA** seeks to mspirc **RAMA** with Courage -I38 CONTENTS BooJt IV-KISHKINDHA 1. **RAMA** describes the Spring and the Sentiments it evokes in him —z. **SUGRIVA** sends **HANUMAN** to interview **RAMA** 3· **HANUMAN**'s Meeting with **RAMA** 4· **HANUMAN** brings **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** into the Presence of **SUGRIVA** -5· The Alliance hetween **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** 6. **SUGRIVA** shows Sits's Qoak and Jewels -t8o 7· **SUGRIVA** consoles **RAMA** -8. **SUGRIVA** implores Ram.a for his help against Bali -The Story of Bali and Mayavi -to. The

Origin of Bali's Hatred of **SUGRIVA** -n. **SUGRIVA** tells **RAMA** of Bali's Exploits -xSg 12. The Fight between Bali and **SUGRIVA** CONTENTS aat ;.; s..;.,h ..r !!: = CONTENTS Boolt V-SUNDAIIA 1. The DepartUre of **HANUMAN** -2. in Lanka -CONTENTS 41. 4· 43· 44· 45· 46. 47· 48. 49· so. 51. 52. 53· 54· 55· s6. 57· s8. 59· 6o. 61. 62. 63. 64 6s. 66. 67. 68. **HANUMAN** destroys the Ashoka Grove -He slays the Kinkaras ——-He burns the Temple and Monument -The Death of Jambumalin —-**HANUMAN** slays the Sons of Ravena's Ministers -He annihilates five Generals and their Forces -The Death of Aksha -**HANUMAN** allows himself be taken Captive by the Titans ————His Astonishment on beholding **RAVANA** -**HANUMAN** is questioned by the Titans His Words -Bibishana pleads for **HANUMAN** -**HANUMAN** is led bound through the City -He sets Fire Lanka **HANUMAN**'s Fears concerning **SITA** He takes Leave of her The Return of **HANUMAN** -He recounts his Experiences -41S **HANUMAN** appeals to the Monkeys to rescue **SITA JAMBAVAN** reJects **ANGADA**'s Project —-The Devastation of Madhuvana -The Fight between Dadhimnka and the Intruders Dadhimnka relates how Madhuvana been laid waste 491 **SUGRIVA** consoles **RAMA** -**HANUMAN** tells **RAMA** of bis Meeting with **SITA** -**RAMA**'s Grief -**HANUMAN** describes his Interview with **SITA** -He repeats his Words of Consolation to **SITA** Sol Glossaries ————-SOS sii ENTERING the vast Dandaka Forest, the invincible **RAMA**, master of his senses, saw a circle of huts belonging to ascetics, strewn with bark and kusba grass, blazing with spiritual effulgence. scarce to be borne by mortal eye, as tbe noonday sun is a source of torment men. This retreat, a haven all beings, the ground of which was carefully tended, was frequented by many deer and multitudes of birds and rendered gay by tbe dancing of troops of apsaras. Beautiful with its spacious buts, where the sacred fire burnt, surrounded by ladles and other articles of worship such as skins, kusha grass, fuel, jars of water, fruit roots ; encircled by great and sacred forest trees, bowed with tbe weight of ripe and delectable fruits, tbe whole hermitage was hallowed by sacrificial offerings and libations and re-echoed to tbe

recitation of Vedic hymns. Carpeted with flowers of every kind, possessing pools covered with lotuses, it had been tbe retreat of former hermits, who subsisted on fruit and roots and who, wearing robes of bark and black antelope skins, their senses fully controlled, resembled the sun or fire. Now great and pious sages, practising

BOOK III

Aranya Kanda

After ten years of forest life, the demoness Surpanakha is humiliated and her brothers slain. In revenge, Ravana abducts Sita to Lanka. The aged eagle Jatayu fights the Titan and falls, dying in Rama's arms. The grief-stricken brothers begin their search.

CHAPTER 1

Rama is welcomed by the Sages of the Dandaka Forest

RAMA is welcomed by the Sages of the Dandaka Forest ENTERING the vast Dandaka Forest, the invincible **RAMA**, master of his senses, saw a circle of huts belonging to ascetics, strewn with bark and kusba grass, blazing with spiritual effulgence. scarce to be borne by mortal eye, as tbe noonday sun is a source of torment men. This retreat, a haven all beings, the ground of which was carefully tended, was frequented by many deer and multitudes of birds and rendered gay by tbe dancing of troops of apsaras. Beautiful with its spacious buts, where the sacred fire burnt, surrounded by ladles and other articles of worship such as skins, kusha grass, fuel, jars of water, fruit roots ; encircled by great and sacred forest trees, bowed with tbe weight of ripe and delectable fruits, tbe whole hermitage was hallowed by sacrificial offerings and libations and re-echoed to tbe recitation of Vedic hymns. Carpeted with flowers of every kind, possessing pools covered with lotuses, it had been tbe retreat of former hermits, who subsisted on fruit and roots and who, wearing robes of bark and black antelope skins, their senses fully controlled, resembled the sun or fire. Now great and pious sages, practising dwcllers in the wood were astonished at Ranta's handsome mien, his youthful appearaoce, majesty and graceful attire and, struck with wonder, gazed unwinkingly on Raghava, **LAKSHMANA** and Vaidehi, as on a great marvel. Then, those blessed sages, engaged in the welfare of all beings, conducted **RAMA** to a leaf-thatched hut, where, offering him the ttaditional hospitality, those fortunate and pious men, resembling fire

itself, brought water that he might wash his hands and feet. Experiencing great delight, those high-souled ascetics, bidding bim welcome, gathered flowers, fruit and roots, placing the whole content of the hermitage at the disposal of that magnanimous hero. Thereafter, those ascetics, versed in the sacred lore, with joined palms addressed him, saying : " O Raghava, a king is the defender of the rights of bis people and their refuge; he is worthy of all honour and respect, he wields the seepue, he is the Guru and partakes of a fourth part of the glory of **INDRA** ; he enjoys the highest prerogatives and receives every homage. We, being under thy dominion. should be protected by thee, whether living in the capital or the forest; thou art our Sovereign, O Master of the World ! “Having renounced all desire for revenge, subdued anger and mastered our senses, do thou protect us in the practice of virtue, as a mother protects the infant at her breast.” With these words they paid reverence to **RAMA**, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, offering bim fruit, roots, flowers and every product of field and forest, whilst other ascetics, resembling the fire in lusue, observers of sacred vows, honoured the Lord according to uadition.

CHAPTER 2

The Demon Viradha carries off Sita

dwcllers in the wood were astonished at Ranta’s handsome mien, his youthful appearaoce, majesty and graceful attire and, struck with wonder, gazed unwinkingly on Raghava, **LAKSHMANA** and Vaidehi, as on a great marvel. Then, those blessed sages, engaged in the welfare of all beings, conducted **RAMA** to a leaf-thatched hut, where, offering him the ttaditional hospitality, those fortunate and pious men, resembling fire

itself, brought water that he might wash his hands and feet. Experiencing great delight, those high-souled ascetics, bidding bim welcome, gathered flowers, fruit and roots, placing the whole content of the hermitage at the disposal of that magnanimous hero. Thereafter, those ascetics, versed in the sacred lore, with joined palms addressed him, saying : " O Raghava, a king is the defender of the rights of bis people and their refuge; he is worthy of all honour and respect, he wields the seepue, he is the Guru and partakes of a fourth part of the glory of **INDRA** ; he enjoys the highest prerogatives and receives every homage. We, being under thy dominion. should be protected by thee, whether living in the capital or the forest; thou art our Sovereign, O Master of the World ! “Having renounced all desire for revenge, subdued anger and mastered our senses, do thou protect us in the practice of virtue, as a mother protects the infant at her breast.” With these words they paid reverence to **RAMA**, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, offering bim fruit, roots, flowers and every product of field and forest, whilst other ascetics, resembling the fire in lusue, observers of sacred vows, honoured the Lord according to uadition. There, trees, creepers and shrubs bad been trampled under foot, so that tbe paths were bately distinguishable and the reftection from the pools and lakes was dazzling ; no birds sang in thst whole demesne, which was filled with the humming of crickets.' Followed by **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA** searched the depths of the forest with his gaze and in that wood, abounding in ferocious beasts, Kakutstha, accompanied by **SITA**, beheld a titan as luge as a mountain creating a great uproat. Of formidable aspect, hideous, deformed, his eyes sunk deep in his forehead, with a vast mouth and protruding belly, clad in a tiger skin, covered with blood and loathsome to look upon, he struck terror into the heatts of all beings ; it appeared as if death itself were approaching with open jaws. Three lions, four tigers, two leopatds,

four dappled deer and the head of a great elephant with its tusks, from which tbe fat ran down, hung from his spear. Seeing **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA**, the Princess of Mitbila, he rushed upon them in fury, like Time at the destruction of the worlds. Then, creating a great uproat, causing the eattb to tremble, he seized Vaidehi in his atms and began to carry her away, saying : " O Ye, westing matted locks, clad in robes of batt, accom panied by a common consort, ye ate about to die ! Entering the Dandaka Forest, armed with weapons, bows and speats, whence have ye come, O Ascetics and why do ye dwell here in the company of a woman ? Perverse and evil wretches, who ate ye, bringing disrepute on the sages ? I am the Titan Viradha, this is my retreat and I roam the impenetrable forest, armed with weapons, feeding on tbe flesh of ascetics. This woman of lovely limbs sball become my wife and, in combat, I will drink the blood of ye both, O Miscreants I " The daughter of J anaka, **SITA**, heating the cruel and arrogant speech of the wicked-hearted Viradba, filled with dread, began to tremble like a palm shaken by the wind. **RAMA**, seeing Viradha bearing the lovely **SITA** away, growing pale, said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O Friend, behold the daughter of J anaka, my chaste consort, an illustrious princess, reated in luxury, held fast in the arms of Viradha ! Alas ! **KAIKEYI**'s desire bas been fulfilled to-day ! O **LAKSHMANA**, the enthronement of her son did not suffice that designing woman, since she caused me to be banished to the forest despite the love my subjectS bore me. Now she who reigns supreme in the midst of our mothers will be satisfied! That another should have laid bands on Vaidehi is the greatest of my misfortunes, worse even than the death of my sire or the loss of my kingdom, O Saumitri ! " Hearing the words of Kakutstha, **LAKSHMANA**, his eyes streaming with tears, hissing like a wounded snake, said harshly: " O Kakutstha, O Protector of All Beings, who art equal to lndra himself,

since I am thy servant, why dost thou lament as though thou badst no defender ? " Pierced by the shaft I am about to loose in my wrath, the Titan Viradha will die and the earth drink his blood. The bitterness, I felt towards **BHARATA** for his desiring the throne, I shall expend on Viradha, as the God who bears the thunder bolt discharges it at a mountsin ! With all the strength of mine arm, letting fty this sharp arrow, I shall pierce his breast! May he yield up his life and fall rolling on the earth ! "

CHAPTER 3

The Struggle between Viradha and the two Brothers

" **W**ho are ye, where are ye going, answer me t " Then the illustrious **RAMA** answered that titan, whose countenance was inftamed with anger, aaying : " Know us to be two warriors of the race of lkshwaku, 6 fixed in our vows, wandering in the forest ; but now we would know who tbou art, roaming here and there in the thickets ? " Thereupon Viradha said to **RAMA**, whose strength was truth: " Hear and I will tell thee, O Prince of the House of Raghu I I am the son of Java and my mother is Satarhada. I am known among the titanS throughout the world as Viradha. Having gratified **BRAHMA** by my penances, I obtained a boon and was rendered invulnerable to any weapon on earth ; it is impossible to slay me by the of arms I " Forsaking this fair one, do ye, renouncing all hope, without turning back, go hence without delay and I will grant you your lives!" Then **RAMA**, his eyes red with anger, answered that hideous demon, the wicked Viradha, saying : " Wretch that thou art, cursed be thine evil design ; assuredly thou art courting death, verily thou shalt find it in

combat ; stay but an instant and thou shalt not escape alive I " Bending his bow and speedily placing two sharp arrows on it, **RAMA** struck that demon with his pointed shafts and there after, stretching the cord tight, he loosed seven swift arrows, adorned with feathers and tipped with gold, equal in fiight to Suparna and Anila. Having pierced the body of Viradha, those fiery shafts, decorated with heron's plumes, fell to the ground hissing and stained with blood. On receiving those wounds, Viradha loosed his hold on Vaidebi and brandishing his spear in fury hurled himself on **RAMA** and on **LAKSHMANA** who accompanied him. Letting forth a mighty roar, grasping his spear, like unto the standard of **INDRA**, his jaws wide open, he resembled death itself. Then the two brothers rained a volley of flaming arrows on Viradha, who resembled time, death or fate, but that terrible demon, bursting into loud laughter, halting and opening his jaws, threw up those pointed arrows by virtue of the boon he had received. Restraining his breath and brandishing his spear, the demon Viradha again rushed on the two descendants of Raghu, whereupon **RAMA**, the most skilful of warriors, with 7 two arrows cut off that spear, which shone like lightning and resembled a flame in the sky. Shattered by **RAMA**'s shafts, the spear fell to the ground, like a rocky ledge split by lightning. Thereat, unbuckling their swords, those warriors swiftly fell on Viradha like two black serpents, striking him heavily again and again. Though hard beset, their formidable opponent beat them off vigorously with his fists, but they stood firm, whereupon he sought to lift them from the ground and **RAMA**, guessing his intention, said to **LAKSHMANA** : " Let the demon carry us along the path as far as he wishes, O Saumitri ! Allow this Prowler of the Night to bear us according to his whim, since he is proceeding along our way." Thereupon, the demon, proud of bis strength, with great energy lifted them up and placed them on his

shoulders like two striplings ; then having set the two descendants of Raghu on bis shoulders, the demon Viradha, Ranger of the Night, emitting a great roar, strode off into the forest. Entering that forest, abounding in trees of every kind, where diverse birds filled the air with their song and which was thronged with jackals, beasts and serpents, he resembled a great cloud.

CHAPTER 4

Rama and Lakshmana slay the Demon Viradha

SEEING the two brothers, the glory of the House of Raghu, being borne away, **SITA**, lifting up her arms, began to cry aloud, re1lecting thus : ' **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, who is truthful, virtuous and guileless, is being carried away by a demon of terrifying aspect; I shall become a prey to bears, tigers and panthers I ' Thinking thus, she cried out :-" O Foremost of Demons, I beg of thee, take me and spare those two descendants of Raghul" Hearing Vaidebi's worda, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, full of valour, prepared to slay that wicked wretch, whereupon 8 Saumitri broke the left arm of that redoubtable demon and Ramo the right; thereafter, that titan, resembling a mass of cloud, his arms broken, growing weak, suddenly fell to the ground unconscious, like a mountain struck by lightoing. Then the two brothen beat the demon with their fists and feet and pickillg him up, again hurled him to the ground ; yet, though struck by innumetable arrows and wounded by their swords, the demon did not die. Perceiving it to be impossible to slay that giant, like unto a mountain, the blesaed **RAMA**, the refuge of all who are in peril, spoke thus : " By virtue of his penances, O Tiger among Men, this demon cannot be overcome in combat by weapons, let us

therefore cast him into a pit. O **LAKSHMANA**, as if for a great elephant, do thou dig a pit in the forest for this demon of formidable size." Having thus commanded **LAKSHMANA** saying:-" Dig a pit", the valiant Ramo stood with his foot on the neck of the demon. Hearing those words, the demon in humble accents addressed that descendant of Raghu, that Bull among Men, saying : " O Lion among Hetoes, undet the blows of a warrior whose strength equals that of **INDRA**, I am dying. In mine ignorance, I did not recognize thee, O Uon amongst Men I I see now that thou art the noble son of **KAUSHALYA**. O Dear Child, thou art Ramo and this is the fortunate Vaidebi and the illustrious **LAKSHMANA**. " Through a cune, I had to assume the monstrous shape of a titan, but in reality I am the Gandharva Tumburu, who incurred the wnth of Kuveta. That glorious God, being propitiated by me, said:-' When **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, overcomes thee in fight, then, assuming thy natural form, thou shalt return to the celestial region.' Owing to my lack of reverence for him, in anger the Lord Kuvera had denounced me for having conceived an attachment for the nymph, Rambha. By thy grace, I am delivered from this tetriblc cune and shall of austerity, a great and mighty *rishi*, e1fulgent as the sun. Go there, without delay ; he will give thee most excellent counsel! Having buried me in a pit, O **RAMA**, go thy way in peace ! Those demons who are about to die must according to a fixed law be buried in a pit." Having spoken thus to Kakutstha, the courageous Viradha, pierced by many arrows, leaving his body, ascended to heaven.' Then Raghava said to **LAKSHMANA** :-" Dig a pit for this demon of dreadful deeds, as for a great elephant in the forest." Having spoken thus to **LAKSHMANA** saying ' Dig a pit ! ', **RAMA** who was endowed with great prowess, remained standing with his foot on the head of Viradha. Then **LAKSHMANA**, taking up a pick, dug a great pit by the side of the demon, whose ears resembled conches and threw bim

into it, be lerting forth dreadful shrieks the while. Finding they were unable to kill that great titan with their sharp weapons, those two lions among men, having employed all their ingenuity, put an end to Viradha by burying bim in the pit. Viradha himself, a ranger of the forest, desiring to die at **RAMA**'s hands, had indicated to bim how he should proceed, saying :-" I cannot be slain by weapons." Hearing this, the idea had come to **RAMA** to fiing bim into a pit, and while being cast into it, that all-powerful demon caused the forest to resound with bis cries. Having thrown Viradha into the pit, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, their fears removed, rejoiced in that forest, like the sun and moon in the firmament.

CHAPTER 5

The Meeting with the Sage Sharabhanga and his Ascent to Brahmaloka

HAVING slain the mighty and terrible Viradha in the forest, the valiant **RAMA** embraced **SITA** and comforted her ; then addressing the resplendent **LAKSHMANA**, he said :-" This impenetrable forest is dangerous and we are not its natural inhabitants; let us thetefore seek out the Sage Shara bhanga without delay." Raghava then turned his steps towards Sharabhanga's hermitage and, approaching that Sage, whose soul was purified by renunciation, he observed a great marvel. In the sky, he beheld **INDRA**, gorgeously attired in robes free from any particle of dust, his body shining like the sun or fire, mounted on a splendid chariot, followed by all the Celestials and innumerable high-souled sages like unto himself, who served as his escort. Bay horses were yoked to that aerial car, that shone like the rising sun and, luminous as the

moon's disc, resembled a mass of white clouds. **RAMA** also observed an immaculate canopy with magnificent garlands and marvellous fans made of yaks' tails with handles of gold of great price, which two women of rare beauty, waved to and fro over the head of that God, whilst Gandharvas, Immortals, Celestial Beings and great *Rishis*, paid homage to him with sublime chants, as he hovered in space. Seeing Shatakratu conversing with the Sage Sharabhanga, **RAMA** pointed out the chariot to his brother and bade him gaze on the marvellous sight. **HE** *said*:-" O **LAKSHMANA**, dost thou behold that dazzling of great brillisnce shining like the sun in the skies ? With out doubt, these are the celestial bay horses of **INDRA** of whom we have heard, who travels through space and who is constantly invoked at the time of sacrifice. Those youthful warriors wearing earrings, who in groups of hundreds, with swords in their hands, stand round him in the sky, with their broad chests and strong arms resembling maces, clad in magnificent purple, look like fierce tigers. On their breasts, gleam rows of pearls, and those lions among men, of handsome mien, appear to be twenty-five years old which is the age at which the Gods ever remain, O Saumitti. Tarry here a moment, O **LAKSHMANA**, so that I may discover who this great hero in the chariot really is." Having uttered the words ' Tarry here' to Saumitri, Kakutstha advanced towards the hermitage of Sharab hanga. II Seeing **RAMA** approaching, the Lord of Sachi, taking leave of the sage, said to the Gods : " **RAMA** is coming hither, take me to mine abode 'ere be addresses me ; later he shsll behold me ! When be returns victOrious, having fulfilled bis purpose, I shall readily show myself to him. It is for bim to perform a great exploit impossible for any other to accomplish." Thereafter, offering salutations to the ascetic, in all humility, the God who bears the thunderbolt, the Scourge of his Foes, ascended to heaven in bis chariot, harnessed with horses. When the God of a Thousand Eyes

had departed, Raghava rejoined his consort and his brother and together they approached Sharabhanga, who was seated before the sacred fire. Embracing bis feet, **RAMA**, **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA**, on bis invitation, seated themselves in the place assigned to them. Questioned by Raghava concerning Indrs's visit, Shara bhanga related everything to him. **HE** *said*: " O **RAMA**, that magnanimous God wished to conduct me to Brahmaloka, the region I have attained by the merit of my penances, which is inaccessible to those who are not masters of themselves. "Seeing thee approaching, know well, O Foremost of Men, that I had no desire to enter Brahmaloka 'ere I had enjoyed thy gentle presence in my hermitage. O Lion among Men, O Virtuous and Magnanimous Prince, having had intercourse with thee, I shall ascend first to the three lower heavens and thereafter to the highest. These worlds of unsurpassed beauty that have been conquered by me, these subliroe abodes of **BRAHMA**, that are mine by right, do thou accept, O Lion among Men I" Hearing the words of the *Rishi* Sharabhanga, Raghava, that lion among men, versed in the Shastras, answered : " I also have conquered all the worlds, O Great Ascetic, but in obedience to my vow I desire to remain in the forest." Thus addressed by Raghava, whose might was equal to Indrs's, the emioently sagacious Sharabhanga spoke again, saying: " O **RAMA**, the illustrious and virtuous Sutikslma lives in ARANY A *KANDA* this forest; that saint will tell thee what is best for thee to do. "Follow the river Mandakini, that stream which is covered with a carpet of flowers, and thou wilt reach his dwelling place. There is the path, O Tiger among Men, but stay with me a moment yet, till I abandon this body as a snake casts off its slough." Thcrcaftcr, having prepared a fire and poured clarified butter therein, Sharabhanga, that sage of supreme merit, entered the ftames to the accompaniment of sacred formulas. The hair of the magnanimous one was consumed together with his wrinkled

skin, his bones, his flesh and his blood, whereupon, assuming a youthful and splendid appearance, Sharabhanga rose from the pyre like a ftamc. Traversing the region where the sacrificial fires arc tended by high-souled sages, as well as that of the Gods, he ascended to **BRAHMA**'s abode. That foremost of *Rishis*, of purified *karma*, there beheld the Grandsire of the World with those attendant on him, who, seeing that sage, addressed him, saying:-" Thou art welcome!,

CHAPTER 6

The Sages seek the protection of Rama

SHARABHANGA having ascended to heaven, the assembled ascetics presented themselves before **RAMA**, the offspring of Kakutstha of flaming energy, and among them were those who had sprung from the nails and the hair of **BRAHMA**'s body, also from the water in which his feet were bathed ; there were those who lived on the moon's rays ; those who subsisted on milled grain ; those who did penance by standing in water ; those who slept on the naked ground ; those who lived in the open air the whole year round ; those who subsisted on water and wind alone ; those who never sought the shade ; those who underwent long fasts ; those who practised uninterrupted repetition of prayer ; those who gave themselves up to perpetual penance ; those who dwelt on the summit of high mountains ; those who had subdued their senses and those who lived between five fires.' All these sages, fiaed in *Yoga*, endowed with the powers of **BRAHMA**, gathered in Shatabhanga's hermitage in order to approsch **RAMA**. Those virtuous companies of *Rishis*, having assembled there, addressed **RAMA**, Foremost of the Good, who was conversant with his supreme duty, saying: " O Lord of

the House of Ikshwaku and of the whole world, Warrior of the Great Car, thou art our defender and leadet, as Maghavan is of the Gods. " Thou art famed in the Three Worlds for thy valour and glory I Filial devotion, justice and faith find their consum mation in thee, O Lord. It behoves thee, who cognisant with virtue, to pardon our temerity in approaching thee in order to make our supplication. “It were a signal defect for a king to receive one-sixth of the revenue of his people, if he did not protect them as his own sons. Should he however defend those who inhabit his kingdom as his own life or as the lives of his offspring, to whom he is ever devoted, he will occupy an exalted position in the region of **BRAHMA**. " The supreme blessedness acquired by those ascetics who live on roots and fruit is not equal to a quarter of that attained by the monarch who governs his subjects according to the law. " Do thou become the defender of those countless *brahmins* who live in the forest who are without a protector, and so defend them from the cruel persecution of the titans. " Come and behold the bodies of innumerable ascetics of pure heart, who have been slaughtered in diverse ways in the forest by titans. " They have in1licted great carnage amongst the people who dwell on Lake Pampa, by the river Mandakini and on Cbittrakuta. We are no longer able to endure the terrible plight of these sages, brought about in the forest by those titans of erue1 deeds ; therefore we take refuge in thee ; protect us, O Rams, 14 against those Prowlers of the Night, who seek our destruction. We have no asylum on earth but thee, O Valiant Prince; do thou save us from the titans.” Having listened to the sages, the virtuous Kakutstha answered them, who were rich in heavy penances, saying : " Do not entreat me thus ; am I not the servant of the sages ? It is solely to fulfil my duty, that I have entered the forest. It is in order to deliver you from the oppression of the titans and to carry out the commands of my sire that I am here. It is in

your interest and for your happiness that I have come here of mine own will. " My sojourn in the forest will be greatly to your advantage; I shall slay the titans, the enemies of the ascetics. Let the sages witness my prowess in combat and my brother's also, O *Rishis*!" Having yielded to the entreaty of the ascetics, that hero, firm in his duty, accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, directed his course towards the hermitage of Sutikshna, followed by the sages, who paid him every honour.

CHAPTER 7

The Meeting between Rama and Sutikshna

having proceeded far and crossed many deep rivers he beheld a wonderful mountain as high as Mount Meru. Thereafter those two scions of the House of Raghu went forward with **SITA** through a forest filled with many kinds of trees and having penetrated into that dense woodland, abound ing in trees laden with flowers and fruit, **RAMA** observed in a solitary spot a hermitage decorated with garlands and bark. There he beheld the Sage Sutikshna, a mine of asceticism, his hair matted, covered with dust, seated in the lotus posture and addressed him, saying : " O Blessed One, I am **RAMA**, who have come hither to IS behold thee. Be gracious enough, O Virtuous and IDustrious *Rishi,* O Essence of Sanctity, to speak to me." Seeing **RAMACHANDRA**, the sage, foremost of the ascetics, took him in his arms and addressed him thus : " Be thou welcome, O Best of the Raghus, O **RAMA**, chief of virtuous men. Henceforth this hermitage, which thou hast entered, has a protector. I have waited for thee, O Illustrious Hero, and for this reason did not ascend to the region of the Gods, leaving my body here on earth. I had heard that thou, being banished from thy kingdom, had gone to

Chittrakuta, O Kakutstha ! " The Chief of the Gods, Shatakratu, came hither and approaching me, that mighty King of the Celestials made it known to me that I had conquered all the worlds by virtue of my good *karma*. " All those blessings acquited by the divine sages through asceticism I offer to thee ; do thou enjoy them with thy con sort and **LAKSHMANA**." To that great and illustrious sage of rigid vows and devout speech, **RAMA**, the master of his senses, replied, as Vasava addresses Brahms, saying : " O Illustrious Sage, I myself have conquered the worlds ; yet in accordance with the command received by me, I have elected to dwell in the great forest. ' Thou art possessed of every thing, yet art engaged in the welfilre of all beings ', were the words of the ascetic Sharabhanga, that Gautama of great soul, to me." Hearing Rams's words, the great *Rishi*, renowned throughout the world, graciously addressed him, saying : " Do thou live in this hermitage, O **RAMA**, which is pleasant and frequented by companies of sages, where one may gather roots and fruit in all seasons, where herds of marvellous deer gather without injuring any and come and go enchanting all with their beauty. No harm is to be encountered here, save what the dur bring about." Hearing the words of the great *Rishi*, the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**, lifting up his bow and arrows, said : " O Blessed Lord, what could be more unfortunate than that I with my bow and sharp burnished arrows should slay I6 those deer that gather here, and thus give thee pain; fur this reason I shall not sojourn long in this sanctuary." Having spoken thus, **RAMA** became silent and performed his evening devotions ; theresfter with **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA** he prepared to pass the night in Sutikshna's enchanting hermitage. The evening having passed and night fallen, the magnani mous Sutiksbna with his own bands disttibuted hulled grain, the ttaditional food of the ascetics, to those Lions among Men, having paid homage to them.

CHAPTER 8

Rama takes leave of Sutikshna

dawn bathed with **SITA** in the cool waterS fragrant with the scent oflotuses. At the proper time, having duly worshipped **AGNI** and the Gods in that forest containing the retteats of the ascetics, **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and Videha's daughter, observing the sun had risen, approached Sutikshns with courtesy, saying : " O Lord, thou hast ministered liberally to us and paid us every honour, now we ask leave to depart, since the ascetics who accompany us wish us to press on without delay. " It is our wish to visit all the retteats inhabited by holy men of devout practices in the Dandaka Forest. We therefore beg to take leave of these great sages, fixed in their vows, purified by penance and resembling clear flames. "We desire to go hence 'ere the rays of the sun shine too fiercely and become unbearable, like one who has usurped royal prerogatives by unlawtUI means I " Having spoken thus, Raghava with Sawnitti and **SITA**, bowed down to the feet of the sage, and that Foremost of Ascetics, raising up those two heroes, clasped them affectiouately to his beart and said : 17 " Go thy way safely, O **RAMA**, in the company of Saumitri and **SITA**, who follows thee like a shadow. Visit the enttancing solitudes of the Dandaka Forest, where those hermits dwell whose souls are purified by renunciation. Thou shalt see there woods abounding in fruit, roots and flowers, magnificent herds of deer, flocks of tame birds, tufts of lotus in bloom, ttanquil lakes abounding in waterfowl, charming mountain springs and splendid cataracts falling from the hills with marvellous groves echoing to the peacock's cry. Go, O Cbild, and thou also, **SUMITRA**'s son ; then come again to this retreat when thou hast seen all." Thus addressed, Kakutstha

and **LAKSBMANA** *answered*: " Be it so ! " and circumambulating the sage, prepared to depart. Thereafter the large-eyed **SITA** handed those brothers their excellent quivers, bows and shining swords, and taking leave of the great sages the two descendants of the House of Raghu, of unsurpassed beauty, fastening on their quivers and bearing their bows and swords, swiftly set out with **SITA**.

CHAPTER 9

Sita implores Rama not to attack the Titans

" Thou art righteous, humble and faitbful to the commands of thy sire ; in thee, justice and integrity flower in their fullness. All this is possible to those who have mastered their senses, O Long-armed Warrior, and thou art fully self-subdued, O Thou of Cbatming Presence ! " The third evil, which through ignorance leads men to bear hostility to one another without cause, now shows itself in thee ! O Valiant Prince, thou hast vowed to the dwellers of the Dandaka Forest, whose defender thou art, to slay the demons without mercy, and for this reason, equipped with bows and arrows, thou hast set out with thy brother to the forest known as Dandaka. Seeing thee advancing thus my mind is filled with apprehension and I am pondering how to act in the most profitable manner for thy welfare in this world and the next. Thy departure for the Dandaka Forest does not find favour with me, O Hero ; I will tell thee the reason. " Entering the forest with thy brother, armed with bows and arrows, it may well be that, on seeing the titans, thou wilt loose thy shafts ! As the proximity of faggots increases the violence of the fire, even so does the possession of a bow increase the strength and energy of a warrior ! " In former times, O Long-armed Prince, in a sacred forest

frequented by deer and birds, dwelt a devout and virtuous ascetic. With the intention of obstructing his austerities, **INDRA**, the Lord of Sachi, in the guise of a warrior, went to that hermitage, sword in hand. In this retreat, he left that excellent sword, requesting the sage, engaged in pious acts, to guard it as a trust. Receiving that weapon, he, fully con scious of the charge laid upon him, ranged the forest, carefully watching over the sword entrusted to him. Intent on preserving it, he ventured nowhere without that sword, either to gather fruit and roots or for other reasons. Constantly bearing this weapon and neglecting his penances, by degrees, that ascetic developed warlike inclinations. In time that foolish hermit, carrying the sword, began to enjoy nothing so much as violence and, losing his sobriety, was led astray and fell into hell. " This, formerly, was the result of bearing arms I As contact I9 c with fire works change in a piece of wood, so the carrying of arms works alteration in the mind of him who carries them. " From affection and reverence for thee, I draw thine atten tion ro this matter. I do not venture to instruct thee. Equipped with bows as thou art, I ask thee ro renounce all thought of slaying the titans in the Dandaka Forest without provocation. O Warrior! the world looks askance on those who strike without cause. It is the duty of warriors ro protect those of subdued soul who are in peril. The bearing of arms and retirement ro the forest, practice of war and the eaercise of asceticism are opposed ro each other ; let us therefore honour the moral code that pertains ro peace. Murderous thoughts, inspired by desire for gain, are. born of the handling of weapons. When thou dost return to Ayodhya, thou wilt be able to take up the duties of a warrior once more. The joy of my mother and father-in-Jaw will be complete, if during the renunciation of thy kingdom, thou dost lead the life of an ascetic. Thus happiness accrues to one who discharges his duty; througb performance of one’s duty, the whole world is conquered, duty

constituting its very marrow. It is by the complete negation of self that the saints acquired bliss ; happi ness is not born of pleasure ! “O My Friend, with a pure heart fulfil thy duty in solitude; thou art conversant with the nature of the Three Worlds. “It is through feminine weakness that I speak thus, for who would dare to instruct thee in thy duty ? Having rellected carefully on what I have said, do what thou considerest best without further delay I "

CHAPTER 10

Rama reminds Sita of his promise to the Ascetics

Saying: " O Noble Lady, it is in appropriate words, dictared by thine alfection, that thou hast sought ro instruct me in the duties of my caste. " How shall I answer thee, O Princess ? Thou thyself bast said: 'Warriors bear their bows, so that the word “oppression” may not be heard on earth.' O **SITA**, it is on account of those ascetics of severe penances, beset with perils in the Dandaka Forest, who have sought my protectinn, that I have come hither. Dwelling in the forest at all times, where they live on fruit and roots, they are unable to enjoy a peaceful existence on account of the titans, O Timid Lady. These hermits of the Dandaka Forest are devoured by those terrible demons, who live on human flesh. ' Come to our aid ' was the cry of those excellent Twice-born, and when I heard those words falling from their lips, I promised to obey them and answered ' Fear not ' ! It was a source of the greatest distress to me to see them kneeling at my feet, when it was I who should have heen touching theirs." "'What do you desire of me ? ', I enquired of that assembly of the Twice-born, whereupon, drawing near, they spoke the following words : " ' In the Dandaka Forest, innumerable demons, assuming different

forms, torment us cruelly. O **RAMA**, do thou protect us I The time of the *Homa* sacrifice and the days of the full moon have come, O Irreproachable Prince I Thou the sure refuge of all the saints and ascetics who harassed by the titans seek thy protection. By the power of our asceticism it were easy for us to destroy these Rangers of the Night, but we are loath to lose the fruits of austerity, earned over a long period. " 'Prolonged penance is subject to innumerable hindrances, and is exceedingly hard, O **RAMA** I For this reason we refrain from pronouncing a curse on these demons, though they devour us. Tormented thus by the titans who frequent the Dandaka Forest, we implore thee and thy brother to protect us; thou art our support., " " Hearing these words, I promised my protection to the sages of the Dandaka Forest, O Daughter of J anaka ! " As long as I live, therefore, I cannot violate the promise given to the ascetics. " I may yield up my life or even thee, O **SITA**, as well as **LAKSHMANA**, but I cannot be false to a vow made to *brahmins*. " Even bad I not promised them anything, O Vaidehi, it is my bounden duty to protect the sages ; how much more so now! " I am pleased with thee, O **SITA**, for one does not olfcr advice to those one does not love. Thy words arc worthy of thee, O Beautiful One. By pursuing the path of duty thou bast become dearer to me than life itself." Having spoken thus to **SITA**, the daughter of the King of Mithila, the magnanimous Ramo, carryiug his bow, continued to roam through those ravishing solitudes with **LAKSHMANA**. CHAPTER **RAMA** visits the different Retreats and hears of llgastya WALKING ahead, **RAMA** was followed by **SITA**, while behind her came **LAKSHMANA**, bow in hand. With **SITA**, they proceeded further, seeing many hills and plains, woods and enchanting rivers with geese and cranes frequenting their banks and pools covered with lotuses, abounding in waterfowl, and herds of deer, horned buffaloes in rut, bears and elephants, the

destroyers of trees. Having travelled a great distance, they beheld, as the sun was setting, a marvellous lake, some four miles in length, carpeted with lotus and water-lily blooms, graced with herds of wild elephants and abounding in geese, swans and teal. From this enchanting lake of tranquil waterS, the sound of singing and musical instruments could be heard, yet no one was visible there. Captivated, Ramo and **LAKSHMANA** began to question a sage named Dharmabhrit, saying : " O Great Ascetic, this wonderful music, heard by us all, moves us strangely ; what can it be ? Be gracious enough to tell us." Thus questioned by Ragbava, the magnanimous sage began at once to relate the history of that magic lake. **HE** *said*:-" This lake, called Panchapsara,' is always filled

CHAPTER 11

Rama visits the different Retreats and hears of Agastya

" **E**ven bad I not promised them anything, O Vaidehi, it is my bounden duty to protect the sages ; how much more so now! " I am pleased with thee, O **SITA**, for one does not olfcr advice to those one does not love. Thy words arc worthy of thee, O Beautiful One. By pursuing the path of duty thou bast become dearer to me than life itself." Having spoken thus to **SITA**, the daughter of the King of Mithila, the magnanimous Ramo, carryiug his bow, continued to roam through those ravishing solitudes with **LAKSHMANA**. CHAPTER **RAMA** visits the different Retreats and hears of llgastya WALKING ahead, **RAMA** was followed by **SITA**, while behind her came **LAKSHMANA**, bow in hand. With **SITA**, they proceeded further, seeing many hills and plains, woods and enchanting rivers with geese and cranes frequenting their banks and pools covered

with lotuses, abounding in waterfowl, and herds of deer, horned buffaloes in rut, bears and elephants, the destroyers of trees. Having travelled a great distance, they beheld, as the sun was setting, a marvellous lake, some four miles in length, carpeted with lotus and water-lily blooms, graced with herds of wild elephants and abounding in geese, swans and teal. From this enchanting lake of tranquil waterS, the sound of singing and musical instruments could be heard, yet no one was visible there. Captivated, Ramo and **LAKSHMANA** began to question a sage named Dharmabhrit, saying : " O Great Ascetic, this wonderful music, heard by us all, moves us strangely ; what can it be ? Be gracious enough to tell us." Thus questioned by Ragbava, the magnanimous sage began at once to relate the history of that magic lake. **HE** *said*:-" This lake, called Panchapsara,' is always filled with water and was created by the penances of the Sage Mandarkini. " Practising a rigid asceticism, this great sage, lying in water for thousands of years, lived on air alone ! Then the Gods with **AGNI** at their head became agitated and, coming together, said to each other :-' This sage aspires to our state ! ' Thus did they speak, their minds full of apprehension. "Then all the Gods, in order to destroy the merit of the sage acquired through his penances, sent down five of the most beautiful nymphs, whose complexion resembled lightoing and, though the ascetic was fully conversant with what was good and evil, be was captivated by those nymphs and fell under the sway of the God of Love. " These five nymphs became the wives of that sage, who constructed a secret dwelling in the lake for them. There they live happily, bringing delight to the ascetic, who by virtue of his penances bas become youthful. They pass their time in dalliance and this is the cause of the entrancing music mingling with the tinkling of their ornaments." Such was the strange tale recounted by that sage of pure soul. Conversing thus, the illustrious

RAMA and his brother visited the circle of hermitages, strewn with kusha grass and bark, which were resplendent with the lustre of the *brahmins*. Accompanied by Vaidehi and Laksbmaua, the Descendant of Raghu, Kakutstha penetrated into the blessed circle of those Lions among Men. Received with delight and honoured by those great risbis, **RAMA** roamed through the silent woods, that great warrior sojourning with the ascetics, sometimes for ten months, some times for a year, sometimes for four months or five or six months, sometimes for many months or a month and a half only, sometimes three months and sometimes eight. In this way, engaged in innocent pastimes, ten years passed away. Having visited all the retreats of the ascetics, **RAMA** returned to Sutikahns's hermitage and, receiving the homage of the sages, that Subduer of his Foes remained there awhile. One dsy, as be sat at the feet of the ascetic, in all humility he addressed him, saying : " O Blessed One, I have beard that Agastya, that foremost 23 of sages, dwells in this forest, but it is so vast, tbat I do not know where bis hermitage is to be found. Where does the retreat of tbat sagacious *Rishi* lie ? By thy favour, O Blessed Lord, I, my younger brother and **SITA** wish to pay our respects to him." Hearing the words of the virtuous **RAMA**, that illustrious sage, Sutiksbna, well pleased, answered the son ofDasaratba, saying: " It was my intention to speak of this to thee and **LAKSHMANA**, O Raghava and say : ' Do thou, with **SITA**, seek out Agastya.' Now thou thyself hast proposed it and it is well. I will now tell thee, O **RAMA**, where tbat great Ascetic Agastya dwells. "My Child, four miles from here to the south, thou wilt come to the hermitage of the brother of Agastya, situated in a fertile plain, covered with charming groves of fig, abounding in fruit and ftowers, where the song of many birds may be heard. Innumerable lakes of tranquil water, carpeted by lotuses and frequented by swans, ducks and geese add to its beauty.

Having passed the night there, do thou at dawn follow the path, through a glade, to the south and there thou shalt come upon Agastya's retreat, at four miles distance, in an enchanting spot planted with lovely trees. Tbis place will charm Vaidehi as well as **LAKSHMANA** and thee, for this comer of the forest shaded by innumerable trees, is ravishing. " Shouldst thou desire to visit that great ascetic, Agastya, then set out to-day, O Prince of Surpassing Wisdom." At these words, **RAMA** with **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA**, having made obeisance to Sutiksbna, set out to seek the Sage Agastya. Enjoying the marvellous woods and hills, which resembled a mass of clouds, and the lakes and rivers to be seen on the way, **RAMA** proceeded qnickly along the path pointed out by the sage Sutikshna, and full of deligbt tbat magnanimous One said to Laksbmana : " Assuredly, this must be the retreat of the illustrious brother of Agastya, tbat sage of blessed *karma*, tbat we now bebold. Observe how along the woodland ride thousands of trees, bowed with the weight of their fruit and dowers, can be seen, and the pungent odour of ripe figs is borne on the breeze. Here and there heaps of fire-wood lie, with darbha grass, the colour of lapis lazuli ; see also tbat column of smoke, like a 24 plume of dark cloud, rising in the forest from a fire freshly lit in the hermitage. " Having performed their ablutions in the sacred ponds, the Twice-born are offering ftowers they themselves have gathered. The words spoken by Sutiksbna have proved true O Friend. Here indeed is the retreat of Agastya's brother. " In his desire to be of service to tbe worlds, by virtue of his austerities tbat great sage overcame death and set apart this quarter as a place of refuge. " Here formerly the cruel demons Vatapi and Ilvala lived, two great *asuras* who together conceived a plan for slaying the *brahmins*. " Assuming the form of a sage, the pitiless Ilvala, using the sanskrita language, invited the ascetics to partake of a feast. Preparing his brother disguised as a ram in a disb,

he fed the Twice-born, according to traditional rites. When the ascetics bad eaten, Ilvala cried out in a loud voice:-' O Vatapi, come forth.' “At the sound of his voice, Vatapi, bleating like a ram, tearing the bodies of the ascetics, emerged. " Thus thousands of *brahmins* were slain by those devourers of human ftesb, who changed their shape at will and were full of deceit. " At the request of the Gods, the great *Rishi* Agastya went to the feast and ate up the huge *asura,* after which llvala said: ' It is well,' and offering the guest water to wash his bands, cried out:-' Come forth O Vatapi I’ " But as this Slayer of Ascetics was speaking thus, Agastya, tbat excellent sage, breaking into laughter, said to him: " ' How can tbat demon come forth, since I have consumed him ? Thy brother in the shape of a ram, has entered the abode of **YAMA**.' " Hearing tbat his brother was dead, the demon in anger rushed at the ascetic, hurling himself on tbat **INDRA** of the Twice-born, but the sage, blazing with spiritual power, by a single glance consumed him, and he perished. " This is the hermitage, beautified by lakes and groves, belonging to the brother of tbat sage, who in compassion for the ascetics performed tbat arduous feat.” as While **RAMA** was speaking thus to Saumitti, the sun set behind the mountain and the night drew on ; duly performing his evening devotions, he entered the hermitage and offered obeisance to the ascetic. Warmly received by thst blessed one, Raghava passed the night there, having partaken of fruit and roots and, wben morning came and the disc of the sun was visible, he paid homage to the brother of Agastya, saying : " Reverent Sir, I salute thee and thank thee for the peaceful night I have passed here, I will now go and seek out my spiritual preceptor, thine elder brother.” " So be it,” replied the sage, whereupon the descendant of Raghu went along the path pointed out to him, enjoying the forest with the innumerable Nirvara, Panasa, Sala, V anjula, Tinisha, Shiribilwa, Madbuka, Bilwa and Tinduka trees in full

Bower entwined with blossoming creepers, and ripped by the truuka of elephants, where moukeys disported themselves and which resounded to the warbling of a myriad birds. Then the lotus-eyed **RAMA** said to the valiant and heroic **LAKSHMANA**, who was following him: " From the glossy foliage of the trees and the tameness of the deer and the birds, we are undoubtedly not far distant from the retreat of thst great and pure-souled *Rishi* of virtuous practices. " This hermitage thst removes all weariness, belonging to the Sage Agastya, well known among men for his virtue, with its groves filled with a rare fragrance, its robes of bark and garlands hanging here and there, frequented by herds of tame deer, the leafy boughs pervaded by coundess birds, can now be seen by us. " Having overcome Mrityu by his power, in his desire to do good to the whole world, he created this inviolate refuge in the south, which is eschewed by demons who fear to lay it waste. " From the day thst this region was rendered habitable by thst virtuous ascetic, the demons have ceased to exercise their hatred and cruelty bere. This fortunate land of the South, famed in the Three Worlds, associated with the name of thst blessed sage, is no longer haunted by those wicked beings. 26 “The mountain Vindhya, foremost of its kind, that threatened to intercept the rays of the sun, dared not grow higher, submitting to Agastya’s command and this enchanting retreat, frequented by deer, belongs to that long-lived one of exalted achievement. The virtuous Agastya, honoured by men, who is ever engaged in the welfare of all beings, will on our arrival accord us a great welcome. " I wish to pay homage to that great ascetic personally and to pass the rest of mine exile in the forest with him, O Mild One I Here the Gods, Gandharvas, Siddhas and the great Sages, who live on a bare subsistence, constantly pay homage to the Sage Agastya, but dishonest, cruel, wicked and perverse men are not able to remain in the presence of that great ascetic. “The lmmottals,

however, the Yakshas and those of the Serpent Race, the great *Rishis* also, dedicated to virtuous living, dwell here, and fixed in holiness, those exalted beings, discarding their worn-out bodies, assuming new ones, ascend to heaven in chsriots resembling the sun. “There the Gods fulfil the desires of the virtuous, granting them immottality, divine powers and every degree of majesty. “We have now come to the hermitage, O Saumitri, do thou enter it and announce my arrival with **SITA**, to the *Rishi*.” CHAPTER Agastya recei’IJeS **RAMA** into his Hermitage Having entered the hermitage, **LAKSHMANA**, the younger brother of Raghava, approached a disciple of Agastya and said to him: " The eldest son of King **DASARATHA**, the illustrious **RAMA**, has come with his conson, **SITA**, to pay homage to the sage. I am his younger brother, obedient and devoted to him and his humble servant ; perchance thou hast heard of us ? “We have penetrated into this dangerous forest at the command of our royal sire. We three desire to see the blessed One, do thou make it known to him.”

CHAPTER 12

Agastya receives Rama into his Hermitage

“The mountain Vindhya, foremost of its kind, that threatened to intercept the rays of the sun, dared not grow higher, submitting to Agastya’s command and this enchanting retreat, frequented by deer, belongs to that long-lived one of exalted achievement. The virtuous Agastya, honoured by men, who is ever engaged in the welfare of all beings, will on our arrival accord us a great welcome. " I wish to pay homage to that great ascetic personally and to pass the rest of mine exile in the forest with him, O Mild One I Here the Gods, Gandharvas,

Siddhas and the great Sages, who live on a bare subsistence, constantly pay homage to the Sage Agastya, but dishonest, cruel, wicked and perverse men are not able to remain in the presence of that great ascetic. “The lmmottals, however, the Yakshas and those of the Serpent Race, the great *Rishis* also, dedicated to virtuous living, dwell here, and fixed in holiness, those exalted beings, discarding their worn-out bodies, assuming new ones, ascend to heaven in chsriots resembling the sun. “There the Gods fulfil the desires of the virtuous, granting them immottality, divine powers and every degree of majesty. “We have now come to the hermitage, O Saumitri, do thou enter it and announce my arrival with **SITA**, to the *Rishi*.” CHAPTER Agastya recei’IJeS **RAMA** into his Hermitage Having entered the hermitage, **LAKSHMANA**, the younger brother of Raghava, approached a disciple of Agastya and said to him: " The eldest son of King **DASARATHA**, the illustrious **RAMA**, has come with his conson, **SITA**, to pay homage to the sage. I am his younger brother, obedient and devoted to him and his humble servant ; perchance thou hast heard of us ? “We have penetrated into this dangerous forest at the command of our royal sire. We three desire to see the blessed One, do thou make it known to him.” 27 Hearing **LAKSHMANA**’s words, the disciple said :-" So be it I " and went to inform Agastya at the place where the sacred fire burned. With joined palms approaching that Foremost of *Munis* whose austerities had rendered him invincible, he conveyed the news of **RAMA**’s arrival to him. In conformity with **LAKSHMANA**’s words, the cherished disciple of **AGASTYA** *said*:-" The two sons of King **DASARATHA**, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, have come to the hermitage with **SITA**. These two warriors, Conquerors of their Foes, have come to look on thee and to offer their services ; be gracious enough to instruct me in what should now be done I " Having heard from his disciple that **RAMA**, followed by

LAKSHMANA and the auspicious Vaidehi, were waiting, **AGASTYA** *answered*:-" How fortunate that after so long a time **RAMA** has come to see me to-day. It was ever the desire of my heart to behold that grest prince. Bid **RAMA** welcome and ask him to enter together with his consort and **LAKSHMANA** who accompanies him ; let them be brought into my presence ; why has this not already been done ? " Thus addressed by that mighty *muni*, learned in the spiritual tradition, the disciple saluted him with joined palms and said : “Be it so!” Thereafter, issuing from the hermitage, he approached **LAKSHMANA** and addressed him, saying : “Which of you is **RAMA**? Let him enter and approach the sage.” Thereupon **LAKSHMANA**, moving nearer to the gateway of the hermitage, pointed out **RAMA** and **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, to him, and the disciple humbly communicated *Rishi* Agastya’s message, conducting **RAMA** into the hermitage. **RAMA**, accompanied by **SITA** and Laksbmana, entering the austerities, the valiant **RAMA** said to **LAKSHMANA**, the increaser of his delight : " O **LAKSHMANA**, behold that blessed ascetic, Agastya, leaving the place of sacrifice ; it is with pride that I bow before that treasury of renunciation.” Speaking thus of Agastya, who shone like the sun, whilst he advanced towards him, the joy of the House of Raghu took hold of his feet and paid obeisance to him. Having saluted him, the virtuous **RAMA** stood before him with joined palms, in company with Videha’s daughter and Saumitri. Thereafter, embracing Kakutstha and honouring him with water and a seat, questioning him as to his welfare, the saint bade him welcome according to the tradition of the forest. Offering oblations into the fire, and presenting his guests with the arghya, that ascetic entertained them with food and placing himself at the side of **RAMA**, who, conversant with his duty, sat with joined palms, said to him : " O Prince, an ascetic who fails to offer proper hospitality will feed on his own flesh in the

other world, as does one who bears false wimess. O Lord of the Universe, Observer of Thy Duty, Warrior of the Great Car, who art worthy of all honour and respect, thou art come at last and art my beloved guest.” With these words, the Sage Agastya, as a symbol of homage, offered **RAMA** fruits, roots, flowers, water and other things in great profusion, and said to him : " Here is a celestial and powerful bow, encrusted with gold and diamonds, that belouged to **VISHNU**. O Tiger among Men, it is the creation of Vishwakarma. " Here also is the Brahmadatta dart, which is infallible and resembles the sun ; it is pre-eminent and was given to me by Mahendra ; here also are these two inexhaustible quivers, filled with sharp arrows that blaae like torches and here a mighty silver scabbard and a sword decorated with gold. " With this bow, O **RAMA**, **VISHNU** slew the great *asura* in battle and formerly acquired inexpressible glory amongst the dwellers in the celestial regions. " This bow, these two quivers, the dart and the aword, pledges of victory, do thou a=Pt, O Proud Warrior, and bear them as Vajradhara the thunderbolt.” 29 Thus speaking, the illustrious and fortunate Agastya gave to **RAMA** the whole panoply of weapons belonging to the mighty **VISHNU**, and once more addressed him : CHAPTER I3 **RAMA** goes to Panduwati on the adr!ice of Agastya " O RAMA, may happiness attend thee I O **LAKSHMANA**, I am pleased with thee that with **SITA** thou hast come hither to pay me homage. Undoubtedly the long journey will have wearied you both, as also Maithili, whose sighs betray it. " That youthfullacly, who is unaccustomed to exertion, has come to the forest out of love for her lord, though the way is beset with difficulties ; therefore, O **RAMA**, do that which will give her pleasure. “Since the beginning of time, O Joy of the House ofRaghn, it has been woman’s nature to cling to a man in prosperity and abandon him in adversity. Swift as lightning in thought,

sharp as a sword in speech, her moods comparable to an eagle's flight, such is woman I But thy consort is wholly free from these defects, she is worthy of praise and is the foremost of those devoted to their lord ; amongst the Gods she is known as a second Arundhati. That region will be renowned where thou, Saumitri and this princess have sojourned, O Conqueror of Thy Foes." Thus did the sage address Raghava, who, with joined palms, in humble accents, answered that ascetic who shone like a flame, saying : " I am overwhelmed with favour, since the foremost among ascetics is gratified with me, as also with my brother and my consort who accompany me. " Do thou direct me to a place abounding in trees, and with abundant water, where we csn dwell in peace and happiness." Hearing **RAMA**'s words, that excellent and magnanimous sage, reftecting an instant, made this judicious reply : " My Dear Son, at eight miles distance from here, is a spot

CHAPTER 13

Rama goes to Panchavati on the advice of Agastya

Thus speaking, the illustrious and fortunate Agastya gave to **RAMA** the whole panoply of weapons belonging to the mighty **VISHNU**, and once more addressed him : CHAPTER I3 **RAMA** goes to Panduwati on the adr!ice of Agastya " O RAMA, may happiness attend thee I O **LAKSHMANA**, I am pleased with thee that with **SITA** thou hast come hither to pay me homage. Undoubtedly the long journey will have wearied you both, as also Maithili, whose sighs betray it. " That youthfullacly, who is unaccustomed to exertion, has come to the forest out of love for her lord, though the way is beset with difficulties ; therefore, O **RAMA**, do that which will give her pleasure. "Since the

beginning of time, O Joy of the House ofRaghn, it has been woman's nature to cling to a man in prosperity and abandon him in adversity. Swift as lightning in thought, sharp as a sword in speech, her moods comparable to an eagle's flight, such is woman I But thy consort is wholly free from these defects, she is worthy of praise and is the foremost of those devoted to their lord ; amongst the Gods she is known as a second Arundhati. That region will be renowned where thou, Saumitri and this princess have sojourned, O Conqueror of Thy Foes." Thus did the sage address Raghava, who, with joined palms, in humble accents, answered that ascetic who shone like a flame, saying : " I am overwhelmed with favour, since the foremost among ascetics is gratified with me, as also with my brother and my consort who accompany me. " Do thou direct me to a place abounding in trees, and with abundant water, where we csn dwell in peace and happiness." Hearing **RAMA**'s words, that excellent and magnanimous sage, reftecting an instant, made this judicious reply : " My Dear Son, at eight miles distance from here, is a spot 30 known by the name of Panchavati, where rootS, fruit and water abound and where there are many deet. Go thither and with Saumitri establish a hermitage, living there happily and carrying out the behests of thy sire. " By the power of my penance and by virtue of the affection I bore for King **DASARATHA**, I am acquainted with thy history, O Irreproachable Prince. Though thou hast promised to remain with me in these solitudes, yet mine austerities have revealed to me the true desires of thine heart. Therefore I say to thee again: ' Seek out Panchavati! ' It is an enchanting woodland, that will delight Maithili. That place, worthy of all praise, is not far from here, O Raghava, and is close to the Godaveri river ; **SITA** will be happy there. Abounding in roots, fruit and every kind of bird, it is set apart, O Long armed Hero, and is lovely, delightful and sacred. Thou of righteOus ways, who art ever active and able to

defend all beings, wilt dwell there, O **RAMA**, in order to protect the ascetics. To the north of the Madhuka woods, which thou art able to see from here, O Hero, thou wilt find a grove of fig trees. Scale the mountain ridges, not far distant, and thou shalt come upon the renowned Panchavati, lying there with its flowering woods." Hearing the words of the Sage Agastya, **RAMA**, accompanied by Saumitri, took leave of that illustrious ascetic, and having circumambulated him, paid homage to his feet and with his permission departed towards the solitudes of Panchavati, accompanied by **SITA**. The two princes, invincible in combat, taking up their bows and strapping on their quivers, resolutely followed the path to Panchavati, pointed out by the great sage.

CHAPTER 14

Jatayu reveals his Lineage to Rama

the woods, the two illustrious princes, Ramo and **LAKSHMANA**, 31 thinking him to be a demon in another form, said to him : Who art thou ? " Then, in gentle caressing tones, the bird, as though addtessing one deat to him, answered, saying : " Dear Child, know me to be the friend of thy sire ! " In deference to this relationship, Raghava paid obeisance to bim, and enquired of him concerning his name and lineage, and he, hearing Ramo's words, said : " In a former age thete existed the Prajapatis, whom I will enumera-the first of them was Kardama and immediately succeeding him was Vikrita, then came Shesha and Samshraya, the fathet of many powerful sons, theteafter came Sthanu, Marichi, Atri, Kratu who was full of enetgy, Poulastya, Angira, Pracheta, Pulaha and Daksha followed by Vivaswat and Atishtanemi; O Raghava, the renowned Kashyapa was the last of these. O Hero of Infinite Renown,

we have heard that Prajapati Daksha had sixty lovely and illustrious daughters. Kashyapa wedded eight of these damsels of elegant waist, Aditi, Diti, Kalika, Tamra, Krodhavasa, Manu and Anita and well pleased, said to them : ' Do ye all beget sons, like unto myself, who shall be Lords of the Thtee Worlds.' " Thereupon Aditi consented, O **RAMA**, as did Diti, Danu and Kalika, but the others refused. " Aditi became the mothet of the Thirty-three Immortals. O My Son, Diti gave birth to the illustrious Daityas ; it was to them that the earth with its seas and forests belonged. " Danu gave birth to a son named Ashagriva, O Subduer of thy Foes, and Kalika gave birth to Naraka and Kalaks; and the five famous daughters, Krauncbi, Bhasi, Shyeni, Dhritarashtri and Shuki were produced by Tamra. " Krauncbi begot the owls and Bhasi the vultures ; Shyeni was the mother of the hawks and eagles possessed of great energy ; Dhritarashtri, of swans, flamingoes and water fowl. " The beautiful Shuki begot Nata whose daughter was Vinata. O **RAMA**, Krodhavasa brought forth ten daughters : Mrigi, Mrigimanda, Hari, Bhadramada, Matangi, Sharduli, Sheveta, Surabhi and Surasa, who were all endowed with beauty ; finally Kadrulta was born. 32 " O First of Men, Mrigi became tbe motbet of all tbe deer ; Mrigamanda begot bears, bu1faloes and yaks. " Bhadramada had a daughter named Iravati who was the motber of Airavata, who is tbe guardian of the world. " Hari gave birth to powerful lions and monkeys, lovers of tbe forest ; Sharduli begot chimpanzees and tigers. Of Matangi were born elephants, O Kakutstha, O Best of Men I Sbiveta gave birtb to tbe elephants who suppott tbe eatth. " Two daughters were born of tbe Goddess Sutabbi : Robini, and tbe auspicious Gandharvi. " Robini produced cows, and Gandharvi brought fotth horses. Sarasa was the mother of the hooded serpents, O **RAMA**, and Kadru gave bitth to all otber soakes. " Manu, wife of tbe magnanimous Kashyapa, gave birth to men, *Brahmins*

Kshattriyas, Vaisyas and Shudras, O Lion amongst Men. " According to ttadition, from her moutb were born the Bmhmins, from her breasts tbe Kshattriyas, from her thighs tbe Vaishyas and from her feet tbe Sbudtas. " All tbe trees witb succulent fruits were born of Anala. " Vinata, whose gmndmotbet was Shuki, herself begot Kadru and her sister, Surasa. " Of Kadru were born thousands of serpents, the suppotters of tbe eatth, and Vinata had two sons, **GARUDA** and Aruna. " Know that I was born of Aruna, as also was Sampati, my elder brother. My name is **JATAYU**, tbe descendant of Shyeni. O Subduer of Thine Enemies. “O My dear Child, I will take up my abode in tby vicinity, CHAPTER IS **RAMA** takes up his Abode in PanchafJati WHEN he had reached Panchavati, frequented by wild beasts and deer, **RAMA** said to his brother **LAKSHMANA**, who was burning with energy : " O Dear One, we have reached the place described by the sage, this woodland of flowering trees, the much-loved Panchavati. O Thou who art full of resource, look about on every side and ascertain in which spot it is fitting for us to construct our hermitage. Let it be in the viciniry of a pool where the charm of the forest and the water adds to its beaury, where thou, Sits and I, may dwell in peace, where flowers, fuel and kusha grass abound” Hearing the words of **RAMA**, the offspring of Kakutstha, **LAKSHMANA**, with joined palms, in the presence of **SITA**, answered him: " Wert thou to live a hundred years, I should still be thy servant, O Kakutstha ! Do thou select some place favoured by thee and command me to build a retreat.” Well pleased with **LAKSHMANA**’s compliance, that illustrious hero, looking here and there, chose a site which combined every advantage, and on that spot, taking the hand of Saumitri in his, said : " Here is a level place that is pleasant and surrounded by trees ; it is here that I desire thee to construct a retreat. Nearby is an enchanting river, rendered beautiful by lotuses, bright as the sun, exhaling a delicious fragrance, as described to me by

that *Rishi* of pure soul, Agasrya. This is the delightful river Godaveri, bordered with flowering trees, teeming with swans and waterfowl, geese enhancing irs beaury and thronged with herds of deer, neither too near nor too far away, that come here to drink. " And re-echoing to the cry of peacocks, lovely hills covered with blossoming trees containing many a cave, resembled great

CHAPTER 15

Rama takes up his Abode in Panchavati

CHAPTER IS **RAMA** takes up his Abode in PanchafJati WHEN he had reached Panchavati, frequented by wild beasts and deer, **RAMA** said to his brother **LAKSHMANA**, who was burning with energy : " O Dear One, we have reached the place described by the sage, this woodland of flowering trees, the much-loved Panchavati. O Thou who art full of resource, look about on every side and ascertain in which spot it is fitting for us to construct our hermitage. Let it be in the viciniry of a pool where the charm of the forest and the water adds to its beaury, where thou, Sits and I, may dwell in peace, where flowers, fuel and kusha grass abound" Hearing the words of **RAMA**, the offspring of Kakutstha, **LAKSHMANA**, with joined palms, in the presence of **SITA**, answered him: " Wert thou to live a hundred years, I should still be thy servant, O Kakutstha ! Do thou select some place favoured by thee and command me to build a retreat." Well pleased with **LAKSHMANA**'s compliance, that illustrious hero, looking here and there, chose a site which combined every advantage, and on that spot, taking the hand of Saumitri in his, said : " Here is a level place that is pleasant and surrounded by trees ; it is here that I desire thee to construct a retreat. Nearby is an

enchanting river, rendered beautiful by lotuses, bright as the sun, exhaling a delicious fragrance, as described to me by that *Rishi* of pure soul, Agasrya. This is the delightful river Godaveri, bordered with flowering trees, teeming with swans and waterfowl, geese enhancing irs beaury and thronged with herds of deer, neither too near nor too far away, that come here to drink. " And re-echoing to the cry of peacocks, lovely hills covered with blossoming trees containing many a cave, resembled great 34 elephants with huge howdahs embroidered in gold, silver and copper, that are studded here and there with tiny mirrors. " Sola, Tala, Tamala, Kharjura, Panasa, Nivara, Tinisha and Punnaga trees are their decoration, while Cuta, Ashoka, Tilaka, Ketaka and Champaka entwined with flowering creepers and plants, abound as also Syandana, Chandan, Nipa, Panasa, Lakuka, Ohara, Ashwakarna, Khadira, Shami, Tinduka and Patala trees. In this sacred place, this enchanting spot filled with deer and birds, let us dwell with **JATAYU**, O Saumirti." Thus addressed by his brother Ramo, **LAKSHMANA**, Slayer of Hosrile Warriors, endowed with great energy, built him a retreat there without delay and constructed a spacious hut with walls of mud, supported by strong stakes made of long graceful bamboos, thatched with boughs of the Shami tree. Creepers, kusha and sarpat grass strengthened it, while reeds and leaves were also used for the roof, its floor being well levelled. Then the fortunate **LAKSHMANA**, having constructed that excellent hut, lovely to behold, went to the river Godaveti, and after bathiog, gathered lotuses and fruit, returning to the hermitage to offer the flowers there and perform those traditional rites proper to the peace of that dwelling, thereafter leading Ramo to the hut he had set up. Seeing that charming retreat and the thatched hut, Raghava, who was accompanied by **SITA**, experienced intense delight. Highly gratified, he pressed **LAKSHMANA** to his heart and in a voice full of tenderness and feeling, said to him : " I

am pleased with thee ; thou hast accomplished a great feat, O My Brother, for which as a token of satisfaction I now embrace thee. Whilst thou dost still live, with thy zeal, thy devotion and thy virtue, O **LAKSHMANA**, our illusrtious sire is not dead." Having spoken thus to **LAKSHMANA**, Raghava, the source of others prosperity, began to dwell happily in that region abounding in fruit. And ministered to by **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA**, that illusrtious One lived there with them for some time, like the Gods in heaven. 35 CHAPTER I6 Description of Winter by **LAKSHMANA** WmLST the magnanimous **RAMA** was sojourning there, autumn passed away and the wintei season set in. One day at dawn, the issue of the House of Raghu went to the enchanting river Godaveri to perform his ablutions and the valiant Saumitri, pitcher in hand, following humbly with **SITA**, addressed him, saying: " Now that season deaz to thee has come, O Amiable Prince, during which the whole year seems to clothe itself in splendour ! The ground is covered with frost and water is no longer pleasant to drink. " Having offered ripened grain to the Pitris and the Gods, men are purified of their sins, their sacrifices having been made at the proper season. Desirous of the necessities of life, all are now abundantly supplied with milk and butter. " Kings, dreaming of conquest, set out on their campaigns. The sun veering towards the southern region, beloved of Antaka, causes the north to resemble a woman, whose tilak mark is effaced. The Himavat Mountain, covered with snow, justly bears its name. Those clear days, when one seeks the sun and flees from shade and damp, are exceedingly pleasant, but now there is only faint sunshine, constant frost, piercing cold and deep snow. The long cold nights are with us, when it is no longer possible to lie in the open, and the Pushya star which served as a beacon is now obscured in the snow-laden air. The moon, that draws its brilliance from the sun, no longer shines, and its frozen disc is dim, like

a mirror tarnished by the breath ; wrinkled by the cold, that orb's surface, though at the fnll, no longer sends forth its rays, like **SITA**, when her complexion, tanned by the sun, loses its radisnce. " Now that the snow is blended with its breath the west wind is icy, and the mornings are bitingly cold. The woods

CHAPTER 16

Description of Winter by Lakshmana

CHAPTER I6 Description of Winter by **LAKSHMANA** WmLST the magnanimous **RAMA** was sojourning there, autumn passed away and the wintei season set in. One day at dawn, the issue of the House of Raghu went to the enchanting river Godaveri to perform his ablutions and the valiant Saumitri, pitcher in hand, following humbly with **SITA**, addressed him, saying: " Now that season deaz to thee has come, O Amiable Prince, during which the whole year seems to clothe itself in splendour ! The ground is covered with frost and water is no longer pleasant to drink. " Having offered ripened grain to the Pitris and the Gods, men are purified of their sins, their sacrifices having been made at the proper season. Desirous of the necessities of life, all are now abundantly supplied with milk and butter. " Kings, dreaming of conquest, set out on their campaigns. The sun veering towards the southern region, beloved of Antaka, causes the north to resemble a woman, whose tilak mark is effaced. The Himavat Mountain, covered with snow, justly bears its name. Those clear days, when one seeks the sun and flees from shade and damp, are exceedingly pleasant, but now there is only faint sunshine, constant frost, piercing cold and deep snow. The long cold nights are with us, when it is no longer possible to lie in

the open, and the Pushya star which served as a beacon is now obscured in the snow-laden air. The moon, that draws its brilliance from the sun, no longer shines, and its frozen disc is dim, like a mirror tarnished by the breath ; wrinkled by the cold, that orb's surface, though at the fnll, no longer sends forth its rays, like **SITA**, when her complexion, tanned by the sun, loses its radisnce. " Now that the snow is blended with its breath the west wind is icy, and the mornings are bitingly cold. The woods 36 are shrouded in mist and the fields of barley and wheat, covered in rime, sparkle in the rising sun, while herons and cranes call in chorus. Fields of rice with ears resembling Kharjura flowers bend gracefully under the weight of the grain. " With its rays scarcely penetrating the snow-laden clouds, the sun, long after it has risen, resembles the moon, but gradually gaining strengrh during the morning hours, rejoices the heart at noon, its rays shedding a pale beauty on the earth causing the woodland rides, covered with grass and drenched with dew, to sparkle. " The wild elephant, suffering from extreme thirst, with draws its trunk suddenly on coming in contact with the frozen water, and the waterfowl, standing on the banks, dare not enter the stream, like unto cowardly warriors, fearful of setting foot on the battlefield. " Enveloped in dew at evening and wreathed in cold grey mist at dawn, the trees, bereft of flowers, seem to sleep. Streams are shrouded in fog and the cranes, their plumage hidden under the snow, can only be distingoished by their cries; the sands on the banks too are wet with snow. " On account of the weakness of the sun's rays, the water remains in the hollows of hard rocks after the fall of snow and tastes sweet. The lotuses are nipped by frost, their stamens dried up, their petals fallen, only the stalks remaining, and in the grip of the bitter cold have lost all their beauty. " O Lion among Men, at this season, in devotion to thee, the unfortunate and faithful **BHARATA** is undergoing penance in the city. Renouncing kingdom, pomp and every

pleasure, practising austerity, he gives himself up to fasting and restraint, and at this very hour is certainly making his way to the river Sarayu surrounded by his ministers in order to perform his ablutions. " Brought up in luxury, exceedingly frail, tormented by the cold, how, in the last hour of the night, is he able to endure the icy water ? " With his large eyes resembling lotus petals, his dark skin and depressed navel, that great and virtuous **BHARATA**, who is dutiful, truthful, restrained, his senses fully controlled, of sweet speech and gentle, that long-armed hero, the subduer of his foes, renouncing every pleasure, is wholly devoted to thee, O **RAMA**. “My Brother, the magnanimous **BHARATA**, by living as if baoished the forest, in imitation uf thee resident there, has conquered heaven, O **RAMA**. " It is said that a man resembles his mother and not his father. If it be so, how can a woman as cruel as **KAIKEYI** be his mother ? " Thus spoke the virtuous **LAKSHMANA** in brotherly affection, but Ranta, unable to brook their mother being blamed, answered him, saying : " She who occupies the second place among the queens, O My Friend, should not be disparaged in any way whatsoever. Do thou continue to speak of **BHARATA**, the protectDr of the House of lkshwaku. " Though I have determined to dwell in the forest, yet my love for **BHARATA** shakes my resolve and causes me to waver anew. I recollect his gentle and affectionate words well, sweet as amrita, delighting the soul. O when shall I be re united with the magnanimous **BHARATA** and the valiant **SHATRUGHNA**, together with thee, O Joy of the House ofRaghu?” Lamenting thus, Kakutstha came to the Godaveri river, where he, his younger brother and **SITA** performed their ablu tions ; then having offered water the Gods and the Pitris, those sinless ones worshipped the rising sun and the Lord Narayana, thus purifying themselves. Thereafter, **RAMA**, accompanied by **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA**, appeared beautiful, resembling the Lord **SHIVA**

accompanied by Nandi and the Daughter of the Mountains.'

CHAPTER 17

The arrival of Shurpanakha at the Hermitage

HAVING bathed in the Godaveri river, **RAMA**, **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA** left its banks and returned to the herntitage. On reaching their retreat, Raghava with **LAKSHMANA** performed their morn ing devotions and entered the leaf-thatched hut. In the hut, that long-armed hero with **SITA** at his side dwelt happily, honoured by the great *Rishis*, and shone like the moon accom panied by the Chitta star. One day, while **RAMA** was recitiog the traditional texts, a female demon chanced to pass that way, by name Shurpanaltha who was the sister of **RAVANA**. Approaching **RAMA**, she observed that he resembled a God, with his radiant conntenance, his long arms, his large eyes like nnto lotns petals, his majestic gait resembling an elephant's, matted locks crowning his head ; youthful, full of valour, beatiog the marks of royalty, his colour that of the blue lotns and alluring as the God of Love himself. Beholding that hero, the equal of **INDRA**, the *Rakshasi* was overwhelmed with desire. **RAMA** was handsome, she hideous ; his waist was slender, hers thick and heavy; he had large eyes, hers squinted; his locks were beautiful, hers were red; his whole appearance was pleasing, hers repellent. **RAMA**'s voice was sonorous, hers strident ; he was fair and youthful, she old and haggard ; he was amiable, she sullen ; he was self controlled, she nnruly ; he was captivating, she odious. Consumed with passion, the *Rakshasi* said to **RAMA** : " With thy matted locks and ascetic guise, bearing bow and arrows, why hast thou, accompanied by thy conson, come to these woods, which are frequented by demons ?

What is the purpose of thy journey ? " Hearing the words of the *Rakshasi*, Shurpanaltha, that hero, the Scourge of his Foes, with perfect candour began to relate all. **HE** *said*:-" There was a king nsmed **DASARATHA**, who was as powerful as a God. I am his eldest son, known among men as **RAMA**; this is my yonnger brother, **LAKSHMANA**, my faithful companion, and this, my conson, the illustrious **SITA**, daughter of the King of Videha. " Bonnd by the will of my site and in order to carry out my duty, I have come to dwell in the forest. " But now I wish to know who thy father is, who thou art, and what thy race ? To judge by thy charms, thou art a *Rakshasi* I Tell me truly, what has brought thee hither?" Hearing the words of **RAMA**, the *Rakshasi*, tormented by the pangs of love, answered : 39 " Hear O **RAMA** and I will tell thee the truth I I am Shurpanakha, a *Rakshasi*, who can change her form at will. I wander about in the forest, striking terror in the hearts of all beings. My brothers are **RAVANA**, of whom thou bast doubtless heard, and the powerful and somnolent Kumbha karna, the virtuous Bibishana a stranger to our practices, and two others famed for their martial qualities, Khara and Dushana. " I, who am more powerful than they, having seen thee, O Ramo, wish to unite myself with thee, O Lord, O First of Menf " I am endowed with power and able to range at will by thought alone ; therefore do thou become my master. What is **SITA** to thee ? " Deformed, without beauty, she is not worthy of thee, whereas I should prove a well-matched partner, my beauty equal to thine own ; do thou look on me as thy consort. This unsightly, grim-visaged human female, of lean abdomen, will be devoured by me this day in thy presence, together with that brother of thine. " Thou and I shall wander on the summit of the mountains and through the forests together, exploring the whole region of Dandaka, according to thy whim." Speaking thus, the Raksbasi threw impassioned glances at **RAMA**, who,

smiling, made the following astute reply.

CHAPTER 18

The Mutilation of Shurpanakha

" **H**ear O **RAMA** and I will tell thee the truth I I am Shurpanakha, a *Rakshasi*, who can change her form at will. I wander about in the forest, striking terror in the hearts of all beings. My brothers are **RAVANA**, of whom thou bast doubtless heard, and the powerful and somnolent Kumbha karna, the virtuous Bibishana a stranger to our practices, and two others famed for their martial qualities, Khara and Dushana. " I, who am more powerful than they, having seen thee, O Ramo, wish to unite myself with thee, O Lord, O First of Menf " I am endowed with power and able to range at will by thought alone ; therefore do thou become my master. What is **SITA** to thee ? " Deformed, without beauty, she is not worthy of thee, whereas I should prove a well-matched partner, my beauty equal to thine own ; do thou look on me as thy consort. This unsightly, grim-visaged human female, of lean abdomen, will be devoured by me this day in thy presence, together with that brother of thine. " Thou and I shall wander on the summit of the mountains and through the forests together, exploring the whole region of Dandaka, according to thy whim." Speaking thus, the Raksbasi threw impassioned glances at **RAMA**, who, smiling, made the following astute reply. a wife's company and desires a consort. He is youthful and attractive and would therefore be a fitting husband for thee. Take my brother as thy lord, O Lady of large eyes and lovely hips, and enjoy him without a rival, as Mount Meru, the sunlight." Hearing these words, the *Rakshasi*, blinded by passion, leaving **RAMA**, at once addressed

LAKSHMANA, saying : " My beauty renders me a worthy wife for thee; therefore come and we will range the Dandaks Forest and mountains happily together." Thus accosted by the *Rakshasi* Shurpanakha, **LAKSHMANA**, the son of **SUMITRA**, skilled in discourse, smiling, gave this ingenious reply : " How canst thou wish to become the wife of a slave, such as I? I am wholly dependent on my noble brother, O Thou whose complexion resembles the lotus, who art pleasing to look upon and chaste ? O Lady of large eyes, thou art a paragon, do thou become the consort of that matchless hero. Re nouncing that ugly, evil and peevish old woman, whose limbs are deformed, he will certainly devote himself to thee ! O Lady of ravishing complexion and lovely limbs, what sensible man would sacrifice that unrivalled beauty of thine for an ordinary woman ? " Thinking **LAKSHMANA**'s words to be sincere and not under standing his jest, that cruel and misshapen *Rakshasi*, in the blindness of her passion once more addressed **RAMA**, the Scourge of His Foes, who was seated in the leaf-thatched but with **SITA**, and said : " Is it for this hideous, evil and peevish woman, who is old and deformed, that thou dost slight me ? "I shall devour her in thy presence to-day, and shall live happily with thee without a rival." Speaking thus, the *Rakshasi*, whose eyes blazed like torches, hurled herself in fury on **SITA**, like a great meteor descending on the planet Rohini. Then the mighty **RAMA** restrained her, as, like the noose of death, she advanced towards Sira, and in anger addressed **LAKSHMANA**, saying :-0 Saumitri. Take heed, see, Vaidehi is in danger, O Friend I Do thou maim this hideous demon of protruding belly, who is evil and filled with fury." The valiant **LAKSHMANA**, highly incensed against the *Rakshasi*, thereupon drew his sword from its scabbard and, in the presence ofRama, cut offher ears and nose. Her ears and nose severed, Shurpanakba uttered a terrible cry and ran into the forest. Being mutilated, the *Rakshasi,* streaming with blood,

created a terrible uproar, like a tempest in the rainy season and, dripping with blood, that hideous monster, lifting up her arms, plunged howling into the deep woods. Thereafter the injured Shurpanakha sought out her brother Khara of great might, who, surrounded by a troop of demons, was seated in Janasthana and threw herself on the ground before him, like a meteorite falling from heaven. Wild with terror and covered with blood, Kbara's sister, almost deprived of her senses, related everything concerning Raghava's arrival in the forest with his consort and **LAKSHMANA** and the circumstances of her disfigurement.

CHAPTER 19

Shurpanakha tells her brother Khara of her disfigurement

SEEING his sister lying on the ground, mutilated and streaming with blood, the demon, inflamed with anger, said to her : " Rise ! Tell me why thou art distraught; master thy terror and narrate lucidly, who has disfigured thee in this fashion. Who has dared to touch a black and venomous serpent, stretched peacefully beside him, with his foot ? That fool who has thus dealt with thee, is unaware that this day he has swallowed a virulent poison and placed the noose of death round his neck. " Who has brought thee to this state, thou who art imbued with energy and courage, who art able to range everywhere at will, the rival of An taka himself? How is it that thou art .p found in this sorry plight ? Amongst Gods, Gandharvas, mighty Sages and other Beings, who is sufficiently powerful to have disfigured thee ? I know of none in all the worlds who would dare to provoke me, save it be Mahendra, He of the Thousand Eyes, who overcame the demon Paka. To-day I shall exact the

life of thy traducer with my desth-dealing arrows, as swans suck out the milky substance that lloats on the water. " Struck down in the fight, mortally wounded by my shafts, whose foaming blood will the earth drink to-day ? Whose limbs will the vultures, drawn by my summons, tear apart and devour with delight when they fall under my blows in combat ? " Neither the Gods nor the Gandharvas nor the Pisachas nor the *Rakshasas* shall be able to save that wretch from my grasp, in that fierce encounter. " Compose thyself and in tranquillity, tell me who that miscreant is and who, abusing his power, has ill-treated thee thus?" Having listened to her brother's words, Shurpanakha, beside herself with rage, answered weeping : " They are two most handsome and powerful youths, with large eyes resembling lotuses, clad in bark and black antelope skins, living on fruit and roots, their senses under control, practising penance and the brahmacharya vow, the sons of King **DASARATHA**, two brothers, Rams and **LAKSHMANA**, who bear the marks of royalty and resemble the King of the Gandharvas. I am unable to say if they be human beings or Gods. Between them, I saw a young and beautiful damsel of slender waist, adorned with many kinds of jewels, and it is on account of this youthful woman that I am reduced to this plight, like one uncared for and set at naught on account of her infidelity. wish to d.-ink the blood of this womsn and those two youths on the battlefield." Hearing his sister utter these words, Khara, msd with anger, called on fourteen demons of great strength, equal to Antaka and also that wretch herself. My sister desires to drink their blood ! O Ye Rabhasas, this is my sister's desrest wish, go therefore with all speed sod in your grest might desuoy them. On seeing the two brothers struck down by your blows, my sister will drink their blood on the field, with joy." Receiving this command, the fourteen demons swiftly departed, accompanied by Shurpanakha, like clouds driven before the wind.

CHAPTER 20

Rama slays the Demons sent by Khara

THE cruel Shurpanakha, having resched Raghava's hermitage, pointed out the two brothers sod **SITA** to the demons, and they beheld **RAMA**, full of valour, seated in his hut of lesves, in compsoy with **SITA**, attended on by Lakshmsoa. Seeing Shurpanakha and the demons who accompanied her, the illustrious desceodant of the House of Raghu, **RAMA**, said to Lakshmsoa who was burning with courage : " Stay a moment with **SITA**, O Saumitri, so that I may slay these demons who have followed the *Rakshasi*." Hearing the worda of **RAMA**, versed in knowledge of the Self, that prudent offshoot of the House of Raghu answered with deference, saying : " Be it so." Then the righteous Raghava, stretching his grest bow, inlaid with gold, addressed those demons, saying : " We are the sons of **DASARATHA**, two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, who have come with **SITA** to the inaccessible Dandaka Forest. Living on roots sod fruit, with our. senses under conuol, we practice penance sod the brahmacharya vow and pass our days in the woods. Why do yon seek to do us injury, wrerches that you are? It is at the request of the Sages, At these words, those slayers of *brahmins*, the fourteen demons, bearing spears in their hands, inflamed with anger, their eyes red, terrible to behold, filled with a fierce exultation, answered **RAMA**, whose fiery glances and sweet speech mani fested a courage they had not seen till that hour, and said : For having incurred the displeasure of our master, the most magnanimous K.hara, thou art about to fall under our blows in battle. What power hast thou single-handed to slay so many in the field; it is thou who shalt Jose thy life to-day in this conflict. Our arms bearing maces, spears and dartS

will rob thee of thy strength, and thy bow shall fall from thy hand." Thus speaking, the fourteen demons, brandishing their formidable weapons, hurled themselves on **RAMA**, Jetting fly their spears at the invincible Raghava, but Kakutstha with as many arrows tipped with gold cut off those fourteen spears. And that illustrious warrior, full of wrath, taking out more arrows, which had been sharpened on stone, seized his bow and placing them on the string, made the titans his target. Then Raghava, loosing those shafts, as **INDRA** his thunderbolt, speedily pierced the breasts of those demons, and the arrows, all bloody, penetrated the earth like serpents disappearing into an ant heap. With their breasts pierced by those arrows, the demons fell to the ground, like trees, whose trunks have been severed. Bathed in blood, mutilated, bereft of life, they lay stretched on the earth, and Shurpanakha, seeing them thus, blind with rage, sped away, to seek out her brother Khara. Wounded afresh, the blood coagulating like a tree exuding resin, Shurpanakha fell down before her brother and in his presence set up a mighty uproar, wailing and shrieking, raining tears, her features distorted. Having seen the demons fall on the field of battle, Shur panakha, returning in all haste to her brother Khara, described their deaths to hitn in every detail. 45 CHAPTER Shurpanakha urges Khara to fight **RAMA** SEEING Shurpanakha beside herself, lying on the ground, having returned without accomplishing her design, Khara addressed her in harsh tones, saying : " Have I not placed those valiant demons, living on flesh at thy disposal, for thy pleasure? Why dost thou still com plain ? They are zealous, loyal and have ever been my trusted servants. Though invincible, even had they to die, they would not disobey me. What is this ? I wish to know the reason why thou art rolling on the earth like a serpent, crying O, my Lord '. Why, since I am thy protector, dost thou lament like one abandoned ? Rise, rise ! Let us have no more of these

tears and swoonings.” Thus did Khara, her brother, speak to that terrible *Rakshasi* to comfort her, and she, wiping away her tears, said : " When I came hither with my nose and ears severed, drenched in blood, which flowed forth like a river, thou didst console me. To please me, thou didst command fourteen valiant demons to slay the ruthless **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. These demons, incensed against **RAMA**, armed with spears and pikes, have fallen victims to his murderous arrows, in combat. Witnessing those skilled warriors, felled to the ground in an instant and **RAMA**’s great exploit, I am filled with extreme fear. " Trembling in every limb, terrified and beside myself, I take refuge in thee once more, O Prowler of the Night, seeing cause for apprehension on every side. Submerged as I am in the infinite ocean of distress, haunted by the crocodiles of affliction and the billows of fear, wilt thou not rescue me ? Under **RAMA**’s fiery arrows, the demons, eaters of flesh, who followed me, are lying on the ground. " If thou hast any pity for me and for these demons, if thou art possessed of the courage and strength to meet **RAMA** in

CHAPTER 21

Shurpanakha urges Khara to fight Rama

CHAPTER Shurpanakha urges Khara to fight **RAMA** SEEING Shurpanakha beside herself, lying on the ground, having returned without accomplishing her design, Khara addressed her in harsh tones, saying : " Have I not placed those valiant demons, living on flesh at thy disposal, for thy pleasure? Why dost thou still com plain ? They are zealous, loyal and have ever been my trusted servants. Though invincible, even had they to die, they would not disobey me. What is this

? I wish to know the reason why thou art rolling on the earth like a serpent, crying O, my Lord '. Why, since I am thy protector, dost thou lament like one abandoned ? Rise, rise ! Let us have no more of these tears and swoonings." Thus did Khara, her brother, speak to that terrible *Rakshasi* to comfort her, and she, wiping away her tears, said : " When I came hither with my nose and ears severed, drenched in blood, which flowed forth like a river, thou didst console me. To please me, thou didst command fourteen valiant demons to slay the ruthless **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. These demons, incensed against **RAMA**, armed with spears and pikes, have fallen victims to his murderous arrows, in combat. Witnessing those skilled warriors, felled to the ground in an instant and **RAMA**'s great exploit, I am filled with extreme fear. " Trembling in every limb, terrified and beside myself, I take refuge in thee once more, O Prowler of the Night, seeing cause for apprehension on every side. Submerged as I am in the infinite ocean of distress, haunted by the crocodiles of aflliction and the billows of fear, wilt thou not rescue me ? Under **RAMA**'s fiery arrows, the demons, eaters of flesh, who followed me, are lying on the ground. " If thou hast any pity for me and for these demons, if thou art possessed of the courage and strength to meet **RAMA** in 46 battle, then, O Prowler of the Night, slay this thorn in the side of the demons, who bas set up his hermitage in the Dandaka Forest. " If thou dost not bring about the death of **RAMA**, the Slayer of his Foes, this very day, I shall yield up my life in thy presence, dishonoured. I see clearly, that even supported by thy forces, thou art not able to meet **RAMA** in pitched battle. " Thou deemest thyself to be a great hero, but thou art not really so, thy prowess exists only in thine own conceited imaginings; therefore do thou leave Janasthana, in all baste, with thy companions, O Stigma of Thy Race ! Do thou return victor in the struggle, for, if thou bast neither the strength, nor the valour

to slay these two men, how caDSt thou remain here? " Defeated by **RAMA**'s prowess, thou wilt surely die, for he is truly brave, that son of **DASARATHA**, **RAMA**, and his brother also, who disfigured me is supremely valiant ! " Thus, in the presence of her brother, did that Raksbasi lament again and again, beating her breast and, overcome with mortification, lost consciousness. Then, after a space coming to her senses, exercised with grief, she continued to cry out and strike her breast with her bands.

CHAPTER 22

Khara and his fourteen thousand Demons march against Rama

" Thy contempt incites me to ungovernable fury, I am beside myself and can no more endure this than it is possible to support salt poured into a wound. I hold **RAMA** to be of no account and regard him as already dead. His offence will bring about his end this day ; therefore restrain thy tears, do not distresS thyself further. I shall despatch **RAMA** and his brother to the region of death, and thou, O *Rakshasi*, 47 shalt to-day drink the warm blood of that one of evil deeds struck down by mine axe." Overjoyed on hearing these words, falling from her brother's lips, Shurpanakba, in her folly, began to praise Khara, the Foremost of Titans. First condemned, then extolled by her, Khara called on Dushana, the commander of his army, saying : " O Friend, make resdy fourteen thousand trained titans who are obedient to my commands, full of martial ardour, who never tl"treat in battle, who resemble thunder clouds and who revel in cruelty and delight in slaying men. " Do thou, with all speed, bring my chariot also, with bows, arrows, glittering swords, darts

and javelins, that have been well sharpened. I wish to place myself at the hesd of those magnanimous titans, in order to slay the haughty **RAMA**, O Skilful Warrior ! " As he was speaking, Dushana harnessed excellent horses to the great car, that shone like the sun, whereupon Kbara ascended the chariot resembliog the peak of Meru, that was vast, inlaid with pure gold, with golden wheels and shafts ser with emeralds. Decorated with symbols of good fortune, such as fish, flowers, trees, rocks, mountains, birds and stars, it was furnished with banners and spears, hung with delightful bells and yoked to excellent steeds. Then Kbara, chafing with impatience, as also Dusbana, seeing that great host, furnished with chariots, shields, weapons and banners, cried to that multitude of demons :-“Advance I " Thereafter that mighty titan army, numbering fourteen thousand, equipped with formidable shields, weapons and banners, rushed out impetuously, amidst a great tumult. Armed with hammers, picks, spears, sharp axes, sabres, discus and shining javelins, as well as darts, formidable clubs, immense bows, goads, swords, maces and thunderbolts, terrible to look upon, those ferocious titans, obedient to the commands of Khara, left Janasthana, and he, withdrawing himself a little, reviewed those titans of malignant aspect, wbo were rushing forth, and thereafter followed them. Obedient to Khara’s command, the charioteer mounted on the car of that Slayer of His Foes, spurring on his dappled 48 steeds, whose harness wss wrought with pure gold, advanced with all speed, causing the cardinsl points and other reginns to ring with the sound. Aud Khara, in harsh tones, inflamed with anger, chsfiDg with the desire to destroy his adversary, endowed with great strength, equal to Autaka, urged on his charioteer agsin and agsin, roaring like a great cloud about to let loose a stream of hail. The Titan Army advances amid evil Portents AT that time terrible portents appeared and from a dark cloud a shower of blood fell. The

swift-footed steeds yoked to Khara's chariot, stumbled on the level road of the royal high way, strewn with llowers; the sun was covered with a black disc, edged, as it were with blood, like a circle of burning coals, whilat a frightful vulture settled on the standard with its golden suppon. Birds and beasts of prey, roaming in the vicinity ofJanasthana, emitted deafening cries, creating an appalling clamour, and near that region, terrible jackals gave fonh fearful and blood curdling howls, like fiends. Immense and formidable thunderclouds resembling elephants with crushed Temples, showered down a rsin of blood, which hid the entire firmament ; a great darkness fell, causing the hair to stand on end, obscuring the four quaners. Dusk arrived before the appointed time, assuming a sanguinous hue and, as Khara proceeded, wild beasts and birds of terrifying aspect barred his path, whilst herons, hyenas and vultures raised a ghastly clamour. Hideous jackals, a sign of misfonune in war, howled at the approaching army, flames darting from their jaws and a headless trunk, resembling a club, was seen close to the sun. Thuugh the time of eclipse had not come, yet that golden orb was seized by the planet Swarbhanu ; the winds blew violently

CHAPTER 23

The Titan Army advances amid evil Portents

Steeds, whose harness wss wrought with pure gold, advanced with all speed, causing the cardinsl points and other reginns to ring with the sound. Aud Khara, in harsh tones, inflamed with anger, chsfiDg with the desire to destroy his adversary, endowed with great strength, equal to Autaka, urged on his charioteer agsin and agsin, roaring like a great cloud about to let loose a stream of hail. The Titan Army advances amid

evil Portents AT that time terrible portents appeared and from a dark cloud a shower of blood fell. The swift-footed steeds yoked to Khara's chariot, stumbled on the level road of the royal high way, strewn with llowers; the sun was covered with a black disc, edged, as it were with blood, like a circle of burning coals, whilat a frightful vulture settled on the standard with its golden suppon. Birds and beasts of prey, roaming in the vicinity ofJanasthana, emitted deafening cries, creating an appalling clamour, and near that region, terrible jackals gave fonh fearful and blood curdling howls, like fiends. Immense and formidable thunderclouds resembling elephants with crushed Temples, showered down a rsin of blood, which hid the entire firmament ; a great darkness fell, causing the hair to stand on end, obscuring the four quaners. Dusk arrived before the appointed time, assuming a sanguinous hue and, as Khara proceeded, wild beasts and birds of terrifying aspect barred his path, whilst herons, hyenas and vultures raised a ghastly clamour. Hideous jackals, a sign of misfonune in war, howled at the approaching army, flames darting from their jaws and a headless trunk, resembling a club, was seen close to the sun. Thuugh the time of eclipse had not come, yet that golden orb was seized by the planet Swarbhanu ; the winds blew violently 49 and the sun was bereft of lustre ; though not yet night, stan thick as fireflies appeared. Birds and fishes dived into the depths of the lakes, on which the lotuses had witheted, and in that hour the trees were bereft of Bowers and frnit, and sombre dust-clouds arose without the stirring of the wind. Parrots called wildly Cbichikucbi ' and comets of sinister aspect fell without a sound ; the earth with her mountains, woods and forests, shook. As Khara, standing in his chariot, was raising his war-cry, his left arm twitched and his voice died away ; glancing round on every side, his eyes were suffused with tears, his head throbbed, yet in his folly he did not turn back. Witnessing these evil

portents that caused his hair to stand on end, with a defiant laugh, Khara addressed that host of titans saying : " I hold these terrible portents, dreadful to behold, as nought compared with my power and disregard them as do the strong, the weak ! I am able to shoot down the stars from heaven with my sharp arrows ! I can subjugate the empire of death itself! Till by means of my powerful weapons, I have brought **RAMA** low, who depends on his strength alone, as also **LAKSHMANA**, I shall not turn back. May my sister, for whose sake I have sworn to bring about the death of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, drink the blood of these two. Till this hour, I have not known defeat on the field of battle ; ye are witness to it, I do not utter falsehood I In my wrath I am able to slay the Chief of the Gods bearing the thunderbolt, mounted on the intoxicated Airavata, how much more am I able to slay these two mortals ? " Hearing those boastful words, the vast army of the titans, whom death already held in his noose, was filled with incom parable joy, and advanced full of vigour, anxious to join issue in battle. Thereupon, the high-souled *Rishis, Devas*, Gandharvas and Charanas assembled and those vittuous beings said one to the other: " Reverence to the cows, the *brahmins* and all those who have acquired spiritual merit in the world I so " As **VISHNU**, bearing the discus in bis hand, subdued the *Asuras*, so may **RAMA** too triumph over the titans in this fight." Repeatedly expressing this wish and many others, those illustrious Risbis and the Gods, stationed in the sky, gazed down on the army of the titans, that was about to be destroyed. Then K.hara in his swiftly-moving chariot rode out to the head of his army and those twelve of exceeding prowess: Karaviraksha, Parusha, Kalakarmukha, Hemamalin, Mahamalin, Sarpasya, Shyengamin, Prithugriva, Vajnashatru, Vihangama, Dirjaya, Krudhirashana, surrounded him, and Mahakapala, Sthulaksha, Pramatha and Trishiras, these four followed Dushana. As a group of planets rush

towards the sun or moon, so in their eagerness to enter the fight did that formidable army of of titans hurl themselves with tremendous impetus on the two princes.

CHAPTER 24

The Combat opens between Rama and the Titans

WHEN Khara of great prowess advanced on **RAMA**'s hermitage, the two princes observed many dreadful portents, and **RAMA**, deeply moved, said to **LAKSHMANA** :-" O Mighty-armed One, these inauspicious omens, causing terror to all beings, foretell the destruction of the demon hosts. "Yonder dun-coloured clouds, resembling asses' skin, pass across the sky, raining blood in dreadful convulsions. Behold, O **LAKSHMANA**, smoke rising from mine arrows, as if they rejoiced at the coming contest, and my bow of beaten gold moving of itself, eager for action. Meseerns the cry of wild birds that frequent the woods foretells danger, nay, that the very lives of our foes are in jeopardy. Assuredly a great battle will shortly take place ; the twitching of my left arm betokens it. O Hero, for us victory is imminent, and the defeat of the titana assured. Thy countenance is resplendent and exultant, s " O **LAKSHMANA** l Those warriors who enter into combat with a rueful mien are lost. " I hear the roar of those titans of cruel deeds and the sound of their drums. If a prudent man desires success and wishes to escape defeat, he should be forearmed against the future. Therefore, bearing thy bow and arrows, taking Sits with thee, repair to a mountain cave, screened by rrees and di11icult of access. O **LAKSHMANA**, do not oppose my commands, but, swearing obedience to my feet, go thither, O Friend, without delay. Thou art valiant and well able to strike down the

titans, but I desire to slay these Prowlers of the Night single handed." Having spoken thus, **LAKSHMANA**, taking up his bow and arrows, withdrew with Sits to an inaccessible cave. As **LAKSHMANA** entered the cavern with Sits, **RAMA** rejoiced at his brother's submission and donned his coat of mail. Oothed in armour that shone like fire, **RAMA** resembled a mighty flame illumining the darkness, and that hero, standing erect, took up his bow and arrows and, by the twanging of the cord, caused the four cardinal points to re-echo. Then the Gods, Gandbarvas, Siddbas and Charanas gathered together to wimess the struggle and the great-souled *Rishis* began to converse one with the other, saying : " May it be well with all the cows and *brahmins* found on the earth ! May Ragbava overcome the descendants of Poulastya in combat ! May he be as victorious as **VISHNU**, who with his discus routed the foremost of the *asuras* l " Having spoken thus, exchanging glances, they added : " But how can **RAMA** overcome those fourteen thousand demons of fearful deeds single-handed ? " Thereafter those Rajarishis and Siddbas, stationed in their aerial chariots, were moved with curiosity as to the outcome of the confiict and seeing **RAMA**, splendidly accoutred, standing alone on the field of battle, all those beings were filled with apprehension; the peerless **RAMA**, however, the doer of noble deeds, assumed the aspect of that high-souled and avenging God, Rudra! Whilst the Gods, Gandbarvas and O!aranas were still conversing, the army of the titans, creating a fearful clamour, 52 clad in mail, bearing weapons and banners, appeared on every side. Uttering loud battle cries, jostling one another, twanging their bowstrings, opening their jaws wide, they shouted : " We will destroy the enemy ! " This appalling tumult filled the forest and struck terror into the hearts of its denizens, who fied from the sound, not daring to look back. Then the demon army, resembling a stormy sea, brandishing every kind of weapon, rapidly

approached Ramo, but he, an experienced warrior, looking round on every side, saw that army of Khara's advancing and went out to meet it, taking his arrows from their quiver and stretching his dread bow, letting fonh a piercing shout presaging the death of the titans. Dreadful to behold in his wrath, he resembled the fire at the dissolution of the world and seeing him filled with energy the forest deities fled away. In his anger, Ramo resembled the Bearer of the Pinaka bow intent on destroying Daksha's sacrifice. With their bows and weapons, their cars and their armour, which shone like fire, the hosts of those eaters of human Oesh resembled a mass of dark clouds at the hour of sunrise.

CHAPTER 25

The Fight continues

in his chariot amidst those Yatudbanas, resembled the planet Mars encircled by stars. Loosing a thousand shafts, Khara emitted a tremendous war cry and all the demons in fury showered various missiles on that invincible archer **RAMA**, striking him in their frenzy with iron clubs, swords, spears and axes. With their colossal stature and extraordinary power, they resembled mountains as they bore down on Kakutstha with their chariots and horses. In their desire to overcome **RAMA**, those demon hordes, mounted on elephants as high as the peaks of mountains, covered him with a hail of weapons, like great clouds letting loose their rain on the King of Mountains, and Raghava was hemmed in on all sides by those ferocious looking demons. As at evening time Mahadeva is surrounded by his satellites, so was **RAMA** beset by the lances of the titans, but that prince received the missiles hurled against him as the sea receives the rivers that empty themselves

therein. As the Himalayas remain unmoved, when struck by lightning, so did he, when those dreadful weapons tore his flesh. Pierced in every limb, the blood gushing forth on all sides, he resembled the evening sun enveloped in cloud. Beholding **RAMA** encircled by thousands of titans, the Gods and sages were profoundly moved, but he, growing enraged, bending his bow like a sickle, let loose hundreds and thousands of pointed shafts, that could not be intercepted and carried death to those they pierced. As if in sport, on the battlefield **RAMA** let fly countless arrows furnished with herons plumes, tipped with gold, destroying innumerable titans like the noose of death itself. Unconcernedly loosed by **RAMA**, those arrows passed through the demons' bodies and, stained with blood, flew through the air like blazing torches. Countless shafts drawn from **RAMA**'s quiver fell in hundreds and thousands, robbing the demons of their life's breath, tbeir bows, their banners, their shields and their armour, their arms embellished with ornaments and their thighs resembling the trunks of elephants. The arrows of **RAMA**, discharged from the bowstring, cut down horses yoked to the chariots with their golden trappings S4 together with the charioteers ; elephants with their riders, horsemen with their steeds, were all transfixed by his shafts and despatched to the region of **YAMA**. Pierced by those pointed shafts, the Rangers of the Night, emitted terrible shrieks, and decimated by those death-dealing arrows, the demon host was unable to defend itself, as dried wood is ignited by the proximity of fire. Then certain demon warriors, full of energy and zeal, in a paroxyam of rage, let fly lancea, tridents and other weapons at **RAMA**, but he, intercepting them, cut off the heads of those demons with his shafts, thus depriving them of their lives. They, having had their heads, their shields and their bowstrings severed, fell to the earth, like trees thrown down by the blast of **GARUDA**'s wings. Then the remaining titans fled, seeking refuge from

those death-dealing arrows with Khara, but Dushana, taking up his bow, rsllied them and rushed on **RAMA** as if he were Antaka himself; thereafter the titans, growing bolder, hurled themselves on **RAMA** anew, armed with the trunks of Sala and Tala and huge rocks. With lances, maces and snares, bearing darts, clubs and nooses in their hands, those great warriors covered the whole field with a bail of missiles, discharging volleya of trees and rocks. Thereafter the combat waxed furious, causing the hair to stand on end, and now it seemed as if **RAMA** were the victor and again the demons appeared to triumph. Then, seeing himself beseiged on all sides, that mighty warrior **RAMA**, covered by a bail of darts, sent up a terrific shout, placing the *mantra*-propelled Gandharva weapon on his bow, whereupon a thousand arrows sped from his bent bow, covering the ten regions. With such skill did **RAMA** discharge his arrows, that the demons were unable to distinguish when he drew them from their quiver and when he loosed them and his shafts caused darkness to spread over the sky and obscure the sun. Slain in their thousands, the demons fell in heaps and the battlefield was strewn with corpses. Struek down, dis embowelled, transfixed, tom and haeked asunder, they could be seen in their hundreds, and the ground was scauered with ss heads wrapped in turbans, arms encircled with bangles, thighs and torsos with their ornaments, horses, mighty elephants, shattered chariots, chowries, fans, umbrellas and standards of every kind, and beholding the slain, the remaining demons were affiicted and unable to withstand Rarna, that captor of hostile citadels, further.

CHAPTER 26

Rama destroys the Titans and slays Dushana

SEEING his forces destroyed, the mighty-armed Dushana placed himself at the head of five thousand intrepid and invincible titans, to whom retreat was unknown. Nevertheless, as Dushana rushed upon him, **RAMA** cut off both his arms with his arrows, and that mace, loosed from his grasp, fell forward on the field like unto the banner of **INDRA**, whilst Dushana, bereft of it, his arms severed, sank to the earth like a mighty elephant that, stripped of its tusks, succumbs. Seeing Dushana lying on the battlefield, all beings, witness ing that con11ict, cried out " Well done ! Well done I " and paid obeisance to **RAMA**. Meantime, impelled by fate, the three generals, Mahakapala, Sthulaksha and the mighty Titan Pramatbin rushed on **RAMA** ; Mahakapala brandishing a great trident, Sthulaksha bearing a harpoon and Pramatbin, a huge axe. Seeing them advancing, Raghava, taking out some sharp steel-pointed arrows, went forward to meet them, as one receives a guest, and the Delight of the House of Raghu severed the head of Mahakapala with a single arrow and assailed Pramatbin with innumerable shafts, whereupon he fell to the earth like an axed tree; thereafter, **RAMA** blinded Sthulaksha with his sharp arrows and, inflamed with wrath, with five thousand shafts slew an equal number of Dushana's followers, sending them to the nether regions. Hearing that Dushana and his warriors were lying dead, Khara, in great fury, addressed the leaders of the army, saying:-" Let all the titans attack that evil wretch, **RAMA**, and strike him with weapons of every kind." Speaking thus, Khara, full of wrath, fiung himself on **RAMA**, followed by Durjaya, Karaviraksha, Parusha, Kalakarmuka, Hernamalin, Maharnalin, Sarpashya, Syengamin, Pritbagriva, Vajnasarru, Vihangama and Rudhinashana, those twelve valiant generals with their forces, who fell upon Ramo, dis charging their excellent shafts. And **RAMA**, endowed with supreme energy, with his gold and diamond encrusted arrows, despatched the remainder of

Khara's forces, and those shafts, bereft of feathers, like golden stalks, resembling flames wreathed in smoke, laid those demons low, as lightning fells the giant trees. With a hundred ear shaped arrows, **RAMA** slew a hundred titans ; and a thousand with as many shafts. Their breastplates and ornaments shattered, their hows broken, thOse Rangers of the Night fell on the earth, hotbed in blood. Their hair dishevelled, covered S1 with gore, they lay on the battlefield, like kusha grass scattered on the altar, and that great forest, strewn with the corpses of demons and befouled with their flesh and blood, resembled the region of hell. Founeen thousand demons of cruel deeds were slain by Rams, a mortal, single-handed and on foot I Out of the whole army only Khara of the great Car and the Titan, Trishiras survived, all others being slain by **LAKSHMANA**'s elder brother, the illustrious Rams. Thereafter, seeing that vast army destroyed in the great conflict, Khara, ascending his splendid chariot, advanced on Raghava with his mace upraised.

CHAPTER 27

Rama and Trishiras meet in Combat. Trishiras is slain

Trishiras approached him and said:-" O Lord, refrain from engaging **RAMA** in combat and having recourse to me, who am possessed of prowess, witness his defeaL I swear to thee by my sword that I will slay **RAMA** and avenge the death of the entire demon host. In this fight I shall be as Mrityu to him or he to me, but thou, O Excellent One, shouldst restrain thy martial ardour awhile and be a spectator only. Should Rams Trisbiras, having pierced **RAMA**'s forehead with three dans, that hero, enraged, addressed him in biting accents, saying: " O Valiant Titan, the

arrows thou hast loosed I bear on my brow as a wreath, do thou now receive the shafts from my bow." Thereupon **RAMA** let fly founeen serpentine arrows striking Trisbiras on the breast and with four funher shafts brought down his four steeds, killing his charioteer with eight other darts and with a single arrow severing the up-raised standard in the front of his car. Then, as that Ranger of the Night was alighring from his shattered chariot, **RAMA** pierced his breast with further arrows, depriving him of his senses, and that one of immeasurable prowess with his swift arrows cut off the three heads of Trishiras, causing the blood to flow from the stricken trunk, and the heads of that Ranger of the Night fell while he yet stood upright after the destruction of his forces. Then the remaining titans, losing bean, sped away like deer stampeding on the approach of a hunter, and Khara, beholding them fleeing, waxing wrath, rallied them and rushed on **RAMA** as Rahu on the moon.

CHAPTER 28

The Combat between Rama and Khara

Irresistible shafts, which resembled tongues of fire, and all space was filled with arrows on every side, which had been loosed by Khara and **RAMA**. As those two heroes struggled together, the sun was obscured and darkness descended ; then, like a mighty elephant struck with a goad, **RAMA** assailed his opponent with Nalikas, Narachas and sharp-pointed Vikarnas, and that demon, standing in his chariot, bow in hand, resembled Death himself carrying his noose. At that moment Khara deemed the destroyer of his forces, endued with heroism, the extremely powerful **RAMA**, ro be overcome with fatigue, but Ranta remained unmoved under Khara's assaults, as a mighty lion ignores the

presence of an insignificant deer. Then Khara, in his chariot blazing like the sun, drew near ro **RAMA**, as a moth approaches a flame and, displaying his skill, severed **RAMA**'s bow at the point where he held it, thereafter loosing seven mace-like shafts resembling **INDRA**'s thunderbolts, which shattered the armour of his adversary resplendent as the sun itself, so that it fell on the earth. Roaring like a lion, he let loose a thousand arrows, wounding Ranta of unparalleled might, and in that conflict Khara set up a mighty shout. Pierced by Khara's arrows, the body of Ranta resembled a clear and smokeless flame, and that Destroyer of his Foes, in order ro compass the titan's defeat, took up another great bow, stringing it with a mighty twanging. Holding aloft that prodigious bow, named Vaishnava, bestowed on him by the *Rishi* Agastya, Ranta rushed on Khara, letting fly his arrows furnished with golden feathers and cut down his banner plated with gold, which fell from the chariot, as the sun falls on the eanh, cursed by the Gods. Highly provoked, Khara aimed at the heart of Ranta and pierced him with four arrows, so that he resembled a great elephant under the deluge in the rainy season, and Ranta, sorely wounded by his shafts, covered with blood, wued wrath and that foremost of bowmen, with consummate skill, let fly six well-directed arrows. With one, he struck the head 6o of Khara, with two others, his arms, and with the remaining thtee crescent-shaped darts, he pierced his breast. There after that illustrious warrior, in his ire, let fly thirteeo arrows sharpened on the whetstone, blazing like the sun; one severed the shafts of his adversary's car, four more felling the steeds; with a sixth he smote the head of his charioteer, and with thtee others that great and intrepid warrior, shattered the axles of the chariot; with the twelfth he severed Khara's bow at the point where he held it, and with the thirteenth arrow, that shone like lightning, Raghava, who was equal to **INDRA**, trans fixed Khara, as it were in

sport. His bow shattered, deprived of his chariot, his horses slain, his charioteer fallen, Khara, mace in hand, sprang to the ground and stood waiting. Seeing **RAMA**'s feat of arms that was unsurpassed, the Gods and great Sages rejoiced and, assembling in the sky, with joined palms, extolling the wonderful exploit of that mighty warrior, offered obeisance to him.

CHAPTER 29

Rama and the demon Khara taunt one another

Slaying thee to-day I sball wipe away the tears of their relatives." Spesking thus, Khara, filled with fury, hurled his marvellous gold-encircled mace at **RAMA**. Leaving the hand of Khara, that massive and effulgent mace, resembling a blazing thunder bolt, consuming the trees and bushes to ashes, drew near to **RAMA**, but he, as it was about to fall like the noose of death, shattered it to fragments with his arrows while yet in the air. Crushed and broken, it fell to earth like a serpent stricken by the efficacy of herbs and the power of incantations.

CHAPTER 30

The Death of Khara

Thereafter the Rajarishis and Paramarishis, accompanied by Agastya, joyfully paid homage to **RAMA** and said : "It was for this that the Slayer ofPaka, the mighty Purandara, visited the hermitage of the Sage Sharabhanga. It was for this that the great *Rishis* brought thee to this place, O Prince, that thou mightest compass the destruction of the titans

of evil deeds. Thou hast fulfilled thy mission amongst us, O Son of **DASARATHA** ; from to-day the virtuous sages may per form their devotions in the Dandaka Forest in peace." Then that hero, **LAKSHMANA**, accompanied by **SITA**, issued from the mountain cavern and joyfully entered the hermitage, and the victorious and heroic **RAMA**, honoured by the great Sages, returned to the *ashrama*, where Lakshrnana paid him obeisance. Seeing her consort returning victorious, having brought felicity to the ascetics, the happy V aidehi embraced him. Beholding those hosts of demons slain, and that Destroyer of Enemy Hosts worshipped by the magnanimous sages, the daughter of J anaka began to minister to her lord and full of joy, embracing him afresh in her delight, experienced supreme happiness.

CHAPTER 31

Ravana, the King of the Titans, hears of the Death of Khara and determines to slay Rama

heretofore impregnable, as also my generals, Khara and Dushana. Do thou, therefore, aid me in bearing off his consort, **SITA**." Hearing these words of the King of the Titans, **MARICHA** *answered*:-" O King, the man who has thus counselled thee concerning **SITA** is assuredly an enemy in the guise of a friend. By such advice, he has unquestionably affronted thee and is envious of thy great might. " ' Bear **SITA** away ! ' who has uttered such words ? Who seeks to cut off the hesd of the entire titan host ? Without doubt the man who has thus counselled thee is thine enemy, since he desires thee to extract the poison fangs of a serpent with thy bare hands. Who is it who seeks to lead thee astray and strikes thine head whilst thou art sleeping happily ? " Raghava, that intoxicated

elephant, may not be withstood on the field of battle. With the lineage of an illustrious House as his trunk, his valour the ichor, his outstretched arms the tusks, thou art wholly unable to pit thyself against him. Do not rouse that sleeping lion who hunts the titans as d=, the arrows of whose quiver are his talons, his sharp sword the jaws. " O King of the Titans, do not hurl thyself into that dreadful and bottomless ocean called Ramo, whose bow is the crocodile, the strength of whose arm is the quagmire, whnse shafts are the rising waves, and whose battlefield is its waters. " O Lord of Lanka, compose thyself and return in peace to thy capital. O **INDRA** of Titans, continue to enjoy the company of thy consorts, and let **RAMA** delight in his own, in the forest." Hearing the words of Maricha, the ten-hesded **RAVANA** returned to the city of Lanka and re-entered his palace. CHAPTBR 32 Shurpanakha upbraids Rawma and urges him to datToy Rturra WHBN Shurpanakha saw those fourteen thousand titans of dreadful deeds slain by Ramo single-handed on the field of battle, together with Khara, Dushana and Trishiras, she once

32 . Shurpanakha upbraids Ravana and urges him to destroy Rama

heretofore impregnable, as also my generals, Khara and Dushana. Do thou, therefore, aid me in bearing off his consort, **SITA**." Hearing these words of the King of the Titans, **MARICHA** *answered*:-" O King, the man who has thus counselled thee concerning **SITA** is assuredly an enemy in the guise of a friend. By such advice, he has unquestionably affronted thee and is envious of thy great might. " ' Bear **SITA** away ! ' who has uttered such words ? Who seeks to cut off the hesd of the entire titan host ? Without doubt the man who has thus counselled thee is thine

enemy, since he desires thee to extract the poison fangs of a serpent with thy bare hands. Who is it who seeks to lead thee astray and strikes thine head whilst thou art sleeping happily ? " Raghava, that intoxicated elephant, may not be withstood on the field of battle. With the lineage of an illustrious House as his trunk, his valour the ichor, his outstretched arms the tusks, thou art wholly unable to pit thyself against him. Do not rouse that sleeping lion who hunts the titans as d=, the arrows of whose quiver are his talons, his sharp sword the jaws. " O King of the Titans, do not hurl thyself into that dreadful and bottomless ocean called Ramo, whose bow is the crocodile, the strength of whose arm is the quagmire, whnse shafts are the rising waves, and whose battlefield is its waters. " O Lord of Lanka, compose thyself and return in peace to thy capital. O **INDRA** of Titans, continue to enjoy the company of thy consorts, and let **RAMA** delight in his own, in the forest." Hearing the words of Maricha, the ten-hesded **RAVANA** returned to the city of Lanka and re-entered his palace. CHAPTBR 32 Shurpanakha upbraids Rawma and urges him to datToy Rturra WHBN Shurpanakha saw those fourteen thousand titans of dreadful deeds slain by Ramo single-handed on the field of battle, together with Khara, Dushana and Trishiras, she once 68 more emitted dreadful shrieks and roared like thunder. Perceiving the incomparable prowess of Ragbava, she became exceedingly agitated and proceeded to Lanka, **RAVANA**'s capital. There she beheld **RAVANA** shining in glory, surrounded by his ministers on the terrace of his palace, like **INDRA** amidst the Maruts. Seated on his golden throne, blazing like a flame, **RAVANA** resembled a great fire kindled on an altar, kept alive by sacrificial offerings. Unconquered by Gods, Gan dharvas, *Rishis* or other creatures, that warrior, who resembled death itself with wide-open jaws, bore on his person the wounds inflicted by the thunderbolts in the war between Gods and titans and on his breast the marks of Airavata's tusks.

Having twenty arms, ten heads, a broad chest, wearing gorgeous attire and bearing the marks of royalty, he was adorned with a chain of emeralds and ornaments of fine gold and with his great arms, white teeth and enormous mouth resembled a mountain. In the combat with the Gods, **VISHNU** had struck him a hundred times with his discus, and he bore the markS of other weapons from that great struggle, yet his limbs were intact and had not been severed. He who was able to chum up the seas, a feat not to be performed by any other, whose missiles were the mountain crests, he the scourge of the Gods, who transgressed every moral law, the ravisher of others' wives, the wielder of celestial weapons, the destroyer of sacrifices, who descended into the city of Bhogavati and subdued the serpent V asuki, from whom, on his defeat, he stole the gentle consort ; he who scaled Mount Kailasha and overcame Kuvera depriving him of his aerial cbariot Pushpaka, which trans paned him wheresoever he desired ; he who in his anger destroyed the garden of Chaitaratha, the lotus pool and the Nandana Grove and all the pleasurable retreats of the Gods, and with his vast arms, resembling the peaks of' mountains, arrested the course of the sun and moon, twin scourgers of their foes, rising in splendour ; practising asceticism in the mighty forest for a thousand years he offered his heads in sacrifice to Swyarnbhu and obtained the boon that neither *Deva*, Danava, Gandharva, Pisacha, Pataya nor Uraga should be able to slay him, but of man there was no mention; 69 proud of his strength, he stole the *Soma* juice, sanctified by mantras, before irs pressing by the Twice-born in the sacrifice ; this perverse wretch, **RAVANA** of evil deeds, slayer of the *brahmins*, ruthless, pitiless, delighting in causing harm to others, was verily a source of terror to all beings. The titan woman beheld her brother full of power, resplendent in gorgeous attire, adorned with celestial garlands, seated on his throne, resembling Time at the

destruction of the worlds, that lndra of Demons, the proud descendant of Poulastyli and she, trembling with fear, in order to address him, drew near to the Slayer of his Enemies, who was seated amidst his counsellors. Distracted with terror and passion, Shurpanakha, who was wont to roam everywhere unafraid, now mutilated by the order of that magnanimous **RAMACHANDRA**, displaying her ravaged features before RavaDO, whose latge eyes appeared to shoot forth flames, uttered these bitter words to him :

CHAPTER 33

Shurpanakha's Speech to Ravana

" **O RAVANA**, wholly devoted to pleasure and indulging in every whim without scruple, thou art oblivious of the great calamity that threatens thee. That monarch who is given up to lust and other dissipations and who is covetous, is disregarded by his subjecrs, as is the fire in the crematorium. That king who does not fulfil his duties at the proper season brings ruin on his state. The Prince who, committing excess, is ruled by his consorts and readily gives credence to other’s counsel, is shunned as the mud of a river is shunned by an elephant. Those rulers who are unable to protect their lands or reclaim the territory wrested from them, live without glory, like moun· rains submerged in the ocean. " At enmity with the Gods, the Gaodharvas and the Danavas, who are masters of themselves, doing what ought not to be done and inconstant, how art thou able to rule as king ? 10 " O Titan, thou art childish aud thoughtless and art not conversant with that which should be known to thee ; how canst thou govern ? Those monarchs who have neither emissaries, wealth nor policy at their disposal, resemble a common man,

O Prince of Conquerors ! Since kings are informed by their spies as to what is taking place abroad, they are said to be far-sighted. Meseems thou dost not discharge thy duty and that the counsellors who surround thee are in experienced, since thou art insensible to the destruction of thy people aud their territory. " Fourteen thousand titans of dreadful deeds with .Khara aud Dushana have been slain by **RAMA** single-handed; **RAMA** of imperishable exploits has freed the ascetics of fear, estab lished peace in the Dandaka Forest and harassed Janasthana, but thou, who art covetous and a slave to lust, art unaware of the dauger that threatens thy dominion. None will help that monarch in time of peril, who is mean, violent, dissolute, haughty and perfidious. 'llven his own relatives will overpower a king who is excessively vain, pretentious, boastful and irascible. That monarch who fails in his duty and, under the threat of danger is lulled into a false security, will in time of adversity be swept from his kingdom like a straw. Dry wood, turf or dust have some value, but a king who is degenerate is worthless and resembles a faded wreath or a worn-out garment. That monarch who is vigilant however, conversant with what is happening and virtuous, establishes his throne in perpetuity. The king who, even while sleeping, is yet awake to the ordering of his kingdom, who manifests his anger or approval at a fitting time, is revered by all. " O Thou, whose emissaries have failed to inform thee of the great carnage among the titans, who art bereft of wisdom, O Ravaua, thou art lacking in all these great qualities. " Disregarding others, given up to the pleasures of the senses, not able to reap the advantage of time and place or discriminate between what is good and evil, having sacrificed thy kingdom, thou wilt soon perish.” Reflecting on the infirmities his sister had ascribed to him, Ravaua, the Lord of the Titans, opulent, arrogant aud powerful, became absorbed in thought.

CHAPTER 34

She urges Ravana to slay Rama and wed Sita

HEARING Shurpanakha's bitter words, **RAVANA** surrounded by his ministers enquired angrily :-" Who is **RAMA** ? Wbat, is his strengrh ? How does he look and whst is the measure of his prowess ? Why hss he penetrated into the lonely and inaccessible depths of the Dandaka Forest ? With whst weapons did he destroy the titans in that conflict, slaying Khara and Dushaoa as also Trishiras ? Tell me truly, O Lovely One, who has disfigured thee ? " Thus addressed by the Lord of the Titans, Shurpaoakha in a transport of rage began to relate the history of **RAMA**. **SHE** *said*: " **RAMA**, the son of lting **DASARATHA**, resembles the God of Love ; his arms are long, his eyes large ; clad in robes of bark and a black antelope skin, bearing a bow encircled with gold like unto Indta's, he lets fly blazing arrows resembling venomous snakes. Emitting a great shout, he discharges his formidable shafts, and in the struggle I could not distinguish him but beheld the host being decimated under the rain of his arrows, as the hsrvest is destroyed by the hail sent by Iodra. In a short space, single-handed, standing alone, he slew fourteen thousand titans with Khara and Dushsoa, thus bringing peace to the sages in the Daodaka Forest and deliver ing them from fear. Chivalrous of soul, **RAMA**, the Knower of Self, would not countenance the slaying of a woman and, hsving been mutilated at his command, I escaped. "His brother, endowed with great valour, is renowned for his virtue ; his name is **LAKSHMANA** and he is devoted to **RAMA**. Full of fire, indomitable, victorious, powerful, intelligent and wise, he is his right hand and his very life's breath. And **RAMA**'s virtuous, tender and wedded wife, of large eyes, whose face resembles the full moon, is ever engaged in what

is pleas ing to her lord. With her lovely locks, well-formed nose, beautiful shoulders and her grace and dignity, one would deem 72 her to be a forest divinity or Lakshmi herself. With a skin of the colour of molten gold, nails that are rosy and long, that surpassingly lovely woman is **SITA**, the slender-waisted Princess of Videha. No woman so beautiful has ever appeared in the world, either among the Gods, Gandharvas, Y akshas or Kinneras. He whose wife **SITA** becomes and whom she will warmly emhrace will live in the world more happily than Purandara. With her natural amiability, her marvellous beauty, which is without equal on earth, she would prove a worthy consort for thre, and thou too art fit to be her lord. It was to hring thee this lady of shapely hips, softly rounded hreasts and charming features, that I put forth my endeavoura, when, O Mighty-armed One, I was mutilated by the ruthless **LAKSHMANA**! “When thou dost behold Vaidehi, whose countenance resembles the full moon, thou shalt instantly be pierced with the darts of the God of Love. If thou desirest to win her, then set off speedily on thy right foot and lay siege to her heart. If, O **RAVANA**, my counsel meets with thine approval, then, O King of the Titans, follow it without delay. “Knowing the weakness of these people, O Valiant Chief of the Titans, make **SITA**, who is without blemish, thy consort. Hearing that **RAMA** with his arrows that never missed their mark has slain the titans established in Janasthana, and of the death of Khara and Dushana, thou hast a duty to perform.”

CHAPTER 35

Ravana visits the Demon Maricha once again

HEARING the words of Shurpanakha, causing his hair to stand on end, **RAVANA** dismissed his ministers and began to reflect on what should or should not be done. Exploring the true significance of the undertaking and weighing the desirability and undesirability of the matter, he came to the conclusion 73 Thus should I act', and, fixed in his resolve, went secretly to the splendid pavilion where his chariots were heldinreadiness, commanding his driver to bring out his car. At his order, the zealous charioteer, in an instant, prepared that superb and marvellous chariot, and **RAVANA** ascended the golden car set with gems, that coursed wheresoever he desired, to which mules in golden trappings, bearing the heads of goblins, were harnessed. Mounted on that chariot, the wheels of which made a sound like thunder, the younger brother of Dbanada, the God of Wealth, proceeded beside the Lord of Rivers and Streams along the seashore. Seated under a pure-white canopy with his white cbanwaras, his ten heads the colour of lapis, wearing ornaments of pure gold, with ten necks and twenty arms, the younger brother of Dbanada, the enemy of the Gods, the slayer of the foremost among the ascetics, possessed of huge heads, like unto the **INDRA** of Mountains with its ten crests, appeared beautiful, standing in his chariot, coursing at will like a mass of cloud, crowned with lightning and accompanied by a fiock of cranes. And that Great One, endowed with prowess, beheld the shores of the sea with its rocks and coundess trees, laden with fruit and fiowers of every kind, bordered by lakes of limpid water filled with lotuses, and spacious hermitages with their altars and groves of plantain trees lending brilliance to the scene, which was enhanced by blossoming Coconut, Sala, Tala and Tamala trees. These places bad been rendered illustrious by the presence of thousands of great *Rishis* of rigid penance and Nagas, Supsmas, Gandbarvas and Kinneras ; they were rendered pleasant by Siddbas and Cbaranas, who

were fully self-subdued and those descendants of **BRAHMA** who derived their nutriment from the solar rays and those who lived on a bare subsistence such as the Ajas, Vailthanasas, Mashas, Valakhilyas and Danavas and other Celestial Beings who fed on Amrita fre quented that place. Swans, cranes, pelicans and waterfowl dispotted themselves on the emerald sward, wet and shining with the sea mist ; spscious cars festooned with celestial garlands from which strains of sweet music issued, flew here and there at the will of those who had conquered the worlds by their austerities, together with Gandharvas and Apsaras. **RAVANA** surveyed countless forests of sandalwood, whose roots were full of fragrant sap, delighting the olfactory sense, and groves of excellent Agallocha and Takkola trees with pear trees and bushes of black pepper and heaps of pearls lying on the shore, and coral reefs and gold and silver promontories, tumbling cataracts of crystsl water and cities filled with grain and treasure, where the pearls of womanhood could be seen and which were thronged with horses, elephants and chariots. On the shores of the ocean, the Lord of the Titans beheld a level and charming spot over which cool breezes blew resembling heaven itself, in the centre of which grew a great fig tree, like a bright cloud, where many sages sheltered, and on every side its branches stretched to a distance of several yojanas. It was there that the mighty **GARUDA** brought a huge elephant and a giant tortoise in his claws, wishing to devour them among the branches, but the bough broke under the weight of that enormous bird, and the Vaikhanasas, Mashas, Valakhilyas, Marichipss Ajas and Dhumras being assembled there, **GARUDA** had compassion on them and transpotted the branch together with the elephant and tortoise in one claw to a distance of one hundred yojanas, where that excellent bird regaled himself on their flesh. Destroying the empire of the Nishadas with the severed branch, thus

delivering the sages, his joy was re-doubled and his energy increased, whereupon filled with strengrh he resolved to steal the Nectar of Immortality. Having broken the iron bars, he entered the jewelled keep and bore away the Amrita from that place where it had been hidden by the mighty **INDRA**. It was this same Nyagrodha tree, frequented by groups of great sages, that still bore the marks of Supsrna and was called 'Subhadra ', that the younger brother of Dhanada now saw before him. 75 Passing over to the further side of that Lord of the Waters, the Ocean, **RAVANA** saw a solitary hermitage, an ancient and holy retreat in the middle of a forest. There he found the Demon Maricha clad in a black antelope skin, wearing matted locks and given up to the practice of asceticism. **RAVANA** having approached him, Maricha, according to tradition, entertained him in many ways not known to man. Placing pure food and water before his sovereign, he humbly addressed him saying : " Is all well with Lanka, O Chief of the Titans ? With what purpose hast thou come hither again so speedily ? " · On hearing this enquiry, the mighty and eloquent **RAVANA** answered in this wise :

CHAPTER 36

Ravana reveals his Project to him

" **O** MAluCHA, listen to me as I relate everything to thee I O My Child, I am deeply aiHicted and thou alone canst temper my distress I " Thou art conversant with J anasthana, it was there that my brother Khara, the long-armed Dushana, my sister Shur panakha and the powerful Trishiras and other flesh-eating titans, prowlers of the night, had at my command taken up their residence, in order to harass the sages in that vast forest, who were engaged in their austerities. " Fourteen

thousand titans of terrible deeds, full of courage and supremely skilled, dwelt in Janasthana under the leadership of Khara. These powerful warriors assembled there, met with Rams in the field. Furnished with every kind of weapon, clad in mail, and headed by Khara, they were assailed by the iofuriated Rams, without a single provocative word having been uttered, who directed the arrows of his bow against them, and under the fiery darts of a mere mortal, fighting single-handed and on foot, those fourteen thousand titans of grest prowess fell ; Khara perished in that struggle and Dushana 76 was laid low with Trisbiras also ; peace was thus established in the Dandaka Forest. " Having been exiled to the forest with his wife by an out raged sire, that insignificant mortal, **RAMA**, the obloquy of the warrior class, a man without moral principle, ruthless, passionate, fanatical, acquisitive and a slave to his senses, dwells in his hermitage, having forsworn his duty. Essentially unjust, seeking to harm others without cause, depending on his own strength alone, he has mutilated my sister by cutting off her ears and nose. " I have resolved to carry off his consort, **SITA**, by force, who resembles a daughter of the Gods, and I now solicit thine aid in this undertaking. O Hero, I with my brothers have nothing to fear from the Gods, therefore do thou accompany me as a loyal ally; O Titan; thou hast no equal in pride and courage in battle and in strategy; thou art also a master, being versed in the laws of magic. " Learn from me how thou canst best assist me ! Assuming the form of a golden deer, flecked with silver, do thou pass to and fro near **RAMA**'s hermitage in the presence of **SITA**. Seeing that lovely doe, assuredly **SITA** will say to her lord and **LAKSHMANA** :-c Do ye capture it!' " When they are far distant and, by good fortune, **SITA** is left alone, I shall bear her away without hindrance, as Rahu devours the splendour of the moon. The abduction of his consort will cause **RAMA** to die of grief, and I shall regain my happiness

and security in a heart wholly satisfied ! " Hearing these words concerning **SITA**, the benevolent features of Maricha wilted with terror and, passing his tongue over his dry lips, with a fixed gaze like unto one dead, he regarded **RAVANA**. Filled with dread, knowing well the defence of the forest to be valiantly upheld by **RAMA**, with joined palms Maricha addressed **RAVANA** in words tending to his welfare :

CHAPTER 37

Maricha seeks to dissuade Ravana from his Design

HEARING the words of that Sovereign of the Titans, the wise and eloquent Marich answered him, saying : " O King, those who have recourse to flattery are easy to find, but rare are those who are willing to listen to that speech which is severe yet salutary. Assuredly thou dost not know **RAMA** and art not conversant with his great qualities, which equal those of Mahendra and **VARUNA**. " Thou art thoughtless and thy spies are incompetent ; bow canst thou dwell in security with thy titans, O Friend ? Is not **RAMA** in his wrath able rid the world of titans ? Will not the daughter of **JANAKA** prove to be that which will determine thy death ? Will not **SITA** become the cause of a great catastrophe? " Will not the city of Lanka perish with thee and thy titans, since it has thee who followest the dictates of thy passions, who art a slave to thy senses and who knowest no restraint, as its lord ? An unprincipled monarch, such as thou, is the slave of his desires and in his perversity heeds only evil counsels, thus placing his subjects and his kingdom in jeopardy. " Rams has neither been disowned by his sire, nor is he uofaithful to his duty, nor is he avaricious nor wicked, nor the obloquy of the warrior caste. The son of **KAUSHALYA** is neither canst thou think of bearing her

away by force? Do not enter the inextinguisbable fire of **RAMA**, who on the battlefield employs his sbafts as fiames and his bow fuel. No matter how grest thine anger, it bebovetb thee not to approach that invincible warrior, bearing his how, his countenance infiamed with ire, furnished with every weapon, the Destroyer of his Foes! " Unless thou art willing to forfeit thy kingdom, thine bappiness and life itself, tbat is dear to all, do not approach **RAMA**, who resembles Antska himself. How canst thou bear away the daughter of **JANAKA** from the forest, who is protected by Ramo's how of immeasurable power? The beloved spouse of that Lion among Men, whose chest is broad, is desrer to him than his own life, and she is wholly devoted to him. The Princess of Mithila of slender waist will never be tom from the arms of tbat great warrior who resembles a fiame in a lit brazier. " Why enter upon such a vain endeavour, O Grest King ? Should **RAMA** single thee out on the battlefield, all would be over with thee. Since it concerns thy life, thy fortune and thy kingdom, heretofore invincible, take counsel with thy ministers with Bibishana at the-ir head. In honour refiect and weigh carefully the merits and demerits, gain and loss, of this matter. Compare thy valour with tbat of Raghava ! Con sider wbat is to thine advantage and then do wbat thou thinkest right. It does not appear fitting to me, tbat thou shouldst meet the son of the King of Kosbala on the battlefield. I collll!el thee for thine own good, O King of the Night Rangers!" CHAPTER. 38 MtJriclra describu his first Brlounter fllith RtJmtJ " O KDIG, formerly I possessed grest powers and ranged the earth in a body resembling a mountain, endowed with the strength of a thousand elephants. In colour like a dark cloud, wearing bracelets of fine gold, my brow encircled by a diadem,

CHAPTER 38

Maricha describes his first Encounter with Rama

Canst thou think of bearing her away by force? Do not enter the inextinguisbable fire of **RAMA**, who on the battlefield employs his sbafts as fiames and his bow fuel. No matter how grest thine anger, it bebovetb thee not to approach that invincible warrior, bearing his how, his countenance infiamed with ire, furnished with every weapon, the Destroyer of his Foes! " Unless thou art willing to forfeit thy kingdom, thine bappiness and life itself, tbat is dear to all, do not approach **RAMA**, who resembles Antska himself. How canst thou bear away the daughter of **JANAKA** from the forest, who is protected by Ramo's how of immeasurable power? The beloved spouse of that Lion among Men, whose chest is broad, is desrer to him than his own life, and she is wholly devoted to him. The Princess of Mithila of slender waist will never be tom from the arms of tbat great warrior who resembles a fiame in a lit brazier. " Why enter upon such a vain endeavour, O Grest King ? Should **RAMA** single thee out on the battlefield, all would be over with thee. Since it concerns thy life, thy fortune and thy kingdom, heretofore invincible, take counsel with thy ministers with Bibishana at the-ir head. In honour refiect and weigh carefully the merits and demerits, gain and loss, of this matter. Compare thy valour with tbat of Raghava ! Con sider wbat is to thine advantage and then do wbat thou thinkest right. It does not appear fitting to me, tbat thou shouldst meet the son of the King of Kosbala on the battlefield. I collll!el thee for thine own good, O King of the Night Rangers!" CHAPTER. 38 MtJriclra describu his first Brlounter fllith RtJmtJ " O KDIG, formerly I possessed grest powers and ranged the earth in a body resembling a mountain, endowed with the

strength of a thousand elephants. In colour like a dark cloud, wearing bracelets of fine gold, my brow encircled by a diadem, 79 armed with a club, I sowed terror in the hearts of all creatures. " Wandering in the Daodaka Forest, I fed on the llesh of ascetics, aod the great and virtuous Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, alarmed, went in person to King **DASARATHA** and addressed that **INDRA** among men, saying:-' Let **RAMA** protect me with vigilance on the day of sacrifice ! O Chief of Men, I fear Maricha exceedingly.' " To these words, the righteous monarch **DASARATHA** answered that illustrious ascetic, **VISHWAMITRA**, saying:-' Raghsva is not yet twelve years old aod is not skilled in the use of weapons, but I myself willlesd an army composed of four angas' against those Prowlers of the Night, O Thou Best of Ascetics and will destroy thine adversary in accord with thy desire I ' " Thus addressed by the King, **VISHWAMITRA** *answered*: " Verily thou wert the refuge of the Gods aod thine exploits are renowned in the Three Worlds, yet, however powerful thine army, none but **RAMA** on this earth has the power to overcome these demons. Do thou therefore remain here, O Scourge of Thy Foes! Though still a child, **RAMA** is fully able to subdue the demons, I shall therefore take him with me; may all be well with thee!' " Having spoken thus, the Sage **VISHWAMITRA**, highly gratified, took the king's son with him to his hermitage. " In the forest ofDaodaka he initiated the traditional sacrifices, whilst **RAMA**, with his bow strung in readiness, remained close at hand. Yet a child, with his dark skin of bluish hue aod his shining glances, clothed in a aimple tunic, bearing his bow, his locks tied in a knot, wearing a golden chain, he illumined the Dandaka Forest with his radiaoce, like unto the new moon about to rise. " At that instant, full of power aod proud of the boons won from **BRAHMA**, shining like a cloud aod wearing golden earrings, I entered the hermitage. Seeing me, **RAMA** took up his arrow aod placed it on the

string of his bow with care. In mine ignoraoce I passed him by, deeming him to be but a child and roshed towards the altar where **VISHWAMITRA** stood. Thereujon **RAMA** let loose a sharp arrow fatal to his foes, aod striking me, hurled me into the sea, a distanCe of a hundred yojanas ! O Friend, the valiant **RAMA**, having no wish to kill me, spared my life, but overwhelmed by the violence of the blow I lost consciousness and was thrown into the depths of the sea. Aftet a loog while, recoveriog my senses, I returned to Lanka. Though my life bad been spared, yet my companions, who went to mine aid were all slain by the child **RAMA** of imperishable deeds, who proved himself a master in the science of archery. " If, setting me aside, thou dost pit thyself against him, then thou shalt surely draw down an immediate, dreadful and inescspable retribution, not to be eschewed. " The titans who know of nought but diversions and enter tainments of every kind and who dream only· of assemblies and festivities will be plunged in fruitless misery. " On account of **SITA**, the City of Lanka, with its temples and palaces, encrusted with every kind of gem, will be razed to the grouod under thine eyes. " Even those who are pious and innocent, suffer for the misdeeds nf others through their contact, as fish in a snake infested lake. " Their limbs perfumed with divine sandal-paste, weariog celestial ornaments, thou shalt see the titans lying on the earth on account of thy folly. Tbe survivors with their consorts, save those who have been horne away, will Bee in all directions, unable to find refuge. Under a hail nf arrows, ringed in flames, thou shalt see the edifices of Lanka burnt to ashes. " O King, there is no greater sin than consorting with another’s wife ; thou bast thousands of concubines in thy train; therefore, cleaving to thy lawful consorts, preserve thy line, thine honour, fortuoe, kingdom and thy life. If thou desirest to live happily with thy wives and friends, do not enter into conflict with **RAMA**. " If, despite my friendly counsels,

thou dost bear **SITA** away by force, then thou and thy kinsmen, together with thine whole army will surely descend to the region of Y ama under Ramo’s deadly shafts.”

CHAPTER 39

Maricha again seeks to dissuade Ravana from pursuing his Design

" **O** RAVANA I have told thee how my life was spared; now hear what happened further. " I was in no way daunted by this event and, accompanied by two demons, I entered the forest of Dandaka disguised as a deer. There I roamed about living on the flesh of ascetics, visiting the sacred retreats, the sacrificial fires and places of worship, sowing terror amongst the sages, whom I persecuted. Growing exceedingly rapacious, I slew those ascetics, drinking their blood and devouring their flesh, my cruelty rendering me the terror of all the inhabitants of the forest. " As I roamed here and there throwing obstacles in the way nf the religious rites, I encountered **RAMA** living a life of asceticism with the blessed **SITA** and the mighty **LAKSHMANA**, engaged in pious practices and devoted to the welfare of all. " Filled with contempt for the mighty Rams, who had retired to the forest, and reflecting : ' So he has now become an ascetic,' I, remembering my former defeat, filled with anger, rushed at him with lowered horns, in my folly desiring to kill him. But he, swift as Supama or Anila, drawing his great bow, loosed three sharp and deadly arrows, and these dread shafts with burnished points resembling lightning, flew off as one, thirsting for blood. “Knowing Rams’s skill and prowess from former times and .recognising the peril in which I stood, I ran away and escaped, but the two titans who

accompanied me were slain. Having with supreme difficulry evaded Rams's arrows thus preserving my life, I retired to this place, adopting the path of an ascetic and practising *Yoga*. From that day, I behold Rams, clothed in bark, wearing a black antelope skin, bearing his bow, in every tree, like unto the God nf Death himself carrying his noose I In my terror, I see thousands of Ramas, O **RAVANA** I The whole forest assumes the form of **RAMA** and even in 8z deserted places I behold him ! O Chief of the Titans, in sleep also he appear to me and I start up in fear. Such is the terror he inspires in me, that even those words beginning with the syllable 'Ra ', such as 'Ratna " and 'Ratha ',' fill me with alarm. " Having recognized the prowess of that descendant of Raghu, I am persuaded that thou art not able to withstand him in combat, when even Bali and Namuchi succumbed to him. Whether thou dost enter into conflict with him or makest thy peace, do not speak his name to me, if thou wouldst see me live! " In this world, there are countless virtuous souls engaged in the practice of *Yoga*, fulfilling their every duty, who yet perish with those about them through another's fault. I too, therefore, should be doomed to die for another's misdeeds ! O Ranger of the Night, do what thou deernest to be right, but follow thee I will not. Truly **RAMA**, who is full of zeal, courage and prowess, will prove to be the destroyer of the titans of this world. Though the wicked-minded Khara of J anasthana was slain by him on account of Shurpanakha, how, in truth, is he to blame for that ? " I have uttered these words for thy good and the good of thy kinsmen ; if thou disregardest them, thou and thy people will assuredly perish in combat with **RAMA** ! "

CHAPTER 40

Ravana's Wrath

to this salutory discourse, replied in harsh and ill-considered accents, saying : " Thou Wretch, what thou hast spoken will bear no fruit, as seed that is sown on barren soil comes to nought, nor will it alter my determination to enter into combat with Rams, who is but a witless and insignificant creature. " In thy presence I shall bear away the beloved wife of **RAMA**, the slayer of Kbara, who has renounced father, mother, kingdom and friends for a woman of no account. O Maricha, my mind is fixed ; neither Gods nor titans nor **INDRA** himself can alter my resolve. “It is proper, when asked, to put forward the advantages and disadvantages of a project and what will best serve or injute a putpOSe; a wise minister, questioned by his sovereign, seeking his master’s good, will answer with due deference, standing before him with joined palms, in words fitting to the occasion, but a gloomy discoutse does not please a monarch, who, having regard to his dignity, is thereby affronted. " Kings of limitless power represent the five Gods : **AGNI**, **INDRA**, *Soma*, **YAMA** and **VARUNA**, symbolising ardour, valout, gentleness, retribution and forgiveness ; therefore at all times they should be honoured and revered. Thou, nevertheless, disregarding thy duty, dost only manifest arrogance. Thou to whom I have come as a guest hast treated me as a miscreant. I have not consulted thee regarding what is expedient or proper, O Titan, I ask thee for thy suppon in this enterprise. Hear how thou canst assist me. “Assuming the form of a golden d= studded with silver, proceed to Rams’s hermitage and pass to and fro before Vaidehi; after captivating her, thou canst depan. Seeing thee transfonned into a deer by thy magic power, Vaidehi struck with wonder, will instantly call on **RAMA** to

capture thee. When Kakutstha is far away, having left the hermitage, do thou, imitating his voice, utter such cries' as : O **SITA** l O **LAKSHMANA** ! ' " At this call, urged on by **SITA**, Saumitri, in fraternal love, being perturbed, will hastily foUow in Rams's wake. Kakutstha and **LAKSHMANA** being both far distant, I shall bear **SITA** away, as the thousand-eyed God carried off Sachi. Having accom plished this according to my design, I shall confer half my kingdom on thee, O Titan. " O Friend, do thou pursue the path which leads to the success of this enterprise and I will foUow in my chariot, Obtaining possession of **SITA** without a struggle by deceiving Rams, I shall rerum to Lanka with thee, my putpose fulfiUed. 14 " If thou dost not obey me, even against thine inclination, O Maricha, I shall slay thee instantly ! I shall compel thee I None can attain happiness and prosperity by opposing his sovereign's will. Verily by coming before **RAMA** thoy dost risk thy life, but certain death awaits thee if thou opjlOSe me ; therefore reflect carefully on what is most expedi..t, and do what thou deemest proper."

CHAPTER 41

Further Counsels of Maricha to Ravana

THus commanded by the imperious King of the Titans, Maricha replied in bold and fearless tones, saying : " What wretch has counselled thee to take this course, which will lead to thine extinction, together with thy children, thy kingdom and thy counsellors, O Ranger of the Night ? O King, who is that evil person, envious of thy good fortune, who seeks to open the portals of death to thee ? Assuredly he is thine enemy, who in his impotence plots thy defeat under the blows of a superior antagonist. What miscreant of evil intent seeks to propel thee along the

path of self-destruction? The counsellors, who do not dissuade thee from thy fell design, merit death and yet live. Upright ministers ever restrain a king, who following his own desires, enters on an evil path. engaged in their duties, have met with destruction with their relatives through the fault of others. A cruel despot is as unable to protect his subjects as a jackal is unable to defend a herd of deer. The titans, whose lord thou art, foolish, ruthless and a slave td thy passions, are doomed. " It is' not I who should be pitied for this unexpected calamity that has overtaken me, but thou, who with thine artny will soon meet with destruction. Having been struck down by **RAMA**, he will speedily despatch thee. My mission accomplished, I shall meet my death under the blows of thine adversary. Rest assured that I shall perish as soon as I appear before **RAMA** and know well that the abduction of **SITA** will cost thee thy life as well as that of thy kinsmen. " If thou succeedest in beariog **SITA** away from the hermitage with mioe aid, it is the end of thee, of Lanka and of the titans. " Though seeking thy good and desiriog to be of assistance to thee, thou dost disregard my words, as those for whom the last hour has struck do not heed the counsel of their friends." CHAPTER 4::1 Maricha assuming the form of a Deer goes to the Hermilll(fl addressed these bitter words to **RAVANA**, Maricha, full of apprehension, said :-" Let us go, but know that when I come before that warrior furuished with arrows, sword and bow, which he will wield to my destruction, my life is forfeit ! Nay, he who opposes **RAMA** will not return alive ! For thee he will prove the Rod of Death and thou shalt fall beneath his blows. In what way can I further thine evil design ? Yet I will go. May prosperity attend thee, O Ranger of the Night! " Highly gratified by these words, **RAVANA**, embracing him warmly, addressed him in honeyed accents, sayiog : " This magnanimity is worthy of thee; now that thou art williog to accede to my request I know thee truly to be Maricha; heretofore

another demon addressed me. Do thou with me ascend my winged chariot, encrusted with gems, to which

CHAPTER 42

Maricha, assuming the form of a Deer, goes to Rama's Hermitage

engaged in their duties, have met with destruction with their relatives through the fault of others. A cruel despot is as unable to protect his subjects as a jackal is unable to defend a herd of deer. The titans, whose lord thou art, foolish, ruthless and a slave td thy passions, are doomed. " It is' not I who should be pitied for this unexpected calamity that has overtaken me, but thou, who with thine artny will soon meet with destruction. Having been struck down by **RAMA**, he will speedily despatch thee. My mission accomplished, I shall meet my death under the blows of thine adversary. Rest assured that I shall perish as soon as I appear before **RAMA** and know well that the abduction of **SITA** will cost thee thy life as well as that of thy kinsmen. " If thou succeedest in beariog **SITA** away from the hermitage with mioe aid, it is the end of thee, of Lanka and of the titans. " Though seeking thy good and desiriog to be of assistance to thee, thou dost disregard my words, as those for whom the last hour has struck do not heed the counsel of their friends." CHAPTER 4::1 Maricha assuming the form of a Deer goes to the Hermilll(fl addressed these bitter words to **RAVANA**, Maricha, full of apprehension, said :-" Let us go, but know that when I come before that warrior furuished with arrows, sword and bow, which he will wield to my destruction, my life is forfeit ! Nay, he who opposes **RAMA** will not return alive ! For thee he will prove the Rod of Death and thou shalt fall

beneath his blows. In what way can I further thine evil design ? Yet I will go. May prosperity attend thee, O Ranger of the Night! " Highly gratified by these words, **RAVANA**, embracing him warmly, addressed him in honeyed accents, sayiog : " This magnanimity is worthy of thee; now that thou art williog to accede to my request I know thee truly to be Maricha; heretofore another demon addressed me. Do thou with me ascend my winged chariot, encrusted with gems, to which 86 mules with goblins' heads are harnessed. Having captivated Vaidehi in accord with my desire, lly thence, and she, being left alone, will be forcibly home away by me." " Be it so", answered Tataka's son, whereupon **RAVANA** mounted the chariot resembling a celestial car, and !'"lving that solitary place set out with all speed. Looking down on many villages, forests, mountains, rivers, kingdoms and cities, they finaUy reached the forest of Dandaka in which **RAMA**'s hermitage stood. Descending from the golden car, the Lord of the Titans, accompanied by Maricha, beheld **RAMA**'s retreat and taking that demon by the hand, **RAVANA** said to him : " Here is **RAMA**'s hermitage shaded by palm trees ; now accomplish the purpose for which we have come hither." Hearing **RAVANA**'s words, Maricha in an instant transformed himself into a deer and began to pace to and fro before **RAMA**'s hermitage. Assuming a marvellous form, wonderful to behold, the points of his horns studded with gems, his skin dappled, his mouth like a red lotus, his ears azure-tinted, his neck out stretched, his belly of a sapphire hue, his llanks the colour of the Madhuka llower, shining like the filaments of the Kanja llower, his hoofs like emerald, his legs slender and well proportioned, his haunches gleaming with all the colours of the rainbow, that demon in an instant had become a ravishing gazelle of iridescent hue, studded with every kind of gem, of exceeding beauty. The whole forest and **RAMA**'s enchanting retreat were filled with the radiance of that form, wonderful

to behold, that had been assumed by the titan. In order to capture the glances ofVaidehi with his shimmering colours, he strayed here and there in the grass among the llowers. His skin was stippled with hundreds of silver spots, giving him an enchanting appearance, as he wandered about nibbling the green shoots of the trees. Approaching the circle of palm trees, he passed slowly here and there between the Karnikara trees in the hermitage, some times appearing in full view of **SITA**. That charming fawn of many cnlours strayed hither and thither in the vicinity of **RAMA**'s ashrams, coming and going at will, sometimes dis appearing into the distance, then drawing near again, gambolling 87 playfully, thereafter crouching on the earth, or following a herd of deer ; then again it would appear at their head, and by every means this titan, in the form of a gazelle describing a thousand frolicsome circles, sought to attract the attention of **SITA**. The other fawus, approaching, snuffed its scent and then scattered in all directions, but that demon, who formerly had taken delight in slaying them, now, in order not to betray his real nature, abstained from molesting those who approached him. Meantime Vaidehi of brilliant glances was engaged in gathering Bowers, diverting herself in the midst of the Karnikara, Ashoka and Cuta trees that she loved so well. As she wandered here and there plucking the blossoms, that princess of tender looks, who did not merit exile in the forest, saw before her the fawn studded with precious gems, its limbs encrusted with diamonds and pearls. Beholding that doe, with its beautiful teeth and lips, its skin the colour of silver, the slender-waisted **SITA** opened her eyes wide in wonder and delight, and the marvellous fawn, seeing **RAMA**'s beloved consort, continued to pace to and fro before her, illumining the forest. Looking at that deer, never before seen by man, **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, was amazed.

CHAPTER 43

Sita is enamoured of the Fawn

THEN the lovely **SITA**, of fiawless limbs and skin of a pure golden hue, gathering Bowers, beheld that ravishing fawn with gold and silver Banks, and highly delighted called to her Lord and **LAKSHMANA**, who were furnished with weapons, saying : " O Prince, do thou come quickly with thy younger brother ! " Thus she cried again and again, while continuing to watch the deer, and at her call those two lions among men, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** turned their eyes in that direction and beheld the fawn. 88 Astounded, **LAKSHMANA** *exclaimed*:-" Undoubtedly the titan Maricha has assumed the form of a deer. Kings who hunt in the forest, lured by this deceptive shape, are slain by him and, O **RAMA**, this brilliant fawn, whose radiance rivals the sun, is the device of a magician ; such a deer does not exist on earth, O Master of the World, it is an illusion, born of cunning." As **LAKSHMANA** was speaking thus, **SITA** with a delighted smile interrupted him and being wholly captivated by this phantom, said : " O Son of a King, this marvellous fawn has taken possession of my heart; take it captive, O Great Warrior, it will serve as a plaything. Many beautiful creatures, lovely to look upon, range the forest in the vicinity of our hermitage, such as Chamaras, Srimaras and Rikshas, while troops of Prishatas, *Vanaras* and Kinneras disport themselves here, but O Long armed Heroes full of grace and strength, I have never seen a wild creature whose brilliance and gentle nimble ways are equal to this wonderful fawn's. With its slender many-coloured body encrusted with gems, it illumines the whole forest around me with a lustre resembling the moon's. What beauty! What resplendence ! What grace ! What radiance ! This marvellous fawn with its graceful limbs

possesses me utterly. If thou art able to capture it alive, it will prove an object of supreme wonder in the hermitage and when our exile is over it will be an ornament to the palace of the queens. " O Lord ! Prince **BHARATA** and my mothers, seeing this celestially beautiful deer, will be struck with amazement. If thou art not able to capture this wonderful fawn alive, its skin will be most precious, O Lion among Men. I shall delight to sit on its golden hide, strewn with kusha grass. I crave pardon if this cruel wish may seem unworthy of a woman, but the beauty of the deer exciteS my admiration ! " This graceful creature with its golden skin, its horns set with precious gems, shining like the rising sun or the Milky Way, captivated **RAMA** himself, who, hearing **SITA**'s words, yielded to her wish and gaily addressed **LAKSHMANA**, saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, mark how this deer has excited Vaidehi's desire. On account of its supreme beauty this fawn will lose its life to-day. Neither in the forest, nor in the region of Nandana, nor in the solitude of Chaitaratha, nor anywhere on earth does such a· fawn exist. " See how, whichever way its velvety striped skin is brushed, it glistens. When it opens its mouth, its tongue shoots forth like a bright flame in a lit brazier or lightning from a cloud. With its head of emetald and crystal, its belly shining like mother of pearl, whose heart would it not steal away with its indescribable beauty ? Who, on beholding this divine apparition, shining like gold, coveted with every kind of getn, would not be charmed? " It is for food and sport that kings, bearing their bows, hunt wild beasts in the forest, and many treasures of different kinds are found thete by chance, such as pearls, diamonds and gold, increasing man's possessions, surpassing the imagination of **INDRA**, and, O **LAKSHMANA**, this is the wealth spoken of by those who are versed in the Artha-Shastra. "The slender-waisted Vaidehl will sit with me on the fleece of that marvellous deer ; neither the skin of Kadali, Priyaka, Prabeni or Abiki compares in

texture to that of this deer. Truly exquisite, this gazelle and its counterpart' in the heavens are both divine, the one amongst the stars and the other on earth, yet if thou art certain that this is an illusion created by the titan, O **LAKSHMANA**, I will destroy it. That cruel and evil-souled Maricha slew many great ascetics ranging in the forest ; innumerable kings, armed with bows, hunting here, have fallen under his assaults when he assumed the shape of an illusive deer ; let us therefore end his life. "Formerly Vatapi oppressed the Sages here also, and, entering their stomachs, emerged, riving them, as the embryo of a mule may cause the death of its mother. One day that demon encountered the great Sage Agastya, gifted with divine powers and was devoured by him when presented in the form of an offering by his brother Ilwali ; when the repast was concluded that titan called out ' Vatapi come forth' but the excellent Risbi, addressing Ilwali with a smile, said : " ' Since being blinded by thy power, many illustrious sages have fallen victim to thee on this earth ; thy brother is now wholly consumed by me.' " O **LAKSHMANA**, this titan will also be annihilated like Vatapi for having set me at nought, who am fixed in my duty and master of my senses. He shall meet his end, as did Vatapi who defied Agastya. Do thou remain here without absenting thyself and gusrd **SITA** with care. It is our first duty, O Delight of the House of Raghu! I shall either slay that deer or bring it back alive; till I return with the deer, which I shall do without delay, do thou remain here with **SITA**, O Son of **SUMITRA**. She shall have the fawn ; its skin will cost it its life this day. Now keep watch over **SITA** in the hermitage. Till with a single arrow I have brought down this dappled fawn and slain it, do thou stay here, O **LAKSHMANA**, with the mighty raven, J atayu, who is strong and wise and ever engaged in pious acts, and protect Maithili in every way."

CHAPTER 44

Rama slays Maricha

great prowess, girded on his sword in its golden scabbard, and taking up his triply-curved bow, his personal insignia and two quivers filled with arrows, he set forth with long strides. Beholding that lndra among Men, the king of the beasts in fear disappeared only to re-appear once more. Girt with his sword and bearing his bow in his hand, **RAMA** ran in the direction of the deer and beheld it in all its beauty, close to him. Bow in hand, fixing his eyes on the fawn as it fled into the forest, he saw it sometimes taking a single bnund, and then, in order to lure him on, allowing him to draw closer. Timid and fearful, it would leap into the air, at times becoming visible and then disappearing in the depths of the thickets. As in the autumn, stray clouds pass across the moon's face, so that she sometimes shines in all her brilliance and at others 91 seems filr away, so appearing and disappearing, Maricha, in the form of a deer, enticed **RAMA** far from the hermitage. Kakutstha found himself, despite his exertions, thus beguiled aod the fawn, feigning fatigue, would crouch in the grass or, the better to deceive him, join a herd of deer, but when **RAMA** approached, it would take to flight once more, concealing itself, only to re-appear in the distance. Sometimes, in fear, it would make itself invisible, then, with **RAMA** in desperate pursuit, it would appear in a far off thicket. Thereupon increasingly wrath, **RAMA** drew out a death-dealing glittering arrow more brilliant than the sun's rays and placing it firmly on his bow, stretching it with great energy, let fly that shaft that resembled a fiery serpent. Loosing that flaming arrow, which resembled a lightning flash, fashioned by **BRAHMA** himself, that marvellous shaft, pierced the bean of Maricba, who had assumed the

form of a deer. Thereat, bounding into the ait as high as a palm tree, the titan fell mortally wounded and lay on the earth, having but a few moments to live. On the point of death, emitting a terrible cry, Maricha abandoned his assumed form. Recollecring the words of **RAVANA** and reflecting on bow to induce **SITA** to send away **LAKSHMANA**, so that in her isolation she might be home away, Maricha, deeming the moment to be at band, imitating **RAMA**'s voice, cried out" O **SITA**, O **LAKSHMANA** I " Stricken to the bean by that extraordinary arrow, discarding his deer's form, Maricha took on the huge shape of a titan. Then **RAMA**, beholding that titan of formidable size, writhing on the eanb about to die, his limbs covered with blood, remembered the words of Laksbmana and reflected:-" The illusion created by Maricha, spoken of by Laksbmana is manifest, it is Maricha whom I have slain. What will **SITA** not do on hearing the cry of the stricken titan : ' O **SITA**, O **LAKSHMANA**'? To what a pass will the mighty **LAKSHMANA** now have come ? " Thus did the vinuous **RAMA** reflect, his bait standing on end and, having slain the titan in the form of a deer aod beard his cry, a great dread seized him. That dappled fawn being slain, **RAMA** speedily killed aod seized the carcase of another deer and hastened towards the hermitage.

CHAPTER 45

Sita sends Lakshmana to Rama's Assistance

" **D**ost thou not recognise the voice of Raghava ? Go quickly and see what has befallen him. Hearing his cry, my heart is filled with anxiety ; he must be in great peril to call out thus ; go to the assistance of thy brother, he is in need of thee. He has been overpowered by the titans like a bull by lions." Recollecting Kama's command, **LAKSHMANA**

withstood **SITA**'s appeal and did not move, whereupon J anaki, highly provoked, said to him : " O Son of Sumitta, under the guise of affection thou dost show emnity towards thy brother, since thou dost not instantly proceed to his aid ! Because of me, **RAMA** is about to die I In thy desire to possess me, thou dost refuse to follow Raghava; thou dost welcome his death and hast no affection for him. It is for this reason that thou dost remain indifferent to his plight; if he is in peril, of what use is my life? It is on his account that I came hither." Thus, weeping and overcome with grief, did Vaidehi speak, and **LAKSHMANA** answering her, who was ttembling like a frightened doe, said : " O Vaidehi, neither serpents, titans, celestial beings, Gods, giants nor demons can overcome thy lord. Assuredly, O Princess, among Gods and Kinneras, wild beasts and goblins, there are none who can stand against **RAMA** in battle. O Beautiful One, he who is equal to **INDRA** is invincible. Do not speak thus I I dare not leave thee alone in the forest without **RAMA**. "Even the Three Worlds and the Gods, with **INDRA** Himself at their head, meeting **RAMA** in combat, would be overcome by him, therefore calm thyself and banish all fear. Thy lord will soon return, having killed the marvellous deer ; that voice 93 is assuredly not his, nor that of a God ; it is an illusion, like the city of the Gandharvas and has been produced by the titan. " O Vaidehi, thou hast been left io my charge by the magnani mous **RAMA**. O Fair One, I dare not leave thee here alone. We are an object of hatred to the titanS aioce the slaying of Khara and the destruction of Janasthana. The titans are able to siroulate the voices of others io the great forest and delight io doiog so io order to trouble the virtuous. O Vaidehi, have no anxiety ! , At these words, **SITA**, her eyes fiashiog with anger, answered: " O Thou Evil-hearted Wretch, Obloquy of thy Race, who delightest io **RAMA**'s misfortune! Is it a source of wonder that a villain such as thou, perverse, whose motives are con

cealed, should speak thus io the hour of **RAMA**'s distress ? By an excess of perfidy, thou hast accompanied **RAMA** to the forest and, practising guile, lusteth after me, while assuroiog the fortn of a friend I Or hast thou been engaged by **BHARATA** as his agent? Thy desigo as also **BHARATA**'s, shall not succeed, O Saumitri ! How should I desire another after serviog the lotus-eyed **RAMA** as my lord ? Rather would I yield up my life io thy presence, O Saumitri ; without **RAMA**, I cannot maintaio life on this earth for an iostant." Heariog these cruel words, causiog biro to shudder, **LAKSHMANA**, the master of his senses, with joioed palma answered her, saying : " It is not for me to gaiosay thee ; thou as a goddess to me. An ill-considered utterance from a woman causes no surprise. Negligent io her duty, fickle and peevish, woman is the cause of dissension between father and son ; truly I am unable to endure these words of thioe that pierce my ears like fiamiog darts, O Daughter of **JANAKA** I O Vaidehi, may all the inhabitants of the forest bear witness that to my re spectful address thou hast responded with such bitterness I It will go hard with thee this day for haviog set me at nought, I, who am obedient to the behests of mine elder brother I May all the Deities protect thee, O Lady of Large Eyes I Sioister portents present themselves to me I May I find thee safe when I return I " At these words, the daughter of J anaka began to weep and scalding teatS bathed her countenance as she answered : " If I am separated from **RAMA**, I shall cast myself into the rivet Godaveri ! O **LAKSHMANA**, I shall hang myself or enter into the fire, but I shall never approach any man other than Raghava!" Thus protesting before **LAKSHMANA**, **SITA**, distraught, beat her breast with her hands and lamented. In the filce of her despair, **LAKSHMANA**, distressed, sought to comfort her, but she refused to answer the brother of her lord, whereupon he, bending low before her, set out to rejoin **RAMA**, looking back again and again.

CHAPTER 46

Ravana approaches Sita

STUNG by **SITA**'s bitter words, **LAKSHMANA**, in his ardent desire to rejoin his elder brother **RAMA**, set out without further delay. Thereupon **RAVANA**, in the guise of a mendicant, availing himself of the opportunity, rapidly approached the hermitage with the purpose of seeking out Vaidehi. With matted locks, clad in a saffron robe and carrying a triple staff and loshta, that highly powerful one, knowing **SITA** to be alone, accosted her in the wood, in the form of an ascetic, at dusk when dark ness shrouds the earth in the absence of the sun and moon. Gazing on **SITA**, the consort of **RAMA**, **RAVANA** resembled Rahu regarding Rohini in the absence of Shasi. Beholding that monstrous apparition, the leaves of the trees ceased to move, the wind grew still, the turbulent course of the river Godaveri subsided and began to flow quietly. The ren-headed **RAVANA**, however, profiting by **RAMA**'s absence, drew near to **SITA** in the guise of a mnnk of venerable appear ance while she was overcome with grief on account of her lord. Approaching Vaidehi in an hnnourable guise, as Saturn draws near to the Chitta star, **RAVANA** resembled a deep well 9S overgrown with grass. He stood thete gazing on the glorious consort of **RAMA** of incomparable beauty, **SITA**, with her brilliant lips and teeth, her countenance as radiant as the full moon, seated on a carpet of leaves, overwhelmed with grief, weeping bitterly. On seeing the Princess of Videha alone, clad in a yeUow silken sari, whose eyes resembled lotus petals, the titan, struck by Kama's arrow, joyfully accosted her, feigning the gentle accenrs of a *brahmin*. Praising her beauty, unequalled in the Three Worlds, which caused her to resemble Shri, he said: " O Thou,

possessed of the brilliance of gold and silver, who art clad in a yellow silken sari and who, like a pool of lilies, art wreathed in garlands of fresh flowers, art thou Lakshmi bereft of her lotus or Kirti or a nymph of graceful aspect ? Art thou Bhuti of slender hips, or Rati disporting herself in the forest ? " How even, sharp and white are thy teeth, how large thy slightly reddened eyes with their dark pupils, how weD pro portioned and rounded are thy thighs and how charming thy legs, resembling the tapering trunk of an elephant ! How round and plump are thy cheeks, like unto the polished fruit of the Tala trees ; how enchanting is thy bosom, decorated with pearls ! " O Lady of Sweet Smiles, lovely teeth and expressive eyes, as a river sweeps away its hanks with irs swift current so dost thou steal away my heart, O Graceful One. Slender is thy waist, glossy thine hair, thy breasts touching each other enhance thy loveliness ; neither the consorrs of the Gods, the Gan dharvas, the Y akshas nor the Kinneras can compare with thee. 'Till this hour, I have never seen any on earth so perfect ; thy youth, thy beauty and thy grace are unequalled in the Three Worlds ! " Seeing thee dweUing here in solitude distresses my heart. Come with me ! It is not fitting that thou shouldst remain here ; this place is frequented by ruthless demons, who are able to assume different forms at will. It is for thee to reside in sumptuOus and delightful palaces in the vicinity of pleasant cities, surrounded by groves of sWeet smelling shrubs and 96 green trees, where thou canst wander clad in beautiful robes, decked in fragrant garlands, with a consort worthy of thy beauty, O Charming One. O Dark-eyed Lady of Sweet Smiles, art thou wedded to one of the Rudras, the Maruts or Vasus ? Thou appearest divine to me, yet these are not the haunts of the Gandharvas, *Devas* or Kinneras, but of the Titans. How haat thou come here ? " Dost thou not fear to live amidst monkeys, lions, tigers, deer, wolves, bears, hyenas and leopards ? O Fair One, dost thou

not tremble before those terrible elephants, maddened with the exudation of temporal juices, in this great forest ? Who art thou ? To whom dost thou belong? For what reason dost thou range the Dandaka Forest alone, which is frequented by terrible titans ? " With these flattering words did the evil-minded **RAVANA** address **SITA**, and seeing him in the guise of a *brahmin*, she entertained him with the traditional hospitality due to an uninvited guest. Leading him to a seat, she brought water to wash his feet and offered him food, saying :-" Be pleased to accept this repast ! " Seeing him in the form of a Twice hom with his loshta and saffron robe, unrecognizable in his disguise, **SITA** welcomed him as a ttue *brahmin*, saying : " Be seated, O *Brahmin*, and accept this water for washing thy feet, also this meal, composed of ripe fruits and roasted grain, prepared for thee, which please enjoy." Thus did she receive him with hospitable words, but **RAVANA**, his gaze fixed on the Princess of Mithila, determined to bear her away, thus preparing his own destruction. **SITA**, anxiously expecting the retum from hunting of her illustrious lord, with Prince **LAKSHMANA**, searched the vast and darkening forest with her eyes but was unable to see either **RAMA** or his brother there.

CHAPTER 47

The Conversation of Ravana and Sita

TM CotlfJBTsation of **RAVANA** and **SITA** THUS addressed by **RAVANA** in the guise of a mendicant, who had resolved to bear her away, **SITA** reflected : ' This person is my guest and a *brahmin* ; if I do not answer him he may curse me ! ' and thinking thus, she said: " May good betide thee ! I am the daughter of the high souled **JANAKA**, the

King of Mithila, my name is **SITA** and I am the beloved consort of **RAMA**. For twelve years, I dwelt in the palace of Ikshwaku, where all my desires were gratified and I enjoyed every comfort. “In the thirteenth year, the king with the approval of his ministers decided to enthrone **RAMA**. All being ready for the installation of Raghava, **KAIKEYI**, one of my mothers-in-law, requested a boon of her lord. Having gtatified my father-in law by her services, she extracted two promises from him, the exile of my husband and the installation of her son **BHARATA**, saying:-' I shall neither eat drink nor sleep if **RAMA** is enthroned and it will prove the end of my life.' " The Lord of the Earth, my filther-in-law, hearing her speak thus, offered her diverse gifts, but **KAIKEYI** refused them. At that time, my lord was twenty-five years old and I eighteen. Being loyal, virtuous, honourable and devoted to the good of all, my lord, **RAMA**, endowed with long arms and large eyes, was renowned throughout the wnrld. Our father King **DASARATHA**, blinded by passion, in order to please **KAIKEYI**, did not install **RAMA**, and when he came before his sire, in order to receive the crown, **KAIKEYI** addressed the following bitter words to him :-" O **RAMACHANDRA**, hear from me the decree issued by thy father. This great kingdom is to be given to **BHARATA** and thou art to dwell in the forest for fourteen years. Now go hence, and save thy sire from the sin of perjury.” " Then the imperturbable **RAMA** *replied*: ' So be it ' and acted accordingly. My lord of firm vows, accustomed to give 98 and not to reccive commands, who ever speaketh truth without prevarication, hearing these words acquiesced and hss fulfilled his vow to the uttermost. His brother, the valiant **LAKSHMANA**, a Lion among Men and the companion of **RAMA** in combat, the Destroyer of his Foes, given to asceticism, bearing his bow, followed **RAMA** into exile with me. " Thus Raghava, fixed in his vow, wearing matted locks, accompanied by myself and his younger brother,

penetrated into the depths nf the forest of Dandaka. We have all three been banished from the kingdom by **KAIKEYI** and, depending on our own strength, wander about in the forest. Remain here awhile, O Foremost of the Twice-born, my lord will soon return with an abundance of roots and fruit and sufficient venison, having slain deer, kine and boar. But thou, O *Brahmin*, tell me who thou art and what thy name, family and lineage. Why dost thou range the Dandaka Forest alone? " Hearing the words of **SITA**, the consort of **RAMA**, the mighty titan replied in these harsh words : " O **SITA**, I am that **RAVANA**, King of the Titans, in fear of whom the world, the Gods, titans and men tremble. O Source of Delight, since I beheld thee shining like gold, clad in silk, my consorts have ceased to find favour with me. Do thou become the chief queen of those coundess women, stolen away from many quarters by me. " Lanka, my capital, set in the midst of the sea, is built on the summit of a hill. There, O **SITA**, wander with me in the groves and thus forget the forest. O Lovely One, if thou dost become my wife, five thousand servants adorned with diverse ornaments shall attend on thee." The blameless daughter of **JANAKA**, being thus addressed by **RAVANA**, was filled with indignation and answered that titan with contempt, saying : " I am dependent on my lord, **RAMA**, who is as steadfast as a rock, calm as the ocean and equal to Mahendra himself, **RAMA**, endowed with evecy good quality, who resembles the Nyagrodha tree in stature. I am dependent on that illustrious and noble warrior, whose arms are long, whose chest is broad, whose gait is like a lion's, nay, who resembles that king of beasts ; to him, the greatest of men, I give my whole allegiance. H To **RAMA**, whose countenance resembles the full moon, the son of a king, master of his passions, of immeasurable renown and power, I shall ever remain faithful. "O Jackal, thou desirest a she-lion but art no more able to possess me than grasp the light of the

sun I Thou Wretch, who seekest to carry off the beloved spouse of Raghava ! Verily thou dost imagine the trees that thou seest before thee to be made of gold, that thou art seeking to draw the teeth of a famished and courageous lion, that enemy of the deer, or extract the fangs of a poisonous snake. Dost thou desire to lift up the Mandara mountain with thy bare hands or Jive at ease after drinking poison ? Thou dost seek to rub thine eyes with a needle and lick a razor with thy tongue ! Thou desirest to cross the ocean with a stone round thy neck or grasp the sun and moon. O Thou who seekest to bear away the beloved wife of **RAMA**, thou art endeavouring to carry a blazing fire in thy robe or walk on iron spikes. " The disparity between thee and **RAMA** is as that between a jackal and a lion, a brook and an ocean, the nectar of the Gods and sour barley gruel; between gold and iron, sandal and mud, an elephant and a cat, an eagle and a crow, a peacock and a duck, a swan and a vulture. Even shouldst thou steal me, if that mighty archer, **RAMA**, whose prowess is equal to the Lord of a Thousand Eyes, still Jives, thou wilt no more be able to devour me than a fty can eat the clarified butter into which it has fallen." Addressing that cruel Ranger of the Night thus, the guileless **SITA** shook like a leaf in the wind. Perceiving her distress, **RAVANA**, terrible as death, began to boast of his race, his power, his name and his exploits, in order to increase her fear.

CHAPTER 48

Sita defies Ravana

PROVOXED by **SITA**'s proud words, **RAVANA**, scowling, answered her in fierce accents : " O Lady of Fair Complexion, may prosperity attend thee I I am the brother of the Lord of Wealth, my name is

RAVANA. I am the mighty Daahagriva from whom, as all crearures befure death, the Gods, Gandharvas, Pisachas, Patagas and Nagas flee in terror. I have subdued my blood-brother Kuvera, who for a certain reason I incited to combat and who, vanquished by me, lied in alarm from his sumptuous abode and sought refuge on Kailasha, the Lord of Mountains. " By virtue of my prowess I robbed him of his marvellous chariot, Pushpska, that moves according to one's will, and in it I range the skies. Seeing my dread visage, the Gods with **INDRA** at their head flee in terror, O Maithili. Wheresoever I roam, the wind blows temperately and the rays of the sun resemble the moon's. Where I stay, the leaves of the trees become motionless and the rivers cease to flow. " Beyond the sea stands my magnificent capital, Lanka, inhabited by powerful titans, equal to **INDRA**'s citadel, Amaravati. " That beautiful stronghold, encircled by dazzling battle ments with gnlden ramparts and gates of emerald, is a city of dreams. " Filled with elephants, horses and chariots, echoing to the sound of bugles, it is embellished by pleasant gardens planted with diverse trees, yielding fruit of every desirable taste. O **SITA**, OThou Daughterofa King, in that city thou shalt dwell with me, forgetting the lot of mortal women. There thou shalt taste celestial delights ! O Lady of exquisite countenance, think of **RAMA** no more, who is but human and whoae end is near. Placing hia beloved son on the throne, King **DASARATHA** aent hia heir of negligible prowess to the forest. What wouldst thou with that **RAMA**, deprived of hia kingdom, living as an ascetic in solitude, O Large-eyed Beauty ? I, the Lotd of all the titans, have come to thee in person, pierced by the shafts of the God of Love. It does not befit thee to disregard me. O Timid Lady, if thou dost pass me by, thou wilt repent, like Urvashi, who thrust away Puraravas with her foot. Rams is but a mortal and not equal to even a finger of mine in combat. By good fortune I have come to thee ; do thou

therefore yield thyself to me, O Fair One.” At these wotds, Vaidehi, her eyes flashing with anger, though alone, answered that Lotd of the Titans boldly, saying: " Since thou claimest to be the brother of the God, Kuvera, who is held in veneration by all the Celestials, how dost thou dare to commit this infamous deed, O **RAVANA** ? Undoubtedly all the titans will meet with destruction, having so cruel, senseless and lustful a person as thee as their sovereign. The ravisher of **INDRA**’s consort, Sachi, may survive, but he who bears away the wife of Rams will never live in peace. O Titan, it were possible for the one who deprives the Bearer of the Thunderbolt of his consort of unsurpassed beauty to live on earth, but he who insults me will never escape death, were he to drink the water of immortality ! "

CHAPTER 49

Sita's Abduction by Ravana

Speech, addressed her, saying : " Methinks thou hast taken leave of thy senses, hast thou not heard of my great prowess and valour ? Standing in space, I am able to lift up the earth ; I can drink the waters of the ocean and destroy death himself in combat. With my shafts I can pierce the sun and cleave the terrestial globe. Thou, who dost allow thyself to be deceived by any trick and dost follow any whim, behold how I can change my shape at will.” Speaking thus, **RAVANA**, full of wrath, his eyes glowing like burning coals, resembled a ftame, and discarding his benign aspect, he, the younger brother of Kuvers, assumed a terrible sbape, resembling death itself. With smouldering eyes, a prey to anger, resplendent in ornaments of fine gold, like a dark cloud, tbat Ranger of the Night appeared before her with his ten heads and twenty arms.

Abandoning his ascetic disguise, the King of the Titans took on his native form ; wearing a blood-red robe, he fixed tbat pearl among women, Maithili, with his gaze, thereafter address ing her, who resembled the sun, whose hair was dark and who was clothed in a robe and jewels, saying : " O Fair Lady, if thou desirest a master famed throughout the Three Worlds, then surrender thyself to me. I am a husband worthy of thee ; do thou serve me forever ! I sball do thee great honour nor will I ever displease thee. Re nouncing thine attaclunent to a man, place thine affection on me. Wbat binds thee to Rams, O Thou Foolish One who deemest thyself wise ; he who has been banished from his domain, who bas failed to fulfil his destiny and whose days are numbered, Rams, who on the injunction of a woman aban doned kingdom, friends and people to inhabit a forest frequented by wild beasts ? " Speaking thus to Maithili, who was worthy of tenderness and gentle of speech, tbat wicked titan, inflamed by passion, seized hold of her as Budba seizes Rohini. With his left band he grasped the bair of the lotus-eyed **SITA**, and with his right, ber thighs. Seeing **RAVANA** with his sharp teeth like the peak of a mountain, resembling death itself, the Celestial Beings fied away in terror. Then instantly the great chariot belonging to **RAVANA**, made of gold, to which braying mules were harnessed, appeared and, addressing **SITA** in barsh tones, he lifted her up and, clasping her, ascended the car. Then the virtuous and unfortunate **SITA**, being overpowered by the titan, begsn to cty aloud, " **RAMA** ! **RAMA** ! " but he was far away in the depths of the forest. Though she possessed no love for him, **RAVANA**, burning with passion, rose high into the air with her, as she struggled like the consort of the **INDRA** of Serpents. Seeing herself borne through the air by the King of the Titans, **SITA** with piercing shrieks, distracted with anguish, aied out : " O **LAKSHMANA**, thou long-armed warrior, ever ministering to the

satisfaction of thy superinrs, dost thou not know that I am being carried away by a titan able to assume any shape at will ? O Raghava thou, who art willing to renounce life and happiness in the cause of duty, dost thou not see that I have been borne away by one of unsurpassed wickedness ? O Thou, the Scourge of Thine Enemies, art thou not accustomed to punish evildoets ? Why dost thou not subdue the arrogance of this wicked titan? It is true that an evil deed does not bear fruit immediately, but time causes the grain to ripen. “For this outrage, bereft of thy senses by fate, thou shalt, O **RAVANA**, meet with a terrible retribution, bringing about thine end. Alas ! The designs of **KAIKEYI** are crowned with success, since I, the virtuous consort of **RAMA** am separated from that hero. I invoke Janasthana and the 1lowering Karni kara trees, so that they may tell **RAMA** speedily that **SITA** has been home away by **RAVANA** ! I appeal to the Godaveri river, that re-echoes to the cry of cranes and swans, to inform **RAMA** that **RAVANA** has stolen **SITA** away! Offering salutations to the forest Deities, I call upou them to tell my lord of mine abduc tion ! I beseech all creatures, whatever they may be, whether beast or bird or those that inhabit the forest, to make these tidings known to **RAMA** and to tell him that his tender spouse, dearer to him than life, has been forcibly horne away by **RAVANA**. Were death himself my ravisher, that mighty-artned one, hearing this report, would rescue me by his prowess ! " In the extremity of her grief, the large-eyed **SITA**, uttering this lament, observed the vulture **JATAYU**, perching on a tree. Thereupon beholding him, the beautiful **SITA**, home away by **RAVANA**, who was filled with camal desire, cried out in piteous tones: " O Noble **JATAYU**, see how I am being ruthlessly carried off by the wicked King of the Titans, like a woman bereft of her protector. Thou wilt not be able to resist him, for this cruel and evil Ranger of the Night is powerful, arrogant and furnished with weapons. Nevertheless, O Bird,

do thou bear the tidings of mine abduction to **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** and tell them all, omitting nothing." CHAPTER SO **JATAYU** att4tks Ratana JATAYU, who was fast asleep, awoke on hearing these words and beheld **RAVANA** and the daughter of Videha. Thereupon, the King of Birds, with his sharp beak resembling the peak of a mountain, perching on the tree, spoke softly to **RAVANA**, saying : " O Dashagriva, I am conversant with the Puranas, firm in my vows, and follow the path of *dharma*. O Brother, it does not become thee to commit this infamy in my presence ! My name is **JATAYU**, the King of the Vultures ; she whom thou dost seek to bear away is the beautiful **SITA**, the faithful and illustrious conson of the ProteCtor of the Worlds, that Lord of Men, **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, who is equal to **VARUNA** and Mahendra and ever engaged in the welfare of all beings. "How can a king, fixed in his duty, look upon another's wife ? O Thou of mighty prowess, it is for thee particularly to defend the consons of kings, therefore control thy base inclination to insult the wife of another. A noble person will ever eschew that which may bring reproach on him, and protects another's wife as if she were his own. " O Delight of Poulastya, whether it concerns that which is expedient or agreeable, in the absence of the authority of the scriptures, men of honour follow the example of a king in matters of duty. A king represents duty, a king represents desire and is the supreme ueasucy of his subjects ; he is the root of good and evil. " O King of the Titans, thou art wicked and fickle by nature; how hast thou obtained a kingdom, like unto a sinner winning the celestial abode ? It is haed for an unruly and passionate man to change his nature ; noble counsels are not long remem bered by perverse persons. Since the mighty and virtuous **RAMA** has never done a wrong in thy kingdnm or capital, why dost thou seek to provoke him ? Is **RAMA** of irreproach xos

CHAPTER 50

Jatayu attacks Ravana

CHAPTER SO **JATAYU** att4tks Ratana JATAYU, who was fast asleep, awoke on hearing these words and beheld **RAVANA** and the daughter of Videha. Thereupon, the King of Birds, with his sharp beak resembling the peak of a mountain, perching on the tree, spoke softly to **RAVANA**, saying : " O Dashagriva, I am conversant with the Puranas, firm in my vows, and follow the path of *dharma*. O Brother, it does not become thee to commit this infamy in my presence ! My name is **JATAYU**, the King of the Vultures ; she whom thou dost seek to bear away is the beautiful **SITA**, the faithful and illustrious conson of the ProteCtor of the Worlds, that Lord of Men, **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, who is equal to **VARUNA** and Mahendra and ever engaged in the welfare of all beings. “How can a king, fixed in his duty, look upon another’s wife ? O Thou of mighty prowess, it is for thee particularly to defend the consons of kings, therefore control thy base inclination to insult the wife of another. A noble person will ever eschew that which may bring reproach on him, and protects another’s wife as if she were his own. " O Delight of Poulastya, whether it concerns that which is expedient or agreeable, in the absence of the authority of the scriptures, men of honour follow the example of a king in matters of duty. A king represents duty, a king represents desire and is the supreme ueasucy of his subjects ; he is the root of good and evil. " O King of the Titans, thou art wicked and fickle by nature; how hast thou obtained a kingdom, like unto a sinner winning the celestial abode ? It is haed for an unruly and passionate man to change his nature ; noble counsels are not long remem bered by perverse persons. Since the mighty and virtuous **RAMA** has never done a wrong

in thy kingdnm or capital, why dost thou seek to provoke him ? Is **RAMA** of irreproach xos able action to blame if he slew tbe wicked Khara in Janastbana on account of Shurpanakha ? Why dost thou seek to bear away the conson of tbat Lord of Men ? Release Vaidehi this instant, lest, witb his dread glance resembling a glowing brazier, he consume tbee, as **INDRA** reduced Vrirra to ashes witb his tbunderbolt. " O **RAVANA**, tbou an unwittingly carrying a highly venomous serpent in tby robe ; without discerning it, tbou an wearing the noose of deatb round tby neck. A man should only bear tbat weight which will not crush him and eat only tbat which does not give rise to sickness. Who will engage himself in an act which is neitber praisewonhy, just, nor honourable, and which will cost him his life ? " O **RAVANA**, I am sixty tbousand years old and have ruled over tbe domain of mine ancestors witb justice. I am exceed ingly aged, tbou an youthful and furnished witb a bow, annour and arrows, mounted on a car, yet tbou shalt not escape without injury, if thou seekest to bear Vaidehi away. Thou shalt no more be able to cony her away by force in my presence, tban it is possible to destroy tbe wisdom of tbe Veda by logic. " If tbou an not afraid, O **RAVANA**, tben halt an instant and fight ! Tbou shalt fall on the eanh as Khara before tbee I Ramo, clad in robes of bark, who more than once vanquished the Daityas and Danavas in tbe field, would soon have slain tbee in combat. As for me, what can I do ? The two princes are far away and undoubtedly tbou an fleeing in all haste in fear of tbem, Tbou Wretch! Yet while I still live, tbou shalt not bear away tbe lovely **SITA**, the beloved consort of Ramo, whose eyes resemble tbe petals of tbe lotus. Even at the risk of my life I shall render this service to tbe magnanimous Ramo, as if to King Dasaratba himself. Stay ! Stay I O Dashagriva, reflect but for a moment. O **RAVANA**, I shall hurl tbee from tby great chariot like a ripe fruit from its stalk I O Prowler of tbe Night, I challenge tbee to fight to the last.”

CHAPTER 51

The Combat between Jatayu and Ravana

anger, fell upon him and a terrible struggle ensued in the sky, resembling clouds impelled by the force of the wind; in that conftict **JATAYU**, King of Vultures, and **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, resembled two vast winged mountains. Then **RAVANA** began to shower innumerable steel-pointed shafu on the mighty King of the Vultures, but he, the chief of those whose wings are their chariot, received them unmoved and with his feet and sharp talons that foremost of birds inflicted countless wounds on the titan. Thereupon Dashagriva, filled with fury, anxious to destroy his adversary, taking out formidable shafts, equal to the God of Death, drew his bow up to his ear and pierced the vulture with those arrows, whicb, flying straight at their target, penetrated it with their steely points. Seeing the daughter of **JANAKA**, her eyes bathed in tears, in the titan's car, **JATAYU**, disregarding those shafts, hurled himself at his opponent and, with his claws that valiant prince of the feathered tribe broke that bow decorated with pearls and gems and the arrows also. Thereupon **RAVANA**, transported with anger, seized another bow and covered him with a hail of hundreds and thousands of arrows. Buried beneath those shafts, **JATAYU** resembled a bird in its nest, but flapping his wings, he broke through that cloud of arrows and with his sharp claws snapped that mighty bow ; with a stroke of his wings he shattered **RAVANA**'s blazing shield, that resembled fire, and brushed aside the flaming darta that encompassed him. Then **JATAYU**, in that conflict, slew the swift-coursing mulea with demons' heads, harnessed with gold, and demolished the chariot of **RAVANA**, furnished with a triple standard of bamboo staves, whicb was driven by

thought alone, bright as tire, its steps studded with precious gems. With a single movement of his wiDgs, **JATAYU** struck down the canopy, like unto a full moon, with the chowries and the titans who wielded them. His bow shattered, bereft of his chariot, horses and charioteer, **RAVANA** sprang to the ground, clasping **SITA** to his breast. Seeing **RAVANA** descend, his car destroyed, all beings voiced their delight and ptaised the King of the Vultures again and again, paying obeisance to him. **RAVANA**, however, perceiving that winged hero to be failing through exhaustion and age, greatly encouraged, rose high into the air, clasping the daughter of J anaka to him. Though without a bow, his other weapons being broken in combat, possessing his sword alone, he clasped Janaki passionately to his breast. Then the King of the Vultures darted towards him, barring his passage, and said to him : " O Insensate One, thou art carrying away the beloved consort of **RAMA**, radiant as lightning; it is to thy perdition that thou bast brought about her abduction. Like thirsty men drinking water, thou art swallowing poison, with thy friends, kinsfolk, ministers, artny and people. Those who through want of discrimination fail to foresee the consequences of their acts soon perish, as thou too shalt meet thine end. Caught in the noose of death, whither wilt thou fiee ? Thou art like unto the fish that swallows the hook as well as the bait. Assuredly those two invincible heroes, Offspring of the House of Raghu, will not brook the violation of their domicile. The deed that thou hast basely committed will be denounced by the world, as the path frequented by brigands is eschewed by honest people. If thou art not a coward, fight, O **RAVANA**, or pause an instant and thou shalt lie dead on the earth, as did thy brother Khara. Truly thou art engaged in that which will prove thy destruction, as one on the brink of death com mits an impious deed. Those actions leading to evil are not undertaken even by the Lord of Creation, Swyambhu Himself.” Uttering

these harsh words, the valiant **JATAYU** swooped on the ten-headed demon and, seizing him in his claws, tore his fiesh like the rider of a restive elephant. Infiicting deep wounds, he plunged his beak into his back and tore his hair Io8 with his talons. Thus assailed by the Vulture King, the titan, trembling with rage, pressing Vaidehi to his left side, foaming with anger, struck **JATAYU** with the palm of his hand, whereupon the mighty vulture **JATAYU**, the Destroyer of his Foes, hurled himself on Dashagriva and with his beak tore off his ten left arms. His arms being severed, in an instant as many others sprang up again, like serpents issuing from an ant heap, spirting furth poison. Then, in his anger, the mighty Dashagriva released **SITA** in order to beat off the King of the Vultures with his fists and feet, and a mighty struggle arose between those two intrepid com batants, the Chief of the Titans and the Foremost of Birds, until **RAVANA**, drawing his sword, cut off the wings and feet of **JATAYU**, piercing the side of that champion of Ramo. The Ranger of the Skies having sundered the two wings of that King of Vultures, J atayu fell to the earth, at the point of death, and seeing him on the ground, bathed in blood, Vaidehi, exceed ingly distressed, darted towards him, as to one of her own kin. Then the Lord of Lanka beheld that noble bird of exceed ing prowess, with his yellow breast and plumage resembling a dark cloud, lying on the earth, like an extioguished torch, whereupon the weeping **SITA**, daughter of **JANAKA**, whose couotenance was like uoto the full moon, pressed that winged creature, victim of the wanton **RAVANA**, to her breast.

CHAPTER 52

Jatayu being slain, Ravana resumes his Flight

O Kalrutstha, O Laksbmana, basten to mine aid I " Thus did that lovely woman cry in her terror, as if they could hear her, and the Chief of the Titans, **RAVANA**, continued to pursue her, who, far from her protectors, bearing a faded garland, was calling for aid. Clinging to the trees like a twining creeper, crying : " Save me I Save me ! ", she ran hither and thither pursued by the King of the Titans. Bereft of Raghava, who was far away in the forest, she was calling " **RAMA**, **RAMA** I " when **RAVANA**, resembling death itself, to his destruction seized her by the hair. At this outrage, the whole universe of animate and inanimate beings trembled and a profound darkness covered all. The wind grew still, the sun dim, and the Grandsire of the World, Swyambhu Himself, through his divine power seeing **SITA** overcome, exclaimed : " Our purpose is accomplished ! " Perceiving violent hands laid on **SITA**, the illustrious Sages inhabiting the Dandaka Forest, recognising that the destruction of **RAVANA** was now assured, were filled with joy ! The Lord of the Titans, however, laying hold of **SITA** who was weeping and crying out : " **RAMA** ! **RAMA** ! O Laksbmana!" ascended with her into the air. Of the hue of molten gold, attired in a yellow sari, that daughter of a king resembled lightning athwart the clouds ; her silken robe, streaming in the wind, lent **RAVANA** the sem blance of a blazing volcano, and the coppery and fragrant lotus leaves, falling from Vaidehi of incomparable beauty, covered him. Her yellow silken robe floating in the air resembled a cloud illumined by the setting sun, but her pure countenance, as she was being transported through space far from **RAMA**, had lost its radiance, like a lotus detached from its stalk. Resembling the moon that rises from the heart of a dark cloud, **SITA**, her fair brows crowned with lovely locks, appeared like a lotus in fiower that had lost its brilliance. With her sharp and brilliant teeth, glorious eyes, well formed nose, sweet mouth and ruby lips, she resembled the

moon, lovely to look upon, and transported through the air IIO in **RAVANA**'s lap, her face, bathed in tears, shone as faindy as does that orb during the daylight hours. The golden-hued **SITA** seen against the dark-bodied titan looked like the girth of gold encircling an elephant. Like unto the yellow lotus, the daughter of **JANAKA** with her shining ornaments irradiated **RAVANA** as lightning illumines a thunder cloud, and accompanied by the clashing of her jewels the King of the Demons appeared like unto a muttering cloud. As **SITA** was being borne away, the petals from her hair fell in a shower on the earth, and this rain of blossom, caused by **RAVANA**'s rapid flight, covered him also, as a wreath of stars encircles Mount Meru, and suddenly her anklet, encrusted with pearls, struck the earth like a flash of lightning. Like rosy twigs she covered the dark limbs of the King of the Titans with a radiance equal to the golden girth of an elephant and, as a mighty meteor illumines the heavens with its splendour, so was she borne through the air by the younger brother of Vaishravana. Her jewels, flashing like fire, fell tinkling on the earth, where they broke into pieces, like meteors falling from the firmament, and her chain of pearls, bright as the moon, fell from her breast, emitting a blaze of light, like the Ganges falling from heaven. The trees, sheltering a myriad birds, buffetted by the following wind that swayed the topmost branches, seemed to whisper " Fear not ! " and the lakes, carpeted with faded lotuses, filled with fish and stricken aquatic creatures, appeared to be weeping for Maithili as for a friend. Rushing in wrath from all sides, lions, tigers and other beasts and birds followed **SITA**'s shadow, and the mountains too, with their cataracts like faces bathed in tears, their crests like arms upraised, seemed to lament for **SITA**, as she was being borne away. Beholding Vaidehi carried through the air, the glorious sun, oppressed with sadness, lost its brilliance and became but a pale disc. “There is neither

justice, equity, nor truth, nor sincerity, nor kindness, since the consort of Ramo, the Princess of Videha, is being carried away by **RAVANA**." Thus did the assembled beings lament, whilst the young of the wild crcatttres, forlorn and terrified, emitted plaintive cries. Lifting up their eyes, III glassy with fear, again and again, the forest Deities, trembling in every limb, witnessed the anguish of Vaidehi, who was being borne away so cruelly and who was constantly looking towatds the eatth and crying in faint accents : " O **LAKSHMANA**, O **RAMA** ". The guileless Vaidehi, her hair streaming behind her, her ti1aka effaced, was borne away by Dashsgtiva to his own destruction, and Maithili with her beautiful teeth and gracious smile, bereft of her friends, not beholding **RAMA** or **LAKSHMANA**, grew pale and felt herself wholly crushed under the weight of her despair.

CHAPTER 53

Sita censures Ravana

Of fear, her eyes red with tears and indignation, her voice broken by sobs, addressed that ferocious King of the Titans who was bearing her away, in plaintive tones, saying :-, " O Base Wretch, art thou not ashamed of this act ? Knowing me to be alone, thou hast laid hands on me and carried me away. O Sinful Being, thou it was who, seeking to abduct me, didst in the form of a deer lure my lord away by the power of illusion. " The King of the Vultures, that friend of my father-in-law, who sought to defend me, lies slain I Verily thou hast shown great courage, O Last of the Titans ! To thine eternal shame, thou didst not win me in fair fight but without discloaing thy cursed be thou in the world, for thy conduct ! How should any restrain thee who fleest so precipitately ? Halt

but for an instant and thy life is forfeit ! Shouldst thou come within the range of those two Kings of Men, thou wouldst not survive for a single moment even wert thou supported by an army ! As a bird is not able to besr the blazing forest fire, neither couldst thou withstand the least of their shsfts ; therefore, for thine own good, release me instantly, O **RAVANA**! " Provoked by mine abduction, my lord with the aid of his brother will strive to destroy thee if thou dost not let me go. Thine evil intention, on account of which thou dost seek to besr me away, that vile purpose, will never find fulfilment; for even were I never again to see my lord, who is endowed with supreme wisdom and should fall a victim to an enemy, I should not survive long. " Thou dost disregard thine own good and resemblest one who, in his last hour, chooses what is fatal to him ; none who desires his end courts that which will save him. I see the noose of death about thy neck, since thou dost not tremble in this exigency, O Titan. Without doubt, thou shalt see those golden trees, with leaves like shsrp swords and the dreadful river Vaitarani flowing with blood and the terrible forest and Shamali tree, with its flowers of refined gold and its leaves of emerald, bristling with iron thorns.' " Having offered this affront to the high-souled **RAMA**, thou shalt not survive the poison that thou hast swallowed, O Merciless One. Thou art caught fast in the noose of death ; whither wilt thou turn for refuge from my magnanimous lord ? He who, in the twinkling of an eye, without his brother, destroyed

CHAPTER 54

Ravana returns to Lanka with Sita

On the summit of a mountain. Thereupon that lasge-eyed princess of surpassing charms, let fall among them her silken mantle, bright as gold and her rich jewels. Refiecting' May they convey the tidings to **RAMA** , the beautiful **SITA** dropped her cloak and ornaments in their midst. In his anxiety the red-eyed Dashagriva did not observe this proceeding but these excellent monkeys beheld the large-eyed **SITA**, who did not move her eyelids as she was crying out. Then that Lord of the Titans, passing beyond the Pampa lake, his face turned towards Lanka, continued on his way, clasping the wailing Maitlilli. Although experiencing a transport of joy, **RAVANA** in truth was carrying his own destruction in his arms, like a sharp-toothed and poisonous serpent. Coursing through the air, he left behind forest, rivers, mountains and lakes and speeding on like an arrow shot from, a bow he passed over that sanctuary of whales and crocodiles, the indestructible abode of **VARUNA**, the refuge of rivers, the ocean. Beholding **SITA** borne away, the waters became con vulsed and the great serpents and fish were startled. Then the voices of the Charanas and Siddhas could be heard in the sky, saying : " The end of Dashagriva is at hand I ". **RAVANA** however, who symbolised desth itself, bear ing the struggling **SITA** in his lap, entered the city of Lanka. Reaching that capital with its broad and spacious highways, he entered the palace and penetrated into the inner appartments. It was there that the dark-browed **SITA**, a prey to grief and despair, was set down by **RAVANA** in his own domain, as Maya sheds his illusion. ARANY A *KANDA* Then **RAVANA** addressed those demons of dreadful aspect, saying: " Let none look on **SITA** without mine authority ! It is my will that she have pearls, rubies, robes and ornaments to the extent of her desire! Whoever speaks harshly to her, either knowingly or unknowingly, will forfeit his life!" Having spoken thus to the titan women, **RAVANA** left the inner apartment and began to refiect on what more should now be done. Observing eight

valiant, flesh-eating titans, that exceedingly powerful One, blinded by the boon he had received, after extolling their strength and heroism, said to them : " Equipped with every kind of weapon, betske yourselves with all speed to Janasthana, where Khara formerly dwelt and, summoning up your courage, banishing all fear, establish yourselves in that place, which is now a desert on account of the massacre of the titans. A great and mighty army was entrenched in Janasthana, which, with Khara and Dushana, was destroyed in combat with **RAMA**. Since that time, an inordinate rage which I am unable to control has taken possession of me, precluding all rest. I wish to avenge myself on my sworn enemy, nor shall I sleep till I have slain him in fight. In the hour that I bring about the death of the slayer of Khara and Dushana, I shall rejoice, as a beggar on the acquisition of wealth. " Established in Janasthana, keep me scrupulously informed concerning **RAMA** and his movements. Without respite, let the Rangers of the Night take action and constantly strive to bring about **RAMA**'s end. Being acquainted with your valour, which I have often witnessed in the field, I have chosen you to repair to Janasthana." Hearing these flattering and significant words of **RAVANA**'s, those titans, bowing down to him, left Lanka in a body and took the direction of]anasthana in all haste, having first made themselves invisible. But **RAVANA**, having secured Mithila's daughter and brought her to the palace, though he had thus incurred the hostility of **RAMA**, gave himself up to transports of senseless joy. us

CHAPTER 55

Ravana implores Sita to become his Consort

Sidered that he had prepared himself for every eventuality. Brooding on Vaidehi, sorely pierced by the shafts of the God of Love, he hastened to his sumptuous apartments, inllamed with desire for her presence. Entering there, Ravaua, the King of the Titans, observed **SITA** overcome with grief, surrounded by titan women, like a ship foundering in the sea at the mercy of a storm or a gazelle separated from the herd beser by hounds. Then **RAVANA** approaching that princess, whose head was bowed and who was disconsolate, compelled her to view that mansion resembling the abode of the Gods, containing many storeys and spacious apartments, inhabited by innumerable women and enriched by countless gems, whilst flocks of birds filled it with their carolling. Graceful pillars of gold, ivory, crystal and silver, encrusted with emeralds and diamonds could be seen and celestial gongs resounded there. **RAVANA**, in company with **SITA**, ascended the magoificent golden stairway, ornamented with burnished gold. Those lofty buildings possessed excellent windows of gold and ivory covered with golden trellises, and their marble floors were inlaid with precious stones that shed their lustre everywhere. Then Dashagriva showed Maithili the fountains and pools covered with lotuses and every kind of flower ; all this did he bring to the notice of **SITA** who was overcome with grief; and after directing Vaidehi's attention to the splendours of the palace, that perverse wretch, with the intention of seducing her, said: " O **SITA**, apart from the aged and the children, ten thousand titans, rangers of the night, all of whom are famed for their exploits, acknowledge me as their lord, and each among them n6 bas placed a thousand loyal servants at my disposal. This entire smte, as also my life, is thine, O Large-eyed Lady. Thou art dearer to me than life itself! O **SITA**, become the queeo of those numerous excellent women who are my wives. O Beloved, be my coosort, it is to thine advantage. What boots it to consider aught else, do

thou give my proposal thy consideration ; it behoves thee to look favourably on me, who am burning with desire. " Surrounded by the ocean, this city of Lanka, extending for a hundred yojanas, can never be mken by storm, even by the Gods themselves with **INDRA** at their head. Among the Celestials, Yaksbas, Gandharvas and Nagas, I can see none in all the worlds equal to me in prowess. Deprived of his kingdom, without possessions, dedicated to ascetic practices, travelling on foot, what canst thou hope from **RAMA**, a mere man without resources ? " O **SITA**, I am a consort worthy of thee, do thou accept me ; youth soon passes, O Darling ; enjoy these delights with me. O Lady of charming mien, do not think of seeing Raghava again. How could he come hither even in thought ? Who can fetter the impetuous wind in the sky or seize the pure llame of a brazier? None in the Three Worlds may snatch thee from mine arms. Do thou rule over this vast empire of Lanka and all beings, animate and inanimate ; even I and the Gods shall be thy servants. Laving thyself in the crystal waters, be happy and live in delight. Thy former evil *karma* has been expiated by the time passed by thee in the forest. It is here that thou wilt be able to pluck the fruit of thy good deeds. In my company, O Maithili, enjoy these garlands with their divine fragrance and these magnificent ornaments. With me do thou disport thyself in the aerial chariot Puskpaka, bright as the sun, that was once Vaishravana's, which I won by my prowess in combat, that vast and beautiful car, swift as thought. " Thy countenance, llawless and lovely to look upon, pure as a lotus, is wan on account of sorrow and has lost its radiance, O Lady of lovely limbs and gracious features." Whilst he was speaking, the beautiful Sim covered her face that sparkled like the moon with the hem of her robe and Thereat the sinful **RAVANA**, that Ranger of the Night, addressed **SITA** who was sunk in thought and forlorn, het cheeks pale on account of grief, saying : " O Vaidehi, do not

fear to contravene *dharma*; the cere mony that shall coosecrate our union is sanctioned by the Veda ! I press thy tender feet with my heads ; grant my prayer speedily ! I am thy slave and ever obedient to thee I May these words, inspired by the torments of love, not prove fruit less ; never before has **RAVANA** bowed his head before a woman.” Having spoken thus to Maithili, the daughter of **JANAKA**, Dashagriva undet the sway of destiuy, thought : " She is mine I.,

CHAPTER 56

Sita is guarded by the Titan Women

HEARING these words, Vaidehi, though still distressed, ceased to tremble and placed a blade of grass between herself and **RAVANA**, saying : " King **DASARATHA**, the indestructible rampart of justice, whose piety brought him renown, had a son, Raghava. Famed in the Three Worlds, that virtuous one, possessed of powerful arms and large eyes, is my God and my lord. It is he, that hero, born in the House of Ikshwaku, illustrious, possessing shoulders like unto a lion’s, who, with his brother Laksbsnana will rob thee of thy life ! " Hadst thou laid violent hands on me in his presence, he would have compelled thee to refrain and would have slain thee in single combat, even as he slew Khara himself in Janasthana. Those titans of grim visage, whom thou dost extol to me, valiant though they be, would be deprived of their power in Raghava’s presence, as serpents yield up their poison before Supama. Those gulden shafts, loosed from the string nf Rams’s bow, would pierce their bodies, as the Ganges bears away het hanks ! Though thou mayest not be slain by us *Asuras* or Gods, now that thou hast incurred the fury of Raghava, thou wilt not escape alive. " Thou hast but

a short time to Jive ! Raghava will compass thine end ! That life which thou deemest impossible to lose is as a beast's bound to the sacrificial stake ! If **RAMA** lets fall on thee his glance inllamed with ire, thou wilt instantly be consumed, O Titan, as Mamatha by Rudra ! He, who is able to bring down the moon from the skies and destroy it or dry up the ocean, is assuredly able to deliver Sits. Thy life, thy prosperity, thy being and faculties are forfeit; Lanka, bereft of its inhabitants, will be left desolate through thy fault. Nay, this outrage will bring thee nought but misfortune, O Thou who in the absence of my lord didst bear me away by force, never more wilt thou know felicity ! "My illustrious lord, accompanied by his brother, depend ing on his own energy, does not fear to Jive in the Dandab Forest. Thy prowess, thy strength, thine arrogance and thy presumption, will all be wiped out under the rain of his shafts in battle. When the hour, appointed by destiny for the destruction of beings, is at hand, they become mad under its sway. Mine abduction presages thine end and that of the titans and of those dwelling in the inner apartments. As an untouchable may not approach the sacred altar, furnished with ladles and vessels of worship at the time of sacrifice, so the legitimate spouse of one fixed in virrue, faithful to his vows, may not be approached by a sinner such as thou, O Last of the Titans! " How should a royal swan, sporting amidst the tufts of lotuses with her mate, concern herself with a cormorant on the bank? Bind or destroy this insentient body', I have neither desire to preserve it nor my life, O Titan, for I will never submit to dishonour." After speaking thus in her wrath, causing the blood to freeze, Vaidehi became silent, and **RAVANA** answered her in menacing tones, saying : " Reflect well, O Lovely Princess ; if thou dost not yield to me within the perind of twelve months, my cooks shall cut thee to pieces for my morning repast." ..... Having spoken thus, **RAVANA**, the Challenger of His Foes, exceedingly

wroth, addressed those female titans in these words: " Ye terrible demons of ferocious aspect, who subsist on fiesh and blood, do ye instantly crush the pride of this woman! " When he had said this, those monsters of fearful aspect, joining hands, surrounded Maithili, and **RAVANA** commanded those women, formidable to look upon, who walking struck the earth with such force that it shook, saying : " Do ye take Maithili to the centre of the Ashoka grove, and there, encircling her mount guard over her secretly, and some times by menaces and at others by soft speech seek in every way to break her will, as one would a female elephant." Thus commanded by **RAVANA**, those titan woman, taking hold of Maithili, dragged her to the Ashoka grove which was planted with trees covered with dowers of every kind and many fruits, able to satisfy every desire, where birds disported themselves in love. And, as a gazelle in the midst of tigresses, **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, her limbs giving way under her despair, fell under the sway of those titans. Like a timid antelope taken in a snare, Maithili, the daughter of **JANAKA**, overwhelmed with grief and fear, could find no relief. And threatened by those terrible monsters, the Princess of Mithila, unable to rest, remembering her lord and beloved brother-in-law, under the weight of terror and sorrow, swooned away.

CHAPTER 57

Rama sees terrible Portents

Cry raised by Maricha in the guise of a deer, imitating my voice, if heard by **LAKSHMANA**, may cause him to leave **SITA** in order to come to mine aid ! It may be that the titans have resolved to slay **SITA** and for this reason Maricha, in the form of a gazelle, lured me away ! Having

brought me a great distance, that titan fell a victim to my shafts and feigning my voice, cried out : ' O **LAKSHMANA**, I am slain ! ' Is all well with them, deprived of my presence in the forest? On account of Janasthana, I have rendered myself hateful to the titans, and many and dreadful are the portents I now see around me." Reflecting thus on hearing the jackals' cries, **RAMA** hurriedly made his way towards the hermitage, pondering on the means adopted by the titan in assuming the form of a deer to lure him far away from his dear ones. Directing his steps towards Janasthana, his heart filled with apprehension, he observed the birds and beasts passing to his left, emitting fearful cries, and witnessing these dreadful signs Raghava beheld **LAKSHMANA** approaching, pale of mien. Already a prey to anxiety, **RAMA** became even more distressed on seeing his brother thus cast down. Observiug that he had left **SITA** alone in the solitary wood frequented by titans, taking **LAKSHMANA** by the left hand, he spoke to him in a gentle voice, in sad and reproachful tones, saying: " Ab ! **LAKSHMANA**, thou hast done wrong to come hither, leaving **SITA** unprotected. O My Friend, how can this prove auspicious? Assuredly the daughter of **JANAKA** has been slain or even devoured by the titans who range the woods I Since so many evil portents have appeared to me, O **LAKSHMANA**, I question whether we shall find **SITA**, the daughter of Janab, alive, O Lion among Men I Since this multitude of beasts and jackals are emitting fearful cries and the birds also, as they lly towards the south, I fear that all is not well with that ldng's daughter, O Hero of great prowess ! " That titan, wearing the form of a deer, deceived me and drew me far from the hermitage. Having slain him with difticulty, at the point of death, he revealed himself to me in his true form. My heart is heavy and bereft of all delight, and my left eye throbs. Undoubtedly, O **LAKSHMANA**, **SITA** is no longer there and has either been carried away or is dead or lost in

the forest.”

CHAPTER 58

Rama's Lament

SEEING **LAKSHMANA**, cast down and dejected, approaching without Vaidehi, the vinuous son of **DASARATHA** enquired of him, saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, where is Vaidehi, who followed me to the Dandaka Forest and whom thou hast left alone to come hither? Where is that one of graceful fonn, the companion of my misfortune when I was banished from my kingdom and, dispirited, roamed the Dandaka Forest; where is **SITA**, without whom I cannot live for an instant, my life’s companion, who resembled a daughter of the Gods ? “O Hero, separated from that daughter of **JANAKA**, whose skin was like gold, I have neither a desire for the sovereignty of the Gods or the eanb. O **LAKSHMANA**, **SITA** is dearer to me than life itself. O Saumitri, has my banishment been rendered void ? If, on account of **SITA**, I should die and thou return to the city alone, will it not prove the consummation of **KAIKEYI**’s desires and she find felicity ? Will not **KAUSHALYA**, her son dead, become the abject slsve of **KAIKEYI** when, having accom plished her design, she rules the dominion with her son ? If Vaidehi still lives, I will rerum to the hermitage, but if my virtuous spouse be dead, I shall yield up my life, O **LAKSHMANA**! If on returning to the *ashrama* the daughter of Videha, whose words were ever preceded by a smile, does not speak to me, I shall renounce my life. " Tell me, O **LAKSHMANA**, ifVaidehi is living or no, or whether in consequence of thy leaving her that unfortunate creature has been devoured by the titans. Alas l The wretched **SITA**, so tender and fragile, never having experienced

unhappiness, tza will be wholly desolate in mine absence. Did that titan, full of cunning and craft, crying out ' O **LAKSHMANA** ', inspire thee with feat ? I surmise that V aidehi, heating that cry for help uttered in a voice resembling mine, besought thee to find out what had become of me and thou didst come hither with all speed. Thou hast done an irretrievable wrong in abandoning **SITA** in the forest, thus affording those cruel and ruthless titans an opportunity for avenging themselves. Those flesh-eating demons are aggrieved on account of Khara's death and now, without doubt, have slain **SITA**. Alas ! I am wholly submerged in an ocean of sorrow, O Destroyer of thy Foes ! What shall I do now ; I tremble before that which awaits me ! " Thus immersed in the thought of **SITA**, that paragon among women, Raghava hastened towards J anasthana in company with **LAKSHMANA**. Heaping reproaches on his younger brother, who was over whelmed with distress, tormented by hunger, fatigue and thirst, **RAMA**, sighing heavily, his countenance pale, a prey to despair, entered his hermitage and found it deserted. Returning to the *ashrama*, that hero ran hither and thither where **SITA** was wont to disport herself and, recollecting those haunts where she used to roam, he became distracted, his hair standing on end.

CHAPTER 59

Rama reproaches Lakshmana

" Nay, it was not of myself that I came hither, nor of mine own inclination that I left **SITA** and set out to meet thee, but I was urged thereto by her entreaties to come to thine aid. " The cry, ' O **LAKSHMANA**, save me I ' as if uttered by her lord, broke on Maithili's ears and she, hearing this despairing call, from affection for thee,

weeping and filled with terror, said unto me : ' Go I Go I '. While she thus continued to urge me, repeating 'Go', I spoke to her, seeking to reassure her, saying : ' I know of no titan who can excite Ramo's fear ; lt is not he, but another who calls, O **SITA**. How should that illustrious warrior, the inspirer of awe in the Gods themselves, utter so base and shameful a word as ' save me ' ? Who has imitated the voice of my brother and pronounced these cowardly words and for what motive ? Assuredly it is a demon who, in his extremity, has uttered the cry,' Help!'. O Lovely One, it does not become thee to tremble like a low-born womao ! Take courage, calm thyself and banish thine anxiety. There is none born, nor yet to be bom in the Three Worlds, who is able to triumph over Raghava in the field in open fight. He is incapable of being defeated in combat, even by the Gods with **INDRA** at their head.' " Thus addressed by me, Vaidehi, distracted and shedding tears, uttered these cruel words : " ' O **LAKSHMANA**, in thine extreme perversity thou seekest to unite thyself with me on the death of thy brother but thou shalt never possess me ! It is on **BHARATA**'s instigation that thou hast accompanied **RAMA**, since, despite his despairing cry, thou dost not go to his aid. Concealing thy true purpose, thou hast treacherously followed Ramo for my sake and for this reason dost refuse to assist him.' "Hearing Vaidehi's words, I left the hermitage, my lipa trembling, mine eyes inflamed with wrath." When Saumitri had spoken thus, Ramo, who was distracted with anxiety, said to him : " O Friend, thou hast done a great wrong by coming hither without **SITA**. Thou knnwest well that I am able to defend myself against the titans, yet on account of a hasty word thou didst abandon Vaidehi. 124 " I am not pleased that thou didst leave bet nor that thou hast come here on account of the reproaches of an indignant woman. Submitting to **SITA** and giving way to the impulse of anger has caused thee to contravene the spiritual law and disobey my

command. " That titan who assumed the form of a deer in order to lure me from the hetmitage now lies stricken by mine arrows. Stretching my bow, I placed an arrow on it and loosed it, as it were in sport, laying him low. " Discarding his deer's form and assuming the shape of a titan adorned with bracelets, he emitted cries of agony ; there after feigning my voice, in accents capable of being heard afar off, he called out, and on hearing that sinister cry thou didst abandon Maithili and came hither."

CHAPTER 60

The Search for Sita

auspicious signs, he enquired repeatedly of Laltshmana : " Can all be well with **SITA** ? " Eager to see her again, he quickened his pace and hastened on, but when he reached the hermitage, he found it deserted and, filled with apprehension, began to run hither and thither, searching everywhere. To that descendant of Raghu, his thatched hut, without **SITA**, appeared like a lake bereft oflotuses, shnm of its beauty at the end of summer. Seeing the deserted hermitage, with its trees that seemed to be weeping, its Bowers faded, the deer and the birds melancholy, bereft of charm, wholly desnlate, the forest Deities having forsaken it, the mats and deer-skins lying here and there, the grassy seats withered and trampled upon, **RAMA** began to weep and cry out: us " Hath that timid one been carried away or killed or devoured or is she drowned or has she hidden herself in the forest ? Perchance she has not yet returned from gathering fruit and flowers or she has gone to bring back water from the pools or the river ? " Faint with seeking, without finding any trace of his beloved in the forest, running from tree to tree, scaling the hills, search

ing by river and stream, lamenting the while and overcome with grief, he appeared like one struggling in a morass I " O K.edumbra Tree ", he cried, " hast thou not seen my dear one, who cherished thee ? If thou knowest aught, then tell me where the lovely **SITA** can he found ? O Bilwa Tree I Say hast thou seen her, who wears a silken robe, who is as fair as the young green shoots and whose breasts resemble thy fruit ? Or thou, O Arjuna Tree ! Give me tidings of the one who loved thee, that daughter of **JANAKA**; dost that frail creature still live ? This Kadubha Tree knoweth for certain of Maithili, whose thighs resemble its fruit, and here stands the beautiful Vanaspati enveloped in flowering creepers, buds and leaves, in whose shade the bees hum, undoubtedly thou art the crown of trees ! Surely this Tilaka who loved **SITA** knows where she is now ! O Ashoka Tree, dispeller of grief, prove the truth of thy name and allay the pain pressing on my heart by disclosing my loved one to me without delay. O Tala Tree, have pity on me and if thou hast seen that fair damsel, whose breasts resemble thy ripe fruit, do thou tell me! O Jambu Tree, if thou hast seen my dear love, whose radiance resembles the Jambunada, then speak without fear, and thou, the first of the Karnikara trees, whose flowers are of surpassing loveliness, O Gentle One, say, hast thou seen my Beloved ? " Thus did the illustrinus **RAMA** question every tree, Cuta, Nipa, giant Sala, Panasa, Kuravasa, also Vakula, Punnaga, Candana and Ketaka trees, running hither and thither in the forest like one demented. Thereafter he addressed the beasts, saying: “O Deer, do ye not know where Maithili is to be found, whose eyes resembled a gazelle’s, who with her doe-like glances was followed by the fawns she had tamed ? O Elephant, methinks thou dost know her, whose thighs resembled thy trunk : pray tell me, hast u6 thou seen her ? O Tiger, if thou hast seen my gentle spouse, whose countenance resembled the moon in radiance, then tell me fearlessly. " Why art thou

hiding, O My Beloved ? I see thee, O Lotus eyed One ! Do not conceal thyself amidst the trees without replying ! Stay ! Stay ! O Princess of lovely Limbs, hast thou no pity for me ? Why dost thou mock me ? It is not thy nature to yield thyself to this folly, O Lady of Fair Com plexion, it is vain for thee to fly me, thy yellow sari renders thee easily distinguishable, I have seen thee! Stay, if thou hast any love for me ! Alas ! It is not she—my **SITA** of gracious smiles I Without doubt, she has perished since my grief leaves her unmoved ! " Assuredly that youthful woman has been devoured in mine absence ; **SITA**, with her lovely countenance, exquisite t"\'th and lips, shapely nose and beautiful earrings, whose skin resembles the winter jasmine, has perished, and her beauty is extinguished, as the full moon under eclipse. The slender neck of my well-beloved, of the hue of sandal, adorned with a necklace, has been devoured, like that of one poor and helpless, possessing neither kith nor kin. " O Mighty-armed One, dost thou not see my loved one anywhere? O Where hast thou gone, O **SITA**, O My Lovely One?" Thus did **RAMA** lament, and calling, ran from grove to grove, sometimes turning like a whirlwind, sometimes appearing like one who has lost his wits. Intent on finding his love, ranging the forest, scaling the mountain, exploring the rivers and waterfalls, he sped through the woodlands without rest. Searching on every side without pause, seeking Maithili throughout the forest, hoping to find his Beloved, he became utterly exhausted.

CHAPTER 61

Rama's Plaint

RAMA, the son of Dararatha, lifting up his beautiful arms, uttered these sorrowful words : " O **LAKSHMANA**, where is Vaidehi, where has she gone? O Saumitri, who has carried away or devoured my dearest one ? O **SITA**, if thou hast concealed thyself behind a tree and art mocking me, then bring this jest to an end ; thou hast enjoyed my distress long enough ! O Darling, the young gazelles with whom thou didst play, languish in thine absence, thctr eyes filled with tears. Without **SITA** I cannot live, O **LAKSHMANA**, I am overwhelmed with grief on account of her abduction. To-day I shall rejoin that great monarch, my sire, in the other world, who will reproach me, saying : ' How comes it that thou, having left me in order to redeem my vow, art come hither before the appointed time? O Slave of thy desires, thou art bereft of honour and loyalty, woe unto thee!' " Without doubt, thus will my father address me in the other region ! O Crud One ! distracted as I am and over whdmed with sorrow, thou hast deserted me, as a fair name parts company with a swindler ! O Lovdy Princess, do not leave me! O Slender-waisted Lady, in the abyss in which thou hast plunged me, I shall yidd up my life I " Thus did **RAMA** lament, desiring to behold **SITA** once more, but the uofortunate Raghava could not sec the daughter of **JANAKA** anywhere. Sunk in misery on account of **SITA**, he resembled a mighty dephant trapped in marshy ground in which it has set foot. Then **LAKSHMANA** in his ardent desire to console him said: " O Hero, O Mine of Wisdom, do not grieve I Let us unitedly put forth our endeavours. This hill is famed for its many caves, and Maithili, who, enamoured of the woods often wandered in these thickets, has doubtless ventured into us the deep forest or visited the Jake covered with lotuses in bloom or sbe has gone to tbe river lilled with fisb and frequented by birds of beautiful plumsge. Perchance she has hidden herself in tbe gorge to frighten us and to see if we will search her out. O Lion among Men, let us seek her without delay ! O Fortunate

Prince, if thou deemest her to be somewhere in the forest, we will leave no quarter unexplored; do not grieve, O Kakutstha!" These words of **LAKSHMANA**, inspired by fraternal affection, comfoned **RAMA**, who with Saumitri began to search for **SITA** once more with a tranquil bean. But ranging the woods, hills, rivers and Jakes on every side, searching the plateaus, caves and summits of the mountain, those two sons of **DASARATHA** could not find **SITA** anywhere, and having sought her in every pan of that mountain **RAMA** said to Laksbmana : " I see no trace of the lovely Vaidehi on this mountain, O Saumitri!" Then Laksbmana in great distress addressed his brother, who was endowed with flaming energy, saying:-" It is by ranging the Dandaka Forest that thou wilt be re-uuited with Maithili, the daughter of J anoka, O Sagacious One, as **VISHNU** covered the earth on subduing Bali." Being thus addressed by tbe valiant **LAKSHMANA**, Raghava, whose bean was heavy with sorrow, answered in piteous accents, saying : " The whole forest has been searched with care by us and the Jakes where tbe lotus blooms and this mountain with its many caves and waterfalls also, O Prudent Prince, yet no trace of Vaidehi who is dearer to me than my life's breath can I find." Thus mourning, Ramo, overcome by anxiety, his bean contracted with grief, in an excess of anguish, swooned away. Trembling in every limb, his mind bewildered, stunned and broken, that unhappy prince heaving deep and burning sighs, in a voice strangled with sobs, cried out : " O **SITA**, O My Beloved! " Thereupon Laksbmana, distracted with anxiety, sought to console his dear brother by every means, standing before him with joined palms. But Ramo gave no heed to the words that fell from **LAKSHMANA**'s lips and, not beholding his dear **SITA**, continued to call upon her again and again.

CHAPTER 62

His Despair

IN the absence of **SITA**, the lotus-eyed, righteous and mighty **RAMA**, his mind distraught with suffering, tortured by love for her, though unable to see her, with bitter sighs, reproached her as if she were present, saying : " O Thou, whose youthful flowering is more graceful than the Ashoka branches, do not conceal thyself and increase my pain I O Darling ! Thy thighs resemble the plaintain boughs which conceal thee, yet, O Goddess, thou canst not hide from me ! Laughing, thou hast taken refuge in the Karnikara grove, but enough of this jesting which is tonuring me ! It is not fitting to spon thus in a hermitage, though I know laughter to be natural to thee, O Darling l Return, O Large-eyed Damsel, thy hut is desolate ! " Alas ! It is cenain that those titans have devoured my **SITA** or borne her away and it is for this reason that she does not appear ; she would never mock me thus in my sorrow, O **LAKSHMANA** ! " O Saumitri, observe these deer from whose eyes the tears fall and who seem to say that **SITA** has been devoured by those Rangers of the Night. O Noble Lady, where hast thou gone? O My Chaste One, my Lovely One! Alas! The desires of **KAIKEYI** are fulfilled to-day I I went into exile with **SITA** and shall now return alone. How shall I enter the palace of the queens bereft of her presence ? Will not the people say : ' He is a heartless wretch I ' " By the loss of **SITA**, I shall bear the stigma of cowardice and when my exile is over, **JANAKA**, the King of Mithila, will enquire of me as to our welfare. How shall I answer him ? The Sovereign of Videha, seeing me return without **SITA**, will be overwhelmed with grief on account of her death and become a prey to madness l " No, I will never return to Ayodhya ruled over by **BHARATA**

; heaven itself would prove a desert without **SITA**. Do thou leave me in the forest and return to the opulent city of Ayodhya. As for me, I cannot live anywhere without **SITA**. Embracing **BHARATA** tenderly, say to him in my name: 'It is Rams's command that thou rule the earth.' Making obeisance to our mothers, **KAIKEYI**, **SUMITRA** and Kausbalya, with due respect, protect them with all thy might, taking counsel of the wise. O Destroyer of Thy Foes, it is for thee to recount to them the death of **SITA** and mine own, in every detail." Thus did Raghava lament, while ranging the forest full of distress, far from **SITA** of lovely locks, whilst **LAKSHMANA**, his features blanched with terror, felt himself about to lose his reason in the excess of his grief.

CHAPTER 63

He continues to lament

THAT son of a king, stricken with sorrow and a prey to anxiety, separated from his dear one, having caused his brother distress, fell into deeper and deeper despondency. Sunk in an abyss of grief, **RAMA** with burning sighs and deep groans addressed **LAKSHMANA**, who was overwhelmed with anxiety, in words inspired by his own affiiction, saying: " There is none in the world I deem more wretched than I ; misfortune after misfortune follow each other in uninterrupted succession; it is breaking my heart. Surely, formerly I either designed or executed innumerable evil acts and now their fruit has matured and greater and greater calamities beset me ! The loss of my kingdom, separation from my relatives, the parting from my mother, the remembrance of these things adds to the sum of mine unhappiness. Yet those griefs were forgotten as also the privations of mine exile in the

forest, but now the disappearance of **SITA** re-awakens tbeir memory as an almost extinct brazier suddenly bursts into flame. “My youtbful and timid spouse bas been carried away through the sky by a titan, emitting heart-rending cries un ceasingly in her terror, she who formerly was wont to converse so sweetly. Assuredly the breast of my Beloved, sprinkled with saffron of great price, is now soiled with blood aud dust, yet I still live ! **SITA**, whose speech was gende, clear and sweet, whose beauty was enhanced by her curly locks, bas grown pale, having fallen a prey to the titans and she has lost her radiance, as the moon in the mouth of Rahu. The neck of my beloved aud faitbful consort, decorated with a string of pearls, may even now have been severed by the titans in some desened place, where they are drinking her blood. Deprived of my presence, surrounded by titans in the forest where they dwell aud borne away by them, the unfonunate large-eyed **SITA** will be erying out pitifully like a wounded osprey. " In this valley **SITA** of gracious mien, sitting beside me, addressed thee with gende words and sweet smiles, O Laksh mana. Is she perchance wandering on the banks of this most beautiful of rivers, the Godaveri, so loved by her, but no, she was never wont to walk alone ! She whose face resembled the lotus, her eyes like their petals, has gone to gather water lilies, but how is this possible, since without me she would never gather flowers ? " Has she entered the forest full of blossoming trees, fre quented by flocks of birds of evety kind ? Alas, no! She was too timid to venture fonh alone and would have died of fear ! O Sun, witness of all that takes place on eanh and of every act, be it good or evil, has my beloved wandered away or bas she been abducted ? O tell me, lest I die of grief I O Wind, nothing in the world is unknown to thee; say, bas **SITA**, the flower of her race, lost her way or been carried off, or is she dead?” Thus did **RAMA** lament, a victim to grief and despair, and the valiant Saumitri, fixed in his duty, addressed

him in words fitting to the occasion saying : " O Hero, abandon thy grief and take bean ! Look on the disappearance of thy spouse with detachment and engage with vigour in thy search for her. Men of spirit do not allow themselves to be cast down, even in the face of extreme adversity.” Thus did the highly powerful **LAKSHMANA** speak, despite his distress, but **RAMA**, the foremost of the House of Raghu, paid no heed to his words and once again gave himself up to his great sorrow.

CHAPTER 64

Rama's Wrath

STRICKEN with grief, **RAMA** addressed **LAKSHMANA** in broken accents, saying :-" O **LAKSHMANA**, repair with all baste to the river Godaveri; it may be that **SITA** bas gone thither to gather lotuses.” At these words, **LAKSHMANA** immediately proceeded to the lovely river Godaveri and baving visited the sacred fords, returning, spoke to **RAMA**, saying : " I bave searched all the holy places but I have not seen her anywhere nor does she answer to my call. Where can Vaidehi bave gone ? I do not know where that lady of slender waist can be, O **RAMA**.” Hearing **LAKSHMANA** speak thus, the unfortunate **RAMA**, dis tracted with anxiety, ran to the banks of the Godaveri river and there cried out :-" Where is Sits ? " But neither the spirits of the forest nor the river dared to inform **RAMA** that she bad been borne away by that lndra of Titans who merited death. The Godaveri, recollecting the former exploits of the wicked **RAVANA**, was restrained by fear from imparting wbat was known to her of Vaidehi’s fate. The river’s sUence caused **RAMA** to abandon all hope of seeing **SITA** again and overcome with despair at her disappearance he said to Saumitri : " The beloved

Godaveri bas no answer for me, O **LAKSHMANA**. What shall I say to **JANAKA** or Vaidehi's mother when, returning without her, we meet once more ? Seeing me without Vaidehi, I shall become an object of odium to them. " When, dispossessed of my kingdom, I was forced to live in the forest on wUd fruits, my misery was assuaged by the 133 Princess of Videha. Where is she now ? Far from my kins meo, unable to find Vaidehi, how shall I pass the long nights. without sleep ? " I hsve searched everywhere, by the Mandakini, in Janssthsna and on the mountain Prasravana to find **SITA**. O Hero, observe the wild deer, full of energy, who regard me unceasingly and by their glances seem to wish to communicate with me." Beholding them, that Lion among Men, Raghava, fixing his gaze on them cried :-" Where is **SITA** ? " in a voice broken by sobs. Thus addressed by that Lord of Men, the deer rose and turned their heads towards the south, looking upward, thus indicating the path by which **SITA** had beeo borne away. Thereafter those deer, turning southwards, sometimes fixing their gaze on that Chief of Men and then looking towards the sky, emitted cries, running in front of the two brothers, seeking to attract their attention, and **LAKSHMANA**, understanding their movemeots and their cries, said to his elder brother : " O My Lord, since thou accosted these deer saying : ' Where is **SITA** ? ' they, rising up, have indicated a southerly direction, let us therefore follow thst path ; perchsnce we sball discover some trace of thst noble lady or she herself." " Be it so " answered Kakutsths, directing his step towards the south, followed by **LAKSHMANA**. Thereafter casting his gaze on the earth, he observed some flowers scattered on the ground and, exceedingly distressed, said to his brother: " O **LAKSHMANA**, I remember these flowers, for I gathered them in the forest and gave them to Vaidehi, with these she decorated her hair. Methinks the sun, the wind and the earth have preserved them for my pleasure." Thereafter **RAMA**

addressed the mountain of innumerable torrents, saying : " O Lord of the Hills, hsst thou seen thst princess of lovely limbs, thst gracious one I left in this chsrming grove ? " Thereupon, in tones of anguish he began to threaten thst mountain, as a lion roars in the presence of a deer, and cried out :-" O Mountain, show me thst lady whose skin resembles beaten gold or I will shstter thy crests." Thus questioned by **RAMA** concerning **SITA**, the Princess of fear of **RAVANA** it remained silent ; whereupon the son of **DASARATHA** addressed that rocky mass, saying : "My fiery arrows shall reduce thee to ashes, thou shalt be stripped of thy verdure, thy trees, and thy creepers, and none shall inhabit thee. O **LAKSHMANA**, this river too shall be dried up by me if it does not reveal where **SITA** may be found, whose radiance resembles the full moon in her course." In his wrath, **RAMA** would fain have consumed the mountain with his glance, when suddeuly he beheld the imprint of the titan's foot on the ground and those of Vaidehi, who in her terror had run hither and thither before being dragged away by him. Seeing the marks of **SITA**'s feet and those of the titan, with the shattered bow, two quivers and parts of the chariot, **RAMA**, his heart beating rapidly, said to his beloved brother : " See, O **LAKSHMANA**, the scattered fragments of Vaidehi's ornaments and the many garlands and the drops of blood shining like molten gold covering the earth on every side. It is certain, O **LAKSHMANA**, that the titans who change their form at will, have hewn the body of **SITA** to pieces, which they have now devoured. On account of **SITA**, a terrible struggle has taken place here, O Saumitri. " This great bow, encrusted with pearls, marvellously inlaid, which is broken and lying on the earth, to whom can it belong, O Friend? To what titan or to what God, O My Child, does this golden armour belong, bright as the rising sun, enriched with emeralds and pearls, the pieces of which are strewn on the earth ? Whose canopy is lying here, possessing a hundred staves, decorated with

celestial garlands, its supports broken ? And whose are these mules, harnessed with gold, having goblina' heads, terrible to behold, that have been slain in the fight ? This chariot of war, shining like a flame, which is overturned and broken, to whom does it belong ? These arrows too, a hundred fingers in length, of terrifying aspect, their golden tips blunted, lying in a hundred fragments and the two quivers filled with excellent shafts, whose are they ? " See the charioteer lying on the earth, the lash and reins still in his hands, who was his master ? Without doubt these footprints are those of a mighty titan, O **LAKSHMANA**. Behold 135 how under a thousand guises the bitter hatred of these titans, who are ruthless and able to change their form at will, is made manifest! Alas, the blessed Vaidehi has been carried hence or she is dead and has been devoured ! If vinue was not able to protect V aidebi from being carried away by stealth in the great forest and she has been devoured, O **LAKSHMANA**, how can even the great ones of this world offer me any solace ? The supreme Creator of the Universe Himself, were He to manifest compassion, would be misunderstood and held in contempt by the world, and I, who am by nature gentle, who have subdued my senses and who exercise mercy, desiring the welfare of all, shall be thought wanting in valour by the Gods. "O **LAKSHMANA**, my virtues shall be overshadowed to-day, as thou shalt soon witness, and my wrath be manifest in the destruction of the demons and all created beings ! As the rising sun obscures the splendour of the moon, so will my great attributes be withdrawn and my naked splendour blaze forth; there will be no escape for any in the Three Worlds, neither Y aksha, Gandharva, Pisacha, *Rakshasa*, Kinnera, nor man, O Lakshrnana. Soon shalt thou see mine arrows filling the firmament, the planets stayed in their courses, the moon veiled, lire and wind restrained, the brightness of the sun obscured, the crests of the mountains shattered, the lakes dried up,

creepers and trees uprooted and the ocean drained. " If the Gods do not bring back **SITA** to me, I shall blot out the Three Worlds! Then, O Saumitri they will be forced to acknowledge my prowess! None shall lind refuge anywhere in space, O Lakshrnana ; to-day thou shalt see the universe pass beyond its bournes. With the help of the arrows loosed from my bow, which I shall stretch up to mine ear, no being will be able to survive ; for **SITA**'s sake I shall rid the world nf goblins and demons and the Gods shall wimess the power of these missiles, loosed in my wrath. "The worlds of the Gods, Giants, Yakshas and Titans will be annihilated under the impact of my shafts. With mine arrows I shall shatter the defences of the Three Worlds, if the Gods do not restore Vaidebi to me as she was before she was borne away. If they do not bring back my beloved un 136 harmed, I sball lay waste the entire universe and all contained therein. Until I find myself in **SITA**'s presence once more, I sball let loose every weapon of destruction." Having spoken thus, **RAMA**, his eyes flashing with anger, his lips compressed and trembling, tied fast his robe of bark and deerskin and knotted his hair, whereupon that sagacious One resembled Rudra bent upon the destruction of Tripura. Taking his bow from **LAKSHMANA**'s hands, he drew it with might, selecting a terrible steel-pointed shafr resembling a venomous serpent, and the effulgent **RAMA**, filled with wrath, the Scourge of his Foes, resembling the Fite at the destruction of the world, said : "As beings cannot escape old age, destiny or death, so is none able to restrain my wrath ! O **LAKSHMANA**, if I do not recover **SITA** this day in all her pristine beauty, I sball destroy the universe with its Gods, Gandharvas, human beings, Punnagas and mountains."

CHAPTER 65

Lakshmana seeks to pacify Rama

Of the Worlds. With burning sighs he contemplated the stringed bow, as Hara at the end of the world-cycle stands ready to consume the universe. Seeing **RAMA** transported with rage, hitherto never manifested by him, **LAKSHMANA**, his features pale with terror, addressed him with joined palms, saying : “Formerly thou wert ever gentle, of controlled mind and devoted to the welfare of all beings, do not now give way to wrath and renounce thy true nature. As the radiance of the moon, the brilliance of the sun, the velocity of the wind and the forbearance of the earth, so is thy glory manifested without equal and without end. Wherefore dost thou seek to destroy the worlds on account of one man’s sin ? 137 " It is not yet known to whom this shatteted chariot belongs nor because of whom nor between whom, the struggle, of which we see the traces, took place. This spot bears the marks of wheels and feet and is sprinkled with drops of blood ; it is the scene of a desperate struggle, O Son of a Kiog, but it is a fight between single combatants, O Most Eloquent of Men I I see no trace of a great army and it is not fitting that thou shouldst destroy the worlds on account of one man. " Kiogs should always rule with justice, gentleness and moderation. Thou wast ever the refuge of all beings and their supreme asylum. Who would condone the bearing away of thy consort, O Ragbava ? Rivers, seas, mountains, Gods, Gandharvas and Danavas have no desire to displease thee, even as the officiating priest will not harm the one under taking a sacrifice after he has perfortned the preparatory rites. " O Prince, it is for thee to seek out **SITA**’s abductor, followed by the great sages and by me with my bow. We will search the ocean, the hills, the forests, the deep caves and

innumerable lakes filled with lotuses. We will enquire of the Gods and Gandharvas in every region, until we find the captor of thy consort. If the Chiefs of the Gods do not restore thy wife peaceably, then, O Kiog of Koshala, adopt those measures that thou considcrest fitting. If, through gentleness, humility and prudence, thou dost not regain thy spouse, O **INDRA** among Men, then let loose thine innumerable golden-tipped arrows, resembling Mahendra's thunderbolts."

CHAPTER 66

Lakshmana seeks to inspire Rama with Courage

the son of **SUMITRA**, taking hold of his feet and pressing them, sought to console and comfort him, saying : " By great austerity and innumerable pious acts did the King **DASARATHA** obtain thee, as the Celestiala acquired the 138 Nectar of Immortality. Bound to thee by thy virtues, that great monarch on thy departure returned to the heavenly region, thus have we heard from **BHARATA**. If thou art not able to endure the calamity that has overtaken thee, then how should an ordinary man do so ? " O Chief of Men, take courage ! What living being is not subject to adversity, which approaches like a flame and instantly passes away? Even so is the world. Did not Yayati, the son of Nahusha, fall from heaven overcome by ill fortune? In a single day the great Sage **VASISHTHA**, the chief priest of our sire, was bereft of four hundred sons born to him ; and the Mother of the World, the Earth herself, revered by all, is sometimes known to tremble, O Master of Koshala l The sun and moon, the eyes of the world, the very symbols of virtue by whom all things are ordered, suffer eclipse. Those great beings, the Gods themselves, are subject to fate, O Lion among Men ; how much

more man ? It is said that even **INDRA** and the Gods endure vifissitudes ; it doth not behove thee, therefore, to lament. Even should Vaidchi be dead or carried away, O Raghava, it is not worthy of thee to yield to despair like a common man. Thine equals are never moved even in the greatest perils but look on all with equanimity, O Kakutstha!

CHAPTER 67

Rama encounters Jatayu

AT these apposite words, full of wisdom, uttered by his younger brother **LAKSHMANA**, Raghava, regaiuiug possession of himself, rallied his courage anew. Controlling his wrath, the long armed **RAMA**, leaning on his marvellous bow, said to **LAKSHMANA** :-" O My Friend, what should be done ? Whither shall we go, O **LAKSHMANA** ? How shall we find **SITA** agaiu ? Let us consider these thiugs carefully." To these anxious enquiries, **LAKSHMANA** *answered*:-" It is for thee to search J anasthana which is inhabited by innumerable titans and covered with trees and .creepers of every kiud. There, iuaccessible cliffs, chasms and caves are to be found and dark caverns iuhabited by herds of wild beasts, the retreat of Kiuneras and the resort of Gandharvas ; with me explore these places. As the mountains are not affected by tempest, neither can adversity daunt the wise such as thou, O Lion among Men." Thus speaking, **LAKSHMANA** began to scour the forest, and **RAMA**, still chafing under adversity, advanced holdiug his bow on which was strung a formidable steel-poiuted shaft, when suddenly he beheld **JATAYU**, that excellent King of Birds, resembling a mountaiu peak, lyiug on the earth covered with blood. Seeiug that great vulture, like unto the crest of a mountaiu, **RAMA** said to **LAKSHMANA** : " Without doubt, here is the

titan, who, rangiug the forest under the guise of a vulture, has destroyed **SITA**, the Priucess of Videha ! Haviug satisfied himself by devouring that ilqe eyed priucess, he is resting at ease ; I shall pierce him with my dread and fiety shafts that fly straight to their target." Speakiug thus, **RAMA**, fixing a sharp arrow on his bow, ran towards bim and in his ire it seemed he would destroy the eatth, whose boundaries are the sea. I.fO Vomiting blood, that bird then addressed **RAMA** the son of **DASARATHA**, in the mournful accents of one about to die, saying: " O Thou of long life, that divinity whom thou seekest in tbe great forest, as one does a healing herb,' has been borne away by **RAVANA**, as has my life also. " O Raghava, in the absence of **LAKSHMANA** and thyself, that princess was seen by me, being dragged away by the all powerful **RAVANA**. Flying to the aid of Sits, O Lord, **RAVANA** was thrown to tbe earth by me in the struggle that ensued, and his chariot and canopy shattered. With a stroke of my wing, I slew the charioteer, but being at the end of my strength, my two wings were severed by **RAVANA**'s sword, and he, seizing hold of Sits, tbe Princess of Vidcha, escaped into the air. That titan has left me here to die ; do not slay me, O Prince." Receiving these precious tidings concerning **SITA**, **RAMA**, dropping his great bow, embraced the King of the Vultures, and then, despite his resolve, fell to the ground overcome with grief and began to lament with **LAKSHMANA**. Seeing Jatsyu alone in that perilous and isolated pathway, moaning un ceasingly, **RAMA**, overwhelmed with pity, said to Saumitri : " The loss of my kingdom, exile to the forest, the abduction of **SITA** and the death of this Twice-born, renders my fate such that it would consume fire itself. Even were the sea filled to the brim and I to enter it this day, that Lord of the Rivers would dry up on account of my misfortunes. " Such is the adversity that encompasses me that there is none in all the worlds amongst animate and inanimate beings who is so

wretched as I ! On account of mine evil *karma*, this childhood friend of my sire, the mighty King of the Vultures, lies dying on tbe earth I " Repeating these words again and again to **LAKSHMANA** who accompanied him, **RAMA** began to caress Jatsyu, passing his hand lovingly over tbe body of his father's friend. Thereafter taking the King of tbe Vultures, whose winga were severed and who was bathed in blood, in his arms, he said : " Where has Maithili gone, who is dearer to me than life ? " and having spoken thus, Ragltava sank down on the earth.

CHAPTER 68

Jatayu's Death

IN the presence of the vulture, whom the terrible **RAVANA** had struck down, **RAMA**, full of compassion for all, addressed the son of Saumitri in these words : "This bird, who sought to defend my interests, has been mortally wounded in the struggle with the titan and for my sake now lies dying here. Its vital breaths are barely per ceptible, O Laksbmana, its eyes are dimanditisunabletospeak. " O **JATAYU**, if it be possible for thee, then say what has become of **SITA** and how thou hast come to this sorry pass. For what reason has **RAVANA** carried away my dear one ? How did that radiant and enchanting face, resembling the moon, appear at that time, O Best of the Twice-born. What words did **SITA** utter at that moment ? What is the strength, the appearance and the *karma* of that titan ? Where does he dwell, O Friend, answer me ! " Beholding **RAMA** lamenting like an orphan, the virtuous **JATAYU** answered in feeble accents : " **SITA** has been carried away by that **INDRA** of Titans, **RAVANA**, that evil wretch who resorts to the aid of sorcery and is able to

loose the wind and the tempest. O Dear Child, I being exhausted, that Prowler of the Night severed my wings and, thereafter taking hold of **SITA**, fled in a southerly direction. My breathing is laboured and my sight dim, O Raghava, I see before me the golden trees with leaves formed of Ushira. The hour in which **RAVANA** bore **SITA** away was that in which the loser soon recovers that which is lost, ' Vindya ' is its name, O Kakutstha, and **RAVANA** was unaware of it. Like a fish that swallows the bait, he will soon perish ! Do not, therefore, despair of recovering Janaki; thou wilt soon sport with her, having slain **RAVANA** in battle 1" While the vulture was thus replying to **RAMA**, blood and morsels of flesh flowed from his beak and, on the verge of death, retaining his consciousness, **JATAYU** *added*:-" **RAVANA** is the son of Vishravas and the brother of Vishravana ! " and thereafter yielded up his life. " Speak ! Speak further I " cried **RAMA**, addressing him with joined palms, but the life-breaths, withdrawn from that vulture's body, were already dissipated. Thereupon the King of the Vultures fell on the earth, his legs, body and head stretched out and, beholding that bird resembling a mountain of vast proportions, that bird of reddened eyes, deprived of life, **RAMA**, staggering under the weight of his misfortune, said to Saumitri in bitter tones : " Passing many years happily in the forest, the resort of titans, this bird has at length given up his life ! Having lived innumerable years, he now lies here inanimate! None can withstand the course of destiny ! Behold, O **LAKSHMANA**, this vulture who died in my service having songht to protect **SITA**, and who has been slain by **RAVANA** of superior power. He renounced the dominion bequeathed to him by his ancestors and sacrificed his life for my sake. Undoubtedly the virtuous practise courage, devotion and the fulfilment of duty, even in the animal kingdom, O Saumitri ! I did not feel so keen a grief for **SITA**'s abduction as for the death of this vulture, who has sacrificed

him.elf for me, O Scourger of Thy Foes ! " I hold this King of Birds in the same veneration as I did the illustrious and fortunate monarch, **DASARATHA**, O Saumitri ! Do thou bring fuel that I may ignite the pyre of that King of Vultures, who died for me. Placing the body of that protector of the realm of winged creatures on the funeral pile, who has been destroyed by the cruel titan, I shall cremate it. O King of the Vultures, O Magnanimous Being, cremated and blessed by me, depart, and ascend to those regions, further than which it is not possible to go and which are the abode of those who habitually offer sacrifice, those heroes who never retreat on the battle field and those who distribute land in charity." With these words, the virtu"us **RAMA** placed the King of Winged Creatures on the funeral pyre and, full of grief, ignited the ftame as if perfortning the rite for his own kinsman. Thereafter, the illustrious **RAMA**, accompanied by Saumitri, entered the forest and, killing a few fat Rohi deer, strewed the 143 flesh on the green grass as an oblation to that bird. Tearing off the tlesh of those deer and kneading it into balls, he offered it to the vulture in that pleasant fotest land, placing it on fresh grass. Theteafter, in order that **JATAYU** might soon reach the celestial abode, he recited those sacred formulas uttered by the *brahmins*, after which the two princes repaired to the Godaveri river to offer water in honour of the kingly hird. Following the traditional rites, those two Descendants of Raghu bathed and performed the Udaka ceremony for the King of the Vultures, who, having fallen on the field of battle, had executed a glorious and difficult deed and now, blessed by Rarna, had attained to the place prepared for him in the realm of the saints. Thereupon those two princes, after offering the last rites in honour of that excellent bird, as if to their aire, entered the forest, their minds set on the recovery of **SITA**, like **VISHNU** and Vasava, the Sovereigns of the Gods.

CHAPTER 69

Rama and Lakshmana meet Ayomukhi and Kabandha

HAVING performed the purificatory rites in honour of **JATAYU**, the two princes entered the forest in quest of **SITA**, proceeding in a south-westerly direction. Armed with sword, bow and arrow, those offshoots of the House of Ikshwakn followed a hitherto untrodden path, overgrown with bushes, trees and creepers of various kinds, which was difficult of access, with dense thickets on either side and of sinister appearance; never theless the two mighty warriors pressed on through that vast and dangerous wood. Having traversed Janasthana and covered a further three leagues, those brothers, endowed with great energy, penetrated into the thick woodlands of the Krauncha Forest, which resembled a group of clouds and presented a smiling aspect with its many brilliant flowers and the herds of wild deer and flocks of birds that inhabited it. After exploring this forest, anxious to behold the Princess of Videha once more, sometimes halting to bewail her disappear ance, the two brothers resumed their journey, and covering a distance of three leagues came to the hermitage of Matanga. Having searched the whole forest fiUed with fearful beasts and birds and planted with innumerable trees and dense thickets, the two sons of **DASARATHA** beheld a cave in the moun tain, deep as the region under the earth where eternal darkness reigns. Then those two Lions among Men, approaching that cave, perceived the vast shape of a female titan of hideous appear ance. Fearful of aspect, she was an object of terror to weaker creatures with her loathsome countenance, vast stomach, sharp teeth, immense stature

and harsh voice. This monster subsisted on the flesh of ferocious beasts and now appeared before **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, her hair dis hevelled, and addressed them, saying : “Come let ns pass the time in dalliance together.” There after she laid hold of **LAKSHMANA**, who had preceded his brother and added: " I am named Ayomukhi, I am thine; do thou become my lord, O Hero I Let us give ourselves up to a long life of pleasure on the summits of the mountains and among the islands in the rivers.” Hearing these words, the Slayer of his Foes, **LAKSHMANA**, fuU of wrath, drew his sword and cnt off her ears, nose and breasts. Her ears and nose being severed, that terrible titan ran away with aU speed, and when she had disappeared, the two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, Scourgers of their Foes, hastily pressed on and entered the dense forest. Thereafter the mighty **LAKSHMANA**, fuU of loyalty, charm and nobility, addressed his resplendent brother with joined palms, saying : “I am conscious of a violent throbbing in my left arm and my mind is fiUed with apprehension, whilst on every side I perceive inauspicious omens ; do thou therefore hold thyself in readiness, O Great One, aod foUow my counsel ; these 145 different portents foretell imminent danger. The Vanehulaka bird is emitting fearful cries whieh indicate a speedy vietory for us.” Thereupon the two brothers courageously began to explore the entire forest, when a terrible clamour arose appearing to rend the trees ; such was the uproar that it seemed as though a mighty wind had suddenly swept through the forest. Seeking to ascertain the cause of this disturbance, **RAMA**, armed with a sword, bow in hand, advancing with his younger brother, beheld a titan of vast proportions, possessing huge thighs, standing before him. Headless, his mouth in his belly, covered with bristling hairs, in stature equal to a mountain, his complexion that of a dark cloud, terrible to look upon, his voice resounded like thunder. Shining like a lit toreh, he seemed to emit sparks ; his single eye,

furnished with yellow lids opening in his breast, was strange and hideous and this monster, possessed of enormous teeth, was licking his lips. Despite their ferocity and size, he fed on bears, lions, deer and birds, catching them with his great arms at a distance of four miles. With his hands he seized hold of flocks of birds and herds of deer, whieh he put into his mouth. Having observed them a mile off, he obstructed the progress of the two brothers and stood awaiting them. That colossal, hideous and dreadful creature of sinister aspect, with his trunk and vast arms, fearful to behold, stretching out, seized the two valiant brothers and gripped them with all his strength. On account of his coolness and courage, the valiant Raghava remained unmoved, but Lakshrnana, being a mere stripling and volatile by nature, began to tremble, and that younger brother of Raghava said to him : " O Hero, behold how I have fallen into the power of this titan ; do thon leave me as an offering to the evil forces and go thy way happily; thou wilt soon be re-united with Vaidebi, this is my firm conviction ! O Kakutstha, when thou hast regained the kingdom of thy forbears and art installed on the throne, remember me ! " At these words, uttered by Lakshrnana, the son of **SUMITRA**, **RAMA** *answered*:-" Have no fear, O Valiant One, persons of thy valour arc never perturbed." 146 Meanwhile the headless titan, of huge arms, the foremost among the giants, said to them : " Who are you, whose shoulders resemble a hull's, armed with great swords and bows ? It is fortunate indeed for me that by chance you have come within my range in this dangerous place. Say for what reason you have come here, where I wait ravaged by hunger, ye who are armed with arrows, bows and swords and resemble bulls with pointed horns ? Having approached me, your death is imminent." Hearing the words of the wicked Kabandha, **RAMA**, his face growing pale, said to **LAKSHMANA** : " We have fallen from one danger into a greater one, O Hero ; this ill chance

may cost us our lives without our being able to rejoin our beloved **SITA**. The power of desriny over all beings is inexorable, O **LAKSHMANA** I See, O Lion among Men, how ill-fortune dtives us to the last extremity ; there is nothing that weighs so heavily on man as destiny. Even the brave, the mighty, the great and skilful warriors on the field of hattie, overtaken by destiny, are swept away like banks of sand." Thus spoke that heroic and illustrious son of **DASARATHA**, filled with distress, his eyes fixed on Saumitri, while in his soul his composure was fully established.

CHAPTER 70

Rama and Lakshmana sever the Arms of Kabandha

"We shall soon become the food of this vile demon, who with his vast and powerful arms subdues all beings ; let us with our swords sever his arms with all speed, O Lord, or he will make an end of us. It is shameful for warriors to make away with those who cannot defend themselves like an animal deprived of its freedom that is led to sacrifice." These words infuriated the demon, who opened his terrible mouth wide, preparing to devour them, whereupon the two brothers, choosing a favourable moment, as if in sport cut off his two arms at the shoulders, **RAMA** cutting the right and **LAKSHMANA** with a vigorous stroke of his sword, the left. There upon Kabandha, his vast arms severed, emitting loud shrieks which resounded through the esrth and sky like thunder, fe!l upon the ground. Beholding his two arms severed and the blood flowing in streams, the unfortunate demon enquired of those two warriors in feeble accents :-" Who are you? " Thus accosted, the supremely

courageous **LAKSHMANA** began to extol the virtues of Kakutstha, saying : " This is **RAMA**, the descendant of the House of lkshwaku, known throughout the earth, and I am his younger brother, **LAKSHMANA**. Deprived of his kingdom by the Queen **KAIKEYI**, Ragbava was exiled to the great forest, where he lived with his consort and myself. While this hero, mighty as a God, dwelt in that pastoral retreat, a titan bore away his consort, in search of whom we have come hither. " And thou, who art thou, wandering in these woods emitting tlarnes, thy thighs sunk into thy body ? " On hearing **LAKSHMANA**, Kabandha, calling **INDRA**'s words to mind, answered joyfully : "Welcome to you, O Tigers among Men, beholding you is my salvation; for my good, you have cut off my arms. Do you hear, how, due to mine arrogance, I carne to assume this monstrous shape. O illustrious Ones, I shall relare all to you truthfully."

CHAPTER 71

Kabandha relates his History

KJzbandluJ tells his Story " O LoNG-ARMllD RAMA, formerly I was filled with unimaginable energy and courage ; my beauty was famed throughout the Three Worlds and equal to the sun, the moon and **INDRA** himself. Assuming a terrible form, I became an object of fear to all and struck terror into the hearts of the ascetics living in the forest. " O **RAMA**, on a certain occasion I incurred the wrath of a great *Rishi* named Sthulashira, whom I tormented in this loathsome shape, whilst he was gathering wild fruits. Fixing his gaze on me, he pronounced a terrible curse, saying : 'Do thou retain for ever this fearful form, assumed by thee in order to harm others ! ' " Appealing ro that provoked ascetic to

rescind his curse, he took compassion on me and said : ' When **RAMA** cremates thee in the lonely forest, having severed both thine arms, thou ahalt regain thy great and wonderful form.' " O **LAKSHMANA**, know that I am really the son of Danu, who was extremely handsome to look upon ; my present appearance is due to a curse pronounced by **INDRA** on rhe field of battle. " By rigorous penances I gained the goodwill of **BRAHMA**, and he granted me rhe boon of longevity. Thereafter I was filled with pride and, thinking ' What can lndra do to me now ', I challenged him to combat, whereupon he hurled his mace of a hundred edges at me. By the force of this weapon, my thighs and head were thrust into my body ; I prayed to him to end my life, but he, saying : ' May rhe words of **BRAHMA** prove true ', compelled me to go on living. Then I addressed Mahendra, saying:-' How shall I live without food, since thou hast thrust my head and thighs into my body ? ' 149 " Thereat, **INDRA** caused my arms to extend over four miles and placed a mouth with sharp teeth in my belly. Ever since, stretching out my arms, I wander in the forest and seize hold of lions, tigers and deet and put them into my mouth. Then **INDRA** said to me : ' When **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** cut off thine arms, thou shalt attain heaven '. " Since then, O Great One, I have laid hold on every living being I have found in the forest and have been awaiting **RAMA** to sever my arms ; anticipating this, I have waited for death. Now, O Lord, thou hast come, be thou blessed I None but thou can put an end to my life ; the words of the great *Rishi* have proved true, O Illustrious One. I will put my counsel at thy service, O Bull among Men, and, when I have received the consecration of fire, will form a pact of friendship with you both." At these words of Danu, **RAMA**, in the hearing of **LAKSHMANA**, answered him, saying :-his tired steeds withdraws behind the western horizon cast me into the pit, O **RAMA**, and cremate me according to the traditional rites. "

Cremated by thee with due ceremonial, O Joy of the House of Raghu, I shall tell thee who is acquainted with that titan. It is for thee to seal a pact of friendship with him according to the law. O Raghava, that swift-footed hero will lend thee his assistance. “For one reason or another, he has traversed the Three Worlds and there is nothing in the Universe that is not known to him.”

CHAPTER 72

Kabandha tells Rama how to find Sita

AFrliR Kabandha had spoken thus, those two warriors, the foremost among men, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, sought out a hollow on the mountain-side and ignited a fire. With the aid of glowing brands, **LAKSHMANA** lit the pyre that burst into flame on every side. The vast trunk of Kabandha began to melt in the heat of the fire like a lump of butter, and later the powerful Kabandha, scattering the ashes, rose up from the pyre wearing spodess raiment and a celestial garland, and that handsome demon, his limbs covered with diverse ornaments, ascended a chariot of dazzling beauty drawn by swans, in his splendour illumining the ten regions. Thereafter, standing in the sky, he addressed **RAMA**, saying : " Learn, O Raghava, by what means thou shalt be able to recover **SITA**. There are six expedients’ by which misfortUne may be combated, and in the light of which all things should be considered. He who has fallen into the worst misfortune may find solace if he has someone with whom to shate his lot, but thou and **LAKSHMANA** are deprived of this consolatinn in the calamity that has befallen you through the theft of Sira. O Ranta, thou who art thyself the foremost of friends art in need of a friend. After due retlection, I see no possibility of

success for thee except by this. " Hearken, O Ranta, to what I am about to teU thee. There is a monkey named **SUGRIVA**, who was banished in anger by his brother Bali, the son of **INDRA**. This sagacious and valiant **SUGRIVA** with four of his companions inhabits the lofty mountain Rishyamuka situated on the borders of Lake Pampa. " This Indrs among Monkeys, who is fuU of energy and prowess, of brilliant appearance, loyal, temperate, intelligent and magnanimous, skilful, courageous, wise and powerful, has been banished by his brother for the sake of the kingdom. He will surely prove thy friend and assist thee in thy search for **SITA**. O **RAMA**, do not be disturbed on this account ; that which is destined must come to pass. O Lion among the Ikshwakus, fate is inexomble ! “Do thou go hence with all speed, O Valiant Raghava, and seek out the powerful **SUGRIVA**. Without delay conclude an alliance with him and, swearing mutual loyalty in the presence of fire, unite thyself with that beneficent being. Thou shouldst not disregard that King of the Monkey Tribe, **SUGRIVA**, who is of a gmteful disposition, able to change his form at will and worthy of thy friendship. Thou too wilt be able to accomplish his designs, but benefited by thee or no, he will execute thy purpose. " This son of Rikshamjas’ consort and of Bhaskara, wanders about restlessly on the borders of Lake Pampa and is at war with Bali. Laying aside thy weapons, seek out the retreat of that monkey on the Rishyamuka Mountain witbout delay and enter into a bond of friendship with that inhabitant of the forest. That Foremost of Monkeys is conversant with all the haunts of the ftesh-eating titans in the world and has thoroughly explored their retreats ; there is nothing on this earth that is not known to him, O Raghava. r,a " long as the many-rayed sun continues to shine, O Scourge of Thy Foes, he with his companions will search the rivers, the crags, the inaccessible mountains and the caves for thy consort. He will send out his monkeys of vast stature to scour every

region in order to find **SITA**, separation from whom has rent thine heart. He will seek for Maithili of lovely limbs even in **RAVANA**'s own abode. Should thine irreproachable and beloved **SITA** have been taken to the summit of Mount Meru or abandoned in the nethermost hell, that Lion among the Monkey Tribe, having slain the titans, will restore her to thee."

CHAPTER 73

Kabandha's Advice to Rama

Saying: " This is the path leading westwards to the Mount Rish yamuka, O **RAMA**, abounding in blossoming trees ; Jambu, Priyala, Panasa, Nyagrodha, Plaksha, Tinduka, Ashwattha, Karnikara, Cuta, Naga, Tilaka, Naktamala, Nilashoka, Kadamba, Karavira, Agnimukha, ahoka, Raktachanda, Paribhadraka and many other trees grow there and, climbing or bending them by force, they should be used by you to sustain yourselves on the way with their sweet fruits. " Passing through these flowery woodlands, O Kakutstha, thou wilt reach others resembling the Nandana Gardens, where, as with the northern Kurus, the trees bear fruit and produce honey in every month of the year and every season is represented simultaneously as in the forest of Chaitaratha. There, great trees with mighty branches, bowed under the weight of their fruit, resemble towering clouds on the mountain side. **LAKSHMANA** will climb those trees with ease or pull them down to offer thee the fruit equal in taste to the Nectar of Immortslity. Ranging over those lovely mountains, wander ing from hill to hill and wood to wood, O Hero, ye shall reach the lake Pampa covered with lotuses, free from boulders and 153 gravel, whose level hanks present no crevice and therefore no

danger of falling. O **RAMA**, its bed is sandy and it is covered with ftoatiog lilies ; swans, ducks, herons and ospreys are heard calling sweetly on the waters of that lake ; nor do they fear man, O Raghava, since none has ever hunted there. Do ye feed on these birds, fat as butter, O **RAMA**, as well as on Rohita, Chakratunda and Nala. " O **RAMA**, the devoted **LAKSHMANA** will offer thee diverse and excellent fish, devoid of scale or fin, plump, possessing a single bone, which may be speared with arrows and roasted on the fire. And when thou hast feasted, **LAKSHMANA**, drawing pure water, fragrant with the scent of lotuses, fresh, limpid, sparkling like silver, shall offer it to thee on a lotus leaf. " In the evening, ranging here and there, **LAKSHMANA** will point out to thee the great monkeys who dwell in the woods and in the hollows of the hills, and thou shalt see those wild and savage apes, roaring like bulls, coming to the borders of the lake to drink. “Wandering abroad at dusk, thy grief will be assuaged on beholding the ftowering trees and the auspicious waters of the lake, and thou shalr see the blossoming Tilaka and Naktamala trees with the red and white full-blown lotuses, which will dispel thy sorrow .. No man has ever gathered those blooms nor do the garlands made of them ever fade away, O Raghava, for the disciples of the great ascetic Matanga lived there, who, proficient in penance, laden with the wild fruits they had collected for their Guru, covered the earth with drops of their perspiration from which these ftowers have sprung ; by virtue of their austerities these blooms never die. " Those ascetics have now passed away but there still liveth one who served them, a mendicant woman named Shahari. O Kakutstha, she, who is ever fixed in her duty, is now extremely old and, on beholding thee who art honoured by the whole world, will ascend to heaven. " O **RAMA**, having reached the western hank of Lake Pampa, thou shalt see a lovely, isolated and concealed spot, which is Matanga’s hermitage. There, in

fear of his divine authority, ARANY A *KANDA* of the House of Raghu, where every variety of bird sings and which resembles the Garden of Nandana or a celestial grove, thou wilt be able to rest. " The Risbyamuka mountain, covered with fiowering trees and filled with birds, rises opposite Lake Pampa and is difficult of access, young elephants barring the way. This lofty moun tain was formerly created by **BRAHMA** and a virtuous man who sleeps on its summit and dreams of treasure wiU find wealth on waking, whereas an evil-doer who attempts scale it will be seized by demons while yet asleep. There too, the trumpeting of the young elephants who disport themselves in the Lake Pampa can be heard. O **RAMA**, in that part of the hermitage where Matanga lodged them, wild elephants of vast size, streaming with crimson ichor, rush to the lake, full of ardour, like great clouds; there they slake their thirst in the cool waters, that are limpid, pleasant and extremely auspicious to those who bathe in them and which exhale a sweet fragrance. Having disported themselves, these elephants re-enter the thickets with the bears, panthers and wolves. Beholding them, as also the deer of gentle countenance re sembling sapphire, who are harmless and do not fear man, thy grief will be assuaged. " O Kakutstha, on this mountain, bewo out of the rock is a great cavern, drllicult of access, covered on aU sides with delightful fruits, and at the entrance is a great lake of cool water filled with every kind of reptile ; there the virtuous **SUGRIVA** and his companions dwell, though sometimes he resides on the summit of the bill." Having thus instructed the two princes, **RAMA** and Laksbmana, Kabandha, resembling the sun in brilliance, wreathed in garlands, illumined the heavens with his splendour. Thereupon those two heroes, seeing that blessed One stationed in the sky, spoke unto him, saying :-" Go in peace I " whereto Kabandba answered saying :-" Do ye proceed, ye will achieve your purpose!" Then Kabandba, having

regained his pristine beauty, shining in grace and splendour, fixed his gaze on **RAMA** and spoke

CHAPTER 74

Rama visits Shabari

THE two princes, following the instructions of Kabandba, proceeded along the path to the west leading to Lake Pampa. Wending their way, desirous of finding **SUGRIVA**, they gazed on the many trees laden with flowers and fruit, tasting of nectar, growing on the mountain-sides. Passing the night on a plateau, those two Descendants of Raghu reached the western bank of the Pampa abounding io lotuses and beheld Shabari's pleasant retreat. Approachiog that charmiog hermitage, shaded on all sides by ionumerable trees, they beheld that perfected One who, seeiog them, rose up and with joioed palms touched the feet of **RAMA** and the prudent **LAKSHMANA** and, according to tradition, offered to riose their mouths and bathe their feet. Thereupon **RAMA** addressed that female ascetic, fixed io her spiritual duty, and said :-" Hast thou overcome all obstacles to asceticism, O Thou of gentle speech ? Do thioe austerities iocrease daily ? Hast thou subdued thioe anger and thy need for food ? O Solitary One, hast thou observed thy vows and attained ioner tranquillity ? Has thioe attendance on thy Guru borne fruit ? " Thus ioterrogated by **RAMA**, the virtuous Shabari, revered by the Gods, extremely aged, standiog before him, offered him homage and said : " Blessed by thy presence, I have acquired perfection and my asceticism is crowned. To-day my birth has borne fruit and the service of my Gurus has been fully honoured. To-day my pious practices have found fulfilment. O Foremost of Men, Greatest of the Celestials,

worshippiog thee, I shall attaio the heavenly realm. O Gentle One, O Slayer of thy Foes, O Thou who dost confer honour on men, purified by thy compassionate regard, I shall, by thy favour, attain the imperishable worlds, O Subduer of Thy Foes. rs6 " When thou didst set foot on the Mount Chitttakuta, those ascetics I setved, ascending celestial cars of incomparable splendout, departed to heaven and those great sages, convetSant with virtue, said to me : " ' **RAMA** will visit thy boly retreat ; do thou receive him and **LAKSHMANA** with traditional hospitality. On beholding him, thou shalt attain the highest sphete from whence none returneth.' " O Foremost of Men, thus did those blessed ascetics address me, and for thee I have gatheted the wild fruits of diverse kinds that grow on the borders of Lake Pampa." Hearing these words, Raghava said to her, who had not been left in ignorance by het Gurus concerning the past and the futute: " I have heard the truth about the greatness of thy Gurus from Danu and now I would fain witness it with mine own eyes, if thou judgest it fitting." Listening to these words falling from Rams's own lips, Shabari, guiding the two brothets to the vast forest, addressed them, saying : " O Raghunanda, behold this forest resembling a dark cloud, filled with birds and beasts, known as the Matsnga Wood. Here my Gurus of pure soul sacrificed unto fire, their persons consecrated by mantras through which they had purified them, thus consecrating the forest and rendering it a holy place. Hete too is the altar facing the west, whete, with hands trembling with fatigue, my worshipful preceptors offered Rowers to their Gods. O Foremost of the Raghus, behold this altar of incomparable beauty, which, through the powet of their penances, still sheds its lustre illumining the fout regions. Behold also the Seven Seas, drawn here by virtue of their thought, since, through fasting and the weight of years, they wete unable to walk. These robes of bark, left hanging on the trees by them at the completion of their

ablutions, are still wet and the lotuses of azute hue offered by tbem in worship have not faded. " Now thou hast seen the forest and hast heard all that thou didst deire to know ; I will abandon my body so that I may approach those pure-souled ascetics whom I used to wait upon, to whom this hettnitage belongs and whose servant I am.” rs7 Hearing these pious words, **RAMA**, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, experienced great delight and exclaimed : “Wondetful it is! " Thereafter, addtessing Shabati of ascetic practices, he said : " O Holy One, I have been fully honoured by thee ; now repait whither thou wilt and be happy.” Having received permission from **RAMA** to depart, Shabari, wearing matted locks, robes of bark and a black antelope skin, cast herself into the fire, thereafter rising into the air like a bright fiame. Adorned with celestial ornaments, wreathed in garlands, emitting a divine fragrance, sprinkled with sandal-paste and clad in celestial raiment, she appeared exquisite and illumined the heavens like a llash of lightning. By virtue of her medita tions she ascended to those sacred abodes whete her spiritual preceptou, those high-souled ascetics, dwelt.

CHAPTER 75

Rama reaches the Lake Pampa

RMna reaches the Lake Pampa WHEN Shabari had ascended to heaven through the merit of her spiritual prowess, **RAMA** with his brother **LAKSHMANA** began to ponder over the pious influence of those great ascetics and, reflecting within himself on the divine authority of those holy men, Raghava said to his brother : " O Friend, I have now visited the retreat of those magnani mous sages of miraculous deeds, where deer and tigers roam, together with birds of every kind. O

LAKSHMANA, we have performed our ablutions in the sacred waters of these seven seas and have offered oblations to our ancestors. Our evil *karma* has thereby been destroyed and prosperity made manifest ; my heart is filled with peace. Metbinb, O Lion among Men, that we shall soon meet with good fortune. Come, Jet us walk towards the enchanting Lake Pampa I The Rishyamuka Mountain may be seen in the distance ; it is 158 there that the four great monkeys with **SUGRIVA**, **SURYA**'s son, dwell in constant fear of Ball. I am impatient to see this Lion of the Monkey Tribe, **SUGRIVA**, for it is he who wtl1 ascertain where **SITA** can be found." Thus did the heroic **RAMA** speak, and Saumitri answered him, saying : " Let us repair thither without delay ; my heart too reaches out to that place." Thereupon, issuing from Matanga's hermitage, the mighty **RAMA**, Lord of Men, accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, proceeded towards lake Pampa. On every side he saw innumerable trees in full flower and pools where small white cranes nested in the reeds, and peacocks, lapwings and woodpeckers, filling the forest with their cries, as also a multitude of other birds. Enjoying the trees of varying fragrance and the many ponds, **RAMA**, transported with delight, approached one whose waters, delicious to the taste, drawn from the Matangs lake. There the two Descendants of Raghu stood in quiet recollection. Thereafter, grief once more invading the heart of Raghu, the son of **DASARATHA**, he entered the enchanting lake covered with lotuses. Adorned on all sides with Tilaka, Ashoka, Punnaga, Vakula and Uddalaka trees, which were nourished by its waters, it was framed in charming groves and its waves, pure as crystal, on which hibiscus blooms floated, flowed over fine sand. Fish and turtle abounded there and the banks were embellished by trees intertwined with friendly creepers. Kinneras, Uragas, Gandharvas, Y altshas and *Rakshasas* frequented it and diverse trees and shrobs cast their shade over it. That

lake was verily a jewel with its fresh and limpid waters, its lotuses and water-lilies lending it a coppery sheen, whilst clumps of nymphoae cast silvery reflections and the blue of sapphire was added by other flowers. Aravinda and Utpala blooms abounded round the lake, which was covered with innumerable lotuses, whilst groves of mango in flower lent theit shade, and peacocks filled it with their cries. **RAMA**, the mighty son of **DASARATHA**, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, seeing the Lake Pampa adorned like a bride with Tilaka. Bijapura, Vata, Lodhra, Suldadruma, Karavira, IS9 Punnaga in flower, bushes of Malati and Kunda, Bandira, Nichula, Ashoka, Saptaparna, Ketaka, Atimukta and diverse other trees of varying perfume, gave expression ro his grief : " There stands on the right bank the mountain Rishyamuka, abounding in various metals and famed for the variety of its trees and flowers, spoken of by Kabandha, where the son of the magnanimous Riksharajas, the valiant **SUGRIVA**, dwells. 'O Foremost of Men, seek out the King of the Monkeys', were his words." Thereafter, **RAMA** spoke to **LAKSHMANA** again, saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, how will **SITA** be able to live without me ? " Having spoken thus to **LAKSHMANA**, the foremost of the Raghus, tormented by his love, which precluded him from thinking of aught else, entered the marvellous Lake Pampa, having given voice to his sorrow. Proceeding slowly, observing the forest, **RAMA**, coming to Lake Pampa, surrounded on all sides with enchanting groves, filled with a multitude of birds, entered its waters with **LAKSHMANA**. END OF J6o **RAMA** describes the Spring and the Sentiments it e'DOkes in him his steps towards Lake Pampa, which was covered with lotuses of various kinds, **RAMA**, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, his mind troubled, began to lament. Beholding that lake, his heart was filled with delight, and under the sway of love, he said to the son of **SUMITRA** : " O **LAKSHMANA**, how beautiful is the Lake Pampa with its pure and limpid

waves, its lotuses and flowering water-lilies, its many kinds of trees. Oh ! How delightful ! O Saumitri, observe the Pampa Woods, how pleasant they are to look upon, those magnificent trees resembling crested mountains. I am overwhelmed and stricken with grief on recollecting **BHARATA**'s distress and the abduction of **SITA**. " Though my heart is heavy, yet the Pampa lake is still able to charm me, with its ravishing woods luxuriant with every kind of blossom and its fresh and delicious waters. The month of flowering lotuses lends it an extreme beauty ; serpents and wild animals frequent it, whilst deer and birds abound. The thick grass, of a deep emerald hue, is sprinkled with different flowers that have fallen from the trees and resembles a bright carpet. On every side the tops of the trees, bending under the weight of their blossom, are wholly hidden by the creepers with their flowering fronds. " O **LAKSHMANA**, it is the season of auspicious breezes and tender love, the fragrant spring month when flowers and fruit are brought to bitth on the trees. See how lovely are these flowering woods, O Saumitri, showering down a rain of petals, like watet from the clouds. " In the enchanting valleys on the escarpments, innumerable trees, shaken by the wind, scattet their blossom on the eatth. O **LAKSHMANA**, see how the breeze, agitating the myriad branches

BOOK IV

Kishkindha Kanda

Rama allies with Sugriva, exiled king of the monkey tribe, slaying his usurping brother Vali. Hanuman emerges as Rama's foremost devotee. The vanara hosts are dispatched in every direction to find Sita; the southern host, with Hanuman, learns from Sampati that she is held in Lanka.

CHAPTER 1

Rama describes the Spring and the Sentiments it evokes in him

CHAPTER **RAMA** describes the Spring and the Sentiments it e'DOkes in him his steps towards Lake Pampa, which was covered with lotuses of various kinds, **RAMA**, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, his mind troubled, began to lament. Beholding that lake, his heart was filled with delight, and under the sway of love, he said to the son of **SUMITRA** : " O **LAKSHMANA**, how beautiful is the Lake Pampa with its pure and limpid waves, its lotuses and flowering water-lilies, its many kinds of trees. Oh ! How delightful ! O Saumitri, observe the Pampa Woods, how pleasant they are to look upon, those magnificent trees resembling crested mountains. I am overwhelmed and stricken with grief on recollecting **BHARATA**'s distress and the abduction of **SITA**. " Though my heart is heavy, yet the Pampa lake is still able to charm me, with its ravishing woods luxuriant with every kind of blossom and its fresh and delicious waters. The month of flowering lotuses lends it an extreme beauty ; serpents and wild animals frequent it, whilst deer and birds abound. The thick grass, of a deep emerald hue, is sprinkled with different flowers that have fallen from the trees and resembles a bright carpet. On every side the tops of the trees, bending under the weight of their blossom, are wholly hidden by the creepers with their flowering fronds. " O **LAKSHMANA**, it is the season of auspicious breezes and tender love, the fragrant spring month when flowers and fruit are brought to bitth on the trees. See how lovely are these flowering woods, O Saumitri, showering down a rain of petals, like watet from the clouds. " In the enchanting

valleys on the escarpments, innumerable trees, shaken by the wind, scattet their blossom on the eatth. O **LAKSHMANA**, see how the breeze, agitating the myriad branches of the llowering trees, seems to play with the blossom thst bas fallen or is still on the trees. The God of the Wind frolics to the accompaniment of the humming of bees and to the song of the amorous nightingale, desiring, as it were, to make the trees dance. Emerging from the mountain caves, the wind gives forth a kind of music, shaking the trees violently from side to side, causing the extreme tips of their branches to meet, uniting them one with the other. The zephyr with soft caress ing breath, diffusing the perfume of sandalwood, dispels all fatigue. " Agitated by the wind, these trees seem to add their voices to the humming of the bees amidst the soft and fragrant groves. " On the enchanting mountain plateaus, the crags, whose points touch, resplendent with large trees bearing beautiful llowers, sparkle with beauty, and the trees, tossed by the airy currents that stir them, their crests covered with blossom and crowned with bees, seem about to break into song. " See, on every side, the marvellous blossoming of the golden Karnikara trees, resembling men robed in silk ! This season of Spring, O **LAKSHMANA**, with its choir of birds of every kind revives the pain caucd by **SITA**'s absence. In this overwhelming grief, pangs of love torment me. The gay trilling of the cuckoo tantalizes me ; the joyful Datyuhaka bird thst sings from the waterfalls of the forest increases my pain, O **LAKSHMANA** ! Formerly when she heard its voice in our hermitage, my beloved, intoxicated with love and happiness, would call to me. " See how the birds of varied plumage, giving forth every kind of note, seek refuge on all sides amongst the trees, bushes and creepers ! The females accompanied by the males llock together according to their kind and rejoice ; intoxicated by the Bhringaraja's exultant cries, they chirrup melodiously. Here, in the home of **SITA**, the assembled birds are

made merry by the joyous song of the Datyuhaka responding to the cuckoo's call. " The rustling of the trees rekindles the fire of my love, of which the bunches of the Ashoka blooms are the fuel, the humming of the bees the crackling, and the buds the golden tongues of llame. 16.4 " This fire of Spring is consuming me I Nay, far from that lady of lovely eyelashes, beautiful looks and gentle speech, I cannot survive, O Saumitri ! The season that brings delight to the woods is the time she loved, and beyond all, she was enamoured of the forest echoing to the call of the cuckoo on every side, O Irreproachable Hero ! " The tender feelings I bear for my sweet One and the delights of Spring that increase them are a burning fire that will soon consume me utterly. I shall not live long separated from my spouse ; the beauty of these trees increases the pangs of my love. Being unable to see **SITA** any more intensifies my anguish, whilst the presence of Spring causes the sweat of desire to break forth on me. Thinking of that lady, whose eyes resemble a doe's, gJ.ief holds me in thrall ; the cruel Spring breeze from the woods tortures me, O Saumitri ! " Here and there, peacocks dance, spreading their brilliant wings in the breeze, and their tails, decorated with eyes, resemble crystal lattices. The females surrounding them are intoxicated with desire and this strengthens the love with which I am filled. " See, O **LAKSHMANA**, on the mountain plateau, how the peacock dances and how the peahen, her heart intoxicated with joy, closely follows him ! He spreads his radiant wings and his cries seem to mock my pain, for in the forest his loved one has not been carried away by a titan and he can dance in these enchanting groves with his tender love. In this month of flowers, in **SITA**'s absence, my stay here is unendurable ! THE RAMAYANA OF VALMlKl dwells, who has now fallen under the sway of another, she will be sharing my ardour. Yet if the Spring has not reached that place where she is, how will that dark-eyed lady be able to

go on living in my absenec ? lf this season has not come to where my gentle love resides, what will that fair-limbed lady do, who has been overpowered by a mighty adversary? My youthful and beloved consort, whose eyes resemble lotus petals and who is gentle of speech, will certainly yield up her life at the first breath of Spring. ln my heart, l feel assured that the gentle **SITA** will not be able to survive separation from me. Devotion to Vaidehi invades my entire being and my love is wholly centred on her. " When I remember my gentle love, this caressing breeze, so fresh and cool, carrying the fragrance of flowers, is like a burning fire to me. The God of the Wind, who was ever welcome when **SITA** was present, is to-day a source of pain to me. In her absence, that bird llying through the air emitting cries, the crownowperching on a tree, makes a delightful sound. This winged creature will prove a messenger and bring my remembrance to the mind of the large-eyed Vaidehi. " Listen, O **LAKSHMANA**, to the birds' intoxicating chorus of love, as they warble in the flowery crested trees. That bee suddenly llying towards the young green shoots of the Tilaka tree, blown by the breeze, is like a lover trembling with desire. The Ashoka tree, that increases the torment of lovers, rises with its plumes of llowers waving in the wind, to tantalize me. Look, O **LAKSHMANA**, at the flowering mango trees, resembling those who are distracted by the pangs of love ! " O Saumitri, O Lion among Men I See how amidst the magnificent range of trees that grow on the borders of Lake Pampa, the Kinneras wander about on every side I Observe those Nalina llowers of subtle scent, O **LAKSHMANA**, gleaming on the water like unto the sun about to rise. See the calm surface of the Pampa Lake, fragrant with lotus and blue water lilies, frequented by swans and waterfowl, and the stamens of the lotus llowers, bright as the dawn, that the bees have scattered on the waves. seem to be pursuing each other, resembling lovely womeo at play. " The

breeze passes through the trees from erag to erag, from wood to wood. Amongst them, some are in full flower and give o1f a soft fragrance, others, covered with buds, have a sombre air. What sweetness ! How pleasant ! What blossom! " Amidst these trees on the borders of Lake Pampa, the bees seem to be resting in the heart of the flowers, staying a momeot, then flying off again, quickly alighting elsewhere, greedy for nectar. " The fortunate earth is heaped with masses of blossom that has falleo on the ground, resembling the covering of a couch. On the mountain sides unrolls a brilliant carpet of gold and red Bowers of every kind, O Saumitri. At the end of winter all these trees are now in full Bower, O Lakshmaoa. In this month of blossom, the plants open, vying with each other, and the trees, where the six-legged insects hum, seem to challenge one another, manifesting a great brilliance, their branches crowned with flowers. " The Karandava bird plunging into the limpid waves, dis porting itself with its mate, seems in some way to inspire love. Like that of the Mandakini, the beauty of the Lake Pampa is enchanting ; its perfections are famed throughout the world and, in proximity, ravish the heart. " If I might find my gentle Love onee again, and we could take up our abode here, I should not even covet **INDRA**'s realm or regret Ayodhya. Here, on these charming slopes, I should sport with her and neither my thoughts nor desires would lead me away. " In the absence of my beloved, the trees of these woods, wholly covered with every kind of flower, almost deprive me of my reason. " Gaze on this lake of limpid waters, O Saumitri, which is covered with lotuses, frequented by the Chakravaka bird, the abode of Karsndavas, abounding in pelicans, herons and wild beasts and re-echoing to the warbling of birds; verily Lake Pampa is a paradise ! The myriad birds with their delightful antics and the memory of that youthful woman, my beloved, whose ace shines like the moon, whose eyes resemble lotuses, r68 all

inflame my desire. I, who am separated from **SITA**, whose eyes resemble the doe's and the gazelle's, on seeing them dis porting themselves there, am rroubled, as it were. " On that pleasant hillside, filled with Bocks of birds, intoxi cated with love, might I but see my gentle One, I should be content. O Saumirri, I should certainly live anew if **SITA** of slender waist were inhaling the auspicious air of Lake Pampa at my side. Fortunate is he, O **LAKSHMANA**, who drinks that pleasant air from the woods of Lake Pampa that carries the fragrance of the lotus and dispels all grief. " How is that youthful woman, whose eyes resemble lotus petals, the beloved daughter of **JANAKA**, able to bear the exist ence of a slave ? What shaD I say to that virtuous king, the faithful **JANAKA**, when, in the presence of the people, he asks me if all is well with **SITA** ? · " She who foUowed me to the dreary forest whither my father had banished me, that **SITA**, fixed in her duty, where is she, my beloved, now ? Separated from her, how, in mine adversity, O **LAKSHMANA**, shall I be able to endure life ? I am losing my reason! When shall I hear the incomparable voice of Vaidehi again ? Though she found nought but misfortune in the forest, yet that youthful woman, in her tenderness, con versed sweetly with me, who was consumed with love, as if she had ceased to be unhappy and was full of joy. How shall I, in Ayodhya, reply to **KAUSHALYA**, O Prince, when that vener able queen asks me : ' Where is my daughter-in-law and what has befallen her ? ' " O **LAKSHMANA**, return and seek out **BHARATA**, our devoted brother; as for me, I can no longer continue living without the daughter of **JANAKA**." Thus did the magnanimous **RAMA** lament, as if deprived of support, and his brother, **LAKSHMANA**, in judicious and measured words, answered him, saying :-" O **RAMA**, summon up thy courage and be happy, do not grieve, O Thou, the Best of Men. Those in thy condition have nothing with which to reproach themselves and should not give way to despair. Calling to

remembrance the grief caused by separation from that being who is dear to thee, banish all excessive attachment. In proximity to intense heat, even a damp net catches fire. Though THE RAM A Y AN A O F v:A L M I;K I he descend into hell or yet lower, **RAVANA** will in no way survive his deed, O Beloved R.ama. Let us first seek out this wicked demon ; either he shall yield up **SITA** or he is lost. Should **RAVANA** descend into the womb of Ditiwith **SITA**, I shall slay him if he does not restore her to thee. Return to thy normal state, My Noble Friend, and throw off these mournful thoughrs. Assuredly no success is gained by those who abandon their undertakings without making due efforrs. Exertion is a powerful weapon, O Lord, there is no power superior to it. With effort, nothing is impossible in this world. Resolute men do not fail in their pursuits. By our efforts alone we shall recover J anaki. Do not permit thyself to be dominated by thy love or thy grief; cast it behind thee. Hast thou perchance forgotten the greatness of thy soul, the fixity of thy purpose and character ? " Thus spurred on by **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA**, who had allowed himself to be overcome by sorrow, banished his grief and distraction and regained his valour. Calm and brave beyond imagining, **RAMA** crossed the Pampa that was full of charm, enchanting with irs trees of waving branches. When he had explored the whole forest with its waterfalls and ravines, the magnanimous R.ama, agitated and overcome with grief, set out with **LAKSHMANA**, and with the joyous gait of an elephant intoxicated with Mada juice, the intrepid and magnanimous Saumitri, with rapid strides went on his way serenely, consoling R.ama by his fidelity and valour. As they neared the vicinity of Rishyamub, the King of the Monkeys observed those heroes of unusual aspect and, despite his courage, trembled but made no move towards them. That magnanimous monkey, who walked with the dignity of an elephant, seeing those two brothers advancing, was filled with

extreme apprehension and became distracted with fear. In their terror at the sight of R.ama and **LAKSHMANA**, those monkeys concealed themselves in that pleasant solitude, the refuge of the D= of the Trees.' CHAPTER SugrifJtl sends **HANUMAN** to **RAMA** BEHOLDING those two illustrious brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, bearing great swords in their hands, **SUGRIVA** grew anxious and, with a beating heart, glancing round on every side, could find no place in which to take refuge. Seeing those two heroes, he moved about restlessly from place to place and, in his terror, felt himself about to swoon. Exceedingly perturbed, the virtuous **SUGRIVA** with his companions began to ponder on the varying aspects of the sitoation and that Chief of the Monkey Tribe, pointing out those two watriors, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, to his ministers, said : " Without doubt, Bali has sent these two heroes to this wood, which is inaccessible to him, and they, assuming robes of bark, have come hither and have penetrated this stronghold." Then those counsellors of **SUGRIVA**, perceiving the two skilful archers, sped away from that ridge to a higher crest, slipping off hurriedly behind their leader and thereafter they encircled that King of the Forest Dwellers. In close formation, they leapt from crag to crag, causing the rocks to tremble with their bounds. Jumping with extreme force, they broke down the flowering trees growing in that altitode and those amazing monkeys, leaping in every directinn on that great mountain, struck terror in the hearts of the deer, the wild cats and the tigers. Thereafter, the counsellors of **SUGRIVA**, assembling on that **INDRA** of mountains, gathered round their sovereign with joined palms, and the eloquent **HANUMAN** addressed **SUGRIVA**, who in his terror suspected some project of his brother's to be afoot, saying : " Let all banish fear of Bali I There is nothing to inapirc terror on this, the highest of mountains. I do not see any sign here of that cruel Bali of evil aspect, who has filled thee

CHAPTER 2

Sugriva sends Hanuman to interview Rama

CHAPTER SugrifJtl sends **HANUMAN** to **RAMA** BEHOLDING those two illustrious brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, bearing great swords in their hands, **SUGRIVA** grew anxious and, with a beating heart, glancing round on every side, could find no place in which to take refuge. Seeing those two heroes, he moved about restlessly from place to place and, in his terror, felt himself about to swoon. Exceedingly perturbed, the virtuous **SUGRIVA** with his companions began to ponder on the varying aspects of the sitoation and that Chief of the Monkey Tribe, pointing out those two watriors, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, to his ministers, said : " Without doubt, Bali has sent these two heroes to this wood, which is inaccessible to him, and they, assuming robes of bark, have come hither and have penetrated this stronghold." Then those counsellors of **SUGRIVA**, perceiving the two skilful archers, sped away from that ridge to a higher crest, slipping off hurriedly behind their leader and thereafter they encircled that King of the Forest Dwellers. In close formation, they leapt from crag to crag, causing the rocks to tremble with their bounds. Jumping with extreme force, they broke down the flowering trees growing in that altitode and those amazing monkeys, leaping in every directinn on that great mountain, struck terror in the hearts of the deer, the wild cats and the tigers. Thereafter, the counsellors of **SUGRIVA**, assembling on that **INDRA** of mountains, gathered round their sovereign with joined palms, and the eloquent **HANUMAN** addressed **SUGRIVA**, who in his terror suspected some project of his brother's to be afoot, saying : " Let all banish fear of Bali I There is nothing to inapirc terror on this, the highest of mountains. I do

not see any sign here of that cruel Bali of evil aspect, who has filled thee with apprehension and caused thy flight, O Bull among Monkeys. That cunning creature whom thou fearest, thy wicked elder brother, is not here, O Friend: I see no cause for thine apprehension. It is evident, O Plavamgama, that thy simian nature is asserting itself, since, by giving way to dis traction of mind, thou art not able to see clearly. Thou art intelligent, experienced, able to read the expression of others and fully prepared for any eventuality, but a prince who gives way to agitation is not able to forestall any." Hearing **HANUMAN**'s pregnant utterance, **SUGRIVA** answered him with greater calm saying : " Seeing those two long-armed warriors of large eyes, armed with bows and swords, resembling the offspring of the Gods, who would not be afraid ? I deem these two powerful heroes to be the messengers of Bali. Kings have many friends, and I do not feel able to trust them. Those who are cautious invariably find the weak spot in those who are over-confident. Bali is crafry in every enterprise. Those monarchs who are well-informed are able to overcome their enemies and should spy out their actions with the help of ordinary men. " Go, O Plavamgama, in the guise of a common man and find out the intentions of these two strangers. Study their gestures, their manners and their speech ; observe their attitude and how they are disposed. " By praise and repeated courtesies inspire them with confidence. Interrogate those two archers in my name, O Bull amongst Monkeys, and enquire of them for what reason they have come to these woods. Discover if their purpose be honest, O Plavamgama ; their speech and manner will betray them if they are ill-intentioned." Thus commanded by **SUGRIVA**, the Son of Maruta prepared to seek out **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. His master, through extreme fear, having rendered himself unapproachable, the monkey **HANUMAN** of noble artributes, listening to his words with

respect, answered : " Be it so I " and went forth to meet the mighty **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** who accompanied him.

CHAPTER 3

Hanuman's Meeting with Rama

AT the command of the magnanimous **SUGRIVA**, **HANUMAN**, with one bound, left the Mountain Rishyamuka and placed himself in the path of the two Raghavas. Discarding his monkey form, **HANUMAN**, the son of Masuta, by the power of illusion, assumed the guise of a wandering monk and, in gentle and pleasing tones, addressed those two brothers with humility, paying obeisance to them. Approaching those two heroes, that Foremost of Monkeys praised them as they deserved, offering them every courtesy and in accord with **SUGRIVA**'s wish spoke graciously to them, saying: " O Ascetics of renowned penance, who are full of faith and valour and who resemble the *Rishis* and the Gods, why have you come to this region, sowing fear amongst the herds of deer and other denizens of the forest, surveying the trees on every side that grow on the borders of Pampa, that lake of sparkling waves, the splendour of which you enhance with your radiance, O Heroes of Great Daring ? " O Valiant Strangers, who are you, whose skin gleams like gold and who are clad in robes of bark, possessing strong arms, you who are sighing deeply and whose sight inspires fear in all beings ? You have the air of lions or warriors who are full of courage and heroism, armed as you are with bows, resembling lndra's, the Destroyers of your Foes ? "Full of majesty and beauty, mighty as great bulls, your arms resembling the trunks of elephanrs, radiant, the first among men, youthful, illumining the king of the mounrains with your effulgence, you who are worthy of ruling

kingdoms and like unto the Gods, what purpose brings you here ? O Heroes, whose eyes are as large as lotus petals, who wear your matted locks coiled like crowns on your heads, who resemble each 173 other, have you come hither from the celestial region? Verily the sun and moon have descended to esrth of their own free will. O Broad-chested Warriors, ye who are men, yet have the aspect of divine beings, whose shoulders are like unto a lion's, who are endowed with great strength and resemble two bulls intoxicated with desire, whose large and massive arms look like clubs that should be adorned with every kind of ornament, yet bear none, it seems that you are both worthy of ruling the whole esrth, whose decorations are the Vindhya and Meru mountains with their lakes and forests. How beautiful are your two shining bows, glistening with perfumed paste, covered with gold and shining like the mace of **INDRA** ; the two quivers also, filled with sharp death-dealiog and formidable arrows resembling hissing snakes ; your two swords of immense length and size, encrusted with fine gold that gleam like serpents that have just cast their slough ! But why do ye not answer me ? " **SUGRIVA** is the name of that virtuous King of the Monkeys, that hero banished by his brother, who roams the earth in great distress. I have come here under the orders of that magnanimous one, the Chief of the Great Monkeys. The illustrious **SUGRIVA** desires your friendship. Know me to be his minister, a monkey, the son of Pavana, ranging where I please and coming here under the guise of a wandering monk from the Rishyamuka Mountain in order to please him." Having addressed those two heroes, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, in discreet and courteous terms, **HANUMAN** fell silent and hearing that speech, the blessed **RAMA**, delighted, addressed **LAKSHMANA** who stood beside him, saying : " This is the minister of the King of the Monkeys, the magnanimous **SUGRIVA**, whom I seek. O Saumitri, answer **SUGRIVA**'s counsellor who

is eloquent and warm-hearted and the subduer of his foes in courteous terms. Only one versed in the Rig-Veda and, who is conversant with the Yajur and the Sama Vedas, would speak thus. He has studied grammar thoroughly, and though he has spoken at length, it has been void of error. I see naught to offend, either in his mouth, bia eyes, his brow, limbs, or attitude. His speech is neither lacking in fulncss, depth, assurance or distinction ; his voice 174 issues from his breast in clear modulated tones. He expresses himself with admirable felicity without any hesitation ; his tone is harmonious and moves the heart agreeably. What foe, having drawn his swotd, would not be disarmed by the charm of that voice that enunciates each syllable so perfectly. O Irreproachable Prince, the king who employs messengers gifted With such talent is certain to succeed in all his under takings, since they are enhanced at the very outset, by such eloquence." On this, Saumitri addressed that eloquent minister of **SUGRIVA**'s in well-chosen words, saying :-" O Sage, we have been told of the great attributes of **SUGRIVA** and are at this moment looking for that King uf the Monkeys. That which he commands we will carry out on thine insttuctions, O Excellent **HANUMAN**." When he heard this gracious speech, that monkey, born of Pavana, who wished nothing more than that **SUGRIVA** should triumph, resolved to bring about a friendly alliance between **RAMA** and his master.

CHAPTER 4

Hanuman brings Rama and Lakshmana into the Presence of Sugriva

RAMA would be willing to assist him, joyfully refiected that **SUGRIVA**'s triumph was already assured. He thought : " Undoubtedly the magnanimous **SUGRIVA** will not fail to regain his kingdom, for here is one who will enable him to accomplish his design." Then the wholly delighted and eloquent **HANUMAN**, the Foremost of Monkeys, said to **RAMA:-**" What brings thee with thy younger brother to this perilous and inaccessible forest?" On this enquiry, **LAKSHMANA**, prompted by his brother, related the history uf **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, to him. 175 " There was a king named **DASARATHA**, who was illustrious, fixed in his duty and, according to the law, the protector of the four castes. Without a foe, he himself hating none, he appeared to all living beings to be a second **BRAHMA**. " The firstborn son of **DASARATHA**, who possessed every excellent quality, the refuge of all, endowed with royal virtues and of great majesty, was banished from his dominion and obedient to the behests o'f his sire, has come to dwell in the forest. Submitting to the paternal decree, he was followed by his consort, **SITA**, as the glorious sun by the sunset glow at evening. "My name is **LAKSHMANA**. I, who am inferior to him in every respect, am his brother and accompany him as his servant. This dutiful prince, who is ever mindful of what should be done, is exuemely learned and this hero, who spends his life in promoting the welfare of all beings, who is worthy of happiness and honour, deprived of supreme power, passes his days in the forest. A titan, who was able to change his form at will, carried off his consort, she being alone, and her abductor is unknown to us. " The son of Diti, Danu, who, through a curse, had been forced to assume the form of a titan, imparted the name of **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, to us. Now I have answered thine enquiries folly in all sincerity ; **RAMA** and I both seek the help of **SUGRIVA**. The distributor of all wealth, he, who bas reached the peak of glory and was formerly

the guardian of the worlds, has come to seek **SUGRIVA**'s protection. The son of that instructor of his people, who was devoted to his duty, of whom **SITA** was the daughter-in-law, **RAMA**, seeks the protection of **SUGRIVA**. The suong defender of the whole universe, that was fortnerly his highway, my Guru **RAMA**, whom thou seest here, has come to seek refuge with **SUGRIVA**. He, under whose compassion all beings rest, **RAMA**, has come to appeal to the goodwill of that King of the Monkeys. It is the eldest son of King **DASARATHA**, who was endowed with every good atuibute and on this earth constantly showered honours on monarchs, **RAMA**, renowned in the Three Worlds, who now seeks refuge in **SUGRIVA**, Lord of the Monkeys. **RAMA**, a victim to grief, overwhelmed with aftliction, has come !]6 as a suppliant ! It is for **SUGRIVA** with the leaders of the monkey tribes to show favour to him." Hearing **LAKSHMANA**, uttering this appeal, his tears flowing the while, **HANUMAN** graciously replied : " Such suppliants, endowed with wisdom, who have mastered their anger and other passions and whose fortune has led them to his presence, are worthy to be brought before that lndra of Monkeys. He too is exiled from his kingdom and the object of his brother's enmity, who has carried off his consort and, after maltreating him cruelly, forced him to flee trembling to the forest. That offspring of Sutya, **SUGRIVA**, will form a pact of friendship with you, and I shall accompany him in his search for **SITA**." Having spoken thus in a gentle and kindly tone, **HANUMAN** said to Raghava in friendly accents :-" Let us seek out **SUGRIVA**." At these words, the righteous **LAKSHMANA** bowed courteously to him and addressed the virtuous Raghava, saying : " What this monkey, born of the Wind-God, has gladly told us, his master will carry out ; it is here that thy purpose will find fulfilment, O **RAMA**. Goodness is painted on his countenance; be speaks cheerfully and his words ring true." Then that extremely

intelligent son of Maruta, **HANUMAN**, went away, taking the heroes, the descendants of Raghu, with him. Abandoning the guise of a mendicant and assum ing the form of a monkey, that great ape, taking those two warriors on his shoulders, departed. Thereafter, that intelligent son of Pavana, who was renowned among the monkeys and endowed with great prowess, delighted to have accomplished his design, scaled the mountain with immense bounds taking **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** with him. CHAPTER S The Alliance of **RAMA** and Sugri'Dtl FRoM the Rishyamuka mountain, **HANUMAN** bounded to the Mt. Malaya and presenting the two valiant descendants of Raghu to **SUGRIVA**, said :

CHAPTER 5

The Alliance between Rama and Sugriva

as a suppliant ! It is for **SUGRIVA** with the leaders of the monkey tribes to show favour to him." Hearing **LAKSHMANA**, uttering this appeal, his tears flowing the while, **HANUMAN** graciously replied : " Such suppliants, endowed with wisdom, who have mastered their anger and other passions and whose fortune has led them to his presence, are worthy to be brought before that lndra of Monkeys. He too is exiled from his kingdom and the object of his brother's enmity, who has carried off his consort and, after maltreating him cruelly, forced him to flee trembling to the forest. That offspring of Sutya, **SUGRIVA**, will form a pact of friendship with you, and I shall accompany him in his search for **SITA**." Having spoken thus in a gentle and kindly tone, **HANUMAN** said to Raghava in friendly accents :-" Let us seek out **SUGRIVA**." At these words, the righteous **LAKSHMANA** bowed courteously to him and addressed the virtuous Raghava, saying : " What this monkey, born of

the Wind-God, has gladly told us, his master will carry out ; it is here that thy purpose will find fulfilment, O **RAMA**. Goodness is painted on his countenance; be speaks cheerfully and his words ring true." Then that extremely intelligent son of Maruta, **HANUMAN**, went away, taking the heroes, the descendants of Raghu, with him. Abandoning the guise of a mendicant and assum ing the form of a monkey, that great ape, taking those two warriors on his shoulders, departed. Thereafter, that intelligent son of Pavana, who was renowned among the monkeys and endowed with great prowess, delighted to have accomplished his design, scaled the mountain with immense bounds taking **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** with him. CHAPTER S The Alliance of **RAMA** and Sugri'Dtl FRoM the Rishyamuka mountain, **HANUMAN** bounded to the Mt. Malaya and presenting the two valiant descendants of Raghu to **SUGRIVA**, said : 177 " This is **RAMA**, O Great and Wise King, who has come here with **LAKSHMANA**, his brother ; this true hero, botn in the dynasty of lkshwsku, is the son of King **DASARATHA**. " Fixed in his duty, he is carrying out the behests of his sire, that great king who, grstifying the Deity of Fire, **AGNI**, with the Rajasuya and Ashwamedha sacrifices, at those times distributed hundreds and thousands of cows in charity. " On account of a woman, his son, **RAMA**, who is present here, was exiled to the forest aod, while that magnanimous hero was dwelling there, practising asceticism, **RAVANA** carried off his consort ; he now seeks thy protection. " These two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, solicit thy friendship ; do thou receive these heroes, worthy of homage, with honour ! " Hearing these words of Haouman, **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, who had now become easy of access, said to **RAMA**: " This is a great fortune aod the greatest of gains for me O Lord, that thou desirest to ally thyself in friendship with me, who am one of the Monkey Tribe. Should that friendship find favour with thee, then here is my

haod, take it into thine and let us bind ourselves fast with a vow." Hearing **SUGRIVA**'s sweet words, **RAMA** with a joyful heart clasped his haod aod, happy in the thought of the alliaoce they were about to conclude, embraced him warmly. Then Haoumao, the Subduer of his Foes, who had put off his monk's guise, assuming his own shape, kindled a fire by rubbing two pieces of wood together. The fire beiog lit and flowers cast into it, thus preparing it, he placed it between delighted **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, in his tum, offered **LAKSHMANA** a branch of blossoming sandalwood. Thereafter, full of happiness, **SUGRIVA**, his eyes wide with delight, said to **RAMA** in sweet and gentle tones : " Cruelly persecuted, O **RAMA**, I came hither in great fear, my consort having been wrested from me, and, in deep distress, I took refuge in this inaccessible part of the forest, where I now dwell, my mind distracted with terror. "My brother oppresses me and is mine enemy, O **RAMA**, O Great Hero ; do thou deliver me from the fear which Bali inspires in me ! Act, O Kakutstba, in such a way that my courage may be restored." At these words, the illustrious and virtuous **RAMA**, a lover of justice, smiling, answered **SUGRIVA**, saying : " I know well that the fruit of friendship is mutual aid, O Great Monkey ! I shaii slay that Bali, who has carried off thy consort ! These pointed shafts that thou perceivest, these arrows bright as the sun, fly straight to their target. Decorated with heron's feathers and resembling **INDRA**'s thunderbolt, skilful)y wrought, their points sharpened, resembling provoked serpents, they will pierce that perverse wretch with force. To-day thou shalt see Bali fall on the earth like a cleft mountain struck by these pointed darts, resembling venomous snakes." Encouraged by **RAMA**'s words, **SUGRIVA**, overjoyed, spoke again, saying:-" May I by thy grace, O Valiant Lion among Men, regain my consort and my kingdom. O King, do thou restrain my wicked elder brother from harming me hereafter." At the

moment when **SUGRIVA** and **RAMA** concluded their alliance, Sits's left eye, resembling a lotus, twitched,' as also did tbat of the **INDRA** of Monkeys, which resembled gold, and that of the titan, **RAVANA**, which was like a flame.

CHAPTER 6

Sugriva shows Rama Sita's cloak and Jewels

IN his joy, **SUGRIVA** addressed Raghava, the delight of the House of Raghu, once again, saying : " I have learnt thine history from my servant, the best of counsellors, **HANUMAN**, and why thou hast come to these sylvan solitudes, where thou residest with thy brother **LAKSHMANA**. " Borne away by a titan, thy consort, Maithili, the daughter of]anaka, is grieving far from thee and the sagacious **LAKSHMANA**. That titan seeking an opportunity to do thee mischief, having slain the .vulture, **JATAYU**, carried off thy consort, thus rendering thee unhappy. Thou shalt soon be freed from the sorrow that the abduction of thy loved one causes thee. " Whether she is to be found in heaven or hcll, I shall seek out that lady and bring her back to thee, O Conqueror of Thine Enemies ! Know well, I speak truly, O Ragbava. **SITA** is not desrined to be the food of gods or titans ; thy consort will prove to be a poisoned dish to them ! " Banish thy grief, I will bring thy dear one back to thee. Aa I surmised, it was undoubtedly **SITA** that I saw when that titan of cruel deeds bore her away. She was crying : O **RAMA** ! O **LAKSHMANA** ! ' in a pitiful voice and struggling in **RAVANA**'s arms, like the female of the Serpent King. " Seeing me with my five companions standing on the summit of the mountain, she dropped her cloak and magnificent jewels, which we collected and preserved, O

RAMA. I will bring them to thee and thou wilt perchance be able to call them to remembrance." On this, **RAMA** answered **SUGRIVA** in all affection and said: " Go quickly and bring them to me here without delay, O Friend!" At these words, **SUGRIVA**, intent on pleasing **RAMA**, ran in all baste to a deep cave in the mountain, and seizing the cloak and jewels, that monkey showed them to **RAMA**, saying: " These are they, O Ragbava ! " I8o Then **RAMA**, talting the raiment and the sparkling jewels, found his eyes to be misty with tears, as the moon is veiled in cloud, tears that in his affection for **SITA** fell in torrents, and, losing his composure, be fell to the earth, sobbing : " O My Dear One I " Pressing the precious jewels to his breast, heaving deep sighs like the furious hissing of a snake in its hole, his eyes streaming with tears, perceiving **LAKSHMANA** at his side, he began to lament bitterly, saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, behold Vaidehi's cloak and jewels, which, while beiog catried away, she allowed to fall on the earth ; without doubt, it was on this grassy slope that **SITA**, while beiog borne away, scattered her ornaments, their condition confirms it., Hearing **RAMA**'s words, **LAKSHMANA** *said*:-" I do not recognize the bracelets or earrings, but I koow the anklets, for I worshipped her feet alone."' Then **RAMA** said to **SUGRIVA** :-" In what place didst thou behold Vaidehi, my chaste spouse, dearer to me than life itself? What hideous titan bore her away? Where does that monster dwell, who has plunged me in this mourning ? Having catried **SITA** away and kindled my wrath, he has forfeited his life and opened the portals of death. Say, who is this titan, who, in the forest, has by craft borne away my tender consort? O Chief of the Monkeys, to-day I shall dispatch him to the region of death."

CHAPTER 7

Sugriva consoles Rama

Sobs, answered him, saying : " Indeed I do not koow where that wicked titan dwells, nor his strength, nor the extent of his valour, nor the tribe to which that vile monster belongs, but, O Subduer of Thy Foes, I beg thee in all sincerity to master thy grief. . " By mine efforts, I shall succeed in restoring Maithili to thee ! By slaying **RAVANA** and his entire house and mani festing my personal courage to the uttermost, I shall act in such a way that thou wilt be happy 'ere Joog. Thou hast yielded to despair sufficiently, now exhibit thy native resolution! Men like thee should not give way to despondency I " I too suffer greatly on account of separation from my consort, but I do not despair like thee, nor have I lost courage. Though but a common monkey, I do not indulge in complaint. How much Jess shouldst thou do so, O Magnanimous Hero, thou who art wise, valiant and illustrious ! " Thou shouldst resolutely resuain the tears that fall; it becometh thee not to Jose patience, that quality that distin guishes men of nobility. " A brave man has recourse to reason and does not allow himself to be moved either in adversity, consequent on separa tion from relatives, or on the loss of possessions, or at the time of death. But the man who is Jacking in courage and gives way to despair inevitably succumbs to his grief, like an overloaded ship in the water. " Bowiog low before thee with joined palms, I beseech thee to summon up all thy fortitude and not yield to misery. Those who permit themselves to be overcome by grief never succeed, and their suengrb is decreased ; do not therefore give thyself up to sorrow. “He who is overwhelmed by despair is in danger. Banish thy sorrow, O **INDRA** amoog Men, and revive thy courage; let it be fully restored ! I speak to thee for thine own

good, as a friend; I do not wish to insuuct thee. Therefore for our friendship's sake, do not yield thyself up to grief." Tenderly consoled by **SUGRIVA**, **RAMA** wiped his face, which was wet with tears, with the comer of his tunic and, returning to his normal state as a result of **SUGRIVA**'s words, the Lord Kakutstha, embracing him, said.: " O **SUGRIVA**, thou dost fulliJ the role of a devoted friend, that of being of service with dignity. O Friend, see how, through thy good counsel, I have become myself again. It is not easy to find such an ally, who is suffering the same adversity; therefore exert thyself to find Maithili and the cruel titan, r82 that perverse **RAVANA**, and tell me frankly what I should do. Thou a rich field that the rains have visited ; everything will succeed with thee. Further, the words I recently pro nounced' with confidence, O Tiger among Monkeys, will without doubt come to pass. Never have I uttered a falsehood, nor shall I ever do so. I swear by the truth, that what I have said will come to pass I " Hearing the words of that King of Men, the wise leader of the valiant monkeys felt in his heart that his purpose was accomplished. CHAPTER **SUGRIVA** implores **RAMA** to help him against Bali on hearing these words, **SUGRIVA** joyfully addressed the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA** in this wise : " Undoubtedly I am favoured by the Gods, since I have a virtuous friend, full of great qualities, such as thou I With thy help, O Irreproachable One, it would be possible for me even to conquer the celestial realm, how much more regain my kingdom, O Lord ! I am the object of reverence to my friends and kinsmen, O **RAMA**, since, witnessed by the sacred fire, I have formed an alliance with thee ! O Descendant of the House of Raghu, thou wilt soon find me worthy of thy friendship, but it does not become me to speak of mine own good qualities. It is in great heroes such as thou, masters of themselves, that affection, like true courage, remains fixed, O Best of Well-born Men I Silver, gold and

precious gems are shared amongst friends as belonging to either ; rich or poor, happy or wretched, destitute or gifted with good qualities, a friend is ever a friend. Good fortune, prosperity or country, O Irreproachable Hero, are all sacrificed for the sake of a friend ; only devotion to him maners." " True indeed," replied the blessed **RAMA** to the handsome **SUGRIVA**, in the presence of **LAKSHMANA**, who equalled V asava in wisdom.

CHAPTER 8

Sugriva implores Rama for his help against Bali

that perverse **RAVANA**, and tell me frankly what I should do. Thou a rich field that the rains have visited ; everything will succeed with thee. Further, the words I recently pro nounced' with confidence, O Tiger among Monkeys, will without doubt come to pass. Never have I uttered a falsehood, nor shall I ever do so. I swear by the truth, that what I have said will come to pass I " Hearing the words of that King of Men, the wise leader of the valiant monkeys felt in his heart that his purpose was accomplished. CHAPTER **SUGRIVA** implores **RAMA** to help him against Bali on hearing these words, **SUGRIVA** joyfully addressed the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA** in this wise : " Undoubtedly I am favoured by the Gods, since I have a virtuous friend, full of great qualities, such as thou I With thy help, O Irreproachable One, it would be possible for me even to conquer the celestial realm, how much more regain my kingdom, O Lord ! I am the object of reverence to my friends and kinsmen, O **RAMA**, since, witnessed by the sacred fire, I have formed an alliance with thee ! O Descendant of the House of Raghu, thou wilt soon find me worthy of thy friendship, but it does not become

me to speak of mine own good qualities. It is in great heroes such as thou, masters of themselves, that affection, like true courage, remains fixed, O Best of Well-born Men I Silver, gold and precious gems are shared amongst friends as belonging to either ; rich or poor, happy or wretched, destitute or gifted with good qualities, a friend is ever a friend. Good fortune, prosperity or country, O Irreproachable Hero, are all sacrificed for the sake of a friend ; only devotion to him maners." " True indeed," replied the blessed **RAMA** to the handsome **SUGRIVA**, in the presence of **LAKSHMANA**, who equalled V asava in wisdom. The following day, **SUGRIVA**, seeing **RAMA** standing by the valiant Laksbmana, scanned the forest hurriedly and, observing a Sala tree at no gteat distance, coveted with fiowetS and heavy with luxuriant foliage, in which bees were humming, tore off a magnificent leafy branch, and spreading it on the gtound sat down on it with **RAMA**. Seeing the two thus installed, **HANUMAN**, in his turn, break ing off a branch of a Sala tree, invited the sdf-elfacing **LAKSHMANA** to take his place there. Beholding **RAMA** seated at his ease on that lofty mountain, coveted with ftoweting Sala trees, radiating serenity like a peaceful lake, **SUGRIVA**, in his ddight, in soft and gentle tones, leaning towards his friend who was manifesting extreme joy, said to him in accents trembling with emotion : "Harassed by my brother, my declared enemy, O **RAMA**, fear of Bali preys on my mind. O Thou who the refuge of the world, I am without a defender, gtant me thy support ! " Hearing these words, the illustrious and virtuous **RAMA**, fixed in his duty, smiling, answered **SUGRIVA**, saying: " Administering relief is the fruit of friendship, harming others that of enmity! This very day, I shall slay the abductor of thy consort. Here are my winged shafts and fiery arrows, O Fortunate One, whose hafts, inlaid with gold, resembling Mahendra's thunder-bolt, have come from the forest of Karttikeya and are adorned with heron's plumes. Their

smooth joints and sharp points lend them the appearance of angry snakes. Thou shalt see that enemy, thy brothet called Bali, tainted with evil deeds, struck down with these arrows, like a mountain crumbling into dust." Hearing **RAMA**'s words, Sugtiva, the leader of the monkey army, fdt an inexpressible joy. "Excellent! Excellent! ", he cried. " O **RAMA**, I have been overwhdmed with distress and thou art the refuge of the alllicted. Knowing thee to be mine ally, I have poured out my sorrow on thy breast. Having clasped thy hand in mine, witnessed by the fire, thou hast become the most valued friend of my life ; by the truth I swear it. I have taken thee as my friend and speak to thee in confidence. The misfortune that has overtaken me constantly gnaws at my heart." Thus spoke **SUGRIVA**, his eyes brimming, his voice strangled with sobs, unable to continue. Then, stemming the stream of his tears, that flowed like a raging torrent, **SUGRIVA**, in **RAMA**'s presence, mastering himself in an instant and, stifling his sobs, wiped his beautiful eyes. Thereafter, that illustrious monkey once again addressed Raghava, saying : " O **RAMA**, formerly Bali, overwhelming me with insults, banished me from the kingdom. Seizing my consort, dearer to me than life itself, he bound my friends in chains. Then that perverse wretch sought to destroy me, O **RAMA**, and often the monkeys themselves were bribed to that end, but I slew them. Full of apprehension on seeing thee, O **RAMA**, I did not venture to go out to meet thee, being a prey to fear and yet in dread. " These monkeys with **HANUMAN** as their leader are my sole companions ; it is due to them that I am still alive, though the situation is grave. These loyal monkeys surround and protect me, accompanying me on all my journeys, remaining with me wherever I decide to stay. " O **RAMA**, of what use is it to speak further ? My elder brother, Bali, distinguished for his cruelty, is mine adversary. If he dies, at that very moment my misfortunes will be at an end. My happiness, nay, my very life, depends

on his destruc tion. This is the only remedy for my woes. I tell thee this while yet overcome with grief; happy or unhappy, a friend is ever the refuge of a friend ! " At these words, **RAMA** enquired of **SUGRIVA**, saying:-" I wish to know the source of this hostility, tell me the cause of your mutual enmity. When the reason for thine hatred is known to me, O Monkey, I will concern myself with thy relief. I shall reflect carefully on the marter and on its strength and weakness. Great is mine indignation to learn of thine ill treatment, my heart beats faster, as in the rainy season the river's flow is augmented. Speak with serene confidence while I string my bow, and know that when I loose my shaft to strike thine adversary, he is already slain." Hearing the speech of the magnanimous Kakutstha, **SUGRIVA** and his counsellors were highly gratified, and with a cheerful countenance **SUGRIVA** began to relate the real cause of his enmity with Bali to the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**.

CHAPTER 9

The Story of Bali and Mayavi

and I, also, lo\'ed him. When his father died, he being the elder, the ministers, who thought highly of him, mstalled him as King of the Monkeys. During his rule over that immense empire of his ancestors, I lived in constant subjection to him, as one of his ser\'Bnts. On account of a woman, a grest quarrel arose berween Mayavi, the illustrious elder son of Dundubhi and Bali. One night, whilst others slept, Mayavi approached the gates of Kishkindha, roaring with anger and challenged Bali to fight. Roused from deep sleep by those formidable cries, my brother, unable to contain himself, went forth immedi ately, advancing in fury on that powerful titan in order to kill him. His wives and I tried to

restrain him and I threw myself at his feet, but he repelled us all and went forth full of valour. “Then, out of devotion, I followed him. Seeing my brother and me following within a short distance, the titan, in fear, lied in all haste. Struck with terror he ran on, but we ran even faster. The moon, that had risen, flooded the path with its light. Hidden by grass, a large hole in the ground came into view and the titan threw himself into it precipitately. We reached the edge and halted. Bali, who was overcome with rage, his senses perturbed, said to me : '" O **SUGRIVA**, remain here, without leaving the mouth of the cave, while I enter in order to engage the enemy and slay him! ' “Hearing these words I besought that Destroyer of his Foes to go no further but he, under the threst of a curse, told me not to move from there and disappeared into the cavern. “After his entry into the cave, a whole year elapsed and I remained at my post without ; I imagined him to be dead and I86 KI SHKINDHA *KANDA* in my affection for him was deeply distressed and a prey to fearful presentiments, reflecting : ' I shall not see my brother again.' “Then, for a long time, blood mixed with foam flowed from the cave and the roaring of the titan reached my ears, but I did not hear the cries of triumph that my elder brother emitted in the struggle. Thereafter on account of the various signs, I went away, thinking that my brother was dead, but first I blocked up the mouth of the cave with a rock as large as a mountain. O My Friend, overcome by sorrow, I offered up the ceremonial water for my brother and returned to Kishkindha. “Despite mine efforts to keep the matter secret, the ministers learnt of it and having taken counsel together, they installed me as sovereign. I ruled the empire with justice, O **RAMA**. In the meantime Bali, having slain his enemy, the titan, returned. Seeing me installed with all the insignia of royalty, his eyes became red with anger and he overwhelmed me with reproaches and bound my ministers in chains. “Having slain his

adversary, my brother returned to the city, and I, paymg obeisance to that great warrior, offered him the traditiOnal homage, but he did not respond to my cordial congratulations. I touched his feet with my forehead, O Lord, but Bali in his anger retused to pardon me.”

CHAPTER 10

The Origin of Bali's Hatred of Sugriva

" IN my desire to make peace, I tried to placate my brother, who, returning, was incensed against me. there, my heart was filled with anguish and my mind deeply troubled. I then closed the opening of the cavern with a great rock and left that place to return to Kishkindha in deep distress. Seeing me, the people of that city and the ministers also placed me on the throne, without my desiring it. There fore pardon me, thou who art our Sovereign. I was invested with royal dignity in thine absence and thus preserved the city, its ministers and inhabitants, from anarchy. This kingdom has been as a trust to me ; I now render it back to thee, O Friend. Do not be wrath against me, O Destroyer of thy Foes ! Placing my head at thy feet, O King, with joined palms, I appeal to thee. It was on the insistence of the ministers and the united populace, that I was placed on the throne, they reflecting that the country would be seized by an enemy in the absence of a monarch.' “To this humble speech, Bali answered with invectives, saying :-' Cursed be thou ! ' and repeated the imprecation. Then, gathering his subjects and ministers together, he in veighed against me, in the midst of my friends, reproaching me with bitter words, saying : " ' Know wcll, that in anger the great Titan, Mayavi, one night challenged me to a long-desired combat. Hearing his voice, I left my royal dwelling and was followed

immedi· ately by my unscrupulous brother, who is present here. In the night, seeing me followed by another, that great titan fled terrified and both of us pursued him closely. In his haste to escape, he entered a great cave, and, seeing that vast and fearful cavern, I said to my false-hearted brother : ' I cannot closed. I called **SUGRIVA** again and again but there was no response and my situation was serious. By dint of kicking, I was able to roll back the rock and emerged, after which I returned to the city. Tbat is why I am incensed against the wicked **SUGRIVA**, whose desire for the throne overcame his brotherly affection.' " With these words, the monkey Bali, bereft of all sense of sbame, cbased me from the kingdom with but a single garment, baving ill-treated me and carried off my consort, O **RAMA**. Wretched and deprived of my companions, I took refuge on this lofty mountain, Rishyamuka, to which, for a particular reason, Bali bas no access. This is the whole story of the origin of our intense hostility ; I bave not merited the great humilia tion tbat bas visited me, as thou now seest, O Ragbava. O Thou who art the dispeller of fear, do thou take this dread of my brother from me and punish him in my name." The virtuous prince, baving heard the faithful **SUGRIVA**'s narrative, smiling, answered him saying : " These arrows of mine, bright as the sun, never fail to reach their target and with their sbarp points will strike down that evil Bali with force. As long as I do not behold this ravisher of thy consort, this wretch of perverse practices will live, but not an instant longer. " I see thee to be plunged in an ocean of grief, as am I, and I shall aid thee to traverse it ; thou shalt certainly regain thine erstwhile prosperity." Hearing these words, tbat increased his joy and courage, **SUGRIVA**, in extreme delight, uttered the following memorable words.

CHAPTER 11

Sugriva tells Rama of Bali's Exploits

Closed. I called **SUGRIVA** again and again but there was no response and my situation was serious. By dint of kicking, I was able to roll back the rock and emerged, after which I returned to the city. Tbat is why I am incensed against the wicked **SUGRIVA**, whose desire for the throne overcame his brotherly affection.' " With these words, the monkey Bali, bereft of all sense of sbame, cbased me from the kingdom with but a single garment, baving ill-treated me and carried off my consort, O **RAMA**. Wretched and deprived of my companions, I took refuge on this lofty mountain, Rishyamuka, to which, for a particular reason, Bali bas no access. This is the whole story of the origin of our intense hostility ; I bave not merited the great humilia tion tbat bas visited me, as thou now seest, O Ragbava. O Thou who art the dispeller of fear, do thou take this dread of my brother from me and punish him in my name." The virtuous prince, baving heard the faithful **SUGRIVA**'s narrative, smiling, answered him saying : " These arrows of mine, bright as the sun, never fail to reach their target and with their sbarp points will strike down that evil Bali with force. As long as I do not behold this ravisher of thy consort, this wretch of perverse practices will live, but not an instant longer. " I see thee to be plunged in an ocean of grief, as am I, and I shall aid thee to traverse it ; thou shalt certainly regain thine erstwhile prosperity." Hearing these words, tbat increased his joy and courage, **SUGRIVA**, in extreme delight, uttered the following memorable words. able to burn up the worlds with thy sharp arrows, like the fire at the end of the great cycle ; reflect on the courage of Bali and, haviDg beard me with attention, consider what should be done. " 'Ere the sun rises, tbe

indefatigable Bali snides from the western to the eastern ocean and from tbe northern to the southern sea. He is so powerful that be is able to break off tbe lofty mountain peaks, throwing them into tbe air and catching them again. In order to demonstrate his strength, be will snap in two innumerable trees of every kind in the forest. " Once, there existed a giant, named Dundubhi, in the form of a buffalo, who resembled the peak of Mt. Kailasba and who was as strong as a thousand elephants. The thought of his own might intoxicated him and he was puffed up with pride on account of the boons he bad received. " That giant came to the sea, the Lord of Rivers, and approached that ocean of tumultuous waves, rich in pearls, saying :-' Let us enter into combat one with the other ! ' But that righteous Lord of tbe Waters, rising up in all his majesty, answered that titan who was driven on by destiny, saying:-' O Skilful Warrior, I am not able to take up thy challenge, but bear and I will tell thee of one who can match thee in fight. " ' On a vast plain, the retreat of the ascetics, there lives a monarch of the mountains, named Himavat, the far-famed father-in-law of **SHIVA**. He possesses great rivers, many ravines and waterfalls and is well able to satisfy thine over whelming lust for combat.' Reflecting : ' The ocean holds me in dread', that foremost of titans sped to the forest of Himavat, as swift as an arrow loosed from a bow. " Breaking off the great white cliffs, Dundubhi let them roll down, shouting with exultation. Then, like a mass of white cloud, Himavat of gentle and benign aspect, standing on the summit of the mountain, addressed that titan thus :-' Do not torment me, O Dundubbi, O Thou who delightest in justice I I am not concerned with the exploits of warriors but am a refuge of the ascetics.' " Hearing these words of that righteous monarch of tbe mountains, Dundubhi, his eyes red with anger, answered : 1!10 " ' If thou hast not the strength to fight and art paralysed with fear, then tell me who is able to match his

prowess with mine, for I wish to enter into combat with him.' " Hearing this, the wise Himavat, skilful in discourse, answered that powerful titan to whom he had spoken previously, saying: " ' The name of that hero of great intelligence, who dwells in Kishkindha, is Bali, the illustrious son of Shakra. That great sage is a skilful warrior and of thy stature, he is as well able to enter into combat with thee as Vasava with Namuchi. Go with all speed and seek him out, since thou art thirsting to fight ; he has little patience and is ever full of martial ardour.' " Having listened to the words of Himavat, Dundubhi in fury went to Kishkindha, Bali's city, and assuming the form of a terrible buffalo with pointed horns, resembling a thunder cloud charged with rain in the sky, that powerful titan came to the gates of the capital. Causing the earth to tremble with his cries, he uprooted the trees near the entrance of the city, snapping them in two. Then, like an elephant, he burst open the gates. "My brother, who was in the inner apartments, hearing the tumult, came out, full of impatience, surrounded by his people with favours. Look long on Kishkindha ; enjoy the company of thy wives, fur I am about to chastise thee for thine insolence. To slay a drunken man or one who is demented or whose strength has ebbed away or who is without weapons or defence, or one, like thee, given over to lust, is considered equal to infanticide in the world.' " Dismissing all his wives, including Tara and others, my brother, restraining his wrath, smiling, answered that chief of the titans, saying : " ' Do not make a pretext of my being inebriated if thou art not afraid to enter into combat with me ! Know that in the present issue this intoxication is the wine of warriors ! ' " With these words he threw off the golden chain that his sire, Mahendra, had given him and began to fight. Seizing Dundubhi by the horns, who resembled a mountain, that elephant among monkeys roared aloud and began to assail him with blows. Thereafter Bali with a tremendous shout threw

him on the ground and blood began to flow from the stricken buffalo. " Then betwixt the two combatants, Bali and Dundubhi, mad with anger, each desirous of overcoming the other, a terrible struggle ensued. My brother fought with matchless courage, equal to **INDRA**'s, dealing blows with his fists, knees, feet and also with rocks and trees. The duel between the monkey and the titan caused the latter to weaken, whilst the strength of the former grew. In the end, Bali, lifting Dondubhi up, let him fall on the earth and in this death struggle the giant perished. " As he fell blood flowed in rivers from the veins of his body and that titan of rast limbs lay stretched on the ground, having rejoined the elements. " Lifting up the inanimate corpse in his two arms, Bali with one throw sent it ftying to a distance of four miles. From the titan's jaws, shattered by the violence of the fall, blood spouted forth and the ·drops were carried by the wind to Matanga's hermitage. Seeing that rain of blood, the Sage, displeased, reftected : ' What perverse wretch has dared to spatter me with blood ? Who is this evil, perfidious and vile creature, this madman ? ' " Thinking thus, that excellent *Muni* went out of the her mitage and beheld the buffalo, as large as a mountain, lying dead on the ground. By virtue of his austerities, he knew that a monkey was responsible for this deed and he pronounced a terrible curse on thatapewho had thrown the corpse there saying: " May he never come here ! If that monkey who, with a stream of blood, has desecrated this wood where I have built my retreat, ever sets foot in this place, he will die ! Should that wicked wretch who has thrown the corpse of this titan here, breaking my trees, come within four miles of my hermitage, he shall assuredly not survive and his confederates, whosoever they may be, who have sought refuge in my forest, will not be permitted to remain here following this malediction. Let them go where they will, for I shall assuredly curse any who stay in these woods, that I have protected like

mine own off spring, and destroy the foliage and young shoots, plucking the fruit and scratching up the roots. From to-day, every monkey that I see here will be changed into stone for the period of a thousand years ! ' " On hearing the words of the ascetic, all the monkeys that frequented those woods went away, and, beholding them issuing from the forest, Bali enquired of them, saying : " ' Why have ye all come here, ye dwellers in the Matanga Forest ? Happy are they who dwell in the woods ! ' " Then those monkeys told Bali, who wore a chain of gold, the cause of their departure and also of the curse that had been laid on them. " My brother, hearing the monkeys' words, sought out that great *Rishi* and with joined palms attempted to appease him, but Matanga refused to listen to him and re-entered his hermitage. " Trembling under the shadow of that curse, Bali began to roam about aimlessly, but, terrified of the malediction, that monkey did not dare approach the great mountain Rishyamuka or even glance in that direction, O Prince. " Knowing he will never venture here, O **RAMA**, I wander about these woods with my companions, free of all anxiety The heaped bones of Dundubhi, the victim of the arrogance, his strength inspired in him, are here and resemble the peak 193 of a vast mountain. Bali in his might, snipped all the leaves from these seven giant Sala trees with their mighty boughs, one after the other. His strength is immeasurable, O **RAMA** ; I have now proved it to thee. In consequence, 1 do not see how thou canst overcome him in battle, O King." Thus spoke **SUGRIVA** and **LAKSHMANA**, smiling, then enquired of him: " What can **RAMA** do to convince thee that he is able to overcome him ? " **SUGRIVA** then made answer : " If **RAMA** is able to penetrate these seven Sala trees, that Bali pierced again and again, with a single arrow, then, by that sign, I shall know he can overcome him. At the same time, let him with a single kick send the carcase of the buffalo ftying to a distance of a hundred bows'

length.” Having spoken, **SUGRIVA**, the comers of whose eyes were slightly red, reftected awhile and then once more addressed **RAMA**, the descendant of Kakutstha, saying : “Full of courage and audacity, renowned for his strength and energy, that powerful monkey has never ben defeated in combat. His exploits are famous ; the Gods themselves are not able to accomplish them. It was on remembering them, filled with terror, that I resolved to take refuge on the Rishyamuka Mountain. Thinking of that lndra among Monkeys and how invincible, irresistible and ruthless he is, I came here. Filled with distress and anguish, I wander about in these woods with my devoted and excellent companions, **HANUMAN** and others. Thou art for me a glorious and illus trious friend, O Thou who art dear to thy friends, O Lion among Men ! I take refuge with thee as in another Himavat ; yet I am conversant with the strength of my wicked brother and his overbearing nature and I am not acquainted with thy skill as a warrior, O Raghava. Assuredly, it is not that I wish to test thee or humiliate thee nor inspire thee with fear by re counting his great exploits. Mine own cowardice is well known ! O **RAMA**, thine accents, thine assurance, thy temerity and thy stature truly manifest thy gteat power, which is like a fire concealed beneath the ashes.” Hearing the words of the magnanimous **SUGRIVA**, **RAMA** began to smile and answered him, saying : 194 “If thou dost not trust in our courage, O Monkey, I will instil thee with that confidence so essential in war.” Then with his foot, that mighty hero sent the dried up carcase of that titan flying. Seeing the carcase hurtling through

CHAPTER 12

The Fight between Bali and Sugriva

“If thou dost not trust in our courage, O Monkey, I will instil thee with that confidence so essential in war.” Then with his foot, that mighty hero sent the dried up carcase of that titan flying. Seeing the carcase hurtling through eye tbat shaft with the speed of lightning, having pietced the seven ttces with extreme velocity, returned to **RAMA**’s quiver. Seeing those seven trees pietced by **RAMA**’s impetuous arrow, that Bull among Monkeys was extremely astonished and, overcome with joy adorned with all his ornaments, prostrated himself before Raghava with joined palms, his forehead touching the earth, Amazed at Rams’s prowess, he addressed tbat great warrior, skilled in the scriptural traditions, as also in the use of every weapon, who stood before him and said : " O Lion among Men, with rhine arrows, thou art able to destroy aU the Gods with their King in combat, why not Bali also ? O Kakutstha, who can resist thee on the field of battle, thou, who hast pierced seven Sa1a trees, the mountain and the earth with a single arrow ! Now my anxieties arc dispelled and my satisfaction complete. Where could I find a friend such as thou, who art equal to Mahendra and Varona? For my sake do thou subdue mine adversary in the form of a brother, I implore thee ! " **RAMA**, embracing the handsome **SUGRIVA**, like unto Lalsh mana, in his great wisdom answered him, saying: " Let us leave here without delay for Kishkindha. Do thou precede us. When we come to tbat city, O **SUGRIVA**, it is for thee to challenge Bali, who is a brother in name only.” Thereafter they started out in aU haste for Kishkindha, Bali’s capital. Concealing themselves behind some trees, they halted in a dense wood where **SUGRIVA** hurled defiance at Bali with a deep and challenging roar. His clothes tightly wrapped round him, he shouted with aU bis strength, shattering the silence of the firmament. When the powerful Bali heard his brother emitting rhis tremendous clamour, he was livid with anger and rushed out 1ile the sun rising over the mountain

top. Then a terrible struggle ensued between Bali and **SUGRIVA**, resembling the claah of Mars and Jupiter, in the heavens. With the striking of their palms lile the clap of thunder and their fists tbat were as hard as diamonds, the two brothers, filled with fury, assaulted each other, whilst **RAMA**, bow in hand, watched those two combatants, who resembled the Ashwins. Ig6 Not being able to distinguish between Bali and **SUGRIVA**, **RAMA** was loath to loose his death-dealing shaft. Then Sugtiva, overcome by Bali, seeing that Ranta refrained from coming to his aid, ran towatds the Rishyamuka Mountain. Exhausted, his limbs covered with blood, crushed by his brother's blows, who pressed him furiously, he took refuge in the vast forest. The mighty Bali, seeing him penetrating deep into the woods, said : " Go ! I spare thee ! " he himself not venturing to enter there, through fear of the curse. Then **RAMA**, accompanied by his brother and **HANUMAN**, re entering the wood, found the monkey **SUGRIVA**. When the latter perceived **RAMA** returning with **LAKSHMANA**, he hung his head in shame and in a tearful voice, his eyes fixed on the ground, said : " After demonstrating thy strength, thou didst issue the command : ' Challenge thine adversary ! ' Thereafter thou didst allow him to defeat me. Why hast thou done this ? O Raghava, thou shouldst have told me frankly : ' I do not wish to slay Bali,' then I would not have left this place." Thus in sad and reproachful tones did the great-souled **SUGRIVA** speak, and **RAMA** answered him, saying : " O **SUGRIVA**, My Dear Friend, do not vex thyself but hear the reason why I did not discharge mine arrow. Thine ornaments, clothes, shape and gestures and those of Bali so resembled each other that there was no difference between you ! The voice, colour, look, prowess and speech were wholly similar, O Monkey I Disconcerted by thine exact resemblance, O Best of Monkeys, I did not let fly my swift and dreadful death-dealing arrow, the slayer of the foe, for this reason. ' One must

have a care not to destroy them both,' I reflected. In truth, had I made an end of thine existence, O Chief of the Monkeys, through ignorance or carelessness, then my stupidity and heedlessness would have been apparent. To kill one's ally is assuredly a great and heinous sin. Further, I, Laksh mana and the fair-complexioned **SITA** are all wholly dependent on thee ; in the forest, thou art our refuge. Enter once more into combat, therefore, and fear nothing, O Monkey. In the twinkling of an eye, thou shalt see me piercing Bali with my 197 shaft and striking him down ; thou shalt see him writhing on the field of battle. Do thou, however, wear a distinguishing sign, O Chief of the Monkeys, by the help of which I may recognize thee in the thick of the struggle. O **LAKSHMANA**, these blossoming and beautiful Gajapushpi flowers, do thou place round the neck of the magoanimous **SUGRIVA**." Plucking the blossoming Gajapushpi from where it grew, **LAKSHMANA** placed it round the neck of **SUGRIVA**. The creeper that the fortunate **SUGRIVA** wore round his neck was as bright as the sun and resembled a circle of cranes illumining a cloud over which they are planing. Sparkling with beauty and encouraged by **RAMA**'s words, **SUGRIVA** started on the road to Kishkindba with him.

CHAPTER 13

The Hermitage of the Saptajanas

THE virtuous elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**, together with **SUGRIVA**, left the Rishyamuka Mountain and proceeded towards Kishkindha, which was maintained by Bali's valour, **RAMA** bearing his golden bow and carrying his arrows that shone like the sun in his hand. **SUGRIVA**, his neck adorned with a wreath of flowers, full of courage, strode before

the magoanintous Raghava and Laksh mana, behind whom came the hero **HANUMAN** with NaJa, the valiant Nila and the illustrious general Tara, renowned among the monkeys. They observed the trees bowed with the weight of their dowers and the rivers beariog their peaceful waters to the sea. The ravines and cliffs with their chasms, caves, peaks and charming dales, the lakes with their limpid waters of emerald hue, adorned with opening lotuS buds, drew their gaze as they passed. Ducks, cranes, swans, woodcock and other waterfowl were heard calling, whilst in the clearioqs of the woods deer could be seen grazing on the tender grass and young shoot, without fear of the wild beasts that roamed everywhere. Wild and ferocious elephants adorned with ivory tusks, who proved a menace to the lakes by causing the banks to 198 crumble, wandered about here and there and intoxicated with Mada juice, striking their foreheads against the rocks, resembled moving mountains. Monkeys as large as elephants, covered with dust and every species of wild beast and bird were seen by the followers of **SUGRIVA** as they passed on their way. Advancing thus in all haste, the Joy of the House of Raghu, **RAMA**, seeing a grove of trees, enquired of **SUGRIVA** :-" What is this clump of trees like a cloud in the sky ? Indeed they seem like a mass of clouds ringed round by plantain groves ! Great is my curiosity concerning them, O My Friend. I wish to learn of thee what these arc." On this enquiry from **RAMA**, **SUGRIVA**, still walking on, told him the history of tbat great wood. " O **RAMA** ! It is a vast hermitage tbat removes all weariness and encloses many pleasant gardens and groves ; the roots, fruit and water are delicious. Under the name of Saptajanas, seven *Munis* of rigid vows lived there, lying in the water, their heads alone emerging from it. Every seven days they partook of food, which was the wind from the mountain on which they dwelt. After seven hundred years they ascended to heaven in their bodies. Through the

power of their asceticism, this hermitage, encircled by a hedge of trees, is inaccessible even to the Gods and *Asuras*, as well as their leaders. The birds eschew it, as also the other beasts of the forest ; those who enter it un wittingly never return. Lovely melodies are heard issuing therefrom with the music of instruments and singing. Some times a divine fragrance is spread abroad from there, O Raghava, and three fires arc lit ; it is their smoke tbat one can sec from here ; the tops of the trees are enveloped in it like a golden cloud, resembling the plumage of a dove. " These trees arc magnificent with their tops crowned with smoke, like unto mountains of emerald crowned with rain clouds. Pay obeisance with reverence to them with joined palms, O Valiant Raghava, as also thy brother, **LAKSHMANA**. Those who offer salutations to those *Rishis* of pure soul experi ence naught tbat is grievous." Then Raghava with his brother **LAKSHMANA**, with joined palms, otrcrcd salutations to those illustrious ascetics. Having paid reverence to them, the virtuous **RAMA**, his brother Laksh mana and **SUGRIVA** with his monkeys went on happily. Having left the hermitage of Saptajanas far behind, they beheld the inaccessible Kishkindha protected by Bali. **RAMA**, his younger brother **LAKSHMANA** and the monkeys, famed for their valour, seizing their weapons, once more prepared to slay their enemy in that city which the son of the Chief of the Gods protected by his prowess. CHAPTER I4 Sugriw again challenges his brother to fight REnnooNG to Kishkindha, Bali's city, they all concealed themselves behind the trees in the dense forest. Glancing round on evety side, the Friend of the Woods, the thick necked **SUGRIVA** began to exhibit signs of extreme anger and, surrounded by his kinsmen, let out a loud roar, challenging his brother to fight. Shattering the firmament with his war cry which resembled a great thundercloud propelled by a high wind, that monkey, who was endowed with a leonine gait and resembled the rising sun, stepped forth. Looking

at Rams who was skilled in combat, **SUGRIVA** said to him :-" Behold Kishkindha, surrounded by its walls made of gold and a rampart of monkeys, that is bristling with instru ments of war and from which innumerable banners stream. This is Bali's citadel. Now fulfil the promise formerly made to me of slaying him, O Hero, as the blessing of Spring visits the aeepcrs." At **SUGRIVA**'s words, the virtuous Rams, the destroyer of his foes, answered :-" Thou an wearing that which will enable me to distinguish thee, this garland of Gaja Bowers, placed by **LAKSHMANA** round thy neck ! This creeper worn by thee lends thee the brilliance of the sky in which the sun is surrounded by stars, O Wanior. To-day, O Monkey, I will deliver thee from the fear and hostility that Bali inspires in thee. Point out thine adversary in the guise of a brother,

CHAPTER 14

Surgriva again challenges his Brother to fight

Paid reverence to them, the virtuous **RAMA**, his brother Laksh mana and **SUGRIVA** with his monkeys went on happily. Having left the hermitage of Saptajanas far behind, they beheld the inaccessible Kishkindha protected by Bali. **RAMA**, his younger brother **LAKSHMANA** and the monkeys, famed for their valour, seizing their weapons, once more prepared to slay their enemy in that city which the son of the Chief of the Gods protected by his prowess. CHAPTER I4 Sugriw again challenges his brother to fight REnnooNG to Kishkindha, Bali's city, they all concealed themselves behind the trees in the dense forest. Glancing round on evety side, the Friend of the Woods, the thick necked **SUGRIVA** began to exhibit signs of extreme anger and, surrounded by his kinsmen, let out a loud roar, challenging his brother to fight.

Shattering the firmament with his war cry which resembled a great thundercloud propelled by a high wind, that monkey, who was endowed with a leonine gait and resembled the rising sun, stepped forth. Looking at Rams who was skilled in combat, **SUGRIVA** said to him :-" Behold Kishkindha, surrounded by its walls made of gold and a rampart of monkeys, that is bristling with instru ments of war and from which innumerable banners stream. This is Bali's citadel. Now fulfil the promise formerly made to me of slaying him, O Hero, as the blessing of Spring visits the aeepcrs." At **SUGRIVA**'s words, the virtuous Rams, the destroyer of his foes, answered :-" Thou an wearing that which will enable me to distinguish thee, this garland of Gaja Bowers, placed by **LAKSHMANA** round thy neck ! This creeper worn by thee lends thee the brilliance of the sky in which the sun is surrounded by stars, O Wanior. To-day, O Monkey, I will deliver thee from the fear and hostility that Bali inspires in thee. Point out thine adversary in the guise of a brother, O **SUGRIVA** I Till Bali is sauck down in the forest, let him make merry, for when he crosses my path, he will not retlll'll alive. If he should do so, thou wilt be justified in reproaching me for not honouring my word. " In thy presence, seven Sala trees were transfixed by me with a single arrow ; rest assured that Bali will fall to-day on the field of battle under my shafts. " No light word has ever passed my lips, even in adversity, nor ever shall, even were it to attain my purpose ; therefore banish all anxiety. " Like a field rendered fertile by the rains of Shatakratu, do thou challenge Bali of the golden diadem. O **SUGRIVA**, raise a shout that will cause that monkey, proud of his victory, whom thou wert unable to subdue before, and who is bellicose by nature, to come forth. Those who deem themselves brave are not able to endure the war-cry of their foes, above all in the presence of women. Hearing **RAMA**'s words, the golden-hued **SUGRIVA** let out a deafening roar, rending the skies.

Terrified by the clamour, the kine ran hither and thither, like noble women exposed to danger of hostile attack through the negligence of their loved ones, and the wild deer lied away like maddened war horses wounded in battle, whilst the birds fell to the ground like planets whose virtue is exhausted. Then that son of **SURYA** emitted a roar resembling thunder, confident of his strength and radiant with courage, like the ocean whose waves arc lashed by a tempest. CHAPTER IS Tartis Adrlice to Bllli His brother Bali, who was seated amidst his wives in the inner apartments, heard the cry of the great-hearted **SUGRIVA** and was filled with wrath. When he caught the sound of that uproar, causing tertor to all beings, his feelings of lust changed

CHAPTER 15

Tara's Advice to Bali

O **SUGRIVA** I Till Bali is sauck down in the forest, let him make merry, for when he crosses my path, he will not retlll'll alive. If he should do so, thou wilt be justified in reproaching me for not honouring my word. " In thy presence, seven Sala trees were transfixed by me with a single arrow ; rest assured that Bali will fall to-day on the field of battle under my shafts. " No light word has ever passed my lips, even in adversity, nor ever shall, even were it to attain my purpose ; therefore banish all anxiety. " Like a field rendered fertile by the rains of Shatakratu, do thou challenge Bali of the golden diadem. O **SUGRIVA**, raise a shout that will cause that monkey, proud of his victory, whom thou wert unable to subdue before, and who is bellicose by nature, to come forth. Those who deem themselves brave are not able to endure the war-cry of their foes, above all in the presence of women. Hearing **RAMA**'s words, the

golden-hued **SUGRIVA** let out a deafening roar, rending the skies. Terrified by the clamour, the kine ran hither and thither, like noble women exposed to danger of hostile attack through the negligence of their loved ones, and the wild deer lied away like maddened war horses wounded in battle, whilst the birds fell to the ground like planets whose virtue is exhausted. Then that son of **SURYA** emitted a roar resembling thunder, confident of his strength and radiant with courage, like the ocean whose waves arc lashed by a tempest. CHAPTER IS Tartis Adrlice to Bllli His brother Bali, who was seated amidst his wives in the inner apartments, heard the cry of the great-hearted **SUGRIVA** and was filled with wrath. When he caught the sound of that uproar, causing tertor to all beings, his feelings of lust changed to those of violent anger and, his limbs trembling with fury, he who formerly shone like gold suddenly lost his brilliance, like the sun under eclipse. Grinding his teeth, his eyes fiash ing with fire, he resembled a lake from which the lotuses have been uprooted. Hearing that unendurable cry, that monkey strode forth in great haste, stamping on the earth as if he wished to shatter it. Then Tara, embracing him tenderly, once more avowed her devotion to him and, timid and troubled, addressed him in these words, the wisdom of which the future was to prove : " O Brave Warrior, this anger that has tllken hold of thee is like a raging torrent ; do thou abandon it, as on rising in the morning thou dost throw aside a faded garland. To morrow at dawn, enter into combat with **SUGRIVA**, O Valiant Forest Dweller, for thou dost not yet know the strength or weakness of thine enemy. That thou shouldst set out immedi ately does not meet with my approval. Hear while I tell thee the reason why I seck to delay thee ! " Formerly **SUGRIVA**, in greatangcr, came hither and challenged thee to fight, but defeated and overwhelmed by thy blows, he lied. Having been assaulted and crushed in this wise, he now returns to

challenge thee again, which rouses my suspicion. To roar thus in so insolent and arrogant a manner, so filled with wrath, is not done without a particular motive. To my mind, **SUGRIVA** has not returned alone but has an escort who is ready to rush to his defence ; hence this cry of defiance. **SUGRIVA** is a naturally clever and sagacious monkey and will never ally himself to one whose valour has not been tried. This, O Warrior, is what I have heard from the youthful Prince **ANGADA** ; tllke heed therefore and have a care; it is to thine advantage ! He hath told me all that he has heard from his emissaries concerning **SUGRIVA** while journeying in the forest. Two sons were born to the King of Ayodhya, full of courage, invincible in combat ; they are of the House of Ikshwaku and are renowned ; their names are **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. " Theae two indomitable heroes have sealed a pact of friend ship with **SUGRIVA**, and this ally of thy brother is **RAMA**, famed for his military exploits, the Destroyer of Enemy Hosts, who resembles the fire at the end of the wotld cycle. He dwells in the forest and is the supreme refuge of all the virtuous who seek his protection. He is the support of the oppressed, the unique repository of all glory and is conversant with both secular and spiritual learning ; his pleasure consists in carrying out the behests of his Sire. " As the King of the Mountains is a treasury of precious metals, so is he a mine of every good quality. It is peace and not war that thou shouldst seek with that magnanimous One, the invincible **RAMA**, whose prowess on the battlefield is without limit. O Hero, I have no desire to oppose thee, but tell thee this for thy good. Therefore, heed my counsel ! Do not seek a quarrel with thy younger brother, O Valiant Monarch. I am certain it is to thin advantage to contract a friendship with **RAMA**. Reconcile thyself with **SUGRIVA** and put all thoughts of hatred fur from thee. Thy younger brother is an inhabitant of the forest of amiable qualities. Whether he dwell here or there, he is bound to thee from every

point of view, and I do not see any like him in the world. With gifts, honours and in other ways, bind him to thyself through kind ness. Abandon thine ill-will and let him in future dwell near thee. The thick-necked **SUGRIVA** is a powerful, valuable and natural ally. Win back thy brother's affection ; there is no other way to happiness for thee here. If thou dost desire to please me and recognizest my devotion to thee, then in the name of affection, O My Friend, I implore thee to act aa I have counselled. Follow my advice which is salutary ; trust me and do not give way to anger ; live in peace with the son of the King of Koshala ; do not quarrel with him, his valour is equal to **INDRA**'s." In these words, which were fUll of wisdom and would have enabled him to save himself, Tara addressed Bali, but he refused to listen and, driven by the force of destiny, advanced to meet his death.

CHAPTER 16

Rama inflicts a mortal Wound on Bali

THUS spoke Tara, whose mce was as radiant as the moon, and Bali answered hcr in tones of reproach, saying: " When my brothcr, who is above all mine adversary, challenges me in angcr, how shall I endure ir, O Lady of Lovely Countcoance ? The brave who are not accustomed to bearing insults and who nevei back in battle, O Timid One, would rather suffcr death than such ignominy. I may not disregard the weak-necked **SUGRIVA** who, in his detcrmination to entcr into combat, has offered me so insolent a challenge. " Have no anxiety on my behalf regarding Raghava, for he is convcrsant with *dharma* and pious by nature. How could he do wrong ? Return home with thy companions ! Why follow me furthcr ? Thou hast demonstrated thy tender devotion sufficiently! I

am about to set out to fight **SUGRIVA**; control thine emotions. I shall punish his insolence, but I shall not lllke his life. I shall entcr into combat with him, since he desires it, and, assailed by the blows dealt with my lists and the trunks of trees, he will flee. Tbat coward will not be able to withstand my strength and prowess. O Tara, thou hast accompanied me far enough and shown thine affection for me sufficiently, now return, and I, having oblllined saris merion from my brothcr on the battlefield. will follow thee; I swear it by my life and race." Then the virtuous Tara, embracing Bali and speaking tendcrly to him, weeping, circumambulated him, keeping him on hcr right hand, and bidding him mewell according to the tradition and reciting the sacred texts so that he might return victorious, she re-entcred the inner apartments, distracted with grief. When Tara reached the inncr sanctuary with the othcr women, Bali, distraught with anger, went out of the city, 204 hiss.ing like a great serpent. Full of ire, breathing heavily, he ran with aU his strength, looking round on every side, esger to find his adversary. At last he beheld that powetful monkey, the golden-hued **SUGRIVA**, clothed in excellent armour, fuU of confidence, resem bling a brazier, and, seeing him in1lated with pride, Bali wrspped his garments more tightly about him, a prey to extreme anger. Having thus girded up his apparel, his fists clenched, fuU of vigour, be advanced to meet **SUGRIVA** and engage him in combat. From his side, **SUGRIVA**, also doubling his fists in rage, went out to meet his brother who was wearing a crown of gold. Then Bali, addressing **SUGRIVA**, whose eyes were red with anger, who was skilled in the an of fighting and was rushing towards him in fury, said: " With this clenched fist, its fingers tightly closed, I shaU deal thee a blow tbat wiU cause thee to yield up thy life." At these words, **SUGRIVA**, livid with anger, answered :-" It is mine that wiU drive the life's breath out of thee by caving in thy skull."

Thereafter, violently assaulted by Bali, be hurled himself on him in fury, rivers of blood streaming from him, like a mountain from which torrents faU. Unperturbed, **SUGRIVA**, tearing up a Sala tree, struck his rival's body as lightning fells a mountain peak. Struck by the Sala tree which unnerved him, Bali resembled a heavily-laden ship, sinking with aU its cargo in the waves. Endowed with terrific strength and as agile as Suparna, both fought like two formidable giants resembling the sun and moon in the sky. Each of these two destroyers of their foes sought to find the weak point of his enemy. Bali excelled in strength and valour while the son of **SURYA**, **SUGRIVA**, despite his great energy, was the weaker, and his courage beginning to dwindle, he ceased to boast and, cnrsged with his brother, made a sign to **RAMA**. The uprooted trees with their branches and crests, the blows from fists, knees and feet, feU thick and fast in the formidable struggle that resembled the duel between Vritta and Vasava. Covered with blood, the two monkeys, dwellers in the forest, whilst fighting resembled two thunderclouds clashing together with a great uproar. 205 **RAMA**, observing **SUGRIVA**, the Prince of Monkeys, exhausted scanning the horizon without ceasing to struggle, and, seeing that he was almost overcome, selected an arrow for the purpose of slaying Bali, and that great hero stretched his bow and with that shaft, resembling a venomous serpent, held it ready, like Antaka, bearing the Wheel of Time. The twanging of the bowstring caused alarm among the birds, who flew away, as also the wild beasts who fled in terror as at the end of the world period. Discharged by **RAMA** with a sound like the crash of thunder, that formidable arrow of dazzling aspect pierced Bali's breast, and under its fatal impact the powerful and valiant King of the Monkeys fell to the earth, resembling **INDRA**'s banner ruthlessly thrown to the ground on the day of the full moon in the month of the constellation of Aries. Stricken and senseless, Bali fell, his voice

strangled with sobs which gradually died away. **RAMA**, the strongest of men, discharged that formidable, fiery and death-dealing arrow, shining like gold, resembling Time itself at the end of the world, which shot forth like smoke issuing from the flaming mouth of Hara, and, streaming with blood looked like unto a blossoming Ashoka tree on the mountain-side, whereupon the Son of Vasava, like the banner of lndra that has been overthrown, fell senseless on the field of battle.

CHAPTER 17

Bali reproaches Rama

fine gold, his limbs paralysed, he sank to the ground, like the banner of the Chief of the Gods, its cord severed. At the fall of the King of the Monkeys, the earth grew dark, resembling the firmament bereft of the moon. Though lying on the earth, the body of that high-souled Bali was neither robbed of its beauty nor of its life's breath, nor did his courage 206 fail him, for that excellent golden necklace that **INDRA** had bestowed on him preserved the life, strength and beauty of that Lord of Monkeys. Adorned with that golden chain, the heroic Monkey Chief appeared like an evening cloud tinged with the roseate hues of dusk ! His chain, his body and the arrow piercing his heart blazed in triple glory, even after he had fallen. That arrow loosed by the valiant **RAMA** from his bow, by its virtue opening the way to heaven, brought Bali supreme deliverance. Lying on the field of battle, like a fire without flame, he resembled Yayati cast forth from the divine realms, fallen on the eanh, his merits exhausted. Like the sun that Time, at the end of the world, throws down on the earth ; unapproach able like Mahendra, inaccessible as U pendra, with his golden necklace, his broad chest, his

vast arms, his mouth inflamed, his glances wild, that son of a mighty king lay. And **RAMA** followed by **LAKSHMANA**, their eyes fixed upon him, approached that warrior lying there like a naked flame about to be quenched. Full of respect for that hero, who was gazing at them, the two valiant brothers, **RAMA** and Laksbmana, approached with slow steps. On perceiving them, the supremely courageous Bali uttered these harsh words, that seemed both restrained and just. Stretched on the earth, almost without lustre, mottally wounded, motionless, in words pregnant with meaning he addressed that warrior proudly, saying: " Striking me from behind, what merit dost thou hope to earn by this, O Thou who bast inflicted a mortal wound on me, while I was engaged in combat with another ? ' The virtu ous **RAMA** is full of nobility, generosity and valour; be is compassionate, devoted to the welfare of all beings, fixed in his duty; gracious, omnipotent and conversant with the rules of conduct and austerity ; these are the praises sung of thee, these are the merits attributed to thee by the whole world! " Self-mastery, forbearance, loyalty, fixity of purpose, good will and heroism are the virtues of kings, O Prince, as also the repression of evil deeds. It was reflecting on these virtues, believing them to be thine, that I came to fight **SUGRIVA**. ' Whilst I am filled with rage and engaged in combat with 207 another, he will not attllek me ' was my conviction, even without knowing thee. Now I perceive that thou art a perverse crestute, feigning piety whilst in truth thou an like a well concealed in the grass, without faith and resoning to evil deeds. Outwardlyvirrnous, wearing the cloak of integrity, thou art in reality a scoundrel, like a fire bidden by ashes, nor do I recognize thee behind the concealing mask of virrne. " Since I have neither laid waste thy land, nor thy city and have not offered thee insult, why hast thou destroyed me -I who am guiltless and who have ever fed on fruit and roots, a monkey dwelling in the forest, who never sought to

enter into combat with thee but who was engaged in fighting another ? Thou an the son of a king and inspired confidence by thy benign aspect and, what is more, thou wearest the livery of sanctity; who of the warrior caste, conversant with what is good and evil, in the garb of a righteous man, would commit such a wicked deed ? " Thou art born of the House of Raghu and art spoken of as virtuous, how canst thou, assuming the guise of an ascetic, wander about thus ? Equanimity of soul, liberality, forbear ance, justice, loyalty, constancy and courage are the character istics of a king, O Prince, also the meting out of punishment to the guilty. “We live in the forest, O **RAMA**, and are but wild beasts who feed on roots and fruits, which is natutal to us ; but thou art a man, O Prince ! Land, gold and besuty are the causes of discord, but here in the woods, who will envy us fruit and roots ? In temporal and spiritual matters, as well as in the dispensing of reward and punishment, a king should be wholly given up to the task of government and not dominated by any desire for pleasure, but thou art consumed by thy desires ; irascible, restless, disregarding the royal code, thy bow is thy cherished argument! Thou dost not pursue the path of duty nor does thine understanding concern itself with the interests of the people ; a slave to lust, thou dost permit thy senses to rule thee, O Chief of Men. In a word, Kakutstha, thou hast slain me, who never did thee any harm I How wilt thou answer in the assembly of the virrnous, having committed this reprehensible deed ? aos " The regicide, the brahmanicide, the slayer of the cow, the thief and the one who finds pleasure in the destruction of other beings, the unbeliever and the one who weds before his elder brother, all these enter hell. The informer, the miser, the one who slays his friend or defiles his Guru’s bed, un doubtedly descends to the region of evil-doers ! “It is not permitted to the well-born to clothe themselves in my skin, nor may those, such as thou, partake of my flesh if they follow the

tradition. There arc five kinds of animals possessing five nails on each paw that may be enjoyed by the *brahmin* and the warrior, O **RAMA**. They arc the porcupine, the hedgehog, the deer, the hare and the tortoise. O **RAMA**, men of worth will not touch my skin or bones nor eat my flesh. " Alas I I disregarded Tara, who, sagacious and prudent, offered me sound counsel, but in my folly, overpowered by fate, I did not heed it. O Kakutstha, like a virtuous woman who has married a man devoid of faith, the earth is without a protector, since thou its protector. How canst thou be born of the magnanimous **DASARATHA**, seeing that thou art deceitful, mischievous, evil-hearted and treacherous ? Having exceeded the bounds of restraint, broken the law of the virtuous and disregarded the goad of justice, that elephant, **RAMA**, has struck me down. Guilty of such an infamy, condemned by the wise, finding thyself in their presence, what wilt thou say? " That valour that has been so grcady vaunted to us who arc neutral, I do not see thee exercising against evil-doers I If thou hadst fought me openly, O Prince, thou wouldst now find thyself in the presence of death, having been slain by me. Thou didst overcome me by taking me unawares, as a serpent bites a sleeping man, I who was else invincible. Thou art ruled by evil. In order to gratify **SUGRIVA**, thou hast struck me down. " If thou hadst first confided thy purpose to me, I would have brought **SITA** hack to thee in a day. Not only this, but I should have placed that wicked ravisher of thy spouse, the titan, **RAVANA**, in thy power, a chain round his neck, having laid him low in combat. Even if **SITA** had been cast into the bottom of the sea or hell itself, I should have brought her hack to thee at thy command, as **VISHNU** recovered the scriptures that had been borne away by Hayagriva. 209 " **SUGRIVA** would have obtained the throne legitimately on my depanure to the celestial realm, whereas now he has acquired it wrongfully, since thou hast overcome me by craft on the field of battle.

As desth in this world is inevitable, I hold it as naught but how wilt thou justify thy conduct towards me ? " Thus, pierced by an arrow, his features altered, did that magnanimous son of the Monarch of Monkeys speak whilst looking on **RAMA**, who was as radiant as the sun, after which he fell silent.

CHAPTER 18

Rama answers Bali

mortally wounded, made to **RAMA**. Resembling the sun shorn of its rays or a parched cloud or a fire that has been extinguished, that illustrious King of the Monkeys, endowed with justice and reason, having upbraided **RAMA** with severity, was addressed by him in the following words : " O Bali, why dost thou inveigh against me like a child, since thou art wholly ignorant of the traditions of duty, profit and social convention ? Without consulting thine eldera, who are held in respect by the *brahmins*, in thy simian folly thou hast presumed to address me thus, who am filled with good-will towards thee. " This earth belongs to the Ikshwakus, together with its mountains, forests and woods and they have jurisdiction over the wild beasts, birds and men. It is ruled by the virtuous **BHARATA**, who is fixed in his duty and fully conversant with the law, with the proper means to acquisition of wealth and the right pursuit of pleasure and who is ever engaged in repressing evil-doers and recompensing the virtuous. It is the duty of a king to develop the art of government, be established in virtue, be endowed with valour and know how to estimate time and place. We other princes carry out his righteous commands and range the whole earth in our desire to promote the law. When that Lion among Men, **BHARATA** who cherishes

equity, rules the entire world, who would dare to commit an injustice ? Fixed in our supreme duty, obedient to Bbarata's will, in accord with the law, we put down transgression. Thou hast violated justice and thy conduct is condemned by all, lust being thine only mentor, ignoring as thou dost the royal path. " One who pursues the path of duty should regard his elder brother, the one who bas given him birth and the one who instructs him in wisdom as his three fathers. Righteousness demands that a younger brother, a son and a virtuous disciple should be regarded as one's own offspring; even for the virtuous, duty is subtle and not easy to grasp, the soul residing in the heart alone knows what is right and wrong. "O Heedless Monkey, thou art surrounded by irresponsible simian counsellors, who are unable to control themselves, thus it is a case of the blind leading the blind, how canst thou learn from them ? I am speaking frankly to thee ; thou badst no possible right to reproach me in my wrath. Learn now for what reason I srruck thee down. " Thou bast acted in opposition to the spiritual law. While **SUGRIVA** yet lives, thou hast bad marital relations with Ruma, who is thy sister-in-law. O Perverse Wretch, in order to satisfy thy lust, thou bast rransgressed the law of righteousness and, O Monkey, since thou hast not respected thy brother's wife, this retribution bas followed thee. I see no other means of restraining him who acts conrrary to the interests of his subjects and does not conform to the social code but by punish ment, O King of the Monkeys ! " Being a warrior of an illustrious race, I am unable to brook thy villainy. The man who makes his daughter, his sister or his sister-in-law an object of lust, is punishable by death ; this is the law ! " Though Bbarata is the supreme monarch, we carry out his behests. How canst thou who bast broken the law, escape punishment ? He who fails to listen to his insrructor in the form of the law, will be judged according to the law by the King. " Bbarata seeks to repress

dissolute customs, and we who carry out his commands fully try to bring to justice those who, like thee, overstep the boundaries of the law, O Chief of the Mookeys. " **SUGRIVA** is my friend and equal to **LAKSHMANA** ; it is for the recovery of his wife and kingdom that be entered into a pact of friendship with me. In the presence of his ministers, I pledged my word ; how can a man like myself fail to meet these obligations ? “For all these reasons based on the law, thou caust judge for thyself, whether thy punishment is merited or no. That it is wholly just, thou wilt be forced to admit and, further, that one is bound to help a fnend if one acknowledges one’s duty. Thou wouldst have done likewise if thou hadst followed the law. Two of the verses of Manu are specislly devoted to these rules of conduct and are known to the authorities of the law ; I have been fuithful to them. ' Those men who, having done wrong, submit to the penalty imposed by the king, are washed free from every stain and ascend to heaven like the good and those who do benevolent deeds. Further punish ment or pardon exonerates the thief from his fault, but the king who does not put down vice himself assumes the guilt.' " My worthy ancestor Mandhata voluntarily underwent a terrible expistion for a monk who was guilty of an offence similar to thine whom he pardoned. Other monarchs, in their folly, have also done wrong, but have practiced penance; it is by this means that passion is subdued. But enough of recriminations ! Thy death has been decreed in accordance with the spiritual law, O Lion among Monkeys ; we are not acting on personal impulse. " Listen to a further reason, O Valiant Bull among Monkeys; having grasped its significance, thou wilt no longer be able to reproach me. Neither did I follow mine own whim, nor did I act hastily, nor in anger. " Snares, nets and traps of every kind, either open or con cealed, are used to catch innumerable wild beasts, whether they be fieeing in terror, or, unaftaid, are standing

still. Whether these beasts are maddened with fear or no, they who feed on fiesh run them through without pity while their back is turned ; it does not seem to me that they arc at fault. In this world, even royal *Rishis*, versed in their dnty, indulge in the chase. This is why, with a single arrow, I struck thee down while engaged in combat with thy brother, O Monkey. What boots it, whether thou didst enter into combat with me or no, since thou art but a monkey. " Unquestionably it is kings who dispense the unwritten law and happiness in life, O Best of Monkeys I One should never reproach them, nor address them disrespectfully, nor disrcgsrd them ; they are Gods who, assuming human form, dwell on earth! But thou in thine ignorance of the law, dominated by anger, didst insult me, who have ever conformed ro the established tradition of mine ancestors." Hearing Ratna's words, Bali, deeply mortified, no longer sought to denounce the son of Raghu, the task of duty now having been rendered clear to him, and with joined palms that King of the Monkeys answered him, saying : " Undoubtedly, O First of Men, what thou hast uttered is truth ! To gsinsay an eminent personage is not permitted ro one who is of common stock. It was in ignorance that I formerly addressed thee in disrespectful terms. Do not hold it agsinst me, O Raghava, thou who art conversant with the significance and implication of things and devoted to the welfare of all. In the serenity of thine understanding, that nothing disturbs, the working out of cause and effect are known to thee. O Thou whose speech accords with justice and who art conversant with duty, rescue me who am fallen and the first of those to transgress the law." In a voice strangled with sobs, Bali, groaning, ezprcssed himself with laboured effort, his eyes fixed on Ratna, and resembled an elephant sinking in a morass. " I am not concerned for myself or Tara or my relatives, as much as for my virtuous son, **ANGADA**, of golden bracelets. Beholding me no more, that

uofortnnate one, who has been so cherished from childhood, will pine away with grief, like a pool whose waters have dried up. He is yet young and his understanding has not yet matured ; he is my only son and most dear to me. Tara is his mother, O Ratna; do thou protect that powerful **ANGADA**. " Show extreme kindness to **SUGRIVA** and **ANGADA** ; be their guardian and their guide, O Thou who art fully convenant with the laws of righteousness and unrighteousness. What thou wouldst perform for Bhatata and **LAKSHMANA**, do for **SUGRIVA** and **ANGADA**. " See that **SUGRIVA** does not hold the sagacious Tara re sponsible for the fault I have committed or fail to treat her with respect. Under thy protection, let him govern the kingdom and, living obedient to thy counsels, he will attain heaven as well as rule the earth. As for myself, despite Tara's words, I wished to receive death at thine hands and came forth to enter into a duel with my brotber **SUGRIVA**." Having spoken thus to Rams, the now humble King of the Monkeys became silent. Then **RAMA** consoled Bali who was still fully conscious and spoke to him in a gentle voice, expressing the essence of spiritual and secular wisdom, saying : " Have no anxiety either on our behalf or thine own, O Best of Monkeys. We know what should be done, above all in that which concerns thee. He who punishes the goUty and he who is goUty and pays the penalty have both ful1illed the purpose of cause and effect and therefore eschew calamity. Thus, thanks to the punishment that frees them from all taint, they regain their immaculate nature by the very path which paved the way to the penalty. " Put away grief, bewilderment and fear with which thine heart is filled ; thou canst not avoid thy fate, O Chief of the Monkeys. What **ANGADA** was to thee, O King of the Monkeys, he will be to **SUGRIVA** and myself; do not doubt it." The magnanimous Rams, intrepid in combat, uttered these words full of tenderness and benignity, in accord with righteous ness, and the dweller in the forest answered him

humbly, saying: " Pierced by thine arrow, my mind bewildered, I insulted thee without knowing what I was doing, O Lord, Thou whose immeasurable valour is equal to Mahendra's I Be pacified and pardon me, O Veritable Sovereign of the Monkeys." 19 Tara's Grief THE mighty King of the Monkeys, who lay piexced by an arrow, did not reply further to Rams's judicious words. His limbs crushed by rocks, sevexly bruised by the trees that **SUGRIVA** had hurled at him, ttansfixed by Rams's shaft, at the point of death, he swooned away. Tara, learning that he had been sttuck down by an arrow discharged by **RAMA** in the sttuggle and receiving the dis ttessing tidings that her lord lay dying, with a troubled heart hastily emexged with her son from the rocky cavern. The monkeys who followed **ANGADA**, however, on seeing **RAMA** with his how, ran away in fear. Pexceiving those monkeys fleeing in texror, like deer that scatter when the Jeadex of the herd falls dead, Tara, though herself distraught, rallied the frightened monkeys, who sought to escape from **RAMA**, as if his shafts had already been dis charged at them, and said : " O Monkeys, you are the servants of that Lion among Monarchs ; why are you abandoning all and flying in disorder? Has Bali not been laid low by his wicked brother on account of the throne? It was from afar that **RAMA** loosed his far reaching arrow I " Thus did the consort of Bali speak, and those monkeys, who were able to change their shape at will, answered with one voice in words fitting to the occasion, saying : " O Thou, who art the mothex of a living son, return home and protect **ANGADA** I Death, in the fortn of Rams, has sttuck Bali down and is hearing him away. Having launched a volley of immense trees and great rocks, Bali fell, horne down by arrows that resembled the lightning. Beholding that Lion among Monkeys ovexcome, him whose prowess was equal to **INDRA**'s, the whole army of monkeys has taken to flight. Let the warrinrs save the city and install

ANGADA as king I The

CHAPTER 19

Tara's Grief

Tara’s Grief THE mighty King of the Monkeys, who lay piexced by an arrow, did not reply further to Rams’s judicious words. His limbs crushed by rocks, sevexly bruised by the trees that **SUGRIVA** had hurled at him, ttansfixed by Rams’s shaft, at the point of death, he swooned away. Tara, learning that he had been sttuck down by an arrow discharged by **RAMA** in the sttuggle and receiving the dis ttessing tidings that her lord lay dying, with a troubled heart hastily emexged with her son from the rocky cavern. The monkeys who followed **ANGADA**, however, on seeing **RAMA** with his how, ran away in fear. Pexceiving those monkeys fleeing in texror, like deer that scatter when the Jeadex of the herd falls dead, Tara, though herself distraught, rallied the frightened monkeys, who sought to escape from **RAMA**, as if his shafts had already been dis charged at them, and said : " O Monkeys, you are the servants of that Lion among Monarchs ; why are you abandoning all and flying in disorder? Has Bali not been laid low by his wicked brother on account of the throne? It was from afar that **RAMA** loosed his far reaching arrow I " Thus did the consort of Bali speak, and those monkeys, who were able to change their shape at will, answered with one voice in words fitting to the occasion, saying : " O Thou, who art the mothex of a living son, return home and protect **ANGADA** I Death, in the fortn of Rams, has sttuck Bali down and is hearing him away. Having launched a volley of immense trees and great rocks, Bali fell, horne down by arrows that resembled the lightning. Beholding that

Lion among Monkeys ovexcome, him whose prowess was equal to **INDRA**'s, the whole army of monkeys has taken to flight. Let the warrinrs save the city and install **ANGADA** as king I The monkeys will obey Bali's son, who will take his place. If these conditions do not meet with thine approval, O Lady of agreeable looks, then the monkeys will seek other inaccessible retreats. Amongst those who live in the forest, some have no wives, others have common wives, but we fear those who have been deprived of their wives and still desire them. " As they were but a short distance away, that Lady of Sweet Smiles heard them and answered with dignity, saying : " Since that Lion among Monkeys is dying, of what use to me is my son or the entire kingdom ? I shall seek out the feet of that magnanimous hero whom **RAMA** has slain with a single arrow." Speaking thus, overcome with grief, beating her head and breast with her two hands and weeping, in her distress she rushed towards him and, still running, beheld her lord lying on the earth, he, the slayer of the foremost of monkeys, who never turned back in battle; he, who was able to hurl great mountains, as Vasava discharges his thunderbolt with all the fury of a storm, roaring the while like a great mass of thunder, clouds; he whose valour was equal to Shakra's; that hero pierced by a single arrow, lay on the earth, like the leader of antelopes a tiger has struck down for its prey, or like a place of sacrifice, held sacred by all, with its banners and its altars laid waste by Suparna on account of a serpent. Then Tara beheld the mighty **RAMA** leaning on his bow, standing with his younger brother and the brother of her lord, and, beside herself with grief, she approached her spouse, who had fallen on the battlefield and, seeing him lying there, was overcome by distress and fell to the ground. Then, rising as if newly waking from sleep, seeing her lord caught in the noose of death, sobbing, she cried out : " O King I " Her piercing cries, resembling an osprey's, moved

SUGRIVA deeply, as did the presence of **ANGADA** also.

CHAPTER 20

Her Lamentations

SEEING her lord lying on the earth, pierced by that death dealing arrow discharged by **RAMA**, Tara, whose face resembled the moon, approaching him, embraced him. At the sight of Bali, who lay like an elephant wounded by an arrow, that monkey resembling a huge mountain or an uprooted tree, Tara poured out her heart, tom with grief, in lamentation : " O Thou who wert full of valour in combat ! O Hero ! O Best of Monkeys! It is because of my recent importunities that thou wilt not now speak to me I Rise, O Lion among Monkeys and rest on a comfortable couch ! Those great monarchs, thine equals, do not sleep on the earth ; or is the earth thy cherished love, since even in dying thou dost lie by her and scornest me ? " Without doubt, O Warrior, thanks to thy great exploits, thou hast founded another and more glorious Kishkindha in heaven ! The pleasures once shared in the woods and in the fragrant bowers are henceforth at an end. I am bereft of all joy and hope and sunk in a sea of sorrow, since thou, tbe King of Kings. art returning to the five elements.' My heart must be made of stone, since, seeing thee lying on the earth, grief does not cause it to break into a thousand pieces. Thou didst steal away **SUGRIVA**'s consort and sent him into exile ; it is tbe fruit of this double fault that thou art now expiating, O Chief of the Monkeys ! " Intent on thy welfare, I submitted to thy senseless re proaches ; I, who in the desire to be of service to thee gave thee nought but wise counsel, O **INDRA** of Monkeys I Now, O Proud Lord, beguiled by their youthful and seductive beauty, thou art moving

the hearts of tbe Apsaras. It is irrevocable fate which this day has put an end to thine existence ; thou whom **SUGRIVA** could not vanquish hast resigned thyself to its power I " Having without cause struck down Bali who was engaged in combat with another, though it is censurable, Kakutstha has no regrets. I who, till now, did not know distreas, de prived of thy support, at the height of misfortune, must pass my life as a widow. What will the fate of **ANGADA** be, the object of my tenderness, a valiant though youthful prince accustomed to pleasure, now at the mercy of his paternal uncle, who is filled with anger against us ? Look long on thy virtuous Sire, O My Beloved Son ! Soon thou shalt see him no more. " And Thou, O comfort thy son, give him counsel, em bracing his brow before thou departest on thy last journey I Assuredly **RAMA** has accomplished a great feat in striking thee down, but he is guiltless, for all be did was to obey **SUGRIVA**. O **SUGRIVA**, rejoice, regain possession of Ruma and enjoy the kingdom without hindrance; thy brother, thine adversary, is wounded unto death. " But Thou, O My Beloved, why dost thou not answer my complaint ? See, thy numerous and lovely wives surround thee, O King of the Monkeys." Hearing Tara's lamentations, those unfortunate women, placing **ANGADA** in their midst, emitted pitiful cries on every side. Then Tara spoke once again, saying : " How canst thou abandon **ANGADA**, O Thou whose powerful arms are decorated with bracelets, and go forth on thy last journey thus? It is not meet to abandon a son who possesses thy virtues and is aimiable and handsome. If inadvertently I have offended thee, O l.ong-armed Hero, then forgive me ! O Chief of the Monkey Tribe, I lay my head at thy feet." Thus did Tara with the other queens lament bitterly at the side of her lord and that lady of matchless beauty resolved to die of hunger lying on the earth at Bali's side. CHAPTER :ll Hammum's Speech HANvMAN, however, the Leader of the Monkeys, gently tried to

console Tara, who was lying on the earth like a star fallen from the heavens, and said : " The fruits of all that is done undet the impulse of vinue or vice must be plucked after death, whether they be good or evil. O Unhappy One, for whom dost thou weep ? Unfortunate One, whom dost thou bewail ? For whose life, that bubble, should one mourn ? Henceforth the youthful **ANGADA** should be the object of thy solicitude, since he alone survives. From now on, thou shouldst concern thyself on his account and render him fitting service. Thou knowest well how uncertain is the future of all beings ; therefore it is for thee to perform noble deeds here, who conversant with thy duty and who art a stranger to common acts I " He under whom hundreds and thousands of monkeys lived has now reached the uttermost bourne of his destiny, and since he fulfilled the injunctions laid down by the law and was distinguished for his impartiality, his liberality and his tolerance, he now dwells among the virtuous conquerors. Why shouldst thou mourn for him ? O Irreproachable One, thou hast now become the protectress of all the leading monkeys, thy son, and also this kingdom of the apes and bears. Little by little do thou console these two (***SUGRIVA** and **ANGADA***) who are a1Hicted, and under thy tutelage, O Fair Lady, let **ANGADA** rule the earth. · " To ensure the future and reflect on the present is the whole duty of a prince; it is so decreed by destiny. **ANGADA**

CHAPTER 21

Hanuman's Speech

CHAPTER :ll Hammum’s Speech HANvMAN, however, the Leader of the Monkeys, gently tried to console Tara, who was lying on the earth like a star fallen from the heavens, and said : " The fruits of all that is

done undet the impulse of vinue or vice must be plucked after death, whether they be good or evil. O Unhappy One, for whom dost thou weep ? Unfortunate One, whom dost thou bewail ? For whose life, that bubble, should one mourn ? Henceforth the youthful **ANGADA** should be the object of thy solicitude, since he alone survives. From now on, thou shouldst concern thyself on his account and render him fitting service. Thou knowest well how uncertain is the future of all beings ; therefore it is for thee to perform noble deeds here, who conversant with thy duty and who art a stranger to common acts I " He under whom hundreds and thousands of monkeys lived has now reached the uttermost bourne of his destiny, and since he fulfilled the injunctions laid down by the law and was distinguished for his impartiality, his liberality and his tolerance, he now dwells among the virtuous conquerors. Why shouldst thou mourn for him ? O Irreproachable One, thou hast now become the protectress of all the leading monkeys, thy son, and also this kingdom of the apes and bears. Little by little do thou console these two (***SUGRIVA** and **ANGADA***) who are a1Hicted, and under thy tutelage, O Fair Lady, let **ANGADA** rule the earth. · " To ensure the future and reflect on the present is the whole duty of a prince; it is so decreed by destiny. **ANGADA** " I would rather cling to the body of this hero than a hundted sons like **ANGADA**. I am not able to govern the monkeys nor is he ; such a duty devolves on his paternal uncle, **SUGRIVA**. O **HANUMAN**, it is not for me to confer the kingdom on **ANGADA** ; the true relative of the son in succession to his father is the uncle, who stands as a second father to him and not the mother, O Foremost of Monkeys. There is nought better for me in this world or in the next than to take refuge near the King of the Monkeys, my lord ; it is fitting for me to share the bed of him who has fallen facing the foe."

CHAPTER 22

Bali's last Words

brother, **SUGRIVA**, before him. Addressing him whose victory had assured him of the possession of the dominion of the monkeys, he spoke in clear and affectionate tones, saying : " O **SUGRIVA**, do not approach me with any evil intent, I who was carried away by a fatal loss of understanding. It would seem to me, O My Friend, that it was not our destiny to live at peace with one another ; though friendship is natural between brothers, yet with us it has been different. To-day, thou wilt regsin the kingdom of the forest-dwellers, whereas I, mask well, am leaving this world and going to the region of death. Not only am I abandoning in an instant, life, kingdom and great prosperity but also a reputation without stain. At this supreme moment, I make an appeal to thee and, difficult though it is, it must be done, O Valiant Prince. " See, stretched on the earth, his face bathed in tears, **ANGADA**, who is worthy of happiness, brought up in luxuty and, though a child, possessing nought that pertains to child hood I Do thou proteCt him from all peril, he who is my son and dearer to me than life, the issue of my loina and whom I now abandon, though he does not merit abandonment Be his father, his benefactor and his guardian in all circumstances and in danger be his refuge, as I have ever been, O Chief of the Monkeys I " Born of Tara, that fonunate prince, tbine equal in valour, sba1l ptecede thee in the destruction of the titans. That youthful **ANGADA**, Tara's son, that valiant hero, whose prowess is great, will manifest it in deeds of valour wonhy of me. Further, when the daughter of Sushena (*Tara*), of profound discernment and conversant with future happenings, bids thee saying : Do this, it is right ', do so without hesitation. There is no

presentiment of Tara's that does not come to pass. " Whatever Raghava proposes, do thou carry out with the same resolution ; it were wrong to disobey him and he will punish thee for thy contempt. Take this golden chain, O **SUGRIVA** ; the glorious Shri who dwells in it will leave it at my death." Hearing Bali's affectionate and brotherly words, **SUGRIVA** was bereft of joy and grew sad, resembling the moon in eclipse. Pacified by Bali and anxious to act in a fitting manner, on his brother's request, he took off the golden chain. Having thus made over this mark of royalty, Bali, at the point of death, gazing on his son **ANGADA**, who stood before him, addressed him tenderly, saying: " Do thou act in a manner fitting to the rime and place. Suffer pleasure and psin with equanimity ; in joy and sorrow be obedient to **SUGRIVA**. Assuredly, O Long-armed Warrior, thou hast ever been cherished by me, but it is not by living thus that thou wilt eam **SUGRIVA**'s respect. Do not ally thyself with those who are not his friends, still less his foes, O Conqueror of Thine Enemies ! Be loyal to **SUGRIVA**, thy master, with thy senses fully controlled and ever be attentive to his interests. Be not inordinately attached to any nor hold any in contempt ; both ememes are a great error, therefore pursue the middle course." With these words, suffering intensely from the arrow, his eyes staring wildly, his great teeth chattering, Bali expired. Then a great tumult arose among the monkeys, thus deprived of their leader, and all the forest dwellers gave vent to lamema· lions, saying :-" Henceforth Kisbkindha is nought but a desert, the King of Monkeys baving ascended to heaven ; his gardens are but a wilderness, as are the mountains and the woods. That Lion of Monkeys bas passed away; the forest-dwellets are stripped of their glory. " He engaged the illustrious and long-armed Golaba, the Gandbarva, in a terrible battle lasting ten years and yet anothet five ; that struggle did not cease day or night ; then in the sixteenth year, Golaba was struck down, that foolhardy one falling

under the blows of Bali of strong teeth. How bas he who protected us from all peril fallen in his tum ? " Tbat valiant Lesder of Monkeys being slain, the forest dwellers will not be able to find any safe place of refuge, like kine in the midst of a lion-infested forest." On hearing these words, Tara, who was submerged in an ocean of grief, gazing on the face of her dead lord, fell to the earth, embracing Bali like a creeper clinging to an uprooted tree.

CHAPTER 23

Tara weeps over the Body of Bali

her dead consort, saying : "Not baving followed my counsel, O Warrior, thou art now stretched on the rough, hard and stony ground. Hast thou then chosen the earth as thy love rather than myself, since thou now liest embracing it, whereas to me thou dost not utter a single word ? " Alas ! Fate bas favoured **SUGRIVA**, that valiant One, whose noble exploits will now cause him to be regarded as a hero. The Leaders of the Hears and Monkeys pay homage to thy prowess I Hearing their cries of distress and those of the unfortunate Aogada and myself, why dost thou not wake ? Having been slain in combat, thou sleepest on tbat bard bed, the place where formerly thine enemies rested struck down by thy blows. O My Beloved, thou art the offshoot of a glorious race renowned for its heroism ; thou, for whom war was but a sport, art gone, leaving me alone without a protector, O Proud Monarch! Nay, a wise man should never give his daughter in marriage to a warrior. Mark how I, wedded to a *Kshatriya*, am about to die, having been made a widow. My pride is humbled, and from this moment the path to ever lasting life is closed to me. I am submerged in an ocean of grief without ground or

bourne ! How bard is my heart tbat, even seeing my dead lord, it does not break into a thousand fragments-my friend, my lord, naturally dear to me, tbat hero, who, falling on the field of honour under the blows of a warrior more powerful than he, bas returned to the five elements. The woman who loses her consort, even if she have sons and be endowed with wealth, is yet a widow, say the wise. O Hero ! Thou art lying enveloped in the blood that flows from thy limbs, as thou wert formerly with the scarlet silk of thy couch. Dust and gore covers thy body on every side, so that I cannot hold thee in mine arms, O Bull amongst Plavagas. “To-day, **SUGRIVA** has achieved the purpose for which he engsged thee in this formidable struggle. A single arrow discharged by **RAMA** freed him from all fear. That shaft tbat pierced thine heart now prevents me from embracing thy body and I can but gaze on thee, who art rejoining the five elements.” At tbat moment the General Nala drew out from the corpse the arrow which resembled an angry snake issuing from a mountain cave and glittered as he withdrew it, like the sun whose rays have been intercepted by the peak of a mountain. Thereupon streams of blood instantly began to flow again from those wounds on every side, resembling the water of a river tbat is stained by the sandstone washed down from a mountain. Tara, wiping off the dust of combat with which he was pierced by Rams’s arrow, his limbs all covered with blood. Then, addressing her son **ANGADA**, whose eyes were red, she said to him : " Behold the bitter end of thy sire, O My Son ! How tragic it is ! This is the outcome of an hostility born of perfidy ! This body, gleaming like the sun about to rise, has entered the region of death. Embrace that proud monarch, O My Son!” At these words, **ANGADA** rising, seized hold of the feet of his father with his rounded arms, saying :-" It is I, **ANGADA** ! When I embraced thee formerly thou didst say ' Live long, O My Son’, why dost thou not speak to me thus

now?” **TBEN TARA** *said*:-" Here I stand beside thine inanimate body, like a cow with its calf beside a bull that a lion has just slain ! I do not see the gift that the King of the Gods bestowed on thee when gratified by his victoty over the *Asura*, that glorious chain of gold, why is this ? Tbou shalt not be robbed of the insignia of royalty even after death, O Proud Monarch, for the King of the Mountains continues to glow after the sun has set. " Thou didst not follow my sage counsel and I was unable to restrain thee. Thy death on the battlefield has brought about mioe own and my son’s also. Tbe Goddess of Prosperity’ has renounced both thee and me.”

CHAPTER 24

Sugriva's Remorse

SEEING Tara submerged in the fathomless ocean of grief, Bali’s younger brother was filled with remorse for his tragic end and overcome with distress, his face bathed in tears, in her presence, slowly approached **RAMA** surrounded by his attendants. Raghsva, bearing all the marks of royalty, stood apart. full of dignity and majesty, bearing his bow and arrows, which resembled serpents, in his hands. O:,. Then **SUGRIVA** addressed him, saying :-" In accord with thy promise, O lndra among Men, thou didst accom plish this deed, the results of which are here made manifest. In the midst of my triumph, O Prince, in the presence of the slain, my spirit is troubled. On accouot of the dead monarch, his chief queen is wailing piteously, the city is giving vent to lamentation and **ANGADA** is pluoged in affiiction ; all this, O **RAMA**, robs sovereignty of any delight for me. “At tint, anger, resentment and extreme vexation caused me to view the death of my brother with

satisfaction, but soon, in the presence of the corpse of that King of the Monkeys, a great sadness seized me, O First of the House of lkshwaku. Now it is made clear to me that it would have been better to continue to live I formerly did on the lofty summit of the Rishysmuka mouotain, than slay my brother. " ' I have no desire to destroy thee ! Begone ! ' were the words that magnanimous warrior addressed to me. This utterance was worthy of him, O **RAMA**, and I, by killing him, have acted vilely. How can any, even if he be devoid of virtue, approve the murder of a brother or balance the happiness experienced on attaining a kingdom with the grief suffered by his death. Unquestioningly he had no intention of slaying me, being too great of soul, but in my perversity I have robbed him of his life. " In the struggle, when, uoder the blows of the trees, I was about to succumb and cried out, he at once reassured me, saying : ' Do not repeat thine impudence ; go hence ! ' " He was ever filled with brotherly affection, nobility and justice, whereas I was full of anger, envy and the natural characteristics of a monkey. " That which should be excluded from one's thoughts, feelings, desires and conduct is what I have harboured in murdering my brother, a crime equal to the slaying of Vish warupa by **INDRA**. But **INDRA**'s guilt was shared by the earth, having committed such an infamous deed that entails the destruction of one of mine own race. " I have perpetrated a vile and ignoble act, condemned by the whole world. An overwhelming sorrow fills me, as torren tial rain fills a ravine. I am crushed by the bank of a river that has been trodden down by an intoxicated elephant, whose back and tail are the murder of my blood-brother, whose trunk, eyes, head and tusks are the remorse bearing me away. " This sin, the weight of which is intolerable, O Prince, O Son of the House of Raghu, has destroyed all that is best in my heart, as fire consumes gold, leaving only dross. The company of the great leaders of monkeys, O Prince, are half dead

through my fault and also on account of the violent despair of **ANGADA**. “Rare indeed is a son as obedient as **ANGADA**, but a son is easily acquired ; where however in the world can one akin to a blood brother be found, O Hero? To-day, if **ANGADA**, that Chief of Warriors, and his mother live, she, though overcome with grief will surely care for him, for bereft of him she would die. As for me, I wish to enter the blazing pyre in order to regain the affection of my brother and his son. " Those leaders of monkeys will set out in search of **SITA** whenever thou commandest. O Son of that **INDRA** among Men, I, the Destroyer of my Race, who am no longer worthy to live after committing this ouuage, bid thee farewell, O **RAMA**.” Hearing the words of the wretched **SUGRIVA**, Bali’s brother, that noble descendant of the House of Raghu, Rams, began to weep, he, the Destroyer of Hostile Armies, for his mind was troubled. Thereafter, glancing here and there, that support of the earth, the protector of the world, Rams, in the midst of his distress, observed Tara groaning under the load of her afiliction. The chief queen of that Lion among Monkeys, of lovely eyes, was lying beside her lord, whom she held in her arms. Then the first of the ministers raised up that valiant consort of the King of the Monkeys, and she, trembling as they separated her from her lord, whom she was embracing, beheld **RAMA**, whose radiance equalled the sun’s, standing with his bow and arrows in his hand. Adorned with all the distinguishing marks of royalty, that large-eyed prince, whom she had never yet beheld, that first of heroes, was recognized by Tara, whose eyes resembled a doe’s, and she reflected It is Kakutstha ! ' Then that noble and unfortunate lady, who had so suddenly been plunged into aftliction, tottering, approached the one who was the equal of **INDRA**, inaccessible and all powerful. The venerable Tara, her beautiful frame wasted with grief, drawing near to the pure-souled **RAMA**, who by his valour ever attained his end in

combat, addressed him thus : " Thou art of immeasurable courage, unapproachable, master of thy senses and of supreme faith ; thy fame is imperishable, thou art full of wisdom and the support of the eartb ! Thine eyes are the colour of blood ; thou bearest a bow and arrows in thine hand ; thou art endowed wirh great strength and strong limbs ; thou hast renounced the concerns of the body in this world in order to enjoy divine attributes. The shaft with which thou didst pierce my beloved lord, now use to destroy me also. When I am dead, I shall be reunited to him; without me, Bali will never be happy, O Hero. Far from me, even in heaven, amidst the red-haired Apsaras, whose locks are braided in various ways and who are gor geously attired, he will not be happy, O Thou whose eyes resemble the pure petals of the lotus. " Thou knowest well that he who is separated from his loved one is wretched I On account of this, slay me, so that Bali shall not suffer in mine absence. If, in the greatness of thy soul, thou shouldst reflect ' I will not be guilty of slaying a woman ', say to thyself, She is part of Bali himself' and strike me down. It will not be a woman whom thou hast put to death, O Son of that **INDRA** among Men ! By virtue of the law and according to the different Vedic texts, women are not other than the higher self of man. Therefore the wise say that the gift of a woman is assuredly the greatest of gifts. In this wise thou doat give me back to my dear one in order that I may fulfil my duty to him, O Warrior; by this offering thou shalt not incur the sin of slaying me. “Filled with sorrow, bereft of support, left desolate, thou shouldn’st not spare my life. The more so that far from that sagacious Prince of Monkeys, whose joyful gait resembled an elephant’s, with his glorious golden chain, the insigna of supreme majesty, I shall not live long, O Prince.” Thus spoke Tats, and in order to console her, the magoanimous Lord addressed her with wisdom and understanding, saying : " O Consort of a Hero, do not grieve ! The whole

universe is ordered by the creator ; similatly it is established that the sum of good and evil is ordained by Him, nor do the Three Worlds, obedient to His will, transgress His fixed laws. Because of this, thou wilt attain supreme happiness and thy son become heir-appatent to the kingdom. The Lord has ordained this in the order of things; the consorts of heroes do not complain." Thus comforted by the magnanimous and powerful victor of his foes, the wife of the valiant Bali, the gorgeously-attired Tata, ceased to lament.

CHAPTER 25

Bali's Funeral Rites

FULL of compassion for **SUGRIVA**'s distress and that experienced by Tata and **ANGADA**, Kakutstba, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, in order to console them, said : "It is not by weeping that the happiness of the depatted is assured ! Carry out your immediate duty without delay I By shedding teats, you have observed the demands of social convention ; it is vain to seek to avoid fate. Time' is the driving force that orders the world's events; it is Time that creates all conditions here below. None is the real agent of action and none truly causes action to take place. The world abides by virtue of the dictates of its own inner being. Time is its source, stay and goal. Time does not overstep its own bounds, nor does it suffer decrease. Self-depeodent, there is neither kinship nor friendship in it, nor is it restrained by any, nor has it any cause. Assuredly, he who sees cleatly is aWatC of the working of Time. Duty, prosperity and pleasure are subject to Time ; it is on this account that Bali attained his own true state. The King of the Plavagas bas reaped the fruit of bis works, acquired by his merits, through bis

integrity and liberality. He bas attained heaven on account of bis observance of duty and he has taken possession of it by sacri ficing bis life. The Sovereign of the Monkeys bas reached the highest state. Thou bast mourned long enough ; now perform the last rites." When **RAMA** ceased speaking, **LAKSHMANA**, the Slayer of His Foes, spoke sagely to **SUGRIVA**, who was distraught, saying: " O **SUGRIVA**, inaugurate the obsequies without delay with the assistance of Tam and **ANGADA**. Issue the order that a large quantity nf dry wood be gathered togerher with the sacred sandalwood, for the funeral pyre. Banish indecision; this city depends on thee. Let **ANGADA** bring garlands and robes of every kind, together with butter, oil, perfumes and all that is requisite. "O Tam, do thou find a palanquin without delay; prompt action is always praiseworthy, the more so at such an hour. Let those who are skilful and srrong, accustomed to palanquins, hold themselves in readiness to bear Bali away." Having spoken thus to **SUGRIVA**, the on nf **SUMITRA**, Laksh mana, the Slayer nf His Foes, took up bis position beside his brother. Hearing **LAKSHMANA**'s command, Tara with a beating heart hastened to the cave, bent on finding a litter, and soon rerumed with one borne by strong monkeys to whom the work was familiar. It was indeed magnificent, well-cushioned and resembling a chariot, the sides being marvellously decomted and enriched with carved wooden figures. Resting on wonderful supports, it was gorgeously fitted like a palace belonging to the Siddbas and was furnished with windows and balconies that were spacious and cmhellished with carvings, a work nf extreme artistry. Large and well constructed nf wood from the mountain-side, priceless ornaments, strings nf pearls and splendid crowns gave it a dazzling appearance and it was covered with clay, painted red and sprinkled with sandal-paste. Festooned with wreaths of lotuses, shining like the dawn, it was strewn with innumerable !lowers. Z29 . Beholding

it, **RAMA** said to **LAKSHMANA** :-" Let Bali's body be placed upon it with all speed and let the funeral ceremony proceed." Then **SUGRIVA**, weeping, assisted by **ANGADA**, raised Bali's body and placed it on the litter. Having laid the corpse on its couch, he covered it with ornaments of every kind together with wreaths and cloths. Thereafter, **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, commanded that the last rites of his noble brother should be carried out on the banks of a river. The great monkey leaders preceded the litter, scattering jewels of every kind in profusion. Every honour due to a king of this world was offered by the *Vanaras* to their lord that day. Then the funeral rites began immediately, **ANGADA**, Tara and the others surrounding the master they had lost. On their side, the women who had lived subject to his authority gathered together crying : " O Hero, O Hero ", thus bewailing the death of their lord. All the wives of Bali, who had been widowed, with Tara at their head, accompanied their deceased sovereign, lamenting pitifully. Their cries were heard in the depth of the forest and re-echoed through the woods and among the rocks on every side. Then on a deserted sandbank surrounded by water, formed by a torrent issuing from the mountain, innumer able monkeys, inhabitants of the forest, constructed a pyre, and those excellent bearers reverently lowered the litter from their shoulders and all stood round, plunged in mourning. Seeing her lord lying on the funeral bed, Tara, taking his head in her lap, a prey to extteme grief, began to lament : " O Illusuious and Mighty Prince, O My Dear One, look on me ! Why dost thou not cast a single glance on all those who arc plunged in sorrow ? Thou smilest even in death, O Noble Hero, and thy countenance resembles the rays of the rising sun ! Death, in the guise of **RAMA**, has struck thee down, O Monkey ! A single arrow discharged by him on the field of battle has made us all widows. Thy wives, present here, who no longer know how to leap, O lndra among Kings, have

come this pai.nfil1 road step by step on foot, is it not known to thee ? Dost thou no longer love these women whose radiant looks resemble the moon ? Why dost thou not look 230 on **SUGRIVA**, O King of the Monkeys ? Here are thy counsellors, O Sovereign, also Tara and the others and the leading citizens surrounding thee, all plunged in grief. Dismiss thy ministers as thou wert wont to do, O Vanquisher of thy Foes, and we will go to the woods with thee in happy dalliance." Then the women, themselves overwhelmed with allliction, caused Tara to rise. Assisted by **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA**, sobbing, bore his sire to the funeral pyre, his mind distraught with grief, and, igniting the fiames according to the traditional rites, keeping his father on his right hand, he circumambulated him, sorrowfully watching him setting forth on his last journey. Having performed the ritual acts in honour of Bali, that Bull among Monkeys, accompanied by **SUGRIVA** and Tara, performed his ablutions. Associating himself with **SUGRIVA**'s Joss, the mighty Kakutstha, sharing his grief, officiated at the funeral rites. The body of Bali, chief of heroes, fuJI of glory, whom that descendant of lkshwaku had slain with his marvellous arrow, having been cremated, **SUGRIVA**, whose splendour resembled a clear fiame, approached **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** who accom panied him.

CHAPTER 26

Sugriva is installed as King

THB chief ministers encircled **SUGRIVA**, who was clad in dripping garments and overcome with grief. Approaching the illus trious **RAMA** of imperishable exploits, he stood before him with joined palms like the Sages before the Grand-sire of the World. Then **HANUMAN**, the son of

Maruta, who resembled a moun tain of gold, his face shining like the rising sun, addressed him with profound reverence in the following words : " May it please thee, O Kakutstha, to reinstate **SUGRIVA** in the vast and impregnable kingdom of his mighty ancestors. Be gracious unto him, O Lord, and permit him to return to his magnificent capital. May he regulate his affairs with the co-operation of his many friends. " After the purificatory bath of perfumes and atomatic herbs of every kind, he will pay thee homage and bestow gifts and garlands and precious gems, scents and herbs on thee. Thou shouldst enter this marvellous cave, carved out of the mountain, and unite these monkeys with a master, thus making them happy ! " Hearing **HANUMAN**'s words, **RAMA**, that Destroyer of Hostile Warriors, answered him with wisdom and eloquence, saying: Most beloved **HANUMAN**, in accordance with the behests of my sire I may not enter a village or city for fourteen years. Let **SUGRIVA**, that Bull atnong Monkeys enter that prosperous and glorious city and be installed as king according to the traditional rites ! " Having spoken thus to **HANUMAN**, **RAMA** said to **SUGRIVA** : Thou who art conversant with thy duty, proclaim that noble and valiant hero, **ANGADA**, heir-apparent to the kingdom. He is the eldest son of thy elder brother and equal to him in courage ; **ANGADA** has a valiant heart and deserves to be thine heir. It is now Shravana, the first month of the rainy season, that brings the floods; it is no time for military exploits therefore return to thy capital. As for me, I shall live on the mountain with **LAKSHMANA**. This cavern, carved out of the rock, is large and airy and possesses a lake whose crystalline waters abound in lotuses of every kind. When the month of Kartika' has come, make ready to slay **RAVANA**, this is our pact ; meantime, O Friend, return to thine home and receive the royal anointing, thus gratifying thy friends." Thus dismissed by **RAMA**, **SUGRIVA**, that Bull among Monkeys penetrated into the

enchanting city of Kishkindha of which Bali had been the supreme lord. Following their sovereign, thousands of monkeys prostrated themselves, touching the dust with their foreheads, and **SUGRIVA**, full of valour, called on them to rise, addressing his subjects with affection. That mighty warrior thereafter entered his brother's private apartments and, having come there, the powerful hero, **SUGRIVA**, that Bull of Forest-dwellers, was proclaimed king by his friends, as was formerly the God of a Thousand Eyes. Then they brought him a white canopy, decorated with gold, and two magnificent whisks of yak's tails with gleaming golden handles, also gems of every kind and grain and grass, together with blossoming branches, llowers and rich stuffs, white unguents, fragrant garlands, wild llowers and those that grow in water, sacred sandalwood, varied and numerous perfumes, roasted grain, gold, panic seed, honey, butter, curds, a tiger skin and wonderfully wrought sandals. Thereafter six lovely young girls, bringing scents, taUow and red and yellow pigments, entered joyfully and distributed gems, raiment and food among the foremost of the twice-born. Those versed in the sacred formulas then prepared heaps of kusha grass and, igniting a fire, poured out the *Soma*, purified by the recitation of traditional prayers. Then **SUGRIVA**, seated on a gorgeous golden-based throne, covered with rich draperies and a magnificent three-tiered baldaquin, decorated with marvellous garlands, facing the East, was enthroned. Those Lions among the Forest-dwellers had visited the banks of rivers and streams, far and wide, well the sacred places and the seas, in order to draw pure water which they brought back in pitchers of gold. Employing golden vases and the polished horns of bulls, Gaja, Gavaksha, Gavaya, Sharabha, Gandhamadana, Mainda, Dvivida, **HANUMAN** and **JAMBAVAN** in accordance with the tradition laid down in the scriprures and on the instructions of the Sageo, poured the clear and fragrant water

over **SUGRIVA**, as formerly the Vasus bathed Vasava of a Thousand Eyes. When the enthronement was completed, aU those illustrious leaders of the monkeys raised a shout of joy again and again. Thereafter, in order to follow **RAMA**'s counsel, **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, embracing **ANGADA**, jnstalled him as heir apparenL **ANGADA** received the investiture, and those magnanimous Plavagas acclaimed him crying " ExceUent I ExceUent I ", praising **SUGRIVA** and the great-souled **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. All were overjoyed on this auspicious occasion ; a large and m=y crowd, fully satisfied, filled the streets, cartying bannctS and standatds in the enchanting city of Kishkindha, which had been hollowed out of the mountain. Having informed the illustrious **RAMA** of the great coronation ceremony and being reunited with his conson, Ruma, the heroic leader of the monkey army took possession of his kingdom, like the Chief of the Immortals.

CHAPTER 27

Rama describes Prasravana

black stone like a piece of antimony washed in oil ; to the north, O Friend, the crest of the mountain is magnificent and looks like a mass of polished collyrium or a stationary cloud. To the south, it stretches like a white veil, resembling Mount Kailasha, rich in metals, which give it a dazzling appearance. "ObsetVe this rivet of translucent watet like unto Jahnavi on the Mount Trikuta ! Candana, Tilaks, Sala, Tamala, Atimuktaks, Padmaks, Sarala and Ashoka trees embellish it ; Vanira, Timida, Bakula, Kctaka, Hintala, Tinisha, Nipa, Vctasa and Kritamalaka trees grow on its banks, adorning it on cvety side, like a woman attired in rich raiment and precious gems. " Innumerable flocks of birds fill it

with their various notes and waterfowl enliven it with their amorous frolics. The riVet has created enchanting islands which arc frequented by swans and cranes ; its smiling aspect calls to mind a beautiful woman wearing innumetable ornaments. Here it is carpeted with blue lotuses, thete shining with the red and in the distance white watet-lilies may he seen. Ducks sport hete in their hundreds, whilst peacocks and curlews fill this riVet, full of chartn and colour, with their cries, and groups of sages frequent it. " Sec how the Sandal and Kadubha trees grow in clusters of five, as , if planned by an intelligent will. Ah ! What an enchanting spot! O Saumitri, Thou Scourget of Thy Foes, let us enjoy it to the full and make our retreat a happy one. Kishkindha too is not far from hete, that marvellous city of **SUGRIVA**'s, whete songs and the sound of musical instruments are heard, O Most illustrious of Conquerors I It is the monkey warriors sporting to the sound of drums. " Having recovetcd his consort and his kingdom, that monarch of the monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, surrounded by his com panions, is assuredly celebrating his return to full prosperity." With these words, **RAMA** with **LAKSHMANA** took up their abode on the Mountain Prasravana, where thete wete innumerable caves and woods. 235 Yet despite the beauty and abundance of fruits, **RAMA** was unable to find the least pleasure there. Remembering the woman who had been torn from him and who was as dear to him as his very life's breath, the more now, when the moon was rising over the summit of the mountain, he was unable to sleep, passing the nights on the couch, sighing, his spirit troubled, a prey to constant grief. Seeing **RAMA** desolate and a victim to profound melancholy, **LAKSHMANA**, who was equally alllicted, addressed him in affectionate words, saying :-" Cease to mourn, O Hero, thou shouldst not distress thyself thus. One who grieves is never successful, thou lmowest it well. In this world, one should have faith and trust in God, pursue virtue and

engage in action, O Raghava ! If thy mind is agitated, thou wilt never be able to overcome that titan, thine adversary, in combat, for he is a crafty fighter. " Banish thy grief and persist in thine endeavour ; it will be thine to triumph over this demon and his entire family. O **RAMA**, thou canst overthtow the earth with its oceans, forests and mountains, how much more **RAVANA** I Wait but till the autumn, for it is now the rainy season, then thou shalt destroy him, his kingdom and his kinsfolk. Truly I desire to rekindle thy dormant valour, as at the hour of sacrifice the fire buried beneath the ashes is revived by glowing libations." This salutary and opportune counsel of **LAKSHMANA**'s was received by **RAMA** with respect and he answered in tender and friendly accents, saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, inspired by devotion, thou hast spoken to me with wisdom and courage. Henceforth I shall manifest that valour no danger is able to subdue. I shall wait for the autumn and in accord with thy counsel depend on **SUGRIVA**'s willing co-operation and the state of the rivers. He who has rendered a service merits repayment ; the ungrateful who do not honour an obligation lose the respect of the good." With joined palms, **LAKSHMANA** listened with approval to this judicious speech and addressed **RAMA**, who had regained his cheerful mien, saying: "Thou speakest truly, O Chief of Men; without fail, that monkey will bring about thar which thou desircst. Meantime, while awaiting the autumn, endure 236 the rains, resolving to slay thine adversary. Restraining thine anger, let us pass these four months of autumn together, dwelling on the mountain frequented by lions, and then hold thyself in readiness to destroy thine enemy."

CHAPTER 28

Rama describes the Rainy Season

" Now the rainy season is here, sec how the heavens arc laden with clouds as large as hills. After nine months, the sky, by the action of the sun's rays, has sucked up the waters of the ocean and is now giving birth to the showers. " Ascending to heaven by the stairway of the clouds, one might decorate the sun with garlands of Kutaja and Arjuna blossom. The sky appears like one wounded, bound with the rags of moisture-laden clouds, stained with the vivid tints of the setting sun, bordered with red. With the gentle bree2e as its breath, the saffron colour lent by the twilight and its yellow clouds, the sky seems like one who is sick with love. Tormented by the sun's rays, the earth is shedding tears, like **SITA** racked by grief. Emerging from the heart of the clouds, cool as camphor, redolent with the fragrance of Ketaks flowers, the balmy winds can, as it were, be sipped from the palms of the hands. " This mountain of blossoming Arjuna trees, planted with Ketakas and anointed by showers of rain, resembles **SUGRIVA** freed from his foes. These mountains, that the dark clouds clothe as with antelope skins, catch the rain drops as the sacri ficial thread, their caverns filled with the wind lending them a voice; they resemble studious *brahmin* disciples reciting the holy Veda. " Whipped by lightning like unto golden thongs, the sky seems to be crying out in pain. The flash that convulses the breast of that sombre cloud is to me like **SITA** struggling in the arms of **RAVANA**. When covered by dense cloud, the 237 quarters of the sky, so dear to lovers, are blotted out, together with the moon and the stars. " On the ridges of the mountain, as if drowned in tears, these Kutaja trees in full flower, that sighed for the rain, rekindle love in me in the midst of the grief that overwhelms me. " The dust has settled and a cold wind blows ; the heat of the summer is allayed ; the martial undertaking of kings is suspended, and travellers have returned to their own country. " Now the waterfowl, in their haste to regain the Manasa lake, have left with their dear

companions. Chariots and other conveyances no longer venture on the roads, deeply rutted by continuous rain. “Sometimes visible, sometimes invisible, the sky, sown with clouds, looks like a ocean encircled with hills. The streams carrying away the Sarja and Kadarnba blossom assume a yellow hue from the metallic deposits of the rocks and pass swiftly on amidst the cry of peacocks. “The Jambu fruit, full of savour and gilded like a bee, is pleasant to the taste, and ripe mangoes of many tints fall to the ground shaken by the wind. Oouds like high mountains, having the lightning as their banner and cranes for their garlands, give forth a reverberating sound, like great elephants intoxicated with Mads juice who are about to fight. " The grassy slopes of those forest tracts, revived by the rain where delighted peacocks dance, gleam brightly under the moon at night. Charged with an immense weight of water, clouds surrounded by cranes emit a muttering sound and in constant movement journey on and on, sometimes resting on the mountain tops. In their joyous circling flight, cranes, in love with the clouds, resemble an enchanting garland of lotus flowers suspended in space at the mercy of the breeze. " The earth with its fresh grass strewn with tiny ladybirds, looka like a woman, whose limbs are swathed in a bright green cloth flecked with red. " See how the groves are rendered gay by the dance of peacocks and bow the Kadamba trees are covered with 11owers ; bulls, filled with desire, follow the cows and the earth is rendered charming by forests and fields of grain. “Rivers rush onwards, clouds discharge their rain, frenzied elephants are trumpeting, the woods grow more fair, lovers yearn for their loved ones, peacocks dance and the monkeys have regained their zest for life. Drunk with the aroma of the blossoming Ketaka trees, amongst the thundering water falls, the great elephants mix their amorous trumpeting with the peacocks’ cries. “Flowers, bruised by the downpour, are expelling their nectar, that the bees gaily plundered

from the branches of the Kadamba, trees and now it is falling drop by drop. With their abundant fruit resembling ashes, full of savour, the boughs of the Jambu tree are swarming with bees. " Following the woodland track amidst the hills, the chief of the elephants, hearing the roar of thunder behind him, halts in his tracks, thirsting to fight and, deeming it to be a challenge, turns back in fury. " Filled now with the humming bees, now with blue-necked peacocks that dance or great elephants in rut, the woods take on a thousand varying aspects. " Abounding in Kadamba, Sarja, Arjuna and Kandala trees, the forest with the ground saturated with water, resembling wine and the intoxicated peacocks that cry and dance, takes on the appearance of a banqueting hall. The raindrops, like pearls, falling in the folds of the leaves, rest there happily, and the many coloured birds drink of them, delighted by this gift from the King of the Gods. " The soft humming of the bees, the joyous croaking of the frogs blended with the rumbling thunder of the clouds, resemb ling the roll of drums, create a veritable orchestra in the forest. " The peacocb with their richly decorated tails are the THE RAMAYANA OF VALMJKJ " The rivers, frequented by waterfowl, bear away their crumbling banks proud of their speed, and happy in their fullness, rush towards their lord, the ocean. " Sombre clouds charged with fresh rain melt into each other and resemble the rocks scorched by the forest fire whose bases cohere with those that are equally laid bare. " Elephants wander in the midst of the charming groves, that are filled with the cries of intoxicated peacocks in the grass sprinkled with ladybirds and planted with Nipa and Arjuna trees. Ardently embracing the lotuses, whose stamens are flattened by the recent showers, the bumble bees eagerly drink the nectar from these and from the Kadsmba blossom that has been laid waste. Bull elephants in rut and leaders of kine disport themselves in the forest ; the king of beasts bounds through

the thickets and the kings of men are enraptured and forget their cares and anxieties whilst the Chief of the Gods is disporting himself in the clouds. Torrents of rain loosed from the sky, causing the seas and rivers to overfiow, fiood the streams, lakes and ponds togetbet with the entire earth. With sheets of rain falling and the wind blowing with ememe violence, the banks of the rivers are swept away and the surge onwards so that the familiar paths can no longer be trodden. " Like kings bathed by their servants, great mountains stand under the downpour from the clouds, which resemble ewers emptied by the King of the Celestials assisted by the Wind God, and seen thus, stand forth in all their native splendour. “The sky, overcast with cloud, renders the stars invisible; the eartb is saturated with the recent rains and the four quarters are shrouded in darkness. The summits of the mountains washed by the rain sparkle, their great cataracts twisting and falling like strings of pearls. Obstructed in their course by the jutting rocks, these mighty waterfalls precipitate themselves from the heights into the valleys like necklaces of pearls that break and scatter. Those rushing torrents, bathing the lower reaches of the rocky crests, fall into immense chasms, where they find themselves imprisoned and spray, resembling strings of pearls, which celestial nympha have broken in the violence of their emotions, are scattered in unparalleled showers on every side. " Only when the birds withdraw to the aees and the lotus closes, whilst the evening jasmine opcru;, can one divine that the sun bas set behind the Astacbala Mountain. Kings postpone their warlike expeditions and even the army, already on the march, halts ; hostilities cease, for the roads are water-Jogged. It is the month of Prausthapada,' when the btahmins who cbant the Veda, the singers of the *Soma* Veda, begin their studies. " Assuredly **BHARATA**, the King of Koshala, baving collected the revenue and completed the storing of provisions, is now engaged in celebrating the festival of the

month of Asbada.' " The Sarayu river must be overflowing its banks and the current increasing in velocity, like the shouts of acclamation with which Ayodhya will greet my return. " **SUGRIVA** will be listening with joy to the sheets of rain falling, since he bas overcome his adversary, recovered his consort and regained his vast kingdom; but I, O **LAKSHMANA**, separated from **SITA**, exiled from my immense dominion, resemble the bank of a river that bas been carried away by the current and precipitated into an abyss. “My grief is without bourne, the rains close every avenue and **RAVANA** appears to me a formidable and invincible foe. Unable to aavel on these impassable roads, I wish to make no demands on **SUGRIVA** despite his devotion, who after prolonged suffering is reunited with his spouse ; I do not desire to press for an interview on account of the urgency of his private concerns. " As for that, when he bas rested and the time is ripe, **SUGRIVA** will of himself remember the help he has promised me, there is no doubt of it. Because of this, I wait hopefully, till the rivers and **SUGRIVA** are favourable to me, O Thou who bearest the auspicious marks of royalty I " A favour obliges a man to show gratitude ; the ungrateful who fail to honour an obligation wound the heart of honest men.” **LAKSHMANA**, standing with joined palms, fuJJy concurred with these words to which he listened with exaeme respect; then addressing the magnanimous **RAMA** with a joyful air, he said: " O Prince, the King of the Monkeys will not delay in carrying out the desire thou hast expressed ! Wait for the autumn and let the rainy season pass, re-affirming thy resolution to overcome thine adversary.” CHAPTER Z9

CHAPTER 29

Hanuman urges Sugriva to honour his Promise

then addressing the magnanimous **RAMA** with a joyful air, he said: " O Prince, the King of the Monkeys will not delay in carrying out the desire thou hast expressed ! Wait for the autumn and let the rainy season pass, re-affirming thy resolution to overcome thine adversary." CHAPTER Z9 **HE** *said*: " Thou hast recovered thy throne and thy glory and added to the prosperity of thine house; it now remains for thee to concern thyself with thy friends ; this is thy duty ! He who, recognizing the fitting moment, conducts himself honourably towards his friends, sees the increase of his glory and his power. " He who treats with equal regard, wealth, sceptre, friends and life itself, O Prince, acquires a vast empire. Let this be thy conduct, establish thyself in the path of honour, this is what thou shouldst do for thy friends in accordance with thy vow. " He who does not abandon everything in order to occupy himself with the interests of his friends, whatever his aim, enthusiasm or undertakings, is courting failure. " In the same way, he who allows the occasion for coming to the assistance of his friends pass is worthless, even if he achieve great things. We are losing this opportunity of serving the interests of our friend Raghava, O Vanquisher of Thy Foes. Let us occupy ourselves with finding V aidehi. **RAMA** has not reminded thee that the time appointed has gone by, though he is fully conversant with the hour ; albeit hard pressed, that sagacious prince has graciously resigned himself, O King ! " It is to Raghava that thou owest the prosperity of thine House, he wields immense influence, his power is immeasur able, his personal attributes incomparable. Render back the service he has done to thee, O Chief of the Monkeys, call together the leaders of thy people ! The delay is not yet serious, as long as **RAMA** does not call upon thee to redeem thy promise, but if thou defer till he constrain thee by force, it will be too late. " Even had he done nought for thee, it would be thy duty to assist him in his quest, O Chief of Monkeys ! How much

more so after the service he has rendered thee in re-establishing thee on thy throne and slaying Bali. “Thou art powerful and thy courage is extreme, O Thou who rulest the monkeys and the bears, therefore thou art under a greater obligation to assist **RAMA**. " Without doubt the son of **DASARATHA** is able to overcome the Gods, the demons and the great serpents with his arrows, he is merely awaiting the fulfilment of thy vow. It was not without risking his life that he bestowed such happiness on thee. Let us sarur the earth and, if need be, the sky, in search of **SITA**. Neither the *Devas,* Danavas, Gandbarvas or Asurai accompanied by the hosts of Maruts, nor the Yakshas are able to make him tremble, much less the titans. " It is imperative, O Prince of the Tawny-coloured Ones, that thou shouldst try to please Rams with thine whole soul, who is endowed with that power that formerly succoured thee. “We will not hesitate to enter the subterranean regions beneath the waters nor ascend into the sky if thou commandest it, O King of the Monkeys ! Do thou decree who shall proceed and how and in what order. There are more than ten million monkeys of indomitable strength ready to serve thee, O lrteproachable Prince I " Hearing these apposite and reasonable words, Sugtiva, in his rectitude, made a supreme decision. Wisely commanding Nila of inexhaustible valour to gather the from every quarter, he said: " Do thou muster mine entire army with its leaders and generals, whom none can resist, and bring them here immedi ately. The Plavagas who are stationed on the frontiers are skilled and brave, let them come here, see to it personally that I am instantly obeyed. He who does not present himself within fifteen days from now will be summarily executed, none shall escape. " With **ANGADA**, seek out the veterans, carry out my orders scrupulously.” Having made all these arrangements, the Chief of theM.onkeys, the valisnt Sugtiva, returned to his private apartments.

CHAPTER 30

Description of Autumn

SIIGRIVA re-entered his palace, and the sky being free from clone!, **RAMA**, who, during the rainy season, had been overcome by the intensity of his grief, gazing on the pure and tranquil moon and the marvellously clear autumnal nights, pertci.ving 244 that **SUGRIVA** was leading a life of pleasure and rdlecting on bis own loss, also that time was passing, fell into a profound melancholy. Though be soon mastered bis mood, yet the wise Ragbava temained absotbed in the thought of **SITA**, and seeing the sky free from cloud taking on a setene aspect, re-echoing to the call of cranes, be began to lament in sorrowful accents. Seated on the jutting ridge of a mountain rich in gold, under the autumnal sky, bis thoughts went out to bis beloved spouse and be rdlected : “What joy can my youthful wife experience now, she, who loved the call of the cranes in the forest and imitated their note ? In mine absence, how can that tender maid take any delight in the tufts of flowers shining like pure gold, she, who formerly wakened to the cry of the swans ? What felicity can **SITA** of soft speech and tender form enjoy now ? " When she hears the cry of the wild geese, travelling in skeins, what will become of that princess, whose eyes are as large as lotuses ? I feel no happiness without **SITA**, whose eyes resembled the doe’s, when wandering by river, lake and forest, and my beloved in her tenderness will suffer cruelly in mine absence, through the desire that the beauty of autumn inspires.” Thus did that son of a King lament like unto the Saranga bird when it solicits water from **INDRA**. At that moment, **LAKSHMANA**, who bad gone out in careful search of fruits, returned from the enchanting mountain slopes and perceiving bis elder brother

absorbed in sorrowful thoughts, bis mind distraught, alone in that solitude, the sagacious Saumitri, who was deeply distressed by the grief of bis un fortunate brother, said to bim : " Why, O Noble Prince, hast thou become a slave to love? Why this reversion of thy former resolution ? Thy distress precludes thee from rdlectiog calmly ; tranquillity of mind is essential to carrying out any design ; after mature consideration, the time ordained together with the strength of thine ally should be utilised by thee for carrying out thy project without delay, O Friend I " Nay I The daughter of **JANAKA** supported by thee, will Dot be of easy access to the foe, O Protector of the Human 245 Race. None may approach a blazing fire without being burnt, O Valiant Warrior ! " Oo this, **RAMA** answered the indomitable **LAKSHMANA** in characteristic accents that were worthy of him, saying : " Thy words are practical and wise, full of good sense and in accord with duty and the law. We should reflect on how to act without delay ; this quest must be pursued ; when one is powerful, invincible, youthful and valiant, one should have no misgivings amceming one's success." Then recollectiug **SITA**, whose eyes were as large as lotus petals, **RAMA** with a downcast mien again addressed **LAKSHMANA**, saying: " The Thousand-eyed God, having saturated the earth with water and caused the grain to germinate, his task accomplished, is now resting. The clouds, which amidst a deep and pro longed rumbling spread over the mountains, forests and cities, letting loose their showers, are stationary, O Prince. The fury of the thunderclouds, resembling intoxicated elephants, black as the leaves of the blue lotus, darkening the ten regions has abated. Swollen with water, the clouds have visited the fragrant groves of Kutaja and Arjuna trees with wind and rain and have now disappeared in theiraityflight, OMyFriend. The clamour of the herds of elephants, the cry of the peacocks and the sound of the rain have ceased, O Irreproachable

LAKSHMANA. " Washed by dense clouds that have removed their impurities, the mountains with their magnificent escarpments shine forth illumined by the moon’s rays. " Autumn now manifests her grace in the branches of the Saptacchada trees, in the light of sun, moon and stars and in the gait of the majestic elephants, and her influence appears everywhere. In the tufts of lotuses opening to the first rays of the sun, in the scent of the Saptacchada flowers, in the music of the humming bees, autumn shines in all her splendour. " The geese with their large and graceful wings, friends of the God of Love, have just arrived, covered with the pollen of the lotuses and are walking to and fro on the sandy banks of the rivers, disporting themselves with the swans. " In the intoxicated elephants, in the kine, in the tranquilly 11owing rivers, autumn is reflected in her myriad aspects .146 Seeing the sky bereft of cloud, the peacocks in the woods, sborn of their caudsl beauty, are no longer attracted to their chosen ones and having lost tbeir brilliance, their delight has evaporated and they appear absorbed in their own thoughts. " The tall of sweet fragrance, the tips of whose branches are bent under the weight of their blossom, shining like gold, enchantiog to look upon, seem to light up the depth of the forest. " Accompanied by their females, the gteat elephants, fre.. quenters of the pools covered with lotuses and the woods, who formerly stood amidst the flowers, intoxicated with ichor, now walk with a slow and languid pace, merged in amorous sport. " The sky has cleared and is as bright as a drawn sword ; the water in the river flows slowly ; a breeze, refreshing the white water lilies, blows and those regions delivered from the darkness shine forth. " Freed from mud by the growing warmth of the sun, the soil is covered with a thick dust that the wind carries to a gteat distance. " It is the time when kings, at enmity with each other, start on their campaigns. " Shining with beauty with which the autumn has endowed

tbem, exulting, their limbs powdered with dust, mad with desire and thirsting to fight, the bulls bellow amidst the kine. " Sharing his love, the noble she elephant, eager and affec tionate, with a slow tresd circles round the bull intoxicated with ichor and follows him in the woods. " Bereft of their tail feathers, their marvellous natural adorn ment, wandering on the banks of the rivers, the peacocks, as if scorned by the cranes, move about forlornly, in flocks. " With their formidable cries, the chief of the elephants strike terror in the ducks and geese standing in the pools covered with flowering lotuses and, having sprinkled them selves with water again and again, begin to drink. " On the rivers, free of mud, with their sandy banks and peaceful ripples frequented by herds of kine, re-echoing to the cry of cranes, herons frolic joyously. " The sound of the rivers, the clouds, the waterfalls, the winds, the cry of the peacocks and the croaking of frogs has 247 ceased. Many coloured venomous serpents, greatly emaciated, deprived of food duriog the rains, tormented with hunger emerge from their holes where they have been confined so long. " The evening, caressed by the rays of the trembling moon, casts aside her veil, revealing her roseate countenance with its stars, in an ecstssy of joy. The night, whose gentle face is the full moon, resembles a youthful woman, the clusters of stars her smile and charming mien ; lit by the orb at Its full it seems as if wrapped in a white mantle. " Gorged with ripe grain, an enchanting tlock of cranes joyfully crosses the sky in rapid Bight, blown by the breeze like a garland of flowers tastefully interwoven. " The waters of the great lake, with a solitary swan floating there asleep amidst countless waterlilies, resembles the heavens free from cloud, illumined by the full moon and a myriad Stars. With their girdle of swans, their wreaths of blue and white lotus in flower, the great lakes are surpassingly beautiful and resemble lovely women decorated with jewels. " At break of dawn, blending with

the sound of the breeze blowing through the reeds, resembling the notes of a flute, the deep roarings in the caverns, increased by the wind and the bellowing of bulls, seem to answer one another. " The river banks adorned with flowering grasses, stirred by a gentle breeze, resemble bright linen cloths from which the stains have been washed away. " Bumble bees, roaming at will in the forest, gorged with nectar, heavy with the pollen of lotuses, where they have rested, in an elcess of joy accompanied by their loved ones, follow the God of the Wind, in the woods. " The calm waters, the flowering grasses, the cry of curlews, the ripened paddy fields, the gentle breeze, the immaculate moon, are all celebrating the departure of the rainy season. “To-day the rivers, weariog their silver fish as girdles, flow by slowly, like lovely women, moving languidly, having passed the night in love. “Wirh the geese, aquatic plants’ and the reeds that cover them like woven shawls, the rivers, sparkling, resemble the faces of women. " In the forest, adorned with arches of blossom and full nf the joyous humming nf bees, the God of Love, to-day, im patiently wields his fiery bow. " Having saturated the earth with their profuse showers and filled the lakes and rivers, preparing the soil for the harvest, the clouds have disappeared from the sky. " Little by little, the rivers in autumn uncover their banks, like chaste brides disclosing their charms. " O My Friend, the waters having subsided, the rivers re echo to the cry of ospreys and llocks of geese abound in the ponds. " It is the time, O Beloved Prince, when kings declare war on each other and thirsty for conquest enter upon their cam paigns. The inception of hostilities for monarchs bas begun, O Prince, and I do not see **SUGRIVA** making ready for an expedi tion of this kind. " Asana, Saptaparna, Kovidara trees are in full flower as also the Bandhujiva plant and the Tamala trees on the mountain slopes. " O **LAKSHMANA** I Behold the sandy banks of the rivers abound in swans,

cranes, geese and osprey that are seen on every side. The four months nf rain that have passed seemei to me like a hundred years, so filled with grief was I onaccountofSita’sabsence. " Like the Chakravaka bird with its mate, she followed me in the forest and the dreadful loneliness nf the Dandaka solitudes seemed to that youthful woman a garden of delight. Though far from my beloved, overcome with sorrow, bereft nf my kingdom and an exile, **SUGRIVA** shows no pity for me, O Laksbmana I " ' He is without support, deprived nf his kingdom, affronted by **RAVANA**, unhappy, exiled, that amorous prince bas taken refuge with me.' Thus will **SUGRIVA** speak, O My Friend, and in his perversity, he, the King of the Monkeys, holds me in contempt, I, the Scourge of My Foes. Having fixed a time to set out in search of **SITA** and entered into a formal contract to do so, this false one, having obtained his ends, bas forgotten his pledge. " Do thou enter Kisbkindha and in my name, address that Bull of the Monkeys, the wretched **SUGRIVA**, the slave of domestic bliss, saying :-' He who, having raised the hopes nf those who have sought his help in adversity and who formerly rendered 249 him a service, fails to fulfil his promise to them, is considered the least of men in this world but that valiant one, who for good or evil loyally honours his given word, he is the best of men. " ' Even the carnivorous heasts refuse to feed on the flesh of those ungrateful beings, who, having obtained their end, do not assist their friends to do so in their tum. " ' Assuredly thou desirest to behold the gleam of my gold backed bow, resembling a series of lightuing flashes, stretched ready for combat. Then shalt thou hear the dread twanging of my bowstring like unto the clash of thunder, when in wrath, I range the field of battle.' " Having brought my renowned valour to his remembrance, O Illustrinus Prince, thou, who my companion, it would be strange if he did not pause and reflect. O Thou Conqueror of Hostile Cities, since he, the King of the

Plavagas, has gained his desire, he no longer recollects the time chosen, and the King of the Monkeys, wholly given over to pleasure, does not appear to be aware that four months have passed. Drinking and roystering with his ministers and his court, **SUGRIVA** does not trouble himself about us, who are filled with anxiety. " Go and address him, O Valiant Hero, inform him of our displeasure and speak to him in those terms, which are in spired by my wrath, saying :-' The Gate of Death, through which Bali passed, is not closed ! O **SUGRIVA**, honour thy pledge, for fear that thou mayest follow in the path taken by him!' Thy brother died alone, struck down by tuine arrow but if thou failest in faith, I shall destroy thee together with thine whole House.' " O Greatest of Men, say all that will further our desire, we must not delay, O Prince. Say to him ' Honour the promise thou didst make to me, O King of the Monkeys, recollect that virtue is eternal or, losing thy life this day, thou shalt fall into the jaws of death, where my shafts shall despatch thee to seek out Bali I ' " Seeing his elder brother, who was affiicted in his great misfortune, in the throes of violent anger, **LAKSHMANA**, burning with courage, the promoter of the glory of Manu's Race, pro foundly distressed, felt a deep resentment towards the King of the Monkeys. KlSHKINDHA *KANDA* Laluhttuzna goes to Kishkindha THE offspring of that lndra among Men, the son of a king, then spoke to his eldex brothex, who, full of tenderness, cheex less, despite his natural gaiety and full of distress, had but now expressed his desire to him : " Nay, that monkey is not a civilized being ; he does not consider the immediate consequences of his acts nor will he enjoy the glory of the monkey realm ; it is not fitting he should take advantage of circumstances in this wise. In his stupidity, he has become the slave of domestic bliss without calling to mind the debt he owes to thee ; let him therefore die and seek out Bali ; the throne should not be confexred on one devoid of virtue. I

am unable to contain my violent rage ; I shall slay that disloyal **SUGRIVA** immediately. That son of Bali with the leadexs of the monkeys shall this day assist us to recover the princess.” Then **RAMA**, the Destroyer of Warriors, in terms that were prudent and appropriate, addressed Lakshrnana, who bow in hand desired to follow up his words with action and who full of ire was burning to fight : " Nay, thine equals in this world do not commit such an

CHAPTER 31

Lakshmana goes to Kishkindha

KISHKINDHA *KANDA* Laluhttuzna goes to Kishkindha THE offspring of that lndra among Men, the son of a king, then spoke to his eldex brothex, who, full of tenderness, cheex less, despite his natural gaiety and full of distress, had but now expressed his desire to him : " Nay, that monkey is not a civilized being ; he does not consider the immediate consequences of his acts nor will he enjoy the glory of the monkey realm ; it is not fitting he should take advantage of circumstances in this wise. In his stupidity, he has become the slave of domestic bliss without calling to mind the debt he owes to thee ; let him therefore die and seek out Bali ; the throne should not be confexred on one devoid of virtue. I am unable to contain my violent rage ; I shall slay that disloyal **SUGRIVA** immediately. That son of Bali with the leadexs of the monkeys shall this day assist us to recover the princess.” Then **RAMA**, the Destroyer of Warriors, in terms that were prudent and appropriate, addressed Lakshrnana, who bow in hand desired to follow up his words with action and who full of ire was burning to fight : " Nay, thine equals in this world do not commit such an hand his bow,

resembling **INDRA**'s, high as the peak of a moun tain, like unto Mt. Mandara. Faithful to the behest of Rsma, his younger brother, the equal of Brihaspati, reftected in himself how he should address and answer **SUGRIVA** and, filled with ire on account of his brother's anguish and displeasure, Laksbmana advanced like a loosened tempest, uprooting Sala, Tala, Ashwakarna and other trees in his impetuous strides, like a great elephant shattering the mountains and crushing the rocks under his feet, thus cutting short he distance to his goal. That Tiger among the Ikshvakus then beheld the splendid city of the King of Monkeys, the inaccessible Kishkindha, hollowed out of the mountain and filled with warriors. His lips trembling in his fury against **SUGRIVA**, **LAKSHMANA** beheld those formidable looking monkeys ranging round the city and seeing that foremost of men, those monkeys resembling elephants, tore up parts of the mountsin, rocks, boulders and great trees. **LAKSHMANA**, observing them seizing hold of these missiles, felt his anger redoubled, like a brazier lit with innumer able brands, and they, beholding that infuriated warrior, who resembled the God of Death himself at the dissolution of the worlds, fled in their hundreds on all sides. At that, those Foremost of Monkeys, returning to **SUGRIVA**'s palace, informed him of **LAKSHMANA**'s approach and of his anger, but that King of the Monkeys who was passing his time in dalliance with Tara paid no heed to what those Lions among Monkeys were saying. Thereupon, under the orders of the ministers, those monkeys, their hair standing on end, large as mountsins or elephants or clouds, issued out of the city and terrible to behold with their nails and teeth, their jaws like tigers, stationed themselves in the open. Many had the strengrh of ten elephants, others In the face of **SUGRIVA**'s debauched indifference and the provocative attitude of the monkeys, the valiant ukshmana, guardian of the interests of his elder brother, was seized with fresh anger, and that lion among

men, heaving deep and burning sighs, his glances flashing with fury, resembled a brazier belching forth smoke. With his pointed darts as the fticketing tongue, his military ardour the poison, his bow the coils, he resembled a five headed snake or the blazing fire at the end of the world or the enraged serpent king. Then **ANGADA**, who had gone out to meet him, in his terror, suffered extreme discomfiture and that illustrious warrior **LAKSHMANA**, his eyes red with anger, commanded him saying : " O Child, inform **SUGRIVA** of my advent and tell him that the younger brother of **RAMA** has come. O Conqueror of thy Foes, tormented by his brother's grief, **LAKSHMANA** waits at thy gate. Do thou seek to prepare that monkey by addressing him in this wise and return with all speed to inform me ofhis answer, O Dear Child." Hearing these words spoken by **LAKSHMANA**, **ANGADA**, filled with distress, went to seek out his uncle, who now occupied his father's place and said to him : " Saumitri is come ! " Then **ANGADA**, overwhelmed by the harsh accents of that hero, his countenance bearing the traces of profound distress, went away, first offering obeisance to the feet of the king in great reverence and thereafter to those of Ruma. That valiant prince, having touched the feet of his father, then made obeisance to his mother also and finally pressed the feet ofRuma having informed **SUGRIVA** of what had taken place. **SUGRIVA**, heavy with sleep and fatigue, did not wake up but lay in a drunken stupor, sexual indulgence having dulled his reason. Meantime, seeing **LAKSHMANA**, fear troubling their hearts, the monkeys welcomed him with shouts to appease his wrath. Beholding him near at hand, they raised a great clamour, re sembling a huge wave or the growl of thunder or the roaring of lions; and this great tumult roused that red-eyed monkey adorned with garlands who was bemused with liquor, his mind bewildered. 253 Recognizing his voice, two ministerS of that king of tbe monkeys, accompanied by **ANGADA**, approached him. Both were of

noble and venerable appearance and were named Yaksba and Prabbava. Ingratiating themselves by their speech that went straight to the point and sitting down near the king, who resembled lndra, the Lord of the Maruts, they said to him: " There are two brothers, full of nobility and power, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, who in human form are wortby of the kingdom they confer on others. One of tbem, bow in hand, stands at the door ; beholding him, the monkeys, terrified, are raising a great clamour. This brother of Ragbava, **LAKSHMANA**, his spokesman, charged by him to communicate his wishes, has come at **RAMA**'s command and the son of Tara, the beloved **ANGADA**, has been sent to thee in all haste by **LAKSHMANA**, O King, as his deputy, O Irreproachable Prince. " Tbat valiant warrior **LAKSHMANA** stands at the door, his eyes inflamed with anger and consumes the monkeys with his glances, O King. Go quickly and place thy head at his feet with all those who belong to thee, O Great Monarch, so that his anger may be instantly appeased. " Tbat which the virtuous **RAMA** desires, do thou carry out scrupulously so that his wrath be softened ; execute his wishes with care, O King, fulfil thy pledge and be true to thy word ! "

32 . Hanuman's Speech

AT these words of **ANGADA** and his ministerS, **SUGRIVA**, learning of **LAKSHMANA**'s anger, rose from his seat and came to himself. Having considered the different aspects of the matter, he addressed his counsellors, who were versed in the sacred formulas, with which he too was conversant and of which he was a strict observer, saying : " I bave neither spoken nor acted wrongfully; why is tbe brother of Ragbava, **LAKSHMANA**, incensed against me, I ask 2.54 myself? Evilly disposed

persons, enemies ever looking for an occasion to charge me with imaginary crimes, have set the younger brother of Raghava against me. It behoves ye all to reftect on the maner wisely in order to discover the cause of his anger. Assuredly I do not fear **LAKSHMANA** any more than Raghava, but a friend who becomes angry without reason invariably creates anxiety. It is easy to contract a friendship, but extremely difficult to sustain it, for owing to the fickleness of the mind a friendship can be broken for the most trivial reason. Because of this, I am apprehensive in regards to the magnani mous **RAMA**, for I have not been able to render back a proportionate service to him for that which he has done for me." **SUGRIVA** having spoken, **HANUMAN**, that foremost of monkeys, answered according to his understanding, saying : " It is in no way surprising, O Chief of the Monkey Tribes, that thou art unable to forget the significant and unexpected service rendered to thee by **RAMA**. Assuredly that hero, for thy well-being, fearlessly slew Bali, equal to **INDRA** in power. Un doubtedly **RAMA**'s feelings have been wounded, which is evidenced by his sending his brother Laksbmana, the increaser of his happiness, as his deputy, to thee. O Thou, the most skilled in discerning the seasons, autumn is here in all her glory, the Saptacchada and Shyama trees being in full ftower, but thou, given up to pleasure, doth not perceive it. The sky, free from cloud, is filled with brilliant stars and planets, and on all the regions, lakes and rivers, calm prevails. "The time has come to inauguratethesearchfor **SITA** of which thou art conversant, O Bull among Monkeys. Finding thee forgetful, **LAKSHMANA** has come to inform thee that the hour is at hand. Grieving over the abduction of his spouse, the magnanimous **RAMA** will speak harshly to thee through the lips of this hero ; is it a cause for wonder ? Having acted im properly towards him, I see no other means tending to thy welfare but to offer obeisance to **LAKSHMANA** and crave his pardon.

"Armed with his bow, **RAMA**, in his wrath, is able to subdue the whole world as also the Gods, the *Asuras* and the Gand hsrvas. It is unwise to provoke one of whom subsequently forgiveness must be craved, the more so, when the recollection of a favour received plaees one under the obligation of gratitude. Therefore incline thine head before this man with thy son and thine entourage, O King, and remain faithful to thy promise, as a woman to her husband's will. It is ill-advised of thee to oppose **RAMA**'s behests, even in thought, for thou well aware of this man's power. whose prowess is equal to **INDRA** and the Gods."

CHAPTER 33

Tara pacifies Lakshmana

AT **ANGADA**'s request, and in accord with **RAMA**'s command, **LAKSHMANA**, the slayer of hostile warriors, entered the beautiful city of Kisbkindha situated amidst caves. Seeing **LAKSHMANA** approaching, the highly powerful monkeys of immense size guarding the gate, stood with joined palms and beholding the son of **DASARATHA** filled with wrath, breathing heavily, dared not obstruct his entty. Then that mighty warrior, gazing about him, beheld that great city decorated with jewels and flowery gardens and rendered magnificent by heaps of precious stones with which it was filled ; abounding in spacious buildings and temples, with jewels of every kind in abundance offered as merchandise, it was em-Labhmana beheld great mansions also, as high as the Vindhya and Meru mountains, and streams of pure watet flowing through the city. He surveyed the enchanting abodes of **ANGADA**, Mainda, Dvivida, Gavaya, Gavaksha, Gaja, Shatabha, Vidhumati, Sampati, Sutyaksha, **HANUMAN**, Virabahu, Subahu and the great souled Nala, Kumuda,

Sushena, Tara, **JAMBAVAN**, Dadhi baktra, Nila, Sunetra and Supatala, dwellings like unto white clouds adorned with fragrant garlands and filled with jewels, grain and lovely women. The magnificent and inaccessible abode of the King of Monkeys, like the palace of Mahendra, stood on a white rock and was decorated with pinnacled domes resembling the peaks of Mt. Kailasha. Trees in full flower, bearing fruits of every kind of delicious flavour, had been planted there and resembled blue clouds, enchanting with their cool shade, celestial blooms and golden-hued fruit. Valiant monkeys, bearing weapons in their hands, guarded the resplendent gateway, the arches of which were of fine gold adorned with magnificent garlands. The mighty Labhmsna entered **SUGRIVA**'s palace without hindrance as the sun enters a great cloud, and having traversed the seven courtyards, filled with conveyances and seats, he beheld the inner apartments of that Chief of the Monkeys abounding in gold and silver couches with rich coverlets and fine seats. On entering there, he heard sweet music blending with the rhythmic cadence of singing to the accompaniment of stringed instruments; and in the private apartments of **SUGRIVA**, many a high-born woman, distinguished for her youth and beauty, sumptuously attired, crowned with flowers and engaged in weaving garlands was observed by the high-souled **LAKSHMANA**. He nOted too, that there were none of the king's attendants, who were not richly apparelled, happy, well fed and eager to offer their services. Hearing the sound of the women's anklets and girdles, the virtuous Labhmana became confused and incensed by the 1inkling of those ornaments ; and that hero stretched the cord of his bow so that the twanging resounded on all sides. There after the valiant Labhmana, indignant on **RAMA**'s account, withdrew into a comer and stood silent, reflecting on his "57 presumption in entering **SUGRIVA**'s private apartments. Hearing the

twanging of the bow, **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, recognizing the presence of Laksbmana, began to tremble on his splendid throne. He reJiected : ' As **ANGADA** previously informed me, Saumitri, through brotherly solicitude, bas undoubtedly come hither.' Tben tbat monkey, informed by **ANGADA**, bis tidings now made doubly sure by the sound of the bow, understood tbat **LAKSHMANA** bad come and he grew pale, bis heart being filled with appre hension, and **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, addressed Tara, of charming appearance, in well considered words saying: " O Lady of Lovely Eyebrows, wbat cause for displeasure has the younger brother of **RAMA**, who is gentle by nature ? Why bas he come hither like a raving madman ? Dost thou know the reason of this prince's anger ? Assuredly tbat lion among men cannot be enraged without cause. If bave un wittingly displeased him, then considering the matter carefully, inform me without dt!lay or go thyself to him. " O Lovely One, by thy sweet speech seek to conciliate him. Seeing thee, his mind will become tranquil and bis anger be allayed, for great warriors do not permit themselves to treat women with harshness. When thy gentle words bave soothed him and his mind and senses are under control, then I, in my turn, will approach tbat prince, whose eyes are as large as lotuS petals and who is the conqueror of bis foes." On this, Tara, swaying slightly, her eyes bright from the drinking of wine, her girdle loosened, banging by a golden thread, wearing the insignia of royalty, with downcast looks approached **LAKSHMANA**. And when tbat great warrior beheld the consort of the King of the Monkeys, he, restraining his wrath in the presence of a woman, bowed his head, conducting himself like an ascetic. Under the influence of wine and observing the benign attitude of tbat Prince, Tara, discarding all diffidence, addressed him in a conciliatory manner, in words calculated to gain bis confidence and said: " From whence springs this anger, O Son of a King ? Who has

failed to carry out thine orders ? Wbat reckless person bas ss approached the forest where the treeS are dry with a flaming torch?" Mollified by this soft speech, **LAKSHMANA** replied with studied courtesy: "Why, given over to lust, does thy consort neglect his duty and his own true interests ? And thou, who art devoted to him, why dost thou not give the matter thy consideratinn ? He has become indifferent to the aflilirs of the kingdom and of ourselves and our displeasure. Surrounded by parasites, O Tara, he gives himself up to sensual enjoyments. " The four months appointed as the of waiting have passed, but the King of the Monkeys in an orgy of drunken ness and pleasure, is unaware of it. Assuredly dissipation is not a proper means to the observance of one's duty and obliga tions. Intemperance brings in its train the loss of wealth, virtue and the capacity for enjoyment. "Not to requite a service received is to fail wholly in one's duty and to lose a good friend is immensely injurious to one's higher interests. From the point of view of prosperity, the greatest of virtues is friendship that is rooted in loyalty and justice ; he who fails in these is not fixed in his duty. This being so, what should therefore be done, O Thou, who art conversant with the path of duty ? " Hearing these just and reasonable words, expressed with gentleness, Tara assured the prince of the certain fulfilment of his enterprise and again addressed **LAKSHMANA** saying : " O Son of a King, this is not the time for recrimination, thou shouldst restrain thine anger against my lord ; he has thine interests at heart, forgive his folly, O Warrior. " O Prince, how can a man endowed with every good quality be indignant with one who is lacking in them ? Which of thine equals, despite his good character, would give way to wrath? I know the reason for the displeasure of **SUGRIVA**'s valiant ally, I am conversant with the service that you have both rendered us and which we must return. I know further, O Best of Men, that one must master one's passions. I am aware

in what company **SUGRIVA** has yielded to lust, which is the cause of the present pro crastination that incites thy wrath. When man yields to desire he forgets time and place as also his duty and whatshouldrightfully 259 be done. Do thou pardon this Leader of the Monkey Race, who, at my side, without shame, gives himself up to sensual enjoyment to which he is the slave. Even the great *Rishis*, devoted to the practice of asceticism, when carried away by desire, lost control of their minds, how should this monkey, ,therefore, volatile by nature, when overcome by passion, not become a slave to pleasure, king though he be ? " Having addressed these words of profound understanding to **LAKSHMANA**, whose courage was immeasurable, the gentle Vanari, with a troubled look, on account of her conjugal affection, then added for the good of her lord : " O Most Excellent of Men, though overcome by desire, **SUGRIVA** has long since made preparation to thine advantage. Already hundreds, thousands and millions of valiant monkeys, able to change their form at will, inhabiting every kind of tree, have come here. “Be pleased to enter, therefore, O Long-armed Warrior; the chaste conduct of a sincere friend authorizes him to look on the wives of others.” Al Tara’s invitation and urged by a desire to carry out the commands that had been laid upon him, that illustrious hero, the conqueror of his foes, entered the inner apartment. There, seated on a golden throne, covered with a rich cloth, he beheld **SUGRIVA**, resembling the sun itself, his person decked with celestial ornaments, of a godlike beauty and dignity. Wearing superb raiment and wreaths he looked like Mahendra himself, on every side he was surrounded by women adorned with crowns and jewels meet for goddesses, and his reddened eyes gave him the appearance of Antaka. Of the hue of fine gold, clasping Ruma firmly in his arms, seated on a magnificent throne, that large-eyed hero saw before him the mighty Saumitri of expansive eyes.

CHAPTER 34

Lakshmana reproaches Sugriva

SEEING that indomitable lion among men, **LAKSHMANA**, entering full of wrath, **SUGRIVA** was troubled and, observing that Son of **DASARATHA** breathing heavily and burniog with indignation on account of the calamity that had overtaken his brother, the King of the Monkeys rose and, leaving his golden seat that re sembled the highly decorated standard of **INDRA**, his eyes infiamcd, approached Prince **LAKSHMANA** and stood before him like the mighty Kalpa tree. Thereupon the women, lead by Ruma, followed him, like a cluster of stars surrounding the moon. Then **LAKSHMANA**, filled with ire, said to **SUGRIVA** standing amidst the women with Ruma at his side, like the moon sur rounded by stars : " That king who is endowed with great and noble qualities and is compassionate, who has subdued his senses and is grateful and loyal, obtaios renown io the world, but the monarch who is rooted in unrighteousness and is unjust to his friends who have rendered him assistance, is the object of opprobrium. “To utter a falsehood with reference to a horse is to be guilty of the death of a hundred horses, io regard to a cow of a thousand cows, but to utter a falsehood io regard to a man is to destroy one’s self as well as one’s kindred. " That ungrateful wretch, who, having gained his end, does not render service for service, is guilty of the murder of all beiogs, O King of the Plavagas ; this is the text recited by **BRAHMA** on beholding one who was guilty of iogratitude ; it is known throughout the world, O Plavamgama. He who kills a cow or drioks iotoxicating liquor or is a thief or violates his vow is still able to expiate his sio, but for him who is guilty of io gratitude, no expiation is possible. " Thou art an ignoble, false and ungrateful wretch, O

Monkey, for having obtaioed what thou didst seek from Rams without requiting his services. Having achieved thy desire through Rams, is it not thy duty to do everything in thy power to recover **SITA** ? Yielding thyself up to sensual delights, unaue to thy promise, Rams does not know thee for the serpent croaking like a frog, that thou art. " In his compassion for thee, O Wicked Wretch, the magnani mous **RAMA** enabled thee regain the kingdom of the monkeys. Thou hast failed to acknowledge the benefits conferred on thee by the higb-souled Raghava, therefore pierced by sharp arrows thou shalt follow Bali. The path thy brother took at death is not yet closed I Honour thy promise, O **SUGRIVA**, do not follow in his wake. Since thou dost not behold the Prince of the Ikshwakus loosing his fiery shafts, thou art still able to remain serene and happy, without concerning thyself about his anxieties."

CHAPTER 35

Tara defends Sugriva

THUS spoke **LAKSHMANA**, the son of **SUMITRA**, inftamed with anger and Tara, whose face was as fair as the moon, answered him saying : " O **LAKSHMANA**, the King of the Monkeys has not merited this harsh language, particularly from thy lips. **SUGRIVA** is not ungrateful nor false nor worthy of condemnation nor, O Hero, does he utter what is not aue nor is he an impostor I " The valiant monkey, **SUGRIVA**, has not forgotten the assist ance rendered to him by **RAMA** on the field of battle, which no other was able to give. With the aid of the magnanimous Rams, **SUGRIVA** has regained his glory and the lasting dominion of the monkey realm and has been restored to Ruma and myself once again, O

Scourge of thy Foes ! " Having been subject to cruel adversity and now enjoying the summit of good fortune, he has become insensible to the arrival of the time for the fulfilment of his promise, as was the Sage **VISHWAMITRA** of old. For ten years, that virtuous Sage was attached to the nymph Ghritaehi and failed to perceive that time was passing, he, who was skilled in discerning time. " **SUGRIVA** had been deprived of physical pleasures over a long period, he was exhausted and had not experienced any relaxa tion, O **LAKSHMANA**, therefore **RAMA** should pardon him. And thou, O **LAKSHMANA**, shouldst not give way to wrath like an inferior person without ascertaining what has taken place. Virtuous people like thee, O Lion among Men, do not give way to immediste and unreasoning anger. In all humility, I appeal to thee on behalf of **SUGRIVA** to control the grief that gives rise to this anger in thee. It is my firm conviction that **SUGRIVA** is ready to renounce Ruma, **ANGADA**, myself, kingdom, wealth, grain and herds to please **RAMA**. Having slain that vile demon, **SUGRIVA** will restore **SITA** to **RAMA**, as the moon is re-united with Rohini. " In Lanka there are hundreds, thousands and millions of irrepressible demons able to change their shape at will ; without destroying these formidable beings, it is impossible to overcome **RAVANA**, by whom Maithili has been borne away. **SUGRIVA** is unable to defeat those demons of terrible exploits without the support of auxiliaries, O **LAKSHMANA**. This was Bali’s con sidered opinion, that resourceful and experienced monarch of the monkeys. Knowing nought of the matter, I heard it from his lips. " In order to render thee assistance, the foremost of the monkeys have been summoned for this enterprise with in numerable carefully selected troops. Awaiting those valiant and powerful monkeys, chosen to assure the success of **RAMA**’s undertaking, the King of the Monkeys has not yet left the city. " O Lakshmans, some time ago **SUGRIVA**, wisely

ordered that these monkeys should come together this very day. Thousands and millions of bears and hundreds of Golangulas' as well as innumerable kotis' of monkeys, burning with energy, will be at thy disposal to-day. " Therefore O Conqueror of Thy Foes, subdue thy wrath. Seeing thy face distorted with anger and thine eyes in1lamed, the wives of these foremost of monkeys, far from being reassured, are suffering all the anguish of their former fear."

CHAPTER 36

Lakshmana is reconciled to Sugriva

BY nature geude, **LAKSHMANA** listened to those just and gracious words of Tara with deference. Perceiving the magnanimous acceptance of her speech, the King vf the Monkeys threw off his fear as one discards wet clothing. Thereafter **SUGRIVA** tore off the gaudy and variegated garland from his neck and threw it away, his intoxication being dissipated and that Chief of the Monkeys addressed the re doubtable warrior **LAKSHMANA** with humility, thus gratifying him, and said : " O Saumitri, I had lost my fortune, my fame and the kingdom of the monkeys which by **RAMA**'s favour have been wholly restored to me. Who is able to equal this or render it back even in part to that divine **RAMA**, renowned for his exploits, O Prince? The virtuous Raghava will recover **SITA** and slay **RAVANA** by his own valour alone ; as for me, I shall merely accompany him. What need of assistance has he who, with a single arrow pierced seven giant trees and a mountain, penetrating deep into the earth ? He by the sound of whose stretching bow the earth with its mountains quakes, what need has he for aid ? I shall follow that **INDRA** among Men, O **LAKSHMANA**, when he goes forth to destroy his

adversary, **RAVANA**, together with his House. " If I have betrayed his friendship or confidence in some measure, may he pardon me; is there any without fault ? " These words vf the magnanimous **SUGRIVA** pleased Laksh mana who addressed him affectionately, saying : " Assuredly my brother will not lack support, O Prince of the Monkeys, above all, O **SUGRIVA**, with thy co-operation, who art full of humility. Such is thy valour and sincerity, that thou art worthy of enjoying the unequalled prosperity of the monkey realm. " With thine aid, undoubtedly, O **SUGRIVA**, the illustrious **RAMA** will soon slay his enemies in battle. Virtuous, mindful of what should be done, intrepid in the field, thou utterest noble words that are worthy of thee, O Friend. Who else, recognizing his fault, at the height of his power, would speak thus, O Bull among the Monkeys, save mine elder brother and thee ? " Thou art equal to **RAMA** in courage and strength ! Thou has been ordained his ally by the Gods, O Chief of the Monkeys. Why delay further, O Hero, let us go forth together and offer consolation to thy friend, who is afflicted on account of separa tion from his consort. " O **SUGRIVA**, forgive those reproaches that I addressed to thee on account ofRama’s profound distress.”

CHAPTER 37

Sugriva assembles his Troops

" Call together all those who inhabit the heights of the Mahendra, Himavat, Vindhya, Kailasha and Mandara mountains, as also those from the peaks of Mt. Pandu and the Five Hills ; those who dwell on the mountains that are bright as the dawn; those who inhabit the furthest shores of the sea in the western region and those on the mountains in the

mansions of the sun ; those formidable monkeys who have taken refuge in the Pad machalu woods ; those monkeys resembling clouds of collyrium, who possess the strength of the lord of elephants, who dwell on the Anjana hill ; those possessing the splendour of gold, inhabiting the caves of the Mahashaila mountains and those who frequent the slopes of Mt. Meru, as well as those dwelling on Mt. Dhumra ; those who possess the brilliance of the rising sun, of immense bounds, who, on the Mt. Maharuna, drink the heady wine Maireya ; those who dwell in the vast, fait and fragrant forests with their charming glades, where the ascetics' hermitages are found. With the aid of the fteetest of monkeys summon 265 them all from every quarter of the world by means of gifts and conciliation, Already I have sent out messengers who are famed for their agility, yet, in order to expedite matters further, let them be followed by other emissaries. " Bring those leaders of monkeys also, who are lazy or given over to pleasure. If they have not responded to my appeal in ten days, they will suffer the death penalty for infringing the royal command. Let those lions among monkeys under my dominion carry out my orders with all speed in their hundreds, thousands and millions. " Resembling mountains of mist shrouding the heavens, let those excellent monkeys of terrifying aspect come at my call. Let all the monkeys who are acquainted with the way, scour the earth; call them together at my command with all speed." At the words of the Monkey King, the Son of the Wind dis patched groups of intelligent monkeys to every quarter. Setting out to that region traversed by **VISHNU**, by the paths fre quented by birds and stars, the monkeys, under the commands of their sovereign set fonh immediately. Scouring the seas, mountains, forests and lakes, they called all the different monkeys together to help **RAMA**. When these monkeys heard of **SUGRIVA**'s order, a very death warrant, they, in fear, at once set out for Kishkindha. Those of the

Plavagama Tribe, who were as black as collyrium, filled with energy, came from the Mt. Anjana to the number of three kotis to join **RAMA**. Those who frolicked on the high hills, where the sun sets, shining like gold, offered themselves in ten kotis. From the heights of Mt. Kailasha, monkeys whose colour resembled a lion's mane, came to the number of a thousand and those who lived on fruit and roots, who dwelt on Himavat came in tens of millions, whilst those terrible apes of fearful deeds, resembling burning coals, descended in haste aom the VIJldhya mountain in thousands of millions. Those who dwelt on the shores of the white sea, the dwellers of the Tamala forests and those who fed on coconuts could not be numbered. From woods, caves and rivers, a vast army of monkeys issued forth, whn seemed able to drink up the sun's rays. Now those mighty monkeys, who had gnne out in all haste to spur others on, 266 found a great tree growing on the summit of Mt. Himavat. In ancient times on that divine and sacred peak, a great sacrifice bad been performed which found favour with Mabadcva, who satisfies all the desires of the Gods. Thereafter many varieties of fruit and roots resembling ambrosia bad sprung up in that quarter from the sacred offerings of grain and seed,' and those who partook of them had no need of further sustenance for the period of a whole month. Then those foremost among the monkeys gathered those celestial fruits and roots with medicinal herbs from that place of sacrifice and they brought fragrant flowers also to please **SUGRIVA**. Having called all the monkeys of the world together, those chosen messeogers returned with speed at the head of their troops and soon those fleet and spirited monkeys bad returned to Kishkindba, where **SUGRIVA** was ; and they presented him with the fruit, herbs and roots that they bad gathered, saying : "We bave scoured the mountains, rivers and forests ; all the monkeys of the earth bave come at thy call." These words pleased **SUGRIVA**, the King of the

Monkey Tribe, who freely accepted all the gifts they bad brought.

CHAPTER 38

Sugriva goes to meet Rama

Having sent away those thousands of monkeys, who had per formed their task, he deemed his mission, as that of the mighty Ragbava, well nigh accomplished. Thereupon **LAKSHMANA** addressed the redoubtable **SUGRIVA**, the foremost of monkeys, with a deference which moved him, saying :-" O Friend, be pleased to set out from Kishkindha." Hearing these words spoken by Shri **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA** filled with joy answered :-" Be it so, let us go forward, I am at thy command." Having thus spoken to the illustrious **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA** dismissed Tara with the other women and thereafter summoning the leaders of the monkeys in a loud voice addressed them, saying :-" Come hither ! " At the sound of his voice all those admitted to the presence of women came immediately and stood with joined palms before the king, whose brilliance equalled the sun's and who said to them: " Go with all speed and bring a litter, O Monkeys I" At this command they set out with rapid strides to seek that mar vellous litter and, when it was made ready, the supreme Sovereign of the Monkeys said to Saumitri :-" Be pleased to ascend the litter. O **LAKSHMANA** ! " Speaking thus, **SUGRIVA** with **LAKSHMANA** mounted the golden litter that shone like the sun and was supported by a large number of monkeys. A white canopy was spread over **SUGRIVA**'s head and magnificent fans made of yaks tails were waved about him. Eulogized by bards, to the sound of conches and trumpets, he set out in regal state. Surrounded by hundreds of war-like monkeys bearing weapons in their hands he proceeded to the

place whereRama dwelt and, having arrived at that excellent spot, that illustrious prince descended from the litter with **LAKSHMANA** and approached **RAMA** with joined palms. Then the monkeys, grouped about him, did likewise and, seeing that great army of monkeys resembling a lake covered with lotos buds, **RAMA** was well pleased with **SUGRIVA**. Raising the King of the Monkeys, who had prostrated him self before him and whose forehead touched his feet, the virtuous **RAMA** embraced him to demonstrate his affection and esteem and requested him to be seated. Thereafter seeing him seated on the ground, **RAMA** *said*: " He who divides his time judiciously between duty, pleasure and the legitimate acquisition of wealth and honours his responsi bilities in these things is truly a king, O Best of Monkeya ; but he who neglects his duty, his true interests and legitimate pleasures is like one who sleeps o"\ the top of a tree and does not 268 wake up till he has fallen. The monarch who is evet ready tn destroy his foes and delights in showing favour to his friends, who plucks the fruit of the threefold food, has fulfilled his duty. “The time has now come tn act, O Scourge of Thy Foes, thetefore take counsel with thy ministers, O King of the Apes ! " Thus addressed, **SUGRIVA** answeted **RAMA**, saying :-" I had lost fame and fortune togethet with the entire monkey realm, O Long-armed Warrior but, through thy filvour have received them again by thine and thy brother’s grace, O Great One, O Greatest of the Conquetors. He who does not acknowledge a service done to him is an object of contempt. " These enetgetic leaders have gone out in their hundreds to summon all the monkeys in the world, O Slayet of thy Foes. Monkeys, bears and apes full of valour, of fetocious aspect, familiar with the woods and inaccessible forests, monkeys that are born of the Gods and Gandharvas, able to change their shape at will, are on their way followed by their troops, O **RAMA**. " These monkeys are proceeding here surrounded by

hundreds and thousands,' by millions and tens of millions ; these monkeys and their chiefs, who are as valiant as Mahendra and resemble mountains in stature, are coming togethet from the Meru and Vindhya ranges. They will unite with thee to fight the demon **RAVANA** and, laying him low on the battlefield, will restnre **SITA** to thee." Seeing the preparations made by that valiant monkey, in accord with his desire, the illustrious prince was delighted and his countenance resembled the blue lorus in ftowet. CHAPTBil 39 1M Arrival of **SUGRIVA**'s Forces THVs spoke **SUGRIVA**, standing with joined palms before Ramo, and that most virtuous of men, taking him in his arms, embraced him saying :-" It is no wonder that **INDRA** sends the rain, nor that the sun with its thousand rays dispels the darkness from the sky, O My dear One, nor that the moon by its brilliance makes the night clear, nor that thine equals create the happiness of their friends, O Scourge of Thy Foes. To find nobility of character in thee is not strange ; I know thee by the affectionate tenor of thy speecb. With thy support, O My Friend, I shall vanquish all my foes on the battlefield ; thou art mine ally and shouldst assist me. " To his own destruction, did that vile demon bear Maithili away, as Anuhlada' carried away Sachi, havingfirstdeceivedher sire.' Ere long, I shall pierce **RAVANA** with my sharp arrows as Shatakratu, that slayer of his enemies, slew the haughty father ofPaulomi." At that moment, darkness covered the firmament and veiled the fiery brilliance of that orb of a thousand rays ; a pall of dust hung over all regions, and the earth with its mountains, forests and woods trembled. The entire earth was covered with in numerable monkeys resembling kings of men and who, having sharp teeth, were gifted with great strength. In the twinkling of an eye, those foremost of monkeys surrounded by troops, number ing hundreds of kotis, endowed with extreme energy, roaring like thunder, gathered from the rivers, mountains and seas with others who inhabited the

forests. Monkeys the colour of the rising sun or white like the moon or of the tint of lotus stamens or psle, having their home on the golden mounrain, appeared in tens of thousands in attendance on that renowned and valiant monkey Shatavali. Then the puissant

CHAPTER 39

The arrival of Sugriva's Forces

CHAPTBil 39 1M Arrival of **SUGRIVA**'s Forces THVs spoke **SUGRIVA**, standing with joined palms before Ramo, and that most virtuous of men, taking him in his arms, embraced him saying :-" It is no wonder that **INDRA** sends the rain, nor that the sun with its thousand rays dispels the darkness from the sky, O My dear One, nor that the moon by its brilliance makes the night clear, nor that thine equals create the happiness of their friends, O Scourge of Thy Foes. To find nobility of character in thee is not strange ; I know thee by the affectionate tenor of thy speecb. With thy support, O My Friend, I shall vanquish all my foes on the battlefield ; thou art mine ally and shouldst assist me. " To his own destruction, did that vile demon bear Maithili away, as Anuhlada' carried away Sachi, havingfirstdeceivedher sire.' Ere long, I shall pierce **RAVANA** with my sharp arrows as Shatakratu, that slayer of his enemies, slew the haughty father ofPaulomi." At that moment, darkness covered the firmament and veiled the fiery brilliance of that orb of a thousand rays ; a pall of dust hung over all regions, and the earth with its mountains, forests and woods trembled. The entire earth was covered with in numerable monkeys resembling kings of men and who, having sharp teeth, were gifted with great strength. In the twinkling of an eye, those foremost of monkeys surrounded by troops, number ing hundreds

of kotis, endowed with extreme energy, roaring like thunder, gathered from the rivers, mountains and seas with others who inhabited the forests. Monkeys the colour of the rising sun or white like the moon or of the tint of lotus stamens or psle, having their home on the golden mounrain, appeared in tens of thousands in attendance on that renowned and valiant monkey Shatavali. Then the puissant sire of Tara, who resembled a golden hill, appeared at the head of many thousand kotis. Thereafter the father of Rums, father in-law of **SUGRIVA**, who resembled the filaments of a lotus and was like a youthful sun, arrived accompanied by other thousands of kotis of monkeys; and that foremost of monkeys, Kesharin, **HANUMAN**'s illustrious sire, appesred in company with many thousands of monkeys. And Gavaksha, King of the Golangulas, endowed with dtesdful power came, surrounded by millions of monkeys ; Dhumra also, the destroyer of his foes, advanced with two thousand bears endowed with terrific speed. Thereafter the lesder of herds, Panasha of exceeding prowess came, ac companied by three million mighty and dtesdful warriors and he was followed by Nila of immense stature, who resembled a mass of collyrium, with ten kotis of monkeys. And bright as a golden mountain, the heroic Gavaya arrived with five kotis of monkeys, and in his devotion to **SUGRIVA** the brave chief Dari mukha brought a thousand kotis. Thereafter the two powerful Ashwiputras, Mainda and Dvivida presented themselves with a thousand million monkeys. The brave warrior Gaja conducted an army of thtee kotis of monkeys, and the illustrious king of the bears, called J ambavan, came at the hesd of ten kotis, placing himself under **SUGRIVA**'s command. The renowned Rumana followed with a hundted kotis of intrepid monkeys in all haste. A hundted thousand million monkeys followed Gandhamadana, and an infinite number were under the command of Prince **ANGADA**, who, like his father, was full of courage.

Thereafter, shining like a star, came Tara of supreme valour, accompanied by five kotis of monkeys from a grest distance and there followed Indtajanu, a brave and skilful general, who in his turn presented himself at the head of eleven kotis, and also Rambha with an ayuta' of soldiers; and there followed the monkey leader Durmukha, that valiant one full of phenomenal courage, with two kotis of monkeys, resembling the peaks of Mt. Kailasha. **HANUMAN** himself was accompanied by thousands of monkeys and the supremely brave Nala was followed by the inhabitants of the woods to the number of an hundted, a thousand and an hundted monkeys. The fortunate Darimukha was escorted by ten kotis of monkeys and with loud shouts took his place beside **SUGRIVA**. And Sbarabha, Kumuda, Vahni and Rambha came, those monkeys who were able to change their shape at will, with their forces of incalculable numbers covering the entire earth, its mountains and forests. All the monkeys inhabiting the earth gathered round **SUGRIVA**, leaping, gambolling and roaring, and those Plavagamas surrounded **SUGRIVA** like massed clouds round the sun. Full of courage and energy, they gave voice to repeated shouts of acclamation, bowing their heads in salutation to the King of Monkeys. Others, the leaders of armies, according to tradition, approached the king and stood by his side with joined palms; and **SUGRIVA** standing in extreme devotion before **RAMA**, informed him of the arrival of the monkeys and then addressed his generals, who were burning with zeal, saying:-" O Chiefs of Monkeys, station your forces duly on the mountain near rills in the woods and let each ascertain the exact number of his uoops."

CHAPTER 40

Sugriva sends his Monkeys to the East in search of Sita

THEN the Lord of the Monkeys, his purpose accomplished, said to that lion among men, Rarna, the destroyer of hostile hosts : “Here, gathered together, are the foremost of monkeys in habiting my dominions, who are equal to Mabendra and are able to transpnrt themselves anywhere at will. These ferocious monkeys, resembling giants and titans, of immeasurable prowess, renowned for their exploits, bellicose, valiant, indefatigable and supremely sagacious in all their deliberations, have come with their vast forces. " O **RAMA**, these untold millions, who inhabit varinus mountain tracts, traversing land and sea, have come to place themselves at thy service. All are intent on their master’s welfare and obedient to thy behests ; they are at thy command, it is for thee to dispose of them as thou wilt. Though I am fully conversant with thy design, yet do thou order all as thou judgest besL” Thus spoke **SUGRIVA** and **RAMA**, the son of Dasaratba, taking him in his arms, said to him : " O Dear and Wise Friend, let us learn if **SITA** still lives or no and ascertain in what country **RAVANA** dwells. Then, having come to where Videha’s daughter is to he found, we will adopt those measures that circumstances dictate, the hour having been fixed. " O Lord of the Monkeys, it is not for me to command this expedition nor for **LAKSHMANA**; it is thou who must direct it; thou shalt be its leader. Do thou, O Lord, take the command thyself in this matter, thou art fully acquainted with my purpose, O Hero. Thou, the second of my friends, art full of courage, wise, knowing bow to choose the fitting moment,

devoted to my true interests, supremely loyal and accomplished." Thus addressed, **SUGRIVA**, in the presence of **RAMA** and the sagacious **LAKSHMANA**, said to his general, Vinata, who resembled a great hill and whose voice resounded like thunder : " O Foremost of Leaders, who art accompanied by monkeys as bright as the sun and moon, thou art able to tum time and place to advantage and art skilled in conducting thine affairs ! Taking with thee hundreds and thousands of apes, explore the eastern region with its forests, woods and mountains, in search of **SITA**, the Princess of Videha and also **RAVANA**'s stronghold. Search among the mountain fastnesses, the forests and rivers for **RAMA**'s beloved consort, the daughter-in-law of King Daaratha ; search by the beautiful Bhagirathi, the Sarayu, the Kaushiki and the Kaliudi, the enchanting Yamuna and the great hills bordering the Saraswati, the Sindhu and the Shona of ruby waters, the Mahi and Kalamahi with their splendid wooded hills. " Look for them in the Brahmamalas, Videhas, Malavana, Kashikoshalas, and Magadhas, the Pundras and Angas, lands where the silkworm and silver mines abound and on the mountains and cities skirting the sea. Search through the houses in Mandara, amongst those people whose ears resemble cloths reaching to their nether lip, whose faces are black and dreadful, who are one-footed, though fleet withal, and whose bodies do not deteriorate ; those also who feed on human llesh, and the Kiratas, hunters who are golden-hued, of pleasing looks, possessing thick hair worn in a knot, who subsist on raw fish and those creatures, tiger-men, terrible to behold. " O Dwellers in the woods, search carefully in all these places that are accessible by climbing and swimming and the Island of the Seven Kingdoms Yava, also and the islands Suvama and Rupayaks, full of gold mines, called the gold and silver islands. Beyond these, is the mountain Shishita, whose peaks reach to the heavens, and which is inhaloited by Gods and Giants. Seek

here in the mountain fastnesses, cascades and forests for the glorious consort of **RAMA**. “Thereafter you will reach the red and swiftly ftowing river Shona ; from there descend to the seashore, where the Siddhas and Charanas dwell. In these enchanting sacred spots, seek everywhere for **RAVANA** and Sira. Explore the forests, mountain sprung rivers, wild tracts and cavernous heights. It behoves you to examine the terrible islands in the ocean, where great waves arise and, whipped by the tempest, let forth a thunderous roar. There dwell *Asuras* of immense size, who by **BRAHMA**’s permission, seize the shadows of birds ftying over the sea. Arriving at that vast ocean, that resounds like clouds at the time of the dissolution of the universe, frequented by huge serpents, keep careful watch and crossing over that sea, called Lohita, whose red waters are terrible to behold, you will come upon the mighty knarled Shamali tree. There, constructed by Vish waksrma, like unto Mt. Kailasha, decorated with every kind of gem, towereth the abode of **GARUDA**. Terrible demons resembl ing hills of diverse forms, named Mandehas, hang suspended from the rocks there. Day after day, at the rising of the sun, those demons tormented by that planet, fall into the water, struck by **BRAHMA**’s energy and then suspend themselves on the rocks once more. “Proceeding further, you will come to the sea, named Kshiroda, that resembles a white cloud with its waves shining like a necklace of pearls. In its centre rises the great white mountain Rishabha, planted with trees, bearing fragrant blossoms and a lake named Sudarshana covered with dazzling silver lotuses having golden stamens, where flamingoes abound. Vibudhas, Charanas, Yakshas and Kinneras in the company of troops of Apsaras, disport themselves on the shore of that lake. Z74 “Leaving the Kshiroda Sea behind, O Warriors, you will come to the Jalada sea which is a source of terror to all beings. There the *Rishi* Aurva created a shining object by the power of his anger, which

was transformed into the head of a horse by **BRAHMA**. Its heat is unequalled and its food is the universe of movable and immovable beings. There the cries of the creatures of the sea, who are unsble to bear the flames, can be heard wailing in its vicinity. " To the north of the Svadu Sea rises the high mountain Jatarupashila, covering thirteen yojanas, of the splendour of gold. There, O Monkeys, you will behold the supporters of the earth, the serpent resembling the moon, with eyes as large as lotus petals, worshipped by the Gods, and possessing a thousand heads, the divine Ananta of dark hue sleeping on the summit of the mountain. There stands a golden palm tree with three branches resembling a standard set upon an altar. This is the boundary of the Eastern region set up by the Gods. " Reaching up to the heavens, measuring a hundred yojanas, the mountain, Udaya, rises with its golden peak, beautiful with its Sala, Tamala and flowering Karoikara trees bright as the sun. " There also is the peak Saumanasa four miles in breadth and forty in height. From there in former days, **VISHNU**, the supreme Lord, measured the earth with three strides, the second being Mt. Meru. " The sun passing from Jambudwipa on the north and reach ing the summit of Saumanasa, again becomes visible to the dwcllers in Jambudwipa. It is there that the great *Rishis*, Vaikhanasas, bright as the sun, perform their austerities. " This is the island Sudarshana, where the sun rises, giving light to all beings. Search for Janaki and **RAVANA** on these mountain fastnesses and in the forests and woods. Here, when the sun shines on the Shalla mountain, the east appears roseate. Because the sun rises there, Brahms established it, in ancient times, as the gateway of the world, called the East. Here you should look for **SITA** and Ravaoa on the mountain breast, in the caves and by the waterfalls. " Beyond is the impassable eastern quarter inhabited by the Gods, bereft of sun and moon, covered by darkness. Search for the princess in all those rocks,

woods and streams that I have msde known to you, but, O Foremost of Monkeys, you are only able to proceed thus far. Beyond is the region without sun or bourne of which I have no knowledge. Proceeding in search of Vaidehi and Ravena's abode, having reached the mountain Udaya, return, when a full month shall have passed. Do not exceed the period ; he who does so, will be punished by death. " Having attained your end, and met with Maithili and with care explored the favourite region of Mahendra, which is covered with woods and thickets, return satisfied.

CHAPTER 41

He sends other Monkeys to explore the Southern Region

THEN having sent away that mighty host of monkeys to the east, **SUGRIVA** dispatched another well tried army to the south. Appointing **ANGADA** leader of those heroic monkeys, that hero, the lord of the monkey bands, conversant with the countries that had to be explored, sent out those endowed with speed and valour : Nila, the Son of **AGNI**, and the monkey Hanumsn, the exceedingly energetic **JAMBAVAN**, Suhotra and Sharari, Sharagulms, Gaja, Gavaksha, Gavaya, Sushena, Vrishabha, Mainda, Dvivida, Gandhamadana, Ulksmukha and Ananga, the two sons of Hutashaoa. And the King of the Monkeys began to describe those regions that were difficult of access to those aimian chiefs, saying : " You will first behold the Vindhya ranges, poasessing a hundred peaks covered with trees and shrubs of every kind, and the enchanting river, Narmada, frequented by mighty serpents, and the wide and charming stream, Godavari, with its dark reeds, and the captivating

Krishoaveni ; the regions of Mekha1as and Utkala and the city of Dasharoa also ; AbraVBIIti and Avanti, 276 Vidarbhas and Nishtikas and the charming Mahishabs. You will see too, the Matsyas, Kalingas and Kaushikas, where you should search for the princess and the Dandaka Forest with its mountains, rivers and caverns and the Godavari, also examine the districts of Andhras, Paundras, the Cholas, Pandyas and Keralas. Then repair to the Ayomukha Mountain, rich in ore, with its marvellous peaks and fiowering woodlands ; that mountain, possessing lovely forests of sandalwood, should he carefully searched by you. " Thereafter you will behold that divine river of pure waters, the Kaveri, rendered gay by troups of Apsaras. On the summit of the mighty Mountain Malaya, bright as the sun, you will behold Agastya, the foremost ofRishis. By the permission of that high souled one, you will cross over the great river, Tamrapami, abounding in crocodiles. Ravishing forests of sandalwood cover the islands of tbese waters fiowing to the sea, which resemble a youthful bride going to meet her lover. " Proceeding further, O Monkeys, you will see the golden gates set with pearls of the city of the Pandyas ; then in order to ensure the success of your enterprise, you will approach the sea and ascertain your ability for crossing it. In the centre of the ocean, Agastya bas set that foremost of mountains, Mahendra, its slopes covered with trees. Entirely made of gold it extends deep down into the waters; the abode of Gods, *Rishis,* Yakshas and Apsaras, thronged by innumerable Siddhas and Charanas and of surpassing loveliness, it is visited by the thousand-eyed God at each new moon. " On the other side of the sea is an islaud, four hundred miles in length, inaccessible to men and splendid to look upon ; search there with particular care, it is the abode of the wicked **RAVANA**, who merits death, the Lord of the Titans, in splendour equal to lndra himself. " In the middle of the ocean dwells the female titan named

Angaraks, who procures her prey by seizing the shadow of those who fiy in the air. Your doubts at rest, search there for the consort of that king of men whose glory is limitless. " Beyond that islaud in the sea there rises a lovely hill on which Celestial Beings dwell, named Pushpitaka, bright as the raya of seem to pierce the heavens. Of these, one all golden, on which the day's orb lingers, the ungrateful and the unbeliever may not behold. Inclining your heads to that peak, offer salutations and search on. After this you will come to another mountain, difficult of access, named Suryavan extending over fourteen yojanas and, beyond this, the mountain Vaidyuta, ever green, with trees bearing every desirable fruit in all seasons. Par taking of these delectable fruit and roots and drinking the honey, pass on, O Monkeys. " Beyond there is the Mountain Kunjara which delights the eye and heart, where Vishwakarma constructed the abode of Agastya. Extending over four miles, this stately golden edifice adorned with many kinds of gems rises to the height of ten yojanas. There also is the city of Bhogavati, the abode of the Serpent Race, with spacious streets, incapable of being captured, guarded by formidable snakes and sharp-toothed highly-poisonous serpents, where the dread King of the Serpents, Vaauki, dwells. Search that city with care in every hidden place wheresoever it may be. " Going beyond, you will find the beautiful Rishabha Mountain in the form of a bull, filled with gems where excellent Goshiraka, Padmaka, and Harishyama trees and those possessing the brilliance of fire are seen. Approaching the sandalwood forest by no means should you enter there, for a certain Gandharva, named Rohita, protects it with five other Celestial Beings re splendent as the sun, named Shailusha, Gramani, Shiksha, Shuka and Rabhru. " Thereafter you will see the retreat of those ascetics, whose splendour resembles the sun, moon and fire ; this is the end of the earth where those who have won the heavenly regions, dwell. Beyond is the dread

abode of the Pitris, which is inaccessible. There Death has his city, enveloped in abysmal gloom, O Bulls among Monkeys. Pursue your explorations thus far; but thnse who go beyond never return. " Having searched all those reginns which are accessible to you, seeking for some trace of the princess, he who shall return within a month saying ' I have seen **SITA** ' will pass his days in happiness, enjoying prosperity equal to mine, in the midst of every delight. None will be dearer to me ; I .mill cherish him 278 as a relative and, however great the number of his faults, he will become my friend. " Your strength and vigour are immeasurable and you are born in families endowed with great qualities ; strive manfUlly therefore to find the princess ; set forth on this mission of supreme importance and demonstrate your heroism."

CHAPTER 42

Searchers are sent to the Western Region

HAVING despatched those monkeys in a southerly direction, **SUGRIVA**, addressing the leader, Sushena, who resembled a cloud, with bent head and joined palms approached his father-in-law, Tara's sire, who was endowed with great prowess, and spoke to him also. Then he issued orders to Maricha, the son of Maharshi and the mighty ape, Archismat, surrounded by the foremost of monkeys, possessing the splendour of Mahendra and like unto Vainateya in brilliance, and also to Maricha's offspring, the Marichas, the mighty Archirmalayas, that all these sons of the ascetic' should march towards the reginn of the West, saying : " O Ye Monkey Chiefs, let two hundred thousand monkeys, led by Sushena, set out in search of Vaidehi I Scour the countries of the Saurashtras, the Bahlikas and Chandrachitras abounding in antimony

and other provinces and populous places and fair and pleasant cities and Kukshi, dense with Punnaga trees and filled with Bakula and Uddalaka trees, as well as the tracts covered with Ketakas and the auspicious streamS whose cool waters Bow towards the west. " Explore the forest of the ascetics and the mountain wood lands ; there, having searched the tracts resembling deserts, the towering cliffs and the mountain ranges, extremely difticult of access, proceed further, when you will behold the sea, which abounds in whales and crocodiles, O Monkeys. " Then the apes shall disport themselves amidst the groves coveted with Ketakas and dense with Tamala and coconut trees. Look for **SITA** and **RAVANA**'s stronghold there, in hills and woods, on the shores of the sea and explore Murachipattana and the delightful cities of Jatapura, Avanti and Angalapa as also the forest of Alakshita and all these spacious kingdoms. " There, where the river Sindhu joins the ocean, is a high mountain named Somagiri, possessing a hundred peaks and covered with tall trees. On its slopes dwell the Sinhaswho carry whales and elephants to their nests. These are found on the mountain ridges and on the extensive plateaus, where wild elephants range, gratified with food, whose trumpeting re sembles the roar of thunder. The monkeys, able to change their sbape at will, should scour tbat golden summit, towering to the sky and covered with graceful trees. " In the middle of the sea rises the golden summit of the Mountain Pariyatra, extending over a hundred yojanas. There dwell thousands of powerful Gandharvas, effulgent as fire, formidable and mischievous, resembling Hames. O Valiant Monkeys, do not approach them nor seek to eat the fruits from tbat region. These fruit trees are guarded with ferocious vigilance by those mighty Gandharvas, nevertheless you should search for Janaki there, nor bave you ought to fear if you pre serve your monkey form. " There is a mighty hill, the colour of emerald, shining like a diamond, named Vajra,

covered with trees and cr..,....., an hundred yojanas in height and area ; carefully search all the caves of tbat mountain. " In the fourth quarter of the ocean is the Mt. Cbaravat ; there Vishwakarma forged the discus Sabasrara, which together with the conch was taken possession of by Shri **VISHNU** when he bad slain Panebajana and the Danava Hayagriva. In those deep caverns and amidst those charming slopes, search for **RAVANA** and Videba's daughter with care. " Beyond, rising from the deptba of the sea, is the mighty mountain, Varaba with its peak of pure gold which measures four and sixty yojanas. On it is the golden city named Pragjyotisba where the giant, Naraka, dwells. There do you search for **RAVANA** and Vaidehi among the beautiful plateaus and huge caves. " Passing beyond that foremost of mountains, revealing glimpses of the gold in its depths, you will come to the Mountain Sarvasauvama with its many fountains and waterfalls ; there elephants, wild boar, lions and tigers roar ceaselessly on every side, filling it with their clamour day and night. Then there is the mountain named Megha where the Gods crowned the fortunate Mahendra, he of the hay hones, the Vanquisher of Paka. Having passed that mountain protected by Mahendra, you should repair to a range of sixtY thousand golden bills, bright as the rising sun, casting their light on every side and embellished with blossoming golden trees. In their midst rises the monarch of mountains, Meru, the foremost of bills, on whom Aditya, well pleased, conferred a boon saying : " ' By my grace all the mountains under thy protection sball be golden by night and day and those Gods who inhabit thee, the Gandharvas and Danavas, sball both assume the radiance of gold.' "At dusk, the Vishwadevas, the Vasus, the M1r11ts and the Celestial gather to adore the Sun-god and wonhipped by them the sun sinks below the horizon travening forty thousand miles in the space of an hour, when it withdraws behind the mountain range. On the summit of that mountain

rises a palace resembling the sun in splendour, consisting of countless towen, which was built by Vishwakattna and is graced by various trees filled with birds. It is the ahode of the magnanimous **VARUNA**, who bears the noose in hia hand. " Between the Meru mountain and the Astachala Range there is a great Tala tree with ten crests, made of pure gold, which shines with extreme bri1liance on a marvellous base. Search all the inaccesoible places on this mountain, as well as the Jakes and riven for **RAVANA** and Vaidehi. " It is there that the virtuous Merusavarni dwells, oanctified by hia asceticism and equal to **BRAHMA** himself. Bowing down, you should make enquiries of the Maharishi Merusavarni,lwho resembles the sun, concerning Mithila's daughter. " From the end of the night, all those reginns, that the sun illumines till it sets behind the Astachala mountains, should he a8r searched by you, O Bulls among the Mookeys, but of that which lies beyond which is covered in darkness and without bourne, we know nought ! " Search for **SITA** and **RAVANA** in this region as far as the Astachala Mountain and at the end of a month, return ; those who tarry beyond this term will die. My father-in-Jaw of long arms gifted with great prowess, I appoint as your leader ; you should abide by his commands and listen to all he says ; he is my spiritual preceptot. All of you are valorous and well able to ascertain the wisdom of a course, still you will be doing your duty in accepting him as your leader. In this wise, explore the western quarter. Having requited the good that has been done to us, we shall attain our end. Do you also determine what is pleasing to Rams and, in accord with time and place, execute it." Then those monkeys and their leaders with Sushena at their head, having given a due hearing to the wise counsel delivered by **SUGRIVA**, offered salutations to him and set out fot the quarter protected by Varona.

CHAPTER 43

Other Monkeys are sent to the Northern Region

Words fraught with his own and Rams's interests :-" With an escort of a hundred thousand rangers of the woods, the sons of Vaivasvat and thy counsellors, do thou explore the northern region, O Hero, which is crowned with the snowy peaks of Himalaya, and search everywhere for Rams's illustrious consort there. " O Most Circumspect of Beings, having executed this rask and done that which is pleasing to the son of **DASARATHA**, we shall have honoured our obligation and achieved success. The magnanimous Raghava has rendered us a great service and, if we can make some return, our life will not have been lived in vain. To render assistance to any in need is to make one's life KISHKINDHA KAN;DA fruitful, even if one is under no obligation to do so ; how much more if one is able to repay one's benefactor. Reflecting on this, those who value our well-being and happiness should do all in their power to discover Janaki. " **RAMA**, the foremost of men, revered by all beings, the conqueror of hostile citadels, is united with us in friendship. Endowed with courage and discrimination, do you explore these numerous and dangerous regions, rivers and mountains. " Search the lands of the Mlecchas, Pulindas, Shurasenas, Prasthalas, Bbaratas, Kurus, Madrakas, Kamhojas and Yavanas. The cities of Sbakas should be visited by you as well as the Varadas, thereafter do you explore Himavat. In tbe tracts of Lodbras and Padmakas and in the Devadaru woods, search on every side for **RAVANA** and Vaidehi. Reaching the *Soma* hermitage, frequented by *Devas* and Gandharvas, proceed to the mountain named Kala, possessing spacious plateaus. In the midst of these mountainous tracts, in the valleys and caverns search for tbat

illustrious lady, **RAMA**'s irreproachable consort. Haviug traversed tbat golden breasted mountain, you should scale Mt. Sudarsbana and further Mt. Devasakha, the refuge of birds, filled with every variety of winged creature and covered with trees of differing fragrance. Amidst its golden rocks, fountains and caves, search for **RAVANA** and Videba's daughter. Going beyond this mountain, you will come upon an open space, measuring four hundred miles in extent, devoid of mountains, rivers and trees, nor are any living beinga to be found there. Speedily traversing this desert you will reach the stainless Kailasba Mountain which will fill you with delight. There, resembling a pale cloud, you will see the charming domain of Kuvera, of burnished gold, constructed by Vish wakarma, where lies a great lake covered with flowering lotuses and lilies, frequented by swans and ducks, where troops of Apsaras disport themselves. There the King Vaishravana, adored by tbe whole world, the gracious dispenser of riches, sports with the Guhyabs. Amidst these mountains, bright as tbe moon, as also in tbe caverns, search carefully for **RAVANA** and **SITA**. THE RAMAYANA OF VALMI«:I Coming to Mt. Krauncha, with exceeding circumspection, enter its inaccessible caverns, which are wcll known to be ex tremely hard to penetrate. There dwcll certain great and illustrious *Rishis*, effulgent as the sun, adored by the Gods, whose forms they assume. You should explore the other caves, plateaus and peaks of the Krauncha Mountain thoroughly. Tben the tree-less Manasa peak will be seen, the abode of birds, and the scene of Kama's austerities, where no way for any creature, God or Titan exists ; this mountain should also be searched by you. Beyond this is the Mainaka Mountain where the great giant Maya has built his abode ; this place with its plateaus, plains and woods must also be searched by you. Women with the faces of horses dwcll there. " Going beyond there, you will reach the abode of the Siddhas, where the ascetics-Valalthilyas and

Vaikhanasas are. Pay obeisance to those great beings, whose austerities have cleansed them from all sin and, in humility, enquire of them concerning **SITA**. There is the Vaikhanasa lake covered with golden lotuses, the resort of beautiful swans, bright as the dswn. The elephant of Kuvera, Sarvabhauma by name, in the company of she-elephants, wanders about in that region. " Beyond that lake is a sky bereft of moon, sun, stars and clouds but it is illumined as ifby so many solar rays, through the effulgence of god-like Sages crowned by asceticism, who rest there. Leaving that region behind, you come to the river Shailods, on whose banks the Kichaks reeds grow, by the help of which the Siddhas cross to and fro. There are the Uttara Kurus, with whom those who have acquired spiritual merit take refuge. There are lakes there, whose waters are covered with golden lotuses and innumerable rivers abounding in dark green leaves and pools of the hue of the rising sun, embcllished by clumps of crimson lotuses. Pearls and gems of great price and masses of blue Bowers possessing golden stamens cover those tracts and rivers with Boating islets, where gold abounds and gems desired by men and women ; some also bear fruit which can be partaken of in every season. Some trees bring forth precious couches bedecked with costly and variegated coverlets and others furnish enchanting garlands, costly drinks and various kinds of viands. Women possessed of every accomplishment distinguished for their youth and beauty, are there, sporting with Gandbarvas, Kinneras, Siddbas, Nagas, and Vidyadbaras of great splendour; and all those of righteous deeds engaged in pleasure and those who enjoy what is pleasant and useful, sojourn there with their wives. " There the continual sound of musical instruments, blended with sweet laughter, is heard, giving delight to all beings: there is none there who is not happy or wants for any desirable object and every day the enchantment of that place increases. " Beyond

that region is the Northern Sea. There in the bosom of the deep rises the Somagiri Mountain of immense size. Though bereft of the sun, yet on account of the brilliance of the *Soma* mountain, that land is as bright as if Vivasvat himself bad warmed it with his luminous rays. There dwells the Soul of the universe, Sbambhuinin, in his cosmic form as the eleven Rudras surrounded by Brabmarishis. " O Foremost of Monkeys, you should not venture beyond the region of the Uttara Kurus, nor is there any way for creatures to do so. That mountain, named *Soma*, is incapable of being scaled, even by the Gods. Sighting this mountain, turn back speedily. You may proceed so far, O Foremost of Monkeys, but the region beyond, where unending night broods, is unknown to us. " You should search all those places, which I have described to you, and also those I have omitted to mention. O You who are equal to the wind and fire, by discovering the place of con cealment of Videba's daughter, you wUl be doing what is exceedingly pleasing to the son of **DASARATHA** as well as to me I Having achieved your purpose, do you with your relatives, honoured by me and having acquired every distinction, your enemies slain, range the earth, the support of all beings, O Monkeys."

CHAPTER 44

Rama gives his Ring to Hanuman

Would accomplish his purpose. Then the monkey king, the lord of all the dweUers in the woods, weU pleased, addressed the son of the Wind-God, the peerless **HANUMAN**, saying :-" Nowhere on the earth, in the air or sky, in the celestial regions or in the deptha of the sea, do I know of any obstacle that can impede thy course, O Best of Monkeys !

AU the worlds with the *Asuras*, Gandharvas, Nagas, Men and Gods, as weU as the mountains and the seas are weU known to thee. In motion, speed, skill and energy thou art the equal of thy sire, O Valiant One, and there exists no creature on this earth that is like thee in vigour, O Hero of infinite resource I Reflect therefore on how **SITA** may be found ! In thee, O **HANUMAN**, repose strength, wit, courage and policy in conjunction with the knowledge of time and place." Realizing that success in the venture depended on **HANUMAN** and that **HANUMAN** himself was chosen on account of his ex ploits, Rams reflected : " This Lord of the Monkeys has supreme confidence in **HANUMAN** and **HANUMAN** too is sure of success ; he who has been tested by his deeds and who is con sidered worthiest by his master is certain to accomplish his purpose." Thereupon that mighty warrior, Rams, considering that his ends were already gained, felt a great felicity flooding his mind and heart and that scourge of his enemies, highly gratified, gave **HANUMAN** a ring inscribed with his name that would be a sign to the princess and said to him : " O Foremost of Monkeya, by this token, the daughter of **JANAKA** will not fail to recognize thee as my messenger. O Warrior, thy resolution, thy courage and thine experience as also **SUGRIVA**'s words seem to me to predict success." 286 Thereupon, taking the ring and placing it to his forehead, that foremost of monkeys, offering obeisance to the feet of **RAMA**, prepared to depart. Taking with him a mighty band of monkeys, that hero, the son of Pavana, resembling the moon in a cloudless sky encircled by stars, set forth. And **RAMA** addressed that mighty warrior saying :-" O Thou endowed with the strength of a lion, I depend on thy valour ; by summoning up thy great resources, do all in thy power, O Son of the Wind, O **HANUMAN**, to bring back the daughter of **JANAKA**." CHAPTER 4S 1M Departure of the Monkeys SUMMONING all the monkeys, the Lord of the Apes, **SUGRIVA**, spoke

to them touching the success of **RAMA**'s enterprise, and said: " O Chiefs of the Monkeys, knowing my commands, go forth and search those regions indicated by me." Whereupon, covering the earth like locusts, the army started out. During the month fixed for the search for **SITA**, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** remained on the mountain Prasravana. The valiant Shatavali set out with all speed for the north, that marvellous region where the monarch of the mountain rises' whilst the leader of the monkey bands, Vinata, went towards the east. Tara, **ANGADA** and others, in company with that monkey bom of Pavana, marehed towards the southern region inhabited by Agastya ; and Sushena, that lion among monkeys, went to the west, that fearful region protected by **VARUNA**. Having despatched the generals of his forces to each of the quarters, that king of the monkey hosts experienced supreme satisfaction. Under the orders of their sovereign, all the monkey leaders departed in great haste, each in the direction assigned to him and, full of valour, those monkeys shouted, cheered, howled and

CHAPTER 45

The Departure of the Monkeys

Thereupon, taking the ring and placing it to his forehead, that foremost of monkeys, offering obeisance to the feet of **RAMA**, prepared to depart. Taking with him a mighty band of monkeys, that hero, the son of Pavana, resembling the moon in a cloudless sky encircled by stars, set forth. And **RAMA** addressed that mighty warrior saying :-" O Thou endowed with the strength of a lion, I depend on thy valour ; by summoning up thy great resources, do all in thy power, O Son of the Wind, O **HANUMAN**, to bring back the daughter of **JANAKA**."

CHAPTER 4S 1M Departure of the Monkeys SUMMONING all the monkeys, the Lord of the Apes, **SUGRIVA**, spoke to them touching the success of **RAMA**'s enterprise, and said: " O Chiefs of the Monkeys, knowing my commands, go forth and search those regions indicated by me." Whereupon, covering the earth like locusts, the army started out. During the month fixed for the search for **SITA**, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** remained on the mountain Prasravana. The valiant Shatavali set out with all speed for the north, that marvellous region where the monarch of the mountain rises' whilst the leader of the monkey bands, Vinata, went towards the east. Tara, **ANGADA** and others, in company with that monkey bom of Pavana, marehed towards the southern region inhabited by Agastya ; and Sushena, that lion among monkeys, went to the west, that fearful region protected by **VARUNA**. Having despatched the generals of his forces to each of the quarters, that king of the monkey hosts experienced supreme satisfaction. Under the orders of their sovereign, all the monkey leaders departed in great haste, each in the direction assigned to him and, full of valour, those monkeys shouted, cheered, howled and chattered, rushing on and on amidst a great uproar. Having listened to the instructions of their monateh, the leadets of these monkeys cried: "We shall bring **SITA** back and slay **RAVANA** ". **SOME** *said*: " I alone shall defeat **RAVANA** in open combat and having laid him low, shall deliver the daughtet of **JANAKA**, still trembling with fear, saying to het Rest hete, thou art weary'." **OTHERS** *said*: " Singlehanded I shall recovet Janaki even if it be from the depth of hell ; I shall uproot the trees, cleave the mountains, penetrate the earth and churn up the ocean." One said, " Without doubt I can clear four miles in one bound ! " and another, " I can clear a hundred," and yet another, " I am able to leap more than a hundred. Neithet on earth, in the sky nor on the sea nor mountains nor in forests, not even in the nethet

regions can anything bar my progress ". Thus in turn did the monkeys, proud of their strength, speak in the presence of their king.

CHAPTER 46

Sugriva narrates his Travels through the World

THE leadetS of the monkeys having departed, Ramo enquired of **SUGRIVA** saying :-" How is it that thou knowest all the quarters of the earth ? " Then **SUGRIVA**, bowing low, said to **RAMA** : " Hear me and I will tell thee all. " When Bali pursued the giant Dundubhi, in the form of a brother is certainly dead ' and I placed a rock, as large as a bill, at the mouth of the cave, thinking ' The buffalo will not be able to come out and will die' ; after which I returned to Kishkindha giving up all hope of Bali being alive. " There obtaining the mighty kingdom with Tara and Ruma, surrounded by my friends, I began to pass my days in peace. " That bull among monkeys, however, having slain Dundubhi returned, and trembling with fear, in all humility, I made over the crown to him. " That wicked wretch, however, beside himself with rage, wishing to slay me, followed me whilst I sought to By with my ministerS. It was then that, hotly pursued by him, I passed by various streams, forests and cities. The earth appeared to me like the refiection of a whirling firebrand seen in a mirror or a puddle.' " Journeying towards the eastern region, I beheld many kinds of trees, beautiful mountains, charming caverns and lakes. I saw the Udaya Mountsin rich in gold and the white sea, the abode of Apsaras. Pursued by Bali, fiying on and on, O Lord, I turned and continued my course then, changing my direction once more, I made for the south, covered by th Vindhya Forest and embellished with sandal wood trees. Theresfttr, seeing Bali among the woods, on the

mountsins, I went west wards still followed by him. “It is thus that I grew conversant with every kind of region and finally reached the Astachala Mountsins. Beyond that most beautiful and elevated of ranges I turned to the north and passed Himavat, Meru and the Northern Sea. " Unable to find refuge from Bsli, the sagacious **HANUMAN** said to me:-' O King, I recollect now that the Lord of the Monkeys was formerly cursed by the Sage Matanga in this vety hermitage. If he should enter this asylum, his head will be split into a hundred pieces ; we can, therefore, take up our abode here without anxiety.' " O Son of a King, I, thereupon, went to the Rishyamub Mountsin, nor did Bali dare to come there for fear of the Sage Matanga. This is how, O King, I visited evety part of the world and took refuge in this cave."

CHAPTER 47

The Return of the Monkeys

IN order to find Vaidehi, those leaders of monkeys, in obedience to their sovereign’s will, speedily weot forth in all directions to their destinations, and they explored lakes, streams, plains, cities and tracts rendered impassible by torrents. Then those chiefs of the monkey bands searched the regions described by **SUGRIVA** with their mountains, woods and forests. Engaged during the day in seeking for **SITA**, when night fell, they stretched themselves on the ground, and coming to trees covered with fruits in all seasons, they slept there. Counting the day of their departure as the first, at the end of a month, giving up hope, they returned to their king on the Prasravana mountain. Having scoured the eastern region with his forces, the mighty Vinata returned without having seen **SITA**. Thereafter the great monkey Shatabali came back

disappointed with his forces, having scoured the whole of the northern quarter. And Sushena, at the end of the month, ranging the western region without success, presented himself in company with his monkeys before **SUGRIVA**. Coming before **SUGRIVA** who was seated with **RAMA** on a ridge of the Prasravana Mountain, and paying obeisance to them, **SUSHENA** *said*: "We have searched all the mountains, deep woods, valleys, ravines and the countries situated on the shores of the sea. All the places described by thee have been scoured by us, as also all the jungles intertwined by creepers abounding in thickets that are impassable and the billy districts. Huge animals have been encountered by us, which we have slain, and we have searched these densely wooded regions again and again, O Lord of the Monkeys. It is **HANUMAN**, who is mighty and nobly born, who will discover Maithili ; the son of the Wind has undoubtedly gone to where **SITA** has been taken.

CHAPTER 48

Angada slays an Asura

THE monkey **HANUMAN**, accompanied by Tara and **ANGADA**, swiftly set out to tbe quarter assigned to him by **SUGRIVA**. Witb all tbose !cadets of monkeys, he travelled a great distance and explored tbe woods and caves of the Vindhya Mountains. Rugged crags, impassable rivers, lakes, vast jungles, groves, innumerable hills covered witb forests were searched by tbe monkeys on every side, witbout their being able to find Maitbili, tbe daughter of **JANAKA**, anywhere. Subsisting on various roots and fruits, tbey were overcome by fatigue in that uninhabited and waterless region amidst the fearful ravines and solitary places. Having searched that immense area extremely hard of access, with its mighty

forests, containing caves, all tbose foremost of monkeys fearlessly penetrated into anotber equally inhospitable region, where tbe trees yielded neither fruit, fiowers nor foliage and where the streams were dried up and even roots were rare. There, neitber buffaloe nor deer, nor elephants, tigers, birds nor any otber animals, that are found in tbe forest, could be seen. There were neitber uees, grass, plants nor herbs, and in that place tbere were no pleasant pools with fiowering or fragrant lotuses and no bees to be observed. There dwelt tbe fortunate Sage, Kandu, a treasury of ascetic ism, of uutbful speech, whose austerities had rendered him in vincible and who was irascible, having lost his young son at tbe age of ten years in tbe forest. Filled witb wratb on account of his death, that great-souled One had laid a curse on tbe entire vast forest, rendering it unlit to harbour any creature. This in accessible region, deserted by beasts and birds, tbe hidden recesses of tbe woods, tbe mountain caves and tbe bends of tbe rivers were carefully searched by tbe monkeys in order to carry out **SUGRIVA**'s desire, but tbey were unable to find tbe daughter of **JANAKA** or her abductor, **RAVANA**, tbere. Having entered a wood, overgrown with creepers and briars, they beheld a terrible titan, of dreadful deeds, cherishing no fear, even for the Gods. Seeing that formidable titan, who stood erect like a great hill, the monkeys pressed close to each other girding up their loins. Then that mighty *Asura* said to them " You are lost ! " and, clenching his fists, rushed upon thero in fury, but **ANGADA**, the Son of Bali, thinking it was **RAVANA**, struck him with the palm of his hand with such force, that he fell to the earth like a great hill, vomiting blood. When he had ceased to breathe, the triumphant monkeys searched that mountain cavern ; and having satisfied theroselves that it had been thoroughly explored, those dwellers of the woods entered into another fearful cave. After having searched that place also, they emerged exhausred and wholly dispirited

sat down at the foot of a solitary tree.

CHAPTER 49

The Monkeys search the Southern Region in vain

THEN the eminendy wise **ANGADA** addressed all the monkeys and, though himself fatigued, exhorted them to take courage, saying : " We have searched the forests, mountains, rivers and im .. penetrable wilds, valleys and caverns with care, without finding the daughter of J auaka, **SITA**, or that wicked wretch, the titan, who bore her away. A great part of the time assigned to us by **SUGRIVA**, whose commands are inexorable, has elapsed ; therefore, banishing languor, despondency, torpor and fatigue, together let us examine every region once again. Search in such a way that **SITA** may be discovered by us. Perseverance, ability and ardour are said to conduce to success ; I therefore address you thus :-0 Dwellers in the Woods, explore the whole inaccessible forest to-day without counting the cost, success will wholly depend on your exertions ; to permit yourselves to be overcome by fatigue or give way to sleep is not fitting. **SUGRIVA** is irascible and inflicts harsh punishments ; he is ever to be feared, as also the magnanimous **RAMA**. I speak in your own 393 interests ; therefore, if you concur, act accordingly or let someone point out what alternative will benefit us all, O Monkeys." Hearing **ANGADA**'s words, Gandhamadana, though faint from thirst and fatigue, spoke in clear accents, saying :-" That which **ANGADA** has said is worthy of him and is appropriate and timely, let us act upon it! Let us search the hills, caves, rocks, desert places and waterfalls, in accord with the instructions given by **SUGRIVA**; let us scour the forest and the mountain ridges together!" Then the monkeys,

rising, full of valour, began to range the south covered by the Vindhya forests, afresh. Scaling the mountain that resembled an autumnal cloud, rich in silver, with its innumerable peaks and valleys, those foremost of monkeys, eager to find **SITA**, ranged the enchanting Lodhra forests and the woods of Saptapama trees. Ascending to the summit of the mountain, though endued with immense energy, they were overcome with fatigue, yet they did not see Vaidehi, the beloved consort of **RAMA**, anywhere. Having surveyed that hill with its innumerable ravines, as far as eye could see, the monkeys looking on every side, descended and, reaching the base, harassed and beside themselves, halted for an instant under a tree ; then finding themselves less fatigued, they prepared to explore the southern region again. Thereafter the chiefs of the monkeys, with **HANUMAN** at their head, began to range the Vindhya hills once more.

CHAPTER 50

Hanuman and his Companions enter the Rikshabila Cavern

Separsted from esch other by a short distance, Gaja, Gavaksha, Gavaya, Sharsbha, Gandhamadana, Mainda, Dvivida, **HANUMAN** and **JAMBAVAN**, the youthful Prince **ANGADA** and Tars, dwellers of the woods, began to sesrch those regions in the south covered by the mountain range. While they were exploring this place on every side, they observed the opening to a cave named Rikshabila, difficult of entry, guarded by a giant. Tortured with hunger and thirst and overcome with exhaustion they espied this cavity overgrown by trees, bushes and creepers, from which herons, swaus, geese and waterfowl were issuing,

dripping with water and covered with the pollen oflotuses. Drawing near to that fragrant cave, diflicult of access, those monkeys were struck with astonishment and desired to enter it. Then those foremost of monkeys, seeing signs of water, full of joy, approached that subterranesn chamber abounding in every kind of creature, resembling the abode of **INDRA**, which was im penetrable and fearful to behold. And **HANUMAN**, the son of the Wind-god, who resembled the peak of a mountain, said to those redoubtable monkeys, who dwelt in the woods and forests:-" We have explored the southern region covered with a chain of mountains ; we are exhausted with fatigue and unable to find Maithili. From yonder cave, swans, cranes, herons and waterfowl are emerging on every side, drenched with water. Without doubt there is a well or pool to be found there for these trees at the month of the cave are green." **HANUMAN** having spoken thus, all the monkeys entered into the dark cave, bereft of sun and moon, that caused their hair to stand on end. They heard the roar of lions and the sound of deer and hirds and those invincible monkeys felt their coursge and prowess fail ; moving with the speed of the wind and despite the darkness, their sight being unimpaired, they penetrated deep into the cave and beheld a luminous, enchanting and marvellous region filled with different kinds of trees of varying fragrance. Pressing close to one another, they advanced fout 294 miles into the interior and fainting with fatigue, bewildered, seeking for water, they continued to descend into the darkness. Emaciated, their faces woe-begone, spent, despairing of their lives, those monkeys then beheld a light. Happily they approached that spot and saw trees glistening like gold, posses sing the brilliance of fire, and they beheld Salas, Talas, Tamalas, Punnagas, Vanjulas, Dhavas, Champakas, Nagavrikshas and Kamikaras in full ftower with clusters of golden blossom, crimson buds, twigs and creepers adorning them, dazzling as the dawn, their trunks being of

emerald and their bark luminous. There were also lakes of blue lotus, abounding in waterfowl, there, and great golden trees encircled that place, that shone like the first light of dawn and fishes of gold and enormous loruscs were to be seen in pools of tranquil waters. Gold aud silver palaces were to be found there with little windows of refined gold festooned with chains of pearls, the ftoors paved with silver and gold aud encrusted with pearls and diamonds. And the monkeys beheld splendid mansions everywhere and trees laden with fruit and ftowers that shone like coral and precious gems and golden bees and honey in abundance. Couches and marvellous seats of immense size, decorated with gold and diamonds, drew their gaze, as well as gold and silver vessels, heaps of aloes and sandal, pure foods, fruits and roots, costly vehicles, delicious syrups, priceless raiment and great piles of woollen cloths and wonderful skins. Whilst wandering here and there abont that subterranean chamber, those courageous monkeys beheld a woman at a short distance from them. Attired in robes of bark and a black antelope skin, that ascetic, given to fasting, shone with a great effulgence. Astonished, those monkeys halted suddenly and Hannman addressed her saying:-" Who art thou? To whom does this cavern belong ? " Bowing down to that aged woman, Hannman, who resem bled a mountain, with joined palms, enquired of her: “Who art thou ? To whom does this rcucat, this cave and its jewels belong?” CHAPTER SI The Tale of the Ascetic HAVING spoken thus to that blessed ascetic given to the practice of austerity, who was clad in bark and a black antelope skin, **HANUMAN** *added*: " We entered this cave enveloped in darkness being wholly exhausted with hunger and thirst and overcome with fatigue ; having penetrated into the depths to seek for something to eat, we have become disuacted on seeing all these marvels so that we have almost taken leave of our senses. " To whom do these golden uees belong, that

shine like the snn about to rise and these pnre foods, roots and fruits; these mansions of gold and silver with their windows of gold refined in the crucible and their network of pearls ? Who has produced these golden uees covered with marvellous flowers and fruit emitting a delicious fragrance, the golden lotuses that float on the pure waters, the golden fish and the turtles ? Are they sprung from thy power or do they owe their existence to another? It behoves thee to tell us, who are ignorant in the matter. Hearing the words of **HANUMAN**, the virtuous ascetic, engaged in the welfare of all beings, replied to **HANUMAN** saying:-" O Foremost of Monkeys, Maya is the name of the magician of great powers, by whom this entire golden grove has been con suucted. He who created this enchanting and celestial place was formerly the chief architect of the Giants. Having prac tised austerity for a thousand years in the vast forest, he obtained a boon from the Grandsire of the World, in virtue of which he attained complete mastery in his art, as well as an abaolute con uol over the materials required therein. Having accomplished everything , that wonderful one, commanding every enjoyment, for a time lived happily in the mighty forest. Thereafter he conceived a great passion for the nymph Hema, whereupon Purandara hurled his thunderbolt at him and slew him.

CHAPTER 51

The Tale of the Ascetic

CHAPTER SI The Tale of the Ascetic HAVING spoken thus to that blessed ascetic given to the practice of austerity, who was clad in bark and a black antelope skin, **HANUMAN** *added*: " We entered this cave enveloped in darkness being wholly exhausted with hunger and thirst

and overcome with fatigue ; having penetrated into the depths to seek for something to eat, we have become disuacted on seeing all these marvels so that we have almost taken leave of our senses. " To whom do these golden uees belong, that shine like the snn about to rise and these pnre foods, roots and fruits; these mansions of gold and silver with their windows of gold refined in the crucible and their network of pearls ? Who has produced these golden uees covered with marvellous flowers and fruit emitting a delicious fragrance, the golden lotuses that float on the pure waters, the golden fish and the turtles ? Are they sprung from thy power or do they owe their existence to another? It behoves thee to tell us, who are ignorant in the matter. Hearing the words of **HANUMAN**, the virtuous ascetic, engaged in the welfare of all beings, replied to **HANUMAN** saying:-" O Foremost of Monkeys, Maya is the name of the magician of great powers, by whom this entire golden grove has been con suucted. He who created this enchanting and celestial place was formerly the chief architect of the Giants. Having prac tised austerity for a thousand years in the vast forest, he obtained a boon from the Grandsire of the World, in virtue of which he attained complete mastery in his art, as well as an abaolute con uol over the materials required therein. Having accomplished everything , that wonderful one, commanding every enjoyment, for a time lived happily in the mighty forest. Thereafter he conceived a great passion for the nymph Hema, whereupon Purandara hurled his thunderbolt at him and slew him. " Then **BRAHMA** bestowed this marvellous forest with his golden mansion on Hema with the perpetual enjoyment of her desires. I, Swayamprabha by name, the daughter of Merusavarni, guard this dwelling belonging to Hema, who, skilled in the arts of dancing and singing, is my dear friend, O Foremost of Monkeys ! By her favour, this vast forest has been given into my hands. Now tell me for what purpose

and with what motive you have come hither ? Why arc you roaming in these inaccessible woods ? Having partaken of these fruits and roots and drnnk of the pure water, tell me all.”

CHAPTER 52

Swaymprabha frees the Monkeys from the cave

THAT virtuous ascetic, gready mystified, addressed aU those leaders of monkeys who were now rested, saying : " O Monkeys, if, satisfied by the fruits, your fatigue is alleviated, I would fain listen to your story if it is fit to be heard by me.” Hearing these words, **HANUMAN**, the Son of Maruta began to relate all with perfect candour, saying : " The Sovereign of the whole world, **RAMA**, who is equal to Mahendra and Varona, the illustrious son of **DASARATHA**, retired to the Dandaka Forest in company with his brother **LAKSHMANA** and his consort Vaidebi. The latter was forcibly carried away by **RAVANA**. " His friend is that valiant monkey named **SUGRIVA**. By that monarch, the foremost of monkeys, we have been sent hither and with the assistance of those led by **ANGADA**, we have been dis patched to search the southern region inhabited by Agastya and protected by **YAMA**. We have been commissioned to search for **SITA**, the daughter of Videha and the demon **RAVANA**, who is able to change his form at will. Having scoured the forests and the seas of the south, overcome with hnnger, we sat down at the foot of the trees. Our faces drained of colour, absorbed in thought, we were sunk in an ocean of amtiety which we were unable to cross. " Casting our eyes round, we observed a huge cave hidden by trees and creepers and enveloped in gloom. Now swans, geese ?.97 and osprey flew out from that cave their wings dripping with water, and I said to

those monkeys, ' Let us enter there ! ' which all agreed to do. Anxious to accomplish our purpose, went in grasping each others hands, thus forcing an entry into that dark cave ; this is our purpose and the reason why we have come hither. Having come here, famished and exhausted, we, who were sorely tried by hunger, have been entertained on fruits and roots with the traditional hospitality. Thou hast saved us, who were and suffering from starVation ; now say what service the monkeys may render thee in return ? " Thus addressed by the apes, the all-knowing Swayamprabha replied to those monkey leaders, saying : " I am well pleased with all these excellent monkeys ; I am but fulfilling my duty and have no need of anything." Thus answered in words filled with nobility and virtue, **HANUMAN** addressed that irreproachable lady saying: "We have all found refuge with thee, O Virtuous Ascetic, bnt the time fixed by the magnanimous **SUGRIVA** has run out since we entered the cave, it behoves thee, therefore, to assist us to leave this place. If the commands of **SUGRIVA** he disregarded, it will mean death for us. Please deliver us all ; the fear of **SUGRIVA** aflliets us. Great is the task that has been undertaken by us and if we remain here, that work of ours will not he accomplished." Thus addressed by **HANUMAN**, the ascetic answered him say ing :-" For a living being to emerge from this cave alive, is hard, but by the power of my asceticism acquired through self control I shall deliver all the monkeys from this subterranean chamber. Do you all close your eyes, for none will suoeeed in issuing from this place if their eyes remain open." Then, desirous of going out, all those magoanimous monkeys instantly closed their eyes covering them with their hands, possessed of slender fingers, and in the twinkling of an eye, the ascetic transported them outside the cave and having saved them from danger, in order to encourage them, said: " This is the auspicious Vindhya Monntain covered with trees and herbs, there the Prasravana Mountain

and the great ocean. May good fortnne attend you ! I go to my abode, O Foremost of Monkeys.” With these words Swayamprabha re-entered the cave.

CHAPTER 53

Angada and his Companions consider what course to adopt

It were preferable to die here than perish ignomiuously at the hands of **SUGRIVA**. Further, I was not installed as heir-apparent by **SUGRIVA** but by Rams, that king among men of immortal exploits. Entertaining enmity to me of old, the king, finding me at fault, will determine to take my life by cruel means. Of what use is it to meet death iu the presence of my friends who will witness the last moments of my existence ? I shall rentaiu here en the sacred shore of the sea for the last supreme fast.” Heariug the words of the crown priuce, all those monkeys, exclaimed iu sympathy : " **SUGRIVA** is harsh by nature and Raghava is devoted to his tender spouse. The king, perceiving that the time has past without our having been successful in our undertaking and that we have not found Vaidehi, will certainly put us to death iu order to do what is agreeable to **RAMA**. Those who fail (*to execute his commands*) may not enter the presence of a king. Having come hither as the principal servants of **SUGRIVA**, must either find **SITA** or obtaiu information concerning her or else we must enter the region of **YAMA**, O Hero.” Heariug the monkeys speak thus iu their terror, the **GENERAL TARA** *said*:-" Of what use is it to yield to despair? Let us re enter the subterranean chamber and take up our abode there. That place abounding in flowers, food and water, which has been created by the power of illusion, is inaccessible. There we need

not fear Purandara Himself or Raghava or the Kiug of the Monkeys.” At these words to which **ANGADA** himself assented, all the monkeys with renewed confidence, cried :-" Without delay, let us from now on employ those means that will save us from death.” CHAPTER S4 **HANUMAN** seeks to discourage **ANGADA** from his Design WHEN the General Tara, who was as radiant as the moon, had spoken thus, **HANUMAN** deemed that **ANGADA** had already usurped supreme authority. He knew the son of Bali to be endowed with the eightfold intelligence, the four powers and the fourteen qualities,' to be possessed of valour, energy and martial ardour, waxing in glory like the moon in the bright fortnight, the equal of Brihaspati in wisdom, in bravery resembling his sire and obedient to Tara’s counsel as Purandara regards the instruction of Shukra. Thereupon, **HANUMAN**, versed in all branches of learning, resolved to win over **ANGADA**, who had become lax in the service of his sovereign and bring him back to the right path. Reflecting on the four means for bringing about peace, he chose the second, that of sowing dissension amongst the monkeys by subtle suggestion ; when the disaffection was general, he sought to instil fear in **ANGADA**’s heart, by harsh words uttered in severe tones: **HE** *said*:-" O Son of Bali, surely thou art a warrior more skilful even than thy sire and art able to govern the monkey kingdom as well as he, but, O Foremost of Monkeys, the apes were ever fickle by nature. Bereft of their wives and sons, they will never suffer thy rule. This I declare to thee in the presence

CHAPTER 54

Hanuman seeks to discourage Angada from his Design

CHAPTER S4 **HANUMAN** seeks to discourage **ANGADA** from his Design WHEN the General Tara, who was as radiant as the moon, had spoken thus, **HANUMAN** deemed that **ANGADA** had already usurped supreme authority. He knew the son of Bali to be endowed with the eightfold intelligence, the four powers and the fourteen qualities,' to be possessed of valour, energy and martial ardour, waxing in glory like the moon in the bright fortnight, the equal of Brihaspati in wisdom, in bravery resembling his sire and obedient to Tara's counsel as Purandara regards the instruction of Shukra. Thereupon, **HANUMAN**, versed in all branches of learning, resolved to win over **ANGADA**, who had become lax in the service of his sovereign and bring him back to the right path. Reflecting on the four means for bringing about peace, he chose the second, that of sowing dissension amongst the monkeys by subtle suggestion ; when the disaffection was general, he sought to instil fear in **ANGADA**'s heart, by harsh words uttered in severe tones: **HE** *said*:-" O Son of Bali, surely thou art a warrior more skilful even than thy sire and art able to govern the monkey kingdom as well as he, but, O Foremost of Monkeys, the apes were ever fickle by nature. Bereft of their wives and sons, they will never suffer thy rule. This I declare to thee in the presence of all ! Neither by conciliation, gifts nor penalties shalt thou succeed in drawing **JAMBAVAN**, Nila, the mighty ape, Suhotra, or myself to thy side. One who is strong can overcome the weak and usurp his place, therefore, he who is weak should, for his own safety, never incur the enmity of the strong. This cave, that thou deemcst to be a safe refuge and which is said to be impregnable, can easily be penetrated by **LAKSHMANA** with his arrows. Formerly this tiny rift was made by **INDRA** hurling his thunderbolt against it, but Laksbmana will pierce it like a leaf by means of his keen arrows. He possesses innumerable arrows of this kind, whose impact rcscrobles lightoing, capable of

shattering the mountains thcrosclves. " O Scourge of Thy Foes, as soon as thou dost install thyself in that place, tbc monkeys, remcrobering their wives and sons, will decide to forsake thee. Pining for domestic happiness, ever restless, anxious and weary of their pitiable plight, they will abandon thee. Thereafter, bereft of friends, relatives and those who seek thy welfare, even the trembling of a blade of grass will fill thee with terror. " **LAKSHMANA**'s arrows, irresistible in flight, keen, formidable and of exceeding velocity, wiU transfix thee where thou hast sought to conceal thyself. "If, however, assuming a humble guise, thou, with us, dost present thyself before **SUGRIVA**, he will establish thee in the kingdom and restore thee as rightful heir. A virtuous monarch, firm in his vows, honorable and loyal, he desires thy welfare and will assuredly not kill thee. Thy paternal uncle is devoted to thy mother and wishes to do what is agreeable to her, this is the purpose of his life and she has no other son, therefore, O

CHAPTER 55

The Monkeys decide to die of Hunger

HBARING **HANUMAN**'s speech uttered with humility, filled with wisdom and justice and reflecting honour on **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA** answered him saying : "Stability, purity of mind and disposition, compassion, rectitude, daring and perseverance are unknown to **SUGRIVA**. He who, while her son was living, united himself to the beloved queen of his elder brother, on whom he should rightfully have looked as a mother, is to be condemned. What does he know of morality who, while his brother was in the grip of an *Asura*, closed up the opening of the cave ? What gratirude will he manifest who, having

clasped his hand in friendship, forgot the favours received from his great benefactor, Raghava, of im· perishable deeds ? Where is righteousness in one who directed us to search for Sits here, not from fear of disloyalty but of **LAKSHMANA** ? Who would trust that fickle, impious and un grateful wretch, more especially those sprung from his own race ? Whether he be possessed of good qualities or no, having estab lished me in the kingdom, will he suffer the son of his enemy to live ? How can I, whose counsels have been disclosed, who have been found guilty, who am powerless, poor and weak, expect to survive if I repair to Kishkindha ? In his desire to retain the throne, **SUGRIVA**, who is wily, cunning and cruel, will assuredly place me in chains. For me death through fasting is preferable to being tortured and confined. Let all the monkeys abandon me here and return home. I vow I shall never re enter the city but shall stay here and fast to the end ; death is better for me. " Bowing to the king and also to the mighty Raghava, enquire after their welfare for me and bring news of my health and state to my adopted mother Ruma. To Tara, my real mother, oiJer consolation, for she is compassionate and pious and narurally full of love for her son. When she learns of my death, she will certainly yield up her life." Having said this, **ANGADA**, making obeisance to the elders, his countenance woe-begone, weeping, spreading out some kusha grass sat down on the ground ; as he sat there, those foremost of monkeys groaned, burning tears falling from their eyes. Thereupon surrounding **ANGADA**, condemning **SUGRIVA** and praising Bali, those monkeys resolved to starve themselves to death and, seating themselves on the seashore on heaps of darbha grass, pointing towards the south, those excellent monkeys sipping water, facing the east, resolved to die, saying:-"This is better for us ! " As they spoke of the exile of **RAMA**, the death of **DASARATHA**, the carnage in J anasthana, the slaying of J atayu, the abduction of Vaidehi, the killing of

Bali and the wrath of Raghava, those monkeys were filled with fear; and while those in numerable monkeys, resembling the peaks of mountains sat there, the whole region with its torrents and caverns resounded with their lamentations like the roll of thunder in the skies.

CHAPTER 56

The Intervention of Sampati

Chance carne to that place. That long-lived bird, the fonunate brother of **JATAYU**, was renowned for his strength and prowess. Issuing from a cave on the mighty Vindhya Mountain, he observed the monkeys seated there and, highly gratified, said: " Every man reapeth the fruit of his former acts, on account of this, after along time, this food comes to me. I shall eat up these monkeys one by one as they die." Eyeing those apes, the Vulture expressed himself thus, and hearing the utterance of that famished bird, **ANGADA**, full of apprehension, addressed **HANUMAN** in faint accents, saying : " Behold, on account of **SITA**, Death, the descendant of Vivasvat, bas come to this place to destroy the monkeys. Rams's purpose not having been effected nor the mandate of the 304 king obeyed, this calamity has overtaken the monkeys unaware. Thou conversant in detail with all that **JATAYU**, that Prince of Vultures did for the sake of **SITA**. All beings, even those born of the mating of beasts, desire to please **RAMA** at the cost of their lives as we have done. On account of **RAMA**'s love and com passion, people bear each other affection and pity. The blessed **JATAYU** voluntarily laid down his life for the good of **RAMA** ; we too, exhausted and about to die, came to this forest to render a service the Son of Raghu. We have searched the woods in vain for Maithili. Happy is that Prince of Vultures who was slain in

combat by **RAVANA** for he is freed from the fear of **SUGRIVA** and has attained the supreme abode. The death of **JATAYU** and King **DASARATHA** and the abduction ofSita has placed the monkeys in jcopatdy. The sojourn of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** in the forest with **SITA**, Raghava's slaying of Bali with an arrow, the slaughter of innumerable demons by **RAMA** in his wrath, all owe their origin to those boons granted to **KAIKEYI**. Hearing these piteous words and seeing the monkeys stretched on the ground the magnanimous King of the Vultures was deeply moved and that sharp beaked bird cried out : " Who is it who, causing my heart to tremble, speaks thus of the death of my brother, dearer to me than life itself? How did the demon and the vulture come to fight in Janasthana? It is after a long time that I hear the name of my brother spoken. I wish to descend from this lofty mountain height. I am well plcssed to hear of my youthful and valiant brother, renowned for his exploits. I wish to learn of the death of my brother, **JATAYU**, O Foremost of Monkeys, and how King **DASARATHA**, whose elder son is **RAMA**, beloved of his elders, came to be his friend ? I am unable to fly in consequence of my wings having been scorched by the rays of the sun. Assist me to descend from this mountain, O Conquerors of your Foes I " THE RAMA YANA' OF VALMIKI CHAPTER S7 A11{fada's "'Narratiw the voice of Sampati faltered on account of grief, the Chiefs of the Monkeys did not trust him, doubting his in tentions. Seated for the purpose of fasting to death, the monkeys, seeing that vulture, framed the following resolution, saying : " Let us help him to descend and he will then devour us all ; should he do so, while we are seated here fasting, we shall have achieved our purpose and shall speedily attain success." Having thus resolved, they assisted the vulture to descend from the summit of the mountain and **ANGADA** addressed him saying: " There was a great King of the Monkeys named Riksharajas, the founder of our

race ; he was my grandsire, O Bird. He had two virtuous sons, Bali and **SUGRIVA**, both were exceedingly powerfuL My father Bali, was famed throughout the world for his exploits. " Now it happened that the Sovereign of the whole earth, the descendant of lkshwaku, the great and illustrious car warrior, **RAMA**, the son of King **DASARATHA**, obedient to the injunctions of his sire, fixed in the path of righteousness, entered the forest of Dandaka with his brother **LAKSHMANA** and his consort Vaidehi. His spouse was forcibly borne away from Janasthana by **RAVANA** and the friend of **RAMA**'s father, the Prince of Vultures, **JATAYU**, observed **SITA**, Videha's daughter, being carried through the air. Having shattered **RAVANA**'s chariot and released Maithili, that vulture being old and exhausted finally fell under **RAVANA**'s blows. Slain by the powerful **RAVANA**, he had his funeral rites performed by **RAMA** himself and attained the celestial abode. Then Raghava allied himself with my paternal uncle, Sngriva, and slew my sire, who had banished him from the kingdom with his ministers. " Having killed Bali, **RAMA** installed Sngriva as Lord and Monarch of aU the Monkeys. We have been sent by him in all 3o6

CHAPTER 57

Angada's Narrative

THE RAMA YANA' OF VALMIKI CHAPTER S7 A11{fada's "'Narratiw the voice of Sampati faltered on account of grief, the Chiefs of the Monkeys did not trust him, doubting his in tentions. Seated for the purpose of fasting to death, the monkeys, seeing that vulture, framed the following resolution, saying : " Let us help him to descend and he will then devour us all ; should he do so, while we are seated here fasting, we

shall have achieved our purpose and shall speedily attain success." Having thus resolved, they assisted the vulture to descend from the summit of the mountain and **ANGADA** addressed him saying: " There was a great King of the Monkeys named Riksharajas, the founder of our race ; he was my grandsire, O Bird. He had two virtuous sons, Bali and **SUGRIVA**, both were exceedingly powerfuL My father Bali, was famed throughout the world for his exploits. " Now it happened that the Sovereign of the whole earth, the descendant of lkshwaku, the great and illustrious car warrior, **RAMA**, the son of King **DASARATHA**, obedient to the injunctions of his sire, fixed in the path of righteousness, entered the forest of Dandaka with his brother **LAKSHMANA** and his consort Vaidehi. His spouse was forcibly borne away from Janasthana by **RAVANA** and the friend of **RAMA**'s father, the Prince of Vultures, **JATAYU**, observed **SITA**, Videha's daughter, being carried through the air. Having shattered **RAVANA**'s chariot and released Maithili, that vulture being old and exhausted finally fell under **RAVANA**'s blows. Slain by the powerful **RAVANA**, he had his funeral rites performed by **RAMA** himself and attained the celestial abode. Then Raghava allied himself with my paternal uncle, Sngriva, and slew my sire, who had banished him from the kingdom with his ministers. " Having killed Bali, **RAMA** installed Sngriva as Lord and Monarch of aU the Monkeys. We have been sent by him in all 3o6 directions under **RAMA**'s orders to search for **SITA** but we have not found Vaidehi, as by night one is unable to perceive the splendour of the sun. Having explored the Dandaka Forest, we, through ignorance, penetrared into a cave through a rift in the earth. That cavern was constructed by the illusive power of Maya and there we passed the month fixed by the King of the Monkeys, as the appointed ; while executing the commands of **SUGRIVA**, we exceeded the time fixed and from fear have seated ourselves here, resolved to die

of hunger, for, if we return to face the wrath of Kakutstha, **SUGRIVA** and **LAKSHMANA**, we shall surely be put to death ! "

CHAPTER 58

Sampati tells the Monkeys of Sita's place of Concealment

in his eyes, answered them saying : " O Monkeys, you have told me, that J atayu, my younger brother, was slain in combat by **RAVANA**, who was his superior in strength. Old and bereft of my wings, I can only resign myself to these tidings for I no longer have the power to avenge my brother's death. "Formerly, when **INDRA** slew the demon Vritra, my brother and I, wishing to prove whicb of us was superior, soared into the sky, drawing nearer and nearer to the sun with its aureole of rays. Flinging ourselves into the currents of air, we rose rapidly higher and higher, but the sun having reacbed its zenith, **JATAYU** grew faint. Seeing my brother tormented by the sun's rays, I covered him affectionately with my wings, for he was suffering greatly, whereupon they were scorched and I fell on the Vindhya Mountain, O Foremost of Monkeys, where I remained, not knowing what had befallen him." Thus addressed by Sampati, **JATAYU**'s brother, the eminently sagacious **PRINCE ANGADA** *answered*:-" If thou arr indeed the brother of **JATAYU** and hast heard what I have related, then tell us, dost thou know aught of that titan's abode? Say, if thou knowest, whether the retreat of that short-sighted, vilest of demons, **RAVANA**, is near or tar away ? " Then the illustrious elder brother of **JATAYU** answered in words worthy of him, causing delight to the monkeys, and said : " O Monkeys, my pinions being burnt, I am a vulture bereft of strength, yet by my words

alone, I shall render **RAMA** a signal service. " I know the realm of **VARUNA** and those covered by **VISHNU**'s three strides. I am also conversant with the wars between the Gods and *Asuras* and the churning of the ocean, from whence the Amrita issued. Though age has deprived me of strength and my vitality is ebbing away, this mission of **RAMA**'s must he· my first concern. " I saw a young and lovely woman, beautifully attired, being carried off by the 'ilicked **RAVANA** and that beautiful creature was crying out' O **RAMA** ', 'O **RAMA** , 'O **LAKSHMANA** '. Tearing off her ornaments she cast them on the earth ; her silken cloak, resembling the rays of the sun striking on a mountain summit, shone against the dark skin of the demon like a lightning flash irradiating a cloudy sky. Since she was calling '**RAMA** ', ' **RAMA** ' I believe her to have been **SITA**. Now hear me, and I will tell you where the abode of that demon is to he found. " The son of Vishravas and brother of Kuvera, that demon, named **RAVANA**, resides in the city of Lanka, constructed by Vishwakarma, which lies a full hundred yojanas from here no an island in the sea, furnished with golden gateways and ramparts of Kancana gold, with lofty palaces gleaming with Hema gold adorniug it. A great wall, bright as the sun, en circles it, and it is there that the unfortunate Vaidchi, attired in a silken cloth, is confined in **RAVANA**'s inner apartments, carefully guarded by demon women. It is there you will find **SITA**. " Four hundred miles from here on the southern shore of the sea dwells **RAVANA**. O Monkeys, hie thither speedily and demonstrate your valour ! By supernatural means, I know that having seen that place you will return. The first course is the path taken by the fork-tailed shrikes and others living on grain ; the second by those who live on insects and fruit ; the third by 308 cocks ; the founh by herons, hawks and birds of prey ; the fifth by vultures ; the sixth by swans endowed with strength, energy, youth and beauty and the last by eagles ;

we have all derived our origin from Vainateya,' O Foremost of Monkeys. I shall avenge that execrable deed of that eater offtesh (***RAVANA***) as tlso his cruelty to my brother. " Resting here, I am able to see **RAVANA** and Janaki, for we all possess the supersensual sight of Suparna. It is by vinue of our nature and on account of the food we eat, that we can see clearly to a distance of four hundred miles. We are instinctively drawn to search for our food at a distance, whilst other birds scratch it up with their claws at the foot of the trees where they roost, their sight being limited. " Do ye look about for a means to cross over the salty waves ; having found Vaidehi, rerum, your purpose accomplished. Now I desire to be taken by you to the shore of the sea, the abode of **VARUNA**; I will there perform the water ritual for the spirit of my high-souled brother, who has gone to the celestial abode." At those words those mighty monkeys carried Sampati, whose wings had been burnt, to the shore of the ocean, after which they brought back that King of the Birds to the Vindhya Mountain ; and, having received the information concerning **SITA**, they experienced great joy.

CHAPTER 59

He encourages them to pursue their Quest

forget the power of the arrows of Dasaratba that fty with tbe speed of lightning and those that are loosed by **LAKSHMANA** ? " Then Sampati, once again consoling those monkeys who bad risen from their fasting and who were all attention to what was being related concerning **SITA**, well pleased, said to them : " Hear how I came to learn of **SITA**'s abduction at this place and who it was that told me where that large-eyed lady could be found ! It is a long time since I fell on to this inaccessible

mountain, many miles in extent. Now I am old and feeble in life and limb; in this condition my son, named Suparshwa, tbe best of birds, brought me food regularly. If the Gandharvas are extremely pleasure loving and the serpent race prone to anger and the deer exceedingly timid, we, in our turn, are voracious. " One day, tormented with hunger, I demanded food and my son ftew off at sunrise to procure it, but returned at night with out any ftesh. He, the increaser of my delight, had grown tired of searching for nourishment and in order to propitiate me said in all sincerity : '"My dear father, wishing to bring thee thine accustomed portion, I ftew into the air and stationed myself near the approach of the Mahendra Mountain in order to obstruct the passage of thousands of creatures who range the sea. There I was, look ing down, guarding the pass, when suddenly I observed some one resembling a mass of collyrium, carrying a woman as beautiful as the dawn. Seeing tbem, I resolved to seize them for my prey, but he humbly implored me in peaceful accents to let him pass. None on eanh, not even the wicked, devour the peaceful willingly, how much less a creature like myself I He passed on quickly, pushing away the air, as it were, with his energy. Thereafter, those beings that inhabit space approached me and paid obeisance to me and the great *Rishis* said to me: " ' " By good fortune **SITA** still lives ! It is well for tbee that he has passed by thee with this woman." " ' Then the glorious Siddhas addressed me and infonned me that it was **RAVANA**, the King of the Demons, whom I had seen with the conson of **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, tbe daughter of **JANAKA**, who, her silken attire torn, overcome with an excess KISHKINDHA KAN_DA of grief, her hair falling about her, was calling the names of "**RAMA**" aod "**LAKSHMANA** ". Thus, O My Father, is how the time bas passed.' " All this did Suparshwa tell me, aod even on hearing it I did not consider exerting my strength, for witbout wiugs, how can a bird

undertake anything ? But hear how I can help you with my word and knowledge, so tbat you can manifest your prowess ! By my speech aod my experience I will do what is agreeable to you. I shall make the concern of the son of Dasaratba my con cern, do not doubt it. Possessed as you are of intelligence, energy and wisdom, incapable of being overcome even by the Gods, you bave been sent here by the King of the Monkeys. The arrows of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** furnished with heron plumes are able to destroy the Three Worlds. Although the ten-necked **RAVANA** is endowed with strength and energy, yet assuredly none can resist your united efforts I There is no need for further delay. Now accomplish your purpose. The wise, such as you, are not dilatory in their undertakings."

CHAPTER 60

The Story of the Ascetic Nishakara

WHEN the vulture bad offered oblations of water for the spirit of his brother and performed his ablutions, the monkey chiefs sat down on tbat marvellous mountain, placing him in their midst. Then Sampati, in order to reassure them, said cheerfully to **ANGADA**, who was seated surrounded by all the monkeys who escorted him :-" Listen to me with attention aod in silence, O Monkeys, aod I will tell you truly how I came to know of Mairhili. " A long time ago, I fell on the summit of the Vindhya Mountain, O Irreproachable Prince, my wings scorched by the heat of the sun, which consumed them with its rays. On re gaining consciousness at the end of six days, faint aod bereft of strength, looking round, I was unable to distinguish anything. Nevertheless on scanning the lakes, rocks, rivers, ponds, wooda mountain tilled with cheerful

birds, containing deep caves and innumerable ridges is certainly the Vindhya Peak on the shores of the southern sea.' " Here lay a sacred hermimge revered by the Gods them selves, where a Sage named Nishakara, of severe austerities, dwelt ; since that time, that saint conversant with virtue has ascended to heaven. " I passed eight thousand years on this mountain. Then not having seen that ascetic, crawling slowly and pain fully down from that high peak to the ground covered with sharp pointed grass, eager to see that sage, I rejoined him with great difficulty. Formerly Jamyu and I visited that sage many times. " In that neighbourhood, soft and fragrant breezes blew and there was no tree without flowers or fruit. Approaching that sacred hermitage, desirous of seeing the blessed Nishakara, I waited at the foot of a tree. Then, at a distance, I beheld that).Ushi, blazing with effulgence, who, having performed his ablutions, was returning towards the north. “As all living beings surround a giver, so was he surrounded by bears, srimaras, tigers, lions and snakes of various kinds. And when they observed that the saint had entered his hermitage, they all went away, as when a king retires, the ministers who have esconed him withdraw. " The Sage, on seeing me, was pleased, and retiring into his hermimge for a while, came out again and enquired as to my welfare. **HE** *said*:-' O My Friend, on account of thy dis coloured plumes, I am unable to recognize thee ; thy two wings have been scorched by fire and thy frail frame is shaken by gasps. In former times, I knew two vultures resembling the wind in speed, who were brothers, able to change their shape at will. Thou art, I know, the elder, Sampati, and **JATAYU** is thy younger brother. Both assuming human shape were wont to massage my feet with their hoods. " ' By what disease hast thou been afBicted ? From whence comes the loss of thy wings ? Who has inflicted this punish ment on thee ? Do thou tell me alii ' " 312 CHAPTER 6I Sampati tells his Story to the Sage

Nishakara Sampati related to the ascetic the whole of his fearful, arduous and rash act of flying towards the sun : " O Blessed One, the wounds I have received, the shame I feel and the exhaustion I experience, all prevent me from enter ing into a lengthy narrative. " From pride in our power of tlight, **JATAYU** and I, in order to test each other's powers, vowing in the presence of the sages on Mt. Kailasha that we would follow the sun till it set behind the Astacbala Mountain, flew into the sky. Reaching a great height together, we looked down on the earth with its various cities that appeared like chariot wheels. Sometimes the sound of musi::al instruments reached us, at others the tinkling of ornaments. In certain places we saw many damsels clad in red who were singing. " Passing rapidly through the air, we followed the path of the sun and observed a forest intersected with green rides ; the mountains appeared like pebbles and the rivers like threads binding the earth ; Himavat, Vindhya and that mighty mountain, Meru resembled elephants standing in a pond. " Nevertheless we were perspiring freely and were 6lled with anxiety and extremely fatigued, no longer being able, in our bewilderment, to distinguish between the south, west or the quarter presided over by Fire ; the earth seemed to us to have been consumed by flames, as at the end of the world period. My mind and my eyes failing, with a violent effort I fixed them on the sun and with great difficulty succeeded in doing so. The blazing orb seemed to us much larger than the earth in cstent, and at that instant, **JATAYU**, without speaking to me, began

CHAPTER 61

Sampati tells his Story to the Sage

CHAPTER 6I Sampati tells his Story to the Sage Nishakara Sampati related to the ascetic the whole of his fearful, arduous and rash act of flying towards the sun : " O Blessed One, the wounds I have received, the shame I feel and the exhaustion I experience, all prevent me from enter ing into a lengthy narrative. " From pride in our power of tlight, **JATAYU** and I, in order to test each other's powers, vowing in the presence of the sages on Mt. Kailasha that we would follow the sun till it set behind the Astacbala Mountain, flew into the sky. Reaching a great height together, we looked down on the earth with its various cities that appeared like chariot wheels. Sometimes the sound of musi::al instruments reached us, at others the tinkling of ornaments. In certain places we saw many damsels clad in red who were singing. " Passing rapidly through the air, we followed the path of the sun and observed a forest intersected with green rides ; the mountains appeared like pebbles and the rivers like threads binding the earth ; Himavat, Vindhya and that mighty mountain, Meru resembled elephants standing in a pond. " Nevertheless we were perspiring freely and were 6lled with anxiety and extremely fatigued, no longer being able, in our bewilderment, to distinguish between the south, west or the quarter presided over by Fire ; the earth seemed to us to have been consumed by flames, as at the end of the world period. My mind and my eyes failing, with a violent effort I fixed them on the sun and with great difficulty succeeded in doing so. The blazing orb seemed to us much larger than the earth in cstent, and at that instant, **JATAYU**, without speaking to me, began Janasthana, but my wings scathed, deprived of strength, I fell on the Vindhya Mountain. "Bereft of my dominion, my brother, my wings and my power, I now long to hurl myself headlong from the summit of this mountain and put an end to my existence." CHAPTER 6z Sampati learns where **SITA** is from the Sage Nishakara "HAVING spoken thus to that foremost of

Sages, in my distress, I began to weep, and that blessed One, refiecting for a while, said tome: " ' Thy two wings with their feathers will grow again anfi thou wilt recover thy sight, thine energy and thy prowess. Having learnt it from the Puranas and foreseen it by mine ascetic power, I know that a great event is about to take place. " ' It concerns a certain king, named **DASARATHA** of the race of Ikshwaku, to whom a son, full of valour, will be born ""Y the name of **RAMA**. He will repair to the forest with his b'other **LAKSHMANA**, having been constrained to do so by his sire. " ' The son of Nairriti, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, in capable of being slain by Gods or Danavas, will bear off his consort from the forest of Janasthana. And, albeit tempted by delicious viands and objects of enjoyment and desire, that noble and illustrious one, overcome by grief, will not partake of them. Then Vasava learning of this will offer her 'payasa' resembling ambrosia that the Gods themselves only obtain with difficulty. Receiving this food, Maithili, knowing it to come from lndra, will offer part of it to **RAMA**, by pouring it on the ground, saying : - Whether my husband or his younger brother still live or have anained the celestial state, may this food be acceptable to them.' " ' **RAMA**'s envoys having been sent hither, it will be for thee

CHAPTER 62

Sampati learns from him where Sita is

Janasthana, but my wings scathed, deprived of strength, I fell on the Vindhya Mountain. "Bereft of my dominion, my brother, my wings and my power, I now long to hurl myself headlong from the summit of this mountain and put an end to my existence." CHAPTER 6z Sampati learns where **SITA** is from the Sage Nishakara "HAVING spoken thus to

that foremost of Sages, in my distress, I began to weep, and that blessed One, refiecting for a while, said tome: " ' Thy two wings with their feathers will grow again anfi thou wilt recover thy sight, thine energy and thy prowess. Having learnt it from the Puranas and foreseen it by mine ascetic power, I know that a great event is about to take place. " ' It concerns a certain king, named **DASARATHA** of the race of Ikshwaku, to whom a son, full of valour, will be born ""Y the name of **RAMA**. He will repair to the forest with his b'other **LAKSHMANA**, having been constrained to do so by his sire. " ' The son of Nairriti, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, in capable of being slain by Gods or Danavas, will bear off his consort from the forest of Janasthana. And, albeit tempted by delicious viands and objects of enjoyment and desire, that noble and illustrious one, overcome by grief, will not partake of them. Then Vasava learning of this will offer her 'payasa' resembling ambrosia that the Gods themselves only obtain with difficulty. Receiving this food, Maithili, knowing it to come from lndra, will offer part of it to **RAMA**, by pouring it on the ground, saying : - Whether my husband or his younger brother still live or have anained the celestial state, may this food be acceptable to them.' " ' **RAMA**'s envoys having been sent hither, it will be for thee wing11 but by waiting here thou canst render a service to the worlds. Even so, thou shalt be doing thy duty to the two princes, the *brahmins*, thy spiritual preceptors, the sages and **INDRA**. I also am desirous of beholding the two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, after which I shall yield up my life. " Thus did that great *Rishi*, conversant with the nature of all thing11, speak to me."

CHAPTER 63

The Wings of Sampati grow once more

Thereafter I crawled slowly out of the cave and scaled the Vindhya Mountain to wait for you. Since that time, a whole century has passed, and, keeping the words of that hermit in my heart, I await the time and place. " Nishakara has ascended to heaven and I, distracted by many thoughts, have been consumed with grief. When the idea of death comes to me, I put it away, remembering the words of the Sage. The determination he inspired in me to preserve my life dissolves my distress, as a flame in a lit brazier dispels the darkness. " Though fully conversant with the power of the evil-hearted **RAVANA**, yet I approached my son saying:-' Hearing her lamentations and knowing these two princes to be deprived of her, how is it that thou didst not free **SITA**?' In my affec tion for King **DASARATHA** I was displeased with my son." AB Sampati was spesking thus to the monkeys, his win!!" suddenly began to grow again in the presence of those dwellers in the wooda. Thereupon seeing his body covered with tawny feathers, he experienced an immense joy and said to those monkeys :-" By the grace of Nishakara, that Sage of immeasurable power, my wingll, that had been scorched by the sun's rays, have grown again and the prowess I possessed in my youth has returned. To-day I have regained my strength 3IS and vigour. Do you spare no effort to find **SITA**; the recovery of my wings is a pledge of your success." Having spoken thus to the monkeys, Sampati, the foremost of birds, anxious to ascertain his powers of ftight, ftew up to the mountain top. Heating his words, those mighty monkeys were delighted and confident of their success, prepared to demonstrate their valour. With the speed of the wind those foremost of monkeys, intent upon finding **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, set out towards the south to the quarter dominated by Abhijit.'

CHAPTER 64

The Monkeys are discouraged on seeing the Ocean

ting cries of delight. Hearing from Sampati that **RAVANA** would be slain, the happy monkeys reached the sea, anxious to discover **SITA**. And coming to that place, those redoubtable warriors beheld the ocean, the mirror of the whole world. Arriving at the northern side of the southern sea, those exceedingly powerful and heroic monkeys halted there. And seeing the ocean which at rimes appeared to be asleep, at others playful, sometimes covered with huge waves and thronged with aquatic animals, causing their hair to stand on end, those fore most of monkeys were amazed and became despondent. Be holding that ocean incapable of being traversed, even as the sky itself, the monkeys began to lament, crying : " What is now to be done?" Then the foremost of the monkeys, the mighty **ANGADA**, seeing the despair of the army at the sight of the sea, began to reassure those warriors a111ictcd with terror, saying: " One should never give way to agitation, of all thinga it is the most fatal : agitation destroys a man even as a provoked serpent doth a child. He who, when the time is ripe for dis playing his valour, becomes agitated, will grow weak and fail to attain his object." The night having passed, **ANGADA** took counsel with the older monkeys, and that monkey host surrounding him resembled the hosts of the Maruts surrounding Vasava. Who, save Bali's son or **HANUMAN** was capable of maintaining dis cipline amongst those troops ? Having called the elders together in company with the army, the fortunate **ANGADA**, the subduer of his foes, saluting them, spoke words fraught with good sense, saying : " Who amongst you is of sufficient stature to cross the ocean ? Who is able to carry out the commands of **SUGRIVA**, the conqueror of his foes ? Which

valiant monkey can leap the four hundred miles and deliver the leaders of the monkeys from their great anxiety ? By whose favour shall we, crowned with success and content, return and behold our wives, our sons and our homes ? Who will enable us to meet **RAMA**, the mighty Laksh mana and that dweller in the woods, **SUGRIVA**, with a light heart ? If there be any monkey capable of leaping over the ocean, then may he show his blessed form to us and deliver us from fear ! ' Hearing **ANGADA**'s speech, no one uttered a word and the entire monkey host appeared stunned. Then that foremost of monkeys once more addressed them saying : " O Ye Excellent Warriors, of tried valour, unimpeachable family and worthy of honour, say how far each of you is able to leap over the sea without any being able to hinder you ! "

CHAPTER 65

The Leaders of the Monkeys, each state what they are able to accomplish

HAVING listened to **ANGADA**'s words, those Chiefs of Monkeys, each in tum, began to dilate on what he was able to accomplish Gays, Gavaksba, Gavaya, Sharabha, Gandhamadana, Mainda, 317 Dvivida and **ANGADA** as also **JAMBAVAN**. Gaya speaking lint, said: " I can leap a hundred miles ! " and **GAVAKSHA** *said*:-" I can leap two hundred I " Then the monkey Sharabha said to his companions:-" I am able to leap three hundred miles, O Monkeys ! " thereafter Rishabha said, " I can undoubtedly cross over four hundred miles ! " and the mighty Gandhamadana said" I can leap five hundred miles ! " In his tum the monkey, Mainda, said " And I, six hundred miles " and the illustrious Dvivida " Without difficulty I can leap over seven hundred miles!" Then

Sushena, full of energy, the best of monkeys said, " I declare that I can leap eight hundred miles ! " And as they were speaking thus, the oldest of them, **JAMBAVAN**, offering salutations to them all, spoke in this wise:-" Formerly I, also, had the power of motion but now I am advanced in years. Nevertheless in the present situation, nothing should be over looked to assure the success of both Ramo's and the King of Monkeys' mission: I shall therefore leap three hundred miles. There is no doubt whatever about this." Then **JAMBAVAN**, addressing all those monkeys, added : " Alas ! I have assuredly not the strength for that ! Of old, I circumambulated the eternal **VISHNU** when he covered the world in three strides at the sacrifice of Virochana's son ; now, however, I am old and tire quickly. When I was yonng, my energy was great and unmatched ; to day, I can only go as far as I have told you, which is not sutlicient to bring success to our undertaking." Thereupon the sagacious **ANGADA**, bowing to that mighty monkey, addressed him in pregnant words, saying: "I am able to leap these four hundred miles easily but should I be able to return ? Nothing is certain I " Thereat **JAMBAVAN** answered that excellent monkey and said : " O Foremost of Monkeys, thy power of motion is well known, should take care of the root of a thing, this is the practice of men of experience; the root being sound, the juices that have for their purpose the maturing of the fruit will be safeguarded. Thou art the essential part of this undertaking and, O Subduer of Thy Foes, thou, furnished with wisdom and valour, art the principle underlying it. Thou art our superior and the son of our superior, O Excellent One; with thy support shall be able to accomplish our mission." Thus, in his great wisdom, **JAMBAVAN** spoke and that mighty monkey born of Bali, **ANGADA**, answered him saying : " If I do not go nor any among these powerful monkeys does so, then undoubtedly we must begin our supreme fast once more, for if we return without having

fulfilled the commsnds of that lord of the monkeys, then I do not see how we can hope to preserve our lives. Whether he show clemency or wrath, he is the chief of the monkeys and to disregard his will means death. In this mstter no other alternative is possible ; there fore it is for you who are able to see clearly to refiect upon it." Thus spoke **ANGADA** and that powerful and heroic monkey, **JAMBAVAN**, answered him in felicitous words saying: " O Warrior, this mission will be carried out without obstruc tion I I will call on the one who is able to accomplish it." Thereupon that heroic monkey sent for the foremost of the apes, **HANUMAN**, who was sitting tranquilly apart.

CHAPTER 66

Jambavan appeals to Hanuman to sacrifice himself for the good of all

THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI " Arisbtanemi's' son, the mighty Vainateya, the illustrious **GARUDA** is the foremost of all winged creatures. Many a time I have seen that all-powerful bird of immense wings and exceed ing energy bearing away serpents from the ocean ; the strength that is in his wings resembles the might and vigour of thine arms; none can withstand thee. Thine energy, intelligence, courage and loyalty sets thee apart from the rest of beings, therefore prepare thyself to cross the ocean. " The most noble of all the Apsaras, Punjika-Tbala, under the name of Anjana, became the wife of the monkey Kesarin. She was renowned in the three worlds and her beauty was unequalled on earth. As a result of a curse, O Friend, she was born in the monkey race, able to change her form at will. " Once that daughter of the king among the monkeys, Kunjara, having assumed the form of a woman radiant

with youth and beauty, adorned with garlands of various kinds, clad in silk, was wandering about on the summit of a mountain, which resembled a mass of clouds in the rainy season. " And it happened that the God of the Wind stole away the red-bordered yellow robe of that large-eyed maiden, who stood on the mountain top. Then Maruta perceived her rounded, well-proportioned thighs and her breasts touching each other and her amiable and pleasing mien. Beholding that youthful woman oflovely limbs and slender waist, her whole being radiant with beauty, be was filled with desire and beside himself, en veloping that irreproachable lady in his arms, Manmatha em braced her. " In her distress, Anjana, faithful to her conjugal vows, cried out :-' Who desires to sever the ties of a woman devoted to her lord ? ' Hearing these words, the Wind-God answered, ' I do not wish to wrong thee, O Lady of Lovely Hips, let not thy heart be troubled. By embracing thee and entering into thee thou shalt bear a son endowed with strength and intelligence, of immense energy, of noble nature, possessed of vigour and courage and in agility and speed equal to myself.' " These words pleased thy mother and she gave birth to thee in a cave, O Foremost of Monkeys. " While still a child, thou didst see the sun rise over the great forest and taking it to be a fruit sought to seize it. Bounding into the ait, thou didst mount up for a thousand yojanas, O Great Monkey and, though the burning rays of the sun beat upon thee, thou didst not falter. Seeing thee rushing through space, **INDRA**, full of wrath, hurled this thunderbolt at thee, whereupon, falling, tbou didst fracture thy lefr jaw on the point of a rock from which arises thy name, **HANUMAN**. Observing thee in this state, Vayu the Destroyer, the Bearer of Fragrance/ in the height of anger, ceased to blow throughout the Three Worlds. " Then all the Gods were distressed on account of the calamity that bas befallen the worlds and these Lords of the Univerae sought to

pacify the wrathful Wind-god, whereupon Pavana being placated, **BRAHMA** accorded thee the boon of invulnera bility in combat. Seeing how thou didst sustain the impact of the thunderbolt, that God of a Thousand Eyes was pleased with thee and also conferred an excellent boon on thee, saying : ' Thou shalt not die till thou desireth to do so ! Thou, en dowed with extreme vigour, the son of Kesarin, resembling the Wind God in energy, art born of his loins and equal to him in speed'. O Friend, we are lost, but thou, possessed of skill and courage, art in our midst a second Lord of the Monkeys. "In the time when **VISHNU** covered the world with three strides, I, O Child, circumambulated the earth with its mount ains, forests and woods, one and twenty times. Then com missioned by the Gods, we gathered all the herbs which (*when cast into the sea*) produced the nectar of immortality and at that time our strength was great. Now I am old and my prowess bas deserted me, but thou, endowed with every virtue art amongst us. Employ thy valour, O Hero, for tbou are most lined to do so. Bestir thyself and cross the vast ocean, O Redoubtable Monkey ; the entire monkey host is eager to behold thy prowess. Arise and leap over the mighty sea, for thou surpassetb all beings in motion. Canst thou remain in· dift"erent to the despair of all the monkeys ? Put forth thy strength, as did **VISHNU** when traversing the Three Worlds with three strides, O Lion among Monkeys ! " Thus exhorted by the foremost of monkeys, **HANUMAN**, renowned for his great might, the son of the Wind, assumed a form preparatory to crossing the sea that gladdened the hearts of those monkeys.

CHAPTER 67

Hanuman prepares to go to Lanka

SEEING that extremely agile leader of monkeys stretching him self in preparation for crossing the four hundred miles of sea, the monkeys, renouncing all despondency, were filled with delight and began to shout and praise the heroism of **HANUMAN**. And, struck with amazement, beings from every sphere re joiced unitedly, even as when they beheld the Lord Himself displaying his powers, when taking the three strides. Thus acclaimed, the mighty **HANUMAN** expanded in size and waved his tail in pleasure, demonstrating his strength. Ap plauded by the older monkeys and tilled with energy, he assumed an unparalleled shape, like a lion that stretches himself at the mouth of a rocky cavern, and that Son of Maruta began to yawn and the mouth of that intelligent monkey resembled a blazing brazier or a smokeless fire. Rising in the midst of those monkeys, his hair standing on end for joy, he paid obeisance to the older leaders and said to them: " I am the son of him who shatters the mountain peaks and is the friend of fire, the mighty and incommensurable Vayu, who circulates in space, Maruta, of impetuous bounds, rapid pace and great soul. A thousand times am I able without pausing, to encircle Meru, that colossus that seems to lick the heavens. With my strong arms, churning up the sea, I can inundate the world with its mountains, rivers and lakes ; with my thighs and legs, I can cause the ocean, the abode of **VARUNA** with its great denizens, to overflow. I can encircle Vainateya, revered by all, who feeds on serpents, a thousand times while he courses once through space. What is more, I am able to reach the sun which rises in glory crowned with rays, before it sinks in the west and return without touching the earth. I can leap beyond the 3-U stars and planets, suck up the ocean and rive the earth ; I can shatter the mountains with my bounds and in the immeasurable energy of my leaping I can cause the sea to overflow. When I mount into the sky, flowers from countless shrubs and trees will be borne away by me on my

aerial course this day and studded with flowers my path shall resemble the Milky Way. " And, O Monkeys, all beings shall behold me coursing through the air, encompassing the firmament, now rising, now descending, as it were devouring space. I shall scatter the clouds, shatter the mountains and dry up the ocean with my constant leaping. My powers are equal to the eagle's or the wind ; I know of none that surpasses the King of the Birds, the Wind-god or myself. In the twinkling of an eye, I shall float through the air like lightning from a cloud. While crossing the sea, my form will resemble **VISHNU**'s taking his three strides. My heart foretells that I shall encounter Vaidehi, therefore rejoice. Equal to Maruta in motion and **GARUDA** in speed, I shall cover ten thousand miles ; this is my firm conviction. am able to wrest the' amrita' from **INDRA**, armed with his thunder bolt or from **BRAHMA** himself. Be assured, that having turned Lanka upside down, I shall return ! " That monkey of immeasurable vigour roared thus, and astoun ded, the monkeys gazed on him with joy ; and hearing those words that dissipated the distress of his kindred, that foremost of monkeys, **JAMBAVAN**, transported with delight, said:-" O Hero ! O Son ofKesarin! O Offspring of the Wind! Thou hast dispelled the immense anxiety of thy fellows, and these foremost of monkeys assembled here will perform acts tending to thy welfare. By the grace of the Sages, the approval of our elders and the blessing of our spiritual preceptors do thou cross the ocean. We will stand on one foot awaiting thy return. On thee depend the lives of all the inhabitants of the woods ! " Then that tiger of the monkeys said to those rangers of the woods :-" None in this world will be able to sustain the force of my leaping. Here is the mountain Mahendra with its com pact mass of rocks and high escarpments, it is from its summit that I shall spring. With its trees of varied fragrance that cover it and its many crags, it will be able to bear

my weight, when I prepare to leap over fonr hundred miles." With these words that monkey, the scourge of his foes, born of Maruta, whose equal he was, scaled that monarch of mountains, carpeted with flowers of every kind and grassy swards ranged by deer, containing tlowering creepers and trees laden with fruit and blossoms, frequented by lions and tigers and herds of intoxicated elephants maddened with ichor ; there flocks of birds trilled and waterfalls rumbled on every side. Ascending that mountain, that foremost of monkeys, equal to Mahendra in power, began to wander from one crest to another and crushed between the arms of that high-souled one, that great mountain emitted a loud clamour, like a mighty elephant that has been attacked by a lion and waters gushed out from the scattered rocks and deer and elephants were seized with fear, whilst the giant trees shook. Its spacious uplands were deserted by the. pairs of Gandharvas engaged in drinking and dalliance, the birds flew away and the hands of Vidyadharas 1led from the high plateaus ; the huge serpents hid themselves in terror and the cliJfs and spars broke away. With its serpents hissing, their bodies half issuing from their holes, the mountain shone, as if decorated by pennants. The *Rishis* in fear and agitation 1led from that support of the earth so that it resembled a wayfarer in a vast forest, deserted by his companions. And that agile and valiant monkey, endowed with great speed, the destroyer of his foes, filled with an exalted purpose, had already reached Lanks in thought.

The Departure of **HANUMAN**

THEN that Scourge of His Foes, **HANUMAN**, prepared to follow the path of the Charanas in quest of the place to which **SITA** had been borne away by **RAVANA**. Desirous of accomplishing this difficult feat without hindrance, impossible to any other, that powerful monkey, stretching out his head and neck like a bull, frightening the birds, up rooting the trees with his breast and destroying innumerable creatures, like a lion overflowing with energy

joyfully bounded over the grassy slopes resembling the sea. On that mountain plateau, frequented by the Chiefs of the Serpent Race, embellished by blue, red, yellow, rose and various coloured metals, thronged with Celestial Beings, Y akshas, Kinneras and Gandharvas, able to change their form at will, that foremost of monkeys stood like a Naga in a lake. Then, having paid homage to the Sun-god, Mahendra, Pavana, Swyarnbhu and all beings, he prepared to set out on his journey. Turning towards the east and saluting his sire, the resourceful **HANUMAN**, having resolved to cross the ocean to fulfil **RAMA**'s purpose, in order to reach the southern region, expanded his body under the eyes of the leaders of the monkeys, as the sea increases under the full moon. Assuming an immense stature, desirous of traversing the ocean, he pressed the mountain with his bands and feet and that immoveable peak shook under his weight and all the blossom from the tops of the trees fell in a shower wholly covering it with a mass of fragrant blooms. Under the extreme pressure of that monkey's weight, water gushed forth from the mountain like ichor from the temples of an elephant in rut. Trampled underfoot by that mighty furest

BOOK V

Sundara Kanda

Hanuman leaps the ocean to Lanka, finds Sita in the Ashoka grove, delivers Rama's ring, sets fire to the city and returns to Rama with news. The book is considered the most beautiful of the seven, and is recited as a devotional whole.



CHAPTER 1

The Departure of Hanuman

CHAPTER The Departure of **HANUMAN** THEN that Scourge of His Foes, **HANUMAN**, prepared to follow the path of the Charanas in quest of the place to which **SITA** had been borne away by **RAVANA**. Desirous of accomplishing this difficult feat without hindrance, impossible to any other, that powerful monkey, stretching out his head and neck like a bull, frightening the birds, up rooting the trees with his breast and destroying innumerable creatures, like a lion overflowing with energy joyfully bounded over the grassy slopes resembling the sea. On that mountain plateau, frequented by the Chiefs of the Serpent Race, embellished by blue, red, yellow, rose and various coloured metals, thronged with Celestial Beings, Y akshas, Kinneras and Gandharvas, able to change their form at will, that foremost of monkeys stood like a Naga in a lake. Then, having paid homage to the Sun-god, Mahendra, Pavana, Swyarnbhu and all beings, he prepared to set out on his journey. Turning towards the east and saluting his sire, the resourceful **HANUMAN**, having resolved to cross the ocean to fulfil **RAMA**'s purpose, in order to reach the southern region, expanded his body under the eyes of the leaders of the monkeys, as the sea increases under the full moon. Assuming an immense stature, desirous of traversing the ocean, he pressed the mountain with his bands and feet and that immoveable peak shook under his weight and all the blossom from the tops of the trees fell in a shower wholly covering it with a mass of fragrant blooms. Under the extreme pressure of that monkey's weight, water gushed forth from the mountain like ichor from the temples of an elephant in rut. Trampled underfoot by that mighty furest dweller, the mountain let

loose innumerable sueams of gold, silver and collyrium and, from that rocky mass, enormous boulders detacbed themselves cootaining red arsenic so that it resembled a brazier wreathed in smoke. Crushed on every side by the mookey, those creatures, dwelling in the caverns, bruised and stilled, emitted strange cries and the formidable clamour created by them filled the whole earth and other regions. Great serpents, rearing their distinctive hoods, vomited fire and bit the rocks with their fangs and those great crags, split by the venom, broke into flames and were shivered into a thousand fragments. The medicinal herbs also, which grew there, were affected by the poison which they were unable to neuualise. Then the ascetics, terrified, reflecting that the mountain was being riven by great Beings, fled away, as well as the Vidya dbsras with their attendant women. Forsaking their golden seats, goblets and precious vessels \\ith the ewers of gold in the feasting hall ; abandoning the priceless sauces, wines and viands of every kind and the hides and swords with guards of Kanalta gold ; intoxicated, their necks encircled with jewelled chains, adorned with garlands and red sandal paste, their eyes resembling blue lotuses, they rose into the air ; and those fair Ones, wearing suings of pearls, rings and bracelets, startled, ascended smiling into the sky, close to their loved ooes. Witnessing this great marvel, Maharishis and Vidyadharas stood in the firmament gazing down on the mountain and they heard those pure-minded ascetics saying : " This **HANUMAN**, born of the Wind, endued with great energy, desirous of crossing the ocean, the abode of **VARUNA**, in order to carry out Rarna's purpose and that of the monkeys, is eager to reach the further shore, a most difficult feat." Hearing the words of the ascetics, the Vidyadharas beheld that foremost of monkeys oo the mountain, bristling and quivering like a flame, emitting a great roar like the rumble of thunder. Then raising his tsi1 which twitched convulsively, like a snake shaken

by an eagle, he waved it to and fro and, lying curled across his back, it resembled a great serpent borne away by **GARUDA**. And that monkey, stiffening his arms like unto two immense clubs, girded up his limbs and, crouching down, contracted his neck and arms, summoning up all his streogth and courage. Scanniog the path he was to take and examining the distance to be covered, he drew in his breath, pressing his two feet firmly on the ground and that elephant among monkeys, **HANUMAN**, Oattening his cars, leapt forward and, full of energy, addressed the forest dwellers, saying : " As an arrow loosed by Raghava fties with the speed of the wind so shall I course to Lanka which is guarded by **RAVANA**. If I fail to find the daughter of **JANAKA** there, I shall repair with the same speed to the region of the Gods, where, if despite mine efforts I do not recover Sits, I shall bring hack the King of the Titans in chains. Either, achieving success, I shall retnrn or uprooting Lanka from its foundation, I shall bear it hither, together with **RAVANA**." With these words, **HANUMAN**, the foremost of monkeys, without pausing for breath, deeming himself to be a second Supama, sprang into the air and, such was the force of his leap, that the trees growing on the mountain, toSsing their branches, were sent spinning on every side. In his rapid Bight, **HANUMAN** bore away those trees with their flowering boughs filled with lapwings intoxicated with love, into the empyrean. Carried away by the impetUs of his tre mendous bound, those trees followed in his wake, like relatives accompanying their dear one setting out on a journey to a far country. Uprooted by the force of his motion, Sala and other forest trees followed in **HANUMAN**'s wake, like an army its leader. Surrounded by countless trees, the crests of which were laden with blossom, the monkey **HANUMAN**, resembling a glorious mountain, was wonderful to behold. And those great trees, full of sap, fell into the sea, as formerly the mountains in fear of **INDRA**

plunged into **VARUNA**'s abode. Covered with flowers of every kind, as well as young shoots and buds, that monkey shone like a cloud or a hill aglow with fircfties. Tom away by his leaping, those trees, scattering their blossom here and there, plunged into the sea, like friends who, having escorted one of their company, return. Borne away in their fragility by the wind produced by the monkey's impetnous 3a9 flight, which had detached them from their stems, the multi coloured Bowers fell into the sea. Covered with a drift of fragrant blooms of diverse tints, that monkey, in his 11ight, resembled a mass of clouds embellished by lightning and the waters strewo with the blossom of his leap, looked like the firmament when the enchanting stars appear. His two arms oUtstretched in space, resembled two five-headed serpents issuing from the summit of a mountain. Sometimes that mighty monkey seemed to be drinking up the ocean with the multitudinous waves and sometimes it seemed as if he would swallow the sky itself. As he thus followed the wind's path, his eyes, shining like lightning, sparkled like two fires that have been kindled on a mountain. The eyes of that tawny-hued one resembled the sun and moon in juxtaposition, and his coppery nose lent his countenance the same hue as the solar orb at the approach of dusk; his uplifted tail caused that offspring of the wind to appear like the rmed hanner of lndra. With his coiled tail and white teeth, that exceedingly sagacious son of Anila, **HANUMAN**, shone like the star of day encircled by a halo of rays and his plump form, of a coppery hue, caused him to resemble a mountain which is being excavated for its deposits of red ochre. Bounding over the waters, the air imprisoned in the armpits of that leouine monkey, emitted a sound like thunder. As in space, a meteor from a higher region rushes through the skies so did that elephant of monkeys appear or like a great bird soaring into the air or a great tusker tightly-bound by a girth, whilst the re11ection of his body cast on the

deep resembled a vessel fOundering in a storm. Wherever that great monkey passed, the sea rose tumultuously under the force of his bounds and, rushing on with extreme speed, with his breast like a great prow, he caused the salty sea to surge mountainously. Pushing those high heaving billows befure him, that lion among monkeys seemed to be separating heaven and eatth ; the waves that rose up resembled Mount Meru and Mandara and, hreaated by him in his impetuous course, the waters lashed by his speed, overspread the sky like autumnal clouds. Whales, crocodiles, huge fish and turtles wete uncovered in tum, like the limbs of one shedding his 330 attire, and sea serpents, beholding that lion among monkeys travelling through space took him to be Suparna himself. The shadow of that great monkey, forty miles in extent and thirty wide, grew larger in the rapidity of his flight and, re sembling a mass of white clouds, falling on the salty waters, looked exceedingly beautiful. That supremely illustrious and mighty monkey of vaat body appeared like a winged mountain as he followed his aerial path without rest. Wherever that mighty elephant among the monkeys passed, the sea was instantly transformed into a fountsin and, following the path of the birds, **HANUMAN**, like the King of the feathered tribe, thrust aside the massed clouds like the Wind-god himself. Great clouds, red, blue, pale or dark, scattered by the monkey's flight, looked exceedingly beautiful and he, now entering into them, sometimes hidden sometimes visible, resembled the moon. Seeing that Plavaga' coursing with such speed, the Gods, Gandharvas and Danavas began to rain flowers on him and, aa he sailed on, the sun refrained from tormenting him and the wind ministered to him for the sake of **RAMA**'s enterprise. Then the *Rishis* praised that dweller of the woods as he was coursing through the sky and the Gods and Gandharvas extolled him in song. Seeing him bounding in space, Nagas, Yakshas and *Rakshasas* of various races lauded that excellent

monkey and the ocean, ever solicitous for the honour of the House of Ikshwaku, reflected :-" If I do not lend aasistance to this Lord of Monkeys, I shall be an object of obloquy to aU those gifted with speech ; was I not reared by Sagara, the foremost of the race of Ikshwaku ? This monkey is their counsellor, it is therefore incumbent on me not to let him perish in the waves. It behoves me to act in such wise that he may rest and, thus relieved by me, he will happily traverse the remaining way." In this magnanimous thought, the sea addressed that most excellent of mountains, the golden-hued Mainaka, which was covered by waves, saying : " Thou haat been placed here by the King of the Celestials, aa a rampart against the *Asuras* inhabiting the nether regions. Their power is wcll known and, lest they rise up anew from that hcll of immeasurable dimensions, thou art here to prevent their escape. Nevertheless thou art able to move upwards and down wards and from side to side. I command thee, therefore, O Best of Mountains, to rise up. That lion among monkeys, performer of mighty exploits, engaged in Rarna's service, over come with fatigue is passing over thee ; thou art witness of his exertions, now lift thyself up ! " Hearing the Ocean's words, the golden-breasted Mountain Mainaka with its tall trees and creepers, instantly rose from its watery bed and, as the sun with its burning rays divides the cloud, that gteat mountain, which the waters had concealed, on Sagara's request, exposed its golden peaks inhabited by Kinneras and gteat serpents, shimmering like the sun at dawn, as if it were licking the skies. The summits of that high mountain, shining like a sword, possessed the brilliance of gold and its gilded crests emitted a dazzling light lending it the lustre of a thousand suns. Beholding that mountain suddenly emerge before him from the middle of the sea, **HANUMAN** reflected : ' This is an obstacle ', and that mighty and impetuous monkey crushed that stony mass with his breast as the wind

scatters the clouds ; then that fore most of mountains, recognizing the power of **HANUMAN**, shouted for joy. Thereupon, assuming the form of a man, stationing himself on his own summit, with a glad heart he addressed **HANUMAN** saying : " O Most Excellent of Forest Dwellers, thou hast undertaken an arduous task, take thine ease on my crest and continue without fatigue. The ocean king was born in the House of Raghu and, seeing thee engaged on **RAMA**'s behalf, offers obeisance to thee. To render service for service is the divine decree. Desirous of serving Raghu's race, he is worthy of thy consideration. To do thee honour, the Sea God adjured me thus: " ' Traversing a hundred yojanas through the air, this monkey is worn out by his exertions, let him rest awhile on thy summit and continue his way without fatigue.' Do thou therefore re main here, O Best of Monkeys and repose thyself. Having feasted on these many sweet and fragtant fruits and roots, 332 proceed on thy course at thy leisure. O Foremost of Monkeys. the sum of thy virtues is well-known in the Three Worlds. Son of the Wind, of all the Plavagas who ahound in energy, I esteem thee to be the chief, O Lion among Monkeys ! Even an ordinary man is honoured as a guest by one conversant with his duty, how much more one such as thou ? Thou art the Son of Maruta, the Foremost of the Celestials and dost equal him in speed, O Best of Monkeys! In honouring thee, who art con versant with virtue, one is honouring thy sire, therefore thou dost merit my reverence. Hearken, there is a further reason for this: " In olden times, Dear Child, the mountains, endowed with wings, began to range the four quarters with the speed of **GARUDA**, and journeying thus, the companies of Celestials, ascetics and other Beings trembled with fear lest they should fall. Then, highly enraged, the God of a Thousand Eyes, the performer of an hundred sacrifices severed the wings of those hundreds and thousands of mountains with his thunderbolt. " When, full of wrath, the

Lord of the Celestials approached me, brandishing his mace, I was suddenly swept away by that high-souled Wind-god. O Foremost of Monkeys, I was thus cast into the salty waves and, retaining my wings, was preserved unhurt by thine ancestor. On account of this, thou art an object of adoration to me and this is the powerful hond which unites us, O Chtef of the Monkeys. The time for honouring the benefit conferred having come, it behoves thee to accord this felicity to the Ocean and myself, O Illustrious One ! Repose thyself therefore and accept our homage, who are worthy of thy respect, O V enerablc **HANUMAN** ! Happy am I to see thee here ! " Thus accosted by Mainaka, the foremost of mountains, that excellent monkey answered, saying :-" I am grateful for thy welcome but time presses and I have vowed not to rest on the way ; day is declining, let nothing disturb thy serenity." Then, touching the mountain with his hand, that lion among monkeys, smiling, sailed on through the air, whereupon the mountain and the ocean offered him their respect and gave him their blessings. Rising high into the sky, he looked down on the mountain and the vast ocean and proceeded unsupported in the pathway of the wind. 333 Seeing **HANUMAN** achieve this difficult feat, tbe Celestial Beings and the ascetics acclaimed him ; then tbe Gods present, in their tum, applauded tbe action of that golden mountain of beautiful slopes, as did **INDRA**, tbe Thousand-eyed Deity also, and supremely gratified, tbe consort of Sachi paid homage to that illusuious mountain personally, saying : " O Lord of Mountains, I am extremely pleased with thee I I grant thee full security, proceed therefore where thou desirest, O Friend. Thou hast fearlessly offered assistance to **HANUMAN**, who was exhausted after crossing four hundred miles of sea, despite every hazard. It is on **RAMA**'s behalf, the Son of King **DASARATHA**, that the monkey has undertaken this journey and thou hast welcomed him to the best of thy power, I am well pleased with thee

! " Beholding tbe King of the Gods, Shatakratu highly gratified, that foremost of mountains experienced supreme felicity and having received that boon from **INDRA**, resumed its former place. Then **HANUMAN**, in a short space, sped over the sea. Thereupon the Gods, Gandharvas and Siddhas with the ascetics called upon Surasa, the Mother of Serpents, who resembled the sun, saying : " The etfulgent Son of the Wind is crossing the main, it is for thee to delay him awhile Assuming the form of a terrible *Rakshasi,* as high as a mountain, with monstrous jaws and coppery eyes, do thou reach up to the sky. We desire to test his strength and measure his fortitude to see if he is able to over come thee or if he retires discomfited." At these words, Surasa, having been honoured by tbe Gods, rose from tbe ocean in the form of a female demon, deformed and hideous, inspiring terror in all beings and, staying **HANUMAN** in his flight, addressed him saying : " O Foremost of Monkeys, thou hast been destined by tbe Lords of tbe World to be my food, I am about to devour thee, do thou enter my mouth I This boon was formerly granted to me hy Dhatar." With these words she opened her vast mouth wide, placing herself in Maruti's path. Having listened to Surasa's speech. **HANUMAN**, smiling, answered her : 334 " **RAMA**, the Son of **DASARATHA**, who retired to the Dandaka forest with **LAKSHMANA** his brother, and Vaidehi his consort, as a result of a certain exploit, became the enemy of the demons. His beloved wife, the illustrious **SITA** was subsequently carried away by **RAVANA**. I have been sent to her on **RAMA**'s behalf, to whom thou shouldst proffer assistance, O Thou who in habitest his dominion. Having found Maithili and rejoined **RAMA**, whose deeds are memorable, I shall return and enter thy mouth, this I promise thee in good faith." Thus addressed by **HANUMAN**, Surasa, who was able to change her form at will, anawered :-" None shall pass me alive, this is the boon I have received." Then seeing him continue on his way, the

Mother of **SERPENTS** *added*:-" I have received this favour from Brahms, first enter my mouth then go thy way." Thereafter, extending her capacious jaws, she placed herself in front of Maruti. Surasa's words incensed that lion amung monkeys and he said : " Open thy mouth wide enough to swallow me." Having said this in anger, Surasa extended her jaws to the width of forty miles and **HANUMAN** increased his girth accordingly; thereat Surasa enlarged her mouth to fifty miles, and seeing the jaws of Surasa wide open with its long tongue, terrible to look upon, resembling a mountain, measuring fifty miles, **HANUMAN** enlarged himself to that extent also. Then Surasa increased her mouth to sixty miles and the heroic **HANUMAN** to seventy, whereupon Surasa widened her jaws to eighty miles, and **HANUMAN**, resembling Fire' itself, to ninety miles. Then Surasa enlarged her mouth to the extent of an hundred miles and **HANUMAN**, reducing his body like a cloud to the size of a thumb's breadth entered into her mouth and, re-emerging from it, standing in space, addressed her saying : " O Daltshayani, salutations to thee, I have entered thy mouth, now I go to seek out Vaidehi. Thy boon has been hcmoured I" Seeing **HANUMAN** emerging from her mouth like the mooo from the mouth of Rahu, that goddess, assuming her own form, said to the monkey : .. Go, O Best of Monlreys ! Accomplish thy mission. Thou hast done well, O Friend! Now restore **SITA** to the JDagnani mous Ragbava ! " Seeing this third supremely difficult feat accomplished by salty waves. Seeing that monster, the Son of the Wind-god, reflected :-' This is without doubt that creature of wonderful form, possessed of exceeding power, given ro securing its prey the sea and the lands bordering it and the growing on its shores as also the mouths of the ocean's consortS.' Gazing down on his own body which resembled a great cloud covering the sky that self-contained monkey reflected : " Ob serving mine immense stature and the rapidity of my

flight the demons will be seized with curiosity concerning me." Thinking thus, in his great prudence, be contracted his body, which was the size of a mountain and assumed his ordinary form as one whose wits have been scattered resumes his normal state. Abandoning his gigantic dimensions, be took on his native form, as did **VISHNU**, the depriver of Bali's power, when be made the three strides. Constantly mindful of his mission, **HANUMAN**, who was able to assume various graceful forms, having crossed the sea, a feat not to be accomplished by any other, reduced his body to its former size. Thereafter that high-souled One, resembling a cloudy pavilion, alighted on the summit of the glorious mountain Samva, of many splendid peaks which was covered with Ketaks, Uddalaks and Narikela trees. Reaching the shore of the sea, the monkey beholding Lanks on the top of the foremost of mountains, descended, having assumed his native form, causing agitation among the deer and birds. Through his valour having traversed the ocean heaving with waves and abounding in Danavas and Pannagas, **HANUMAN**, aligbong on the further shore, beheld Lanks which resembled the city of Amaravati.

CHAPTER 2

Hanuman's arrival in Lanka

the sea and the lands bordering it and the growing on its shores as also the mouths of the ocean's consortS.' Gazing down on his own body which resembled a great cloud covering the sky that self-contained monkey reflected : " Ob serving mine immense stature and the rapidity of my flight the demons will be seized with curiosity concerning me." Thinking thus, in his great prudence, be contracted his body, which was

the size of a mountain and assumed his ordinary form as one whose wits have been scattered resumes his normal state. Abandoning his gigantic dimensions, be took on his native form, as did **VISHNU**, the depriver of Bali's power, when be made the three strides. Constantly mindful of his mission, **HANUMAN**, who was able to assume various graceful forms, having crossed the sea, a feat not to be accomplished by any other, reduced his body to its former size. Thereafter that high-souled One, resembling a cloudy pavilion, alighted on the summit of the glorious mountain Samva, of many splendid peaks which was covered with Ketaks, Uddalaks and Narikela trees. Reaching the shore of the sea, the monkey beholding Lanks on the top of the foremost of mountains, descended, having assumed his native form, causing agitation among the deer and birds. Through his valour having traversed the ocean heaving with waves and abounding in Danavas and Pannagas, **HANUMAN**, aligbong on the further shore, beheld Lanks which resembled the city of Amaravati. Lanka and that ape endowed with great prowess was covered by a shower of blossom that fell from the trees on every side, nor did that fortUnate monkey, who had just traversed many hundreds of miles of sea without pausing for breath, experience any fatigue. ' I am able to journey many hundreds of miles, what then is this ocean measuring four hundred miles only ? ' Thus think ing, that foremost of monkeys, endowed with great energy, turned quickly towards Lanka, having crossed the mighty ocean and he passed between green fields and dense thickets fragrant with the scent of honey and traversed the mountainous district covered with trees and blossoming woods. Stationing himself there, the Son of the Wind-god beheld forests and groves and Lanka itself perched on the summit of the mountain. Sarala, Karnikara, Kharjura trees in full flower with the balmy Priyala, Muchulinda, Kutaja, Ketaka and Priyaugu trees heavy with scent; Nipa,

Saptachchada, Asana, Kovidara and Karavira trees laden with buds and flowers, whose crests, waving in the wind abounded with birds, were seen by him and pouds filled with swans and waterfowl and carpeted with white and blue lotuses; flower gardens with ornamental fountains and marvellous parks planted with every kind of tree which yielded fruit and flowers in every season. Drawing nearer to Lanka, which was protected by **RAVANA**, surrounded by a moat embellished with blue and white lotuses, the auspicious **HANUMAN** noted that a strong guard had been placed round it since **SITA**'s abduction; and demons with for midable bOws ranged it on every side and that great and mar vellous city was encircled by a golden wall, its buildings as high as mountains, resembling autumn clouds. The main highways were lined with tall white buildings with hundreds of turrets decorated with flying pennants and banners. Most wonderful, with its golden archways festooned with climb ing plants, the city of Lanka appeared to **HANUMAN** to be like the city of the Gods. Builr on the summit of a mountain, with its palaces of dazzling white; it resembled an aerial city. Con strucred by Vishwakarma and ruled by the Lord of the Titans himself, it seemed to that monkey to be suspended in the sky with its ramparts as the thighs, the stretches of water and woods, z the raiment, Shataghnis and spears the hair, the t=aces the diadem, lanka resembled a woman, a creation of Vishwakarma's thought. Reaching the northern gate resembling Mount Kailasha, which seemed to cleave the skies and support the firmament with its splendid lofty towers and, observing that city thronged with ferocious titans, like a cavern full of venomous snakes, protected by the ocean and, recollecting that terrible adversaty, **RAVANA**, the monkey reflected : ' Even should the mighty armed Raghava succeed in reaching this dread and impregnable city protected by **RAVANA**, what could he do ? It is not possible to enter into negotiations with these demons nor could

one win them over by bribes nor succeed in sowing dissension among them nor overcome them in fight. Among the monkeys, only four have power to reach this place-Bali's son, Nila, the sagacious **SUGRIVA**, and I. But first let me ascertain if Vaidehi still lives or no; after seeing **JANAKA**'s daughter, I shall consider these matters further.' Then that elephant among monkeys, stationed on the summit of the mountain, bethought himself how he could discover **SITA**, the delight of **RAMA**. ' In this shape I shall not be able to enter the city guarded by valiant and ferocious demons nor outwit those warriors full of courage, energy and prowess. In order to find Janaki, I must enter the city by night at a favourable moment, in a form which will not attract attention so that I may carry through this great enterprise.' Beholding that city, inaccessible even to the Gods and *Asuras*, **HANUMAN**, sighing deeply, reflected within himself: ' How can I succeed in finding Maithili, the daughter of **JANAKA**, without being discovered by the perfidious **RAVANA**, Lord of the Demons ? How may the work of **RAMA**, who is cognisant of the Self, not be brought to nought? How may I see the daughter of **JANAKA** alone and in secret? Undertakings fail in the face of hindrances raised by time and place or through the fault of an incompetent messenger, as darkness is dispelled by the rising sun. When it concerns that which should be undertaken or avoided, the best laid plans may come to nought through the heedlessness of a messenger nor do they appear in all their splendour ; a pre sumptuous messenger may spoil alii ' How shall I act so that there shall be no incompetence on my part ? How may my crossing of the ocean bear fruit ? If I am discovered by the demons, the project which the sagaci ous **RAMA** has formed, who desires the destruction of **RAVANA**, will miscarry. Even if I assume the form of a demon I cannot remain here long without being discovered by them, how much less in some other shape. Even the wind is not able to

circulate here unrecognized, I deem. Nothing escapes the vigilance of these formidable titans. If I remain here in my native form, I shall be courting disaster and the purpose of my master will be frustrated, therefore, reducing my size, I shall enter Lanka as a monkey in order to carry through **RAMA**'s design. Entering this inaccessible city by night, I shall penetrate into every dwell ing in order to find **JANAKA**'s daughter.' Having thus resolved, **HANUMAN**, eager to find Vaidehi, waited for the sun to set. When the day's orb had sunk behind the Asta Mountain, Maruti reduced his body to the size of a cat, extraordinary to behold and, in the dusk, the mighry **HANUMAN**, springing up, entered that marvellous city traversed by wide streetS with rows of houses adorned \\ith golden pillars and balconies, which lent it the appearance of a city of the Gandharvas. Then he beheld that capital containing seven and eight storied buildings with marble fioors iulaid with golden mosaic and golden archways, lending it a great brilliance and, seeing the unimaginable splendour of Lanka, in his eagerness to find Vaidchi, he experienced both sadness and delight. With its garlands of palaces rivalling each other in whiteness and the arches interlaced with gold of great price, that magnifi cent city protected by **RAVANA** was encircled by intrepid warriors of great prowess. And the moon at its full with its flocks of stars seemed to be ministering to **HANUMAN** and, with its myriad rays, filled the worlds with its light. Then that hero among monkeys gazed on the moon shining like a conch-shell, white as milk or a lotus stalk that, floating all luminous in space, resembled a swan swimming on a lake.

CHAPTER 3

He enters the City

HAVING rested on Mount Samva of lofty summits, that resembled a great cloud, **HANUMAN**, the son of Maruta, that lion among monkeys, confident of his own strength, entered Lanka by night, with its wealth of ravishing groves and waters, guarded by **RAVANA** ; that enchanting city with its dazzling palaces re sembling autumn clouds, wbere the sound of the sea could be heard, the breezes of which it inhaled day and night. Prosperous, surrounded by great forces, resembling Vitapavati with its white gates and decorated arches, protected by infuri ated elephants, splendid as Bhogavati filled with huge serpents, similar to the city of **INDRA**, embellished by hosts of stars, resounding to the clamour of blustering winds, encircled by a golden mmpart, re-echoing to the pealing of innumerable bells and adorned with banners, that city was approached by **HANUMAN** in exaltation, his heart full of wonder. And he surveyed it on every side, with its golden gates, the lintels of emerald and the pavements studded with pearls, crystal and gems ; with its steps inlaid with precious stones, and floors of lapis lazuli, the grilles of refined gold and parapets of silver ; tbe stairways of crystal that, free from dust, were possessed of emerald treads. And there were charming rooms, which, on account of their elegance, seemed to be built in tbe air. Tbe cries of curlews and peacocks could be heard and geese frequented that place whilst swans floated majestically on the lakes ; everywhere tbe sound of the beating af drums and tbe tinkling of ornaments resounded and, beholding Lanka that resembled Vasvakara and seemed to be built in spaee, the monkey was filled with mpture. Gazing on that splendid city belonging to the Lord of tbe Titans, that no other surpassed in opulence, the sagacious **HANUMAN** reftected :-'This capital, protected by **RAVANA**'s warriors is not to be subdued by force and is only accessible to Kumuda, **ANGADA** and that mighty monkey, Susbeaa or 342 Mainda and Dvivida or the offspring of Vivaswata or the monkey

Kushaparva or Riksbya, that foremost of monkeys, or myself.' Thereafter, recollecting the valour of the long-armed Raghava and the prowess of Laksbmana, the confidence of that monkey was restored. And that mighty monkey surveyed Lanka, the capital of the Lord of the Titans, that had the sea as her raiment, cow sheds and stables for her pendants, the armouries her breasts, decked out like a woman, where darkness was dispelled by the bright light of torches and the gleaming of the stars. And as that tiger among monkeys, son of the great Wind-god, entered the city, the Deity who presided over the capital pro tected by **RAVANA**, she of monstrous aspect, rose up and barred the way of that heroic son of Vayu. Emitting a great roar, she challenged the offspring of the Wind-god, saying : " O Dweller of the Forest, who art thou and for what purpose hast thou come hither ? Answer trutbfully if thou dost value thy life ! Under no pretext wilt thou be able to obtain entry into this Lanka protected by the forces of **RAVANA**, which patrol it on every side., Then the valiant **HANUMAN** answered her, who stood before him, saying :-" I sball tell thee all about that on which thou questioneth me anon but say first who thou art in this hideous form and why thou dost admonish me in anger, O Irascible One." Hearing **HANUMAN**'s words, the Goddess of Lanka, able to change her shape at will, waxed wrath and in harsh tones addressed the son of the Wind-god, saying : " Obedient to the mandate of the magnanimous **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, I guard the city. None may pass me, yet if any should contrive to enter here, be will soon fall under my blows, deprived of his life breaths. I am the city of Lanka itself, and whatever beride I sball remain true to the words I have uttered I " **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, the foremost of monkeys, stood motiooless like a rock and beholding her in the form of a woman, that lion among monkeys, endowed with intelligence and courage, spoke to her thus : 343 " I wish to behold this city with its

turrets, walls and arches, and have come hither for this purpose. Great is my desire to see it and explore its woods, groves and gardens, as also its great buildings.” Hearing these words, the presiding Deity of Lanka, who was able to change her form at will, was still further provoked and answered in anger : " O Insensate One, O Last of the Monkeys I without over coming me, thou canst not behold this city to-day, which is ruled over by the King of the Titans.” Then that lion among forest dwellers replied to that female ranger of the night, saying:-" After viewing the city, O Auspicious One, I shall return from whence I came.” On this, Lanka emirted a tetrible ety and struck that excellent monkey with the palm of her hand. Under the force of bet blow, the valiant Son of Maruta let out a roar and closing the fingetS of his left hand, pushed her away with his fist. Reflect ing’ She is a woman’ he controlled his anger, nevettheless the demon fell to the ground instantly, her face distoned and, seeing her lying on the earth, **HANUMAN**, who was full of courage and nobility, had compassion on her, she being but a woman. Thetenpon, Lanka, exceedingly agitared, addressed that monkey in low and faltering accents, saying : " O Mighty-armed One, have pity on me ! Spare me, O Best of Monkeys I Those endowed with strength and prowess, stay their hand betimes ! O Thou of great might, thou hast oveteome me by thy valour ! Hear the following truth from me which was proclaimed by Swyambhu who prophesied saying : ' In the hour that a monkey overcomes thee by force, the titans will cease to be invincible.' " That time, fixed by Swyambhu has come, as is shown by thy presence here to-day ! The truth ordained by the Self· create is unalterable. The destruction of the unrighteous King **RAVANA** together with all the titans is imminent, in consequence of the abduction of **SITA**. Therefore, O Best of Monkeys, do thou enter this city, which is protected by **RAVANA**, and accom plish all thou desirest. Enteting this splendid city, protected by

the Lord of the Titans, which is doomed, go about freely whete soever thou wilt, in search of the chaste daughter of Janak."

CHAPTER 4

He observes the City and its Inhabitants

BY his valour, the mighty **HANUMAN**, foremost of monkeys, having triumphed over Lanka, that splendid city, able to change her form at will, without passing thtough the gate, leapt over the wall and, by night, penetrated into the centre of the capital. **HANUMAN**, faithful to the interests of the King of the Monkeys, having found his way into that city, thus placed his left foot on the heads of his foes ; and that excellent son of Maruta, entering by night, proceeded along the royal highway strewn with fiowers and continued to advance through that enchanting capital where the sound of musical instruments blended with laughter. That magnificent city with its innumerable dwellings bearing the mark of the mace and the goad, with windows of diamond, resembled the sky adorned with clouds. Lanka belonging to the titans, with its opulent mansions like white clouds, adorned with lotuses and swastikas, hung with garlands, highly decorated, was viewed by **HANUMAN** with delight, who ranged it on **RAMA**'s behalf and in the interests of **SUGRIVA**. That illustrious monkey passing from house to house, observed the many dwellings of varying forms, on evety side and listened to the melodious chanting in triple modulation, of women sick with love, who resembled celestial nymphs. He heard the tinkling of their girdles and the clashing of their anklets, as they ascended the stairways of those dwellings belonging to the great Ones, and here and there the sound of clapping of hands and the clicking of castanets. He heard also the intoning of sacred

formulas in the dwellings of the titans and the recitation of those occupied in the study of the Veda. He also saw titans who were singing the praises of **RAVANA** in 8 loud voice, 8 great company of them being stationed on the royal highway which they obstructed ; and he observed 8large concourse of spies in the central courtyard, who had been initiated, some with matted locks, some shaven, some wearing deerskins and some stark naked, bearing handfuls of darbha grass, braziers, picks, clubs and staves, and others in rags, who had only a single eye or ear or breast which twitched ; and some were dwarfs, hideous to behold ; and there were bowmen, swordsmen and warriors bearing clubs and iron bars or efful gent in curious armour ; some were neither exceedingly fat nor too lean nor unduly tall nor short nor extremely fair nor dark nor humpbacked nor dwarfed ; some were deformed, some handsome, some distinguished and there were also standard bearers and some who carried flags and every kind of weapon. And **HANUMAN** observed that some were armed with spears, darts, harpoons, arrows, slings and other weapons and many ranging about at will wore garlands and were daubed with paste, sprinkled \\ith perfume, clothed in rich stuffs and adorned with magnificent jewels ; some of these mighty warriors were furnished with javelins and maces and hundreds and thousands of them were garrisoned in the central courtyard, engaged in guarding the private apartments with vigilance by order of their king. And he saw the famous palace of the Lord of the Titans, built on the summit of tbe mountain, with golden arched gate ways, surrounded by a moat, embellished with pale lotuses and completely encircled by a rampart, reserobling heaven itself; and it was marvellous, resonant with pleasant sounds and filled with the neighing of superb steeds and well-bred beasts and the noise of chariots and elephants; and there were four tusked elephants reserobling great clouds and many herds of deer. Then the monkey entered that

palace protected by the Titan King, guarded by thousands of mighty Yatudhanas, the portals of which were richly decorated witb beasts and birds and he penetrated to the inner apartment encircled wirh walls of Hema and Jambunada gold, its ceilings adorned with pearls and gems of great price and pervaded by the fragrance of aloe and sandalwood. CRAPTBR 5 **HANUMAN** ranges tlu City without finding **SITA** TRBN the fortunate **HANUMAN** beheld that brilliant orb of the night in the midst of the stars covering all beings with its light, like a bull inflamed with desire in the midst of a herd of cows, and that heroic monkey gazed on that moon, floating in the sty, white as the sheen of a conch or a lotus stalk, that star of cool ing rays which destroys the sorrows of the world, draws up the tides and sheds its light on all beings. That brightness which shines on the summit of Mount Mandata and at dusk sparkles on the sea, as well as on the lotuses of the lakes, now blazed from the face of that nocturnal planet. Like a swan on its silvery nest or a lion in a cave of the Mandata Mountain or a warrior on a proud elephant so was the splendour of the moon in the heavens. Like a humpbacked buffalo with pointed horns or the lofty Mountain Shveta with its high peaks or an elephant with gold-encircled tusks, so did the moon appear with its clearly defined prominence. Just as the great orb of the sun dissolves the ice and frost on muddy pools so was darkness dispelled by the brilliance of the auspicious moon, whose symbol is the hare, so that even the dark patches on its surface appeared bright. Like the King of Beasts issuing from his cave or the lord of elephants entering the deep woods or a sovereign of men ranging his dominions so did the moon appear in its full splendour. The brightness of its rising had dispelled the night, accentuat ing the swarthiness of the titans, those eaters of flesh, and awakening thoughts of love in the lover. Women, whose melodious voices had charmed the ear, having disported themselves, now slept in

the arms of their lorda, whilst titans of strange and terrible deeds went forth marauding. And the sagacious **HANUMAN** beheld mansions where intoxica tion and folly reigned, where chariots, horses and golden seats were seen everywhere in luxurious and warlike abundance He beheld titans in violent debate, raising their great arms, discoursing wildly, railing at each other and eJtchanging

CHAPTER 5

He ranges the City without finding Sita

CRAPTBR 5 **HANUMAN** ranges tlu City without finding **SITA** TRBN the fortunate **HANUMAN** beheld that brilliant orb of the night in the midst of the stars covering all beings with its light, like a bull inflamed with desire in the midst of a herd of cows, and that heroic monkey gazed on that moon, floating in the sty, white as the sheen of a conch or a lotus stalk, that star of cool ing rays which destroys the sorrows of the world, draws up the tides and sheds its light on all beings. That brightness which shines on the summit of Mount Mandata and at dusk sparkles on the sea, as well as on the lotuses of the lakes, now blazed from the face of that nocturnal planet. Like a swan on its silvery nest or a lion in a cave of the Mandata Mountain or a warrior on a proud elephant so was the splendour of the moon in the heavens. Like a humpbacked buffalo with pointed horns or the lofty Mountain Shveta with its high peaks or an elephant with gold-encircled tusks, so did the moon appear with its clearly defined prominence. Just as the great orb of the sun dissolves the ice and frost on muddy pools so was darkness dispelled by the brilliance of the auspicious moon, whose symbol is the hare, so that even the dark patches on its surface appeared bright. Like the King of Beasts issuing

from his cave or the lord of elephants entering the deep woods or a sovereign of men ranging his dominions so did the moon appear in its full splendour. The brightness of its rising had dispelled the night, accentuat ing the swarthiness of the titans, those eaters of flesh, and awakening thoughts of love in the lover. Women, whose melodious voices had charmed the ear, having disported themselves, now slept in the arms of their lorda, whilst titans of strange and terrible deeds went forth marauding. And the sagacious **HANUMAN** beheld mansions where intoxica tion and folly reigned, where chariots, horses and golden seats were seen everywhere in luxurious and warlike abundance He beheld titans in violent debate, raising their great arms, discoursing wildly, railing at each other and eJtchanging 347 aaimonious words ; and some were striking their breasts and brandishing great bows, whilst others adjusted their attire or embraced their consorts. And Hanwnan observed courtesans performing their toilet, whilst others slept and incomparably lovely women laughing or frowning in anger. Here gigantic elephants trumpered, there worship was being performed, whilst warriors were utter ing threats, so that the city resembled a lake filled with angry serpents. And he beheld in that place, persons full of intelligence, able debators, pious men, leaders of fashion and observers of ritual, and beholding those magnificent beings, endowed with every attribute in accord with their nature, **HANUMAN** was delighted ; such was their splendour, that even those who were ugly, appeared fair. And he saw their consortS, full of nobility and of great beaury, worthy of adornment, like unto stars in the excellence of their conduct, who were filled with affection for their protectors, some casting tender glances, others exchanging tokens and some drinking. And by night, Hanwnan observed lovely women being em braced by their paramours, affecting modesty or passion, like birds sporting with their mates, whilst others, in their

homes, lay peacefully on the breasts of their lords, full of tenderness, and faithful to their conjugal duty. Some, lying without raiment, deserted by their lovers, bad the radiance of gold and were marvellously beautiful with their golden skins, graceful limbs and complexions like the moonlight. And Hanwnan saw other women in their homes experiencing the height of joy with their lords, full of delight, decked with flowers, charming the hearts of their consort<. with their beauty. These lovely women of radiant countenance, resembling the moon, possessing marvellous eyes with sweeping lashes and slant ing lids and adorned with innumerable jewels, seemed to **HANUMAN** to resemble flashes of lightning. But of the nobly-born **SITA**, offspring of a royal House, fixed in the path of virtue, resembling a delicate flowering creeper or the frail Sadhujata plant, sprung from the mind of **BRAHMA** Himself, he could find no uace. **SITA**, established in the path 348 of chastity, her gaze ever fixed on **RAMA**, ever absorbed in his contemplation, his very mind and heart itself, exalted above all women, a prey to burning grief, her bosom wet with she who was formerly adorned with priceless ornaments, Sits with her charming lashes and enchanting throat, resembling a blue-necked peahen disporting itself in the woods, or the blurred outline of the moon or a golden ingot covered with dust or a scar left by a wound or a golden arrow snapped by the wind. And that monkey, after his long search, not finding Sits, conson of that lord of men, **RAMA**, the foremost of those skilled in speech, was overcome with grief and bereft of aU courage.

CHAPTER 6

He explores Ravana's Palace

Of Lanka, and that auspicious one came to the abode of that Lord of the Titans, encircled by a shining wall, sparkling like the sun and guarded by terrible demons, as is a mighty forest by lions. And that foremost of monkeys beheld that marvellous palace with its fretted archways, inlaid with silver and embellished with gold, abounding in splendid couns and gateways, fiUed with the drivers of elephants and indomitable warriors, irresistibly swift horses harnessed to chariots and curious waggons, covered with lion and tiger skins, that were embossed with images of gold and silver and hung with jingling bells. Strewn with precious stones and furnished with rich seats, this was the favourite haunt of the Maharathas and their meeting place. Rare deer and birds of every species and variety abounded here, whilst disciplined sentries proteCted it. Everywhere noble and distinguished women could be seen and the palace was fiUed with the tinkling of their ornaments ; there the fore most of the titans dwelt and it was decorated with royal symbols and ftagrant with sandalwood. Crowded with great beings, like a forest fiUed with lions, resounding to the beating of gongs, 349 rambourines and the blare of conches, it was also the place of worship of the titans, where olfcrings were made at the times of the moon’s change ; sometimes, in fear of Ravaoa, silent as the sea and sometimes resounding like the wsves, tbat vast abode belonging to the mighty Ravaoa wss strewn with precious gems, and tbat great 010Dkey beheld it blazing in. splendour and filled with elephsnts, horses and chariots. 'It is the jewel of Lanka’ reflected tbat illustrious monkey, Hanumao, wandering about the outskirts of the palace and he began to range the dwelliogs of the titans and their gardens, and he bounded into the abode of Prahasta and then plunged courageously into the ps1arc of Mahaparshws; thereafter, tbat mighty monkey entered the residence of Kumbhskama which resembled a mass of clouds and also tbat of Bibishsna ; then in turn he visited the

dwellings of Mahodara, Virupaksha, Vidyujjibhs and Vidyunmala and with a bound he entered the house of Vahudsnshtra and thst of Suka and the intelligent Saraoa. Then the mansions of **INDRAJIT**, Jambumala and Sumala were explored by tbat foremost of monkeys and thereafter he passed on to the abodes of Rashmiketu, Suryasachu and Vajra kaya; and next the olfspring of the Wind-god searched the hsbitatioos of Dhumrakshs, Sampati, the grim Vidyudruna, Phaoa, Vighana and Sukaoabhs, Shakra, Shstba, Kapatba, Hrasvakama, Danshtra and the demon Lomasa, Yudhyonmatta, Matta and the horseman, Dhwsjagriva, Sadin, Vidyujjibhs and Vijibhs, as also tbat of Hastimukha and of Karala, Visbala and Sonitakshs. The illustrious Son of Maruta tbeo searched the dwellings of otber prosperous titans one after the otber, marking their aflluence. And hsviog searched all the residences belonging to those titans in every way, tbat fortunate 010Dkey approached the palace of the king. Then the foremost of OlODkeys observed demon women of menacing looks, prowling outside the apartments where **RAVANA** slept, bearing darts and maces in their hands and equipped with spears and clubs and he beheld innumerable bands of them in the abode of the titan king and gigantic demons brandishing weapons of every kind. He behdd steeds of exceeding swiftness, red, white and black and wonclerfully bred dephaots, vanquishers of hostile tuskers, trained for every 3SO suitable purpose and equal to Airavata himself in conflict and these elephants, the destroyers of hostile armies resembled scurrying clouds or moving hills and their uumpeting was 1i1re the crash of thunder. Then that monkey, the son of the Wind-god, beheld thousands of the titan host in that palace and cars of gold and glittering mail which shone like the rising sun ; he saw also many litters of different shapes, and bowers, picture galleries, gymnasiums, mountains construcred of wood, pavilions and entertainment halls. And

in that palace belonging to **RAVANA**, waa a charm ing edifice as beautiful as the Mandara Mountain and pens for peacocks and banners and flagpoles. Heaps of jewels lay about and a great accumulation of treasure had been brought there by the exploits of those valiant titans so that it resembled the palace of Kuvera. On account of the lustre of those gems and the resplendence of **RAVANA** himself, that palace glittered like the sun with its myriad rays. And that monkey chief beheld couches and seats of gold, and vessels wrought with pearls overflowing with wines,' and the dimensions and maguificence of that place caused it to resemble the mansion of Kama or the abode of Kuvera, and that palace resounded with the tinkling of anklets and girdles, with drums and cymbals and other musical instruments and was thronged with women as lovely as pearls and surrounded by ramparts.

CHAPTER 7

Description of the Aerial Chariot Pushpaka

THEN that mighty monkey continued to explore those dwellings fitted with golden windows, studded with emeralds, resembling a mass of clonds in the rainy season rent by lightoing and tra versed by flocks of cranes. And he beheld varinus halls and buildings stored with conches, bows and weapons of war, furnished with turrets as bigh as hills, and these mansions, con taining treasure of every kind were held in regard by both Gods and titans and were flawless and constructed by **RAVANA** by his own power. Hanumao having scoured the mansions of that Lord of Lanka meticulously furnished with every comfort as if Maya had created them, thereafter visited the palace of that King of *Rakshasas* himself, which surpassed all others and resembled a mass of towering

clouds. Of incomparable loveliness, it seemed as if heaven itself had descended on earth and its beauty was dazzling. Teeming with innumerable gems, trees of every kind covered it with flowers like the summit of a mountain on which snow has fallen; beautiful women served as its ornaments and it shone like a cloud riven by lightning ; such was its splendour that it resembled a marvellous chariot drawn through the skies by ravishing swans. Like the peak of a mountain rich in ore or the firmament adorned by the moon and stars or like clouds of many hues, it glistened with innumerable gems. Artificial rocks made of clay, resembling mountain ranges, planted with counterfeit trees laden with heaps of flowers, fashioned with stamens and leaves could be seen there and improvised dwellings, dazzlingly white, with pools covered with flowering lotuses possessing golden stamens, and diverse groves and ravishing fountains. The monkey gazed on the vast aerial chariot named Pushpaka, which, gleaming like pearl, planed above the highest buildings and contained birds made of emerald, silver and coral and serpents marvellously fahioned of various metals and life-sized horses and birds with charming beaks and wonderful wings which contracted and expanded, their plumage like that of Kama himself, posed on gold and coral flowers ; and there were elephants with tapering trunks, bearing lotus leaves, engaged in Yet that monkey searching that exalted city, protected by the ten-headed **RAVANA**, was unable to find the daughter of **JANAKA**, so highly regarded and deeply aftlicted and who had been con quered by the virtue and valour of her lord. And not finding **JANAKA**'s daughter, despite his investigations and the vigilance of his search, the illustrious **HANUMAN**, who was virtuous and generous of soul, felt a burning anguish take possession of his bean.

CHAPTER 8

Further Description of Pushpaka

fully. Fashioned of plated gold, embeUished with lovely images, regarded by Vishwakarma himself as an incomparable artistic achievement, traveUing in space like a guiding light in the orbit of the sun, it was immeasurably resplendent. No detail of that car had been executed unskilfully, no ornament but appeared to be a jewel of great price nor was there anything surpassed by the chariots of the Gods, every pan being excellently wrought. By the merit of his asceticism and contemplation **RAVANA** had obtained it and it repaired wheresoever its master directed it by the power of his thought. Irresistible and swift as the wind, a source of happiness to those magnanimous beings given to pious deeds, who had reached the peak of prosperity and glory, capable of ranging the firmament, containing many apanments and furnished with innumerable works of art, captivating to the mind, stainless as the autumnal moon, re sembling a mountain with splendid peaks, borne by thousands of demons whose cheeks were graced with earrings, voracious eaters, of large unwinking eyes, who travelled through space with exceeding velocity day and night, that aerial chariot, Pushpaka, splendid to look upon, covered with ftowers, fairer than spring itself, drew the gaze of that Prince of Monkey Warriors.

CHAPTER 9

Hanuman searches the Inner Apartments

WITHIN these precinctS, a magnificent building, remarkable for its spaciousness and splendour, arrested the attention of **HANUMAN**, the son of Maruta ; it was two miles in width, four in length and belonged to the King of the Titans himself. And **HANUMAN**, the slayer of his foes, ranging here and there in search of the Princess of Videha, the large-eyed **SITA**, beheld that goodly residence where the titans dwelt together and he approached the palace of the king, surrounded by three and four tusked elephants and guarded in its entire length by warriors bearing weapons m their hands. He beheld that dwelling, thronged with titan women, consorts of **RAVANA**, and also the daughters of kings who had been forcibly carried away by him, which resembled an ocean teeming with crocodiles, sharks, whales, enormous fish and serpents, agitated by the force of the tempest. And the splendour of tiP abode of Vaish ravaoa, Chandra and Harivahana was reflected in Ravaoa's palace, a splendour that was unequalled and changeless and the prosperity of the residences of Kuvera, **YAMA** and **VARUNA** were rivalled, nay surpassed, by that of the titan's abode. In the centre of that palace, the offspring of the wind, saw yet another edifice, well constructed and furnished with in numerable grilles. Formerly created in heaven at Brahms's wish by Vishwakarma, that noble car embellished with gems was called Pushpaka, which Kuvera had acquired by pro longed austerities and of which the King of the Titans, having vanquished him by his might, took possession. And that mighty monkey ascended that splendid car, containing figures of wolves made of Kartasvara and Hiranya gold and adorned with slender pillars of dazzling splendour, furnished with private rooms and gleaming pavilions, resemblitg the Meru and Mandata Mountains, licking the skies and blazing like tbe suo. 354 This masterpiece of Vishwakarma had many golden stairways and a superb and marvellous ceiling ; it

contained balconies and galleries of deep blue sapphire and other precious gems ; the ftoors were encrusted with rare pearls which rendered it blindingly beautiful ; built of red sandalwood and shining like pure gold, it resembled the rising sun and subtle perfumes rose therefrom. That mighty monkey, stationed there, smelt the rich odour of wines and viands which rose on every side, and those ambrosial and penetrating fumes seemed to him to be the embodiment of Anila herself and were inhaled by him as coming from an intimate friend, and that aroma seemed to say to **HANUMAN** " Come hither where **RAVANA** is to be found ", and he proceeded further and beheld a vast and glorious hall. Now that spacious apartment was very dear to **RAVANA**, who looked on it as a greatly cherished woman and its jewelled stairways and galleries of pure gold gave it a dazzling appear ance, the ftoors being of crystal with inlay of ivory, pearl, diamond, coral, silver and gold. It was adorned with many jewelled pilasters, which were symetrical, straight, elegant and inlaid with exceeding artistry and it was supported by tall pillars of equal size resembling wings so that the building seemed to be ftying in the air and the ftoor was covered by a carpet, wide and four-cornered like the earth' and patterned as with varied countries, kingdoms and dwellings, and there the song of birds could be heard and it was pervaded by a celestial fragrance. Hung with rich tapestries, darkened by incense fumes, spotless and pure as a swan, garlanded with leaves and ftowers lending it the resemblance of Kamadhenu, bringing delight to the heart, colour to the cheek, giving birth to prosperity and banishing all sorrow, the apartments of the King of the Titans gratified every sense, as if it were a mother. Entering that abode protected by **RAVANA**, **HANUMAN** asked himself: " Can this be paradise or the region of the Gods or lndra's capital or the state of supreme bliss ? " and he examined the golden lamps, which resembled gamblers -· absorbed in

their dice, who, defeated by their opponents, are plunged in thought, and **HANUMAN** perceived that the brilli ance of the lamps and the lustre of **RAVANA** and the splendour of the decorations, illumined the appartment. He beheld innumerabl women, lying on the rugs, attired in every kind of raiment with wreaths on their heads, who, under the inlluence of wine, had fallen asleep, having ceased to disport themselves, half the night being spent. And, on account of the silence, that great company, decked with orna ments, the tinkling of which was no longer audible, resembled a vast lake filled with lotuses where the sound of the swans and the bumming of bees has ceased. Maruti gazed on the faces of those lovely women with eyes and mouths shut fast, emitting a flower-like fragrance and they resembled lotuses rhat, folding their petals at evening, wait for the dawn to open them once more or like water Jilies which the bees, intoxicated with Jove, visit continually. With just cause did that noble and mighty monkey compare them nymphoeae, for the harem was bright with their radiance, as the starry heavens on a serene autumnal night and, in their midst, the King of the Titans blazed like a fair moon, encircled by attendant stars. Then that monkey said to himself: " Those planets that have fallen from the firmament, their merit exhausted, are all re-united here", and in sooth, those women in their grace, beauty and magnificence shone like dazzling meteors. Some Jay wrapped in slumber into which they had fallen in the midst of dancing and feasting, their hair and crowns in disarray, their omameots scattered here and there ; others amongst those lovely beings had lost their anklets and the tilaka mark on their foreheads had been effaced ; some had allowed their garlands to fall aside, some had broken their pearls and, their raiment in disorder, the!f girdles loosened, resembled disburdened mules, whilst others, bereft of ear rings, their garlands tom and crushed, looked like flowering creepers

trodden under foot by great elephants in the forest. Sometimes the loosened pearls, like the scintillating rays of the moon, Jay between the women's breasts like sleeping swans, whilst chains of emerald resembled drakes or those of gold 356 looked like Chakravata birds. And those women were like unto rivers, their thighs being the banks, where swans, geese and other waterfowl disport themselves or, sleeping, resembled streams, the golden bells on their girdles, the ripples, their faces, the lotuses, their amorous desires, the crocodiles, their grace, the banks. On their tender limbs the marks of the ornaments looked like bees, whilst the veils of others, rising and falling with their breath, fluttered gracefully before their faces like bright streamers of many-coloured yarn and the earrings of others vibrated gently with the circulating air. Their subtly perfumed breath impregnated with the aroma of sugar-sweetened wines which they had drunk, caused **RAVANA** delight and, some of his consorts, in dream, savoured the lips of their rivals again and again, deeming them to be the king's. Passionately devoted to their lord, these lovely women, no longer mistresses of themselves, offered their companions marks of their affection. Some, in their rich attire, slept leaning on their arms laden with bracelets, some rested on their companions' breasts, some on their laps, their bosoms, their thighs and backs, and under the influence of wine, cling ing amorously to one another, those women of slender waist, slept, their arms intertwined. Those groups of damsels enfolding one another, resembled a garland of flowers visited by amorous bees or, like creepers opening to the caress of the vernal breeze tbat intertwine, forming clusters of blossom or the interlocking branches of great forest trees full of swarming bees ; thus seemed this gathering of **RAVANA**'s consorts. And on account of the proximity of these women, sleeping close to one another, it was impossible to distinguish to whom the

jewels, veils and garlands covering their limbs, belonged. While **RAVANA** slept, the beauty of those women resembling golden lamps, seemed to watch over him and there were daughters of Rajarishis, Giants and Celestial Beings, who had become his consorts and tbat war-like titan king had acquired them after subduing their relatives, though some had followed him of theu own accord from love. None had been forcibly borne away who had not been attracted by his prowess and 3S7 qualities and none had belonged to another, save the daughter of Janala whose heart was set on **RAMA** ; none was devoid of nobility, beauty, intelligence and gtace and each was the object of **RAVANA**'s desire. Then the lord of the monkeys, endowed with virtue, reflected: " If the consort of Raghava were as one of these women, the King of the Titans wou!d indeed be blessed to-day, but **SITA** is far superior to them on account of her great qualities, which is evident, since for her sake that mighty monarch of Lanka has committed this wicked deed.

CHAPTER 10

He perceives Ravana in the midst of his Wives

With couches of emerald mounted on ivory and gold and coveted with rich and priceless rugs. And he saw a white canopy, in that place, festooned with celestial garlands that gleamed like the moon. And he observed a magnificent couch inlaid with gold, flaming like fire and bearing garlands of Ashoka Bowers, around which figures were waving fans and fro, crearing cooling draughts and perfumes of every kind wreatbed it with delicious fragrance. Spread with soft woollen cloths and decked with chaplets of Bowers, it was adorned on every side. And tbere, resembling a thundercloud, the Sovereign of the Titans lay with

bright and Bashing earrings, reddened eyes, golden raiment, his limbs smeared with saffron and fragtant sandal, like a purple cloud at dusk, riven with lighrning. Adorned with celestial ornaments, magnificent to behold, able to change his form at will, as he lay asleep he resembled tbe Mandara Mountain with its trees, grnves and bushes without number. Having ceased from dalliance, decked with priceless ornaments, the delight of the titans and dear to all the titan women, his feasting over he lay sleeping on the golden bed, breathing like a serpent. And **HANUMAN**, filled with awe, shrank back in fear, and stationed himself on a landing of the stairway, pressing himself against the inner wall ; then that courageous monkey looked down on that lion among titans lying there in a drunken stupor. And as the King of the Titans lay sleeping, his luxurious couch resembled a great watetfall by which a mighty tusker in mustha is resting. **HANUMAN** looked down on the two outstretched arms, encircled with golden bracelets of that gigantic monarch, resembling the standards of lndra, which had formerly been pierced in combat by the sharp tusks of Airavata and tom by the discus of **VISHNU** and the great shoulders that had been lacerated by lndta's mace. Those vast arms, firmly set with well-formed, powerful muscles and thumbs and nails bearing auspicious marks, rings coverings the fingers, those arms, thick as clubs, rounded like the trunk of an elephant, that lay along the opulent couch as it were two snakes with five heads, smeared with sandal of the colour of hare's blood, fresh, extremely rare and of a delicious fragrance massaged by women of sovereign beauty with precious unguents, those arms that had caused Y akshas, Panna gas, Gandharvas *Devas* and Danavas to cry out in terror, that monkey gazed upon as they lay along the couch, like two great and angry reptiles sleeping in a cave on the Mandara Mountain. And with his two great arms, the Chief of the Titans resembled Mount Mandara with its twin

peaks. The scent of the Mango or Punnaga tree, impregnated with that of the Bakula blended with the savour of viands and the aroma of wine, issued from the vast mouth of that Monarch of Titans during sleep and seemed to fill the whole apartment. His diadem was decorated with rubies and precious stones, gleaming with gold and he was adorned with earrings, smeared with red sandal, his well-developed chest bearing a string of pearls ; a white silken cloth, fiung aside, revealed his scars and he was covered with a costly yellow coverlet. Like a mass of light he lay, hissing like a serpent so that it seemed as if an elephant lay asleep in the deep waters of the Ganges. Four lamps, set on golden pillars, cast their light to the four aides as lightning reveals the surface of a mass of cloud. 3S9 Then that foremost of monkeys saw the wives of that great monarch of the titans sleeping at the foot of their lord, their faces bright as the moon, wearing precious earrings and fresh garlands. Skilled musicians and dancers, they lay in the arms and on the breast of that **INDRA** of Titans, artired in beautiful raiment, and the monkey gazed on those women wearing golden bracelets and earrings set with diamonds and emeralds, their faces fair as the moon, illumined by the reflection of their glittering earrings, lighting the hall as stars illumine the firmament. Overcome with drinking and amorous dalliance, those slender waisted wives of the King of the Demons lay fast asleep where they had been seated ; and one, possessed of lovely limbs, skilled in the dance, slept there, wearied by her graceful motions, whilst another, embracing her Vina, looked like a lotus that had fallen into the water clinging to a passing raft ; a third dark eyed maiden held her Mankuka in her lap, as a youthful woman would her child, while yet another with graceful limbs and shapely bosom, slept with her tambourine pressed to her heart, as one embraces his love after a long absence. This one, with eyes like !otoses had fallen asleep clasping her Vina, as a beautiful girl enfolds

her beloved one affectionately in her arms. Here one of restrained sense lay beside her lute which she encircled with her arms, resembling one affianced lying by the side of her chosen one ; there, one whose limbs gleamed like Kanada gold, dimpled, ravishing, her eyes heavy with wine, though sleeping, was striking her dtum. One of slender waist and flawless beauty, worn out by feasting, slept with a cymbal in her lap and yet another held a Dindima and had another slung on her back so that she looked like a young mother with her husband and her child. One, with eyes large as lotus petals, clasping her Adambara tighdy to her breast, had fallen asleep under the influence of wine and yet another, her water vessel overturned, resembled a flowery wreath that is sprinkled with water to keep it green ; another, falling under the sway of sleep, with her hands covered her breasts resembling two golden cups, and one, with eyes like lotuses, fair as the moon, had fallen asleep embracing one of her companions possessed of lovely hips. Peerlessly beautiful women, clasping musical 36o SJUN;DARA *KANDA* instruments, pressed them to their bosoms like lovers their chosen ones. And that monkey beheld a marvellous bed set apart, on which one of these lovely women lay, richly attired, adorned with pearls and precious gems, who seemed to lend radiaoce to that magnificent apartment. Qad io silk bright as Kanaka gold, **RAVANA**'s favourite Queen, **MANDODARI** by name, that slender-waisted woman of gracious features, lay fast asleep, adorned with ornaments and, seeing her, that offspring of the Wiod-God said to himself: " This one, endowed with the wealth of youth aod beauty may be **SITA** " and he rejoiced exceediogly. Thereafter, io his delight, he leapt into the air, waving his tail and manifestiog his joy by his aotics, frolicking, siogiog, climbiog up the pillars from whence he dropped to the ground, thus demoustrating his monkey nature. CHAPTER II Description of the BantJUBU"'f Hall THEN that ntighty

monkey disntissed this thought concemiog **SITA** and began to reflect funher : " Separated from **RAMA**, that lovely womao would be unable to sleep, eat or adorn herself nor would she subntit to any other, were he King of the Celestial himself, for **RAMA** has no equal even among the Gode; this is therefore some other." In this conviction, that foremost of monkeys began to search the banquetiog hall anew, anxious to discover **SITA**. Leaning on their tambourioes, drums and Celikas, or stretched on luxurious couches, all these women slept soundly, worn out with playing, sioging, dancing and drinking. And that leader of monkeys saw thousands of women beautifully adorned, some having fallen asleep discussiog each other's charms, some debating the art of singing, some skilled in dis cerniog time and place, discoursmg on circumstance, some given over to merriment and, elsewhere also, he observed beautiful and youthful women who had fallen asleep talking of

CHAPTER 11

Description of the Banqueting Hall

SJUN;DARA *KANDA* instruments, pressed them to their bosoms like lovers their chosen ones. And that monkey beheld a marvellous bed set apart, on which one of these lovely women lay, richly attired, adorned with pearls and precious gems, who seemed to lend radiaoce to that magnificent apartment. Qad io silk bright as Kanaka gold, **RAVANA**'s favourite Queen, **MANDODARI** by name, that slender-waisted woman of gracious features, lay fast asleep, adorned with ornaments and, seeing her, that offspring of the Wiod-God said to himself: " This one, endowed with the wealth of youth aod beauty may be **SITA** " and he rejoiced exceediogly. Thereafter, io his delight, he leapt into the air, waving his

tail and manifestiog his joy by his aotics, frolicking, siogiog, climbiog up the pillars from whence he dropped to the ground, thus demoustrating his monkey nature. CHAPTER II Description of the BantJUBU"'f Hall THEN that ntighty monkey disntissed this thought concemiog **SITA** and began to reflect funher : " Separated from **RAMA**, that lovely womao would be unable to sleep, eat or adorn herself nor would she subntit to any other, were he King of the Celestial himself, for **RAMA** has no equal even among the Gode; this is therefore some other." In this conviction, that foremost of monkeys began to search the banquetiog hall anew, anxious to discover **SITA**. Leaning on their tambourioes, drums and Celikas, or stretched on luxurious couches, all these women slept soundly, worn out with playing, sioging, dancing and drinking. And that leader of monkeys saw thousands of women beautifully adorned, some having fallen asleep discussiog each other's charms, some debating the art of singing, some skilled in dis cerniog time and place, discoursmg on circumstance, some given over to merriment and, elsewhere also, he observed beautiful and youthful women who had fallen asleep talking of 361 beauty, or, full of perspicacity, deciding what was opportune. And in their midst, the Lord of the Titans, resembled a hull in a spacious stall, surrounded by graceful kine. Encircled by those women, that King of the Titans looked like a mighty tusker accompanied by female elephants in the forest. In the abode of that powerful Titan King, that lion among monkeys searched the banqueting hall throughout, furnished with every desirable object and he beheld the flesh of buffalo, deer and bear in separate dishes together with peacock and fowl on golden platters, that had not been broached, and percupine, deer and peacocks, seasoned with curds and sochal salt and goats, leverets and fiah half consumed, with portions of dressed venison and sauces. There were wines of superior vintage and rare dishes with salted pies spiced with vinegar and diverse

confections capable of stimulating the appetite. Costly bracelets and anklets were scattered here and there and fruit was arranged in small dishes, whilst flowers were spread about, lending the whole floor an air of splendour, and elegant couches and seats set round that place of feasting caused it to ahine like fire. In addition, meats of every kind and flavour, seasoned with diverse substances and dressed by skilful cooks, were placed round the hall and **HANUMAN** ob served delicious beverages made of a variety of ingredients, some from sugar, some distilled from fruit and flowers or impregnated with fragrant powders. The vast floor reflected the innumerable garlands, golden vessels, crystal bowls and cups lying everywhere and looked exceedingly beautiful and that mighty monkey saw golden wine jars studded with gems, some of which were full of wine, some half full and some wholly drained ; and there were many wines that had not yet been served and various kinds of viands that remained untouched. Elsewhere he saw many couches that were unoccupied, and some, where women of unsurpassed beauty slept, clasping each other in their arms. One of these youthful women had forcibly possessed herself of another's quilt and, wrapping herself therein, had fallen asleep. The gentle breathing of these women barely stirred their attire or t1te garlands that adorned them but caressed them as it were and a gentle breeze, laden 362 with the odour of sandal and the sweet-tasting Sidhu, with the diverse llonl wreaths and flowers, perfumed bark pre pared for ablutions and incense, spread over the aerial car, Pushpaka. And in that residence of the titan there were women of incomparable beauty, some dark-skinned, some the colour of Kancana gold, who, overcome by slumber and worn out with dalliance, resembled sleeping lotuses. Thus that mighty monkey searched every qnarter of **RAVANA**'s private apartments without seeing Janaki anywhere and, having scanned the faces of all these women, he was filled with

apprehension, fearing lest he had failed in his purpose. Then he reflected : " Beholding the wife of another while she is sleeping, is undoubtedly an infringement of the moral law, verily to look on another's wife was never my intention but here I have seen one who hath lusted after the wives of others." Then another thought came to that sagacious monkey, single-mindedly bent on the execution of his duty : "All these consorts of **RAVANA** have been beheld by me without their knowledge yet I find no fluctnation in the tenor of my mind. The mind is the motive power of every movement of the senses, whether it be good or evil and mine remains untroubled ; further, how could I search for **SITA** otherwise? It is amongst women that one should look for women ; every being is to be sought amongst its own kind, none searches for a woman among deer. Therefore with a pure heart I have explored **RAVANA**'s inner apartment but I have not seen the daughter of J anaka." And **HANUMAN** scrutinized the faces of the daughters of *Devas*, Danavas and Nagas, without finding **SITA** and, not finding her in that place, he left the banquetiog hall and began to search elsewhere. Leaving that place of feasting, the olfspring of the Wind-god began to look for **SITA** in another qnarter. CHAPTER **HANUMAN** becomes despondent in the precincts of the palace, Hannman searched the arbours, galleries and the sleeping apartments, eager to discover Sira but without being able to find that lady of gracious appearance there ; and, not finding the beloved of tbat descendant of Raghu, the mighty monkey reflected : " Since, despite mine exertions I am unable to find the daughter of Mithila, assuredly **SITA** is no longer alive. That youthful and virtuous woman, anxious to defend her honour, has been slain by the wicked Lord of the Tirans for remaining faithful to her conjugal duty or the daughter of King J anaka bas died of fright on seeing those consorts of the Sovereign of the Tirans, who are deformed, sallow-skinned, misshapen and who possess huge heads and monstrous

forms. Failing to discover **SITA**, my valour has been expended in vain and a large part of the term allotted to the monkeys has run out; I dare not present myself before **SUGRIVA**, who is powerful and given to meting out harsh punishment. I have explored the inner apartments thoroughly but the gentle **SITA** was not to be found there and I have spent myself in vain. Further, on my return, the assembled monkeys will enquire of me saying : “O Valiant **HANUMAN**, having reached the further shore, what didst thou accomplish there, tell us ? " Not having seen **JANAKA**’s daughter, what sball I answer? The term fixed having passed, assuredly it is meet that I should fast to death, and what will the aged **JAMBAVAN** and **ANGADA** say with all the assembled monkeys since I have crossed the ocean to no purpose ? Yet perseverance is the root of success, perseverance is the root of prosperity, perseverance brings supreme felicity, therefore I will search all those places still left unexplored by me. Moreover it is my intention to put forth fresh elfurts and investigate all those regions not yet visited by me and the banqueting balls, the gardens, the sports pavilions, the courtyards, dwellings, highways, alleys and

CHAPTER 12

Hanuman becomes despondent

CHAPTER **HANUMAN** becomes despondent in the precincts of the palace, Hannman searched the arbours, galleries and the sleeping apartments, eager to discover Sira but without being able to find that lady of gracious appearance there ; and, not finding the beloved of tbat descendant of Raghu, the mighty monkey reflected : " Since, despite mine exertions I am unable to find the daughter of Mithila, assuredly

SITA is no longer alive. That youthful and virtuous woman, anxious to defend her honour, has been slain by the wicked Lord of the Tirans for remaining faithful to her conjugal duty or the daughter of King J anaka bas died of fright on seeing those consorts of the Sovereign of the Tirans, who are deformed, sallow-skinned, misshapen and who possess huge heads and monstrous forms. Failing to discover **SITA**, my valour has been expended in vain and a large part of the term allotted to the monkeys has run out; I dare not present myself before **SUGRIVA**, who is powerful and given to meting out harsh punishment. I have explored the inner apartments thoroughly but the gentle **SITA** was not to be found there and I have spent myself in vain. Further, on my return, the assembled monkeys will enquire of me saying : “O Valiant **HANUMAN**, having reached the further shore, what didst thou accomplish there, tell us ? " Not having seen **JANAKA**’s daughter, what sball I answer? The term fixed having passed, assuredly it is meet that I should fast to death, and what will the aged **JAMBAVAN** and **ANGADA** say with all the assembled monkeys since I have crossed the ocean to no purpose ? Yet perseverance is the root of success, perseverance is the root of prosperity, perseverance brings supreme felicity, therefore I will search all those places still left unexplored by me. Moreover it is my intention to put forth fresh elfurts and investigate all those regions not yet visited by me and the banqueting balls, the gardens, the sports pavilions, the courtyards, dwellings, highways, alleys and S UNDARA *KANDA* chariots, though already searched by me, shall be examined once again. Having thus resolved, **HANUMAN** set about explormg the basements, temples and many-storied dwellings, going up and down, to and fro, opening doors and closing others, entering here and making an exit there, till there was not even the space of four fingers left unscrutinized by him. And he visited the galleries running inside the ramparts and

terraces supported by stanchions and the groves and lotus pools and he saw there hideous and monstrous female titans of every shape but not the daughter of **JANAKA**; and the illustrious consons of Vidyadharas fell under his gaze but not the beloved of Raghava. **HANUMAN** beheld there also the daughters of Nagas, of lovely limbs, whose faces shone like the full moon, who had been furcibly brought there by the Lord of the Titans, but not the cherished daughter of J anaka and, not seeing her among all those lovely women, a profound despair seized that warrior born of Maruta. Reflecting that the exertions of all those leaders of monkeys and the crossing of the ocean had proved vain, the son of Anila became extremely anxious and descended from that aerial car. Thereafter **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, grew pensive and a great melancholy invaded his soul.

CHAPTER 13

Hanuman's Dilemna

" **T**be King of the Vultures, Sampati, affirmed that **SITA** was in **RAVANA**'s palace but I do not see her there, how can this be ? Or has the daughter of Videha, Maithili, born of]anaka, who was carried away against her will, being wholly helpless surrendered to **RAVANA**? Or perchance, fearing **RAMA**'s arrows, in his rapid flight, that titan has allowed **SITA** to slip from his grasp or she seeing herself borne away on the path of the Siddhas and beholding the ocean, has yielded up her life ? Who can say whether that noble large-eyed lady has not succumbed on account of the great speed assumed by **RAVANA** and the pressure of his arms ? "It may happen that, while **RAVANA** flew over the sea, the daughter of **JANAKA** struggling to free herself, fell into the waves, or

alas, far from her lord, seeking to defend her honour, was devoured by that vile **RAVANA**. May not that innocent dark eyed lady have become the food of those impure consorts of that **INDRA** of demons ? Ever absorbed in the contemplation of **RAMA**, whose countenance resembles the moon, has she breathed her last, bewailing her lot and crying : ' O **RAMA** ! O **LAKSHMANA** ! O Ayodhya ! ', or, having been banished to the dungeons of **RAVANA**'s palace, is that youthful woman grieving like a caged bird ? How could the slender-waisted consort of **RAMA**, born of the blood of **JANAKA**, possessing eyes like lotus petals, submit to **RAVANA** ? But whether she be slain or is lost or has died, I dare not speak of it to **RAMA**. To tell him would be an offence, yet it is also wrong to with hold it from him ; what should I do ? I am perplexed ! In such a dilemna, how shall I act ? " Thus thinking, **HANUMAN** *added*:-" If, without finding **SITA**, I return to the city of that lord among monkeys, in how far will my courage have availed me ? My crossing of the ocean has come to nought as also my entry into Lanka and my survey of the titanS. When I come to Kishkindha, what will **SUGRIVA** and the assembled monkeys say to me or those twin sons of **DASARATHA** ? If I approach Kakutstha with these fatal tidings saying: 'I have not found **SITA** , he will give up his life. Hearing these cruel, terrible, heartrending and barbarous 366 words, he will not survive and, when his mind has been with· drawn into the five elements, the sagacious **LAKSHMANA**, deeply attaChed to **RAMA**, will also cease to exist I Then, hearing that his two brothers are dead, **BHARATA** will yield up his life and **SHATRUGHNA** will renounce his existence also. Beholding their sons dead, their mothers, **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA** and **KAIKEYI** will undoubtedly surrender their lives and, seeing **RAMA**'s plight, his grateful and loyal friend, **SUGRIVA**, will give up his life. Then the grief-stricken Ruma, distracted and crushed with sorrow, will perish on

account of her lord and the Queen Tara, already inconsolable on account of Bali's end, worn out by suffering will be unable to continue living. The loss of his parents will lead the youthful **ANGADA** to the brink of death and, overwhelmed by the passing of their leader, the inhabitants of the woods having been cherished with gendeness, gifts and regard by their illustrious monarch, will strike their heads with their fists and die. " Thenceforth, those foremost of monkeys will no longer assemble to disport themselves in the woods, among the rocks and caves, but with their sons, wives and servants, in despair on account of their master's death, will hurl themselves from the height of the rocks into the abysses and chasms. And they will take poison or hang themselves or enter the fire or fast to death or fall on their own weapons. It is certain that a great calsmity will follow my return and the House of Ikshwaku and the inhabitants of the forests will meet with destruction. " But, if I do not return, those two virtUOus and great car watriors as also the swift-footed monkeys will continue to live in the hope of receiving tidings of **SITA**, and I, not having found **SITA**, shall exist by that which falls to my lot, living a life of privation and subsisting on fruit and roots in the forest. " Preparing a funeral pyre on the shores of the sea, in a place abounding in roots, fruits and water, I shall enter the flames or allow myself to die of hunger and, without fail, offer my emaciated frame as food for the birds and beasts of prey. In my belief, this is the death the sages envisaged for them selves; either I must find Janaki or enter the sea. "My bright garland of glory, so nobly plaited and begot of courageous acts has perished because I have not been able 367 to find **SITA**. I shall therefore become an ascetic living under the trees but return I will not without having seen that dark eyed damsel. If I go back without finding **SITA**, neither **ANGADA** nor the other monkeys will survive. Yet incalculable ills lie in store for one taking his own life ; if however I con tinue to live,

I may achieve success, therefore I shall maintain my existence ! If I live, the re-union of Ranta and **SITA** may be effected." Revolving these innumerable and painful considerations in his ntind, that lion among monkeys sought to prevent himself from being overcome by despair. Summoning up all his courage, that ntighty monkey said to himself : " I shall slay Dasbagtiva the terrible **RAVANA** and thus avenge the abduction of **SITA** or, crossing the sea, I shall drag him before **RAMA** as a beast is offered up to Pashupati." Reflecting thus, that monkey, who was filled with anxiety and grief, not having been able to find **SITA**, thought : " So long as I do not find the illustrious consort of **RAMA**, I shall not cease from searching the city of Lanka on every side. If, according to Sampati's words, I bring **RAMA** hither, Raghava, not beholding his consort, will bum all the monkeys with the fire of his wrath. Therefore I shall stay here, living a life of abstinence with my senses under control lest all men and monkeys perish through my fault. " Here is a great Ashoka grove, containing huge trees, whieh has not yet been searched by me. Having paid reverence to the Vasus, the Rudras, the Adityas, the Ashwins and the Maruts, in order to increase the torment of the titans, I shall enter it. Having vanquished the demons, I shall restore the divine **SITA**, the delight of the House of Ikshwaku to Ranta as the fruit of austerity is bestowed on an ascetic." Having thus reflected for a space, the ntighty offspring of the Wind-god suddenly rose and said : " Salutations to Ranta accompanied by **LAKSHMANA** and Anila I Salutations to Chandra, **AGNI** and the Maruts ! " After paying obeisance to all the Gods as also to Sugtiva, the offspring of the Wind-god, surveying the four quarters, in imagination as it were advanced towards that magnificent grove and began to consider what should be done further. 368 He reflected : " This Ashoka Grove which is sacted with its dense thickets must be filled with titans, its are surely

protected by trained guards and the blessed Vishvatam himself refrains from blowing vigorously here. In **RAMA**'s interests I shall contract my form so that I may not be detected by **RAVANA**. May all the Gods, as also the hosts nf sages, confer success on me I May Swyambhu, the Celestisl Beings, as also the ascetics, the God of Fire, the God of the Wind, the Bearer of the Thunderbolt, **VARUNA**, the Moon and the Sun, the high-souled Ashwins and all the Maruts grant me success ! May all beings and the Lord of all Beings and those unknown, who are met with on the way, confer success on me! " When shall I behold that noble and irreproachable queen with her arched nose, pearly teeth, sweet smile and eyes resembling lotus petals, bright as the King of the Stars, O when ? " O how will that frail and virtuous one, ruthlessly borne away by that wicked and vile wretch, the scourge of human beings, who masks his savagery under an alluring disguise, disclose herself to me ? "

CHAPTER 14

The Ashoka Grove

THE RAMAYANA OF VALMJKJ with gold and silver saplings and containing flocks of birds and deer· with trees of varying fragrance which .filled him with wonder. Abounding in trees of every kind, laden with flowers and fruit, where cuckoos called deliriously and swarms of bees hummed, where all creatures expressed happiness in their movements, where the cries of the peacock could be heard and waterfowl teemed, the heart of the beholder was ravished. And **HANUMAN**, searching for that princess of beautiful and faultless limbs, woke the birds that had been sleeping sweetly and blown by the wind set up by the wings of those birds in flight, a shower of variegated blossom

fell, covering **HANUMAN**, the son of the Wind-god in the midst of the Ashoka Grove lending him the loveliness of a hill covered with ftowers. Then all the creatures beholding that monkey, as they darted from all sides, thought : " It is the God of Spring ". Wholly hidden in blossom which had fallen from the trees, the earth looked like a bride covered with jewels and, shaken in diverse ways by the motion of that impetuous monkey the trees rained down a shower of multi-coloured blooms. And those trees, whose tops were stripped of leaves, from which both blossom and fruit had fallen, looked like gamblers who have staked their raiment and possessions only to lose all. Buffetted by **HANUMAN**'s leaping, those lovely trees speedily let their ftowers, leaves and fruit fall to the ground and, deserted by the birds, no longer able to seek shelter there. on account of the shaking administered by Maruti, presented their bare branches only, so that the Ashoka grove, battered by the blows of the monkey's feet and tail, resembled a youthful woman with her locks dishevelled, the brighmess of her lips and teeth dimmed, her tilaka mark effaced and her arms and legs scarred. And in his haste, that monkey snapped the clusters of creepers as the wind dispels the clouds during the rainy season. Ranging here and there, that monkey observed places that were paved with gold and silver with ponds filled with trans lucent water, their steps encrusted with valuable gems, pearls and coral, their fioora being of crystal and the banks set with trees of Kancana gold which emitted a dazzling light. 370 These pools were covered with clumps of lotuses and lilies whilst waterfowl enhanced their beauty and they re-echoed to the cry of Natyuhas, swans and geese ; broad and beautiful streams, bordered on every side by trees, fed them with their waters wbich resembled Amrita and glided under variegated shrubs decorated by hundreds of creepers, the ground being carpeted by rhododendron and oleander flowers. Then that foremost of monkeys

beheld a bigh bill, bright as a cloud crowned with lofty peaks, many kinds of trees and filled with caves, and it was one of the wonders of the world ! And he beheld a river falling from those heights, like a youthful woman tearing herself from her lover's mms in order to leave bim and the branches of the trees, sweeping the water, looked as if the companions of that damsel were detaining her, whilst fwther down, **HANUMAN** beheld that stream returning on its course, as if the maiden, appeased, were reconciled to her beloved. Thereafter at some distance from the river, a pool filled with lotuses, frequented by birds of every kind drew the gaze of that lion among monkeys, **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta ; and he saw a fountain of fresh water with enchanting steps made of precious gems, its basin strewn with pearls, which was embellished on every side with countless herds of deer, ravishing groves, and mansions built by Vishvakarma himself, adorned with artificial woods and trees laden with fruit and Bowers, their branches spreading like umbrellas giving shade, whilst the ground beneath was paved with gold and silver. And that great monkey beheld a single golden Shingshapa tree surrounded by a golden dais and he saw many Bower beds and trees which resembled flames, the radiance of which rivalled Mount Meru and caused him to think they were made of gold. Seeing those beautiful golden trees, with their flowering crests, buds and shoots agitated by the wind, ernirting a sound like the tinkling of many ommnents, **HANUMAN** was astounded. Climbing quickly into that many-leafed Shingshapa tree **HANUMAN** reftected : " From here I may perchance behold Vaidehi, that unhappy being who sighs for **RAMA**'s presence and who, filled with grief, wanders aimlessly to and fro. Without doubt, this Ashoka Grove embellished by Candana, Champaka and Vakula trees, belongs to the wicked **RAVANA**. Here by this lovely pool frequented by birds, that princess and royal spouse, **SITA**, will

certainly repair. She, the beloved of Raghava, accustomed to wander iu the woods, bereft of **RAMA**, will assuredly come hither. That lady, whose eyes resemble a doe's, tormented with grief on account of separation from **RAMA**, fond of roving iu the woods, will certainly walk iu this grove. She, the chaste and virtuous wife of **RAMA**, **JANAKA**'s daughter, who ever loved the creatures of the forest, anxious to offer up her devotion, will come to this river of translucent waters, for this purpose. " Truly this beautiful grove is worthy to be the abode of that chaste consort of the king of men, **RAMA**. If that goddess, whose countenance resembles the moon, still lives, she will inevitably visit this river of cool waters." Thus reJiected the high-souled **HANUMAN**, expecting the consOrt of that lord of men to appear and, concealiug himself iu the Shiugshapa tree covered with leaves and flowers, gazed out over the whole scene. CHAPTER IS **HANUMAN** sees **SITA** SEATED iu the tree, glanciug round iu quest of **SITA**, **HANUMAN** surveyed the entire grove filled with trees iutertwiued with ereepers and redolent with celestial odours. Manifesting every aspect of beauty, possessing the splendour of the Nandana Gardens, it was iuhabited by various animals and birds, embellished by palaces and temples and re-echoed to the call of the cuckoo. Adorned with pools filled with golden lotuses and silvety waterlilies, furnished with seats and cushions, buildings and courtyards, with its ravishiug trees laden with fruit and dowers iu every season and the blosaomiug Ashoka trees, it resembled the etfulgence of the risiug sun. Seated there, Maruti never wearied of gazing on those lovely woods, whose foliage was almost concealed by hundreds of birds disporting themselves there and the beauty of those 37.3

CHAPTER 15

Hanuman sees Sita

Champaka and Vakula trees, belongs to the wicked **RAVANA**. Here by this lovely pool frequented by birds, that princess and royal spouse, **SITA**, will certainly repair. She, the beloved of Raghava, accustomed to wander iu the woods, bereft of **RAMA**, will assuredly come hither. That lady, whose eyes resemble a doe's, tormented with grief on account of separation from **RAMA**, fond of roving iu the woods, will certainly walk iu this grove. She, the chaste and virtuous wife of **RAMA**, **JANAKA**'s daughter, who ever loved the creatures of the forest, anxious to offer up her devotion, will come to this river of translucent waters, for this purpose. " Truly this beautiful grove is worthy to be the abode of that chaste consort of the king of men, **RAMA**. If that goddess, whose countenance resembles the moon, still lives, she will inevitably visit this river of cool waters." Thus reJiected the high-souled **HANUMAN**, expecting the consOrt of that lord of men to appear and, concealiug himself iu the Shiugshapa tree covered with leaves and flowers, gazed out over the whole scene. CHAPTER IS **HANUMAN** sees **SITA** SEATED iu the tree, glanciug round iu quest of **SITA**, **HANUMAN** surveyed the entire grove filled with trees iutertwiued with ereepers and redolent with celestial odours. Manifesting every aspect of beauty, possessing the splendour of the Nandana Gardens, it was iuhabited by various animals and birds, embellished by palaces and temples and re-echoed to the call of the cuckoo. Adorned with pools filled with golden lotuses and silvety waterlilies, furnished with seats and cushions, buildings and courtyards, with its ravishiug trees laden with fruit and dowers iu every season and the blosaomiug Ashoka trees, it resembled the etfulgence of the risiug

sun. Seated there, Maruti never wearied of gazing on those lovely woods, whose foliage was almost concealed by hundreds of birds disporting themselves there and the beauty of those 37.3 Ashob trees, bending under the weight of their flowers, so thst their blossoming seemed to extend to their very roots, dispelled all sorrow. The entire region seemed ablaze with the brilliance of the Kamikars and Kimshub trees in flower ; the giant-rooted Punnags, Saptspama, Cbampaka and Udda lab blazed forth in blossom and there were thousands of Ashob trees some of a golden colour, some like flames of fire and some as dark as collyrium so thst the whole place resembled the Garden of Nandana or the enchanting domain of Chaitaratha or even surpassed them. This celestial un imaginably beautiful region was like a second heaven, having flowers for its constellations or a fifth ocean, its pearls being the blossom scattered there. Planted with trees, which bloomed in every season, emitting honeyed scents, that gsrden was filled with the cries of birds and beasts and redolent with exquisite scents, a delicious spot, equal to thst King of Moun tains, a second Gandhamadana. Now, in that Ashob Grove, that lion among monkeys observed, at a short distance, a splendid temple as white as Mount Kailasha, flawless, supported by a thousand pillars, its steps of coral, its floors of refined gold, dazzlingly beautiful, blinding to the eyes and of such a height thst it seemed to kiss the sky. Then, all at once, he beheld a woman, in soiled raiment, surrounded by female titans and she was emaciated through fasting, sorrowful, heaving frequent sighs, immaculate as the moon’s disc in its first quarter, resplendent with a radiance which now shone but dimly so thst she seemed like a flame wreathed in smoke. Clad in a soiled robe of yellow silk, divested of every orna ment, she resembled a lotus pool stripped of its flowers. Oppressed, racked with grief and tormented, she was like unto Rohini pursued by Ketu. Her face bathed in tears,

distressed, worn out by privation, plunged in anxiety and separated from her kith and kin, no longer able to behold **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** but only the titans, she appeared like a gazelle surrounded by a pack of hounds. With her long hair resembling a black serpent, hanging down her back, she looked like the earth with its dark blue 373 forests in the rainy sesson. That large-eyed lady, worthy of happiness, not having known adversity till that hour, sunk in woe and emaciated was attired in soiled raiment. Then **HANUMAN**, beholding her, for many ressons deduced that it was **SITA** and reflected :-" That princess, borne away by the titan, able to change his shape at will, must be this woman before me." Her face shone like the full moon and she possessed besutiful brows and gracefully rounded bressts ; by her radiance she dispelled the darkness in all regions ; her neck was of a bluish tint, her lips like the Bimba fruit, her waist slender and her carriage full of dignity, her eyes, resembling lotus petals equalled those of Rati, the beloved spouse of Manmatba, lovely as the moon, adored by all. Now that youthful woman of graceful form was sested on the ground practising austerity like a female ascetic and that timid lady was hesving frequent sighs like the consort of the Serpent King. Entangled in a mighty web of sorrow, her besuty was veiled like a flame enveloped in smoke or a traditional text obscured by dubious interpretation or wealth that is melting away or faith that is languishing or hope that is almost extinguished or perfection unartained on account of obstacles or an intellect which is darkened or fame tarnished by calumny. Distracted by her separation from **RAMA**, tormented by the presence of the female titans, her eyes, like a young doe's ranged here and there scorching everywhere in her distress. Tesrs stresmed from her eyes with their arched brows and dark lashes and, her festures altered, she sighed again and again. That unfortunate one, worthy of every decoration, now bereft of all, covered with stains,

resembled the King of the Stars obscured by hesvy cloud. Beholding **SITA** in that pitiable state, **HANUMAN** was perplexed as one whose lesming is lost for Jack of sustained endesvour and, seeing her without omatnents, be recognised her with difficulty as a text that is wrongly construed. Beholding that large-eyed and irreproachable princess, **HANUMAN** concluded from her many distinctive charactetistics that it must indeed be **SITA**. Perceiving on her person such ornaments as bad been SU_NDARA *KANDA* described by **RAMA** at the time of his depanure, such as the Svadangstras and jewelled armlets, which were now darkened by dust and neglect, nevertheless, they appeared to **HANUMAN** to be those mentioned to him and he redected :-" Those which were cast off by **SITA** on the way, I do not see but those she preserved are certainly here. " The rich silken mantle shining like Kanaka gold, which she let fall, was found by the monkeys caught in a tree and the valuable ornaments cast off by her fell on the earth with a tinkling sound. The robe she now wears is exceedingly worn but its colour remains and resembles her own radiance. Here is the one for whom **RAMA** has suffered torment through affection, pity, grief and love: through affection in con sequence of his beloved spouse being borne away ; through pity, by his inability to protect her who is dependent on him ; through grief, at her loss, and through love by his separation from her. Verily from the grace of her person and her beauty, that resembles his, this lady of dark eyes must be his spouse. She has her mind fixed on him, and he on her, it is on account of this that they are able to survive. Indeed the Lord **RAMA** has achieved a great feat by still existing separated from her and not yielding up his life in grief." Having beheld **SITA**, the Son of Pavana allowed his thoughts to fly to **RAMA**, to whom he silently offered obeisance, and to that princess also.

CHAPTER 16

His reflections on seeing Sita

THE RAM"AYANA OF VALMIK;I to bis preceptors, has met with this misfortune. Conversant with the prowess of **RAMA** and the sagacious **LAKSHMANA**, that divine lady is no more perturbed than is the Ganges at the approach of the rainy season. In character, age, conduct and family, they are equal and Raghava is worthy of Vaidehi, that one of dark eyes, who is bis." Seeing **SITA**, radiant as newly minted gold and who resembled Lakshmi beloved of the worlds, **HANUMAN** approaching **RAMA** in thought, said : "On account of tbis large-eyed lady, the mighty Bali was slain, and Kahanda, equal to him in strength ; for her, the mighty demon Virsdha, despite bis renowned prowess, also succumbed in the forest under the thrusts of the valiant **RAMA**, as Shambara under Mahendra's blows. It was for her that fourteen thousand demons of outstanding exploits were pierced by Rams's arrows resembling tongues of fire in Janasthana. Khara too was brought low on the field of battle ; Trishiras was overthrown and the mighty Dushana also by the righteous Raghava. And it was on her account that that supreme and inaccessible kingdom of the monkeys belonging to Bali was acquired by **SUGRIVA**, renowned in the Three Worlds; it is for this large-eyed damsel, that the effulgent Lord of the Waters has been crossed by me and tbis city explored. Me thinks that if **RAMA** had turned the whole earth, with its boun daries, upside down for her sake, it were fitting I Were the dominion of the Three Worlds on one side and **SITA**, born of **JANAKA**, on the other, the former would not equal a fraction of the latter ; such is the virtuous daughter of the magnanimous King of Mithila, who is wholly devoted to her lord. She, as a field was being

dug, rose from a furrow which the blade of the plough had turned, covered with dust which gleamed like the pollen of a lotus ; she, the eldest daughter-in-law of King **DASARATHA**, who was full of courage and nobility and was never known to retreat in battle ; she, the beloved consort of the faithful and dutiful **RAMA**, knower of bis own Self, is now in the power of the titans. " Renouncing every pleasure, actuated by love of her lord, disregarding the inevitable privations, she entered the beautiful forest to live on fruit and roots, ever engaged in the service of SU.N(DARA *KANDA* her spouse and considered herself to hsve attained the peak of felicity there, as if it were the palace itself. This lady, whose limbs resemble Kanab gold and who was ever wont to smile when conversing, now suffers unimaginable woes and Raghava, like a thirsty man panting fur a stream, sighs for the sight of thst noble woman oppressed by **RAVANA**. Re united with her, Ragbava will enjoy felicity once more, as a king who hss been deprived of his throne rejoices on regaining it. " Deprived of all comfort and pleasure, far from her kinsmen, she preserves her life in the hope of seeing **RAMA** and being re united with him. Oblivious of the titans and the trees covered with fruit and !lowers, her spirit is wholly absorbed in the thought of **RAMA**. For a woman the greatest decoration is her lord and **SITA**, though incomparably beautiful, no longer shines in Rams's absence. It is only Rams's heroism that makes it possible fur him to continue living separated from his consort and prevents him from being overwhelmed with grief. This lady of dark eyes, resembling the moonlight, worthy of happiness, is now utterly wretched and my heart is troubled. Patient as the earth, this lady whose eyes resemble lotuses, who was fortnerly protected by **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, lying at the foot of a tree, is being guarded by demons of hideous aspect. Like a wateriDy snapped by the frost, the daughter of **JANAKA**, her beauty faded, is fainting under

the rain of misfortunes and, like a doe separated from the herd, is fallen into this distress. The Ashoka trees with their boughs bend ing under the weight of their blossom seem to increase her grief, as also the moon of pure beams that is rising in this spring season." Reflecting thus, thst valiant monkey, being convinced thst it was **SITA**, stationed himself in the Shingshspa tree.

CHAPTER 17

Description of the Female Titans guarding Sita

like countenance who, under the load of grief, resembled a heavily laden ship foundering in the waves. And gazing on Vaidehi, **HANUMAN**, bam of Maruta, observed a number of grim-visaged titan women at a distance, some with but a single eye or ear, some with ears concealing their visage, some without ears, some with noses on their foreheads, some possessed of disproportionately large heads and long necks, some with sparse hair and others covered with hair so that they appeared to be wrapped in a woollen cloth ; the ears and brows of some were set low, and their breasts and bellies protruded ; others were knock-kneed, stunted, humpbacked, crooked, dwarfed, unkempt, their mouths set awry, their eyes inllamed, their faces fearful to behold Hideous, irascible, quarrelsome, they were armed with spears, darts, hammers and mallets and some had snouts like bears or the muzzles of deer or the faces of tigers, camels, bu1falo, gosts and jackals and some had the feet of elephants, camels, horses and the heads of some were sunk in their breasts. Some had a single hand or foot, some the ears of asses, horses, kine and elephants or some the ears of monkeys. Some had enormous noses, some crooked noses and some none at all, some had noses like the

trunks of elephants, some had their noses fixed in their foreheads, through which they breathed like beasts. The feet of some were like elephants and some had the feet of kine, some were hairy ; some had huge heads, gigantic faces and long tongues ; some had the heads of goats, elephants, cows, pigs, horses, camels and donkeys. These titan women of formidsble appearance held spears and maces in their hands, they were ill-humoured and rejoiced in discord. Their hair was black as soot or smoke-coloured, their aspect repellant and they feasted continually, regaling themselves on wine and meat without surcease, their bodies being spattered with blood ftom the flesh they conaumed. That foremost of monkeys surveyed those titan women whose appearance caused his hair to stand on end and who were seated in a circle round the many-branched nee under SUNlDARA *KANDA* which the divine and irreproachable Janaki stood. And the graceful **HANUMAN** bebeld that daughter of **JANAKA** bereft of her radiance, consumed with grief, her locks soiled with dust, like a star which bas fallen on the earth its merits exhausted, **SITA**, famed throughout the worlds for her fidelity, yer with little hope of being re-united with her lord. Stripped of her jewels, she whose chief ornament was her devotion to her lord, held captive by **RAVANA**, appeared like a female elephaut separated from the herd who has been attacked by a lion or like the moonlight enveloped in cloud at the end of the rainy season. Her beauty dimmed, she resembled a stringed instrument that one has ceased to pluck and has laid aside. Far from her lord, that illustrious one bad fallen under the sway of the titans without having merited it. Sunk in an ocean of grief, surrounded by those titan women in the midst of the Ashoka Grove, she looked like Rohini about to be devoured by Rahu and, beholding her there, **HANUMAN** thought she resembled a creeper divested of its blooms. Having lost her radiance, her limbs covered with dust, with her hidden

grace she looked like a lotus spattered with mud. The monkey, **HANUMAN**, beheld that youthful woman, whose eyes resembled a doe's, clothed in a soiled and tattered cloth and though that blessed one was shorn of her beauty, yet her soul did not lose its transcendency, upheld as it was by the thought of **RAMA**'s glory and safeguarded by her own virtue. Beholding **SITA**, whose eyes, wide with fear, resembled a doe's, casting her glances here and there like a fawn and con suming the trees and theit leaves with her sighs, like a moun tainous wave rising from the ocean of adversity, incomparably beautiful with her slender limbs and graceful form, bereft of ornaments, Maruti experienced a great felicity ; and **HANUMAN** CHAPTER 8 **RAVANA** goes to th4 Ashoka Grtlf)e SURVEYING the woods filled with flowering trees, desirous of beholding **SITA** closely and the night being almost spent, towards dawn, **HANUMAN** heard the chanting of the Vedas by those among the titans conversant with the holy Shastras and the six supplementary portions. Then the mighty ten-headed Lord of the TitanS awoke to the sound of auspicious music, delightful to the ear and, waking, that great and powerful king, his garlands and attire in disarray, remembered Vaidehi. Passionately enamoured of her, that titan filled with pride could not restrain his desire. Thereupon, adorned with every kind of ornament, gor geously robed, he entered the Ashob Grove filled with in numerable trees, laden with fruit and flowers of every kind with pools embellished with lotuses and lilies, enlivened by birds of rare beauty ecstatic with love and sculptured wolves wonderful to behold. Dashagriva gazed on those avenues with their arches of gold and gems, thronged with deer of every sort and carpeted with the fruit that had fallen on the earth. And one hundred damsels, daughters of the Gods and Gandharvas, followed in the train of the son of Poulasrya, resembling the nymphs who follow Mahendra and some carried lamps of gold whilat others bore chanwaras

and fans in their hands. Some carrying water in golden ewers, walked ahead, others following with a golden seat and round cushions and one on his right bore a cup encrusted with gems and filled with wine whilst another carried a canopy resembling a swan, golden-ribbed like the moon and having a handle of line gold. In this way, the most beautiful of **RAVANA**'s wives, their eyes heavy with sleep and wine followed their august lord like

CHAPTER 18

Ravana goes to the Ashoka Grove

RAVANA goes to th4 Ashoka Grtlf)e SURVEYING the woods filled with flowering trees, desirous of beholding **SITA** closely and the night being almost spent, towards dawn, **HANUMAN** heard the chanting of the Vedas by those among the titans conversant with the holy Shastras and the six supplementary portions. Then the mighty ten-headed Lord of the TitanS awoke to the sound of auspicious music, delightful to the ear and, waking, that great and powerful king, his garlands and attire in disarray, remembered Vaidehi. Passionately enamoured of her, that titan filled with pride could not restrain his desire. Thereupon, adorned with every kind of ornament, gor geously robed, he entered the Ashob Grove filled with in numerable trees, laden with fruit and flowers of every kind with pools embellished with lotuses and lilies, enlivened by birds of rare beauty ecstatic with love and sculptured wolves wonderful to behold. Dashagriva gazed on those avenues with their arches of gold and gems, thronged with deer of every sort and carpeted with the fruit that had fallen on the earth. And one hundred damsels, daughters of the Gods and Gandharvas, followed in the train of the son of Poulasrya, resembling

the nymphs who follow Mahendra and some carried lamps of gold whilat others bore chanwaras and fans in their hands. Some carrying water in golden ewers, walked ahead, others following with a golden seat and round cushions and one on his right bore a cup encrusted with gems and filled with wine whilst another carried a canopy resembling a swan, golden-ribbed like the moon and having a handle of line gold. In this way, the most beautiful of **RAVANA**'s wives, their eyes heavy with sleep and wine followed their august lord like ftashes of lighming following a cloud. Their bracelets and necklets of pearl, swung to and fro, their sandal-paste was effaced and their hair hung loose while drops of perspiration stood on the brows of those women of lovely mien who stumbled on account of the effects of wine and sleep, and the sweat had caused the flowers that adorned them to wither and their locks were full of shreds from their garlands; in this way, those women of tender appearance full of pride and affection, followed the King of the Titans. And that powerful lord, the slsve of his desires, his heart fixed on **SITA**, proceeded at a slow pace. Then the monkey beard the sound of the bells on the women's girdles and anklets, and the joy of Maruta beheld **RAVANA** of inconceivable prowess, whose energy and valour were un imsginable, as he entered the gate ; and he was illumined on all sides by the innumerable lamps, fed with fragrant oil, which were carried by those damsels and, intoxicated with pride, desire and wine, his eyes of a coppery red, he looked like Kandarpa himself bereft of his bow. He adjusted his msgnificent cloak, decorated with flowers, stainless as the foam of Amrita when churned, and which flung back was held by a clasp. **HANUMAN**, concealed behind the curtain of leafy branches, stared at him as he approached and from his hiding place, that elephant among monkeys beheld that mighty king, **RAVANA**, surrounded by beautiful and youthful brides, with majestic strides enter that grove, which

re-echoed to the cry of deer and birds. Already intoxicated, adorned with priceless orna ments, possessing pointed ears resembling darts, full of energy, that Son of Vaishravas, the Lord of the Titans, appeared sur rounded by lovely women, as the moon amidst the stars, and that illustrious monkey, beholding him, reflected : " This is the long-armed **RAVANA** who was formerly sleeping in that sumptuous apartment in the centre of the city." Then the valiant **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, despite his great courage and though highly effulgent, found himself eclipsed by **RAVANA**'s giOty and effaced himself among the leafy branches. **RAVANA** however, eager to see that dark-eyed **SITA** of faultless limbs, whose breasts touched each other, and whose tresses were black, strode on.

CHAPTER 19

Sita's Grief

jewels, that irreproachable princess trembled like a palm agitated by the wind and, covering her breasts and belly with her bands, seeking to conceal them, shrank away. Dasbagriva gazed on Vaidehi, who was guarded by com panies of female titans and that unfortunate One, given over to grief, resembled a ship foundering in the sea. Seated on the naked ground, Sits who was fixed in virtue, resembled a branch severed from a tree that bas fallen to earth. Her limba covered with a soiled cloth, she, who was worthy of ornaments, now no longer adorned, resembled a lotus stalk stained with mnd and, though radiant, her beauty was dimmed. In imagination, she took refuge with that lion among men, **RAMA**, her mind a chariot drawn by the steeds of resolution and that charming princess, devoted to **RAMA**, emaciated, weeping, separated

from her kinsfolk, was a prey to anxiety and grief and saw no end to her misfortune. Rocking herself to and fro, she resembled the female of the King of the Snakes under the spell of an incantation or the planet Rohini pursued by Dhumaketu or a saindy and virtuous woman of a noble house who finds herself, thtough marriage, placed in a low born family. She resembled a great reputation that has been lost or a faith that has been disregarded or a mind that bas become clouded or a hope destroyed, a future shattered, an order misinterpreted, a region obliterated at the destrnction of the world or an offering rejected by the Gods, a night on which the full moon is obacured by clouds or a lotus pool laid waste, an army bereft of its warriors, a moon under eclipse, a dried up river, an altar which bas been desecrated or a flame 382 that bas been extinguished or a lotus pool bereft of flowers, its birds struck with terror agitated by the trumpeting of elephants. In separation from her lord, consumed with grief, she appeared like a river whose waters have run dry and on account of her limbs not having been washed, she resembled night during the period of the waning moon. That lovely and graceful woman, accustomed to a palace filled with precious gems, now, with wasted limbs, resembled the stalk of a lotus freshly plucked and wilring in the sun. As the female elephant which has been captured, chained to a stake, grieving for its mate, sighs again and again, so seemed she. Her long datk tresses, utterly neglected, lay along her back so that she appeared like the earth covered with a datk forest at the end of the rainy season. Tortured by hunger, sorrow, anxiety and fear, emaciated, desolate, weakened by abstinence and given over to austeriry, stricken with grief, resembling a goddess, her hands were joined offering prayers to Ramo for the destruction of **RAVANA**. And beholding that blameless Maithili with her beautiful dark eyes and graceful lashes, **RAVANA**, to his own destruction, sought to seduce her.

CHAPTER 20

Ravana begs Sita to wed him

THEREUPON **RAVANA** approaching **SITA**, who was helpless, sur rounded by female titans and vowed to a life of austerity, with sweet words and courteous gestures said to her : " O Thou whose thighs resemble the trunk of an elephant, who, beholding me dost seek to conceal thy breasts and thy body as if thou didst fear me, O Lady of large eyes, I love thee. Be gracious to me, O Thou of charming looks, who att adored by all the world I There is no man present here nor any titan able to change his form at will therefore banish the fear which I inspire in thee, O **SITA**. 383 " It has ever been the unquestioned and special privilege of titsns to unite themselves with the wives of others, either taking them of their own free will or bearing them away by force. In spite of this, O Maithili, I shall not lay hands on thee since thou hast no affection for me but, for myself, I am completely under thy sway, therefore trust in me and respond to my love. O Goddess, have no fear of me, take courage, O Dear One, and do not let thyself be consumed with grief. To wear but a single plait, to lie on the earth in soiled attire and fast unnecessarily does not become thee. In my company, O Maithili, do thou enjoy garlands, perfumes, sandal, orna ments, wine, ricb beds and seats, singing, dancing and music. Thou art a pearl among women, do not remain in this condi tion, adorn thyself as heretofore. Having united thyself with me, O Lady of Lovely Form, what will not be thine ? " Thine enchanting youth is passing away, whicb like the water of a river, once gone, does not return. O Thou of Fair Looks, the creator of thy loveliness, Vishvakrita, after devising thee, ceased from his work for I see none who is equal to thee in loveliness and grace ! Who, having seen

thee, resplendent with beauty, could withstand thee O Vaidehi? Even Brahms Himself is moved, how mucb more other beings? O Thou whose countenance resembles the moon, on whatever part of thy body mine eyes rest, my gaze is riveted. O Maithili, do thou become my consort and renounce this thy folly. Be come the foremost queen of these innumerable andlovelywomen who belong to me. O Timid One, all the treasure I have won throughout the worlds I offer thee as also my kingdom. O Spottive Damsel, for thy sake, having subjugated the entire earth with its many cities, I will confer them on King **JANAKA**. None on this earth can withstand my prowess ; behold tnine immeasurable valour in battle ! Did not the Celestials and the Demons find me irresistible on the battlefield as I broke through their ranks shattering their standards ? " Therefore yield to my desire and attire thyself in splendid robes, letting brilliant gems adorn thy person. O Timid One, enjoy every comfort and luxury according to thy pleasure, divert thyself and distribute land and treasure to others. Live happily depending on my support and eercise supreme 3114 authority. By my favour, all thy relatives shall slwe thy felicity. Observe my prosperity and glory, O Gentle Lady, what canst thou hope from **RAMA** who is clothed in robes of batk ? O Fonunate One, **RAMA** has been deprived of his kingdom and is bereft of his might, be practises asceticism, his couch is the hate eatth, indeed it is doubtful whethet he still lives. O Vaidehi, **RAMA** will never he able to find thee, thou who resemhlest a star veiled hy dark clouds preceded by cranes. Raghava will never rescue thee from my hands, as Hiranyakashipu was not able to recover his consort Kirti, who had falleo under the sway of lndra. " O Lady of Sweet Smiles, O Thou of lovely teeth and beautiful eyes, thou dost ravish my heart as Suparna carried away a serpent. Although thy robe is tom and stained and thou art stripped of ornaments, seeing thee, my mind turns away from all my other consorts. O Daughter

of **JANAKA**, do thou hold sway over all tbe women in my harem, who are endowed with every accomplishment. O Princess of raven locks, these women, tbe foremost among the beauties of the world, shall be thy slaves and attend on thee as tbe Apsaras attend on Shri. O Graceful Princess, enjoy the pleasures of tbe world with me and tbe riches of Kuvera to tbe utmost of thy desires. O Goddess, neither in asceticism, streogth, prowess, wealth nor fame is **RAMA** equal to me. Therefore drink, eat, enjoy thyself and indulge in every pleasure. I shall confer on thee immense wealth, nay, tbe whole world. “Do thou satisfy all thy desires in my company, O Timid One, and let thy relatives sbate thy felicity also. Adorned with dazzling goldeo bracelets, O Beautiful One, in my com

CHAPTER 21

Sita rejects Ravana with disdain

authority. By my favour, all thy relatives shall slwe thy felicity. Observe my prosperity and glory, O Gentle Lady, what canst thou hope from **RAMA** who is clothed in robes of batk ? O Fonunate One, **RAMA** has been deprived of his kingdom and is bereft of his might, be practises asceticism, his couch is the hate eatth, indeed it is doubtful whethet he still lives. O Vaidehi, **RAMA** will never he able to find thee, thou who resemhlest a star veiled hy dark clouds preceded by cranes. Raghava will never rescue thee from my hands, as Hiranyakashipu was not able to recover his consort Kirti, who had falleo under the sway of lndra. " O Lady of Sweet Smiles, O Thou of lovely teeth and beautiful eyes, thou dost ravish my heart as Suparna carried away a serpent. Although thy robe is tom and stained and thou art stripped of ornaments, seeing thee,

my mind turns away from all my other consorts. O Daughter of **JANAKA**, do thou hold sway over all tbe women in my harem, who are endowed with every accomplishment. O Princess of raven locks, these women, tbe foremost among the beauties of the world, shall be thy slaves and attend on thee as tbe Apsaras attend on Shri. O Graceful Princess, enjoy the pleasures of tbe world with me and tbe riches of Kuvera to tbe utmost of thy desires. O Goddess, neither in asceticism, streogth, prowess, wealth nor fame is **RAMA** equal to me. Therefore drink, eat, enjoy thyself and indulge in every pleasure. I shall confer on thee immense wealth, nay, tbe whole world. “Do thou satisfy all thy desires in my company, O Timid One, and let thy relatives sbate thy felicity also. Adorned with dazzling goldeo bracelets, O Beautiful One, in my com-fortunate **SITA**, a111icted and trembling, faithful to ber lord and anxious to preserve ber virtue, her heart fixed on **RAMA**, placed a straw between **RAVANA** and berself and witb a sweet smile answered him, saying : " Take back tby heart and set it on tbine own consortS. As a sinner may not aspire to heaven, so shouldst tbou not expect to win me. That which should never be done and is condemned in a woman faithful to her lord, I shall never do. Bom in a noble House, I have been joined to a pious family.” Having spoken tbus to **RAVANA**, tbe virtuous Vaidebi, turning her back on him, continued : “It is not meet that I become thy wife since I am united to another. Do tby duty and follow tbe tules laid down by men of integrity. The wives of others, like tbine own, are deserving of protection, O Prowler of the Night. Do thou furnish a good example and enjoy tbine own consorts. That wretch who, in the inconstancy and levity of his heart, is not satisfied witb his own wives, will be brought to misery by tbose of others. Either no pious men exist here or thou dost not follow their example, since tby mind is perverse and turns from what is virtuous; or tbe wise having uttered sage

counsel, tbou, to tbe destruction of the titans, dost ignore tbem. " Prosperity, kingdom and city are all brought to nought in tbe bands of a vicious monarch who is not master of himself, hence Lanka, overflowing witb treasure, having tbee for her king, will suffer destruction 'ere long. O **RAVANA**, that wicked being who brings about his own dowDfall, succumbs, to tbe delight of all. When thou meetest witb tbine end, this evU deed will cause tbe oppressed to say : Fortunate are we that this great tyrant has fallen.' " Thou art not able to tempt me witb wealth and riches ; as tbe light of the sun cannot be separated from tbe sun so do I belong to Ragbava. Having rested on tbe arm of that Lord of Men, how should I depend on any other ? Like unto tbe spiritual trutb known to a *brahmin* faithful to his vows, I belong to tbe Lord of tbe World alone and am lawfiilly wedded to him. It is to thine own advantage to restore me to **RAMA**, wretched as I am, like untoasbe-elepbant anxiously await ing ber mate in tbe forest. It behovetb thee to seek **RAMA**'s 386 friendship, that lion among men, if thou desireth to preserve Lanka and dost not wish to bring about thine own destruction. He is wise, conversant with every duty aod ever eager to serve those who seek his protection ; form an alliance with him if thou desirest to survive. Seek to conciliate Rams, who is full of devotion to those who take refuge in him and humbly conduct me to him once more. If thou dost bring me back to the greatest of the Raghus, thy well-being is assured but if thou dost act otherwise thou art doomed. Thou mayest evade the thunderbolt of **INDRA**, even death himself may over look thee but there will be no refuge for thee from the fury of Raghava, that lord of men, when thou dost hear the terrible twanging of Rams's bow resembling the thunderbolt hurled by **INDRA**. Soon shall those arrows, bearing the impress of **RAMA** aod **LAKSHMANA**, like serpents with flaming jaws, penetrate Lanka and those shafts, decorated with heron's

plumes, shall cover the whole city annihilating the titans. As Vainateya bears away great reptiles, so shall that eagle, Rams, speedily bear away the titans. " And like unto **VISHNU** wresting the radiant Shri from the *Asuras* by covering the worlds in three strides, so shall my lord, the destroyer of his foes, recover me from thee. " This cowardly deed has been perpetrated by thee in order to revenge thyself for the destruction of Janssthana and the hosts of the titans. In the absence of these two brothers, those lions among men who had gone forth hunting, didst thou carry me away, O Vile Wretch; but, dog that thou art, thou didst not dare stand before those tigers, **RAMA** and Lakshmans ! Wealth and friends will be of no avail to thee in conftict with them aod thou shalt be defeated as the one handed Vritra who entered into combat with the two-handed **INDRA**. " Soon shall my protector, Rams, accompanied by Saumitri, draw out thy life's breaths, as the sun with its rays dries up shallow water. Whether thou takest refuge in the abode of Kuvera or terrified, descendest into **VARUNA**'s realm, thou shalt assuredly perish, struck down by the son of **DASARATHA**, like a mighty tree felled by lightning."

CHAPTER 22

Ravana's Threats

"In the world it is said the more gentleness one manifests towards a woman, the more responsive she becomes, but the more kindness I show to thee the more thou dost repulse me. Verily only the Jove I bear thee restrains my wrath, as a skilful charioteer controls the horses who seek to leave the road. Mighty indeed is the power of Jove, for even if the object of his affection invoke his anger, man covers her with pity and

tenderness. It is on this account, O Lady of lovely mien, that I do not slay thee, thou dost merit death and dishonour, thou who delightest in asceticism without reason. For each and every harsh word which thou hast addressed to me, thou meritest a dreadfuJ end, O Maithili., Having spoken thus to **SITA**, the Princess of Videha, **RAVANA**, Lord of the Titans, filled with indignation, added :-" I shall grant thee two months as the term assigned to thee, after which thou must share my bed. If thou should'st refuse, my cooks shall mince thy limbs for my morning repast." Hearing these threats addressed by the King of the Titans to Janaki, the daughters of the Gods and Gandharvas were exceedingly perturbed and, by the expression of their lips and eyes and their gestures sought to reassure **SITA** thus menaced by him. Encouraged by them, **SITA**, fortified by her virtue and her pride in **RAMA**, addressed **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, in his own interests, saying : " It appears that there is none in this city who desires thy welfare and therefore seeks to prevent thee from this despicable deed. Who in the Three Worlds would desire to possess the chaste consort of the high-souled One, who resembles lndra's Sachi ? O Vilest of Demons, how wilt thou escape the con SUNDAilA *KANDA* sequences of this insult offered to llsma's consort, he whose valour is immeasurable ? Like unto an infuriated elephant, encountering a hare in the forest, so shalt thou, the wretehed hare, meet with that elephant llsma. Thou dost not fear to rail at the Chief of the Ikshwakus so long as thou art not in his presence. Why do not those cruel, terrible, coppery eyes of thine fall out, looking on me so lustfully, O Ignoble Creature ? O Contemptible Wretch, when thou didst threaten the spouse of that high-souled llsma, the daughter-in-law of King **DASARATHA**, why did not thy tongue dry up ? O Ten necked One, by the power of my asceticism, I could reduce thee to ashes instantly had I llsma's mandate. On account of my consuming virtue and ascetic

observances, I could never have been wrested from **RAMA**, were it not that thine evil act was to be the cause of thy destruction, O Dashagriva ! Assisted by the brother of Kuvera and proud of thine own heroism, thou didst lure **RAMA** from the herntitage and succeed in bearing me away by stealth." Hearing **SITA**'s words, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, cast ferocious glances at her. Like a mass of black clouds, with his enormous arms and neck, endowed with an elephantine gait, his eyes smouldering, his tongue like a darting flame, of immense stature, wearing a plumed diadem, covered with necklaces, sprinkled with perfume, decked with garlands and, bracelets of gold, his waist encircled with a dark blue belt so that it resembled the Mandara mountain encompassed by the snake at the time of the churning of the ocean ; with his vast arms, the Lord of the Titans looked like a mountain with twin peaks. Adorned with earrings gleaming like the rising sun, he resembled a hill between two Ashoka trees enveloped in crimson flowers and buds or like the wish-fulfilling tree or spring incarnate or an altar in a crematorium. Then llsvana cast furious glances from his bloodshot eyes at the Princess of Videha and, hissing like a serpent, addressed her, saying:-" O Thou who art attached to that wretch without resource or moral sense, I shall destroy thee to-day as the sun's radiance is obliterated at the time of dusk." Having spoken thus to Maithili, llsvana, the oppressor of his foes, looked at those female titans of formidable appearance, THB RAMA YANA OF VALMIKI some of whom had a single eye or ear, some enormous ears and some the ears of kine or elephants. Some had ears that hung down and some none at all, some had the feet of elephants, some of horses, some of kine, some were hairy, others possessed but a single eye and foot, some had enormous feet and others none at all. Some had heads and necks of inordinate size, some enormous chests and bellies, some dis proportionately large mouths and eyes or long tongues and nails and

some had no nose or possessed jaws like lions, some had mouths like oxen or snouts like pigs. Then **RAVANA**, transfiising those titans with his glance, said to them:-" Ye Titans seek by fair or foul means, by threats or persuasion or honeyed words or gifts to induce **SITA** to look on me with favour." Repeating his command again and again, the King of the Titans filled with desire and anger began to inveigh against Jaoaki, whereupon a female titan named Dhanyamalini, approaching Dashagriva, embraced him and said : " O Great King, enjay thyself with me, what need hast thou for this human being who is wretched and whose counten ance is pale ? O King of the Titans, it is not with her that the Gods have destined thee to taste the exquisite pleasures that are the reward of the strength of thine arms. He who loves one who is unwilling exposes himself to torment, whereas he whose love is reciprocated, enjoys perfect happiness." Having said this, the female titan drew **RAVANA** away but he, resembling a mass of cloud, turned back, laughing scornfully. Then Dashagriva strode away, causing the earth to tremble, and returned to his palace that shone with the brilliance of the orb of day. Surrounding **RAVANA**, the daughters of the Gods and Gand harvas as well as those of the Serpent Race returned to that sumptUous abode with him. Thus **RAVANA**, distracted with desire, left the Princeas of Mithila of irreproachable virtue trembling and entered his own dwelling.

CHAPTER 23

The female Titans seek to persuade Sita to wed Ravana

HAVING spoken thus to Maithili and issued his commands to the titan women, **RAVANA**, the scourge of his foes, went away. And that Sovereign of the Titans having returned to his inner apartment, those women of hideous appearance bore down on **SITA** and, filled with ire, addressed her in harsh tones, saying: " Thou dost not fully value an alliance with the offspring of Poulastya the illustrious **RAVANA**, the magnanimous Dashagriva, O **SITA**.u Thereafter, one among them named Ekjata, her eyes in flamed with anger addressed **SITA** of small belly, saying : “According to tradition, Poulastya is the fourth of the six Prajapatis, a mind-born son of **BRAHMA** renowned in all the world, O **SITA**, and that glorious Ascetic Vaishravas sprang from the mind of that great *Rishi* whose glory equalled the Praja patis. O Large-eyed Princess, his son was **RAVANA**, the scourge of his foes; it behoveth thee to become the consort of that King of Titans. Why dost thou not consent, O Thou of Lovely Form? " Thereupon another titan called Harijata, rolling her eyes that resembled a eat’s, said furiously : " It is for thee to become the wife of one who defeated the thirty-three Celestials and their king in combat ; dost thou not desire to be united with him who is heroic, of indomitable prowess and never turns back in battle ? Renouncing his cherished and beloved Queen Mandodsri, that mighty King **RAVANA** will be thine, and seek the gorgeous inner apartment, enriched by thousands of women adorned with jewels, and thou wilt be the object of his worship I " There followed another titan by name Vikata, who said : " He who again and again triumphs over the Gandharvas, Nagas and Danavas Dy his valour in battle has made advances 391 to thee, why dost thou not wish to be the wife of that illustrious Lord of Titans, **RAVANA**, who is endowed with riches ? " Thereafter the titan, Durmukhi spoke saying :-" O Lady of Lovely Lashes, why dost thou not yield to him, in fear of whom the sun dares not shine nor the wind blow,

at whose command the trees shower down their blooms and the hills and clouds loose their fioods. " O Beautiful One, why dost thou not consent to be the consort of that King of kings, **RAVANA** ? We speak thus for thy welfare ; accede to our request, O Goddess of Sweet Smiles or thou shalt surely die."!

CHAPTER 24

Their Menaces

"**W**hy dost thou not consent to dwell in that inner apart ment abounding in costly couches ? O Lady, thou pri2est union with a mere man ; dismiss **RAMA** from thy thoughts for assuredly thou wilt not see him more. Live happily with **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans as thy consort who owns the treasure of the Three Worlds. Thou art a woman, O Irre proachable Beauty, and for this dost mourn a man who is banished from his kingdom and who leads a life of misery." Hearing the words of those titans, **SITA**, her lotus eyes filled with tears, answered them, saying :-"What you have uttered is immoral and wholly reprehensible and will never lind acceptance with me. A mortal woman may not become the wife of a demon. Devour me, if you wish, I will never accede to your request. Poor or deprived of his kingdom, he who is my husband is my spiritual preceptor and I shall ever follow him, as Suvarchala follows the sun or the blessed Sachi re mains at **INDRA**'s side or Arundhati near **VASISHTHA** or Rohini by Shashin or LopRmudra by Agastya, Sukanya by Syavana, 392 Savitri by Satyavat, Shrimati by Kapila, Madayanti by Sandasa, Keshini by Sagara and Damayanti, the daughter of King Bhima by her Lord Naishada." These words of **SITA** infuriated those titan women, who had been sent by **RAVANA** and they

overwhelmed her with hard and bitter reproaches while **HANUMAN** crouched silently in the Shingshapa tree. And that monkey heard those demons threatening **SITA** in this wise. Surrounding **SITA** on every side, licking their burning lips again and again and, armed with spears, they menaced her in a paroxysm of rage, saying : " Dost thou think that the great King of the Titans, **RAVANA**, is not wonhy to be thy lord ? " Threatened by those terrible looking titan women, the lovely **SITA**, wiping away her tears, took refuge beneath the Shingshapa tree, where, surrounded by those women, that large-eyed princess, overcome with distress, seated herself. And all those hideous demons overwhelmed her with reprosches, as, clad in a mud-stained sari, reduced to the last extremity, her countenance wan, she remained absorbed in her grief. Thereupon, a grim-visaged demon, named Vinata, having hideous teeth, and a protruding belly, cried out angrily : " O **SITA**, thou hast demonstrated thy devotion to thy lord sufficiently but all excess leads to suffering. May good betide thee! We are satisfied, thou hast preserved the conventions common among men, now hear what I say to thee for thy good I Do thou take **RAVANA** for thy lord, he, the chief of the titan host who, like unto Vasava, triumphs over his enemies and is brave, liberal and gracious to all beings. Forsaking that wretched wight, **RAMACHANDRA**, take **RAVANA** as thy hus band ! Thy person, sprinkled with celestial perfume and adorned with excellent ornaments, do thou, O Vaidehi, like unto Swaha, the conson of **AGNI** or the goddess Sachi, wife of lndra, from to-day become the Queen of the Worlds I What shalt thou do with Ramo who is wretched and has but a short time to live ? If thou dost not follow my counsel, that very instant we shall devour thee." Thereafter, another titan, named VJkata, with pendulous breasts, clenching her fists angrily addressed **SITA**, saying :-: 393 " O Foolish Daughter of Mithila's King, out of compassion and forbearance, we

have endured thy harsh speech and yet thou dost not follow our sage and expedient counsel. Thou hast been transported to the furthet shore of the ocean which is inaccessible to otbets ; **RAVANA** has imprisoned thee in his private apartments to be guarded by us, O Maitbili, not even **INDRA** himself can liberate thee. Cease from weeping and lamenting and yield thyself up to pleasure and delight, O **SITA**; disport thyself with the King of the Titans. O Timid Damsel, dost thou not know how swiftly the youth of women is gone ? Ere it fades, pass thy days happily. Till then range the enchanting woods, groves and hills with the sovereign of the titans, O Thou of Sparkling Eyes I Thousands of women will attend on thee if thou dost take the lord of all the titans as thy consort, but if thou dost not follow my counsel, I will tear thy heart out and feast on it, O Maitbili." Then another titan of ferocious looks, named Chandari, brandishing a great spear, said: " Seeing this youthful woman, with the eyes of a young doe who was carried away by **RAVANA** and brought hither, whose breast is now trembling with fear, I feel an intense desire to feast on het liver, spleen, breast, heart, limbs and head." At this, a female titan called Praghasa, said : " Of what use to argue about het ? Let us stop the breath in the throat of this heartless woman and inform **RAVANA** of her death. He will undoubtedly say: 'Do ye devour her'." The titan, Ajamukhi then said : " Let us divide her equally ; disputation is unpleasing to me ; let our favourite drink and different garlands be brought hither speedily." At that moment the demon **SHURPANAKHA** *said*: " I am in full accord with Ajamukbi's words, let wine that dispels all anxiety be brought without delay. Gorged with human flesh, we will dance in the Nikumbbila Grove." Hearing the monstrous titan's threats, **SITA**, who resembled the daughter of a God, her endurance at an end, burst into tears.

CHAPTER 25

Sita gives way to Despair

THE many barbarous threats of the titan women, caused the daughter of **JANAKA** to give way to tears and the noble Vaidehi, terror stricken, in a voice broken by sobs, answered them, saying: " A mortal woman may not be the wife of a titan ; tear me to pieces if you will but I shall never follow your counsels." Surrounded by those demons and threatened by **RAVANA**, **SITA**, who resembled the daughter of a God, could find no refuge anywhere and, seized with violent trembling, she shrank away from them, as a fawn in the forest, separated from the herd, surrounded by wolves. Oinging to the flowering branch of an Ashoka tree, sunk in grief, **SITA** bethought herself of her lord. Streams of tears bathed her lovely breast and over come with affliction, she could see no end to her distress. Like a plantain tree uprooted by the storm, she lay, the fear tbat the titan women inspired in her blanching her cheek ; her long thick plait moving to and fro as she shook, resembling a gliding serpent. Groaning in her grief and overcome with indignation, Maithili, weeping, began to lament, exclaiming sorrowfully: " O **RAMA**!" and again, "O **LAKSHMANA** ", "O My Mother **KAUSHALYA** ", " O **SUMITRA** ". " True indeed is the saying of the sages : ' neither man nor woman can die ere the hour strikes ', since tormented by the savage titans and separated from **RAMA**, I am still able to survive an instant. Alas ! A woman of little virtue and wretched, I am about to die far from my protector as a laden vessel founders in the midst of the waves driven by the blast of the tempest. In the absence of my lord, I am sinking under the load of my affliction, like a river bank undermined by the current. Happy are those who are able to look upon my lord, whose eyes resemble the petals of

the blossoming trees, whose gait is like a lion’s and who is full of gratitude and gentle of speech. Deprived of the 395 presence of **RAMA** of subdued soul, it is as hard for me to brestbe as for bim who bas swallowed a virulent poison and henceforth my life is forfeit. What heinous fault have I committed in a previous existence that I should now have to suffer such cruel misfortune ? So intense is my grief that I long to die, but alas, I am surrounded by tbese titan women and cannot be reunited witb **RAMA**. Cursed is tbe human state, cursed is dependence on others, since one may not yield up one’s life when one so desires it.”

CHAPTER 26

Sita prophesies the Titan's Destruction

HER face batbed in tesrs, witb bowed hesd the daughter of **JANAKA** began to lament once more and, distracted witb grief, beside herself, she rolled on tbe esrth like a colt as tbough she had lost her senses, crying : " I, the spouse of Raghava, who allowed bimself to be deceived by the titans able to change their form at will, was seized by the ruthless **RAVANA** who bore me away. Having been made captive by the titans, subject to their insults and menaces, sunk in grief and anxiety, I am no longer able to endure life. Of what use is existence, weslth or jewels to me, living amidst tbe demons far from **RAMA** of the grest Car ? Assuredly my heart must be of iron, ageless and imperishable, since it does not break under mine aflliction. Woe is me, vile and wicked creature that I am, since I still bresthe, in tbe absence of my lord. Even my left foot shall not touch that Ranger of the Night, how should I feel any love for **RAVANA**, a titan ? He, who in bis perversity seeks to seduce me, is not conversant witb my nature, nor my race, nor tbe aversion in

wbich he is held by me. Tom to pieces, rent limb from limb or cast into tbe fire, I shall never submit to **RAVANA**, what use is there in further discussion ? " It is well known that Raghava is righteous, grateful and compassionate ; that he bas become pitiless is due to mine 396 evil kanna. Will he not deliver me, he who in Janasthana destroyed fourteen thousand titans singlehanded ? Even wete Lanka in the midst of the sea and inaccessible, Raghava's arrows would transcend all obstacles. What can prevent the valiant Ramo from rejoining his beloved wife, who has been borne away by a titan ? I fear that the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA** does not know that I am hete, for if he did, that warrior would not endure this affront. " The King of the Vultures, who would have informed **RAMA** of mine abduction, was slain by **RAVANA** in the struggle. Great indeed was the courage manifested by **JATAYU** in coming to mine aid and, despite his age, seeking to destroy **RAVANA**. Did Raghava know that I was here, this very hour, he would rid the world of titans with his llaming shafts ; he would burn up Lanka, swallow the ocean and blot out the might of **RAVANA**. From each dwelling the groans and cries of the female titans, their husbands slain, would have risen, as mine do now or even loudet, and Ramo, aided by **LAKSHMANA** would range the city, slaughtering the titans, for the foe in stantly yields up his life, who comes face to face with them. Then Lanka, its streets filled with smoke issuing from the funeral pyres, encircled by wreaths of vultures, would soon resemble a charnel house. Soon shall I be avenged ! This matter will cost you all dear, for such inauspicious omens are to be seen in Lanka, that she will soon be shorn of bet splendour. The King of the Titans, the vicious **RAVANA** having been slain, Lanka, now prosperous and happy, will resemble a widow. Assuredly I shall soon hear the wailing of the daughters of the titans in every dwelling, mourning in their sorrow. Plunged in darkness, deprived

of her glory, bet valiant titans slain, the city of Lanka will perish. consumed by Ramo's arrows, when that hero, the comers of whose eyes are red, learns that I am held captive in the titan's abode. The time fixed by that cruel and wicked **RAVANA** is at hand and that vicious wretch has resolved to destroy me. To ignore what is prohibited, is the practice of these base demons. Terrible is the calamity which will follow this outrage ; those titans who live on flesh are ignorant of virtue. Assuredly that titan 397 intends me for his morning repast ; I am helpless, what can I do in the absence of my beloved ? Deprived of my lord's presence, stricken with grief, not beholding **RAMA**, the comers of whose eyes are red, may I soon see the God Vaivasvata I Nay, the elder brother of **BHARATA** is unaware thst I still live, else he and **LAKSHMANA** would have scoured the earth for me. Without doubt, overwhelmed by my foes, thst warrior, the elder brother of Laksbrnana has renounced his body and repaired to the Celestial Region. Happy are the Gods, Gandharvas, Siddhas and the great *Rishis* who are able to look on the heroic **RAMA**. It may be thst the sagacious and royal Sage **RAMA**, has been absorbed in the Absolute and hath no longer any need of a consort or thst one who is present inspires joy, but the absent are forgotten. Perchance the fault is mine, and I have lost the right to happi ness, I, the lovely **SITA**, separated from the illustrious **RAMA**. Death to me is preferable to life, bereft of thst magnanimous One, thst great hero of imperishable exploits, the destrOyer of his foes! It may be thst the two brothers, those chiefs of men have laid down their arms, they who feed on the roots and woodland fruits, passing their lives in the forest or they have been put to death through treachery by the vile **RAVANA**, the last of the titans. If thst be so, then with all my heart I long for death nor is it forbidden me in my distress. Blessed are those high-souled ascetics who are illumined, their senses subdued, for whom there is neither desire nor aversion ; for them,

neither love nor hate gives rise to joy or pain ; they are free ; salutations to those great beings ! Forsaken by the beloved **RAMA**, versed in the science of the soul and having fallen into the power of the wicked **RAVANA**, I shall yield up my life."

CHAPTER 27

Trijata's Dream

THEsE words of **SITA** roused the female titans to great fury and some hurried away to repeat them to that vile creature, **RAVANA**. Then those monsters of hideous aspect approached her and hegan to threaten her in the same way as before with as little success and some said : " O Wretched **SITA**, to-day those demons whose destruction thou hast planned, will devour thy flesh at their pleasure." Seeing **SITA** threatened by those vile demons, **TRIJATA**, who was aged and prudent, said to them : " Ye Wretches, devour me, but do not lay hands on **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA** and the beloved daughter-in-law of King **DASARATHA**. Last night, I had a terrible dream causing my hair to stand on end, fore telling the overthrow of the titans and the triumph of this woman's husband." Hearing these words uttered by **TRIJATA**, all those titan women, filled with ire, terrified, demanded that she should speak further, saying :-" Do thou relate the manner of thy dream and what thou didst behold last night." Hearing those words, falling from the lips of the titan women, **TRIJATA** began to relate the dream that had come to her in the early hours, saying : "I beheld a celestial chariot made of ivory, drawn by a hundred swans traversing the ethereal regions in which Raghava accompanied by Lakshrnana stood clad in dazzling raiment, adorned with garlands. And I saw **SITA** wearing the purest white,

standing on a snow-white mountain surrounded by the sea and she was re-united with **RAMA**, as the light with the sun. And again I beheld Raghava seated on a mighry elephant possessing four tusks, resembling a hill, as also Laksh mana, whereupon those two lions among heroes, ablaze with their own effulgence, approached J anaki arrayed in dazzling robes and decked with garlands. Upon this, she mounted on the shoulders of an elephant led by her lord, appearing in the sky near the summit of that mountain ! Thereafter, that lotus-eyed one, rose into the air from her husband's embrace and I beheld her wiping the sun and moon with her hand. Then that foremost among elephants with those two princes and the large-eyed **SITA** stood over Lanka. "And again, in dream, I saw **RAMA**, clothed in brilliant attire, wearing garlands, accompanied by Lakshrnana, in a chariot drawn by eight white bullocks and I beheld that foremost of 399 men, **RAMA**, whose essence is valour with his brother Laksh mana and **SITA** ascending a celestial fiowery car, bright as the sun, driving towards the notthem regions. "Then I saw **RAVANA**, lying on the eatth covered in oil, shaven, attired in red, garlanded with oleander fiowers, intoxicated and still drinking. And I beheld him falling from the fiowery chariot, Pushpaka, on to the earth, shorn, wearing a black cloth, dragged hithet and thither by a woman. Thereafter I saw him seated in a chariot drawn by asses, robed in red, with his body stained likewise, quaffing sesamum oil, laughing and dancing, his mind confused, his senses clouded, speeding

CHAPTER 28

Sita's Lament

Threatened by **RAVANA** and encircled by the titans, that timid damsel gave way to despair like a young girl abandoned in a wood. She reftected : " The sages affirm truly that death does not come before the appointed hour since, worthless creature that I am, I still live after these insults. Bereft of happiness, filled with misery, my heart must be hard indeed that it does not break into a hundred pieces this day, like the crest of a mountain strUck by lightning. Nay, I am not to blame for this -I may be slain by that dreadful monster but I can no more give him my affection than a *brahmin* can impart the teachings of the Veda to one of low caste. If that Lord of the Worlds does not appear at the appointed hour, that vile King of the Titans will cut me to pieces with his sharp weapons as a sur· geon cuts the foetus from the heart of its mother. Two months will quickly pass away and I shall have to suffer the pain of death, unhappy creature that I am, like a thief, who having disobeyed his sovereign is bound and being led to execution when the night is over. " O **RAMA**, O **LAKSHMANA**, O **SUMITRA** I O Mother of **RAMA** I O My Mothers! I am about to perish miserably as a ship foundering in the sea battered by the storm. Assuredly those two valiant princes must have fallen under the blows of that creature disguised as a deer, like a bull or lion struck by light· ning. There is no doubt that it was fate in the furm of a deer that deluded me, unfortunate creature that I am and in my fully I sent those two princes, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** to capture it. Alas I O **RAMA**, O Thou of trUthful vows and long arms I O Thou, whose countenance shines like the full moon ! O My Life, thou, the benefactor and friend of all beings, art not aware that I am about to be put to death by the titans. For me, who have no other God tban my lord, my patience, my sleeping on the bare ground, my observance of duty, my devotion to my husband have all been in vain, as a service rendered to one who is ungrateful. Vain has it been, that I have fulfilled my duty and that I am

wholly devoted to thee alone since I do not behold thee and in thine absence, wasting away, pale and weak, have given up all hope of being re-united with thee. Having courageously carried out 402 the behests of thy sire, having fu11illed thy vow, returning from the forest, thou shalt sport with many large-eyed ladies in peace. O **RAMA**, I, who conceived a lasting love for thee, to mine own destruction was wholly attached to thee ; having practised asceticism and observed my vows, I am about to lose my life, woe unto me, unfortunate wreteh that I am ! Gladly would I take my life by means of poison or by sharp weapons but there is none who will bring them to me in this city of the titans." Overcome by sorrow, reliecting for a long time, **SITA** undid the cord that tied her hair, saying :-"I shall bang myself with this cord and reach the abode of death." Then the lovely **SITA**, whose form was full of grace, toOk hold of a branch of the tree under which she stood and became absorbed in the thought of **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and her kinsfollt; and many auspicious signs removing her grief and lending her courage, well-known in the world, appeared to her, in dicating the advent of future well-being.

CHAPTER 29

Sita observes auspicious Ponents

WHILST the irreproachable and lovely princess remained bereft of joy and full of anxiety, she beheld auspicious portents on every side, resembling willing servants attendant on a wealthy man. And the large left eye of that lady of lovely looks, with its dark pupil, began to twitch like a lotus set spinning by a fish. And her beautiful plump and rounded arm, sprinkled with sandal and aloes which ere this, had served her lord

as a pillow, began to tremble again and again. Her left thigh, like unto the tapering trunk of an elephant, moved convul sively foretelling that she would soon behold **RAMA** and the golden sari, now covered with dust, of the large-eyed Maithili, whose teeth were like the seeds of a pomegranate, slipped from her beautiful shoulders. Comforted by these signs and others also, that fOretold a happy ending, **SITA** of lovely lashes resembling a plant dried by the wind and sun, reviving under tardy rain, experienced a great felicity. Then her countenance, her lips like Bimba fruit, her beautiful eyes, the curve of her lashes and her sharp teeth, recovered their beauty once more as the moon issuing from the mouth of lbhu. Her despair and exhaustion removed, her fever allayed, her grief was assuaged and her heart filled with joy and that noble lady looked as beautiful as the moon of cool rays in its waxing period.

CHAPTER 30

Hanuman's Reflections

THE valiant **HANUMAN** who bad heard all that **SITA**, **TRIJATA** and the titans had said, gazed on that illustrious damsel who resembled a celestial being from the Nandana Gardens and many thoughts flitted through the mind of that monkey. He rellected : " She, who was sought in every place by thousands and millions of monkeys, is here and it is I who have found her. Engaged as a skilful spy to disoover the strength of the enemy I have stolen into the city and know everything concerning the might of **RAVANA** and the resources of the titans as also of their capital. It is for me to console the consort of that immeasurably illustrious prince, who is com passionate to all beings, for she is pining for her lord. I shall seek to gain the confidence of this lady, whose

countenance resembles the full moon, who formerly was unacquainted with suffering and who cannot see any end to her woes. If I return, without having comforted that virtuous lady whose soul is overwhelmed with grief, my journey will have been in vain. In sooth, when I have departed, that illustrious Princess Janaki, giving up all hope of deliverance, will yield up her life and that long-armed watrior, whose countenance resembles the full To speak to her in the presence of these titans is impossible, what then shall I do ? I am in a great dilemna. If I do not give her some reassurance in the last hour of the night, she will undoubtedly give up her life and if **RAMA** enquires of me, ' What did **SITA** of slender waist say ? ' what answer can I give to him if I have had no converse with her ? If I return without having achieved my purpose regarding **SITA**, Kakutstha will consume me with his fiery glance, then it were vain to urge my master to take action for Rams's sake, by placing himself at the head of his forces. " I shall take the first opportunity offered by these titan women to reassure that sorely ttied lady, yet in this insigni ficant form and monkey shape, if I assume a human voice and spcsk in sanskrit like a sage, Sits will deem me to be **RAVANA** and she will be terrified! It is essential however that I express myself in the human tongue, how otherwise can I inspire this irreproachable lady with courage ? Seeing my shape and hear ing me speak, Janaki, who has been terrorised by the titans, will be seized with an even greater fear and that illusttious and large-eyed Sits will ety out, imagining me to be **RAVANA**, who is able to change his form at will. " Hearing her ccy, the whole company of titans, armed with every kind of weapon, will form themselves into a great mass resembling death itself and, hideous and indomitable, will rush on me from every side and seek to destroy me or take me captive. Then, beholding me leap from branch to branch and climb to the tops of the highest trees, they will become exceedingly

alarmed and will fill the woods with their wild cties ; thereafter they will call the titans who are engaged in guarding the king's palace to their aid and, on account of their native excitability, will seize hold of every kind of weapon, spears, darts, and swords and hasten to join in the fray. Surrounded by them on all sides, if I slay that host of titans, exhausted, I shall be unable to cross the ocean or they, out numbering me, will succeed in capturing me and, being a prisoner, that lady will reap no benefit from my attempt. " Alternatively, in their passion for evil doing, they may even slay the daughter of **JANAKA**, which will completely defeat the great design of **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** I Janaki dwells in an 405 inaccessible and secret place surrounded by the sea, guarded on all sides by the titans with all its approaches closed. If I am slain or captured by the titans in combat, I know of no other monkey who can cross the four hundred miles of sea. Even if I destroy thousands of titans, I should not then be able to reach the other shore of the vast ocean. Battles are hazardous and I do not like to engage in so uncertain an enter prise ; wbat wise person would take any risk in a matter of trust? It would be a great error to frighten Vaidehi by address ing her, yet if I do not do so, she will surely perish. Under takings often fail through an incompetent messenger unable to take advantage of time and place, as darkness is overcome by the rising sun ; in such cases, whether it concerns the accom plishment or avoidance of any matter, the most widely planned projects do not succeed. Assuredly a presumptuous messenger ruins all ! How shall I act therefore, so tbat my mission does not prove vain ? How shall I show myself equal to this charge ? How shall the crossing of the ocean not prove to bave been use less ? How can I persuade **SITA** to listen to me without inspiring fear in her ? " Having put all these questions to himself, **HANUMAN** formed the following resolution : " I shall speak to her of Rams of inunortal exploits, for then his dear consort

will not be afraid of me since she is wholly absorbed in the thought of her lord. In a gentle voice, utter ing the name of Rams, the foremost of the Ikshwakus of subdued soul and, lauding his piety and renown in sweet accents, I shall induce Sits to listen to me. There is nothing I will not do to inspire her with confidence., Thereupon, the mighty **HANUMAN**, looking down on the consort of the Lnrd of the World from the branches of the tree where he sat concealed, spoke to her in melodious and candid tones.

31 . Hanuman praises Rama

" There was a king named **DASARATHA**, the possessor of chariots, horses and elephants, one by nature devout and illustrious, the glory of the Ikshwakus. To harm none was his delight and he was high-minded and compassionate, a true hero of his race that found its splendour and the growth of its prosperiry in him. Clad in all the insignia of royalty and majesty, that lion among kings, renowned in the four regions, shed the felicity he enjoyed over all. His beloved eldest son, whose countenance was as bright as the moon, was called Rams, possessor of a keen intellect and the most skilled of archers. Faithful to his vows, the defender of his people, the protector of all beings, upholder of justice, he was the scourge of his foes. " At the command of his aged sire, his word his bond, that hero accompanied by his consort and his brother was banished to the forest. Whilst giving himself up to the chase in that vast solitude, he slew large numbers of valiant titans who were able to change their form at will. When **RAVANA** learnt that he had destroyed Janasthana and killed Khars and Dushana, he in fury, bore Janaki away, having lured her lord far into the forest by the aid of Marich in the form

of a deer. " Whilst searching everywhere to discover the divine and irreproachable **SITA**, Rams found a friend in the forest, the Monkey **SUGRIVA**, Bringing about the destructinn of Bali, Rams, the conqueror of hostile cities, conferred the monkey kingdom on the msgnanimous **SUGRIVA** and by his decree, thousands of monkeys, able to change their form at will, set out to search for that goddess in every region. I am one of those who, at the instance of Sampati, crossed the sea four hundred miles in width, on account of that large-eyed beauty. Hearing of her comeliness, her grace and distinguishing characteristics from **RAMA**, I have been enabled to find her at last." Having spoken thus, that bull among monkeys fell silent. And Janaki was extremely astonished, hearing that speech and brushing aside her lovely tangled locks which concealed her face, she looked up into the Shingshapa tree. Hearing the words of that monkey, **SITA** glanced enquiringly flooded her whole being as she remembered Ramo. Then, glancing from side to side and up and down, she espied the son of Vata, who resembled the rising sun, that minister of the King of the Monkeys of incomparable wisdom.

32 . Sita sees Hanuman

among the branches, bright as a cluster of Ashoka flowers and like gold refined in the crucible, **SITA** was greatly agitated. Observing that foremost of monkeys of humble mien, Maithili said to herself in extreme surprise: "Ah ! What a terrible looking monkey, unacceptable and hideous to behold." Thinking thus, her fears increased and she broke into countless plaintive lamentations. Then tbe lovely **SITA** cried out in her terror : " O **RAMA**, O **RAMA**, O **LAKSHMANA** ! " and the voice of that virtuous princess grew fainter and fainter till, casting her eyes on

that excellent monkey once more, who had assumeii a reverent attitude, Maithili said to herself: " It must be a dream.” Observing the face of that lndra among Monkeys with its deep scars as has been described and, looking on that excellent ape, the most honourable son of the Wind, the first of the wise, **SITA** lost consciousness and became like one dead. There after, slowly regaining her senses, she said to herself: " This vision of a monkey is condemned by the scriptuses and is an inauspicious dream! Can aU be well with **RAMA**, who is accom panied by **LAKSHMANA** and my father King Janaks ? Yet it can be no dream for, in the grief and misfortune that over whelms me, I am no longer able to sleep and, far from him whose countenance resembles the full moon, no joy remains for me. Through conatantly thinking and calling on **RAMA**, I imagine I hear and see only those things which are related to **RAMA**. For my love is a torment, my whole being flows 408 towards him, ever absorbed in his rememberance I see and hear him alone. Is it an illusion ? This is what perturbs me and makes me uneasy. I deem this to be but a phantom of the mind yet thinking thus, I still behold it, while an imaginary object can nevet have a form and he who is thus addressing me has a distinct form. Salutations to Vachaspati who is accompanied by the God who bears the Thunderbolt ! Saluta tions to Swyambhu and the God who partakes of offerings I May they grant that the creature who has spoken in my presence, be real and not illusory I "

CHAPTER 33

Hanuman's Converse with the Princess Sita

SLIPPING down from the. tree, **HANUMAN**, whose face was the colour of coral, attired in a humble guise, approached **SITA** and that mighry son

of the Wind with joined palms addressed her in gentle tones, saying : “Who art thou, O Lady, whose eyes resemble lotus petals, who, wearing a soiled silken garment att supporting thyself by the braneh of the tree ? O Irreproachable One, why are tears of suffering falling from thine eyes, that resetnble the lotus, as water ftows from a broken vessel? O Fair One, who att thou among the Celestials, Titans, Nagas, Gandharvas, Rakshas, Yakshas and Kinneras? Or do the Rudras claim that thou an born of them or the Wind-gods or the Vasus, O Lady of exquisite features? To me thou appearest to be of divine origin. Art thou Rohini, foremost and most brilliant of stars, who, separated from the moon has fallen from the abode of the immortals ? Or an thou the lovely dark-eyed Arundhati, who hath 1led in wrath or in pride from her lord, Shri Vasishrha? Is it for a son, a father, a brother or a husband, whose departure from this world thou att mourning, O Lady of slender waist ? By thy tears and sighs and thy lying on the earth, it seems to me that thou an not a celestial being and further thou dost evet and again call on the name of a king. From the marks on 409 thy person I deem thee to be the consort or the daughtet of a monarch. Art thou not **SITA**, who was ruthlessly borne away by **RAVANA** from Janasthana? May prosperity attend thee I From thy wretched plight, thine unrivalled beauty and thine ascetic garb, I deem thee to be **RAMA**’s consort.” Hearing **HANUMAN**’s words and filled with joy at the sound of **RAMA**’s name, Vaidehi answeted him, as he stood beneath the tree, saying : " I am the daughtet·in-law of **DASARATHA**, foremost among the kings of the world, a knowet of the Self, the destroyet of hostile armies. I am the daughter of King **JANAKA**, the magnanimous sovereign of Videha and my name is **SITA**, the consort of the highly intelligent **RAMA**, who is endowed with wisdom. For twelve years I dwelt in Raghava’s abode, experiencing every earthly delight and satisfying evety desire. In the

thirteenth year, the king, with the approval of his ministers, resolved to install **RAMA**, the joy of the House of Ikshwaku on the throne. As they were preparing to anoint **RAMA** as heir-apparent, Queen **KAIKEYI** addressed bet lord, saying : " I will neither eat nor drink of that which is served to me each day but sball put an end to my existence if **RAMA** be installed. Let the boons that, in gratitude, thou didst grant me, be redeemed and let Raghava repair to the forest '. " The king, faithful to his bond, recollected the boons made to the queen and hearing those cruel and unpleasing words was lost in grief. Then that aged monarch, adhering firmly to his vow, weeping, besought his eldest son to renounce the throne. That illustrious prince to whom the words of his sire were more to be prized than the throne, inwardly assenting, promised to obey. **RAMA**, evet a givet, seeking no return, truthful, never utteting a falsehood even wete his life to be made forfeit, is essentiaiiy brave. Laying aside his costly attire, the highly glorious **RAMA** with his whole heart, re nounced the kingdom and gave me into his mothet's keeping, but I, assuming the garb of an ascetic, quickly prepared to accompany him to the forest, for, separated from him, I could not bear to dwell even in the celestial regions. Then the fortunate Saumiui, the enhancer of his friends' delight, donning robes of bark and kusha grass also prepared to follow his elder brother. In deference to the will of our sovereign, firm in our vows, we entered the dark and unknown forest. While that one of immeasurable effulgence was dwelling in the Dandaka Forest, I, his consort, was carried away by the Titan, **RAVANA** of perverse soul. Two months is the time fixed by him, after which I am to die."

CHAPTER 34

Sita's hesitations on seeing Hanuman

her, said: " O Divine Vaidehi, by Rams's decree I have come as a messenger to thee; he is safe and enquires as to thy welfare. Rams, the son of **DASARATHA**, who is versed in the Veda, con versant with the use of the Brahmastra, the foremost of the lesmed, offers salutations to thee, O Queen I The highly resplendent **LAKSHMANA** too, the most powerful and cherished companion of thy lord, in the midst of his burning anxieties, bows before thee and wishes thee well." Hearing of the welfare of those two lions among men, Sits, trembling with delight, said to **HANUMAN** :-"Verily the wise say that happiness visits a man even if it be at the end of a hundred years." Thereupon Sits and **HANUMAN** began to converse with delight and mutual confidence. Hearing Sits speak in this wise, **HANUMAN**, the son of Maruts drew nearer to her who had been overwhelmed with grief and, as he did so, she grew apprehensive and reflected :-"Alas ! Why have I entered into converse with him? It is **RAVANA** in another guise!" There upon, letting go the Ashoka branch, Maithili of faultless limbs, exhausted with suffering, sank down on the earth. Then that long-armed monkey bowed unto **JANAKA**'s daughter, who, filled with terror, did not dare raise her eyes to him, yet, 4II seeing him bowing humbly before her, **SITA**, whose face re sembled the moon, sighed deeply and said to him in gentle accents: "If thou **RAVANA**'s self, who has assumed a perfidious guise in order to increase my distress, it is a vile act. Thou art he, who, renouncing his own shape, appeared to me in J anasthana as a mendicant, O Ranger of the Night. O Thou, wearing shapes at will, it doth not behove thee to torment me, who am distressed and emaciated with fasting. "Yet thou

canst not be he whom I fear, since my heart feels delight in seeing thee. If thou art truly **RAMA**'s messenger, may good betide thee I Thou art welcome, O Best of Monkeys for it is sweet to me to hear of **RAMA**. Set forth the virtues of **RAMA**, O Monkey, and ravish my soul, O Gentle One, as the current of a river bears away its banks. O how sweet a dream does an inhabitant of the woods bring to me so long after mine abduction ! If I might only see the valiant Raghava accompanied by **LAKSHMANA** once more but even a dream denies me this delight. Can it be a dream ? To see a monkey in dream does not give rise to happiness yet I am happy now ! Is my mind not deranged or has fasting disturbed the humours of my body and caused this delusion or is it perchance a mirage ? Nay, it cannot be an hallueination for I am in full possession of my senses and perceive this monkey clearly." Such were the thoughts that haunted **SITA**, as also that the titans were able to change their form at will, which convinced her that this was the King of the Titans himself. Having anived at this conclusion, the daughter of **JANAKA**, of slender waist, ceased to converse with the monkey but **HANUMAN**, divining what was passing through her mind, consoled her with sweet words, enhancing her delight saying: " Bright as the sun and like the moon, beloved of all, that sovereign of the world is as munificent as Kuvera. In valour resembling the glorious Vishou, of sweet and truthful speech like unto Vachaspati, handsome, illustrious and fortunate like the God of Love, the just dispenser of punishment to evil-doers, he is the foremost of car-warriors in the world. " He in whose anus the whole world takes refuge, that magnanimous Raghava was lured away from the hermitage by means of Maricha in the form of a deer, thus allowing **RAVANA** to bear thee away. Soon shall that mighty hero destroy **RAVANA** in combat with his fiery shafts discharged in anger. It is he, who has sent me with these tidings. Worn with grief at thy separation, he enquires as to thy

welfare, as also the highly resplendent **LAKSHMANA**, enhancer of **SUMITRA**'s delight, who offers salutations to thee. The king of the monkey hosts, **SUGRIVA** by name, who is **RAMA**'s friend, also pays homage to thee; **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SUGRIVA** have thee ever in mind ; though subject to the titans, by good fornme thou dost still live, O Vaidehi. Ere long thou shalt behold **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** of the great car with **SUGRIVA** of limitless prowess. "I am **SUGRIVA**'s minister, the monkey **HANUMAN**, I have entered the city uf Lanka, having crossed the ocean, thus setting my foot on the head of **RAVANA** of perverse soul. I have come here to see thee, depending on my own prowess, I am not he whom thou deemest me to he. Do thou renounce thy doubts, and have confidence in my words."

CHAPTER 35

Hanuman makes himself known to Sita

" **W**here didst thou encounter **RAMA** and how didst thou come to know **LAKSHMANA**? How did men and monkeys come to form an alliance ? O Monkey, describe the distinctive characteristics of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** once again and so dispel my grief. Speak to me uf **RAMA**'s grace and form, his arms and thighs, as well as **LAKSHMANA**'s." To these questions of Vaidehi, **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, began to give a detailed description of **RAMA** and said : " By good fortune, recognising me to be a messenger of **RAMA**, O Vaidehi, whose eyes are as large as lotus petals, thou hast asked me to describe the person of thy lord as well as that 413 of **LAKSHMANA**. O Large-eyed Lady, hear me while I tell thee of those marks of royalty I have observed in the persons of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. O Daughter of **JANAKA**,

RAMA has eyes like unto lotus petals, his countensnce resembles the moon and he is endowed with great beauty and virtue. In radiance like the sun, in patience resembling the earth, in wisdom like unto Brihaspati, in renown equal to Vasava, he is the protector of all beings and the upholder of his race, the guardisn of law and tradition and the scourge of his foes. O Lovely One, **RAMA** is the preserver of the people and the four castes, he inaugurates and establishes the social order, he is worshipped by all like the sun and is an observer of pious vows ; he knows well the proper time to pay honour to holy men and is conversant with the path of right action. " Born with royal prerogatives, the servant of the *brahmins*, learned, endowed with nobility, humble, he is the scourge of his foes. Versed in the Y ajur Veda, honoured by those con versant with the Vedas, he is proficient in archery and possesses a thorough knowledge of the Vedas and V edangas. Broad shouldered, long-armed, handsome, possessing a conch-shaped neck his ribs are well covered and muscular and his eyes are red ; such is **RAMA** renowned among men. The tone of his voice resembles the Dundubhi, his skin is smooth, his three limbs, thigh, fist and wrist are hard, and the others, long, his navel, abdomen and breast are well-proponioned and high. The rims of his eyes, his nails and palms are red, his voice and gait grave ; there are three folds in the skin of his hody and neck ; the lines on the soles of his feet and breast are deep ; his neck, hack and thighs are muscular ; his hair is coiled in three circles ; his thumb is marked with four lines indicating his deep knowledge of the Vedas ; there are four lines on his forehead, the sign of a long life ; he is four cubits in height ; his arms, thighs and cheeks are plump ; wrists, knee-joints, hips, hands and feet are well-proportioned, his four front teeth have auspicious marks ; his gait is like a lion’s, a tiger’s, an elephant’s or a hull’s; his lips and jaws are fleshy, his nose long, his face, speech, down and skin, cool

; his two arms, little fingers, thighs and legs, alender ; his countenance, eyes, mouth, tongue, lips, palate, breast, 414 nails and feet resemble lotuses ; his forehead, neck, arms, navel, feet, back and ears are ample. He is gifted with grace, renown, and radiance ; his lineage is pure on both sides ; his armpits, abdomen, breast, nose, shoulders and forehead are elevated ; his fingers, hair, down, nails, skio, eyesight and intellect, clear and sharp. Raghava delights in what is just and true, he is filled with energy and is well able to judge how to act under all circumstances ; he is benevolent to all. " His brother Saumitri, whose mother is second in rank among the queens, whose glory is intmeasurable, resembles him in beauty, devotion and good qualities ; he is of a golden complexion whereas **RAMA** is dark of hue. Those two tigers among men, who yearn to see thee once more, scouring the earth for thee, with us in the forest. Ranging the earth in search of thee they beheld the King of the Monkeys, who had been banished by his elder brother, at the foot of the Rishyamuka Mountain that is covered by innumerable trees. We in attendance on the handsome **SUGRIVA**, Lord of the Monkeys, who had been driven from the kingdom by his elder brother and, beholding those foremost of men, clad in bark, bearing splendid bows in their hands, that monkey fled to the summit of the mountain, distrscted with terror. Thereafter he sent me out to meet them in all haste and, at **SUGRIVA**'s command, I approached those two princes, those lions among men, with joined palms. " Distinguished by their handsome features, those two heroes, being informed of what had taken place, were well pleased and I, placing them on my shoulders, transported them to the crest of the hill where the magnanimous **SUGRIVA** was to be found. There I related all to **SUGRIVA** and they conversed together and a great friendship grew up between those illustrious persons, the King of the Monkeys, and those monarchs among men. Then they comforted each other, narrating their

respective misfortunes and **LAKSHMANA**'s elder brother consoled **SUGRIVA** who had been banished by Bali of great prowess on account of the love of a woman. Thereafter, **LAKSHMANA** related the suffering and loss that had befallen **RAMA** to **SUGRIVA**, who, hearing this recital from his lips, was bereft of his radiance like the sun under eclipse. Then 415 gathering together all the ornaments that thou didst let fall on the earth when the Titan bore thee away, the monkeys brought them to **RAMA** with delight, but they were ignorant of where thou wen. " All those ornaments which had fallen tinkling to the ground, and had been collected by me, I gave over to **RAMA**, who was beside himself with grief and, clasping them to his breast, that God of divine beauty, the son of **DASARATHA**, inftamed with grief, with many groans bewailed his loss. For a long time that magnanimous hero lay crushed under the weight of his aflliction and I addressed many words of comfon to him, persuading him to rise. Whereopon **RAMA** with Saumitri, gazing again and again on those precious objects, gave them over to **SUGRIVA**. In thine absence, O Noble Lady, Raghava is consumed with grief, like a volcano burning with perpetual fire. On account of thee, sleeplessness, sorrow and care consume the magnanimous **RAMA**, as the sacred fires bum down a temple in which they are enclosed. The pain of thy separation has shattered him as a violent earthquake shatters a great mountain. O Daughter of a King, he wanders among the enchanting woods, on river banks and by the side of waterfalls but nowhere finds delight. O Daughter of Jauaka, ere long, **RAMACHANDRA** will undoubtedly bring about the destruction of **RAVANA** with all his kith and kin, and that foremost of men will soon liberate thee. " It was thus that **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** entered into a friendly alliance to encompass Bali's destruction and institute a search for thee. Thereupon, retUrning to Kiahkindha with those two heroic princes, that lord of monkeys slew

Bali in battle and having struck him down by his prowess in fight, **RAMA** made **SUGRIVA** king of all the monkeys and bears. Such was the alliance between **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA**, O Goddess, know then that I am **HANUMAN** who have come as their deputy. When he had recovered his kingdom, **SUGRIVA**, gatheriug all the great and powerful monkeys together, sent them fonh to every region to seek for thee. Under the commands of their king, **SUGRIVA**, those mighty monkeys, equal to the lndra of Moun tains, scoured the land on every side. Since that time, in fear of **SUGRIVA**, those monkeys have been exploring the whole 416 earth ; I am one of those. The mighty and illusaious son of Bali, **ANGADA** by name, set out with a third patt of the attny under him ; many were the days and nights we spent over whelmed with distress, having lost our way on the foremost of mountains, Vindhya. Despairing of accomplishing our pur pose and the time appointed having passed, in fear of that lord of the monkeys, we resolved to give up our lives. Having searched the mountains and the inaccessible fastnesses, the rivers and waterfalls without finding any trace of thee, we made up our minds to die. Thereafter we began our final fast on the sununit of the mountain. " Submerged in an ocean of grief, **ANGADA** lamented un ceasingly, retlecting on thine abduction, O Vaidebi, on the death of Bali, on our resolution to die of hunger and on the death of]atayu. Whilst we were fasting thus, waiting for death, having given up all hope of carrying out the behests of our lord, to the good fortune of our enterprise, there appeared, a mighty vulture, the brother of **JATAYU**, by name Sampati. Hearing of his brother's death, he cried out in anger : " By whom was my younger brother slain and where does he dwell ? I wish to hear this from you, O Excellent Monkeys I ' " Thereupon, **ANGADA** related all in detail to him and how that Titan of terrible form destroyed **JATAYU** on thine account in Janastbana. In his grief for]atayu's death, that son of

Aruna told us that thou wast to be found in **RAVANA**'s abode, O Exquisite Damsel I " Hearing the words of Sampati, our joy was extreme and led by him we all rose up and, leaving the Vindhya Mountain came to the shores of the sea. There a cruel anxiety seized the monkeys anew, eager as they were to find tbee, but I was able to dispel that sharp anguish of the monkey host, who beholding the main had lost heart. Then, removing their fear I leapt a hundred leagues over the sea and entered Lanka by night, which was filled with titans; there I beheld **RAVANA** and saw thee overcome with grief, O Irreproachable Lady ! " Now I have told thee all, do thou, in thy turn speak to me, O Goddess I I am the messenger of the son of **DASARATHA** and have come here to thee, to carry out Rams's purpose. Know me to be **SUGRIVA**'s minister and the Wind-god's son I AU 417 is well with thy lord, Kakutstha, the foremost of those bearing weapons, as also with **LAKSHMANA** possessed of auspicious tnatks and ever engaged in the worship of his superiors and the well-being of his lord. " I have come here at **SUGRIVA**'s command and have accom plished the journey alone. Changing my form at will, I have scoured the southern region and, in my eagerness to find thee, have sought thee on every side. With tidings of thee, I shall by divine grace be able to dispel the grief of the monkey host, who have been lamenting on thy account and my cross ing the ocean will not have been in vain. I shall win renown for having found thee, O Goddess and the highly powerful Raghava will rejoin tho. without delay, having first slain **RAVANA**, the king of the Titans with his sons and relatives. "Mount Malyavat is the highest of mountains, O Vaidehi, and there dwells my sire, Kesatin. Obedient to the will of the divine Sages, he once repaired to Gokarna and at that sacred spot belonging to the Lord of the Rivers, brought about the destruction of the Titan, Samvasadana. I was born of the consort of Kesarin, O Maithili

and my name is **HANUMAN** ; I am known throughout the world for my exploits. To inspire thee with confidence, I have described the virtues of thy lord. Ere long, O Goddess, Raghava will certainly take thee hence." Reassured by the proofs given to her, **SITA**, exhausted by suffering, recognised **HANUMAN** to be **RAMA**'s messenger. Then Janaki, in an excess of joy, allowed tears of felicity to fall from her eyes fringed with dark lashes. The gentle counten ance of that large-eyed damsel with her reddened eyes shone like the moon released from Rahu's hold. Taking him for a real monkey at last, she re11ected in herself: " How could it be otherwise ? " Then **HANUMAN** again addressed that lady of charming mien, saying: " I have told thee all, now have confidence in me, O Maithili! What more can I do for thee and what is thy pleasure, ere I return ? When the Asurs, Samvasadana was destroyed in combat by the foremost of monkeys at the behest of the celestial sages, I was born of Vayu, O Maithili, and though a monkey, I am his equal in prowess ! "

CHAPTER 36

Sita questions Hanuman

assuring words, saying : " O Fortunate One, I am a monkey, the messenger of the sagacious **RAMA**; behold this precious ring on which his name is engraved ! O Goddess, it was given to me by that magnani mous hero so that thou shouldst have faith in me. Take heart therefore, may good betide thee ! Soon shall there be an end to thy grief ! " Then Janaki, taking the jewel that had adorned the finger of her lord, was overcome with joy, as if he himself were present. Her gentle countenance with its large eyes began to sparkle with delight resembling the moon released from Rahu's hold. Blushing with pleasure on

receiving this token from her lord, that youthful woman, in her satisfaction, began to look on that great monkey as on a friend and paid tribute to him in the following wise : " O Foremost of Monkeys, verily thou who have entered this city of **RAVANA**'s alone, art full of courage, valour and address. With admirable tenacity thou hast traversed the ocean, four hundred miles in breadth, the abode of great monsters, reducing it to the measure of a cow's hoof. I do not look on thee as an ordinary monkey, O Uon among Forest Dwellers, aince thou dost not stand in awe of **RAVANA**. O Best of Monkeys, thou hast merited associstionship with me, since **RAMA** the knower of Self has dispatched thee as hia messenger. It is certain that the invincible **RAMA** would never have sent thee to me without first testing thy prowess. By good fortune the virtuous and truthful **RAMA** as also the illustrious Laksh mana, enhancer of **SUMITRA**'s delight, are well, yet if Kakutstha live 1111touched by ill, how is it that he doea not bum up the earth encircled by the sea in his wrath like the fires at the dis solution of the worlds ? Those two heroes are able to subdue the Gods themselves and yet they refrain from action ; I deem therefore that my sufferings are still not at an end ! Is **RAMA** not disquieted ; is he not tom with anxiety on my account ? Is that son of a king making every preparation to deliver me ? Is he sorrowful and pre-occupied ? Has he lost sight of his ultimate purpose ; is he fulfilling his duty with fortitude ? Is that slayer of his foes, desirous of victory, propitiating his friends with forbearance and gifts and employing the three fold means of desling with his enemies ? Does he show good will to his friends and have they confidence in him ? Does he ally himself with those of good repute and do they pay him honour ? Does that son of a king seek the favour of the Gods; does he depend on them for his power and fortune ? Has **RAMA**'s affection for me decreased as a result of my living far from him ? Will he deliver me

from this peril ? Is he not unstrung by this extreme misfortune, being accustomed to felicity and unused to adversity? Has he received frequent good tidings of **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA** and also **BHARATA** ? Is not Raghava, worthy of honour, overcome with grief at my absence ? Is he rellecting on how he may rescue me ? Will not **BHARATA**, ever devoted to his brother, send out a great army led by experienced generals for my sake ? O Foremost of Monkeys, will not the King of the Monkeys, the fortunate **SUGRIVA**, come to mine aid at the head of a host of valiant monkeys using their teeth and nails ? Will not the heroic **LAKSHMANA**, the increaser of **SUMITRA**'s delight, skilled in the use of weapons, destroy the titans with his shafts ? Shall I not see **RAMA** strike down **RAVANA** on the battlefield ere long with his friends and kinsfolk by means of Rudra's weapon ? Is the golden countenance of Raghava, fragrant with the sceot of lotuses, not dimmed under adversity, like a lotus deprived of water under the burning sun ? Does he still retain his fixity of purpose, he who, for the sake of righteousness, with out regret renounced the throne and on foot entered the forest with me ? Neither for his mother nor his father nor for any other does he bear the love that he cherishes for me. l shall only live as long as I hear of him." .po Having addressed these words, full of meaning and sweetness to that monkey, that charming lady became silent so that she might hear more of her lord. And listening to **SITA**, Maruti, of immeasurable prowess, with joined palms paid obeisance to her and spoke again, saying: " O Illustrious Princess, the lotus-eyed **RAMA** does not know that thou art here and for this reason has not delivered thee as Purandara rescued Sachi. Learning this from me, Raghava will instandy come hither with his great army of bears and monkeys and, having triumphed over the invincible ocean, the abode of Varona with his terrible shafts, Kakutstha will rid the city of Lanka of all the titans. Even if death himself or the

Gods or the mighty titans seek to bar his passage, he will destroy them all. O Princess, in thine absence, **RAMA** stricken with grief is no longer able to find rest, like an elephant who is attacked by a lion. O Goddess, I swear to thee by the Mandara, Malava, Vindhya, Meru and Dardura Mountains and all the fruits and roots, that thou shalt soon behold **RAMA**'s lovely countenance with his beautiful eyes, lips like unto the Bimha fruit, and charming earrings, who resembles the risen moon. Soon thou shalt see **RAMA** on Mount Prasravana, O Vaidehi, like Shatakratu seated on Airavata. Eschewing flesh and wine, **RAMA** subsists on the fruits and roots of the forest alone, carefully prepared by **LAKSHMANA** of which he partakes at the fifth period of the day. So absorbed is he in the thought of thee that he no longer drives away flies, insects and worms from his body. Sunk in his reflection, lost in grief, he is wholly absorbed in thy contemplation. **RAMA**, the fore most among men no longer sleeps but should his eyelids close in weariness he starts up Ctying : ' O **SITA** I ' in gende accenta. Whenever he beholds a fruit or flower or any other object dear to women, he sighs ' O My dear Love I '. O Goddess, that prince unceasingly calls on thee, crying : ' O **SITA** ', and in order find to thee has resorted to every means." Hearing **RAMA**'a praises, **SITA** waa gready delighted, but grieved also to learn of his pain so that she resembled the autumn moon entering a dark cloud to re-appear once more.

CHAPTER 37

Sita refuses to be rescued by Hanuman

THE moon-faced **SITA**, hearing this speech, addressed **HANUMAN** in words, fraught with piety and sound judgment : " O Monkey, thou hast

revealed to me that **RAMA** is wholly pre-occupied with my remembrance and also that he is plunged in grief, which is as nectar mingled with poison. Whether man be at the height of his power or in the abyss of sorrow, death draws him as with a cord. Living beings are unable to escape their destiny, O Excellent Monkey, behold how I, **RAMA** and Saumitri are sunk in misery! As a wreck floating on the waters seeks to reach the shore, so does Raghava seek to come to the end of his woes. " After destroying the titans, slaying **RAVANA** and laying Lanka waste, will not my lord see me once again ? Do thou tell him to hasten, for at the end of this year I must die. This is the tenth month and two alone remain, that is the term fixed for me by that evil wretch, **RAVANA**. His brother Bibi shana made great entreaty to him to restore me, but he paid no heed to his proposals. **RAVANA** does not look with favour on my release for death lies in wait for him, driven on, as he is, by fate. O Warrior, on her mother's request, Kala, Bibishana's eldest daughter told me of this. There is an old and trusty titan, named Avindha, full of wisdom, virtue, intelligence and nobility, highly revered by **RAVANA**, who prophesied the im minent destruction of the titans by **RAMA**, but that perverse wretch disregarded his salutory words. O Best of Monkeys, I still hope that my lord will soon be re-united with me, for my heart is pure and **RAMA**'s virtues are infinite. He is endowed with endurance, courage, compassion, gratitude, energy and strength, O Monkey. What foe would not tremble before him, who slew fourteen thousand demons in J anasthana without his brother's aid ? That lion among men cannot be surpassed by the titan warriors ; I am conversant with his powers u .pz Sachi is with **INDRA**'s. O Monkey, that sun, **RAMA**, with his innumerable arrows as bis rays. will dry up the lake of hostile titans! Speaking thus, Sits, overwhelmed with grief at the thought of **RAMA**, her face bathed in tears, was again addressed by **HANUMAN**, who said to

her : “No sooner shall I have spoken to Raghsva, than he will hasten hither at the head of a powerful army composed of bears and monkeys or shall I deliver thee this very day from the grasp of those titsns and these present a111ictions ? Do thou climb upon my back, O Irreproachable Lady, and bear ing thee on my shoulders, I will cross over the sea ; verily I am able to carry away the City of Lanka together with **RAVANA** himself. This day, as Ani1a bears the sacrificial offerings unto Sbakra, I shall bring thee back to Raghava on the Prasravana Mountain, O Maithili ! To-day thou shalt behold **RAMA**, who is accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, preparing to destroy the enemy, as **VISHNU** engaged in the destruction of the Daityas and thou shalt see that mighty hero, eager to behold thee, on that solitary mountain, resembling Purandara on the head of the King of the Serpents. " O Lovely Goddess, mount on my shoulders, do not hesitate and be united with **RAMA**, as Robini is restored to Shashanka, as Sachi to **INDRA**, or Savarsbala to the Sun. I shall cross the ocean by the aerial path I O Fair One, bearing thee away from here, none of the dwellers in Lanka will be able to follow me. I shall return as I came, O Vaidehi, bearing thee through space.” Hearing these astonishing words, Maithili, trembling with joy, said to **HANUMAN** : " How canst thou hope to carry me so great a distance, O **HANUMAN** ? Tbis demonstrates thy monkey natore ! How dost thou deem it possible that thy little body should convey me from here to my lord, that king among men, O Monkey ? " At these words **HANUMAN** reflected : " Tbis is the first affront I have suffered ! Vaidehi is unaware of my prowess and strength. She shall learn that I am able to assume any shape at will! " Thinking thus, that foremost of monkeys, **HANUMAN**, the scourge of bis foes, showed himself to Sits in bis true form. 423 In order to inspire **SITA** with confidence, leaping down from the tree, that monkey began to expand in size and grew equal to the Meru or Mandata Mountain or a

fiaming brazier and that lion among monkeys, of a coppery countenance, his body like a mountain, with nails and teeth like diamonds, standing before **SITA**, said : " I am capable of uprooting Lanka with its hills, woods, fields, palaces, rampartS and gates and its monarch also I Take heart therefore O Queen, do not delay further, O Vaidehi! Come and dispel the grief of Raghava as also **LAKSHMANA**'s." Seeing the son of the Wind-god grow to the size of a moun tain, the daughter of **JANAKA**, whose eyes resembled lotus petals, said to him : " O Mighty Monkey, now I recognise the extent of thy powers and thy speed which equals the wind, also thy radiance like unto fire. How should an ordinary monkey have reached this land beyond the infinite ocean ? I know that thou art able to take me from here and bear me away, but, O Foremost of Monkeys, I must consider if the consequences are to mine advantage. Furthermore, is it fitting for me to go with thee ? Thy speed equal to the wind may render me giddy and I mjght fall from thy back whilst thou wert proceeding high over the ocean. Flung into the sea filled with sharks, croco diles and giant fish, I should certainly become the chosen prey of those monsters. Nay, I cannot go with thee, O Destroyer of Thy Foes and for thee undoubtedly there is also grave danger. When the titans see thee bearing me away, they will pursue thee at the wicked **RAVANA**'s command and, surrounded by those warriors furnished with spears and maces, canying a woman, thou wilt be beset with peril, O Hero! Fully armed, in great numbers, those titans would pursue thee, who art unanned ; how couldst thou then resist them and protect me ? And when thou art engaged in combat with those terrible demons, O Foremost of Monkeys, I, stricken with fear, will slip from thy back. Those terrible, huge and powerful titans would then end by overcoming thee in the con1lict, O Excellent Monkey. Or turning my head, whilst thou art engaged in fight, I should fall and those wicked titans would

bear me away and bring me hither or, wresting me from thy grasp, -P4 tear me to pieces. Victory or defeat is uncertain in combat I If I died under the threats of the titanS, O First of the Monkeys, all thine efforts to deliver me will have been in vain. Though thou art well able to destroy all the titanS, **RAMA**'s fame would thereby suffer decrease or the titanS, beating me away, would confine me in a secret place unknown to the monkeys or to **RAMA**. Then, all thine efforts to rescue me will have been fruitless, but if **RAMA** returnS with thee, great will be the chances of success. "O Great-armed Warrior, the lives of Raghava, of his two brothers and of King **SUGRIVA** depend on me. Having given up hope of delivering me, worn out with grief and anxiety, those two brothers with all the bears and monkeys would end their existence. O Monkey, furthermore, being

38 . She gives Hanuman her Jewel

HIGHLY gratified by **SITA**'s words, that lion among monkeys answered thus : " O Fair Lady of auspicious presence, thou hast spoken in accord with thy feminine nature and with tbe modesty of one devoted to her lord ! As a woman, it would not be possible for thee to cross the sea, four hundred miles in width on my back and the plea that thou hast made, saying 'I may not touch tbe body of any save **RAMA**' is worthy of thee, O Goddess, con sort of that magnanimous One. Who but thou would utter such words, O Janaki? Truly Kakutstha shall hear from beginning to end all thou hast said and done in my presence, O Princess. For many reasons did I speak to thee thus, O Lady, anxious as I was to compass **RAMA**'s design, and my heart troubled with feelings of affection. Further it was with great difficulty that I penetrated into the

City of Lanka and traversed the ocean and debating what was meet for me to do, I addressed thee in this wise. I wished to bring thee back to the one who is the delight of tbe House of Raghu this day ! It was my devotion for him and in regard for thee, that I uttered those words. As, however, thou art unable to come with me, O Irreproachable Lady, do thou give me some token which will inspire **RAMA** with faith in me." Being thus addressed by **HANUMAN**, **SITA**, who resembled tbe daughter of tbe Gods, answered him in faint accents, her voice broken with soba :-" This is the most perfect token thou canst take to my dear lord ! Do thou say this to him : ' O **RAMA**, when we formetly resided at tbe foot of the Chittra kuta Mountain in the eastern region, not far distant from where the ascetics dwelt, in a place rich in roots, fruit and water near the river Mandakini, whilst ranging the fiowery groves, redolent with fragrance, thou, having sported in tbe lake, resred all dripping on my breast. At that moment a .p6 crow, approaching, sought to peck me and I threw a stone at it ; nevertheless that ferocious devourer of offerings, deter mined to wound me, would not leave its prey and in my wrsth I removed my girdle, in order to srrike the bird and my robe slipped down. On seeing this, thou didst laugh at me, whereat I blushed with shame and indignation. Harassed by that crow, who was wild with hunger, I took refuge with thee, and ex hausted, threw myself into thine arms as thou wert seated there. Though I was still vexed, thou didst pacify me by thy laughter and my face being bathed in tears, gently dried my eyes ; thus I was seen by thee, greatly enraged by the crow, O Lord. Exhausted, O **RAMA**, I slept for a long time on thy breast, and thou in thy turn, didst sleep on mine, O Elder Brother of **BHARATA**. Then, as I awoke, that crow approached me once more and, as I rose from thine arms, tore my breast with its beak, O Raghava. Thereupon, at the shedding of blood, thou didst wake and beholding my breast lacerated, O Long armed Hero,

highly incensed and hissing like a serpent, thou didst speak thus : " O Thou, whose thighs resemble the trunk of an elephant, who has wounded thy breast ? Who seeks to play with an angry five-headed serpent ? " “Thereafter, looking round, thou didst perceive that crow, who, with sharp and bloody talons stood before me. That bird, prince of winged creatureS, was the son of **INDRA** and with the swiftness of the wind, it disappeared into the earth. Then thou, O Long-armed Warrior, thine eyes rolling in fury, resolved to destroy that crow and, plucking a blade of kusha grass, from where thou hadst lain, transformed it into Brahms’s shaft and it burst into ftame, like unto the fire of death before the bird. Hurling that fiery brand, it followed that bird high into the sky and, pursued by the fiery dart, the crow flew this way and that, thus traversing many regions and ranging through the Three Worlds, repulsed by his sire and the sages; at last it sought refuge with thee, falling on the earth and beseeching mercy of thee. Though worthy of death, thou, O Kakutstha, ever willing to succour all beings, out of com passion, spared him. Then, speaking unto the one who was exhausted and distressed, thou didst say :-" This weapon nf .P7 Brabma may never remain ineffective, therefore say what is now to be done ? " Then the crow answered :-" I will give up my right eye,” whetenpon **RAMACHANDRA** destroyed the right eye of that crow. Having sacrificed the right eye, his life was spared and, paying obeisance to Rams, as also to King **DASARATHA**, the crow, delivered by that warrior, returned to his abode. O Thou, who, on my behalf, didst discharge the Brabma-weapon, even at a crow, why dost thou leave him who bore me away, unpunished? O Foremost of Men, show thy compassion to me and inspire me with hope. I am conversant with thy great energy, thine immense endurance, thine amazing strength, thine irresistible power unfettered by the limitations of time and space, incapable of being disturbed, thou who art deep like

the ocean, lord of the earth and the equal of Vasava himself I Thou, the first among bowmen, who art full of ardour, and courage, wherefore dost thou not direct thy weapons against the titans ? Neither Nagas, Gandharvas, Gods nor Maruts can resist thee in combat '. " If that warrior still retains any regard for me, why does he not exterminate the titans with his whetted shafts, or why does not **LAKSHMANA**, the repressor of his foes, endowed with energy, deliver me at his brother's behest? Since those two tigers among men, equal to Vayu and **INDRA** are invincible even against the Celestials, why do they disregard me ? " Alas ! I must be guilty of some heinous sin, since those twin scourges of their foes, though able to do so, fail to come to my rescue ! " Hearing Vaidehi's piteous words, uttered with her eyes full of tears, the mighty **HANUMAN**, foremost of the monkeys, said :-" O Bxalted One, I swear to thee that Rams's features are altered on account of the sorrow he feels for thee and, seeing his brother overwhelmed with grief, **LAKSHMANA** too is lilled with distress, this is the truth, O Goddess. Since I have now found thee, there is no cause to lament further and thou shalt soon see an end to thy woes, O Lovely One. Those two tigers among men, those princes of incalculable energy, in their eagerness to see thee, will burn the worlds to ashes. Having slain that formidable warrior, **RAVANA** with his kinsfolk, Raghava shall return with thee to the palace. 4a8 " Now tell me what I shall say to **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, who are filled with valour and the illustrious **SUGRIVA** and all the assembled monkeys ? " **HANUMAN** having uttered these words, **SITA** answered him saying: " Bowing low to that Lord of the World, enquire after the welfare of that protector of men, whom **KAUSHALYA** has brought forth and wish him all prosperity from me. Then offer salutations to the one of whom **SUMITRA** is the happy mother, he, who renounced garlands, jewels, his beloved consort, the dominion of a vast realm hard to attain and his

father and mother, after bidding them a tender farewell, in order to follow **RAMA**. That virtuous prince, who, in his devotion, sacrificed unsurpassed felicity, accompanied his brother Kakutstha to the forest, watching over him ; he who is great, wise and pleasing to look upon, possessing broad shoulders and who looks on **RAMA** as his father and reverences me as his mother, that valiant **LAKSHMANA**, who did not know that I was being borne away. Full of deference for the aged, dignified and brave, measured in speech, the foremost of those dear unto that king's son and worthy of his father-in-law, he who even undertaketh these tasks to which he is not equal, whose presence causes **RAMA** to forget his sire, who is dearer to him than I ; **LAKSHMANA**, the brother of **RAMA**, to him do thou offer obeisance from me and repeat my words to him. May that noble and virtuous one, beloved of **RAMA**, ever mild and pure, bring an end to my sufferings, O Best of Monkeys ! O Chief of the Monkeys, do thou bring about the success of this undertaking. May **RAMA**, on thine instigation, make a supreme effort on my behalf. Further, do thou repeat these words of mine again and again to him : " ' I have but one month to live, O Son of **DASARATHA** I After that month I shall die ; I swear to thee that this is the truth I speak ! Deliver me from the hands of that cruel and wicked **RAVANA**, O Hero, as Kaushiki was delivered from hell '." Saying this, **SITA** drew from her robe the pearl which formerly adorned her forehead, which shone with celestial radiance, and bestowing it on **HANUMAN**, said : " Give this to Raghava." TH!l RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI Then the valiant **HANUMAN**, taking the priceless jewel, placed it on his finger, it being too small for his arm and, that foremost of monkeys, having received the pearl, paid obeisance to **SITA**, circumambulating bet from left to right. Filled with delight on having found the princess, **HANUMAN** bad already returned to **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** in thought. And taking that costly and superb

ornament that the daughter of King **JANAKA** had carried carefully concealed in bet sari, **HANUMAN**, as if delivered from a hurricane that bad ovenaken him on a high mountain, his heart full of serenity, once more prepared to set out on his return journey.

CHAPTER 39

Hanuman calms Sita's Fears

" This token is well known to Ragbava and seeing this peatl, the valiant **RAMA** will call three people to mind, my mother, myself and King **DASARATHA**. O Best of Monkeys, thy heroism being further stimulated by this enterprise, consider carefully what fresh efforts are needed ; thou capable of under taking this task, think therefore what course **RAMA** should adopt to bring my misfortunes to an end. O **HANUMAN** seek by thine exertions to terminRte my sufferings l " Thereupon the son of the Wind-god of immense energy, replied : " So be it," and making obeisance to Vaidehi, pre pared to depart, but that exalted one, Videha's daughter, seeing **HANUMAN** about to leave, bet voice strangled with sobs, said unto him : " O **HANUMAN**, do thou communicate my desires for the happiness of **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA**, his ministers and all the other monkeys and, O Best of Monkeys, in consounce with righteousness, wish them well. It beboveth thee to do that which will cause the long-armed **RAMA** to deliver me from the ocean of aflliction in which I am plunged. **HANUMAN**, do thou speak so that the illustrious **RAMA** rescue 430 me from here while I am yet alive and thereby reap the fruits of virtue. Listening to that which thou shalt relate to him of me, that son of **DASARATHA**, ever filled with valour, will feel his daring increaaed a hundredfold in the thought of reunion with me. The heroic

RAMA, hearing the appeal I have charged thee to deliver to him will be inspired to display increasing prowess.u Listening to **SITA**'s words, **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, with joined palms, made answer to her saying : " Soon shall Kakutstha, surrounded by the foremost monkeys and bears, come, and vanquishing his enemies in fight, dispel thy grief. I know of none among monals, titans or Gods, who can withstand him when he discharges his arrows. Wert thou the price of victory, he would be able to challenge the Sun or Parjanys or Vaivasvata or **YAMA** himself in con11ict and would prepare to conquer the whole eanh that is bounded by the sea, O Delight of **JANAKA**." Hearing theae pleasing, true and sweetly expressed words, J anaki addressed **HANUMAN** with respect, who had spoken out of devotion to his master, and said:-" O Hero, if thou judgest it to be wise, then tarry here for one day more and, having rested in some hidden spot, set out to-morrow ! Thy presence, O Monkey, will cause me to forget my great mis fonune awhile, I who have experienced so little happiness. But shouldst thou depan to-day, O Lion among Monkeys, my life will be in danger till thy return, this is certain. Funher more, not seeing thee will prove an increased torment, alfticted as I am with grief and, O Hero, this doubt haunts me con tinually,-' How will that powerful King, in the ntidst of the forces of his monkeys and bears and those two sons of a monarch, cross the impassable ocean ? ' In all the worlds, three beings alone have the power to traverse the sea ; **GARUDA**, thou and Maruta I In the face of this insurmountable obstacle, what means to success canst thou see, O Most Skilled of Beings? Undoubtedly thou an able to encompass this undertaking unaided, O Destroyer of Hostile Warriors but thou alone wouldst then reap the glory. If **RAMA**, however, together with his armies vanquished **RAVANA** and, delivering !De, returned to his own city, that exploit would be worthy 431 of him. If, crossing the sea and besieging

Lanka, that destroyer of hostile forces Kakutstha, bore me hence, he would have accomplished what is natural to him. Do thou therefore act in such wise that that valisnt warrior may be able to manifest his prowess ! " Hearing these words, fraught with sense and reason, full of affection, **HANUMAN** replied mildly : " O Queen, the lesder of the forces of bears and monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, full of energy, has resolved to liberate thee. Sur rounded by millions of monkeys, that destroyer of titans will come hither without delay. Tbere are, under his command, monkeys endowed with valour, energy and extreme prowess, swift as thought, able to go upward or downward and to every side, nothing can impede their course, no task, however hard, defeats their immeasurable courage. Nay, more than once, by their amazing endurance, they have encircled the entire earth with its seas and mountains on every side, by resorting to the wind's path. Among those Rangers of the Woods, some are equal to me and some superior and, in the whole of **SUGRIVA**'s company, there is none who is less so. Since I have reached this place, how much more are those valisnt monkeys able to do so ! Nor are the superior ones sent on errands but those of less account. Queen, have no anxiety and abandon thy grief; with a single bound, those fore most of monkeys will reach Lanka and those two brothers, resembling the sun and moon about to rise, will speed to thy side, riding on my back. Having slain **RAVANA** and his hordes, Ragbava, the delight of the House of Raghu, will take hold of thee, O Lady of Lovely Limbs, in order to bring thee back to thine own city. Therefore let courage and happiness attend thee, have faith in the dawning of that hour ; ere long, thou shalt behold **RAMA** shining like a flame. "That **INDRA** of the Titans, his sons, counsellors and kinsfolk, being slain, thou sbalt be re-united with **RAMA** as Shashanka with Robini. Soon thou shalt see the end of thy woes, O Divine Maitbili, and **RAVANA** will fall under **RAMA**'s blows before

thine eyes I " SUNDAR.A *KANDA* " Thou shalt soon behold tbe destroyer of his foes, Raghava of subdued soul, as also Laksbmana, bearing his bow in his hand at tbe gates of Lanka. Ere long tbou shalt see tbose valiant monkeys, endowed witb tbe courage of lions and tigers, resembling tbe lord of elephants, figbting with tbeir nails and teetb. O Noble One, innumerable companies of monkeys will be seen by tbee, resembling hills or clouds, roaring on tbe plateaus of Malaya and Lanka. Like an elephant attacked by a lion, R.sma is deeply wounded by tbe formidable shafts of tbe God of Love ! O Goddess, weep no more, but banish fear and sortow from tby heart ; tbou shalt be reunited witb tby consort, O Beautiful One, as Sachi was to **INDRA**. " Who can overcome R.sma ? Who is equal to Saumitri ? Those two brothers, resembling tbe wind and fire, are tby support. O Goddess, tbou shalt no have to dwell long in this place inhabited by formidable titans ; tby beloved will not delsy his coming ; have patience till I return 1 " CHAPTBR 4 He ta1ru le(*Jf*)e of **SITA** HBAluNG tbe words of that magnanimous son of Vayu, **SITA**, who resembled a daughter of tbe Gods, replied in significant words, saying : “As tbe rain, ripening tbe grain, rejoicetb tbe eartb, so am I gladdened on seeing tbee, O Monkey, who speaketb sweetly of my beloved. In compassion for me, who am emaciated witb suffering, do that which will enable me to meet witb that tiger among men, soon. O Foremost of Monkeys, call to his remembrance, that reed tbe crow destroyed in his anger, having been deprived of an eye and also how, when my tilab mark was etfaced, he painted anotber on my cheek, which he will surely remember. Say : ' O Thou who resemblest **INDRA**, how, witb tby valour, canst thou suffer **SITA** to be horne away lUl!l set in tbe midst of the titans ? That celestial pearl which

CHAPTER 40

He takes leave of Sita

SUNDAR.A *KANDA* " Thou shalt soon behold tbe destroyer of his foes, Raghava of subdued soul, as also Laksbmana, bearing his bow in his hand at tbe gates of Lanka. Ere long tbou shalt see tbose valiant monkeys, endowed witb tbe courage of lions and tigers, resembling tbe lord of elephants, figbting with tbeir nails and teetb. O Noble One, innumerable companies of monkeys will be seen by tbee, resembling hills or clouds, roaring on tbe plateaus of Malaya and Lanka. Like an elephant attacked by a lion, R.sma is deeply wounded by tbe formidable shafts of tbe God of Love ! O Goddess, weep no more, but banish fear and sortow from tby heart ; tbou shalt be reunited witb tby consort, O Beautiful One, as Sachi was to **INDRA**. " Who can overcome R.sma ? Who is equal to Saumitri ? Those two brothers, resembling tbe wind and fire, are tby support. O Goddess, tbou shalt no have to dwell long in this place inhabited by formidable titans ; tby beloved will not delsy his coming ; have patience till I return 1 " CHAPTBR 4 He ta1ru le(*Jf*)e of **SITA** HBAluNG tbe words of that magnanimous son of Vayu, **SITA**, who resembled a daughter of tbe Gods, replied in significant words, saying : “As tbe rain, ripening tbe grain, rejoicetb tbe eartb, so am I gladdened on seeing tbee, O Monkey, who speaketb sweetly of my beloved. In compassion for me, who am emaciated witb suffering, do that which will enable me to meet witb that tiger among men, soon. O Foremost of Monkeys, call to his remembrance, that reed tbe crow destroyed in his anger, having been deprived of an eye and also how, when my tilab mark was etfaced, he painted anotber on my cheek, which he will surely remember. Say : ' O Thou who resemblest **INDRA**, how,

witb tby valour, canst thou suffer **SITA** to be horne away lUl!l set in tbe midst of the titans ? That celestial pearl which 433 adorned my forehead, I have preserved with In my misfortunes, I have oft looked on it with delight as on thyself, O Irreproachable Hero I Yielding up this jewel, I shall not live long, being overwhelmed with grief. For thy sake, O **RAMA**, I endure insufferable misery and the menaces of the titans which cleave my heart ! O Destroyer of thy Foes, I shall live for one more month, after which, bereft of thee, I shall yield up my life. The King of the Titans is a source of dread to me ; if I learn that thou dost hesitate in coming to mine aid, I shall instandy give up my life'." Witnessing Vaidehi's tears and lamentations, the mighty **HANUMAN**, hom of Maruta, answered: " O Goddess, thy misfortunes have rendered Rams's features wan, I swear to thee this is the truth and seeing **RAMA** overcome . with sorrow, **LAKSHMANA** too is deeply distressed. Now that I have found thee, there is no cause for despair ! Soon, soon, thou shalt see an end to thy woes, O Lovely Princess ! Those blameless princes, foremost of men, eager to see thee, will reduce Lanka to ashes. Having slain **RAVANA** in combat, those two scions of the House of Raghu will take thee back to their own city, O Large-eyed Lady ! O Irreproachable Damsel, it is now for thee to give me such a token, that **RAMA** will instandy recognise and that will delight his heart." **SITA** *answered*:-" I have already furnished thee with an excellent token. Seeing that jewel, **RAMA** will instandy believe thy words." Receiving the marvellous pearl, the Prince of the Monkeys inclined his head to that exalted one and prepared to depart. Beholding that foremost of monkeys expanding his form and, charged with energy, preparing to leap, her face bathed in tears, in a voice choked with sobs, **SITA** said to him : " O **HANUMAN**, do not fail to offer my good wishes for their welfare to those two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, who resemble two lions

and to **SUGRIVA** also and his court. Do that which will cause the long-armed Raghava to deliver me from this ocean of a111iction, where I am held prisoner. On thy return, when thou art near him, tell him of my harsh and hitter a111iction and the threats of the titans I May prosperity attend thee, O alief of the Monkeys." 434 Having received these instructions from the princess, the monkey, his purpose accomplished, exceedingly exultant, reftecting that little remained for him to do, had already crossed the northern region in thought.

CHAPTER 41

Hanuman destroys the Ashoka Grove

HAVING been honoured by **SITA**, the monkey, leaving that place, began to reftect on what little remained for him to do since he had discovered that dark-eyed Princess. Dismissing the three means to success, the fourth now appeared to him as appropriate and he reftected in himself: " Because of their nature, one may not enter into negotiation with the titans nor do gifts avail with the wealthy ; one is unable to sow dissension among those who are ptoud of their strength, there remains therefore prowess as applicable here. In these circumstances, valour is the only resource. When these titans see the foremost of their warriors fall in combat, their martial ardour will be subdued. He who accomplishes his main purpose and compasses innumerable other engage ments without jeopardising the original enterprise, is a skilful messenger. He who employs all his resources to execute a minor task, has no sagacity, but the one who uses countless means with the minimum c1fort, is wise. Though my mission has been fulfilled, yet if, returning to the abode of the King of the Monkeys, I have ascertained

the strength of the foe and ourselves in the field, I shall have truly carried out his commands. How shall I act so that my ptesence here provea fruitful ? How can I provoke an encounter with the titans and what can I do so that that Ten-necked One will be made to measure his strength with mine own? Coming face to face with Dashagriva on the field accompanied by his counsellors, his army and charioteer, I shall easily read his intentions and then take my leave. " I shall now proceed to lay waste this magnificent grove, resembling the Nandana Gardens, that ravishes the eye and where every variety of ttee and creeper, is found, as the forest fire consumes the dead ttees and this destruction will incite **RAVANA**'s fury. Thereafter the King of the Titans will call upon bis immense army furnished with ttidents and iron pikes, and the horsemen, chariots and elephants, of which it is composed, and a formidable sttuggle will ensue. Then I shall fight with all my sttength against those titans and having defeated the assembled forces of **RAVANA**, I shall return safely to the King of the Monkeys." Thinking thus, Maruti, like a raging tempest, with immense energy began to root up the trees with his powerful and sinuous thighs, breaking them down, as also the creepers of that grove, where the ttumpeting of maddened elephants could be heard. With its ttees uprooted, its foundations shattered, the crests of the hills broken away and all that was fair laid waste, the copper-tinted buds, the ttees and creepers withering away, that grove appeared as if a fire had consumed it and the flowering sprays blown hither and thither, resembled women with their robes in disarray. With its grassy dells and charm ing pavilions ruined, tiger, deer and birds emitting cries of fear and the edifices crumbling, that great demesne was bereft of beauty. And that grove, belonging to the women of the inner apartments, where they were wont to sport, with its avenues of Asboka ttees and its creepers, now laid waste by that monkey, was

ttansformed by him into a heap of ruins. Then having given that powerful lord of the earth cause for severe displeasure, that monkey, eager to fight against those countless valiant titans single-handed, stationed himself at the gate, blazing with e1fulgence. CHAPTER 4Z He destroys the Kinkaras Ml!ANwim.B the cries of hirds and the crasb of falling ttees, sttuck terror into the hearts of the inhabitants of Lanka. Wild

CHAPTER 42

He slays the Kinkaras

" I shall now proceed to lay waste this magnificent grove, resembling the Nandana Gardens, that ravishes the eye and where every variety of ttee and creeper, is found, as the forest fire consumes the dead ttees and this destruction will incite **RAVANA**'s fury. Thereafter the King of the Titans will call upon bis immense army furnished with ttidents and iron pikes, and the horsemen, chariots and elephants, of which it is composed, and a formidable sttuggle will ensue. Then I shall fight with all my sttength against those titans and having defeated the assembled forces of **RAVANA**, I shall return safely to the King of the Monkeys." Thinking thus, Maruti, like a raging tempest, with immense energy began to root up the trees with his powerful and sinuous thighs, breaking them down, as also the creepers of that grove, where the ttumpeting of maddened elephants could be heard. With its ttees uprooted, its foundations shattered, the crests of the hills broken away and all that was fair laid waste, the copper-tinted buds, the ttees and creepers withering away, that grove appeared as if a fire had consumed it and the flowering sprays blown hither and thither, resembled women with their

robes in disarray. With its grassy dells and charm ing pavilions ruined, tiger, deer and birds emitting cries of fear and the edifices crumbling, that great demesne was bereft of beauty. And that grove, belonging to the women of the inner apartments, where they were wont to sport, with its avenues of Asboka ttees and its creepers, now laid waste by that monkey, was ttansformed by him into a heap of ruins. Then having given that powerful lord of the earth cause for severe displeasure, that monkey, eager to fight against those countless valiant titans single-handed, stationed himself at the gate, blazing with e1fulgence. CHAPTER 4Z He destroys the Kinkaras Ml!ANwim.B the cries of hirds and the crasb of falling ttees, sttuck terror into the hearts of the inhabitants of Lanka. Wild 436 beasts and birds lied hither and thither in terror on every side and inauspicious omens appeared. Waking from sleep, those grim-visaged titan women beheld the grove devastated by that mighty and heroic monkey and, in order to inspire them with fear, that long-armed one, full of energy, began to increase in size and they, observing that immense ape, as high as a hill, of unimagined power, enquired of **JANAKA**'s daughter, saying : " Who is this being ? From whence and wherefore has he come hither ? Why did he converse with thee ? Tell us, O Large-eyed Lady, have no fear O Dark-eyed Lovely One." Thereupon, the virtuous Sits, of faultless limbs, answered them saying :-" Since the titans arc able to change their form at will, by what means should I be able to recognise them ? Ye know what he is and what he is about! Without doubt, serpents know the secret of the serpent's tail I As for me, I am terrified nor do I know what he is but believe him to be a titan, who has come hither, able to change his form at will." Hearing Vaidehi's words, the titan women lied with all speed, a few only remaining, whilst some hastened to inform **RAVANA** of what had taken place. Thereafter those female titans of hideous aspect,

approached the King of the Titans and informed him of that monsttous and formidable monkey in the Ashoka grove, saying : " O King, there is a monkey of immense size, endowed with immeasurable sttength, who, having held converse with Sits, remains there. We besought the daughter of **JANAKA** whose eyes resemble a doe's, to inform us who this monkey was but she would not disclose it. It may be that he is an emissary of **INDRA** or Kuvcra or even of Rams himself, who is anxious to discover where Sits is. This being of suangc aspect, bas complctcly desuoyed thy wonderful pleasure garden that was filled with beasts of every kind. There is not a single quarter that has not been laid waste by him, save the place where the divine Janaki abides, whether to preserve her or for reasons of exhaustion, we know not, bnt since he is a sttanger to fatigue, we deem it is on account of this woman. And the Ashoka ttce, covered with bnds and lovely foliage, under the shade 437 of which **SITA** is sheltering, has been spared by him. It behoveth thee to in11ict some severe penalty on this formidable being, who has held converse with **SITA** and destroyed the grove. O Lord of the Hosts of Titans, who would dare to converse with her for whom thine heart yearns without suffer ing death?" Hearing the words of the demons, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, his eyes rolling in rage, ftamed up like a funeral pyre and, in his wrath tears fell from his eyes like drops of burning oil from a lighted lamp. Then that mighty monarch ordered those titans named Kinkaras, whose strength equalled his own, to seize **HANUMAN** whereupon eighty thousand of those retainers speedily issued from the palace, bearing maces and iron hooks in their hands. Possessing huge stomachs and large teeth, formidable to look upon, filled with valour and martial ardour, they were all burning to lay hold of that monkey. Approaching **HANUMAN** who was standing at the gate ready to fight, those powerful titans rushed upon him like moths on a tlame. Equipped with maces of

different kinds and gold-encircled bracclets, with arrows bright as the sun, hammers, axes, spears, darts and lances, they surrouoded **HANUMAN** and began their attack. Then he, full of strength and courage, resembling a hill, lashing his tail, began to roar, waving it to and fro, and expanding in size, that son of the Wind-god filled Lanka with his bellowing. On accouot of the noise of the swishing of his tail and his roaring, the birds began to fall from the air and he proclaimed in a loud voice :-" Victory to the mighty Rams and the valiant **LAKSHMANA** ! Victory to **SUGRIVA**, protected by Raghava I I am the servant of the Sovereign of Koshala, Rams, of im perishable exploits, I am **HANUMAN**, the destroyer of hostile armies, the offspring of Maruta. A thousand Ravanas cannot stand before me in combat, when I crush them beneath a myriad trees and rocks I Under the very eyes of the titans, I shall destroy the City of Lanka and, paying obeisance to Maithili, depart, my purpose being accomplished I " On hearing his shouts, the titans were seized with terror and they beheld him standing aloft like a great evening cloud and, knowing now that that monkey had been despatched by 438 bis master, under the oommand of their lord they began to assail him on all sides with every kind of formidable weapon. Surrounded by those warriors, that mighty monkey seized hold of an iron bar that stood the gate, and lifting it, struck those Rangers of the Nigbt, and he appeared like Vinata’s offspring carrying away a struggling serpent. Grasping the weapon, that valiant monkey began to destroy those demons, moving here and there in the air, as **INDRA** of a thousand eyes crushed the Daityas with bis thundetbolt. Having slain the titans, that heroic and powerful son of Maruta, thirsting for combat, stationed himself at the gate. Thereafter the few titans, who had escaped, informed **RAVANA** of the destruction of bis servants and, hearing that a mighty host of demons had been slain, the king, bis eyes rolling in wrath,

commanded the son of Prahasta, who was endowed with matchless courage, invincible in battle, to go forth.

CHAPTER 43

He bums the Temple and Monument

not destroyed the sacred temple, I shall now demolish tbis sanctuary., Tbinking thus, the son of Maruta, displaying bis prowess, bounded to the temple that was as bigh as the peak of Mount Meru, and scaling that edifice, that resembled a mountain, that thief of the monkeys, manifested a great effulgence, equal to the radiance of the sunrise. Thereafter he began to destroy that lofty sanctuary wbich shone with a glory equal to the Pariyatra Mountain. Assuming immense proportions, the illustrious son of Maruta, in bis intrepidity, caused Lanka to tremble, filling it with bis roaring and, at that terrifying and deafening clamour, the birds and the guardians of the temple, fell to the ground, their senses ovcroome. Thereupon **HANUMAN** cried out : " Victory to Rams, skilled in the use of weapons and to the courageous **LAKSHMANA** ! Victory to King **SUGRIVA**, **RAMA**'s henchman ! I am **HANUMAN**, the destroyer of hostile armies, son of Maruta, and the servant of Rams, King of Koshala, of immortal exploits ! When I hurl down trees and roclts, not even a thousand Ravanas can withstand me in combat. Having destroyed the City of Lanka and paid my obeisance to the daughter of the King of Mithila, my purpose fulfilled, I shall depart." Having spoken thus, the colossal leader of the monkeys, standing on that edifice, emitted a roar and the hideous clamour struck terror into the hearts of the titans. In consequence of that great tumult, a hundred temple guards sallied forth, bearing every kind of weapon, dart, scimitar, arrow and axe ; and

surrounding Maruti struck him with clubs and bars encircled with golden bands. Hurling them selves on that excellent monkey with arrows bright as the sun, that host of titans resembled a mighty whirlpool in the Ganges. Thereat the son of the Wind, the mighty **HANUMAN**, waxing wrath, taking on a formidable aspect and tearing up from that sanctuary a huge pillar plated with gold, which emitted a hundred rays, spun it round rapidly with great energy, so that the fire generated therefrom set the temple ablaze. Seeing that monument in Oames, the leader of monkeys having despatched a hundred titans, resembled Iudra slaying the demons with his thunderbolt and, standing in space, he cried out exultingly : " Thousands of leaders of monkeys, resembling myself, valiant and brave, are scouring the whole earth under **SUGRIVA**'s command. Among these, some are as strong as elephants, others ten times as strong, some have the energy of a thousand elephants, some of a whole herd and some have the strength of the wind, wbile a few possess a strength that may not be measured. Such are the monkeys, armed with teeth and claws, that in hundreds and thousands and millions, will accompany **SUGRIVA** when he comes to exterminate yon all. Then neither the city of Lanka nor any of you nor **RAVANA** himself will survive, since they have incurred the wrath of that hero of the House of lkshwaku."

CHAPTER 44

The Death of Jambumalin

bow. Wearing garlands and red attire with a crown and brilliant ear-rings, that invincible warrior of immense stature, rolling his eyes ferociously drew his great bow, furnished with shining arrows, equal to

INDRA's, with a noise like thunder. Then the entire sky and the four quarters at once re-echoed to the sound of the stretching of that bow. Beholding him advance in a chariot yoked to asses, **HANUMAN**, endowed with great vigour, emitted cries of exultation. Thereat the highly powerful Jambumalin riddled him with whetted shafts, piercing the face of that leader of monkeys with a crescent-shaped arrow, his head with one furnished with plumes and his arms with ten having iron tips. Struck by those arrows, his coppery countenance shone like an autumn cloud lit by the rays of the sun and his ruddy face, stained with vermilion, resembled a red lotus in the sky, sprinkled with drops of gold. Wounded by those shafts, that mighty monkey was enraged and seeing a great rock of vast size lying near, he raised it up and hnrled it against his adversary with violence, who countered it with ten of his shafts. Perceiving this feat brought to nought, **HANUMAN**, in fury, tore up a mighty Sala tree and began to whirl it in the air, whereupon the highly powerful Jambumalin, seeing that great monkey spinning the Sala tree, let loose innumerable shafts, severing it with fonr arrows and piercing the arms of that monkey with five others, his belly with a further dart, thereafter piercing him between the breasts with ten more. His body, covered with darts, a prey to violent anger, **HANUMAN**, seizing a club, spun it with extreme velocity, allow ing it to fall on the huge chest of his adversary, whereupon 441 neither his head, arms, thighs, bow, his chariot, his steeds nor arrows could be distinguished, and that mighty car warrior, Jambumalin, dropped to the earth, like an oak that has been felled, his limbs and ornaments crushed. Then **RAVANA**, hearing that Jambumalin had been slain, as also the powerful Kinkaras, was overcome with wrath. Roll ing his eyes inflamed with fury, that Lord of the Titans in stantly issued a command that the sons of his ministers, who were endowed with exceeding valour and strength, should go forth

to the attack.

CHAPTER 45

Hanuman slays the Sons of Ravana's Ministers

THEN under the command of that **INDRA** of Titans, the sons of his ministers, seven in number, resembling the fire in splendour, set out from the palace. Escorted by a large army, furnished with bows, full of energy, skilled in the use of wea pons, they, the flower of warriors, were each burning for victory. Mounted in great chariots plated with gold, sur mounted by banners, yoked to horses, they created a noise resembling thunder. Of unequalled courage, stretching their bows inlaid with refined gold, like unto flashes of lightning athwart the clouds, those warriors sallied forth. Their mothers nevertheless, knowing of the death of the Kinkaras, were overcome with anxiety as also their friends and kinsfolk. And, exhorting one another, clad in golden armour, they rushed on **HANUMAN**, who stood erect at the gate. From their thundering cars, they loosed innumerable shafts like clouds in the rainy season, and, covered by that hail of missiles, **HANUMAN**'s body was concealed, as the King of the Mountain is obscured by rain. Then that monkey evaded those arrows and their swiftly moving chariots by executing countless skilful evolutions in the air and appeared like **INDRA** sporting with his archers, 442 the clouds. Sending up a mighty shout which struck terror into the great host, that valiant monkey leapt on the titans. The scourge of his foes struck some of them with the palm of his hands and others with his feet ; some he hit with his fists and some he tore with his nails, striking them down with his chest and thighs, while some fell to the ground by the force of his cry. Felled to the earth, those warriors Jay dying and the

entire army fled to the four quarters, filled with terror. Elephants trumpeted and horses fell slain; the ground was strewn with the broken fragments of chariots, seats, banners and canopies ; rivers of blood could be seen flowing on the highways and Lanka re-echoed with fearful cries. Having slaughtered those mighty titans, that heroic monkey, burning with courage, desiring to measure his strength against other demons, stationed himself at the gate once more.

CHAPTER 46

He annihilates five Generals and their Forces

ance, concealing his fears, formed a resolution which he deemed would prove decisive. Tbeteupon Dashagriva commanded the leaders of his forces, Virupakaha, Yupaksha, Durdharsha, Praghasa and Basakama, masters of strategy, endowed with the speed of the wind, brave and skilful warriors, to take **HANUMAN** captive, saying: " Yc Generals, who arc full of valour, set out at the head of your troops with your ftcet of horses, chariots and elephants and take this monkey prisoner. Approaching that dweller of the woods, exercise great circumspection and act with due consideration for time and place. Having regard to his con duct, I do not judge him to be a monkey, he being endowed with extraordinary prowess. I deem him to be a higher being and not a monkey ; perchance be is an emissary created 443 by **INDRA** by virtue of his penances in order to destroy us. Under my command, ye have all uiumphed over Nagas, Yakshas, Gandbarvas, *Devas*, *Asuras* and great *Rishis*; un doubtedly they arc plotting some tteachery against us, there fore seize this being by force. O Generals, let each go forth at the head of a mighty host, attended by horses, chariots and elephants and take this

monkey prisoner. In former times I have seen monkeys endowed with immense energy, like Bali, **SUGRIVA**, the exceedingly powerful **JAMBAVAN**, the General Nils and others, such as Dvivida, yet there was nothing alarm ing in their gait, their energy, their prowess, their intelligence, their conduct or their capacity to assume different forms, this, however, is some great being masquerading as a monkey. Even though the Three Worlds with **INDRA**, the Gods, the titans and men cannot resist you on the field of battle, great efforts will be needed to lay hold of him. Nevertheless, even a seasoned warrior, desiring to uiumph in combat, is not able to defend his life without exertion, for the outcome of a battle is uncertain." Obedient to the commands of their lord, all those valiant titans, resplendent as fire, attended by their troops, threw them selves in all baste into their chariots with sharp and pointed weapons and on to their swift steeds and elephants maddened with ichor. Then those warriors beheld that mighty monkey, shining like the sun that rises with its diadem of sparlding rays, and seeiug him stationed at the gate, possessed of immense strength and speed, highly intelligent and brave, with his vast stature and huge arms, they were afraid and assailed him from all sides with their dreadful weapons. Then Durdharaha discharged five white iron, and yellow pointed arrows at **HANUMAN**'s fotehead, possessing the lustre of lotus petals, and his head being pierced with those shafts, that monkey leapt into the air mating the ten cardinal points ring with his ety, whereupon that powerful and heroic warrior Durdharsha, standing in his chariot with his bow stretched, advanced, letting fly a hundred arrows at once. Thereupon, **HANUMAN**, like unto the wind driving away clouds, intercepted those arrows while coursing in the sky, and sore beset by 444 Durdharsba, the offspring of the Wind expanded in size, emitting loud roars, and thereafter, with a great bound swooped on the chariot of Durdharsba with extreme force,

like a succession of lightning flashes striking a mountain. Thrown from his car, his eight steeds mangled, the pole and the shafr broken, that warrior fell to the earth, slain. Then Virupaksha and Yupaksha, seeing him lying on the ground, waxing wrath sprang up and advanced on **HANUMAN** dealing blows with their maces, striking the chest of that long-armed monkey as he stood in space ; whereupon he meeting the shock of their assault, evaded their arrows and, that exceedingly powerful monkey, the son of Anila, swooped down on the earth like an eagle ; thereafter seizing and up rooting a Sala tree, assailing those titans with blows, that ofl'spting of the Wind-god slew those two mighty and heroic demons. Then learning that those three titans had been slain by the monkey, endowed with great swiftness, the courageous Praghasa rushed upon him laughing scornfully and the audacious Basskarna enraged, armed with a spear, also advanced towards him. Then each from his side attacked that lion among monkeys. Praghasa assailing him with a sharp-edged axe and Basakama with his spear and, with his body streaming with blood, his limbs lacerated by their blows, that monkey, highly enraged looked like the rising sun. Thereafter that heroic monkey, **HANUMAN**, breaking off the peak of a mountain, together with its beasts, snakes and trees, crushed those titans, grinding them to dust; and having alain those five generals, that monkey proceeded to destroy the remaining host. As the Thousand-eyed Deity destroyed the *Asuras*, so did **HANUMAN**, the horses with horses, the elephants with elephants, chariots with chariots, and warrinra with warriors and the pathways were choked with elephants, shattered chariots and the bodies of the titans. Having destrOyed those heroic generals with their forces and vehicles, that hero, resembling Time, pausing at the destruction of the worlds, rested at the gate. THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI

CHAPTER 47

The Death of Aksha

TM Death of Aksha that those five genetals with their forces and vehicles bad been struck down by **HANUMAN**, tbe King of the Titans glanced at the youthful Aksba, who full of martial ardour sat before him; and that impetuous warrior, armed with a bow inlaid with gold, responding to his glance, leapt up like a 8ame that blazes forth when fed with clarified butter by the foremost of sages in the sacrificial chamber. And he ascended a chariot, acquired at the price of accumu lated sacrifice, plated with refined gold, dressed with flags embroidered with pearls, yoked to eight steeds swift as thought, unconquerable by Gods or titans, surmounting every obstacle, flashing like lightning, of superb workmanship, able to travel through space, equipped with quivers, arrows, eight swords, darts and lances in orderly array, bound with golden ropes, shining with its myriad weapons, bearing golden garlands, rivalling the radiance of the sun and moon. Filling the firmament, the earth and its mountains with the sound of horses, elephants and great chariots, Aksba, at the hesd of hia forces, advanced on that monkey, who was stationed on the gate. Coming before that monkey, Aksba, with the gaze of a lion, in which admiration and respect were mingled, measured **HANUMAN** with his glance, who resembled the fire at the dis solution of the worlds intent on destroying all creatures. Theresfter that mighty son of **RAVANA**, reftecting on the exceed ing valour of that monkey, his prowess in regards to the enemy and on his own strength, swelled up with pride and resembled the sun at the end of the world cycle. Then summoning up his courage, enraged, he took his stand resolutely in the field, and with conoentrated mind cballenged **HANUMAN**, irresistible in

combat and of unimaginable prowess, directing three whetted shafts upon him. Observing that audacious monkey, indifferent to fatigue, accustomed to oveteoming his foes and proud, Aksha took up his bow, holding his arrows in his hand. Wearing a corselet and braceletS of gold, with marvellous earrings, endowed with martial ardour, Aksha rushed on that monkey and a terrific struggle ensued which was unparalleled on earth and struck terror even in the Gods and titans. Witnessing that mighty conflict between the monkey and the youthful titan, the earth cried out, the sun ceased to pour down its warming rays, the wind no longer blew and the mountains shook ; the whole firmament was filled with the sound and the ocean was convulsed. Then that hero, skilled in directing his aim, fixed his shafts and loosing them pierced that monkey in the forehead with three steel pointed winged arrows plated with gold and resembling venomous snakes. Wounded by those murderous darts, his eyes blinded by the blood flowing from his brow, **HANUMAN** resembled the rising sun, having arrows for its rays. Beholding that offspring of the foremost of monarchs with his splendid weapons upraised and his marvellous bow, that valiant counsellor of the Lord of the Monkeys rejoiced and in his ardour put forth his whole strength. Resembling the sun crowned with an aureole of rays as it rises over the peak of the Mandara Mountain, **HANUMAN**, inflamed with ire, filled with strength and energy, consumed the youthful Aksha with his forces and vehicles by his fiery glances. Thereupon that titan, from his bow equal unto lndra's charged with innumerable darts, let fall a mighty shower of arrows on the foremost of monkeys in the fight, as a cloud looses its waters on a lofty mountain. Seeing the youthful Aksha on the field, seething with wrath and filled with valour, energy and strength, furnished with arrows, that monkey shouted aloud in exultation and, as an elephant draws near to a pit concealed in the grass, so did Aksha, in

the inexperience of his youth, giving rein to his fury, proud of his valour, approach that incomparable warrior in conllict. **HANUMAN** struck by those shafts, emitted a loud roar resembling a thunder cloud and, assuming a formidable aapect, full of vigour, agitating his legs and arms, churned up the air. 447 Leaping upwards, that valiant titan, raining arrows, burled himself upon **HANUMAN** and that foremost of titans, exceed ingly skilled, greatest of car-warriors, Aksha, burning with courage, covered him with a bail of shafts, a cloud covers the mountains with hailstones. Evading those arrows by darting between them, that heroic monkey, with the speed of the wind, swift as thought, began to range the path of the air. Casting glances full of pride on Aksba, who was armed with bow and arrows, burning to fight and, filling the sky with his countless excellent shafts, that offspring of the Wind god became thoughtful and his breast, pierced by the shafts of that youthful and powetful hero, be emitted a great shout. Recognising the skill of Aksha, be pondered on the warlilte qualities of that warrior, reftecting : “This great and powetful warrior, lilte an infant sun in splendour, has accomplished deeds incapable of being per formed by a boy ; I am loath to slay one who bas shown himself equal to every martial feat ; he is high-souled, filled with valour, concentrated and able to endure extreme hardship in war, worthy of being honoured by the great Sages, Nagas and Yakshas ; his strength and courage lend him a noble assurance and standing before me, be looks me straight in the eyes. Forsooth the heroism of this audacious being would shake the soul of the Gods and titans themselves. Verily be is an adversary not to be despised, his prowess increases as he fights ; if I disregard him, be will defeat me, therefore I must destroy him for a spreading fire may not be neglected.” Refiecting thus on the strength of his foe and his own, that powerful one, endowed with energy, resolved to slay his adversary. Thereafter that

valiant monkey, hom of Pavana, coursing through the air, struck those eight excellent steeds of immense size capable of bearing a heavy burden in combat with the palm of his hand and, that great chariot, overturned by the blow administered by the counsellor of the King of the Monkeys, its pole shattered, the shafts riven, the steeds slain, fell to the earth from the sky. Thereupon, abandoning his car, bearing his bow and sword, that warrior leapt into the air, as an ascetic consequent on his penances ascends to heaven on leaving the bndy. of48 Rising into the sky frequented by the King of the Birds, the wind and the Celestials, that monkey, with a single bound, seizing hold of his legs, as **GARUDA** catches hold of a snake, with a strength equal to his sire's, spun him round and round and threw him violently on the eanh. With his arms, thighs and chest crushed, vomiting blood, his bones and eyes pulverised, his joints dislocated, his sinews tom, he fell to eanh sisin by the Son of the Wind. Theteupon that mighty monkey trod his rival underfoot, striking terror into the heart of the King of the Titans, and all the *Rishis*, Cakracaras, Bhutas, Yakshas, Pannagas and Suras assembled with their leader lndra, who gazed with wonder on the simian slayer of that youthful titan. And **HANUMAN**, having destroyed the stripling Aksha, whose eyes were inflamed with blood on the field of battle, returned to the gate once more and waited there like Death at the time of the destruction of all creatures.

CHAPTER 48

Hanuman allows himself to be taken Captive by the Titans

THE youthful Aksha having been slain by **HANUMAN**, **RAVANA**, controlling his agitation, filled with anger, commanded Indrajita, who resembled a god, to take the field, saying :-of thine arms in combat, nay, depending on thee, I have no anxiety regarding the outcome of the fray. " In truth I did not put the same reliance on those who have succombed that I now place in thee, O Destroyer of Thy Foes, neither in the Kinkaras nor in J ambumalin, the son of my counsellor nor in the five generals going forth at the head of their troops with innumerable forces, accompanied by horses, elephants and chariots nor in the youthful, dearly beloved, Aksha, slain by that monkey. O Hero, thou sur passest them all, therefore, rellecting on thine own strength, with all haste act in such a manner that the destruction of the army may be avoided. O Foremost of those bearing arms, considering thine own prowess and that of thine adversary, who now reposes quietly after creating carnage among these hostile hosts, act so that his might may be subdued. Powerful forces can serve no purpose here, for great armies flee before **HANUMAN** nor do maces avail ; the speed of Maruti is irre sistible and, like unto **AGNI**, he may not be slain by weapons. Therefore, revolving all these things in thy mind and reflecting on the divine quality of thy bow, with the intention of bring ing about a successful issue, strive with determination to overcome thy foe by frustrating his attacks. Assuredly it was not my will to expose thee to this hazard, O Foremost among those endowed with intelligence, yet this course of action is approved by warriors and is in accord with the duty of kings. In war one must be versed in the traditions as also in the rules of milirary science in order to emerge triumphant ftom the struggle.” Hearing the words of his sire, Indrajita, whose prowess was equal to that of the son of Daksha, circumambulated him and inspired with martial ardour, prepared to fight. Overwhelmed with homage by his cherished companions, who

had assembled there, he set out for battle. And the resplendent son of the King of the Titans, whose eyes resembled the petals of a lotus, bounded impetuously forward, like the ocean at the time of the full moon. Thereafter, Indrajita of matcbless prowess, equal unto **INDRA**, ascended his chariot, swift as the eagle or the wind, moving freely, drawn by four lions with pure white teeth. Standing in his chariot, that most skilled of archers, fully conversant with the use of weapons, the foremost of warriors drove rapidly to where **HANUMAN** was to be found. Hearing the rumbling of wheels and the twanging of the bowstring, the delight of that monkey was redoubled, where upon Indrajita, seizing his bow and steel-pointed arrows, versed in the art of warfare, proceeded towards **HANUMAN** and as he advanced light-heartedly, his weapons in his hand, the four quarters grew dark and jackals set up a hideous howling. Nagas, Yaksbas, Maharishis, Cakracaras and Siddbas assembled and the sky was filled with birds emitting piercing cries. Seeing that chariot bearing down on him, the standard of **INDRA** unfurled, that monkey raised a great shout and expanded his body; whereupon, Jndrajita in his celestial car, drew back his marvellous bow, emitting a sound like thunder and those two powerful heroes closed in conflict, the monkey and the son of the King of the Titans, like unto God and demon. Indifferent to danger they began to fight and that mighty monkey evaded the impetuous army of that valiant archer and consummate warrior in his great car, by executing a myriad evolutions in the air with indescribable agility. Thereupon, the heroic lndrajita, slayer of his foes, began to discharge his tnarvellous superbly-fashioned sharp steel-pointed and winged arrows, tipped with gold, swift as lightning. Hearing the rumbling of that chariot, the rolling of the drums together with the sound of the stretching of the bow, **HANUMAN** leapt hither and thither and that mighty monkey, evading the rain of arrows, skilfully eluded that dexterious bowman,

whose target he was, and stretching out his arms, **HANUMAN**, the son of Anila, turning aside from those missiles, leapt into the sky. Thus those skilfW. and spirited warriors, exceedingly swift in motion and versed in the art of warfare, engaged in combat to the wonder of all beings. Nor was the titan able to take **HANUMAN** unawares nor Maruti surprise lndrajita, as they hurled them selves on one another with a courage worthy of the Gods. Observing him unscathed although the target of his infallible arrows, Indrajita, controlling his senses, engaged in profound cnnccottation of thought on **HANUMAN**, and finding him incapable of being slain, he began to consider how he could be bound fast and that most experienced of warriors, full of exceeding energy, discharged that powerful weapon conferred on him by **BRAHMA** on that illustrious monkey. Knowing him to be incapable of being slain, Indrajita, skilled in strategy, bound that offspring of the Wind-god with the aid of that weapon. Struck by the titan with the **BRAHMA**-weapon, that monkey fell to the earth unconscious, but knowing himself to be bound by a shaft belonging to the Lord, he did not experience the least pain and though bereft of strength, that monkey bethought himself of **BRAHMA**'s blessing. Then that heroic monkey began to recollect the boons conferred on him by **BRAHMA** and thinking of that weapon bestowed by the Self-create, consecrated by mantras, he refiected : " I may not release myself from these bonds in virtue of the power of that Guru of the World. Further, this subjugation has been ordained by Him and must be endured by me." Thereupon, reflecting on the power of that weapon and the compassion of the Grandsire of the World towards him, also of the possibility of delivetance, that monkey submitted himself to **BRAHMA**'s decree. He thought: "Though made fast by this weapon, I experi ence no fear; the Grandsire of the World, Mahendra and Anila will protect me ; in sooth I deem it to be to mine advantage to fall into the hands of the

titans and thus come face to face with their great king, therefore let mine enemies take me captive!" Having thus resolved, that destroyer of his foes, full of circumspection, lay motionless and being rutblessly pininned by the titans, he responded to their threats and abuses by leonine roars. Beholding that subduer of his foes lying motionless, the titans bound him with plaited ropes of hemp and bark and he willingly allowed himself to be tied and in sulted by his foes in order that he might converse with the King of the Titans, should he, out of curiosity, desire tn see him. Bound with ropes, the monkey was no longer under the sway of the **BRAHMA-**weapon, for, he being secured by other honda, it was rendered void. Bebo1ding that excellent 452 monkey bound with bark, the valiant Indrajita recognised him to be freed from that supernatural weapon and became pensive, saying aloud : " Alas, those titans have rendered my exploit useless, not being conversant with the power of mantras and that Brahms weapon being rendered void, no other is effective, thus we are all placed in a great predicament for this weapon may not be loosed twice." Though delivered from the power of that weapon, **HANUMAN** betrayed it by no sign, despite the suffering caused by the fetters that bound him and he allowed himself to be ill-treated by the titans and assaulted by those cruel demons who struck him with their fists and dragged him before **RAVANA**. Freed from the **BRAHMA-**weapon, yet bound by hempen ropes, that powerful and heroic monkey was paraded by Indrajita before **RAVANA** and his court. And those titans related to the king everything con=ning that foremost of monkeys, who re sembled a maddened elephant that has been bound. On seeing the foremost of monkeys made captive, those war like titans enquired saying :-"Who is this? Who has sent him? From whence has he come? What is his mission? Who are his supporters ? " and others exclainted angrily : " Kill him ! Burn him ! Devour him I " Having come

some way, **HANUMAN** observed elderly attend ants seated at the feet of their sovereign and he gazed with admiration on the palace decorated with gems. Then the exceedingly powerful **RAVANA** bebeld that foremost of monkeys dragged hither and thither by those hideous titans, and **HANUMAN** gazed at the Lord of the Titans, who was like unto a blazing sun in his might and glory. Seeing **HANUMAN**, that Ten-headed One issued orders to his chief ministers, distinguished for their lineage and character, who stood before him and commanded them to interrogate that monkey. Thereupon, questioned in turn by them concerning the purpose of his coming, **HANUMAN** *answered*: " I am a mesaenger, I come from King **SUGRIVA**." 4,3

CHAPTER 49

His Astonishment on beholding Ravana

Whose eyes were red with anger and who was blazing with rare and dazzling gold, adorned with a splendid diadem studded with pearls and excellent ornaments of diamonds and precious stones created by the power of concentrated thought. Attired in cosdy linen, daubed with red sandalpaste painted with variegated devices, he looked splendid with his reddened eyes, fierce gaze, brilliant sharp teeth and protruding lips. To that monkey, that Ten-Headed One, who was resplendent and of great energy, resembled the Mandara Mountain with its summits infested with innumerable snakes or a mass of blue antimony. A string of pearls gleaming on his breast, his countenance possessing the lustre of the full moon, he resembled a cloud illumined by the rising sun. With his great arms laden with bracelets, smeared with sandal paste, his fingers, like five-headed serpents covered with sparkling rings, he was seated on a

superb and marvellously inlaid crystal throne studded with gems and covered with rich hangings. Women, sumptuously attired, surrounded him, chowries in their hands and he was attended by four experienced counsellors, Durdhara, Prahasta, Mabaparshwa and the minister Nikumbha who stood round him like the four seas surrounding the earth ; and other counsellors too waited upon him as do the Gods on their King. Then **HANUMAN** gazed on the Lord of the Titans, clothed in extreme splendour, resembling the peak of Mount Meru surrounded by thunder clouds and, though suffering at the hands of those titans of dreadful prowess, **HANUMAN** experienced extreme astonishment at the sight of that monarch and be holding the effulgence of that Lord of the TitanS, dazzled by his magnilicence, he became absorbed in thought. 454 ' What splendour, what power, what glory, what majesty, he reflected, ' nothing is lacking ! Were he not evil, this mighty monarch of the titans could be the protector of the celestial realm and **INDRA** himself, but his cruel and ruthless deeds, abhorrent to all, render him the scourge of the worlds as also of the Gods and demons ; in his anger he could make an ocean of the earth 1 ' Such were the diverse thoughts of that sagacious monkey on beholding the immeasurable power and might of the King of the Titans.

CHAPTER 50

Hanuman is questioned by the Titans

With violent rage. Gazing on that lion among monkeys radisting splendour, his mind filled with apprehension, he reJ!ected : " Is this the blessed Nandi, who bas come hither, he who formerly cursed me when, on Mount Kailasha, he became the object of my mockery ? Or is he

perchance Vana Bali's son in the form of a monkey." His eyes red with anger, the king then addressed the fore most of his counsellors, Prabasta, in words that were opportune and fraught with good sense, saying : "Demand of this perverse wretch, whence he has come, for what reason he laid waste the grove and why he slew the titans ? What is his purpose in entering this impregnable citadel and why did he attack my retainers ? Interrogate this scoundrel concerning these matters ! " At these words of **RAVANA**, Prabasta said to **HANUMAN** : " O Monkey, be of good conrage, thou hast nought to fear 1 If it be **INDRA** who has sent thee to **RAVANA**'s abode, tells us frankly 1 Have no anxiety, thou shalt be liberated 1 If thou art from Vaishravana, **YAMA** or **VARUNA** and have penetrated into our city disgoising thy real form or if thou hast bcen 455 dispatched by **VISHNU**, hungry for conquest, then tell us. Thy form alone is thst of a monkey, not thy prowess. Unfold all this unto us faithfully, O Monkey and thou shalt instantly regain thy freedom but if thou liest, thou shalt pay for it with thy life I Therefore tell us why thou hast entered **RAVANA**'s abode,, Thus addressed, the foremost of monkeys answered the Lord of the Titans, saying : " I am not from Shakra nor Y ama nor V aruoa nor am I allied to Kuvera nor am I sent by **VISHNU**. I am truly a monkey as I appear to be, who have come here in order to behold the King of the Titans and for this purpose I destroyed the grove. To preserve my life I fought with the titans who, full of valour, presented themselves before me. Neither weapons nor chains can subdue me, even those of the Gods and titans themselves, I having received this boon from the Grandsire of the World. It was because I desired to see the king thst I suffered myself to be overcome by the **BRAHMA** weapon. Though I was not under the spell of that weapon, yet I permitted the titans to capture me in order to further Ramo's design for which purpose I have entered the Icing's presence. Knowing me to be

the messenger of Raghava, whose power is limitless, listen to my words, which will prove to thine advantage, O Lord.”

CHAPTER 51

His Words

SEEING the mighty ten-headed **RAVANA**, that intrepid monkey addressed him fearlessly, in words fraught with penetration, saying: " I have come here at the command of **SUGRIVA**, O Lord of the Titans I As a brother, thst Sovereign of the Monkeys offers salutations to thee. Hear the counsel of a brother, the magnanimous **SUGRIVA** ; his words are in accord with justice, advantageous and salutary both in this world and hereafler. King Dasaraths, the master of chariots, elephants and hnrses, in splendour equal to lndra, was the friend of all and 456 like unto a father to his subjects. His eldest son, mighty-armed, the dsrling of his sire, at his command, entered the Dandab Forest with his brother Lakshmans and his consort **SITA**. His nsme is **RAMA** and he is exceedingly valiant and ever abides in the path of virtue. His faithful consort, **SITA**, the illustrious daughter of the high-souled **JANAKA**, King of Videha, vanished in the forest of Janastbana. Seeking for that princess, the king’s son with his younger brother came to Rishyamuka and met with **SUGRIVA**. That King of the Monkeys promised to undertake the sesrch for **SITA** and **RAMA** agreed to aid him in recovering the monkey kingdom. Thereupon, slaying Bali in combat, that king’s son established **SUGRIVA** on the throne, as lord of all the besrs and monkeys. Bali, that bull among monkeys, formerly known to thee, was slain by **RAMA** with a single srrow in the fight, whereupon the Lord of the Monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, true to his vow, eager to find **SITA**, dispatched

monkeys in all directions. Hundreds, thousands and millions of monkeys are exploring every region high and low, even up to the heavens and some resemble Vainataya and some the wind and those highly energetic monkeys course hither and thither without rest, incapable of being stayed. I am named **HANUMAN**, the beloved son of Msruta and, in order to find **SITA**, I have crossed four hundred miles of sea. Having passed over the ocean, wandering through thy palace, I observed **JANAKA**'s daughter. " It does not become thee, who art conversant with what is meet and proper and hast enriched thyself by thy penances, to besr away another's wife, O Eminently Sagacious One. Intelligent beings, such as thou, should not commit acts prohibited by the law of righteousness which lead to ruin I Who, even among the Gods and titans, can withstand the shafts loosed by **LAKSHMANA** or those of Raghava in his wrath ? Nay, in the Three Worlds, there is none who may affront **RAMA** with impunity. Following the path of duty and profit, do thou ponder these words fraught with advantage to thee in the three divisions of time and restore Janaki to **RAMA**, that lion among men! " I have seen **SITA** and achieved that which was ditlicult to compass, as for whar remaineth to be done, **RAMA** himself shall accomplish it. I have beheld her in thine abode, sutfering 457 grievously ; thou art seemingly unaware that thou harbourest a five-headed serpent in thy mansion. Even as food mixed with poison may not be digested even by Gods or titans, so is she. It is not worthy of thee to bring to nought that merit acquired by extreme mortification, as also a long and prosperous life. Thou deemest thyself by thy penances, to have won immunity from death even from Gods, Immortals or titans, but **SUGRIVA** is neither a God nor an Immortal nor a titan. Raghava, O King, is a mortal and **SUGRIVA**, the Lord of Monkeys, therefore how wilt thou preserve thy life ? The fruits of virtue do not blend with those of vice nor does equity destroy iniquity, Till to-day

thou hast plucked the fruit of thy merits but soon thou wilt reap the fruit of thine evil deeds. Having learnt of the destruction of Janasthana, the death of Bali and the alliance of **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** ; ponder on these things to thine own advantage. I am undoubtedly able to destroy Lanka with its horses, chariots and elephants single-handed yet I have not received the mandate to do so. In the presence of the trOOps of monkeys and bears, **RAMA** vowed to slay his foes, those who bore **SITA** away. Assuredly, in doing injury **RAMA**, even **INDRA** himself could not dwell in peace, how much less one like thee. This **SITA**, who is known to thee and who stays in thine abode is the night of death that will bring about thine end and that of Lanka. Beware of placing thy neck in the noose of death in the form of **SITA**. Consider how thou mayest save thyself. Thou shalt behold this mar vellous city with its palaces and highways consumed by Sits's power and the 1lames fed by **RAMA**'s wrath. Do not therefore abandon friends, ministers, kinsfolk, brothers, sons, servants, wives and Lanka to this fate. O **INDRA** among Titans, follow this good counsel since it is offered to thee by one who is a monkey, the servant and mesaenger of **RAMA**. " Having wholly annihilated the worlds and their inhabitants with all that moves or does not move, the illustrious Raghava could re-create them all. Among the chiefs of the Gods, Titans, Y akshas, Danavas, Nagas, Vidyadharas, Gandharvas, wild beasts, Siddhas Kinnerss or birds, in no way nor any where, at no time, among any beings, has any been found, who could stand against **RAMA** whose valour is equal to **VISHNU**'s. 458 Since thou hast offered that lion among kings, **RAMA**, this affront, thy life is forfeit I " Dcvas, Daityas, Gandhsrvas, Vidyadharas, Nagas and Y akshas are all unable to hold their own in combat with **RAMA**, the Protector of the Three Worlds, O King of the Titans I Even were it the Four-headed **BRAHMA**, Swyambhu Himself or the Three-eyed Rudra, the destroyer of Tripura, or the mighty

INDRA, Chief of the Gods, not one of them could with stand Raghava in the field.” Hearing this distasteful ecellent speech of that bold and fearless monkey, the Ten-Necked One, his eyes rolling in anger, ordered him to he put to desth.

CHAPTER 52

Bibishana pleads for Hanuman

however, issued by the King of the Titans in his perversity on one who had proclaimed himself to be a messenger, did not meet with the approval of Bibishana. Knowing that Lord of the Titans to be eceeding wrath and the affair about to be concluded, that prince, firm in justice, began to consider what should now be done and that subduer of his foes, having resolved how to act, addressed his elder brother in words which were essentially true and mild, saying: " O King of the Titans, control thine anger and with a tranquil mind hear me, extend thy favour to me. Righteous thou, sufFer themselves to be mastered by anger, then the study of the scriptures is only a weariness of the ftesh. Be pacified therefore, O Slayer of thine Enemies, O Unconquerable Sovereign of the Titans and consider what is meet and just in dealing out punishment to a foe.” Hearing Bibishana’s words, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, in a violent rage, answered him saying : " O Scourge of Thy Foes, to slay an evil-doer is no sin, therefore I shall make an end of this worker of iniquity.” Hearing this infamous and unscrupulous speech, essentislly perverse, Bibishana, who was the foremost of those endowed with wisdom, answered in words fraught with integrity, saying: " O Lord of Lanka, King of all the Titans, be gracious unto me and listen to that which embodies the significance of vittue and profit. Under no

conditions is an envoy put to death, this is the unanimous verdict of the good. Undoubtedly this is a formidable adversary and he has inflicted immeasurable injury on us, yet men of honour do not sanction the slaying of a messenger though innumerable punishments have been ordained for them. Mutilation of the body, the whip, stripes, shaving of the head, branding, one or all of these may be inflicted on a messenger but of punishment by death, none has ever heard. How can a hero such as thou art, whose mind is swayed by a sense of duty and who is discriminating and conversant with what is noble and ignoble, sufFer himself to be overcome by anger ? The vittuous do not give way to wrath ! Thou hast no equal among those who rule over a people and thou art able to comprehend the import of the scriprures ; thou surpasseth the titans and the Gods. In vincible to the Gods and titans who are endowed with prowess, martial ardour and intelligence, thou hast oft-times in battle routed the King of the Celestials and other monarchs. Fools who, even in thought seek to injure thee, who art a great and intrepid warrior, who hast fought with Daityas and *Devas*, heroic, intrepid and unconquerable, are already deprived of their lives. I sec no justification for putting this monkey to death. It is on those who sent him, that the punishment should fall. Whether he be honest or not, the responsihility 46o rests with them. Advocating another's interests and dependent on them, an envoy does not merit death. Further if this one be killed, no other sky-tanger may present himself to us, therefore, O Conqueror of Hostile Citadels, do not seek to take his life ; direct thine efforts against the Gods and their leader. O Thou who lovest warfare, if he be slain, I see none who can incite those haughty princes to take arms against thee. It is not fitting for thee, whom the Gods and titans cannot conquer, to rob the Nairritas, whose delight thou art, of the opportunity of wimessing that encounter ! They are devoted to thy welfare, courageous,

disciplined warriors distinguished for their great qualities, intelligent, renowned for their burning ardour and fine besring. Therefore let some of these, setting out under thine orders to-day, seize those two princes and establish thy supremacy among thy foes." On this, **RAVANA**, that sagacious Lord of the Titans, the formidable foe of the celestial realm, recognised the wisdom of the inspired words uttered by his younger brother.

CHAPTER 53

Hanuman is led bound through the City

Saying: " Thou hast spoken truly, the slaying of a messenger is to be deprecated, it is therefore necessary to in11ict some punish ment other than death on him. In the case of monkeys, the tail is unquestionably the most cherished embellishment, therefore let it be set on fire and, having been burnt let him go, whereafter his friends, kinsfolk and allies as all those dear to him shall behold him degraded and mutilated." Then the Lord of the Titans issued this command : " With his tail in llames, let him be led through the city of Lanka and its highways." THE RAMAYANA OF VALM1K1 Hearing his words, the titans in their savage fury began to wrap the tail of **HANUMAN** in cotton rags and thus swathed, that colossal monkey increased in size like unto a fire in a forest fed by dry wood. And having soaked the clotha in oil, the titans set them on fire and **HANUMAN**, filled with rage and indignstion, his face shining like the rising sun, lashed out at them with his blazing tail, whereupon that lion among monkeya was secured more tightly by the assembled demons. Accom panied by women, children and the aged, those rangers of the night gathered to enjoy the spectacle and the valiant

HANUMAN, who was bound, began to refiect on the matter and thought to himself: " Assuredly, though fettered, the titans arc not able to prevent me from breaking my bonds and leaping amongst them creating fresh carnage, still it is in the interest of my master that 1 have taken this journey and it is under the orders of their lord that they have bound me, 1 shall not therefore resist them. From the point of view of stature, I am wcll able tn engage all these titans in battle but for love of **RAMA** I shall suffer this outrage. I shall survey Lanka anew, since during the night I was not able to view the fortifications, it proving too difficult. The night having passed I shall behold Lanka by day. Let them bind me anew ; even though they infiict pain on me by the burning of my tail, my mind is not troubled." Meanwhile the titans seizing hold of that great monkey of fonnidsble aspect who was full of courage, an elephant among apes, aultant, advanced joyfully, proclaiming his misdeeds with conches and trumpets and those demons of cruel exploirs dragged **HANUMAN**, the conqueror of his foes, through the city, he willingly submitting himself to them. Thereupon, passing through the titan's capital, that greu monkey surveyed those marvcllous palaces, covered highways, wcll laid out squares and streets Banked with mansions and cross roads, lanes and alleys, as also the interior of the dwcllings and on the terraces and roads and along the royal highways all those titans cried out : " This is a spy I " Then those hideous titan women informed the divine **SITA** of these unpleasant tidings, saying :-" O **SITA**, that red-faced monkey, who had converse with thee, is being led through the SUNDAVA *KANDA* streets, his tail ablaze." And hearing those words, Vaidehi remembering her own abduction, overcome with grief, having duly purified herself, called upon that God who nourishes himself on the sacrifices and urgently implored him to show his favour to that mighty monkey. And the large-eyed **SITA**, standing before the fire said : " If I am possessed of

true devotion to my lord and hsve practised penances, if I have been a chaste wife, then do thou prove cool this monkey. If the sagacious **RAMA** still hss any compassion for me, if my merits are not wholly exhausted, then do not bum **HANUMAN**." Whereupon Anala of ardent rays, as if communicating with that lady, whose eyes were like a doe's, blazed up and, at the same time, **HANUMAN**'s sire, in order to please that goddess, blew on that flaming tail with ice-cold breath and the monkey, whose tail was ablaze, thought :-" How is it that this fire, blazing up, does not bum me ? I see a great flame, yet feel no pain, even as if the snow had fallen upon it. In sooth this is a wonder due to **RAMA**'s power which I witnessed when crossing the main. If the ocean and the virtuous Mainaka acted in such a manner, in reverence for him, whst will the God of Fire not do? It is on account of Sits's virtue, Raghava's power and my sire's affection for me, thst Pavaka does not bum me." Thereafter that elephant among monkeys reflected : " Why should a warrior such as I, suffer himself to be bound by these vile titans ? It is meet that I should manifest my valour and avenge myself! " Then that imperuous and mighty monkey snapped his bonds and springing into the air uttered a shout and that offspring of the Wind-god reached the gate of the city which was as high as the peak of a mountain and where no titans were to be found. Then, he who resembled a great hill, assumed a diminutive form and casting off his fetters became free, where upon he expanded to the size of a mountain once more. Look ing about him he observed an iron bat lying at the gate and the long-armed Matuti, seizing hold of that weapon, employed it for slaying the guatds. Having destroyed them, in his ardour, that one of exceeding prowess, with the burning plume of his tail resembling an aureole, looking like the glorious sun surrounded by rays, cast his eyes over Lanka. 463 CHAPTER $4 He fir to Lanka SURVEYING Lanka, that monkey, having attained his purpose, began

to consider what he should do further and reflected in himself:-" What more remains for me to do to alllict the titans ? The grove laid waste, those vile titans slain, a part of the army destroyed, nothing is left for me but to demolish their citadel. With their fort destroyed, it were easy to bring my labours to an end ; with a little effort I can complete my task and obrain the price of my trouble. The Bearer of Sacrificial Offerings that llames on my tail must be propitiated by me, I shall therefore burn up these excellent buildings." Thereat, with his tail in flames, which lent him the appear ance of a cloud charged with lightning, that great monkey began to range the roofs of the dwellings of Lanka. Glancing round, passing from mansion to mansion, with a calm mind he encircled those stately edifices and gardens and leaping im petuously towards the palace of Prahasta, that one of exceeding prowess in strength resembling the wind, set fire to it. There after the mighty **HANUMAN** bounded to the mansion of Maha parshwa lighting a fire equal to that at the end of the world. Then that monkey of immense energy leapt on the residence of Vajradanshtra and on those belonging to Shuka and the in telligent Sarana. In the same way that leader of monkeys burnt down the habitations of lndrajita, Jambumalin and Sumali and those of the titans Rashmiketu, Suryashatru, Hrasvakarna, Damshtra, Romasba, Yuddhonmatta, Matta, Dwajagriva, Vidyujjihva and Hastimukha and the dwellings of Karala, Vishala, Shonitaksba, Kumbbakarna, Maharaksha, those of Narantaka, Kumbba, Nikumbha and the magnnimous YajDashatru and Brahmaahatru. That mighty bull among monkeys thereafter set fire to the accumulated treasure of those aflluent titans and having paaaed

CHAPTER 54

He sets Fire to Lanka

CHAPTER $4 He fir to Lanka SURVEYING Lanka, that monkey, having attained his purpose, began to consider what he should do further and reflected in himself:-" What more remains for me to do to alllict the titans ? The grove laid waste, those vile titans slain, a part of the army destroyed, nothing is left for me but to demolish their citadel. With their fort destroyed, it were easy to bring my labours to an end ; with a little effort I can complete my task and obrain the price of my trouble. The Bearer of Sacrificial Offerings that llames on my tail must be propitiated by me, I shall therefore burn up these excellent buildings." Thereat, with his tail in flames, which lent him the appear ance of a cloud charged with lightning, that great monkey began to range the roofs of the dwellings of Lanka. Glancing round, passing from mansion to mansion, with a calm mind he encircled those stately edifices and gardens and leaping im petuously towards the palace of Prahasta, that one of exceeding prowess in strength resembling the wind, set fire to it. There after the mighty **HANUMAN** bounded to the mansion of Maha parshwa lighting a fire equal to that at the end of the world. Then that monkey of immense energy leapt on the residence of Vajradanshtra and on those belonging to Shuka and the in telligent Sarana. In the same way that leader of monkeys burnt down the habitations of lndrajita, Jambumalin and Sumali and those of the titans Rashmiketu, Suryashatru, Hrasvakarna, Damshtra, Romasba, Yuddhonmatta, Matta, Dwajagriva, Vidyujjihva and Hastimukha and the dwellings of Karala, Vishala, Shonitaksba, Kumbbakarna, Maharaksha, those of Narantaka, Kumbba, Nikumbha and the magnnimous YajDashatru and Brahmaahatru. That

mighty bull among monkeys thereafter set fire to the accumulated treasure of those aflluent titans and having paaaed 464 over the other dwellings that powerful and auspicious one approached the residence of the King of Titans. Then the virtuous **HANUMAN**, emitting loud cries, resembling a cloud at the dissolution of the world, with the tip of his blazing tail set fire to that foremost of buildings decorated with every variety of gems resembling Mount Meru or Mandara, en riched with sumptuous decoration. Fanned by the wind, the 1lames spread everywhere, casting livid gleams like the Fires of Time and those palaces, en riched with gold, decorated with pearls and gems, richly bejewelled, toppled to earth, crumbling to dust like the mansions of the Celestials, who have fallen from heaven their merit exhausted. Then there arose a mighty uproar among the titans, who fted in all directions unable to preserve their dwell ings, bereft of their treasure, crying out:-" Verily it is the God of Fire himself in the form of a monkey ! " Some of the titan women with babies at their breasts ran shrieking from their homes and some, enveloped in llames, their hair in disorder, fell from the high balconies like Hashes of lighrning in the sky. And **HANUMAN** saw various metals ftowing in a molten mass, mixed with diamonds, coral, emeralds, pearls and silver, streaming from the palaces and, as fire is not sated in consuming wood and straw, neither did **HANUMAN** weary of alaying those leaders of titans nor the earth from receiving their corpses. As Rudra consumed the Demon Tripura so did that impetuous and mighty monkey burn up Lanka and, from the summit of that mountain where Lanka stood, that dreadful conftagration kindled by the intrepid **HANUMAN** shot forth in tongues of ftatne. Resembling the fires at the destruction of the world, the smokeless conftagration, lit by Maruta blazed up to the skies aided by the wind, feeding on the dwellings of the titans and their bodies like sacrificial offerings and,

with the fierce ardour of a million suns, it consumed Lanka wholly as with increasing volume the fire cleaves the mundane Egg with a sound resemhling innumerable thunderclaps. That fire of incalculable fury, rising into the sky, with its ftatnes resemhling Kimshuka ftowers, its clouds of smoke like unto the blue lotus, looked =eedingly beautiful. " Verily this is the God who bears the thunderbolt, Mahendra, the Chief of the Thirty or **YAMA** or **VARUNA** or Anila. This is no monkey but the God of Death himself who has come I Or perchance it is a manifestation of Brahms's wrath, the four faced God who, in the form of a monkey has come hither to destroy the titans or is it the supreme power of **VISHNU**, un imaginable, unutterable, infinite and unsurpassed, which, by his Maya, has assumed the form of a monkey ? " Thus did the chief titans speak, being assembled and, seeing their city suddeoly consumed by fire with its inhabitants, horses, chariots, flocks of birds, beasts and trees they began to lament, crying:-" O My Father, O My beloved Son, O My dear One, O My Friend I Woe, alas I O My Lord, our spiritual merit is exhausted I " Thus amidst, a frightful clamour, did the titans cry aloud, and Lanka, encircled with flames, her heroes slain, her warriors succumbing to the swift wrath of **HANUMAN**, appeared to have fallen under a curse. In the midst of the tumult **HANUMAN** with pride, surveyed Lanka bearing the marks of that violent blaze and its terror stricken demons as Swyambhu surveys the final destruction of the world. Having demolished the grove planted with rare trees and slain those powerful titans in combat and burned that city 1iiled with splendid palaces, that monkey born of Pavana rested. Having dispatched those titans in great numbers, destroyed the dense woods and spread the fire amongst the titan dwell ings, the illustrious **HANUMAN** became absorbed in the thought of **RAMA**. Thereupon all the Celestials lauded that prince among monkey warriors endowed with immense energy,

equal to Maruta in swiftness, that sagacious and excellent son of Vayu. And all the Gods, the foremost of the Ascetics, the Gandharvas, Vidyadharas, Pannagas and Bhutas experienced an exceeding and indescribable joy. And having devastated the forest, aiain the titans in conflict and burnt the great city of Lanka, that mighty monkey, seated on the roof of the foremost of buildings, spreading the rays of his flaming taillike a aureole, resembled the sun encircled with 466 a nimbus. Then having consumed the city of Lanka, that great monkey quenched the fire of his tail in the sea. Bebolding Lanka consumed by fire, the Gods, Gandbarvas, Siddhas and great ascetics were struck with amazement.

CHAPTER 55

Hanuman's Fears concerning Sita

SEEING Lanka consumed by fire and that city with its terror stricken titans filled with tumult, the monkey **HANUMAN** became thoughtful and a great anxiety invaded his mind. He reflected :-" In burning Lanka, I have without doubt done something reprebensible ! Blessed those great souls, who, in their wisdom extinguish the anger born within them as a fire is quenched by water. What evil is not committed by those who give way to wrath ? In anger one may even slay one’s spiritual preceptor ; nor does he who is enraged, refrain from affronting virtuous men. He who gives way to wrath is unable to discriminate as to when it is fitting to speak or when to be silent ; there is no iniquity that cannot be per petrated by him. He is truly said to be a man, who, con trolling himself, subdues the anger rising within him as a snake casts off its slough. Woe is me, wretched and shameless doer of evil that I am, who, forgetting **SITA**, have slain my lord by fire. Should that noble daughter of **JANAKA**

have perished in this conllagration, which has wholly consumed the city of Lanka, I have frustrated the purpose of my master ; **SITA** having been burnt, I have marred my lord's design. To bum down Lanka is a trilling occurrence, but suffering myself to be overcome by anger I have cut at the very root of my mission. Assuredly J anaki has perished for there remains no comer of Lanka that has not been laid waste, the entire city lies in ashes. Since I have sacrified everything through my lack of understanding, I shall yield up my life this instant, either I shall throw myself into the fire or into the jaws of Vadava, or give my body to the denizens of the deep. Living, I am not able to face the King of the Monkeys or those two All THE RAMAYANA' OP VALMIKI tigers among men, having marred their purpose. Through my culpable anger I have manifested my undisciplined simian nature to the Three Worlds. Woe to the unbridled passion, uncurbed and unrestrained, under which I failed to protect **SITA** when it was in my power to do so. She, hsving perished, those two heroes will die also and on their ceasing to exist, **SUGRIVA** will yield up his life with all his kinsfolk. On hearing these tidings, how shall the virtuous Bhsrata, devoted to his brother or Shstrughna, survive ? Then on the extinction of the illustrious race of Ikshwaku, their subjects will be overcome with grief. " Unfortunate am I, whose merits hsve been annulled through being false to the ties of duty and advantage, suffering myself to be dominated by a corrupting passion, thus becoming the destroyer of creatures I " Immersed in these melancholy rdlections, **HANUMAN** re collected certain auspicious signs thst he hsd previously observed and said to himself: " Is it possible thst that Lovely One, protected by her own spiritual merit, hss hsppily escaped death ? Fire cannot burn fire I Nay, Pavaka would not dare to approach that virtuous one, preserved by her own purity, who is the consOrt of one of immeasurable glory. That Bearer of Sacrificial

Offerings has not burned me owing to **RAMA**'s power and the virtue of Vaidehi. How should she therefore, the object of worship of those three brothers, Bhsrata and the others and the beloved nf **RAMA**'s heart, perish ? Since it is the nature nf fire to burn, he who reigns invincible as master everywhere yet who has not burned my tail, why should he consume thst eulted One ? " Thereafter **HANUMAN** remembered with wonder how the Mainaka hill hsd appeared to him in the ocean and he reflected: " By virtue nf her asceticism, sincerity and undeviating devotion to her lord, she is able to consume fire itself but it cannot consume her!' Pondeting thus on the magnitude nf the divine **SITA**'s spiritual merit, **HANUMAN** heard the high-souled Chsranas conversing thus : " Assuredly **HANUMAN** has accomplished a difficult feat in igniting a fierce and terrible fire in the dwellings nf the titans. 468 The hosts of women, cbildren and the aged are fleeing away and the tumult re-echoes as in a cavern ; the city of Lanka with its towers, walls and gateways is wholly consumed but Janaki still lives, a great wonder ! " Such were the words, resembling ambrosia, which feU on **HANUMAN**'s ears and from that instant, happiness flooded his heart once more. On account of the auspicious portents, his own conclusions, the merits of **SITA** and the words of the saints, **HANUMAN** was delighted beyond measure. Thereupon that monkey, having attained his end, knowing the princess to be safe, resolved to leave Lanka after seeing her once more.

CHAPTER 56

He takes Leave of her

O Destroyer of Hostile Warriors, thou alone art competent to perform this task, thou shalt attain renown by thy prowess ; yet, if Kakutstha, the

scourge of his foes were able to lay Lanka waste with his forces and bear me away, it would be wortby of bim. Therefore do that which will enable the magnanimous **RAMA** to manifest his prowess in conformity with a warrior's nature." Heating these words full of loving solicitude, reason and significance, the valiant **HAOUMAN** *answered*: " O Noble Lady, that lord and foremost of monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, endowed with power, has resolved to deliver thee. Attended by thousands of billions of powerful monkeys, he will not delay in coming hither, O Vaidehi, and those foremost of men, the fiower of the human race, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, coming here, will alflict Lanka with their arrows. Having destroyed the titans and their adherents, the son of Raghu, O Exceedingly Fair One, shall bear thee away and bring thee to his capital. Take heart, therefore, O Gentle One and await that hour ! Soon shalt thou see **RAMA** strike down **RAVANA** on the field of battle. The Lord of the Titans slain with his sons, ministers and people, thou shalt be re-united with **RAMA**, as Rohini with the moon. Ere long Kakutstha will appear accompanied by the foremost of monkeys and bears and, triumphing in the fight, shall remove thy grief." Having thus consoled Vaidehi, **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, prepared to depart, offering salutations to her and, having comforted her and displayed his surpassing strengrh by render ing that city desolate, having thwarted **RAVANA** and exhibited his immeasurabke power, **HANUMAN**, paying obeisance to Vaidehi, intent on returning, resolved to cross the ocean once more. Then the repressor of his foes, that powerful monkey, eager to see his lord, ascended the foremost of mountains, Arishta, covered with dark groves of Padmaka trees, resembling a mantle which, with the clouds clinging to its sides, seemed to expand with joy under the sun's rays ; the metals scattered here and there appeared to be its eyes and the solemn sound of its torrents resembled its voice chanting the Veda ; the

water falls, the singing of its song and the tall Devadaru trees caused of70 s;UNDARA *KANDA* the mountain to resemble a giant with uplifted arms, the thundering of the torrents were its cries re-echoing round about and the autumnal woods agitated by the wind made it appear as if it trembled ; as the breeze whistled through the reeds, it seemed to be piping while great and venomous ser pents created the illusion of its hissing in anger. With its ravines shrouded in mist, investing it with a solemn air, as if it were deeply absorbed in contemplation and the clouds moving bere and there on its slopes lending it the appearance of walking; with its peaks towering heavenwards, so that it appeared to be yawning, it was bristling with escarpments and filled with innumerable caves. Planted with Sala, Tala. Kharjura, Tamala, Kama and Vanisha trees with a myriad creepers laden with llowers and abounding in herds of deer and containing innumerable streams, with countless crags, rich in minerals, intersected by rills, frequented by Maharishis, Yakshas, Gandharvas, Kinneras and Uragas, impenetrable on account of the thorns and briars, its caves were filled with lions, and tigers and other beasts abounded there and that mountain was furnished with trees having delicious fruit and roots. Then the foremost of monkeys, the son of Anila, ascended that mountain burning to behold Ramo once more and, wherever he placed his foot on those enchanting slopes, the rocks crumbled and broke away with a thundering sound. Having scaled the **INDRA** of Mountains, that mighty monkey gathered up his strength, desirous of crossing from the southern to the northern shore of the salty sea and, reaching the summit, he beheld that formidable expanse of water inhabited by dreadful monsters. Then the son of Maruta, with the swift· ness of the wind as it blows through space, leapt from the southern region to the northern shore and, pressed under foot by that monkey, the mountain giant re-echoing to the cries of

countless denizens sank into the bosom of the earth with its peaks toppling and its trees overturned. Borne down by **HANUMAN**'s prodigious bounds, trees laden with blossom fell to the ground as if struck by **INDRA**'s thunderbolt and the dreadful roar of great lions lurking in the caverns rent the skies as they were crushed by the falling mountain. Vidya dharas, their raiment tom and their ornaments in disnrder, 471 fled in terror from that place and large and powerful serpeniS, 6lled with poison, shooting out their tongues, lay in coiled heaps, their heads and necks crushed Kinneras, Uragas, Gandharvas, Yakshas and Vidyadharas, deserting that mountain, returned to the celestial realm and that mighty hill, measuring forty miles in extent and thirty in height, was levelled to the earth with ill trees and lofty summits Then that monkey, desirous of crosaing over the salty sea, whose shores were thteatened by the tides, rose into the ait.

CHAPTER 57

The Return of Hanuman

LIRE a winged mountain, with one impetuous bound, **HANUMAN** sailed over the aity sea, whose serpents were the Y akshas and the full-blown lotuses ; the Gandharvas the moon was the lily on those enchanting waters, the sun its waterfowl, Tishya and Shravana its swans and the clouds its reeds and moss ; Pumavasu was the whale and Lohitsnga the crocodile ; Airavata the spacious island ; Swati, its decoration in the form of a swan; the breezes were its billows and the rays of the moon its cool and peaceful waves. Unwearyingly, **HANUMAN** swallowing up that space adorned with the sun and stars, skimmed past the King of the Planets. Cleaving the clouds and crossing

that ocean withont atigue, he beheld great masses of cloud, white, roseate, purple, blue, yellow and black, looking exceedingly beautiful and he, entering and re-emerging from them, looted like the mooa, when it is lost to sight and becomes visible again. Coursing through those massed· clouds in his white attire, thar hero could at times be seen and again was hidden in the aky, like unto the moon. Borne through space, that son of the Wind constantly dispersed the groups of clouds, sailing on and oa, emitting lond roars resembling thunder and, having slain the litans. rendered his name amons, laid the city of Lanka waste, 472 harassed **RAVANA**, inflicted defeat on those mighty warrion and paid homage to Vaidehi, he was now returning full of glory, across the sea. And that one endowed with prowess, paid homage to the foremost of mountains, Mainab, as he sped on like an arrow loosed from the bowstring. Approaching from afar, he observed that lofty Mountain Mahendra, like a great cloud and that mighty monkey, having a lusty voice resembling thunder, filled the ten cardinal points with his roars. Reaching the southern shore, eager to see his friends once again, he began to wave his tail to and fro and emit loud cries and as he proceeded in the path of Supama, the clamour rent the skies and it appeared as if the firmament and the sun's disc were shattered. Thereupon those mighty warriors on the northern shore of the ocean, anaiously awaiting the Wind-god's offspring, heard the sound created by the thighs of **HANUMAN** proceeding at great speed, resembling clouds blown by the wind and those rangers of the woods, who had been dispirited, heard the roan of that monkey which were like unto thunder. Hearing that clamour raised by **HANUMAN**, those monkeys who were eager to see their friend once again, were gready excited and **JAMBAVAN**, the foremost of the monkeys, his heart exultant, addressing them all, spoke thus : " Undoubtedly **HANUMAN** has been wholly successful in his enterprise ; if

it were not so he would not have raised this clamour." Thereupon the monkeys, hearing the violent movements of that magnanimous one, as also his shouts, highly delighted, leapt up and in their joy, bounding from rock to rock and from peak, like a winged bill, whose pinions have been clipt and who has fallen from the sky. Then instantly all the monkeys with glad hearts began to gather round the magnanimous **HANUMAN**, encircling him, their faces shining with joy, drawing near to him in the excess of their felicity. Then offering obeisance to him they brought roors and fruirs to that greatest of monkeys, born of Maruta. In their delight, some emitted shours of joy and the foremost of the monkeys brought branches of trees so that he might be seated. Meanwhile that mighty ape, **HANUMAN**, paid obeisance to his elders and the aged with **JAMBAVAN** at their head, as well as Prince **ANGADA**. And honoured by them all, as he had merited to be and overwhelmed by courtesies, he informed them briefly :-" I have seen the Goddess ! " Then taking the hand of Bali's son, he sat down in the enchanting grove on the Mahendra Mountain and, questioned by them, he joyfully addressed those foremost of monkeys, saying : " In the midst of the Ashoka grove, I observed Janaki; that irreproachable one is guarded by dreadful titan women. That damsel is wearing a single plait of hair and constantly sighs for **RAMA**'s presence. She is faint on account of fasting, stained with dust, emaciated, and wears matted locks." Those foremost of monkeys, hearing the words of Maruti : " I have seen her ", sweet as Amrita, intoxicated with joy began to shout and emitting cries of pleasure raised ululations. Some waved their tails to and fro, others raised them up lashing them or bounded to the summit and with delight touched the fortunate **HANUMAN**, that chief of monkeys. And when **HANUMAN** had spoken, **ANGADA**, in the midst of those valiant monkeys, paid tribute to **HANUMAN** in excellent words, saying : "For

valour and courage thou hast no equal, O Monkey, since thou hast crossed the immense ocean and hast now returned. Thou alone hast given us back our lives, O Great One. By thy grace, our purpose accomplished, we can rejoin Raghava. O What devotion thou hast shown to thy master I What prowess ! What endurance I By the grace of heaven, thou hast seen the divine and glorious consort of **RAMA**. By 474 the grace of heaven, Kakutstha will abandon the grief that **SITA**'s absence bas caused bim I " Thereafter, surrounding **ANGADA**, **HANUMAN** and **JAMBAVAN**, the monkeys full of joy brought large rocks and, seated thereon, eager to hear how he had crossed the main and seen Lanka, **SITA** and **RAVANA**, they waited with joined palms, their eyes fixed on Maruti. And the youtbful **ANGADA**, surrounded by innumerable monkeys, resembled the Chief of the Gods enthroned in heaven amidst the myriad hosts. When the glorious and renowned **HANUMAN** with the illus trious **ANGADA**, who was adorned with bracelets were seated, that elevated and mighty peak shone with splendour. CHAPTER S8 **HANUMAN** recounts his Experiences THI!RI!APTI!II, on the summit of Mount Mahendra, those monkeys, their eyes fixed on the mighty **HANUMAN** were filled with delight and when all those bigb-souled and happy monkeys were seated, **JAMBAVAN**, glad at heart, enquired of the great and fortunate offspring of the Wind concerning the success of bis mission, saying : " How didst thou discover that noble lady ; how doth she fare there; how doth that cruel Ten-headed One bear himaelf towards her ? Do thou truthfully relate all this unto us, O Mighty Monkey I " How wast thou able to trace the divine **SITA** ? What did she reply to thine enquiries ? Having learnt all, we can take counsel as to what should be done I Do thou tell us also what, on our return, we should say and what we should conceal, O Thou who art well able to subdue thyself! " Thereupon, that messenger, bis

hair standing on end with joy on hearing these words, inclining bis head in token of his reverence for Sits, answered : 47S

CHAPTER 58

He recounts his Experiences

the grace of heaven, Kakutstha will abandon the grief that **SITA**'s absence bas caused bim I " Thereafter, surrounding **ANGADA**, **HANUMAN** and **JAMBAVAN**, the monkeys full of joy brought large rocks and, seated thereon, eager to hear how he had crossed the main and seen Lanka, **SITA** and **RAVANA**, they waited with joined palms, their eyes fixed on Maruti. And the youtbful **ANGADA**, surrounded by innumerable monkeys, resembled the Chief of the Gods enthroned in heaven amidst the myriad hosts. When the glorious and renowned **HANUMAN** with the illus trious **ANGADA**, who was adorned with bracelets were seated, that elevated and mighty peak shone with splendour. CHAPTER S8 **HANUMAN** recounts his Experiences THI!RI!APTI!II, on the summit of Mount Mahendra, those monkeys, their eyes fixed on the mighty **HANUMAN** were filled with delight and when all those bigb-souled and happy monkeys were seated, **JAMBAVAN**, glad at heart, enquired of the great and fortunate offspring of the Wind concerning the success of bis mission, saying : " How didst thou discover that noble lady ; how doth she fare there; how doth that cruel Ten-headed One bear himaelf towards her ? Do thou truthfully relate all this unto us, O Mighty Monkey I " How wast thou able to trace the divine **SITA** ? What did she reply to thine enquiries ? Having learnt all, we can take counsel as to what should be done I Do thou tell us also what, on our return, we should say and what we should conceal, O Thou

who art well able to subdue thyself! " Thereupon, that messenger, bis hair standing on end with joy on hearing these words, inclining bis head in token of his reverence for Sits, answered : 47S " In your presence I leapt from the summit of the Mahendra Mountain into space with a coruentrated mind, desirous of reaching the southern shore of the sea. In my murse, a formidable obstacle presented itself to my view and I beheld a gteat mountain having a golden peak, divine and splendid, which obstructed my path. Approaching the sun-like summit of that mighty mountsin, reflecting: 'I will ahatter this', I struck it with my tail and tbat pesk which shone like the sun, broke into a thousand fragments. Seeing its mndition, tbat gteat mountain addressed me in sweet accents, bringing as it were refreshment to my soul, and said : " ' Know me, O My Son, to be the brother of thy father Matsrishvat, famed as Mainaka, dwelling in the deep. Formerly, all the larger mountains were furnished with wings and ranged over the earth causing devastation everywhere. Hearing of the conduct of those mountains, Mahendra, tbat blessed One, by whom Paka was chastised, with his thunder bolt severed the wings of those mountains by thousands but I was delivered by thine illustrious sire and tbat high-souled Wind-god cast me into the sea, the abode of **VARUNA**. O Subduer of thy Foes, I am williog to render assistance to Raghava, Ramo is the foremost among virtuous men and is as powetful .. Mahendra himself " Hearing the words of the msgnanimous Mainaka, I an fided my purpose to him and he gave me leave to depart. Then, counselling me to proceed, be vanished in his human form and in the shape of a mountain became submerged in the sea. " For along time I travclled onward with speed till I observed the divine Surasa, Mother of Serpents, in the midst of the ocean and tbat Goddess addressed me saying : " ' Thou art destined by the Celestials to be my food, O Best of Monkeys, I am about to devour thee since thou bast been assigned to me

'. " Hearing this, I, with humility, turning pale, made obeisance to her with joined palms and uttered these words : " ' **RAMA**, the fortunate son of **DASARATHA**, the Scourge of his Foes, withdrew to the Dandska Forest with his brother **RAVANA** ; I am proceeding to her on **RAMA**'s behest. In tbis matter tbou shouldst assist **RAMA**. Having seen Mithila's daugbter as also her lord of imperiabable exploits, I sball return and enter tby moutb, tbis I promise tbee '. " Thus accosted by me, Surasa, able to change her form at will, said : ' None is able to pass by me, tbis is tbe boon I have received '. " Thus addressed by Surasa, I attained tbe magnitude of ten yojanas and tben anotber ten, but her moutb assumed even greater proportions. Seeing her jaws tbus dilated, I instantly assumed a tiny form measuring a tbumb's size and quickly entered her moutb, emerging immediately, whereupon the divine Surasa, taking on her normal abape, said to me : " ' O Best of Monkeys, O Dear One, go, accomplish tby mission and restore Vaidchi to tbe magnanimous **RAMA**. Be thou blessed, O Migbty One ! I am pleased witb tbee I ' " Then all beings praised me saying: ' llxcellentl Excellent! ' and I again leapt into tbe infinite blue like unto **GARUDA**, when suddenly, witbout anytbing being visible, my shadow was held fast. Stayed in my course, I surveyed the ten car dinal points unable to discover who held me prisoner. Then the tbougbt came to me : ' What is tbis obstacle that has risen in my patb ? I cannot discern its nature ! ' And as I looked down bewildered, I beheld a dreadful demon lying in tbe waves, tbereupon that monster,laugbing scornfully, addressed tbese inauspicious words to me, who !bough undaunted, remained motionless : " ' Whitber art tbou bound, O Thou of gigantic form ? Do tbou become my food, who am hungry, and gtatify tbis body deprived of sustenance for a long period.' Saying :-' Be it so ' I expanded my body to more tban the capacity of her moutb but she increased the size of her huge and dreadful jaws in order

to swallow me nor could she comprehend that I was able to assume dift'erent shapes at will. In the twinkling of an eye, abandoning my vast size, I, extracting her heart, Sew into the sky. " Throwing up her arms, that cruel demon sank under the salty waves like a mountain, whereupon I heard the har monious voices of !bose magnanimoots beings stationed in the n THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI air, saying :- That dreadful demon Sinhika has been swiftly slain by **HANUMAN**.' " That monster destroyed, I recalled to mind the urgency of my mission, and the delay that had occurred in discharging it and, after traversing a great distance, I beheld the southern shore of the ocean and the mountain on which Lanka was situated. The sun having set, I penetrated the abode of the titans unnoticed by them and, as I did so, a woman resembling the clouds at the end of the world period rose before me, breaking into laughter. Striking that exceedingly dreadful form, having Hames for her hair, who had sought to take my life, with my left fist I thrust her aside and entered there at dusk, whereupon that one, affrighted, addressed me saying : "I am the city of Lanka, O Warrior I Vanquished have I been by thy prowess, thou shalt also triumph over all the titans I' "Meanwhile I sought for **JANAKA**'s daughter all through the night, penetrating into **RAVANA**'s inner apartments, but did not find her there. Not finding **SITA** in **RAVANA**'s palace, I was submerged in a sea of sorrow and in the midst of my distress I saw an enchanting grove with a mansion surrounded by a lofty golden wall. Having scaled that enclosure I hebeld a grove of Ashoka trees in the midst of which a great Shimshapa grew. Ascending it, I observed a thicket of golden aspens and hard by the Shimshapa tree, I beheld that supremely beautiful one, dark blue of hue, whose eyes resembled lotus petals, clad in a single piece of cloth. Emaciated with fasting, her hair soiled with dust, **SITA**, fiaed in devotion to her lord, was surrounded by cruel and hideous titan women living on

blood and fiesh, as a doe encircled by tigresses. Wearing a single plait, absorbed in the thought of her lord, lying on the earth, her limbs wasted, she resembled a lotus at the advent of winter. Deprived by **RAVANA** of the object of her desire, she had resolved to die. “Beholding that lady, whose eyes resembled a doe’s, the illustrious consort of **RAMA**, I remained seated in the Shimshapa tree. " Thereafter I heard a great clamour mixed with the jingling of girdles and anklets, issuing from the palace of **RAVANA** and, exceedingly agitated, contracting my body, I concealed myself 478 like a bird in the thick foliage of the Shimsbapa tree. There upon the mighty **RAVANA** accompanied by his consorts came to the place where **SITA** was and, seeing the Lord of the Titans, Janaki of lovely hips, shrank into herself, concealing bet breasts with her arms and, in great dread and extreme con fusion, glancing here and there and finding no refuge, tbat unfortunate being was seized with violent trembling. " Then Dasbagriva, inclining his head, bowed to the feet of the priocess, who was overcome with extreme grief and said to her: " ' O Fair One, do thou regard me with favour ! If, O **SITA**, through pride, thou dost refuse to honour me, at the end of two months I sball drink thy blood ! ' “Hearing these words spoken by the wicked **RAVANA**, Janaki growing exceedingly wrath, answered with dignity : " ' O Vilest of Titans, baving uttered such a speech to the consort of Ramo of immeasurable prowess, to me, the daughter in-law of Dasaratba of the Ikshwaku line, why bas thy tongue not fallen out? O Vile Wretch, great indeed was thy valour to bear me hence far from the illusrrious Ramo, in his absence I Thou art not even worthy to be the slave of Ragbava, tbat invincible, loyal, courageous and illustrious warrior I " Thus addressed in harsh terms, Dasbagriva blazed up with wrath like a lire on to which a brand bas been cast and, rolling his eyes in rage, clenching his right fist he prepared to strike Mithila’s daughter. " Then all the titan women

cried out : ' Hold I Hold I and from their midst, the wife of tbat evil wretch, the lovely **MANDODARI**, ran towards him and with gentle words, inspired by the love she bore him, contrived to pacify him. " **SHE** *said*:-' Thou whose valour is equal to Mahendra's, wbat need hast thou for **SITA** ? Divert thyself with me, who am in no way inferior to bet or do thou disport thyself with the daughters of the Gods, the Gandbarvas or Yakshas. What is **SITA** to thee ? ' " Thereafter, tbat company of women raised up tbat powerful Ranger of the Night and conducted him back to his residence. " **RAVANA** baving departed, those titan women of hideous upect, railed at **SITA** in barsh and cruel terms, but Janaki paid 479 no more heed to their speech tban to a straw, and their taunts were lost on her ; and those titan women, who fed on llesh, failing in their attempts, informed **RAVANA** of Siu's unconquer able resolution, whilst others, tired of tormenting her, giving up hope, exhausted, lay down to rest. " And while they slept, **SITA**, devoted to her lord, gave voice to bitter lamentation in the extremity of her distress. "Thereafter, rising in their midst, **TRIJATA** spoke, saying: " Devour me this instant, if you will, but do not lay hands on the dsrk-eyed **SITA**, daughter of JSDaka, the virtuous daughter-in-law of King **DASARATHA**. In truth I have had a fearful dream, causing the hair to stand on end, presaging the destruction of the titans and the triumph of this one's lord. It is for us to seek the grace of Vaidehi, who alone I deem, can defend us from Raghava. Let us therefore relate this dream to her, for one who is the object of such a vision, being freed from her distress, will attain the height of felicity. By bowing low in submission, we shall earn the favour of Janaki, who alone can deliver us from this great peril! ' " Thereat that chaste and youthful woman, on hearing of the comiog victory of her lord, rejoicing, said : "'If **TRIJATA** speak truly, then indeed will I protect you all.' " Observing **SITA**'s unfortunate plight, I became absorbed in thought and my mind

was perturbed. Then I cast about as to how I might find some means of speaking to Janaki and I began to extol the race of lkshwaku. " Hearing the words I uttered embellished with the praises of those Rajarishis, that exalted lady, her eyes suffused with tears, enquired of me saying :-' Who art thou ; how and on whose behest hast thou come hither ? From whence comes thine attachment to **RAMA** ? It behoveth thee to relate all to me.' " Listening to her speech, I made answer to her in this wise: .. ' O Goddess I **RAMA**, thy consort, hath found an ally endowed with supreme prowess, named Sugtiva, who is the redoubtable and powerful King of the Moakeys. Know me to be his servant, **HANUMAN**, who has come hither to thee, dispatched by thy lord of imperishable aploits. o mustrious .flo Lady, that highly dl'ulgent son of **DASARATHA**, foremost of men, bath sent this ring as a token to thee. O Queen, wbat is thy behest ? Shall I bring thee back to **RAMA** and Lakshmaoa on the northern sbore of the ocean ? ' " Hearing this, **SITA**, the delight of JIIIIBka, reftected within berself awhile and said : " ' Suffer Ragbava to destroy **RAVANA** and himself carry me bence.' Inclining my head to that noble and irreproachable lady, I requested some token from her which might enhance the delight of Ragbava, whereupon **SITA** said to me : " ' Take this excellent jewel for which thou shalt be highly regarded by that One of mighty arms.' " Thereupon, that princess of lovely limbs gave me a mar vellous jewel and in a voice strangled with sobs, bade me fare well. I bowed to that daughter of a king with deep respect and, circumambulating her began to consider returning home, but she, baving searched her heart, addressed me once again, saying : " ' O **HANUMAN**, do thou relate my story to Ragbava in such wise that those two beroes, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, will come bere instantly accompanied by **SUGRIVA**, or else, baving but two months to live, Kakutstha will see me no more, like one without a protector.' " Hearing these dreadful worda, a

wave of anger surged over me and I instantly resolved on wbat I should do. Thereupon, expanding my body to the size of a mountain, burning to fight, I laid waste the grove. Tben all the beasts and birds began to flee away in fear and those terrible titan women awoke and beheld the devastation. Observing me, they all assembled and instantly ran in haste to inform **RAVANA**, saying : "' O Valiant Sovereign, this thine inviolable grove has been destroyed by a wretched monkey who sets thy prowess at nought. Slay that perverse creature instantly, who thus affronts thee, lest be escape I ' " On this, the King of the Titans, **RAVANA**, sent out in numerable warriors called Kinbras and eighty thousand of those titans, armed with spears and maces, were slain by me in the grove with an iron bar. Tben a few, who survived, quickly went to **RAVANA** to inform him of the destruction of his troops. " Thereupon I resolved to destroy the marvellous palace with its monument and slew the guards stationed there. In my fury I laid this building, the ornament of Lanka, low, whereupon **RAVANA** sent out the son of Prahasta, Jambumalin with a company of titans of grim and featful aspect. " With my fonnidable mace I slew that mighty and stilful warrior with his retinue and **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, on hearing this, dispatched the highly powerful sons of the ministers followed by a regiment of iufantry but with my iron bar I sent them all to the abode of death. " Learning that, despite their ardour, I had struck down the sons of his ministers on the field, **RAVANA** qnickly ordered five of his heroic commanders to set out at the head of their troops, but I slew them all, whereupon Dashagriva sent out his highly powerful son, Aksha, with countless titans, to engage me in combat. Then that youthful son of **MANDODARI**, a skilful warrior sprang into the air and I seized him by the feet, whirling him round and throwing him on the earth. " Thereat the ten-necked **RAVANA**, full of ire, hearing of the downfall of Aksha, sent his second son **INDRAJIT**, full of

courage and martial ardour, against me and I, rendering the prowess of all those titans ineffectual, experienced extreme delight. Nevertheless, that long-armed warrior in whom **RAVANA** had supreme confidence, infiamed with wine, continued to fight at the head of his warriors. " And he, realising that I was invincible and seeing his forces routed, made me captive by aid of the **BRAHMA**-weapon, whereupon the titans bound me with ropes and talting hold of me brought me before **RAVANA**. Then that One of vicious soul entered into conversation with me and enqnired of me regarding my coming to Lanka and why I had slain the titans, whereto I replied: "'I have done all this for **SITA** I To find het I came hither I I am the son of Maruta, the monkey **HANUMAN** ! Know me to he **RAMA**'s messenger and the minister of **SUGRIVA**. It is to carry out **RAMA**'s design that I stand before thee I Hear me now O Lord of the Titans ! The King of the Monkeys offers thee salutations and enquires as to thy welfare, O Mighty Hero ! He has commissioned me to communicate this mesaase 4lb in words that are both fitting and in accord with duty, legitimate pleasure and profit. " ' While sojourning on Rishyamuka, that mountain covered with trees, I entered into an alliance with Raghava, that great warrior, invincible in combat, and he spoke to me saying : ' O King, my consort has been borne away by a titan ; it behoves thee to assist me in this matter!' Thereafter, in the presence of fire, the Lord, Raghava, who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, allied himself to me in friendship, who had been deprived of my royal prerogatives by Bali. " ' And he hath made me lord over all the monkeys, after slaying Bali in combat with a single arrow. It is therefore fitting that we should assist him by every means and by virrue of this contract I have despatched **HANUMAN** unto thee as envoy. Do thou therefore speedily return **SITA** to **RAMA**, ere those valiant monkeys overthrow thy forces. Who is not conversant with the monkeys' prowess, whose aid

has been solicited even by the Gods themselves ? ' " Speaking thus to **RAVANA**, he bent his furious glances on me as if he would consume me and that ruthless titan ordered me he put to death, being unaware of my power. " Meanwhile his high-souled brother Bibishana, endowed with great sagacity, interceded for me in the following wise; saying : ' O Thou Foremost of the Titans, abandon thy resolve, which is not in accord with the royal code. The death of an envoy is not sanctioned by royal tradition, O Titan. A messenger simply communicates the mandate of his master I O Thou of incomparable prowess, there is no warranty for his destructon, yet, if his guilt be considerable, he may be mutilated.' " At these words of Bibishana, **RAVANA** issued this command to the demons : ' Set fire to the monkey's tail! ' " On this behest, those titans wrapped my tail in hemp and cotton rags and they, in well-wrought armour struck me with their clenched fists and sticka and set fire to my tail. Bound and fettered with ropea by the titans, I submitted to it, resolving to set fire to the city. Thus pinioned and enveloped in flames, those warriors, ahouting, led me along the royal highway to the pta of the city. There, contracting my body I assumed a 'f83 diminutive form and casting oft' my bonds, I seized an iron bar and assailed those titans, thereaftet with one bouod vault ing the gate, I rapidly burnt down the whole city and its gates and towers with my flaming tail, resembling the fire that con sumes all beings at the end of the world. "Seeing Lanka in flames I reftected with anxiety that Janaki must without doubt hsve perished since there was no comet of the city that hsd not been reduced to ashes. Thinking thus, overcome with grief, I overheard the Chsranas saying in auspicious accents : " ' Janaki has not perished in the flames ! ' and hearing these wonderful words, proclaimed by their enchanting voices, I ugained my courage. I was thereafter reassured by many auspicious signs, that Janaki hsd been saved from the flames and though

my tail was on fire, I had not been consumed I My heart was filled with joy and the wind spread its delicious perfumes. By virtue of these propitious manifestations, by my confidence in **RAMA**'s prowess and in **SITA** and the words pronounced by the great sages, felicity filled my soul. Then, re-visiting Vaidehi once again, I took leave of her and, scaling the Mount Arishta, leapt in this direction in order to see you all once more. Following the path of the wind, sun, moon and the Siddhss and Gandhsrvas, I found you here. " By the grace of **RAMA** and your prowess, I hsve carried out **SUGRIVA**'s charge to the nttetmost. I have related all to yon in detail and it now remains for you to accomplish what is still to be done."

CHAPTER 59

Hanuman appeals to the Monkeys to rescue Sita

flame to which one reaches out is not so greatly to be feared as is Sits's wrath. " It now behoveth all the mighty monkeys and others, with **JAMBAVAN** at their head to take pan in this expedition, the purpose of which is now known to you, in order to behold Vaidehi re-united with those two princes. " Alone I was able to enter Lanka, inhabited by titans and have aftlicted that city by my prowess, as also **RAVANA** and his people. What more could I not do therefore with the coura geous and powerful Plavagas, endowed with heroism and martial prowess, strong and eager for victory ? "I shall destroy **RAVANA** with his entite army, his sons, brothers and followers in combat. I shall destroy all the titans and circumvent those invisible weapons and other missiles, bestowed on Indrajita by Brahms, Rudra, Vayu, **VARUNA**, scattering them and slaying the titans ; with your sanction my prowess will bring them under

restraint. Hills and moun tains tom up by me will I discharge continuously, which even the Gods themselves cannot withstand, how much less those rangers of the night? Wete the sea to overftow or Mount Mandara move ftom its place, **JAMBAVAN** will never be daunted by an enemy host in con11ict. And that heroic monkey, the son of Bali, is alone able to destroy the entite host of R.akshasas. With the movement of his vigorous thighs, the powerful Nila could overthrow Mount Mandara itself, how much more the titans on the field of battle. Amongst the Celestials, the Titans, Yakahas, Gandharvas, serpents or birds, show me any who could withstand Dvivida ? Nor do I know any who could resist those two sons of the Ashwins, endowed with supreme energy, the foremost of monkeys, in the arena. " Single-handed I have laid Lanka low and, setting it on fire have reduced it to ashes. On every highway I proclaimed aloud : May Victory crown the invincible **RAMA** and Labh mana ! May the King **SUGRIVA**, whose support is Raghava, prosper. I am the servant of the King of Koshala, the otr spring of Pavana I 1 am **HANUMAN** ! ' 1 have announced this everywhere. " In the centre of the Ashoka grove of the viciousoo$0uled **RAVANA**, the virtuous **SITA** waits forlornly at the foot of the Shimshapa tree surrounded by titan women, emaciated with sorrow and suffering, resembling the orb of the moon bereft of its splendour in the midst of cloud. Spuming **RAVANA**, whose powers have rendered him arrogant, Vaidebi, the daughter of Jauska of fair limbs, remains undeviatingly faithful to her lord. Wholly devoted to **RAMA**, the lovely Vaidebi, thinks of him alone, as Poulomi, Purandara. Clad in a single garment, soiled with dust, I beheld her in the grove surrounded by titan women who were heaping insults upon her. Her hair, dressed in a single braid that unfortunate heing was absorbed in the thought of her lord. Lying on the earth, pale as a lotus at the approach of winter, separated by **RAVANA** from the object of her love, she had

resolved to yield up her life. " With difficulty I was able to re-kindle **SITA**'s hopes by addressing that damsel, whose eyes resemble a doe's, and relating all to her. And she, hearing of the alliance between **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** became happy and, fixed in her devotion, her eonjugal affection reached its zenith. Fortunate is that ten-necked demon that she has not destroyed him, due to the boon he received from Brahms ; but it is for **RAMA** that the destruction of that monster is reserved. "Already greatly reduced, Janaki grows frailer every day, in **RAMA**'s absence, as learning wanes that is prosecuted on the first day of the lunar fortnight. " Thus liveth **SITA** worn out by grief I It is for you to take eounsel as to what it is proper to do in the matter." CHAPTBK 60 Jam/Jaootm rejects A"'fada's Praject

CHAPTER 60

Jambavan rejects Angada's Project

" In the centre of the Ashoka grove of the viciousoo$0uled **RAVANA**, the virtuous **SITA** waits forlornly at the foot of the Shimshapa tree surrounded by titan women, emaciated with sorrow and suffering, resembling the orb of the moon bereft of its splendour in the midst of cloud. Spuming **RAVANA**, whose powers have rendered him arrogant, Vaidebi, the daughter of Jauska of fair limbs, remains undeviatingly faithful to her lord. Wholly devoted to **RAMA**, the lovely Vaidebi, thinks of him alone, as Poulomi, Purandara. Clad in a single garment, soiled with dust, I beheld her in the grove surrounded by titan women who were heaping insults upon her. Her hair, dressed in a single braid that unfortunate heing was absorbed in the thought of her lord. Lying on the earth, pale as a lotus at the approach of winter, separated by **RAVANA**

from the object of her love, she had resolved to yield up her life. " With difficulty I was able to re-kindle **SITA**'s hopes by addressing that damsel, whose eyes resemble a doe's, and relating all to her. And she, hearing of the alliance between **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** became happy and, fixed in her devotion, her eonjugal affection reached its zenith. Fortunate is that ten-necked demon that she has not destroyed him, due to the boon he received from Brahms ; but it is for **RAMA** that the destruction of that monster is reserved. "Already greatly reduced, Janaki grows frailer every day, in **RAMA**'s absence, as learning wanes that is prosecuted on the first day of the lunar fortnight. " Thus liveth **SITA** worn out by grief I It is for you to take eounsel as to what it is proper to do in the matter." CHAPTBK 60 Jam/Jaootm rejects A"'fada's Praject having overcome the mighty celestial host, drank up the nectar of immortality. These inftamed with ire, are able to destroy the entire city of Lanka with its horses, chariots and elephants, what of other monkeys ? I myself am capable of destroying the city with its titans and the mighty **RAVANA** ! How much more so if I am accompanied by powerful warriors, masters of themselves, well-armed, skilful and desirous of victory? " We have heard that the courageous son of Vayu alone set fire to Lanka. He has seen the divine **SITA** but has not brought her back. I deem it unfitting that warriors as renowned as you are acquaint **RAMA** of this. There are none in leaping and in prowess, whose skill and bravery equal yours in the worlds of the Immortals or amongst the Daityas, O Foremost of Monkeys. Few have escaped the carnage wrought by **HANUMAN**, therefore it only remains for us to slay **RAVANA** and the rest of the titans and bring back the daughter of **JANAKA**, placing her between **RAMA** and Lakl.hmana! What need have we to trouble those other residents of Kishkindha? It is for us to proceed to Lanka and, having slain the titans, return to **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SUGRIVA**."

Such was the project of **ANGADA**, whereupon **JAMBAVAN**, the foremost of monkeys, in his wisdom, cheerfully made answer in words fraught with good sense, saying : " O Great Monkey, O Thou of supreme understanding, we have received a mandate from the King of the Monkeys and the virtuous **RAMA** to explore the southern region to its utmost confines, but we have not been commanded to bring back **SITA** nor would it find favour with that lion among monarchs, **RAMA**, if we did so, for he, proud of his lineage, has vowed before all the leading monkeys that he will himself deliver her. How should his words be rendered null and void ? What is the use of undertaking that which is not conducive to his pleasure ? This display of our prowess will prove fruitless, O Foremost of Monkeys I Let us therefore return to where **RAMA**, with Lakahmana and the illustrious **SUGRIVA** can be found and inform them of the result of our quest. What thou hast proposed finds favour with us, O Prince, yet it is by adhering to Rams's design that thou shouldst look fot success."

CHAPTER 61

The Devastation of Madhuvana

ALL the heroic monkeys headed by **ANGADA** and the great ape **HANUMAN** highly approved **JAMBAVAN**'s words and, those foremost of monkeys led by the son of Vayu leaping down from the summit of the Mahendra Mountain, bounded forward. Resembling the mountains Meru and Mandara, they appeared like elephants maddened with ichor, covering the whole of space as it were with their shadow, their eyes fixed on the highly powerful **HANUMAN** gifted with velociry, having control of his senses and honoured by the Siddhas. Resolved on bringing

about the success of Rams's design, proud of the results obtained, desirous of communicating their auspicious tidings, all those virtuous inhabitants of the forest, eager to assist **RAMA** and avid for combat, jumping and frisking, reached Madhuvana. And they came that celestial grove protected by **SUGRIVA**, planted with countless trees, enchanting to look upon, where none might enter. And **SUGRIVA**'s maternal uncle, the mighty monkey Dadhimukha guarded that picturesque and spacious garden belonging to the Lord of Monkeys. Extremely anxious to partake of the fruits of that beautiful orchard, those tawny coloured monkeys, greatly delighted, craved permission of the prince to taste the honey, yellow as they. Then he graciously allowed those venerable monkeys, headed by **JAMBAVAN**, to drink of the honey. Thereupon, under **ANGADA**'s command, authorised by that youthful son of Bali, those monkeys ascended the trees, swarm-some bounded into the air or chased each other round the from rock to rock, responding to each other's songs and laughter, groans and lamentations, exchanging blow for blow. Then a general confusion arose amongst that host of monkeys and there were none who were not inebriated or inflamed with excitement. Seeing the wood laid waste, the trees stripped of their leaves and dowers, Dadhimukha was filled with anger and sought to restrain them. But that heroic and elderly monkey, the protector of the wood, was in turn upbraided by those insolent monkeys whereupon he grew even more determined to defend the forest that was entrusted to his care agsinst them. There after he spoke to some in harsh terms without fear or fore thought and struck others with the palm of his hands, approach ing some threateningly and others with soothing words. They, however, excited with liquor, restraiued by Dadbi mukha, began to ill-treat him brazenly without reflecting that the fault lay with them, scratching him with their nails, biting him with their teeth, assailing him with blowa of their hands

and feet, and knocking him senseless laid waste to the whole of Madhuvana.

CHAPTER 62

The Fight between Dadhimuka and the Intruders

Happy in the thought that **HANUMAN** bad discovered Maithili and having bad tidings of her, with the consent of Angads they drank the hnney and feasted on the fruits. Hurling themselves on the guardians of that orchard who approached them in hundreds, they overwhelmed them with blows and beat them off. Collecting honeycombs, a drona in size with their hands, those monkeys, yellow as honey them selves, drank the nectar and threw away the combs ; some in frolic pelted each other with or piling up the branches sat down under the trees ; some, heavy with drink, heaped leaves nn the earth and lay down exhausted whilst others, stimulated by the intoxicating nectar, reeling, strUck out at their companions wildly. Singing at the top of their voices, some imitated the roar of lions and some whistled like birds, others, drunk with honey, slept nn the ground ; some roared with laughter or burst into tears, some babbled wildly whilst others tried to interpret their utterances. Meanwhile the guards of the forest, the servants of Dadhi mukha, set upon by those terrible mnnkeys, crushed between their knees, lied in all directions. Wrought up with fear, they approached Dadhirnukha and said :-" Empowered by **HANUMAN**, those terrible mnnkeys have, despite us, laid waste to Madhuvana and, crushed between their knees, we all but gave up our lives." Highly incensed, Dadhirnukha, beholding the destruction in the Madhu Wood, which had been entrusted to his guards, consoled his subordinates, saying:-" Proceed to that place and fall upon

those insolent monkeys; I myself shall aoon follow and drive away by force those who are drinking the hnney." Hearing the words of their master, those valiant monkeys returned to Madhuvana and Dadhirnukha, in their midst, accompanied them with great speed, bearing huge trees. Arming themselves with rocks, trees and stones, all those monkeys, highly incensed, proceeded to where the Plavam gamas were to be found, where, biting their lips in anger, they remonstrated with them again and again, seeking to suppress them by force. Then all those monkeys, headed by **HANUMAN**, beholding Dadhimukha gready enraged, drove him back with violence and, as the mighty Dadbimukha of huge arms advanced bearing a tree in his hands, the powerful **ANGADA** incensed, intercepted him with his hands and, beside himself with inebriation, without showing the least mercy, though he merited it being his great-uncle, thtew him to the ground with violence. Then that monkey, his arms and thighs broken and his face mutilated, bathed in blood, fell senseless for a space, thereafter, dis engaging himself with difficulty, that foremost of monkeys withdrew to a distance and addressed his attendants, saying : " Let us all proceed with haste to where the thick-neclted **SUGRIVA**, resides with **RAMA**. I shall relate all Prince **ANGADA**'s misdeeds to him and filled with ire that Sovereign will punish all the monkeys. The enchanting Madhu Wood, enjoyed by his forefathers, inviolate even to the Gods, is gready beloved by **SUGRIVA** and he will mete out heavy punish ment to those perverse wretches avid for honey and will slay those who have disobeyed their sovereign, with their friends and kinsfolk. Then shall my wrath, which I am unable to restrain, be appeased." Speaking thus to the guards of the forest, Dadhimultha, their leader, departed with them with all speed and in the twinkling of an eye, reached the place where that sagacious offspring of the Sun, **SUGRIVA**, was. Beholding **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA**

and **SUGRIVA**, that great and heroic monkey, Dadhimukha, descending from the sky, alighted on the ground and with a sorrowful mien placing his joined palms to his forehead, touched **SUGRIVA**'s feet.

CHAPTER 63

Dadhimuka relates how Madhuvana has been laid waste

Sagacious Dadhimukha rose and spoke as follows : " O Lord, that wood which neither thou nor Bali suffered to be enjoyed by the monkeys, has been laid waste by them I Seeking ro drive them away with my attendants, they, dis regarding me, continued to feast there merrily. I resisted their depredations with the assistance of my guards, but without showing any consideration for me, O Prince, those savages continued their orgy. These attendants of mine, assaulted by them, driven from the wood and those countless powerful monkeys. their eyes inftamed with anger, broke their arms and feet and, crushing them between their thighs, flung them into the air. Thou art the living lord of these warriors who have been assaulted by those monkeys, who even now are pillaging Madhuvana and quaffing the honey." While **SUGRIVA** listened to these tidings, the sagscious Laksh mana, Slayer of his Foes, enquired of him saying :-" O King, who is this monkey, the guard over the forest who has come to thee and what distress has led him to speak thus ? " Being thus addressed by the high-souled **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA**, skilled in converse, answered : " O Noble **LAKSHMANA**, this is Dadhimukha and this heroic monkey informs me that those war-like forest dwellers led by **ANGADA** have drunk the honey and eaten the fruits of the orchard. Such an escapade would not have been indulged in by those who had failed in

their mission. Assuredly they have been successful since they have devastated the wood. It is for this reason that they have beaten with their knees those who have obstructed their revelry and have disregarded the valiant Dadhimukha whom I myself appointed as guardian to my orchard. In sooth, **HANUMAN** and none other must have discovered the divine **SITA**. **HANUMAN** alone could accom plish such a feat. The success of that enterprise depended on the sagacity of that foremost of monkeys endowed with courage, strength and learning. Where Jamhavan and **ANGADA** are the leaders ad **HANUMAN** the moving spirit, success is assured. Aasuredly Madhuvana has been laid 4PZ waste by those heroic monkeys led by **ANGADA**. Having explored the southern region, on their return this orch ard 5cited their cupidity, whereupon they plundered it and drsnk tbe honey, assaulting the guards and beating them with their knees. This monkey, the gentle-voiced Dadhi mukha, renowned for his prowess has come to communicate these tidings to me. O Migbty Saumitri, undoubtedly **SITA** must have been found else these monkeys would never have destroyed the wood bestowed on us by the Gods." Heating these words pleasant to the ear falling from **SUGRIVA**'s lips, the virtuous **LAKSHMANA** and Raghava were overcome witb joy and the illustrious **SUGRIVA**, exultant on receiving these tidings from Dadhimukha, answered that gusrdian of the forest, saying : " Highly gratified am I that those warriors, being successful, have eaten the honey and fruit ! One should bear with the arrogance of those who have been victorious. Return to the Madhu Wood immediately and send all those monkeys with **HANUMAN** at their head, here! With these two descendants of Raghu, I wish to interrogate those deer of the branches without delay, who, wirh the boldness of lions have fulfilled their task, in order to learn if they have discovered **SITA**." Beholding those two princes, their eyes dilated with joy, in the height of felicity, the King of

the Monkeys, realising the success of his enterprise was near, ""PCrlenced ...rreme satisfaction.

CHAPTER 64

Sugriva consoles Rama

THUS addressed by **SUGRIVA**, the monkey Dadhimukha cheer fully offered obeisance to him and gave salutations to Raghava and **LAKSHMANA**. Thereafter, having honoured **SUGRIVA** and those powerful sons of the House of Raghu, escorted by his alllendmts, he sprang into the air. Departing with the same speed by which he had come, he descended from the 493 sky and, alighting on the earth, entered the Madhu wood. There he beheld those foremost of monkeys, now sober, spending the hours happily, having relieved themselves, the outcome of drinking honey, and approaching them, that hero with joined palms addtessed **ANGADA** in the following words: " O Noble Prince, do not harbour any ill-feeling towards the guards, who, enraged, sought to drive thee away by force. May peace attend thee I O Thou of great strength, do thou partake of the honey freely which is thine by right, since thou art the heir-apparent and o"ncr of the wood. It behoveth thee to pardon us for our wrath, arising out of ignorance ! Like unto thy sire formerly and **SUGRIVA**, so art thou Lord of the monkey host! O Irreproachable Prince, I have related all unto thine uncle, who, hearing of the presence of the monkeys here, of thine arrival and also of the devastation of the forest, was not the least incensed, rather was he gratified. Highly pleased, thy paternal uncle, **SUGRIVA**, King of the Monkeys, said : ' Send them all here without delay ! ' " Hearing those words of Dadhimultha, **ANGADA**, Prince of the Monkeys, skilled in

speech, addressed all his companions, saying: " O You Leaders of the Monkey Host, undoubtedly all these events have been related to **RAMA**. This may be inferred by Dadhimultha's tidings. It does not behove us to linger here further, our mission having been accomplished, O Slayers of your Foes! You have all dtunk honey in full measure, O Heroic Forest Dwellers, nothing remains for us but to rejoin **SUGRIVA**. Whatever all of you counsel me to do, I shall put into effect. I am your servant and, though the heir-apparent, it is not for me to issue orders to you. You have all accomplished your task ; it would therefore be unfitting for me to treat you arbitrarily." Hearing these admirable words of **ANGADA**, those monkeys, full of delight, spoke thus : " Who, of thy status, O Foremost of Monkeys, would speak thus ? Drunk with power, each says : ' I am the leader I ' None but thee would utter words of such felicity. Thine humility augurs well for us. We are all ready to returD to 494 **SUGRIVA** the King of the Monkeys without delay, but without thy word of command none among us is able to advance a single step." On this, **ANGADA** answered them, saying :-" It is well, let us go ! ", whereupon all those warriors sprang into the air and the space was entirely filled as if by stones shot from a mortar. Preceded by **ANGADA**, who was followed by **HANUMAN**, those Plavamgamas bounded tempestuously into the air with a great clamour, like clouds driven before the wind. **ANGADA** having arrived near to **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys addressd the lotus-eyed **RAMA**, who was consumed with grief, and said : " Be of good courage ! Rest assured the divine **SITA** has been found ! These monkeys would not have returned otherwise, the time fixed by me being already past ; I infer this from Aogada's joy! Had the long-armed Aogada, the foremost of monkeys not been successful, he would not have come back to me. If they had not succeeded in their enterprise, after such an escapade, that youthful prince, his mind troubled, would

have appeared dejected. Without having seen the daughter of **JANAKA**, they would not have dared to destroy Madhuvana which was obtained from my forbears or attacked that venerable monkey who guards it. O Noble Son of **KAUSHALYA**, O Thou fixed in thy vow and faithful to thine obligations, in sooth **HANUMAN** and none else has discovered **SITA**. No other is qualified to encompass this end. O Thou, the foremost of the virtuous, the means to suceess are intelli gence, resolution, valour and knowledge and **HANUMAN** is endowed with all these. Where **JAMBAVAN** with **ANGADA** leads and **HANUMAN** directs the work, there can be but one outcome. O Thou of immeasurable prowess, have no anxiety ! Those dwellers of the wood, having reached the height of insolence, would not have entered into an escapade of this kind had they failed in their mission. They have laid waste Madhuvana and taken the honey, I infer therefore that they have been successful." At that instant, cries of " KiJakila " resounded in the sky from those inhabitants of the woods, who, proud of **HANUMAN**'s 49S exploit, were proceeding towards Kisbltindha, thus proclaim ing their trumph. Hearing that tremendous clamour, the King of the Monkeys, curling and uncurling his tail, became greatly excited, whilst those monkeys, eager to see **RAMA**, with **ANGADA** at their head and **HANUMAN** before them, drunk with joy, alighted from the sky in front of their sovereign and Raghava. Thereafter the mighty-armed **HANUMAN**, inclining his head in salutations, informed **RAMA** of **SITA**'s physical and spiritual well-being. And hearing from **HANUMAN** the auspicious words sweet as Amrita : " I have seen **SITA** ", the joy of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** was extreme and **LAKSHMANA** gazed on **SUGRIVA**, who had placed the matter in the hands of the son of Pavana, with profound respect, whilst Raghava, the destroyer of his foes, in extreme felicity looked on **HANUMAN** with venera tion.

CHAPTER 65

Hanuman tells Rama of his Meeting with Sita

Preceded by the heir-apparent, **ANGADA** and bowing to **SUGRIVA** and the monkeys, he began to recount the story of **SITA** and ber confinement in Ravma's harem, of the threats of the female titans, of her unflinching devotion to **RAMA** and the time fixed for her execution. All this did the monkey relate in **RAMA**'s presence. And bearing of Vaidehi's well-being, **RAMA** *said*:-" O Monkeys, where is the illustrinus **SITA** to be found and what are her feelings towards me ? Do ye relate everything unto me I " Hearing **RAMA**'s words, the monkeys requested **HANUMAN**, conversant with the matter, to describe all in detail. And be, versed in the an of speech, acquiescing in their desire, in clining his bead in salutation to the divine **SITA**, turning to the south described his meeting with her and bestowed on **RAMA** 496 the heavenly jewel, blazing in its own elfu1gence ; then the son of Maruta offered obeisance to him and said : " Anxious to behold **SITA**, 1 crossed the ocean four hundted miles in extent and after a time reached Lanka, that city be longing to the wicked **RAVANA** which is situated on the southern shore of the sea. There 1 beheld **SITA** in the inner apartments of **RAVANA** and there she dwells, O **RAMA**, centring all her thoughts on thee. I observed her reviled by hideous titan women who are guarding her in the grove and that noble lady, accustomed by thee to felicity, is now stricken with grief in thine absence, O Hero. Imprisoned in **RAVANA**'s inner apartments under the strict surveillance of those female demons, wearing a single plait, forlorn, that unfortunate being is absorbed in the thought of thee! Lying on the earth, emaciated, resembling a lotus on the approach of winter, spurning **RAVANA**, she is resolved to yield up her life. " O

Kakutstha, O Guileless Prince, with considerable diffi culty I discovered that princess of whom thou art in some sort the very soul and, narrating the glories of the lkshwaku Race, I succeeded in gaining her confidence, whereupon I told her all. " Hearing of the alliance between thee and King **SUGRIVA**, she was grestly delighted and she remains constant to thee in faith and love. O Foremost of Men, it was in this condition that I discovered her engaged in severe penances with her heart fixed on thee. Bestowing this jewel upon me, she requested me to relate to thee what happened on Chittrakuta concerning the crow, O Sagacious One and, addressing me thus, she said : " ' O Son of Vayu, do thou describe all that thou hast seen here to **RAMA** and present him with this jewel, which has been preserved by me with care. Do thou remind him of the mark traced with red powder on my countenance I Say : ' O Sinless One, seeing this unique pearl formed by the apartments. I have related all faithfully to thee, O Raghava, now take counsel in order to bridge the ocean." Seeing those two princes filled with renewed hope, the son of Vayu having presented the jewel as a token of recogoition to Raghava, described everything to him from beginning to end.

CHAPTER 66

Rama's Grief

AT these words of **HANUMAN**, **RAMA**, bom of **DASARATHA**, press ing the jewel to his heart, wept with **LAKSHMANA**. And be holding that marvellous gem, Raghava, stricken with gtief, his eyes suffused with tears, said to Sugtiva : " As milk fiows from the udders of a cow on beholding its calf, so does my heart brim over on beholding this jewel ! This pearl was conferred on **SITA** by my father-in-law on the occasion of

our nuptuals and she wore it on her brow, thus enhancing her beauty. Obtained from the waters and rever enced by the Gods, it was conferred on **JANAKA** by the sagacious Shakra, gratified by his adoration at a sacrifice. " Seeing this magnificent gem, I recall the presence of my sire and my father-in-law, the King of Videha. This lovely ornament appeared beautiful on the forehead of my beloved and seeing it, it seems as if she herself were present here As if sprinkling water on one who has lost conscinusness, do thou relate to me what Vaidehi hath said, again and again, O Friend I What could be more poignant, O Saumitrl. than seeing this pearl obrained from the waters, without Vaidehi? If she survive one month more, she will live long, but it is hard for me to exist an instant without **SITA** I Do thou lead me to where thou hast seen my beloved ; after hearing these tidiogs, I cannot brook a moment's delay. How can that lady of lovely hips, who was ever timorous, endure life amidst those grim and fearful demons ? As the autumnal moon, enveloped in cloud is unable to shine forth, so **SITA**'s counten· anoe is no longer resplendent. O **HANUMAN**, do thou relate 498 unto me again and again what **SITA** said to thee. These words will revive me as the sick are cured by medicine. O **HANUMAN**, what did my gentle, sweet-spoken and beautiful lady, who is separated from me, say to thee ? How is that daughter of **JANAKA** able to survive in her dire misfortune ? ,

CHAPTER 67

Hanuman describes his Interview with Sita

BEING thus addressed by the hlgh-souled Raghava, **HANUMAN** began to relate all that **SITA** had said to hlm : " O Lion among Men, in order to give credence to my report, the divine **SITA** described what took place

on Mount Chittrakuta. Sleeping happily at thy side, Janaki one day was the first to wake, when suddenly a crow wounded her breast with its beak. O **RAMA**, thou wert then asleep on **SITA**'s lap and that crow again attacked her, pecking her cruelly, and, being bathed in blood and suffering, she did arouse thee. O Slayer of thy foes, seeing her breast wounded, thou, like an angry serpent didst enquire, saying :-' Who, O Timid One, hath with his claws wounded thee ? Who hath dared to play with a five-headed snake ? ' Then, looking here and there, thou didst perceive the crow with its talons sharp and bloody standing before thee. And that foremost of birds was **INDRA**'s son, who with the speed of the wind disappeared into the earth. Then thou, O Mighty-armed One, didst roll thine eyes furiously and resolve to destroy that crow. Taking a tuft of Kusha grass from where thou hadst lain, pronouncing the **BRAHMA**-*mantra*, thou didst hurl the blade that blazed up like the fire at the dissolution of the world at the bird and that fiaming grass followed in its wake. "Forsaken by the Gods, who were terrified, that crow traversed the Three Worlds without finding a protector and returned to thee, O Subduer of thy foes, seeking refuge in thee and falling on the earth before thee. Thereupon, O Kakutstha, ai< thou in thy compassion didst pardon ir, albeit it merited death. But thinking it improper that the purpose of the weapon should be rendered void, thou didst destroy the right eye of that crow, O Raghava. Then paying homage to thee and to King **DASARATHA**, that bird, thus delivered, returned to its abode. " **SITA** *said*:-' O Raghava, thou art the foremost of those skilled in weapons, mighty and full of integrity, why dost thou not discharge thy shafts against the titans ? Neither the Gods, Gandharvas, *Asuras* or Maruta can withstand thee in battle. If thou in thy magnanimity hast any regard for me, then with thy well-directed shafts destroy **RAVANA** without delay. Under the behest of his brother, why does not Laksh

mana, the scourge of his foes and the foremost of men, fly to my defence ? " ' How is it that those two mighty lions among men, the equals of Vayu and **AGNI** in valour, whom the Gods them selves are unable to overcome, have forgotten me ? Assuredly I have committed a great sin, since those two scourges of their foes, who are able to do so, do not unite to deliver me ! ' “To those plaiotive and gentle words of the noble Vaidehi, I answered : 'O Illustrious Lady, **RAMA** is sorely stricken on account of thine absence and seeing his brother a prey to sorrow, **LAKSHMANA** too is suffering, 1 swear it. Since 1 have found thee at last, the time for lamentation is past. In an instant thou shalt see the end of thy woes, O Lovely Princess. Those two sons of a king, the foremost of men and subduers of their foes, eager to see thee once more, will reduce Lanlra to ashes. Having alaio the cruel **RAVANA** with his kinsfolk in battle, Raghava will take thee back to his capital, O Charming One ! O Irreproachable Lady, do thou bestow some token on me that is known to **RAMA** and will bring him delight.' " Thereat **SITA**, glancing round on evety side, drew from het robe an excellent jewel which had fastened her locks and bestowed it on me, O Mighty One. " Then I, inclining my head in salutation, took the gem into my hands and made ready to depart, O Beloved of the Raghu Race I Whereupon, seeing me about to take my leave expand ing my body, **SITA**, the besutiful and unfortunate daughter of]anaka, het face bathed in tears, addresaed me in a voice 500 strangled with sobs and, in the inteosity of distresS at my departUre, said to me : " Happy art thou, O Monkey, since thou shalt behold the mighty Ramo whose eyes resemble lotuses and the long-armed **LAKSHMANA**, my illustrious brother-in-law I ' " To these words of Maithili, I made answer :-' Climb on my back without delay, O Noble Lady, and this very day I will show thee **SUGRIVA**, **LAKSHMANA** and thy consort Ramo, O Fortunate Dark-eyed Princess ! '

" Then that Goddess answered me, saying :-' It is not proper for me to climb on thy back of mine own accord, O Grest Monkey ! Although before this I was touched by the demon, it was on account of my helplessness, subject as I was to destiny. Do thou thyself repair to where those two princes are ! ' After this she added : " ' O **HANUMAN**, do thou greet those two lions among men with **SUGRIVA** and his ministers ! Do thou describe unto **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** of immeasurable prowess the intensity of my despair and the insults heaped on me by the titans. May thy journey be prosperous, O Foremost of Monkeys ! ' " Thus did that illustrious princess speak to me in the midst of her grief. Re1lecting on my narrative, have faith in the integrity of the virtuous **SITA**."

CHAPTER 68

He repeats his Words of Consolation to Sita

" **O** FOIII!MOST of Men, that Goddess then addtessed me in the midst of her grief out of love for thee and solicitude on my account, saying : " ' Do thou repeat all this to the son of **DASARATHA**, so that he may come with all speed and, having slain **RAVANA** in combat, take me hence. O Hero, O Subduer of thy foes, if it find approval with thee, rest concealed here in some secret spot for one more day to relieve thy fatigue and to-morrow thou canst make ready to depart ! o **HANUMAN**, in thy com SOl pany I am able to forget my sufferings awhile. O Thou gifted with great prowess, I shall await thy but doubt if I sball be living then. Beholding thee no tnore, I sbalJ be consumed with fear, unfortunate creature that I am, overwhelmed with aflliction ! Moreover I am filled with doubt regarding thy companions, the bears and monkeys and how in effect, they and those two princes will be able to cross the impassable

ocean. O Irreproachable Warrior, there are only three creatures qualified to traverse the sea-**GARUDA**, Vayu and thyself. In view of this insurtnountable obstacle, what possibility of success dost thou see, O Thou foremost of those skilled in the art of converse ? True it is, that thou art able to accomplish this work single-handed, O Subduer of thy foes, but such a manifestation of prowess would benefit thee alone. If **RAMA** however, with his forces, slaying **RAVANA** in fight, were to bring me back in triumph to his capital, it would redound to his gloty. It would not be worthy of Raghava to capture me by stealth as did **RAVANA**, who under a disguise bore me away from the forest. Truly it would prove a feat of signal excellence, worthy of him, if Kakutstha, the con queror of his foes, should destroy Lanka and deliver me. Do thou so act that that high-souled hero may display his prowess!' " Hearing these words, full of good sense, reasonable and affectionate, I replied for the last time : " ' O Goddess, **SUGRIVA**, the Leader of the bears and monkeys, gifted with valour, has resolved to deliver thee. He hath under his command innumerable powerful and courageous tnonkeys gifted with prowess, who are as swifr as thought, able to go upwards or downwards and to every side, whom nothing can impede nor may they be daunted by the hardest tasks. Moreover those great and powerful tnonkeys, endowed with vigour, have circled the earth again and again, coursing through the air. **SUGRIVA** has many tnonkeys equal to me and greater ; none are inferior. If I am able to cross the sea, how much more these heroes ? The great ones are never sent out on a mission but those of ioferior merit only. “O Lady, now abandon grief; in one bound those leaders of the tnonkey hosts will reach Lanka and these two lions SUNDARA KANJDA among men, like unto the sun and moon, will present them selves to thee, O Princess. Soon shalt thou see at Lanka’s gate, Raghava, resembling a lion and **LAKSHMANA**, bow in band. And thou shalt soon

behold those monkey warriors, endowed with the strength of lions and tigers, whose weapons are their nails and teeth, resembling the lords of the elephants, hastening here without delay. Ere long thou shalt hear the roaring of those leaders of monkeys on the summit of the Mount Malaya, resembling the rumbling nf clouds. Soon thou shalt see Raghava, the Slayer of His foes, retUrning from his exile in the forest, installed on the throne with thee in Ayodhya.' " Thereafter the daughter of the King of Mithila, though profoundly aftlicted by thine absence, was comforted by these auspicious words and experienced great peace." END OF GLOSSARY (For Flowers, Trees and Weapons, see separate Glossaries) A ABHIJrr. The twenty-second Nakshatra q.v. ABm. A sheep. purificatory rite at which water is tsken io the palm of the haods and poured over the head and breast and the mouth riused. It alSo iocludes touching various of the body. spiritus! Preceptor. A drum. .... c::. space and iofinity. GLOSSARY Wife of the *Rishi* Atri. A demon, son of the Sage Kashyapa and Diti Aodhaka said to have a thousand arms and heads and slain by Shivs. The kingdom ruled over by King Lompada, probably· Bengal. A or limb. Ao army may be divided into angas and in this context has been translated as divisions. The of Bali, a monkey warrior. A female demon. ANILA. The God nf the Wind. ANJALI. A salutation made with joined palms. ANJ A nymph with whom the God of the Wind became enamoured and who subsequently gave birth to **HANUMAN**. Son of Asamanjas. See for his story. A name of **YAMA**, the God of Death. A measure implying the utmost number. The son nf Hiranya-kashipu, a Daitya and the father of Prahlada whose story is told in the **VISHNU** Purana. Hir anyakasipu slain by **VISHNU** in his incarnation of Nrai ngha, half man, half lion. A.PsARA. “Ap " meaning water and " sara " to emerge from ; the name means a water-sprite or nymph. The Apsaras were the wives nf the Gandharvas.

A forest. A number approximating to a hundred million. A traditional offering of water, milk, kusha grass, rice, Durva grass, sandalwood, flowers, etc. AatsHtANEMI. A name of **GARUDA**'s meaning "The Felly of whose wheel unhun ". AaTHA. *Dharma*, Artha and Kama-duty, prosperity and legiti mate pleasure, which are said to be the three ends of life. The science of moral and political government. The Artha Shastras are ancient Hindu treatises summarizing the main duties of man in the field of politics and economics, where the subjectS are treated from the individual and not the universal point of view. AauNA. B:rother of **GARUDA**. AauNDHATI. Wife of the *Rishi* **VASISHTHA**, a model nf conjugal excellence. Also the moming star. GLOSSARY Dantolukhalis. Tbooe who took raw food such as grain crushing it between their teeth. GatmasayYU. Thooe who slept on the ground without making a bed. Marichipas. Thooe who lived by absorbing the rays of the sun or moon. Pancagni. Those practising asceticism between live fires, i.e. : four fires and the sun above. Patraharas. Those who lived on the leavea of trees. Sampraksalas. Those said to be bom of the water in which **BRAHMA**'s feet were cleansed. Vaikhanasaa. Bom from the of the Creator, **BRAHMA**. Valakhilyas. Bom from the body of **BRAHMA**. The month that covers of June and July. One of King **DASARATHA**'s counsellors. For the tree of this name see separate Glossary. Hermitage or forest retreat. The month September-october. or Celestial horsemen, precursors of the dawn, twin offspring of the sun and patrons of medicine. AsuBA. A Demon or Titan, enemy of the Gods. Horse sacrifice of Vedic times, performed only by kings. The fourth Veda. See Bala and Atibala. A musical instrUment. ATRI. One of the Seven Immortal Sages. One of King Daaaratha's counsellors. or OM. The sacred syllable, said to have been the first sound in creation. Its impon can be studied in the Mandukya Upanishad. A great *Rishi*, the grandson of Bhrigu. His name

is derived from " uru ,, or thigh as he was said to have beon produced from his mother's thildl. His austerities alanned the Gods and his anger agsinst the watrior class, who had slain his forbears, was unparslleled. Eventually it was mitigated by the interVention of the Pittris and he cast the fire of his wrath into the sea, where it became a being with a horse's head named Haya-shira. GLOSSARY B ll.uwtla. A tide of honour, conferred by Mohammedm kiDp, simiiM a tnightbood. IIALA and ATIBALA. The Science of Sacred Formulas, gM:a **RAMA** the **VISHWAMITRA**. BALI or VALI. King of the Moukeys, slain by Rsma. His brother wuSugriVL JIALimAs or V BactriiDI or people of the North 111d West of India. A Deity meotioned in the Vedas, who was Aditya presiding over love and marriage. The name means " Wealthy Master Gracious Lord ", " Bestowcr of Wealth". A descendmt of King Sagara, who by penances brought the sacred river Gunga down earth. A name of the river Gunga or Gmges, so called after the Sage Bhagiratha. A Sage who entertained R.ama, **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA** in the forest and subscquend,Y created a great feast for **BHARATA**. See . Many Vedic hymns are attributed to him. The younger brother of Rima and of Queen Kaikcyi, Ancient Indis. A vulture or bird of prey. BIWliAIIA. Father of **SUGRIVA**. A name of the Sun. BHmus. kettledrum. IIHOGAVATt. The voluptuous subterranean capital of the Serpent Race also called Putkari. Sage, said be the son of Manu, the progenitor GLOSSARY Ba.urMA-Lou. The abode or regioa of Bnluna. llaAHMAN. The Absolute or highest Reality. Attributelesa BeiDg. BIIAHAL\PtJTRA. Son of Bnluna. BRAHMARSHI. A constellation said by some to be Shravana or A Titan slain by **INDRA**. or The spiritual Preceptor of the Gods, also said to be the Regent of the planet Jupiter which is called by the same name. The planet Mercury. CAlTYA. Tombstone, colUJDD, or pile of stones. Lit. : Goinjl in a circle. A class of heavenly beings.

CASTES. The four: PriCSt, Warrior, Merchant and those who serve these three. Musical instrument. or King of the Gandharvas A fish resembling a whccl in appcaranoc. Brahmany duck or ruddy goose. CHAMARA. Chowrie, a fan made of Yaks' tails, insignia of royaltl· CHAMARA. A Yak, Bos Grunniens, highly prized for its bushy tail. An outcaste. The moon. The Panegyrists of the Gods. anTRA. The planet "Spica. The month Chitta or Chaitra is of February and March. CllrrTRAituTA. A sacred mountain where **RAMA** and **SITA** dwelt while in czile. It is still a holy retreat. GLOSSARY IBvARISIII. See Ullder *Rishi*. The Gods or Shining Ones. DEVt. A title given to Parvati q.v. A name of Kuvera, the God of Wealth, "Giver of Wealth." Wife of the Sage Kashyapa. Traditiooally ordained course of conduct or duty. The Law of Righteousness. *Dharma* is personified in one of the Prsjapatis, God of moral and religious duty. Also the four enda of life : Legitimate eojoyment, prosperity and duty, the fourth being the attainment of spiritual bliss. A Sage whom **RAMA** encountered near the Lake of the Four Nymphs. or Creator, Author or Founder, a name given to **VISHNU** or **BRAHMA** and others. One of the chief counsellors of King Dasarstha. The God of smoke. A meteor, comet or falling star. The personified descending node. Slayer of the Demnn Dhundu, a title of the King Kuvalayashwa. DILIPA. Father of the Bharadwaja. DINDIMA. A musical instrument. Dm. Daughter of Daksha, wife of Kashyapa, mother of the Daityas. the Three. Past, and A measure approximating to 92 lbs. DvrttrLA. Woven silk or very fine cloth made of the innn bark of the plant of the same name. A giant slain by Bali. Also a kettledrum. A General of Khara's army, slain by **RAMA**. Prince of S'abra, father of Satyavanta. GLOSSARY Celestial Musicians. The sacred river Gunga, also known under many other names such as Bhagirathi, Harasekhara, or the " Crest of **SHIVA**," Khapaga, "Flowing from Heaven," Tripathaga,

“Three—way Flowing,” Mandakini, Gendy Flowing, Jabnavi, after the Sage Jahnu, etc. King of the Birds, the vehicle of Shri **VISHNU** and the destroyer of serpents, sometimes portrayed as an eagle or jay. A great sage, the husband of Abalya q.v. The most sacred prayer of the Rig-Veda. A Goddess, wife of **BRAHMA**, mother of the Four Vedas. A river close to the Dandaka Forest. GoDRA. A piece of leather or metal wom on the left arm to protect it from the bow-string. GoRA. A soft leather, possibly cow or doeskin. GoLANGULA. A black monkey that bas a tail like a cow’s. GoLoBRA. A giant. A measurement equal to a cow’s hoof. WORLD. A tide of Brabma. GRIDHIRAS. Birds of prey. GRim. A person who, having finished his education, marries and becomes a householder. Also mown as Gribasta. GUHA. King of the Nisbadas, a mountain tribe. A great devotee of **RAMA**. Hidden Beings, attendants on Kuvera q.v. GUNAS. " Guna " literally means a thread or strand. It is also GLOSSARY A of **GARUDA** meauing “Bearer of Vislmu ". IIAsTA. A star, the thirteenth lunar asterism identified as Corvus. HAW A particular offering to tbe Gods ; an ancieut fire ceremony. Lit.: “horse—necked". AccordiDg to one legend, Vislmu himself assumed this form to recovet the Veda which had been carried off by two Daityas, Madhu and Kaitabba. A nymph ; also a kind of gold. One of the Elephants of the Four Quarters, suppotting the earth. Lit.: “The Abode of Snows". The King of Himalsya. HIIANYA-KAsJHPU. Lit.: “Golden Dress". A Daitya who ob tained tbe sovereignty of the Three Worlds from **SHIVA**, for a million years, and persecuted his son Prahlada, a devotee of **VISHNU**. *HoMA*. The *Homa* sacrifice is the act of making an oblation to the Gods by pouring butter into the fire, to the accompanimeut of prayers and invocations. It is regarded as one of tbe five great sacrifices called " Dcva-*yajnas* , . Son of Manu, founder of the Solar Race of Kings wbo reigned in Ayodhya. A demon subdued by the

Sage Agastya. INDIA. The King of the Goda, who is known under many other names, such as : Mahendra, or Great **INDRA**, Sbatakratu, or “He of a hundred sacrifices", Purandara, Destroyer of Citiesn, Vajrapani, Of the Thunderbolt hand n, Lord of ,, Magbavan, “Possessor of Wealth". The Abode of **INDRA** or the Celestial Realm. IIAVAn. Mother of tbe elephant Airavata. GLOSSARY J AIWTIIANA. The colony of TitiUIS in Dandab Forest. Silent repetition of a ptayer or aacred formula. Gold in its origirial purity. The King of the Vultures, who attempted to prevent **RAVANA** from carrying **SITA** away. A Goddess, producer of weapons. King **DASARATHA**’s minisrer. The matted loeb of a devotee. K An Asuta or Demon, slain by **RAMA** and Labhmans. GLOSSARY Tide of **VISHWAMITRA** after his grandfather. Also a devotee who went to hell for having poioted out a road to robbers, by which they pursued and killed some persoos who were fleeing from them. KAUSIUKI. A river said to be **VISHWAMITRA**’s sister. Celebrated jewel churned from the ocean and worn by Shri **VISHNU**. A class of Celestial Bciugs. Kl!SHNI. Orief Queen of King Sagara. The brother of **RAVANA**. A demon, slain by **RAMA**, KHivA or Frumenty, hulled wheat boiled in milk and sweetened. Celestial Beings attendsnt on Kuvera q.v. Knm. A celestial Nymph, personifying fame and glory. The country ruled over by Bali, possibly Mysore. This Kingdom was given to **SUGRIVA** by **RAMA**. KnoWER Knower of Truth or Reality. An illumined being. The kingdom ruled over by King **DASARATHA**. Ten million. The lapwing. A species of heron, Ardea Jaculator. A Sage. A forest. Lit.: “The Forest of the Heron". KaAuNCHI. The dsughter of Kashyapa and Tamra, mother of owls and birds of prey. A partridge. and Two Dairyas who carried olf the Vedas and were slain by **VISHNU**. The Pleiades, nurses of the God of War. The Ocean of Milk. A hunchback servant of Queen **KAIKEYI**. Brother of **RAVANA**, a monster killed by **RAMA**. GLOSSARY the sign

till the whole is above the horizon. Lagna literally means the point whete the horizon and the path of the planet meet. I.AKsHMANA. Son of King Dasaratba and Queen **SUMITRA**, favourite brother of **RAMA** who accompanied him in exile. **LAKSHMANA** was said to be the incarnatiOn of the thouaand-headed Shesha, GLOSSARY MiDa or Mynah, a small percher about the size of a swallow which can be taught to repeat words. or A golden mountain, north of Kailasha. Also a numph who tempted **VISHWAMITRA**. or Muu!YA. Liquor extracted from the bloasom of the Lythrum Fructicosum mixed with sugar. or MITHILA. The kiogdom ruled over by King **JANAKA**. MAITIULI. A name of **SITA**, as daughter of the King of Mithila. MAITIA. Period of the early morning. MAXAIA. A kind of sea monster, sometimes confounded with a shark, crocodile or dolphin. A mountain. A lake on Mount Kailasha, lit. : " The Lake of the Mind ", said to be hollowed out of the mind of **BRAHMA**. A river near Mt. Chittrskuta. A mountain used in the churning of the ocean by Gods and Titans. A Sage who created the Lake of Five Nymphs. Bhsrata's wife, daughter of King Kushadwaja. or A kiog. The wife of Rsvana. A musical instrument. A name of Kama, the God of Love. The hunchbacked maid of **KAIKEYI**. Mantras or mantrams are sacred formulas. The First Man who given the Holy Truth by his father Vivaswat-oee Bhagawadgita, Chapter IV, opening verses. MAITCHA. A demon who, disguised as a deer, lured Rsma ftom his hermitage. MAIICJUPAS. A class of asatics who derive their nourishment from particles of light. A Sage, remarkable for his austerities. MARuri. A name of **HANUMAN** as son of Maruta, the God of Wind. MARurs. The Wind-Gods, or Gods of the Tempest. GLOSSARY to be bom of the sacred cow Sbabola for her protecliol. See . MllmANGA. A kind of drum. MlltGt. Daughter of Krodhavasha, mother of elephants. MRrrYu. The God of Death, anotber name for **YAMA**. An instant, a moment, an

hour, according to the context. MUNt. A holy Sage, a pious and learned person, a tide applied to *Rishis* and others. A tamboutine. People cursed by **VISHWAMITRA** who assumed the lowest caste. N The son of Yayati and fatber of Aja, who was **DASARATHA**'s father. The Serpent Race. The father of King Yayati, Nahusha's curious story is found in the Mahabharata and Putanas. GLOSSARY A of Shri **VISHNU**, 10 called because the waten his first place of motion. A river. A bird. A galliuile. NmHIS. The personified Treasures of the God of Wealth, Kuvera. A grove on the outskirts of Lanb. NILA. A monkey chief, general in **SUGRIVA**'s army. NIMI. A ancestot of King **JANAKA**. A mountain tribe dwelling in the Vindbya Mountains, living on hunting. NISHKA. A gold piece or nugget, sometimes worn as an OM. See Aum. OSHADI or OsHADI-PRASTHA. " The Place of Medicinal Herbs ", a city in the Himalayas mentioned in' Kumara-Sambhava.' p PADMA. A measuretnent, a thousand billions. Warriors born from the sacred cow Shabsla, possibly Persians. See . A detnon slain by **INDRA**. A lake by which **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** rested in their exile. A tabor or cymbal. GLOSSARY **SHIVA**-Duti, Uma and countless others. Lord of Creatures, a title of **SHIVA**. Winged creatures. A kind of drum. The infernal regions. See Poulastya. Wife of Kashyapa, mother of the Danavas. A name of **AGNI**, the God of Fire. The God of the Wind, father of **HANUMAN**. A preparation of rice and milk. Nakshatra, q.v. Sacred bow. "Tawny Ones", a name given to the monkey race. Ghosts or evil spirits. PITTRrs. Manes or Ancestors. or by bounds; a title given to the Monkey Race. One of the Seven Immortal Sages, Grandfather of **RAVANA**. The consort of the Moon, also the personification of the light of the Sun. The Sun. A minister of **SUGRIVA**'s. Circumambulation in a reverent manner from left to right. Father of **JAMBAVAN**, a general in **SUGRIVA**'s army. A Period of the dissolntion of the world. A monkey renowned for his

courage. The vital air or breath. A mountain. A sacred grove, a site facing the West. August-September. GLOSSARY A mountain. constellation of three stars considered auspicious. Also the sixth lunar mansion. PtlTTBA. A son who is said to deliver his father from hell. l'uTTREsTI. A ceremony performed for the of the race by the birth of sons. R A title of those belonging to the House of Raghu to which King **DASARATHA** and his forbears belonged. RAHu. A mythical demon said to cause the eclipse of the sun and the moon. or Flamiogo. RAJAS. See Guna. GLOSSARY Maharishi-A great Risbi, Brahmarishi-A sacred *Rishi*, Devarisbi-A divine *Rishi*. A mountain on which **SUGRIVA** took refuge. The" Deer-homed" Son of the Sage Vibbandaka who matried the daughter of King Lomapada, Sbanta, later petformed the Puttresti ceremony(q.v.)for King Dasaratba RITviJs. Priest officiating at the installation ceremony. RoB!. A fish, Cyprinus Rohita Ham. ROBIN!. The star Aldebaran. RomrA. A kind of deer. RomrAS. Name of the horses of the suo, also a Deity celebrated in the Atbarva Veda, probably a form of Fire or the Sun. RuoRA. A oame of **SHIVA**. The of Kashyapa and Aditi. RuMA. **SUGRIVA**'s Consort. **SUGRIVA**'s general, a monkey chief. RDRu. A deer. s **INDRA**'s Consort. The personified rites and prayers of the Vedas who dwell between heaven and earth, a class of Deities. A King whose history is told in . A vulture, brother of **JATAYU**. Lord of Rivers, the Ooesn. One of the mind-hom of **BRAHMA**. One of the five trees in **INDRA**'s Paradise. The Sapindi Ceremony is for the establishing of a connection with kindred tbmugh funeral offerings. GLOSSARY The Kali *Yuga* or Black Age, also called the Iron Af,e. One of the elephants of the four quarters. SAUMITRI. **SUMITRA**'s son, LabhiDIIIIIl. SAURA. A divine potion. Lit. : " Relatiag to the Sun ". Sochal salt or alkali. SBABARI. A female ascetic, devotee of Rsma. SHAUA. A name of IndtR's. SHAI.MAti. A fi.bulous thorny rod of the

cotton tree used for ing the wicked in hell. A Porcupine. See also Weapons. SIWIIIARA. The Demon of Drought, represented in the Rig VedR as the enemy of IndtR. A measurement, a hundred billions or a hundred thousand crores. (*A crore is ten millions*). SHANEU. Ten billions. SHANTA. The daughter of King Lomspada who was wedded to the Sage Rishyashringa. The mother of the Demon Viradha. A Sage visited by Rsma Olld **SITA** in the Dll1ldab Forest. SHAsANEA. The Consort of RohiDi or the moon. SHASI. The moon. Lit. : " Hare-marked". Teschings of divine Olld recognised authority. Son of the Sage Gautama Olld spiritual director to the Kin§]Ollsb. ' Having a hundred petals". (See Lotus, under Flowers ROd Trees Glossary.') ' Having a hundred feathers,' said of a peacock or ctll1e. Having a hundred wings ' or conveyances, said of Brihaspati, q.v. King **DASARATHA**'s fourth son, whose mother was **SUMITRA**. Lit.: 'Child-killer', a word used for crocodile, porpoise or dolphin. SHIVA. The Lord as Destroyer of Ignorll1Ce, also Lord of Bliss. SHIVYA or SHIVI. A King of the Raghu Dynasty who rescued the God **AGNI** when he had transformed hiiDself into a pigeon ROd was pursued by IndtR, in the form of a hawk. SHONA. A sacred river. GLOSSAR.Y SBlmPANAmA. Sister of Ravaua, a female Titan mutilated by **RAMA** md Laksbmll18. SHVAJlAMSHTIWl, Earrings. A name of the Wind-god. Also of the Demon of Drought slain by lndra. SHYBNAS. Falcons, bawks, eagles, etc., the offspring of ShF.i. SHYBNI. Daughter of Kashyapa and Tamra, mother of birds of prey. A mountain. SmDHARTA. One of King **DASARATHA**'s couosellors. SmDHAS. Semi-divine beings, who dwell between the earth and the sun. SmHU. A kind of rum distilled from molasses. StMHIKA, StNHIKA or SINGHIKA. A female demoo who caught hold of HanumOll's shadow. SINDHU. The river Indus. Also a country east of Koshala. SITA.

Daughter of King Jrmab, King of Mithila, and **RAMA**'s consort. Stx T Sweet, bitter, acid, salt, pungent, acrid Olld barsh. SMRITI. Tradition. Lit. : " What is remembered ,, . *SoMA*. The fermented juice of ' Asclepias-acid ', used as a beverage or libation in sacred ceremonies. SoMADATTA. Daughter of Urmila and mother of Brabmadatta. GLOSSARY SuRAs. A of the Gods. In the Vedas it applied 10 ollilprias of the Sun. SuliAsHTRAs. One of King **DASARATHA**'s ministers. SDRYA. The Sun, one of the three chief deities of the Vedas. SuSHENA. The father of Tara, Bali's coasort. SUTIKSHNA. A Sage who dwelt in the Dandaka Forest and enter tained **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SITA** during their wanderings. Khara's charioteer. SuTRAS. Poetical rhythms or stanzas. SuvAIUL\LA. The consort of the Sun. SUYA)NA. Spiritual Director of King **DASARATHA**. in the Word of power or invocation. SvARBHAIIU. The Demon Rahu, q.v. SVATI. The Star Arcturus. A Porcupine or Hedgehog. SwrAMBHU. The Self-Existence, a of the Creator, Shri **BRAHMA**. The Daughter of the Sage Merusavarni. The ceremony of choosing a consort. A river. T TALA. A leather strap used by archers. A clapper used io music. A river. T One of the wives of the Sage Kashyapa. *TAPAS*. Penance or austerity. TAPOVANA. A forest. TARA. The consort of Bali. T A female demon. TAIIKSHYA. In ancient times coasidered as the personification of GLOSSARY TISHYA. An asterism shaped like an arrow, contaiDing lhree stars, also called Pusbya and Sidhys. TRIJATA. A *Brahmin* whose story is told in Balakands. Also a female titan who spoke in defence nf Siza. TRIKUTA. "Three-Peaked", the mountain on which Lanka was built. TRIPATHAGA. " Three-way flowing", the Traverser of Three Worlds, a Dllllle of the Ganges. TRIPURA. A demon slain by **SHIVA**. A city burnt by Gods. TRIBHANKU. A King nf the Solar whose story is told in . TRzsHtRAS. A demon a1ain by RRma.

TRmKRAMA. The name of Shri **VISHNU**, when taking lhree strides covering the earth. TRmSTAPA. The world of **INDRA**. “Three-eyed” a Dllllle nf **SHIVA**. TWICE-BORN. Ooly a *brahmin* can strictly be twice born ", but the term came to be extended to the warrior and agricultural classes. TuMBURU. A Gandharva cursed by the God Kuvera and born as the Demon Viradha. u The white horse of **INDRA**’s, produced from the churning of the ocean. It is said to be fed on ambroshl and be King of Horses. UDAYA. A golden mounlain. UMA. A name nf Parvati, dsugbter nf Himavat and of **SHIVA**. UPA-NAYA. The ceremony of investiture nf the sacred thread, by which oct spiritual birth is conferred on a youth and be is considered a member nf the *Brahmin* or Twice-bom claos. The age at which this ceremony lakes place is betWeen eight aod sixteen yesrs. UPANISHAD. Esoteric doctrine. The third division of the Vedso, GLOSSARY UTTARA-Plw.GUNI. A constellation, under which **SITA** was oaid to have been bom. VACBASPAn. Mother of the Gods, Goddess of speech and lesrnillg. or Lit.: 'Mare’s Fire’, the subterranean fire or lire of the lower regions, fabled to emerge from a cavity called the ' Mare’s mouth ' under the sea at south pole. A bird, dark throated and white winged. Also a species of food. VAIDEHA or VmEHA. The killgdom ruled over by Janak. V A oame of **SITA** as daughter of King of Videba. V A of *Rishi* or Hermit. V A oame of Bali. Sacrilice in honour of Shri **VISHNU**. A oame of Kuvera, **RAVANA**’s brother. V A oame of God **AGNI**. V The merchant or agricultural class. V The River of Hell. A name of the God **YAMA**. VAJAPEYA. A sacrifice at which an acetous mixture of meal and is offered to the Gods. “Wielder of Thunderbolt", a oame for Indta. VAI.AitHILYAS. Divine Being1, the size of a thumb, sixty thousand of whom from body of **BRAHMA** and the chariot of sun. VAU. See Bali. V A also an Indian lute. Poet, Sage, author of Ramayana. The Holy Dwarf, fifth divine

Incarnation of Shri Vuhnu. V A great *Rishi*, p!CSent at Rams's installation. VANA. Forest. VANAPIWTHA. A festival similar to a Harvest Festival. GLOSSARY A name of Vayu, q.v. A demon consumed by Ibe Sage Agastya. The God of the Wind. The Holy Scriptuies of Ibe Hindu religion. Fountain of Divine Knowledge. A sacred science considered subordinate to and in some sense a of the Vedas-six subjects come under the denomination : Siksha-pronunciation. Kalpa-religious rites. 3· Vyakarana-Gtammar. t· Chandas-Prosody. 5· Jyotish -Astronomy. 5· Nirukn-Explanation of difficult words. An altar of Kusha grass. Place of sacrifice. Son of Ibe Sage Kashyapa and faiber of Rishyashringa. VmxsHANA. See Bibishana. Celestial Beings. A country, probably Bintr, whose capital was Kun dinaputa. See Vaideha. "Arranger", "Disposer n, "Creator". Name of Btahma. Lit. : "Magical knowledge holder". Particular good or evil spirits attendant on the Gods. An Indian lute. The mother of **GARUDA**. The auspicious hour for finding what has been lost. A mountain ordered by Agastya not to increase in height. An Indian lute. A demon, son of Java and Shatarade who was slain by **RAMA** and had formerly been the Gandharva Tumburu. A of Bali. Elephant of one of the Four Quarters. VtsHAKAs. One of the lunar asterisms, also a month of the flower GLOSSARY y The son of Yayati and D..,.yani, Yayati was the founder of the Yadavas in which line Krishna was botn. A sacrifice or penance. Y The of the Veda that treats of ceremonies and rites. FLOWERS AND TREES (Wherever possible an English equivalent has been given or some description of the plant or tree ; some however could not be traced) A Semicarpus Anancardium Zeylanica, the Plumbago or Plumbago Zeylauica. A white ftowered shrub, that blooms in June or July; its ftowers are set in spikes. The plant is The Marking Nut plant. PhyUanthus Emblica. A many branched shrub re sembling

Hemlock. AMRA. Mango Mangifera Indica. A shon-trunked tree covered with evergreen foliage, which ftowers from January to March, the blossom being panly white and panly greenish yellow with an orange stripe on each petal. or ANkOTA, Alangium Hexapetalum. A poison, A.nkola-sara, is prepared from this plant. AkAvtNDA. Nymphoea Nelumho, a water-lily. Sapindus Saponeris, the Soap plant. ARJuNA or ARJuNAKA. Tertuinalia Arjuna, a species of Nimba tree. A tall evergreen tree usuaily found on the banks of streams. The leaves cluster at the end of the branches and the ftowers are tiny. The Arjuna-Jarul, is the Queena ftower or Crepe ftower. AlANA. Terminalia Tormentosa or, the plant Marsilla Quadrifolia. The first is a common forest tree yielding exeellent timber similar to the Arjuna tree and rarely seen outside forest areas. GLOSSARY Premna Spinoza. The wood by which attrition il produced. Racemosa. or Zixypbus Jujuba. Tbe JujuM Plant. = GLOSSARY D DADIMA. Common Pomegranate. Bears double llomrs. DADINA. Punica Granatum. Pomegranate. A shrub with large red llomrs and bald globose frUit. DBVADAliU. A variety of pine. DBVA PARNA. The Divine Leaf. A medicinal plant. DBANVANA. Gtewia Asiatica. Also, under iliJfetent spcllings, various other plants. DHANWAliiA. Echites Antidy Sentetin. A Twining Plant. DHAIIA. Woodfotdia Florebunds. A smsll spreading shrub from which red dye is obtained from the bright red ilowers. Also a species of Acacia. DHATRI. Sterospermum Aciderifolium. Datura Stramonium L. (*Solansceae*) Thom apple. A poisonous drug is made from this tree. DHuvA. One of the Acacia family. DURVA GRASS. Psnicum Dactylon. Bent Grass. B F G GAJAPUSBPI. Blephsnt Flower. A sort of Atum. GosHn!sHAxA. A Sandal-tree. Gm.All. A resinous tree, frsgments of which are put into the water in a losbts for ceremonial purposes. H HAlllmYAMA. See Shyama. HniTALA. Phoenix

Sylvestus. The Manhy Date Tree.]AMBU. Eugenia Jambolana. The Rose Apple or]ova Plum.]AMNII. Prunus Padus L. Bird Cherry. “I GLOSSARY K Musa Sapientum. A plantain. It hu a soft pcriahable stem and is symbol of the of hWIWl life. Nauclea Cadumba, a plant. A white lily. Terminalia Arjuua. A tall with a or:,r s:"!. wi-1i,.gr=.,.';” GLOSSARY KovmARA. Banhinia Variegata, also the " Tree of Paradise. " One of the loveliest of Indian trees with a dark brown smoothish bark. The leaves fall in the cold season and the large sweetly scented flowers open on the bare branches. Their colour varies from magenta, mauve, pinlt with crimson martiup or white with a splash of yellow. Cassia Fistula. Indian Laburnum. Also the com mon Bottle Flowet. KuAYRAL. Mountain Ebony. KtJJAJA. Wrightia Awtidy Senterica. A medicinal plant. A white watet lily. KUNDA. Jasmine Multiftorum. KUitAkA. Boswellia Thorifeta. Olivanum Tree. KuaANDA. A plant commonly called Sakarunda. Dronapushpi. The Drona flowet. Drona meaninB a vessel, cup ot pot, it probably produces a gourd. GlASS. Demostaehya Bipeonata. Sacred Grass used for religious ceremonies. This grass has long stallts and pointed leaveslilte rushes. KuvALA. A water lily. LAIuCA.} Artocarpua Lacucha. The same genus as the Jack uk’.d.a. Fruit, cultivated in the plains of Northern India. Simplocos Ratemosa. The bark of this tree is used as a M A Mango. Bassia Latifolia. A species of leguminous plant. Also Basil and a ltind of Panic grass. MAnHUKA. Bassia Latifolia. lllir Buttet Tree. A large deci ':d GLOSSARY N NAGA. Mosua Ferrea. A small tree. A mountain shrub. or Caledubs Arborea or Dalbergia Arborea or Pongamia Glabra. NALINA. Nelumbium Speciosum. A water lily. GlASS. Phragnutes Karka Trin. A species of Reed. NARIIO!LA. Coconut Palm. NtCHVLA. Barringtonia Acutangola commonly called Hijjal. NILASHOKA. An Asboka with blue dowers. NtLOTPALA. The

Blue Lotus. NtMBA. Aradirachta Indica. A tree with bitter fruit, the leaves of which are chewed at funerals. NIPA, NIPAKA. A species of Kadamba Tree. NtvABA or NAJVAIA. Wild Rice. Ficus Indica. Indian Fig Tree. p PADMA, A pink lotus, Costus Speciosus or Arabicus, a kind of Fir. Arto Carpus Intergrifolia. Jack-fruit Tree, bearing the largest edible fruit in the world, weighing up to too lbs., oblong or tound and irregular. This fruit is in great demand but less favoured than the mango or plantain. This tree grows in the forests in the Western Gbats. PAIAIHADRAIA. Erythrininina Fulgens. Coral Tree, which beara angular spikes of rich rod blooms along its bare branches from January to March. GLOSSARY Q R RAitTACHANDAN. The red Sandal Tree. RA]JVA. A red Lotus. Barbadoes Pride. The Red Wood or Coral Pea Tree. s SALA. Shorea Robusta. The Sal Tree. SALI.AKA. Bignonia Indica. The Gum Tree. SANGANDHIKA. The White and mue Water-lily. SAPTA. A kind of grass. Sacharum Cylindricum. Seven-leafed Milk Plant or Poon Tree or Devil'a Tree. Alstonia or Echites Scholaris. Ut.: Seven-leafed Tree. SAilALA. Pinus Longifolia. A species of Pine. SAIIJA. White Murdah. SARPAT GRASS. Saccharium Bengalense Retz. (S. Sara Roxb.). One of the sugar canes. SHA.MI. Acacia Suma. This tree possesses very tough and hard wood supposed to contain fire-it is employed to kindle the sacred fires by rubbing bits togetber. Also the shrub Serratula anthelmintica. Vallianeria Octandra Bexica. An aquatic plant. SHALMALI. The Silk Cotton Tree. . SHIMSHAPA SHINGSHAPA. Dattergia Sisu. An Asbob. SHIRASHAKA. Probably a form of fragrant Sirissa. GLOSSARY T Pinieta Acris. Borassus Flabdliformis. A kind of Palm. Phyllanthus Emblica. The name Myrabolan is applied to the fruit which with that of another tree makes a tonic called Tregala Churan. 1'ILAKA. CommoDiy called Tila. A ttee with beautifUl flowera to the Sesamum

plant. TlMmA. The Sesamum plant, TwniA. An aquatic plant. or A kind of pumpkin or water-melon. Also GLOSSARY w z WEAPONS The Fire Weapon. lndra's Weapon. AlsHJXA. An Arrow. A f J:::l"" that aumot be followed in ita course. GLOSSARY DIWIMA-PASHA. The Weapon that has the power of entangliDg the Foe. DIIRlSHTA. The active Weapon. gn;:; GLOSSARY K.\sHA. A Whip. KouMODAK!. Weapon giving joy to the earth. KRouNCHA or KRAUNCHA. A Weapon named after bird of that name. KsliAPANl. An oar or net. Something that destroys the destroyer. An arrow with a razor-like edge. Crescent-shaped arrow. KuNTALA. A Sickle-shaped Weapon. KUTA. A Poniard. A concealed Weapon, similar to a Hammer. A Weapon that can be followed in its course. LoruTA MUKHI. The Bloody-mouthed Weapon. M MAHA-NABHA. The Lorge-navelled Weapon. MARA V The Great-armed or handed Weapon. MALl. The Chain Weapon. That which holds or binds. The Weapon of Manu. MATHANA. The Weapon thai infficts injury The Great Deception or Illusion. The Weapon of Inebriation. MoHA. The Weapon that causes loss of Consciousness. MoHAN. The Weapon of attraction. MUSHALA or MOUSHALA. A Qub. N NALIKA. An Iron Arrow or Dan; also a Pike or Javelin. NANDANA. The Joy-producing Weapon. GLOSSARY p AsTRA. The Ghosdy Weapoa, belongiug to the Piaacba, ghoota or demoas. DAliA The Supreme Oearing Weapon. An Axe or Hatchet. An Iron Bludgeon or Iron-studded Cub. The Weapon aacred to **SHIVA**. A kind of Sword. The Bow aacred to **SHIVA**. PlTRIYA. The Weapon of the Pittris (*Ancestors*). The O.urner. A Bearded Dart. The Weapon of Destruction. Weapon dealing with the vital airs. That which neutrolizes the of otb.., weapons. PtnwiG MUKBA. A Weapon that has ita face averted. Q R The Desolator. RAn. The Weapon of Enjoyment. The Approving Weapon. RUDRA. The Weapon aacred Rudra (***SHIVA***). s GLOSSARY

Either spited mace or round with lzon spikes. The Hundred-mouthed Weapon. The Hundred-bellied Weapon. SHITESU. A sharp Arrow. SHOSHANA. A Weapon used to dry up water and counteract the Varshana Weapon. SHUCIDVANU. The Pure-handed Weapon. SHUSHKA. The Dry Weapon. An Arrow resembling a heron's feathers. A Weapon resembliDg lion's teeth. SoMASTRA. The Weapon. The Weapon of the controlled mind. SUNAIHUKA. The Fine-aaveUed Weapon. To do with the act of sleeping. The Rich-uaveUed Weapon. T ToMARA. An Iron bat, crow-bat, lance or javelin. The Gaper. TwASHTRA. A Weapon possessing the power of Twashtra, the Architect of the Gods. u A Scimitar. GLOSSARY w y YAMIYA. The Weapon of" Dead>. YoGANDHARA. The United. z Translated by HARI PRASAD SHASTRI Vol. III. SHANTI SADAN 29 CHEPSTOW VILLAS LONDON, W.II

CONTENTS BooK I. **RAMA** felicitates **HANUMAN**. His Pcxplexities z. **SUGRIVA** consoles **RAMA** 3· **HANUMAN** describes the Strength of Lanka to **RAMA** 4· The Army reaches the Shores of the Sea S· **RAMA** is atllicted when thinking of **SITA** IS 6. **RAVANA** consults his Subjects -I6 7· The Titans persuade **RAVANA** to make War and remind him of his former Exploits I8 8. The boasting of **RAVANA**'s I9 9· Bibishana advises **RAVANA** to send back **SITA** 10. Bibishana insists that **SITA** should be given back to **RAMA RAVANA** summons his Assembly zs The Discourse between **RAVANA** and Kumbhabrna I3. **RAVANA** teils the Story of the Nymph Punjikasthala I4. Bihishana blames the attitude of **RAVANA**'s Courtiers 3I 15. Bibishana reproaches lndrajita for his boasting -I6. **RAVANA** rebukes Bihishana who takes his depanuxe I7. Words of the leading Monkeys regarding Bibishans 18. **RAMA** listens to the Advice of the Monkeys about receiving Bibishana I9. Bibishana is brought before **RAMA** 20. Ravans sends Shuka to Sugtiva 2x. **RAMA** looses his Arrows on Sagara 22. The Army crosses the Sea SI 23. **RAMA** sees diverse

Portents CONTENTS 35· Malyavan advises **RAVANA** to make peace 36. **RAVANA** directs Lanka's Defences —37· **RAMA** his Plans for the Attack -38. The Ascent of Mount Suvda 39· Description of Lanka ———-40. The extraordinary Combat between **SUGRIVA** and **RAVANA** 41. Ram.a sends **ANGADA** to **RAVANA** 42. The Titans make a Sortie -43· The Conflict between the Monkeys and the Titans 44· **ANGADA**'s Exploit -45· **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** are struck down by lndrajita no 46. The despair of **SUGRIVA** and his Army. Bibishana re assures Him -II2 47· **SITA** sees **RAMA** aod Lakshmaoa lying on the Battlefield II5 48. **SITA**'s Lamentations **RAMA** returns to consciousness and **LAKSHMANA** 50. **GARUDA** liberates **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** -51. Dhumraksha goes out to fight the Monkeys 52. Dhumraksha fights and is slain by **HANUMAN** 53· Vajradamshtra enters the Lists 54· **ANGADA** slays Vajradamshtra I 32 55· Akampana goes out to fight against the Monkeys -56. Akampana is slain by **HANUMAN** -57· Prahasta goes out to fight -58. The Death of Prahasta -59· **RAVANA**'s prowess. **RAMA** overcomes him but grants him his Life 6o. The Titans rouse **KUMBHAKARNA** The Story of Kumbhakama 62. The Meeting between **KUMBHAKARNA** and **RAVANA** 63. **KUMBHAKARNA** consoles **RAVANA** 64. Mahodara's Speech 65. **KUMBHAKARNA** enters into combat —-!66 66. **ANGADA** reproaches the Monkeys for flying from **KUMBHAKARNA** -67. **KUMBHAKARNA**'s Exploits. He is slain by **RAMA** -CONTENTS 15· Lanka is set on fire by the Monkeys —,6. The Prowess of **ANGADA** and Kumbha : Kumbha is slain 224 11· The Fight between Nikumbha and **HANUMAN** -78. Maharaksha goes out to meet **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** 19· Mahsraksha falls under **RAMA**'s Blows —So. lndrajita sets out fight once mOte -81. Indrajita's Stratagem. **SITA**'s Apparition —-82. **HANUMAN** rallies His Forces : lndrajita's Sacrifice -83. **LAKSHMANA**'s Speech -84. Bibishana consoles **RAMA** -85. **LAKSHMANA** goes to the Nikumbhila Grove to fight lndrajita -86. Indrajita bteaks off his Sacrifice fight with **LAKSHMANA** 249 87. Indrajita and Bihishana denounce each othet -88. The Combat between **LAKSHMANA** and lnclrajita 89. **LAKSHMANA** and

lndrajita continue fight 90. Indrajita loses his Charioteer, Chariot and Hones -91. The Death of Indrajita -92. **RAMA** commends **LAKSHMANA** who is cuted of His Wounds by the Monkey Sushena —93· **RAVANA**'s Grief on hearing of his Son's Death -94· **RAMA**'s Exploits -95· The Lamentations of the Titan Women -96. **RAVANA** goes out to fight and encounten ill Omens 97· The Fight between Virupaksha and Sugtiva : Virupaksha's Death -98. Mahodata is slain by **SUGRIVA** -99· The Combat between **ANGADA** and Mabapanhwa -roo. **RAMA** and **RAVANA** fight with magic Weapons -ror. **RAVANA** flees from **RAMA** —**LAKSHMANA**'s miraculous Recovery -103. **RAMA** and **RAVANA** renew their Combat -104. **RAMA** arraigns **RAVANA** and reprosches him for his Misdeeds -ros. **RAVANA** reproaches his Charioteer —CONTENTS 115. **HANUMAN** carries **RAMA**'s Message to **SITA** -u6. **RAMA** sends for **SITA** 117. **RAMA** repudiates **SITA** ————-uS. **SITA**'s Lamentations. She undergoes the Ordeal Fire 336 119. **BRAHMA**'s Praise of **RAMA** -**SITA** is restored to **RAMA** -**DASARATHA** appears to **RAMA** On **RAMA**'s Request, **INDRA** restores the Army 123. Bibishana places the Chariot Pushpaka at **RAMA**'s disposal 124. **RAMA** sets out for Ayodhya 125. **RAMA** tells **SITA** of the Places over which they are passing 350 126. **RAMA**'s Meeting with the Sage Bharadwaja 127. **RAMA** sends **HANUMAN** to seek out **BHARATA** 128. **HANUMAN** tells **BHARATA** of all that befell **RAMA** and **SITA** during their Exile 129. **BHARATA** sets out to meet **RAMA** I 30. **RAMA** installed as King. The Benefits that accrue from the Recitation and Hearing of the "Ramayana" 365 CONTENTS I. The Sages pay homage to **RAMA** -37S 2. The Binh of Vishtavas -3· Vishtavas becomes the Protector of Wealth -4· Origin of the *Rakshasas* and of the Boons they received 38z S· The Story of the three Sons of Sukesha -6. **VISHNU** goes to the defence of the Gods -7. The Combat between **VISHNU** and the *Rakshasas* -8. The Combat between **VISHNU** and Malyavan -39S 9· The Binh of Dashagriva and His Brothers -Concerning the Penances practised Dashagriva and His Brothers -40I Dhanada cedes Lanka to Dasbagriva -The Marriages of the

Rakshasas -**RAVANA**'s Crimes -I4. The Combat bciween **RAVANA** and the Yakshas -4I2 IS· The Combat between **RAVANA** and Dbanada. **RAVANA** seizes Pushpaks —4I4 I6. The Origin of **RAVANA**'s Name -4I7 I7. The Story of Vedsvati -42D 8. The Gods assume a thousand Forms in fear of **RAVANA** 423 I9. **RAVANA** fights with who dies prophesying the *Rakshasa*'s End -42S CONTENTS 24· **RAVANA** carries off a number of Women and is cursed by them 457 25. Dashagriva allies himself to Madbu -46o 26. Nalakuvara curses **RAVANA** -27. The Fight henveen the Gods and the Raksbasas. The Death of Sumali —-28. The Duel between !nella and **RAVANA** - 470 30. Telling of the Curse pronounced the Sage Gautama on Shakra -31. **RAVANA** goes to the Banks of the Natmada Rivet -33· Arjuna releases **RAVANA** at the request of Poulastya -34· Bali hangs **RAVANA** on his Girdle -35· The Story of **HANUMAN**'s Childhood -36. The Boons bestowed on the Child **HANUMAN** and how he was cursed by the Ascetics 37· Homage is paid to Shri Rams -First of the Interpolated Chaptets. 2nd Series -soo Second of the Interpolated Chaptets. 2nd Series -Third of the Intetpolated Chapters. 2nd Series -sos Fourth of the Interpolated Chapters. 2nd Series -Fifth of the Interpolated Chapters. 2nd Series -38. **RAMA** leave of His Allies -39· Rams loads His Allies with Gifts -40. **RAMA** leave of the Bears, Monkeys and Titans SIS 41. Rams dismisses the Pushpaks Chariot —42· The Felicity enjoyed by Rams and **SITA** -**RAMA** Himself His 44· **RAMA** His Brothers -522. 45· Rams commands **LAKSHMANA** to take **SITA** to the CONTENTS ss. Shukra curses Yayati ———-59· Puru the place of His Father by Shukra 547 First of the IntetpOiated Chapters. 3rd Seties -Second of the Interpolated Chapters. 3rd Setieo -sso Third of the IntetpOiated Chapters. 3rd Series -6o. The Ascetics seek out **RAMA** —61. The Story of Madhu -62. **SHATRUGHNA** permission to fight Lavana -63. The Installation of **SHATRUGHNA** -s6z 64. **SHATRUGHNA** sets out to meet Lavana ——65. The Story of Saudasa who is cursed by **VASISHTHA** -66. The Birth of Kusha and Lava -67. The Story of Mandhata -68. **SHATRUGHNA** encounters Lavana -69. The Death of

Lavana -57Z **SHATRUGHNA** establishes Himself in the City of Madbu 574 71. **SHATRUGHNA** seeks out Sage **VALMIKI** -7Z. **SHATRUGHNA** to see **RAMA** -73· The Death of a *Brahmin*'s Son -74· Narada's Discourse -sSo 75· **RAMA** a Tour of Inspection of His Kingdom 58z 76. Shambuka is br **RAMA** -77· The Story of Swatgto —78. Shveta tells His Story -79· The hondred Sons of lkshvaku -Danda insults Aruja -St. The destruction of Danda's Kingdom -59Z Bz. **RAMA** takes leave of Agastya —83. **BHARATA** persuades **RAMA** not to perform the Rajasuya Sacrifice -84. The Story of Vritra -85. The Death of Vritra -86. **INDRA** is liberated by means of the Ashvamedha Sacrifice 599 CONTENTS 97· **SITA** descends into the Earth —98. Kama's Anger and Grief, Brahm appeases Him -99· The Death of the QueeDS -103. 104. 105. 106. 108. 109. no. **RAMA** sends **BHARATA** to conquet the Gandharvas -The slaying of the Gandharvas and the conquest of Their Country **-RAMA** bestows Kingdoms on **LAKSHMANA**'s Sons Death is sent to seek out **RAMA** 62S Death delivers his Message The Sage Durvasa comes to visit **RAMA** **-RAMA** banishes **LAKSHMANA** **RAMA** installs Kusha and Lava on the Throne **-RAMA** issues His last Commands Kama's Depattun: for the Mahaprasthana **-RAMA** ascends to Heaven with the other Beings The Supreme Virtue of the Ramayana RaiiUJ felicitates Hamurum.-His Perplexities HlwuNG **HANUMAN**'s faithful narrative, **RAMA**, full of joy, said : " The mission that **HANUMAN** has carried out is of great significance and the most arduous in the world ; none other could have achieved it, even in thought ! Other than **GARUDA** and Vayu, verily I know of no being able to cross the mighty ocean save **HANUMAN** himself. Neither Gods, Danavas, Yakshas, Gandbarvas, Uragas nor *Rakshasas* could enter Lanka whieb is protected by **RAVANA** and, did any in his presumption enter it, would be return alive ? Who is able to capture that citadel by assault, that has been rendered inaccessible by its rampart of titans, but one wbose and valour are equal to **HANUMAN**'s ? **HANUMAN** has carried out this important service for **SUGRIVA** by manifesting a strength equal to his audacity. That servant to whom his

master confides a diflicult task and who acquits himself with aesl is aaid to be a superior man. The one who is ready and capable hut who yet does no more than his sovereign exacts from him, in order to render himself agreeable, is called an ordinaty man, but he who is well and able and does not out the command of his king, is said to be the least of men. **HANUMAN** has fulfilled the task confided to him unfalteringly, to the satisfaction of **SUGRIVA**; in consequence, through the discovery of Vaidehi's retreat by this faithful messenger, the House of Raghu, the valiant **LAKSHMANA** and I have been saved. Yet even so my heart is heavy, since I am not able to requite the besrer of these good tidinga in a fitting manner. Let me at least embrace the mag nanimous **HANUMAN** since, in the present circumstances, this is all that is permitted to me I " Having spoken thus, Rams, trembling with joy, clasped **HANUMAN** in his arms, who, master of himself, his mission fulfilled, had returned.

BOOK VI

Yuddha Kanda

The vanara army bridges the ocean. After a long sequence of pitched battles, Kumbhakarna and Indrajit fall, and Ravana is slain by Rama. Sita proves her purity by the ordeal of fire. The fourteen years of exile complete, Rama returns to Ayodhya for a long and glorious reign.



CHAPTER 1

Rama felicitates Hanuman. His Perplexities

CHAPTER RaiiUJ felicitates Hamurum.-His Perplexities HlwuNG **HANUMAN**'s faithful narrative, **RAMA**, full of joy, said : " The mission that **HANUMAN** has carried out is of great significance and the most arduous in the world ; none other could have achieved it, even in thought ! Other than **GARUDA** and Vayu, verily I know of no being able to cross the mighty ocean save **HANUMAN** himself. Neither Gods, Danavas, Yakshas, Gandbarvas, Uragas nor *Rakshasas* could enter Lanka whieb is protected by **RAVANA** and, did any in his presumption enter it, would be return alive ? Who is able to capture that citadel by assault, that has been rendered inaccessible by its rampart of titans, but one wbose and valour are equal to **HANUMAN**'s ? **HANUMAN** has carried out this important service for **SUGRIVA** by manifesting a strength equal to his audacity. That servant to whom his master confides a diflicult task and who acquits himself with aesl is aaid to be a superior man. The one who is ready and capable hut who yet does no more than his sovereign exacts from him, in order to render himself agreeable, is called an ordinaty man, but he who is well and able and does not out the command of his king, is said to be the least of men. **HANUMAN** has fulfilled the task confided to him unfalteringly, to the satisfaction of **SUGRIVA**; in consequence, through the discovery of Vaidehi's retreat by this faithful messenger, the House of Raghu, the valiant **LAKSHMANA** and I have been saved. Yet even so my heart is heavy, since I am not able to requite the besrer of these good tidinga in a fitting manner. Let me at least embrace the mag nanimous **HANUMAN** since, in the present circumstances, this is all that is permitted to me I " Having spoken thus,

Rams, trembling with joy, clasped **HANUMAN** in his arms, who, master of himself, his mission fulfilled, had returned.

CHAPTER 2

Sugriva consoles Rama

Of Trikuta, **RAVANA** is slain as it were, but unless a bridge is tbtown over that formidable domain of **VARUNA**, the sea, the Gods and *Asuras* themselves with their leaders cannot force an entry into Lanka. " When that dyke on the waters in the vicinity of Lanka is constructed and all the troops sball have passed over it, **RAVANA** is, as it were, alresdy defeated, so valiant are these monkey warriors who are able to change their form at will. “Enough of this faint-hearted attitude, fatal to any enterprise, O King. In this world, man is unbraced by sorrow ; that which must be done should be accomplished with resolution, it is assuredly expedient to act swiftly ! For this enterprise, O Great Sage, unite energy with virtue, for, if it be a question of loss or death, the great warriors, thy peers, see grief as the con sumer of their resources. Thou art the foremost of the wise and versed in all the scriptures ; with allies such as I am, thy victory is assured I In sooth I see none in the Three Worlds able to withstand thee in combat when thou art armed with thy bow I With the success of thine enterprise in the hands of the monkeys, thou canst not fail. When thou hast crossed the imperishable ocean thou shalt see **SITA** ere long. Desist from this melancholy that thou hast allowed to invade thee and yield to thy legitimate indignation, O Prince. Unadventurous warriors never win honour but all fear the wrathful. It is for the purpose of crossing the formidsble ocean, the Lord of Rivers, that thou hast come hither with us; now with thy resourceful mind ponder on

it. Once the ocean has been crossed by my forces, know victory to be certain ; verily when the whole army has passed over the sea, our triumph is assured I " The monkeys, those courageous soldiers, who are able to change their form at pleasure, will crush their opponents with an avalanche of rocks and trees. Whatever the means employed, once we have crossed **VARUNA**'s domain, **RAVANA** is as dead in mine eyes, O Destroyer of Thy Foes I But of what use are all these words ? Thy victory is assured and the portents, which I perceive, fill my heart with joy."

CHAPTER 3

Hanuman describes the Strength of Lanka to Rama

THEsE words of **SUGRIVA**, judicious and full of good sense, pleased Kakutstha who said to **HANUMAN** : " By the power of mine austerities, I am well able to cross the ocean by throwing a bridge over it or even drying it up. What are the fortifications of this ina=ssible Lanka ? Describe tbem fully to me, I wish to hear all about tbem as if I had myself beheld them, O Monkey. How are its gates manned; what is the strength of the army ; what kind of moats surround it and how ate tbe retreats of the titans constructed ? Thou didst explore Lanka at tby leisure when opportunity arose, now in tbe light of thine obsetVBtions give me exact and complete information thereon. Thus interrogated by **RAMA**, **HANUMAN**, the Son of Matuta, tbe most eloquent of narrators, said : "Hear, O King, I will tell tbee tbe extent of tbe defences, of the moats and the number of troops guarding that city. I will describe to tbee tbe opulence of those titans and the great prosperity of tbeir capital due

to **RAVANA**'s austerities; I will tell tbee also of the formidable ocean and tbe many regiments of infantry and tbe strengtb of the cavalry ". After this preamble, the foremost of monkeys began to relate lucidly everything he knew and said : " Filled witb happy people, Lanka abounds in elephants intoxicated witb Mads juice and is swarming witb chariots and titans. It has four immense gateways that are extremely high and furnished witb strong doors which are closed witb massive iron bars. Catapults, darts and stones are placed near at hand, capable of repelling the assaults of the enemy and the valiant titans have heaped in readiness, formidable spears in tbeir hundreds. "The city is encircled by a high golden wall difficult to scale, Uned within with precious gems, coral, emerald and pearl. 6 On all sides awe-inspiring moats of great splendour, lilled with icy water, have been dug, which are deep and abounding in crocodiles and fishes. At the entrance to these dykes there are four long draw-bridges furnished with innumerable weapons and five great cannons are placed round about which defend the entries against the approach of the enemy, whose battalions would be flung by these engines of war into the moats on every side. The most important of these bastions, impossible to force, is of unsuperable strength and dazzling with its pillars and fulcrums of gold. " Endowed with great physical strength, O Prince, **RAVANA** is avid for combat, ever on the alert and constantly reviewing his forces. Lanka is therefore impregnable, it is a celestial citadel that inspires terror. Surrounded by water, built on a mountain with its fourfold defences', it is situated on the other side of the impassable ocean, O **RAMA**, where no vessel can approach it, as it of!'ers no harbourage anywhere. Built on the summit of an inaccessible rock, Lanka, where horses and elephants abound, resembling the City of the Gods, is extremely difficult to conquer. With its moats and Shataghnis, its engines of war of every kind, that capital of

the wicked **RAVANA** is unique. “The eastern gate is defended by ten thousand men, all skilled warriors armed with spears, the foremost of swordsmen ; the southern gate is guarded by a hundred thousand warriors, there a whole army of seasoned fighters is assembled ; ten thousand troops armed with swords and shields, all accustomed to the wielding of weapons, defend the western gate ; the northern gate is proteCted by a million men who are mounted in chariots or who ride on horses; they are the sons of distin guished families. Titans to the number of hundreds and thousands occupy the centre of the city with one million tested troops in addition. " I have destroyed the ramparts and filled up the moats and, having tom down the walls, have set fire to the town, therefore, if we can find some means of crossing **VARUNA**’s domain, the city is ours; let the monkeys deliberate on the matter. “**ANGADA**, Dvivida, Mainda, **JAMBAVAN**, Panasa, Nala and the General Ni!a will fall upon Ravaca’s capital with its hills, woods, moats, archways and rampam and briDg **SITA** back to thee, O Raghava, what need is there of the rest of the monkeys ? Come, give the command quickly to the whole army of these valiant monkeys and. at a propitious hour, let us set out I "

CHAPTER 4

The Army reaches the Shores of the Sea

“Now that thou hast told me everything concerning Lanka, that dresd citadel of the terrible demons, I shall make prepara tions to destroy it without delay, this is the truth I " O **SUGRIVA**, be gracious enough to order our departure; the sun is in suid-heaven and has entered the constellation of victory’. As for **SITA**’s abductor, he shall not escape, wherever he may go I When **SITA** learns of my approach, her hopes will

revive, as one who, having drunk poison and on the point of death, quaffs the nectar of immortality. " The northern planet Phalguni is in the ascendent and will be in conjunction with the Hasta Star to-morrow. Let us depart, O **SUGRIVA**, and let all the troops accompany us; every portent is favourable ! Having slain **RAVANA**, I shall return with **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**. My right eye-lid is twitching which is an indication that victory is near and that my purpose will be accomplished." At these words, King **SUGRIVA** and Lakahmana, bowing low, paid obeisance to Ramo, who, full of faith and versed in the moral law, spoke once more, saying : " Let General Nila with a guard of a hundred thousand intrepid warriors go before the army to explore the way. He should lesd his forces speedily by the path where fruit, roots, shade, fresh water and honey abound. In their wickedness, the demons are capable of destroying the roots and fruita and vitiating the water on the way. Keep them at a distance and be on your guard I Let those dwellers of the woods search the ravines and dense thickets in the forest in order to discover the ambushes of the enemy. " Those who are weak should remain here for your task is formidable and demands endurance; therefore let the foremost of the monkeys gifted with prodigious prowess lead the vanguard, composed of hundreds and thousands of monkeys, resembling the waters of the sea. Let Gaja who is like unto a hill and the esceedingly powerful Gavaya and Gavaksha go abead like proud bulls leading the kine. The leader of monkeys, Rishabha, skilled in leaping, should proteCt the right Bank of the army and the fiery Gandhamadana, resembling an elephant in mustha, should defend the left Bank. I myself, mounted on the shoulders of **HANUMAN**, lilte lndra on Airavata, will march in the centre of my troops in order to encourage them. **LAKSHMANA** who resembles death itself, will ride on the shoulders of **ANGADA**, as Kuvera, the Lord of Creatures and God of Wealth on Sarva

bhauma. Let the mighry Lord of the Bears, **JAMBAVAN** with Susbena and the monkey Vegadarshin, all three, protect the rear of the army." Hearing Raghava's words, **SUGRIVA**, commander of the forces, gave his orders to the monkeys. Tbereupon a multitude of monkeys, eager to fight, issued from the caves and mountain peaks, leaping on all sides. Honoured by the King of the Monkeys, as also by **LAKSHMANA**, the virtuous Rams, accoru panied by hundreds and thousands of monkeys resembling elephants, set out in a southerly direction and under **SUGRIVA**'s command, that great army in high spirits, betraying its delight, escorted him. Guarding the Banks of the army and pressing forward, they ran towards the south, leaping on all sides, emitting leonine roars, growling and shouting, feeding on honey and delicious fruits, brandishing great trees and flowering sbrubs. In their pugnacity, some lifted their fellows up and threw them down or climbed on each others backs vying with one another in turning somersaults. "We will slay **RAVANA** with all his nocturnal rangers I " Thus did those monkeys roar in the presence of **RAMA**. 9 Going in advance of the army, Risbabba, the valiant Nila and also Kumuda cleared the way with the assistance of innumerable monleys. lo the centre, the King **SUGRIVA**, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, scourges of their foes, were surrounded by countless redourable warriors. Tbe courageous monley, Sbatabali, at the head of ten kotis, was, in himself, sufficient to protect the entire bost of monkeys ! With an escort of a hundred kotis, Kesarin and Panasa, Gaja and Arka with their battalions protected the ftanks of that army, whilst Sushena and **JAMBAVAN** surrounded by a multitude of bears, having placed **SUGRIVA** at the head, formed the rearguard. Tbe valiant General Nila, a lion among monleys, who excelled in marching, constantly inspected the ranks, and Valimukba, Prajangba, Jambba and the monkey Rabbasa went about everywhere encouraging the Plavamgamas. Whilst

those lions among monkeys advanced on every side proud of their strength, they bebeld the great Mountain Sahya crowned with hundreds of trees and lakes and lovely pools covered with flowers. Under the command of **RAMA** of searing wrath, skirting the precincts of cities and public highways, that vast and terrible army of monkeys, like the ocean tide, surged forward with a thunderous sound. At the side of the son of **DASARATHA**, those heroic monkeys bounded forward with agility, like swift steeds urged on by the spur. And those foremost of men, borne on the shoulders of the monkeys, appesred beautiful like the sun and moon, in conjunction with those two great planets, Rahu and Ketu, and honoured by the King of the Monleys and **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA** accompanied by his army, proceeded towards the south. Then **LAKSHMANA**, mounted on **ANGADA**'s shoulders, spoke to **RAMA** who was accomplishing his design, in sweet accents, saying: " Having regained Vaidehi and slain **RAVANA** her abductor, behind the army, that is soft, health-giving and auspicious; birds and beasts emit cheetful and sonorous sounds ; all the quarters are serene and the sun shines clearly. Ushanas, Bhrigu's son, too, wears an auspicious aspea for thee, and the pole star is unaccompanied by adverse planets, the seven *Rishis*, pure and btilliant, circumambulating it. Before us shines the grandsire of the high-souled lkshvakus, the immacu late Trishanku accompanied by his priest ; and the twin Vishakas, our racial star, gleam free from obstruction. " Nairrita, the ruling star of the titans, is bsdly aspected and in opposition to the rising planet Dhumaketu, presaging the ovetthrow of the titans. Those about to die, in their last hour, become a prey to Grabs. The water of the Jakes is fresh and tasteS sweet, the woods are laden with fruit, fragrant breezes blow softly and the trees are flowering out of season, O Lord I The army of the monkeys looks splendid in its formations, like the Celestial Host at the destruction of Taraka.

Surveying the whole scene, O Noble One, thou shouldst experience supreme delight ! " Thus did Saumitri speak in gay tones to his elder brother in order to console him and meantime the army of the monkeys advanced, covering the eatth. The dust raised by those mighty bears and monkeys, furnished with nails and claws, enveloped the whole eatth and the splendour of the sun obscured. Like a mass of cloud enveloping the sky, that monkey army advanced in solid formation encompassing the southern region. As they pressed on mile on mile, crossing the rivers and streams against the current, they traversed many leagues in one stretch. Resting by Jakes of pure water, passing over mountains covered with forests, across plains, through woods laden with fruit, skirting them or passing through the centre, they went on, covering the entire earth, and their countenances manifesting joy, they ran with the swiftness of the wind. AU those monkeys were zealous in **RAMA**'s service, each vying with the other in high spirits, vigour and prowess. Some, proud of their youth and supple limbs, increased their pace, running with extreme speed and executing handsprings and some of those rangers of the woods shouted KiJa ! Kila ! ' lashing their taila and stamping on the eatth whilst others with II upraised arms broke off the trees and rocks here and there or climbed to the summit of the mountains like true mountaineers. Emitting loud cries and roaring, they frequently tore down handfuls of creepers with their thighs. In their energy, with their jaws set, some juggled with rocks and trees. It was by hundreds and thousands and millions that these formidable monkeys covered the earth with their splendour ; and that great army of monkeys, full of energy, proceeding under **SUGRIVA**'s orders, eager for battle and anxious to deliver **SITA**, did not linger even for an instant. Then **RAMA**, seeing the Sahira and Malaya Mountains with their dense woodlands frequented by various kinds of wild animals and marvellous forests, streams and rivers,

went towards them, and the monkeys broke down Champaka, Tilaka, Cuta, Praseka, Sindubaraka, Tinisha, Karavira, Ashoka, Karanja, Plaksha, Nyagrodha, Jambuka and Amlaka Trees, and, seated on those enehanring plateaus, the forest trees shaken by the wind covered them with ftowers. A soft breeze, fresh and perfumed with sandal, blew while the bees hummed in the nectar scented woods. From this mountain, rich in ore, the dust raised by those monkeys enveloped that immense army on all sides. On the smiling mountain slopes, Ketaka Trees, Sinduvara, charming Vasanti, scented Madhavi, clumps of Jasmine, Shiribilva, Madhuka, Vanjula, Vankula, Ranjaka, Tilaka Nagavriksha, all in ftower, with Cuta, Patalika, Kovidara, Muchulinda, Arjuna, Shimshapa, Kutaja, Hintala, Tinisha, Shurnakha, Nipaka, the blue Ashoka, Sarala, Ankola and Padmaka Trees bloomed and teemed with monkeys disporting themselves there. Enchanting lakes and pools, frequented by waterfowl, ducks and herons, were to be found on that mountain, which was the haunt of boars, deer, bears, hyenas, lions and tigers inspiring terror, and innumerable venomous snakes infested it. Kumudas, Utpalas and many other 1lowers embellished the lakes, and 1locb of hirds of various kinds sang on that mountain side. Having bathed in those waters and quenched their thirst, the monkeys began to disport themselves and splashing one another, climbing the mountain, they plucked the delicious ftuilll as fragrant as ' Amrita ' and the and ftowers from the trees. Yellow as honey themselves, they, delighted, feasted on the combs, a ' dtona ' in size, which were suspended from the uees, and, shaking the lovely branches and letting them spring back again, they tore down the creepers ; some drunk with nectar, dancing joyfully as they continued on their way; some climbed the treeS, others quenched their thirst and the whole earth, covered with monkeys, resembled a field of ripe corn. Reaching the Mahendra Mountain, the long-armed **RAMA**, whose eyes resembled

lotus petals, climbed to the summit adorned with various trees and from that peak, the elder son of King Dasaratba beheld tbat vast sea with illl rising waves full of fish and turtle. Having crossed the Sahya and Malaya Mountains, the army halted in their ranks along the shores of the sea with illl thunder ing waves. Then tbat foremost of men, **RAMA**, descended from the heighlll and accompanied by **LAKSHMANA** and **SUGRIVA**, quickly entered a lovely wood on the shores of the ocean and reaching that immense strand strewn with boulders, washed by the billowing waves, he spoke thus : " O **SUGRIVA**, we have reached the abode of **VARUNA** ; now we should consider the maner with which we were formerly preoccupied. This ocean, the Lord of Rivers, with illl vast expanse, is impossible to cross unless some special course be adopted. Let us camp here therefore and deliberate on the means by which we can transport the army to the further shore." Speaking thus, tbat long-armed hero, who had been rendered desolate by **SITA**'s abduction, approached the sea and issued orders for the troops quartering. " Let the whole army pitch their camp on the shore, O Lion among Monkeys ! The time bas come to take counsel and devise some way to cross the main ; let every leader remain with his forces and, under no preteXt whatever, shall he leave them; meantime they should find out if any ambush has been laid by the enemy." At Ramo's command, **SUGRIVA**, assisted by **LAKSHMANA**, caused his forces to camp on the shore which was covered with trees and the monkey host looked resplendent like a second ocean 13 whose waves were yellow as honey. Reaching that wooded shore those lions of monkeys encamped, eager to reach the funher side of the ocean; and the tumult caused by those forces pitching their tents could be heard above the roating of the sea. That vast army of monkeys, commanded by **SUGRIVA**, ranged in thtee divisions, wete deeply concerned with the accomplish ment of **RAMA**'s mission and, from the

shore where they were stationed, the monkey host gazed with delight on the vast ocean lashed by the tempest. Then those leaders of monkeys surveyed that abode of **VARUNA** of limitless expanse, whose distant shore was inhabited by titans. Rendered formidable by the ferocity of its sharks and crocodiles, that ocean, with its foaming waves at the close of day and the approach of night, appeared to laugh and dance. When the moon rose, whose image was reflecred limitlessly in its bosom, the ocean surged, swarming with gigantic sharks, whales and great fish, strong like the tempest, and it was fathomless, abounding in serpents of flaming coils and many aquatic animals and reefs. In that ocean, difficult to cross, whose ways wete impassable, haunted by titanS, the waves, in which sharks and sea monsters swarmed, rose and fell joyfully, whipped into motion by the breeze. Emitting sparks and turbulent with its gleaming reptiles, the ocean, that dread refuge of the enemies of the Gods, the eternal region of hell, resembled the sky and there seemed no difference between them. The waters simulated the firmament and the firmament the waters, both manifesting the same appearance with the stars above and the pearls below with which they were filled and, one with its racing clouds and the other with its squadrons of waves, caused the sea and sky to look identical. As wave clashed against wave without pause, the King of Rivers emitted a terrific clamour like the souud of the beating of great gongs in the sky. With its murmuring waves, its innumerable pearls and its monsters as it were pursuing it like a pack of hounds, the ocean, in the grip of a hurricane, seemed to leap excitedly. And the magnanimous monkeys surveyed that ocean lashed by the winds and the waves which, whipped by its blast, seemed to groan. Struck with astonishment, those monkeys regarded the sea with its dashing waves, roDing on and on. CHAPTER S **RAMA** is ajflieted rohm lhinki'"f of **SITA** ON the northern shore, the army under the command of

Nila halted and the generals, Mainda and Dvivida, foremost among the monkeys, patrolled up and down and on all sides in order to protect the monkey host. The army being thus encamped on the shores of the Lord of the WaterS, **RAMA**, observing **LAKSHMANA** standing at his side, said to him : " Sorrow invariably decreases with the passing of time but in the absence of my beloved, mine increases daily ! Not that my sufferings are caused by separation from my companion nor my misforrune by her abduction, wbat I deplore is that her youth is slipping away. O Breeze, speed to tbat place where my beloved is and, baving caressed her, touch me, thus causing me the same delight that a weary traveller experiences when gazing on the moon l Tbat which consumes my limbs as though I bad swallowed poison, is the cry of my dear one, while being borne away, ' Help, O Thou who an my defender ! ' With my separation from her as the coals and my thoughts of her as the shimmeting flames, the fire of my love consumes my body day and night l " O **LAKSHMANA**, remain here while I plunge into the sea ere I sleep, so that the fire of my distress shall cease from tormenting me. It is enough that she and I sleep on the same eanh. As dry land draws nourishment for its vegetation from marshy ground, so do I exist in the knowledge that **SITA** still lives I O When shall I, baving overcome mine enemies, behold her of graceful limbs, whose eyes resemble lotus petals, the equal of Shri herself? When, gently raising her lotus-like face with its ravishing lips and reeth, shall I drink in her glances, as a sick man the nectar of immonality ? When will that playful maiden embrace me, her round and quivering breasts like unto Tala IS

CHAPTER 5

Rama is afflicted when thinking of Sita

CHAPTER S **RAMA** is ajflieted rohm lhinki'"f of **SITA** ON the northern shore, the army under the command of Nila halted and the generals, Mainda and Dvivida, foremost among the monkeys, patrolled up and down and on all sides in order to protect the monkey host. The army being thus encamped on the shores of the Lord of the WaterS, **RAMA**, observing **LAKSHMANA** standing at his side, said to him : " Sorrow invariably decreases with the passing of time but in the absence of my beloved, mine increases daily ! Not that my sufferings are caused by separation from my companion nor my misforrune by her abduction, wbat I deplore is that her youth is slipping away. O Breeze, speed to tbat place where my beloved is and, baving caressed her, touch me, thus causing me the same delight that a weary traveller experiences when gazing on the moon l Tbat which consumes my limbs as though I bad swallowed poison, is the cry of my dear one, while being borne away, ' Help, O Thou who an my defender ! ' With my separation from her as the coals and my thoughts of her as the shimmeting flames, the fire of my love consumes my body day and night l " O **LAKSHMANA**, remain here while I plunge into the sea ere I sleep, so that the fire of my distress shall cease from tormenting me. It is enough that she and I sleep on the same eanh. As dry land draws nourishment for its vegetation from marshy ground, so do I exist in the knowledge that **SITA** still lives I O When shall I, baving overcome mine enemies, behold her of graceful limbs, whose eyes resemble lotus petals, the equal of Shri herself? When, gently raising her lotus-like face with its ravishing lips and reeth, shall I drink in her glances, as a sick man the nectar of immonality ? When will that playful maiden embrace me, her round and quivering breasts like unto Tala IS fruits pressed against my body, like sovereignty united with prosperity ? " Alas I Though I am her suppon, thst dark-eyed princess, who has fallen among the titanS, resembles an orphan ! How

can it be thst the daughter of **JANAKA**, my beloved, is now in the midst of titanS, she, the daughter-in-law of Dasaraths ? “When I have put those demons to llight, Sits will live anew as the autumnal moon shines fonh again when the clouds are scattered. By nature slender, Sits, on account of grief, fasting and circumstance, is now a shadow of her former self. " When, with my shafts piercing the breast of thst King of Titans, shall I empty my bean of sorrow ? When shall I behold the virtuous Sits, resembling a daughter of the Gods, her arms encircling my neck, shedding tears of joy ? When, like a soiled garment, shall I discard the pain bom of my separation from Maithili ? " As the sagacious Ranta was thus lamenting, the day declined and the disc of the sun, diminishing slowly, disappeared below the horizon. Thereupon Ranta, whom **LAKSHMANA** soughr to console, his mind still engaged in the thought of Sits, whose eyes were as large as lotus petals, distracted by grief, performed his evening devotions.

CHAPTER 6

Ravana consults his Subjects

IN the face of the terrible and awe-inspiring feat executed in Lanka by **HANUMAN** who was the equal of lndra in prowess, the King of the Titans, discomfited, with bowed head addressed his subjects, saying : " Lanka, hitherto inaccessible, has been laid waste by a mere monkey wbo has had converse with the daughter of **JANAKA**, Sits. Overthrowing the palaces and slaying the foremost of the titanS, he has turned the city upside down, such is **HANUMAN**’s achievement I What should I do now ? May prosperity attend you I What plan do you consider fitting fot me to 16 adopt first ? Say what you hold to be proper for us to do and which

will be to our advantage I “The wise affirm that good counsel is the root of victory, that is why, O Brave Ones, I desire to consult you concerning **RAMA**. “There are three kinds of meo in the world, the good, the had and the mediocre. I will describe the qualities and defects of them all to you : “He, who in his deliberations consults experieoced counsellors, his frieods with whom he shares common interests, his relatives and his superiors and theo pursues his design with eoergy and the help of God, is considered to be the foremost of men. " He, who eoters into deliberation aod pursues his dury by himself single-handedly, accomplishing that which should be accomplished, is considered a mediocre mao. " He, who fails to weigh the advantages aod disadvantages of a matter aod refuses God’s aid, merely saying ' I shall do it ', disregards his duty and is considered the least of meo I " Just as there are always those who are superior, those who are mediocre and those who are inferior among meo, so there exists also good, bad and indi1£erent counsel. “That judgemeotwhich is giveo afteraclear-sightedenmina tion of the question and to which, re-inforced by scriptural authority, the counsellors agree, is considered excelleot. “Those deliberations, where unanimity is finally reached after innumerable discussions, are considered mediocre, and those in which each person continues to stand by his own opinion aod opposes those of others and where no conclusion can be reached, are considered pernicious. Therefore an undertaking that follows on wise deliberation will succeed. " You, who are all emineotly sagacious, must decide what should be done and I will subscribe to it. **RAMA**, surrounded by thousands of heroic monkeys, is advancing on Lanka to exterminate us. Undoubtedly Raghava will cross the ocean with ease by virtue of his natural powers and be followed by his younger brother and the monkey host. He is able to dry up the sea through his valour or he may use aome

other means (*to bridge the ocean*). In view of **RAMA**'s attack on you with those monkeys, do you devise some plan to protect the ciry and the army!"

CHAPTER 7

The Titans persuade Ravana to make War and remind him of his former Exploits

Powerful titans, in their ignorance, instilled him with contempt for the enemy and with joined palms, offered him ill-considered advice, saying : " O King, we possess a vast army furnished with maces, spears, swords, lances, harpoons and barbed dans, why art thou apprehensive ? Didst thou not enter Bhogavati, having overcome the Serpent Race in war ? Didst thou not subdue Dhanada, who inhabited the summit of Mt Kailasha, surrounded as he was by Y akshas, creating a terrible carnage amongst them ? Though be regarded himself as the Lord of Men and prided himself on his friendship with Mahadeva, in thy wtath thou didst vanquish him on the field of battle. " O Foremost among the Titans, Maya, the Lord of the Danavas in fear gave his daughter to thee in wedlock and thou didst also subjugate the powerful and arrogant giant, Madhu, the joy of Kumbhinasi ! Descending into the nether regions thou didst defeat the Serpents Vasuki, Takshab, Shankha and Jati despite their irresistible power, courage and the boons conferred ou them, O Lord! After fighting for a whole year, confident though they were in their own strength, thou didst force them to submit to thy yoke and learnt the science of magic from them, O King of the Titans, Vanquisher ofthyFoesl " O Great Heru, the valiant sons of **VARUNA** were defeated by thee in the open field as also the fourfold army attending on them,

and thou didst descend into the vast ocean, that dark region, whose sceptre is the aquatic world, his crown the Shalmali The earth was peopled with innumerable and valiant watriots, equal to lndra in prowess, resembling giant trees, yet thou didst destroy those invincible heroes! Raghava is neither their equal in courage, virtue nor in might I Yet do thou remain here, O Great King, why fatigue thyself? Indtajita is able to exterminate those monkeys single-handed. That prince, O Great Sovereign, returning from a sacrifice to Maheshwara, who is surpassed by none, received a boon from him not easily obtainable in this world and, approaching that divine sea, whose fish are lances and spears, which abounds in weapons for its trees, whose turtles are the elephants and whose frogs are the teeming hotses, whose cetaceans are the Adityas and Maruts, its great serpents the Vasus, its waters the chariots, steeds and elephants, the sandy banks its infantry, that vast ocean of the Celestial Hosts, lndrajita approached, in order to bear away their king and bring him to Lanka. Thereafter that Monarch was liberated by the command of the Grandsire of the World and the Vanquisher' of Shambara and Vritra rerumed to his abode where all the Gods paid homage to him. " Therefore let thy son, Indrajita, go forth and destroy the army of the monkeys and **RAMA** also, O King ; it is not worthy of thee to imagine harm can come from common persons, such thoughts should not even enter thy mind for assuredly thou shalt bring about **RAMA**'s end ! "

CHAPTER 8

The boasting of Ravana's Generals

THEN the heroic general, the Titan Prahasta, who resembled a dark cloud, joined his palms together and expressed himself thus: " We are able to overcome the *Devas*, Danavas, Gandharvas, Pisachas, Patagas and Uragas in the open field, how much more those two mortals ! “Under the in11uence of liquor and trusting in our own strength, we sulfered ourselves to be deceived by **HANUMAN** but as long as I live, that ranger of the woods will not enter here again alive, I shall sweep the land surrounded by the sea clean of monkeys together with its hills, forests and jungles ; thou bast but to issue the command I I shall rid thee of that monkey, O Ranger of the Night and thou shalt not have to suffer on account of thine offenceY Thereafter Durmukha, in his tum, spoke in measured tones, saying: " Assuredly we shall not tolerate this outrage that he has committed against us all. The devastation of the city and the palaces and the insult offered to our sovereign by this monkey shall be avenged by me. Serting out alone, I shall merminate those monkeys, whether they have taken refuge in the dreadful deep, in heaven or in hell ! , Then the powerful Vajradamshtra, in a transport of rage, began to speak, brandishing a huge mace stained with ftesh and blood, and said : " What is that puny and miserable monkey, **HANUMAN**, to us as long as the mighty **RAMA**, **SUGRIVA** and **LAKSHMANA** exist? This very day, I shall return, having slain **RAMA**, **SUGRIVA** and **LAKSHMANA** single-handed with the blows of my mace and routed that army of monkeys, or, if it pleaseth thee, hear this further plan of mine ; he, who is resourceful, may easily over come his adversaries. " Thousands of titans, able to change their shape at will, courageous, invincible, of terrifying aspect, are devoted to thee. Let them, assuming human form, present themselves before Kakutstha, foremost of the Raghus, and, full of confidence, say to him: " We are here on behalf of **BHARATA**, thy younger brother’, whereupon **RAMA**, summoning his forces will

instantly come hither ; then armed with lances, picks and maces, carrying bows, arrows and swords in our hands, we will set out with speed from here and meet him. Thereafter, stationed in battalions in the air, we will ezterminate that army of monkeys under a hail of rocks and shafts and send them to the reginn of **YAMA**. Should they fall into the trap, it will prove disastrous for them and **RAMA** and Labhmana will inevitably lose their lives." Then the son of Kumbbakama, the valiant and powerful Nikumbba, in the height of anger, said in the presence of **RAVANA**, the destroyer of the worlds : " Let all of you remain here with our great king ; by myself I sball slay Ragbava, **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA** and also **HANUMAN** and all the monkeys." Thereafter in his turn, a titan named Vajrabanu, as tall as a mountain, who, in his wrath, was licking his lips, took up the tale, saying : " Free from all anxiety, occupy yourselves with those things which afford you entertainment, single-banded I shall consume the entire monkey host. Remain here at ease and drink wine'; alone I shall slay **SUGRIVA**, **LAKSHMANA** and also **HANUMAN**, **ANGADA** and all the monkeys."

CHAPTER 9

Bibishana advises Ravana to send back Sita

THE Generals Rabbasa, the mighty Suryasbatru, Saptagbna, Yajnakopa and Mabaparshwa, Mahodeva, the irrespressible Agniketu and the Titan Rashiketu, the lusty Indrasbatu, son of **RAVANA**, also Prabasta, Vimpaksba and the exceedingly powerful Vajradamshtra, Dhumraksba, Nikumbba and the Titan Durmukba, brandishing maces, harpoons, lances, darts, spears, axes, bows furnished with arrows and swords ahining like a great expanse of water, all of whom were blasing

with anger addressed **RAVANA** saying : " To-day we sball slay **RAMA**, **SUGRIVA** and **LAKSHMANA** as also that wretch **HANUMAN** who laid Lanb waste I " Then Bibisbana, restraining those who bad seized hold of their weapons, persuaded them to be seated and spoke thus with joined palms : " My Dear Brother, the wise a1lirm that when the end which THE RAMA YANA OF VALMIKI when force should be employed are determined by the tacticians. O Friend, deeds of valour which have been tested according to prescribed injunctions, succeed against those who arc careless when attacked, or who arc in opposition to the divine power. Now, **RAMA** is on his guard, he is eager for victory, he is upheld by divine power, he has subdued his passions and is invincible, yet you seek to defeat him. " When **HANUMAN** crossed the ocean, that formidable Lord of Streams and Rivers, who could have conceived or even imagined the path he would take ? Our adversary has immense resources and troops at his disposal O Rangers of the Night, you should in no way disregard him ! What wrong has the illustrious **RAMA** ever done to the King of the Titans that he should go to Janasthana and bear away the consort of that great One ? " If Khara, who had trespassed into a region that was not his own, was slain in combat by **RAMA**, is it not legitimate for every one to defend his life? It is on account of Vaidchi's abduction that we arc in this great peril and we should therefore yield her up. What advantage is there in continuing the quarrel? Nay, it is not proper to enter into hostilities with that powerful and virtnous prince, who would never initiate warfare without a definite cause. Therefore do you give hack Maithili to him ere he, by means of his arrows, destroys this city abounding in wealth of every kind with its horses and elephants ! Before that formidable and mighty monkey host attack this, our Lanka, do you give back **SITA**. Lanka with all her heroic titans will perish unless the beloved consort of **RAMA** is voluntarily returned to him. " I

adjure you by the blood that unites us to follow my counsel, which is salutory. Return Maithili to **RAMA** ere he looses his shafts for your destruction, which are freshly sharpened, steely, infallible, plumed and bright as the autumnal sun. Give back Maithili to the son of **DASARATHA** without delay ; renounce a resentment which destroys all felicity and virtue and pursue righteousness which increases well-being and glory. Be pacified, that we may live in tranquillity with our sons and kinsfolk. Give back Maithili to **DASARATHA**'s son I " Thus spoke Bibishans, and **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, dismissing them all, entered his private apartments . .z.z CHAPTER Bibishana insists that **SITA** should be giflen back to **RAMA** As the day dawned, Bibishana, renowned for his exploits, fixed in the knowledge of what was just and profitable, entered the palace of the King of the Titans which resembled a mass of crags like unto the peak of a mountain. That vast area was the resort of the great ; wcll ordered and divided, it was inhabited by learned persons and guarded by loyal and vigilant titans on all sides. Re-echoing to the sound of the wind blended with the trumpeting of intoxicated elephants, the blare of conches and the blasts of trumpets, groups of lovely girls filled the alleys with their chartering. Its gates were of pure gold enriched by magnificent decorations resembling the abode of the Gan dharvas or the mansions of the Maruts, and it contained heaps of gems like unto the Serpents dwcllings. Then that One of exceeding energy and renown entered the palace of his elder brother, as the sun of sparkling raya enters a cloud, and he heard the blessings invoked on his brother for his victory uttered in a loud voice by those versed in the Veda. And he beheld those priests instructed in the science of 'Manuas' and the Veda, worshipped with vessels of curda, clarified butter, flowers and hulled rice. Thereafter the mighty armed Bibisbana, duly honoured by the titans, observed the younger brother of the Bcstower of Riches',

who was seated there. Approaching the throne that was covered with gold, embclliahed by the person of the king, he paid homage, extending fitting courtesies to him and took the seat indicated by **RAVANA**'s glance. Thereafter he addressed the mighty Dashagriva in the presence of his ministers alone and, standing before him, with soothing speech sought to pacify him, manifesting his knowledge of time and place, and expressed himself thus : " O Subduer of thy Foes, ever since Vaidcbi was brought here, inauspicious omens have been observed I The sacrificial fire emits sparks and its brightness is dimmed by smoke ;

CHAPTER 10

Bibishana insists that Sita should be given back to Rama

CHAPTER Bibishana insists that **SITA** should be giflen back to **RAMA** As the day dawned, Bibishana, renowned for his exploits, fixed in the knowledge of what was just and profitable, entered the palace of the King of the Titans which resembled a mass of crags like unto the peak of a mountain. That vast area was the resort of the great ; wcll ordered and divided, it was inhabited by learned persons and guarded by loyal and vigilant titans on all sides. Re-echoing to the sound of the wind blended with the trumpeting of intoxicated elephants, the blare of conches and the blasts of trumpets, groups of lovely girls filled the alleys with their chartering. Its gates were of pure gold enriched by magnificent decorations resembling the abode of the Gan dharvas or the mansions of the Maruts, and it contained heaps of gems like unto the Serpents dwcllings. Then that One of exceeding energy and renown entered the palace of his elder brother, as the sun of sparkling raya enters a cloud,

and he heard the blessings invoked on his brother for his victory uttered in a loud voice by those versed in the Veda. And he beheld those priests instructed in the science of 'Manuas' and the Veda, worshipped with vessels of curda, clarified butter, flowers and hulled rice. Thereafter the mighty armed Bibisbana, duly honoured by the titans, observed the younger brother of the Bcstower of Riches', who was seated there. Approaching the throne that was covered with gold, embclliahed by the person of the king, he paid homage, extending fitting courtesies to him and took the seat indicated by **RAVANA**'s glance. Thereafter he addressed the mighty Dashagriva in the presence of his ministers alone and, standing before him, with soothing speech sought to pacify him, manifesting his knowledge of time and place, and expressed himself thus : " O Subduer of thy Foes, ever since Vaidcbi was brought here, inauspicious omens have been observed I The sacrificial fire emits sparks and its brightness is dimmed by smoke ; impure vapours arise therefrom even after the oblations have been poured to the accompaniment of sacred formulas nor docs it bum in a proper manner. In the kitchens, sscred pavilions and the halls, where the Vedas are recited, reptiles are to be found and ants are discovered in the sacrificial offerings. The milk of the kine has dried up, ichor no longer flows from the strongest of the elephants, horses find no satisfaction in their fodder and neigh incessantly, while the asses, bu1lillo and mules, their hair standing on end, shed tears, and, though ministered to by experts, do not behave normally, O King. " Fierce crows gather together from all sides, emitting harsh cries and are seen swarming on the roofs of the temples. Vultures plane mournfully over the city and at dusk, jackals appear howling lugubriously. Wild beasts and deer assemble at the gates of the city, setting up an ominous noise to the accompaniment of growls. These omens indicate that thy fault should be expiated as the Lord thinks

proper by returning Vaidehi to Raghava. “If, through error or expediency, I have given cause for offence, thou shouldst not condemn me, O Great Monarch I All thy people, both male and female and thy court allirm that the fault is thine I It is through feat that thy ministers dare not counsel thee but I feel compelled to inform thee of what I have seen and heard. Judge what thou considerest to be right and act accordingly.” Thus spoke Bibishana in measured words to his brother, **RAVANA**, Lord of the Titans, in the presence of the ministers, and, hearing that judicious, reasonable, moderate and logical speech, productive of grest good for the past, present and future, **RAVANA**, who had conceived a passion for **SITA**, answered with mounting anger, saying : " I see no cause for fear anywhere ! Rarna shall never regain Maithili I Even were **LAKSHMANA**’s elder brother upheld by the Gods with **INDRA** at their head, how could he withatand me in the field?” Having spoken thus, that destroyer of Celestial Hosts, Dashagriva, who was endowed with terrific strength and cmeme prowess in combat, dismissed his brother Bibishana of frank speech. CHAPTER ilafJfJ714 summons his Asstmlbly THAT unrighteous monarch, a slave to his passion, diSiegarding his real friends, in consequence of his evil act began to suffer decrease. His lustful desire exceeding all bounds, his thoughts con stantly occupied with Vaidehi, though the occasion for war was lacking, with his ministerS conceived that the time for entering into hostilities had come. Thereupon, sallying forth, he ascended his mighty chariot plated with gold, encrusted with corsl and pearl and harnessed to well-trained horses. Seated in that excellent car, which reverberated like thunder, Dashagriva, the foremost of titans drove to the plaoe of assembly. Titans with swords, bucklers and every kind of weapon preceded their king on the highway, some garbed in attire covered with every kind of gem marched at his side or followed in his wake, and they

surrounded him on all sides. The foremost of the car-warriors speedily precipitated them selves in his vanguard with their chariots or on great elephants intoxicated with Mada juice or horses which they caused to rear. Brandiahing maces and crowbars, they held picks and darts in their hands. As **RAVANA** approached the assembly, the sound of innumerable musical instruments could be heard and the blare of trumpets broke forth to the accompaniment of the rolling of vehicles whilst the great chariot of that **INDRA** of Demona passed along the splendidly decorated highway. The canopy, that was held over his head, shone with an immaculate purity, resembling the king of the stars at his full, and two fans of Yaks tails with crystal handles and golden fringes were waved to and fro from le.tl: to right. All the titans having alighted, stood with joined palms and bowed heads in homage to their king who was seated in his car. :as

CHAPTER 11

Ravana summons his Assembly

CHAPTER ilafJfJ714 summons his Asstmlbly THAT unrighteous monarch, a slave to his passion, diSiegarding his real friends, in consequence of his evil act began to suffer decrease. His lustful desire exceeding all bounds, his thoughts con stantly occupied with Vaidehi, though the occasion for war was lacking, with his ministerS conceived that the time for entering into hostilities had come. Thereupon, sallying forth, he ascended his mighty chariot plated with gold, encrusted with corsl and pearl and harnessed to well-trained horses. Seated in that excellent car, which reverberated like thunder, Dashagriva, the foremost of titans drove to the plaoe of assembly. Titans with swords, bucklers

and every kind of weapon preceded their king on the highway, some garbed in attire covered with every kind of gem marched at his side or followed in his wake, and they surrounded him on all sides. The foremost of the car-warriors speedily precipitated them selves in his vanguard with their chariots or on great elephants intoxicated with Mada juice or horses which they caused to rear. Brandiahing maces and crowbars, they held picks and darts in their hands. As **RAVANA** approached the assembly, the sound of innumerable musical instruments could be heard and the blare of trumpets broke forth to the accompaniment of the rolling of vehicles whilst the great chariot of that **INDRA** of Demona passed along the splendidly decorated highway. The canopy, that was held over his head, shone with an immaculate purity, resembling the king of the stars at his full, and two fans of Yaks tails with crystal handles and golden fringes were waved to and fro from le.tl: to right. All the titans having alighted, stood with joined palms and bowed heads in homage to their king who was seated in his car. :as Amidst acclamations and aies of triumph from those titans, that scourger of his foes made his solemn enuy into the assembly hall that had been constructed by Vishvakarma. The floor was of refined gold and six hundred evil spirits guarded it. Into that excellent audience hall, a masterpiece of Vishvakarma, **RAVANA** made his enuy sparkling with magnifi cence and seated himaelf on a gorgeous throne wrought of emeralds, carpeted with skins of deer and furnished with thick cushions. Thereupon he issued his orders imperiously to exceedingly fleet messengers, saying : " Summon the titans hither with all speed ! " thereafter adding, " A great blow is about to be struck by the enemy ! " Hearing this command, his envoys dispersed to search throughout Lanka, entering every house and scouring the high ways and pleasure resorts, assembling the titans without ceremony. Some started out in

excellent chariots, some on swift and mettlesome horses or elephants and some on foot. The city was thronged with cars, elephants and horses and resembled the sky filled with birds. Then they abandoned their mounts and chariots of every kind in order to enter the audience chamber and they resembled lions penetrating into a rocky cavern. Having, each in turn, paid homage to the feet of the king, they took up their positions, some on seats, some on cushions, some on the ground, and gathering in that hall at his command they grouped themselves according to rank round their sovereign, the Lord of the Titans. They came in hundreds ; ministers distinguished for their skiD in dealing with affairs and talented sagacious counseUors able to view all with the eye of understanding ; warriors also in great numbers gathered in the hall that sparkled with gold, in order to prepare for the success of their campaign. At that moment, arriving in a magnificent chariot, its various Tbe titans were adorned with fine gold and every kind of ornament, arrayed in rich vestures, and the fragrance of aloes and rare sandalwood from their garlands perfumed the hall on every side. Neither harsh accents nor ill-advised utterances nor loud whisperings could be heard in the assembly and, their desires crowned, all those titans of extreme prowess fixed their eyes on the face of their sovereign. In the midst of those skilled warriors full of energy, the intelligent **RAVANA** appeared resplendent in that assembly like unto the God with the Thunderbolt amongst the Vasus. CHAPTER The Discourse betr.oeen Rtwana and **KUMBHAKARNA** THEN **RAVANA**, the conqueror of hostile armies, let his gaze wander over the assembly and addressing himself to the General of his forces, Prahasta, said : " O General, it is for thee, who art conversant with the four branches of strategy, to dispose of thy forces in the way that the defence of the city demands."' Thereupon Prahasta, alert to his sovereign’s behests and eager to carry them out, distributed the

whole of his troops within and without the fortress and, having disposed of his entire army in the city's defence, he returned to his seat in front of the king and said: " O Mighty Lord, I have stationed thy forces within and without the city, now accomplish that which thou hast resolved to do speedily and without anxiety I " At these words of Prahasta's, that monarch, who aspired to happiness and who was devoted to the public welfare, expressed himself thus amidst his followers : " Should duty, plessure or self-interest endanger whatever is plessant or unpleasant, whether it be in prosperity or adversiry,

CHAPTER 12

The Discourse between Ravana and Kumbhakarna

The titans were adorned with fine gold and every kind of ornament, arrayed in rich vestures, and the fragrance of aloes and rare sandalwood from their garlands perfumed the hall on every side. Neither harsh accents nor ill-advised utterances nor loud whisperings could be heard in the assembly and, their desires crowned, all those titans of extreme prowess fixed their eyes on the face of their sovereign. In the midst of those skilled warriors full of energy, the intelligent **RAVANA** appeared resplendent in that assembly like unto the God with the Thunderbolt amongst the Vasus. CHAPTER The Discourse betr.oeen Rtwana and **KUMBHAKARNA** THEN **RAVANA**, the conqueror of hostile armies, let his gaze wander over the assembly and addressing himself to the General of his forces, Prahasta, said : " O General, it is for thee, who art conversant with the four branches of strategy, to dispose of thy forces in the way that the defence of the city demands."' Thereupon Prahasta, alert to his sovereign's behests and eager to carry them out, distributed the

whole of his troops within and without the fortress and, having disposed of his entire army in the city's defence, he returned to his seat in front of the king and said: " O Mighty Lord, I have stationed thy forces within and without the city, now accomplish that which thou hast resolved to do speedily and without anxiety I " At these words of Prahasta's, that monarch, who aspired to happiness and who was devoted to the public welfare, expressed himself thus amidst his followers : " Should duty, plessure or self-interest endanger whatever is plessant or unpleasant, whether it be in prosperity or adversiry, gain or loss, whether useful or disadvmtageous, you are bound to point it out. No undertaking of mine, that I have engaged in with you, re-inforced by the recitation of sacred formulas, has ever proved fruitless I As the Msruts, the moon, the stars and the planets follow in Vasava's wake, so do you all follow me in a splendid procession assuring me of victory ! "In truth I intended to mobilize you all but, on account of Kumbbakarna being asleep, I have not pressed this tnatter I After sleeping for six months, the foremost of those bearing arms, has just risen. As regards the beloved consort of Ratna, the daughter of]onaka, I brought her here from the solitudes of theDandaka Forest which is frequented bytitans. That princess of languid pace does not wish to share my bed, though in the Three Worlds, I see none to compare with her. Slender waisted, with well developed hips, her countenance resembling the autumnal moon, she is like an image made of gold created by Msya.' Her palms are rosy, her feet are delicate and well set, her nails coppery and, seeing her, I am overcome with desire. Shining like the flame of the sacrificial fire she rivals the bright ness of the sun ; her face with its arched nose is flllwless and fair, her eyes beautiful. On beholding her I am no longer master of myself and become the slave of love. Torn between anger and delight, this passion has proved my undoing, the cause of tuin and the eternal source

of pain and suffering. In anticipation of the advent of her lord, Ratna, that lovely large eyed lady has solicited a year's grace of me and I have lOoted with favour on the request of that one of tender glances but, like unto a spent steed on the highway, I am weary of the pricks of passion. "How will those inhabitants of the woods cross the impassable ocean with the innumerable monsters that inhabit it and how can those two sons of **DASARATHA** traverse it ? The outcome of this enterprise is impossible to predict. Say what you think in this tnatter I A mere man causes no apprehension ; yet ponder on it carcfiJily I "Formerly, in the war between Gods and Titans, thanb to your support I was victorious and you are still ready to stand by me. " Having ascertained where **SITA** is, those princes, preceded by the monkeys with **SUGRIVA** at their head, have reached the shores of the sea. It is not for us to return **SITA** but to destroy the two sons of **DASARATHA**, therefore deliberate on this and adopt a judicious line of conduct. In truth, I know of none in the world who can overcome us, even should he cross the water with the monkeys ; victory is thertjre indubitably mine." Hearing the ramblings of that bashful lover, **KUMBHAKARNA** ftew into a transport of rage and said : " On first seeing **SITA**, the consort of **RAMA**, who is accom panied by **LAKSHMANA**, she who was brought here by force, thy mind was wholly possessed by her as the waters of the 1ake are filled by the Yamuna. O Great King, this conduct is not worthy of thee ! Thou shouldst have consulted us at the outset of this affair. The king who acquits himself of his obligations punctiliously, O Ten-faced One, and whose mind is concen trated on what he is about, has nor to repent later ! Those undertakings that are carried out carelessly and against the scriptural law turn out badly, like unto impure offerings poured into the sacrificial fire by those who are heedless. To seek to end where one should begin or to begin where one should conclude is to ignote what is proper and what is

nor. If an adversary examines the defects of one who is unrestrained, he soon discovers his weak points, as birds the fissures in the Krauncha Mountains. Thou didst make this assault without forethought and it is fortunate that **RAMA** did not slay thee, as poisoned food the eater thereof ! Nevertheless I shsll do my part in this campaign that thou dost contemplate launching against thine enemies, O lrteproachable One I I shall destroy thine adversaries, O Ranger of the Night, even as **INDRA**, Vivasvat, Pavaka, Maruta, Kuvera or **VARUNA** themselves, I shsll fight against them ! “Entering the combat with my enortnous body, the size of a mountain and my sharp reeth, roaring the while and brandishing my immense mace, I shall strike terror into Purandara himself I “Ere the foe can deliver a second blow, I shall drink his blood, therefore take comfort, for by slaying **DASARATHA**’s son I shall bring thee an auspicious victory I Having destroyed **RAMA** as a1ao **LAKSHMANA**, I shall devour all the monltcy leaders ! Enjoy 29 thyself therefore and drink the most excelleot of wines to the extent of thy desire without anXiety ; do what thou judgest to be best I “When I have despatched **RAMA** to the region of desth, **SITA** will be at thy disposal for ever.” CHAPTER. 13 **RAVANA** tells th4 Stary of th4 Nymph PulljikasthGla SEEING **RAVANA** wrought up with ire, the mighty General Mahaparshwa reflected a moment and, with joined palms, spoke thus: " He who, having penetrated into a wood frequented by wild bessts and serpents, does not partake of the honey he finds there, is a fool! “Who is thy master? Thou art the master, O Scourge of Thy Foes ! Enjoy thyself with Vaidehi, having placed thy foot on the hesd of thy foe I Act in the manner of a cock, O Valiant Prince I Approach **SITA** again and again in order to enjoy her and pass the time in dalliance with her. Having sated thy passion, what is there to fear ? Whether taken unawares or no, thou art well able to meet every exigency ! Without support **KUMBHAKARNA**

and Indrajita of immense energy, would be capable of challenging the God who bears the Thunderbolt armed with his mace I “Bestowal of gifts, conciliation and sowing dissension in the ranks of the enemy are the mesns of subduing them, aceording to the wise, but in the present circumstances, I incline to the uae of the fOUrth I O Lord, we shall subdue thy foes by the suengtb of our arms, do not doubt it I " Thus spoke Mahaparshwa and the king, thanking him, replied thus : " O Mahapatahwa, I will answer thee by recounting a strange adventure that befell me a long time ago. “While ahe was going to worship the Grandsire of the World, I came upon the nymph, Punjikasthala, flashing through the sky 3D

CHAPTER 13

Ravana tells the Story of the Nymph Punjikasthala

thyself therefore and drink the most excelleot of wines to the extent of thy desire without anXiety ; do what thou judgest to be best I “When I have despatched **RAMA** to the region of desth, **SITA** will be at thy disposal for ever.” CHAPTER. 13 **RAVANA** tells th4 Stary of th4 Nymph PulljikasthGla SEEING **RAVANA** wrought up with ire, the mighty General Mahaparshwa reflected a moment and, with joined palms, spoke thus: " He who, having penetrated into a wood frequented by wild bessts and serpents, does not partake of the honey he finds there, is a fool! “Who is thy master? Thou art the master, O Scourge of Thy Foes ! Enjoy thyself with Vaidehi, having placed thy foot on the hesd of thy foe I Act in the manner of a cock, O Valiant Prince I Approach **SITA** again and again in order to enjoy her and pass the time in dalliance with her. Having sated thy passion, what is there to fear ? Whether taken

unawares or no, thou art well able to meet every exigency ! Without support **KUMBHAKARNA** and Indrajita of immense energy, would be capable of challenging the God who bears the Thunderbolt armed with his mace I “Bestowal of gifts, conciliation and sowing dissension in the ranks of the enemy are the mesns of subduing them, aceording to the wise, but in the present circumstances, I incline to the uae of the fOUrth I O Lord, we shall subdue thy foes by the suengtb of our arms, do not doubt it I " Thus spoke Mahaparshwa and the king, thanking him, replied thus : " O Mahapatahwa, I will answer thee by recounting a strange adventure that befell me a long time ago. “While ahe was going to worship the Grandsire of the World, I came upon the nymph, Punjikasthala, flashing through the sky 3D like a !lame. I snipped her of her attire in order to deflower her, after which like a faded lotus she reached the abode of Swyambhu. The magnanimous Ordainer of the World, learning of the matter, addressed me in anger, saying : "' O **RAVANA**, from to-day, if thou dost violence to any other woman, thy head will be split into a hundred pieces, this is certain!' “This alarmed me and it is for this reason that I have not forced **SITA**, the Princess of Videha, to ascend the nuptual couch. My fury is like unto the sea and my speed resembles the wind hut the son of **DASARATHA** is unaware of it and it is on this account he has set out to fight me. Who would seek to waken a lion lying asleep in a hidden mountain den whose anger resembles the God of Death himself? “**RAMACHANDRA** has not seen my arrows in combat that resemble snakes with forked tongues, wherefore he is considering marching against me. From my bow, loosing my shafts that like unto lightning on him from a myriad sides, I shall speedily consume **RAMA**, as a forest is set on fire by flaming btands. I shall wipe out his army with mine, as the rising sun blots out the light of the stars. Neither Vasava of a thousand eyes nor **VARUNA**

can withstand me in battle! It was by the strength of mine that I conquered the city defended by Kuvcra!, CHAPTI!R Bihilluma blames 1M Attiltule uf Raw.tw.'s Courtiers PiuNCB BmiSHANA listened to the boasting of **RAVANA** and the thundering of Kumhhakarna and addressed the king in words that were profitable and sagacious, saying : " O King, why bast thou brought that great serpent in the form of **SITA** hither, her bteasts its coils, her anxieties its poison, her laughter its sharp fangs, her five fingers its five hoods ? While Lanb is yet not assailed by those monkeys, armed with their teeth and nails, who are as high as hills, give back Maithili to the son of **DASARATHA** I

CHAPTER 14

Bibishana blames the attitude of Ravana's Courtiers

like a !lame. I snipped her of her attire in order to deflower her, after which like a faded lotus she reached the abode of Swyambhu. The magnanimous Ordainer of the World, learning of the matter, addressed me in anger, saying : "' O **RAVANA**, from to-day, if thou dost violence to any other woman, thy head will be split into a hundred pieces, this is certain!' “This alarmed me and it is for this reason that I have not forced **SITA**, the Princess of Videha, to ascend the nuptual couch. My fury is like unto the sea and my speed resembles the wind hut the son of **DASARATHA** is unaware of it and it is on this account he has set out to fight me. Who would seek to waken a lion lying asleep in a hidden mountain den whose anger resembles the God of Death himself? “**RAMACHANDRA** has not seen my arrows in combat that resemble snakes with forked tongues, wherefore he is considering marching

against me. From my bow, loosing my shafts that like unto lightning on him from a myriad sides, I shall speedily consume **RAMA**, as a forest is set on fire by flaming btands. I shall wipe out his army with mine, as the rising sun blots out the light of the stars. Neither Vasava of a thousand eyes nor **VARUNA** can withstand me in battle! It was by the strength of mine that I conquered the city defended by Kuvcra!, CHAPTI!R Bihilluma blames 1M Attiltule uf Raw.tw.'s Courtiers PiuNCB BmiSHANA listened to the boasting of **RAVANA** and the thundering of Kumhhakarna and addressed the king in words that were profitable and sagacious, saying : " O King, why bast thou brought that great serpent in the form of **SITA** hither, her bteasts its coils, her anxieties its poison, her laughter its sharp fangs, her five fingers its five hoods ? While Lanb is yet not assailed by those monkeys, armed with their teeth and nails, who are as high as hills, give back Maithili to the son of **DASARATHA** I 31 “Neither Kumbhakama nor Indrajita, O King, neither Mahaparshwa nor Mahodara neither Nikumbha nor Kumbha nor yet Atikaya arc able to withstand **RAMA** on the field of battle I Thou wouldst never escape from **RAMA** alive even wert thou proteCted by Savitar or the Maruts or if thou didst take refuge violent by nature and whose actS are thoughtless, llattet him, as though you were his foes, to the destruction of the titans I Rescue and deliver that king who is held fast in the illimitable coils of a serpent possessed of a thousand hoods and who is formidable and of exceeding energy. It is for the sovereign’s friends, whose desires have been gratified by him, to save him, even were it by dragging him by the hair of his head, like one who has failcn a prey to fiends of immeasurable power. It is for you unitedly to rescue that monarch from the surging waters of the ocean **RAMA**, he who is sinking into the mouth of the Kakutstha hell ! " I will here repeat those words that are to the advantage of the city, the titans, the king and the host of courtiers I I

repeat them loyally and candidly ' Let Maithili be given back to that Prince!' “He who, having estimated the strength of his foes, his own resources, the situation and the loss and gain of his undertaking and, after mature reflection, expresses himself frankly and judiciously to his master, is a true counsellor.” CHAPTER IS Bihishana reproahes lndrajita jar his boastilf8 speech of Bibishana’s, who was equal to Brihaspati in wisdom, displeased the great lndrajita, Leader of the Nairrita Hosts, who replied to him thus : “What do these idle words fraught with fear signify, O Youngest of my Uncles ? None other, even were he the issue of another race than our own, would speak thus or even conceive such thoughts! Valour, courage, endurance, steadfastness, audacity and strength are lacking in Bibishana alone, the youngest brother of my sire. " Who uc, in fact, these two sons of a lting of men? One of us single-handed, were he the lcsst of the titans, would anllice to extcmlinate them both I O Coward, from whence springs thy fear? Was I not able to cast the Protector of the Tbrcc

CHAPTER 15

Bibishana reproaches Indrajita for his boasting

Violent by nature and whose actS are thoughtless, llattet him, as though you were his foes, to the destruction of the titans I Rescue and deliver that king who is held fast in the illimitable coils of a serpent possessed of a thousand hoods and who is formidable and of exceeding energy. It is for the sovereign’s friends, whose desires have been gratified by him, to save him, even were it by dragging him by the hair of his head, like one who has failcn a prey to fiends of immeasurable power. It is for you unitedly to rescue that monarch from the surging waters of the ocean

RAMA, he who is sinking into the mouth of the Kakutstha hell ! " I will here repeat those words that are to the advantage of the city, the titans, the king and the host of courtiers I I repeat them loyally and candidly ' Let Maithili be given back to that Prince!' “He who, having estimated the strength of his foes, his own resources, the situation and the loss and gain of his undertaking and, after mature reflection, expresses himself frankly and judiciously to his master, is a true counsellor.” CHAPTER IS Bihishana reproahes lndrajita jar his boastilf8 speech of Bibishana’s, who was equal to Brihaspati in wisdom, displeased the great lndrajita, Leader of the Nairrita Hosts, who replied to him thus : “What do these idle words fraught with fear signify, O Youngest of my Uncles ? None other, even were he the issue of another race than our own, would speak thus or even conceive such thoughts! Valour, courage, endurance, steadfastness, audacity and strength are lacking in Bibishana alone, the youngest brother of my sire. " Who uc, in fact, these two sons of a lting of men? One of us single-handed, were he the lcsst of the titans, would anllice to extcmlinate them both I O Coward, from whence springs thy fear? Was I not able to cast the Protector of the Tbrcc 33 Worlds to the ground, the Lord of the *Devas* himself? Struck with terror, the Hosts of the Gods scattered in all directions and the loudly trumpeting Airavata was brought down by me, whose tusks I rooted our, dispersing the celestial armies by my valour. I who humbled the pride of the Gods themselves and a11licted the Dairyas, am I in mine immeasurable eoergy not able to subdue these two princes, insignificant mortals as they are ? " At this speech of that invincible and powerful rival of lndra, Bibishana the foremost of warriors answered him in words fraught with good seose, saying : " My Child, thy reflections are worthless ! Thou art young and thine intellect is not ripe ; further, to our ruin, thou art incapable of ascertaining what is expedieot and inexpedieot. " Under the

guise of a son, O lndrajita, thou art in truth a hiddeo foe to **RAVANA** and, hearing him prate of slaying Raghava, thou dost support him. Thou dost merit death, as also he who had the grievous idea of bringing thee here this day and intro ducing a youthful, rash and arrogant warrior into an assembly of counsellors I O lndrajita, thou art thoughdess, imprudent, feeble of intellect, thy mind ruined by folly and extreme frivolity and thou speakest thus from childishness. Who can withstand the shock of those shining arrows which Raghava looses in combat resembling the Rod of **BRAHMA**, like unto fate or the Sceptre of **YAMA**? Do thou give back **SITA** to **RAMA** with treasure, pearls, rich omameots, celestial attire and gems, so that we may dwell here without anxiery, O King."

CHAPTER 16

Ravana rebukes' Bibishana who takes his departure

Worlds to the ground, the Lord of the *Devas* himself? Struck with terror, the Hosts of the Gods scattered in all directions and the loudly trumpeting Airavata was brought down by me, whose tusks I rooted our, dispersing the celestial armies by my valour. I who humbled the pride of the Gods themselves and a11licted the Dairyas, am I in mine immeasurable eoergy not able to subdue these two princes, insignificant mortals as they are ? " At this speech of that invincible and powerful rival of lndra, Bibishana the foremost of warriors answered him in words fraught with good seose, saying : " My Child, thy reflections are worthless ! Thou art young and thine intellect is not ripe ; further, to our ruin, thou art incapable of ascertaining what is expedieot and inexpedieot. " Under the guise of a son, O lndrajita, thou art in truth a

hiddeo foe to **RAVANA** and, hearing him prate of slaying Raghava, thou dost support him. Thou dost merit death, as also he who had the grievous idea of bringing thee here this day and intro ducing a youthful, rash and arrogant warrior into an assembly of counsellors I O lndrajita, thou art thoughdess, imprudent, feeble of intellect, thy mind ruined by folly and extreme frivolity and thou speakest thus from childishness. Who can withstand the shock of those shining arrows which Raghava looses in combat resembling the Rod of **BRAHMA**, like unto fate or the Sceptre of **YAMA**? Do thou give back **SITA** to **RAMA** with treasure, pearls, rich omameots, celestial attire and gems, so that we may dwell here without anxiery, O King." ever seck to bring down the one who is endowed with authority, energy, learning and loyalty and, should he be a hero, he is the more condemned by them. Constantly finding delight in the discomfiture of one another, their bows ready to strike eaeh other down, their hearts full of deceit, they are both formidable and dangerous. "Those verses formerly recited by the elephants in the Padma Forest, on seeing men with snares in their hands, are well known ; I will repeat them to thee :-' Neither fire nor weapons nor uaps strike terror into us but those of our own kind who are cruel and self-interested, it is they whom we fear I They alone, undoubtedly divulge the means of making us captive ! ' " Of all perils, those that spring from relatives are the worst, this is known to us. From cows we have milk, aom relatives malice, from women capriciousness, from *brahmins* asceticism. That I am held in honour by my subjects and have been called to rule over an empire by descent and have set my foot on the heads of mine enemies, will certainly not have found favour with thee ! As drops of water are unable to remain on the lotus leaves, so does friendship slip from the hold of worthless persons. As in autumn the thunderclouds, whieh empty themselves, fail to saturate the earth, so does friendship fail with

the vicious, As bees lly away after they have sucked out the honey they have found, so do the unworthy relinquish a fr;iendship after it has served their purpose. As the honey stealer in its greed, feeding on the Kusha Flowers, does not exhaust their nectar neither do the wicked savour friendship to the full. " If any other had addressed sueh a speech to me, O Ranger of the Night, he would have ceased to breathe at that very instant I As for thee, a curse upon thee, O Obloquy of thy Race!" At this aft'ront, Bibishana, who ever spoke what was true, rose up mace in hand with four other titans and, filled with indignation, that fortunate one, standing in space, said to his brother, the King of the Titans: " Thou hast lost thy reason, O King, but say what thou wilt, an elder brother is the equal of a father and must be reverenced even if he leave the path of equity ; nevertheleas I am unable to tolerate these ouuageous utterances of thine ! Words of wisdom tbat are dictated by a desire for the welf8re of others, O Ten necked One, are not acceptable to those who are not masters of themselves and have fallen under the sway of death ! Those who make flattering speeches are easy to find but rare are they who utter salutory though unpleasing words or those who will listen to thero ! I could not brook seeing thee caughr in the noose of death, who bears away all beings, neither did I desire to see thee pierced by the sharp and golden arrows of **RAMA** resembling flaming torches. Even stout-hearted persons full of skill and courage fall in combat and are carried away like walls of sand if death overcomes them. Thou shouidst accept this counsel on account of its import for thine own good ! By every means defend thyself as well as this city and the titans ! In thine own interest I sought to restrain thee but my words have not found favour with thee, O Ranger of the Night. Fare-thee well, I go ; thoo wilt be happier without me I At the point of death, those whose life has ron its course do not listen to the advice of their friends I "

CHAPTER 17

Words of the leading Monkeys regarding Bibishana

HAVING spoken thus severely to Ravans, Bibisbana went away and almost immediately reaehed the place where **RAMA** and Lskahmana were. Resembling the peak of Mount Meru, like a flasb of lightning in the sky, he was seen by the leaders of the IIIOllkeys who were moment, addressed the monkeys with **HANUMAN** and others anxiously, saying : " Without doubt, this titan, armed with weapons and accompanied by fOUt of his kind, is coming to slay us ! " Hearing these words of **SUGRIVA**, all the leading monkeys braodisbing grest trees 80d rocks, said to him : " Do thou speedily order us to slay these evil doers, O King I Let us strike these weaklings down so that they fall on the earth!" As they were speaking thus, Bibisbaoa, who was master of himself, had reached the northern shore 80d baiting there, that highly intelligent 80d powerful tit80, who was fully self subdued, on perceiving **SUGRIVA** 80d the monkeys, said aloud to them: " **RAVANA** is the name of a wicked titan 80d their lord, 80d I am his younger brother, my name is Bibishana. It is **RAVANA** who, having killed **JATAYU**, carried off **SITA** from Janasthana. That unfortunate one is held captive against her will amidst the female titans who guard her jealously. I have tried to persuade them by diverse arguments, continually repeated, to return **SITA** to **RAMA** but **RAVANA** impelled by fate will not listen to my sage advice. Reviled by him and treated like a slave, I, ab80doning my consort and my son, have come to take refuge with **RAMA**. Do thou inform the high-souled Raghava, that magnanimous protector of the worlds, that I, Bibishana,

have come hither.” At these words, the swift-footed **SUGRIVA**, full of indignation, rao to find **RAMA** and, in the presence of Laksbmana, said to him: " Having belonged to **RAVANA**’s forces, here is 80 adversary taking us unawares, who without warning has come hither to slay us at the first opportunity, like 80 owl destroying crows I Thou knowest all concerning the plans, organization, distribution of troops and the secret service of the =nkeys, as also of thy foes, O Thou who art their scourge I May good betide Thee I These titaoS, who are able to chaoge their forms at will, conceal their designs ; they are bold and inventive in strategy, assuredly one may not trust them I “This must be 80 emissary of the Lord of the TitaoS who, craft, he himself intends to attack us one day. Assistance that is provided by a friend or an inhabitant of the woods like our sdves or by a compatriot or a servant, may be accepted but one should eschew that offered by a foe, O Lord I This deserter who has come to us is a titan by nature and the brother of thine adversary, how can we trust him on first sight? He is Bibishana, the younger brother of **RAVANA** and he has come with four titans to ask for thy protection. Nay, it is **RAVANA** who has sent this Bibishana ; it is essential that thou satisfy thysdf regarding him, O Thou, the most circumspect of persons ! This titan of deceitfill soul has come hither for the purpose of treacherously striking thee down when thou dost least it, O Irreproach able Hero ! Let him and his confederates die in extreme torture, this brother of the wicked **RAVANA** ! " Having given vent to his fury in the presence of the eloquent **RAMA**, the King of the Monkeys, a skilled orator, became silent ! Hearing **SUGRIVA**’s words, the mighty **RAMA** said to the monkeys headed by Hanurnan who stood near: " You have heard for yoursdves what your Sovereign has expressed in judicious words of deep significance regarding the younger brother of **RAVANA** ; in times of crisis one should always receive the counsd of one who

desires the welfare of his friends, and who is intelligent and prudent." Thus addressed by **RAMA**, all those monkeys, ardently desiring his success, hastened to express their opininn, sayiDg : "Nothing is unknown to thee in the Three Worlds, O Raghava ; it is in deference to us that thou dost consult us as friends I Thou art loyal, brave, pious, established in heroism and dost act only after thou hast considered the matter in accord with traditinn with tiJll confidence in thy friends. Let all the intelligent and experienced ministers debate this matter thoroughly, each in his turn." Thus spoke those monkeys and first the sagacious Aogada suggested to Raghava that he should enquire into Bibishana's intentions, sayiDg : " One should souod a deserter who presenta himsdf in every way. It would not befit us to put tiJll trust in Bibishana at once. It is in concealing their real nature that these perfidious beings aet, and further they attack unexpectedly, which would prove 38 fatal to us. Examine him to disawer what is right or wrong before taking any decision and, if it prove to our advantage, form an alliance with him ; if to our disadvantage, reject it. If it be fraught with danger, then renounce it, but if it sbould bring us res! benefit, let us give him a fitting welcome I " Thereafter Sharabha, having rellected awhile, gave bia opillion, revealing his motives, saying : " Without delay, O Lion among Men, send out a spy and, having by means of a wary agent, undertaken a thorough investigation, deal with him in a suitable manner." Then]ambavan, inspired by bia knowledge of the scriptures and his own experience, expressed himself in irreproachable and lucid terms saying : " Bibishana has come to us from a declared enemy, the wicked Lord of the Titans, and he has arrived here without any regard for time and place ; let us be on our guard against him ! " In bia tum, Mainda, $killed in the matter of truth and error, a lluent speaker, uttered these prudent words : " Bibishana is the younger brother of **RAVANA**, let

us interro gate him gently and progressively, O King of Kings I When thou hast informed thyself of his feelinga, then act according to whether his intentions are honest or no, O Prince of Melli " Thereafter, **HANUMAN**, the foremost of beings versed in the scriptures, spoke in sweet accents in words fraught with integrity, saying: " Even Bibishana himself excel thee who art of an esal.ted intellect and the foremost of those $killed in speech. It is not from a desire to speak nor out of emulation nor a sense of superiority nor from a love of debate that I open my mouth, O my Lord **RAMA**, but on account of the impottanoe of the matter in hand. That which thy counscllors have said seems to me erroneous and the real question does not lie there. If one does not interrogate this titan, it is impossible to discover why he haa come hither but to make use of him has its disadvantages also. Concerning the sending out of a spy to make investigations u thy minister advises, I regard it as unwise nor wiU it succeed. It haa been said that Bihishana had no regard fur time and place when he aune hither, I reserve my judgment here ; it appean to me that the time and place are appropriate, bia fault or merit 39 oonsists in leaving one for another. Knowing the wicRdness of **RAVANA** and thy true value, Bibishana has, by his arrival, shown his tact and intelligence. Further it was said, O Prine, ' Let emissaries in disguise question him ' and this speech suggested several thoughts to me. He who is suddenly in terrogsted, if he be wise, becoiDCS cautious and refuses to speak ; the most amiable of those, wbo come as friends, will change after such an useless enquiry. It is not possible, O King, to discover the character of a stranger immediately but only after frequent conversations when words may escape him that will betray any perfidy. The speech of this titan does not indicate an evil nature and further he has an open countenance and I have no doubts conceruing him. He is in no way embarrassed and is master of himself,

he does not appear to be a knave. His language is not that of a perverse being and I do not feel any suspicion regsrding him. Inevitably people's real nature is only gradually revealed. When an undertaking is suited to the time and place, O Most experienced of Men, and it is a practical proposition, it will meet with speedy success. Bibishana is aware of thy magnanimity and also of **RAVANA**'s baseness. He has heard of the slaying of Bali and the crowning of **SUGRIVA** and what is more he has a desire to rule the kingdom ! If this is what has determined him to come hither and these are apparently his motives, then this is what his alliance is worth to us. I have said what I had to say to prove the upright charcter of this titan ; thou hast listened to me and the depends nn thee, O Prince of the Wise."

CHAPTER 18

Rama listens to the Advice of the Monkeys about receiving Bibishana

At these words, **SUGRIVA**, that lion among monkeys, reftectiog carefWiy, replied in more reasonable words and in eloquent terms addressed **RAMA**, saying : " What mattetll it if this ranger of the night be well or ill intentioned, if in time of peril he abandons his brother, whom will he not betray subsequently?" At these words of the King of the Monkeys, Kskutlltha looked round on that company and, smiling gently, said to Lakshmaoa, distinguished for his saintly characteristics : " He who has not studied the scriptUres nor possessed reverence for authority could not utter such words as have been expressed by the Lord of Monkeys ! There is however some thing peculiar in these circumstances, it seems to me, which is particularly to be seen in monarchs. Kings have

two avowed enemies, their kinsmen and their neighbours, who tum against them in times of adversity ; this is what brings this titan here ! " Relatives who are not of a perverse nature, honour those of their own family who have treated them well but in the case of kings even a virtuous relative is suspect ! As to the fault that you point out which consists in accepting the assistance of a foe, I will tell you what the scriptures say on this, hear me ! “We are not related to the titans and it is not our kingdom that he covets. It is certain his compatriots are ioformed about Bibishaoa’s departure and for this reason we should receive him. They will have assembled with joy and without anxiety and thereafter the cry ' This one or that is afraid ', will have created a division amongst them ; this is what has brought about Bibishaoa’s arrival here. “All brothers, O Dear One, do not resemble **BHARATA** nor all sons what I was to my sire nor do all friends resemble each other.” Thus spoke **RAMA**, and **SUGRIVA** rising, as also Lakshmaoa, bowed low and thereafter that exceedingly sagacious monkey said: " Know that it is Ravaoa who has sent out this ranger of the nlght ! I regard it as imperative that we should make an end 41 of him, O Thou, the most circumspect of pmcma I This demon under the order of a perverse creature bas come hither to make an assault on thee, myself and alsbmana, when we arc un prepared tor it, O Irreproachable Warrior. He merits death, this Bibishana, brother of that inhuman **RAVANA**, as well as his aaomplices.” Having spoken thus to the eloquent prince of the House of Raghu, **SUGRIVA**, the leader of the army, a flucut speaker became silcut and **RAMA**, having listcued to Sngriva, that liou among monkeys, reflected awhile and tbcu addtessed that tbrcmost of monkeys in mcasutcd terms, saying : " Whether this titan be ill-iutcutioued or no, what does it matter, he caunot do me the least mischief. On csrtb, Pisacbas, Danavas and Yakshas, as also the titans can be slaiu by me

with the tip of my fiuger, if I so desire it, O Kiug of the Monkeys. “It is related how a pigeon with whom his adversaty had taken refuge cutertaiued him and invited him to partskc of his own flesh, even though he was the ravisher of his mate. Such was the hospitality offered by a pigeon ; what ahould therefore a man like myself not do ? Hearken to these verses, prc-emincndy sacred, sung aforetimes by the sou of Kanva, that gtcat ascetic of truthful speech, Kandu : "'A miscreant who apptoaches with joined palms, scc1ting refuge, should not in the name of humanity be slaiu cvcu if he be a foe, O Parantapa I The untbrtunstc or the fearful wbo plead for shelter or throw themselves ou the mercy of their enemy, ahould be protected by him who is master of himself. If, conforming to the tradition, oue does not rcuder assistance according to one’s capscity, either tor reasons of fear, delusion or anger, oue is reproached by all and the suppliant, who pcriahca before the eyes of the oue of whom he bas sought help in vain, carries away all his merit I ' “Therefore it is a heinous crime not to give shelter to those wbo pctitiou it ou this earth; it is to deprive ouesclf of heaven and glory and to lose oue’s sucugtb and prowess I Couscqncnd.y to me, O Monkey, I shall offer him security whether he be Bibishana or **RAVANA** himself! " Thus did **RAMA** speak and **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, answered that son of Kakutstha, whom he held in deep affection, thus: " What wonder is it that thou who art loyal, virtuous and established in righteousness, thou who shinest like a jewel in the head of kings, shouldst speak thus ? I, also, in my heart, am convinced of Bibisbana’s integrity. Deduction, feeling, everything bas been used to probe this matter thoroughly ; let him be admitted immediately amongst us on equal terms, O Ragbava ! Let Bibishana, who is full of wisdom, join our alliance!, At these words of **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, Ramo immediately joined Bibisbana as Purandara the King of the Birds.

CHAPTER 19

Bibishana is brought before Rama

looking down on the earth. Thereafter he descended joyously from the sky to the ground with his faithful companions and that virtuous one ran towards Ramo and, falling at his feet with the four titans, addressed him in words full of loyalty and discretion, fitting the occasion : " I am **RAVANA**'s younger brother and I have been greatly affronted by him. I have therefore come to seck refuge with thee, the protector of all beings I Abandoning Lanka, friends and possessions, I place my kingdom, life and happiness at thy disposal!" At these words, Ramo, in soothing tones, while seeming to consume him with his gaze, said : " O Bibishana, tell me truly what is the strength and weakness of the titans ? " 43 Thus questioned by **RAMA** of imperishable exploits, that titan described the might and extent of **RAVANA**'s power, saying : " By virtue of a special boon conferred on him by Swyambhu, Dashagriva is invulnerable to all beings, Gandharvas, Serpents and Birds, O Prince. I have also another brother older than myself, the valiant **KUMBHAKARNA**, the illustrious rival of Indta in war. " O **RAMA**, **RAVANA** has Prahasta commanding his forces, who is perhaps known to thee. It is he who vanquished Manibhadta in combat on Mount Kailasha ! When clad in armour that no arrow can pierce, furnished with his archer's gloves, Indrajita, taking up his bow, makes himself invisible, and on the battle field, having propitiated the God of Fire, that fortunate one sows carnage amongst the foe, O Raghava. Mahodara, Mahaparshwa and the Titan Akampana, who are his lieutenants, resemble the Lokapalas on the field of battle. "Ten thousand kotis of titanS, able to change their form at will, feeding on f!eh and blood, inhabit Lanka. At their head, their sovereign the

wicked **RAVANA** made war on the supporrers of the earth as also the Gods who were all overcome by him.” Having listened to Bibishana and weighed his words caretiilly, **RAMA** expressed himself thus : " These exploits of **RAVANA**’s that thou hast faithfblly described are well known to me ; I shall slay Dashagriva as also Prahasta and his sons; thereafter I shall install thee as king; believe me, this is the truth I Were he to plunge into the region of Raastala or even Patala or take refuge with the Grandsire of the World, he would not escape alive I Before I have annihilated **RAVANA** with his sons, his kinsfolk and his allies in battle, I shall not Thereupon Saumitri, in acxord with **RAMA**’s behest, performed the royal anointing in the midst of the leading monkeys and immediately those monkeys, beholding Bibishana raised to that supreme rank, acclaimed that magnanimous titan, crying : “Excellent! Excellent 1 ". Meanwhile **HANUMAN** and **SUGRIVA** enquired of Bibishana, saying: " How shall we, with the mighty army of monkeys who surround us, cross the ocean, that indestructible empire of **VARUNA** ? What means should we employ to ttaverse the refuge of the Lord of Streams and Rivers speedily with our troops?” At this question, the virtuous **BIBISHANA** *answered*:-" That Prince, the offspring of the Race of Raghu, should approach the ocean that was excavated by Sagara and he will assuredly help one of his own race,,. Thus spoke Bibishana, that sagacious titan, and **SUGRIVA** instantly went away with **LAKSHMANA** to join **RAMA**. Thereafter the thick-necked **SUGRIVA** conveyed to him this salutory counsel of Bibishana’s to take refuge with Sagara and it found favour with the virtuously minded **RAMA**. Then that illustrious prince replied to **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, who was acxompanied by **LAKSHMANA**. Full of respect for that monkey, who sought to gratify him in every way, he smiled upon him as also on his brother **LAKSHMANA** and said : " This plan of Bibishana’s pleases me, O

SUGRIVA and **LAKSHMANA**. **SUGRIVA** is sagacious and was ever a prudent counsellor : do ye both retlect on the matter and say what you consider to be best." Having spoken thus to them, those two warriors **SUGRIVA** and **LAKSHMANA** answered in respectful tones, saying : " How should the counsel of Bibishana not find favour with us in these circumstances ? He bringa us the means to success. Without throwing a bridge over the sea, that redoubtable dominion of Lanb will remain inaccessible even to the Gods and titans with their leaders. Let us carry out the suggestion of the virtuous Bibishana scrupulously ; enough time has been lost. Let us approach Sagara, so that with our army we may reach Lanb of which **RAVANA** is the support." At these words, **RAMA** proceeded to the shore that was covered with Kusba Grass belonging to the Lord of Streams and Rivers as the God of Fire ascends the altar. CHAPTER Rtwana sends Shuka to **SUGRIVA** Now the titan, Sbardula by name, who had gone out to recon noitre, beheld the army encamped under **SUGRIVA**'s command, and that spy belonging to the wicked **RAVANA**, King of the Titans, having inspected those troops, returned and, regaining Lanka with all speed, said to his sovereign : " Behold a multitude of monkeys and bears, immeasurable and boundless as the sea, approaching Lanka. The sons of **DASARATHA**, the brothers **RAMA** and Lsksbrnana, who are illus trious and endowed with beauty, have come to search for **SITA**. Having reached the shores of the sea, they have encamped there, O lliusuious Prince. These forces cover ten leagues in extent in every direction ! O Great King, it behoves thee to inform thyself of the true state of a11irirs immediately! Let thine emissaries enquire into the matter speedily ; restitution, conciliation or sowing dissension are involved here." Hearing Shardula's words, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans becsme perturbed and, reflecting on the matter, iostantly gave orders to Shuka, the most skilled of negotiators, saying : "

Go and seek out **SUGRIVA** on my behalf and say to that prince in persuasive and ingratiating tones : “Assuredly thou, the offspring of a race of gteat monarchs, the mighty son of the King of the Bears, art exceedingly powerful! Thou hast nothiog to fear ; thou art to me as a brother, O Lord of the Monkeys. If I bore away the consort of that crafty prince, what is it to thee ? Do thou return to Kishkindba ; Lanka annot be conquered by these monkeys by any means nor by the united efforts of the Gods with the Gandbarvas, how much less by men or apes?'

CHAPTER 20

Ravana sends Shuka to Sugriva

At these words, **RAMA** proceeded to the shore that was covered with Kusba Grass belonging to the Lord of Streams and Rivers as the God of Fire ascends the altar. CHAPTER Rtwana sends Shuka to **SUGRIVA** Now the titan, Sbardula by name, who had gone out to recon noitre, beheld the army encamped under **SUGRIVA**’s command, and that spy belonging to the wicked **RAVANA**, King of the Titans, having inspected those troops, returned and, regaining Lanka with all speed, said to his sovereign : " Behold a multitude of monkeys and bears, immeasurable and boundless as the sea, approaching Lanka. The sons of **DASARATHA**, the brothers **RAMA** and Lsksbrnana, who are illus trious and endowed with beauty, have come to search for **SITA**. Having reached the shores of the sea, they have encamped there, O lliusuious Prince. These forces cover ten leagues in extent in every direction ! O Great King, it behoves thee to inform thyself of the true state of a11irirs immediately! Let thine emissaries enquire into the matter speedily ; restitution, conciliation or sowing dissension are involved here.” Hearing Shardula’s words,

RAVANA, the Lord of the Titans becsme perturbed and, reflecting on the matter, iostantly gave orders to Shuka, the most skilled of negotiators, saying : " Go and seek out **SUGRIVA** on my behalf and say to that prince in persuasive and ingratiating tones : “Assuredly thou, the offspring of a race of gteat monarchs, the mighty son of the King of the Bears, art exceedingly powerful! Thou hast nothiog to fear ; thou art to me as a brother, O Lord of the Monkeys. If I bore away the consort of that crafty prince, what is it to thee ? Do thou return to Kishkindba ; Lanka annot be conquered by these monkeys by any means nor by the united efforts of the Gods with the Gandbarvas, how much less by men or apes?' At this command of the King of the Titans, that Night ranger Shuka, rising into the air, rapidly passed through space and, having journeyed for some time high over the waters, halted and, standing in the sky, repeated all he had been told by the wicked **RAVANA** to say to **SUGRIVA**. As he was still speak ing, the monkeys bounded into the air and, smiting him with their fists, prepared to tear him to pieces and fiing him to the ground. Thus maltreated by the monkeys, Shnka spoke in this wise : " One does not assault an ambassador, O Kakutstha, therefore send away these monkeys. He who withholds the message of his master and gives voice to that which he has not been author ized to utter, merits death.” Hearing Shnka’s complaints, Ramo issued a command to those monkeys, who were assaulting that titan, saying:-" Do not slay him! " and Shnka having received immunity from the attacks of the monkeys, steadying himself in the air with his wings, spoke again, saying : " O **SUGRIVA**, Thou who art endowed with magnanimity, O Hero, who art full of energy and valour, what shall I say to thee on the part of **RAVANA**, the Scourge of the World?” Being thus addressed, that mighty King of the Monkeys, the foremost of all the apes, interrupted that Ranger of the Night, Sbnka, and made the following proud reply, characteristic of his nature : " Thou

art not my friend nor art thou worthy of my pity, thou ott neither my benefactor nor dost thou find favour with me I Thou and thy kinsfolk are the enemies of Ramo, thou shalt perish like Bali and thou meritest death! I shall annihilate thee, thy sons, thy relatives as also Lanka to which I shall lay siege at the head of my great army and reduce it to ashes I "Nay, thou insensate **RAVANA**, thou shalt never escape Raghava even if thou wert proteCted by the Gods themselves with their leaders. Wert thou to make thyself invisible in the sun's path or enter into heU or take refuge at the lotus feet of the King of the Mountains, thou with thy followers wilt succumb to Ramo's blows. In the Three Worlds, I see none whether be it Piaacha, Rabhasa, Gandharva, or *Asura*, who is able to protect thee ! Thou hast slain the aged King of the Vultures and carried off the large-yed **SITA** in the presence of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** and, having made her captive, dost not recognize her for what she is ! Thou art unaware how strong, powerfUl and irresistible to the Gods themselves is this Prince of the Race ofRaghu, who shall deprive thee of thy life." Thereafter the foremost of monkeys, the son of Bali, **ANGADA**, took up the discourse and said : " O Virtuous King, this is no ambassador, he has the appear ance of a spy ; he is only here to count our forces, let him be arrested, do not allow him to return to Lanka. Such is my opinion." Thereupon at a sign from the king, the monkeys flung them selves on that titan, whom they seized and bound, whilst he, without defence, wailed loudly. Ill-treated by those furious monkeys, Shuka began to cry upon the magnanimous **RAMA**, born of **DASARATHA**, saying : " They are tearing out my wings ruthlessly and putting out my eyes, may the consequences of all the evil deeds that I have done since the day I was born till the night I die, fall on thee if I lose my life ! " Hearing his cries, **RAMA** would not sanction his death and ordered the monkeys to release him.

CHAPTER 21

Rama looses his Arrows on Sagara

Obeisance in honour of the ocean and laid hisnself down. That Scourge of his Foes pillowed his head on his arms that resembled the coils of a serpent and were adorned with ornaments of gold, their habitual decoration ; those arms that formerly were perfumed with sandal and aloes, saffron of the hue of tbe dawn lending them lustre ; those arms on which **SITA** leant on the nuptual couch causing them to shine as do the watera of the 48 Ganges the body of Takshaka ; those arms, resembling the shafts of a chariot, that iocreased the distress of his foes and the delight of his friends, were stretched out on the shore of the sea. The tightening of the bow-string had rubbed the skin off the left arm of that skilful archer and the right, that bestower of thousands of kine in charity, resembled a great mace. Leaning on his powerful elbow, the mighty-armed **RAMA** *said*: " Sagara will grant me a passage or he shall be slaio by me ! " Having thus resolved, he lay down by the ocean, restraioiog his speech and with a concentrated miod in accord with tradition. There, followiog the scriptural iojunction, **RAMA** lay on the ground spread with Kusha Grass and slept peacefully for three nights. For three nights **RAMA**, endowed with learning and piety, remained beside Sagara, the Lord of the Waters. Nevenheless that indolent one did not appear to that hero, who had yet paid him honour as was his due. Thereupon, his eyes suffused with wrath, Raghava, enraged agaiost him, said to **LAKSHMANA**, the hearer of auspicious marks, who stood near : " It is from contempt that the Ocean does not appear to me io person ! Deference and forbearance, integrity and friendly speech, these qualities belonging to virtuous men are not valued by those who are deptived of

them, who regard them as weakness, whereas the braggart, the dissolute and the arrogant who boast openly and commit every kind of excess, are overwhelmed with regard ! Meekness will never briog victory on this earth, O Lakshrnana, any more than io the forefront of battle! To-day, pierced by my shafts, thou shalt behold aquatic monsters by their leaping chum up the waters where they dwell on every side I See, O Lakshrnana, how I shall sever the serpents' coils and the limbs of the great fish like unto the trunks of elephants. To-day I shall dry up the ocean with its multitudinous waves, shells, pearls, fish and monsters. Because I have manifested patience, the Ocean, the abode of whales, regards me as power less I Away with forbearance to such persons I It is on account of my mildness that he manifests his true nature ! Bring me my bow, O Saumitri and mioe arrows resembliog venomous snakes, I shall dry up the sea and the monkeys may then cross it on foot I To-day, iodomitable though he be. I shall yet overthrow Sagara with my shafts ; he who is bounded 49 by the shore and who is filled with a myriad waves I I shall wipe out that Ocean, the Abode of **VARUNA**, that is inhabited by great giants." Speaking thus, bow in band, his eyes dilated with anger, **RAMA** appeared exceedingly terrible, like unto the Fire at the end of the world cycle. Grasping his formidable bow with its batbed and fearful sbafts more firmly, he caused the earth to tremble as does Sbatakratu with his thunderbolts. His flaming and impetuous arrows, unrivalled in power, pencttated the waters of the sea and struck terror in the serpents. And those waves of the sea with their sbarks and moostcrs, were cxtremcly agitated, so that with the roaring of the wind, a formidable clamour arose. lo a trice, the ocean became a mass of clasbing waves, throwing up spray, sheDs and fragments of mother of pearl, and panic spread among the Pannagas of flaming jaws and brassy eyes and amidst the mighty Danavas in their abode, the depths of hcll. Waves in their

millions as high as the Vindhya and Mandara Mountains rose from that Lord of Waters with his crocodiles and great fish and the Ocean emitted a lond roaring, amidst the breaking billows, with the terrified serpents, demons and great crocodiles in llight. Then Saumitri rushed towards **RAMA**, who, in his burning ardour, was stretching his incomparable bow with loud muttcrings, crying:-" Stay I Stay! " and thus speaking, he took hold of that weapon, saying : " Thou bast no need to act in this wise to accomplish thine end and bring Sagara to subjection, O Foremost of Heroes I Thy peers do not permit themselves to be overcome by anger I Call to mind the forbearance of virtuous men I " At that instant, the Brahmarishis and cclestial *Rishis*, who, invisible, were stationed in the sky, cried out :-" Hold I Hold ! do not act thus I " YUjDDHA *KANDA*

CHAPTER 22

The Army crosses the Sea

THEREAPTER the Prince of the Raghus addressed the Ocean in menacing tones, saying: " To-day I shall dry up the sea with the nether regions ! O Sagara, with thy waters consumed by my shafts, thy denizens slain by my blows, a gteat cloud of dust will arise from thy drained bed and the monkeys will cross to the othet shore on foot! “Thou hast sougbt to oppose me but att unaware of my valour or my strength ! O Abode of the Danavas, being full of pride, thou canst not forcscc thy fate ! " Thereafter, fixing an arrow resembling the Rod of **BRAHMA** and placing it on his excellent bow, Raghava stretched that weapon, and heaven and earth sccmcd to be riven, as it were, and the mountains trembled, darkness covered the earth and all the regions were obscured. Tremors ran througb the lakes and rivers ; the sun, moon and stars

swerved in their course and though the sky was lit by the sun's rays, it was enveloped in darkness and blazed with a hundred mcrcors, whilst thunder reverberated with an unparalleled sound in the firmament. The five celestial Maruts blew and like massed legions tore up the trees, dispersing the clouds in the twinkling of an eye, breaking off the points of the rocks and shattering the mountain peaks. In the sky, loud thunder clapa resounded with immense power and tumult. The invisible beings emitted cries of fear and, lying prostrate on the earth in their agony, sbook with terror, convulsed and unable to move. Thereafter the Ocean with ita mass of water, serpents and demons surged beyond its confines to the ment of a league, though the time of the final deluge was not yet at hand ; nevertheless **RAMA**, the descendant of Raghu, scourge of his foes, did not rcttest before the disordered heavings of that Lord of Rivers and Streams I · Sagara himself rose out of the waves, like the day's orb rising sr over the eastern mountain, Meru, and that Ocean appeared with the Pannagas of flaming jaws and he was of the hue of emetald, adorned with gold ; wreatha of pearls festooned his attire and on his head he bore a diadem of every kind of flower ; ornaments of refined gold and pearls from his domain were his decoration. Covered with gems and metals of every kind, resembling the Himavat Mountain, the waters surging round him, he was encircled by the clouds and winds, while the rivers Gunga aud Sindhu were his escorts. Rising, the noble Sagara, escorted by the rivers with the Gunga and Indus at their head, approached **RAMA** with joined palms, who stood arrows in hand, and, reflecting awhile the **OCEAN** *said*: " Earth, wiud, air, water and light, O Beloved Raghava, remain fixed in their own nature. Neither from desire nor ambition nor fear, O Prince, nor from affection am I able to solidify my waters inhabited by sharks ; nevertheless I will make it possible for thee to cross over them ! This is my resolve the sharks will remain inactive

while the army makes its way across and, for the monkeys, I shall become like the earth I " On this, **RAMA** said to him :-“Hear me, O Thou who art the refuge of **VARUNA** I This arrow of mine must accomplish its intended end ! Where shall I let this mighty shaft fall ? " Hearing **RAMA**’s words and seeing that fortnidable missile, the exceedingly powerful **OCEAN** *replied*: " To the north of this place is a sacred region, Drumakulya, a name as renowned in the world as thine own I There innumerable robbers of fearful aspect and deeds, having Abhiraa as their chief, drink my waterS. The vicinity of those perverse beings is intolerable to me ; it is there, O **RAMA**, that thou shouldst loose thy shaft that never misses its target.” Thus spoke the magnanimous Sagara and **RAMA**, in accord with his wish, let fly that marvellous dart in his presence. And the place, where that arrow resembling a flash of lightning fell, is YUD!DHA KA!NDA was filled with the water of the deeper springs ; it seemed as if the earth was riven and wells and ponds appeared there. This place became known as Marukantara and is famous in the Three Worlds. Thereafter **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, having dried up the waters of the ocean, conferred a boon, saying : " This place shall be rich in pasturage and free from disease ; it will abound in fruit, roots, honey, ghee and milk and be fragrant with aromatic herbs; thus it will remain retaining those excellent qualities ! , In this way the Desert of Maru came to possess these manifold features and by the grace of **RAMA**’s liberality, assumed a pleasant aspect. When the waters had been dried up, Samudra, the Lord of Streams and Rivers, said to Raghava, who was skilled in the use of weapons : “My Friend, there stands NaJa, the son of Vishvakarma, whose father has overwhelmed him with gifts ; he is generous and devoted ; great are the powers of that monkey ; let him construct a bridge over my waters, I will uphold it; NaJa is as skilled as his sire ! , At these words the Ocean disappeared and NaJa,

that prince of monkeys spoke to the valiant **RAMA** thus : " Resorting to the skill I have inherited from my sire, I shall build a bridge over the spacious and vast domain of aquatic monsters ; what the Ocean has said is true ! “When one has to do with the ungrateful, in my opinion the rod is the most salutary method for men ! A plague on forbear ance as also on generosity and kindness! Assuredly Sagara, that formidable mass of water, in fear of punishment, wished to see a bridge constructed and out of fear was willing to suffer Raghava to pass over it. “My mother received a boon on the Mandara Mountain from Vishvakarma, who said to her :-' A son will be born to thee who will resemble me, O Goddess ! ' “No one having questioned me, I have not spoken of my powers but I can assuredly construct a causeway over **VARUNA**’s domain; from to-day let all the leading monkeys set to work I " At **RAMA**’s command, those lions among the monkeys entered the mighty forest with alacrity in hundred and thousanda on every side and those leaders of the simian tribes, tearing up the " S3 rocks, which in size they resembled, and the trees also dragged them to the sea and theycovered the ocean with Sala, Ashvakama, Dbava, Vamshs, Kutaja, Arjuna, Tala, Tilaka, Tinishs, Balalaka, Saptapama and Karnikama Trees in full flower, as also Cutas and Ashokas. Those foremost of monkeys tranS potted those with or without bearing them like so many standards of lndra and they heaped Talas and piles of Dadina, Narikela, Bibhitaka, Kanya, Bakula and Nimba Trees here and there. With the aid of mechsnical devices, those powerful colossi dug up stones as big as elepbaots and rocks, and the water suddenly spouted into the air only to fall instantly. Thereafter those monkeys churned up the sea by rushing into it on all sides or pulling on the chains. That immense causeway constructed by Nala in the bosom of the sea was built by the arms of those monkeys of formidable exploits and it extended over a hundred leagues. Some

brought trunks of and others set them up ; it was by hundreds and thousands that those monkeys, like unto giants, made use of reeds, logs and blossoming trees to construct that bridge, rushing hither and thither with blocks of stone resembling mountains or the peaks of crags, which, ftung into the sea, fell with a resounding crash. The first day those monkeys resembling elephants, of immense energy, full of high spirits and exceedingly merry, erected fourteen leagues of masonry. The second day, those highly active monkeys of formidable stature set up twenty leagues. Bestirring themselves, those giants threw twenty-one leagues of structure over the ocean on the third day and on the fourth, working feverishly, they built up twenty-two leagues in extent. The fifth day, those monkeys, industrious workers, reached to twenty-three leagues distance from the further shore. That fortunate and valiant son of Vishvalwma, leader of monkeys, constructed a causeway worthy of his sire over the ocean and that bridge erected by Nala over the sea, the bannt of whales, dazzling in its perfection and spleadour, wu like the constcllation of Svati in space. Then the Gods, Gandbarvas, Siddbas and supreme *Rishis* assembling, stood in the sky, eager to see that masterpiece and the Gods and Gandbarvas gazed on that causeway, 10 dillicult S4 of construction that was ten leagues in width and a hundred in length built by Nala. Those monkeys thereafter dived, swam and shouted at the sight of that unimaginable marvel that was almost inconceivable and caused one to tremble ! And all beings beheld that causeway thrown over the ocean and by hundreds and thousands of kotis, those monkeys, full of valour, having built that bridge over the immense repository of waters, reached the opposite shore. Vast, well-constructed, magnificent with its wonderful paved ftoor, solidly cemented, that great causeway like unto a line traced on the waves, resembled the parting of a woman’s hair. Meanwhile Bibishana, mace in

hand, held himself ready at his post with his companions in case of an enemy attack. Thereafter **SUGRIVA** addressed **RAMA**, who was valiant by nature, saying : " Monnt on the shoulders of **HANUMAN** and **LAKSHMANA** on those of **ANGADA**. O Hero, vast is this ocean, the abode of whales ; those two monkeys who freely range the sky will transport you both ! " Then the fortunate **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** advanced thus and that magnanimous archer was accompanied by **SUGRIVA**. Some monkeys strode forward in the centre, some threw themselves into the waves, some sprang into the sky, others marched on the bridge, some ranged through space like birds, and the terrific tumult of the tramping of that formidable army of monkeys, drowned the roar of the ocean. When those simian had passed over the sea by the grace of Nola's causeway, the king ordered them to camp on the shore which abounded in roots, fruits and water. At the sight of that masterpiece that had materialized under the command of Raghava, despite the difficulties, the Gods, who had drawn near with the Siddhas and Cbaranas as also the great *Rishis*, anointed **RAMA** in secret there, with water from the sea and said: .. Mayest thou be victorious over thy foes, O Thou, who art a God amongst men I Do thou rule over the earth and the sea eternally I " Thus in varinus auspicinus words did they acclalm **RAMA** in the midst of the homage ofFaed to him by the *brahmins*. ss

CHAPTER 23

Rama sees diverse Portents

THB elder brother of **LAKSHMANA** beheld certain portents and as their significance was known to him, he embraced Saumitri and said: " O **LAKSHMANA**, OCCilpying this region provided with fresh water, and

woods abounding in fruit, let us speedily divide these innumerable forces and form ourselves into battalions ! Great is the danger I foresee, boding destruction to the world and the slaughter of the valiant bears, monkeys and titans. “A dust storm is blowing up, the earth trembles and the peaks of the mountains sbake; trees fall, clouds resembling wild beasts emit a terrible roaring and let loose dreadful showers mingled with blood; there is an awe-inspiring twilight, lurid like unto red sandalwood ; from the blazing sun, a circle of fire falls; filled with terror, wild beasts and birds with harsh voices are raising mournful cries to the sun on every side. In the night, the moon, bereft of brilliance, burning with a black and red halo as it rises, resembles the destruction threatening the world. A dark stain appears on the solar disc which is diminished, sombre, without radiance and coppery. Behold, O **LAKSHMANA**, a thick dust blOts out the stars and seems to foreshadow the end of the world ! Crows, eagles and vultures Thereupon all the valiant monkeys with Bibisbana and **SUGRIVA** at their head rose up crying destruction on their powerful foe and the boisterous demonstration of those heroic monkeys, made with the object of pleasing **RAMA**, filled that son of the House of Raghu with delight.

CHAPTER 24

Shuka describes his reception by the Monkeys to Ravana

THAT army of warriors in well-ordered. formations looked splendid with the radiance **RAMA** conferred on it which resembled the full moon on a starry night, and the earth, pressed under foot by the energetic tread of that multitude like unto the sea, trembled with fear. Meanwhile those

inhabitants of the woods heard a great tumult arising in Lanka and the formidable rolling of drums and clashing of gongs caused their hair to stand on end. This clamour filled the leaders of the monkeys with joy and, in their ardout, they emitted shouts that surpassed that uproar, and the cheering of the Plavamgamas, resembling the rumble of thunder in the skiea, reached the ears of the titans. Seeing Lanka dressed with many coloured banners, the son of **DASARATHA** bethought himself of **SITA** and his heart was filled with grief. He reflected-' It is there that that youthful woman, whose eyea resemble a gazelle's, is held captive by **RAVANA**, like sways the branches from which the birds dart, where bees swarm and where cuckoos abound." Thus did **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA** address **LAKSHMANA** and thereafter ranging his forces according to the traditional methods, he issued the following commands to that army of monkeys. " Let the valiant and invincible **ANGADA** place his troops in the centre with the General Nila. Surrounded by the simian battalions, Rishabha should establish himself on the right wing of the army, and he who resembles an elephant in mustha, the indomitable and courageous Gandhamadana, should place himself at the head of the left flank. I shall go to the forefront of the army with **LAKSHMANA** as mine aide-de-camp and **JAMBAVAN**, Sushena and Vegadarshin to spy out the land. "Those three high-souled ones, the leaders of the bears, should protect the centre of the forces and the rearguard be under the command of the Lord of Monkeys, as the western region is dominated by the sun of brilliant rays." The innumerable divisions being thus skilfully distributed, that army, led by the foremost of monkeys armed with boulders and huge trees, resembled the heavens with its mass of clouds ; and those monkeys advanced on Lanks that they were eager to destrOy. " It is with the peaks of mountains that shall demolish Lanka or if need he with our bare fists ! " such was the resolve of those powerful

monkeys. At that instant the exceedingly valiant **RAMA** said to **SUGRIVA** : " Our forces are properly marshalled, now let Shuka he released!, Under the order of that lndra of Monkeys, who was full of energy, **RAVANA**'s agent was set at liberty. Released on **RAMA**'s command and harassed by the monkeys, Shuka, in a frenzy of terror went to seck out the King of the Titans, whereupon **RAVANA** with a sneer enquired of him : " What is the meaning of thy fettered wings ? Why are thy flanks torn ? Hast thou fallen into the power of those capricious monkeys?" Thereupon Shuka, wrought up with fear, pressed by his exceedingly powerful sovereigD, made this reply : ss " Repairing to the northern shore of the sea in order to deliver thy message faithfully by employing gentle and soothing tones, those barbarous Plavamgamas, barely having caught sight of me, hurled themselves upon me and began to beat and pound me with tbeir fists. It was quite impossible to enter into any form of mediation with them or discuss anything ; those monkeys are ferocious and violent by nature, O Lord of the Titans I The slayer of Viradha, Kabandha and Khara, **RAMA**, however, who is accompanied by **SUGRIVA**, is searching for **SITA**. Having thtown a bridge over the sea and traversed the salty waves, that archer, Raghava, has come hither and sets the titans at nought. "The beats and monkeys, gathering in thousands of divisions equal to mountains or clouds, cover the earth. There is no more possibility of an alliance between the monkeys and the titans than between a God and a demon ! Before they reach the ramparts decide quicldy how thou wilt act ; either restore **SITA** to **RAMA** or enter into con11ict with him ! " Thus spoke Shuka and **RAVANA**, his eyes red with anger, looked at him as if he would consume him with his glance and said: " Even had I to enter into conOict with the *Devas*, Gandharvas and Danavas, I would not restore **SITA**, were the whole earth to shake ! When will my shafts fall on Raghava as the

intoxicated bees fall on the blossoming trees in Spring ? When, with mine arrows, shall I consume his body flowing with blood as 11aming torches destroy an elephant. " His forces will suffer eclipse before my powerful army as the brilliance of the starS at the rising of the sun. That son of **DASARATHA** is not aware that I possess the strength of Sagara and the swiftness of Maruta, that is why he desires to meet me in combat. **RAMA** has not yet seen the shafts resembling venomous serpents that repose in my quiver ; that is why he wishes to enter into combat with me ! That Raghava is not yet conversant with my great might nor with the Vina in the form of my bow that I pluck with mine arrows, the bow-string producing a formidable sound, the cries of the wounded its terrible accom paniment, the dsrts its innumerable nOteS and which, when I enter the river of the enemy ranks as into a vast arena, I shall cause to resound on the lield of battle ! S9 “Neither the thousand-eyM Vasava i.o person nor **YAMA** of the fiery missiles nor Vaishravana himself is able to overcome me in battle!”

CHAPTER 25

Ravana sends out Shuka and Sarana to spy on the Monkeys

“Neither the thousand-eyM Vasava i.o person nor **YAMA** of the fiery missiles nor Vaishravana himself is able to overcome me in battle!” Terrified at the sight of **RAMA** and despairing of their lives, the two demons, with joined palms, said to !lim in great fear: .. O Most Cherished Issue of the House of Raghu, we have been sent by **RAVANA** to find out about the whole army ! " Hearing these words, **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, who delighted in the welfare of all beings, smiling,

answered them, saying: " If you have inspected the whole army and examined their positions carefully and fulfilled the missinn entrusted to you, then return in peace. But if there is anything you have not investigated and you still wish to see, then Bibishana will show it to you fully. Your arrest should not cause you any apprehen sion with regards your lives, you envoys and, having laid aside your arms, have been taken captive ; you do not merit death! “O Bibishaua, setthese two rangers of the night free, who have come in disguise to spy on us with the intention of creating division amongst their foes. And you, when you return to the great Oty ofLanlta, repeat my words faithfully to the King of the Titans, saying : " 'That force on which thou didst rely when taking **SITA** away from me, employ freely with the aid of thy troops and allies. To-morrow at break of day, thou shalt see mine arrows demolish the Oty ofLanlta with its ramparts and arches as well as the army of titans I My dreadful ire will fall on thee and thy forces at dawn, O **RAVANA**, as the God bearing the Thunderbolt, Vasava, discharges it on the Danavas !'" Receiving this command, the two Titans, Shuka and Sarana, admiring his justice, cried out:-" Mayest thou he victorious I " and paid obeisance to **RAMA**. Returning to Lanka, they said to the Lord of the Titans : " Bibishaua took us captive with the intention of slaying us, O King, but **RAMA**, he whose valour is immeasurable, seeing us, let us go! “In that place four of the foremost monkey leaders are assembled who are equal to the Protector of the Worlds. Their warriors, sltil1cd in the use of weapons, of proved prowess, are **RAMA** the son of Dasaratba, the fortunate **LAKSHMANA**, Bibishaua 61 and the bighly energetic **SUGRIVA**, whose strength is equal to the great **INDRA**’s. “Even without the monkeys themselves taking pan, they are able to penetrate into this Oty of Lanka with its walls and arches and tear up the foundations and ttansplant them elsewhete. Such is **RAMA**’s capacity and such his

weapons that he could ovenhrow the city single-handed, his three companions stsnding by! Under Ramo, **LAKSHMANA** and **SUGRIVA**'s protection that atmy is completely invincible even against the Gods and *Asuras* combined I Now that atmy of powerful and aggressive monkeys, dwellers in the woods, is breathiog it is useless to dispute with them. Make peace and restore Maithili to the son of **DASARATHA** I "

CHAPTER 26

Sarana tells Ravana of the principal Leaders of the Monkeys

" Even did the Gods, Gandhatvas and Danavas unitedly seek to attack me and were all beings to tremble, I would not restore **SITA**; O Friend, having been roughly handled by the monkeys thou dost feat them and for this deemest it opportune for me to give up **SITA** ! What adversaty is able to overcome me in ? " Having uttered this atrogant speech, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, in order to survey the horizon, proudly went up to his palace that was as white as snow and as high as innumerable palm ttees. Accompanied by his ministers, **RAVANA**, who was ttansponed with anger, swept the mountains, forests and ocean with his glance and he beheld the entire region covered with Plavamgamas. Seeing that illimitable and invincible atmy of monkeys, **RAVANA** enquired of Satana, saying : " Who are the leaders of these monkeys ? Who are their Watriors ? Who their ptinces ? Who are those marching at their head in order to demonattate their valour ? Who are 63 **SUGRIVA**'s counsellors and his generals? Tell me all, O Ssrana I What is the sttength of these monkeys ? " Sarona, thus interrogated by thst Sovereign of the Titans being well-informed, pointed out the leaders of those dwellers in

the woods to him. **HE** *said*: " That monkey who stands before Lanka roaring amidst a hundred thousand leaders who escort him, whose powerful voice shatters the whole city with its walls, gates and arches, its rock., forests and jungles and who is in command of the army of the magnanimous **SUGRIVA**, Lord of all the Deer of the Trees, is the valiant General Nita. “He who holds his arms bigh and who tramples the esrth under his feet as he marches, thst hero whose face is turned towards Lanka and who, in fury, yswns convulsively, who resembles the peak of a mountain in stature and the filaments of a lotUS in hue, who, in an excess of anger, continuously lashes out with his tail, the swish of which is heard in the ten regions, thst warrior whom Sugliva, the King of the Monkeys, installed as heir-apparent, is named Angads and he is challenging thee to combat. That warrior, the equal of his sire, Bali, is beloved of **SUGRIVA** and as devoted to Raghava’s interests as **VARUNA** is to Shakra’s. That **JANAKA**’s daughter has been seen by **HANUMAN**, who is as swift as the wind and the servant of Raghava, is all due to the advice of **ANGADA**. Having formed innumerable hartalions with the foremost of monkeys, thst warrior is marching againat thee at the head of his army in order to destroy thee. “Qose to Bali’s son and himself surrounded by a considerable number of troops, the valiant Nala, the builder of the bridge, stands ready on the battlefield. “Those soldiers clad in saffron colour, who are stretching their Umbs, roaring and gnashing their teeth, are following the one who boasts thst he will overthrow Lanka with his forces : it is Shveta of silver hue, who is exceedingly agile and brave ; thst intelllgent monkey, a warriot renowned in the Three Worlds bas come to take bis orders from **SUGRIVA** and willlesve at once ID place the army of IIIOIIkeys in strategic positions and inspire enthusiasm amongat his divisions. “That one who formerly ranged the Mountain Ramys, thst is also called

Samrocana on the borders of the Gawnati River and 63 wbicb is covered with of varying fragrance, ruled over a kingdom there, is the General Kumuda and that other, who joyfully draws in bia ttain hundreds and thousands of warriors with long hait and immense tails hanging dowo, who ate coppery-coloured, ycllow, black, wbite and matted, hideous to look upon, is the intrepid Monkey *Kanda*. He yeatnS to tight and boasts that he will destroy Lanka with bis forces. “The thitd, who resembles a tawny lion with a great mane and whose gaze is fixed attentively on the city as if he wished to consume it with bia glances, who dwells mostly on the Mountains Krishna and Sahya of the Vindhya Range of pleasing aspect, is the General Rambba, O King. Three hundred kotis of the most valiant of monkeys who ate formidable, impetuOus, burning with ardour surround him and follow in bia steps for the purpose of causing the destruction of Lanka by their blows. “The one who is shaking bis ears and yawning continuously, who, when facing death remains immoveable and who never retreats in the face of a hostile army but eyeing them askance foams with rage ; he who lashes out with bia tail and gnashes bia teeth, that hero of immense energy, wholly devoid of fear, O King, has bis abode on the ravishing Mountain of the Sa!veyas and the name of that leader is Sharabba ; to him belong forty hundred thousand monkeys named Viharas’. " The one who is like unto a great cloud enveloping space and who, surrounded by monkey warriors, resembles Vasava amidst the Gods, whose voice like the roll of a drum, can be heard from the midst of the monkeys, who is eager to fight, dwclls in Pariyatra, a mountain that is exceeded by none in height ; that general ever invincible in combat is named Panasa. That commander with fifty lakhs of lieutenants, each of whom leads bia own battalion, who sbines resplendent amidst the host of monkeys of terrifying bounds, who are encamped on the seashore challenges thee to combat. His

lieutenants are full of daring and vigour and each commands a battalion. That monkey whose body is well nourished and who is of the colour of red ochre, who, in the pride of his strength ever holds the other monkeys in contempt, is the illustrious Gavaya. He is advancing towards thee full offury and seventy hundred thousand warriors accompany him ; he also boasts that he will lay Lanka waste with his troops. “Those invincible heroes may not be numbered and the flower of their captains are each at the head of his own particular force.”

CHAPTER 27

Sarana continues his Deposition

“I shall describe these valiant leaders that thou art able to see, who are devoted to Raghava, full of prowess and who count their lives as nought. That one, the hairs adhering to whose enormous tail are coppery, yellow, black, white and hideously matted and that stand on end, a tail that brilliant as the sun’s rays brushes the earth as he advances, is the Monkey Hara. He is followed by hundreds and thousands of monkeys brandish ing trees, awaiting the moment to attack Lanka ; they are the leaders of the Monkey King and in the service of the Simian government. “Those warriors, whom thou perceivest in such incalculable numbers, that are no more able to be counted than the sands on the limitless shores of the sea and who cover the mountains, plains and rivers, ranged like sombre clouds, black as collyrium, extremely ferocious and valiant fighters, are the bears ; observe how they are advancing to confront thee, O King. In their midst, surrounded on evety side by them, like Parjanya by stortn clouds, is their sovereign of dreadful glance and fearful aspect ; he inhabits Rikshavat, a very high

mountain and goes to slake his thirst at the Narmada River; he is the lord of all the bears and his name is Dhumra I He has a brother, 6s younger than he, who resembles him in stature but who 1ilr surpasses him in valour ; behold him, **JAMBAVAN**, like unto a mountain ! Of controlled senses, he is full of reverence for his spiritus! superiors and implacable in combat. His intelli gence greatly assisted Shakra in the war between the Gods and the titans and he was the recipient of many boons. These giants hurl down great rocks as large as clouds from the mountain heights, which they have scaled, nor do they tremble in the face of death. Shaggy, resembling *Rakshasas* or Pisachas, those warriors of surpassing energy roam about in great numbers. And that commander on whom the eyes of the monkeys are fixed, who now leaps up in fury and then stands motionless, that foremost of monkeys, O King, dwells on the Sahasraksha Mountain, and the name of that exceedingly valiant leader is Rambha. “He who, walking on all fours touches the mountain a league away with his flanks, whose chest is a league in height, who is not surpassed by any quadruped in beauty is the renowned Samnadana, the Grandsite of the Monkeys. Extremely skiltW, he formerly entered into combat with Shakra on the battlefield, who was unable to defeat him, such is that superinr leader. “Another whose valour equals **INDRA**’s on the battlefield was bom of a youthful Gandharva maiden and Krishnavartman. In the struggle between the Devos and *Asuras* he brought help to the Celestials. That illustrinus one sits beneath the Jambhu tree on that mountain, the King of Peaks,' frequented by Kinneras, which constantly affords delight to thy brother, O Lord of the Titans. It is near there that that fortunate one, that powerful Lord of the Monkeys, General Krathana, whose prowess is not confined to words and who ever eschews defeat, sports. He is standing surrounded by thousands of monkeys ; he also undertakes to crush Lanka I “The one

who usually roams by the Ganges, sowing terror among the elephants, remembering, as he does, the old quarrel between elephants and monkeys, that leader with a voice of thunder, who dwella in the mountain caves, subduing the tllllren in the woods and uprooting the trees, that Prince of Monkeys, like unto **INDRA** himself, passes his life happily at the bad. of a host of monkeys by the river !hat issues from the Himalayas or Usbirabija, otherwise Mandara, the highest of mountaios. Hundreds and thousands and millions of monkeys, proud of their strength and agility, full of prowess and fire, roaring loudly, follow that indomitable warrior, their leader, named Pramatbin. It is he, resembling a great cloud propelled by the wind, whom thou hast pointed out, surtounded by a furious band of intrepid monkeys who stir up a cloud of yellow-coloured dust wbich the wind carries in all directions. Those formidable and powerful black-snouted Golangulas, numbering a hundred times a hundred thousand, who, having assisted in the constrUction of the causeway, have gathered growling round the General of the Golangulas, named Gavaksha, threaten to demolish Lanka themselves. There where, frequented by bees, the yield fruit in evety season, on that mountain encircled by the sun, the brightness of wbich it equals, the radiance of wbich shed on beast and bird, lends them the same brilliance, whose plateaus are never forsaken by the magnanimous and great Risbis, whose trees are laden with fruit possessed of evety desirable savour, where exceedingly rare honey abounds ; on that golden and ravishing mountain, the General Kesharin lives amidst those delights, O King. “There are sixty thousand wonderful golden mountaios in the midst of wbich Savamimeru stands out, as thou amongst the titans, O King I It is on that mountain, that brown, wbite and copper-coloured monkeys or those yellow as honey dwell, who possess pointed teeth and nails and who resemble lions ; they

are as indomitable as tigers, the equals of Vaishvanara, with their long coiled tails like unto serpents vomiting poison or like elephants intoxicated with ichor as bigh as great bills, and they roar like thunder ; their eyes are grey and round and when they are on the march they create an appalling uproar ; all of them stand looking on Lanka as if they were about to destroy it. In their midst is the powerful leader who ever faces the sun ; he is eager to conquer thee; bis name is renowned in the world, it is Shatahali, O King, and he swears to destroy Lanka with bis troops. Courageous, powerful, full of daring, he prides bimaelf on bis personal valour. In bis devotion to **RAMA** that lllOllkey will not spare bis life. " Gaja, Gavaksba, Gavaya, Nala, Nila, all those monkeys are surrounded by ten kotis of fighters each, as also other leading monkeys impossible to count, so great is their number, agile inhabitants of the Vindhya Raoge. All, O Great King, are exceedingly powerful, their stature is equal to high hills and all are capable of levelling the earth by uprooting and razing its mountains to the ground."

CHAPTER 28

Shuka in his turn enumerates the Enemy

SARANA hBving described the forces of the enemy to RBvana, the Lord of the TitanS, Shuka, in his tum, took up the tale, saying : " Dost thou observe those resembling elephants intoxiCBted with ichor, rising up like hanian trees on the banks of the Ganges or Sals Trees on the Himalayas ? " O King, those warriors, able to change their form at will, are irresistible, equal to the Daityas and Danavas and, in war, are endowed with the valour of the Gods. They number twenty-one million or more; they are **SUGRIVA**'s companions and Kishkindha is their

accustomed abode ; those monkeys born of the Gods and Gandharvas are CBpable of assuming different shBpes at will. " The two who stand there, who resemble each other and hBve the appearance of Gods, are Mainda and Dvivida, none is their equal in comhBt. Sanctioned by **BRAHMA**, they hBve drunk the water of immortality and they boast thBt they will demolish Lanka by their own prowess. " As for thBt monkey whom thou seest there, resembling an intoxiCBted elephant, who in strength and fury is able to chum up the ocean itself, it is he who came to Lanka to find Vaidehi and spy on thee, O Lord. ThBt monkey whom thou perceivest, has returned, he is the eldest son of Kesarin and his sire is said to be Vayu ; he is **HANUMAN**, who crossed the ocean. Able to change his shBpe at will, thBt handaome and courageous wanior “While yet a child, seeing the sun rise, he desired to eat it and, springing up, followed it to a distance of three thousand leagues, reftecting :-'I shall seize hold of Aditya and my hunger will be appeased forever ! ' In this thought, intoxicated with bis own strength, he leapt into the air but was unable to reach that God, who is invincible even to the Celestials, Risbis and Demons, and be fell on the mountain where that radiant orb rises. In bis fall he fractuted bis jaw slighdy on a rock and on account of the strength of his jaw he was called **HANUMAN** I " By associating with those monkeys I was enabled to leam bis history, yet I am quite unable to describe his ptowess, beauty and vigour adequately. He plumes himself on being able to desttoy Lanka single-banded ; it was he who formerly set fire to the city ; bow is it that thou dost not remember him ? “Nearby is a warrior, dark of hue with eyes like lotuSes, the Atiratha’ among the Ikshvakns ; bis heroism is well known in the world ; bis sense of duty never wavers nor does he ever swerve from righteousness ; he knows how to loose **BRAHMA**’s weapon and is conversant with the Veda ; indeed he is the most learned of Vedic scholars ; he shatters the

firmament with hia anows and rends the earth; his ire is equal to Mrityu's and he resembles **INDRA** in valour ; his consort is **SITA**, whom thou didst beat away from Janastbana ; he is **RAMA**, who bas come to wage war on thee, O King. " He who stands on his right, radiant as gold refined in the crucible, with a broad chest, reddened eyes and dark curly locks, is **LAKSHMANA**, who is devoted to bis brother's interests and fortune; a general and a seasoned soldier, he knows better than any bow to handle every weapon. Full of ardour, invincible, victorious, brave, accustomed to success and powerful, he bas ever been **RAMA**'s right band and hia very life's breath. Where it concerns Ragbava he would never be the one to seek to pteserVe bis life. He bas alao sworn to exterminate all the titans in battle. " He who stands on **RAMA**'s left and who is sunounded by a group of titans, is Bibisbana, whom that king of kings has installed as sovereign of Lanka ; he, filled with ire, is advancing in order to enter into conllict with thee I " The other whom thou seest standing in the centre like an immoveable rock, rules over the foremost of those deer of the branches; his prowess is immessurable; for energy, glory, intelligence, streogth and nobility, he stands out among those monkeys as Himavat amongst the mountains. He dwells with the principal monkey leaders in Kishkindha with its groves and trees, an inaccessible citadel of impenetrable approaches, excavated from the mountains. He wears a golden chain, wrougbt with a hundred lotuSes in which Lakshmi, who sym bolises prosperity, beloved of Gods and men, dwells. That chain, his consort Tara and the eternal empire of the monkeys, were cooferred on **SUGRIVA** by **RAMA** after he had slain Bali. " O King, a hundred thousand multiplied by a hundred, is called a koti and a hundred thousand such kotis make one shanku. A hundred thousand shankus make one maha shanku, a hundred thousand maha-shankus make one vrinda. A hundred thousand vrindas make a

maha-vrinda and a hundred thousand maha-vrindas make a padma. A hundred thousand padmas make a maha-padma and a hundred thousand maha padmas make a kharva. A hundred thousand kharvas make a samudra and a hundred thousand samudrsa make an ogna. A hundred thousand ognas make a maha-ogna. That Lord of the Monkeys as also Bibishana with his counsellon are sur rounded by a hundred thousand shankus, plus a hundred thousand maha-vrindas, a hundred padmas, a hundred thousand maha-padmas, a hundred kharvas, a samudra and a maha-ogna. a koti of maha-ognas and a thousand samudras, and that **SUGRIVA** has come to make war on thee I “Powetful is that army following the King of the Monkeys, who is ever strong and brave. In the presence of those forces that resemble a blazing meteor, O Great King, prepare thyself to vanquish the enemy and take measures to avoid defeat I " CHAPTBR 2!) Rauana sends out fresh Spies those foremost of monkey lesders pointed out by Shuka-the valiant **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA**’s right arm, his own brother Bibishana stsnding close to Raghava, the King of all the Monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, of exceeding prowess, the heroic Angsda, grandson of the Besrer of the Thunderbolt, the powerful **HANUMAN** and the invincible **JAMBAVAN**, Sushena, Kumuda, Nita and Nata, those paragons among the monkeys, Gaja, Gavaksha, Sharabha, Mainda and Dvivida-**RAVANA**, his heart agitated, became enraged and began to inveigh against those two heroes, Shuka and Sarana, who had completed their report. In a voice strangled with fury, he overwhelmed them with reproaches as they stood with bowed heads before him, saying : " In sooth it is scarcely fitting that such unpleasing words should be uttered by loyal servants to their king who has the power to mete out punishment or reward. That you should both hymn the praises of the foe belonging to an alien race who has come here to attack me, is unbecoming ! In vain have you sat at the feet of your

elders, spiritual preceptors and the aged, since the essential traditions of the scriptures do not rule your lives or, if you have imbibed them, you have not remembered them ; you are over-burdened with ignorance I Having such unintelligent servants as you are, it is a miracle that I am still able to wield the sceptre. Have you no fear of death that you dare address me thus insolently, I, whose tongue dispenses good and evil ?

CHAPTER 29

Ravana sends out fresh Spies

CHAPTBR 2!) Rauana sends out fresh Spies those foremost of monkey lesders pointed out by Shuka-the valiant **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA**'s right arm, his own brother Bibishana stsnding close to Raghava, the King of all the Monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, of exceeding prowess, the heroic Angsda, grandson of the Besrer of the Thunderbolt, the powerful **HANUMAN** and the invincible **JAMBAVAN**, Sushena, Kumuda, Nita and Nata, those paragons among the monkeys, Gaja, Gavaksha, Sharabha, Mainda and Dvivida-**RAVANA**, his heart agitated, became enraged and began to inveigh against those two heroes, Shuka and Sarana, who had completed their report. In a voice strangled with fury, he overwhelmed them with reproaches as they stood with bowed heads before him, saying : " In sooth it is scarcely fitting that such unpleasing words should be uttered by loyal servants to their king who has the power to mete out punishment or reward. That you should both hymn the praises of the foe belonging to an alien race who has come here to attack me, is unbecoming ! In vain have you sat at the feet of your elders, spiritual preceptors and the aged, since the essential traditions of the scriptures do not rule your lives or, if you have imbibed them, you

have not remembered them ; you are over-burdened with ignorance I Having such unintelligent servants as you are, it is a miracle that I am still able to wield the sceptre. Have you no fear of death that you dare address me thus insolently, I, whose tongue dispenses good and evil ? dead, ungrateful creatures, since you have no devotion for me I " Hearing these accusations, which covered them with confusion, Shuka and Sarana paid obeisance to **RAVANA**, saying :-" Be thou victorious ! " and withdrew. Then Dasbagriva said to Mahodara who stood beside him : " Bring me other emissaries quickly I " At this command, that Ranger of the Night, Mahodara, without delay summoned spies and these presenting themselves in all baste before the king, bailed him with joined palms and expressea their desire to see him victorious. Thereupon **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, said to those agents who were fu1J of confidence, courage and zeal and were fearless: " Go and find out **RAMA**'s plans, who are his ministers and who stand nearest to him in counsel and friendship, what are his hours of sleeping and waking and what he intends to do next. "A wise monarch who discovers all that concerns his adversary through his spies, needs to exert himself only to a moderate degree to overcome his enemy on the field of battle." "May it be so ! " answered the emissaries fu1J of joy and, placing Shardula at their head, they honoured their sovereign by circumambulating him. Having paid obeisance to that powerful Lord of the Titans, those spies set out for where **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** were to be found. Leaving in disguise they observed **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA** and Bibisbana near the Mountain Suvela. Beholding that army they were seized with tertor and as they stood there, the righteous Prince of the Titans, Bibisbana, recognized them and arrested them but Shardula alone was held captive, Bibisbana saying :-" This one is the traitor I " **RAMA** however released Sbardula also, who was being harassed by the

monkeys, having already in his compassion given the other titans their freedom. Beaten by those imperuous and agile monkeys, they returned to Lanka, groaning and beside themselves : and those emisaariea, valiant rangers of the night, who were wont to penetrate into enemy territory, retUrned to Dasbagriva and informed him that **RAMA**'s army was camping in the neighbourhood of the Suvela Mountain.

CHAPTER 30

Shardula gives an Account of his Mission to Ravana

THE King of Lanka's spies informed him tbat **RAMA** was camping with bis great army near Mount Suvela and, hearing from them of **RAMA**'s approsch at the head of a vast host, he was perturbed and said to Shasdula : " Thou appearest to be unmanned which is alien to thy nature, O Ranger of the Night I Can it be tbat thou hast fallen a victim to those savage monkeys ? " Thus questioned by tbat tiger among the titans, Shasdula, trembling with fear, answered in a faint voice, saying : " O King, it is impossible to spy on those lions among the monkeys, who are full of energy and prowess and protected by Raghava nor can one interrogate them in order to find out anything ! On all sides the approaches are guarded by monkeys as big as hills. " Scarcely had I penetrated into their ranks when I was recog nized and forcibly seized and myself interrogated in every way by those monkeys, who attacked me with their knees, fists, teeth and the palms of their hands ; thereafter I was led through the entire army by those pitiless monkeys who, having paraded me everywhere, brought me into **RAMA**'s presence, exhausted and bewildered, my limbs covered with blood and wounda. They wished

to murder me despite my supplications made with joined palms, when, fortunately I was saved by **RAMA** who cried ' Stay I ' ' Stay ! ' “That prince who has filled the sea with boulders and crags is encamped at the gates of Lanka, well equipped with weapons, Having reftected on what he had just heard, the King of the TitanS, **RAVANA**, made this significant reply : " Eveo were the Gods, Gandharvas and Danavas to arraign themselves against me and were the whole world in peril, I would not restore **SITA**.” Theo that exceedingly powerful one added : " Thou hast explored the ranb of their army, who are the warriors among the Plavamgamas ? What is the measure of their prowess ? Who are these invincible monkeys ? Whose sons and grandsons are they? Tell me the truth, O Faithful Frieod!” Thus interrogated, Shardula, the most skilled of eovoys, hegao to speak thus in **RAVANA**’s preseoce : " First there is the son of Ribharajas, invincible in war, O King, and the son of Gadgada. There follows another son of Gadgada and the son of the spiritual preceptor of Shatakratu, the father of the monkey who slew so many titans. Theresfter comes the vinuous Sushena, the valiant son of *Dharma*, theo Saumya born of *Soma*, O King, and the monkey Dadimukha and Sumukha, Durmukha and Vegadarshin, the equals of Mrityu, whom Swyambhu formerly begot in the form of monkeys, and further there is the great Nila himself, the son of the Bearer of the Sacrificial Offerings’ and the son of the Wind, **HANUMAN**. Theo there is the grandson of Shakra, the youthful, invincible and courageous **ANGADA**, and Mainda and Dvivida who are both valiant and equal to the Ashvins. Five are the sons of Vivasvata who resembles Time as the Destroyer, Gaja, Gavaya, Gavaksha, Sharabha and Gandhamadana. " There are ten kotis of monkeys full of prowess and martial ardour and I was unable to count the rest of those fortunate children of the Gods. " That son of **DASARATHA** with the body of a lion, that youth, **RAMA**, to

whom none in the world can he compared for valour, slew Dushana, Khara, Ttishirss and Viradha who fell under his blows, as also Kabandha, the equal of Antaka. No one is able to describe Rams's qualities by whom the titans who went to Janasthana were slain. " There too is the virtuous Labhmana like unto the foremost of elephants, Matanga, in the path of whose shafts Vasava himself could not survive I There are also Shvets and Jyotirmukha, both born ofBhashkara and the ofVaruna, the monkey Hemaketu. The heroic son of Vishvakarma, the foremost of monkeys NaJa, and the impetuous son of Vasu, Durdhara. " Finally there is that prince of the titanS, thy brother Bibishana, on whom **RAMA** has conferred the City of Lanka as the reward for his devotion. Thus I have described the entire army of monkeys stationed on the Mount Suvela ; it is for thee to decide what remains to be done ! " RMJana deceiws **SITA** about the Death of **RAMA** the king's spies spresd the tidings in Lanka that Raghava was encamped with his powerful forces on Mount Suvela. **RAVANA**, who knew, through his emissaries, of **RAMA**'s arrival at the head of a vast army, somewhat perturbed, said to his attendants : " Let all the ministets assemble here immediately I O TitanS, the time has come to take counsel together I " On this command, his counsellors instantly csme together and he entered into conference with those loyal titans, then, having duly deliberated with them concerning the immediate

CHAPTER 31

Ravana deceives Sita about the Death of Rama

Of elephants, Matanga, in the path of whose shafts Vasava himself could not survive I There are also Shvets and Jyotirmukha, both born

ofBhashkara and the ofVaruna, the monkey Hemaketu. The heroic son of Vishvakarma, the foremost of monkeys NaJa, and the impetuous son of Vasu, Durdhara. " Finally there is that prince of the titanS, thy brother Bibishana, on whom **RAMA** has conferred the City of Lanka as the reward for his devotion. Thus I have described the entire army of monkeys stationed on the Mount Suvela ; it is for thee to decide what remains to be done ! " RMJana deceiws **SITA** about the Death of **RAMA** the king's spies spresd the tidings in Lanka that Raghava was encamped with his powerful forces on Mount Suvela. **RAVANA**, who knew, through his emissaries, of **RAMA**'s arrival at the head of a vast army, somewhat perturbed, said to his attendants : " Let all the ministets assemble here immediately I O TitanS, the time has come to take counsel together I " On this command, his counsellors instantly csme together and he entered into conference with those loyal titans, then, having duly deliberated with them concerning the immediate Raghava's and a mighty bow, its arrows set, and then present thyself before me ! " On this command, that Ranger of the Night, Vid}ujjihva, answered " Be it so" and displayed his powers as a magician, whereupon **RAVANA**, satisfied, bestowed rich attire upon him. In his impatience to behold **SITA** once again, that mighty monarch of the Nairritas entered the Ashoka Grove and the younger brother of Dhanada beheld that unfortunate One who did not deserve her fate, her head bowed, plunged in grief, lying on the ground in the Ashoka Grove where she had been banished, absorbed in the thought of her lord, hideous titan women sested not far distant from her. Then **RAVANA**, approaching, manifested his gratification and addressed that daughter of **JANAKA** in confident tones, saying : " O Beautiful One, he in whom thou didst trust at the time when thou didst repel me when I sought to console thee, that murderer of Khara, thy consort Raghava, has been slain in comhat. Thy roots

completely severed and thy pride humbled by me ; in consequence of the calamity that has over taken thee, thou art mine ! Give up thy resolution therefore, what wilt thou do with one dead? O Beautiful One, become the chief Queen over all my consorts, thou who till now hast enjoyed so little happiness, thou who art without resources I O Foolish One, who deemest thyself wise, hear how, like unto the destruction ofVritra, thy lord was slain! " In order to destroy me, Raghava alighted on the shore of the ses surrounded by a vast artny assembled by the King of the Monkeys. Having ranged the northern shore with his great legions, **RAMA** strnck camp when the sun set. Sending out “Bibishana, who was wandering about aimlessly, was taken captive whilst **LAKSHMANA** and the monkey warriors fled in all directions. **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Plavagas bad bia neck broken, O **SITA** ; **HANUMAN** of the fractured jaw was slain by the titans. **JAMBAVAN**, wbile attempting to rise from his knees perished in the mElee like an axed tree pierced by innumerable harpoons. Mainda and Dvivida, those two great scourgers of their foes, the foremost of monkeys, groaning and breathless, their limbs bathed in blood were cut to pieces by the sword, and Panasa, crying for help, was stretched on the earth under a tree of the same name. Pierced by coundess Narachas, Darimukha is lyiog in a pit and the exceedingly valiant Kumuda died shrieking, under a hail of missiles. **ANGADA**, assailed on all sides by titans, pierced by innumerable shafts, vomiting blood, fell on the earth and the monkeys themselves were crushed by elephants and mowed down like clouds before the wind. “The enemy Bed in terror under the blows of the titans, who followed on their heels like lions pursuing great elephants. Some ftung themselves into the sea, others took refuge in the sky ; the bears with the monkeys climbed the trees whilst the titans of fierce glance brought about a great carnage amongst the Pingalas in the midst of the rocks and woods on the shores

of the ocean. It was thus tbat thy consort perished with bia forces ! Here is his head, which was gathered up, dripping with blood and besmeared with dust ! " Thereafter tbat abominable **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, said to the titan women in the hearing of **SITA** : " Bring hither Vidyujjihva of cruel deeds, who himself brought back Ragbava's head from the field ! " Then Vidyujjihva, holding the hesd and the bow, bowed before **RAVANA**, whereupon the King said to tbat Titan Vidyujjihva of the long tongue, who stood before him : " Let **SITA** speedily behold the head of Dasaratba's son so tbat she may see clearly the sad end of her lord. " On this command, the titan threw the cherished head at **SITA**'s feet and immediately went away. **RAVANA**, however, brandishing tbat great and brilliant bow, cried out : " Here is **RAMA**'s bow famed in the Three Worlds I This is the bow with its cord stretched belonging to **RAMA** tbat Prahasta 77 brought back from the field after he had slain that hero in the night!" Speaking thus, he cast the bow on the ground near the head, which had been thrown down by Vidyujjihva, and thereafter he addressed that illustrious daughter of the Kiog of Videha, saying: " Now submit thyself to my desire ! " CHAPTER 3Z **SITA**'s Despair that head and the marvellous bow and remembering the alliance with **SUGRIVA** of which **HANUMAN** had spoken; seeing those eyes and the hue of the countenance resembling that of her lord and the locks at the fringe of which a jewel shone on the brow, all those signs that convinced her of her misfortune, that wretched woman began to inveigh against **KAIKEYI** and cry out like an osprey, exclaiming: " Rest content, O **KAIKEYI** I He, who was the deligbr of his House is dead and, thtough thee, the entire race has perished, O Sower of Discord I What had the noble **RAMA** ever done to **KAIKEYI** that she should have presented him with a robe of bark and sent him to the forest ? " Speaking thus, Vaidehi began to tremble and that young ascetic fell to the ground like a plantain

cut to the roots. After a time the youthful large-eyed woman, regaining her breath and consciousness, approached the head and gave herself up to lamentation, ctying : " Alas I I am undone ! O Great-atmed Warrior, faithful to thine heroic vow, herefr of thee, I have fallen into the lowest depth of calamity. It is said that fot a woman, the death of her husband is the greatest of misfortunes I Virtuous consort of a faithful companion, thou hast preceded me in death I I have fallen into the last extremity and am swallowed up in an ocean of grief, aince thou hast been struck down, thou who elae had risen to deliver me I My mother-in-law, **KAUSHALYA**, who

CHAPTER 32

Sita's Despair

brought back from the field after he had slain that hero in the night!" Speaking thus, he cast the bow on the ground near the head, which had been thrown down by Vidyujjihva, and thereafter he addressed that illustrious daughter of the Kiog of Videha, saying: " Now submit thyself to my desire ! " CHAPTER 3Z **SITA**'s Despair that head and the marvellous bow and remembering the alliance with **SUGRIVA** of which **HANUMAN** had spoken; seeing those eyes and the hue of the countenance resembling that of her lord and the locks at the fringe of which a jewel shone on the brow, all those signs that convinced her of her misfortune, that wretched woman began to inveigh against **KAIKEYI** and cry out like an osprey, exclaiming: " Rest content, O **KAIKEYI** I He, who was the deligbr of his House is dead and, thtough thee, the entire race has perished, O Sower of Discord I What had the noble **RAMA** ever done to **KAIKEYI** that she should have presented him with a robe of bark

and sent him to the forest ? " Speaking thus, Vaidehi began to tremble and that young ascetic fell to the ground like a plantain cut to the roots. After a time the youthful large-eyed woman, regaining her breath and consciousness, approached the head and gave herself up to lamentation, ctying : " Alas I I am undone ! O Great-atmed Warrior, faithful to thine heroic vow, herefr of thee, I have fallen into the lowest depth of calamity. It is said that fot a woman, the death of her husband is the greatest of misfortunes I Virtuous consort of a faithful companion, thou hast preceded me in death I I have fallen into the last extremity and am swallowed up in an ocean of grief, aince thou hast been struck down, thou who elae had risen to deliver me I My mother-in-law, **KAUSHALYA**, who 78 cherished thee tenderly, thou, her son Ragbava, now resembles a cow that bas lost its calf. Those wbo boast that they can foretell the future prophesied a long life for thee ; false were their words, for thou bast barely lived, O **RAMA**, or does prudence percbauce sometimes desert those wbo are usually prudent as thou wert, for time, the master of all beings brings all to maturity? How bas death been able to steal upon thee unawares, O Thou, versed in the law of polity and the science of expediency, wbo wert so skilled in warding off evil ? For baving clasped me in thine arms, that cruel and inhuman night of death bas robbed thee of existence by force, O Lotus-eyed One. Here an thou, lying on the ground, O Long-armed Warrior, having deserted me for the eanh, thy more cherished love, O Lion among Men ! O Hero, here lies thy golden bow so dear to me, which I anointed with perfumes and decorated with garlands ! Thou now re-united in heaven with thy Sire **DASARATHA**, my father-in-law and all thine ancestors, O Irreproachable Prince! " Thou dost disdain to rejoin the saintly race ofRajarishis, wbo through the merit of their virtuous conduct bave taken their places amongst the constellations. Why dost thou not look on me, O King ?

Why dost thou not speak to me, I, thy spouse, who joined my youth to thine ? Dost thou not recall the promise made to me when, taking my band in thine, thou didst say ' I shall be thy companion ? ' O Kakutstha, tske me with thee, wretched as I am! “Why, leaving this world for the other bast thou abandoned me in mine alBiction, O Thou, the wisest of Sages ? Wild beasts are tearing that beautiful body, now a corpse, which was formerly perfumed by my hands with divine essences. Having performed the Agnibotra and other sacrifices, accompanied by the bestowal of splendid gifts in charity, how is it that thou art not honoured by the performance of that same ceremony? Kausbalya, a prey to grief will see **LAKSHMANA** alone return of the three wbo went into exile On her enquiry be will inform her of the destruction of thine allies and bow thou wert slain while aaleep, whilst I was taken into the abode of the titsns, whereupon her heart will break ; Kausbalya will not survive, 79 O Raghava I Miserable creature tbat I am, it is on my account that the irreproachable **RAMA** who is till1 of valour, having croased the ocean has perished in the footprint of a cow. It was in an ill-judged moment that the son of Dasatatha wedded me, I, the obloquy of my race, for thus did the illustrious **RAMA** wed death. Without doubt in a previous existence I refused a rare gift, I who to-day weep for my lord, who here was dear to all. " O **RAVANA**, unite the wife with the husband and, without delay, let me die near **RAMA**. Join my head with his head and my body with his body ; O **RAVANA**, let me follow in the path of my magnanimous lord ! " Thus in her burning grief did that large-eyed princess, born of **JANAKA**, lament on seeing the head and bow of her lord and, as **SITA** was thus bewailing, a titan, who was standing guard at the gate, ran to his master with joined palms, crying : " Mayest thou be victorious, O Noble Lord ! " thereafter, approaching, he ioformed him of the arrival of Prahasta, the leader of the army, saying : " Prahasta,

accompanied by all the ministers, has come hither to lind thee ! O Mighty Monarch, thou whom the burden of royalty has rendered forbearing, accord him audience for some urgent decision must be taken I " Hearing these words of the titan, Dashagriva left the Ashoka Grove and went to join his counsellors. Then, having deliber ated with them as to what action to pursue, he entered the council chamber and issued his commands in accordance with the knowledge he possessed of **RAMA**'s forces. Meanwhile the instant **RAVANA** had departed, the illusoty head and bow vanished. Then. the King of the Titans, in consultation with his highly powerful ministers, decided on the measures he would adopt against **RAMA**. All the generals devoted to his interests stood near and **RAVANA** the Lord of the Titans resembled Death the Destroyer while he addressed them, saying : " With the beating of drums, summon all the forces without further ezplanatinn I " " So be it ! " they answered obedient to his commands and iostantly gatheted the vast army together and, when they were all assembled, informed the king who was burning to fight.

CHAPTER 33

Sarama consoles Sita

SEEING **SITA** in distress, that dear Vaidehi whom she loved so tenderly, a female titan named Sarama approached her and, with gentle words, sought to console her, overwhelmed as she was with the grief and anguish into which that lndra among the titans had plunged her. The affedionate Sarama, beholding **SITA** distraught, resembling a mare, who having rolled in the dust has just risen, reassured her and, in her deep devotion for that virtuous princess, said to her: " That which **RAVANA**

uttered and what thou thyself didst reply was overheard hy me as I stood concealed in the solitary grove, for where thou art the cause, I have no fear of **RAVANA**, O Lady of Large Eyes ! And I have also learnt, through my perspicacity, why that Lord of the Titans has gone hence in fear, O Maithili. " It is not possible to take the prudent **RAMA** by surprise during sleep nor can one slay the foremost of those conversant with the Self nor is it possible to wipe out the monkeys who fight with trees and who are under Rams's protection like the Gods under the King of the Celestials. With his long rounded arms, that broad-chested powerful archer, full of fire, e1ad in mail, who is essentially virtuous and renowned in the world, has, with the support of his brother Laltshmana, ever known how to defend himself and others ; he, that illustrinus warrior versed in the science of politics and warfare, the exterminator of hostile battalions, of inconceivable courage, nay that fortunate Ragbava, the scourge of his foes, has not perished, O **SITA**. " Perverse in thought and action, that tyrant who oppresses all beings, made use of magic to deceive thee. Banish thy 81 grief, great happiness awaits thee I Aasuredly thou att beloved of Lakshmi ; now hear some pleasant tidings, O Blessed One ! " Having crossed the ocean with his army of monkeys, **RAMA** bas come to the southern shore where he bas coca mpcd. I perceive that Kakutstha, who is accompanied by Lakshmaoa, bas fully attained his purpose, he is secure in the midst of innumerable allies who have halted on the shores of the sea. " Zealous titanS scot out to reconnoitre by **RAVANA** have brought him news of Ragbava's crossing the ocean. Learning of this, O Large-eyed Princess, he held a council of his ministerS." While Sarama, the titan woman, was conversing thus with **SITA**, a terrifying clamour issuing from the full-thtoated titanS came to her ears and a great din of gongs strUCk with sticks could be heard. Thereupon the gcotlc-spcaking Sarama said to **SITA**: " Listen to that formidable clang of gongs struck

with sticks which resembles thunder. Intoxicated elephants arc saddled and steeds harnessed to chariots ; hosts of combatants are to be scco with darts in their hands mounted on their horses, fully equipped, rushing hither and thither in their thousands. The toyal highways arc choked with soldiers wonderful to behold, leaping and roaring like the waves of the sea. Glittering armour, breast-plates, shields, chariots, horses and elephants belonging to the titans full of 6re and courage, surging forward, follow in the wake of their king. Sec how they scod forth shafts of light of every hue. That multitude of titanS indicates that a terrible calamity is about to descend on them causing the hair to stand on cod. " **RAMA**, thy consort, whose eyes resemble lotus petals, like unto Vasava the Vanquisher of the Daityas, will win thee back by slaying **RAVANA** in combat by his unimaginable prowesa, whereupon, his anger appeased, he will take thee away. Thy lord with I.akshmna will fall on the titanS as Vaaava with **VISHNU** on his enemies the Daityas. I shall soon see thee in the lap of **RAMA** who bas come hither, all thy desires fulfilled and the tyrant fallen. Tears of joy will fall from thine eyes. O Janaki. when thy lord, re-united with thee, will hold thee claaped to his breast. Ere long, O Divine **SITA**, that mighty h **RAMA** will loosen the plait that hangs down thy back which thou hast worn these many months. " Beholding his radiant countenance resembling the full moon, O Queen, thou wilt renounce thy tears, born of grief, as the female snake casts off its slough. " Having destroyed **RAVANA** in combat, he will assuredly not delay in rejoicing thee, O Maitbili, thou, his beloved, so that he may enjoy the felicity he merits. Embraced by the magnani mous **RAMA**, thou shalt be happy, even as the open field bringing forth a harvest under plenteous showers. Do thou now seek refuge with him, O Queen, that sun, thine haven, which spreads from here to the highest of mountains, like a steed that courses rapidly in its path, he is the Lord of all beings ! "

CHAPTER 34

Sarama spies on Ravana's Plans

as the parched earth by rain. Desiring to be of further service to her friend, the affectionate female titan, skilled in the know ledge of time and place, smiling, began to speak in apposite terms, saying : " O Dark-eyed Lady, I am able to carry a message of goodwill from thee to **RAMA** and return secretly, for when I am journeying in the sky, that is extended without support, not even Pavana or **GARUDA** can follow in my wake." Thus spoke Sarama, and **SITA**, her voice no longer charged with grief, answered in gentle and caressing tones, saying : " Thou art capable of ascending to heaven itself or descending into the nethermost regions. Learn what is best for thee to do, if thine intention is to please me and thy resolve is fixed. wish to know what **RAVANA** is doing now. That powerful magician, the ruthless **RAVANA**, a real **RAVANA**' to his foes, has bemused me with his wickedoess as wine recently imbibed ; he threatens me continually and insults me unceasingly while titans of frightful aspect surround me ; I am a prey to terror and my spirit is uneasy. He causes me to tremble with fear in this Ashoka Grove where I am confined. If in the assembly there be any talk of delivering me or keeping me captive, then com municate the decision taken to me and thou wilt render me a great service." Thus spoke **SITA** and Sarama answered in gentle tones, wiping the tears from her face the while : " If this be thy wish, I will go at once and when I have discovered his design, I will retUrn, O Maithili, O Daughter of **JANAKA** 1" With these words she returned to where **RAVANA** was to hear what decision he had taken with his ministers. Having liStened secretly and learnt of the plans that perverse wtetch had made, she returned to the enchanting Ashoka

Grove. On enrering there, she beheld the daughter of J anoka waiting for her, like unto Lakshmi bereft of her lotuS. Thereupon **SITA** ardently embraced Sarama who had returned and addressed her in friendly tones, offering her het own seat, saying: " Rest at ease and tell me exactly all that the ruthless **RAVANA** of perverse soul has resolved to do." Then Sarama described the whole interview of **RAVANA** with his ministers to the trembling **SITA**, saying : " The mother of the King of the Titans, through an aged counsellor, who is devoted to her, insisted again and again that they should let Vaidehi go, saying: " 'Let them retUrn Maithili honourably to that King of Men 1 His astonishing exploits in Janasthana should be a lesson to thee ; what mortal could have accomplished the crossing of the ocean, the discovery of **SITA** by **HANUMAN** and the carnage of the titans in comhat ? ' " Thus did the elderly minister and his mother exhort him but he is no more capable of giving up his treasure than a miser his gold. He will never set thee free unless he is slain in comhat, O Maithili ; such is the resolve of that wicked wtetch made with his counsellors ; impelled by death his determination is fixed. Fear will 110\'er cause **RAVANA** to let thee go ; nor will he do so .. till he is struck down by weapons or all the titans and he himself have succumbed. When he bas destroyed **RAVANA** with his sharp arrows in combat, **RAMA** will take thee back to Ayodbya, O Dark-eyed Lady ! " At that moment the cheering of the whole army blended with the roll of drums and the blare of trumpetS arose and the earth shook. That tumult raised by the monkey forces was heard by the adherents of the King of the Titans, who were assembled in Lanka, and their spirits fell. Seeing no hope on account of their sovereign's olfencc they were plunged in despondency.

CHAPTER 35

Malyavan advises Ravana to make peace

IT was to the beating of gongs and the blare of trumpets that the long-armed Rasns, the conqueror of hostile cities, approached Lanka and, on hearing this tumult, the Lord of the Titans paused a moment to reflect and then addressed his ministerS. The mighty **RAVANA**, in a voice that resounded through the ball, began to decry **RAMA**, his valour, the strength of his arms and his crossing of the ocean, saying : " I have heard all that is reported of Rasns ; I know too of your courage in the field, yet, on beholding that valiant warrior, you now look on each other in silence ! " Thereupon hearing the words of **RAVANA**, whose maternal grandfather he was, the highly intelligent Titan Malyavan answered him thus : " O King, that monarch who is versed in the fourteen sciences, who follows polity, rules an empire over a long period and overcomes his adversaries, who concludes peace or wages war at a fitting time, advances his own party and attains great power. A monarch should ally himself to one stronger than himself or to an equal ; he should never underrate a foe and if he is more powerful, should make war on him. On this account I counsel an allisncc with Rasns and the return of **SITA** o ss who is the actual cause of the dispute. *Devas*, Risbis, Gand harvas, all desire bim to triumph ; do not wage war but resolve to mske pesce with bim ! " The blessed Grandsire created two paths that rest either on righteousness or unrighteousness, the path of the Gods and the path of the titans. Righteousness is the path of the magnani mous Immonals and unrighteousness that of the demons and titans. When virtue consumed evil, it was the Krita Age and when wrong-doing swallowed up virtue, the Tishya planet was in the ascendant and thou, adopting

unrighteousness, didst range the worlds destroying vinue ; it is on account of this that thy foes have waxed powerful ! The serpent of evil, nourished by thy folly, is now consuming us, wbile those allied with the Gods are fortified by their practice of virtue. A slave of the senses, all that thou undenakest excites the wrath of the ascetics, those personifications of the Fire-God whose power is as inesistible as the glowing llames. They purify their souls through austerities and find satisfaction in the perfonnance of their duty. In truth, those Twice-born offer innumerable and excellent sacrifices, kindling the sacred fire in accordance with prescribed rituals ; they recite the Vedas in a loud voice and utter sacred texts while subduing the titans. Scattered in all directions, like the stonny waves during the hot season, the smoke, arising from the Agnihotra performed by those Risbis, the equals of **AGNI**, spreads over the ten cardinal points and diminishes the titans' energy. In the various regions sanctified by their religious observances, the burning austerity ofthose ascetics torments the titans. " Thou hast received the boon of invincibility from *Devas*, Danavas and Yakshas but these are men, bears and powerful Golangulas who, full of energy and prowess, are coming hither roaring like lions. Beholding these sinister and formidable ponents of every kind, I foresee the total extermination of the titans. With a terrifying clamour, monstroua clouds, inspiring horror, rain hot blood on Lanka on every side. Those beasts drawing the ehariots are shedding tears. Discoloured with dust, the four quarters no longer shine ; serpents, jaekals and vultures are invading Lanka, gathering in the public squares with frightful cries ; standing before us in dream, coal black 86 women with white teeth res.:mbling Kali bunt into loud laughter, pillaging the dwellings and chattering incoherently ; in the houses, dogs devour the sacred offerings and donkeys are born of cows, rats of mongoose ; cats mate with tigers, pigs with dogs and Kinneras

with demons and men. Red-footed and white pigeons, messengers of death, by their ftight foretell the extetmination of the titans ; domesticated parrots, falling under the attack of other birds, call Chiehikuchi ' ! Birds and wild beasts, their eyes fixed on the sun, cry out ! Death in the shape of a human monster, deformed, bald and tawny-coloured, visits the dwellings in turn. These and other omens equally sinister appear. R.aghava of fixed prowess is, I deem, **VISHNU** in human form ; he is undoubtedly no mere man ; he who built a bridge over the deep is an exceedingly wonderful being ! Therefore, O **RAVANA**, for thine own good, conclude peace with Ramo who is the king of men." Having spoken thus, Malyavan, the bravest of warriors, aware of what was passing in **RAVANA**'s mind, eyeing him, became silent.

CHAPTER 36

Ravana directs Lanka's Defences

him thus: " I have closed mine ears to the speech thou hast made, albeit with good intentions ; how canst thnu hold a mere man like Ramo, who is single-handed, without any support but hard words to me, unless it be that thou desirest to spur me on I In truth, what man learned in the science of the Shastras would speak thus harshly to a seasoned warrior, were it not to incite him? " Having borne **SITA** away from the forest, she who resembles Sbri bereft of her lows, why, through fear, should I her to Raghava ? Thou shalt see him fall under my blows in the midst of the innumerable monkeys who surround him. How should **RAVANA**, whom the Deities themselves date not meet in single combat, experience fear in this encounter ? Rather would I be cut in rwain than bend before any I

Such was I from birth, it is my nature and unalterable ! Even if **RAMA** by some happy chance has been able to throw a bridge over the sea, what great marvel is there in that, that thou shouldst give way to terror ? It is true he has crossed the ocean with an army of monkeys but I swear to thee he will not alive." Beholding **RAVANA** to be highly provoked and speaking with such fury, Malyavan, abashed, did not reply and duly invoking his success as courtesy demanded, he begged permission to rerire. Meanwhile **RAVANA**, assisted by his ministers, having deliber ated on what ought to be done, set about planning the defence of Lanka. Thereafter he gave over the eastern gate to the Titan Prahasta and that of the south to the warriors Mahaparshwa and Mahodara. At the western gate he placed hia son Indrajita, a powerful magician, with a considerable force of titans and he established Shuka and Sarana at the northern gate, saying : " I myself shall take up that position also I " Finally he commanded the Titan Virupakaha, who was full of energy and courage, to occupy the centre of the city with a large number of soldiers. Taking every precaution for the safety of Lanka, that bull among the titans, under the sway of destiny, deemed his purpose accomplished. Having made provision for the defence of the city, he dismissed hia ministers and received the acclamationa of the assembly, after which he entered hia sumptunus inner apartments.

CHAPTER 37

Rama makes his Plans for the Attack

MEANWHILE that King of Men, the Sovereign of the Monkeys, the Son of the Wind, **JAMBAVAN** the King of the Bears, the Titan Bibishana with Bali's son **ANGADA** and Saumitri, the Ape Sharabha, also Sushena

and his kinsfolk Mainda and Dvivida, Gaja, Gavaksha, Kumuda, NaJa and Panasa, all having reached the enemy's territory, assembled to take counsel together. **THEY** *said*:-" YonderunderourveryeyesistheCityofLanka defended by **RAVANA**, impregnable even to the Gods and *Asuras* together or the Uragas and Gandhasvas. Let us take counsel as to what means to adopt that will ensure the success of our expedition in order to penetrate into the eternal retreat of **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans." At this, the younger brother of **RAVANA**, Bibishana, uttered these words that were both just and irreproachable : " Anala, Panasa, Sampati and Pramati have been to Lanka from whence they have returned. Assuming the forro of birds, all four entered that hostile citadel and studied the measures taken by **RAVANA** closely. I will give a detailed report as it was given to me of the defences organized by that perverse wretch ; O **RAMA**, hear me ! "At the eastern gate, Prahasta is stationed with his division; at the southern gate are the warriors Mahaparshwa and Mahodara; lndrajita is at the western gate where he is in command of a considerable force armed with harpoons, swords, bows, spears and hammers. **RAVANA**'s son has thousands of warriors under his command, holding lances in their hands, furnished with weapons of every kind. "Apprehensive, a prey to great anxiety, **RAVANA**, versed in the sacred formulas, is himself stationed with the titans at the northern gate. As for Virupaksha, he, with a strong detachment armed with spears, clubs and bows occupies the centre of the city. " Having seen these hosts thus distributed, my spies have set out in all haste and returned again. The elephants number some ten thousand, the cavalry twenty thousand and there are more than a million foot soldiers. Hardy and vigorous, these intrepid warriors have ever been their sovereign's favourites; each of the titan generals, when on campaign, commands a million soldiers, O Lord of Men." Having

conveyed this information concerning the city, the mighty Bibishana brought his envoys before **RAMA** and those titans confirmed all that was known regarding Lanka. Thereafter the younger brother of **RAVANA**, in his desire to please Raghava, addressed that Lorus-eyed One further, saying : " O **RAMA**, when **RAVANA** made war on Kuvera, seven million soldiers accompanied him. For vigour, daring, energy, extreme power of endurance and pride, they equalled their wicked king. There is no question here of my wishing to agitate thee by what I have said but a desire ro rouse thine indignation, not thy fears, for in knightly valour, thou art equal to the Gods themselves. Having set out these monkey forces in batde atray, thou shalt destroy **RAVANA** with thy great army composed of four angas which surround thee." Bibishana having spoken thus, Raghava gave his orders for the attack, saying : " At the eastern gate, Nila, that lion among monkeys, should oppose Prahasta with his innumerable infantry and let Bali's son, **ANGADA**, at the head of a strong division, drive away Mahaparshwa and Mahodara from the southern gate; that son of the Wind, whose valour is immeasurable, will penetrate into the city with his great forces. " I reserve the right to slay the wicked King of the Titans, who owing to the boon he has received enjoys oppressing the Daityss and Danavas as also the magnanimous *Rishis* and who ranges the worlds persecuting all beinga. With the aid of Saumitri I shall force an entry through the northern gate and follow in the wake of **RAVANA** and his army. Let the mighty lndra among Monkeys, the valiant King of the Bears and the younger brother of the Lord of the Titans occupy the cenual position. " The monkeys should not assume human form in the fray for, when we are fighting in the tanks, the monkey shape should serve as a sign of recognition amongst us. Seven will attack the foe in human form, I, my brother **LAKSHMANA**, who is full of valour, my friend Bibishana and his four companions." Having

said this to Bibishana for the success of the enterprise, **RAMA**, in the role of a wise leader, decided to stay on Mount Suvela whose ravishing slopes he had observed. Thereafter at the head of his great army which spread over the earth, the magnanimous **RAMA** set out for Lanka with a joyous and exultant air, resolved to destroy his enemy.

CHAPTER 38

The Ascent of Mount Suvela

HAVING resolved to stay on Mount Suvela, Rams, followed by Laksbmana, addressed **SUGRIVA** and also Bibishana the night ranger, who was full of integrity, devotion, sagacity and experience and, in tones of great sweetness and nobility, said : " Let us ascend the Mount Suvela, that king of peaks and plateaus, filled with hundreds of metallic veins, in order to pass the night there. Then we shall be able to survey Lanka, the haunt of that titan, that wretch who bas borne away my consort to his own destruction! He bas neither regard for justice, virtue nor the honour of his House, he, who, in consequence of his base nature, has committed this heinous deed." Thus reflecting and censuring **RAVANA**, **RAMA** approached Mount Suvela with its ravishing slopes and began the ascent. Behind him came Laksbmana, proud of his great valour, alert, bearing his bow and arrows and **SUGRIVA**, who with his ministers and Bibishana scaled the mountain also. Those rangers of the hills bounded with the speed of the wind scrambling from a hundred sides at once in the steps of Ragbava and did not take long to reach the summit. From there they observed that splendid city with its marvellous gates enclosed in magnificent ramparts, as if suspended in the 91 air ; thus did Lanka, filled with warrion, appear to those monkey leaden and,

standing on those wonderful ramparts, the dark hued titans resembled a second wall in the eyes of the foremost monkeys. Beholding them, the monkeys, in **RAMA**'s presence, burning to fight, redoubled their cries. Meanwhile the sun, dyed with the fires of dusk, moved towards the west, and the night, illumined by the full moon, drew on. Then **RAMA**, the leader of the monkey army, having exchanged salutations with Bihishana, established himself happily on the breast of Mount Suvela with the leaders of the monkeys.

CHAPTER 39

Description of Lanka

them to be so extensive, agreeable, pleasant, vast and wide, marvellous to behold, they were seized with admiration. Champakas, Ashokas, Bakulas, Salas and Talas abounded ; Tamalas, Hintalas, Arjunas, Nipas, Saptaparnas in full flower, Nagas, Tilakas, Kamikaras and Patalas grew on every side. The trees with their fiowering crests, round which magnificent erc!epers twined, gave Lanka a brilliant appearance which she owed also to the borders planted with diverse fiowers and red and tender buds as also innumerable shady avenues. The blossom and fragrant fruit with which the trees were laden caused them to resemble men adorned with jewels or the ravish ing Chaitaratha, the equal of the Nandana Gardens, a grove resplendently green in all seasons, filled with swarming bees and sparkling with beauty. Then the valiant monkeys able to change their shape at will penctnted into those groves frequented by waterfowl intoxicated with love and with honey bees where the branches of the trees were filled with cuckoos and resounded to the notes of the shrike and the cry of the osprey and, as they entered there, a

breeze redolent with the scent of fiowers blew like a soft breath. Meanwhile some of the leaders broke away from the monkey ranks and, with the permission of their prince, approached that paved city. Terrifying the birds, deer and elephants, they shook Lanka with their roaring, excelling as they did in shouting and, in their immense ardour, they trampled down the earth so that the dust rose in clouds under their feet. Bears, lions, buffaJo, wild elephants, antelopes and birds, alarmed by the noise, spread over the ten points of the horizon. The Trikuta Mountain had an exceedingly lofty summit that appeared to touch the skies ; it was covered with blossom, sparkling like gold, a hundred leagues in extent, stainless, graceful to behold, smooth, inaccessible in height even to birds and could not be scaled even in thought, much Jess in reality ; it was on this promontory that Lanka was built of which **RAVANA** was the highway. Ten leagues wide, twenty in length, with its tall gates which resembled white clouds and its ramparts of gold and silver, it was a very marvel ! Palaces and temples were the splendid decoration of that city, as clouds at the end of summer are to the region of **VISHNU** that is found between earth and heaven. In Lanka, a building of a thousand piJJars artistically con sttucted, resembling the peak of Kailasha which seemed to lick the firmament, was to he seen. This was the retreat of the **INDRA** of the Titans and the ornament of the city, guarded constantly by a hundred titans. Ravishing with its gold, the mountains served as its decoration and it was dazzling with its rich parks and many squares re-echoing to the song of birds of every kind, frequented by deer, covered with various flowers, inhabited by titans of every degree, and that opulent city of immense resources resembled the celestial regions. Beholding that auspicious capital, the valiant elder brother of Lakahmana was seized with astonishment and **RAMA** with his -t army contemplated that citadel filled with treasure, abundantly

provisioned, garlanded with palaces, exceedingly strong, with its powerful engines of war and solid gates.

CHAPTER 40

The extraordinary Combat between Sugriva and Ravana

THEN **RAMA**, accompanied by **SUGRIVA** and his monkey leaders, ascended the summit of Mount Suvela that bad a circumference of two leagues ; thete he halted awhile, surveying the ten cardinal points and his gaze fell on Lanka which was ravishing with its enchanting groves that had been built by Vishvakarma on the summit of the Trikuta Mountain. Thete above a gateway stood the invincible Lotd of the Titans, white chanwaras being waved above him and the triumphal parasol indicating his rank. Anointed with red sandal-paste, adorned with scarlet ornaments, he was attired in raiment embroidered with gold and resembled a datk cloud. The scars of the wounds, infiicted on him by Airavata with his tusks, pitted his breast, and he was wrapped in a cloak of the colour of hare's blood so that he appeared like unto a cloud dyed with the tints of sunset. The **INDRA** of the Monkeys beheld him as Raghava also and, on seeing him, **SUGRIVA**, gathering up his strength, in an impulse of fury suddenly bounded from the summit of the mountain and descended at the gate. For a moment he paused, then with a fearless soul he eyed that titan whom he regarded as a mere straw and theteafter addressed him harshly, saying : " I am the friend of the Protector of the Worlds, **RAMA** ; by the grace of that King of Kings thou shalt not escape me to-day." Speaking thus he suddenly leapt upon him and, snatching off his brilliant diadem, tbrew it on the earth. Seeing him

about to rush upon him again, that Ranger of the Night said to him : " **SUGRIVA** thou wert unknown to me, now thou shalt be out on the limbs of both and their bodies were red with blood ; each clung to the other, paralysing his opponent's movements and they resembled the Shalmali and Kimshuka Trees. Then followed blows and slaps with hands and arms and an indescribable struggle arose between the two powerfill kings, the Lords of the Titans and Monkeys. Hard and long was the combat between these two doughty champions in the gateway, each in tum lifting the other up, crouching and changing their positions, tripping each other and throwing each other down, crushing one another, bruisiog each other's limbs, and, falling between the Sala Trees and the moat, they would leap up again, pausing an ioatant to regaio their breath. Then, with arms interlaced like ropes, they remained locked together, struggling and furious, full of skill and energy, moving to and fro. Like a lion and a tiger or two young elephants, tbat bave just grown their tusks, scrutinising each other, with arms interlaced and grappling with one another, they fell on the eatth together. Thereafter, rising, they hurled themselves on each other afresh, circling round the arena agaio and again, like skilled and mighty wrestlers nor were they easily fatigued. Like unto great tuskers, with their enormous arms resembling the trunks, they gripped each other tightly. Circling round and round in tbat duel wbich was long and fierce, they trampled down the eatth and, approaching each other, like two wild cats fighting over a piece of meat, each tried to kill bis adversary. Taking up diverse postures, describing ionumerable evolutions, running like an ox's urine, halting, coming and going, they executed a myriad different movements; stepping sideways, making feints, twisting to avoid a blow, turning about, darting to the attack, each hurling bimself on his opponent, standing firm and erect, disengaging themselves, presenting back and ftank, preparing to leap,

lerting go or stealing away, thus **SUGRIVA** and **RAVANA**, to their utmost satisfaction, multiplied such feats in which they excelled. Meanwhile the titan had recourse to magic and when the King of the Monkeys perceived it, he flew into the sky triumph ant, shaking off all fatigue whilst **RAVANA**, overcome with exhaustion, breathing heavily, baftled by the King of the Monkeys, stood confOunded. 9S Thus the Lord of the Monkeys, acquiring fame as a warrior, having \R8ried **RAVANA** in combat, ascended into the infinite blue with the swiftness of thought, and that offspring of the Sun, having accomplished this feat, delighted, rejoined the army, honoured by the monkey leaders, thereby increasing the joy of the foremost of the Raghus.

CHAPTER 41

Rama sends Angada to Ravana

SBBING him bearing the marks of valour, the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA**, embracing him, said to **SUGRIVA** : " Without consuliing me thou hast acted thus imprudently ; such rashness is not seemly in a king. By thy recklessness thou hast caused me great anxiety as also the army and Bibisbana! O Warrior, thou art enamoured of deeds of daring ! Do not act thus in the future, O Vanquisher of thy Foes I If thou hadst come by some misfortune, what would **SITA** or **BHARATA** or my ynunger brothers, **LAKSHMANA** or Shatrughoa have availed me ? " O Valiant Scourge of Thy Foes, if thou hadst not returned, though I am conversant with thy valour, this was my fized resolve ; having destroyed **RAVANA** in fight with his sons, forces and chariots, I should have installed Bibisbana as King of Lanka, suffered **BHARATA** to ascend the throne and renounced my life, O Great Prince.” At these words of

RAMA, **SUGRIVA** answered, saying : " Seeing the one who had borne away thy consort, O Brave Descendant of Raghu, conscinus of mine own strength, how could I have acted otherwise ? " Thus spoke that warrior, and Raghava, having commended him, addressed **LAKSHMANA** who was endowed with auspicious marks, saying : " Beside these cool waters and rrees laden with fruit, let us divide and marshal our forces, O **LAKSHMANA** I I foresee a terrible calamity boding universal destruction and death to the intrepid bears, monkeys and titans. Harsh winds blow, the !J6 earth trembles and the mountains quake ; treeS crash to the earth, sinister clouds resembling birds of prey roar in terrifying wise and let fall rain mixed with blood ; the dusk, red as sandal, is full of horror and from the sun, a ftaming circle falls. Wild beasts and birds emit frantic cties and are ill at ease ; their voicea and fierce aspect deprive them of their beauty. In the night, the moon, shorn of its radiance, surrounded by black and fiery rays, burns red, as at the time of the destruction of the world. A thin, dark, sinister rim of coppery hue is seen round the sun and on its surface a black mark appears nor does that orb approach any other planets as is usual, all of which prefigures the final dissolution of the world. " Behold, O **LAKSHMANA**, how crows, eagles and vultures are tlying low, circulating rapidly, emitting piercing and lugubrious cties ! The earth changed to mud and gore will be covered with rocks, javelins and darts hurled by the monkeys and titans I This very day, surrounded by the monkeys on all sides, let us make an attack on that citadel defended by **RAVANA**." Having spoken thus to **LAKSHMANA**, his younger brother, thar mighty warrior rapidly descended from the summit of the mountain and coming tn the bottom of that bill, the virtuous Raghava inspected his army which was invincible to the foe. Then, the time having come, **RAMA**, who was conversant with the fitting moment to act, gave the signal to advance and, at an auspicious moment, bow in

hand, turned towards Lanka. Bibishana, **SUGRIVA**, **HANUMAN**, Nala, **JAMBAVAN** the King of the Bears, as also Nila and **LAKSHMANA** followed, and behind them the mighty host of bears and monkeys, covering a vast stretch of earth, threw themselves in Raghava's wake. Hundreds of rocks and enormous treeS served as weapons to those monkeys, verily the vanquishers of their foes, who resembled elephants. Soon the two brothers, **RAMA** and I .aksbmana, those subduers of the foe, reached the city of Ravans, garlanded with banners, enchanting with the pleasure gardens which adnrned it, inaccessible with its many gateways, high walls and arches. Then those denizens of the forests, encouraged by the sound of **RAMA**'s voice and obedient to his commands, halted before Lanka, which was impregnable, even to the Gods. Thereafter **RAMA**, accompanied by bis younger brother, bow 91 in hand, surveyed the northern gate, which was as high as the peak of a mountain and took up his position there. That valiant son of **DASARATHA**, followed by I.aksbmana, advanced uodct the walls of Lanka, whose highway was **RAVANA**. None but **RAMA** could have approached and Clllmined the northctn gate whcte **RAVANA** stood, which was formidable and guarded by him as the ocean by **VARUNA** and which was defended on all sides by titans, as the Danavas, who sow tctror in the hearts of the weak, guard Patala. And **RAMA** obsctved innumctable weapons and armour of evcty kind heaped thcte for the combat ants. Meanwhile Nila took up his position with Mainda and Dvivida at the eastctn gate at the head of a host of monkeys. **ANGADA** with his vast forces, assisted by Rishabha, Gavaksha, Gaja and Gavaya, occupied the southctn gate. **HANUMAN**, that virtuous monkey, was stationed at the westctn gate with Prajangba, Tarasa and otbct warriors grouped round him, whilst **SUGRIVA**, pctSOnally occupied an obsctVation post in the centre. At the head of all those leading monkeys,

the equals of Suparna and Pavana, tbirty-six kotis of renowned warriors wcte grouped round **SUGRIVA**. Meanwhile, undct **RAMA**'s command, Laksbmana, assisted by Bibishana, distributed his innumerable divisions at each gate. Behind **RAMA**, Sushena and Jamhavan, those lions among the monkeys, possessing the teetb of tigctS, furnished with trees and rocks, waited delightedly for the signal to fight. Lashing their tails feverishly, tbey used their jaws and nails as weapons ; host of Plavamgamas, nu,mbering millions, who were ranging round the city and those heroic monkeys, with tree trunks in their hands, surrounded the whole of Lanka that even the winds were unable to penetrate. Then the titans, who io their valour rivalled Shakra, seeing themselves besieged by those monkeys like massed clouds, were struck with a sudden terror, and, as they broke rank, a tremendous clamour arose from that host of combatants which resembled the roar of the ocean beating agaiost the shore ! At tbis tumult, the whole of Lanka with its ramparts, arches, bills, woods and forests, began to tremble. Under the direction of **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SUGRIVA**, that army becsme even more inviocible than the hosts of the Gods and titans. Raghava, however, haviog ranged bis forces in order wipe out the demons, took counsel with bis ministers and pondered deeply again and again. Desiriog to act without delay and with circumspection, he, in bis consummate experience with Bibishana's approbation, calling to mind the duty of kings', summoned Bali's son, **ANGADA** and said to him : " Go My Friend on my beltalf and, passing through the City of Lanka without fear, say to Dashagriva :-' Thou hast sacrificed thy renown, destroyed thy kingdom and, in thine haste tn die, hast lost thy wits ! Risbis, Devos, Gandharvas, Apsaras, Nagas, Yakshas and kings, O Ranger of the Night, have been oppressed by thee in thy reckless pride. O Titan, from now on, that arrogance, begot of the boon thou didst receive from

Swyambhu, shall be subdued ! I shall inllict a fitting penalty for thy ruthless abduction of my consort ; it is with the Rod of Chastisement, that I have stationed myself at " ' That virtuous prince of the titanS, the illustrious Bibishana, who is here, will undoubtedly reign in Lanka without opposition. Nay, it is not fitting that, even for an instant, the crown should belong to one as perfidious as thou art, a wicked cresture who surroundest thyself with fools and who is not conversant with the Self! " ' Enter into combat with me, O Titan, exert thy strength and valour in the light, mine arrows will ehasten thee and thou wilt be subdued I Even shouldst thou range the Three Worlds in the form of a bird, O Night-ranger, my glance would follow thee and thou wouldst not return alive. I give thee this salutory counsel-prepare for thine obsequies, let Lanka regain her splendour, thy life is in my hands I ' " Furnished with **RAMA**'s instructions, the son of Tara ascended into the air, like unto the God bearing away a sacrificial offering, and in an instant arrived at **RAVANA**'s palace where he beheld him seated at ease amidst his ministers. That youthful Prince of the Monkeys, **ANGADA** of golden bracelets, like a fiaming torch descended close to the king and having made himself known, addressed the whole of **RAMA**'s exceedingly significant speech, without adding or subtracting anything, to him in the presence of his court, saying : " I am the messenger of the King of K.oshala, **RAMA** of imperishable exploits. I am the son of Bali, **ANGADA** is my name ; perchance thou hast heard of me ? The descendant of Raghu, **RAMA**, the increaser of **KAUSHALYA**'s delight, speaks thus to thee: '" Come forth and enter into combat with me! Manifest thy valour ! I shall destroy thee, thy counsellors, thy sons, relatives and allies. Thou being dead, the Three Worlds will cease to be troubled, O Thou whose enemies are the *Devas*, Danavas, Yakshas, Gandharvas, Uragas and *Rakshasas* ; thou thorn in the side of the

ascetics I Bibishana will become king when thou art slain by me, if thou dost not return Vaidehi, having paid her every homage, and cast thyself at my feet I ' " Hearing these harsh words from that lion among the monkeys, the Lord of the Titans, infuriated, issued the following command repeatedly to his attendants. saying:-" Seize him and put him to death I" On this order being given by Ravans, **ANGADA**, who in hi' splendour resembled a blazing torch, was seized by four terrible titans and the son of Tara suffered himself to be made captive, without offering any resistance, for valiant warrior desired to display his prowess to the host of Yatudhanas. Thereafter, seizing three of the titans, like unto serpents in his arms, he leapt on to the palsce that resembled a mountain. Shaken by his impetuous bound the three titans fell to the ground under the eyes of their king. Then the powerful son of Bali scaled the palace up to its roof, which equalled the summit of a mountain in height, and the impact of his bounds caused it to crumble before Dashagriva's gaze as a peak in the Himalayas is shattered by lightning. Having destroyed the roof of the palace, **ANGADA** proclaimed his name and with a triumphant roar rose into the air. To the exceeding terror of the titans and the great delight of the apes, he alighted in the midst of the monkeys beside **RAMA**. Thereupon Ra.vana, transponed with anger, giving himself up for lost began to sigh heavily. Meanwhile **RAMA**, who was surrounded by Plavamgamas emitting joyful cries, eager to destroy his adversary, advanced to meet him in combat. Now Sushena at the head of innumerable monkeys who were able to change their form at will and, under the order of **SUGRIVA**, he patrolled the gates and that invincible warrior resembled the moon moving amidst the stars. Seeing the hundreds of divisions encamped under the walls of Lanka and marshalled on the shores of the sea, the titans were amazed whilst some were terror-struck and others, overjoyed at the prospect of

fighting, leapt in exultation. Beholding those hosts occupying the whole space between the walls and the moat, however, and seeing the monkeys like unto a second rampart, those rangers of the night, cast down, cried out :-CHAPTBit 42 The Titans ,ake a Sortie THEN those titans approached the abode of **RAVANA** and informed him that **RAMA** and the monkeys had laid siege to the city. This news enraged that Ranger of the Night, who, repeating his former commands went up into the palace. From there he surveyed Lanka with its hills, woods and groves, which was besieged on all sides by countless divisions of monkeys, eager to fight. Beholding the earth all brown with innumerable Plavagas, in great perplexity he reflected : " How can they be exterminated ? " Having pondered long, **RAVANA** regained his confidence and, opening his great eyes wide, he gazed on Raghava and the simian battalions. Meanwhile **RAMA**, at the head of his army was rapidly advancing on Lanka which was guarded on all sides and thronged with titans. Thereafter the son of **DASARATHA**, seeing that city furnished with flags and banners, remembered **SITA** and was filled with anguish. He reflected “That daughter of **JANAKA** whose eyes resemble a young doe’s, will be a prey to anxiety on my account ! Consumed with grief and emaciated, she is pining away, the bare ground her bed!” Reftecting on the sufferings of Vaidehi, the virtuous Raghava speedily issued a command to the monkeys to prepare for the enemy’s destruction. Hearing the order of Raghava of imperishable exploits, the Plavagas, urging each other on, filled the ait with their roaring. " Let us demolish Lanka with rocb and stones or with our fists alone " was the resolve of the monkey leaders and, under the eyes of the King of the Titans, in order to accomplish Ramo’s cherished desire, those troops divided themselves into columns and began to scale the heights of Lanka. Hurling themselves on that city with rocb and trees, those golden-hued Plavamgamas of coppety

countenance, willing to lay down their lives in

CHAPTER 42

The Titans make a Sortie

CHAPTBit 42 The Titans ,ake a Sortie THEN those titans approached the abode of **RAVANA** and informed him that **RAMA** and the monkeys had laid siege to the city. This news enraged that Ranger of the Night, who, repeating his former commands went up into the palace. From there he surveyed Lanka with its hills, woods and groves, which was besieged on all sides by countless divisions of monkeys, eager to fight. Beholding the earth all brown with innumerable Plavagas, in great perplexity he reflected : " How can they be exterminated ? " Having pondered long, **RAVANA** regained his confidence and, opening his great eyes wide, he gazed on Raghava and the simian battalions. Meanwhile **RAMA**, at the head of his army was rapidly advancing on Lanka which was guarded on all sides and thronged with titans. Thereafter the son of **DASARATHA**, seeing that city furnished with flags and banners, remembered **SITA** and was filled with anguish. He reflected “That daughter of **JANAKA** whose eyes resemble a young doe’s, will be a prey to anxiety on my account ! Consumed with grief and emaciated, she is pining away, the bare ground her bed!” Reftecting on the sufferings of Vaidehi, the virtuous Raghava speedily issued a command to the monkeys to prepare for the enemy’s destruction. Hearing the order of Raghava of imperishable exploits, the Plavagas, urging each other on, filled the ait with their roaring. " Let us demolish Lanka with rocb and stones or with our fists alone " was the resolve of the monkey leaders and, under the eyes of the King of the Titans, in order to accomplish

Ramo's cherished desire, those troops divided themselves into columns and began to scale the heights of Lanka. Hurling themselves on that city with rocb and trees, those golden-hued Plavamgamas of coppety countenance, willing to lay down their lives in 102 **RAMA**'s service, destroyed innumerable battlements, ramparts and arches with blows from trees, rocks and fists and filled the moats and trenches of clear water with sand, stones, grass and logs. The commanders led their divisions by thousands and hundreds of millions of thousands to attack Lanka and the Plavamgamas tore up the golden arches, broke down the gates, that equalled the peak of Kailasha in height and from the sides and the centre, hurled themselves on the city like great elephants with aics of " Victoty to the mighty **RAMA** and the valiant **LAKSHMANA** I " " Victory to **SUGRIVA** protected by Raghava ! " Shouting thus, the monkeys, who were able to change their form at will, roaring, rushed to attack the city. Vuabahu, Subahu, Nala and Panasa, having dcmoliahed some of the outpoSts, reached the foot of the walls and assigoed each column to a post of attack. The eastern gate was besieged by the valiant Kumuda surrounded by ten kotis of triumphant monkeys ; his lieutenants were Prasabha and the long-armed Panasa, who were at the head of those forces. At the southern gate was the warrior Shatabali, a monkey of proved valour, who was stationed with twenty kotis to obstruct the exit. Sushena, the father of Tara, full of courage and strength, with a hundred thousand monkeys surrounded the western gate. The northern gate was blockaded by the mighty **RAMA** assisted by Saumitri and **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys. The colossal Golangula, Gavaksha, of grim aspect and immense energy, supported one of **RAMA**'s 8anks with a koti of warriors and the valiant Dhumrs, scourger of his foes, supported the other 8ank with a koti of bears of redoubtable fury. The intrepid Bibishana, attended by his loyal

ministers, followed his ally, the heroic **RAMA**, everywhere, whilst Gaja, Gavaksha, Gavaya, Sharabha and Gandhamadana patrolled every side in defence of the simian army. Meanwhile, his heart filled with rage, the King of the Titans ordered his troopS to make a rapid sortie. At this command filling from **RAVANA**'s lips, a tremendous clamour arose among the rangers of the night and the sound of kettledrums, their discs white as the moon, on which the titans beat with sticks of aold. broke out on every side, while hundreds and thousands of 103 trumpetS blared forth, blown by the titans with their cheeb extended to the full. With their dark limbs adorned with ornaments and their conches, those rangers of the night resembled clouds bordered with lighming or rows of aanes ; and their battalions advanced gaily under **RAVANA**'s imperious commands as, at the time nf Pralaya, the tumultuous sea overllows. At that moment from every side, a clamour arose from the army of the monkeys which filled Malaya with its plains, valleys and chasms, and the sound nf the trumpetS and drums and the leonine roars of those warriors re-echoed over the earth, sky and sea, as also the trumpeting of elephants, the neighing nf horses, the clatter of chariot wheels and the thunder of the titans marching. Thereafter a terrible struggle ensued between the monkeys and the titans as, in former times berweeo Gods and *Asuras*. With their flaming maces, their spears, harpoons and axes, the titans, demonstrating their native prowess, struck the army of the monkeys and from their side, those gigantic apes attacked their adversaries ferociously with blows from trees, rocks, teeth and nails. " Victory to King **SUGRIVA** I " yelled the monkeys, " May our Sovereign prevail! " ahouted the titans and each proclaimed his name, while other demons, standing on the walls, backed at the monkeys below with hooks and harpoons and they, in furiated, leapt into the air and dragged down those soldiers stationed on the walls by seizing them with their arms,

and that conflict berweeo demons and monkeys was appalling and the earth was covered with mud and llesh in that astonishing fiaht.

CHAPTER 43

The Conflict between the Monkeys and the Titans

TM Ctniflkt betwem tM Monkeys and Titaru TBOSB high-souled monkey troops fought with terrible ferocity whilst the titans wakened the ten regions as, mounted on steeda flashing like the sun, they issued forth clad iu marvellous suits of mail, eager to triumph iu **RAVANA**'s name. On their side, the mighty army of monkeys, burning for victory, hurled themselves on those demons of formidable exploits and extraordinary duels arose between titans and monkeys who rushed upon each other. As Tryambaka fought against Andhaka, so did the son of Bali, **ANGADA**, fight with lndrajita, who was endowed with immense energy. Prajangha was attacked by the ever indomitable Sampati and the Monkey **HANUMAN** measured his strength with J ambumali. A prey to violent anger, Bibishana, the younger brother of **RAVANA**, entered into a furious combat with the exceedingly impetuous Shattnghna. The valiant Gaja fought with the Titan Tapana and the powerful Nila with Nikumbha. That lndra of Monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, attacked Praghasa with violence and the forrunate **LAKSHMANA** engaged iu combat with Virupaksha. The unapproachable Agniketu with the Titan Rashmiketu, Mitraghna and Yajnakopa unitedly entered iuto combat with **RAMA**, Vajramushti fought agaiust Maiuda and Ashauipratha agaiust Dvivida, those two foremost of monkeys with the greatest of titans. The valiant son of *Dharma*, Sushena, that great monkey of illustrious name, grappled with Vidyunmalin and, from every side, other monkeys

heroically engaged in countless duels with other titans. Then an appalling battle, causiug the hair to stand on end, took place between titans and monkeys who were full of prowess and eager to triumph. From the bodies of those monkeys and rangers of the rtight, the palm of his hand. The redoubtable Pratapana, yelliDg, rushed on Nala, who with his limbs pierced by the pointed shafts of that skilful titan, suddenly scratched out his eyes. As Pragbasa appeared to be consuming the hosts of the King of the Monkeys, **SUGRIVA** hastily struck him with a Saptaparna Tree, while **LAKSHMANA**, overwhelmed by a hail of missiles by Virupaksha, that titan of ferocious aspect, struck him down with a single blow. Theteaftet the indomitable Agniketu, the Titans Rashmiketu, M.tuagbna and Yajnakopa sought to consume Ratna with their arrows, whereupon he, in fury, with four formidable shafts, resembling tongues of fire, severed the hesds of all four in the struggle. Vajramushti, struck by a blow from Mainda's fist in the fight, was overthrown with his chariot, driver and horses, which resembled an aerial car belonging to the Gods ; Nikumbha battling against Nila, who was like unto a piece of collyrium, pierced him with his whetted shafts as the sun with its rays pierces a cloud ; and, again and again that deft-handed ranger of the night Nikumbha, with a hundred arrows wounded Nila in the fray whereupon that monkey began to laugh and seizing the wheel of his adversary's chariot, he who resembled VIShnu on the battlefield, severed the head of that titan and that of his charioteer. Dvivida, whose impact was like unto a flash of lightning, struck Samaprabha with a great tock at which the titans stated in amazement and that foremost of monkeys, Dvivida, who fought with blows of uees, was pierced in his turn with arrows resembling lightning and his limbs being la=ated by those shafts, that monkey grew enraged and with a single blow from a Sala Tree struck down the titan, his chariot and his

horses. Thereafter Vidyunmalin repeatedly emitting loud cries, stand ing in his car, wounded Sushcna with gold encrusted arrows and seeing him, that foremost of monkeys suddenly overthrew the chariot with a great rock. Vidyunmalin however, that agile night ranger, sprang down from his car and, mace in hand, stood ready on the field whereupon that lion among monkeys, infuriated, seizing a great rock, rushed at the titan hut u he precipitated himself upon him, Vtdyunmalin with a deft strolrie, wounded him in the belly with his mace. Then the acellent P1awp, receiving that terrible anc;l unespected blow dealt by !o6 his opponent, immediately turned and, in a desperate encounter, hurled a rock upon him. Struck by that missile, Vidyunmalin, that prowler of the night, his chest crushed, fell lifeless on the eatth. Thus, under the blows of the sitnian warriors, the heroic titans perished in a series of hand to hand encounters as the Daityas under the blows of the inhabitants of the Celestial Region. Bhallas and other weapons, maces, lances, darts, shattered chariots, war-horses that had been slain, as also elephants from whose temples ichot exuded and the bodies of monkeys and titans, with wheels, axles, yokes and shafts strewed the eatth ; the carnage was fearful, a veritable jackal’s feast. The headless trunks of monkeys and titans lay in heaps every where in the midst of that appalling con8ict which resembled the war between Gods and *Asuras*. In that stubborn engagement, decimated by the foremost of monkeys, the rangers of the night as the day ended, maddened by the smell of blood, in desperation made preparations for the morrow, and those titans, their limbs covered with blood, desired nothing so greatly as that night should fall.

CHAPTER 44

Angada's Exploit

mutual hostility, monkeys and titans, bntning for victory, continued to fight in the gathering gloom. " Art thou a titan ? " asked the monkeys-" Art thou a monkey ? " questioned the titans and struck at each other in the darkness. " Strike ! " " Kill ! " " Come hither ! " " Why lleest thou ? " could be heard in that appalling struggle. Clad in mail, the titans, their datk hue intensified by the impenetrable gloom, resembled hills covered with woods abounding in phosphorescent herbs and, transported with anger, they bounded forward in order to fall on the Plavungamas and devour them, but these hurled themselves on the hones and with indescribable fury tore them down with their sbarp claws. Thus did those mighty monkey warriors sow confusion amongst the titans aod they clawed the elephants and those mounted upon them and the chariots from which the banners streamed, breaking them to pieces with their teeth. Full of fury, **LAKSHMANA** and **RAMA**, with their arrows resembling venomous snakes pierced the foremost of the titans, both those who were visible and those who were invisible, and the dust rising from the hooves of the horses and the wheels of the chariots filled the ears and eyes of the combatants, whilst rivers of blood flowed in dreadful torrents in that ghastly tumult which caused the hair to stand on end. Meanwhile the sound of gongs aod drums, marvellous to hear, joined to the blare of conches and the rattle of wheels, and a terrible clamour arose of horses neighing mingling with the cries of the wounded. The corpses of great monkeys, spears, maces and the bodies of the titans, who were able to change their form at will, lay in heaps as high as a mountain on the battlefield. And those weapons appeared to be offered up as a profusion of flowers by the earth, which was entirely bidden and rendered impsssable by rivers of blood. That fatal night was as calamitous to the monkeys and titans as the night of dissolution wherein no being survives. Meanwhile the titans, aided by that

impenetrable darkness, with great ferocity showered a hail of weapons on **RAMA** and, yelling, advanced upon him in fury like the ocnn at the time of the destruction of all creatures. And **RAMA**, in the twinkling of an eye, with six shafts resembling tongUes of flame struck down six titans-the indomitable Yajnashatru, Mahapsrshwa, Mahodara, Vajradamshtra of colossal stature and the twO emissaries, Shuka and Sarans. With his innumerable shafts, **RAMA** thereafter pierced them all in their vital parts, so that under that shower of arrows they fled from the field, barely escaping with their lives. In an instant, that warrior of the great car lit up the cardinal points with his formidable missUes the firefties in autumn. The cries of the tilliiiS and the roll of drums increased the horrors of that night beyond imagining and, in that tetrible uproar whicb re-echoed on every side, it seemed as if the Mount Trikuta was emitting confused murmurs from its innwnetable caves. The gigantic Golangulas, black as night, crushed the rangers of the night in their arms in ordet to devour them and **ANGADA** destroyed his foes with savagery in the struggle. Then Indrajita, aftet that monkey had slain his steeds and chariotcet, ovetcome with fatigue, made himself invisible and vanished. For this feat, Bali's son, worthy of being honoured, was lauded by the Gods and *Rishis* as also by the brothetS, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. All beings aware of the prowess of the mighty lndrsjita in war, witnessing his discomfiture and, bcbolding that high-souled one, elated and, in the height of joy, the monkeys with **SUGRIVA** and Bibishana, seeing the enemy's defeat, cried out " Excellent I Excellent I " Meanwhile lndrajita, who had been oveteome in the dud with Bali's son of redoubtable deeds, was seized with violent wrath. Rcndeting himself invisible by virtue of the boon be had received from Brahms, that wicked wretch, who was ezhaustcd by the fight, transported with anget, loosed some sharp arrows bright as lightning on **RAMA** and

LAKSHMANA. On the field of battle, in his rage, he pietecd the limbs of those two Raghavas with formidable shafts resembling setpents. Enveloped by illusion, he sought to confuse them in the struggle

CHAPTER 45

Rama and Lakshmana are struck down by Indrajita

ANxious to ascertain what had become of Indrajita, REJna, that illusuious and mighty prince sent out ten monkey leaders in his pursuit ; tbe two sons of Sushena, the monkey, Genetal Nila, **ANGADA** tbe son of Bali, tbe valiant Sharabha, Dvivida, **HANUMAN**, tbe exceedingly courageous Sanuprastha, Rishabha and Rishahaskandha. Those monkeys ftung themselves joyfully into the air brandishing huge trunks of trees in order to explore tbe ten regions, but Ravani', by means of his arrows, loosed witb force from tbe most excellent of bows, arrested their impetuous ftight and tbose monkeys of terrific bounds, who were cruelly pierced by those shafts, were unable to discern Indrajita in the darkness, as the sun is obscured when veiled in cloud. Witb tbose darts, that lacerated the ftesh, the titan transfixed **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** and remained master of the field and tbere was no part of **RAMA** or **LAKSHMANA**'s body that was not pierced by tbose serpentine shafts so tbat streams of blood ftowed from tbeir gaping wounds, and tbey appeared like two Kimshuka Trees in ftower. At that instant, his eyes inftamed, **RAVANA**'s son, who resembled a mass of collyrium mixed witb oil, though still invisible, said to tbose two brotbers :-" When I, making myself invisible, enter into combat, even tbe Chief of tbe Gods, Shakra himself, is not able to discern or approach me, how mucb less

you two! O Descendants ofRaghu, having imprisoned you in tbis network of plumed darts, I, yielding myself up to tbe violence of my wratb, am about to dispatch you to the region of **YAMA** I " Thus addressing tbose virtuous brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, he pierced tbem afresh with his pointed arrows shouting exultantly. Resembling a heap of antimony, the swartby Indrajita, stretching his immense bow, let fty an even tbicker shower of formidable arrows in the fight. That warrior, who knew how to make his darts pierce **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**'s vital parts, set up a continual shouting and the two princes in the forefront of battle, imprisoned in the net of arrows and darts, in the twinkling of an eye, became incapable of distinguisbing anything. Para lysed, pierced in their vital parts, exhausted, those two mighty and courageous archers fell to the earth, they who were her lords ! Lying on that heroes' bed, those two warrinrs, covered with blood, their limbs bristling with arrows, swooned away in their extremity. And there was not a hair's breadth on their bodies from the tips of their fingers to the end of their feet that was not lacerated, pricked and pierced by those irresistible darts and from both those warrinrs who had been struck down by that ferocious titan, able to change his shape at will, the hot blood gushed forth as water from a spring. And **RAMA** fell first, his vital parts pierced by the shafts of the wrathful lndrajita, who had formerly vanquished Shakra, and **RAVANA**'s son riddled Raghava's body with smooth and polished dans as thick as dust clouds. Naracas, Demi-naracas, Bhallas, Anjalis, Vatsadantas, Sinhadantas,and those shafts like unto razors fell on that warrior, who lay on the earth like a hero, allowing his golden bow, which was severed, to sink from his grasp. Beholding **RAMA**, that lion among men, fall under a hail of arrows, **LAKSHMANA** gave up all hope of living and he was overcome by grief on beholding the lotus-eyed **RAMA**, his refuge, who ever

delighted in battle, lying on the earth. The mcmkeys too, witnessing this, suft'ered extreme distress and, their eyes full of tears, overcome with despair, emitted mournful aies ; and while those two warriors lay unconscious on that heroes' bed, the monkeys surrounded them and, assembling there, with the son of the Wind at their head, remained inconsolable and a prey to despair.

CHAPTER 46

The despair of Sugriva and his Army. Bibishana reassures Him

MEANwHILE those inhabitants of the woods, surveying the earth and the sky, beheld the brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, covered with arrows and the titan resting, like unto IndrR having loosed the rains. Accompanied by **SUGRIVA**, Bibishana, lamenting, came to that place in haste, and Nila, Dvivida, Mainda, Sushena, Kumuda, **ANGADA** and **HANUMAN** approached, weeping for the sons of Raghu. Breathing but faintly, bathed in blood, riddled with in numerable darts, motionless, they lay stretched on a bed of arrows sighing like serpents, washed in blood, resembling two golden standards, and those warriors, lying on a hero's couch, were surrounded by monkey leaders whose eyes were suft'used with tears. Beholding the two Raghavas pierced with darts, a profound emotion stirred those monkeys, who were accompanied by Bibishana, and they surveyed the four quarters without being able to discover Ravani, who had veiled himself in his magic during the fight. But while he was bidden by his occult power, Bibishana, alao having recourse to magic arts, looking round, beheld his nephew of incomparable exploits, who was invincible in battle, standing nearby.

Although that warrior, who had no peer in the field, had made himself invisible by virtue of the boon he had received, he was recognized by Bibishana, who was full of energy, glory and prowess. Indrajita, however, contemplating his own feat, gazed on those two warriors stretched on the earth and, in an excess of joy, wishing to share it with all the titanS, said : " Those two mighty brothers, **RAMA** and J,aksbmana, the slayers of Khara and Dushana, are now struck down by my darts I Even were they aided by the Gods and Asuru with the U2 hosts of *Rishis*, they would never be able to release themselves from those arrows that paralyse them I I have overcome **RAMA** for the sake of my sire, who is a prey to anxiety and fear, passing the three watches of the night without allowing his limbs to rest on his couch. I have subdued that wretch, who destroys all beings to their very root, on account of whom the whole of Lanb is agitated like a river in the rainy season. As clouds are dispersed in the autumn, so have the exploits of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** and all the inhabitants of the woods been rendered void." Having spoken thus to all the titans, who had wimessed the scene, Ravani began to assail all the monkey leaders. First he struck down Nila with nine exceedingly powerful javelins, thereafter he wounded Mainda and Dvivida with three more and that mighty bowman, having pierced Jamhavan in the breast with an arrow, loosed ten shafts on the impetuous **HANUMAN**. Then Ravani, in the fight, full of ire, with twin arrows pierced Gavaksha and Sharabha, those two of immeasurable prowess, and the leader of the Golangulas and the son of Bali, Angads, were overcome by innumerable darts by the swift-coursing Ravani. Transfixing the leading monkeys with shafts resembling tongues of fire, that mighty and colossal son of **RAVANA** began to shout in triumph and, having overwbelmed and routed the monkeys with a hail of weapons, that long-armed hero burst into loud laughter, exclaining : " Behold, O

Titans, with a formidable net I have bound thoae two brothers in the presence of their forces ! " Thus did he speak and all those titans, versed in magic, were exceedingly delighted by his exploit and cheered him un animously with a roar like unto thunder, crying:-" **RAMA** is dead I " and bearing these tidings and beholding the two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, lying on the earth without breath or movement, they all paid homage to **RAVANA**'s son, re1lccting " They are slain ! " In a transport of joy, Indrajita, victorious in conllict, returned to Lanb spreading happiness among the Nairritas. A great fear however had taken possession of **SUGRIVA**, wbo was overcome with terror on beholding **RAMA** and I .abhmana riddled with arrows and pierced in every Umb and bone, 113 whereupon Bibishana said to the King of the Monkeys, who was aillicted, his face bathed in tears, his eyes wild with terror : " Have no fear, O **SUGRIVA**, stay this rain of tears ; theBe arc the fortunes of war ; the titan's victory is not assured ; fate may still smile upon us, O Warriot. These two heroes, full of prowess will recover from their swoon. Take courage and inspire me with courage also, who am bereft of a protector, O Monkey I Death cannot strike terror in those who find their felicity in truth and justice." Thus speaking, Bibisbana, dipping his hand in water, washed **SUGRIVA**'s beautiful eyes and, after taking water and uttering a sacred formula, the virtuous Bibisbana then dried the face of that intelligent King of the Monkeys and addressing him in words full of good sense and comfort, said : " This is not the moment, O Greatest of Monkey Kings, to manifest agitation, excessive emotion in such a situation leads to death, therefore abandon this faint-heartedness tbat will prove thine undoing and consider how thou canst best serve the troops. Keep watch over **RAMA** so long as he has not regained consciousness, for when they come to themselves, the two .Kakutstbas will remove all fear from us. This is nothing to **RAMA** nor is

he dying, and Lakshmi', who is inaccessible to those who arc doomed, has not ahandoncd him. Therefore pluck up thy courage and call on thy prowess while I seek to inspire the ranks with renewed confidence. Those monkeys, their eyes dilated, trembling and discouraged by the rumours whis pered from car to car, on seeing me chcerfully going about amongst the ranks of the army, will shandon their fears like a discarded garland, O King of the Monkeys I " Having reassured **SUGRIVA**, that lndra among the Titans, Bibishana, passed through the monkey lines reviving their confidence. Meanwhile Indrajita, that great magician, surrounded by all his forces re-entered the City of Lanka and sought out his sire. Approaching **RAVANA**. with joined palms, he imparted the pleasant tidings to him, saying: " **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** are slain I " Then **RAVANA** joyfully springing up in the midst of the titans, on hearing that his two enemies bad succumbed, smelt the head of his son and in great delight questioned him concerning the matter. Being interrogated by his sire regarding whst hsd taken place, Indrajita related how the two brothers, bound by his shafts, were lying without strength or movement. On hearing those tidings from thst warrior of the great car, joy ftooded **RAVANA**'s inmost being and Dashsgrivs, banishing his fears regarding the son of Dasaraths, warmly felicitated his offspring who stood beside him.

CHAPTER 47

Sita sees Rama and Lakshmana lying on the Battlefield

THE son of **RAVANA** hsving returned to Lanka, his purpose accomplished, the leading monkeys surrounded Raghsva in order to

watch over him, and **HANUMAN**, Angsda, Nila, Sushena, Kumuda, NaJa, Gaja, Gavskshs, Panasa, Sanuprasths and the mighty **JAMBAVAN** with Sunda, Rambhs, Shstabali and Prithu, hsving re-organized their ranks, alert, armed with trees surveyed the quarters of the sky up and down and on every side and, even if a grass stirred, they exclaimed " It is a titan I " Ravsna, meanwhile, full of joy dismissed his son lndrajita and thereafter summoned the female titans who guarded **SITA** and they with **TRIJATA**, hsving hastened there at his command, were sddressed by thst monarch in his delight who said to them: .. Inform Vaidehi thst lndrajita hss slain **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** I Compel her to enter the Pushpaka Plane and show them to her lying on the field of battle ! Her consort, the One depending on whom rendered her so proud thst she refused to be united with me, lies there struck down with his brother in the presence of his army ! From now on, free from anxiety, grief and expectation of re-union, Maitbili, adorned in all her jewels, will submit herself to me. To-day, beholding **RAMA** with **LAKSHMANA** fallen under the sway of death on the battlefield, seeing no other hsven and hoping for nought else, the large-eyed **SITA** will vohtntarily seek refuge with me I" ns At these words of that wicked monarch, they all replied " Be it so ! " and went to where the Pushpaka Chariot was, thereafter ascending it. Taking that aerial car, the female titans, in obedience to **RAVANA**'s behests, rejoined Msithili in the Ashoka Grove. There they found her overcome with the grief that separation from her lord caused her, nevertheless they placed her in the Chariot Pushpaka and when they were sested therein with **TRIJATA**, **RAVANA** took her round the city garlanded with 1lags and banners and at the same time the delighted Monarch of the Titans caused a proclamation to be made in Lanka announcing that **RAMA** as also **LAKSHMANA** had been slain by Indrajita in combat. **SITA**, transported with **TRIJATA** in that car, beheld the monkey troops who

had been slain and witnessed the joy exhibited by those eaters of fiesh and the monkeys affiicted with grief standing round **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. And she beheld those two warriors also, lying pierced with arrows, unconscious, riddled with weapons, their armour shattered, their bows broken, transfixed by darts. Those two brothers, who were filled with vslour, the foremost of heroes were lying stretched on the earth resembling two youthful sons of Pavaka. And when the unfortunate Msithili beheld those two intrepid lions among men, pierced with spears, she broke into piteous lamentations, and the dark-eyed **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, of faultless limbs, beholding her lord and **LAKSHMANA** lying on the earth, burst into soba. Exhausted with weeping and grief on seeing those two brothers resembling the offspring of the Gods and, believing them to be dead, overwhelmed with affiiction, she spoke thus : CHAPTEil 48 **SITA**'s LamentationJ SmmiG her lord lying on the earth as also the valiant I a!rsbmno, **SITA**, in the grief that overwhelmed her, gove voice to her complaint, saying : n6

CHAPTER 48

Sita's Lamentations

At these words of that wicked monarch, they all replied " Be it so ! " and went to where the Pushpaka Chariot was, thereafter ascending it. Taking that aerial car, the female titans, in obedience to **RAVANA**'s behests, rejoined Msithili in the Ashoka Grove. There they found her overcome with the grief that separation from her lord caused her, nevertheless they placed her in the Chariot Pushpaka and when they were sested therein with **TRIJATA**, **RAVANA** took her round the city garlanded with 1lags and banners and at the same time the delighted

Monarch of the Titans caused a proclamation to be made in Lanka announcing that **RAMA** as also **LAKSHMANA** had been slain by Indrajita in combat. **SITA**, transported with **TRIJATA** in that car, beheld the monkey troops who had been slain and witnessed the joy exhibited by those eaters of fiesh and the monkeys affiicted with grief standing round **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**. And she beheld those two warriors also, lying pierced with arrows, unconscious, riddled with weapons, their armour shattered, their bows broken, transfixed by darts. Those two brothers, who were filled with vslour, the foremost of heroes were lying stretched on the earth resembling two youthful sons of Pavaka. And when the unfortunate Msithili beheld those two intrepid lions among men, pierced with spears, she broke into piteous lamentations, and the dark-eyed **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, of faultless limbs, beholding her lord and **LAKSHMANA** lying on the earth, burst into soba. Exhausted with weeping and grief on seeing those two brothers resembling the offspring of the Gods and, believing them to be dead, overwhelmed with affiiction, she spoke thus : CHAPTEil 48 **SITA**'s LamentationJ SmmiG her lord lying on the earth as also the valiant I a!rsbmno, **SITA**, in the grief that overwhelmed her, gove voice to her complaint, saying : n6 " The soothsayers, reading the lineaments of my body, prophesized thus : ' Thou shalt bear sons and never be widowed ! '-now that **RAMA** has been slain, their words have proved to be unttue I Since **RAMA** is slain, those who predicted that I should be the companion and consort of the performer of great sacrificeso have uttered a falsehood I Now that **RAMA** has been slain, those soothsayers, who told me I should be highly honouted by the wives of warriors and kings, are proved not to have spoken auly ! Now that **RAMA** has been slain, the astrologers among the btahmiDs, who openly foretold happiness for me, are proved to have spoken falsely ! " Yet I bear the marks of the lotus on my feet by which

high-born women receive the supreme conseaation with their lords at their coronation nor do I find in myself any marks of ill-fortune which betoken widowhood in those who are ill starred, yet all the auspicious signs appear to be rendered void for me ! These marks of the lotus, said to be of good augury by the Pundits, have no meaning for me, now that **RAMA** is slain ! " My locks are fine, of even length and datk, my eyebrows meet, my legs are round and smooth, my teeth evenly separated, the comers of my eyes are shaped like the conch, my breasts, hands, feet and thighs well proportioned, my nails smooth and polished, my fingers well-shaped, my bressts touch each nther and have depressed nipples, my navel too is deeply indented, my bosom well-fottned, my complexion has the sheen of a peat!, the down on my skin is soft. It is said I possess the rwelve auspicious signs : my feet and hands are without hollows and marked with the barley com' and my smile is langorous. Thus did those, who interpret the marks of youthful maidens, speak of me. "Having purified Janasthana, received the tidings of my fate and croased the impasashle ocean, those rwo brothers have perished in the imprint of a cow's hoof. Did they not recollect (*that they posseased*) the arrows of **VARUNA**, **AGNI**, **INDRA** and Vayn, as alao the Brahmashira weapon ? " By means of magic arts, an invisible foe bas slain thoae two, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, my protectors, who are equal to Vasava in combat and I am now bereft of any support. Nay, if he had come into **RAMA**'s presence, he would not have returned alive even were he possessed of the swiftness of thought but since **RAMA** and his brother are lying struck down on the battlefield, there is no burden too heavy for death to shoulder ! Fate is inexorable. I do not weep so much for **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** or for myself or my mother but for my unfortunate mother-in law, Kaushalys, who dwells constantly on her son's return after fulfilling his vows, she who asks herself, ' When shall I

behold **LAKSHMANA** and Sits with Raghava once more ? ' " Thus did Janaki lament and **TRIJATA** said to her :-" Do not despair, O Goddess, thy lord lives I I will tcll thee what powerful considerations have convinced me that those two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** still live, O Queen. They are, that resolution and martial ardour do not animate the faces of soldiers who have lost their leader, neither would the celestial car, Pushpaka, have brought thee hither, O Vaidehi, if thoae two heroes had succumbed. An army that sees its valiant commander fall is bereft of courage and wanders aimlessly about on the battlefield like a ship which has lost its rudder. Yet there is neither confusion nor disorder among the intrepid forces that mount guard over the two Kakutsthas. I am pointing this out to thee on account of mine affection for thee. These auspicious omens should re-assure thee fully, for know well, the two Kakutsthas arc not dead, I hasten to tcll thee this out of love for thee. " I have never spoken what is not true to thee nor shall I ever do so, O Maithili, for by thy conduct and natural gaiety thou bast found a place in my beart I Nay, those two warriors are not able to be vanquished even by the Gods and Asuraa with their leaders. This is what I have observed and com municste to thee. Yea, there is a great marvel to be seen, O Maithili ; behold how, fallen under those shafts and deprived of their senses, their beauty bas not deserted them. " In the natural course, when men have lost their lives, their features abihit appalling alteration, it is therefore impossible that these two do not atill Uvc. Banish thy grief on account of uS **RAMA** and hkshmana, abandon thy sorrow, O Daughter of Janab!" At these words, **SITA**, who resembled a daughter of the Gods, with joined palms, exclaimed " May it be so ! " Meanwhile the Chariot Pushpaka, swift as the wind, bad returned and the plaintive **SITA** re-entered the city with **TRIJATA**, whereupon descending from the car, she entered the Ashoka Grove with the female titans. Having returned to

the royal enclosure planted with in numerable trees, **SITA**, recalling the princes whom she had just seen, became a prey extreme grief.

CHAPTER 49

Rama returns to consciousness and weeps over Lakshmana

Those foremost of monkeys, the valiant companions of **SUGRIVA**, plunged in grief, were all standing round the two illustrious warriors. Then the mighty Raghava, by virtue of his hardihood and native strength, awoke from his swoon despite the shafts that beld him captive. Beholding his brother bleeding, unconscious, tightly bound and his features changed, **RAMA**, full of grief, lamented thus :-" Of what use to me is the recovery of **SITA** or even life itself, since my brother, now lying before mine eyes, has been struck down in the fight? It were possible for me to find a consort equal to **SITA** in this world of mortals but not a brother, friend and comrade in arms such as **LAKSHMANA** I answer shall I give to **SHATRUGHNA** and the illustrious **BHARATA** wbeo I return without the one who followed me to the forest ? Nay, I should not be able to endure **SUMITRA**'s reproaches ; I will leave my body here; I am unable to continue living. Woe unto me and to my lack of nobility, since, through my fault, **LAKSHMANA** has fallen and lies on a bed of arrows as one who has yielded up his life I " O **LAKSHMANA**, thou didst ever console me in my great miafortune ; now that thou art slain, thou wilt no longer be able to allay my sulferings by thy words. Thou, who, in this battle, struck down innumerable titans, art fallen, pierced by darts, like a hero on the selfsame field. Lying on a bed of arrows, bathed in blood, thou art nought but a heap of weapons I It

appean as if the sun has set behind the Astachala Mountains ! Pierced with spean, thy limbs express thine agony without the aid of words. I shall follow that illustrious warrior to the region of Y ama, as he accompanied me when I retired to the forest ; he, who ever loved his own and was filled with devotion for me, lies in the state to which my misdeeds have brought him, wretch that lam! " Even when deeply provoked, that valiant hero never uttered an unpleasant or harsh word ; he who was able to loose five hundred arrows in one shot and who excelled Kartavirya himself in the science of archery ; **LAKSHMANA**, who was accustomed to a rich couch and who, with his arrows could sever those of the mighty Shakra, is lying slain on the earth. " Those vain words, which I uttered, will undoubtedly consume me since I have not enthroned Bibishana as King of the Titans ! Return at once, O **SUGRIVA**, since bereft of my support thou and thy leaders will be overcome by **RAVANA**. Recross the sea accompanied by thine army led by **ANGADA** with Nila and NaJa, O King. I am fully satiafied by the great military exploit ofHanuman, impossible to any other and by that accomplished by the King of the Bears and the General of the Golangulas. That which **ANGADA**, Mainda and Dvivida did, the terrible combat that Keaarin and Sampati sustained, the formidable struggle in which Gavaya, Gavaksha, Sharabha, Gaja and other monkeys, who are willing to sacrifice their lives for me, took part, are sufficient fot me. Nay, it is not possible for monals to avoid their destiny. O **SUGRIVA**, tearing to fail in thy duty, thou hast done all that a friend and comrade could do ; all that is due to friendship, thou hast accomplished, O Foremost of Monkeys ! I take leave of you all ; go where it seems best to you ! " Hearing **RAMA** lament thus, the monkeys allowed tears to fall from their reddened eyes, when, at that moment, Bibishana, haviog established order io the ranks, mace io hand hurried to rejoio Raghava.

Seeing him, who resembled a mass of collyrium, hastening towards them thus, the monkeys thinking him to be Ravani, fled away.

CHAPTER 50

Garuda liberates Rama and Lakshmana

army resembles a ship amidst the waves struck by a tempest ! " Hearing **SUGRIVA**'s speech, **ANGADA**, the son of Bali, answered : " Dost thou not see **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** of the Great Car, those rwo valiant and illustrious sons of **DASARATHA**, covered with darts lying all bloody on a bed of arrows ? " Thereupon that **INDRA** among monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, said to his son :-" To my miod there is some other cause why the monkeys, bewildered, their eyes distended with terror, are throwiog down their arms in order to flee io all directions without shame and without lookiog behind them, jostling each other and leaping over those who have fallen l " In the midst of this turmoil, the warrior Bibishana came there, a great mace io his hand and said " Victory to **RAMA** ! Victory to **RAMA** !" and **SUGRIVA** observed that it was this titan who had caused the panic among the monkeys whereat he addressed the illustrious King of the Beats, who stood near, and said : " It is Bibishana who has come hither ! On seeing him the monkeys, seized with terror, have fted, deeming him to be **RAVANA**'s son ; do thou rally those fugitives immediately, who, in fear, have scattered in all directions BDd inform them thst it is Bibishalla who has come ! " lD obedience to **SUGRIVA**'s command, JambaVBD perceiving it to be BibishaDa BDd recognizing bis voice, re-assured the monkeys BDd arrested the srampede, whereupon freed from they all retraced their steps. Meanwhile the faithful Bibishaua, on beholding **RAMA**'s body as also

Laksbmana’s covered with arrows, was overcome with distress in his Dipping his haDd in water, he washed their eyes, but, BDguish seizing his heart, he begBD to weep and lament, saying : " Behold to what a pass these two powerful BDd valiant warriors have been brought by thst titBD with his crafty ways ! The sOD of my brother, thst wicked youth of perverse soul, in bis demoniacal CUDDiDg, has deceived those two honourable fighterS. Pierced by arrows, covered with blood, they are lying on the earth like two porcupines. Those two gaJIBDt beings, those two lions among men, on whom depended the position to which I aspired, to my destruction are lying here insensible. I am as one dead BDd, deprived of the hope of becoming king am lost, whilst my rival **RAVANA** sees his vow fulfilled aDd bis desires realised ! .. Thus did Bibishaua lament, whereupon **SUGRIVA** embraced him BDd thst magnanimous King of the Monkeys spoke to him in this wise : .. O VJttUous Prince, thou shalt certainly reign over Lanka ; **RAVANA** BDd his son will not achieve their purpose ; the injury done to **RAMA** BDd Laksbmana is not grave, they will both emerge from their swoon and destroy RaVBDa BDd bis hotdea in battle.” When he had thus consoled and comfotted the titBD, **SUGRIVA** issued bis commands to Sushena, bis stepfather, who stood before him, saying : " Take these two brothers, **RAMA** BDd LakshmBDa with the foremost of the monkey divisions to Kishkindha, till theae two scourgers of their foes have recovered consciousness. As fur me, I shall slay **RAVANA** with his son BDd his relatives and hriDg back Maithili as did Shatra the prosperity he had lost.” Thus did that King of the Monkeys speak and Sushena answered him saying : " Formerly a great war took place between the *Devas* and *Asuras* and, by making themselves invisible again and again, the Danavas overcame the Gods despite their skill in bearing arms. Experienced warriors thougb they were, wounded, unamscious and

almost deprived of life, yet Brihaspati revived them by the aid of remedies accompanied by the recitation of sacred formulas. " Let the monkeys, Sampati, Panasa and others go in haste to gather those simples by the ocean of milk ; undoubtedly those monkeys arc conversant with the two mountain herbs, the celcstial Samjivakarana and Vishalya, which were created by a God. From the bosom of the milky ocean rise the Mountains Chandra and Orona, where the divine ' Amrita ' emerged after the churning, it is there that these mitaculous herbs are to be found. Let the Son of the Wind, **HANUMAN** go to those two mountains placed in that vast sea by the Gods." As he was speaking, a great wind arose accompanied by massed clouds and lightning, whipping up the salty wsves and causing the mountains to tremble as from an earthquake. Under the migbty stroke of Vata's wing the great fell headlong into the briny waters of the sea, their branches broken, whilst terror seized the great snakes who inhabited these regions and those monsters plunged into the depths. Suddenly **GARUDA**, the valiant son of Vinsta like unto a blazing torch appeared to all those monkeys and, on beholding him, the serpents who bound those two warriors in the form of migbty arrows, tied awsy. Thereafter Suparna, touching the two Kakutsthas and offering them his good wishes, with his hands wiped their faces that shone like the moon. Under Vainateya's touch, the wounds of both were closed and their bodies immediately assumed a brilliant and glowing hue. Their valour, vigour, strength, endurance and resolution, those great qualities, also perspicacity, intelligence and memory were redoubled. Having raiaed up those equals of Vasava, the exceedingly valiant **GARUDA** embraced them warmly and **RAMA** said to him :-" Tbanks to thy beneficence and grace we have both been delivered from the strange evil that **RAVANA** brought upon us and OUt strength has returned. As in the pteSence of my father **DASARATHA**, or my grandfather Aja, in thy

presence aJao my heart is filled with felicity. Who art thou endowed with a beauty which distinguishes thee, thou bearing crowns, divine perfumes and celestial ornaments, the raiment which clothes thee being free from dust ? " Then the extremely illustrinus Vainateya, who was full of valour and the Lord of Winged Creatures, his heart enraptured, addteSsed **RAMA**, whose eyes sparkled with delight, and said : " I am thy dear friend, O Kakutstha, thy very breath, **GARUDA**, who have come hither to assist you both. The mighty *Asuras* and exceedingly energetic monkeys as also the Gandharvas with Shatakratu at their head or the Gods themselves would not have been able to sever these formidable bonds wrought with arrows, woven with the aid of great magic by Indrajita of ruthless deeds. These offspring of Kadru of sharp fangs and subtle poison, which the potent arts of the titan bad changed to arrows, bad fettered thee. Fortunate art thou, O Virtuous **RAMA**, thou true bero, as also **LAKSHMANA**, thy bmther, the destroyer of his foes in combat. Hearing of thy plight, summoning up mine energy in affection for you both, giving ear to the call of friendship alone, I came hither with all speed. Now that you are liberated from these formidable bonds let both of you be constantly on your guard ! All titans by nature bave recourse to treachery in war, whilst for you, O Chivalrous Warriors, honOUt is your only weapon. Never trust the titans on the battlefield for such perfidious means are ever employed by them.” Having counselled him in this wise, the mighty Suparna embraced **RAMA** tenderly and craved his permieicm. to depart. saying: " Dear and Virtuous Raghava, thon art a friend to thy foes, allow me to take my leave. Do not enquire indiscreetly into the cause of my friendship, O Raghava, wbo am as near to thee as thy breath, thoup external to thee. Thou abalt know of it wben thou hast achieved success in battle, O Hero I When, under the rain of thy missiles, Lanb has been destroyed save fot die lllflCl 134 and the

cbildren and thou bast slain Ravena, thine adversary, thou shalt bring back **SITA** I " Having said this, Suparna of swift ftight, who bad just healed **RAMA**'s wounds in the presence of the monkeys, having paid obeisance to him and taken bim into bis arms, mounted into the sly with the speed of the wind. Seeing the two Ragbavas healed of their wounds, the leaders of the monkeys, lashing their tails, roared like lions. Thereafter gongs were beaten and drums resounded, whilst conches were blown amidst general rejoicing. Some manifested their strength by breaking down the trees wbich they used as maces and, in their warlike frenzy, those Plavamgamas hurled themselves on the gates of Lanka. Thereafter a terrible and appalling clamour arose amongst the foremost of monkeys as, at the end of summer, the roaring of thunderclouds in the night. Dlnmrraluha goes out to fight 1M Monke:JII THAT formidable clamour, set up by the monkeys who were full of martial ardour, arrested the attention of **RAVANA** and bis titans, and he, hearing the joyful and spirited acclamations and the distant tumult, said to bis ministers who surrounded him : " A great uproar, resembling the muttering of clouds, has arisen from tbat horde of delighted monkeys. Undoubtedly their joy is great, their mighty shouts are agitating the ocean itself. Nevertheless whetted shafts bave rendered the two brothers, **RAMA** and Labhmana, insensible, therefore this tremendous outcry almost alarms me I " Having spoken thus to bis ministers, the Lord of the Titans said to bis Nairritas, who stood round him : " Do ye speedily discover from wbat cause tbis general rejoicing amcmg those forest dwellers proceeds in their present painful situation ! " At this command, the titans hastily climbed the rampam

CHAPTER 51

Dhumraksha goes out to fight the Monkeys

and the cbildren and thou bast slain Ravena, thine adversary, thou shalt bring back **SITA** I " Having said this, Suparna of swift ftight, who bad just healed **RAMA**'s wounds in the presence of the monkeys, having paid obeisance to him and taken bim into bis arms, mounted into the sly with the speed of the wind. Seeing the two Ragbavas healed of their wounds, the leaders of the monkeys, lashing their tails, roared like lions. Thereafter gongs were beaten and drums resounded, whilst conches were blown amidst general rejoicing. Some manifested their strength by breaking down the trees wbich they used as maces and, in their warlike frenzy, those Plavamgamas hurled themselves on the gates of Lanka. Thereafter a terrible and appalling clamour arose amongst the foremost of monkeys as, at the end of summer, the roaring of thunderclouds in the night. Dlnmrraluha goes out to fight 1M Monke:JII THAT formidable clamour, set up by the monkeys who were full of martial ardour, arrested the attention of **RAVANA** and bis titans, and he, hearing the joyful and spirited acclamations and the distant tumult, said to bis ministers who surrounded him : " A great uproar, resembling the muttering of clouds, has arisen from tbat horde of delighted monkeys. Undoubtedly their joy is great, their mighty shouts are agitating the ocean itself. Nevertheless whetted shafts bave rendered the two brothers, **RAMA** and Labhmana, insensible, therefore this tremendous outcry almost alarms me I " Having spoken thus to bis ministers, the Lord of the Titans said to bis Nairritas, who stood round him : " Do ye speedily discover from wbat cause tbis general rejoicing amcmg those forest dwellers proceeds in their present painful situation ! " At this command, the titans hastily

climbed the rampam from where they beheld the army and its leader the illustrious **SUGRIVA** with the two Ragbavas also, freed of their bonds, seated in noble ease, whereupon the titans were thunderstruck. With terror in their hearts, those fierce warriors jumped down from the walls and, deadly pale, rerurned to their king. With downcast mien, those titans, skilled in speech, faithfully informed **RAVANA** of those unpleasant tidings, saying : " The brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, whom lndrajita had bound with his benumbing shafts and whose arms he had pinioned, are freed from the arrows which paralysed them and now appear on the field of battle in their native vigour, resembling two elephants who have snapped their fetters." At these words, the powerful King of the Titans, full of anxiety and highly incensed, grew pale and said: " If mine adversaries, having thus been bound, are now free despite those formidable arrows, those rare boons resembling serpents bright as the sun, that were infallible and with which lndrajita secured them after overcoming them in combat, then mine entire authority is in jeopardy I Verily those darts, bright as fire, which in battle deprived mine enemies of life have been rendered void." Having uttered these words in furious tones, hissing like a snake, he addressed one named Dhumraksha who was seated amidst the titans and said : " Taking with thee a considerable force of titans go without delay and slay **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**." At the command of that crafty monarch, Dhumraksha circumambulated him and immediately left the pslace, thereafter having crossed the threshold he said to the General of the Forces: "Mobilize the army, what need is there for delay when the battle is joined I " Thus spoke Dhumraksha and the General gathered together a large number of troops in accord with **RAVANA**'s command. · Thereafter those prowlers nf the night, who were valiant and of a formidable aspect, with girdles nf bells round their waists, shouted exultandy and ranged themselves round Dhumraksha.

Furnished with every kind nf weapon, brandishing spears, hammers, maces, harpoons, sticks, iron cudgels, ban, hoob, 126 picks, nooses and axes, those terrible titans sallied forth with the noise of thunder. Clad in mail and mounted on chariota that were magnificendy dressed with flags and decorated with bands of pure gold, harnessed to mules of many heads or steeds of exceeding fteetness or elephants maddened with Mada juice, some of those titans bounded forward like veritable tigers. And Dhumraksba, with a great clatter set out in a celestial car to which mules with golden harness and the heads of deer and lions were hitched ; and that valiant general surrounded by the titans set forth amidst mocking laughter through the western gate, where **HANUMAN** was stationed. As he advanced in his excellent car harnessed to mules, whose voices he emulated, birds of ill-omen planed above him and on the top of his chariot a terrible vulture alighted while those devourers of corpses clustered on the point of his standard. Streaming with blood a huge decapitated and livid trunk fell to earth emitting in articulate cries at Dhumraksha's approach and the sky rained down blood, the earth shook, the wind blew adversely with the roar of thunder and darkness obscured every quarter. Beholding those terrible portents that appeared in all their horror, boding ill-fortune to the titans, Dhumraksha was filled with alarm, and terror seized all the soldiers who accompanied him. At the moment when, full of fear, amidst his coundess titans, eager to enter into combat, that valiant general set out, he beheld the vast army of the monkeys resembling a great 1lood, protected by the arms of the Raghavas.

CHAPTER 52

Dhumraksha fights and is slain by Hanuman

SEEING Dhumraksha of redoubtable courage set forth, all the JIIOJlkeys in their martial ardour emitted loud cries and a terrific struggle ensued between those forest dwellers and the titans, who attacked each other with huge trees, spears and maces. On all aides ferocious monkeys were massacred by titans and litans felled to the earth by monkeys employing trees. The titans struck their opponents with pointed arrows furnished with heron's plumes, fearful to behold, which never missed their target and terrible maces, hsrpoons, axes, fotmidsble bars and tridents of all kinds, which, brandished by them, mutilsted those powerful monkeys, while they, exasperated, redoubled their efforts and, without llagging, continued the figln. Their limbs pierced with arrows, their bodies transfixed with spears, those foremost of the monkeys armed themselves with trees and rocks and, with terrific bounds, hsving proclaimed their nsmes to the accompaniment of yells, crushed those intrepid titsns. Theresfter the bsttle wsxed exceedingly furious between monkeys and demons and the former amidst shouts of triumph seized hold of stones of every kind and trees with countless branehes and rocks in order to destroy the enemy ; the titans, who fed on gore, fell in heaps, vomiting blood, their sides slashed open by the trees, whilst others were crushed by the stones and yet others torn to pieces by the monkeys' teeth. Their standards broken, their swords snspped, their chsriots overturned, they wandered about blindly and the eanh was covered with the corpses of great elephants resembling hills and horses with their riders crnshed by the great rocks hurled on them by those dwellers in the woods ; and the monkeys of exceeding valour rushed on the titans, ftinging themselves upon them with great bounds and scratehing their faces with their shsrp nails. Mutilsted, their hair torn out, maddened by the smell of blood, the titans fell in great numbers ; some of those fierce warriors however, in a paroxysm of futy hurled

themselves on the monkeys and struck them with the palms of their hsnds, whieh resounded like the clap of thunder, and the monkeys, receiving thst sharp shock, with an even greater ferocity crushed the titans with blows of their feet, teeth and trees. Seeing his army routed, Dhumrakshs, thst lion among the titans, in his rage, began to create carnsge among those bellicose apes and some pierced with spears lost rivers of blood whilst others, struck down by the blows of the axe, fell to earth. Here some were crushed by iron bars, others torn by harpoons or pierced by javelins, stumbled and fell, yielding up their villi 1:18 breaths. Mowed down, covered with blood, put to flight, those inhabitants of the woods fell dying under the furious onslaught of the titans in the struggle. Their breasts open they lay on their side or, slashed with tridents, their entrails gushed forth. Then that mighty confiict took on fearful proportions by virtue of the number of monkeys and titans who took part and the innumerable darts, stones and trees that were used. With the bowstrings as the tuneful lute, the neighing of the horses, the clapping of the hands and the trumpering of the elephants as the melody, the whole battle resembled a symphony. Meanwhile Dhumraksha, armed with his bow, in the forefront of battle, under a hail of missiles, dispersed the monkeys as in spon on every side, and Maruti, beholding the monkey army being exterminated and put to ftight by thst titan, hurled himself upon him in fury, a great rock in his hand. His eyes inllamed with anger, the equal of his sire in courage, he Bung the rock on the chariot of his foe and seeing the stone fall, Dhumraksha, brandishing his mace, in his agitation leapt quicldy from the car to the ground. Then that rock rolled on the earth, having shattered the chariot with its wheels, its pole, its shafts, banner and Dhumraksha’s bow. Thereafter **HANUMAN**, bom of Maruta, leaving the car lying, slew the titans with the trunks of trees furnished with their branches, and their

heads crushed, covered with blood, mangled by those trees, they fell to the earth. Having routed the army of the enemy, **HANUMAN**, born nf Maruta, breaking otr the peak nf a mountain hurled himself on Dhumraksha, who, brandishing his mace, rushed on his adversary and he advanced with haste towards him shouting. Then Dhumraksha, in his rage, brought down that weapon studded wilh countless points on the head nf the infuriated **HANUMAN** and assailed by that violent and fearful stroke, the monkey, who was endowed with the strength of Maruta, was in no wise disturbed but struck the titan full on the skull with his rocky peak which shattered all his limbs, whereupon Dhumraksha suddenly fell to the earth like a mountain crumbling. Beholding him slain, the night-rangers who had survived the 129 slaughter, terrified, re-entered Lanka, harassed by the Plavamgamas. The illustrious son of Pavana, however, having destroyed his enemies, causing rivers of blood ro flow, weary of slaughter, wirb delight received the cordial felicitations of the lliOIIkey leaders.

CHAPTER 53

Vajradamshtra enters the Lists

Serpent. Wrought up wirb ire, wirb long and burning sighs he addressed the exceedingly powerful Vajradamshtra, saying : " O Warrior, go fortb ar rbe head of rbe titans and triumph over rbe son of Dasararba, **RAMA**, as also over **SUGRIVA** and rbe lliOIIkeys I , " Be ir so ! " answered the general who was versed in rbe of magic, and he depaned speedily wirb rbe innumerable divisions rbar surrounded him. Wirb rbe urmosr care he assembled reams of elephants, horses, donkeys and mules, adorning rbem wirb counrless flags of different coloun, and rhar titan, wearing

bracelets and a diadem of great price, ser our immediarely, bearing his bow and, having circumambulared his chariot dressed wirb pennants, which dazzled rbe gaze wirb irs facings of pure gold, he ascended ir. Thereafter infantry of every kind issued forth, furnished wirb weapons, such as curlasses, innumerable darts, gleaming maces, harpoons, bows, lances, spears, swords, discus, hammers and sharp axes. All rbose illustrious lions among rbe titans in rbeir resplendent and many-coloured uniforms, full of ardour mounred on elephants intoxicated wirb ichor, RSembled moving hills. Their mounrs equipped for combat, driven by mahouts bearing lances and goads, were headed by those distinguished for rbeir trappings and grear strength. And the whole army of titans 1iled our, lookinl u brilliaDr u the clouds riven by lightning in the rainy and thev 130 emerged from the northern gate where the Genctal **ANGADA** was stationed. Thereafter, as they set forth, fearful portents appcatcd and, from a cloudless yet burning sky, meteors fell while jackals, emitting fearful howls, belched forth flames and fire. Hideous beasts foretold the destruction of the titans who entcted into the combat stumbling miSctbly. Yet despite those ill-omens, the mighty Vajradamshtra, full of energy and prowess, went forward eager to meet the foe and, seeing their adversaries advancing, the monkeys, burning fot victory, set up tremendous shouts which echoed in every quartet. Thcteafter a furious struggle ensued between the monkeys and the titans and those redoubtable warriors of ferocious aspect sought to bring about each other's d .. truction. Some of those warriors, their heads and bodies severed, fell to the earth bathed in blood, whilst others, whose arms resembled steel, approached one another, attacking with various weapons, neither giving ground. Trees, stones and javelins clashed with a tremendous noise, striking terror in the heart of the listeners and the appalling clatter of chariot wheels, the twanging of bow-strings, the

blare of trumpets, the roll of drums, the booming of gongs, created an indescribable uproar. Then, throwing away theit weapons, they wrestled with one another in hand-to-hand combat, striking each other with the palms of theit hands, their feet, theit knees and even with trees. Some of the titans had their bodies tom open, some were crushed by rocks and some were beaten down by the blows of the monkeys in the fight. Now Vajradamshtra, having surveyed the scene, began to sow terror among the monkeys, as Antaka, noose in hand, at the destruction of the wotlds. Full of vigour, those skillcd warriors, the titans, transported with rage, decimated the monkey forces with every kind of weapon and, on his side the audseious son of Vayu struck down all those titans in the fight, fury re-doubling his strength, so that he appeared like the Fire of Dissolution. Then the valiant **ANGADA**, the equal of Shakra in valour, brandishing a tree, his eyes red with angct, like a lion amidst defenceless deer, caused a terrible carnage. By the fotce of his blows, the titans of redoubtable courage, their skulls crushed, fell like under the blows of the axe and the esrth, strewn with chariots of every kind, standsrds, horses, bodies of monkeys and tilliDS and rivers of blood, was fearful to behold. Strings of pearls, bracelets, raiment, and parasols decorated the battlefield, wbich glowed like an autumnal night and the tempestuous **ANGADA** scattered the great army of the tilliDS as the wind dispels the clouds.

CHAPTER 54

Angada slays Vajradamshtra

THE extermination of his army through **ANGADA**'s prowess filled the valiant Vajradsmshtra with fury. Stretching his formidable bow, like unto Shskra's thunderbolt, he assailed the lllODkey battalions with a

hail of shafts whereupon the foremost of the tilliDS mounted on chariots, armed with every kind of weapon and full of courage, entered the lists whilst the monkeys, those powerful bulls among the Plavagas, asaembliug on all sides, fought with rocks. Thousands of weapons were hurled in that desperate encounter by the titan and monkey leaders and, from their side, the great monkeys with the ardour of elephants in rut, showered down giant trees and huge lumps of rock on the demons so that between those intrepid warriors, the titanS and the monkeys, who never rettested in battle, a tremendous struggle ensued. Monkeys and tilliDS, still possessing heads but bereft of arms and legs, lay on the earth bathed in blood and bristling with attows, a prey to herons, vultures and crows or devoured by troops of jackals. Monkeys and night-raugers fell on the battlefield ; headless trunks leapt up to the terror of all, their arms, hands and heads severed and their limba hacked to pieces in the fight. Meanwhile the army of Vajradsmshtra, overcome by the monkeys, broke up under his eyes, whereupon that leader, seeinl the titanS terrorised and decimated by the Plavampmas, his eyes red with anger, bow in hand, penetrated the enemy ranks, I3Z sowing panic amongst them. Thereafter he dispatched those monkeys with arrows furnished with heron's plumes that dew straight to their target and pierced seven, eight, nine or live of his opponents simultaneously, thus destroying them in his fury. Put to flight, those simian battalions, their limbs crippled by those darts, sought refuge with **ANGADA** as all creatureS with Prajapati ; and when he beheld those monkey divisions llceing in disorder, the son of Bali exchanged glances of hatred with Vajradamshtra and, in a paroxysm of rage, they entered into a terrible duel one with the other so that it seemed a lion and an elephant into:.icatcd with ichor fought together. And the son of Bali full of valour, was struck in his vital parts by a hundred thousand arrows

resembling tongues of lire and all his limbs were besprinkled with blood. Then that cxccedingly energetic monkey of redoubtable courage hurled a tree at Vajradamshtra but that intrepid titan, seeing it fall, cut it into innumerable pieces which fell in heaps on the earth. Witnessing the strength of his rival, that lion among the Plavagas seized hold of a huge rock which he spun round, emitting a shout and, as it descended, that hero leaping down from his chariot, armed with his mace, stood waiting un perturbed. Meanwhile that rock discharged by **ANGADA** fell on the forefront of the battle where it shattered the charint with its wheels, shafts and horses. Then the monkey broke off a great crag from the mountain once more and it was covered with trees and he brought it down on the head of his adversary so that Vajradamshtra, seized with a sudden giddiness, faltered and began to vomit blood, clenching his mace convulsively and breathing heavily. Thereafter, coming to his senses, in a transport of fury he hit the son of Bali full on the chest with his mace and, letting it fall, began to fight with his fists whereupon a hand-to-hand struggle ensued between monkey and titsn. Exhausted by the blows, spirting blood, those valiant warriors resembled the planets Mars and Mercury. Meanwhile the cxcccdingly powerful **ANGADA**, that lion of Plavagas stood waiting and he seized hold of a ahicld covered with the hide of a bull and a great sword decorated with golden bells enveloped in a leathern sheath. In the midst of innumerable gracd'u1 evolutions, the monkey and the titan attacked eacb other, roaring and thirsting for victory. With their gaping wounds, they shone like two Kimshuka Trees in flower and the struggle robbed them of their breath so that they sank to their knees on the earth. Thereafter in the twinkling of an eye, **ANGADA**, that elephant among monkeys, rose up, his eyes inflamed like a serpent that has been struck with a stick and, with his stainless sword that was well sharpened, the son of Bali who was full of

vigour, struck off the huge head of Vajradamshtra, whose limbs were bathed in blood. Under the stroke of that sword, his beautiful head fell, cleft ·in twain, the eyes rolling. Beholding Vajradamshtra slain, the titans, wild with terror, fled panic-stricken towards Lanka, harassed by the Plavamgamas, their faces woe-begone, their heads bowed in shame. Having struck down the enemy with his powerful arm, the mighty son of Bali experienced great joy amidst the monkey army, honoured by them for his high courage and he resembled the God of a Thousand Eyes surrounded by the Celestials. CHAPTER SS Akampana goes out to fight f16aimt the MOIIoUJII HaA!uNG that Vajradamshtra had been slain by the son of Bali, Rsvana addressed the General of his forces who, with joined palms, stood near him and said : " Let the invincible titans of irresistible courage go forth immediately with Akampana at their head, who is conversant with the use of every weapon and missile; he escels in vanquishing the foe and in preserving and leading his own forces ; he has ever desired my welfare and loved war ; he will prove victorious over the two Kakutsthas and the ezceedingly energetic **SUGRIVA**. The rest of the monkeys toO are formidable but without doubt he will exterminate them all. .. At this command from Rsvana, the ft!iant titan, in great haste, IIIObilized an entire diviaion of the army. Purniahed with every

CHAPTER 55

Akampana goes out to fight against the Monkeys

In the midst of innumerable gracd'u1 evolutions, the monkey and the titan attacked eacb other, roaring and thirsting for victory. With their gaping wounds, they shone like two Kimshuka Trees in flower and the

struggle robbed them of their breath so that they sank to their knees on the earth. Thereafter in the twinkling of an eye, **ANGADA**, that elephant among monkeys, rose up, his eyes inflamed like a serpent that has been struck with a stick and, with his stainless sword that was well sharpened, the son of Bali who was full of vigour, struck off the huge head of Vajradamshtra, whose limbs were bathed in blood. Under the stroke of that sword, his beautiful head fell, cleft ·in twain, the eyes rolling. Beholding Vajradamshtra slain, the titans, wild with terror, fled panic-stricken towards Lanka, harassed by the Plavamgamas, their faces woe-begone, their heads bowed in shame. Having struck down the enemy with his powerful arm, the mighty son of Bali experienced great joy amidst the monkey army, honoured by them for his high courage and he resembled the God of a Thousand Eyes surrounded by the Celestials.

CHAPTER SS Akampana goes out to fight f16aimt the MOIIoUJII HaA!uNG that Vajradamshtra had been slain by the son of Bali, Rsvana addressed the General of his forces who, with joined palms, stood near him and said : " Let the invincible titans of irresistible courage go forth immediately with Akampana at their head, who is conversant with the use of every weapon and missile; he escels in vanquishing the foe and in preserving and leading his own forces ; he has ever desired my welfare and loved war ; he will prove victorious over the two Kakutsthas and the ezceedingly energetic **SUGRIVA**. The rest of the monkeys toO are formidable but without doubt he will exterminate them all. .. At this command from Rsvana, the ft!iant titan, in great haste, IIIObilized an entire diviaion of the army. Purniahed with every 134 kind of weapon, those foremost of titans of terrifying aspect, fearful to look upon, rushed into the fray where their general had despatched them. Akampaua of the stature and colour of a cloud, whose voice resembled thunder, ascended his car decorated with fine gold and set out surrounded by dreadful

demons. He, who was incapable of trembling in battle even before the Gods thetnselves, seemed to the monkeys to be as splendid as the sun. As he sped on his way, furious and eager to enter into combat, the horses drawing his chariot were suddenly deprived of their energy and the left eye of that one who delighted in warfare began to twitch. His countenance grew pale, his voice trembled, the day which had seemed so fair became threatening and a bitter wind began blow. Birds and beasts uttered moutnful cries but that titan, who had the shoulders of a lion and the agility of a tiger, disregarding those portents, rushed towards the battlefield and, as be went forward with his troopa, an immense tumult arose that seemed to convulse the ocean and the sound appalled the simian army, who, furnished with trees, prepared to enter into combat. Thereafter a fearful struggle ensued between monkeys and demons and, ready to sacrifice their lives in the cause of **RAMA** and **RAVANA**, those monkey and titan warriors of esceeding valour, who resembled bills, contended with each other and, the yells they emitted in the thick of the fight and the shouts of defiance that they let forth in their rage created an indescribable clamour. A thick coppery dust, raised by the monkeys and the titans enveloped the whole horizon and, in the midst of that yellow cloud resembling silk which covered them, the combatants could no longer distinguish each other on the field. Neither standard, banner, shield, weapon nor chariot could be discerned in that pall of dust and the terrific clamour of warriors challenging and rushing upon each other was appalling to hear, yet in the confusion no form was visible. In that fight monkeys fell under the blows of enraged monkeys, titans massacred titans in the darkness ; Plavagas and demons slew foe and friend, and the earth drenched with gore was thick with mud. Under the rain of blood the dust was laid, revealing the 13$ THE llAMAYANA OF VALMlltl earth covered with corpses. Then the

monkeys and titans assailed escb other with blows aom trees, spears, maces, javelins, stones, bars and picks, wrestling with their adversaries who resembled mountains. In that encounter those monkeys slew the titans of dresdful deeds and they, transported with rage, bcsring darts and javelins in their hands, destroyed the monkeys with their auel weapons. Thereafter Akampans, the leader of the titans, full of ire, consoled all those fierce and valiant soldiers ; the monkeys however, leaping upon them, shattered their wespons and aushed those titans with blows from trees and stones. At that instant, the courageous monkey Lesders, Kumuda, Nala and Mainda, in a paroxysm of rage, u in sport, with mighty bounds and blows of trees crested a great carnage amongst the titans and all those lions among the monkeys btought about complete disorder in the enemy ranks with their countless missiles.

CHAPTER 56

Akampana is slain by Hanuman

Sowing terror his soldiers, greatly perturbed, set up a mighty shout and, with fourteen pointed anows tbst tore the ftesh, he pienied the exceedingly powetful **HANUMAN**. Riddled with shsrp-pointed iron shafts, tbst simian warrior resembled a mountain covered with forests and, like unto a 11owering Ashoka Tree, he shone like a smokeless llame. Up rooting another tree, with a prodigious hound he struck the head of the Titan General a fearful blow and, by tbst stroke with which tbst lndrs among Monkeys smote him in his fury, Aksmpana fell dead. Seeing their leader lying lifeless on the earth, all the titans trctnbled as trees when the earth quakes. Put to fiight, all those warriors, throwing away their arms, escaped in the direction of Lanka, terrified, pursued by

the monkeys. Their hair loosened, panic-stricken, their pride broken by defeat, their limbs dripping with sweat, in their bewilderment, they 1led in confusion. Thereafter, mad with fear, looking back continually, crushing each other in their haste, they entered the city. And when those titans had entered Lanka, those exceedingly powetful monkeys surrounded **HANUMAN** in order to pay homage to him and the mighty **HANUMAN**, of noble nature, honoured them all in accord with their rank. Then the triumphant monkeys shouted with might and main and once more pursued the titans with the intention of slaying them while tbst great Plavaga, hom of Maruta, returning to his own companions, having slain the titan, enjoyed the same renown in battle as **VISHNU** when he overcame the mighty *Asura* of immense power in the forefront of the fight. Thereafter tbst monkey received the homage of the Gods and ofRama himaelf as also tbst of the exceedingly valiant **LAKSHMANA** and the Plavamgamas led by **SUGRIVA** and the great-souled Bihishana.

CHAPTER 57

Prahasta goes out to fight

having rc1lectcd awhile and deliberated with them, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, passed the fotenoon in inspecting the defences ; and the King passed through that city, decorated with banners and flags, guarded by the titans and filled with innumerable uoops. Seeing Lanka bcseiged, **RAVANA**, the Sovereign of the Titans, said to the devoted Prahasta, a skilled soldier : " This city thus beleaguered and hard pressed, O Skilful Warrior, may only be delivered by myself, Kumbhakama, thou, who art in command of the army, Indrajita or Nikumbha; none else could

undertake such a task ! “Taking a company ofwarriotB,do thou speedily place thyself in their midst and set forth in order to triumph over those inhabitants of the woods. In this sortie, as soon as the army of monkeys hear the uproar created by the titans, they will disperse. Volatile, undisciplined and fickle, the monkeys will not be able to endure thy cry, any more than an elephant can endure the roaring of a lion. His army routed, **RAMA** with Saumitri, robbed of further authority, will fall into thy power, O Prahasta. “A hypothetical miafottune is preferable to one that is certain I Whether it be unpleasing to hear ot no, say what thou conaidercst to be to our advantage I " Thus addressed by that **INDRA** among Titans, Prahasta, the leader of the army, answered him as Ushanas the King of the Asuraa, saying : " O King, formerly we discussed this matter with the wiae and, after ezamining the different points of view, a disagreement arose between us. To return **SITA** was what I conaidercd the most advantageOUS course, not to do so, meant war ; we forsaw this. " I have ever been heaped with gifts and honours by thee as alao with every mark of tiiendship. When the opportunity 139 Irises, is it not for me to render thee a service? Nay, I sball neither spare life, children, wife nor wealth I Know me to be ready to sacrifice my life in thine interest in battle I " Having spoken thus to bis brother, the General Prahasta said to his leading officers who stood before him : " Gather a large army together immediately ; to-day the llesh-eating birda and beasts sball feed on the eoemy that I strike down on the battlefield with my swift arrows ! " At this command those highly powerful leaders assembled the forces in the abode of the King of the Titans. In an instant, Lanka was filled with redoubtable warriors like unto elephants, furnished with weapons of every kind. While they propitiated the God who feeds on offerings’ and paid homage to the brahmina, a fragrant breeze, bearing the scent of clarified butter, began to blow and the titans,

all ready for battle, taking hold of garlands of every kind, adorned themselves with delight. Thereafter, armed with bows and mail, they set out in their chariots at a brisk pace, their eyes turned towards their King, **RAVANA**. And they ranged them selves round Prshasta whilst he paid obeisance to his Sovereign to the beating of a gong of dreadful sound, whereafter, with bis weapons, that geoeral ascended bis chariot that was furnished with all that was needful, bamessed to exceedingly swift steeds, skilfully driveo and in perfect condition. Rumbling like a cloud, shining like the moon itself, tmapproaclutble as the serpent that served as its standard, solidly and artistieally constructed, decorated with a net of pure gold, smiling as it were in its magnificence, sueh was the car in which Prahasta, having received **RAVANA**'s command, stood. Then the titan set out from Lanka immediately in the midat of a powerful army and, at bis depanure, a rolling of drums, resembling the roarofParjanya,and a blast of fanfares arose that seemed to fill the earth and, with the blare of conches, the titans advanced, creating a terrible uprou. Narantab, Kumbhahanu, Mahanada and Samunata, co1ossal giants, bis adjutants, surrounded Prahaata who emerged from the eastern gate in the midat of an immense, formidable and powerful army resembling a herd of elephants and, in the centre of that force, vast as the sea, Prabasta in his fiuy appeared like Death at the end of the world, whilst the uproar, that arose on his setting forth with his titanS raising their war aies, drew a sinister answering call from aU creatures. In a cloudless sky, birds of prey advancing to meet the chariot, circled from left to right ; fcartul jackals vomited forth fire and llames, howling lugubriously ; a meteor fell from heaven and the wind blew chill ; planets, in opposition to eaeh other, lost their brilliance whilst clouds with a raucous sound showered blood on Prabasta's car with wbieh his atteodanta were bespattered ; a croaking vulture, facing the south,

alighted on the top of his standard depriving that titan of his lustre. His charioteer, who never turned back in battle, despite his skill, again and again allowed the goad to faD from his hand. The brilliance of that sortie of incomparable pomp vanished in an instant and the horses stumbled on the even ground. Beholding Prabasta, renowned for his martial valour, advancing to give battle, the army of monkeys, furnished with weapons of every kind, went forward to meet him and a formid able clamour arose amongst them as they tore up the and seized hold of great rocks. Thereafter the titanS yelled and the monkeys roared, both armies being filled with ardour and, in their fiuy and zeal and their impatience to slay eaeh other, they ehaJienged one another with tremendous shouts. Meanwhile Prabasta advanced on the forces of the monkeys whom in his folly he imagined he would destroy and, with an impetuous bound, he hurled bimself upon that army as a grasshopper faUs into a ftame. CBAPTBR “58 T1u DMth 11/ Praluula

CHAPTER 58

The Death of Prahasta

Of that force, vast as the sea, Prabasta in his fiuy appeared like Death at the end of the world, whilst the uproar, that arose on his setting forth with his titanS raising their war aies, drew a sinister answering call from aU creatures. In a cloudless sky, birds of prey advancing to meet the chariot, circled from left to right ; fcartul jackals vomited forth fire and llames, howling lugubriously ; a meteor fell from heaven and the wind blew chill ; planets, in opposition to eaeh other, lost their brilliance whilst clouds with a raucous sound showered blood on Prabasta’s car with wbieh his atteodanta were bespattered ; a croaking vulture, facing

the south, alighted on the top of his standard depriving that titan of his lustre. His charioteer, who never turned back in battle, despite his skill, again and again allowed the goad to faD from his hand. The brilliance of that sortie of incomparable pomp vanished in an instant and the horses stumbled on the even ground. Beholding Prabasta, renowned for his martial valour, advancing to give battle, the army of monkeys, furnished with weapons of every kind, went forward to meet him and a formid able clamour arose amongst them as they tore up the and seized hold of great rocks. Thereafter the titanS yelled and the monkeys roared, both armies being filled with ardour and, in their fiuy and zeal and their impatience to slay eaeh other, they ehaJienged one another with tremendous shouts. Meanwhile Prabasta advanced on the forces of the monkeys whom in his folly he imagined he would destroy and, with an impetuous bound, he hurled bimself upon that army as a grasshopper faUs into a ftame. CBAPTBR “58 T1u DMth 11/ Praluula who with such speed, valour and courage, advances so swiftly ? Mske known to me this brave ranger of the night.” On this enquiry, **BIBISHAAA** *answered*: " Prabasta is the name of this titan ; he is the leader of the army ; a third of the forces belonging to the King of the Titans accompanies him. He is courageous, a master of the science of weapons and a warrior renowned for his prowess.” While the terrible Prabasta of formidable exploits advanced roaring, that colossus, surrounded by his troops, was observed by the great and powerful army of the monkeys who began to emit cries of defiance. Swords, lances, daggers, spears, darts, maces, bludgeons, bars, javelins and axes of every kind with many different bows glittered in the hands of the titans who, desirous of victory, fell upon the monkeys. Trees in flower, rocks, huge and heavy stones were the weapons of the Plavamgamas, who were burning to fight and, as they approached each other, a formidable struggle arose between

those innumerable combatants, who showered down a hail of stones and arrows. In the con1lict, countless titans caused the death of thouaands of mighty monkeys and countless monkeys destroyed as many titans. Some of the combatants fell under the lances, others under great arrows, some were struck down by the blows of bars, others cloven by axes. Deprived of their life's breath they Jay on the earth their hearts transfixed or cut to pieces by the avalanche of missiles. And those monkeys fell on the earth cut in two by the strokes of swords, their sides tom open by those bold titans and they, on their part, full of fury, overthrew the enemy ranks, heaping the earth with them, and they struck at them with trees and crags, administering thundering slaps and terrific blows with their fists, so that the titans, blinded, their faces ashen, vomited blood. Thereafter an appalling clamour arose and, amidst cries of pain and leonine roars, the monkeys and titans, each maddened, their features distorted, following the path of heroes, conducted themselves with great courage. Narantaka, Kumbhahanu, Mshanada and Samunnata, Prahasta's companions, decimated those inhabitants of the woods, hurling themselves on the monkeys in rage, destroying them ; and Dvivida struck down I.p one of them oamed Narantaka ; then the ape Durmukba, leaping up in his tum, with a ready hand, struck Samunnata with a great tree; **JAMBAVAN**, in the bcight of anger, seizing a huge stone hurled it with force on Mahanada's chest and, on his side, the valiant Kumbhahanu, having attacked the General Tara, who was armed with a huge tree, received a blow that cost him his life. Infuriated by the quadruple murder, Prahasta, who stood in his chariot, with the bow held in his hand, caused a dreadful havoc amongst the monkeys and the two armies became a vorteX, resembling a roariog tempest over a vast ocean. In that great battle, the titan, intoxicated with combat, in his fury annihilated the monkeys under an immense avalanche of arrows. The

corpses of monkeys and titans heaped the ground and covered it like hideous mountains and the earth, running with the blood wbich inundated it, shone as in the month of Spring when covered by the blossoming Palasha Trees. With the heaps of warriors for its banks, the broken weapons its uees, the torrents of blood its huge waves, death appeared like an ocean receiving its floods ; livers and spleens its mire, entrails its moss, severed hesds and ttunks the 6sh, and morsels of flesh the grass, innumerable vultures its lovely swans, herons its geese, covered as it was with fat for the foam, the tumult the sound of its waters, the battlefield resembled a river, incapable of being crossed, visited by waterfowl at the end of the rainy season. And the foremost of the titans and the monkeys crossed over that impassable river as elephants lead their herds across a Jake that the lotuses have covered with pollen. Meanwhile Prahasta, standing in his chariot, Jetting fly coundess shafts scattering the Plavamgamas, was obacrved by Nila and, like unto a violent wind, the General of the Titans beheld Nila advancing on him like a mass of clouds in the sky. Directing his chariot bright as the sun towards him, that foremost of archers, stretching his bow in the midst of the fray, covered Nila with his barbed shafts, wbich, piercing him in their rapid flight, passed through his body and, like furious setpcnts, buried themselves in the earth with grest spurts. When Nila ezceedingly redoubtable Prahasta who had set upon him with such fury. Roaring with anger under his blows, thst lion among titans overwhelmed the monkey chief with a rain of arrows and the shower of missiles loosed by thst cruel demon was received by the monkey with closed eyes. Like a bull stsnding under a sudden autumual downpour, so under thst intolerable rain of darts, Nila immediately closed his eyes, suffering it, though it was scarce to be endured. Mad with rage, under the hail of arrows, thst great and mighty monkey, arming himself with a Sa1a Tree,

struCk down Prahasta's horses and thereafter his heart surging with anger he severed the bow of that barbarian, shouting again and again. Deprived of his bow, Prshasta, the leader of the army, seizing a formidable mace, leapt down from hls chariot, and those two generals, filcing each other, adversaries full of courage, their limbs covered with blood, like unto two elephants with broken tuSks, tore each other with their sharp teeth. Lion and tiger in gait, lion and tiger in prowess, those warriors, vanquishers of other heroes, intrepid combatants, thirsting for fame, resembled Vritra and Vasava. Meanwhlle Prshasta with a supreme effort struck Nila on the forehead with his mace, causing the blood to flow, whereupon that powerful monkey, his limbs covered with gore, seized a great tree and struck Prshasta full in the chest with fury. He, however, not heeding the impact, brandishing an enormous iron bar, hurled himself on the valiant Plavamgama. Seeing him advancing towards him with terrific bounds, full of rage, the mighty monkey Nila, snatched up a great rock which he swiftly threw at the head of his bellicose opponent armed with a mace. Loosed by thst monkey chief, thst immense and for midable stone broke into several pieces on Prahasta's head and the titan, deprived of breath, lustre, strength and conaciousnesa instantly fell on the earth, like a tree severed at the root. From his riven head and body the blood flowed, so that it resembled a torrent fii1Jing from a mountain. Prshasts beins slain by Ni!a, the invincible and mighty army of the titsDa oould they be stayed, as the waters of the sea may not be stemmed by a broken dyke. Their lcsder slain, the titans disconsolate regained the abode of their soveteign. Dumb and dispirited, plunged in an ocean of burning grief, they appcated to have lost their wits. The triumphant warriat Nils, howevet, on his return, wu honouted by **RAMA** with **LAKSHMANA** who accompanied him, and experienced supterne joy.

CHAPTER 59

Ravana's prowess. Rama overcomes him but grants him his Life

THEIR General having succumbed in the fight against the fatemost of the monkeys, the heavily armed foras of the King of the Titans took to flight with the speed of the tide. Coming bcfote their lord, they apptised him of the death of their leader who had fallcn under the blows of the Fire-god's ofl'spting, and at these tidings, the king was transpattcd with anger. Learning that Prabasta had perished in the fight, his heart was filled with grief and he addressed the foremost of his leaders, as **INDRA** those who ncvet grow oldand said : " That foe is not to be despised, under whose blows the dcstroyet of **INDRA**'s host, the leader of my army with his folloWetS of praise, frenziedly greeted the departure of the Sovereign of the Titans. Those eaters of flesh, resembling mountains or clouds, whose glances Oashed like torches, surrounded the supreme Lcsdcr of the Titans as he marched out, like unto the Bhutas csconing Rudra, the Lord of the Immortals. Issuing from the city, that monarch observed the army of ferocious monkeys with and rocks in their bauds, ready for combat, roaring like a vast ocean or a mass of thunder clouds. Seeing the demon divisions seething with fury, the incom· parably illustrious **RAMA**, whose arms resembled great serpents, accompanied by his forces, said to Bibishana : " Who is in command of this army furnished with every ltind of standard, banner and canopy, armed with javelins, swords, stakes and other weapons and missiles, that is indomitable and composed of intrepid soldiers and clephauts as high as the Mahendra Mountain ? " Thus interrogated, Bibishana, the equal of

Shakra in valour, pointed out the principal leaders of those coursgeous lions among the titans to him and said : " That hero of coppery hue mounted on the back of an clephaut, causing its head to sway, the rival of the rising sun, know, O Prince, to be Akampana. " He who, standing in his chariot, brandishes his bow which resembles Shakra's, whose standard bears the image of a lion and who is like unto an clephaut with its long curved tusks, is Indrajita, who is renowned for the boons he has received from **BRAHMA**. " That archer yonder, like unto the Vindhya, Asta or Mahendra Mountains, standing in his car, a mighty warrior, who wields a bow of unequalled size, is called Atiksya on acaJunt of his immrnse stature. " The tawny-eyed warrior resembling the dawn, riding a wild clephaut with its bells jangling, who is shouting aloud, is Mahodara. " The rider of the brilliantly caparisoned steed he, who is armed with a gleaming javelin and resembles a mass of evening clouds, whose fury rivals the lightning and poasesses the velocity of a well-directed thunder-bolt, who is seated on the foremost of bulla and shines like the moon, is Trishiras. The other, 146 resembling a thunder-cloud, of large and well-developed chest, who is twanging his bow and has the King of the Snakes as his standard, is Kumbha. " The one who carries a mace decorated with gold and diamonds from which flames and smoke issue, who advances as a standard bearer to the titan army, is Nikumbha of prodigious exploits. " That warrior in a chariot adorned with flags, gleaming like a glowing brazier, who is furnished with bows, swords and arrows, is Narantaka, who, in combat, fights with mountain peaks. " Finally the one who appears surrounded by spectres of dreadful form with heads of tigers, buffalo, mighty elephants, deer and horses, riding under a white canopy with a slender handle, his diadem resembling the moon, he who is the humbler of the Gods themselves, like unto Rudra amidst the Bhutas is the mighty Lord of the

Titans himself. His countenance is graced by swinging earrings, his formidable stature equals the Vindhya, that Lord of Mountains, he who brought Mahendra and Vaivasvat low, is the King of the Titans, equal to the sun in splendour." Then **RAMA**, the subduer of his foes answered Bibishana and said: " Ah! What glory, what exceeding majesty is **RAVANA**'s, the Lord of the Titans ! As one cannot gaze on the sun, neither can the eye rest on him, such is the blinding strcngrh of his magnificence ! Neither *Devas*, Danavas nor heroes possess a body equal to his ! Who can rival the brilliance of the King of the Titans ? All arc as high as hills, all have aags as their weapons, all are furnished with fiery darts. The Lord of the Titans stands out among those ardent warriors as Antaka amidst the impetuous Bhutas of strange form. It is to his destruction that that wretch comes to-day within my sight I To-day I shall slake my wrath born of Sits's abduction ! " At these words, the valiant **RAMA** who was accompanied by **LAKSHMANA**, took up his bow and, standing erect, plsced an arrow, the most powerful of all, upon it. Meanwhile the haughty Monarch of the Titans said to his brave trOOpS : THE ltAMAYANA OP VALMIKI " Take up your positions unfalteringly at the gates and principal exits, the outposts and fortifications. Learning of my presence amongst you, these savages will try and profit by this opportunity to take this heretofore impregnable city by surprise, it being now denuded of its defenders, and they will then immediately put it to the sword with their united forces." Thereafter ltavana dismissed his escort and the titans left on his orders, whereupon he plunged into the sea of monkeys, agitating it as a great fish the waters of the ocean. As soon as that **INDRA** of the Titans with his bow and burnished arrows had thrown himself into the fray, the leader of the monkeys rushed out to meet him, tearing up a great mountain pealr:. Seizing that rock covered with innumerable trees, he hurled it at that

prowler of the night, who, seeing it flying towards him, broke it in pieces with his golden-stemmed arrows. That huge and high pealr: covered with trees being shattered, fell on the earth, and the Lord of the Titans, like unto another Antab, seleeted a dart resembling a great serpent. Taking up that arrow, which rivalled Ani1a in velocity and possessed the brilliance of fire and the force of lightning, he loosed it with fury on **SUGRIVA** in order to slay him, and that weapon, equal to Shakra's thunderbolt, loosed by ltavana's arm, penetrated **SUGRIVA**'s breast in its flight as fOl'lllerly Guba's spear when he discharged it at the Krauncha Mountain. Wounded by that missile which bereft him of consciousness, that warrior fell moaning to the earth. Beholding him stretched on the ground deprived of his senses, the Yatudhanas raised a shout of triumph. Thereupon Gavaksha, Gavaya, Sushena as well as Rishabha, Jyotirmukha and NaJa, of exceeding corpulence, tearing up rocks, hurled themselves on the King of the Titans. Then that Lord of the Titans, with hundreds of arrows possessed of sharp points, rendered their projectiles fruidess and pierced those leaders of the monkeys with a hail of marvellous golden· shafted arrows. Under the blows with which the Euemy of the Gnds asaailed them, those generals of tenifying stature were overcome, whereupon he covered that formidable army of monkeys with a shower of arrows. Assailed and wounded, those warrion emitted aies of terror and pain, and those deer of the branches, whom Ravaoa was destroying with his darts, lied for refuge to the intrepid **RAMA**, whereupon thst mighty and skilful archer, Raghava, seizing a weapon, set out at once. **LAKSHMANA** however, approaching him with joined palms, addressed him in moving tones, and said: .. Truly, O Noble Brother, I am able to slay this wretch I It is I who will destroy him, do thou give me leave, O Lordi" Then the exceedingly powerful **RAMA**, a true hero, answered him saying : " Go, O **LAKSHMANA**, and in

this duel may thy valour prevail ! Without doubt Ravaoa is endowed with great strength, he is a warrior of outstanding prowess; the Three Worlds themselves could not withstand his fury ; seek out his weak points and guard against thine own ; be ever vigilant and defend thyself with eye and bow ! " Thus spoke Raghava and Saumitri embraced him, thereafter offering obeisance to him and bidding him farewell, he entered the lists. There he beheld Ravaoa with arms as large as the trunks of elephants, who was brandishing his dread and fiery bow, covering the monkeys, whose limbs he had severed with a close rain of darts. Beholding this, the exceedingly energetic **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, in order to bring that rain of anows to an end, rushed on Ravaoa and, approaching his chariot, lifted his right arm and threatened him ; thereafter the sagacious **HANUMAN** addressed him, saying : " Thou hast obtained the boon of invulnerability to *Devas*, Danavas, Gandhatvas, Yakshas and also *Rakshasas* but the mollkcys are a danger to thee I This five-branched hand of Then the son of the Wind BDSwered Ra\llll who spoke thus, saying: " Recollect that I have slain thy son Abba already I " At this, the powerful Lord of the Titans struck the son of Anila a violent blow with the palm of his hand and the monkey reeled; thereafter the mighty and illustrious **HANUMAN** recovered his balance and, steadying himself, struck that enemy of the Immortals in fucy. Under the violent impact of the monkey’s blow, Dashagriva shook like a mountain when the earth trembles. Seeing **RAVANA** struck in the fight, *Rishis*, Siddhas and monkeys raised a gteat shout, as also the *Devas*, Suras and *Asuras*. Then the extremely spirited **RAVANA**, having regained his breath, said : " Wcll done I Wcll done ! O Monkey, thou art an adversaty worthy of praise ! " Thus did he speak, and Maruti BDSwcred him, saying : " Cursed be that strength since thou dost still survive, O **RAVANA** ! Now come, enter into a decisive struggle with me, O Perverse Wretch ! Why

this boasting? My fist is about to despatch thee to the abode of Y ama ! " Hearing **HANUMAN**'s words, the powerful RaVliiUI, enraged, his eyes red with fury, whirling his fist with force brought it down violently on the monkey's chest and, under the shock, **HANUMAN** rcclcd once more, whilst the King of the Titans, Dashagriva, that exceedingly fiery warrior, seeing his valiant opponent bereft of strength, rurned his chariot towards Nila. With his arrows, like unto gtest serpents, he pierced the vital parts of his enemy overwhelming the Monkey Gcncral, but Nila, the leader of the monkey army, assailed by that hail of weapons, with one hand flung a gtest rock at the King of the Titans. Meanwhile **HANUMAN**, burning with courage, having re covered his senses, in his martial ire cried out furiously : " O **RAVANA**, King of the Titans, who art engaged in combat with Nila, to artsck one already fighting with another is unjust I " The titan, however, shattered the crag, hurled by Nila, with seven pointed darts so that it fcll in pieces and, seeing the rock of varying fragrance in the fight, whereupon **RAVANA** caught them in his arms and snapped them, showering a formidable rain of shafts, as aom a cloud, on Pavaki' but that colossus, assuming a diminutive form, leapt on to the point of **RAVANA**'s standard. Beholding the offspring of Pavaki thus installed on the point of his standard, the King blazed with fury, whilst Nila let fotth a shout, and sometimes the monkey leapt on to the apex of the banner and sometimes on to the end of the bow and sometimes on to the peak of the <tiadem, so that **LAKSHMANA**, **HANUMAN** and **RAMA** also, were astonished. The intrepid titan too was amazed at the monkey's agility and took up a marvellous and 8aming arrow but the Plavam gamas shouted joyously at Nila's tactics, being amused to see **RAVANA** disconcerted by his leaping about in combat and the shouts of the monkeys infuriated Dashagriva, who, in his con fusion, <tid not know how to act. Taking up an arrow charged with sacred formulas, that

prowler of the night aimed at Nila, who had climbed to the tip of his standard and, at that instant, the King of the Titans, said: " O Monkey, thine agility proceeds from a rare power of magic ; do thou save thyself if thou canst by these innumerable tricks with which thou art familiar and constantly employest I This *mantra*-propelled weapon of mine, that I am about to loose, will sever the existence thou seekest to retain I " Speaking thus, the long-armed **RAVANA**, Lord of the Titans, having placed **AGNI**'s shaft on his bow, struck Nila, the General of the monkey army, with that weapon and he, piereed through the breast by that shaft charged with sacred mantraS, was suddenly overcome and fell to the earth, yet by virtue of his sire's powerful aid and his own native vigour, though brought to his knees he was not deprived of life. Beholding the monkey unconscious, Dashagriva, insatiable in combat, in his chariot, whose rattling resounded like thunder clouds, rushed on **LAKSHMANA** and coming to the centre of the field, halted, stanting there in his glory. Theresfler the majestic Lord of the Titans lifted up his bow, whereupon Saumitri, of indomitable courage, said to him u he prepared to his powerful shaft : " O King of the Night-rangers, now enter into combat with me ; cesse from lighting with the monkeys I " Hesring thst msrvellously modulated voice thst resounded like the twsnging of a bow-string, the King, drawing near to his adversary, who stood close to his chariot, answered in anger : " O Son of Raghu, it is my good fortune thst bringa thee within my range to-day, thou who, in thy folly, advanast to meet thy death ! This very instant thou shalt descend to the region of Mrityu under a rain of missiles loosed by me." Then Saumitri, unmoved, spoke to thst boasrful titan of sharp and protruding teeth, saying : " O King, stout hearts esehew bragging I O Greatest of Evil Doers, thou sounding thine own praises I I am well acquainted with thy strength, prowess, vigour and audacity, O King of the Titans I Approach I Here I

stand with bow and arrows in my hand ; of what use are vain boasts ? " Thus accosted, the Lord of the Titans, infuriated, let fty seven marvellously plumed arrows whieh Lakshmsna shattered with his golden-shafted darts. Observing his shafts resembling great serpents, whose coils had been crushed in an instant, the Lord of Lanka was transported with anger and let fty further sharp arrows. The younger brother of Rams, however, caused a well-aimed rain of missiles from his bow to fall on Ravena, but he, with the aid of weapons in the forms of knives, crescents and long-eared arrowheads, severed them, without allowing them to disturb him. Seeing thst the succession of his shafts proved useleas, the King of those hostile to the Gods, utonished at Lakshmsna's skill, let fty more whened shafts upon him anew and, from his side, Lakshmsna, the equal of Mahendra, placing some sharpened darts on his bow thst were formidable,swift u lightning and of blazing elfulgence, loosed them on the Titan King in order to strike him down, whereupon **RAVANA** shanered those pointed darts and struck his rival in the forehead with a shaft u bright u the Fire of Time, whieh had been beatowed on him by Swyambhu. Then I.abhmana, strudt by that missile, reeled a little, scarcely able to rellin his bow but comiD to hiJIIIelf with dUiiculty, he shattered tbat weapon belcmging to **INDRA**'s foe. Having broken his bow, the son of Dsssratba struck bim with three pointed darts and the king, pierced by those arrows, swooned, regaining bis senses with dUiiculty. Wounded by those shafts, bis bow wholly demolisbed, his limbs spattered with flesh and streaming with blood, the Enemy of the Gods, himself of formidable enetgy, seized a spear which bad been given bim in wsr by Swyambhu. Tbat smoking lance, as bright as fire, the tetror of the monkeys in the fray, the powetful guardian of the titan empire, was hurled on Saumitri the yoUilget brother of Bharats, who received tbat spear falling upon bim with arrows and darts, as if it were a

sacrificial fire ; nevertheless tbat weapon entered his broad chest. The powerful Raghu, struck by tbat spear, lay on the earth, breathing fire and the King of the Titans rushing on bim suddenly, while he was yet insensible, seized bim brutally in bis two bands, yet though he was able to lift up Himavat, Mandara, Meru and the Three Worlds with the Gods, he could not raise the younger brother of Bbarata, for **LAKSHMANA**, though wounded in the breast by **BRAHMA**'s weapon, recollected tbat he was of the substance of **VISHNU** Himself, and tbat thorn in the side of the Gods, though OVetCOmiug Saumitri, was unable to bear bim away. At tbat instant, the son of Vayu, enraged, threw himself in anger on **RAVANA** like a flash of lightoing and struck bim with bis fist on the chest. Under tbat blow, the Lord of the Titans was brought to his knees and stumbling, fell. From bis ten mouths, eyes and ears, blood streamed in torrents and, rolling unconscious, he slid under the body of the chariot; thete he remained deprived of his senses, stupified, not knowing where he was. Beholding **RAVANA**, despite bis redoubtable strength swoon on the battlefield, *Rishis* and monkeys began to shout in triumph u did also the Gods and *Asuras*, whilst the courageous **HANUMAN** lifting up **LAKSHMANA** in his arma, who had heen wounded by his adversary, returned to Raghava. In his tiiendsbip and ememe devotion to him, the son of Vayu found Labhmana, whom foes were unable to move, u light u a feather. Thereafter the spear, tbat bad overcome Saumitri, returned to the titan' chariot. 153 Meanwhile **RAVANA** who was full of energy in combat, having recovered consciousness, selected some steel-pointed arrows and armed himself with an enormous how. On his side, healed and freed from thst lance, **LAKSHMANA** recollected thst he was part of **VISHNU**, and **RAMA**, seeing the innumerable army of powerful monkeys overthrown on the battlefield, rushed on **RAVANA**, but **HANUMAN**, following him, said: .. Qimb on my shoulders in order to overcome the

titan I " Hearing those words from the son of Vayu, Raghava climbed on the shoulders of thst great monkey, as **VISHNU** on **GARUDA**, in order to fight with the Enemy of the Gods. Standing in his chariot, **RAVANA** appeared before that Lord of Men and, seeing him, thst mighty hero rushed upon him, like unto **VISHNU** with his mace upraised rushing furiously on Virochana. Thereupon **RAMA** drew the cord of his how and, like unto the roll of thunder, said in a deep voice to the Lord of the Titans : .. Stay I Stay ! Thou hast evoked my displeasure ! Where, O Tiger among the Titans, wilt thou !lee to escape me ? Even if thou seekest refuge in the region of **INDRA** or Vaivaswata or Bhaskara or Swyambhu, Vaishnavara, Shankara or in the ten regions, even in those abodes thou shalt not elude me from now on. The one who, struck by the spear, fell swooning this day only to recover consciousness immediately, shall now, assuming the form of death, claim thee, thy sons, and grandsons in battle. O King of the Titan People, here is he under whose blows, fourteen thousand titans of terrible form perished, who had established themselves in Janasthsna and were furnished with excellent weapons." Hearing Raghava speak thus, the esceedingly powerful Lord of the Titans full of rage, hurled himself on the son of Vayu, who was bearing **RAMA** with eimeme velocity through the fray was transported with anger and, approaching hia chariot with his slender aod pointed shafts, shattered it with its wheels, hones, banner, caoopy, great standard, charioteer, datts, spean aod swords ; thereafter, with great force, he hurled a weapon like nnto a thunderbolt falling on Mount Meru so that that valiant monateh, whom neither thunder nor lightning could cause to tremble, stumbled, letting fall his bow at the violent impact of **RAMA**'s missile, whieh created a deep wound. Seeing him swooning, the magnanimous **RAMA** took up a flaming arrow shaped like a ctescent moon and used it to shatter the ctown of the supteme Lord of the Titaos,

whieh waa as bright as the sun. Then **RAMA** said to that **INDRA** of the Titaos, whose splendour was dimmed, the setting of his diadem riven, aod who resembled a venomous snake robbed of its poison, or the sun, its rays extinguished, bereft of lustre : " Thou hast accomplished a great feat and my brave soldiers have succumbed beneath thy blows ; now thou art weary ; in this condition I shall not put thee under Mrityu's power with my shafts. Leave the fray aod rerum to Lanka ; I graot thee this reprieve, O King of the Rangers of the Night ! Having regained thy breath, return in thy chariot with thy bow and, staoding on thy car, thou shalt once more hear teStimony to my prowess!" At these words, his joy aod boasting subdued, his bow shattered, his hones aod charioteer slain, pierced with arrows, hia great diadem broken, the king instaody retuined to Lanka. After the departure of that powerful **INDRA** of Night Rangen, Lakshmaoa drew out the arrows from the monkeys, whieh they had received while fighting in the forefront of that vast battle field, and the adversary of the King of the Gods being vao quished, all the Celestials, *Asuras* and creatures of the oceao aod other regions with the great serpents, as alao all beings on earth and in the waterS, rejoiced. 155 CHAPTBR 60 RETDRNING to the City of Lanka, alfticted with the fear of **RAMA**'s arrows, his pride humbled, the king's mind was troubled. Like an elephant by a lion or a snake by **GARUDA**, that monarch had been overcome by the great-souled **RAMA**, and the Lord of the Titans was maddened by the mere recollection of **RAMA**'s shafts possessed of the splendour of lightning, resembling the Rod of **BRAHMA**. Seated on his magnificent and elevated throne made of gold, he let his gaze wander over the titans and said : " Since I, the equal of the mighty **INDRA**, have been defeated by a mere man, all the rigorous asceticism I have practised has been in vain. I asked to be rendered invulnerable to *Devas*, Danavas, Gandharvas, Yakshas, Ratshasas and

Pannagas, but of man I made no mention. **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA** is the one, I deem, of whom Anaranya,' bom of the race of Ikshvaku spoke, saying: " 'O Lord of the Titans, in my House will be born a man who will slay thee in hattie with thy sons, ministers, army and charioteer, O Vilest of Thy Race, O Perverse Wretch I ' “I was fiuther cursed by Vedavati for a former outrage and perchance she has been born as the high-eouled daughter of **JANAKA** and what was predicted by Uma, Nandishwara, Rambha and Punjikasthala, the daughter of **VARUNA**, has come to pass I

CHAPTER 60

The Titans rouse Kumbhakarna

CHAPTBR 60 RETDRNING to the City of Lanka, alfticted with the fear of **RAMA**’s arrows, his pride humbled, the king’s mind was troubled. Like an elephant by a lion or a snake by **GARUDA**, that monarch had been overcome by the great-souled **RAMA**, and the Lord of the Titans was maddened by the mere recollection of **RAMA**’s shafts possessed of the splendour of lightning, resembling the Rod of **BRAHMA**. Seated on his magnificent and elevated throne made of gold, he let his gaze wander over the titans and said : " Since I, the equal of the mighty **INDRA**, have been defeated by a mere man, all the rigorous asceticism I have practised has been in vain. I asked to be rendered invulnerable to *Devas*, Danavas, Gandharvas, Yakshas, Ratshasas and Pannagas, but of man I made no mention. **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA** is the one, I deem, of whom Anaranya,' bom of the race of Ikshvaku spoke, saying: " 'O Lord of the Titans, in my House will be born a man who will slay thee in hattie with thy sons, ministers, army

and charioteer, O Vilest of Thy Race, O Perverse Wretch I ' “I was fiuther cursed by Vedavati for a former outrage and perchance she has been born as the high-eouled daughter of **JANAKA** and what was predicted by Uma, Nandishwara, Rambha and Punjikasthala, the daughter of **VARUNA**, has come to pass I Prahasta being slain and the king himself defeated in the fight, that monsrch issued his commands to the dreadful host, saying: " Guard the gates and man the ramparts, rouse Kumbbakama who is slumbering soundly. He is sleeping peacefully oblivious of all that is passing, his senses overcome by lust, and he remains unconscious for periods of two or three or nine dsys and some times for six, seven or eight months. Hsving in consultation with me nine dsys ago, he has since fallen asleep. In combat, that warrior is the rampart of all the titans ; he will soon strike down all the monkeys and those two sons of a king. He is the very banner of the titans in battle but that insensate one, intent on vulgar pleasures, still slumbers. Though overcome by **RAMA** in this terrible srruggle, my fears will be dissipated when Kumbbakama wakes ; of wbat is this rival of lndra to me, if, in so pressing a danger, he is not ready to assist me?” Hearing their sovereign’s words, the titans ran in great hasre to Kumbbakama’s abode. At **RAVANA**’s command, those eaters of flesh and drinkers of blood took perliunes, garlands and a great store of food and left immediately. They entered that cave with its gates measuring a league in extent, the wonderful refuge of Kumbhskama, from which issued the fragrance of flowers. And with his breathing, Kumbbakama pressed those titans back despite their strength who, with difliculry, had penetrated into the cave. When they had entered into that ravishing underground dwelling paved with precious stones and gold, those lions among the Nairritas beheld that redoubtable giant lying there, and that monster, wrapt in profound slumber, resembled a crumbling mountain and together they sought to

waken him. His limbs covered with down which stood on end, Kumbhskama, he of irresistible valour, was bresthing like a serpent, and, as he slept, he emitted dreadful anorcs, his nostrils being horrible and his mouth a gaping hell. Stretched to his fUll length on the earth, he gave forth an odour of marrow and blood ; his limbs were adorned with golden armlets and he wore a diadem as bright as the sun ; thus did that lion among the Nairritas, Kumbbakama, the slayer of his foes, appear ! 157 Then those powerful titans, in order to satisfy him, placed a heap of venison as high as Mount Meru before him and piled up a great mass of viands, antelope, buffalo and bear and a prodigious mound of victuals, Ieathem bottles of blood and meats of every kind before **KUMBHAKARNA**, the Enemy of the Gods. Thereafter they rubbed that scourge of his foes with the most rare sandalwood and covered him with celestial garlands, and sweet smelling perfumes, and they burnt incense and hymned the praises of that warrior who proved fatal to his foes. The voices of the Yatudhanas burst forth on every side like thunder and with full cheeks they blew impatiently on their conches as bright as the moon, causing a terrible uproar, and those rangers of the night clapped their hands and shook Kumbbakarna, creating a great clamour, in order to awaken him, so that the birds passing through the air fell down at the sound of the conches, drums, gongs, clapping of hands and leonine roars. Aa the illustrious Kumbhakama did not waken from his slumber despite the great uproar, all those troops of titans seized hold of bars, pestles, maces, rocks, clubs, hammers, and with these and blows from their fists, those titans beat the chest of Kumbhakama violently as he was sleeping peacefully on the ground. And Kumbhakama’s breathing prevented those titans from standing upright so that they had to seat themselves round him and, with all their strength, which was considerable, they began to beat drums, cymbals and gongs and to blow

their myriad conches and trumpets. Ten thousand demons sur rounded that colossus who resembled a heap of antimony, and tried in every way to rouse him by their blows and cries ; nevertheless he did not wake. Aa they were unable to rouse him by these means, they had resort to more energetic and ruthless methods, causing hones, camels and elephants, whom they beat with sticks, whips and thongs, to trample upon him, while gongs, conches and trumpets blared forth as they crushed his limbs under piles of heavy logs. The noise of the hammers and pestles they wielded with all their strength and the shouts they raised filled the whole of Lanka with ill hills and woods but still he did not wake. 158 Then they beat a thousand drums simultaneously with sticks of refined gold but yet he did not stir from his profound slumber, being under the spell of the divine curse. Finally those powerful rangers of the night, growing enraged, redoubled their efforts in order to rouse the titan and some beat drums, some shouted, tore out his hair and others bit his ears, pouring hundreds of pitchers of water into them, but Kumbhakama, plunged in deep sleep, did not stir. Some armed with daggers stmck that mighty titan on the head, chest and limbs but that monster did not wake, though smitten by Shataghnis fastened with ropes, and at last a thousand titans ran up and down his body, till **KUMBHAKARNA**, becoming aware of that pressure, he wbo had remained insensible to the violent blows of crags and trees, under the prompting of extreme hunger suddenly emerged from sleep, yawning, and with one bound, stood up. Waving his two arms resembling serpent’s coils or the peaks of mountains, hard as cut diamonds, that ranger of the night opened his monstrous mouth, like unto Vadavamukha and yawned horribly, and when he yawned, his mouth resembled hell and glittered like the sun rising over the high peak of Mt. Meru. That extremely powerful ranger of the night, being awake, yawned, heaving a sigh like unto a tempest that shatters a mountain ; and

KUMBHAKARNA, rising up, resembling Time at the dissolution of the world, prepared to devour all beings and his two great eyes, like glowing braziers, glittering like lightning, resembled two huge flaming planets. Then they pointed to those victuals of every kind, boar and buffalo and the giant devoured them. Thereafter that enemy of Shakra's satisfied his hunger with flesh and his thirst with blood, and he swallowed pitchers full of fat and wine, whereupon he, having feasted, those rangers of the night approached him and, surrounding him, paid obeisance to him. Raising his eyelids that were heavy with sleep, his gaze still veiled, he let his glance fall on the night rangers on every side and, in a voice of authority, that lion among the Nairritas, surprised at being roused, enquired of them, saying : " For what reason have you thus wakened me so suddenly? Is all well with the king or is he in some peril ? In tmth !her< 159 must be some pressing and serious danger from an external source since you have come in baste to awakeo me. I shall drive every misfortune away from the King of the Titans this very day even if I have to cut Mahendra himself to pieces or freeze Anala ! Nay, it is certain that one does not interrupt the slumbers of one, such as I, for any trivial motive. Tell me frankly for what reason you have roused me, Kumbhakama, the vanquisher of my foes ? " At these words, that were tinged with wrath, Yupaksba, the king's confidential minister, with joined palms, answered him saying: " It is not the Gods who threaten us in any way but a man who bas placed us in this evil case, O Prince ! It is not the *Devas* or Danavas who have put us in this peril ; it comes to us from a mortal. Monkeys as large as hills are besieging Lanlcs I Furious on account of Site's abduction, **RAMA** is pressing us heavily. Recently a single monkey set lite to our great city and slew the youthful Prince Aksha with his escort of elephants. ' Get thee hence I ' were the words addressed by **RAMA** to the King of the Titans in person, the offspring of

Poulastya, that thorn in the side of the Gods, he who is equal to Aditya in splendour. That which this monarch never suffered at the hands of the Gods or Daityas or Dana vas, he bas bad to endure from **RAMA**, who spared his life.” Hearing from Yupaksha that his brother bad been defeated in combat, Kumbbakama, rolling his great eyes, said : " This very day, O Yupaksba, the whole army of monkeys with **LAKSHMANA** and Ragbava will be destroyed by me on the field of battle after I have rresented myself before **RAVANA**. I shall gorge the titans on the blood of monkeys and, as for **RAMA** and Lskshmn, I shall drink their blood myself I " Hearing these hold words from that titan, whose anger inaeased his ferocity, Mahodara, the Leader of the Nairrinl warriors, having oft"ered him obeisance with joined palms, said to him : " When thou bast listened to **RAVANA** and weighed the advantages and disadvantages of the matter, then, O Long-armed Warrior, set out immediately and destroy the foe on the battle field." 16o Thus spoke Mahodara and Kumbhabraa, surrounded by titans, full of energy and prowess, prepared to depart. Thereupon the titans, having succeeded in rousing that prince of dreadful aspect and formidable valour, returned to the king’s palace in all baste. Approaching Dasbagriva wbo was seated on the throne, all those night-tangers with joined palms said to him : “Thy brother, Kumbhabraa, has wakened, O King of the Titans, and now is it thy will that he should entet the battlefield or dost thou desite him to come hithet ? " Thetenpon **RAVANA** answered those titans who stood before him and, with a glad heart, said : " I desire to see him hete ; let him receive the honours due to his rank ! " " Be it so ! " answeted all the titans and they returned to Kumbhakama in otder to apprise him of **RAVANA**’s command and said: " Do thou go to the king, that lion of all the titans desites to see thee; go and gratify thy brothet ! " Then Kumbhakama, that indomitable and mighty warrior, hearing what was

his brother's wish, cried :-" So be it I" and leapt up from his couch. Washing his face and bathing, refreshed and delighted, he desired them to bring him to drink with speed, whereupon they brought him a soothing draught and those titans hastened to carry out **RAVANA**'s command and presented him with wines and meats of every kind. Having swallowed two thousand full pitchers, Kumbhalwna prepared to set out and, slighdy inebriated and flushed, he was exhilarated and filled with enetgy. lmpatiendy, he marched away like **YAMA** at the end of the World period, and approaching his brother's palace, he caused the earth to tremble with his tread. His body illumined the royal highway, like unto that orb of a thousand rays which gives light to the earth and, as he advanced, surrounded by a circle of titanS paying him obeisance, he resembled SbatakraN approaching SWfBMbhu's abode. Seeing that slayer of his foes on the royal highway, that monster as high as the peak of a mountain, the inhabitants of the woods, stationed outside (*the city*) as also their leaders, were seized with a sudden panic. Some rushed to **RAMA** for refuge, others fled away in fear, I6I THE RAMAYANA OF VALMJKJ some, terrified, stampeded in all directions, others, panlysed with fright, lay on the ground. Beholding that giant like a great peak, adorned with a diadem. who seemed to quench the sun with his brilliance, the inhabitants of the woods were seized with terror and, at the sight of that prodigy, lied in all directions.

CHAPTER 61

The Story of Kumbhakama

Seeing that Jndra among Titans with golden armlets, who resembled a mountain and was like unto a cloud charged with rain, or Narayanswhen

formerly taking the three strides, the monkeys scattered once more. In view of the stampede of his forces and that titan, who appeared to be increasing in size, Rsma, astonished, enquired of Bibishana : " Who is this hero with a diadem and yellow eyes, resembling a mountain, who is to be seen in Lanka like unto a cloud riven by lightning or a great and strange meteor which has fallen to earth ; he, at whose sight, the monkeys 1lee away on all sides ? Tell me, who is this colossus? Is it a Rabhasa or an *Asura*? Never have J seen such a being ! " Thus questioned by Prince **RAMA** of imperishable exploits, Bibishans, in his great wisdom, answered : " It is he by whom Vaivasvata and Vasava were defeated in battle; it is the illustrious **KUMBHAKARNA**, the son ofVaishravas I There is no titan equal to him in stature, he routed the *Devas*, Danavas, Yakshas, Bhujamgas, Pishitashanas, Gaodharvas, Vidyadharas and Pannagas in their thousands, O Raghava I The Gods themselves are not able to slay **KUMBHAKARNA**, who, spear in hand, is of monstrous aspect. ' It is the God of Death himself. they cry. " The mighty Kumbhaltarna is innately powerful, whilst the foremost of the titans owe their streogth to the boons they have received. As soon as that monster was born and while yet an infant, urged on by hunger, he devoured tbousands of beings. Seeing their kind consumed, tbose creatures, mad with fear, took refuge with Shakra and told him all that had taken place. Enraged, Mahendra struck Kumbhakama with his mighty thunderbolt and, at the impact of **INDRA**'s weapon, that giant reeled howling with terror. " When the cries of the titan were heard, the fear of those beings increased, and in his anger, the mighty Kumbhakama tore out one of Airavats's tuska in order to pierce Vasava's breast and, under the blows of that monster, Iodra appeared like a llame. Seeing this, the *Devas*, Brahmarishis and Danavas were thunderstruck and Shakra with those Celestials went to Swyambhu's

abode and informed Prajapati of **KUMBHAKARNA**'s wickedness ; he also described to the inhabitants of the heavenly region, how he had devoured all tbose creatures, laid waste the hermitages and carried off others wives and said ' If he continues to devour those beings, in a short time the whole world will become a desert'. "Hearing Vasava's words, the Grandsire of the Worlds summoned that titan, who appeared before him. On beholding Kumbhakama, Prajapati was troubled but, recovering himself, said to him : "'Assuredly Poulastya begot thee to the destruction of the worlds I From to-day tbou shalt sleep like the dead I ' Struck by the Lord's curse that titan fell down before him. "Meanwhile **RAVANA**, exceedingly perturbed, said to Brahms: " 'Thou hast hewn down the golden tree which was about to bear fruit I It does not behove thee to curse thine own grandson, O Prajapati ; nevertheless thy words may never prove vain ; assuredly he must slumber but at least appoint a time for sleeping and a time for waking I ' " On **RAVANA**'s request, **SWYAMBHU** *answered*:- He shall sleep for six months and wake for a single day ; for one day that warrior shall range the earth in order to appease his hunger, " It is in fear of thy prowess that the King **RAVANA**, beset with peril, has now awakened Kumbbakama, and that warrior of exceeding valour has emerged from his retreat transported with anger and is rushing upon the monkeys in order to devour them and appease his hunger. Seeing Kumbbakama they have taken to flight ; how am those monkeys Withstand him in combat ? Let them be told that he is merely a mechanical device created to frighten them ; at these tidings they will take heart and remain here." Hearing Bibishana's eloquent and persuasive speech, Raghava said to the General Nila : " Go, rally thy forces and, having occupied the outposts of Lanka, the highways and bridges, let them strike camp, O Pavaki ! See that the monkeys, furnished with rocks, trees and stones, arm themselves with these

weapons.” At Rams’s command, Nila, the leader in chief, a prince of monkeys, issued his orders to the army and thereafter armed with boulders, Gavaksha, Sharabha, **HANUMAN** and Angsda, like unto bills, advanced to the gates. Having listened to **RAMA**, the monkeys, those valiant apes, fell upon the enemy’s army with shouts of triumph, battering it with trees and that ferocious company of monkeys, brandishing crags and trees, appeared as resplendent as a lowering mass of clouds spreading over a mountsin.

CHAPTER 62

The Meeting between Kumbhakarna and Ravana

royal highway ; titans in their thousands surrounded that most invincible of warriors and, from the houses, a rain of ftowers fell upon him as he passed. Thereafter he beheld the vast and enchanting residence covered with gold of that **INDRA** of the Titans which shone like the sun, resembling that orb when it enters a mass of clouds, r64 and he penetrated into the palace belonging to the King of the Titans, observing him from afar on his throne, like unto Shakra approaching Swyambhu seated in state. Coming to **RAVANA**’s abode with his escort of titans, Kumbhakama, peeing the earth, caused it to tremble. Having crossed the threshold of the palace, he passed through the courtyard and perceived his elder btothet, who appeared troubled, seated in the Chariot Pushpaka. Full of anxiety, Dashagriva, beholding Kumbhakatna, immediately rose up joyfully and motioned him to approach. Then that mighty warrior, bowing to the feet of his brother, who was reclining on a couch, enquired of him:-" What dost thou desire of me ? " With renewed delight, **RAVANA** rose and embraced him whereupon with brotherly

salutations and traditional courtesies, Kumbhakama ascended the celestial and shining throne, and that giant being seated, his eyes red with anger, enquired of **RAVANA**: " Why hast thou forcibly tom me from my slumber, O King? Say from whence springs thy feat and whom dost thou wish me to slay this day ? " Then **RAVANA** answered the enraged Kumbhakama seated beside him, who was rolling his in1lamed eyes, and said : “Thou hast slumbered for some time, O Warrior, and, in Foes ! I have placed my supreme hopes and alfections on thee I O Bull among the Titans, how often, in the wars between *Devas* and *Asuras*, bast thou overcome the Gods and Celestial Beings ranged against thee ! Call upon thy valour, assuredly among all creatures none is equal to thee in strength, O Redoubtable Hero ! Render me this great service, O Thou, the lover of combat ; do this for me, O Thou who art devoted to thy friends I By thy personal prowess scatter these hostile forces as the wind scatters the autumnal clouds.”

CHAPTER 63

Kumbhakarna consoles Ravana

HEARING the lament of the King of the Titans, **KUMBHAKARNA** said with a mocking laugh : " As an evil doer falls into hell as a result of his misdeeds, a swift rettibution has followed on the error of judgment we saw thee commit formerly in council through lad: of trust in thy ministers ! Firstly, O Great King, thou didst not rellect on what might happen and, in the pride of thine own strength, overlooked the consequences. He, who trusting in his own power, leaves until last that which should be done first or who does first, that which should follow, is unable to distinguish between what is wise and what is foolish. As

offerings poured into an unsanctified fire so are those actions disastrous which are performed without regard to time and place or in opposition to them. He goes straight to the goal, who, in consultation with his ministers, has examined the three kinds of action and their five aspects'. A king who makes his decisions according to the traditional laws, and allows himself to be advised by his counsellors and consults his friends, pursuing duty, profit and -·· pleasure' at the proper season or following two of them or all of them combined, is a wise monarch and has a sound under standing, O Lord of the Titans. " But the sovereign or bcir-apparent, who, having heard what is best for the cultivation of these three means and yet does not comprehend them, has spent his time listening to instruction in vain. The king who consults his ministers regarding the bestowal of gifts, conciliation, sowing dissension, taking action or uniting himself with the foe as also the consideration of what should or should not be done and the questions of duty, profit and pursuit of pleasure, dealing with them in conformity with circumstances, and is master of himself, is not visited by mis fortune I " He verily is a king, who, with experienced and sagacious counsellors, having studied the advantages he desires to reap from an undertaking and the wisdom of entering into it, takes action. " One should never follow the advice of those admitted to council who are not conversant with the meaning of the scriptures, whose intelligence is equal to the beasts and who, in tbcir conceit, prate continuously I Neither should one follow the advice of those who, in tbcir ignorance of the tradition and the wotks of political science, merely seek to amass wealth. And those counsellors who, in their complacency, hold specious but sinister debates, should be excluded from any deliberation, for they mar every transaction. Those in the pay of well informed enemies, who, in order to betray tbcir master, advise him to act contrary to his interests, will be recognized by the king

when they are in the assembly, and a monarch will soon discover those who, under the mask of devotion hide their treachery, by studying tbcir conduct in their deliberations when they are met together. Those foolish ones, who rush precipitately into action like birds entering a hole in the Krauncha Mountain, are ovcrwhelmcd by the enemy and he who, disregarding the foe, fails to protect himself, experiences nothing but reverses and loses his status. “The advice that the beloved **MANDODARI** and my yoUDger brother, Bibishana, formerly gave thee, I now repeat for thine own good ; do what thou considerest best I " Hearing Kumbhabma’s words, Dasbagriva frowned and replied angrily : .. One should pay the same respect to one’s elder brother as to one’s spiritual preceptor I Of what interest to me are thy counsels ? Why fatigue thyself? Consider what is fitting at the moment ; whatever bas impeded success, whether it has been folly or too great a confidence in the strength of mine army, it is useless to discuss it now ! Advise me as to what should be done in the present circumstances. Let thy valour remedy the evil that mine imprudence has brought about if thou art truly devoted to me and hast confidence in thine own prowess and if thine heart is in this great strUggle and thou considerest it to be of supreme moment. He is a friend who rescues one in distress ; a kinsman he, who helps one who has failed.” Thus spoke Ravans in imperious and harsh accents and Kumbhabma rellecting within himself ' he is enraged ', answered him mildly in soothing tones, Looking fixedly at his brother, whose mind was agitated, he spoke comforting words to him in a quiet voice, saying : " Listen carefully, O King, O Scourge of Thy Foes, O Leader of the Titan Princes, banish thy grief, renounce thine anger and be thyself again I There is no reason for thine heart to be troubled as long as I live, O Lord ! I will slay him who is the cause of thy distress but, in any circumstances, I had, of necessity, to speak for thine own good because

of kinship and brotherly affection for thee, O Monarch. " It is on account of this that I will show myself to be a friend and a brother and, in combat, annihilate the enemy under thine eyes. To-day, O Long-armed Warrior, thou shalt see me in the forefront of battle, having slain **RAMA** and his brother and put the monkey army to ftight. Seeing tue bring back **RAMA**'s head from the battlefield this day, thou wilt be happy, O Warrior, and **SITA** overwheltued with despait. "To-day all the titans of Lanka, whose kinsfolk have perished, will witness the death of **RAMA** who is the object of men's desites I By striking down the foe in battle, I shall dry the I68 tears of those who are overcome with sorrow and have been rendered desolate by the loss of thdr relatives. To-day thou shalt see **SUGRIVA**, the leader of the Plavagas, who resembles a mountain illumined by the sun, lying on tbe earth. The titans, and I also, are eager to slay **DASARATHA**'s son ; this should fill thee with confidence, how is it that thou art still ttembiing, O Irreproachable Hero ? Should he slay me, Raghava will assuredly slay thee also but I have nothing to fear, O Lord of the Titans I Now command me, O Scourge of Thy Foes, do not seek another for this encounter, O Incomparable Hero ! I shall desuoy thy foes despite their sttength ! Even were it Shakra or **YAMA** or Pavaka or Maruta, I should enter into combat with them or with Kuvera or **VARUNA** themselves ; I, who in stature am like unto a mountain, with a sharpened spesr as my weapon, my war-cry, my pointed teeth, at the sight of which Purandara himself ttembles, throwing away my arms, shall strike down the foe with blows of my fists. None will be able to withstand me, no matter how much they may cling to life, nor have I need of lance, mace, sword or whetted dart ; with my bare bands alone, I will kill Raghava, were he accompanied by the God who bears the Thunderbolt himself! If he is able to withstand the force of my fists then mine arrows will drink his life's blood ! O King, I stand bere, why art

thou overwbelmed with despair ? Here I wait ready to exterminate the slayers of titans, by whom Lanka has been set on fite, and also the monkeys, in the struggle that is about to take place. I shall confer a rare and great glory upon thee ! Did the danger come from **INDRA** or Swyambhu or the Gods themselves, I should make them measure their length on the field of battle, O King I I shall overcome **YAMA**, consume Pavaka, hurl down **VARUNA**, pulverize the mountains and shatter the earth ! After my long sleep, let those beings I am about to consume, witness the prowess of Kumbbakama this day I Nay, the Three Worlds shall not be able to glut mine appetite I In ordet to please thee I will slay the son ofDasarathal Having suuck down **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, I shall devour all the foremost of the monkey leaders. Rejoice thetefore, O King and drink wine, do what thou bast to do and banish grief; to-day I shall send **RAMA** to the abode of death and **SITA** will become thine for ever I "

CHAPTER 64

Mahodara's Speech

.. **K**umbhskama, thou art an offshoot of an illusttious race, thou art courageous but thou bast two vulgar characteristics and, in thy conceit, art unable to anticipate the course of events in all its aspects. " It is not trUe thst the king does not undetStand what is politic and impolitic, O Kumbhskama, but thou, in thy youthful impetuosity, knowest only how to prate ! The Lotd of the TiiBDS, who is conversant with the laws of time and place, is also aware of inctease and loss as well as our situstion and the state of the enemy. " What man of sense would attempt thst which an old thick headed soldiet with no respect even for his eldetS

plumes himself on accomplishing? When thou dost assert thst duty, profit and pleasure are essentially opposed to each other, it is a proof thst thou art unaware of their real nature. Action is un doubtedly the source of all experiences and here below, happiness is the fruit we seek even in our most evil acts. Apart from pleasure, duty and profit yield felicity, but the fruit reaped from injustice and unrighteousness is calamitous. Men of suong character undertake those acts, the consequences of which they reap in another world, whilat those who give themselves np to the pursuit of plessure resp the consequences here. " Why should thst which the king has so much at heart and which we approve, namely the chastising of his enemies, be set aside in any way? As for the motives thou bast given for marching against **RAMA** single-banded, I will point out to thee what is ill-considered and reprehensible about them I How canst thou defeat **RAMA** alone, he who formerly desuoyed innumerable exceedingly powerful tiiBDS in Janasthana ? Thoae stricken with fear ? By rousing **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, who resembles a wounded lion, alas thou art waking a sleeping serpent ! Burning with valour and unapproachable in his futy, inaccessible as Mrityu, who would date to challenge him ? This entire army cannot face that foe without being imperilled, therefore it in no wise recommends itself to me that thou shouldat go out to meet him alone, O Child. Who, bereft of resources would be eager to meet with an adversary, ready to sacrifice his life and furnished with every pre-requisite ! **RAMA** has no equal among men, O Best of the Titans, how canst thou plume thyself on entering into combat with him who is the rival of Jndra and Vaivasvata ? " Having spoken thus to the enraged Kumbhakama, Mahodara said to **RAVANA**, the Destroyer of the Worlds, who was surrounded by the titans : " Having formerly borne Vaidebi away, why dost thou delay? If thou desirest Sits to submit to thy will, I see a means of bringing her to thy feet. If it

pleases thee, O **INDRA** among the Titans, then hear me ! " Let it be proclaimed that I, Dvijihva, Samhradin, Kumbhakama and Vitadarna, all five, are going forth to slay **RAMA** I We shall engage him in a fierce struggle and, if we triumph over thine enemy, we need resort to no other means, but, if thy rival survive and we escape from the fight, then we will adopt the measures I have planned. “We shall return from the battlefield and come hither covered with blood, our limbs pierced by darts on which are engraved Ramo’s name, and relate how we have destroyed Raghava and **LAKSHMANA** I Thereafter we shall press thy feet and thou wilt cover us with honour, after which, mounted on an elephant thou wilt publish the tidings throughout the city, relating how **RAMA**, his brother and his army were entirely " Then shalt thou repair secretly to where **SITA** is, in order to o1fer her consolation and tempt her with grain, diamonds and entertainment in order to seduce her. By this deceit, O King, **SITA**’s grief will be increased and she, bctcft of felicity, without a protector, will accede to thy desire. Learning that her charming lord is slain, **SITA**, in despair and on account of womanly frailty, will submit to thy will ! “Brought up in the lap of prosperity, this woman who is worthy of felicity and who is alllicted with misfonune, realising her happiness depends on thee, will surrender herself wholly to thee. “This is the best course for thee to follow. Even to behold **RAMA** may prove disastrous ; have no anxiety I Great happiness awaits thee here without entering into combat I Neither losing thy forces nor courting danger, triumph over thine enemy, O Monarch ! Glory, felicity, ptosperity and renown will long be the Jot of thy sovereign majesty ! "

CHAPTER 65

Kumbhakama enters into combat

" Forsooth I shall dispel the immediate peril this day by slaying that wretch, **RAMA**! Freed from thine adversary, be happy ! Heroes do not thunder in vain like clouds bctcft of tain ! Do thou mark how my threats find fuJfilmcnt in mine exploits ! Warriors do not need to boast. and accomplish the most difficult of feats without bluster I Cowardly monarcha, devoid of intelligence, who plume themselves on being wise, will ever find thy speech acceptable, O Mahodara I " All you eft'eminate creatures, agreeable talkers, who flatter the king, have always ruined any martial enterptisc. Nothing is left in Lanka save its sovereip ; its wealth is exhausted, its army destroyed and that monarch is beset by foes in the guise of friends ! I shall go out and fight, determined to triumph 172 over the foe and, in this wise, redeem thy calamitous policy in this great struggle." Hearing these words of the intelligent Kumbharkama, the King of the Titans answered laughing : " In sooth, **RAMA** has terrorized Mahodara I Assuredly he does not relish battle, O Dear Friend I O Sagacious Warrior, I have none equal to thee in devotion and prowess ; go, slay mine adversary, O Kumbhakama and speed towards victory I "Thou wast sleeping and it was for mine enemy's destruction that I had thee wakened ; this hour is of extreme significance to the titans, O Vanquisher of thy Foes I Go, arm thyself; let those two ptinces, the equals of Aditya in splendour, be thy pasture ! Beholding thee, the monkeys will take to tlight and the hearts of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** will cease to best." Having spoken thus to the exceedingly powerful Kumbhakama, that illustrious lion of the titans felt he had received new life. Aware of Kumbhakama's prowess and knowing his valour, the king expanded with joy like unto the immaculate moon. Heating his words, which filled him with delight, that warrior went away and, having listened to the king's speech, prepared for battle. Then that scourge of his foes vigorously brandished his iron spear decorated with fine gold

that shone brightly and was as renowned as lndra's thunderbolt and equally heavy. The scourge of the *Devas*, Danavas, Gandharvas, Yaltshas and Pannagas, wreathed in garlands, festooned with crimson flowers, emitting Oames, that great spear, stained with the blood of his enemies, was taken up by the illustrious Kumbhakama, who addressed **RAVANA**, saying : " I sball set out alone ; let thy powerful army remain here I To-day in mine hunger and fury, I sba1l devour the monkeys I" At these words of Kumbbalwna, **RAVANA** *answered*: " Do thou go out accompanied by troops tumished with picks and hammers ; those monkeys are brave and exceedingly energetic I He who is rash enough to meet them alone will be torn to pieces by their teeth, yet, though they are extremely di11icult to overcome, surround thyself with warriors and setting out, utterly destroy that enemy host so fatal to the titans I " Tllereat'lu, descending from the throne, the mighty **RAVANA** placed a diadem, the interior of which was encrusted with 173 pearls, on Kumbhalwna's brow and decked out that hero with bracelets, rings, precious gems and a necklace as bright as the moon, covering his limbs with celestial and fragrant garlands and setting earrings in his ears. With the bracelets, anklets and golden coins', with which he was adorned, the large-eyed Kumbhakama shone like the sacrificial fire. Resplendent with his great dark-blue girdle, he resetnbled the Mandata Mountain encircled by the snake at the time of the churning of the water of immorrality. Clad in golden armour thar no arrow could penetrate, which in its natural brilliance seetned to project flames, he was rendered as radiant as the King of the Mountains encircled by evening clouds. His entire body was covered with ornaments of every kind and, spear in hand, that titan called to mind Narayana, when, in his might, he took the three strides. Thereafter that warrior etnbraced his brother and paid obeisance to him by circumambulating him in the traditional manner and, inclining his

head to him, set out to the sound of conches and gongs. Then **RAVANA**, dismissing him with good wishes, caused an escort of well-equipped soldiers to accompany him with elephants, horses and chariots, emitting a sound like thunder clouds. Valiant fighters accompanied that prince of warriors mounted on serpents, buffalo, donkeys, lions, elephants antelopes and birds. It was under a prodigious shower of blossom, a parasol over him, hearing a pointed spear in his hand, full of daring, that the enemy of *Devas* and Danavas, intoxicated with the smell of blood, set forth. And innumerable titans followed him on foot, full of energy and prowess, fierce of aspect, bearing weapons in their banda, their eyes red ; and their ranks measured many leagues in extent and they resetnbled heaps of antimony and brandished maces, swords, sharp axes, javelins, bars, ramrods, hammers, great Sala Trees and were turnished with nets. Meanwhile Kumbhakama, assuming another terrible and ferocious form, advanced impetuously, measuting a hundred bows in breadth and six hundred in height, formidable, full of power and energy with eyes like unto chariot wheels. And, having assembled the tillllls, that colossus with his large mouth, who looked like a llaming crag said with a mocking laugh : " To-day the foremost of the moDkey divisiODS will be consumed by me in my wrath one after the other like moths in a llame. Yet those inbabillllllts of the woods have never given offence and their race adorns the gardens of our dwellings. " The cause of the city being beseiged is Ragbava, and **LAKSHMANA** who accompanies bim ; he being slain, all will be slain ; I shall therefore destroy him in fight." At these words of **KUMBHAKARNA**, the titans emitted a great sbout that seemed to agitate the ocean. Then the crafty Kumbbakarns went forth and sinister portents appeared on every side ; dark and fearful clouds accompanied by meteors were seen, and the earth, the sea and the forests trembled. Jackals of ferocious aspect, with llames darting from their

mouths, began to bowl and birds wheeled from left to rigbt. A vulture alighted on the tilliD's spear as he advanced, and his left eye and arm twitched ; a llaming meteor fell with a terrible crasb ; the sun lost its brilliance and no favourable wind blew. Without heeding these threatening portents, causing the bait to stand on end, Kumbbakarns set out, urged on by the force of destiny. Having crossed the ramparts, that giant, equal to a mountain, beheld the vast army of the monkeys resembling a cloud and, seeing that most powerful of the titans, as higb as a mountain, those monkeys lied in all directions, like clouds driven before the wind. At the sigbt of that tremendous host of monkeys scattering to the four qusrters like a mass of cloud melting away, Kumbbakarns joyfully redoubled his shouts resembling thunder. Hearing those terrible sbouts, like unto the roar of clouds in the sky, countless Plavagas fell to the earth like great Sala Trees whose roots have been severed and, as Kumbhaksrna hurled himself on the enemy with his huge mace in order to destroy bim, he filled the ranks of the monkeys with cmeme fear as does the Lord of Death accomplllied by his minions at the end of the Wotld Period.

CHAPTER 66

Angada reproaches the Monkeys for flying from Kumbhakarna

HAVING leapt over the wall, **KUMBHAKARNA**, that giant, like unto the peak of a mountain, full of valour, set out from the city in haste and emitted a great shout which agitated tbe waters, drowned the thunder claps and appeared to shatter the mountains. Seeing that warrior of fierce glance, as invincible as Maghavat, **YAMA** or **VARUNA**, the monkeys

stampeded, and Prince **ANGADA**, beholding them fleeing, addressed the mighty NaJa, Nila, Gavaksha and Kumuda, saying : " Forgetting your native valour and noble lineage, where are you fteeing in terror like common monkeys ? Come back, O Companions, return ! Is it thus that you defend your lives ? Nay, this titan is not able to tight against you all; he is here to create panic amongst you. This great fear, that the titan inspires in you, will be dispelled by our prowess ; return, O Plavamgamas ! " Rallied with difficulty from here and there and re-assured, those monkeys, armed with trees, halted in the field, and those dwellers in the woods stayed there ready to advance in fury on **KUMBHAKARNA**, like elephants intoxicated with Mada juice. Thereafter they attacked him valiantly with blows from mountain peaks, rocks and trees with their ftowering crests but were unable to overthrow him. Innumerable stones, and trees with blossoming tops fell shattered on tbe earth, having come in contact with his limbs and that hero, enraged, on his side, struck down the ranks of those energetic monkeys by exercising his great strength, like unto a tire which suddenly blazes forth in the forest. Their limbs t».pattered with blood, those lions among the monkeys, ovetOOme and cut down, lay there in great numbers resembling trees with coppery ftowers. Thereafter, those monkeys bounded away without looking in which direction and some threw themselves into the sea and some leapt into the 176 air. Overcome by tbat titan, who was disponing himself, some, despite their valour, fted over the sea by the way by which they hsd come and some, psle and distraught, escaped to the valleys. The bears climbed into the trees and some took refuge in the mountains ; others being no longer able to stand, fell down and remained lying on the earth insensible as if asleep or dead. Seeing the monkeys routed, **ANGADA** called out to them : " Stay ! Let us fight I Return, O Plavamgamas ! Were you to range the whole earth in

your flight I see no refuge for you anywhere ! Why do you seek to preserve your lives ? If you fty, leaving your weapons, lest they impede your course, your wives will deride you for this cowardice, which is desth to men of honour, O Warriors ! Whither are you fteeing filled with fear like common monkeys, you who are born in rich and illustrious families ? Where are those deeds of valour and prowess of which you boasted in the assembly ? The reproach of cowardice will be heard by you ; he, who seeks to save his life by fteeing, is despised ! Follow the path chosen by men of courage and overcome your fears. If, after a brief existence, you lie stretched on the earth dead, you will attain Brahmaloka, inaccessible to cowards. We shall acquire glory by striking down the foe in fight and, if we succumb, we shall enjoy the treasures of heaven in the region of heroes, O Monkeys! Nay, **KUMBHAKARNA** will never alive, having come before Kakutstha, as a moth that draws near to a glowing brazier. If one, despite our numbers, is able to disperse us and we preserve our lives by lleeing, then there is an end to our renown!" Such was **ANGADA**'s speech, he of the golden bracelets, and the fugitives replied to that hero's reproaches, saying : " That Titan Kumbhakama, has caused a terrible carnage amongst us ; it is not the moment to stay ; life is dear to us ! " With theae words the leaders of the monkeys, beholding that giant of fearful glance advancing, scattered in all directions. Neverthdesa **ANGADA**, by his exhortations and arguments, succeeded in rallying them and, re-assured by that sagacious son of Bali, they submitted to his commands and those foremost of monkeys returned to the field.

CHAPTER 67

Kumbhakarna's Exploits. He is slain by Rama

DDthing more than to join issue in the fight. Their confidence restored by the words of the valiant **ANGADA**, those monkeys, feeling their energy revived and their courage mounting, advanced, resolving to die and sacrilice their lives. Then those giants, arming themselves with trees and enormous crags, which they spun with great rapidity, hurled themselves on Kumhhatarna, whereupon, full of ire and vigour, that warrior of immense stature, brandishing his mace, dispersed the enemy on every side. Seven hundred and eight thousand monkeys lay scattered on the earth struCk down by **KUMBHAKARNA** and, like unto **GARUDA** consuming serpents, he seized hold of seven, eight, ten, twenty and thirty in his arms, crushing and devouring them in his extreme fury as he ran. Re-assured with exceeding difficulty, those monkeys rallied here and there and, armed with trees and rocks, took up their stand in the forefront of the battle. At that instant, Dvivida, that lion among monkeys, resembling a threatening cloud, tearing up a rock, hurled himself on the enemy who was like unto a mountain peat ; and that monkey, breaking off the aag, ftung it at Kumbhatarna, missing him, so that the missile fell on the titan force, crushing horses, elephants and charints harnessed to excellent steeds. Another rock created further victims and, under that avalanche of stones, the titans wounded, their horses slain, their charioteers strud down, streaming with blood and mounted in thei1 cars, suddenly let forth terrible cries and with the aid of death-dealing arrows, severed the heads of those foremost of monkeys who were roaring. On their side, the monkeys, full of valour, uprooted great trees in order to crush the chariots, horses, elephants, buflialo and titans and, from the air where he was stationed, **HANUMAN** ?I showered rocks, stones and trees of every kind on the head of **KUMBHAKARNA** but that mighty one split and evaded that rain of trees. And he hurled himself upon that great army of monkeys btandisbing his sbarp pick and,

as he rushed forward **HANUMAN** placed himself in the way armed with the peak of a mountain, and, in futy sttuck Kumbhakama a violent blow, who, in his appalling cotpulence, appeated like a hill! Then he whose limbs were dripping with fat and streaming with blood, stumbled under the shock and the titan hurled his spear, which was as bright as lightning and like a mountain spouting fotth flames, striking Maruti between the arms, as Guha formerly struck the Krauncha Mountain with his formidable lance. His bteast pierced by that spesr, beside himself, vomiting blood, **HANUMAN**, in fury, let fotth a terrible cry in the midst of the battle, like the roar of a thundercloud at the end of the World Period, and a great cheer atOSe from the ranks of the titans as they beheld his plight, whilst the monkeys, distraught and terrified, lied from the field. At that instant, summoning up his courage, the valiant Nila dischatged a crag against that crafty titan, who, seeing it approaching, struck it with his fist and, on the impaet, that rock broke and fell on the esrth emitting spatks of fire. Then Risbabba, Sharabba, Nila, Gavaksba and Gandamadhana, those five tigers atnong the monkeys, hurled themselves on Kumbhakama and, in the struggle, showered him with blows from stones, trees, the palms of their bands, feet and fists, attacking that giant on every side. Kumbhakama, however, scarcely felt those blows and, unheeding, seized the impetuous Risbabha in his two arms. Crushed in this embrace, that bull atnong the monkeys fell to the ground, his mouth 1illed with blood. Thereafter, in the fight, that enemy of **INDRA** struck Sharabha with his fist, Nila with his knee and Gavaksha with the palm of his hand. Dazed by the blows they had received, terrified, covered with blood, they fell on the earth like Kimshuka Treea that have been uprooted. Those powerful lesders of the monkeys being overcome, thenst hurled themselves in thousands Plavagas, who themselves resembled hills, attacked and bit him. With their nails, teeth,

fists and arms, those foremost of monkeys assailed the valiant Kumbhabma, a veritable tiger in stature, and thst titan, coveted by thousands of apes, resembled a mountain overgrown by Crushing all those monkeys in his arms, thst giant devoured them, as **GARUDA** the serpe.nts. Cast into Kumbb.akarna's mouth, thst resembled the pit of hell, the monkeys issued from his esrs and nostrils. As high as a mountain in his rage he devoured those monkeys, and thst prince of titanS crushed them covering the earth with their llesh and blood and ranging through their ranks which he overran, so that he appeared like the Fire of Time itself. Resembling Shakra bearing the thunderbolt in his hand or Death with the noose, so did thst powerful titan appesr, armed with his spear, in the fight. As in the summer season, fire destroys the dry forests, so did Kumbb.akarna consume the simian ranks. Thus decimsted, their leaders struck down, the Plsvamgamas, wild with terror, emitted dreadful cries and, overpowered again and again by Kumbb.akarna, those monkeys lied for refuge to Raghava. Witnessing the massacre of those monkeys, **ANGADA**, bom of the son of the Bearer of the Thunderbolt, hurled himself in rage upon **KUMBHAKARNA** in the struggle. Seizing hold of a crag, he roared again and again, putting all the titans, who accompanied Kumbb.akarna, to llight ; thereafter he struck the head of his adversary with the rock, and thst enemy of **INDRA** inllamed with anger on receiving the blow, leapt with one bound upon the irascible son of Bali. Emitting loud cries, that titan strnck terror among the monkeys and, in his anger, threw his spear with ememe force at **ANGADA**, but with a light bound, thst valiant lion among the monkeys, an experienced warrior, avoided the impact and leapt on his opponent, striking his chest with the palm of his hand. That violent blow dazed the giant, who resembled a mountain, but regaining his senses that most powerful of titans, doubling his fist, with a mocking lsugh, struck,

ANGADA who fell insensible to the earth. As thst lion among the Plsvagas lsy stretched unconscious on the ground, Kumbb.akarna, brandishing his spear, rushed on **SUGRIVA** and, seeing that colossus running towards him, the I8o courageous King of the Monkeys went out to meet him where upon, beholding that **INDRA** among the Monkeys advancing, **KUMBHAKARNA** halted and stood facing him with braced limbs. Beholding **KUMBHAKARNA** standing still, his body streaming with the blood of the great monkeys wbom he had devoured, **SUGRIVA** said to him : " In slaying these warriors thou hast accomplished a most difficult feat and, by devouring my soldiers, hast acquired immense renown ; now let the army of monkeys be, what hast tbou to do with common folk ? Do tbou seek to bear the weight of this rock I am about to hurl on thee, O Titan ! Find thy satisfaction in slaying me, O Titan, tbou wbo resemblest a mountain I" At these words of the King of the Monkeys, who was possessed of courage and fortitude, that lion among the titans, answered : " Tbou art the grandson of Prajapati and the sou of Ribharajas, thou art energetic and brave, hence thine arrogance, OMonkey!" At these words of Kumbhakama, **SUGRIVA**, taking up a stone, hurled it at him suddenly and struck his breast with that missile resembling a thunderbolt. The rock broke on the huge chest of that giant and the titans were appalled, whilst from the ranks of the monkeys rose sbouts of joy. Struck by that rocky peak, Kumbbakama, enraged, roared ; opening his huge mouth wide and braudishiug his spear, that resembled lightning, he hurled it at the King of the Monkeys and the Bears in order to slay him. As it fell, the sou of Auila, **HANUMAN**, with his two hands seized bold of that sharp spear and its gold..:ucircled shaft loosed by the titan's arm and, in play as it were, broke that powerful weapon across his knee. Seeing his lance shattered to pieces by **HANUMAN**, the anuy of monkeys, in a transport of delight, began to cheer. Meanwhile hearing

those rangers of the woods emitting leonine roara and lauding Maruti in their joy, on beholding his spear shattered, that titan became enraged and, pale with fear, tore oft' a peak of the Malaya Mountain nearby, in the vicinity of Lanka, hurling it on **SUGRIVA** in order to strike him down. Struck by that aag, the **INDRA** of the Monkeys fell on the earth insensible and the Yatudhanas let forth a roar of triumph. Thereafter **KUMBHAKARNA**, approacbiug tbat powerful King of the Monkeys, lifted him up and bore him away like unto a violent wind driving away a cloud and, as he ranged the battle field dragging **SUGRIVA** with him, who resembled a great cloud, **KUMBHAKARNA**, with his lofty sutute, appeated like Mount Metu of exceedingly high peaks. Having laid hold of **SUGRIVA**, the mighty Lotd of the Titans turned towards Lanka amidst the acclamations of his own people and the wailing of the Inhabitants of the Celestial Region. who were inconsolable on account of the captute of the King of the Plavamgamas and, having overcome the King of the Monkeys, tbat enemy of Indta and his rival in power, rellected :-' He being dead, the entire simian host is destroyed together with Raghava ! Then **HANUMAN**, the sagacious son of Matuta, seeing **SUGRIVA** home away by Kumbhakama and the monkeys fteeing, thought to himself: ' Now tbat **SUGRIVA** has been made captive what ought I to do ? Assuredly I shall accomplish tbat whieh is fitting ; in otder to slay this titan, I shall assume the shape of a mountain I When I have destroyed the extremely powerful Kumbhakama in combat by pounding his body with blows and have delivered the king, the delight of the monkeys will be general! Yet tbat great monkey is well able to free himself though meseems, tbat, struck by Kumbhakama with a rock in the struggle, the Chief of the Monkeys is not yet conscious of his plight. Presently, when **SUGRIVA** recovers consciousness, he will know how to save himself and the monkeys in this great con11ict. That warrior will not he pleased if I

deliver him, for his fair name would be tarnished and irretrievably lost. That is why I shall delay a while so tbat he may extricate himself ftom this predicament by his own prowess and I shall confine myself to rallying the scattered forces.' Rellecting thus, **HANUMAN**, hom of Matuta, sought to instil courage into the simian army. Meanwhile, hearing the great and quivering form of the monkey in his arms, Kumbhakama returned to Lanka, and ftom highway, little by little the valiant **SUGRIVA** recovered con sciousness. Borne in the arms ofhis powerful rival811d, beholding the great highway of the city, tbat warrior was assailed by innumerable thoughts-' Taken captive in this way, what can I do now ? I shall act in such a way tbat it is to the advantage of the monkeys.' Then with his sharp nails, the King of the Monkeys, instantly attacked the enemy of the Gods and tore olf his two ears with his teeth, biting olf his nose and splitting his thighs with bis feet. With his nose and ears tom olf by **SUGRIVA**'s teeth and nails, Kumbhakama, transported with anger, bis limbs covered with blood, threw the lllOtlkey down in order to crush bitn. Flung to the ground with fearful violence and struck by the Enemy of the Gods, **SUGRIVA** bounced into the air like a ball and with all speed ftew to rejoin **RAMA**. Kumbhabrna, bis ears and nose severed, drenehed in gore, shone like a mountain with its torrents and, covered with blood, vomiting blood, tbat gigantic titan offearful aspect, the younger brother of **RAVANA**, blazed with anger. Like unto a mas1 of dark collyrium or an evening cloud, tbat formidable Ranger of the Night resolved to enter into combat once more and, **SUGRIVA** having escaped, tbat enemy of ludta, furious, immediately threw himself into the struggle but reflecting ' I have no weapon' tbat ferocious warrior seized hold of a huge hammer. Issuing from the city, the valiant titan began to consume the redoubtable army of the monkeys with the violence of Fire at the destruction of the worlds. Famished and

avid for ftesh, Kumbhabrna entered the ranks of the monkeys and, in bis rage, like unto Mrityn at the end of the world period, in dilcriminately ate up titan, monkey, Pisacha and bear. Thereafter in bis fury, he consumed the monkeys, seizing one, two, three or more in one hand and titans also, thrusting them greedily into his mouth so tbat he streamed with ftesh and blood and, though struck by the peaks of mountains, continued to feast on those monkeys, wbilat they, seeing their companions being devoured, took refUge with **RAMA**, whereupon Kumbhakama, in a transport of rage, pursued them in order to consume them. Seiaing them in his arms, in the chase, he took hold of them in groups of seven, eight, twenty, thirty and 183 a hundred ; his limbs were covered with far, 1lesh and blood, while wreaths of tangled entrails hung over his ears, and that colossus, of sharp teeth, began to discharge his weapons so that he appeared like Time at the end of the world. At that instant, the son of **SUMITRA**, the scourge of enemy hosts and the destroyer of hostile citadels, enraged, entered the fight and the courageous **LAKSHMANA** loosed seven darts into **KUMBHAKARNA**'s body, aiming a hail of other missiles on him but **KUMBHAKARNA** shook off those falling shafts. Then the valiant son of **SUMITRA** was provoked beyond measure and covered the shining armour of that titan, that was made of gold, with his shafts, as a mountain is overlaid with clouds by the wind at evening. Like unto a mass of dark collyrium, that titan, riddled with golden dans, blazed like the sun shining amidst the clouds. And that terrible monster, whose voice equalled the crash of coundess thunder-clouds, spoke scorofully, increasing Saumitri's delight, saying : " Thou hast manifested thy courage by entering into combat. fearlessly with me, I who have overcome Antaka himself without difficulty in the field ! He who is able to face the rival of Mrityu himself, armed for combat, is worthy of honour, how much more so if he should enter into

conflict with him l Mounted on Airavata surrounded by the Gods, Shakra, their king, has never dared to challenge me to batde. This courage from a youth is gratifying to me ; now go hence, O Saumitri, I wish to meet Rsghava I “In sooth thy valour, energy and martial prowess are pleasing to me but my only desire is to slay Rsma, when he is slain, all are slain I When Rsma has fallen under my blows, I shall fight with all my might against all those who remain on the batdelield!” Thus boastfWly did the titan speak and Saumitri, with a mocking smile, answered in dread accents saying : " That thy prowess renders thee invincible to Shakra and the other Gods is true, O Warrior, and to-day thou dost manifest the same valour ! Yonder is the son of **DASARATHA** immoveable aaarockl” Hearing these words, that ranger of the night, the mighty and powerfUl **KUMBHAKARNA**, disregarding **LAKSHMANA**, passed him by and, causing the earth to tremble, rushed on **RAMA**. t84 The son of Dssaratba, **RAMA**, however, loosed some pointed arrows with lndra’s weapon on Kumbhsbrna’s breast and, wounded by **RAMA** in his furious course, flames mixed with embers shot from his mouth! Pierced by **RAMA**’s arrow, tbat lion among the titans, emitting a terrible cry, hurled himself’ full of rage upon Raghsva, throwing off the monkeys. With his breast pierced with darts, adorned with peacock’s plumes, his mace fell shattered from his hand and all his weapons were scattered on the earth. Finding himself’ disarmed, tbat colossus created a great carnage with his fists and hands.' Covered with blood, tbat streamed from his wounds, like a torrent falling from a mountain, his limbs riddled with arrows, maddened by the smell of blood, he rushed about in his violent rage devouring the monkeys, titans and bears. Brandishing a huge crag, tbat mighty and formidable giant, the equal of Antaka, hurled it at **RAMA** but before it reached him, tbat hero struck it in the centre with the aid of seven iofallible darts. The virtuous **RAMA**,

elder brother of **BHARATA**, shattered it with arrows encrusted with gold and, like unto the peak of Mcru, that crag, shining with splendour, fell, crushing two hundred monkeys. At tbat instant, the virtuous **LAKSHMANA**, after rcllecting deeply on the various means of destroying Kumbhakama, said to **RAMA**: " O Prince, tbat monster is no longer able to distinguish between monkeys and titans ; drunk with the smell of blood, he devours friends and foes alike ! Let the foremost of the monkeys climb upon him courageously and let their officers and leaders hang upon him on every side ; under the heavy load tbat will crush him as he is rushing over the ground, tbat insensate one will annihilate the titans and not the monkeys." At these words of tbat intelligent prince, the valiant monkeys all flung themselves on **KUMBHAKARNA** with alacrity and he, full of ire against the monkeys, who had climbed on his back, shook them vinlendy as a fierce elephant his keepers. Seeing the titan shaking himself' thus, **RAMA** said to himself': ' He is incensed ' and rushed upon him with his eJ:cellent bow. His eyes red with anger, the intrepid Raghsva, consuming him with his glance as it were, bounded quietly forward, -mar tile leaden, who were tormenting the mishty Kumbhakanaa aDd, in order to encourage the IIIOIIkeys, taking hold of his areat bow encrusted with gold, that with its cord resembled a serpent, **RAMA** adV8Dced with his huge quiver 1W1 of Surrounded by the monkey host, that warrior went fonvard full of valour, followed by Labbmana mel. he bche1cl the illustrious and mighty Kumbhakama, tile vanquisher ofbis foes, surrounded by titans, his eyes inllamcd, adorned with golden bracelets, pursuiog all those monkeys with fury like unto one of the elephants of the four quarterS ; mel. he resembled the Vindhya or Mandara Mounlllills and was vomiting blood like a great cloud pouring down rain. With his tongue he licked the comers of his mouth that were wet with blood while he

continued to destroy the sUnian army like Death at the end of the world. Beholding that Prince of the Titans shiniDg like a glowing 'lm1.\tt, that lion among men stretched his bow, and the sound of that weapon infuriated that foremost of the titans, who, high! y provokd, hurled himself on Raghava. Meanwhile **RAMA**, whose arms were .like unto the great coils of the King of the Serpents, said Kumbhakama who, poasessing the splendour of a mountain, was rushing to attack him like a cloud driven by the tempest : " Come, O Prince of the Titans, tremble not, I await thee bow in hand and in an instant will deprive thee of life I " It is Rams ! ' reflected Kumbhakama and, bursting forth into hideous laugbter, rushed forward in fury, scattering the monkeys on the battlefield. By his monsttous and terrible laughter, like unto the muttering of a thundercloud, he seemed to cleave the hearts of the inhabitants of the woods, and Kumbhakama, in his great splendour, said to Raghava : " Take me not for Viradha, Kabsnda or Khara, Bsli or Maricha ; it is I, Kumbhakama, who stand here I Behold my dreadful and mighty mace wrougbt of iron ; with this, *Devas* and Danavas were formerly struck down by me ! Do not hold me in contempt in that I possess neither nose nor ears, I do not feel the least discomfort or pain on account of their loss I Manifestthesttengthofthylimbs,OTigeramongthe lkshvakus; !86 YUDDRA KA.ND! bavinl displayed thy prowaa a misht, I lball dtrour rhec. O Rahu on the moon in the sky. Thereupon **RAMA** liJ1ed his mouth with steel-pointed and plumed shafts decorated with gold and, with his mouth thus filled, he was unable to spesk and, emitting inarticulated sounds with extreme difticulty, fell senseless. Thereupon Rams selected an arrow bright as the rays of the sun, which resembled the Rod of **BRAHMA** at the time of the final dissolution and was fatal to his foes, the weapon of **INDRA**, well-plumed and sharpened, the rival of

Maruta in speed, and Rams discharged that arrow, the shaft of which was admirably inlaid with diamonds and gold, brilliant as the flames of a blazing sun, swift as Mahendra's thunderbolt, against that ranger of the night. Loosed from Raghava's arm, that missile, which lit up the ten regions with its brilliance and which, in its formidable aspect, resembled a smokeless ftsme, struck that Prince of the Titans, the equal of Shakra and severed his head with its prominent teeth and swinging earrings, like unto the pesk of a higb mountain, as formerly Purandara severed the head of Vritra. The enormous head of Kumbhakama with the curls that adorned it, looked like the moon ftoating in the sky at the time of the sun's rising, when the night has passed. Severed by Rams's shafts, the head of the titan resembling a mountain, fell on the earth crushing the highways, residences, gates and edifices of the city, bearing down the high walls also ; and that gigantic body of great resplendence belnnging to the titan, fell into the sea where it crushed the great sharks, huge fishes and serpents, and plunged into the depths below. When Kumbhakama, that great enemy of the *brahmins* and the Gods, was alsin in comhat, the earth shook as all the mountains also and the Celestials shouted for joy. Thereafter Gods, *Rishis,* Maharishis, Pannagas, Suras, BhutaS, Supamas, Gubyakas and the hosts of Yakshas and Gandharvas, who ranged the skies, loudly extolled **RAMA**'s exploit. But on beholding that valiant Prince of the House of Raghu, the adherents and kinsfolk of the Lord of the NairritaS emitted loud cries at Kumbhakama's fall, as do elephants in the presence of a lion. Having overcome Kumbhakama in the field, **RAMA**, amidst the simian host, resembled the sun emerging from the 188 jam of Rahu when it drives away the darkness from the celcstial region. In their delight, the countless monkeys, whose faces resembled opening lotuses, lauded Prince Raghava, who saw the fulfilment of his desires in the death of his formidable adversary, and the

ddct brother ofBharata rejoiced that he had slain **KUMBHAKARNA**, the Scourge of the Gods, who had never been overcome in any great encounter, as the King of the Cdestials rejoiced at the death of the great *Asura*, Vritra.

CHAPTER 68

Ravana weeps for Kumbhakarna

SEEING **KUMBHAKARNA** fall under the blows of the cxcccdingly courageous Raghava, the titans brought the tidings to their King, **RAVANA**, and said : " O King, the rival of Kala is dead ! Having overthrown the monkey ranks and devoured the Plavagas, he, for a space, displayed his prowess which has now been extinguished by Rams's unconquerable strength and half his body lies submerged in the vast ocean. Streaming with blood, his nose and ears severed, his head obstructing Lanka's gateway, he who resembled a mountain, **KUMBHAKARNA**, thy brother, srruck down by Kakutstha's arrow, is now but a naked and mutilated corpse, like unto a rree consumed by fire ! " Hearing this report of the mighty **KUMBHAKARNA**'s death on the bartlcficld, **RAVANA**, overwhcJmcd with distress, swooned away. Learning that their paternal uncle had been slain, Dcvantaka, Narantaka, Trishiras and Atikaya, a prey to grief, groaned aloud, and Mahodara and Mahaparshwa, on hearing that their brother had perished under the blows of Rams of imperishable exploits, were seized with anguish. Thereafter, regaining his senses with cxrremc difficulty, that lion among the titans, tormented by the death of **KUMBHAKARNA**, his senses troubled, began to lament, saying : " O Hero, O Humbler of the pride of thy foes, O Mighty **KUMBHAKARNA**, urged on by destiny, thou hast left

me for the 189 abode of death I To go whither hast thou deserted me without having extracted that thorn from my side or from the side of my kinsfolk ? O Thou powerful warrior, destroyer of hostile 1'8Dks, from henceforth I no longer eotist since I have lost my rightarm, the support that delivered me from the fear of the Gods and *Asuras*. How has such a warrior, who quelled the pride of the Gods and Danavas, who resembled the Fire of Time, fallen to-day in the fight with Raghava ? How has **RAMA** been able, with a single arrow, to stretch thee on the ground, thou, whom the descent of the thunderbolt could not overwhelm? Seeing thee succumb in combat, the Hosts of the Gods, standing in the heavens with the *Rishis*, emit shouts of joy. Assuredly this very day the Plavamgamas, making use of a favourable occasion, will scale the gates and fortifications of Lanka on every side, which heretofore were impregnable ! I have no further need for a kingdom and what shall I do with **SITA** ? Bereft of Kumbhaltarna, I no longer wish to live. Since I am unable to ldll Ragbava, the slayer of my brother in combat, would it not be better to die, for life is empty to me? To-day I shall go wberc my brother has gone, nay, far from my brother I cannot live for an instant ! Witnessing my plight, the Gods, who were formerly wronged by me, will certainly mock me I O **KUMBHAKARNA**, now that thou art dead, how shall I vanquish Indta? Bibishana's prudent speech, that great soul whom I disregarded in my blindness, has proved true ; the cruel end of **KUMBHAKARNA** and Prahasta has justified his words I This is the disastrous consequence of that deed of mine, the banish ment of the virtuous and fortunate Bibishana." Such were the many burning lamentations to which the Ten-necked **RAVANA** gave voice in the anguish of his soul on account of Kumbhaltarna, his younger brother, the enemy of **INDRA**, and, knowing him to have perished in combat, he swooned away. 190 CHAPTEII 69 Narantaka is slain by **ANGADA**

HI!AIIING the lamentation of the wicked **RAVANA** who was overcome with grief, Trishiras addressed him thus : " O King, brave men do not give way to sorrow even at the death of so valiant a warrior as thy younger brother, our uncle. Since thou art able to conquer the Three Worlds, O Lord, why, like a common man, dost thou sutrer thy courage to falter? Brahrna bestowed on thee a spear, mail, a dart, a bow and a chariot harnessed to a thousand mules, sending forth a rumble hlc unto a thundercloud ; furnished with all these weapons, thou wilt vanquish Raghava ! Y ct if it plcssc thee, O Grcst King, I myself will descend into the arena and bcsr away thy foes, as **GARUDA** the serpents. As Shambara fell under the blows of the King of the Goda and Narala under those of **VISHNU**, so shall **RAMA** fall this day, struck down by me on the battlefield." At these words of Trishiras, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, under the sway of destiny, felt himself to be bom anew and, hearing Trishiras speak thus, Dcvantaka, Narantala and Atikaya, burning with martial ardour, desired nothing more than to enter into combat. "Away! Away!" roared those valiant sons of **RAVANA**, the foremost of the Nairritas, the equals of Shakra in prowess. All were able to fly in the air, all were skilled in magic, all had humbled the pride of the Goda, all were invincible warriors, all were endowed with great strength, all enjoyed great renown, of none was it recounted that they had been defeated in battle even by the Gods, Gandharvas, Kinncras or great Serpents. All were expert in the usc of weapons, all were courageous and able fighters, all were highly learned and all had been the recipients of great boons. Surrounded by his sons, the king, radiant as the solar orb, the destroyer of the power and glory of his foes, shone like Maghavat amidst the Goda, the humbler of the pride of the great Dana-. I9t

CHAPTER 69

Narantaka is slain by Indra

CHAPTEII 69 Narantaka is slain by **ANGADA** HI!AIIING the lamentation of the wicked **RAVANA** who was overcome with grief, Trishiras addressed him thus : " O King, brave men do not give way to sorrow even at the death of so valiant a warrior as thy younger brother, our uncle. Since thou art able to conquer the Three Worlds, O Lord, why, like a common man, dost thou sutrer thy courage to falter? Brahrna bestowed on thee a spear, mail, a dart, a bow and a chariot harnessed to a thousand mules, sending forth a rumble hlc unto a thundercloud ; furnished with all these weapons, thou wilt vanquish Raghava ! Y ct if it plcssc thee, O Grcst King, I myself will descend into the arena and bcsr away thy foes, as **GARUDA** the serpents. As Shambara fell under the blows of the King of the Goda and Narala under those of **VISHNU**, so shall **RAMA** fall this day, struck down by me on the battlefield." At these words of Trishiras, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, under the sway of destiny, felt himself to be bom anew and, hearing Trishiras speak thus, Dcvantaka, Narantala and Atikaya, burning with martial ardour, desired nothing more than to enter into combat. "Away! Away!" roared those valiant sons of **RAVANA**, the foremost of the Nairritas, the equals of Shakra in prowess. All were able to fly in the air, all were skilled in magic, all had humbled the pride of the Goda, all were invincible warriors, all were endowed with great strength, all enjoyed great renown, of none was it recounted that they had been defeated in battle even by the Gods, Gandharvas, Kinncras or great Serpents. All were expert in the usc of weapons, all were courageous and able fighters, all were highly learned and all had been the recipients of great boons.

Surrounded by his sons, the king, radiant as the solar orb, the destroyer of the power and glory of his foes, shone like Maghavat amidst the Goda, the humbler of the pride of the great Dana-. I9t Embracing his sons, he covered them with ornaments and sent them out to fight, besping blessings upon them. Nevertheless **RAVANA** sent his brothers Yuddhonmatta and Matta to accompany those youthful warriors and watch over them in the struggle. Then those heroes of immense stature paid obeisance to the mighty Ravens, the destroyer of creatures, and, circumambula ting him, departed. Thereafter the foremost of the NairritaS, furnished with every kind of medicinal herb and perfume, went away, eager to fight, and Trishiras, Atikaya, Devantaka, Narantaka, Mabodara and Mshaparshwa, under the sway of destiny, set out. A msgnificent elephant, like unto a dark cloud, offspring of Airavata's race, named Sudarsbana, served as Mahodara's mount and thst hero, furnished with every weapon, armed with a quiver, seated on his elephant, shone like the sun on the peak of the Astachala Mountsin. Trishiras, born of **RAVANA**, was seated in an excellent car drawn by the foremost of steeds and it was filled with weapons of every kind. Standing in his cbatiot, armed with his bow, he looked as resplendent as a storm cloud on the peak of a mountain, attended by ligbtuing, thunder, meteors and lndra's bow. With hislriple crown, Ttishiras shone in his cbatiot like Himavat, the Lord of Mountsins with its golden crests. Then the exceedingly war-like Atikaya, son unto thst Lord of the Titans, most skilful of stchers, ascended a superb cbatiot with excellent wheels, stout axles, magnificent steeds, carriage and yoke, rich in quivers and bows, filled with missiles, swords and maces, and thst warrior wore a diadem encrusted with gold and covered with gems so thst he looked like Meru shining in its own splendour. That mighty Prince of the Titans, surrounded by the foremost of the NairritaS, glowed in his cbatiot like

the God who bears the thunderbolt amidst the Immortals. And Narantaka, mounted on a whire steed, as swift as thought, harnessed with gold, resembling Ucchairavas, was armed with a javelin like unto a thunderbolt and appeared exceedingly resplendent, resembling the illusttious Guba, the offspring of Shikhin riding on his pescock. Devantaka, bearing a gilded iron bar, looked like an incarnation of **VISHNU** holding the Mandara Mountain in his arms and Mahaparshwa, full of strength and energy, brandished a mace like unto Kuvera armed for combat. Thereafter those intrepid warriors set out from Lanka like the Gods leaving Amatavati and powerful titans on elephants, horses and in chariots thundering like clouds, followed, armed with excellent weapons ; and those youthful beings shone like the blazing sun with theit brows encircled with diadems, sparkling in splendour like planets flaming in the heavens and, in the brightness of the raiment in whicb they were attired, that brilliant cavalcade resembled an autumn cloud or a flock of cranes in the sky. Determined to die or vanquish theit foe, they went forward in this courageous resolve, eager to fight, boasting, shouting and uttering threats, and those invincible heroes set out furnished with arrows amidst the clamour and clapping of hands, causing the earth to tremble as it were. As the roars of theit troopa seemed to rend the heavens, those migbty titan princes, full of joy, increased theit pace and beheld the simian host brandishing rocks and trees, whilst from theit side, the courageous leaders of the monkeys observed the titan army with its mass of elephants, horses and chariots advancing like unto a thunder cloud to the sound of hundreds of gongs and, furnished with huge weapons, encompassed on all sides by the resplendent Nairritas, resembling blazing torches or suns. Beholding that company approaching, the desire of the Plavamgsmas was realised and, armed with huge rocks, they redoubled theit cries in theit eagerness to

fight the titans, who responded with their shouts. Hearing the roars that the mon keys and theit leaders let forth, the titan ranks, provoked by the joyous cbeering of the enemy, roared with an even greater fUry with heavily-branched trees and the struggle between the titans and the monkeys became desperate. Those monkeys of redoubtable courage let an unequalled showet of trees, stones and rocks fall on the enemy who over whelmed them with a hail of missiles. Titans and monkeys roared like lions on the battlefield ; the Plavamgamss crushed the Yatudhanas with blows from stones and, in fUry struck those warriors coveted in mail and jewels, mounted in chariots, and on elephants and horses in the fray. Then the Plavamgamas redoubled their attacks against the Yatudhanas with crags that they tore up with their hands. Their bodies tense, their eyes starting from their heads, shouting, they stumbled and fell, whilst those lions among the titans, on their side, pierced those elephants among the monkeys with sharp arrows, striking them with spears, malletS, swords, javelins and lances and they mowed esch other down in their desire to triumph. The limbs of monkeys and titans were stresming with the blood of their enemies, and rocks and swords, thrown by the monkeys and titans, coveted the blood-stained esrth in an instant, so that the ground was smothered with titans like unto mountains, who, mad with msrtia1 srdour, had been crushed and mangled by their foes. Thereafter the monkeys, giving and receiving blows, their rocks shsttered, engaged in a fresh and dreadful fight, using the severed limbs as weapons. And the NairritaS struck the monkeys with their own corpses and the apes struck the titans with the titan desd. Tearing the rocks from the hsnds of their foes, the titans broke them on the beads of the monkeys who shsttered the arrows of the titans, uaing the pieces to destroy them. And they overwhelmed each other with crags in the battle and monkeys and titans set up a roaring like unto lions. Then, their

armour and shields pierced, those titans, attacked by the monkeys, dripped blood as trees their sap, and some monkeys in the con11ict, destroyed chariots with chariots, elephants with elephants, horses with hones, whilst the titans employed weapons like razors or hslf moons and Bhsl1as and pointed shafts in order to shstter the rocks and trees of those intrepid monkeys. In that encounter, the esrth became im paasable, coveted as it was with monkeys and titans mangled and crushed under the rocks and trees in the fight. 194 Full of audacity and ardour, the monkeys, engaged in the struggle, casting aside all fear, fought the titanS with a light heart and various kinds of weapons. Witnessing that appalling m!ld, the joy of the monkeys and the massacre of the titanS, the great *Rishis* and hosts of Celestial Beings emitted shouts of triumph. Narantaka howevet, mounted on his steed, that was as swift as the wind, with a pointed lance plunged into the thick of the simian ranks like a fish into the sea and that warrior pierced seven hundred monkeys with his e1fulgent spear and that enemy of Iwlm, of exceeding courage, in an instsnt, single-handed, ovetthrew the army of the foremost of monkeys uodet the eyes of the Vidhyadharas and Maharishis, hacking a pathway for himself through the simian ranks, the bleeding ftesh its mire, and which was coveted with heaps of monkey corpses as high as hills. Whenevet those lions among the monkeys sought to bar his way, so often did Narantaka cleave their ranks by mowing them down. As a fire burns up a forest, so did he consume those simian battalions and each time those inhabitsnts of the woods tore up the trees and rocks, they fell uwlet his lance like moun tsins riven by lightning. Bmndishing his glittering spear in the forefront of battle, the valiant Narantaka ranged the entire welkin, ovetthrowing evetYthing in his course as the wind in the rainy season and, whether they stsyed at their post or went out to meet him, those coumgeous monkeys could neithet stsnd against him

nor escape from him so that all fell, pietced by that warrior. him, observed the army of the lllllllkcys ftceing before Narantaka, terror-stricken and scattering in all directions. Witnessing this stampede, he beheld Narantaka, spear in hand, who was advancing, mounted on his steed. At this, the illustrious **SUGRIVA**, King of the Monkeys, addressed the youthful Ptincc **ANGADA**, a warrior whose valour equalled Shakra's, and said: " Go out against that bold titan, who, riding on a horse, is consuming the army I have sent against him and spccdily deprive him of his life's breaths." At this command from his sovereign, the inucpid **ANGADA**, the foremost of monkeys resembling a rocky mass, broke away from that company like the sun emerging from a cloud and, with the bracelets he wore, be glittered like a mountain with its mctallic veins. Without any weapons save his nails and teeth, that son of Bali, in his great suength, rushed out to meet Narantaka and said to him : " Why dost thou strive with common monkeys ? Do thou with thy spear, the impact of which is equal to lightning, strike my breast which I now present to thee ! " The words of **ANGADA**, son of Bali, angered Narantaka, who bit his lip with his teeth hissing like a serpent, and burled himself upon him in fury. Brandishing his spear, which glittered like fire, he suuck at **ANGADA** but the weapon broke against the breast of that son of Bali, that waa as hard as diamond, and fell to the earth. Seeing his lance shattered, like a snake whose powerful coils arc sundered by Suparns, the son of Bali raised his hand and suuck the head of the steed of his adversary. Sinking to its which equalled Mrityu's in strength and resembled a great rock, brought it down on Narantaka's breast. His chest crushed, broken by the shock, vomiting llames, his limbs streaming with blood, Narantaka fell on the earth like a mountain struck by lightning : and when the mighty Narantaka fell in the struggle with Bali's son, from the sky, the foremost of the Celestials and the

monkeys emitted a great shout of triumph ! And **ANGADA** filled **RAMA**'s heart with joy and he was astonished at his exceedingly difficult achievement. Thereafter that warrior of illustrious exploits eagerly prepared for ftesh encounters.

CHAPTER 70

The Death of Devantaka, Trishiras, Mahodara and Mahaparshwa

Poulastya, wept bitterly. Thereafter Mahodara, mounted on that **INDRA** of elephants like unto a cloud, rushed impetuously on the exceedingly energetic son of Bali. Then the valiant Devantaka, distressed on account of the calamity that had visited his brother, arming himself with a formidable mace, also ran on **ANGADA** and, in his turn, the energetic Trishiras, standing in his chariot, that was as bright as the sun and harnessed to excellent steeda, advanced on the son of Bali. Attacked by three of the foremost of titans, who had humbled the pride of the Gods, **ANGADA** tore up a many-branched tree, and as Shakra his ftaming thunderbolt, hurled that huge trunk with its immense branches at Devantaka. Thereupon Trishiras severed it with his arrows which resembled venomous snakes and **ANGADA**, beholding the tree shattered, darted forward and that elephant among monkeys caused a shower of trees and rocks to fall upon the titans. Enraged, Trishiras broke them with his whetted shafts and, with the head of his mace, Mahodara crushed them, while o 1n Trisbiras pursued the valiant **ANGADA** with his darts. Thcrcsftcr Mahodara urged his elephant to advance on the son of Bali and, in his anger, pietced his bresst with Tomaras that were equal to lightning, and Devantska, provoked, approaching Angads, suuck him

with his mace and swiftly turned away. The combined assault of those thtec Nairritas left that illusuious warrior unmoved; that agile and invincible hero however hurled himself in great fury on the colossal elephant belonging to Mahodara and, with the palm of his hand, suuck it down. Its eyes starting from their sockets, the elephant fell dead and that powerful son of Bali tore out one of its tusks, thereafter, rushing on Devantska, he dealt him a blow in that suuggle which caused him to stumble like a uec buffeted by the wind, and he vomited blood profusely which was the colour of lac. Breathing with dilliculty, the energetic and mighty Devantaka, brandishing his mace, suuck Angads a violent blow. At the impact, the son of that **INDRA** among Monkeys fell to his knees but soon rose up again and, as he did so, Trisbiras, with thtec infallible and formidable darts, pietced that son of the simian king. Meanwhile **HANUMAN** and Nila, beholding Angads assaulted by three of the foremost of the titans, came to his aid, and Nila suuck Trishiras with a rock which the skilful son of **RAVANA** broke with his sharp darts. Shattered by a hundred arrows, its surface broken to pieces, that rocky peak, from which sparks and 1lames spurted, fell. Witnessing their astonishment, the courageous Devantska, full of joy, in the fight flung himself with his mace on the son of Maruta and, as he rushed upon him, that lion among the monkeys leapt to meet him and with his fist suuck him a thunderous blow on the head. Thereafter the heroic son of Vayu, that great and powerful monkey, hatteted in his skull and his roaring caused the titans to uemble. Devantska, the son of the King of the Titans, gasping from the blow, his skull shattered, his teeth prouuding, his eyes starting from their sockets, his tongue hanging out, fell to the earth instantly bereft of life. Enraged by the death of the foremost of the titan warriors, that mighty enemy of the Gods, Trisbiras, let fall a fearful shower of whetted shafts on Nila’s breast and Mahodara, in fury,

quickly 198 mounted a second elephant aa high aa a bill. As the sun scales the Mandara Mountain, so did he let fall a rain of arrows on Nila as, under a rainbo-1., a cloud lets looae a shower on a moun rain amidst the muttering of thunder. Covered with those darts, with which the valiant titan overwhelmed him, the !cadet of the monkey army, his limbs pierced, faltering, swooned away; then comiDg to himself, Nila tote up a rock coveted with mmy branched trees aud, with a terrific bouDd leapt on Mahodma and struck him on the head. Crushed by the impact with which that elephaut among monkeys hsd just overwhelmed him, Mahodara fell to earth deprived of life, like a rock riven by lighmiDg. BeholdiDg his uncle slain, Trishiras seized hold of his bow and, full of ire, pietced Hanumm with his sharp arrows. Thereupon the son of the Wind, provoked, 1lung a crag at the valiant Trishiraa who broke it to pieces with his whetted shafts. Seeing that his missile waa useless, the monkey let fall a rain of trees on the son of Ravans in the so. uggle and he, observing that shower of trees falling through the air upon him, severed thetn in fury with his sharp arrows, emitting shouts of triumph. Then **HANUMAN**, leaping upon his steed, tore at it violelltly with his nails, as the King of the Beasts claws a great elephaut. Thereafter, from his side, the son of Ravans, as Death with his noose, armiDg himself with a spear hurled himself on the son of Anila. As a meteor falls from the skies, so did that lance descend unobstructed and that lion among the monkeys caught it and snapped it, emitting a great shout. BeholdiDg that weapon of formidable aspect destroyed by Hanumm, the monkey forces raised joyful roars like unto the rumble of thunder, aud Trishiraa, the foremost of the titans, drawing his sword, pierced the breast of that **INDRA** of the Monkeys. Wounded by the thrust of his sword, the mighty Hanumm, bom of Maruta, struck that Three-headed One on the breast with the palm of his haud. Smitten by the blow from Hanumm’s palm,

the illustrious Trishiras let his gauntlet fall and dropped swooning to the ground, and as he fell, the great monkey, who resembled a mountain, broke his sword letting out a roar which struck terror in all the titans. Unable to endure the terrible cry of triumph, that ranger of the night rose up THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI and struck **HANUMAN** with his fist. The blow infuriatal the great monkey who, in anger, seized hold of the titan by his crown and, as formerly Shakra severed the head of Tashtri's son,' so **HANUMAN**, with a terrific stroke of his shatp sword, cut off his three heads each encircled with a diadem and decoratal with earrings. The heads of that enemy of **INDRA** with their large eyes resembling stones, their glances like unto a glowing brazier, fell to the earth like stars falling from the sky. When the enemy of the Gods, Trishiras was slain by **HANUMAN**, who was equal to Shakra in valour, the monkeys shouted in triumph and the earth shook, whilst the titans scattered on aU sides. Beholding Trishiras, Yuddhonmatta and the irresponsible Dcvantaka and Narantaka slain, the fury of Matta knew no bounds. Seizing a mace, plata! with gold, stained with flesh, blood and foam, immense, glittering, saturatal with the enemy's gore, its point effulgent, festooned with scarlet garlands, the terror of Airavata, Mahapadma and Sarvabhauma,' he armed himself with that weapon. In his fury, Matta, that lion among the titans, scattered the monkeys like the Fire at the end of the World Period. Meanwhilethemonkcy,Rishabha, rushed towards Mattanika,' the younger brother of **RAVANA**, and stood courageously facing him. Beholding that monkey, as high as a hill, standing before him, Matta, enraged, struck him violently on the chest with his mace that resembled lightning. Under the impact of that weapon, the lion among monkeys, his chest riven, stumbled, blood flowing in streams from the wound. Regaining conscious ness after a long time, that prince of the monkeys, his lips trembling, threw a savage

glance at Mahaparshwa and, with a bound, hurled himself on that titan ; theresfter the impetuous leader of the intrepid monkeys, of the size of a mountain in stature, clenched his fist and struck him full on the chest and, that enemy of the Gods appeared to be dead but, regaining his senses, his colour that of an evening cloud, he threw 1umsclf on the son of the Lord of Waters and struck him. Dazed by the shock, the monkey sank to the ground, but, having regained consciousness, quickly rose again, and, brandish ing the mace resembling a huge rock, he struck the titan a violent blow. When that terrible mace fell on the powerful breast of the enemy of the Gods, hostile to sacrifice and the priests, from his riven breast, blood fell in torrents, as mineral-charged waters flow from a mountain. Thereafter Rishabha, still armed with that formidable weapon, advanced upon him rapidly, striking his mighty adversary again and again and that hero felled Mattanika in the forefront of the battle and, crushed by his own mace, his teeth and eyes pressed in, Matta sank to the earth berefr of life and strength like a rock shattered by lightning. At his f811, all those titan warriors fled and, **RAVANA**'s brother being slain, the whole army of the Nairtitas, which was as vast as the sea, throwing away their weapons, seeking only to preserve their lives, scattered in all directions like the sea bursting its banks.

CHAPTER 71

Lakshmana slays the Titan Atikaya

WITNESSING the rout of his great army, causing the hair to stand on end, and the death of his brothers the equals of Shakra in prowess and, beholding his two uncles Yuddhonmatta and Matta, the foremost of the titans, struck down in the fight, the illustrious Atikaya, who resembled a

rock, the humbler of the pride of *Devas* and Danavas, he who had been favoured by Brahms, fell into a transport of rage. Ascending his chariot, glittering like a hundted suns, that enemy of **INDRA** hurled himself on the monkeys and, stretching his bow, that titan, wearing a diadem and adomed with sparkling they, beholding that gigantic: warrior, reflected :-'**KUMBHAKARNA** has come again ' and, iD their panic, took shelter one with the other. At the sight of that apparition, like unto **VISHNU** tskiDg the three strides, the simian warriors, seized with fear, tied in an clireclions and iD the presence of Atikaya, those monkeys, bewildered, sought refuge with the one who is the refuge of an, the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**. At that instant, Kakutstha beheld the titan, like unto a mountsin, stsndiDg in his chariot, afar off, armed with a bow and roaring like a cloud at the time of the dissolution of the worlda. Seeing that monster, Raghava, struck with astonish ment, re-assuring the monkeys, enquired of Bibishana, saying: " Who is that archer, as bigh as a hill, with yellow eyes, standing in his vast chariot, harnessed to a thousand horses amidat sharp picks, javelins, gleaming and pointed darts, who shines like Maheshwara among the Bhutss and who is surrounded by glittering spears that fill his car like tongues of the Fire of Death, blazing like a cloud riven by lightning, his best and golden-backed bow illumining his marvellous car on an sides, as Shakra in the heavens ? This tiger among titans diffuses a brilliant light over the battlefield as he, the prince of warriors, advances in a ehariot reftecting the sun’s rays. Oo the point of his standard, Rahu has lent him his splendour’ and his arrows like unto the rays of the sun light up the ten regions ; his triply-curved bow, inlaid and backed with gold, resounding like thunder, is as resplendent as Shatskratu’s! With its standard, banner, carriage and the four outriders who escort it, that vast ehariot thunders like a storm cloud. Eight and thirty quivers lie in the car with dreadful

bows furnished with yellow cords I Two shining sworda illumine its sides, their hafts measuring four palms and they are assuredly ten palms in length. With his red garlanda, this hero of the size of a mountsin, dark of hue, his great mouth like unto death, resembles the sun veiled by cloud I Who is this titan leader with his arms loaded with golden bracelets ? .. Thus questioned by Kama, the descendant of Raghu of immense energy, the extremely illustrious **BIBISHANA** *answered*: " It is the valiant son of that king who is without equsl in might, Dashagriva of great splendour, the younger brother of Vaishravana of terrible exploits, the mighty **RAVANA**, Lord of the Titans. Full of reverence for his elders, renowned for his strength, the skilful of those versed in the science of arms, he is able to light on horseback or on the back of an elephant, either with a spear or bow and, whether it be a question of destruction or of sowing dissension or of making peace, of bestowing gifts, of using diplomacy or of strategy, he is highly esteemed. His mother was Dhanyamalini and he is named Atikaya. " Having found favour with **BRAHMA** through his chastity and austerity, he has obtained possession of marvellous weapons with which he has overcome his enemies and Swyambhu granted him invulnerability to Gods and Danavas and bestowed this celestial armour on him and a chariot reflecting the sun's rays. A hundted times has he triumphed over Gods and Danavas, rescued the titans and exterminated the Y akshas. In battle, that intrepid warrior stayed **INDRA**'s thunderbolt with his dam and repelled the noose belonging to the Lord of the Waters, **VARUNA**. He, Atikaya, the most powerful of the titans is the intelligent son of **RAVANA** and the subduer of the pride of *Devas* and Danavas. Speedily direct thine efforts against him, O Lion among Men, lest, with his arrows, he annihilate the monkey race I " At that instant, the mighty Atikaya, shouting again and again, stretching his bow, hurled himself on the monkey host. Beholding that

fearful monster, standing in his chariot, the greatest of car warriors, the foremost of the illustrious monkey leaden advanced to meet him, and Kumuda, Mainda, Nila and Sharabha, coming together, also went out with trees and rocks. Then that mighty titan, prince of warriors, broke those rocks and trees and all the monkeys resisted him, but that virtuous hero of appalling stature, pierced them with iron dam. Over whelmed by that hail of missiles, their limbs dislocated, demoralized, they were unable to endure the furious assaults of Atikaya and that hero sowed terror amidst the hosta of the valiant monkeys, as a lion, proud of ita youth and strength, stands IDIOIIpt a herd of deer ; nevertheless that **INDRA** among the titans desisted from striking any who were defenceless. 203 Thereafter with his bow and quiver, he rushed on Rams and addressed him proudly, saying : " Here I stand in my chariot with my bow and arrows in my hand I I do not contend with common soldiers but he, who desires it and is willing, I challenge, here and now, to combat ! " This speech incensed Saumitri, the slayer of his foes, and, in his rage, he sprang forward with a smile of disdain, bow in hand. Provoked, he advanced, taking an arrow from his quiver and placing himself before Atikaya, stretching his great bow so that the earth, the sky, the sea and the four quarters resounded with the formidable thrumming of the bowstring and terror seized those rangers of the night. Hearing that dreadful twanging of Saumitri's bow, the powerful and valiant son of that **INDRA** of Titans was astounded and, enraged on beholding **LAKSHMANA** advancing towards him, he took out a sharp dart and spoke thus : " Go hence, O Saumitri, thou art but a child without any experience of warfare ; why dost thou seck to measure thy strength with mine, who am the equal of Death ! Nay, assuredly the force of these arrows loosed by mine arm may not be withstood by Himavat himself nor the earth nor the heavens. Thou art seeking to rouse the Fire

of Dissolution which, to thy good fortune, is now sleeping. Throw away thy bow and go hence ! Do not sacrifice thy life by advancing to meet me I Nevertheless if thou art determined not to turn back then stay and, yielding up thy life, enter Yams's abode I Bebold my whetted shafts, which wrought of refined gold, subdue the boasting of mine adversaries and resemble Shivs's trident. This arrow also, resembling a serpent, shall this instant quaff thy blood as the king of the beasts drinks the blood of the lord of the elephants. " Speaking thus, in rage, the titan placed an arrow on his bow and that speech of Atikaya's, full of wrath and threats, infuriated **LAKSHMANA** who was brave and virtuous by nature so that he answered him proudly and with dignity, saying: " Superiority is not measured by speech nor is bragging indulged in by men of worth I Here I am armed with my bow, an arrow in mine hand, manifest thy prowess, O Wretch I Reveal thyself in deeds and cease to blow thine own trumpet I :104 He who conducts himself with courage is said to be a warrior 1 Thou art furnished with every kind of weapon, art mounted on thy chariot and hast a bow ; now manifest thy valour either with arrows or with magic darts ! I shall cut off thine head with my whetted shafts as the wind detaches the ripe fruit of the palm from its stem ! Soon mine arrows, decorated with refined gold, shall drink thy blood, that their points will cause to flow by piercing thy limbs. Thou hast said ' He is but a child ' but let not this thought cause thee to underestimate me. Old or young, know that it is death who is about to enter into combat with thee. **VISHNU**, while a child, covered the Three Worlds in his three strides!" These words of **LAKSHMANA**, fraught with sense and reason, exasperated Atikaya, who laid hold of an exceJient dart. At this, Vidyadharas, Bhutss, *Devas*, Daityas, Maharishis and Guhyakas of great soul, gathered to witness the duel. Thereafter Atikaya, provoked, placed an arrow on his bow and loosed it on

LAKSHMANA and it ate up space, as it were, but that sharpened arrow like unto a venomous snake, in the form of a crescent, as it flew was severed by that slayer of his foes and, seeing his dsrt broken, Atikaya, in a paroxysm of rage rook out five arrows at once, and that ranger of the night loosed them on **LAKSHMANA**, but before they reached him, the younger brother of **BHARATA** shattered them with his whetted shafts. Having severed those missiles with his sharpened dsrts, **LAKSHMANA**, the slayer of his foes, selected a pointed arrow, the brilliance of which sent forth flames and placed it on his excellent bow, then bending it with force, he struck the forehead of that prince of the titsus. That shaft, sinking into the brow of the terrible titan with the blood that covered it, resembled the King of the Serpents entering a mountain and, as the formidable gateway of Tripura shnok, when struck by Rudra's shaft, so did that titan falter at the impact of **LAKSHMANA**'s weapon. Breathing heavily, that colossus reflected ' Assuredly the arrow thus loosed proves to me that thou art a worthy adveraary ! ' Thinking thus, he One, three, five and seven were the arrows selected by that lion among the titans and, placing them on his bow and drawing it, he let them lly and those shafts, bright as the sun, seemed as it were to set the firmament ablaze. Mesntime, unmoved, the younger brother of Raghava severed them with the aid of innumerable whetted darts. Seeing those arrows broken, the son of **RAVANA**, enemy of the Lord of the Gods, incensed, rook hold of a sharp wespon and, placing it on his bow, he loosed it with grest force against Ssumitri, who was advancing towards him, striking him on the bresst. Wounded in the bresst by Atikaya, Ssumitri began to bleed profusely, like an elephant discharging its temporal juices, and that prince plucked out the shaft and threw it away ; theresfter he selected a sharp dart to which he joined a *mantra*-charged arrow and set **AGNI**'s wespon on his bow whereupon both bow and arrow spat forth llames.

Thereupon Atikaya, endowed with grest strength, took up Rudra's wespoo and fixed an arrow with a golden haft, re sembling a serpent, on his bow. Then **LAKSHMANA** loosed that powerful wespon, his llaming and redoubtable tuissile on Atikaya like Aotaks wielding the Rod of Desth. Seeing that shaft joined to the Agoeya dart the Ranger of the Night loosed Rudra's shaft joined to **SURYA**'s wespon, and those two tuissiles rushed towards each other in space and their llatuing points made them appest like infuriated serpents. Devouring esch other, they fell on the esrth, their fire estinguished, reduced to ashes and bereft of their splendour, and having set the sky ablaze, they lay without lustre on the esrth. Thereafter Atikaya, enraged, discharged the Aishika Reed joined to Twashtar's Wespon, but the tuighty Saumitri severed it with **INDRA**'s shaft. Seeing the reed broken, that prince bom of **RAVANA**, enraged, joined a spesr to **YAMA**'s Wespoo and that ranger of the night hurled it at Lakshmans who destroyed it with the Vayavya Wespon. Then, like a mass of cloud letting loose its rain, Lakahmana, in anger, covered the son of **RAVANA** with a rain of tuissiles and those shafts cotuing in contact with Atikaya's coat of mail which was encrusted with diamonds, had their points shattered and fell on the earth. Seeing them rendered fruitless Lakahmana, 206 the slayer of hostile warriors, covered his advenary with a thousand arrows. Inundated by that bail of shafts, Atikaya, that mighty warrior, whose cuirass could not be pierced, remained unmoved and that hero was unable to in1lict a wound on the titan. Thereafter the Wind-god approached him and said : " Because of the boon received from **BRAHMA**, that warrior is clothed io impenetrable armour, do thou therefore strike him with the **BRAHMA** Weapon, else he may not be slain, his mail being proof against aught else ! " On hearing Vayu's words, Saumitri, the equal of lndra in prowess, instantly took up a dart of incredible velocity and joined it to

Brahms's Weapon. Having placed that excellent weapon with the foremost of arrows furnished with shatp points on his bow, every region, the sun, moon and the great planets were struck with terror and the heavens and eatth also shook. Then, having fixed the **BRAHMA** Weapon on his bow, that missile, the stem ofwbich being like death's messenger and equal to lightning, Saumitri let it 11y on the son of **INDRA**'s foe. And Atikaya beheld that shaft loosed by the mighty-armed **LAKSHMANA**, swift as the tempest, with its haft encrusted with gold and diamonds, falling upon him and beholding it, immediately Struck at it with his innumerable shafts but that arrow, swift as Suparna himself, 11ew towards him with extreme velocity and seeing it draw near, like Death at the time of dissolution, Atikaya struck at it with lances, spean, maces, axes, picks and arrows with unrelenting energy, but those weapons of marvellous aspect were rendered fruitless by that 11aming dart, which, striking him, severed his head with its diadem. Cut off by **LAKSHMANA**'s arrow, the head instantly fell on the eatth with its crown like unto the peak of Himavat. Then those rangers of the night, who had escaped the slaughter, beholding the body lying on the ground, its raiment and adorn ments in diaarray, were thunderStruck and, their features distored, those unfortunate beings, exhausted with fighting, suddenly began to emit piercing and inarticulate cries. There after those titsns, who surrounded their dead leader, terrified, without paying him honour, 11ed towards the city. The monkeys, however, their faces shining like full-blown '»7 THE : lotuses, in their delight, all paid homage to **LAKSHMANA** on account of the succeaa he had won in striking down that formidable advetsary who was renowned for his prowess and theretofore invincible.

CHAPTER 72

Ravana, overcome by anxiety, makes further Plans

" Dhumrabha, who is full of ardour and the most skilled in the use of arms, Alwnpana, Prahasta, and Kumbhakama, those valiant titan warriors for combat, the destroyns of hostile forces, ever invincible, brave titanS of immense statute who were versed in the use of every weapon, bave fallen with their trOops under the blows of :Rsma of imperishable exploits. Yet many powerful warriors were struck down by my son Indrajita, who is renowned for his strength and prowess ; those two brothers were fettered by his formidable shafts bestowed on us as a boon. All the Gods and *Asuras* combined, despite their power, could not have broken those fearful bonds, nor the Y akshas, Gand harvas or Pannagas ! I do not know by what force, magic or supernatural means, those bonds were severed by those two brothers, :Rsma and Lskshmana. " Those courageous titans, who went out to fight at my command, have all perished in combat with the exceedingly valiant monkeys. Henceforth I do not see who, on the battle field, will be able to sla) :Rsma and Lskshmana or the powerful **SUGRIVA** and his forces. " Ah ! How mighty is :Rsma I How great is the range of his shafts I Those titanS, who challenged this warrior, have all been destrOyed! Now, on hia account, let defences be set up everywhere, both in the city and round the Ashoka Grove where **SITA** is being guarded. Let the entries and exits be patrolled continuously by our sentinels, wherever they are posted I BstabJish yourselves with the foremost battalions everywhere =a in order to observe the movements of tbe monkeys, O Night rangers I In tbe evening, at midnight or at dawn, no matter when, do not relax your vigilance in regard to the simian army. Observe what troops are

placed in the line by tbe enemy, how they advance and where they halt ; let the gateways and turrets be barricaded at once I " AU tbe titans listened to tbe commands of tbe mighty Lord of the Titans and went away to carry them out. **RAVANA**, the King of tbe Titans, however, having issued these orders, exceedingly despondent, enteted his abode, tbe fire of his anger smouldering within him, and that powerful monarch of those rangers of the night, rdlecting on tbe misfortune that had befaUen his son, sighed without ceasing.

CHAPTER 73

Indrajita, making himself invisible, puts the Monkey Army out of action

RAVANA of the death of their leaders, Devantaka and others, u also Trishiras and Atikaya. Hearing these mournful tidings, great tears immediately filled the Icing's eyes and for a long time he remained absorbed in the melancholy thought of the death of his sona and brothers. Beholding the wretched monarch plunged in an ocean of grief, lndrajita the son of that Lord of the Titans, the foremost of warriors, addressed him thus : " O My Dear Father, since lndrajita stiU lives, do not give thyself up to despair ! O Prince of tbe Nairritas, he whom tbe enemy of lndra strikes with his shafts in tbe light is not able to preserve his life. To-day thou shalt see **RAMA** and Labh mana lying stretched on tbe earth, their bodies pierced, torn to pieces by mine arrows, their limbs riddled with my whetted shafts. Bear witness to the weU-conaiclered vow of Shakra's enemy re-inforced by my prowess and tbe divine power I This very day I shaD overwhelm **RAMA** and Labhmana with aop arrows that never miss their target. Let **INDRA**, Vaivasvata, **VISHNU**,

Rudn, the Sadhyas, Vaishvansn, Chandra and **SURYA** this day witness mine immeasurable ptowess as redoubtable as that of **VISHNU** at Bali's place of sacrifice I " Having spoken thus, that rival of the Lotd of the Celestials, craved permission of the king to depart and with fearless soul ascended his chariot, that was as swift as the wind, harnessed to excellent steeds and furnished with weapons, resembling the car of Hari himself. Then he set out for the battlefield immediately and that magnanimous hero was escorted by innumerable warrion, full of ardour, bearing grest bows in their hands. As they advanced, some on the backs of elephantll, others on prodigious mountll such as tigers, scorpions, cats, mules, buffalo, setpents, boan, cheetahs, lions and jackals, as large as hills, crows, herons and peacocks, those titans of redoubtable courage were armed with javelins, hammers, sabres, axes and maces. To the sound of conches and the rolling of drums, that valiant enemy of the King of the Gods rushed out to fight. With his parasol, pearly like the moon, that slayer of his foes shone like the firmantent when that orb is full. Fanned by marvellous chowries with elegant handles, that warrior, adorned with golden ornaments, the foremost of archers, Indrajita, blazed like the solar disc and he, whose strength was irresistible, illumined Lanka like the burning sun in the sty. Then that intrepid subduer of his foes, on reaching the battlefield, ranged the titans round his chariot and, according to the traditional rites, that Prince of the Titans prayed to the God who feeds on sacrificial offerings,' whose brilliance he possessed, reciting the most auspicious mantras, and, offering libations of *Soma* and roasted grain, with garlands and perfumes, that resplendent leader of the titans invoked Pavaka. Thereafter he brought there weapons such as Sharapatras, Samidhs and Bibhitakas with red robes and an iron spoon and, heaping the fire with Sharapatras and Tomaras, he seized hold of a live goat by the neck.

Blazing up suddenly the fire gave oft' no smoke but manifested the signs betokening victory and, having been lit, the flames bright as gold, whirling in a southerly direction, passed through the crucible and instantly consumed the offerings. Thereafter lndrajita, who was skilled in baDdling arms, took out the Brahms-weapon and pronounced a mantram on his bow, his chariot and on all. Then he, having uttered the sacred formula and invoked Pavaka, the firmament, the sun, the planets, the moon and the stars, trembled. Having called on the God of Fire, whose brilliance he possessed, he, !he equal of lndra in power, whose strength was unimaginable, disappeared in the sky with his bow, arrows, sword, chariot, horses and spear. Then the army of titans, abundantly furnished with horses and chariots, Bags and pennants, burning to fight, set out emitting war cries and, in the struggle, those titans, full of rage, attacked the monkeys with darts of different kinds which were sharp, swift and beautifully wrought, and with spears and hooks. Beholding them, the son of **RAVANA**, addressing those rangers of the night, cried out :-" Attack the foe speedily whom you are burning to destroy ! Be of good cheer ! " At these words, the titans, in their anxiety to triumph, roared aloud and caused a bail of missiles to descend on those re doubtable monkeys. Arming himself with arrows, maces and clubs, Indrajita, on his side, in the midst of the titans, assaulted the monkeys from where he stoOd invisible in the sky. Then those monkeys, struck down in the fight, instantly began to assail Ravaui with blows from stones and trees and, full of anger, Indrajita, born of **RAVANA**, that hero full of power, smote the monkeys with a single lance and, in fierce fury, pierced five, seven and nine monkeys at one time to the great delight of the titans. Thereafter that invincible warrior crushed those monkeys under his shafts that glittered like the sun and were decorated with gold. Their limbs pierced, the monkeys, overwhelmed by those arrows, fell

like great *Asuras* destroyed by the Gods. Before this second Aditya who consumed them with those formidable weapons as his rays, those lions among the monkeys fled away, filled with terror. Their bodies mutilated, their senses confused, they stampeded, bathed in blood and terrified but, in their devotion to **RAMA**, those monkeys, willing to sacrifice their lives. suddenly halted and returned shouting, armed with rocks, and, closing their ranks, showered down a hail of trees, crags and stones on Rsvani. That murderous and fearful avalanche of trees and rocks was however dispersed by the mighty lndrajita, who was ever victorious in combat and, with his arrows as bright as fire, resembling serpents, thst prince pierced the ranks of his foes. With eighteen penetrating darts he wounded Gandhamadaoa ; with nine others he struck NaJa, who stood some way oft', and, in his great strength, he assailed Mainda with seven arrows, tearing out his entrails, and Gaja with seven blunted shafts. Thereafter he pierced **JAMBAVAN** with ten arrows, Nila with thirty and **SUGRIVA**, Rishabha, **ANGADA** and Dvivida -..ith dreadful flaming arrows thst had been received as boons, thus rendering those foremost of the monkeys insensible, who, struck by innumerable shafts fell under his furious onslaught so thst he appeared like the Fire of Death itself. With the aid of arrows as bright as the sun, loosed with skill, thst were exceedingly swift, he scattered those monkey divisions in thst great fight and, with transports of the keenest joy, thst renowned warrior, born of the lndra of the Titans, witoessed the entire simian army, bathed in blood, overwhelmed with that rain of missiles. Under thst shower of arrows and cruel hail of weapons with which he assailed them, the valiant lndrajita ranged the monkey ranks spreading destruction. Then, leaving his army behind, he speedily flung himself on the monkey forces in thst great fight, covering them with a huge wave of formidable shafts like the downpour from a dark cloud. Victims of his magic arts, their

bodies crushed by those missiles loosed by thst vanquisher of Shakra, the monkeys, who were as large as rocks, emitted piteous cries, falling in the fray like great hills struck by **INDRA**'s thunderbolt, and they could see nothing but those sharp arrows decimating their ranks, whilst the enemy of the King of the Gods, that titan, veiled in his magic power, remained invisible. Then thst illustrious Prince of the Titans let fly his whetted shafts thst shone like the sun in all directions coveriog the foremost of the monkeys and destroying them ; au and he caused spears, swords and axes resembling fire, shooting forth flames like a glowing brazier from which sparks fty, to fall on the ranks of the foremost of the Plavagas. Under the arrows and flaming darts, with which the vanquisher of lodra over whelmed them, the mollkey leaders resembled Kimshuka Trees in fullftower. As they looked upwards, some, struck in the eyes were blinded, and jostling one another, fell to the earth. With the aid of javelins, spears and whetted shsfts chsrged with mantras, lndrajita, the Prince of the Titans, crushed all those warriors, **HANUMAN**, **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA**, Gandhsmadana, **JAMBAVAN**, Sushena, Vegadarshin, Mainda, Dvivida, Nila, Gavakshs, Gavaya, Kesarin, Hariloman, Vidyuddamshtra, Suryanana, Jyotimukha, Dadhimukha, Pavakakshs, NaJa and Kumuda and, having disarmed those mollkey leaders, he caused a shower of glittering darts, like unto the rays of the sun, to fall on **RAMA**, and **LAKSHMANA** who accompanied him. Under the wave of arrows, which he heeded as little as though they were drops of rain, Ramo, of prodigious splendour began to ponder within himself and said to his brother : " O **LAKSHMANA**, having overwhelmed the simian army, that lodra among the Titans, the enemy of the Gods, trusting in his powerful wespon, now attacks us afresh with his sharp darts ! In virtue of the boon he has received from Swyambhu, that hero, full of energy and prowess, has made himself

invisible despite his formidable size. How may lodrajita, who has taken up arms against us, be struck down in combat when his body is invisible? " I recognize this to be the weapon and power of Swyambhu, the Beneficent and Incomprehensible One I With a tranquil heart, O Sagacious **LAKSHMANA**, bear the fall of this shsft with me to-day I Let this lodra of Titans, the leader of them all, cover us with a rain of darts I The entire army of the Monkey King, his grearest warriors having been struck down, appears to have lost its splendour, yet when Ravani beholds us lying stretched insensible and impotent, manifesting neither joy nor anger, he will certainly rejoin **RAVANA**, the enemy of the Gods, in his abode, having gained a great victory." Thereafter lodrajita, overwhelmed them both with a hail of missiles and, having reduced them to a state of impotenCe, that Indta among the Titans set up a shout of triumph. In this way, having overcome the simian army in battle, as also **RAMA** and Lakshm.ana, he returned at once to the city ruled by **RAVANA**'s hand where, extolled by the Yatudhanas and filled with rlclight, he related all to his sire.

CHAPTER 74

On Jambavan's Instructions, Hanuman goes to the Mountain of Medicinal Herbs

army of monkeys and their leaders lost courage, nor did **SUGRIVA**, Nila, **ANGADA** or **JAMBAVAN** dare to take any action. Thereupon Bibishana, foremost among the wise, seeing the general despondency, with his sagacious words re-assured those warriors belonging to the simian king, saying : " Although those two princes are lying here without con sciousness, have no fear, you have no cause to despair ; it is

in order to honour Swyambhu's pledge that they have allowed themselves to be struck down by Indrajita with bis rain of missiles I Indtajita received that excellent weapon that is not to be withstood from **BRAHMA**. It is in order to render homage to that God that the two princes have fallen in the fight ; it is therefore not the moment to lose heart I " Having paid honour to **BRAHMA**'s weapon, Maruti answered Bibishana, saying : " Let us console those who still live among the army of the monkeys, which has been decimated by that celestial shaft." Thereupon, with torches in their hands, those two heroes, **HANUMAN** and the foremost of the titanS, began to range the battlefield together during the night, and they beheld the earth covered with tails, hands, hteasts, feet, fingers, necks and severed limbs, scattered here and there, from which the blood flowed, and monkeys as large as bills fallen on the field, their weapons still glowing. Thereafter Bibishana and **HANUMAN** beheld **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA**, Nila, Sharabba, Gandhamadana, **JAMBAVAN**, Susheaa, Vegadarsbin as also Mainda, NaJa, Jyotimukba, Dvivida and all those monkeys lying on the battlefield. Seventy-six kotis of brave monkeys bad been overthrown in the fifth and last period of the day by **BRAHMA**'s cherished weapon. While looking on tbat formidable army, tbat bad fallen under the blows of the enemy and tbat resembled the waters of the sea, **HANUMAN**, accompanied b) Bibishana, began to search for **JAMBAVAN** and, beholding tbat aged one, bowed with the weight of years, riddled with a hundred arrows, the valiant son of Prajapati, like unto an extinguished brazier, the grandson of Poulascya' rushed towards him and said : " O Hero, is it possible tbat those penetrating shafts did not cut off thine existence ? " Hearing the voice of Bibishana, **JAMBAVAN**, the foremost of the bears, who was scarcely able to speak, answered aaying : " O **INDRA** among the Nairritas, thou who art full of valour, I recognize thy voice, O Pious One, aay whether

he, on account of whom Anjana and Matarishwan are bappy parents, tbat hero, **HANUMAN**, still lives ? " On this enquiry from **JAMBAVAN**, **BIBISHANA** *replied*: " Why dost thou remain silent concerning the two princes and question me on the subject of Maruti ? How is it tbat King **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA** or even Ragbava do not inspire thee with an affection as great as tbat which thou bearest for the son ofVayu, O Venerable One ? " Hearing Bibishana's words, **JAMBAVAN** *answered*:-" Hear, O Tiger among the Nairritas, as to why I enquire concerning Maruti ; it is, tbat should the valiant **HANUMAN** still live, even if the army bas been destroyed, it is not destroyed I If Maruti yet lives, O Dear Friend, he, the rival of Maruta, the equal of Vaishvanara in power, then there is still the possibility of survival I" At tbat moment the son of Maruta approached that venersble one with reverence, paying obeisance to him and touching his you-Bibiabana.....,-feet IU1d the voice of HanUDWl moved his heart, so that the Prince of the Plavagas felt new life hsd been bestowed on him. Thereafter the illustrious **JAMBAVAN** said to **HANUMAN** : "Come hither, O Mighty One, it is for thee to deliver the monkeys, none other hss the power and thou art their best friend. This is the moment to demonstrate thy prowess, I see no other ; do thou bring joy to those brave troops of bears and monkeys ! Heal those two unfonunate beings, Ramo and **LAKSHMANA** of their wounds. Prepare to cross far above the great path of the ocean in order to reach Himavat, the highest of mountains, O **HANUMAN**, and there direct thy course to thst golden Peak Rishsbhs, difficult to scale and of an extreme altitude. There the summit of Mount Kailashs will be seen by thee, O Slayer of Thy Foes ! Between the peaks of these two mountains, thou wilt behold the mountain of medicinal herbs rising in unparalleled splendour, where every kind of healing plant abounds. O Foremost of the Monkeys, thou wilt discover four plants growing on the summit, the

radiance of mountain, trod that support of the earth UDder foor, causing the earth and sea to quake ; pressing the mountain under his feet, he opened his mouth like the fearful jaws of Vadava and began to roar with all his might in otder to strike terror into t!>e titans and, when they heard that formidable clamour, those lions among the titans in Lanka were paralysed with fear. Thereafter, paying obeisance to Samudra, Maruti, the scourge of his foes, possessed of redoubtable courage, for Raghava's sake prepared himself for the undertaking. Raising his tail which resembled a serpent, Oattening his ears and opening his mouth wide, like unto the entry to Vadava, he sprang into the air with an impetUOus bound, drawing trees with their branches, stones and a rabble of monkeys in his wake and, borne away by the force of the wind produced by the movement of his arms and thighs, deprived of resistance, they all fell into the ocean. Then the son ofVayu, stretching his two arms that resembled the coils of serpents, with a strength equal to the enemy of reptiles, set out in the direction of that celestial peak of the Lord of the Mountains, displacing all the cardinal points as it were. And he observed the ocean that rolled on and on with its garlands of waves and all the creatures moving in its deptha while he coursed on like the discus loosed by the fingers of **VISHNU**. Mountains, ftocka of birds, lakes, rivers, ponda, vast cities, crowded provinces, passed under his gaze as he journeyed on with the swiftness of his sire, the Wind-god. And the agile and courageous **HANUMAN**, the rival of his father in valour, strove to follow the orbit of the sun and, in extreme haste, the foremost of monkeys went on with the speed of the wind and all the quarters re-echoed to the sound. Then Matuti, that great monkey, full of energy, remembered **JAMBAVAN**'s words and suddenly Himavat appeared with its many streams, its great number of caves and waterfalls, the many kinds of trees that adorned it and its peaks like a masa of white clouds

lovely to look upon. Thereafter he approached that King of Mountains and, as he drew near that **INDRA** of high mountains with im golden peaks of great altitude, **HANUMAN** beheld those illustrious and holy retrears of the ascetics, frequented byothe furemoat of the Gods, *Rishis* and Siddhas, and he saw Brahmakoshs,' Rajatalaya, Shakralaya, Rudrashara pramobha, Hayanana and the blaziug Brahmashiras and he recognized the servants of Vivasvat. Theresfter he beheld the Vahnyalaya and the Vaishravanalaya, Suryaprabhs and the Suryanibandhsna, Brahmalaya and Shanb rakarmukha, thus did he perceive the centre of the esrth ; and **HANUMAN** also discovered the steep Mountain Kailashs and the Rock nfHimavat and Vrishs, thst sublime and golden mountain, illumined by the radiations nf all the curative herbs, the King of Mountains, where all the simples grow. Astonished on beholding thst mountain wreathed in phosphorescent fires, the son of Vasava's messenger descended on thst Lord of Hills covered with medicinal herbs, in order to gather them. Then the great monkey, hom of Maruta, covered a thousand leagues, ranging thst mountain where those specifics grew on thst most elevated of peaks ; nevertheless, those sovereign remedies, knowing thst **HANUMAN** had come to gather them, made themselves invisible. Thereupon thst hero, not being able to see them, grew angry and, in his ire, began to emit loud cries. Impatient, his glances inllamed, he questioned thst mountain, the support of the earth, saying : " What impels thee, thou who art of sueh strength, to show thyself (*to be*) without pity for Raghava? O King of the Mountains, the hour hsving struck, overcome by the power of mine arms, thou shalt see thyself shsttered to pieces ! " Thereupon, seizing hold nf the crest with its trees, elephants, gold and many kinds of ore thst adorned it, with its summit nf jagged peaks and sublime and radiant plateaus, he broke it oft" roughly. Having thus uprooted it, he 11ew into

the air to the great terror of the worlds, the Gods and their leaders and to the acclamations of innumerable inhabitants of the sky. Thereafter he 11ew away with the speed of **GARUDA**, carrying that rocky peak which shone like the luminous orb and he too was filled with radiance as he followed the path of the suu. Coursing thus in the vicinity of that orb, he appeared to be its very image, and that peak spread a great light over the sou of the God, who is the bearer of fragrance, so that it appeared as if **VISHNU** Himself, armed with his discus of a thousand fiery rays, were in the sky. Theu the moukeys, observing him, shouted with delight and he also on beholding them, emitted tremendous roars. Hearing those cries of triumph, the inhabitants of Lanka set up a dreadfUl clamour and Hanumau alighted on a high rock in the midst of that host of moukeys. Thereafter he bowed to the chief monkeys and embraced Bibishaua. Then the two sons of that King of Men, having inhaled those wonderful herbs, were instantly healed of their wounds and the others, those valisnt monkeys, rose up in their tum and all the brave Plavagas were instantly cured of their wounds and suft'erings, having inhaled those wonderful herbs and those who had been slain returned to life like sleepers waking when the night is over. From that moment the moukeys and titans fought in Lanka itself, and thereafter on **RAVANA**'s command and out of perversity, all the titans struck down in the fight by the valisnt monkeys, both wounded and dead were thrown into the sea. Meantime the son of the Bearer of Fragrance, **HANUMAN**, of formidable bounds, carried the peak of medicinal herbs bsck: to Himsvat and returned with speed to rejoin **RAMA**. Zl9

CHAPTER 75

Lanka is set on fire by the Monkeys

AT that moment, **SUGRIVA**, the illustrious King of the Monkeys, addressed **HANUMAN** in words fraught with wisdom, saying : " Now that Kumbhakama bas been slain and the youthful princes have perished, **RAVANA** can no longer harm us I There fore let those valiant and agile Plavamgamas, who are able to do so, hurl themselves on Lanka with torches in their hands I " Meanwhile the sun had withdrawn behind the Astachala Mountains and at the dread hour of night, the foremost of the monkeys approached Lanka with flaming tonhes and those simian ranks, furnished with fiery brands, rushed in on all sides so that the grim-visaged titan sentinels instantly fted away. Then the monkeys joyfully set fire to gates, pavilions, highways and byways and buildings of every kind, and the dwellings were consumed by thousands, and the public monuments, as high as mountains, toppled down and fell to earth ; all was consigned to the ftames! Sands! of great price, pearls, brilliant jewels, diamonds and coral, woollen cloths, rich silks, carpets of many kinds made of Iambs wool, vases and weapons of gold, countless rare objects, harness and horse cloths, collars and girths for elephants, chariots with their furnishings and decorations, warrior’s armour, trappings for their mounts, swords, bows and bow-strings, arrows, spears, goads and lances, cloths of wool and horsehair, tiger skins, innumerable perfumes, palaces enriched with pearls and precious gems, with stores of arms of every kind, all were burnt to ashes. And the fire consumed all the buildings with their ornamentation and devoured the dwellings of the titans who inhabited them. Oad in armour encrusted with gold, decorated with garlands and other ornaments, their eyes wild with inebriation, wine caused those inhabitants of Lanka to reel as they walked, whilst courtesans clung to their apparel, and they were incensed with tiny against their foes. Armed with maces, picks and swords, no they were gorging themselves with meat and drink or sleeping on

sumptuous beds with the objects of their desire. Full of terror they fled distrscted, carrying their sons with them in all haste, whilst their luxurious and splendid mansions, which combined every comfon, were consumed by fire in hundreds and thousands on every side. Those golden buildings that seemed to touch the skies constructed like moons and crescents with their magnificent upper galleries, their trellised windows and terraces decorated with pearls and crystal, re-echoed to the cries of herons, peacocks and the tinkling of ornaments. Asleep in the many-storied residences, the lovely counesans, awakened by the flames that scorched them, threw of!' the jewels that impeded their flight, crying :-'Ah! Alas!' in piercing tones. Meanwhile the palaces crumbled in the fire that consumed them, and those flaming mansions spread their light afar, like unto the summits of high mountains when struck by **INDRA**'s thunderbolts, so that it appeared as if the Peak of Himavat itself were ablaze. The houses on all sides, wreathed in fire, resembled blossoming Kimshuka Trees ; thus did Lanka appear that night ! Elephants and horses that had broken loose from their keepers gave the city an appearance of the ocean with its maddened sharks and crocodiles at the time of the end of the world ! Here a horse was seen running unchecked or an elephant standing motionless in terror. Lanka in flames illumined the sea, the of which, streaked with shadows, seemed to llow with blood. In an instant, the monkeys had set fire the city and it looked as if the whole eanh were aflame, as at the dread destruction of the world. Seeing the smoke, the women began to shriek and, when the flames reached them, their cries could be heard at a hundred leagues distance. The titans rushed out of the city, their limbs covered with hums, whereupon the monkeys, eager to come to blows, fell upon thetn. Monkeys and titans set up such a clamour that it caused the ten regions, the ocean and the whole eanh to re-echo. Meantime, healed of their wounds, the two

brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, intrepid warriors, took up their marvellous bows and, when **RAMA** drew that excellent weapon, the dreadful 231 thrumming thereof struck terror in the titans and, whilst he bent his great bow, Rsghava shone in glory, as Bhava in his fury when he stretches the bow of the Vedas.' Under the shafts loosed by that warrior, one of the gates of the city, resembling the peak of Mount Ksilasha, fell shattered on the eatth, and beholding **RAMA**'s arrows falling on temples and mansions, those Indras among the titans made a supreme effort and, while they closed their ranks, they emitted leonine roars so that it appeared as if the Night of Final Dissolution was at hand. Then the leaders of the monkeys received orders from the magnanimous **SUGRIVA**, who said : " Enter the nearest gate and begin to fight, O Plavagas ! If any amongst you acts contrary to my orders, let him be slain I" Thereupon the monkey leaders bearing torches in their hands, took up their positions at the entrance of the city and, beholding them, Rsvana, transported with fury yawned and the ten regions were thrown into confusion so that it seemed as if Rudra were manifesting his wrath. In his rage he sent out Kumbha and Nikumbha, both born of **KUMBHAKARNA**, with innumerable titans and, at his command, Yupaksha, Shonitaksha, Prajanghs and Kampana set out with the two sons of Kumbhskarna. Then with the roar of a lion, Rsvana said to those valiant warriors: " Go forth immediately, O Titans ! " At his command, those brave titans, with their shining weapons, left Lanka emitting a continuous clamour and, with the splendour of their ornaments and persons they illumined the whole firmament as did the monkeys also with their torches. Then the light of the moon and stars and the brilliance of the two armies irradiated the heaven whilst the rays of the moon, their ornaments and the planets lit up the ranks of monkeys and titans on all sides and the light from the half-demolished mansions projected lurid

flames over the flowing and tumultuous waves. proper to the With their flap and pemllllts, their swords and excellent ues, their formidable cavalry, chariots and elephants, their innumerable hosts of infantry, their spears, maces, sabres, javelios, darts and shining bows, that terrible army of titans of redoubtable valour and ardour seemed to be furnished with flaming missiles and, amidat the clash of hundreds of gongs, their arms, encased in golden shcsths, were brandishing ues, and the javelins of the titans rang as they struck with their arrows and their great bows, whilst the ait was permeated with the fragrance of their garlands and the aroma of wine. Beholding that formidable army of titans that was not to be withstood, emitting the muttering of a great cloud, the Plavamgamas were agitated and, whilst their terrible opponents advanced towards them they let forth loud cries. Thereafter the enemy forces hurled themselves upon them like moths into a flame and, their maces whirling in their fevered hands, emitted lightning flashes which increased the exceeding splendour of that host of exceilent titans. Meanwhile, as if a ptey to intoxication, the monkeys rushed forward eager to fight, striking those rangers of the night with blows from trees, rocks and fiats, whilst they advanced on them loosing their sharp arrows. Then those titans of immense energy, cut off the heads of the monkeys who tore off their ears with their teeth and battered in their skuiis with their fists, crushing their limbs with stones as they moved about. Other rangers of the night, of grim aspect, struck the foremost of the monkeys here and there with their sharp swords and the slayer was slain in his turn, cursing and biting as they massacred each other. Then one cried ' Strike ! ' and was struck in his turn, whilst another called ' It is for me to deal the blow ' and yet others called in chorus ' Whv trouble thyself? Stay I ' Amidst the stained missiles, armour and shattered weapons, long spears were thrust forward and blows from fists, maces, sabres, javelios and ploughshares were

given. Then the en counter between monkeys and titans assumed terrifying propor tions and, in the conftict, the rangers of the night slew their enemies in tens of sevens and, in their turn, the army of titans, their raiment in clisotder, their armour and standards shattered, were assaulted and hemmed in on all sides by the monkeys.

CHAPTER 76

The Prowess of Angada and Kumbha: Kumbha is slain

AT the height of that appalling struggle in which so many valiant soldiers perished, **ANGADA** advanced on the heroic Kumhha ; and the impetuous Kampena, in anger, challenged **ANGADA** and, forestalling him, struck him a violent blow causing him to reel. Thereafter that warrior, coming to himself, hurled a rock on his adversary, who, crushed under the blow, fell to the ground. Seeing Kampana slain, Shonitaksha drove his chariot boldly at the monkey and, in his fury, struck him with his sharp and fiery arrows, tesring his fiesh ; then, like unto the Fire of Death, he loosed innumerable flaming Kshuras, Kshurapras, Narachas, Vatsadantas, Shilimukhas, Karnis, Shalyas and Vipathason him, and that valiant and energetic son of Bali, his limbs pierced, in his might, snapped the formidable bow of that titan and shattered his chariot with its shafts also. Thereupon Shonitaksha instantly took up his sword and shield and, without hesitation, sprang forward with an impetuous bound but the courageous **ANGADA**, receiving the violent impact, with a shout, broke that weapon with his hand. Thereafter that lion among mookeya, as if following the line of the sacred thread, let the blade fall on the titan’s shoulder, cutting it in two the Prince of Monkeys resembled the

full moon betweeD. two Vishakhas.Then Mainda and Dvivida went to **ANGADA**'s aid and stood on guard nesr him, whilst the titans nf immense stature, their bsttalions drswn up, full of vigour, threw them selves furiously on the monkeys with swords, arrrows and msces and the encounter between those Indrss among the monkeys, in the grip of those bulls of titans, was desperate, causing the hair to stand on end. In that fight, the former, seizing trees and stones, discharged them, but Prajangha, who was exceedingly powerful, broke them with his sword. Stones and trees fell thick and fast on his chariot but were all severed by the countless shafts of the mighty Yupaksha, while the trees that, on their side, were thrown by Dvivida and Mainda, were crushed and destroyed by Shonitaksha, who was full of ardour and courage. Thereafter the infuriated Prajangha, brandishing his great sword with which he severed the limbs of his adversaries, leapt on **ANGADA** and, seeing him close beside him, that Indrs among the monkeys, in his great strength struck him a violent blow with an Ashvakarna Tree and, with his fist, hit out at the arm holding the sword which fell at the impact. Beholding his sword lying on the earth, like unto an iron bar, that powerful titan raised his fist and, like unto lightning, brought it down with great force on the brow of the intrepid **ANGADA**, foremost among the monkeys, who reeled for an instant but, having regained his senses, that courageous son of Bali, boiling with rage, atruck Prajangha's hesd from his shoulders. Then Yupaksha, seeing his paternal uncle lying on the field, quickly alighted from his chariot, his eyes full of tears and, as his quiver was empty, drew his sword. Beholding Yupaksha rushing towards him thus, Dvivida, with a mighty blow, struck him on the bresst and, in his ire, ICized hold nf him with furce. Perceiving his valiant brother made captive, the exceedingly energetic Shonitaksha atruck Dvivida on the chest, and the blow caused the intrepid Dvivida to

stumble, but he clung to the mace that his rival sought once more to raise against him. Meanwhile Mainda joined Dvivida, and Shonitaksha and Yupaksha, burning with courage, engaged <-the two Plavagas in a terrible struggle. The mighty Dvivida tore the face of Shonitaksha with his nails and, dragging him to the ground, cruahed him, whilst Mainda, fired with wrath, pressed Yupaksha in his arms so that he fell lifeless on the earth. Then the army of those foremost among the titana, discouraged by the death of their leaders, turned and fled in order to rejoin the sons of Kumbhabrna ; and Kumbha, seeing those soldiers fleeing in all haste, rallied them and, perceiving those valiant warriors to have been cruelly used by the highly powerful monkeys, and their leaders being slain, Kumbha, full of ardour, began to execute difticult feats in the encounter. Taking up his bow, he, the foremost and most skilled of archers, let fly a series of arrows like unto venomous serpents able to pierce the limbs and, with his shafts and marvellous bow, shining with a great lustre he appeared like a second lndrs illumined by thee1fulgeoce of Airavata I Thereafter he stretched that bow up to his ear and struck Dvivida with a golden-hafted and plumed arrow and, as soon as it pierced that foremost of the Plavagas, who resembled the Trikuta Mountain, his legs stiffened and, trembling, he stumbled and fell. Mainda, however, beholding his brother succumb in that great combat, rushed towsrds his adversary with a huge rock and that hero hurled it at the titan, but Kumbha shattered it with five whetted abafts and, taking hold of another dart with a sharp point, resembling a poisonous snake, he struck the breast of Dvivida's elder brother with violence. Under the blow, Mainda, the General of the Monkeys, his cheat tom open, fell unconscious on the earth. Thereupon the fiery **ANGADA**, seeing his matemal uncles overcome despite their prowess, hurled himself on Kumbha who was stretching his bow and, as he

advanced, Kumbha pierced him with five whetted darts, then with a further three, and again with three spears, u if he were attacking an elephant. Thus **ANGADA** was struck by the mighty Kumbha with innumerable shafts but, though his limbs were pierced by a succession of penetrating darts, that were flaming and adomed with gold, yet he remained immoveable Seeing that leader of monkeys, Kumbha cut off his two eyelids with twin arrows, as one blinds an elephant with torches, so that the blood ftowed and his eyes were veiled ; thereupon **ANGADA**, with one hand protected his bloody lids and with the other seized hold of a Sala Tree that stood near and, proppiog it on his chest, he stripped that leafy tree of its branches, and, having bent it a little, discharged it in the fight in the sight of all the titans, and that Sala Tree, that resembled the banner of **INDRA**, appeared like unto Mount Mandara. Thereafter Kumbha cut that tree to pieces and pierced his adversary with seven pointed and murderous shafts so that **ANGADA** suddenly fell down, unconscious. Beholding the invincible **ANGADA** stretched on the ground, like unto the sea when its waters recede, the leaders of the monkeys carried the tidings to Raghava. Then **RAMA**, hearing that the son of Bali had fallen and been overcome in the course of a desperate struggle, issued his orders to the simian leaders who were led by **JAMBAVAN**. At **RAMA**'s command, those lions among the monkeys, full of rage, their eyes red with anger, rushed on Kumbha, who was stretching his bow, and 1lew to the aid of **ANGADA**. Then **JAMBAVAN**, Sushens and Vegadarshin, enraged, threw themselves on that warrior born of **KUMBHAKARNA**, and seeing them advance, the titan cut short the impetUous onalaught of those foremost of monkeys with a hail of arrows, as a rock obstructs the course of a torrent and, in the path sown with arrows, the intrepid monkeys were unable to discern anything, nor, as the sea cannot overstep its shores, were they able to pass. Beholding

the simian ranks overwhelmed by the rain of shafts, the King of the Monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, placing his nephew, **ANGADA**, behind him, fell upon the son of **KUMBHAKARNA** in the fight, as an impetUOus lion on an elephant who is wandering on the slopes of a mountain, and that powerful monkey tore up huge trees, Ashvabrnas and others of varying fragrance, in great numbers, which he hurled at his adversary. Then the illustrinus son of **KUMBHAKARNA**, with his sharp arrows, shattered that irresistible avalanche of trees that covered the whole sky and scattered those forest giants that shnne like Shataghnis. H7 Beholding the rain of missiles dispersed by Kumbba, the valiant Monarch of the Monkeys, full of glory and majesty, remained unmoved and, suddenly struck by an arrow, he seized hold of Kumbba's bow that was equal to **INDRA**'s and broke it, throwing tbat weapon on the ground with violence. Then, baving accomplished tbat incredible feat, he angrily addressed Kumbba, who resembled an elephant whose tusks are broken, and said: " O Elder Brother of Nikumbba, thy strength and prowess in loosing thine arrows are admirable as are thy tllial piety and courage and **RAVANA**'s also. O Thou who art equal to Prahlada or Bali or the Slayer of Vritra or Kuvera or **VARUNA**, thou alnne art like unto thy mighty Sire. Thou only, O Long-armed Warrior, armed with thy mace, the slayer of thy foes, cannot be overcome by the Gods any more than misfortune can over whelm him who is master of his senses ! Advance, O Most Intelligent Prince and wimess me in action I " On account of a boon, thy paternal uncle is able to with stand *Devas* and Danavas and, full of prowess, Kumbbakarna, in his turn, defied the Suras and *Asuras* ! With thy bow thou art equal to **INDRA** and in valour **RAVANA**'s peer I In the world thou art now the foremost of the titans in strength and power I Let all beings wimess the mighty and prodigious duel between ua to-day resembling the combat between Sbakra and Sbambaral By striking down

those valiant monkeys, who were possessed of extreme courage, thou hast accomplished a fest without equal and manifested thy skill in the use of weapons. O Hero, it is from fear of incurriog reprosch tbat I bave not slain thee, for thy great exploits bave wearied thee ; rest awhile therefore, reflecting on my prowess ! " Thus Battered by **SUGRIVA** with fair words, the ardour of tbat warrior was redoubled, as the sacred fire ftames up when butter is poured therein. Then Knmbba seized Sngriva in his two arms, whereupon, like two elephants intoxicated with ichor, those two, breathing heavily again and again, their limbs interlaced, crushed each other, wrestling, and from their moutba emitting Bames mingled with smoke. Under the trampling of their feet, the earth lllllllk and the waters of **VARUNA**'s abode, overflowed on every side. FiDally **SUGRIVA**, having thrown Kumbha down with violence, cast him into the salty waves, thus causing him to become acquainted with the depths of the ocean. NevertbelessKumbha rose again and leapt on **SUGRIVA**, with his fist delivering a furious blow like unto lightning upon his breast, and the armour of the monkey was shattered and blood gushed forth. That violent blow from the titan's list struck against the bones ofhis adversary and, from the impact, a ftame shot fortb resembling the fire that bursts from tbe Mountain Meru when struck by lightning. Thereafter **SUGRIVA**, that mighty lion among the monkeys, effulgent like the solar disc of a thousand rays, parrying the thrust, lifted up a fist resembling a thunderbolt and brought it down with force on his opponent's breast. At the impact, which shattered him, Kumbha, bereft of his senses, sank like a brazier, the brightness of which is extinguished. Under this blow of the fist, the titan suddenly fell down, like unto the Lohitanga of brilliant rays expelled from heaven by tbe force of destiny. And Kumbha falling, his chest crushed hy **SUGRIVA**, resembled the ftaming body of a meteor shooting from tbe sky !

Thereupon Kumbha being struck down in the fight by that Monarch of the Plavamgamas of formidable valour, the eartb with its mountains and forests trembled and a great fear seized the titans.

CHAPTER 77

The Fight between Nikumbha and Hanuman

Of his glance, and that warrior took hold of his brilliant and terrible mace as large as the peak of the Mahendra Mountain, like unto the Rod of Death, tbe support of the titans, which was festnoned with garlands, plated with gold and embellished with diamonds and coral. Brandishing that weapon of a splendour equal to **INDRA**'s standard, tbe fortunate Nikumbha, who was endowed with THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI cries. With his breast adorned with golden pieces, his arms encircled with bracelets, his charming earrings and graceful garlands, his jewels and his mace, Nikumbha shone like a cloud shot with lightning and charged with thunder to which the bow of Indta is added. The tip of his wespon shattered the con junction of the seven winds and that loud-voiced hero glowed like a smokeless llame, whereupon the firmament with the City of Vitapavati, the most lovely palaces of the Gandharvas, the clusters of stars and planets, the moon and great luminaries seemed to be spinning round with the whirling of Nikumbha's mace ! Unapproachable in ardour, Nikumbha was like unto the Fire at the destruction of the worlds, his mace and his ornaments the llames, his wrath the fuel, and, in their terror, neither titans nor monkeys dared to move. **HANUMAN**, however, baring his breast, stoOd fearlessly before him, and that titan, with arms as thick as iron bars which shone like the star of day, brought his wespon down on the breast of that

mighty one so that it broke into a hundred pieces like a meteor snddenly exploding in space. But the great monkey remained unmoved under the impact of that weapon like a mountain in an earthquake. Thus assailed by his adversary, **HANUMAN**, the foremost of the Plavagas, swinging his fist round with force and lifting it up, with a swift bound struck Nikumbha a violent blow on the chest so that his armour was shattered and blood shot forth like lightning from a cloud. The shock caused Nikumbha to stumble but, steadying himself, he seized hold of the energetic **HANUMAN**, whereupon a great cheeting broke out amongst the inhabitants of Lanka, witnessing that combat. Though lifted up in this wise by the titan, the mighty **HANUMAN** struck him a violent blow with his fist and, freeing himself from Nikumbba's grasp, leapt to the ground, thereafter, with a supreme effort, in his rage he struck him down, crushing him and then, leaping into the air, he fell heavily on his chest and taking hold of his neck, pressed it with his two hands while he cried out, whereupon he tore oft" his head which was of an appalling size. Amidst the shrieks emitted by Nikumbha, who had fallen UDder the blows of the son of Pavana, the armies of the son of :a,a Dasaratba and the son of that **INDRA** of the Titans, both filled with fury, entered into a desperate struggle. And Nikumbha beiDg slain, the Plavagas emitted cries of joy that re-echoed in all the quartets of the horizon and the earth seemed to tremble and the heavens crumble, whilst the hosts of the titans were lilled with terror.

CHAPTER 78

Maharaksha goes out to meet Rama and Lakshmana

mad with anger and grief, spoke with urgency to the son of Khara, the latge-eyed Mahsraksha, saying : " Go, O My Son, and, at my command, strike down Ragbava and **LAKSHMANA** with all the dwellers in the woods." On this behest, the son of Khara, Mahsraksha, who waa proud of his courage, answered : " It is wcU ! I shall obey thee I " Thereafter, having paid obeisance to **RAVANA** by circumambulating hito, that valiant warrior emerged from bis sumptuous abode. Then Khara's son addressed the commander of the army, who stood near, saying: " Let my chariot be brought hither immediately and aasemble the troops at the eatliest moment ! " On this, that night-ranger brought bis chariot and assembled the army, wbereupon Mahsraksha, having paid obeisance to the car and circunwnbulat it, caused it to be driven forward urging on his charioteer with the words : ' Drive on I '. Thereafter Mahsraksha issued this order to all the titans : " Do ye precede me, O Soldiers l As for myself, the magnani mous **RAVANA** has commanded me to slay those two brothers, **RAMA** and I.abbmana, in combat I Today I shall lay them low Hearing Maharaksha's words, the rangers of the night, furnished with all sorts of weapons, full of valour, closed their ranks. Able to change their shape at will, ferocious, endowed with sharp claws, their eyes inflamed, emitting the roar of elephants, causing the hair to stand on end, inspiring terror, those giants surrounded the huge son of Khara, shouting joyfully, shattering the vault of heaven. Then conches and drums sounded by thousands in all the quarters whilst they, leaping and clapping their hands, caused a great tumult. Thereafter Maharaksha's charioteer suddenly let the goad drop from his hand, and the standard fell to the ground, whilst the horses, harnessed to his chariot, slackened their pace and stumbled as they advanced, mournfully shedding tears, and, as the illusttious Mahataksha set forth, a sinister and biting dust storm arose. Nevertheless the titans, having wimessed those portents, set

out unheeding and full of courage to meet Rarna and **LAKSHMANA** and their hue was like unto herds of elephants or buffalo and they bore the marks of the blows from maces and swords received in the forefront of battle. " Here stand I I Here stand I! " cried those seasoned warriors beginning to range to and fro on the battlefield.

CHAPTER 79

Maharaksha falls under Rama's Blows

SEEING Maharaksha approach, the foremost among the monkeys rushed forward burning to fight. Thereupon a desperate sttuggle ensued between the rangers of the night and the Plavagas, like unto that combat formerly waged between *Devas* and Danavas, causing the hair to stand on end. Blows from ttees and swords, clashes of maces and iron bars were exchanged, whilst monkeys and night-rangers assailed each other and the titans created carnage among the foremost of the monkeys with swords, maces, lances, javelins, harpoons, goads and arrows, nets, hammers, sticks and other weapons with which they struck out on every side. Overwhelmed by a mass of missiles which the son of Khara hurled upon them, all the monkeys, distracted, fled full of terror and, seeing their enemies routed, the tirana emitted leonine roars and triumphant shouts, while the monkeys scattered in all directions. Theo **RAMA** awered the titana with a hail of arrows and, beholding them overpowered in this wise, Maharaksha, that ranger of the night, conaumed with the fire of his wrath, challenged **RAMA** in these WOtds, saying : " Stay ! It is with me, O **RAMA**, that thou shouldst measure thy strength I With whetted shafts loosed from my bow, I am aboutto relieve thee of thy life ! Since, in the Forest ofDandaka, thou didst slay my sire,

remembering thine iniquity, my wrath has increased ! O Wicked Raghava, a violeot fire conaumes my limbs since I failed to meet with thee in that grest forest ! By good fortune thou art now befote me ; as a hungry lion desires to see its ptey, so did I seek tbis encounter ! Soon shall my swift arrows despatch thee to the region of the dead where thou shalt rejoin the warriors thou hast slain ! Of what use are further words ? O **RAMA**, let all the worlds witness our combat ; let us fight with dsrts, maces, fists or whatever weapon thou preferest ! " Thus spoke Maharaksha and the son of Dasaratba, smiling, interrupted that flow of words, saying :-" O Titan, of what use is this prating ? It is in no wise worthy of thee ! On the battlefield one does not triumph by strength of WOtds but by fighting! Fourteen thousand titans and thy sire, Trishiras and Dushana himself, fell under my blows in the Dandska Forest I Today vultures, jackals and crows shall feed on thy flesh with their beaka, nails and claws, O Wretch!" Hearing these words of Raghava's, Maharaksha loosed innumerable shafts on him with great violence, but **RAMA**, with a shower of dsrts, severed those goldeo-hafted and richly bejewelled arrows again and again so that they fell in pieces on the earth. Thereafter, as they joined issue, a desperate struggle enaued between the son of the demon, Khara, and the son of **DASARATHA**, and the clanging of their bow-strings and the clash of their gauntlets was like the muttering of thunderclouds. Theo *Devas*, Danavas, Gandharvas, Kinneras and great Serpents stood in the sky eager to witnesa that prodigious conflict. Each WOUI1Ci inflicted on the combatantll redonbled their ardour as they exchanged blow for blow, and the countless shafts loosed by **RAMA** were destroyed by the titan whilst those of the titan were severed by **RAMA** again and again. Innumerable missiles covered all the regions and space illlelf and the earth was heaped on every side so that it could not be distinguished. Finally tbe

long-armed Raghava, enraged, broke the bow of his adversary and with eight Narachas wounded his charioteer ; with his shafts he demolished tbe chariot and slew the hones who fcll to the ground. Deprived of his car, Maharaksha, that prowler of tbe night, stood on the ground and, armed with his spear, he shone like Fire at tbe dissolution of the worlds ; and he was irresistible with his great lance, a gift from **SHIVA**, that glittered in tbe air like unto the weapon of destruction.' Beholding that great spear that emitted flames, the Gods, struck with tettor fled on all sides whilst that ranger of the night, lifting it up, hurled it with fury against the magnanimous Raghava. As it fcll flaming from the hand of the son of Khara, Raghava, with four arrows, severed it in itll flight and, broken at many poinlll, that spear with its celestial gilding, having been destroyed by **RAMA**'s shafts, fell to earth like a great meteor. Beholding that weapon shattered by **RAMA** of imperishable cxploitB, the Bhutas cried out in tbe sky :-" Well done! Well done! "and observing his spear to be broken, Maharaksha, that, ranger of the night, raising his fist, called out to Kakutstha, " Stay I Stay ! " Seeing him advancing, **RAMA**, the joy of the House of Raghu, smiling disdainfully, took the Fire-weapon from his quiver whereupon, struck by Kakutlltha's shaft, the titan, his heart transfixed, fell down and perished. Witnessing tbe fall of Maharakaha, all tbe titans, terrified of **RAMA**'s arrows, fled to Lanka. Thereafter the Gods rejoiced at the death of that night rauger, bom of Kbara, who had been stricken by the violent blows of Dasarathi and shattered like a mountain struck by lightning. CHAPTER So Indrajita sets out to fight once more HI!ARING of the death of Maharabha, **RAVANA**, hitherto victOri ous in war, became a prey to violent anger, grinding his teeth and, enraged, he rellected on what ought to be done. Having considered the mattet, in his wrath he sent his son, Indrajita, out to fight, saying : " Having triumphed over those two powetful brothers,

RAMA and Lakshmans, O Hero ! Visible or invisible, thou art superior in every way. Wett thou not victorious in the struggle with lndra of incomparable exploits, therefore why shouldst thou not succeed with these two mortals ? " At this command of the King of the Titans, Indrajita, in obedience, proceeded to the place of sacrifice to offer oblations to Pavaka according to the traditional rites. During the ceremony female titans carrying red turbans also came there and took part in sacrificing to the fire. Thereafter titans came up hurriedly to that place where Ravani was, and, in that sacrifice, weapons such as Sharapattas, Bibhitabs, with fuel, red robes and iron ladles were placed there, then, having heaped the fire with Sharapattas and Tomaras, lndrajita seized hold of a living black buck by the neck. And that smokeless bruier devoured the sacred grass, oblations and fuel, whereupon many auspicious omens, indicative of victory, appeared. With its dames, bright as the moon, whirling in a southerly direction, the fire, having been kindled, seized hold of the offerings. Thereafter, having offered oblations to **AGNI** and gratified the *Devas*, Danavas and Demons, Indrajita ascended his marvellous car which he had rendered invisible. In his magnificent vehicle harnessed to four horses, that hero, furnished with whetted shafts and artned with his great how, appeared resplendent. The chariot with its decorations of refined gold, carved with figures of gazelles, moons and crescents shone with beauty ; and lndrajita possessed a standard that, with its golden ringl and encrustations of emerald, glowed like a brazier.

CHAPTER 80

Indrajita sets out to fight once more

CHAPTER So Indrajita sets out to fight once more HI!ARING of the death of Maharabha, **RAVANA**, hitherto victOri ous in war, became a prey to violent anger, grinding his teeth and, enraged, he rellected on what ought to be done. Having considered the mattet, in his wrath he sent his son, Indrajita, out to fight, saying : " Having triumphed over those two powetful brothers, **RAMA** and Lakshmans, O Hero ! Visible or invisible, thou art superior in every way. Wett thou not victorious in the struggle with lndra of incomparable exploits, therefore why shouldst thou not succeed with these two mortals ? " At this command of the King of the Titans, Indrajita, in obedience, proceeded to the place of sacrifice to offer oblations to Pavaka according to the traditional rites. During the ceremony female titans carrying red turbans also came there and took part in sacrificing to the fire. Thereafter titans came up hurriedly to that place where Ravani was, and, in that sacrifice, weapons such as Sharapattas, Bibhitabs, with fuel, red robes and iron ladles were placed there, then, having heaped the fire with Sharapattas and Tomaras, lndrajita seized hold of a living black buck by the neck. And that smokeless bruier devoured the sacred grass, oblations and fuel, whereupon many auspicious omens, indicative of victory, appeared. With its dames, bright as the moon, whirling in a southerly direction, the fire, having been kindled, seized hold of the offerings. Thereafter, having offered oblations to **AGNI** and gratified the *Devas*, Danavas and Demons, Indrajita ascended his marvellous car which he had rendered invisible. In his magnificent vehicle harnessed to four horses, that hero, furnished with whetted shafts and artned with his great how, appeared resplendent. The chariot with its decorations of refined gold, carved with figures of gazelles, moons and crescents shone with beauty ; and lndrajita possessed a standard that, with its golden ringl and encrustations of emerald, glowed like a brazier. 235 Under the

protection of the Rod of **BRAHMA**, like unto the the mighty Ravani was invincible. Setting out from the city, having invoked **AGNI** and acquired the power to make himself invisible by the aid of sacred formulas lawful to titans, the triumpbant Indrajita spoke thus : " Today I shall slay those who have passed their exile in the forest in vain and, in combat, win a decisive victory for my Sire, **RAVANA**. Today, having destroyed **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, I shall enjoy the supreme felicity of ridding the earth of monkeys!" Having spoken thus, he made himself invisible and thereafter rushed furiously into the fray, whither **RAVANA** had despatched bim. Effulgent, with bow and shafts, that ardent adversaty of **INDRA**, beholding those two valiant heroes like unto a serpent with three heads, who were loosing a stream of arrows in the midst of the monkeys, reflected :-' These arc those I ' and stretching bis bow he covered tbose warriors with a shower of darts, as Parjanya lets loose bis rain. Standing in bis aerial car, invisible to the eye, he overwhelmed **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** with whetted shafts. Enveloped by those swift darts, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** placed celestial arrows on their bows and those valiant warriors covered the sky with a rain of missiles as bright as the sun, without striking lndrajita. Thereupon that powerful titan filled the sky with darkness and smoke, blotting out the cardinal points and shrouding himself in a dense fog; and, during bis airy flight, neither the twanging of bis bow-string nor the sound of the wheels nor the clartering of the horses' hoofs could be heard nor could he bimself be seen. In the midst of that fearful darkness, that long-armed warrior loosed a shower ofNarachas so that it appeared like an avalanche of rocks and, with bis golden shafts, bestowed on bim as a boon, the fUrious Ravani wounded **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** grievously in every limb. 'I'hc!eafter, those two princes, with the aid of innumerable sbaftB, sought to sever the mass of missiles in theirfiightthat burned them cruelly, and the two sons

of **DASARATHA** aimed their cxcellent ahafts in the direction whence those whetted darts fell. Ravani, however, a skilled driver, coursing on every side in his chariot, struck the two sons of **DASARATHA** with swift arrows and sharp sbaftB. Riddled by the golden-hafted arrows that rained upon them incessantly, the two sons of **DASARATHA** appeared like Kimshuka Trees in flower. None could follow the rapidity of the titan's course; none catch a glimpse of him nor his chariot nor his arrows so that he resembled the sun obscured by heavy cloud. Struck down, wounded and slain by him, the monkeys Jay stretched on the earth in hundreds, whereupon **LAKSHMANA**, enraged, addressed his brother, saying: " Shsll I loose the **BRAHMA** Weapon in order to exterminate all the titans ? " But Rams, who bore the marks of royalty, answered him: "Nay, it doth not behove thee to rid the earth of titans! No one may strike him who hss withdrawn from the fight, or who hss sought protection or has hidden himself or stands before thee with joined palms or who is fleeing or intoxicated I O Long-armed Hero, we will strive to slay lndrajita by employing those exceedingly fiery arrows resembling serpents. That magician, that insignificant titan with his invisible chariot will be overthrown by the monkey leaders should he reveal himself. Whether he penetrate heaven or hell or range the firmament, my sbaftB will consume him wheresoever he may take refuge and he will fall, deprived of life I " Having spoken these significant words, that hero of the House of Raghu, who was surrounded by the Plavagas, in his great might, reflected on how he should destroy that barbarian, the perpetrator of evil deeds. 237 Indrajita's Stratagem. **SITA**'s Apparition INDRAJITA, having divined tbe mighty Ragbava's intention, withdrew from tbe fight in order to re-enter tbe city. Thereafter, remembering tbe dcatb of tbose brave titans, his eyes red witb anger, tbe valiant Rsvani set forth once more, leaving by tbe western gate surrounded by titans ;

and tbc extremely energetic Indrajita, tbe descendant of PoulastyS, that tbom in tbe side of tbe Gods, seeing tbose warriors, tbe two brothers, Rsms and **LAKSHMANA** burning to fight, resorted to magic and caused tbe illusoty figure of **SITA** to appear in tbe chariot encircled by a large force and he made seeming preparations to slay her. For tbe purpose of deceiving tbe monkeys, that wretch conceived tbis design and, advancing to meet tbem, resolved to slay **SITA** as it were. Then tbe monkeys, beholding him approach ing, enraged, rushed upon him witb rocks in tbeir hands, burning to fight. At tbeir head marched **HANUMAN**, that elephant among monkeys, armed witb an enormous mountain peak. And he beheld in tbe chariot of Indrajita tbe unfortunate **SITA**, witb a aingle tress, sorrowful, her features wasted on account of fasting ; and tbe beloved of Rsghava wore only a soiled garment nor had she washed her countenance and tbe limbs of that lovely woman were covered witb dust and mud. Seeing Maithili, **HANUMAN** stood a moment as if stupefied, for, but a little while since, he bad beheld tbe daughter of **JANAKA** and, at tbe sight of that unfortunate being standing aorrowtiJlly in tbe car, under tbe sway of that **INDRA** of Titans, **HANUMAN** tbought to himself’ What does tbis titan intend to do ? ' Hsving reflected tbus, that great monkey, tbe foremost of tbe Plavagas, rushed forward to meet Rsvani. Beholding that simian army, tbe son of Rsvana, transported witb rage, drew his sword from its sheatb and brandished it over Sits’s head in tbeir presence, and he struck that woman in tbe chariot, who was created by illusion, whilst she cried out,

CHAPTER 81

Indrajita's Stratagem. Sita's Apparition

Indrajita's Stratagem. **SITA**'s Apparition INDRAJITA, having divined tbe mighty Ragbava's intention, withdrew from tbe fight in order to re-enter tbe city. Thereafter, remembering tbe dcatb of tbose brave titans, his eyes red witb anger, tbe valiant Rsvani set forth once more, leaving by tbe western gate surrounded by titans ; and tbc extremely energetic Indrajita, tbe descendant of PoulastyS, that tbom in tbe side of tbe Gods, seeing tbose warriors, tbe two brothers, Rsms and **LAKSHMANA** burning to fight, resorted to magic and caused tbe illusoty figure of **SITA** to appear in tbe chariot encircled by a large force and he made seeming preparations to slay her. For tbe purpose of deceiving tbe monkeys, that wretch conceived tbis design and, advancing to meet tbem, resolved to slay **SITA** as it were. Then tbe monkeys, beholding him approach ing, enraged, rushed upon him witb rocks in tbeir hands, burning to fight. At tbeir head marched **HANUMAN**, that elephant among monkeys, armed witb an enormous mountain peak. And he beheld in tbe chariot of Indrajita tbe unfortunate **SITA**, witb a aingle tress, sorrowful, her features wasted on account of fasting ; and tbe beloved of Rsghava wore only a soiled garment nor had she washed her countenance and tbe limbs of that lovely woman were covered witb dust and mud. Seeing Maithili, **HANUMAN** stood a moment as if stupefied, for, but a little while since, he bad beheld tbe daughter of **JANAKA** and, at tbe sight of that unfortunate being standing aorrowtiJlly in tbe car, under tbe sway of that **INDRA** of Titans, **HANUMAN** tbought to himself' What does tbis titan intend to do ? ' Hsving reflected tbus, that great monkey, tbe foremost of tbe Plavagas, rushed forward to meet Rsvani. Beholding that simian army, tbe son of Rsvana, transported witb rage, drew his sword from its sheatb and brandished it over Sits's head in tbeir presence, and he struck that woman in tbe chariot, who was created by illusion, whilst she cried out, " O **RAMA**, O **RAMA** I " Thea. **HANUMAN**, born of

Maruta, aeeing the titan seize her by her attire, became greatly alllictcd and tears of grief fell from his eyea as he beheld the cherished consort of **RAMA**, who was so divinely beautiful. Thereafter, in his anger, he addressed the son of the King of the Titans hsrshly, saying : " O Wretch, it is to thy destruction that thou hast laid hands on her hair ! O Offspring of a family of Brahmarishis, thou hast fiillea. into the womb of a female demon. Cursed art thou for thine infamous conduct in cherishing such a desire ! Cruel and ruthless scoundrel, vile and puerile warrior, art thou not ashamed to perpetrate such an infamous deed ? O Pitiless One, without a hesrt, what has Maithili done, as she is from her home, her kingdom and the arms of **RAMA**, that thou shouldst seek to slay her without mercy ? **SITA** being slain, thou shalt undoubtedly not survive long, sinee, deserving desth for such a crime, thou hast fiillen into my hands ! When thou hast yielded up thy life's brestb, thy fate will be the lowest hell to which the slayers of women descend and which is eschewed by the tnoSt infamous of evil...ctoers ! " Speaking thus, **HANUMAN**, atteoded by armed monkeys, hurled himself in fury on the son of that **INDRA** of Titans who opposed the powerful army of monkeys that surged towards him with his titans of redoubtable ferocity. And he himself assailed that simisn host with thousands of arrows and thereafter addressed **HANUMAN**, that monkey leader, saying: " I am about to slay Vaidehi before your eyea, who is the cause of **SUGRIVA**, thee and **RAMA**, coming hither ! She being slain, I shaJJ destroy **RAMA**, **LAKSHMANA**, thou thyself, O Monkey, and **SUGRIVA**, as also the vile Bibisbana. Thou hast said One must not slay a woman', O Plavagama, but assuredly one is justified in doing that which will injure a foe I " Speaking thus, with his sword furnished with a sharp blade, he strnck **SITA**, that illusory phantom, who was sobbing and, having slain her, Indrajita said to **HANUMAN** : " Behold how the beloved of **RAMA** has

fallen under my sword ! Vaidehi is dead, thine arduous undertaking has been in vaml" Having thus alaili her with his great sword, Indrajita, till1 of 33P joy, standing ln his chariot, began to shout aloud, and the mon keys, ranged before him at no great distance, heard him roaring full throatcdly, stationed ln his aerial citadel. Having slain the illusory Sits, the perfidious Ravani manifested great delight and, beholdiog him fully satisfied, the monkeys, a prey to despair, took to fiight. CHAPTER 8:z **HANUMAN** rallies his Furces: Indrajita's Sacrifoe HlwuNG that formidable clamour and beholding Ravani, whose voice resembled lndra's thunder, the monkeys immediately 8ed ln all directions. Then **HANUMAN**, born of Msruta, called to those who, with a downcast mien, sorrowful and fearful, were fleeing on all sides and said: " Why are you fleeing with a cheerless mien io all directions, O Plavamgamss ? Where is your courage ? Do not tum your back on the foe but follow me Into battle ! " At this reprimand from the virtuous son ofVayu, the monkeys, re-assured, armed with rocks and trees, advanced and, io a transport of fury, challenged the titans. Thereafter those lions among the monkeys encircled **HANUMAN** who accompanied them ln the great fight and, as the Consumer of Offerings burns up the east with his rays, so did **HANUMAN**, surrounded on alllides by the foremost of monkeys, consume the enemy host. Cresting carnage among the titans, that most powerful monkey, attended by the simian battalions, resembled Yams on the day of the final dissolution and, stnarting with grief and anger, **HANUMAN** hurled a hnge rock on Ravani's chariot. Seeing that missile descending, the driver, master of his horses, turned his car aside so that neither lndrajita nor the charioteer were struck by that rock which spllt the earth, burying itself after a fruitless flight. Then those Inhabitants of the woods, shouting, rushed oa the

CHAPTER 82

Hanuman rallies His Forces: Indrajita's Sacrifice

joy, standing ln his chariot, began to shout aloud, and the mon keys, ranged before him at no great distance, heard him roaring full throatcdly, stationed ln his aerial citadel. Having slain the illusory Sits, the perfidious Ravani manifested great delight and, beholdiog him fully satisfied, the monkeys, a prey to despair, took to fiight. CHAPTER 8:z **HANUMAN** rallies his Furces: Indrajita’s Sacrifoe HlwuNG that formidable clamour and beholding Ravani, whose voice resembled lndra’s thunder, the monkeys immediately 8ed ln all directions. Then **HANUMAN**, born of Msruta, called to those who, with a downcast mien, sorrowful and fearful, were fleeing on all sides and said: " Why are you fleeing with a cheerless mien io all directions, O Plavamgamss ? Where is your courage ? Do not tum your back on the foe but follow me Into battle ! " At this reprimand from the virtuous son ofVayu, the monkeys, re-assured, armed with rocks and trees, advanced and, io a transport of fury, challenged the titans. Thereafter those lions among the monkeys encircled **HANUMAN** who accompanied them ln the great fight and, as the Consumer of Offerings burns up the east with his rays, so did **HANUMAN**, surrounded on alllides by the foremost of monkeys, consume the enemy host. Cresting carnage among the titans, that most powerful monkey, attended by the simian battalions, resembled Yams on the day of the final dissolution and, stnarting with grief and anger, **HANUMAN** hurled a hnge rock on Ravani’s chariot. Seeing that missile descending, the driver, master of his horses, turned his car aside so that neither lndrajita nor the charioteer were struck by that rock which spllt the earth, burying itself after a fruitless flight. Then those Inhabitants of

the woods, shouting, rushed oa the mountain peaks so that Indrajira was covered by a fearful hail of rrees and srones by those Plavamgamas of redoutable valour. And tbey created havoc in tbe ranks of tbe enemy causing a great rumult and, under tbe ferocious blows of those terrible monkeys, tbe hideous rangers of tbe night fell, overwhelmed by uees on tbe battlefield. Beholding bis forces tbus roughly handled by tbe monkeys, lndrajira, enraged, surrounded by his divisions, advanced towards tbem loosing a quantity of arrows and that intrepid warrior struck down tbe furemost of tbe monkeys in great numbers. Furnished witb spears, rocks, swords, harpoons, picks and maces, tbe monkeys, on tbeir side, annihilated bis companions in tbe suuggle, and tbe exceedingly valiant **HANUMAN** made use of huge uunks and branches of uees, stones and rocks to exterminste tbose titans of terrible exploits. Having tbrown back tbe enemy forces, **HANUMAN** said bis uoops :-" We have acted in order to plesse **RAMA** at tbe risk of our lives but she, for whom we have fuughr, tbe daughter of **JANAKA**, is desd ! Having informed **RAMA** and **SUGRIVA** of tbis on our return, we will do whatever tbey command ". Thus spoke that monkey general and heroically calling in bis uoops, he returned slowly witb tbem. Meanwhile, seeing **HANUMAN** going to rejoin Raghava, tbe wicked Indrajira, desiring to offer oblations, went to tbe sacrificial altar of Nikumbhila and, resching that place, he invoked tbe God of Fire, Pavaka. Having entered tbe place of sacrifice at tbe instance oftbe titans, Indrajira began to pour on tbe libations, and tbe fire blazed up, consuming tbe oblations and blood, and **AGNI**, eft'ulgent, sparkling and satisfied, resembled tbe settiDg sun. Thereafter Indrajira poured libations on tbe eartb fur tbe prosperity of tbe titans, according to tbe rites in which he was well versed and, beholding this, tbe titans, instructed in what was fitting and UDfitting. stood round in gresr

numbers.

CHAPTER 83

Lakshmana's Speech

Objects may be seen and also those which are animate but the spiritual law is not manifest, else the virtuous such as thou would not suffer adversity I If unrighteousness brought evil in its train, then **RAVANA** would now be in hell and thou, who art virtuous, wouldst not be alllicted by ill-fortune. Meanwhile calamity spares the titan in order to strike thee down, which proves the consequences of righteousness and unrighteousness to be reversed ! If virtue produced good results and unrighteous ness evil ones, then those (*like **RAVANA***), who have forsaken virtue, would suffer evil consequences. Those who never take pleasure in ill-doing should not be robbed of felicity since their every delight is in doing good ; those who follow righteousness should pluck the fruits thereof. Since prosperity attends on those in whom unrighteousness abides and those, who make virtue their way of life, are afflicted, these words (*vice and virtue*) have no meaning ! O Raghsva, if the evil-doer perished through his own unrighteousness, unrighteousness itself would perish through its own evil and, it being destroyed, how could it destroy ? If it be through the decree of destiny that a man is slain or slays another, then it is destiny and not the slayer who is at fault. O Thou, Slayer of thy Foes, since one is unable to discern the law of *dharma* meting out retribution or behold its form and it is as if it were not, how is it possible to attain the highest by means of *dharma* ? If *dharma* truly existed, O King, O Most Virtuous of Men, then thou wouldst not have suffered this misfortone ; it is therefore manifest that this law is meaning

less I *Dharma*, being weak and powerless, attsches itself to the strong and, because of its weakness, rubs out any dift'erence between itself and vice, therefore, in mine opinion, one should disregard it. If unrighteousness is merely the result of strength, then abandon it since might is right. But if, as some hold, *dharma* is loyalty to one's \'tord, O Scourge of thy Foes, then thy sire is guilty of adharma in the duplicity and cruelty he meted out to thee without reason I If one accepts the existence of righteousness, then **INDRA**, the Bearer of the Thunderbolt, God of a Hundred Sacrifices, was not justified in performing a :143 sacrifice after slaying the Ascetic Vishvarupa. If righteoumeu gives birth to unrighteousness, it must perish, O Rsghsva I Men will act accordingly to their whim, O Kakutstha. In mine opinion, O beloved Rsghsva, *dharma* has indeed been destroyed ; thou hast severed its roots by abandoning thy kingdom ! Like streams from the mountains, all success is brought to birth by material prosperity. The man of small intelligence, without resources, sees all his deeds come to nought as trickles of water drying up in the hot season. Renouncing wealth when one is accustomed to the advantages in which one is reared, is an error of judgment and is setting out on the wrong path. He who has wealth has friends and kinsfolk ; he who has weslth is verily a man of importance ; he who has weslth is a wise man. The weslthy man is brave, the weslthy man is wise, the weslthy man is powerful, above all the wealthy man is a man of worth ! O Hero, I have pointed out the disadvantages that result from giving up one's good fortune, I see no reason for thy determins tion to abandon the crown. " He who possesses a fortune finds virtue, pleasure and prosperity to be at his disposal ; the poor man who seeks weslth, cannot artsin it and merely dreams of it. Weslth is the creator of joy, pleasure, pride, anger, and inner and outer control ; all these come from weslth, O Foremost of Men ! Prosperity eludes virtuous men and those

who pursue the path of duty in this world, nor can it be discerned any more tban the stars in a stormy sky ! Whilst, in accordance with thy sire's command, thou didst live in exile, O Hero, a titan bore away thy consort who is dearer to thee than life itself. " O Hero, by my valour I shall be able to dissipate this grest grief that Indrajita has caused thee to-day, O Raghava, arise therefore, rise up, O Uon among Men, O Long-armed Warrior, who art fil;ed in thy vows ! Dost thou not know that thou art the Self, the Highest "Self? " Here am I, O Irreproachable Hero, at thy command I The tidings of the death of the daughter of Janata enrages me I With my sbafts I shall overwhelm Lanka, its chariots, hones, titans and its king." CHAPTBK 84 WHILST I .aksbmana, iD fraternal affection, was consoling Rams, Bibisbana, who had been restoring order iD the ranks, came to that place. Four warriors, armed with various weapons, escorted him and they resembled heaps of black collyrium and were like unto the leaders of elephant hetds. Then that hero approaching, beheld Raghava plunged iD affliction, as also the monkeys themselves, whose eyes were full of tears, and he saw the great-souled Raghavs, the joy of the llshvaku Race, stunned with burniDg grief, whereupon Bibishana, his heart pierced with anguish, enquired :-" How is this ? " Then **LAKSHMANA**, seeiDg Bibishana, **SUGRIVA** and the monkeys, uttered these impetuous words : " lndrajita has alaiD **SITA** I Hearing these tidiDgs from **HANUMAN**'s lips, Raghava has been overwhelmed with despair, O My Friend ! " As Saumitri was still speaking, Bibisbana iDtetrupted him and addressed **RAMA**, whose miDd was agitated, iD words fraught with good sense, sayiDg : " O lndra among Men, that which thou hast heard spoken by **HANUMAN** with a sorrowful mien, seems to me as probable as the dryiDg up of the sea ! I am fully conversant with the wicked **RAVANA**'s design ; aBSuredly he would never permit **SITA** to be ill-trested, O Long-armed

Warrior I Though constantly pressed by me, who desired his welfare, to release Vaidehi, he would never listen to me. Neither by persuasion nor threats, concilia tion nor gifts nor by sowing dissensiDn, has anyone been able to behold **SITA**, how much less by force of arms ? It was in order to deceive the monkeys that lndrajita ser out to meet them again ; this seeming daughter of Jansb is the e1fect of illusiDn, O Long armed Warrior. " To-day lndrajita is going to the sacrificial ground of Nikumbhila to ofFer an oblation. Having performed the a

CHAPTER 84

Bibishana consoles Rama

CHAPTBK 84 WHILST I .aksbmana, iD fraternal affection, was consoling Rams, Bibisbana, who had been restoring order iD the ranks, came to that place. Four warriors, armed with various weapons, escorted him and they resembled heaps of black collyrium and were like unto the leaders of elephant hetds. Then that hero approaching, beheld Raghava plunged iD affliction, as also the monkeys themselves, whose eyes were full of tears, and he saw the great-souled Raghavs, the joy of the llshvaku Race, stunned with burniDg grief, whereupon Bibishana, his heart pierced with anguish, enquired :-" How is this ? " Then **LAKSHMANA**, seeiDg Bibishana, **SUGRIVA** and the monkeys, uttered these impetuous words : " lndrajita has alaiD **SITA** I Hearing these tidiDgs from **HANUMAN**'s lips, Raghava has been overwhelmed with despair, O My Friend ! " As Saumitri was still speaking, Bibisbana iDtetrupted him and addressed **RAMA**, whose miDd was agitated, iD words fraught with good sense, sayiDg : " O lndra among Men, that which thou hast heard spoken by **HANUMAN** with a sorrowful mien,

seems to me as probable as the dryiDg up of the sea ! I am fully conversant with the wicked **RAVANA**'s design ; aBSuredly he would never permit **SITA** to be ill-trested, O Long-armed Warrior I Though constantly pressed by me, who desired his welfare, to release Vaidehi, he would never listen to me. Neither by persuasion nor threats, concilia tion nor gifts nor by sowing dissensiDn, has anyone been able to behold **SITA**, how much less by force of arms ? It was in order to deceive the monkeys that lndrajita ser out to meet them again ; this seeming daughter of Jansb is the e1fect of illusiDn, O Long armed Warrior. " To-day lndrajita is going to the sacrificial ground of Nikumbhila to ofFer an oblation. Having performed the a sacrifice, on leaving, the son of **RAVANA** will be invincible in battle even to the Gods led by Vasava. It is he, in the role of a skilled magiciaD, who has made use of tbis illusion in order to undermine the conrage of the monkeys. Let us leave now with our forces ere he accomplishes his object. Shake off the distresa tbat has visited thee on tbis account, O Lion among Men ! The whole army is dispirited on beholding the grief tbat overwhelms thee. Come, pluck up courage, rise, call up thy valout and command **LAKSHMANA** to join with us and the troops which we command. " With his whetted shafts, tbat lion among men will compel Ravani to break off his sacrifice, after which he may be slain. Thy brother's sharp and penettating arrows, tbat fiy on wings and resemble hirds of prey, will drink his blood. O Long-armed Warrior, let I ,abhmana, who is endowed with auspicious marks, bear down on tbat titan in order to destroy him, as **INDRA** looses his thunderbolt. O Best of Men, it is not fittiug to defer the slsying of a foe ; now suffer **LAKSHMANA** to fall on tbine adversary speedily in order to slsy him, as Mahadevalooses his thunderbolt on the enemies of the Gods in order to exterminate tbem." CHAPTER 8S Lllkshmt.ma goes to tha Nikumbhila Gr11W ro fight lndrajita TH11S

did the titan speak, but Rsghava, who was overwhelmed with grief, did not fully comprehend what was said to him. Thereafter, having regained his strength, **RAMA**, the Conqueror of Hostile Citadels, answered Bibishana, who was seated at his side, saying : " O Bibishana, Prince of the Nairritu, I desire to hear once

CHAPTER 85

Lakshmana goes to the Nikumbhila Grove to fight Indrajita

Sacrifice, on leaving, the son of **RAVANA** will be invincible in battle even to the Gods led by Vasava. It is he, in the role of a skilled magiciaD, who has made use of tbis illusion in order to undermine the conrage of the monkeys. Let us leave now with our forces ere he accomplishes his object. Shake off the distresa tbat has visited thee on tbis account, O Lion among Men ! The whole army is dispirited on beholding the grief tbat overwhelms thee. Come, pluck up courage, rise, call up thy valout and command **LAKSHMANA** to join with us and the troops which we command. " With his whetted shafts, tbat lion among men will compel Ravani to break off his sacrifice, after which he may be slain. Thy brother’s sharp and penettating arrows, tbat fiy on wings and resemble hirds of prey, will drink his blood. O Long-armed Warrior, let I ,abhmana, who is endowed with auspicious marks, bear down on tbat titan in order to destroy him, as **INDRA** looses his thunderbolt. O Best of Men, it is not fittiug to defer the slsying of a foe ; now suffer **LAKSHMANA** to fall on tbine adversary speedily in order to slsy him, as Mahadevalooses his thunderbolt on the enemies of the Gods in order to exterminate tbem.” CHAPTER 8S Lllkshmt.ma goes to tha Nikumbhila

Gr11W ro fight lndrajita TH11S did the titan speak, but Rsghava, who was overwhelmed with grief, did not fully comprehend what was said to him. Thereafter, having regained his strength, **RAMA**, the Conqueror of Hostile Citadels, answered Bibishana, who was seated at his side, saying : " O Bibishana, Prince of the Nairritu, I desire to hear once out scrupulously; the divisions of the army are drawn up on all sides and the Jesders have each had their posts allotted to them. O Mighty Lotd, now hear what I have to impart filtther. " O Prince, beholding thee alllicted, we are discouraged ; ahandoo thy distress, that grief which conduces to the joy of the foe afar off I Take courage, O Hero, and destroy the rangers of the night ! May felicity be thine, since thou art to be re-united with Sits I O Joy of the House of Raghu, listen to my sage counsel ! Let Saumitri set out bravely at the head of a consider able force and converge on the Nikumbhila Grove, in order to slay Ravani in combat by the aid of arrows, resembling venomous snakes, loosed from his bow I " That warrior, on account of his asceticism received a marvellous boon, the Brahmasbira Weapon, from Swyambhu and also steeds that course at his will ; he has undoubtedly reached the Nikumbhila Grove with his forces I If he succeeds in carrying through the sscrifice, know that we are lost I " ' The foe who strikes thee ere thou hast reached the Nikumbhila Grove and ignited the fire, armed as thou art, will bring about thy death, O Enemy oflndra! ' Such were the wotds pronounced by the Lotd of the World and thus was the end of that crafty titsn ordained I O Rams, send thy powerful brother to slay Indrajits and, he being slain, **RAVANA** with his friends is also slain ! .. Bibishana having spoken thus, Rams answered him saying : " O Thou, whose prowess is truth, I know the magic power of that barbarian; his knowledge of the **BRAHMA** Weapon endows that skilful and great magician with immense power so that he is able to deprive the Gods and **VARUNA** himself of

consciousness in combat I While he ranges the sky in his chariot, O ruustrious Prince, one is no more able to follow his course than that of the sun in the midst of heavy cloud I " Then Raghava, who was conversant with the magic power of that crafty foe, said to Labhmana who shone with effulgence : " Go with the entire army of the Lotd of the Monkeys with its generals and **HANUMAN** at their head, O Labhmana ; take the army of the bears with their leader **JAMBAVAN**, and destroy the litsn possessed of the power of magic. This mssnanimoua night-ranger' will follow thee with his ministers in order that thou mayest fall upon that master of illusion." Hearing those words of Rsgbava, Lsksbmans of rPoubtsble courage, who was accompanied by Bibisbana, took up his rue bow, the foremost of all, and donning his mail, furnished with a sword and arrows, and full of joy, addtessed him thus : "To-day the arrows loosed from my bow, having pierced Ravani, will lay Lanka waste as herons ravage a lotus pool! This very day the shafts speeding from my bow will pierce the body of that batbarian ! " Having spoken thus to his brother, the illustrious l.akshmana, eager to slay Ravani, departed with all speed and, having paid obeisance to the feet of his elder brother and circumambulated him, he set out for the Nitumbhila Grove, the place of sacrifice, where Ravani was to be found. Followed by Bibishana, Prince l.akshmsna, burning with courage, with the good wishes of his brother, hastened a\\ay. Then **HANUMAN**, at the hesd of count less monkeys and Bibisbana wirh his counsellors speedily followed in his wake. Whilst the great hosts of monkeys threw themselves in his train, Lsksbmans beheld the forces of the King of the Bears stationed in the way. Thereafter **SUMITRA**'s son, the joy of his friends, having alresdy covered a great distance, observed the army of the King of the Titans ranged for battle and, bow in hand, that conqueror of his foes, the joy of the House of Raghu, coming upon that skilful magician, prepared to enter into combat

with him in conformity with Brahms's ordinance, and that prince, who was full of ardour, was accompanied by Bihishana, the valiant **ANGADA** and alao the son of Anita. Thereafter Lsksbmans, as one entering into darkness, pene trated into the ranks of the coundess enemy host that was exceedingly formidable, blazing with its glittering weapons and shaded by its dense rows of mighty chariots with their standards

CHAPTER 86

Indrajita breaks off his Sacrifice to fight with Lakshmana

advantageOUS to his undertaking but detrimental to his foes, saying: " Armed with rocks, throw thyself with thy monkeys on the army of the titan which is now visible and resembles a dart cloud. Seek to overthrow them, O Labhmana, for the son of that lndra of the Titans will become visible the instant the ranks are broken. With thine arrowa, that equallndra's thunderbolt, assail the enemy ; enter into the fray with all speed ere the sacrifice be completed. O Warrior, triumph over that perverse but skilled magician, the wicked Ravani of rutbleas ezploi!S, the terror of the worlds I " At tbeae words of Bibishana, **LAKSHMANA**, endowed with auspicious marts, let loose a rain of shafts on the son of the Lord of the Titans. Thereafter the bears and monkeys in a body, arming themselves with huge treea, rushed on the army of the titans which was drawn up in battle array and which, with sharp darts, swords, picks and spears hurled i!Self on the simian battBiions esger to overcome them. Thereupon a desperate struggle ensued between monkeys and titans and the city re-echoed with the mighty tumult. Missiles of every tind, whetted darts, trees and mountain peats sped

through the air in dresdful wise so that the sty was obscured and innumerable titans, possessed of monstrous arms and faces, hurled their weapons on the foremost of the monkeys, creating cmeme terror amongat them, whilst, from their side, the monkeys struck the titans with whole trees and craga, crushing them in the struggle. And the foremost of the bears and monkeys, of immense stature, created great terror among the titans with whom they fought. Learning that his army, over whelmed by their foes, was losing ground, the invincaDie Indrajita arose, the sacrificial rites as yet uncompleted and, leaving the Nikumbhila Grove, that was darkened by trees, RsVlllli, enraged, ascended his chariot that stood resdy harnesaed and 1\illy equipped ; with his bow and arrows, he was formidable and resembled a hesp of black collyrium, terrifYing to behold with his reddened eyes, like unto Mrityu the Destroyer. Beholding him standing in his chariot and the titan host ranged round about him, rushing to attack **LAKSHMANA** with fury, Hanumao, the scourge of his foes, who resembled a mountain, uprooted a huge tree, difficult to wield and, like unto Kala's consuming fire, that monkey, with repested blows, struck down the enemy on the battlefield where they lay insensible. Seeing the son of Pavaoa cresting confusion in the tanks, thousands of titans attacked him with spesrs, those besting lances with lances, those with swords with blows of their swords and those with harpoons with blows of harpoons. Iron bars, msces, sticks in their hundteds, Shatsghnis,' iron hammers, terrible axes, Bhindipslas, blows from their fists like unto lightning, slaps sounding like thunder, were all delivered at Hanumao, who like unto a mountain in stature, in his rage, crested a terrible carnsge. Then Indrajita beheld the foremost of the monkeys, the intrepid of Pavana, like unto a rock, destroying his adver asries and, addressing his charioteer, be said: " Drive towards that monkey ; he will certainly destroy all the titans if he is suffered to do so

I " At this commsnd, the driver set his course at Maruti and drove the invincible Indrajita, who was standing in the chariot, upon him. Then that redoubtable titan, drawing nesr, let fall arrows, blows from his sword, harpoons, spesrs and axes on the hesd of that monkey, so that those formidable missiles that fell upon him threw Maruti into a transport of rage and he said : " O Perverse Son of Rsvana, if thou hast any claim to valour, then light ; with thy two arms strive with me I O Insensate One, if thou dost withstand my might, thou shalt be accounted as the foremost of the titans I " " The Conqueror of Vasava, the son of **RAVANA**, standing in his car, is about to slay **HANUMAN**! O Saumitri, do thou slay Ravani with thy formidable arrows of incomparable workman ship, the destroyers of their foes, that put an end to their lives I " Hearing Bibishana's words, that magnanimous one, a veritable Bibishana, looked on Indrajita of dreadful prowess, who, standing in his chariot, wss invincible and resembled a mountain.

CHAPTER 87

Indrajita and Bibishana denounce each other

HAVING spoken thus, Bibishana, delighted, taking Saumitri, who bore his bow in his hand, hastened away. Proceeding some distance, they entered a great wood where Bibishana pointed out Iudrajita's place of sacrifice to Lakshmaus and the illustrious brother of **RAVANA** showed Saumitri a huge Nyagrodha Tree of fearful aspect, resembling a dark cloud, and said : " It is here that the powerful son of **RAVANA** offers up his victims and thereafter enters into combat. Becoming invisible to all creatureS, the titan overthrows his enemies in the fight, paralysing them with his excellent shafts. Do thou pierce the valiant son of **RAVANA**, his

chariot, steeds and charioteer with thy flaming darts ere he reaches the Nyagrodha Tree ! " " Be it so ! " replied the mighty Saumitri, the delight of his friends and, taking his stand, he drew his marvellous bow. Thereafter lndrajita, the powerful son of **RAVANA** appeared before them in his chariot, that shone like fire, clad in armour with his sword and banner. Burning with ardour, Lakshmaus challenged that invincible descendant of Poulastya, saying : " I challenge thee to combat I Let it be in fair fight I " Thus accosted, the brave and exceedingly energetic lndrajita, observing Bibishana, overwhelmed him with reproaches, saying: " O Thou, born and bred in this race, the brother of my sire, why dost thou seek to harm his son, O My Paternal Uncle, O Titan ? For thee, O Wretcll, tbere is neither tradition, brotherly feeling nor a sense of duty ! O Impious One, Thou art to be pitied ! O Perverse Being, thou art the object of reproach to the virtuous, thou wbo didst abandon thine own kind in order to seek service with the enemy. Is it not a want of intelligence in thee, that thou dost not discern the great difference between living with one’s kindred and seeking a miserable refuge with penalty thou hast merited for the banh reproaches thou hast made to me this day I From henceforth thou shalt not be able to approach the Nyagrodha Tree, O Vilest of the Titans ! Having outraged Kakutstha, thou canst not survive ! Enter into combat with this God amoug men I Fall on the field of battle and go to the abode of **YAMA** to the satisfaction of the Gods I Display thy prowess, exhaust thy weapons and missiles but if thou approachest within the range of Laksbmana’s shafts, thou and thine army shalt not rerum alive ! "

CHAPTER 88

The Combat between Lakshmana and Indrajita

fury. Standing in his richly decorated chariot, that was yoked to black steeds, his weapons and sword upraised, bearing his mighty, pliant and terrible bow and his arrows that were faral to the foe, he resembled the Destroyer, Death Himself. Then **LAKSHMANA** in all bis splendour appeared before that mighty archer standing in his car, decked with ornaments, the slsyer of his foes, the valiant son of Ravans, and, transponed with fury, Indrajita addressed Saumitri, who was seated on **HANUMAN**'s back and resembled the rising sun, and Bibishana also and the foremost of the monkeys, saying : " Do ye all behold my prowess I In an instant, a rain of snows speeding from mine irresistible bow will fall upon you in the fight like unto a shower of rain from the sky I Soon the shafts loosed from my great bow will scatter your limbs as the unconscious with your escort ; bast thou forgotten it ? Since thou desirest to measure thy strength with mine, I who in my fury resemble a venomous reptile, I deem thou art IUillious to enter the region of death ! " Hearing the taunts of Ravani, that lndra among the Titans, the son of Raghu replied indignandy : " It is not easy to succeed in those undertakings of wl:>ich thou dost boast and, in fact, he who accomplishes his end, alone is skilful ! O Thou whose situation is desperate, thou deemest to have attained thy purpose in this enterprise which is untenable from every aspect, merely by saying I have accomplished mine end ! O Insensate One, rendering thyself invisible on the field of battle is the procedure of a rogue; honest men do not practice it ! Since I am within the range of thy ahafts, O Titan, manifest thy prowess ; of what use is this bragging? " Thus addressed, Indrajita who ever victorious in combat, stretched his dread bow and with a powerful arm let fly his whetted shafts on his adversary. Discharged by him, those swift arrows resembling venomous snakes, struck **LAKSHMANA** hissing like serpents, and the imperuous son ofRavana, lndrajita, with those

arrows of extreme velocity, overwhelmed Saumitri, who wss endowed with auspicious marks, whereupon the fortunate **LAKSHMANA**, his limbs pierced by those darts, covered in blood, ahone like a smokeless flame I Meanwhile lndrajita, contemplating his feat, advanced, emitting an exceedingly loud cry and said : " O Saumitri, the feathered shafts loosed upon thee from my bow will rob thee of thy life, for their impact is mortal ! This very day, O **LAKSHMANA**, hands of jackals, eagles and vultures will descend upon thee when thou bast fallen unconscious under my blows ! **RAMA** of perverse soul will aee thee, his devoted brother, struck down by mine arm, thine armour ahattered, thy bow in pieces, thy head severed, thou who art a warrior by birth only I " To these insolent words of **RAVANA**'s son, the sagacious **LAKSHMANA** replied in measured and judicious terms, saying : " Cease from boasting, O Wretched Titan of crooked wsys, what purpose is served by vain speech ? DemDDstrste thy valour in action ; thou dost vaunt thine exploits ere thou hast accom pliahed them ! To what end, O Titan ? Act in such a wsy that a54 I may believe in thine utterances I Mark how, without addres sing a single word of contempt or provocation to thee and without bragging, I sball slay thee, O Last of Warrinrs I " Thus speaking, Lakshmama, with five Naracbas loosed with great force from his bow, wbicb he stretched up to his esr, struck the titan full in the breast and those feathered sbafts of swift ftight, resembling fiery serpeots, sbone in the breast of the Nairrita like the rsys of the sun. Struck by tbose darts, the son of **RAVANA**, enraged, in his turn, pierced Lakshmaoa with tbree well-aimed artoWS. Thereupon an appalling and fearful excbange of blows ensued between tbose lions among men and titans, who sought to triumph over eacb other. Valiant and endowed with strength, both courageous by nature, escb found it hard to overcome the other, neither having his equal in energy and prowess. Resembling two planets

coursing tbrough the heavens, those two heroes strove, so that tbey seemed like tbose two invincible warriors, Bala and Vritra, struggling proudly like two lions, standing immoveable as tbey showered innumerable darts on eacb other, and that King of Men and Prince of the Titans fought on with extreme ardour.

CHAPTER 89

Lakshmana and Indrajita continue to fight

MBANwmLE the son of **DASARATHA**, slayer of bis foes, arming himself with arrows, loosed them in fury on that Indrs of Titans and at that twanging of bis bow-string, the titan leader, his countenaJce asben, fixed his gaze on Lakshmaoa. Bibishana beholding the blenched features of the son of Ravena, said to Saumitri who was engaged in combat : " O Long-anned Warrior, I behold inauspicious signs round **RAVANA**'s son, hasten therefore for he is assuredly nearing his end!" Thereupon Saumitri, selecting some arrows resembling venomous snakes, let fly tbose barbed sbafts like unto czccedingly poisonous serpents on Indrsjita and he, struck by tbose missjJes lib unto thunderbolts hurled on bim by Ja""hmona, was dazed :ass THE RAMA Y AN A OF VALMI KI awhile, his senses stupefied. Thereafter, beholding tbe valiant son ofDasaratba standing in the field, he flung himself upon him, his eyes red with anger and, drawing ncar, he began to taunt him afresb, saying : " How is it tbat thou bast forgotten my prowess, when at the first encounter thou and thy brother were bound and laid low, thou wbo doat now seck to enter into combat with me anew ? In tbat great struggle under mine arrows resembling thunder bolts, both of you with your followers were first felled to tbe earth by me and then deprived of your

senses. " Mesccms it bas escaped thy memory I Since thou bast dared to cballenge me, it is clear thou desirest to enter the abode of Y ama I If, at tbe first assault thou didst fail to recognize my superior strength, I sball soon demonstrate it to thee ; stay therefore and face me with resolutinn I " Speaking thus, he picreed Laksbmana with seven arrows and **HANUMAN** with ten powerful whetted shafts ; thereafter with re-doubled fury, Indrajita pierced Bibisbana with a hundred well-aimed dsrts. Seeing this, the younger brother of Rams, unmoved, began to laugh, saying : " This is nothing I " and tbat lion among men, Laksbmana, undaunted, taking up some dreadful dsrts, hurled them in anger on Ravani in tbe fight, saying : " Nay, it is not thus armed tbat warriors enter the fray, O Night Ranger I Thy dsrts are trifling and without power, conducing to mine ease ; it is undoubtedly not in this wise tbat brave men fight I " With these words, he, from his bow, loosed a sbowcr of arrows on his adversary. Shattered by **LAKSHMANA**'s shafts, tbe hesvy golden armour of tbe titan fell to pieces on tbe floor of the For a long time these two valiant warriors tore each other with their sharp weapons and, in their unbridled energy, the two skilled combatants sought to overcome each other. Both riddled with a mass of arrows, their armour and standards shattered, they caused the hot blood to flow, as waterfillls let loose their torrents, and they let a dreadtid hail of missiles fty with a great clamour, like unto the dart destructive clouds of doom, loosing their ftoods from the sty. For a long time they fought thus without turning bact or experiencing any fatigue and those foremost of archers let fty their shafts again and again, and the multi-!lbaped darts crossed and re-crosaed each other in the air. With agility, speed and grace, the srruggle between man and titan continued with an appalling din and each, on his side, raised a tremendous clamour inspiring terror, like unto a fearful tempest and the sound of those two redoubtable

warriors in desperate combat resembled two clouds clashing in the sty. With golden-footed Narschas, those two warriors, sought to overcome one another, infticting wounds from which rivers of blood Bowed and from their piereed bodies the golden-hafted arrows, covered with blood, fell to the earth in which they buried themselves. By thousands their whetted shafts converged in the sty, cleaving and riving each other, and both let fall a formidable mass of darts in the struggle, so that they appeared lite heaps of Kusha Grass destined for two sacrificial fires. The bodies of thoseilluatrious heroes, full of wounda, shone like a Kimshuta or a Shalmali Tree, leaf-less and in full Bower in the forest; and the impact was appalling, as Indrajita and Labhmana fought, each desirous of overcoming the other. Latshmana battled with Ravani and Ravani with Latshmana, each striking the other without ceasing and the streams of arrows buried in their ftesh gave those two powerful warriors the appearsnce of two hills covered with trees, and their limba atreaming with blood, riddled with arrows, shone lite twci fires. Thus did they fight for a lcmg time without turning back in combat or giving way to exbaustion. Nevertheless, in order to allow the invincible Labhmana, ever in the forefront of the fight, to overcome the fatigue of combat, the magnmjmo1JI Bibishana threw bimaelf into the ftay remaining him to lend him bia aupport. 2.57

CHAPTER 90

Indrajita loses his Charioteer, Chariot and Horses

It is not fitting for me to slay my father’s son, but, laying aside all pity for Rams’s sake, I will put an end to my brother’s oft’spring ; yet thougb I desire to slay bim, tears fill mine eyes and deter me ; the long-armed

Laksbmana will best know how to subdue bim I O Monkeys, closing in upon him, place yourselves so thst you may wipe out those who stand near to bim." Thus incited by the exceedingly illustrious titan, the foremost of the monkeys demonstrated their delight by lashing their tails, and thereafter those tigers among the Plavamgamas, amidst repeated clapping of bands, emitted every kind of cry, like peaoocks on beholding the clouds. **JAMBAVAN** too was surrounded by bis leaders and their forces and they assailed the tiWll with their nails and teeth and blows from stones. Thereafter thst Lord of the Bears decimated the titans, who, banishing all fear, full of vigour, overwhelmed bim with oountless missiles such as darts, axes, shstp pikes, lances and spears, striking bim, their exterminator, in the fray. Thereupon a formidable conftict ensued between monkeys and titans, like unto the fearful contest between the Gods and the *Asuras* fired with wrath, and **HANUMAN**, enraged, broke off a mountain peak and baving caused Laksbmana to dismount, slew the titans in their thousands. Meanwhile after a fearful oombat with bis maternal uncle, the valiant lndtajita, slayer of bis foes, threw bimse1f aftesh on Laksbmana and a desperate duel arose between those two heroes amidst the general oonllict. Then those valiant warriors let loose a rsin of missiles with wbich they overwhelmed each other and, in the twinkling of an eye, they disappeared under a bail of arrows, as the glowing sun and the brigbmess of the moon under clouds at the end of summer. Their movements were so swift thst one was unable to perceive when they took up their bows or stretched them or changed bands or loosed their shafts or selected or separated them or when they closed their fists or took aim and launched a suecession of arrows with force, filling the sky on every side, nor was any object distinguishsble. Laksbmana struck Ravani and Ravsni, in bis turn, struck Laksbmana and a general confusion 359 arose between them during the COIIIbat.

Barbed ll!ld pointed shafts, loosed by those two warrioH, filled the space in the heavens as it were and those whetted darts, thst fell in hUDdreds, spread over the cardinal points ll!ld the intermediate regions, thst everything was engulfed in darkness ll!ld eztrcme terror took possession of all beings. Then the orb of a thousll!ld rays saDk behind the Asta Mountains enveloped in shadow, ll!ld torrents of blood flowed thst day ll!ld fearful beasts of prey emitted full-throated howls. " May good fortune befall the worlds ! " murmured the grest *Rishis*, whilst the Gandharvas with the Charanas, panic-stricken, lied away. Meanwhile Saumitri with four arrows pierced the four black steeds caparisoned in gold of thst **INDRA** among the Titans, and, with the aid of a sharp, yellow, shining and terrible Bha11a, furnished with beautiful plumes, resembling Mahendra's thunderbolt, resounding like the clang of a gaunder hurled with full force, thst mighty son of Raghu severed the head of the charioteer from his shouldm while he circled round. Thereupon, his charioteer slain, Mll!ldodari's valiant son seized the reins himself, taking up his bow ; and it was marvel lous to behold him driving his chariot as he fought. Yet while his hands were occupied with the steeds, his struck him with pointed darts and while he attended to his bow, the horses were pierced with arrows. Then lndrajita, even though his horses were riddled with darts, caused them to circle bravely under the arrows loosed by Saumitri with exceeding lightness of hand. Seeing his charioteer slain in the fight however, the son of **RAVANA** lost his zest for combat and grew anxious, and obaerv ing the titan's countenance change, the monkey lesdeH began to acclaim **LAKSHMANA** in the height of joy. Thereafter Prsmathin, Rabhasa, Sbal'llbha and Gondbamadana, eager to bring matters to a close, struck a mighty blow, and those foremost of monkeys, endowed with enrcme vigour and remarkable valour, with a rapid bound, threw themselves on the four

magnificent soeeda of Indrajita. Under the weight of those monkeys who resembled mountain, the horses threw np torrents of blood ll!ld thereafter, cruahed ll!ld mangled, fell lifeless on the earth. Having slain the * titan's steeds and shattered his chariot, the IDOilkeys, with a furthet bound, returned to Lakshtnana's side. Springing from his car, the horses having perished, and his charioteet being slain, Ravani caused a showet of darts to fall on Saumitri, whereupon, like unto Mahendra, Lakshtnans ovet whelmed Indrajita with shafts and he, fighting on foot, his excellent steeds being dead, loosed countless whetted and marvcllous darts on Saumitri in the fight.

CHAPTER 91

The Death of Indrajita

in their desire to triumph, those two archetS, armed with bows, hurled themselves against one anothet like two mighty elephants in the forest. Rushing this way and that, titans and monkeys slew each othet, not wishing to abandon their leadetS. At that moment, the son of **RAVANA** began to encourage the titans and praised and gladdened them by addressing them thus : " O Foremost of the Titans, a profound darkness reigns ovet all regions nor can we distinguish between ourselves and the enemy, therefore fight fearlessly in ordet to delude the IDOilkeys and I too shall return to entet into combat in anothet chariot ! O Brave Companions, do not suffer the IDOilkeys to triumph whilst I am in the city I " At these words, the son of **RAVANA**, slayet of his foes, eluding the vigilance of the dwelleta in the woods, re-enteted the City of Lanka, in ordet to provide himself with a fresh chariot ; and he caused a car embellished with magnificent gilding, furnished with javelins, swords

and arrows, harnessed to the most excellent of steeds and driven by a skilful and intelligent cbarioteet to be made ready, wheteaftet the illustrinus Ravani, victor in combat, asceoded it. Surrounded by the foremost of battalions, the a6I valiant son of **MANDODARI**, Indrajita, urged on by the force of destiny, left the city and, drawn by swift steeds, with exceeding courage he rushed on Lskshmana and Bibishana who accom panied him. Beholding the crafty son of **RAVANA**, mounted in a chariot, Saumitri, the intrepid monkeys and the Titan Bibishana were astonished ; Indrajita, however, struck down the foremost of the monkeys with fury. Under the clouds of arrows falling in hundreds and thousands, Ravani, victorious in combat, stretch ing his bow to a circle, slew the monkeys in his wrath, displaying his extreme skill, and the monkeys, overwhelmed by the Narachas of dreadful impetus, took refuge with Saumitri, as all beings with Prajapati. Thereupon, inilamed with martial ardour, that descendant of Raghu severed the bow of Indrajita, thus demon strating his fleetness of lw>.d but he, seizing hold of another, hastened to string it, yet Lsksmnana sbanered it also with three arrows and, having broken his weapons thus, Saumitri pierced Ravani's breast with five darts like unto venomous snakes. Then these shafts, leaving that great bow, having entered Indrajita's body, fell to the earth like huge red serpents. His weapon severed, vomiting blood, Ravani took hold of another powerful bow with its stout cord and, aiming at Lsksh mana, with extreme speed caused a shower of missiles to fall upon him, like unto Purandara letting loose his floods. Yet, irresistible as that hail of arrows, poured down by Indrajita was, Lskshmana, the Conqueror of his Foes, standing immoveable, repelled them. Thus did Ravani witness Lskshmana's marvellous prowess, he who was the intrepid and valiant son of Raghu. Thereafter Lskshmana, in fury, pierced each of those titans with three shafts in the fight,

manifesting the velocity of his arrows, and Indrajits, on his side, riddled him with a hail of shafts. Then that **INDRA** among the Titans, grievously wounded by his valiant adversary, the slayer of his foes, loosed a continuous shower of arrows on Lskshmana but, ere they reached him, they were seYered by the sharp spear of that warrior, the destroyer of his enemies, and Lskshmana, with a crescent-.haped arrow, cut off the head of Indrajita's charioteer in his czcellcDt -· while be was coursing here and there. a6a Deprived of their driver, the hones, without deviating from their course, continued to draw the cbariot, advancing and describing circles in a marvellous manner. Thereupon Saumitri, of fixed courage, unable to control his eger, let fly his shafts against the titan's steeds causing them to tske fright. Provoked by this action, the son of **RAVANA** struck the terrible Saumitri with his ten arrows and those shsfts, equal to lightning, that seemed composed of all the poisons, glanced off his golden armour. Seeing that his coat of mail was impenetrable, the son of **RAVANA**, Indrajita, in a transport of rage, manifesting his lightness of hand, struck Lakahmana in the forehead with thtee arrows of graceful joints, and that illustrious warrior, the joy of the House of Raghu, with thtee shsfts embedded in his forehead, shone in the forefront of battle like unto a triple mountain. Albeit thus smitten by the titan's arrows, Lakahmana, in his turn, instantly let fly five shsfts which struck Indrajita, who was adorned with lovely earrings, full in the face. Thereafter **LAKSHMANA** and Indrajita, warriors of exceeding prowess, armed with powerful and mighty bows, overwhelmed each other with sharp arrows. With their limbs streaming with blood, those two heroes, **LAKSHMANA** and Indrajita, at that instant shone on the field of battle like two Kimshuka Trees in flower and each hurling himself on the other desirous of victory, pierced his opponent's limbs with formidable arrows. Filled with martial ardour, the son of

RAVANA smote Bibishana's handsome countenance with three darts and, having pierced that **INDRA** of the Titans with thtee iron-tipped shsfts, he struck all the monkey leaders one after the other. Highly provoked, the exceedingly energetic Bibishana felled the horses of the wicked Ravani with a mace, whereupon the mighty Indrajita, springing down from his car, his horses slain and his charioteer dead, hurled a javelin on his paternal uncle. Beholding this, the enhancer of Sumitrs's delight, with his sharp arrow, severed it in ten pieces in its flight and it fell on the earth. Thereafter Bibishana, his mighty bow in his hand, let fly tive Marganas, the impact of which being equal to Jightniug, and struck Indrajita, whose horses bad been slain, in the breast. Having passed through his body, those golden-hafted arrows, a63 that flew straight to their target, were stained with blood ao that they resembled huge red serpents. Then, highly incensed against his paternal uncle, lndrajita, standing in the midst of the titans, selected a marvellous arrow of great power that he had received from **YAMA** and, seciug him place that formidable shaft on his bow, the valiant and intrepid **LAKSHMANA** took up one of immeasurable power whieh had been bestowed on him during sleep by the God Kuvera, and that weapon was irresistible, nor could the Gods nor the *Asuras* with their leaders stand before it. And those excellent bows, resembling maces, when stretched by their arms, entitted a piercing sound like unto two ospreys and the two powerful arrows notched on those wonderful bent bows lit up the faces of the two heroes with a vivid glow. Those barbed shafts loosed from the bows illumined the heavens, striking against eaeh other with a violent impact and the shock of those formidsble weapons as they strUck against eaeh other caused them to burst into llame, entitting sparks and smoke. Like unto two great planets colliding together, they fell shattered in a hundred pieces on the battlefidd. Seciug those weapons severed and broken in the

forefront of the battle, **LAKSHMANA** and lndrajita were seized with mortifica tion and fury and, in his anger, Saumitri armed himsdf with **VARUNA**'s shaft whilst Mahendra's conqueror, fighting on foot, let fly Rudra's weapon in the fight whieh shattered **VARUNA**'s dart, despite its immense potency. Thereafter, in his ire, the illustrious Indrajita, victorious in combat, as if about to destroy the worlds, took up the flaming Agneya Weapon but the valiant **LAKSHMANA** diverted it with the Solar Dart and, seeing his shaft thus balDed, Ravani, maddened with anger, seized hold of the *Asura* Weapon that was sharp and fatal to its foe. Then from his bow sped shining Kutamudgaras, spears, Bushundis, maces, swords and axes and, beholding that dire and dreadful weapon, irresistible to all beings, the destroyer of every missile, the illustrious **LAKSHMANA** arrested it with the aid of the Maheshwara Weapon. Thereupon a prodigious strUggle arose between the rivala, causiog the hair to stand on end and, from all sides, Beings, standing in the sky made a circle round **LAKSHMANA** and the 26.4 heavens were filled with a host of Beings overcome with astonish ment at the fearful tumult arising from that dread con11ict between monkeys and titans. *Rishis*, Pitris, Gandhatvas, Garudas and Uragas with Shatakratu at thdr head watched over **LAKSHMANA** during the fight and, in that instant, the younger brother of Raghava took up the foremost of shafts, the Avya Weapon of flaming impact, in order to tranSfix **RAVANA**'s son, and also the well-plumed and gilded dart, skilfully fashinned, to which the Celestial Host paid homage and with which Shakra, that mighty Lord of great energy, who is drawn by bay horses, formerly overcame the Danavas in the war between Gods and *Asuras*. That weapon of **INDRA**'s, undefeated in combat, fore most of shafts was placed by Saumitri on the most excellent of bows and the fortunate **LAKSHMANA**, in order to achieve his purpose, spoke to the presiding Deity of that weapon, thus : " If

RAMA, the son of **DASARATHA**, is truly virtuous and loyal and, in feats of heroism has no rival, then slay the son of **RAVANA** ! " Thus speaking, that warrior, the slayer of his foes, stretched his bow up to his ear and let fly an arrow united to lndra's weapon on Ravani in the fight, that was incapable of missing its target, and it severed the lovely head of lndrajita, graced with earrings and its casque, causing it to roll on the earth. Separated from the body, Indrajita's huge head, streaming with blood, resembled a golden ball thrown on the ground ; and the son of **RAVANA** fell dead on the battlefield with his armour, his helmet and his broken bow. Then all the monkeys with Bibishana, beholding the corpae, shouted in exultation, as the Gods rejoiced at the death of Vritra, and in the skies, the Bhutas, magnanimous *Rishis*, Gandharvas and Apaaras, on beholding the lesdcrs of the great titan army scattering on all sides, harassed by the victorious monkeys, emitted shouts of triumph. Hard pressed by the monkeys, the titans, flinging down thdr arms, hastily fled in disorder towards Lanka and, in the general stampede the titans, throwing away their weapons, lances, swords and axes, ran in all directions at once. Terror-stricken, harried by the monkeys, some re-entered Lanka, others threw themselves into the sea or took refuge on the mountain. Now that Indrajita lay desd on the battlelield, the titans fled away in a6s their thousands. As the sun withdraws behind the Asta Moun· tain and its rays disappear, so did the titans vanish from the horizon when Indrajita had fallen. As the solar orb with its rays extinguished or a fire without heat, so did that long-armed warrior lie bereft of life and the world, freed from her sufferings and delivered from her enemy, rejoiced ! And the blessed Shskra was exceedingly gratified at the death of that titan of evil deeds and the great *Rishis* also, whilst in the heavens, the Gods could be heard striking their gongs and the dancing Apsaras and the magnanimous Gandharvas caused a rain of

Bowers to fall that was marvellous to behold. On the death of that titan of cruel exploits, peace reigned, the waters became limpid, the air pure and *Devas* and Danavas rejoiced at the fall of one who was a source of terror to all the worlds. Thereafter a shout of triumph arose from the *Devas*, Gandharvas and Danavas who asid : " Now let the *Brahmins* go about their pursuits without anxiety, their sins removed ! , Then the monkey leaders, beholding that Bull among the Nairritas slain in battle, whose prowess was irresistible, paid homage to **LAKSHMANA** and Bibishana, **HANUMAN** and **JAMBAVAN**; and all the Plsvamgamas, growling and leaping with chattering of jaws, surrounded that descendant of Raghu, lsshing their tails and clspping their hands. ' Victory to Prince **LAKSHMANA** I ' rose the cry and, embracing each other, the monkeys, their hearts filled with joy, hymned the praises of **LAKSHMANA** in every way. Witnessing that diflicult feat of **LAKSHMANA**'s, he who was the delight of his friends and seeing the corpse of **INDRA**'s adversary, the Gods, highly gratified, experienced supreme delight.

CHAPTER 92

Rama commends Lakshmana who is cured of His Wounds by the Monkey Sushena

their thousands. As the sun withdraws behind the Asta Moun· tain and its rays disappear, so did the titans vanish from the horizon when Indrajita had fallen. As the solar orb with its rays extinguished or a fire without heat, so did that long-armed warrior lie bereft of life and the world, freed from her sufferings and delivered from her enemy, rejoiced ! And the blessed Shskra was exceedingly gratified at the death of that

titan of evil deeds and the great *Rishis* also, whilst in the heavens, the Gods could be heard striking their gongs and the dancing Apsaras and the magnanimous Gandharvas caused a rain of Bowers to fall that was marvellous to behold. On the death of that titan of cruel exploits, peace reigned, the waters became limpid, the air pure and *Devas* and Danavas rejoiced at the fall of one who was a source of terror to all the worlds. Thereafter a shout of triumph arose from the *Devas*, Gandharvas and Danavas who asid : " Now let the *Brahmins* go about their pursuits without anxiety, their sins removed ! , Then the monkey leaders, beholding that Bull among the Nairritas slain in battle, whose prowess was irresistible, paid homage to **LAKSHMANA** and Bibishana, **HANUMAN** and **JAMBAVAN**; and all the Plsvamgamas, growling and leaping with chattering of jaws, surrounded that descendant of Raghu, lsshing their tails and clspping their hands. ' Victory to Prince **LAKSHMANA** I ' rose the cry and, embracing each other, the monkeys, their hearts filled with joy, hymned the praises of **LAKSHMANA** in every way. Witnessing that diflicult feat of **LAKSHMANA**'s, he who was the delight of his friends and seeing the corpse of **INDRA**'s adversary, the Gods, highly gratified, experienced supreme delight. Taking with him Jambavm, **HANUMAN** and all the inhabitants of the woods, the vatiant and illustrious **LAKSHMANA** speedily rerurned to **SUGRIVA** and Ragbava, leaning on Bibisbana and **HANUMAN**. Thereafter, having circumambulated **RAMA** and paid obeisance to him, Saumitri stood beside his brother as Upendra by **INDRA**. Then that hero, Bibisbana, approaching with a look which itself was eloquent of delight, described Indrajita's fearful end and it was with joy that **RAMA** learned how the hesd of Ravani bad been severed by the great-souled **LAKSHMANA** and the tidings that Indrajita bad fallen under **LAKSHMANA**'s blows filled that valiant prince with unequalled felicity so that he cried out: " Well

done, O **LAKSHMANA**, this exceedingly difficult feat pleases me ! Ravani's desth means victory, be assured thereof! " Thereafter, smelling the head of Laksbmana, who bad increased his glory yet who was abashed, the mighty **RAMA** caused him to be seated on his lap and, with gentle strength, having clasped his brother, who was wounded, to his breast, he gaaed upon him tenderly again and again. Then **RAMA**, smelling his head once more, passed his band rapidly over his body and, in order to sooth him, aaid : " Thou bast accomplished an auspicious and highly momen tous feat, O Thou whose exploits ate beyond the power of others I Now that his son is slain, I deem **RAVANA** to be defeated. To-day the death of that perverse wretch confers victory over **RAVANA**, the Scourge of Men, upon me, be thou blessed, O Warrior I Thou hast severed the right arm of the King of the Titans on Having lavished comfon md caresses on his brother, the son of Raghu, **RAMA**, joyfully addressed Sushena, saying : " Do thou pluck out the arrows from the highly intelligent Saumitri, who is ever devoted to his frieuds, IDd restore him. Speedily hesl the wounds of Saumitri, .,.ho is attached to his friends, md do thou nurse back to health all those who received blows and wounds in the conl!ict, those bean IDd monkeys whose valiant battalions have as their weapons." At these words ofRama, the powerful monkey leader, Sushena, administered a sovereign remedy to Labhmana's nostrils and having inhaled it, that hero was at once liberated from his darts and wounds. Restoted to his normal state and freed from the arrows, his burning pains at an end, his fever suddenly allayed, Saumitri experienced supreme delight. Thereupon **RAMA**, the King of the Plavagas, Bibishana IDd the valiant Chief of the Bears with their forces, seeing Saumitri standing free from pain, rejoiced exceedingly. Then that supremely difficult exploit of Labhmana's was praised by Dasarathi of great soul, and, recollecting that the conqueror

of **INDRA** had fallen in the fight, the King of the Monkeys was filled with joy.

CHAPTER 93

Ravana's Grief on hearing of his Son's Death

" **O** Great King, Thine illustrious son has been slain by Labhmana, who was acoompanied by Bibishana ; we were witness thereof I That hero, confronted by a hero, messuted his strength with Labhmana's I Thy son, undefeated in any combat, he who triumphed over the Gods with lndra at their head, has gone to the Celestial Regions, having been overwhelmed by Labhmana's u..tls I " Hearing of the terrible, cruel IDd grievous end of his son on 268 the battlefield, that bull among the titans swooned away and only came to himself after a long time. Distracted with grief on account of his son's death, that unfortunate one, beside himself, burst into lamentation, crying: " O Thou, the Conqueror of lndra, how hsst thou suffered thyself to be overcome by Labhmsna this day ? In thy wrath, wast thou not able to strike down Kala and Antaka themselves with thy shafts, as also the peak of the Mandara Mountain ? How much more was it possible for thee to strike down Labh maua in the fight ? Hereafter the King of Death will be held in greater revereoce by me, since to-day he has brought thee under the sway of destiny, O Long-armed Warrior ! Even among the Celestial Host, this is the path trodden by those skilful warriors who wage a brave fight I He who is slain in the service of his lord goes to the heavenly regiona. Seeing Indrajita slain this day, the Gods and all the Guardians of the World, free from anxiety will sleep in peace! Now the Three Worlds and the entire earth with its woods appears deserted to me without the only lndrajita.

To-day I shall hear the cries of the youthful daughters of the Nairritas in the private apartments, like unto the roar of elephants in a mountain cave. O Hero, where hsst thou gone, relinquishing thy right to the throne, to Lanka, the titans, thy mother, myself and thy consorts ? Assuredly, I should have preceded thee to the abode of death so that I might have received those honours due to the departed, offered up by thee, but the contrary hss taken place, O Hero I Why do **SUGRIVA**, Labhmsna and Raghava still live and why hsst thou deserted me ere thou hadst rid me of this triple thom ? " Having first lamented thus, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans was overcome with a violent rage on account of the death of Indrajita and the grief at losing his son increased the fire of anger within him who was iraacible by nature, as in the summer montha the rays of the sun become more intenSe. From his half opened mouth, he seemed to breathe forth Oame and smoke in his rage, as Vritra formerly from his, and his eyes, naturally red, were further inOamed with ire, glowing in dreadful wise. Under the sway of anger, his aspect, ever a source of terror, caused him to resemble the enraged Rudra ! Tears fell from the eyes of that infUriated monater like boiling oll from two Oaming lamps. 269 Griruling his teeth, he made a IIOIIDd like unto the revolving of the rodwith which the Gods and Danavas churned the milky ocean. Mad with anger, like unto Antab eager to devour all beings animate or inanimate, he allowed his gaze to wander over the four quarterS of the horizon nor did any titan dare approach him, and in a transport of rage the King of the Titans, seated amidst his warriors, in order to excite their ardour, said : " Having practised penance for thousands of years and gratified Swyambhu on countless occasions, as the fruit of mine austerities, he accorded me complete immunity from *Devas* and *Asuras*. "**BRAHMA** bestowed a coat of mail, that glesmed like the sun, on me which, in my confticts with the Gods and *Asuras*, none of

my foes, though armed with thunderbolts, were able to shatter. To-day, clad in that armour and mounted on my chariot of war, who will dare to withstand me, be it Purandara himself? " The great bow with its arrows bestowed on me when I gratified Swyambhu, after an encounter with *Devas* and *Asuras*, that redoubtable bow will be drawn by me to the sound of countless musical instruments, in a mighty battle, to **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**'s destruction ! , Tonnented by the death of his son, the ferocious **RAVANA**, overpowered by anger, having refiected within himself, resolved to slay **SITA**. Rolling his reddened eyes, that cruel and terrible titan, in his anguish, said in the presence of all the Rangers of the Night, in plaintive tones : "My unfortunate son, in order to deceive the monkeys, having had recourse to msgic, showed them an illusory corpse, saying:-' This is **SITA** I' Verily it shall become a reality! I shall slay Vaidebi who is devoted to that evil wretch ! " Having spoken thus, he seized hold of a sword that was well tempered and bright as the stainless sky and rushed out in haste surrounded by his wives and counsellotS. **RAVANA**, whose heart was tom with grief on account of his son, taking up his sword, rushed out to find Maitbili and seeing the king setting out in a great rage, the titans emitted leonine roars and embracinlt each other, said :-"To-day we shall see those two brothers humbled I In his anger, **RAVANA** has overcome the four Guardians of the World and countless others have fallen under his blows; the Three Worlds have yielded up their tressure to him whose prowess and valour have no equal on esrth ! " As they were speaking thus, **RAVANA**, in a transport of rage, was rushing to where **SITA** was to be found in the Ashoka Grove, and, though his friends sought to restrain him, he ran on, as in the sky the planet Rahu bears down on Robini. The irreproachable Maithili, in the midst of the female titans who guarded her, beholding thst furious titan with a great sword, was seized with terror, and the dsughter of **JANAKA**,

SITA, seeing him continue to advance with thst weapon upraised, though his friends sought to restrain him, in the height of misery, wailing, uttered these words: “Beholding thst wicked wretch rushing upon me in fury, I, who am defenceless but who yet have a defender, fear thst he intends to slay me ! Despite my loyalty to my lord, he entreated me again and again, saying ' Be my consort ' and I constantly repulsed him. My refusal has assuredly caused him to give way to despair and, in a transport of futy, he is preparing to slay me. Or it may be thst those two tigers among men, those brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, have, on my account, been cut down to-day on the battlefield. I hear a great clashing of gongs and the exultant shouts of innumerable people rejoicing ! Woe is me, the two princes have died for me or else this titan of cruel intent has come to slay me on account of grief over his son or he has been unable to slay **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** ! Why did I not follow **HANUMAN**’s counsel, miserable creature thst I am ! If I had departed, seated on his back, I should now be resting happily in the lap of my lord. Assuredly **KAUSHALYA**’s heart will break when she learns thst her son has perished in the fight and, weeping, she will recollect the birth, cbildhood, youth, virtuous deeds and beauty of thst magnanimous hero. Overcome with despair, having offered up the obsequies in honour of her dead son, distracted with grief, she will ascend the funeral pyre or cast herself into the river. Cursed be thst wicked hunch-back Manthsra and her sinister counsels ; it is she who is the cause of the sufferings which will overwhelm **KAUSHALYA**.” a71 Hearing the llllf’ortunate Maitbili lamenting thus, she, who resembled Rohioi fallen under the swsy of Rshu in the absence of the Moon, a virtuous and honest counsellor, the sagacious Suparshws, seeking with his oompanions to restrain **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, said to him : “Why, O Dashagriva, dost thou, the younger brother of Vaishravana himself, seek

to put Vaidehi to desth in an access of rsge, disregatding the law ?Thou who an a student of the Veds, who hsst been purified by pious observances and who delightest in the scriptures, how art thou able to harbour the thought of slaying a woman ? O Valiant Monarch of the Titans, spare the besutiful. Maitbili and loose the vials of thy wrsth on that man, entering into oombst with him with our aid. This is the fourteenth dsy of the dark fortnight' and to-morrow, on the dsy of the new moon, march to victory surrounded by thy forces. Courageous, armed with thy sword, in thine excellent cbsriot, a mighty car-warrior, thou shalt cut down the terrible Dasarathi and take possession of Mithila's dsughter I " Thereupon the wicked and powerful **RAVANA**, giving esr to the judicious words of his devoted counsellor, returned to the palace and re-entered the assembly hall surrounded by his friends.

CHAPTER 94

Rama's Exploits

HAVING entered the council chamber, the unhappy king, the mighty **RAVANA**, overwhelmed by the desth of his son, sested on his throne, in the depth of a111iction, bresthing like an enraged lion, saluted the lesders of his army and addressed them saying: " Do ye set out at the head of cavalry with a oolumn of cbsriots, elephants and horses, with which you are abundantly supplied, and, in the fight, hurl yourselves upon Rams only, overwhelming him with a rsin of missiles, like clouds in the rsiny season. Thereafter when your shsrp darts hsve pierced his limbs in that great batde, to-morrow, I myself will put an end to **RAMA**'s life in the presence of all beings." On this command from their king, the titans set out in their swift-moving chariots followed by innumerable

hsttalions. Armed with maces, hsrpoons, swords, arrows and life-destroying axes, all those titans struck the monkeys, who countered them with blows from rocks and trees. Then, as the sun rose, a great and terrible struggle ensued between titans and monkeys, fesrful to behold and they struck each other with countless shining weapons, javelins, swords and axes in the fray and a prodigious dust storm, arising on account of the barde, was laid again by the rivers of blood from titans and monkeys. With elephants and chariots as the banks, javelins as the fish, standards as the trees, corpses as the ftoating logs, rivers of blood ftowed. Though soaked in gore, the valiant monkeys, leaping hither and thither in the fight, hscked the banners, armour, chariots, horses and weapons of every kind to pieces. With their shsrp teeth and nails the Plavamgamas tore the hsir, ears, foreheads and noses of their opponents. A hundred of the foremost of the monkeys leapt on every titan like birds on a felled tree and the titans, like unto hills, struek the redoubtable monkeys with heavy maces, javelins, scimitars and axes. Cut to pieces by their foes, the great army of monkeys sought shelter with **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**, the only true refuge. Then that exceedingly energetic hero, taking up his bow, penetrating into the ranks of the titans, overwhelmed them with a hail of darts, and when he entered their lines, like unto the sun entering the clouds, those formidable warriors, whom he was consuming with the fire of his shafts, were unable to discern him. And the titans, beholding the terrible exploits of that hero so disastrous to them, recognized their author to be **RAMA**, and as the passing of a hurricane through a forest becomes patent, so, when innumerable battalions were overthrown and great cars overturned, they perceived it to be his work. And they beheld their army decimated by arrows, battered and crushed by his shafts but, so rapid were his movements, that they could not see **RAMA** and they were no more able

to discern Raghsva than beings distinguish the soul that governs the senses. " There is the one who is exterminating our cohorts of elephants ! " " There is he, who with his sharp arrows is destroying cavalry and infantry ! " Speaking thus, the titans, taking each other to be **RAMA** in the fight, under this delusion, slew each other in anger, and they were not able to see the real **RAMA**, who, nevertheless, was destroying their army, for they had all been thrown into bewilderment by the exceedingly mighty, marvellous and powerful Gandharva Weapon ! And sometimes on that vast battlefield, thousands of Ramas appeared to the titsna and aometimes they could only see one ; and the bow of that hero seemed to them to be a myriad golden bows, whirling like a circling torch, while Raghava himself remained invisible I With his body the pivot, his strength the lustre, his arrows the spokes, his bow the felly, the twanging of the cord and the gauntlet the sound, the force of his intelligence its radiance, its splendour the impetus of his weapon, its circumference the circle traced by **RAMA**, while he was massacring the titans, he resembled the Wheel of Time in the eyes of all beings. And in the eighth pan of a day, **RAMA** with his ftaming arrows, single handed, exterminated the army of the titsna who were able to change their form at will, which comprised eighteen thousand great elephants, fourteen thousand cavalry and two hundred thousand iofantry. Exhausted, their horses slsin, their chariots shattered, their standards broken, those rangers of the night, who had escaped the carnage, took refuge in the City of Lanka. With the corpses of elephants, infantry and horses, the battle field resembled the ground where the mighty Rudra, enraged, disports himself. Then Devos, Gandharvas, Siddhas and Paramarishis cried out: " Well done I Well done I " lauding **RAMA**'s achievement. And the magnanimous Raghava said to **SUGRIVA** who stood near with **JAMBAVAN** and the fOremost of monkeys, Mainda and Dvivida: " The power to wield this terrible

weapon belougs to me and Having destroyed the army of the King of the TitanS, **RAMA**, the equal of the magnanimous Sbakra, who amidst darts and arrows transeeuded all fatigue, received the delighted homage of the Celestial Host.

CHAPTER 95

The Lamentations of the Titan Women

ALL those thousands of elephants and horses aod those mounted upon them with the myriad ebariots bright as fire and their flaming baoners, as also the innumerable titans who were full of valour, able to change their form at will, armed with maces and axes aod wonderful golden pennaots, fell under the fiery darts, decorated with fine gold, of **RAMA** of imperishable exploits. Beholding this and hearing those tidings, the rangers of the night, who bad escaped the carnage, were filled with terror and those wretched titaos were united in a common misfortune. The female titaos and those who bad lost their sons and kinsfolk, overwhelmed with a1Biction, assembled to wail and lament, crying : " How did Shurpaoakha, who was old, hideous and of aunken belly, dare to approach **RAMA** in the forest, he who was the equal of Kandarpa himself? Seeing tbat handsome youth, full of nobility, ever engaged in the welfare of all beings, tbat monstroua Rabhasi, who should bave been slain by others, was overpowered by lust. How could she, who was devoid of all good qualities, dare to make love to the all-powerful **RAMA** who is possessed of comely features and endowed with every virtue ? To the detriment of her own race, despite her grey bait and wrinkles, through a ridiculous infatuation condemned by all, tbat hideoua creature pursued Ragbava with her importunities to the destruction of the Titaos,

Dusbana and Khars. " It was on her account tbat Ravaoa committed thia oft'ence, the fats! bearing away of Sits, the daughter of Jaoab, and has provoked the emnity of the implacable and powertW Ragbava. " When the Demon Viradba sought to possess Vaidehi, he fell before her under **RAMA**'s blows ; thia aample ahould have a75 proved sufficient ! And fourteen thousand titBDS of terrible deeds were cut down in Janastbana by Rams's sbsfts resembling llaming torches, whilst, in the fight, Khara was also slain with Dusbana aud Trishiras by his dam that glittered like the sun ; this too should have beeo sufficient to prove his prowess ! " Kabaudha too, with his arms four miles in length, who lived on blood, was slain despite his fury and screams ; this too was a manifestation of Rams's might. He slew the powerful son of that God of a Thousand Eyes, the mighty Bali who was as dark as a cloud, this too proved his valour ! And **SUGRIVA**, who dwelt disconsolate on Rishyamukha, the vehicle of his hopes shattered, was restored to the throne by Rams, which was a further proof of his power. " All the titBDS counselled Rsvana to his advantage, and Bibishana, in accord with his duty, offered him good advice in reasonable words but, in his folly, that monarch disregarded them. If the younger brother of Dhanada had given ear to Bibishana, Lanks, which has now become a cemetery, would not have beeo laid waste. " When he learnt that the mighty **KUMBHAKARNA** had been slain by Rsghava aud that the invincible Atikaya had fallen under **LAKSHMANA**'s blows, as also Indrajita, his beloved son, still Rsvana remained blind to the truth I " ' My son, my brother, my lord has perished in the fight ' is the cry heard from the female titBDS in every family. Chariots, horses and elephants have been struck down in their thousands by the mighty Rams aud are lying here aud there with the foot soldiers whom he has also slain. He who is destroying us is Rudra or **VISHNU** or Mahendra or the God of a Hundred Sacri fices, in the form of

Rsma, unless he be the God of Death himself I We live bereft of hope; our warriors slain by Rsma; we see no end to our fears aud we lament the loss of our defenders. " On account of the great boona he has received, Dashagriva seems unaware of the appalling peril that faces him at the banda of Rams. Neither *Devas*, Gandharvas, Pisachas or Rskshasas will be able to rescue him when he falls into Rams's power. Each time Rsvana has entered the lists against Rams, inauspici ous omens have appeared foretelling his destruction I " When the Graudsire of the World was gratified with him, a76 he received immunity from *Devas*, Danavas and Rabhasas but he did not ask to be protected from msn. Here without doubt is one of those who will prove fats! to the titans and Ravans. " Oppressed by thst titsn, who was filled with arrogance on account of the boon he had obtsined through his severe penances, the Vibudhas took refuge with Brahms and, in order to be of service to them, the magnanimous Grandsire of the World uttered these memorable words : " ' From to-day the Danavas and Rabhasas shall not cease to wander through the Three Worlds harried by constsnt fear I ' " Meantime the Gods with **INDRA** at their head approached the Destroyer of Tripura, the God whose vehicle is the bull, who received them favourably and, being gratified, Mahsdeva said to them: " ' For your salvation, a womsn will be born who will bring about the destruction of the titans I This woman, whom the Gods will employ, as formerly hunger was used to wipe out the Dansvas, will be the destroyer of the titans and **RAVANA** .' By bearing **SITA** away in his perversity and misconduct, Ravans has dug a fearful abyss in which all will be engulfed! Who is there in the world who can rescue us ? We have fallen into Raghava's hands, who is the equal of Time, the Destroyer of the Worlds I "As elephants (*thst are*) trapped in a blazing forest, there is no refuge for us in this extreme peril ! The magnanimous Bibi ahana chose

the fitting moment to take refuge with him from whom he foreaaw the danger was to come." Thus did the consorts of those rangers of the night lament with piercing cries, in despair, plunged in grief and terror, their arms interlaced. CHAPTBR 96 Ratuma goer 01t to fight and mcountm ;u Ometu FROM evety dwclling in Lanka the piercing cries emitted by the female titans and their heart-rending lamentations reached **RAVANA**'s ears and, sighing for a long time, thst fierce-eyed IIIOJIBI"ch reflected awhile and thereafter fcl1 iu.to a great rage.

CHAPTER 96

Ravana goes out to fight and encounters ill Omens

he received immunity from *Devas*, Danavas and Rabhasas but he did not ask to be protected from msn. Here without doubt is one of those who will prove fats! to the titans and Ravans. " Oppressed by thst titsn, who was filled with arrogance on account of the boon he had obtsined through his severe penances, the Vibudhas took refuge with Brahms and, in order to be of service to them, the magnanimous Grandsire of the World uttered these memorable words : " ' From to-day the Danavas and Rabhasas shall not cease to wander through the Three Worlds harried by constsnt fear I ' " Meantime the Gods with **INDRA** at their head approached the Destroyer of Tripura, the God whose vehicle is the bull, who received them favourably and, being gratified, Mahsdeva said to them: " ' For your salvation, a womsn will be born who will bring about the destruction of the titans I This woman, whom the Gods will employ, as formerly hunger was used to wipe out the Dansvas, will be the destroyer of the titans and **RAVANA** .' By bearing **SITA** away in his perversity and misconduct, Ravans has dug a fearful abyss in which all

will be engulfed! Who is there in the world who can rescue us ? We have fallen into Raghava's hands, who is the equal of Time, the Destroyer of the Worlds I "As elephants (*thst are*) trapped in a blazing forest, there is no refuge for us in this extreme peril ! The magnanimous Bibi ahana chose the fitting moment to take refuge with him from whom he foreaaw the danger was to come." Thus did the consorts of those rangers of the night lament with piercing cries, in despair, plunged in grief and terror, their arms interlaced. CHAPTBR 96 Ratuma goer 01t to fight and mcountm ;u Ometu FROM evety dwclling in Lanka the piercing cries emitted by the female titans and their heart-rending lamentations reached **RAVANA**'s ears and, sighing for a long time, thst fierce-eyed IIIOJIBI"ch reflected awhile and thereafter fcl1 iu.to a great rage. Bitiag bis lips, his eyes red with qer so tbat the titans themselves were not able to endure hia aspect, he resembled the Fire of Dissolution itself. In a voice choking with fury, he iasued the following otders to the titans who stood ncar, con suming them with his glance, as it were, and said : " Do you summon Mahodara, Mahaparshwa and Virupsksha spccdily and let troops go forth into battle at my command." At these words, in accord with the king's command, the titanS, in fear, called the warriors together and those titans of formidable aspect unanimously cried:-" Let it be so I" and having per formed many bencdictory rites and psid obeisaocc to **RAVANA**, those mighty car-warriors all bowed down with joined palms to their master, whose victory they desired, and set out towards the battlefield. Then **RAVANA**, agitated with fury, with a sneering laugh, said : " To-day with my shafts, loosed from the bow resembling the sun at the end of the world-cycle, I sball send Raghava and **LAKSHMANA** to the abode of **YAMA** I By the death of our foes, I sball avenge Khara, **KUMBHAKARNA**, Prahasta and Indrajita this day! "Neither spscc nor the cardinal points nor heaven nor the seas

themselves will be visible under the cloud of shafts with which I sbaJl cover them. To-day with my bow I sbaJl cut the foremost of the monkey battalions to pieces with a succession of my plumed darts. To-day from the height of my chariot, swift as the wind, I sbaJl submerge the simian army under the rolling waves of mine arrows with the aid of my bow in the guise of the ocean. This day I sball be the elephant who tramples under bis feet those divisions resembling lakes, with open lotuses the faces, the glistening stamens the bodies I This day, with each arrow loosed in the battle, I sbaJl pierce the monkey forces in their hundreds, as they fight furiously with trees. By slaying mine adversary to-day, I sbaJl dry the tears of all those who have lost their brothers or whose sons have perished. To-day, pierced by my shafts, so large a number of monkeys will lie scattered here and there that, through my prowess one will not be able to discern the earth's surface I To-day the crows, vultures and beasts of prey will be sared by the flesh of the foe struck down by my darts. " Let my chariot be yoked with all speed and let my bow be brought immediately ; let those rangers of the Dight, who are still here, follow me into battle I " At this command, Mabapanhwa gave his orders to the army ministers, marched on, full of the ardour of combat and certain of victory. At his command Mabaparshwa, Mahodara and the indomitable Virupaksha ascended their chariots and these warriors, in their delight, emitted war cries loud enough to shattet the earth and, with formidable ahouts, they set out eaget for victory. The highly effulgent monarch, sutrounded by his valiant battalions, ruahed into battle, brandiahing his bow, like **YAMA** at the dissolution of the wotld, and that great wartier, mounted on his car harnessed to swift steeds set out through the gate whete **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** were encamped. At that moment the sun lost its brilliance, the quarters were enveloped in darkaess, the birds emitted dreadful cries, the earth

uembled, the Gods let fall a rain of blood and **RAVANA**'s horses stumbled, whilst a vulture alighted on the pole of his banner and sinister jackals howled. Then that titan felt his left eye twitch and tremors pass through his left arm ; he grew pale and his voice seemed to die away. As Dashagriva set forth to fight, ill omens appeared presaging his death ; a meteor fell from the sky with the crash of thunder and hetons and vultures emitted moumful cries. **RAVANA**, however, remained unmoved by the terrible ponents that appeared and ruahed madly to his doom, urged on by destiny. At the sound of the titan chariots, the *rakshasa* host and the monkey army also prepared to give battle and from every side, impatient for victory, challenged one another. Meanwhile, in his ire, Dashagriva with his golden shafts, created havoc among the monkeys and some among those heroic warriors had their heads severed by him and the beans of others were pierced or their ears cut off and some fell lifeless, the flanks of others being tom, their heads broken or their eyes put out. Whenever the ten-headed titan, rolliDg his eyes furiously, turned his chariot in the fight, the ferocity of his assault was irresistible to the leaders of his foes.

CHAPTER 97

The Fight between Virupaksha and Sugriva: Virupaksha's Death

gamas were as unable to endure that irresistible avalanche of darts looaed by **RAVANA**, as butterflies a scorching fire. Tormented by those sharp arrows, they fled screaming like elephants enveloped in ftsmes and **RAVANA** advanced in the fight scattering them with his darts as the wind disperses the clouds. Having, in his fury, exterminated those

inhabitants of the woods, that **INDRA** among the Titans rushed on to find Raghava. Then **SUGRIVA**, seeing the monkeys cut to pieces and routed, gave over his position to Sushena and addressed himself for battle. Relinquishing his command to that monkey, who was his equal in valour, **SUGRIVA** went out to meet the enemy, a tree in his hand. At his side and following in his footsteps marched all the monkey leaders brandishing enormous rocks and every kind of tree. Thereafter that royal giant let forth a great shout and fell on that mob of titans, destroying their leaders, and that mighty monarch crushed the titan divisions, as at the end of the world cycle the wind breaks down the great trees ; and he let fall a shower of stones on the titan divisions like a huge cloud letting loose hailstones amidst a flock of birds in a wood. Under the avalanche of stones loosed by the King of the Monkeys, the titans, their heads shorn of their ears, fell like crumbling mount ains, and whilst the titans were being overthoown by **SUGRIVA**, who was crushing them as they fell, they cried out. Then Virupaksha, armed with his bow, proclaiming his name, leapt down from his chariot and that indomitable titan mounted an elephant and, advancing thereon, and he, full of vigour, let forth a terrible cry and hurled himself on the monkeys. Thereafter he rained a shower of formidable darts on **SUGRIVA** in the forefront of battle and arrested the rout of the titans by reviving their courage. Riddled with wounda from the sharp arrows of the titans, that **INDRA** of Monkeys, howling with rage, resolved to slay him and, :all bzandishing a tree, that valiant and indomitable monkey leapt forward and strucll: the huge head of his adversary’s elephant, and under the virulence of that blow, the great tusker sank down emitting loud aies. Then the courageous titan jumped down from the bact of the stwllled beast and, turning on the monkey, threw himself upon him, but he, clad in msil covered with the hide of a bull, un shesthing his sword, with a rapid step,

rushed defiantly on **SUGRIVA** who stood fast, wsiting. Then **SUGRIVA** met the impact of Virupakshs and thereafter let fly a great rock lilte unto a cloud, whereupon that lion among the titans, seeing the stone falling, jumped aside and, full of valour, struct the monkey with his sword. Pierced by the valiant titan's sword, the monkey lay on the ground for a time deprived of consciousness, then, suddenly rising to his feet in the great struggle, he whirled his fist round and round, bringing it down violently on the titan's chest. Wounded by his blows, the night-ranger, enraged, with his sword severed **SUGRIVA**'s armour in the forefront of battle and, under the shock, he fell to his knees. Thereupon the monkey, picting himself up, gave the titan a terrific blow thst resounded lilte thunder, but Virupaksha evaded it skilfully and, with his fist, struct **SUGRIVA** on the chest. Thereafter the monkey king waxed even more furious and, seeing thst the titan had parried his thrust, sought an opportunity to attacll: him. In his rage, he struct him a violent blow on the temple lilte unto **INDRA**'s thunderbolt which felled him to the earth, and the blood flowed ftom his mouth covering him lilte

CHAPTER 98

Mahodara is slain by Sugriva

IN that fearful struggle, both armies gradually melted away under each others' blows like two lakes drying up under the summer heat. The destruction of his forces and the death of Virupaksha redoubled the fury of the Lotd of the Titans. Seeing his army decimated and destroyed by the monkeys, he recognized that destiny was opposing him and he became apprehensive. Thereafter he addtessed Mahodara, who stood near him, saying :-" From now on, O Long-armed Warrior, thou art my

only hope of victory I Go, triumph over the enemy forces ! Display thy heroism to-day ; the time has come to return the favours thy master has bestowed on thee ! Fight bravely ! " At these words, that foremost of titans, **MAHODARA** *replied*: " Be it so I " and rushed on the enemy's army as a butterfiy into a Oame. Then that exceedingly powerful titan, whose atdour had been stimulated by the wotds of his master and also on account of his own native valour, began to create carnage among the monkeys. From their side, the noble-hearted monkeys, arming them selves with enormous stones, penetrated into the ranks of the redoubtable titans and slew them all. And Mahodara, at the height of fury, with his golden shafts severed the hands, feet and thighs of the monkeys in the great struggle and they, after a hatd fight with the titans, fled to different quarters, some taking refuge with **SUGRIVA**. Witnessing the rout of his powerful army, **SUGRIVA** rushed upon Mahodara and the Lotd of the Monkeys, seizing a huge and formidable rock resembling a hill, threw it at him with great force, in order to crush him. Seeing the stone falling, Mahodara, unmoved, cut it to pieces with his arrows. Under the titan's darts, it fell in a thousand fragments on the earth so that it resembled a fiock of frightened vultures. Beholding that rock btoken, **SUGRIVA**, mad with anger, tore up a Sala Tree and flung it at his adversary, who btoke it into a83 many pieces. With his shafts, that hero, the scourge of his foes, broke the tree, whereupon **SUGRIVA**, observing an iron stoke lyiog on the ground, btandished the llash" ng bar before the eyes of the titan and, with one exceedingly violent blow, struck down his czcellent steeds. Leaping down from his great car, its tesm of horses having been slain, the valiant Mahodara, highly provoked, took hold of a mace and the two warriots, one armed with an iron bar and the other with a mace, approached each other, bellowing like bulls, resembling two clonds chatged with lightning. In fury, the night-ranger, his lustrous

mace glittering like the sun, rushed on **SUGRIVA** and, as the terrible club was falling upon him, the extremely valiant lesder of the monkeys, his eyes ted with anger, lifted up his wespon and sttuck, whereupon the bar instantly fell shattered to the earth. Then **SUGRIVA**, boiling with rage, from the ground picked up a hnge club gilded on all sides and, brandishing it, hurled it against the mace, striking it, wheteupon, on the impact, the two missiles broke in pieces and fell on the field. Their wespons shattered, the two warrints attacked each other with blows of their fists and, full of ardour and strength, re sembled two lit braziers. Amidst lond cries, they struck each other and, having interchanged blows, rolled on the earth. Leaping np immediately, the two pugilists, great champions, scourgers of their foes, emausted each other, whereupon each seized hold of a sword that lay within resch and, transported with rage, threw themselves upon each other, their weapons upraised. Then those two spirited and experienced warriors moved rapidly from left to right of one another, each seeking to slay his opponent. Meantime the courageous, impetuous and wicked Mahodara, proud of his strength, pierced **SUGRIVA**'s heavy mail with his sword whereupon the wespon snapped on the impact. Then that elephant among monkeys, with his own sword, severed the titan's hesd bearing a helmet and adorned with earrings. Beholding their lesder lyiog headless on the ground, the whole army of titans melted away and, having slain Mahodara, the monkey with his forces began to cheer, whereupon Dashagriva grew furious and Raghsva was filled with joy. 28.4 With downcast mien, the titans, overwhelmed, all fled away mad with terror, but the son of **SURYA**,having laid Mahodara low, who resembled part of a great mountain, shone with effulgence like that orb itself with its inextinguishable brilliance. And the hosts of the Gods, Siddhas, Yabhas and also the beings who move on the surface of the earth, gazed with

grest delight on the King of the Monkeys, who had achieved that supreme victory.

CHAPTER 99

The Combat between Angada and Mahaparshwa

MAHooARA having been struck down by **SUGRIVA**, the all-powerful Mahaparshwa gazed on his slayer, his eyes red with anger and, with his shafts, began to sow disorder in **ANGADA**'s formidable ranks ; and as the wind detaches a fruit from its stalk so did that titan sever the upper limbs of the lesding monkeys. With his darts, he cut off the arms of some and, full of ire, pierced the sides of others. Overwhelmed by those shafts, that Mahaparshwa loosed upon them, the monkeys pale with fright and lost courage. Then **ANGADA**, wishing to give a little respite to his ttoops, who had been trampled upon and decimared by that titan, lespt up full of fury like the ocean on the day of the full tide. Seizing an iron bar that shone like the rays of the sun, that Prince of the Monkeys struck MahapatShwa in the struggle and he, losing consciousness, fell from his chariot, its driver having been slain, and lay senseless on the earth. Thereupon the mighty King of the Bears who resembled a heap of black antimony and was extremely powerful, arming himself with a huge tock like unto the peak of a mountain, strode abesd of his battalion, which resembled a cloud, and with a furious blow struck down the horses and abattered the chariot of the titan. MabapatShws, however, regaining consciousness, lespt up in an instant and, in his great vigour, riddled **ANGADA** with THE RAMAYANA OP VALMIKI innumerable arrows again and again and struck **JAMBAVAN**, the JCiDg of the Bears with three spean fiill in the chest, wounding Gawksha with innumerable

shafts. Thereafter ADgada, who wss transported with rage, seized hold of an enormous stake and with that iron bar, bright as the rays of the sun, the son of Ball, his eyes red with anger, taking hold of it with both hands and brandishing it with force, with the intention of slaying him, hurled it on Mahsparshwa, who stood some distance off. Thrown with force, the bar knocked the bow with its arrows from the hand of the titan and struck off his helmet, whereupon **ANGADA**, with a single bound, seething with rage, struck the titan a blow with his clenched fist on the ear, which was adorned with an earring. Enraged, the valiant and illustrious Mahsparshwa seized hold of a great axe in one hand and with that stainless weapon wsshed in oil, made of solid stone, that titan, in a paroxysm of fury, struck his antagonist violently, but the blow, falling on the left shoulder, glanced off his armour. Then **ANGADA**, the equal of his sire in valour, furious, lifted up his fist which was as powerful as lightning and knowing the vital pans of the body, delivered a blow like unto **INDRA**'s thunderbolt on the chest of the titan, close to his heart. On this the titan, his heart riven by the shock, fell dead on that vast battlefield, and seeing him lying stretched on the eatth without life, his army took fright, whilst **RAVANA** fell into a transport of rage. Thereafter the monkeys with **ANGADA**, let forth a joyous roaring that resounded far and wide, shattering the gates and turrets of Lanka as it were. The Gods too with their king let forth a great shout and that enemy of **INDRA**, the Lord of the Titans, enraged on hearing the immense uproar among the inhabitants of the Celestial Regions and the forests, resolved to enter into the lists once more. :186 CHAPTER IOO BEHOLDING Mahodara and Mahapanhwa slain and, despite his great strength, the valiant Virupskshaalso struck down, a great rage seized **RAVANA**, who urged on his charioteet with these words: " By slaying **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** I shall remove that double scourge, the cause of the slaughter of my

faithful adhetents and the siege of the city. In the fight I shall cut down **RAMA**, that tree of which **SITA** is the 1lower and the fruit, whose btanches are **SUGRIVA**, **JAMBAVAN**, Kumuda, NaJa, also Dvivida, Mainda, **ANGADA**, Gandhamadana, **HANUMAN**, Sushena and all the leading monkeys." Thereupon that mighty car-warrior, who caused the ten regions to resound, drove rapidly on Raghsva with his chariot, and the earth, with its rivers, mountaius and woods, trembled with the uproar, and the lions, gazeUes and birds that inhabited it were seized with terror. Then **RAVANA** employed a dark and magic weapon that was formidable and terrifying and with it he consumed the monkeys, who lied hither and thither. Amidst the dust raised by their battalions, for they were unable to endure that weapon created by **BRAHMA** himself, Raghsva, seeing those countless divisions taking refuge in innumerable places, pursued by **RAVANA**'s powerful shafts, stood ready waiting. Meanwhile that Tiger among the Titans, having routed the army of monkeys, beheld **RAMA** standing there unconquered with his brother **LAKSHMANA**, like unto Vasava with **VISHNU**, and **RAMA** seemed to touch the sky as it were as he stretched his great bow and those heroes with eyea as large as lotus petals were long-armed and the conquerors of their foes. From his side the extremely illustrious and valiant **RAMA**, who was accompanied by Saumitri, seeing **RAVANA** overwhelming the monkeys in the fight, joyfully took hold of the centre of his bow and immediately began to bend that czcellent weapon that was stout and sonorous, riving the earth as it were. :a87

CHAPTER 100

Rama and Ravana fight with magic Weapons

CHAPTER IOO BEHOLDING Mahodara and Mahapanhwa slain and, despite his great strength, the valiant Virupskshaalso struck down, a great rage seized **RAVANA**, who urged on his charioteet with these words: " By slaying **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** I shall remove that double scourge, the cause of the slaughter of my faithful adhetents and the siege of the city. In the fight I shall cut down **RAMA**, that tree of which **SITA** is the 1lower and the fruit, whose btanches are **SUGRIVA**, **JAMBAVAN**, Kumuda, NaJa, also Dvivida, Mainda, **ANGADA**, Gandhamadana, **HANUMAN**, Sushena and all the leading monkeys." Thereupon that mighty car-warrior, who caused the ten regions to resound, drove rapidly on Raghsva with his chariot, and the earth, with its rivers, mountaius and woods, trembled with the uproar, and the lions, gazeUes and birds that inhabited it were seized with terror. Then **RAVANA** employed a dark and magic weapon that was formidable and terrifying and with it he consumed the monkeys, who lied hither and thither. Amidst the dust raised by their battalions, for they were unable to endure that weapon created by **BRAHMA** himself, Raghsva, seeing those countless divisions taking refuge in innumerable places, pursued by **RAVANA**'s powerful shafts, stood ready waiting. Meanwhile that Tiger among the Titans, having routed the army of monkeys, beheld **RAMA** standing there unconquered with his brother **LAKSHMANA**, like unto Vasava with **VISHNU**, and **RAMA** seemed to touch the sky as it were as he stretched his great bow and those heroes with eyea as large as lotus petals were long-armed and the conquerors of their foes. From his side the extremely illustrious and valiant **RAMA**, who was accompanied by Saumitri, seeing **RAVANA** overwhelming the monkeys in the fight, joyfully took hold of the centre of his bow and immediately began to bend that czcellent weapon that was stout and sonorous, riving the earth as it were. :a87 At the sound of **RAVANA**'s loosing a myriad arrows and **RAMA** stretching

his bow, the titans fell to the ground in their hundreds! Thereafter **RAVANA**, coming within a bow's length of the two princes, resembled Rahu in the presence of the sun and moon. Desiring to be the first to enter into combat, Lakshmsna with his sharp arrows, having placed them on his bow, loosed his shafts resembling Oames of fire. Hardly bad that archer let fty his dstts into the air than the extremely energetic **RAVANA** stsyed them in their course, severing one with one, three with three and ten with ten, thus demonstrating his lightness of band. Leaping over Saumitri, that triumphant warrior, **RAVANA** approacbed **RAMA** in the conftict, who StoOd ready like unto an unscalable mountsin. Bearing down on Ragbava, his eyes red with anget, the Lord of the Titsns loosed a rain of shafts upon him but, with the aid of his sharp arrows, Ragbava seveted those innumetable dstts that Oamed in formidable wise and resembled venomous snakes. Thereafter Ragbava struck **RAVANA** with redoubled blows and **RAVANA** struck Ragbava and they riddled eacb other with a hail of varied and penetrating missiles and, for a long time, described marvellous circles round each other from left to right, over whelming eacb other with swift arrows, escb remaining unde feated. And aU beings wete seized with terror witnessing that despetate duel between those two redoubtable bowmen, the equals of **YAMA** and Antska. The sky was coveted with clouds riven by lighming aashes and the firmament became, as it pierced with holes by a rain of whirling arrows of extreme velocity, poasesaing sharp points, adorned with heron's plumes. With their dstts, they first obscured the sky as when the sun withdraws behind the Astscbala Mountsins and two great clouds suddenly appear. Thereafter, between those two warrion, eacb seeking to slay the other, an incompanble and unimaginable struggle ensued like unto the duel between Vritra and Vasava. Both wete furnished with cxcel1ent bows, both wete skilled warrion, both brought exceptional

knowledge in the science of artns to the fight. In aU their manoeuvtings they were followed by a stream of shafts as the waves in two oceans that are whipped up by a tempest. Then, with a skilful hand, **RAVANA**, the Deatroyer of the Worlds, aiming at **RAMA**'s forehead, loosed a formidable succession of iron shafts from his bow, which **RAMA** received unmoved on his head like a garland of lotus leaves. Thereupon, reciting a sacred formula, arming himself with Rudra's weapon and choosing a large number of spears, full of wrath, the illustrious Raghava bent his bow and with force let fly those weapons in rapid succession against that lndra of Titans but those darts fell without breaking through the armour of **RAVANA**, who, like an immense cloud, remained unmoved. Then **RAMA**, skilled in the use of arms, struck **RAVANA** afresh on the forehead, as he stood in his chariot, with arrows to which he had joined a miraculous weapon, and it appeared aa if five· headed serpents in the form of darts were penetrating hissing into the earth repelled by **RAVANA** whom they sought to devour. Thereupon, having rendered Raghava's weapon void, **RAVANA**, in a transport of rage, armed himself in his turn with the dreadful *Asura* weapon which he loosed joined to sharp and terrible arrows with huge points, having the heads oflions, tigers, herons, geese, vultures, falcons, jackals and wolves or resembling serpents with five heads. Others had the heads of donkeys, boars, dogs, cocka, aquatic monsters and venomous reptiles and those sharp arrows were the creation of his magic power. Struck by the Asuric shafts, that lion among the Raghus, he who resembled the God of Fire himself, responded with the Agneya Dart that waa full of power and to it he joined arrows of every ltind with points that burnt like fire and which resembled suns, planets and stars in hue or great meteors like unto flaming tongues. Those for midable missiles belonging to **RAVANA** striking against those loosed by **RAMA**, disintegrated in space and were

annihilated in their thousands. Thereupon all the valiant monkeys with **SUGRIVA** at their head, able to change their form at will, beholding the titan's weapon destroyed by **RAMA** of imperishable *karma*, let forth joyous acclamations and made a circle round him. Then the magnanimous son of Daaaratha, the descendant of Raghu, having destroyed that weapon discharged by **RAVANA**'s own arm, waa filled with felicity, whilst the leaders of the mon· keys joyfully paid homage to him. 28p CHAPTER IOI Rartana j/tel from **RAMA** His weapon having been destroyed, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, whose fury was redonbled, in his wrath instandy produced another; and he loosed the fearful Rudia Weapon, forged by Maya, on Raghava. Thereafter, from his bow, innumersble speaiS, Inaces, flaming ban haid as diamond, mallets, hammers, chains and spiked clubs, like unto fiery thunderbolts, issued fOith like the tempests at the dissolution of the worlds. Then the glorious Raghava, most skilled in the knowledge of excellent shafts, that warrior of great renown, broke that weapon with the aid of the marvellous Gandharva Dart, and when it was shattered by the Inagnanimous Raghava, **RAVANA**, his eyes red with fury, loosed his Solar Weapon whereupon huge and brilliant discs issued from the bow of the skilful Dashagriva of redoubtable courage, which, falling, lit up the sky on every side and the four quarters were consumed by the fall of those flaming missiles that resembled the sun, moon and stsn. With a mass of arrows Raghava destroyed those discs and darts loosed by **RAVANA** in the fore-front of the battle and, seeing his weapon broken, Rsvana, the Lord of the Titans with ten arrows

CHAPTER 101

Ravana flees from Rama

CHAPTER IOI Rartana j/tel from **RAMA** His weapon having been destroyed, **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans, whose fury was redonbled, in his wrath instandy produced another; and he loosed the fearful Rudia Weapon, forged by Maya, on Raghava. Thereafter, from his bow, innumersble speaiS, Inaces, flaming ban haid as diamond, mallets, hammers, chains and spiked clubs, like unto fiery thunderbolts, issued fOith like the tempests at the dissolution of the worlds. Then the glorious Raghava, most skilled in the knowledge of excellent shafts, that warrior of great renown, broke that weapon with the aid of the marvellous Gandharva Dart, and when it was shattered by the Inagnanimous Raghava, **RAVANA**, his eyes red with fury, loosed his Solar Weapon whereupon huge and brilliant discs issued from the bow of the skilful Dashagriva of redoubtable courage, which, falling, lit up the sky on every side and the four quarters were consumed by the fall of those flaming missiles that resembled the sun, moon and stsn. With a mass of arrows Raghava destroyed those discs and darts loosed by **RAVANA** in the fore-front of the battle and, seeing his weapon broken, Rsvana, the Lord of the Titans with ten arrows live sharp severed the bow resembling the tnmlt of an elephant that belonged to the King of the Titans. Tbereafter Bibishana, bounding forward, with his mace slew **RAVANA**'s beautiful horses that were as tall as hills and reaembled a datk cloud in hue, whereupon Dashagriva, leaping quickly from his car, the steeds of which having been slain, was tilled with exceeding wrath against his brother and that powerful and spirited monarch loosed a flaming spear on Bibishana like unto a thunderbolt, but ere it reached its tatget, Labhmana severed it with three arrows, whereupon a great cheer arose amongst the monkeys in that formidable struggle, and that spear, wreathed in gold, fell down shattered in three fragments like unto a great meteor falling from the sky amidst a shower of flaming sparks. Then the

titan, that mighty **RAVANA** of wicked soul, armed himself wih another superior and tested spear which Death himself would have found hard to resist and which was of immense size and shone with its own cffulgence. Brandished with violence by the mighty **RAVANA** of perverse soul it gave out a lurid gleam so that it appeared like forked lightning. Meanwhile the valiant Labhmana, perceiving that Bibishsna stood in peril of his life, placed himself quickly in front of him and that hero, stretching his bow, with a rain of darts riddled **RAVANA**, who stood wsiting to discharge the weapon he held in his hand. Under the shower of with which the Saumitri overwhemed him, thus frustrating his design, the titan no louger thought of striking him in return. Seeing that he had preserved his brother's life, **RAVANA**, who was standing before him, addressed him thus : " O Thou whose strength renders thee arrogant, since thou hast preserved this titan, my spear shall tilll on thee ; having pierced thine heart, this bloodstained weapon that mine arm, equal to an iron bar, will hurl at thee will rob thee of thy life's breath and return to my hand." Thus did **RAVANA**, speak and in a puozysm of rage, levelling that pick adorned with eight extremely loud bells, creared magically by Mays, that was infallibie, the slayer of its foes, the splendour of which flamed up as it were, hurled it at Labhmana with a mighty shout. Loosed with terrible violence 391 and a sound of thunder, that spear fcll with force on **LAKSHMANA** in the forefront of the battle. Then Raghava sought to mitigate the power of that weapon and said: .. May good fortune attend **LAKSHMANA** ! May this mortal impact be rendered void I " Released by the eoraged titan on that indomitable hero, the spear which resembled a venomous Slllike, falling with exueme violence, penettated his great chest and so brilliant was it that it appeared like the tongue of the King of the Serpents. Loosed with force by **RAVANA**, that spear penetrated deep into the body of **LAKSHMANA**

who, with his heart pierced, fell on the earth. Beholding **LAKSHMANA** in that condition, near to whom he stood, the extremely powerful Raghava, full of solicitude for his brother,felt his heartstrickco. but after an instant’s rcllection,his eyes welling with tears, enraged as is Pavalta at the dissolution of the world, he thought-' This is not the time for lamentation ' and thereafter he entered once more into the fearful con11ict, resolved to make a supreme attempt to slay **RAVANA**. His eyes fixed on his brother, **RAMA** saw how he had been pierced with a spear in the great fight and was covered with blood, resembling a mountain with its reptiles. And the most vigorous of monkeys sought to draw out that weapon loosed by the mighty overwhelmed though they were by a hail of shafts discharged by the King of the TitanS ; the spear, however, having passed through Saumitti’s body had penetrated into the earth. Then **RAMA**, with his powerful hands seized hold of that spear and, in his wrath, snapped it, throwing the fragments to a great distance and, as he drew it out, **RAVANA** penetrated his every limb with his shafts that pierced to his very marrow. Ignoring these darts, **RAMA** embraced **LAKSHMANA** and said to **HANUMAN** and that mighty Monkey **SUGRIVA** : " Ye foremost of the mO!Ikeys, gather round **LAKSHMANA** I O King of the MO!Ikeys, the time has come for me to manifest my prowess ! For long I have sought this occaaion I May the wicked Dashagriva of infamou8 ezploits perish I My longiag resembles that of the Cbatak bird’ on beholding the douds at the end of summer. Ere Ions. I awear to thee either **RAVANA** or **RAMA** will cease to exist in the world I Ye shall be witness thereof ! The loss of the kingdom, my sojourn in the forest and my wanderings in the woods of Dandab, the insult offered to Vaidehi, my encounter with the titans, the great and terrible misfortune that has visited me, this torment resembling hell will be wiped out this dsy when I slay **RAVANA** on the battlefield ! He on whose

account I took the army of monkeys in my train, having installed **SUGRIVA**, when I had slain Bali in the open field, and on whose account I crossed the ocean, having thrown a bridge over it, that wretch to-day has come within my range of vision and shall therefore cease to live. Appearing before me, **RAVANA** cannot survive any more than one who comes into the presence of a serpent whose glance is poisonous or a snake falling under Vainateya's gaze. Be tranquil witnesses of my combat with **RAVANA**, O Invincible Ones, Foremost of the Monkeys ; seat yourselves on the brow of the mountain. To-day in this duel, the Three Worlds with the Gandharvas, the Siddhas and Charanas will recognize **RAMA**'s attributes I I shall accomplish a feat that the world with an beings who move or do not move, as also the Gods, will recount as long as the earth exists ! " Speaking thus **RAMA** began to discharge his penetrating shafts embellished with gold at Dashagriva. From his side, **RAVANA**, like a cloud from which the rain fiills, showered down arrows and clubs with violence on **RAMA**. And a mighty uproar arose when, in order to slay each other, those marvellous arrows were loosed by **RAMA** and **RAVANA**. Severed and scattered, the shafts with flaming points discharged by **RAMA** and **RAVANA** feU from the sky on the earth, and the twanging of their bows, causing great terror amongst an beings, was astonishing to hear. Then that amazing hail of missiles, that the mighty hero let fiy in continuous streams from his burning bow, overwhelmed **RAVANA** who, terrified, took to fiight like a great cloud driven before the tempest. 293 CHAPTER lO:Z **LAKSHMANA**'s rrUraculous Recuoery SEEING the courageous **LAKSHMANA** lying on the battlefield dlenched in blood, struck down by the spear discharged by the mighty Rsvaoa, **RAMA** enteled into a tettible duel with that cruel tillm whom he ovenvhclmed with a hail of amws. Then he addressed Sushena and said : " The valiant Laksb.mana, struck down by the

ruthless Rsvaoa, is writhing like a setpent, filling me with anguish ! When I behold that heto, dearet to me than life itself, how, in mine a1Biction, can I find the strength to fight? If my brothet, who is endowed with auspicious marks, that proud warrior, returns to the five clements, of what use is life or prosperity to me? My prowess is ebbing away as it wete and my bow seems to be !ling from my grasp ; mine amws are blunted, mine eyes blinded with tears, my limbs are heavy as when one is overcome by sleep, my thoughts wander and I long to die ! In this extreme misfortune in which I am plunged, weeping, my mind distracted on seeing my brothel, who is emitting insrticulate cries, lying in the dust of the battlefield, brought low by the wicked Rsvaoa, a prey to suffering and seriously wounded in his vital parts, even victory cannot bring me felicity, O Hero. If the moon is hidden from sight what delight can it give ? Of what use is it to fight ? What purpose is served by living ? The combat has no longer any meaning since **LAKSHMANA** is lying dead in the forefront of the battle. As that illustrious warrior followed me when I retired to the forest so will I follow him now to the abode of death. " Evet affectionate to his kinsfolk, he was undeviatingly devoted to me ; I was led to this pass by the titans who have made use of magic in the fight. Wives may be found everywhete and evetyWhere one may meet with friends but I see no place where one could find so dear a brother. Without I akshmana of what use will it be for me to rille over a kingdom, O Invincible Warrior ? What shall I aay to **SUMITRA** who loves her son so

CHAPTER 102

Lakshmana's miraculous Recovery

CHAPTER lO:Z **LAKSHMANA**'s rrUraculous Recuoery SEEING the courageous **LAKSHMANA** lying on the battlefield dlenched in blood, struck down by the spear discharged by the mighty Rsvaoa, **RAMA** enteled into a tettible duel with that cruel tillm whom he ovenvhclmed with a hail of amws. Then he addressed Sushena and said : " The valiant Laksb.mana, struck down by the ruthless Rsvaoa, is writhing like a setpent, filling me with anguish ! When I behold that heto, dearet to me than life itself, how, in mine a1Biction, can I find the strength to fight? If my brothet, who is endowed with auspicious marks, that proud warrior, returns to the five clements, of what use is life or prosperity to me? My prowess is ebbing away as it wete and my bow seems to be !ling from my grasp ; mine amws are blunted, mine eyes blinded with tears, my limbs are heavy as when one is overcome by sleep, my thoughts wander and I long to die ! In this extreme misfortune in which I am plunged, weeping, my mind distracted on seeing my brothel, who is emitting insrticulate cries, lying in the dust of the battlefield, brought low by the wicked Rsvaoa, a prey to suffering and seriously wounded in his vital parts, even victory cannot bring me felicity, O Hero. If the moon is hidden from sight what delight can it give ? Of what use is it to fight ? What purpose is served by living ? The combat has no longer any meaning since **LAKSHMANA** is lying dead in the forefront of the battle. As that illustrious warrior followed me when I retired to the forest so will I follow him now to the abode of death. " Evet affectionate to his kinsfolk, he was undeviatingly devoted to me ; I was led to this pass by the titans who have made use of magic in the fight. Wives may be found everywhete and evetyWhere one may meet with friends but I see no place where one could find so dear a brother. Without I akshmana of what use will it be for me to rille over a kingdom, O Invincible Warrior ? What shall I aay to **SUMITRA** who loves her son so 294 tenderly ? I shall

not be able to endure the reproaches with which she will address me. What shall I say to my mother Kausbalya or even to **KAIKEYI** ? What answet shall I give to **BHARATA** and the exceedingly powerful Sbattugbna ? Having gone with him to the forest, how can I rerum without him ? Better were it to die than suffer the censure of my family. What sin did I commit in a former life that my virtuous brother is now lying dead before mine eyes ? O My Brother, O Foremost of Men, O First of Heroes, O Prince, why, forsaking me, wilt thou repair to the other regions ? How comes it that thou dost not answer me who am lamenting ? Rise, look about thee, why dost thou remsin lying there ? Wimess my grief with thine own eyes ! In my despair, be my comforter, O Long-armed Warrior, overwhelmed as I am with anguish, wandering distracted amidst the woods and mountains." As **RAMA** was speaking thus, overwhelmed with a111iction, Sushena, in order to comfon him, addressed these well considered words to him : .. O Tiger among Men, abandon thi's idea that causes thee pain, this thought that pierces thine hean as a javelin in the forefront of the battle. Nay, **LAKSHMANA**, the enhancer of prosperity, bas not rejoined the five elements for his featurea have not changed nor is he pale, rather is his countenance serene and handsome ! Observe how the palms of his bands resemble the petals of a lotus and his eyes are bright. Those who appear thus have not yielded up their lives, O Lord of all Men ! Do not grieve O Hero, Conqueror of thy Foes, J.akshman Uves, and the proofs are the multiple beatings of his hean united with his sighs even though his body Ues stretched on the eanh." Thus spoke the extrcmely sagacious Sushena to Raghavs and thereafter he addressed that great monkey, **HANUMAN**, who stood near and said: " O Friend, go quickly, repair to the Mountain Mahodaya I Formerly thou bast heard of it from Jambavsn. O Warrior I On the southern peak grow curative herbs, the plants named

Visbalyakarani, Savamyakarani, Samjivakarani and abo Samd-but there he beame anxious, for that illustrious monkey could not recognize those remedial plants. Then the thought came to Maruti, whose strength was immeasurable, ' I will carry bsck the peak of the mountain for it is on the summit that the aus picious herbs are growing, at least I infer so from what Sushena has said. If I return without having picked the Vishalyakarani, the loss of time will prove fatal and a great misfortune will follow.' ReBecting thus, the mighty **HANUMAN** hastened on his way and when he reached that high mountain, he shook the summit three times and having broken it oft', bslanced it, with its multi tudinous trees in full Bower of varying frsgrance, in his two hands. Thereafter, like a dark cloud charged with tain, that monkey sprang into the air carrying the mountain peak and returned in grest haste serting it down and, having rested awhile, he said to Sushena: " I am not conversant with the medicinsl plants, O Bull among Monkeys, here ia the whole summit which I have brought to thee!, At these words of the son of Pavana, Sushena, the foremost of the monkeys, having uprooted the herb, took hold of it and there was grest amazement among the monkeys witnessing **HANUMAN**'s feat which even the Gods themselves could only have accom pUshed with diflkulty. Then the foremost of monkeys, Sushena, having crushed that herb, held it to **LAKSHMANA**'s nostrils and on inhaling it that prince, the scourge of his foes, who was riddled with arrows, instantly rose from the ground released from the dsrts and his sufl'erings. Meanwhile the monkeys beholding him standing Then pained, answered the magnanimous Raghava who had spoken thus 8lld, in a voice trembling with emotion, asid : " Bound by thy vow, O Thou who hast trUth for thy prowess, it does not become thee to utter such cowardly words ! Nay, those who speak with sincerity do not render a promise void and the proof they give is the fulfilment of their vow I

Thou shouldst not give way to despair on mine account, O Irre proachable Hero I Mayes! thou redeem thy word by **RAVANA**'s desth this dsy. Nay, when he comes within the range of thy shafts, thine adversaty must not return alive, as a great elephant may not live when he falls under the sharp tooth of a roaring lion. I desire to see that wretch perish ere the orb of the dsy withdraws behind the Astachala Mountain, his task accomplished. If thou seekest the desth of **RAVANA** on the battlefield, if thou wishest to fulfil thy duty and if thou dost aspire to re-capture the princess, O Illustrious Hero, do what I tell thee without delay." CHAPTER **RAMA** and RIJfJ/m4 rmefJJ their Combat HlwuNG **LAKSHMANA**'s words, the valisnt Raghava, the destroyer of hostile warriors, at the head of his forces, took up his bow and stretching it allowed a shower of his formidable shafts to fall on **RAVANA**. From his side, the Lord of the Titans, mounted on his chariot, rushed on Kakutstha, as Svarbhanu on Bhasbra ; and Dasha griva, standing in his car, aassiled **RAMA** with dsrts like unto lightniDg, as a great cloud covers a huge mountain with its lloods. Then **RAMA**, with his arrows that were decorated with gold and resembled Oaming brands, overwhelmed Dashagriva with them on the battlefield. On this the Gods, Gandharvas and **KINNERAS** *declared*: This combat is unequal, **RAMA** is on foot whilst the titan is in a chariot I ' whereupon the foremost of the Gods, the blessed Shakra, having heard the words of the Immortals, ealled Matali to him and llid :

CHAPTER 103

Rama and Ravana renew their Combat

Then pained, answered the magnanimous Raghava who had spoken thus 8lld, in a voice trembling with emotion, asid : " Bound by thy vow, O Thou who hast trUth for thy prowess, it does not become thee to utter such cowardly words ! Nay, those who speak with sincerity do not render a promise void and the proof they give is the fulfilment of their vow I Thou shouldst not give way to despair on mine account, O Irre proachable Hero I Mayes! thou redeem thy word by **RAVANA**'s desth this dsy. Nay, when he comes within the range of thy shafts, thine adversaty must not return alive, as a great elephant may not live when he falls under the sharp tooth of a roaring lion. I desire to see that wretch perish ere the orb of the dsy withdraws behind the Astachala Mountain, his task accomplished. If thou seekest the desth of **RAVANA** on the battlefield, if thou wishest to fulfil thy duty and if thou dost aspire to re-capture the princess, O Illustrious Hero, do what I tell thee without delay." CHAPTER **RAMA** and RIJfJ/m4 rmefJJ their Combat HlwuNG **LAKSHMANA**'s words, the valisnt Raghava, the destroyer of hostile warriors, at the head of his forces, took up his bow and stretching it allowed a shower of his formidable shafts to fall on **RAVANA**. From his side, the Lord of the Titans, mounted on his chariot, rushed on Kakutstha, as Svarbhanu on Bhasbra ; and Dasha griva, standing in his car, aassiled **RAMA** with dsrts like unto lightniDg, as a great cloud covers a huge mountain with its lloods. Then **RAMA**, with his arrows that were decorated with gold and resembled Oaming brands, overwhelmed Dashagriva with them on the battlefield. On this the Gods, Gandharvas and **KINNERAS** *declared*: This combat is unequal, **RAMA** is on foot whilst the titan is in a chariot I ' whereupon the foremost of the Gods, the blessed Shakra, having heard the words of the Immortals, ealled Matali to him and llid :-" With my chariot repair speedily to where the illustrious Ragbava is fighting on foot I Go to the battlefield

and invite bim to ascend this car; do thou render this signal service to the Gods I" On this command ftom his king, Matali, the celestial chariot eer, bowing, made answer, saying : " With all speed I go to fulfil my duty as a charioteer ! " Thereupon he harnessed the bay horses to the most handsome of can, the body of which being wrought with gold and hung with hundreds of little bells, with its emerald shafts shone like the rising sun, and it was yoked to excellent dappled steeds 1lecked with white, caparisoned in gold, their coats gleaming like the orb of day. A standard fiuttered on a golden staff over tbat marvellous car belonging to lndra and, under the order of the King of the Gods, Matali ascended it and, leaving the Celestial Regions, went to meet Kakutstba. Armed with a lash, standing in the car, Matali, the charioteer of tbat God of a Thousand Eyes, baYing paid obeisance to bim with joined palms, said to **RAMA** : " Sabaraksha,' O Kakutstba, O Renowned Destroyer of thy Foes, bas lent thee this car so tbat thou mayest be victorious ! Here too is lndra's great bow, his shield bright as fire, his arrows shining like the sun and his goodly spear well-burnished! Ascend the chariot, O Warrior, and with me as thy charioteer, triumph over the Titan **RAVANA**, as did Mahendra over the Danavas ! " Thus addressed, **RAMA** whose splendour illumines the worlds, circumambulated the car and, bowing, ascended it. Thereafter a wonderful combat of chariots ensued between the long-armed **RAMA** and the Titan **RAVANA**, causing the hair to stand on end. Raghava, skilled in the use of powerful arrows, fought with the King of the Titans, matching Gandharva Weapon against Gandharva Weapon and Celestial Arrow against Celestial Arrow. Then the royal night-ranger, in a paroxysm of fury let 1ly a formidable missile on his rival, marvelloua, dreadful, befitting a demon. Loosed from **RAVANA**'s bow, those shafts, decorated with gold, fillling on Kakutstba, were transformed into serpents **RAMA**, and those reptiles whose contact was

equal to Vasuki of iron coils and violent poison, enveloped all regions on every side filling the whole of space. Seeing those serpents falling on him in the fight, **RAMA** chose the dreadful and appalling **GARUDA** Weapon and discharged it. Leaving Raghava's bow, those golden-hafted arrows, brilliant as llames, transformed themselves into golden eagles, slayers of serpents, and all the darts in the form of snakes were destroyed by arrows in the shape of birds, that belooged to **RAMA**, who was able to change his form at will. Enraged at the destruction of his weapon, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, caused a shower of formidable shafts to fall on **RAMA** and while he was riddling **RAMA** of imperishable exploits with thousands of darts, he wounded Matali with countless others. Thereafter, having aimed at the golden standard, **RAVANA** shattered it with a single shaft and the golden device fell from the height of the chariot to the lloor. With a series of arrows he snuck lndra's steeds, to the exceeding terror of the Gods, Gandharvas, Charanas and also the Danavas and, seeing **RAMA** wounded, the Siddhas and great *Rishis* were troubled as also the King of the Monkeys and Bibishana. When the moon of **RAMA** was concealed from their sight by Rahu in the form of **RAVANA**, Budha, in the constellation of Prajapati, rushed on Rohini, the beloved of Shashin, to the misfortune of all beings. With its mist-wreathed waves, flaming as it were, the ocean, surging up in fury, seemed to touch the orb of day ; and the sun in the grasp of the Planet Dhumak etu assumed a brassy hue dreadful to behold, its rays extin guished, revealing a headless trunk on its disc ; Angaraka too was in opposition to the brilliant star of the Koshalas, the presiding Deities of which being lndra and **AGNI** ; and in the heavens, that planet tormented Vishaka also, and Dashagriva with his ten faces and twenty arms, equipped with his how, looked like the Mountain Mainaka. Meanwhile **RAMA**, overwhelmed by that ten-necked demon,

was unable to loose his arrows in the conJiict and, knitting his brows, enraged, his eyes inllamed, was ttansported with anger and it seemed as if he would consume the titan. On seeing the furious countenanCe of the virtunus **RAMA**, 299 all beings were seized with terrOr, the earth shook, the moun tains, frequented by lions and tigers, trembled, the swayed to and fro, the Ocean, that Lord of Rivers was agitated and flocks of crows, braying like donkeys, described circles in the sky on all sides. Beholding **RAMA** wrought up with extreme ire and those fearful portents, all beings were filled with fear and Ravena too felt dismayed. The Gods in their chariots, the Gandharvas, the great Serpents, the *Rishis*, the Danavas, Daityas and winged creatures of the air gazed down on that conflict between those two warriors, who fought with every kind of dreadful weapon, so that it appeared like the dissolution of the worlds. Suras and *Asuras* who had come to witness the struggle, with their eyes followed that formidable duel, uttering words of sympathy and encouragement and the assembled *Asuras* cried out to Dasha griva ' Victory to Thee ! ' and the Suras addressing Rams reiterated ' Triumph ! Triumph ! ' At that instant the wicked Ravena, in his fury against **RAMA** whom he wished to slay, took hold of an immense weapon that was as hard as diamond, deafening, the destroyer of its foe, furnished with spikes like unto mountain peaks, dreadful to conceive or behold, and **RAVANA** lifted up that lance with its smoke-wreathed flaming point, like unto the fires at the time of the final dissolution of the worlds, that was greatly to be feared, irresistible and which death itself could not endure, the terror of all beings, whom it was able to crush to fragments. At the height of anger, he raised his arm and, surrounded by his brave ttoops, brandishing his weapon, that colossus, his eyes red with fury, emitted a piercing cry in order to encourage his forces, and earth, sky and the four quaners trembled at that fearful shout of the King of the Titans. With his

stout arm, taking hold of that weapon he emitted a great cry and addressed his opponent insolently in these words : " This spear, as strong as a diamond, O **RAMA**, that I wield in my wrath, through my prowess will shortly rob thee and thy brother of your lives ! Thou shalt share the fate of my brave soldiers whom thou didst massacre in the forefront of the battle. Stay therefore that I may strike thee down with thit lance, O Raghsva ... At these words, the King of the Titans hurled his wespon at **RAMA**, and loosed by **RAVANA**'s band, that lance wreathed in lightning, deafening with its eight bells, passed through the air with a blinding Oasb. Seeing that flaming spear, formidable to behold, **RAMA** stretcbed his bow and discbarged an arrow with force, but as the spear fell, Raghava loosed a mass of arrows to intercept it, so that he appeated like Vasava with his floods seeking to stay the encroachment of the fires at the end of the world period. As butterflies are consumed by Oames, so were those shafts con sumed by **RAVANA**'s huge spear ; then Raghava, seeing his aerial shafts teduced to ashes, pulverized by contact with that lance, was ttansported with anger and furious in the extreme. There after **RAMA**, Joy of the House of Ragbu, took up his spear favoured by Vasava, that Matali had brought to him; wielding it with his powerful arm, that lance, the destroyer of the worlds, with its sonorous bells lit up the sky like unto a brilliant meteor. In its flight, colliding with the spear belonging to that **INDRA** of the Titans, it was shattered by the impact and that enormous lance fell bereft of its splendour. Thereafter **RAMA** pierced **RAVANA**'s swiftly-moving steeds with shafts loosed with great force that were thunderous and flew straight to their target. Displaying all his strength, he wounded his rival in the breast with penetrating javelins and his brow with three arrows, whereupon **RAVANA**, his whole body pierced with arrows and covered with blood, which flowed from wounds in all his limbs, resembled an Ashoka Tree in full flower. His

body riddled with darts loosed by **RAMA**, bathed in blood, feeling himself utterly exhausted, that Lord of the Rangers of the Night, in the midat of his army, was filled with extreme wrath.

CHAPTER 104

Rama arraigns Ravana and reproaches him for his Misdeeds

great combat, overwhelmed Raghava with blows. Like unto a heavy shower, Ravarul deluged **RAMA** as clouds fill a pond. Drowned in a rain of arrows loosed from the titan's bow in the fight, Kakutstha stood firm like unto a mighty mountain. Then that hero, resolute in combat, with his shafts dellected the succession of darts which fell upon him like unto the rays of the sun. Thereafter, with a skilled hand, the ranger of the night, in fury, struck the breast of the magnanimous Raghava with thousands of dsrts and the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**, covered with blood, looked like a huge Kimshuka Tree in ftower in the forest. His wrath roused by the wounds he had received, the exceedingly powerful Kakutstha armed himself with sbafts the lustre of which resembled the sun's at the end of the world period ; and **RAMA** and **RAVANA**, both transported with anger, became invisible to each other on the battlefield that was dsrkened by their shafts. Thereafter at the height of fury, the valiant son of **DASARATHA** addressed his adversary in these mocking and ironic words : " Having carried away my conson against her will in Janas thana, imposing on her ignorance, thou an verily no hero ! Bearing away by force, Vaidehi who was wandering forlornly in the great forest far from me, thou thinkest ' I am a great hero ! ' Because thou hast molested other women who were without a protector, which is the act of

a coward, thou deemest thyself to be a hero, O Valiant One ! O Thou who hast overthrown the rampans of duty, O Arrogant Wretch of fickle nature, in thine insolence, thou hast invited death into thine house, saying ' I am a hero ! ' Is it in the role of the valiant brother of Dhanads that thou, grown presumptuous on account of power, hast accom plished this memorable, great and glorious exploit ? Thou shalt presently receive a fitting recompense for this infamous act. O Wretch, in thine own estimation, thinking to thyself' I am a hero,' thou wast not ashamed to bear **SITA** away like a thief. Had I been there when thou didst a1front Vaidehi, handling her so brutally, I sbould have dispatched thee to rejoin thy brother Khara by striking thee down with my shafts. By good fonune, O Insensate One, thou an now before me ; to-day with my penetrating darts, I shall hurl thee into Y ama's abode. To-day thy head with its dazzling earrings, severed by my weapon, sbal1 301 roll in the dust on the battlefield where the wild beasts will devour it. Vultures will swoop on thy breast when thou art lying stretched on the esrth, O RaVIDll, and will drink the blood greedily that ftows from the wounds inflicted by my shsrp arrows. To-day pricked by my shafts, lying without life, birds of prey will tear out thine entrails as eagles destroy serpents ! " Speaking thus, the valiant **RAMA**, scourge of his foes, covered that **INDRA** among Titans, who stood near, with a hail of arrows, and his courage, strength and martial ardour in loosing his shafts waa redoubled. Then all the celestial WIOipons belonging to Raghava, versed in the Science of the Self, presented them selves before him' and, in his joy, that illustrious hero felt the dexterity of his touch increase. On these auspicious signs appearing of themselves, **RAMA**, the Desttoyer of the Titans, attacked RaVIDll himself with increasing violence. Wounded by innumerable rocks thrown by the monkeys and the darts showered upon him by Raghava, Dashagriva's heart fainted within him and, in the

agitation of his soul, he neither took up his arrows nor stretched his bow nor sought to oppose Rams's valour, while the arrows and missiles of every kind discharged unceasingly by his adversary had death as their target so that the hour of his doom appeared itnminent. Then his charioteer, observng the peril, drove the chariot calmly and slowly out of the fray and, aghast at the appearance of the king, who had sunk down bereft of energy, he turned that dresdful car, rumbling like a cloud, and left the battlefield in haste. CHAPTER lOS Rarlana repriNICha his Clumot..,. DisTRAcm> with fury, his eyes red with anger, urged on by destiny, **RAVANA** addressed his charioteer, saying : "Am I then bereft of valour and strength, deprived of prowess, cowardly, infirm of purpose, weak, without energy, devoid of

CHAPTER 105

Ravana reproaches his Charioteer

roll in the dust on the battlefield where the wild beasts will devour it. Vultures will swoop on thy breast when thou art lying stretched on the esrth, O RaVIDll, and will drink the blood greedily that ftows from the wounds inflicted by my shsrp arrows. To-day pricked by my shafts, lying without life, birds of prey will tear out thine entrails as eagles destroy serpents ! " Speaking thus, the valiant **RAMA**, scourge of his foes, covered that **INDRA** among Titans, who stood near, with a hail of arrows, and his courage, strength and martial ardour in loosing his shafts waa redoubled. Then all the celestial WIOipons belonging to Raghava, versed in the Science of the Self, presented them selves before him' and, in his joy, that illustrious hero felt the dexterity of his touch increase. On these auspicious signs appearing of themselves, **RAMA**, the Desttoyer of

the Titans, attacked RaVIDll himself with increasing violence. Wounded by innumerable rocks thrown by the monkeys and the darts showered upon him by Raghava, Dashagriva's heart fainted within him and, in the agitation of his soul, he neither took up his arrows nor stretched his bow nor sought to oppose Rams's valour, while the arrows and missiles of every kind discharged unceasingly by his adversary had death as their target so that the hour of his doom appeared itnminent. Then his charioteer, observng the peril, drove the chariot calmly and slowly out of the fray and, aghast at the appearance of the king, who had sunk down bereft of energy, he turned that dresdful car, rumbling like a cloud, and left the battlefield in haste. CHAPTER lOS Rarlana repriNICha his Clumot..,. DisTRAcm> with fury, his eyes red with anger, urged on by destiny, **RAVANA** addressed his charioteer, saying : "Am I then bereft of valour and strength, deprived of prowess, cowardly, infirm of purpose, weak, without energy, devoid of magic powers and debarred from combat, that thou hast failed me and actest on thine own understanding ? How comes it that without respect for me and disregarding my commands, in the presence of the foe, thou didst drive my chariot from the field I Through rhine error this day, O Vile Wretch, that which I had won over a long period, glory, valour, honour and renown, are all lost to me ! Before a foe famed for his prowess, who prides himself on his exploi15, thou hast transformed me who delights in battle, into a coward. If it is not through heedlessness that thou hast acted thus, O ViUain, my suspicions arc well founded and thou hast been bribed by the enemy. Assuredly it was not an act of friendship or devotion ; only a foe would condUct himself as thou hast done. If thou hast any loyalry to me, then return in the chariot instantly ere mine advcnary has departed and remember the benefits thou hast received at my hands." At these reproaches from the insensate **RAVANA**, the sagacious charioteer made

answer in words that were moderate and full of good sense, saying : " I am neither afraid, nor am I mad, nor do I yield to the solicitations of a foe, nor am I negligent, nor have I ceased to be loyal to thee, nor have I forgotten the benefits I have received from thy hand ! It was through my desire to be of service to thee and to safeguard thy glory and on account of a sincere attachmeot, that I acted as I thought best ! O Great King, thou shouldst not unjustly regard me as a vile and cowardly wretch, I who seek only to do that which is agreeable to thee. Hear me, I will tell thee the reason why I took thy chariot, resembling a Sowing current driven hack by the tide, from the field. " Observing thy fatigue following on the tremendous strnggle, I no longer recognized thy proud assurance nor thy superior strength. By drawing the chariot unceasingly, my steeds were overcome with fatigue, they were prostrate and overcome with the heat, like unto kine lashed by the rain ; fUrthermore amidst the portents that were manifest in great numbers, not one, it seemed to me, was favourable to us. " One shoald at the proper time and place observe the characteristics, gcsturca, facial expression, depression or ex hilaration and the measure of fatigue of one’s master, O Mighty Hero ; also the place where the earth is firm and where it is 30-4 uneven or level, where it is llat or hilly and the time for combat ; when the enemy lays himself open to attack, bow to advance and retire, to halt or go forward, to meet the enemy or retreat to a distance, all this must be known by a charioteer, as he stands in his chariot. " It was on account of thy prostration and the exhaustion of thy steeds and in order to mitigate this terrible fatigue, that I undertook those specific measures. It was not from caprice, O Warrior, that I drove the chariot away; it was devotion to my lord that made me resolve to act in this wise. Issue any command thou desires!, O Hero, O Scourge of Thy Foes, and I shall fulfil it implicidy with all my heart ! " Then **RAVANA**, fully satisfied with the reply of his

charioteer, addressed many words of praise to him and, in his martial atdour, said: " Speedily drive my chariot towards Ragbava, O Charioteer, **RAVANA** is incapable of turning back ere he bas destroyed his enemies in battle ! " Speaking thus, the King of the Titans standing in his chariot, bestowed a brilliant ring of great price on his charioteer and, under his orders, the driver set out to the banlefield. Urged on by **RAVANA**'s command, the charioteer whipped his steeds into a gallop and, in an instant, the great chariot belonging to that **INDRA** among the Titans stood before **RAMA** in the field.

CHAPTER 106

The Sage Agastya instructs Rama in the Hymn to the Sun

picious, the delight of the good, the destroyer of all ills, the allayer of fear and IIIIXiety, the increaser of life and the most cxcdlent of all verses : " ' O Thou, who on rising art crowned with rays, to whom the *Devas* and *Asuras* pay homage, salutations to Thee I Thou art Vivisvata, the resplendent Lord of the Worlds, the Soul of the Gods, the Effulgent One, Creator of Light, who sustainest the Hosts of *Devas* and *Asuras* and the Three Worlds with Thy rays. Thou art the Creator, Maintainer and Destroyer, Thou art the God of War, the Lord of Creatures, the King of the Celestials, the Distributor of Wealth. Thou art Time and Death, the One posaessed of splendour, the Lord of the Waters, the Ancestors, the Vasus, the Sadhyas, the Maruts, Manu, Vayu and the God of Fire. Thou art the Source of Life and of the seasons, Thou art the Great Nourisher of all, the Generator of all, the Courser in the heavens, the Maintainer, the One possessed of rays, the Golden, the Brilliant, the

Cosmic Energy, the Maker of Day. Thou art all-pervading, myriad-rayed, the Indicator of all paths, from whom proceed the senses, Thou art the Thousand-beamed One, the Subduer of Darkness, the One from Whom all happiness prooeeds, the Remover of the suffer ings of Thy votaries, the Infuser of life in the Muodane Egg, the One possessed of rays. Thou art the Cause of the Creation, Preservation and Destruction of the Universe, the Beneficent One, the Possessor of Wealth, the Bringer of Day, the Teacher, the Fire-wombed,' the Son of Aditi, Thou art supreme Felicity, the Remover of Nescience, the Lord of the Firmament, the Dispeller of Darkness, the One versed in the Rik, Yajus and Sama (*Vedas*), the One from Whom tloweth the showers, the Friend of Waters, the One Who, with a single bouod, crossed the Vindhya Range. Thou art intent on creating the Cosmos ; Thou art adorned with gems ; Thou art the Bringer of Death, the Pingsls, the Destroyer of all, the Omniscent One, Whose form is the Universe, of great energy, beloved of all, Lord of aU actions. O Thou, the Lord of stars, planets and COIIStellations, the Creator of all, the Resplendent amoog the splendid, the Esseuce of the twelve forms, salutations to Thee I Salutations to the Eastern and Western Mountains, salutations to the Lord of the stellar bodies and the Lord of Day I Salutations to Thee, the bringer of victory and the joy that springeth from victory, O Lord of the Golden Steeds ! Salutations to Thee, O Thousand rayed One, O Aditya ! Salutations to Thee Who coutrolleth the seuses, to Thee O Hero Who art worthy of the Holy Syllable,' salutations to Thee Who awakeueth the Lotus I Salutations to Thee, O Fierce One, Who art the Lord of Brahms, Ishaua and Achyuta ! To Thee, O Sun, Possessor of Light, Thou of illumining power, the Devourer of all, Who assumest the form of Rudra, be our salutations ! Salutations to Thee, the Des troyer of darkness, of cold and of the foe ; salutations to Thee of Infinite Soul, the Destroyer of the

ungrateful, the Lord of the Stars ; salutations to Thee, Whose lustre resembles refined gold, the Destroyer of ignorance, the Architect of ttJ,e universe. Salutations to Thee, the Remover of darkness, the Illuminer, the Beholder of all the worlds. It is Thou Who createst all and destroyeth all, Who dryeth up, consumest and annibilateot all. Thou wakest when all creatutes sleep, in whose heart Thou abidest ; Thou art both the Sacrificial Fire and the fruit of sacrifice. Thou art the sum of all action and the Lord thereof.' " O Raghava, he who recites this hymn in the time of peril, in the midst of the wilderness or in any danger does not succumb to it. Do thou offer a deep devotion to that God of Gods, the Lord of the World I He who recites this hymn three times will be victorinus ! O Long-armed Warrior, the hour has come when thou wilt triumph over **RAVANA** I " Having spoken thus, Agastya returned whence he had come. These worda dispelled the grief of the illuatrious Raghava who felt himself fortified, full of ardour and well pleased. Thereafter meditating on Aditya he recited the hymn and experienced supreme felicity. Having rinsed his mouth three times and purified himself, that hero toOk up his bow. Seeing RaVIUUI, he rejoiced and advanced towards him in order to enter into combat, calling up his whole strength with the inteotion of slaying him. At thst instant the Deity of the San, amidst the Host of the Gods, knowing thst the destruction of the Lord of the Rangers of the Night was at hand, casting glances of joy and snpteme satisfaction on Rsms, approached him and said :-" Pat forth thine whole strength I "

CHAPTER 107

Sinister Portents appear

THEREAFTER Rsvana's ehsrioteer drove his car forward speedily, with joy, eating up space as it were, and thst ehsriot, capable of crushing hostile armies, bore an immense stsndard and resem bled the Oty of the Gandhsrvas. Harnessed to excellent steeds, garlanded with gold, it was filled with implements of and adomed with flags and banners. The scourge of enemy forces and the joy of its own, Rsvana's car was driven with exceeding velocity by its charioteer. Then thst prince of men, Rsma, observed the ehsriot of the King of the Titans, rolling noisily along with its great standard, harnessed to dreadful black horses and resembling a Vimana' in space, bright as the san, dazzling to behold, like onto **INDRA**'s bow, and the rain of arrows falling therefrom resembled the waters loosed by a cloud. Seeing the ehsriot of his adversary, which bote down upon him like a cloud, with a sound resembling a mountain shattered by lightning, Rsma instantly stretching his bow, like onto the crescent moon, said to Matali, the ehsrioteer of thst God of a Thousand Eyes : " O Matali, behald the furious pace of the ehsriot of mine adversary as he rushes upon me in vinlent rage l Be vigilant and drive to meet the car of my foe, I wish to destroy him u the wind scatters a rising cloud ! Without swerving or confUsiml. thy glance alert, thy mind steady, holding the reins with a firm hand, drive swiftly l Assuredly thou hut no need of my COUIIICI, aCCUJtOmed u thou art to drive Purandara's charior, yet ill mille ardent desire to illto combat, I make appeal to thine aperience, I do not wtrwt thee." Exttemely gratified by Ramo's words, Matsli, the most excellent charioteer of the Gods inaessed the speed of his car. Passing **RAVANA**'s great chariot on the right hand, he covered it with the dust of his own wheels. Enraged, Dashsgrivs, his eyes inllamed with anger, riddled **RAMA** with arrows as he stood before him. Provoked by the blows, **RAMA**, whose streogth was redoubled by his fury, armed himself with **INDRA**'s extremely powerful

bow aud his great artows of exceeding swiftness thst glittered like the rays of the sun. Thereupon a fierce combat ensued between the two warriors, who stood face to face like two proud lions, csch dcsitous of destroying the other. At thst momenr, *Devas*, Gaudharvas, Siddhss aud Para msrishis, hoping for **RAVANA**'s downfall, assembled to witness thst dud between those chariots. Thereafter dreadfUl portents appeared, causing the hair to staud on end, foreshadowing dcsth to **RAVANA** and victory to Raghsvs. And the Gods caused blood to fall on **RAVANA**'s chariot ; a great whirlwilld blew from left to right whilsr, ill the sky, a large 1lock of vultures fiew over his head following the evolutions of his car. Though still day, Lanka, enshrouded ill the light of dusk, hued like a *Japa* ftower, seemed aglow ; great accompanied by lightning fell with the soWid of thunder aud the titans were seized with terror witnessing those portentS so unfavourable to **RAVANA**. In whstever direction the titan drove, the earth shook aud the limbs of his soldiers appeared u Dreadful birds' fought desperately amoug themselves, falliDg in hundreds before his chariot, emitting fearful cries. From his horses' flanks sparks flew continually and from their eyes tesrs fell, fire and water thus issuing from them simultaneously. Msny other terrifying portents, foretelling **RAVANA**'s death, appeared, whilst omens propitious to **RAMA**, foreshadowiug his imminent triumph, could be seen. Beholdiug those inauspicious signs, Raghava was greatly delighted and regarded **RAVANA** as already slain. Seeing those portents rclatiug to himself, which he knew how to interpret, **RAMA** experienced supreme felicity and, tUl1 of confidence, manifested a matchless energy in the struggle.

CHAPTER 108

The Fluctuations of Combat

The battalions of titans and innumerable companies of monkeys stood motionless with weapons in their bands and, beholding those two warriors, man and titan, all were amazed, their hearts beating rapidly. Ready for combat, their arms filled with every kind of missile, they stood absorbed in the spectacle, forgetting to loose their shafts at one another, and the titans had their eyes riveted on **RAVANA** and the monkeys on **RAMA** so that both armies took on a strauge aspect. Meanwhile, wimessing those portents, both Raghava and **RAVANA**, steady, resolute and tUl1 of auger, fought with deter mined courage. I shall triumph ' rellected Kakutstha, I must die ' thought **RAVANA** and both displayed their tUl1 strength with assurance in the encowucr. At that instant, Dasbagriva, in his wrath, placed his arrows (*on the bow*) and loosed them with force in the direction of the standard on Raghava's chariot but those missiles failed to reach the llag in Purandara's car and, g1anciug oft' the support, fell on the earth. Meanwhile **RAMA**, enraged, stretched his bow with energy, resolving to return blow for blow and, aiming at **RAVANA**'s banner,loosed a sharp arrow resembling a great snake, irresistible, shining in its own lustre; and he 1er fty his weapon in the direction of Dasbagriva's standard, which being severed, fell to the earth. Beholding his ftag torn down and overthrown, the extremely powerful **RAVANA**, inftamed with ire, blazed with wrath and indignation and, under the goad of his fury, let fall a hail of ftaming shafts, striking Rams's horses. These celestial steeds, however, did not ftinch, remaining motionless as if brushed by lotus stalks and, seeing the horses unafighted, **RAVANA**, enraged, discharged a fresh rain of arrows, maces,

iron bars, discus, clubs, rocks, trees, spears and axes, and those weapons were all aeated by magic, and, summoning up all his powers, he loosed them in hundreds and thousands. Appalling and terrible was that unending ftood of weapons re-echoing with a sinister sound but **RAVANA** failed to strike Rams's chariot, though his shafts fell on the monkey host on all sides covering the whole of space, and thus Dasbagriva, unheeding, fought on. Seeing him deploying increasing efforts in the struggle, Kakutstha, as if smiling, took up his sharp arrows and loosed them in hundreds and thousands. Observing them fall, **RAVANA**, with his shafts, covered the entire sky and, on account of that rain of dazzling missiles loosed by those two antagonists, it seemed as if a second heaven of weapons had been created and, amongst them, there was not one that did not attain its target, not one, that did not pierce another and not one, that was loosed in vain; and, having collided with one another, they fell to the ground. Thus **RAMA** and **RAVANA** fought with an increasing supply of weapons and, in the struggle, they showered down their spears without pause to right and left, so that these formidable weapons covered the firmament; **RAMA** striking **RAVANA**'s steeds and **RAVANA** striking those belonging to **RAMA** ; thus, both exchanged blow for blow and both, in the height of anger, entered upon a tremendous duel cauaing the hair to stand on end. Then with sharpened arrows **RAMA** and **RAVANA** continued their combat and, contemplating his broken standard, **RAVANA** was CODSumed with rap.

CHAPTER 109

The Duel continues

WITNESSING the combat between **RAMA** and **RAVANA**, all beings wexe struck with amazement and those two warriors, assuming a dreadful aspect in the struggle, highly enxaged, determined on mutual slaugbter and, in their excellent cars, bore down on each other. Thereupon their drivers, paxading their skill as chariot eers, advanced, circled and manoeuvred in various ways. In their rapid course and swift evolutions, those two marvellous chariots ranged the battlefield, whilst the wsrriors discharged coundess shafts on each other, like unto clouds letting loose their sbowers. Having displayed their immeasurable resouxce in the use of weapons, those two champions halted face to face, chariot shaft to chariot shaft, their horses' heads touching, their standards intertwined. Then **RAMA** loosed fOUI sharp axrows, driving back **RAVANA**'s fOUI spirited steeda and he, furious on beholding them retreat, let fly his penetrating shafts on Ragbava. That hero, however, grievously wounded by the mighty Dashagriva, manifested neither agitation nor emotion and again the Ten-necked One discharged his shafts, that resounded like thunder, aiming at the charioteer of that God who bears the Thunderbolt ; and he struck Matali with his arrows with grest force without being able to distuxb him in any way or csuse him to falter. Nevertheleas Raghava, indignant at the alfront offered to Matali more than if it had been directed at himself, with the aid of a suaeasinn of darta, decided to humble hia adversary, and the valiant Raghava discharged twenty, thirty, siDy and thereafter hundreds and thousands of shafts on his rival's chariot. On hia side, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, standing in his car, enraged, overwhelmed **RAMA** with aa avalanche of maces and clubs and the strUggle became more desperate cauaina the hair to stand on end. Jill At the sound of the maces, clubs and axes and the loosing of plumed arrows, the seven seas were agitated and the tumult of the oceans sowed terro.r in the Danavas and Pannagas

in their thousands, in the depths of hell. The earth shook with its mountains, forests and jungles ; the orb of dsy lost its brilliance and the wind ceased to blow. *Devas*, Gandharvas, Siddhas and Paramarishis were wrought up with amiety as also the Kinneras and Great Serpents. " May good fortune attend the cows and *brahmin* ! May all the worlds endure forever ! May Raghava emerge ttiumphant in his combat with **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans I " Offering up these prayers, the *Devas* accompanied by hosts of *Rishis* witnessed that duel betWeen **RAMA** and **RAVANA**, a spec tacle that caused the hair to stand on end, and the hosts of the Gandharvas and Apsaras, watching that indescribable struggle, cried out :-" The sty resembles the sea and the sea the sty, but the fight betWeen **RAMA** and **RAVANA** resembles nought but itself I " Thus did they speak on beholding the combat betWeen **RAMA** and **RAVANA**. In his rage, the Long-armed Warrior, the increaser of the glory of the Raghus, **RAMA**, placed an arrow, like unto a venomous reptile, on his bow and cut otf one of **RAVANA**'s heads, whereupon that glorious head, adorned with sparkling earrings, roUed on the earth in the presence of the Three Worlds. Never theless another, equal to the former, grew immediately and **RAMA**, with a steady hand, dexterously sundered the seamd head with his sbafts. Hardly was it eliminated when another head appeared which was severed once more by **RAMA**'s darts like unto thunderbolts. Thereafter he struck otf a hundred more, being unable to bring **RAVANA** low, and that hero, conversant with every weapon, he the increaser of **KAUSHALYA**'s delight, who had made use of innumerable missiles, rellected : These were the sbafts by the help of which I slew Maricha, Khara, and Dushana as also Viradha in the Krauncha Wood and Kabandha in the Dandsb Forest ; these were the sbafts where with I trllllfixed the Sala Trees and the mountains and Bali and with which I agitated the ocean ! AU these weapons found their target, how is it that

they have so little power over **RAVANA** ? ' ceasing from action, let loose a shower of arrows on the breast of his adversary. On his side, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Titans, standing in his chariot, enraged, overwhelmed **RAMA** with an avalanche of maces and clubs. Thus the fearful and desperate conflict, causiog the hsit to stand on end, continued in the air and on the ground and thereafter on the summit of the mountain. *Devas*, Danavas, Yakshas, Pisachas, Umgas and *Rakshasas* watched the dteadful combat that lasted seven days and neither by night nor day for a single hour did **RAMA** and Ravena cease from fighting and the son of **DASARATHA** and the Indta of the Titans continued to struggle thus. Then the magnanimous charioteer of the King ufthe Gods, beholding no sign ofRaghava gaining the victory, addtessed him rapidly in the following words.

CHAPTER 110

The Death of Ravana

AT that moment, Matali sought to recall Raghava's thoughts, saying :-" How is it that thou dost act in regsrd to **RAVANA** as if thou wert unaware of thine own powers ? In order to bring about his end, discharge **BRAHMA**'s Weapon upon him, O Lord I Foretold by the Gods, the hour uf his doom is at hand I " Prompted by Matali, **RAMA** took up a 1laming shaft that was hissing like a viper, formerly bestowed on him by the magnani tnous and powerful Sage Agastys. A gift of the Grandsire, that weapon never missed its target and it had been created of yore by **BRAHMA** for **INDRA** and bestowed on the King uf the Gods for the conquest of the Three Worlds. In its wings was the wind, in its point the fire and the sun, in its haft space, and, in siEe, it resembled the

Mountains Meru and Mandara. With its marvellous point, haft and gilding, it was composed of the essence of all the elements and was as resplendent as the sun. Re sembling the Fire of Time enveloped in smoke, it was like unto .an enortnous snake and was capable of riving men, elephants, bones, gateways, ban and even rocb. Dreadful to behold, COVeted “ith blood from countless victims, coated with their flesh and of the temper of lightning, it emitted a thundaoua sound. The disperser of hosts, it created universal alarm, and hissing like a great serpent, it was exceedingly formidable. In war, it was the provider of nourishment to herons, wltures, cranes and hordes of jackals ; it was a form of death itself, the sower of terror, the delight of the monkeys, the scourge of the titans and its wings were composed of innumerable brightly coloured plumes, like unto **GARUDA**’s. That marvellous and powerful shaft that was to destroy the titan was the object of terror to the worlds, the remover of the fear of the supporters of the lkabvakus, the depriver of the glory of the foe, and it filled **RAMA** with delight. Having charged it with the sacred formula, the valiant **RAMA** of indescribable prowess placed that excellent weapon on bis bow according to the method prescribed by the Veda and, when he made ready, all beings were seized with terrOr and the earth shook. Enraged, he stretched his bow with force and, deploying bis whole strength, discharged that weapon, the destroyer of the vital parts, on **RAVANA**, and that irresistible shaft like unto lightning, irrevocable as fate, loosed by the arm of one equal to the God who bears the Thunderbolt, struck **RAVANA**’s breast. Loosed with exceeding force, that missile, the supreme destroyer, pierced the breast of the wicked-hearted titan and, covered with blood, that fatal dart baving extinguished his vital breaths, buried itself in the earth. Thereafter, baving slain **RAVANA**, that shaft, stained with blood wbich dripped therefrom, its purpose accomplished, returned submissively to

the quiver. And Dasbagriva, who bad been struck down suddenly, let his bow and arrow fall from his hand as he yielded up his breath. Bereft of life, that lndra of the Nsirritas of redoubtable valour and great renown, fell from his chariot as Vritra wben struck by **INDRA**'s thunderbolt. Seeing bim stretched on the ground, the rangers of the night who bad escaped the carnage, struck with terror, their sovereign being slain, lied in aU directions and, from every side, the monkeys who, in the presence of the dead Dasbagriva bad assumed a victorious m, hurled themselves upon them, armed with trees. Harassed by the monkey divisions, the titans, terror-stricken, took refuge in Lanka and, baving lost their lord, in despm, gave way to tearS. In the ranks of the monkeys, however, there arose cries of joy and shoull of triumph proclaimiDg Raghava's victory and Rsvana's defeat, and the skies re-echoed to the music of the drums beaten by the Gods. A rain of flowers fell from heaven on to the earth, covering Rsghsva's chariot with a ravishillg and marvellous shower of blossom. The cry of ' Well done I Well done ! ' came from the firmament and the celestial voices of the magoanimous Gods were raised in Rsma's praise. On the d.eath of tbat source of terror to all the worlds a great joy filled the Celestial Host as also the Cbaranas. The blessed Rsghava, by slaying that Bull among the Titans, fulfilled the ambitions of **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA** and Bibishana; peace reigned over all ; tbe cardinal points were stilled ; the air became pure, the earth ceased to tremble, the wind blew gently and the star of the day regained its full glory. At that instant, **SUGRIVA**, Bibishana and **ANGADA**, the foremost of his friends, and **LAKSHMANA** also, approached that happy conqueror and joyfully offered him due homage. Rsma, the delight of the House of Rsghu, surrounded by his adhercnll on the battlefidd, having slain his adversary by hia emaurdinary power, resembled Mahendra amidst the Celestial Host. CHAPTER The Lamentatitnu aj Bibishana SEEING his brother

defeated, lying on the baltlefidd, Bibishaaa, his hean torn with violent grief, began to lament, saying : " O Illustrious Warrior, thou who wert ICDOWDed for thy skill, ezperience and oulltanding courage, even among the valiant, O Thou accustomed to a luxurious couch, how is it that thou art lying stiff and motionless, thy long arms adorned with

CHAPTER 111

The Lamentations of Bibishana

In the ranks of the monkeys, however, there arose cries of joy and shoull of triumph proclaimiDg Raghava's victory and Rsvana's defeat, and the skies re-echoed to the music of the drums beaten by the Gods. A rain of flowers fell from heaven on to the earth, covering Rsghsva's chariot with a ravishillg and marvellous shower of blossom. The cry of ' Well done I Well done ! ' came from the firmament and the celestial voices of the magoanimous Gods were raised in Rsma's praise. On the d.eath of tbat source of terror to all the worlds a great joy filled the Celestial Host as also the Cbaranas. The blessed Rsghava, by slaying that Bull among the Titans, fulfilled the ambitions of **SUGRIVA**, **ANGADA** and Bibishana; peace reigned over all ; tbe cardinal points were stilled ; the air became pure, the earth ceased to tremble, the wind blew gently and the star of the day regained its full glory. At that instant, **SUGRIVA**, Bibishana and **ANGADA**, the foremost of his friends, and **LAKSHMANA** also, approached that happy conqueror and joyfully offered him due homage. Rsma, the delight of the House of Rsghu, surrounded by his adhercnll on the battlefidd, having slain his adversary by hia emaurdinary power, resembled Mahendra amidst the Celestial Host. CHAPTER The Lamentatitnu aj Bibishana SEEING his brother

defeated, lying on the baltlefidd, Bibishaaa, his hean torn with violent grief, began to lament, saying : " O Illustrious Warrior, thou who wert ICDOWDed for thy skill, ezperience and oulltanding courage, even among the valiant, O Thou accustomed to a luxurious couch, how is it that thou art lying stiff and motionless, thy long arms adorned with has overtaken Prahasta, Indrajita, Kumbhakama, Atiratha, Atikaya, Narantab, and thee thyself. Alas ! The rampart of the virtuous has disappeared, the incarnation of duty has de parted, the refuge of the strong and powerful is no more. Tbe sun has fallen to earth, the moon is obscured by darkness ; fire has lost its brilliance, energy is bereft of force, since that hero, the prince of warriors, lies stretched on the earth. What remains now that he is deprived of his might and that tiger among the titans lies as if asleep in the dust ? That great tree, the Lord of the Titans, whose stability was the foliage, his valour the blossom, his asceticism the sap, his heroism the inter rwining roots, has been overthrown on the battlefield by that tempest, Raghava. That elephant in mustha, **RAVANA**, his strength the tusks, his lineage the backbone, his exuberance the trunk, his wrath the limbs, has been seized by the lion, Ikshvsku. That blszing fire, whose prowess and energy are spreading flames, his angry breathing the smoke, his martial ardour the beat, has been extinguished by that cloud, **RAMA**. That bull among the titans with the Nairritas as his tail, hump and horns, his love of pleasure the eyes and ears, he the conquerer of his foea, equal to the wind in swiftness, that tiger of the lords of the earth is lying dead.” Hearing these words, full of good sense and virtue, uttered by Bibishana who was tom with grief, **RAMA** addressed him saying: " Nay, this hero has not succumbed on account of his lack of prowess ! Endowed with burning courage in battle, having displayed the greatest energy, he fell without yielding. One should not mourn for those who, firm in their duty as warriors, for

the sake of renown fall on the field of battle. It is not the time to weep for this brave warrior, the terror of the worlds and their leaders, now that be lies under the sway of death ; no nne is always victorious in war ; sometimes the brave succumb to the blows of the enemy and at other times it is the foe who is overanne by them. This path followed by **RAVANA** was taught to us by the Sages and the warrior class hold it in great honour. Tbe warrior who is slain in battle, should not be mourned, this is the law. In this amviction, do thy duty without further IIIDety and cousider what action should now be taken." 317 Then Bibishana, who was overcome with grief; iostant,ly replied to that noble prince who had spoken to him in his brother's interest and said : " Tbis valiant one who, in previous battles was defeated even by the assembled Gods undet Vasava's command, assailed by thee on the field, beheld his power shatteted as the ocean when coming in contact with its shores. The bestower of gifts on those who desired them, he knew how to enjoy wealth and entertain those who served him. The distributor of treasure amongst his friends, he suft'eted his wrath to fall on his foes. Feeding the sacred fire, he practiced severe penances, was conversant with the Veda and fulfilled his duty as a real hero. Now, with thine approval, I desire to perform his obsequies." Touched by these poignant words of Bibishana's, Rsma commanded him to perform the funeral rites that lead the soul to heaven, and said : " Death hss tetminsted our enmity that now has no reason fur its existence. He is as dear to me as thee ; let us therefore perform the obsequies ! " CHAPTER The I.anrmtatiDIJS of Raoatta's CD1JSOI'ts HEARING that Rsvana hsd fallen undet the blows of the highly powerful Rsghava, the female titanS, like unto cows which hsve lost their calves, overcome with grief; their hsir dishevelled, rushed out of the innet apartments and, though restrained, rolled in the dust again and again. Issuing from the northern gateway with their

attendants, they enteted that dreadful battlefield searching fur their dead lord and cried out, ' O Our King, Our Support ', running hither and thither on the ground that was coveted with headless trunks, mud and gore. Their eyes full of tears, overcome with grief, they emitted cries like unto female elephants who hsve lost the leader of the herd. Then they beheld that great and esceedingly powerful and illustrious Rsvana, their lord, lying in the duat and they immedi· ately all fell upon his body like creepen that have been torn

CHAPTER 112

The Lamentations of Ravana's Consorts

Then Bibishana, who was overcome with grief; iostant,ly replied to that noble prince who had spoken to him in his brother’s interest and said : " Tbis valiant one who, in previous battles was defeated even by the assembled Gods undet Vasava’s command, assailed by thee on the field, beheld his power shatteted as the ocean when coming in contact with its shores. The bestower of gifts on those who desired them, he knew how to enjoy wealth and entertain those who served him. The distributor of treasure amongst his friends, he suft’eted his wrath to fall on his foes. Feeding the sacred fire, he practiced severe penances, was conversant with the Veda and fulfilled his duty as a real hero. Now, with thine approval, I desire to perform his obsequies.” Touched by these poignant words of Bibishana’s, Rsma commanded him to perform the funeral rites that lead the soul to heaven, and said : " Death hss tetminsted our enmity that now has no reason fur its existence. He is as dear to me as thee ; let us therefore perform the obsequies ! " CHAPTER The I.anrmtatiDIJS of Raoatta’s CD1JSOI’ts HEARING that Rsvana

hsd fallen undet the blows of the highly powerful Rsghava, the female titanS, like unto cows which hsve lost their calves, overcome with grief; their hsir dishevelled, rushed out of the innet apartments and, though restrained, rolled in the dust again and again. Issuing from the northern gateway with their attendants, they enteted that dreadful battlefield searching fur their dead lord and cried out, ' O Our King, Our Support ', running hither and thither on the ground that was coveted with headless trunks, mud and gore. Their eyes full of tears, overcome with grief, they emitted cries like unto female elephants who hsve lost the leader of the herd. Then they beheld that great and esceedingly powerful and illustrious Rsvana, their lord, lying in the duat and they immedi· ately all fell upon his body like creepen that have been torn 318 down in the furesr. In a transport of passion, one embraced him sobbing, one pressed his feet, one hung on his neck, whilst another, beating the air with her arms, rolled on the ground and yet another, gazing on her dead lord, swooned away, and one, laying her head in his lap, as she looked on him, her tears bathing his face, as rime covers a lotus flower. Beholding their lord lying stretched on the earth, in their despair, they emitted conrinual cries of pain as their lamentations increased-' He of whom Sbakrs himself stood in awe, he who was the source of terror to Y ama, he, by whom the King Vaishravana was dispossessed of his Chariot Pushpaka, he, who caused the Gandharvas, *Rishis*, and the magnanimous Gods to tremble, is now lying dead on the field. He had nought to fear from *Asuras*, Suras or Pannagas, for it was in man that the peril lay for him ; he, who could not be slain by Devatas, Danavas or *Rakshasas* is lying here on the eatth, struck down by a mere mortal fighting on foot ; he, who could not be slain by Suras, Y akshas or *Asuras*, received his death blow from a man, as one who is defenceless.' Thus did the wretched consorts of **RAVANA** speak amidst their sobs and,

overwhelmed with grief, continued to lament without cessing, saying : " Not heeding the advice of thy friend, who ever offered thee prudent counsel, to our destruction thou didst bear **SITA** away and thus the titans have fallen and we shall perish this day on account of thy fault. Thy beloved brother, Bibishana, speaking to thee in reasonable terms was publicly affronted by thee in thy folly, driven on, as thou wert by destiny; if thou hadat returned the Princess of Mithila to **RAMA**, this fearful and appalling disaster, that is destroying us to the very root, would never have taken place. The wishes of thy brother, of **RAMA** and of thine innumerable friends would have been fulfilled ; none of us would have been widowed nor the hopes of our enemies accom plished. But, in thy perversity, having retained **SITA** by force, the titans, we ouraelves and thou thyself, are all victims of a triple destruction. Nevertheless, O Bull among the Titans, it is not thy passion that is the cause but destiny ; all that dies is Blain by destiny. This destruction of the IIIOIIkeyl and the titans in combat and thine own, O Long-armed Warrior, is the work of 319 destiny. Neither the consideratioos of wealth, desire, valour nor dominion can avert the course of destiny I " Thus the wretched consorts of the King of the Titans lamen ted like ospreya, overwhelmed by grief, their eyes full of tears. The I.ammtatirms of **MANDODARI** : Raoana's F,_al Rites WHtLE the consorts of **RAVANA** were lamenting thus, the foremost amongst them steadily fixed on him a tender and sorrowful glance and, in the presence of her lord, Dashagriva, who had been slain by **RAMA** of inconceivable cxploits, the unfortunate **MANDODARI** cxpreased her grief in this wise : " O Long-armed Warrior, younger brother of Vaisbravana, did not Purandara himself fear to stand before thee in thy wrath and did not the great *Rishis* and the illustrious Gandharvas as also the Oummas, assailed by thee, flee to every quarter ? Now **RAMA**, who is but a mortal, has

defeated thee in combat, thou who didst surpass the Three Worlds in prowess; thou whose strength rendered thee invincible, how is it that thou hast fallen under the blows of a mere man, a wanderer in the forest ? Thou , able to assume any form at will, living in a place inaccessible to man, how can thy defeat by **RAMA** be explained ? " Nay, I do not believe that thou \WSt thus struck down in the forefront of the battle by Rams's actinn, thou who wert ever wont to be victorinus in all circumstances. Rather, having recourse to inconceivable magic, """" it destiny in the form of **RAMA** in person or it may be that it was Vasava who slew thee, O

CHAPTER 113

The Lamentations of Mandodari: Ravana's Funeral Rites

destiny. Neither the consideratioos of wealth, desire, valour nor dominion can avert the course of destiny I " Thus the wretched consorts of the King of the Titans lamen ted like ospreya, overwhelmed by grief, their eyes full of tears. The I.ammtatirms of **MANDODARI** : Raoana's F,_al Rites WHtLE the consorts of **RAVANA** were lamenting thus, the foremost amongst them steadily fixed on him a tender and sorrowful glance and, in the presence of her lord, Dashagriva, who had been slain by **RAMA** of inconceivable cxploits, the unfortunate **MANDODARI** cxpreased her grief in this wise : " O Long-armed Warrior, younger brother of Vaisbravana, did not Purandara himself fear to stand before thee in thy wrath and did not the great *Rishis* and the illustrious Gandharvas as also the Oummas, assailed by thee, flee to every quarter ? Now **RAMA**, who is but a mortal, has defeated thee in combat, thou who

didst surpass the Three Worlds in prowess; thou whose strength rendered thee invincible, how is it that thou hast fallen under the blows of a mere man, a wanderer in the forest ? Thou , able to assume any form at will, living in a place inaccessible to man, how can thy defeat by **RAMA** be explained ? " Nay, I do not believe that thou \WSt thus struck down in the forefront of the battle by Rams's actinn, thou who wert ever wont to be victorinus in all circumstances. Rather, having recourse to inconceivable magic, """" it destiny in the form of **RAMA** in person or it may be that it was Vasava who slew thee, O the Shrivatsa Mark, to Whom prosperity belongs, the invil>.cible, indestructible, everlasting **VISHNU**, the true Hero assuming human form surrounded by all the Gods in monkey shapes, He, the Lord of the Worlds, has slain thee, thou, the enemy of the Gods, with thy kinsmen and the titans who attended on thee ! "Formerly, having subdued the senses, thou didst conquer the Three Worlds and thereafter thy senses conquered thee in their turn. **RAMA** is no mere mortal ; once in Janasthana he slew thy brother Khara and the innumerable titans who followed him ; furthermore when **HANUMAN** audaciously penetrated into the City of Lanka, inaccessible to the Gods themselves, we were sorely distressed. How oft did I address thee, saying, ' Have we nought to fear from Raghava ', but thou didst not heed me. These are the consequences I Without cause thou didst cherish a passion for **SITA**, O King of the Titans, to the destruction of thy kingdom, life and race ! By offering insult to the illustrious **SITA**, who surpasses Arundhati and Rohini, thou didst commit an unpardonable offence ! She is more patient than the earth itlelf, the prosperity of prosperity itself, the beloved consort of **RAMA**, of faultless limbs, who was the splendour of the lonely forest where she dwelt. By bearing that unfortunate one away, assuming a disguise and without being able to enjoy the antici pated delight of union

with Maithili, thou hast brought about thine own destruction ! " O My Lord, the asceticism of that lady faithfol to her husband, has consumed thee ! Since all the Gods and their leaders with **AGNI** at their head feared thee, thou wast not instantly destroyed when thou didst lay brutal hands on that slender-waisted lady. But, O Lord, when the time is ripe, the one who acta wickedly reaps the fruit of his evil actions ; of that there is no doubt. He who behaves virtuously culls felicity and he who acta sinfUlly reaps ill-fortune. Bibishana has found happineas and thou in the same wise has met with disaster. Thou didst posaeas other women who surpssaed Maithili in beauty but in thine infatuation thou didst not perceive it. None dies without a determining cause, for thee it was none other than **SITA**. Far didst thou go to seek that woman who was to be the reason of thy death ; now Maithili, released from aJI her sufl'eriap, will rejoice with **RAMA**. Trilling indeed is my merit, since I have fiillen into this ocean of grief, I who formerly sported on Mount Kailashs, Mandara and Meru and in the woods of Chaitaratha and all the gardens of the Gods with thee, being adomed with marvellous garlands and jewels, roaming at large in a chariot of incomparable magnificcocc, beholding innumerable countries, whilst now I am deprived of all pleasures and enjoyments by thy death, O Hero 1 Here am I, transformed as it were into another; condemned on account of the ftuctuations of the fortunes of kings. O Prince, how gracious wert thou with thy charming eyebrows, brilliant complcsion and arched nose ; thou whose beauty, splendour and radiance rivalled the moon, the lotus and the sun ; dazzling with innumerable diadems and varie gated garlands, thy red lips and brilliant earrings ; handsome sway, thou who enjoyed the wealth of the Three Worlds whom thou didst inspire with a lively fear ; thou who conquered the Guatdians of the Worlds, who overcame Shanlwa with thy shafts, who didst humble the proud and manifest thy great prowess.

Thouwhodidst trouble theuoiverse,the scourge ofthe virtuous, whose strength inspired thee to utter insolent threats in the enemy's presence ; thou the support of thy family and thine attendants, the slayer of redoubtsble warriors, thou who exterminsted the leaders of the Dansvas and Yakshas in their thousands, thou who triumphed in the fight over those wearing impenetrable armour, thou who many a time obstructed the sacrifices, thou the saviour of thy race, who set at nought the Jaws of duty, who took refuge in the power of magic in battle, who robbed the Gods, *Asuras* and men of their daughters from here and there and who didst plunge the wives of thy foes into mourning ; thou, the guide of thy people, who ruled over the Island of Lanka, thou the perpetrstor of dreadful deeds, thou who didst prepare for us many a pleasure and enjoyment, thou the foremost of warriors ; beholding thee, O Lord, who despite thy gteat powers, hast been struck down by **RAMA**, my heart must be hard indeed that I yer live bereft of thee, my Beloved. Having rested on sumptuous couches, O King of the Titans, how is it that thou art now sleeping on the earth, the dust thy coverlet? " When mine illustrious son Iodrajita was struck down by **LAKSHMANA** in the fight, I was deeply distressed but to-day I am undone, I, who, already bereft of parents and kinsfolk, now Jose my last support in thee I Deprived of pleasure and enjoyments, now that thou hast left on the last journey from which none returna, O King, I shaD waste away in thy perpetual remem brance. I cannot live without thee ; take me with thee ; why dost thou leave me in my misery ? Art thou vexed to see me unveiled who have crossed the city boundary to run here on foot, O Lord ? Look on thy cherished consorts who have discarded their veils ; aeeiog them all come forth from the city, art thou displeased? This company, with whom thou didst disport thyaelf, Is desolate, deprived of its leader and thou dost not comfort them. Hast thou no reverence for us ? Thoae women whom thou

hast widowed, O King, and more than one was of 323 noble lineage, who were devoted to their co.nsorh, firm in their duty and submissive to their Gurus, in their grief have cursed thee and, on this account, thou hast fallcn under the blows of thine adversary. Stricken by thee, they have cursed thee and this is the rcuibution I O King, the truth of the saying, The tears of women devoted to their husbands do not fall on the earth in vain ', has been proven by thee I How comes it, O King, that thou, who didst surpass all the worlds in valour, wert so base as to carry off this woman, having lured Rams from the hermitage and covered with blood ? Thou feiguest sleep ; why doat thou DOt auswer me who am overcome with grief? Why dost thou DOt speak to me, the daughter of the supremely powerful Yatudhaua Sumali, who never retreated in battle? Rise I Rise ! Why dost thou remain lying there in the face of this fresh insult ? To-day the rays of the suu fall ou Lanka without fear. Thy mace, that brilliaut weapon encircled with gold, like unto Surys, with which thou didst exterminate thy foes in battle, rcscmbling the thunderbolt of Iudra, which thou didst wield at thy whim to the destruction of the mauy ou the battle ficld, now lies shattered in a thousand pieces by Ramo’s arrows. Why dost thou lie embracing the earth like a loved one ? How is it that thou dost DOt address a word to me as if I were DO longer thy beloved ? “Woe unto me, whose heart did not split into a thousand pieces, riven by grief, when thou didst return to the five clcmcuts!” Thus did Maudodari lament, her eyes full of aud thereafter her heart overflowing with love, she swooned away, falling unconscious on Ravaua’s breast, like a llash of lightuiug striking a crimson cloud at dusk. Thereupon her companions, distressed, raised up her who was lamenting aud placing her in their midst, said : " O Queen, art thou Dot conversant with the uncertainty of fare in this world and how, in a moment, the fortune of kings may change?” To these words,

Maudodari replied with soba and cries, her pure and lovely face and her breast bathed in teats. Then Ramo said to Bibishaua : " Proceed with the obsequies of thy brother and oft'er conso lation to his wives ! " Thereafter the sagacious Bihisbaua, having re1lected within himself, made this auswer that was discreet, reasoned and in conformity with duty and uuderstaudiug, saying :-' he was a barbarian ', but when they learn of **RAVANA**'s wicked deeds, everyone will approve my conduct." Thus did he speak, and **RAMA**, full of joy, the foremost of those who are firm in their duty, answered Bibishana, who was skilled in speech, saying : " I seek thy welfare, since with thine aid I have been victotious, nevertheless it is essential that I should utter what is fitting, O Chief of the Titans I Though unjust and wicked, this night ranger was ever energetic, valiant and courageous in war. It is said that the Gods with Shatakratu at their head were not able to overcome him. He was magnanimous and powertill, this oppressor of the worlds. Death brings emnity to an end ; we have accomplished our purpose, let us perfotm the obsequies ; it is meet for me, as well as for thee, to do so. In accord with tradition, this ceremony should take place in thy presence. Perform this pious act speeclily, thou wilt receive much glory therefrom." At these words of Raghava, Bibishana hastened to carry out the funeral rites. Entering the City of Lanka, that **INDRA** among the Titans, Bibishana, began to prepare fot the Agnihotra Ceremony in honour of his brother. Carts, wood of varying essences, fire, utensils, sandal, logs of evety kind, fragrant gums, perfumes, cloths, jewels, pearls and coral were all assembled by him and he soon returned surrounded by titans, whereupon, accompomied by Malyavan,' he initiated the sacrifice. Having placed **RAVANA**, the supreme Lord of the Titans, wrapped in linen cloths on a golden bier, the Twice-botn with great pyre was built with pieces of Sandal and Padmaka Wood and grass, according to

tradition ; and he was covered with antelope skins. Thereafter, in honour of the King of the Titans, a rare offering was made to the ancestors and the altar was installed to the south-west with the sacred fire in its proper place. Then curd and clarified butter were poured on **RAVANA**'s shoulder and a wooden mortar placed at his feet with one berween his thighs ; vessels of wood and the lower and upper kindling sticks, with a spare pesde, were set there according to the prescribed rules. Now the titans sacrificed a goat in honour of their king, according to tradition, as taught by the great *Rishis*, and, having dipped a cloth in butter, they covered the face of their sovereign, who was adorned with garlands and sprinkled with perfumes. Thereafter Bibishana's companions, their faces bathed in tears, covered the body with cloths and every kind of roasted grain, whereupon Bibishana kindled the pyre according to the sacred rites and, having laved him with a cloth which had been previously wetted with water and mingled with linseed and sacrificial grass, he bowed down to him ; then he addressed the consorts of **RAVANA** again and again in order to console them, finally en tresting them to return home. And when they had aU re entered the City of Lanka, that **INDRA** among the Titans took up his place by **RAMA** in an attitude of reverence. **RAMA**, however, with his army, **SUGRIVA** and Lakshmans, rejoiced at the desth of his enemy, as the God who bean the Thunderbolt on the destruction of Vritra. Having laid aside the arrows and bow that Mahendra had bestowed upon him as also the massive armour, **RAMA**, the slayer of his foes, renounced his wrath, his adversary having been subdued, and once more assumed a geode mien. CHAPTER 14 Bibisluma is installed Ki"' of I.anka HAVING witnessed the death of Ravaoa, the Dews, Gandbarvas and Danavas mounted their respective chariots, discoursing on these matters. Conversing of Ravaoa's fearful end, the heroism of Ragbava, the courageous fighting of the monkeys,

the great valour of Maruti and **LAKSHMANA** and Sits's fidelity to her lord, those blessed ones returned joyfully from whence they bad come. Ragbava, however, sent back the celestial chatiot blazing like a 8ame that lndra bad lent him and took leave of Matali aftet offering his thanks to him. Then Sbakta's charioteer, dismissed by the mighty **RAMA**, mounting his celestial car, ascended into the sky. Matali having returned to heaven in his chariot, Ragbava, the foremost of car-warriors, in the height of felicity, embraced **SUGRIVA** and, having done so, accepted **LAKSHMANA**'s homage and returned to the camp amidst the acclamations of the monkey ranb. Thereafter Kakutstha addressed the son of **SUMITRA**, the devoted **LAKSHMANA**, the bearer of auspicious marks, who stood near him and said : " O Friend, install Bibishana as King of Lanb I On account of his loyalty, his zeal and the service he formerly rendered to us, my greatest desire is to see Bibishaoa, the youoger brother of Ravaoa enthroned in Lanb, O Dear One." At these words from the magnanimous Ragbava, Saumitri, full of joy, said :-" So be it ! " and speedily took up a golden jar which he placed in the hands of the foremost of monkeys. Thereafter that warrior commanded water to be drawn from the four seas and the monkeys went there in all haste and, having drawn water from the ocesns, returned as swifrly as thought. Then Saumitri, at Rams's command, lifting up an excellent jar, caused Bibishaoa to toke his place on a high seat and, following the injunctions laid down in the ascred texts, sur rounded by a crowd of his friends, with that water installed him as King of Lanb amidst the tits111. pi

CHAPTER 114

Bibishana is installed as King of Lanka

Bibisluma is installed Ki'" of I.anka HAVING witnessed the death of Ravaoa, the Dews, Gandbarvas and Danavas mounted their respective chariots, discoursing on these matters. Conversing of Ravaoa's fearful end, the heroism of Ragbava, the courageous fighting of the monkeys, the great valour of Maruti and **LAKSHMANA** and Sits's fidelity to her lord, those blessed ones returned joyfully from whence they bad come. Ragbava, however, sent back the celestial chatiot blazing like a 8ame that lndra bad lent him and took leave of Matali aftet offering his thanks to him. Then Sbakta's charioteer, dismissed by the mighty **RAMA**, mounting his celestial car, ascended into the sky. Matali having returned to heaven in his chariot, Ragbava, the foremost of car-warriors, in the height of felicity, embraced **SUGRIVA** and, having done so, accepted **LAKSHMANA**'s homage and returned to the camp amidst the acclamations of the monkey ranb. Thereafter Kakutstha addressed the son of **SUMITRA**, the devoted **LAKSHMANA**, the bearer of auspicious marks, who stood near him and said : " O Friend, install Bibishana as King of Lanb I On account of his loyalty, his zeal and the service he formerly rendered to us, my greatest desire is to see Bibishaoa, the youoger brother of Ravaoa enthroned in Lanb, O Dear One." At these words from the magnanimous Ragbava, Saumitri, full of joy, said :-" So be it ! " and speedily took up a golden jar which he placed in the hands of the foremost of monkeys. Thereafter that warrior commanded water to be drawn from the four seas and the monkeys went there in all haste and, having drawn water from the ocesns, returned as swifrly as thought. Then Saumitri, at Rams's command, lifting up an excellent jar, caused Bibishaoa to toke his place on a high seat and, following the injunctions laid down in the ascred texts, sur rounded by a crowd of his friends, with that water installed him as King of Lanb amidst the tits111. pi All the IDOIIkeys wciJ the titans assisted at Bibishana's in.stallation arui,

amidst unequalled ttansports of delight, they paid tribute to **RAMA**. Bibishana’s coumellon were exceedingly happy, as also the titans who were devoted to him and, being entbtoned King of Lanka, he, Raghava and **LAKSHMANA**, who accompanied him, experienced supreme satisfaction. Then the new monarch, having spoken graciously to bis subjectS, went to where **RAMA** was to be found. Theteaftet the people of the dty otfered him curds, parched rice, sweetmeats, roasted gnin and flowers, which he placed at the disposal of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, and Raghava, seeing Bibishana’s work accomplished and bis purpose attained, accepted all in deference to him. Then **RAMA** addressed the valiant **HANUMAN**, who resembled a mountain, as he stood before him with bowed head and joined palms, saying : " With the approval of the great King Bibishana, O My

CHAPTER 115

Hanuman carries Rama's Message to Sita

All the IDOIIkeys wciJ the titans assisted at Bibishana’s in.stallation arui, amidst unequalled ttansports of delight, they paid tribute to **RAMA**. Bibishana’s coumellon were exceedingly happy, as also the titans who were devoted to him and, being entbtoned King of Lanka, he, Raghava and **LAKSHMANA**, who accompanied him, experienced supreme satisfaction. Then the new monarch, having spoken graciously to bis subjectS, went to where **RAMA** was to be found. Theteaftet the people of the dty otfered him curds, parched rice, sweetmeats, roasted gnin and flowers, which he placed at the disposal of **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, and Raghava, seeing Bibishana’s work accomplished and bis purpose attained, accepted all in deference to him. Then **RAMA** addressed the

valiant **HANUMAN**, who resembled a mountain, as he stood before him with bowed head and joined palms, saying : " With the approval of the great King Bibishana, O My At the appearance of the mighty HanWIIIIIl, that Goddess remained silent, but thereafter, baving recognized him, she was delighted, and marking her trallquil looks, **HANUMAN** the fore most of IIIOilkeys, prepared to relate all that **RAMA** had said: " O Vaidehi, **RAMA** is well as also **SUGRIVA** and Lskshmana ; he enquires as to thy welre I His purpose is accomplished, he, the conquerer of his foes bas slain his adversary. Assisted by Bibishana and the monkeys, **RAMA**, with the skill and wiadom of Lskshmana, bas slain **RAVANA** despite his prowess, O Goddess I These are pleasant tidings but I will delight thee still further, O Divinity. lo this war, undertaken on thine account, O Virtuous **SITA**, **RAMA** bas achieved a great triumph I Take heart therefore, bave no further anxiety ; **RAVANA** is dead and Lanka subdued. Banishing sleep, I resolved to deliver thee and bridging the sea fuJfilled my vow. Do not fear now to be in **RAVANA**'s abode since Bibishana bas become the Lord of Lanka. Because of this, take courage, thou canst dwell peacefully in the palace ; **RAMA** himself is coming bither with a joyful step eager to see thee." At these tidings, the divine **SITA**, her face radiant as the moon on account of joy, was unable to utter a single word and that prince of monkeys enquired of **SITA**, who remained silent, saying: " or wbat art thou thinking, O Goddess, since thou dost not answer me? Thus interrogated by **HANUMAN**, **SITA**, fixed in the path of duty, in the height of joy, said in a voice broken with sobs : " Hearing these pleasant tidings of the triumph of my lord, for a moment joy rendered me speechless. Nay, assuredly, rellecting on it, O Plavamgama, I do not know wbat gift I can offer thee which would be equal to this I I know nothing on earth comparable to these bappy tidings or with wbat I can recompense thee fittingly. Gold, precious gems of

every kind, even a throne or any object in the Three Worlds cannot be measured against thy message ! " At these words of Vaidehi, the IDOIIkey, standing before her with joined palms, joyfuJJy rep6ed : " O Thou who art ever engsged in wbat is pleasant and advantageous to thy Lord and who desirest him to be victorious, Hearing this, Maitbili, the daughter of **JANAKA** adclreased theae llattering words to the Son of the Wind : " Thy speech which is characteristic, urbane and dictated by the eight-fold intelligence is worthy of thee. Thou, the exceed ingly virtuous son of Ani1a art deserving of praise ! Assuredly sttength, prowess, knowledge of the scriptures, courage, boldness, superior skill, energy, endurance, steadiness, con stancy and humility, these brillisnt qualities and many others are all to be found in thee ! " Unmoved by this praise, **HANUMAN**, standing before her with joined palms, addressed **SITA** respectfully and said : " With thy consent I will slay all those female titans who formerly taunted thee in thy misfortune, O Thou whose lord is a god. I know that those monsters of hideous shape and con duct, those cruel beings of savage looks, those grim-visaged titans, more than once addressed thee in threatening tones at **RAVANA**'s command. Grant me permission to strike down those barbarians of distorted features and fearful aspect. I shall beat them with my fists, heels, long arms, thighs and knees ; I shall tear them to pieces with my teeth, chew up their ears, pull out their hair, knock them down and destroy them, aince they have caused thee pain, O IUustrious Princess I I shall cxterminste those monsters who formerly insulted thee." Hearing **HANUMAN**'s words, the unfortunate **SITA**, friend of the distressed, reflecting carefWiy, asid to bim : " Who would be angry with women, who are dependent on a monarch who is their supporter, and who act on other's advice as mere servants or slaves, O Excellent Monkey ? All that has happened to me is on account of an evil fate and the consequence of some fault committed

formerly. One reaps the fruit of one's actions. Do not speak thus, O Long-armed Warrior, the path of destiny is inexorable I It was inevitable that these circum stances should overtake me and, in this conviction, I wish in compaasinn to protect the slaves of **RAVANA**. It was under the orders of that titan that these women ill-treated me. He being slain, they will no longer oppress me, O Son of Maruta. There is an ancient saying full of wisdnm which a bear uttered formerly in the presence of a tiger, hear it, O Plavamgama I " 'A superior being doea not render evil for evil, this is a 331 muim one should observe ; the ornament of virtuous persons is thm conduct. One should never harm the wicked ot the good or even criminals meriting death. A noble soul will ever exercise compassion even towards those who enjoy injuring others or those of auel deeds when they are actually committing them, who is without fault ? ' " Hearing these Wotds, **HANUMAN**, who was skilled in speech, said to **SITA**, the irreproachable of **RAMA** : " Thou art worthy of Raghava, thou, his chaste wife crowned with many virtues. O Goddess, command me to seek out **RAMA**!" On this, Vaidehi bom of **JANAKA**, said : " I desire to see my lord, the friend of his devotees ! " Hesring bet speak thus, **HANUMAN**, the cxceedingly intelligent son of Maruta made this reply to Maithili, causing that princesa great delight " This day shalt thou see **RAMA**, whose countenance resembles the full moon, with **LAKSHMANA** and his trusted friends, his enemies slain, as Sachi looks upon **INDRA**, the King of the Gods." Having spoken thus to **SITA**, who was as radiant as Shri herself, the cxceedingly valiant **HANUMAN** immediately departed to rejoin Raghava. Without delay, the foremost of monkeys, **HANUMAN**, repeated the words that the daughter of Janak had uttered, in thm proper sequence to **RAMA** who was the equal of the Chief of the Gods.

CHAPTER 116

Rama sends for Sita

muim one should observe ; the ornament of virtuous persons is thm conduct. One should never harm the wicked ot the good or even criminals meriting death. A noble soul will ever exercise compassion even towards those who enjoy injuring others or those of auel deeds when they are actually committing them, who is without fault ? ' " Hearing these Wotds, **HANUMAN**, who was skilled in speech, said to **SITA**, the irreproachable of **RAMA** : " Thou art worthy of Raghava, thou, his chaste wife crowned with many virtues. O Goddess, command me to seek out **RAMA**!" On this, Vaidehi bom of **JANAKA**, said : " I desire to see my lord, the friend of his devotees ! " Hesring bet speak thus, **HANUMAN**, the cxceedingly intelligent son of Maruta made this reply to Maithili, causing that princesa great delight " This day shalt thou see **RAMA**, whose countenance resembles the full moon, with **LAKSHMANA** and his trusted friends, his enemies slain, as Sachi looks upon **INDRA**, the King of the Gods." Having spoken thus to **SITA**, who was as radiant as Shri herself, the cxceedingly valiant **HANUMAN** immediately departed to rejoin Raghava. Without delay, the foremost of monkeys, **HANUMAN**, repeated the words that the daughter of Janak had uttered, in thm proper sequence to **RAMA** who was the equal of the Chief of the Gods. thy victory, expressed a desire to behold thee once more. Confiding in me formerly, her glances warm with emotion, she repeated ' I desire to see my lord again ! ' " These words of **HANUMAN** instantly evoked thoughts in **RAMA**, the first of men, causing bim to shed tesrs. Sighing deeply, he said to Bibishans standing near, who resembled a cloud : "Bring the Princess of Videha, **SITA**, bither, anointed with

celestial unguents, adorned with heavenly jewels, having Javed her head ; do not delay ! " At these words of **RAMA**, Bibishana hastened to the private apartments to fetch **SITA** with her attendants. Beholding the unfortunate Maithili, Bibishana, the powerful King of the Titans, paid obeisance to her, raising bis joined palms to bis forehead, and respectfully addressed her, saying: " O Vaidebi, sprinkle thyself with celestial unguents, adorn thyself with divine ornaments and ascend this palanquin I May happiness attend thee ! Thy lord desires to see thee ! " Then Vaidebi answered Bibishana who had addressed her thus, saying :-" Without having bathed, I wish to see my consort, O Bibishana." Hearing this, **BIBISHANA** *replied*:-" It behoveth thee to do what **RAMA** commands ! " Whereto the virtuous Maithili, who regarded her husband as a god, filled with conjugal duty, said : 'Be it sol' Thereupon **SITA**, her tresses waved, adorned with priceless ornaments, wearing gorgeous raiment, ascended a palanquin home by those titans accustomed to do so, aaompanied by a large escort under Bibishana's command. And Bibishana approaching that magnanimous hero, who was merged in meditation, bowing down to him, joyfully announced **SITA**'s arrival. Hearing that bis consort, who had dwelt long in the titan's abode, had come, rage, joy and grief overwhelmed Raghava, the alayer of bis foes and, beholding **SITA** in the palanquin, **RAMA**, in order to test her, diasembling bis happiness, said to Bibishana : " O Supreme Lord of the Titans, O My Friend who ever rejoiced in my victories, bring Vaidebi nearer to me." At Raghava's command, the righteous Bibishana caused the crowd to disperse, whereupon titans clad in armour, wearing 333 turbans, with drums and bamboo staves in their heads began to move about driving away the wurion, bean, monkeys and titanS, who, scattering, stood apart some way off. And as they were being driven away, a tremendous clamour arose resembling the roar of the sea

buffeted by the winds. Seeing them dispening, whilst confusion was created amongst them, **RAMA** in affection for them, grew indignant at their departure and, highly incensed, with a glance thst seemed as if it would consume him, addressed the exceedingly intelligent Bibishana in of reproacb, aaying : “Why, disregarding me, dost thou harass them, are they not my people ? Her conduct, not raiment, walls, seclusion or other royal prohibitions, are a woman’s shield. In times of calamity, peril, war, the Swyamvara or the nuptual ceremony, it is not forbidden to behold a woman unveiled. It is not prohibited to look upon a woman who has fallen into distress and difficulty, above all in my presence. Therefore, leaving the palanquin, let Vaidebi come hither on foot so thst the dwellers in the woods may see her at my side.” Hearing **RAMA**’s words, Bibishana became thoughtful and conducted **SITA** to him reverently, whilst **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA** and also **HANUMAN**, hearing **RAMA** spesk thus, were aaddened. Then Maithili, confused and shrinking within herself, approacbed her lord accompanied by Bibishana ; and it was with astonishment, delight and love thst **SITA**, whose husband was a god, gazed on **RAMA**’s gracious appearance, she whose own face was still beautiful. Beholding the countenance of her dearly loved lord, whom she had not seen for so long and whicb was as radiant as the full moon when it rises, she cast aside all anxiety and her own face became as fair as the immaculate orb of the night. CHAPTI!R 117

CHAPTER 117

Rama repudiates Sita

turbans, with drums and bamboo staves in their heads began to move about driving away the wurion, bean, monkeys and titanS, who,

scattering, stood apart some way off. And as they were being driven away, a tremendous clamour arose resembling the roar of the sea buffeted by the winds. Seeing them dispening, whilst confusion was created amongst them, **RAMA** in affection for them, grew indignant at their departure and, highly incensed, with a glance thst seemed as if it would consume him, addressed the exceedingly intelligent Bibishana in of reproacb, aaying : “Why, disregarding me, dost thou harass them, are they not my people ? Her conduct, not raiment, walls, seclusion or other royal prohibitions, are a woman’s shield. In times of calamity, peril, war, the Swyamvara or the nuptual ceremony, it is not forbidden to behold a woman unveiled. It is not prohibited to look upon a woman who has fallen into distress and difficulty, above all in my presence. Therefore, leaving the palanquin, let Vaidebi come hither on foot so thst the dwellers in the woods may see her at my side.” Hearing **RAMA**’s words, Bibishana became thoughtful and conducted **SITA** to him reverently, whilst **LAKSHMANA**, **SUGRIVA** and also **HANUMAN**, hearing **RAMA** spesk thus, were aaddened. Then Maithili, confused and shrinking within herself, approacbed her lord accompanied by Bibishana ; and it was with astonishment, delight and love thst **SITA**, whose husband was a god, gazed on **RAMA**’s gracious appearance, she whose own face was still beautiful. Beholding the countenance of her dearly loved lord, whom she had not seen for so long and whicb was as radiant as the full moon when it rises, she cast aside all anxiety and her own face became as fair as the immaculate orb of the night. CHAPTI!R 117 bas been defeated on the battlefield ; I have accomplished all that fortitude could do ; my wrath is appeased ; the insult and the one who ofl’eted it have both been obliterated by me. To-day my prowess has been manifested, to-day mine exertions have been crowned with success, to-day I have fulfilled my vow and am free. As ordained by destiny the stain of thy

separation and thine abduction by that ficlde...minded titan bas been expunged by me, a mortal. Of what use is great strength to the vacillating, who do not with resolution avenge the insult offered to them ? " To-day Hsnuman is pluclting the fruit of his glorious exploits, and **SUGRIVA**, who is valiant in war and wise in counsel, with his army is reaping the harvest of his exertions ! Bibishana too is culling the fruits of his labours, he wbo cast off a brother, who was devoid of virtue, to come to me." When Sits heard **RAMA** speak in this wise, her large doc-like eyes filled with tears and, beholding the beloved of his heart standing close to him, **RAMA**, who was apprehensive of public rumour, was tom within himself. Then, in the presence of the monkeys and the titans, he said to **SITA**, whose eyes were as large as lotus petals, her dark hair plaited, and who was endowed with fauldess limbs : " What a man should do in order to wipe out an insult, I have done by slaying **RAVANA** for I guard mine honour jealously ! Thou wert re-won as the southern region, inaccessible to man, was re-gained by the pure-souled Agastya through hia austerities. Be happy and let it be known that this arduous campaign, so gloriously terminated through the support of my friends, was not undertaken wholly for thy sake. I was careful to wipe out the affront paid to me completely and to avenge the insult offered to mine illustrious House. "A suspicion has arisen, however, with regard to thy conduct, and thy presence is as painful to me as a lamp to one whose eye is diseased ! Henceforth go where it best pleaseth thee, I give thee leave, O Daughter of **JANAKA**. O Lovely One, the ten regions are at thy disposal ; I can have nothing more to do with thee I What man of honour would give rein to his passion so far as to permit himself to take back a woman wbo bas dwelt in the house of another ? Thou hast been taken into **RAVANA**'s lap and he bas esst lnstlW glancea on thee ; how can I reclaim thee, I who 335 boast of belonging to an illustrious House ? The

end which I sought in re-conquering thee has been gained ; I no longer have any attachment for thee ; go where thou desirest ! This is the outcome of my reflections, O Lovely One I Turn to **LAKSHMANA** or **BHARATA**, **SHATRUGHNA**, **SUGRIVA** or the Titan Bibishana, make thy choice, O Sits, as plesaes thee best. Assuredly **RAVANA**, bebolding thy ravishing and celestial beauty, will not have respected thy person during the time that thou didst dwell in bis abode." On this, that noble lady, worthy of being addressed in words, hearing that harsh speech from her beloved lord, who for long had surrounded her with every homage, wept bitterly, and she resembled a creeper that has been torn away by the trunk of a great elephant. **SITA**' LammtatiOIIJ; She undergou the Ordeal by p;,.. HBAiuNo these harsh words from the wrathful Raghava, causing her to tremble, those fearful utterances, which till that time had never been hesrd by her and were now addressed to her by her lord in the presence of a great multitude, Maitbili, the daughter of **JANAKA**, overwhelmed with shame, pierced to the heart by that arrow-like speech, shed abundant tears. Thereafter, wiping her face, she addressed her husband in gende and faltering accents, saying: "Why dost thou address such worda to me, O Hero, as a common man addresses an ordinary woman ? I sweai to thee, O Long-armed Warrior, that my conduct is worthy of thy respect I It is the behaviour of other women that has filled thee with distrust I Relinquish thy doubts since I am known to thee I If my limbs came in contact with another's, it was against my will, O Lord, and not through any inclination on my part ; it was brought about by fate. That which is under my control, my heart, has ever remained faithful to thee ; my body was at the mercy of another ; not being mistress of the situation, what could

CHAPTER 118

Sita's Lamentations. She undergoes the Ordeal by Fire

boast of belonging to an illustrious House ? The end which I sought in re-conquering thee has been gained ; I no longer have any attachment for thee ; go where thou desirest ! This is the outcome of my reflections, O Lovely One I Turn to **LAKSHMANA** or **BHARATA**, **SHATRUGHNA**, **SUGRIVA** or the Titan Bibishana, make thy choice, O Sits, as plesaes thee best. Assuredly **RAVANA**, bebolding thy ravishing and celestial beauty, will not have respected thy person during the time that thou didst dwell in bis abode." On this, that noble lady, worthy of being addressed in words, hearing that harsh speech from her beloved lord, who for long had surrounded her with every homage, wept bitterly, and she resembled a creeper that has been torn away by the trunk of a great elephant. **SITA**' LammtatiOIIJ; She undergou the Ordeal by p;,.. HBAiuNo these harsh words from the wrathful Raghava, causing her to tremble, those fearful utterances, which till that time had never been hesrd by her and were now addressed to her by her lord in the presence of a great multitude, Maitbili, the daughter of **JANAKA**, overwhelmed with shame, pierced to the heart by that arrow-like speech, shed abundant tears. Thereafter, wiping her face, she addressed her husband in gende and faltering accents, saying: "Why dost thou address such worda to me, O Hero, as a common man addresses an ordinary woman ? I sweai to thee, O Long-armed Warrior, that my conduct is worthy of thy respect I It is the behaviour of other women that has filled thee with distrust I Relinquish thy doubts since I am known to thee I If my limbs came in contact with

another's, it was against my will, O Lord, and not through any inclination on my part ; it was brought about by fate. That which is under my control, my heart, has ever remained faithful to thee ; my body was at the mercy of another ; not being mistress of the situation, what could 336 I do ? If despite the prooti of love that I gave thee whilst I lived with thee, I am still a stranger to thee, O Proud Prince, my loss is irrevocable ! " When, in Lanka, thou didst dispatch the great warrior **HANUMAN** to seek me out, why didst thou not repudiate me then ? As soon as I had received the tidinga that I had been abandoned by thee, I should have yielded up my life in the presence of that monkey, O Heto ! Then thou wouldst have been spared useless fatigue on mine account and others lives would not have been sacrificed, nor thine innumerable friends exhausted to no purpose. But thou, O lion among Men, by giving way to wrath and by thus passing premature judgement on a woman, hast acted like a worthless man. " I have received my name from **JANAKA**, but my birth was from the earth and thou hast failed to appreciate fully the nobility of my conduct, O Thou who are well acquainted with the nature of others. Thou hast had no reverence for the joining of our hands in my girlhood and mine affectionate nature, all these things hast thou cast behind thee ! " Having spoken thus to **RAMA**, weeping the while, her voice strangled with sobs, **SITA** addressed the unfortunate Laksbmana, who was overwhelmed with grief, saying : " Raise a pyre for me, O Saumitri, this is the ouly remedy for my misery ! These unjust reproaches have destroyed me, I cannot go on living ! Publicly renounced by mine husband, who is insensible to my virtue, there is ouly one redress for me, to undergo the ordeal by fire ! " Hesring Vaidehi's words, Laksbmana, the slayer of hostile warriors, a prey to indignation, consulted Raghava with his glance and by Rams's gestures be understood what was in his heart, whereupon the valiant Saumitri,

following his indications, prepared the pyre. None amongst his friends dared to appeal to Rams, who resembled Death himself, the Destroyer of Time ; none dared to speak or even to look upon him. Thereafter Vaidehi, having circumambulated Rams, who stoOd with his head bowed, approached the blazing fire and, paying obeisance to the Celestials and brabmins, Maithili, with joined palms, standing before the flames, spoke thus : 337 “As my heart has never ceased to be true to Raghava, do thou, O Witness of all Beings, grant me thy protection I As I am pure in conduct, though Rams looks on me as sullied, do thou, O Witness of the Worlds, grant me full protection ! " With these words, Vaidehi circumambulated the pyre and with a fearless heart entered the flames. And a great multitude were assembled there, amongst which were many children and aged people 'who witnessed Maithili entering the tire. And, resembling gold that has been melted in the crucible, she threw herself into the blazing flames in the presence of all. That large-eyed lady, entering the fire, who is the Bearer of Sacrificial Offerings, appeated to those who watched her to resemble a golden altar. That fortunate princess entering the fire, which is nourished by oblations, seemed, in the eyes of the *Rishis*, Dcvas and Gandharvas, to resemble a sacriftcial offering. Then all the women cried out :-'Alas I ' on seeing her, like a stream of butter hallowed by the recitation of mantras, fall into the flames, and she appeated to the Three Worlds, the Gods, the Gandharvas and the Danavas like a goddess smitten by a curse and cast down from heaven into hell. Then, as she entered the flames, a great and terrible cry rose from the titanS and the monkeys.

CHAPTER 119

Brahma's Praise of Rama

Then the King Vaishravana ancl **YAMA** with the Pitris, the Thousand-eyed Lord of the Celestiala, Varona, Lord of the Waters and Mahadeva the blessed Three-eyed God who rides the Bull, as also **BRAHMA** the Creator of the World, King of the Learned, all gathered together, having hastened there in their chariots as bright as the sun, coming to the Qty of Lanka to seek out Rams. Lifting up their great arms and bands adorned with jewels, they made obeisance with joined palms and the King of the Gods addressing Ragbava, said : " O Creator of the Universe and foremost of those versed in the spiritual science, how canst thou manifest indifference to **SITA** falling into the aames ? How art thou unaware that thou thyself art the Chief of the Gods ? Formerly thou the Vasu Ritadhaman, the Progenitor of the Vasus I Thou art the Creator of the Three Worlds, Swyamprabhu, the eighth Rudra and the fifth of the Sadhyas. The Twin Ashwins are thy ears, the sun and moon thine eyes ; these are the forms at the beginning, middle and end of creation in which thou dost appear, O Scourge of Thy Foes; and yet thou dost distrUSt Vaidehi as if thou wert an ordinary man I " Thus addressed by the Protector of the Worlds, the Leader of the Gods, Raghava, Lord of Peoples, Foremost of the Pious, answered: " I deem myself to be a man, **RAMA**, hom of **DASARATHA** ; who then am I in reality ? From whence have I come ? Let the Grandsire of the World inform me ! " Thus spoke Kakutstha and Brahms, foremost of those who know the truth, addressed him saying : " Thou art the great and effulgent God Narayana, the fortunate Lord armed with the discus. Thou art the One Tusked Boar, the Conqueror of thy Foes in the past and the future. Thou art the imperishable *Brahman*, Existence Itself, transcending the three divisions of time ; Thou art the Law of Righteousneas, the Four-armed, the Bearer of the Shamga Bow ; Thou art the Subduer of the senses, the Supreme Purusha ; Thou art invincible, Thou art the Holder of the Dagger, Thou

art **VISHNU**, Thou art Krishna and of immeasurable might ; Thou art Senani and Gramani, the Controller of passions, the Origin and Dissolution ; Thou art Upendra and the Slayer of the Demon Madhu, Thou art the Creator of lndra and lndra Himself; Thou art the Lotus-navelled One ; Thou dost bring combat to an end. The great and divine *Rishis* acknowledge Thee as their refuge and protector. Thou art the Himalayas of a hundred peaks, the Essence of the Vedas, the God of a Hundred Tongues, the Great Bull, Thou thyself art the Creator of the 339 World, Swyamprabhu; Thou art the Refuge and Bider of the Siddhas and Sadhyas ; Thou art the Sacrifice, the sacred syllable' Vashat' and 'Aum ',the greatest nf the great. None knowll thine origin or end or who Thou really an. Thou art manifest in all beings, in the cows and the *brahmins* ; Thou pervadest all regions, the firmament, the mountains and the rivers, Thou, the Thousand-footed God, the Thousand-headed One, Thou of a Thousand Eyes I Thou art the suppon of all beings and the eanh. When the eanh is withdrawn, under the form of a great serpent, Thou dost appear on the waters suppon ing all the worlds and the Gods, Gandharvas and Danavas, O Rams. I am thy heart and the Goddess Saraswati, thy tongue ; the Gods are the hairs nf Thy body, I, Brahms created them thus. When Thou dost close thine eyes, it is night and when Thou dost open them, it is day. The Vedas are Thy Samskaras nothing exists apart from thee ; the whole universe is Thy body, the eanh Thy forbearance; **AGNI** Thy wrath, *Soma* Thy beneficence, the Shrivatsa Mark, Thy holy symbol. " Thou didst cover the Three Worlds in three strides; Thou didst bind the terrible Bali and establish Mahendra as King. Sits is Laksbmi and Thou, the God Vishou, Krishos and Prajapati. It was in order to slay **RAVANA** that Thou didst enter a human body. This taak that we entrusted to Thee has been accomplished, O Thou, the foremost nf those who observe their duty.

RAVANA having fallen, do Thou ascend to heaven joyfully I Thy might is irresistible, O Rams, and thine exploits are never fruidess. To behold Thee and otrer adoration to Thee is never unprofitable ! It is not in vain that men are devoted to Thee on eanh. Those who are ever faithful to Thee, attain to Thee who art the primeval Purusha and their desires will be fulfilled in this world and the other worlds. Those who recite this eternal, ancient and traditional theme, transmitted by the *Rishis*, will never suffer defeat."

CHAPTER 120

Sita is restored to Rama

Pyre, rose up, and that Bearer of Sacrificial Offerings, assuming a corporeal form, stood up and took hold of the daughter of **JANAKA**. Then that youthful woman, beautiful as the dawn, wearing ornaments of refined gold, attired in a red robe, having dark and curly hair, wearing fresh garlands, the irreproachable Vaidcbi was restored to **RAMA** by the God of Fire. Thereafter the Witness of the whole world, Pavaka, addressed **RAMA**, saying : " Here is Vaidcbi, O **RAMA**, there is no sin in her ! Neither by word, feeling or glance has thy lovely consort shown herself to be unworthy of thy noble qualities. Separated from thee, that unfortunate one was borne away agsinst her will in the lonely forest by **RAVANA**, who had grown proud on account of his power. Though imprisoned and closely guarded by titan women in the inner apartments, thou wast ever the focus of her thoughts and her supreme hope. Surrounded by hideous and sinister women, though tempted and threatened, Maithili never gave place in her heart to a single thought for that titan and was solely absorbed in thee. She is pure and without taint,

do thou receive Maithili ; it is my command that she should not suffer reproach in any way.” These words filled Ramo’s heart with delight and he, the most eloquent of men, that loyal soul, rcllected an instant within himself, his glance full of joy. Then the illustrious, steadfast and exceedingly valiant **RAMA**, the first of virtuous men, hearing those worda addressed to him, said to the Chief of the Gods : " On account of the people, it was imperative that **SITA** should pass through this trial by fire ; this lovely woman had dwelt in **RAVANA**’s inner apartments for a long time. Had I not put the innocence of Janaki to the test, the people would have said : ' **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA** is governed by luar I ' It was well z 341 known to me tbat **SITA** had never given her heart to another and tbat the daughter of **JANAKA**, Maithili, was ever devoted to me. **RAVANA** was no more able to infiuence tbat large-eyed lady, whose chastity was her own protection, than the ocean may pass beyond its bournes. Despite his great perversity, he was unable to approach Maithili even in thought, who was inaccessible to him as a flame. That virtuous woman could never belong to any other than myself for sbe is to me what the light is to the sun. Her purity is manifest in the Three Worlds ; I could no more renounce Maithili, born of **JANAKA** than a hero his honour. It behoveth me to follow your wise and friendly counsel, O Gracious Lords of the World.” Having spoken thus, the victorious and extremely powerful **RAMA**, full of glory, adored for his noble exploits, was re-united with his beloved and experienced the felicity he had merited.

CHAPTER 121

Dasaratha appears to Rama

" **O** Lotus-eyed One, O Thou the possessor of long arms and a broad chest, O Scourge of Thy foes, fortunate it is tbat thou hast accomplished this great feat, O Most Pious of Men I " O **RAMA**, it is well for all beings tbat thou hast dispelled this deep and dreadful darkness of the whole world, this fear created by **RAVANA**. Go now and console the unfortunate **BHARATA** with thy presence, the illustrious Kausbalya, **KAIKEYI** and **SUMITRA**, the mother of Lakahmana. Rule over Ayodhya, giving satisfac tion to thiue innumerable friends and establish the dynasty of the Ikshvaku Race. O Mighty Hero, having performed the Asbvamedha Sacrifice and acquired supreme renown, having distributed wealth among the brshmins, do thou attain the highest State. " Behold King Dasaratba standing in his chariot, thy aire, thy superior in the world of men, O Kakutstba ! Having crossed the 342 sea of relativity by thy grace, full of gloty he baa entered the region of **INDRA** ; with thy brother Labhmana pay homage to him!" Hearing the words of Mahadeva, Raghava who was accom panied by **LAKSHMANA**, bowed before his sire, who was standing in his aerial car on high, and that prince with his brother **LAKSHMANA** beheld his sire blazing in his own elfulgence, clad in spotless raiment. With extreme delight, King **DASARATHA**, standing in his charint, once again beheld his son who was as dear to him as his own life and that long-armed warrior, on his seat, took him in his lap and embracing him, said : " Far from thee I do not prize the heaven in which I dwell with the Gods, O **RAMA**, this is the truth I O Most Eloquent of Men, the words addressed to me by **KAIKEYI**, which were designed to effect thy banishment, have never been erased from mine heart I Embracing thee and Labhmana and beholding thee well and happy, I am delivered from mine allliction as the sun when the mist has been disPelled. By thy grace, O My Son, thou who art truly filial and of noble soul, I am redeemed, as was the virtuous

Brahmin Kahola by Ashtavakra. Now it is made clear to me, O Dear Child, that in order to destroy **RAVANA**, the Gods determined that the supreme Purusha should become incarnate as man. “Assuredly **KAUSHALYA** will see all her desires fulfilled, O **RAMA**, when she beholds thee returning from the forest, O Slayer of Thy Foes. O **RAMA**, the people, seeing thee returning to the city and installed as king and ruler of the world, will indeed be blessed ! I desire to see thee -united with **BHARATA**, thy devoted, valiant, pure and loyal brother. Thou hast passed fourteen years in the forest with my beloved **SITA** and **LAKSHMANA**, O Dear Child. The term of thine ezile is over, thy vows honoured, and further, by slaying **RAVANA** on the battlefield, thou hast gratified the Gods. Thy task is accomplished ; thou hast won infinite renown, O Slayer of Thy Foes ; now, installed as king, mayest thou with thy brothers live for a long time ! " With joined palms, paying obeisance to King **DASARATHA**, who had thus addressed him, **RAMA** *answered*: " O VIrtUous Sire, give thy blessings to **KAIKEYI** and **BHARATA** I Thou didst pronounce a terrible curse upon them, saying :-' I THE RAMAYANA ()p VALMIKI renounce thee thy son I , may this malediction not fall on **KAIKEYI** or her son, O Lord.” ' Be it so ! ' replied that great monarch, paying obeisance with joined palms to **RAMA** who had spoken thus, and thereafter embracing Labhmaaa, he said to him: " Thou hast acquired extreme merit, O Pious One, and thy fame will he great on earth ; by **RAMA**’s grace thou shalt attain heaven thy power shall he inconceivable. Attend on **RAMA** and he happy, O Thou who an the increaser of **SUMITRA**’s delight. Rsma is ever engaged in the welfare of aU beings. The Three Worlds with their Indras, the Siddhas and the great *Rishis* do honour to that great hero and adore him as the supreme Purusha. He, thy brother, is the invincible, imperish able *Brahman*, the essence of the Veda, which is secret, and the Inner Ruler of aU, O Dear

Child ! Thou hast acquired great merit glory in serving him the Princess of Videha with devotion!" Having spoken thus to Labhmaaa, the King paid obeisance to **SITA** who stood before him with joined palms, and addressed her in gentle tones, saying : " My Daughter, do not take it ill that **RAMA** renounced thee I O Vaidebi, he aeted thus in thine own interest in order to demonstrate thine innocence ! The proof of thy chaste conduct, which thou hast given to-day, places thee above aU other women. O My Daughter, thou hast no need to he instrueted regarding thy duty towards thy husband, nevertheless I mnst teU thee that he is the Supreme God."

CHAPTER 122

On Rama's Request, Indra restores the Army

DASAIIATHA having departed, Mahendra, the Vanquisher of Paka, addressed Raghava, who stood before him with joined palms, and said : " O **RAMA**, O Lion among Men, our presence here must not prove unfruitful ; we are pleased with thee ; ask what thou desirest!" Hearing these magnanimous words of the blessed Mahendra, Raghava, of compassionate soul, answered him joyfully : " Since thou wishest to gratify me, O Chief of the Vibudhas, giant me that which I ask of thee ! O Most Eloquent of Orators, let all the valiant monkeys, who for my sake descended into the region of death, be resuscitated and live again. I wish to see all those monkeys happy, who for my sake left their sons and wives, O Great Lord. " Those courageous monkeys, those heroes who courted death and, crowning their sacrifice, succumbed, do thou restore to life, O Purandara ! Devoted to mine interests they disregarded death ; be gxacious enough to give them back to their fiunilies ; I solicit this

favour of thee I I wish to see the Golangulas and the Bears in all their former energy, freed from their sufferings and their wounds, O Munificent God. Let there be llowers, roots and fruits, even though they be out of season, and rivers with pure water in abundance wherever the monkeys are to be found." Heariog these words of the magnanimous Raghava, Mahendra answered graciously : THE : Wielder of the Great Bow, may the trees be laden with fruit and flowers even out of season and the rivers be full of pure water." Thereupon those excellent monkeys, who were formerly covered with wounds, rose up hesled, as persons who have been asleep, and there was general astonishment amongst the monkeys, who questioned each other, saying, ' What is this ? ' Seeing his purpose fulfilled, the Gods, in an excess of joy, unanimously addressed **RAMA**, who was accompanied by Laksh mana, praising him and saying : " Now to Ayodhya, O KiDg and disband the monkeys ; do thou console the devoted and illustrious Maithili I Seek out thy brother **BHARATA** who, in sorrow of thy separation, hss given himaelfuptopenances. ApproachthemagnanimousShstrughna and all thy mothers, O Scourge of Thy Foes ! Be installed as king and rejoice the hearts of the citizens by thy return ! " Having spoken thus to **RAMA** who was accompanied by Saumitri, the Gods, paying obeisance to him, joyfully returned to heaven in their chariots blazing like the sun ; and **RAMA** with his brother ordered the encampment of the army. Thereafter, under **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**'s protection, that great and glorious company of hsppy people, radiant with splendour, resembled the night illumined on all sides by that orb of cool rays.

CHAPTER 123

Bibishana places the Chariot Pushpaka at Rama's disposal

HAVING passed the night, **RAMA** the conqueror of his foes, rose hsppily and Bibishsna, paying obeisance to him with joined palms, addressed him, saying : " Here are various articles for bathing such as unguents, ornaments, sandalwood paste, rahDent and celestial garlands of every kind. Lotus-eyed women, veraed in the art of applying perfume await thy pleasure, as is fitting, O :Raghsva I " At these words, Kakutstha answered Bibishsna saying : " Do thou invite the foremost of the monkeys and **SUGRIVA** to bathe first, for the pious **BHARATA**, aaustomed to hsppiness, thst 346 youthful and loyal hero is suft'ering on mine account. Far from **BHARATA**, Ksikeyi's son, who bas been loyal to his duty, I do not value bathing or raiment or jewels ! Order it so that we may rerum to Ayodhya soon, assuredly the route is extremely arduous." Thus did **RAMA** speak and **BIBISHANA** *answered*: "I will arrange for thee to reach that city in one day, O Prince ! May happiness attend thee ! There is an aerisl car named Pushpaka that shines like the sun, which the powerful **RAVANA** forcibly took from Kuvera, having overcome him in combat. That celestial and marvellous chariot, going everywhere at will, is at thy disposal, O Thou of unequalled prowess ! That car, bright as a cloud, which will transport thee to Ayodhya in perfect safety, is here. But if I am worthy of a boon, if thou dost recall any merit in me, then remain here for at least one day, O Virtuous One. If thou bast any friendship for me, then remain here with thy brother Lakshmans and Vaidehi, thy consort. Having received all possible homage, O **RAMA**,

thou shalt depart. I have prepared those honours dictated by mine affection, O **RAMA**, do thou enjoy them with thine innumerable friends and thine army also. I beg thee in all humility, out of my profound esteem and feeling of friendship for thee, O Raghava ; I am thy servant and therefore may command thee." Then **RAMA** answered Bibishana, who had spoken thus in the presence of all the titans and liiOIIkeys and said : " O Hero, Thou hast honoured me with thy friendship with thine whole soul and in all thine actions bast proved thy supreme affection for me. Nevertheless I cannot accept thy request. O King of the Titans, because m.Y heart urges me to see my brother **BHARATA** again, he who came to Chitrrakuta in order to bring me back to Ayodhya though, as he bowed before me, I did not listen to his appeal. I wish to see Ksushalya, **SUMITRA** and the illus trious Ksikeyi, as also mine house, my friends, the people of the city and the country. Grant me leave, O Dear Bibishana, Thou hast paid me sufficient honour I Do not be angry, O My Friend, I beg of thee. O Foremost of the Titans, prepare the aerial car speedily, my task bas been accomplished, what justification is there for remaining here longer ? " Hearing Ramo's words, that **INDRA** among the Titans, Bibi 347 shana, hastcaed to order the aerial Olariot Pushpaka, gilded and bright as the sun, with its seats of emerald and pearl, its rooms ranged round about, silvered aU over, its white banners and supports and gilded apartments enriched with golden lotuses which were hung with many bells. Round the windows, set with peatls and rare gems, rows of bells were placed giving forth a melodious sound, and that moving palace, resembling the peak of Mount Meru, constructed by Vishvalwma, abounded in rich ornaments, gold and jewels and sparkled with silver, and its ftoors were inlaid with crystal and the thrones of emerald (*displayed there*) furnished with rare coverings. Having prepared that indestructible vehicle, the Chariot Pushpaka, which was as

swift as thought, Bibisbana stood before Ramo, and that aerial car, that went everywhere at one’s will and resembled a mountain, having been placed at his disposal, the magoanimous Ramo who was accompanied by Saumitri, was astonished.

CHAPTER 124

Rama sets out for Ayodhya

THE Chariot Pushpaka, having beeo prepared and adorned with flowers, Bibishana, who stood a little way oft’ with joined palma, reverently enquired of Ramo with some urgency, saying: " What shall I do now, O Raghava ? " Theo the supremely illuotrious Raghava, having reflected awhile, in the preseoceofLabhmana, madeanowc!r affectionately, saying: " All the inhabitants of the wood have brought about the fulfilment of my miasion by their elforts ; O Bibiohana, do thou gratify them abundantly with jewelo and riches of every kind. With their support thou hast recapruted Lanka, O Sovereign of the Titans I Full of ardour, they did not fear to cpooe their lives nor did they ever retreat in combat. They have fu1fi11ed their taok ; now reward them by distributing gold and gems among them. When, in thy gratitude, thou hast loaded them with gifts, the monkeys will be fully satiofied. 341 " Thou dou bow how to give llld how to receive, thou art liberalllld master of thy senses, all know thee to be a renunciate, it is for this that I address thee llld exhort thee, O Prince ; a king will wage war in vain llld his army ablldon him at the first opportunity if he be wholly devoid of those qualities that render him pleasing to all.” Hearing **RAMA**’s words, Bibishana bestowed precious gems and riches of every kind in abundance on all the moukeys llld, beholdiDg the foremost of the

monkeys loaded with jewels llld silver, **RAMA** ascended the chariot of his adversaty, holding the chaste and illustrious Vaidehi to his breast and accompanied by his brother **LAKSHMANA**, that valiant bow-man. Standing in the chariot, Kakutstha bade farewell to all the monkeys, to the mighty **SUGRIVA** and to Bibishana llld said : " O Foremost of Monkeys, you have accomplished all that could be asked of a friend, now go where you will, I give you all leave to depart. O **SUGRIVA**, thou who fearest nought but unrighteousness, thou hast done all that a devoted llld loyal companion could do ; return to Kisbkinda at the head of thine army. And thou, Bihishana, occupy the throne of Lanka that I have conferred upon thee. Even the inhabitants of heaven and their chiefs will not be able to trouble thee. I go to Ayodhya, that was the royal residence of my sire llld wish to take leave of you all llld to offer you my salutations ! " Thus did **RAMA** speak and all the leaders of the monkeys llld the monkeys themselves also the Titan Bibishana, paying obeiaance with joined palms, answered : “We desire to go to Ayodhya, take us all with thee! We sball delight in ranging the woods llld copses llld assisting at thine installation, of which thou art worthy. Having paid obeisance to the Queen **KAUSHALYA**, we sball return to our homes without delay, O Greatest of Kings I " Thus did they speak llld the virtuous **RAMA** answered the monkeys, **SUGRIVA** and Bibishana, saying : " Nothing would be more agreeable to me, as also to mine innumerable friends, than to return to the capital with you all. Hasten to take thy place with thy monkeys in the chariot, O **SUGRIVA**, llld thou too, O Bihishana with thy ministers, O King of the Titana.” THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI Thereupon **SUGRIVA** with the monkeys and Bibishana with his counsellors, took their places in the celestial Pushpaka Chariot and, all being installed, that marvellous aerial car belonging to Kuveta rose into the air under R.aghava’s command. In the chariot, which shone

brightly, and was harnessed to swans, **RAMA** exulted, overcome with delight, and resembled Kuveta himself, whilst all the monkeys, besrs and titans, full of vigour, seated comfortably in that celestial car travelled at ease.

CHAPTER 125

Rama tells Sita of the Places over which they are passing

the Raghus, letting fall his glance on every side, said to the Princess of Mithila, **SITA**, whose face resembled the moon: " See how Lanka has been constructed by Vishvakarma on the summit of the Trikuta Mountain, which resembles the peak of Mount Kailaaha. Behold the battlefield covered with a mire of flesh and blood; there, O **SITA**, a great carnage of monkeys and titans took place. There lies the ferocious King of the Titans, Ravaoa, who, despite the boons he had received, was slain by me on thine account, O Large-eyed Lady. " Here **KUMBHAKARNA** was struck down as also another ranger of the night ; Prahasta and Dhumraksha perished here under the blowa of the monkey, **HANUMAN**. Vidyunmalin was put to desth at this apot by the great-souled Sushens, and in another, Laksh-innumerable other titans perished here and the invincible Mah.araksha whom I slew in combat ; and Akampanawas slain and the powerful Shonitaksha whilst Yupaksha and Prajangha also succumbed in the great struggle. Vidyujjihva, a titan of fesrful aspect fell there and Yajnashatru died also; the migbty Suptaghna too, as also Suryashatru, were slain with **BRAHMA** shatru, who had no equsl,and here **MANDODARI**'s consort, for whom she wept surrounded by her companions to the number of a thousand or more. " Here is the place

where the ocean was traveraed, O Lady of Lovely Looks, and, having passed over the sea, there is the spot where the night was spent. There the bridge that I had thrown mysel£ Let all come, O King, and make baste to depart, O **SUGRIVA** I" Hearing **RAMA**'s command, he whose energy was immeaaur· able, **SUGRIVA**, the illustrious monarch of the monkeys, attended by his ministers entered the inner apartments and, seeing Tara, said to her : " O Dear One, at the command of Rsghava, who wishes to gratity Vaidehi, do thou speedily assemble the coQsorts of the magnanimoiiS monkeys so that they may leave for Ayodhya to visit the wives of King **DASARATHA**." Hearing **SUGRIVA**'s words, Tara, of beautiful limbs, gathered all the female monkeys together and said to them : " **SUGRIVA** comma!lds to leave for Ayodhya; do me the fitvour of acxompanying me and witness the entry of **RAMA** in the midst of the people from town and CDU!Itry and the splendour of the wives of **DASARATHA**." ThiiS commanded by Tara, the female monkeys, having first adorned themselves and circumambulated her, ascended the car, anxioiiS to bebold **SITA**, and that aerial chariot at once rose into the air with them. Then Raghava, gazing down on all sides, havillg reached the vicinity ofRishyamnka, ooce more addressed Vaidehi, saying: " O **SITA**, here is a great moUIItain resembling a clo11d rent by lighming, aboUIIding in gold and other metals. It is here that I palms, as also Sbarabhauga's hermitage where the God of a Thousand Byes, the Destroyer of Oties, entered in secret. O Goddess of slender waist, behold the ascetics with Atri at their head, the equal of **SURYA** and Vaislmava; in that place the Giant Viradha fell under my blows and there, O **SITA**, thou didst visit the virtuous Sage. See, O Lady of beautiful form, the King of Mountains, Chittrakuta, appears ; it is there that the son of Kaikeya came to crave my forgiveness. Here is the enchanting Yamuna with its ravishing woods and here the retreat of Bharadwajalooms into

view, O Maithili. Now we are in sight of the Ganges, that three-branched sacred river. There is the Oty of Shringavera where my friend, Guha, dwells, and there, the River Sarayu with rows of stone pillars on its banks commemorating the Kings of the House of Ikshvaku ! Behold there the royal abode of my Sire ! O Vaidehi, bow down to Ayodhya, we have returned ! " During this time the monkeys and the titans were leaPing about in delight on seeing that city and, with the palaces with which it abounded, its wide spaces and the elephants and horses that filled it, Ayodhya appeared to the monkeys and titanS to resemble Amaravati, the city of the mighty lndra.

CHAPTER 126

Rama's Meeting with the Sage Bharadwaja

THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI awaits thy return. In the presence of thy aandals, to which he pays homage, he rules all in the best intereSts of thy family and counuy. " Beholding thee clad in batk, setting out on foot, thy consort lll8king the third,' banished from thy kingdom, entirely devoted to thy duty, obedient to the behests of thy sire, renounciDg every pleasure, like unto a God driven from heaven, formerly I was filled with pity for thee; then, O Victorious Warrior, thou, dispossessed by **KAIKEYI**, nourished thyself on fruits and roots ; but now I see thee, thy purpose accomplished surrouoded by friends and kinafolk, having triumphed over thine enemy and my joy is supreme ! " I know all that thou hast aperienced of good and ill whilst dwelling in Janasthana, O R.aghava, and how, engaged in procuring the weltVe of the Sages, seeking to protect them all, thine irreproachable consort was borne away by R.avana. know of the appearance of Maricha and Sits’s

delusion ; the meeting with Kabandha ; thine arrival at Lake Pampa, the alliance with **SUGRIVA** when Bali fell under thy blows ; the search for Vaidehi and the aploit of the Wind-god's son; the construc tion of the causeway by NaJa and the finding of Vaidehi ; how Lanka was set on fire by the foremost of the monkeys whilst he was bound ; how R.avana, proud of his strength, fell in the light with his sons, kinafolk, ministers, infanuy and cavalty ; how after the death of R.avana, who was a thorn in the side of the Gods, thou didst meet the Celestisls and receive a hoon from them ; all these things I know by virtue of my penances, O Hero, O Thou who art fixed in virtue. " Therefore I have sent my disciples to carry the news to the city and I too will grant thee a boon, O Most Skilfol ofWarriors ; but first accept theArghya, to-morrow thou shalt go to Ayodhya," Hearing these words, the illustrious prince, with bowed head, answered joyfully,' It is well!' and made the following request : " On the road I tske to reach Ayodhya, though it is not the season, yet may all the trees bear honeyed fruits and those fruits Thereupon the **SAGE** *replied*: " So be it I Thy desire shall be realised immediately I " Then the of tbat region instantly resembled those of Paradise. Those tbat had none, grew ftuim, and those tbat bad no llowen were coveted with blossom ; tbat bad withered were enveloped with foliage and all dripped with honey fur three lesgues along the way. Meanwhile the furemost of the monkeys regaled themselves on those celestial fruits to the extent of their desire and, transported with joy, imagirled they bad entered heaven. CHAPTBII 127 **RAMA** sends H_,., to suk out Bluzrata WHEN he beheld Ayodbya, tbat descendant of Raghu of rapid step fuU of magnanimity, gave himself up to pleasant thoughts and, having re11ected awhile, tbat furtunate and illuatrious hero said to the monkey, **HANUMAN** : " Hasten with all speed to Ayodhya, O Foremost of Monkeys, and ascertain if all are happy in the royal palace. Passing

Shsingavera, communicate with Guba, King of the Nisbadas, who dwells in a wooded country, and offer him my salutstions. When he hears tbat I am safe and well, freed from all anxieties, he will be content, fur he is my second self and my friend. He will gladly show thee the way to Ayodbya and give thee tidings of **BHARATA**. Do thou enquire of **BHARATA** as to his well-being and inform him tbat I have returned with my consnrt and Llbh mana, my mission accomplished. Tell him of Sire's abduction by the ruthless **RAVANA**, of my meeting with **SUGRIVA** and the death of Bali in combat ; of how I set out to find Maithili and how thou didst discover her, having aossed the great waters of tbat domain of the uncbaogesble Lord of Rivers I Tell him of our arrival on the shores of the sea, the appearance of Sagara and how the causeway was constructed ; how **RAVANA** perished ; of the boons bestowed on me by Mahendra, **BRAHMA** and **VARUNA** and, by the favour of Mabadeva, the meeting with my Sire.

CHAPTER 127

Rama sends Hanuman to seek out Bharata

Thereupon the **SAGE** *replied*: " So be it I Thy desire shall be realised immediately I " Then the of tbat region instantly resembled those of Paradise. Those tbat had none, grew ftuim, and those tbat bad no llowen were coveted with blossom ; tbat bad withered were enveloped with foliage and all dripped with honey fur three lesgues along the way. Meanwhile the furemost of the monkeys regaled themselves on those celestial fruits to the extent of their desire and, transported with joy, imagirled they bad entered heaven. CHAPTBII 127 **RAMA** sends H_,., to suk out Bluzrata WHEN he beheld Ayodbya, tbat descendant of

Raghu of rapid step fuU of magnanimity, gave himself up to pleasant thoughts and, having re11ected awhile, tbat furtunate and illuatrious hero said to the monkey, **HANUMAN** : " Hasten with all speed to Ayodhya, O Foremost of Monkeys, and ascertain if all are happy in the royal palace. Passing Shsingavera, communicate with Guba, King of the Nisbadas, who dwells in a wooded country, and offer him my salutstions. When he hears tbat I am safe and well, freed from all anxieties, he will be content, fur he is my second self and my friend. He will gladly show thee the way to Ayodbya and give thee tidings of **BHARATA**. Do thou enquire of **BHARATA** as to his well-being and inform him tbat I have returned with my consnrt and Llbh mana, my mission accomplished. Tell him of Sire's abduction by the ruthless **RAVANA**, of my meeting with **SUGRIVA** and the death of Bali in combat ; of how I set out to find Maithili and how thou didst discover her, having aossed the great waters of tbat domain of the uncbaogesble Lord of Rivers I Tell him of our arrival on the shores of the sea, the appearance of Sagara and how the causeway was constructed ; how **RAVANA** perished ; of the boons bestowed on me by Mahendra, **BRAHMA** and **VARUNA** and, by the favour of Mabadeva, the meeting with my Sire. 355 Inform Bbarata, O My Frieud, that I am coming accompanied by King Bibisbana and the Lord of the Monkeys. Say to him, ' Haviog overcome the army of the enemy and attained a glory without parallel, **RAMA**,his purpose accomplished, is approaching with his valiant frieuds '. Do thou carefully observe the expres sion on the face of Bbarata when he hears these tidings and how he comports himself. Thou wilt know all by his gestures, the colour of his face, his glances and his words. Whose mind would not be moved by the thought of (*ascending*) an ancestral throne, fulfiUing all one's dreams, and to a kingdom abounding in prosperity, hosts of elephants, horses and chariots

? If the fortunate Bbarata wishes to reigo in his owo right, theo, by mutual agreement, let that descendant of Raghu govern the entire earth ! " On receiviog these instructions, **HANUMAN**, born of Maruta, assuming human form, left in all haste for Ayodhya and advanced with speed, lilte unto **GARUDA** swooping on a grest serpent on which he wishes to lay hold. Traversing the path-way of his sire, the shining abode of grest birds and, crossing over the formidable confiuence of the Ganges and the Yamuna, he reached the City of Shringavera. Then the valiant **HANUMAN** sought out Guba and said to him, his voice ringing with joy : " Thy friend, Kakutstha, that true hero who is accompanied by **SITA** as also Saumitri, enquires as to thy welfare. Having spent the fifth night of the moon with the Sage Bbaradwaja, on his request, Ragbava has now taken leave of him and thou wilt see him to-morrow." Having said this, the illustrious and agile Hauuman, whose observed Bharam, clad in a black antelope skin, sad, emaciated, wearing matted loeb, his limbs besmeared with dust, dwelling in a hermitage, a1llicted on account of his brother's misfortune. Living on fruit and roots, practising penance, self-controlled, his hair knotted, dtessed in bark and a black antelope skin, disciplined, pure of soul, like unto a Brabmarishi in radiance, he, having placed **RAMA**'s aanda1a befOre him, ruled the earth by protecting the four castes from every peril with the aid of his ministers, and virtuous priests and senior officers wearing red robes surrounded him. And his subjectS, wtb1W to their duty, had molved not to neglect the welfare of their king, who resembling, righteousness itself, seemed to be the God of *Dharma* incarnate. Then **HANUMAN**, paying obeisance with joined palms, said to that loyal prince : " Thy brother, Kakutstha, for whose exile to the Forest of Dandaka in robes of bark and matted loeb, thou grievest, enquires as to thy welfare. I bring thee good tidings, O Prince, abandon thy despair ; the moment has come when thou wilt be

re-united with thy brother **RAMA**. Having slain **RAVANA** and recovered Maithili, Raghava is returning with his valiant friends, his purpose accomplished. The mighty **LAKSHMANA** too is coming and the illustrious Vaidehi, **RAMA**'s devoted companion, as Sachi is to Mahendra." Hearing **HANUMAN**'s words, **BHARATA**, the snn of .**KAIKEYI** swooned with joy, felicity causing him to lose consciousness. In a moment, however, the desccodant of Raghu, Bharam, rose up breathing with an effort and addressed **HANUMAN** who bad brought him those pleasant tidings. Deeply moved, the fortu nate **BHARATA**, embracing the mnnkey bedewed him with his Hearing from that Prince of Monkeys of the miraculous return ofRama, Bbarata, whose desite to behold his brother again tluew him into a transport of delighr, added joyfully :

CHAPTER 128

Hanuman tells Bharata of all that befell Rama and Sita during their Exile

" VERILY it is with joy that I learn these tidings of my protector after the innumerable years that he bas passed in the foRSt. How felicitous is the well-known saying, ' Happiness comes to man even if it be after a hundred years I ' How did Raghava and the monkeys conclude an alliance and for wbat purpose ? Answer my questions candidly ! " Thus interrogated by the prince, **HANUMAN**, seating bimseif on a heap of Kusba Grass, began to describe **RAMA**'s life in the foRSt and said : " O Lord, thou knowest how he was exiled on account of the two boons bestowed on thy mother ; how the King **DASARATHA** died in consequence of his son's banishment; how the messen gers, O Lord,

brought thee back from Rajagriha ; how, returning to Ayodhya, thou didst refuse the crown ; how thou didst go to Chittrakuts to appeal to thy brother, the scourge of his foes, begging him to accept the throne, thus conforming to the way of virtuous men ; how **RAMA** renounced the kingdom and how, on returning, thou didst bring back the sandsls of that illusuious hero; all this, O Long-armed Warrinr is well-known to thee but wbat happened subsequent to thy departure, now hear from me I "After thy return, distieSs seized the denizens of the foRSt, creating a giest turmoil. Therenpon **RAMA**, **SITA** and Lsbhmana entered the huge, dresdiill and lonely Dandab Forest that was trodden down by elephants and formidable with its lions, tigers and deer. Having penetrated into its depths, the powerfUl Viradba appeared before them emitting fearful cries. Lifting him up, as he was roaring like a giest elephanr, those two 358 warriors threw him headlong into a pit and having accomplished that difficult exploit, the two brothers, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA**, at dusk reached the enchanting hermitage of Sbarabhanga. That Sage having ascended to heaven, **RAMA**, a true hero, paid obeiaance to the ascetics and thereafter went to Janasthana. " Founeen thousand titans, who dwelt in Janasthana, were slain during the time that the mighty Ragbava resided there. For having fallen into the hands of the only **RAMA**, during the fourth watch, those demons were wholly exterminated. Taking advantage of their great power, in order to harass the ascetics, those demons, inhabitants of the Dandaks Forest, were slain by **RAMA** in combat. The demons slain and Kbara also, **RAMA** then despatched Dusbana and snbsequendy Trishiras. Thereafter a female demon, named Shnrpanakba, accosted him and, being ordered to do so, **LAKSHMANA**, rising, took up his sword and instandy cut off her ears and nose. Thus mutilated, that titan woman took refUge with **RAVANA**. " Then a redoubtable titan in **RAVANA**'s service, named Maricba, assuming the

form of a jewelled deer, beguiled Vaidehi, who, on beholding it, said to **RAMA** : " ' O My Beloved, capture it for me, it will enliven our solitude.' " Ragbava, bow in hand, rushed ont in pursuit of that deer and destroyed it with a single arrow, O My Friend. " While Ragbava, however, was thus engaged in the chase, **LAKSHMANA** too bad left the hermitage, and Dasbagriva, entering there, speedily took hold of **SITA**, as Graba seizes Rohini in the sky. Slaying the Vulture Jatayn, who sought to deliver her, the titan, taking hold of **SITA**, departed in aD baste fur his capital. Meanwhile some strange looking monkeys, as large as hills, standing on the summit of a mountain, astonished, observed **RAVANA**, the King of the Titans proceeding with **SITA** in his arms ; and, mounting into the sky with her in the Chariot Puahpsks, which was as swift as thought, the aD-powerful **RAVANA** returned to Lanks. There he entered his vast palace deamated with pure gold and, with many words, sought to console Vaidehi hut she, regarding his speech and his person with disdain and as less than a straw, was imprisoned in the Ashoks Grove. 3SP " Meantime **RAMA** returned, having slain the deer in the forest and, as he did so, he beheld the vulture so beloved of his sire, dead, at which he suffered extreme distress. Thereafter Ragbava with Labhmana set out in search of Vaidehi and they crossed the Godavari River with its ftoweting woodlands. " In the gteat forest, the two princes a titan, nsmed Kabandba, counselled by whom that trUe hero repaired to the Mountain Rishyamuka in order to confer with **SUGRIVA** and, even before they met, they were firm frieods. " **SUGRIVA** bad formerly beeo banished by his irascible brother Bali and, in consequence of this meeting, a sound alliance was formed between them. **RAMA**, by the strength of his arms established him on the throne, having slain Bali, that giaot filii of valour, in the field. Regaining his kingdom, **SUGRIVA** vowed in to set out with all the monkeys in order to find the princess and, under the command of

their magoanimous sovereign, ten kotis of those Plavamgamas repaired to different reginns. " Whilst, discouraged, we were resting on the lofty Vindhya Mountain, plunged in despair, a long time passed. Meanwhile the powerful brother of the King of the Vultures, named Sampati, informed us that **SITA** was dwelling in **RAVANA**'s palace, where upon I, whom thou seest here, was able to dispel the grief of my companions and, resorting to mine owo prowess, crossed over a hundred lesgues of sea and discovered Maitbili alone in the Ashob Grove, clad in a soiled silken cloth, stained with dust, afBicted yet faithful to her conjugal vow. Approaching that irreproachable lady I paid obeisance to her and bestowed a ring on her in **RAMA**'s name as a pledge, and she, in her turo, gave me a brilliant jewel. " My mission accomplished, I returned and gave **RAMA** that tokeo, the bright gem ; and he, receiving tidings of Maithili, regained his zest for life, as one, who in ememity, drink Amrita. SWDIIIDIIing up his strength, he resolved to overthrow Lanka, as, wheo the time has come, Vibbabasu prepares to destroy the worlds. " Reaching the shores of the ses, the Prince commanded Nala to construct a causeway and the army of valiant monkeys crossed the ocean on that bridge. " Prahasta fell under the blows of Nila, Kumbbabma under tbose of Ragbava, Lakshmaua slew Ravsna's son and **RAMA**, **RAVANA** bimself. Having been received by the Granter of Boons, Sbatra, as also **YAMA**, Varona and Mabadeva, Swyambhu and Dasaratba, **RAMA** was showered with favoun by all the Risbis. The glorious Katutstba, Scourge of His Foes, was reodered bappy by obtaining these boons and returned to Kisbkindba accompanied by the monkeys in the Chariot Pusbpaka. " He has reached the Ganges once more and is dwelling with the Sage, where without hindrance, thou sbouldst behold him to-morrow, when the Pusbya Stat is in an auspicious aspect ! " Thereupon, heariog **HANUMAN**'s delightful words, Bharalll, full of joy, paid obeisance to

him and, in acceots pleasing to the heart, said : .. Mter a long time my desires are at last fulfilled ! "

CHAPTER 129

Bharata sets out to meet Rama

HEARING tbose marvellous tidings, **BHARATA**, tbat real hero, the slayer of hostile warrion, delighted, issued a command to Sbatrughna, saying : " Let all righteous men, having purified themselves, wonhip all the Deities and sacred altara of the city with fragrant garlands and diverse musical instruments. Let the bards conversant with the tradition and all the panegyrists, with the queens, mioisters, guards, the army, the courtiers, brahmios, nobles and the fore most of the arTisans isaue forth from the capital in companies, in order to behold the couotenance of **RAMA**, which is as lovely as the moon." At this behest, Sbatrughna, the slayer of hostile warriors, called together some thousands of labouren, whom he divided into groups, and he said to thenr : " Fill up the hollows and level the uneven ground from Ayodbya to Nandigrama. Spriolde every part with water as cold as ice md let others scatter roasted grain and !lowers everywhere ; set up large standards on aU the main highways of the capital. At the rising of the sun, let aU the dwellioga be adorned with crowns and garlands, with many flowers and decor ations in five colours ; let contingents of soldiers stand along the royal highway to keep it free." At this command from Shattughna, which filled everyone with joy, Dhristi, Jayanti, Vijaya, Siddhartha, Arthasadhaka, Ashob, Mantrapala and Sumantra set out. Thousands of elephants intoxicated with ichor and female elephants with golden girths, bearing standards, splendidly adorned, on which illustrious warriors were

mounted, issued forth, whilst others set out on horses and in chariots also, and warriors armed with spears, cutlasses and nets, furnished with banners and pennants were escorted by the foremost of their leaders and thousands of infantry. Thereafter the litters, bearing the consorts of King **DASARATHA**, with Kaushalys and **SUMITRA** at their head, also set out. And **BHARATA**, fixed in his duty, surrounded by the Twice-born, the elders of the city, the merchants and coUDsellors with garlands and sweetmeats in their hands, rejoiced by the sound of conches and drums, his praises sung by panegyrists, having placed the sandals of the illustrious **RAMA** on his head, took up the white parasol decorated with bright garlands and two golden chowriea made of Yaks tails, worthy of a king. Then that magnanimous prince, emaciated by long fasting, pale, wearing robea of bark and a black antelope skin, yet full of joy at the tidings of his brother's approach, set out with his escort to meet **RAMA** and the sound of the horses hooves, the noise of the chariot wheels, the blare of conches and beat of drums, the roaring of elephants, the blast of trumpets and booming of gongs caused the earth to tremble as the whole city proceeded to Nandigrama. Thereafter Bbarata, glancing round, said to **HANUMAN**, the son of Pavana : " Is it due to the levity of thy monkey nature that I do not behold Kakutstha, the illustrinus **RAMA**, Scourge of His Foes ? Neither are those monkeys, able to change their form at will, to be seen I" To these words, **HANUMAN**, testifying to the ttuth, answered the virtue-loving **BHARATA**, saying : 362 " That sylvan army has reached the treeS covered with fruit and flowers, flowing with honey, where the humming of bees intoXicated with love can be heard. All this was created by virtue of a boon bestowed by Vasava on the Sage Bharadwaja, as a reward for his great hospitality. One can hear their shouts of delight and, to my mind, those monkeys have crossed the River Gaumati. Observe that immense cloud of dust near the wood ; in

mine estimation, the monkeys are shaking the bougbs of the Sala Trees; behold that aerial chariot, bright as the moon, which can be seen in the distance, it is the celestial Car Pushpaka created by Brahms's thought and was obtained by that hero after he had slain **RAVANA** and his kinsfolk. Glittering like the rising sun, that celestial chariot, swift as thought, that is bearing **RAMA**, belongs to Dhanada, who received it from Brahms. In it are the two valiant brothers, offspring of the House of Raghu, accom panied by Vaidehi, the supremely illustrious **SUGRIVA** and the Titan Bibishana." At that moment, from women, children, youthful persons and the aged, the joyful clamour ' **RAMA** has come I ' arose, reaching the skies. Alighting from their chariots, elephants and horses in order to go on foot, the people beheld that prince standing in his aerial car, resembling the moon in the sky. With joined palms, **BHARATA** advanced joyfuJiy to meet **RAMA**, to whom he paid obeisance, offering him water wherewith to wash his hands and feet, as also the Atghya. In that chariot, created by Brahms's thought, the elder brother of **BHARATA** with his large eyes, looked as radisnt as the God who bears the Thunderbolt. Then **BHARATA**, with a deep bow, paid reverence to his brother **RAMA**, who was seated in the car, like unto the sun on the summit of Mount Meru, and at Rams's command, that swift and excellent vehicle, harnessed to swans, descended to earth. Then the faithful **BHARATA** approach ing **RAMA**, full of joy paid obeisance once more, and Kakutstha, drawing **BHARATA** to him, whom he had not seen for a long time, caused him to sit on his lap, embracing him aft"ectionatcly. Thereafter, **BHARATA**, the scourge of his foes, approached Labh mana and Vaidehi and saluted them lovingly; then the son of **KAIKEYI** embraced **SUGRIVA**, **JAMBAVAN**, Anpda, Mainda, 363 Dvivida, Nila and Rishabba also, and Sushena, NaJa, Gavaksba, Gandbamadana, Sharabba and Panasa, clasping them in turn in his arms.

In the form of men, those monkeys, able to change their sbape at will, gaily wished **BHARATA** good fortune ; then, after embracing him, that prince, full of valour, said to **SUGRIVA**, that lion among monkeys: " We are four brothers, thou shalt be the fifth, O **SUGRIVA** ; benevolence creates friendship and malevolence enmity ! " Thereafter **BHARATA** addressed Bibisbana in comforting words, saying: " Be thou blessed ; thy co-operation ensured the success of this diflicult enterprise ! " At tbat instant, Sbatrughna, having paid obeisance to **RAMA** and Lakslunana, bowed reverently to the feet of **SITA**. Then **RAMA** approached his mother, who was pale and drawn with grief and, prostrating himself, touched her feet, thus rejoicing her heart, after which he saluted **SUMITRA** and the renowned **KAIKEYI**, thereafter paying obeisance to the other Queens and his spiritual preceptor. Then all the citizens, with joined palms said to **RAMA** : " Be thou welcome, O Long-armed Hero, thou art the increaser of **KAUSHALYA**'s delight ! " To the elder brother of Bbarata, those thousands of bands joined in salutation caused the inhabitants of the city to appear like a lotus in flower. Then Bbarata, conversant with his dury, himself took **RAMA**'s sandals and fastened them on the feet of tbat **INDRA** among Men and thereafter, with joined palms, said to him : " This kingdom tbat I received in trust, I now render back to thee in its entirety. To-day, since I see thee as Lord of Ayodhya, the purpose of mine existence has been fuJfi1Jed and my desires consummated. Now examine thy treasury, thy storehouses, thine house and thine army ; by thy grace, I bave increased them tenfold I" These words uttered by Bbarata out of fraternal Jove, caused the monkeys and the Titan Bihisbana to shed tears. Thereafter, in his joy, Ragbava made Bbarata sit on his lap and, with his chariot and army, proceeded to the hermitage. 364 Reaching that place with Bharasa and his **RAMA** alighted from his aerial car and thereafter spoke to that

most excellent chariot, saying : “Now go hence and place thyself at Vaishravana’s disposal, I give thee leave to depatt." Thus dismissed by **RAMA**, that excellent car proceeded in a northerly direction sud reached Dhanada’s abode. The celestial Car Pushpaka, which had been borne away by the Tisao **RAVANA**, returned at **RAMA**’s commaod with all peed to Dhanada. As Shakra touches the feet of Brihaspati, Raghava, having touched the feet of his friend, his spiritual preceptor, seated himself by his side, a little way apart, ou an excllent seat.

CHAPTER 130

Rama is installed as King. The Benefits that accrue from the Recitation and Hearing of the "Ramayana"

Of **KAIKEYI**’s delight, said to his elder brother, **RAMA**, that true hero: " Thou hast honoured my mother by conferring the kingdom on me ; now I give hack to thee that which was entrusted to me. How can I, who am but a young steer, bear the heavy load that one tiill grown is aearccly able to sussain ? To my mind, it is as hard to preserve the boundaries of this kingdom as to build up a dam which has been swept away by a torrent. How can a doukey outpace a horse or a crow surpass a swau in lligbt ? Nor am I able to follow in thy footsteps, O Hero, O Scourge of Thy Foes ! As a tree with a vast truuk and branches, planted in a courtyard, that has grown immense aud di11icult to climb, driea up when it has bloasomed without yielding any fruit, so, O l.oug armed Prince, if, being our master, thou doat uot uphold us all, the tinkliug of girdles and anklets and the gentle strains of melodious singing that thou dost wake and fall asleep. Do thou rule the world as long as the sun

revolves and the earth endures.” Hearing **BHARATA**’s words, **RAMA**, the conqueror of hostile cities, answered ' So be it ! ' and took his place on an cxeellent seat. Thereafter, at the command of Sbatrughna, skilled and deft banded barbers quickly surrounded Ragbava ; and lint Bbarata bathed and the mighty **LAKSHMANA** also, then **SUGRIVA**, that lndra among Monkeys, followed by Bibisbana, the Lord of the Titans; whereupon **RAMA**, his matted locks shorn, performed his ablutions and he was clothed in robes of great price, covered with garlands and sprinkled with every kind of perfume ; thereafter he re-appeared blazing in his own effulgence. The hero, **BHARATA**, attended on Rams’s robing and Sbatrughna, the upholder of the prosperity of the Ikshvakus, on **LAKSHMANA**’s, and all the consorts of King **DASARATHA** attended on **SITA**. Kau shalya, in love of her son, herself adorned all the consorts of the monkeys with joy. Then Sbatrughna, having issued the command, Sumantra harnessed a magnificent chariot and when that celestial car, btight as fiame, bad been brought before him, **RAMA**, that long armed warrior, conqueror of hostile citadels, took his place therein. **SUGRIVA** and **HANUMAN**, whose beauty equalled Mshendra’s, bathed and attired in robes of divine loveliness and sparkling earrings, followed ; thereafter **SUGRIVA**’s consons, as also **SITA**, advanced eager to behold the capital. In Ayodhya all the ministers of King **DASARATHA**, with Rams’s spiritual Preceptor **VASISHTHA**, at their head, took counsel as to what ought to be done ; and Ashoka, Vijaya and Siddhartba, with undivided mind, entered into consultation regarding the honours to be paid to **RAMA** by the city and said : " Prepare all that is needed for the coronation of the magnani mous **RAMA**, who is worthy of this honour, beginning with the benedictory prayer.” Having issued these orders, the ministers as also the spiritual Preceptor set forth from the city in hatte, in order to behold **RAMA**, who resembled the God of a Thouaand Eyes in

his chariot drawn by bay horses. And Raghava, aeated in his car, proccoded 366 along the highway to his capital ; **BHARATA** toOk up the reins, **SHATRUGHNA** the psrasol, **LAKSHMANA** the fan and **SUGRIVA** one of the chowries, whilst that lndra among the Titans, Bibishana, held the second that was made of Yaks tails of dazzling whiteness and like unto the moon, waving it to and fro over the prince, behind whom he stood. At that instant, the sweet music of **RAMA**'s praises rang out in the sky sung by companies of *Rishis* and Gods with the Marut Hosts. The iUustrious **SUGRIVA**, that bull among the monkeys, was mounted on an elephant named Sbatrumjaya, as high as a bill, and nine thousand elephants carried the monkeys, who in the form of men, proceeded along the way, adorned with ornaments of every kind Then that Lord of Men advanced towards the city encircled with palsces, to the sound of conches and the roll of drums ; and the inhabitants of the city beheld Raghava radiant with besuty advancing in his chariot, and, having exchanged salutations, they took up their places behind Kakutstha, the magnanimous **RAMA**, surrounded by his brothers. In the midst of his coun sellors, the *brahmins* and the people, **RAMA** shone with splendour like unto the moon amidst the stars ; and, as he advanced along the highway, preceded by the musicians and those who bore the Swastika on the palms of their hands, he was attended by a joyous crowd. Before **RAMA** marched those who carried roasted grain and gold, and virgins and kine were there with the Twice born and men with their hands full of Modaka. Meantime **RAMA** informed his ministers of his alliance with **SUGRIVA** and of the prowess of the son of Ani1a; and the monkeys and the inhabitants of Ayodhya were astounded by the narrative concerning the monkeys' exploits and the valour of the titans. Whilst relating these incidents, the illustrious **RAMA**, who was attended by the *Vanaras*, entered Ayodhya, which was filled with healthy and bappy people, and

where every house was decorated. Thereafter they came to the ancesttal dwelling, the abode of the descendants of Ikshvaku, and that prince, the delight of the House of Raghu, paid obeisance to **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA** and **KAIKEYI** and thereafter addressed **BHARATA** in gentle and reason able words asying :-" Let **SUGRIVA** stay in the magnificent palace, set amidst the woods in the Ashob Grove, which abounds in pearls and emeralds." At these words, **BHARATA**, that true hero, took **SUGRIVA** by the hand and led him into the palace. Meanwhile servants bearing oil lamps, couches and carpets entered immediately as comman ded by **SHATRUGHNA** and the exceedingly valiant younger brother of Raghava said to **SUGRIVA** : " Do Thou, O Lord, issue thy commands for **RAMA**'s coronation ! " On this, **SUGRIVA** gave over four golden urns encrusted with gems to the monkey leaders, saying : " To-morrow, at dawn, see to it that ye return with your urns lilled from the four seas, O Monkeys." At this command, those powerfbl moo'-eys, resembling elephants, immediately rose into the air, so that they looked like swift eagles, and they were **JAMBAVAN**, **HANUMAN**, Vegadarahin and Rishabha, who brought hack their urns lilled with water, whilst five hundred other monkeys drew water in their jars from five hundred rivers. Tbe mighty and valorous Sushena returned with his vessel, adorned with every variety of gem, bearing water from the eastern sea ; Rishabha, without delay, brought water from the southern sea ; Gavaya, with his urn powdered with red sandal and camphor, lilled it at the vast ocean of the west, and **HANUMAN**, the marvellous son of AnUa, who was as swift as the wind, with his huge urn, encrusted with diamonds, drew water from the icy notthern sea. Beholding the water brought by those foremost of monkeys for **RAMA**'s coronation, **SHATRUGHNA**, attended by servants, impatrcd the tidings to the chief Priest **VASISHTHA**, and his companions, and that venerable one hastened there

with the brahmius, whereupon he cauacd **RAMA** accompanied by **SITA**, to ascend a throne inlaid with precious gems. Then **VASISHTHA**, Vijaya, Javali, Kashyapa, Katyayana, Gautama and Vamadeva consecrated that lion among men with pure and fragrant water, as the Vasus crowned Vasava of a Thousand Eyea. Then the Ritvijs and the *Brahmins* with sixteen virgins, counsellors, warriors, as also the merchants, were twl of joy and **RAMA** was sprinkled with pure water, and the Celestial Beinp, 368 standing in the firmament with the Lobpalas and the Gods assembled to anoint him with the juice of all the sscred herbs. And hsving been crowned by the magnanimous Vasishths, the priests placed roysl vestments upon him ; and Shstrughna bore the immaculate shining canopy, and **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, the chowry made of Yaks tails, the Lord of the Titans, Bibishsns carrying the second, thst was as bright as the moon. Theresfter, on Vasava's command, Vayu bestowed on Raghsva a brilliant golden garland embellished with a hundred lotuses, and a necklace of pearls enriched with every variety of gem was also conferred on thst Lord of Men by Shskra. The Gods and Gandhsrvas ssng and troops of Apsaras danced at the installation of the virtuous **RAMA**, who was worthy of thst honour. The earth too was covered with rich crops and the trees with their fruit and Bowers gave forth their fragtance in honour ofRaghsva. Hundreds and thousands of horses, cows and heifers were disrributed amongst the Twice-bom by thst prince, who hsd already bestowed hundreds of bulls on the *brahmins* ; and Raghsva gave them thirty crores of gnld and rich arrire and priceless ornaments. Then a golden crown encrusted with precious stones, glittering like the sun's rays, was offered to **SUGRIVA** by thst valiant leader of men, who bestowed two bracelets set with emeralds, the lustre of which rivalled the moon's, on **ANGADA**, the son of Bali. And **RAMA** gave unto **SITA** a necklace of pearls embellished with gems

thst was without peer and like unto moonbeams, and celestial and immaculate raiment richly embroidered with superb ornaments. Then Vaidehi, the delight of Janab, prepared to bestow her own necklace on the son of the Wind as a token and, unclasping it from her neck, she looked on all the monkeys and on her lord again and again, whereupon Rams, looked as radiant as a mountain covered by a white cloud silvered by an aureole of moonbeams. Thereafter aU the elder and leading monkeys received fitting gifts of jewels and raiment, whereupon **SUGRIVA**, **HANUMAN**, **JAMBAVAN** and aU those monkeys baving been overwhelmed with favours by **RAMA** of imperishable exploita, and received precioua gems in addition, according to their merits, with aU that their hearts could desire, returned joyfully from whence they bad come ; and **RAMA**, the acourge of his foes, lord of the earth, sought out Dvivida, Mainda and Nila and aatisficd aU their wiabes. Thereupon the festival which they bad attended being termi nated, the foremost of the monkeys took leave of that lord of men and returned to Kishkindha. And **SUGRIVA**, the King of the Monkeys, having assisted at **RAMA**'s coronation and being overwhelmed with honours by him, went back to his capital. Thereafter, Bibishana, that virtuous monarch, having obtained the kingdom of his forbears, returned to Lanka full of glory with the leading titans. The supremely illustrioua and magnanimous Raghava, having slain his foes, ruled his empire in peace, enhancing the joy of his people. Devoted to virtue, **RAMA** addressed **LAKSHMANA** who was fixed in his duty, aaying : " O Faitbful One, aid me in defending the land protected by the ancient kings with their armies. As was the custom of our ancestors in days of yore, do thou share the weight of stste aft'airs with me as heir presumptive." Yet, despite the earnest entreaties addressed to blm, Saumitri did not accept the dignity, and the high-souled **RAMA** conferred it on **BHARATA**. Thereafter that

prince performed the Paundarika, Ashvamcdha, Vajimcdha and other aacrifices of many kinds again and again. Reigning for ten thouaand years, he offered up ten horse aacrifices, distributing immense wealth in charity, and **RAMA**, whose arms reached to his knees, the powerful elder brother of **LAKSHMANA**, ruled the earth in glory and performed many aacrifices with his sons, brothers and kinafolk. No widow was ever found in distress nor was there any danger from Slllkes or disease during his reign ; there were no malefacton in his 370 kingdom nor did any su1fer harm ; no aged person ever attended the funeral of a younger relative ; happiness was universal ; each attended to his duty and they had only to look on **RAMA** to give up enmity. Men lived for a thousand years, each having a thousand sons who were free from infirmity and anxiety ; trees bore fruit and dowers perpetually ; Parjanya sent down rain when it was needed and Maruta blew auspiciously ; all works undertaken bore happy results and all engaged in their respective duties and eschewed evil. All were endowed with good qualities ; all were devoted to pious observances and **RAMA** ruled over the kingdom for ten thousand years. This renowned and sacred epic, the foremost of all, grsuting long life and victory to kings, was composed by the *Rishi* **VALMIKI**, and he who hears it constantly in this world is delivered from evil ; if he desires sons he obtains them, if wealth he acquires it. He who, in this world, listens to the story of **RAMA**'s enthrone ment, if he be a king, will conquer the earth and overcome his enemies. Women will obtain sons as **SUMITRA** and **KAUSHALYA** obtained **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** and **KAIKEYI**, **BHARATA**. The hearing of the ' Ramayana ' grants longevity and victory equal to **RAMA**'s, he of imperishable exploits. The one who, mastering his anger, listens with faith to this epic, formerly composed by **VALMIKI**, overcomes all obstacles and those who hear this story set forth by **VALMIKI** will return from their

journeys in foreign lands and rejoice the hearts of their kinsfolk. They will obtain fulfilment of all the desires they conceive in this world from Raghava, and its recitation will bting delight to the Celestials ; it pacifies the adverse forces in those houses where it is to be found. Hearing it, a king will conquer the earth ; if he be a stranger he will fiuoe well ; women who hear this sacred epic in their pregnancy, will give birth to sons who are unsurpassed. He who recites it with reverence will be freed from all evil and live long. Warriors should listen to it recited by the Twice-hom with bowed heads in order to achieve prosperity and obtain sons. **RAMA** is ever pleased with the one who hears this epic or who recites it in its entirety and he who does so will obtain a felicity comparable to **RAMA**'s, who is **VISHNU**, the Eternal, the Primeval God, the Long-armed Hari, Narayana, the Lord. Such are the 371 fruits produced by this ancient narrative. May prosperity attend thee ! Recite it with love and may the power of **VISHNU** increase! The Celestial Beings rejoice in the understanding and hearing of' Ramayana ' and the AncestOrS are gratified. Those who, in devotion, transcribe this histOIY of **RAMA**, composed by the *Rishi* Valmild, attain to the region of Bnhma. The hearing of this rare and beautiful poem in this world brings prosperous families, wealth and grain in abundance, lovely wives, supreme felicity and complete success in all undertakings. This narrative which promotes long life, health, renown, brotherly love, wisdom, happiness and power should be heard in reverence by virtuous men desirous of felicity. END OF 37Z UTIARA *KANDA* CHAPTER The SatfeS pay homage to **RAMA** WHEN **RAMA** regained his kingdom, having slain the titans, all the Sages came to pay him homage. Kausbika, Yavakrita, Gargya also, and Kanva, the son of Medhatithi, who dwelt in the esstem region ; Svastiyatteya, the blessed Namuchi and Pramuchi, Agastya and Atri, the blessed Sumukba and Vimukba, led by Agastya,

came from the southern region, and Nrishangu, Kavashin, Dhaumya and the grest *Rishi* Kausheya, who inhabited the western region, also presented themselves with their disciples ; and **VASISHTHA**, Kashyapa, Vishvamitn, Gautama, Jamadagni and Bharadvaja came with the seven *Rishis* who were established in the northern quarter. Reaching the palace of Raghava, those magnanimous ascetics who shone like Fire, tbe devourer of offerings, presented them· selves at the gate and they were all conversant with the Veda and its component parts and versed in the various tnditions. Addressing himself to tbe doorkeeper, the virtuous Agastya, Prince of Sages, said to him : " Let the arrival of the ascetics be made known to the son of Dasarathal" Thereupon the vigilant guardian of the door, hearing these words from the Sage Agastya, instantly went away and, trust· worthy, skilled in the art of procedure, instructed in conduct and gesture, he entered the presence of that magnanimous sovereign. who was as radiant as the full moon, and informed him of the arrival of that Prince of Sages, Agastya. Learning that those ascetics, who resembled the rising sun, had come, **RAMA** said to the door-keeper : " Usher them in with all due respect ! " Thereafter, when the Sages had entered, **RAMA** rose in deference

BOOK VII

Uttara Kanda

The ‘later section’ — doubts of the citizens drive Rama to send Sita to Valmiki’s hermitage, where she bears the twins Kusha and Lava. The boys grow up reciting the Ramayana itself; in time they return to Ayodhya. Sita is recalled, and at last departs into the earth from which she came.



CHAPTER 1

The Sages pay homage to Rama

CHAPTER The SatfeS pay homage to **RAMA** WHEN **RAMA** regained his kingdom, having slain the titans, all the Sages came to pay him homage. Kausbika, Yavakrita, Gargya also, and Kanva, the son of Medhatithi, who dwelt in the esstem region ; Svastiyatteya, the blessed Namuchi and Pramuchi, Agastya and Atri, the blessed Sumukba and Vimukba, led by Agastya, came from the southern region, and Nrishangu, Kavashin, Dhaumya and the grest *Rishi* Kausheya, who inhabited the western region, also presented themselves with their disciples ; and **VASISHTHA**, Kashyapa, Vishvamitn, Gautama, Jamadagni and Bharadvaja came with the seven *Rishis* who were established in the northern quarter. Reaching the palace of Raghava, those magnanimous ascetics who shone like Fire, tbe devourer of offerings, presented them· selves at the gate and they were all conversant with the Veda and its component parts and versed in the various tnditions. Addressing himself to tbe doorkeeper, the virtuous Agastya, Prince of Sages, said to him : " Let the arrival of the ascetics be made known to the son of Dasarathal" Thereupon the vigilant guardian of the door, hearing these words from the Sage Agastya, instantly went away and, trust· worthy, skilled in the art of procedure, instructed in conduct and gesture, he entered the presence of that magnanimous sovereign. who was as radiant as the full moon, and informed him of the arrival of that Prince of Sages, Agastya. Learning that those ascetics, who resembled the rising sun, had come, **RAMA** said to the door-keeper : " Usher them in with all due respect ! " Thereafter, when the Sages had entered, **RAMA** rose in deference were covered with cushions of Kusha

Grass and antelope skins, and those mighty Sages sested themselves according to rank and, questioned by **RAMA** concerning their well-being, the great *Rishis* versed in the Veds, who were accompanied by their disciples, replied to him, saying : " O Long-armed Hero, Joy of the House ofRaghu, all is well with us I By the grace of heaven we behold thee happy and delivered from thine enemies ! By divine grace, O King, thou hast slain **RAVANA**, that destroyer of the worlds, nor is it any great matter for thee to slay **RAVANA** with his sons and grandsons ! Furnished with thy bow, thou canst undoubtedly destroy the Three Worlds ! By heaven's favour, we behold thee with **SITA** victorious to-day. We see thee with thy brother **LAKSHMANA**, who is devoted to thine interesrs, in the midst of thy mothers and other brothers, O Vittuous Prince. By the grace of heaven, the Rangers of the Night, Prahasta, Vikata, VtrUpaksha, Mahodara, Abmpana and Durdharsha have perished. By divine grace, O **RAMA**, Kumbhakama, he, whose monstrous form had no equal in the world, was overthrown by thee in combat. Trishiras, Atikaya, Devantaka and Narantaka, those mighty night rangers, were struck down by thee, O **RAMA**. By the grace of heaven, thou didst measure thy strength against that **INDRA** of Titans whom the Gods themselves were unable to destroy and didst vanquish him in single combat. Assuredly it was no small matter for thee to overcome **RAVANA** in fight but, by divine grace, thou wast able to join issue with Ravani and, in combat, slay him also. " Once thou wast delivered from his magic bonds, O Long armed Hero, by heaven's favour, thou didst triumph over that enemy of the Gods who bore down on thee like Time itself! We marvelled to learn of the death of Indrajita I By granting us the sacred and agreeable gift of security, thou hast enhanced thy victory, O Kakurstba, O Scourge of Thy Foes ! " Hearing those pure-souled Sages speak thus, **RAMA** was extremely surprised and,

with joined palms, answered them, saying: " O Blessed Ones, I vanquished Kumbhakama and that Ranger of the Night, **RAVANA**, both of whom were filled with valour, why, therefore, do you praise me particularly on account 3?6 of Ravani ? Since I vanquished Mahodara, Prahasta, the Titan Virupakshs, also Matta and Unmatta who were both invincible, and those great wsrriors, Devantaka and Narantaka, why this commendstion on lndrajita's account ? Did I not overcome those Rangers of the Night, Atikaya, Trishitas and Dhumraksha who were full of courage ? Why, therefore, do you atol me because of Ravani ? In what lay his special power, sttength and prowess ? How was he superior to **RAVANA** ? If I may leam it, for this is no command I lay upon you, if it be no secret that you may not reveal, I desire to know it, therefore speak I Shakra himself was vanquished by him ; in virtue of what boon and from what source did the son derive those powers that his sire **RAVANA**, did not possess ? From whence did this titan gain pre-eminence over his father in combat ? How was he able to triumph over lndra ? Tell me now of all the boons he received, O Foremost of the Sages I " CHAPTER The Birth of Vishrtmtu THUS questioned by the magnanimous Raghava, the illustrious Kumbhayoni answered as follows : " Learn, O **RAMA**, of the brilliant exploits of that warrior and how he slew his adversaries without being wounded by them ; but first I shall tell thee of **RAVANA**'s birth and linesge, O Raghava, and thereafter of the rare boon accorded to his son. " In former times, during the Kritayuga, there lived a son of Prajapati, O **RAMA**, and that lord, Ponlastya by name, was a Paramarishi equal to the Grandaire of the World Himself. One is unable to enumerate all the virtues he owed to his excellent character and it is sufficient to say that he was the son of Prajapati and, as such, was the favourite of the Gods. He was beloved of the entire world on account of his charming qualities

CHAPTER 2

The Birth of Vishravas

Of Ravani ? Since I vanquished Mahodara, Prahasta, the Titan Virupakshs, also Matta and Unmatta who were both invincible, and those great wsrriors, Devantaka and Narantaka, why this commendstion on lndrajita's account ? Did I not overcome those Rangers of the Night, Atikaya, Trishitas and Dhumraksha who were full of courage ? Why, therefore, do you atol me because of Ravani ? In what lay his special power, sttength and prowess ? How was he superior to **RAVANA** ? If I may leam it, for this is no command I lay upon you, if it be no secret that you may not reveal, I desire to know it, therefore speak I Shakra himself was vanquished by him ; in virtue of what boon and from what source did the son derive those powers that his sire **RAVANA**, did not possess ? From whence did this titan gain pre-eminence over his father in combat ? How was he able to triumph over lndra ? Tell me now of all the boons he received, O Foremost of the Sages I " CHAPTER The Birth of Vishrtmtu THUS questioned by the magnanimous Raghava, the illustrious Kumbhayoni answered as follows : " Learn, O **RAMA**, of the brilliant exploits of that warrior and how he slew his adversaries without being wounded by them ; but first I shall tell thee of **RAVANA**'s birth and linesge, O Raghava, and thereafter of the rare boon accorded to his son. " In former times, during the Kritayuga, there lived a son of Prajapati, O **RAMA**, and that lord, Ponlastya by name, was a Paramarishi equal to the Grandaire of the World Himself. One is unable to enumerate all the virtues he owed to his excellent character and it is sufficient to say that he was the son of Prajapati and, as such, was the favourite of the Gods. He was beloved of the entire world on account of his charming

qualities There, that virtuous soul, his senses fully controlled, gave him self up to the practice of austerity, but some youthful maidens, wbose fathers were *Rishis*, Pannagas and Rajarisbis, wandering in thoae solitudes, disturbed bim. Accompanied by Apaaras, they came to divert themselves in that place and, as it was possible to find fruits in every season and disport oneself in thoae woods, the young girls constantly went there to play. Attracted by the cbarms of Poulastya's retreat, they sang, played their instruments and danced, thus in full innocence, distracting the hermit from the eserciae of his penances. " On this, that mighty and exalted Sage cried out in indigna tion: '" She who Ds under my gaze, will instantly conceive I ' " Thereupon all those maidens, who hesrd the magoanimous Sage, terrified of the *brahmin*'s curse, left that place ; but the daughter of the Sage Trinabindu had not hesrd it. Entering the wood, wandering here and there without fear, sbe was unable to find the companions who had accompanied her. "At that moment the illustrious and mighty *Rishi*, born of Prajapsti, was concentrating on the sacred scriptures, his soul purified by asceticism. Hearing the recitation of the Veda, that youthful maiden approached, and beholding that of asceticism, she instantly grew pale and manifested all the signs of pregnancy. Thereupon, discovering her condition, she became extremely bewildered and said : " ' What has happened to me ? ' Thereafter, realising the truth, she returned to her father's hermitage. " On seeing her in that state, **TRINABINDU** *said*:-' What means this strange condition in which thou dost find thyself? ' " Thereat, with joined palms, the unfortunate girl answered that treasucy of asceticism, saying : " ' I do not know, Dear Father, what has brought me to this psss. Preceded by my companions, I had gone to visit the sacred hermitage of that great and pure-souled *Rishi* Poulastya. Thereafter I was unable to find any of thoae who had accom panied me to the woods but, perceiving the alteration in

my body, seized with fear, I returned here.' " Then that Rajarishi Trinabindu, of radiant aspect, entered into meditation awhile and it was revealed to him that this was 378 the wort of the ascetic and, the curse of that great and pure souled Sage having been made clear to him, he, taking his daughter, went to where Poulastya was to be found and said to him: " ' O Blessed One, accept this daughter of mine in all her native perfection as alms spontaneously offered. O Great *Rishi*, assuredly she will ever be completely obedient to thee who art given to the ptaetice of asceticism and to the mortification of the senses.' " Hesring the words of the virtuous Rajarishi, that Twice born One, who was willing to accept the young girl, said :-' It is well I ' and, having given his daughter to that king of Sages, Trinabindu returned to his hermitage whilst tbe young wife remained with her consort, gratifYing him with her virtue. Her character and conduct so charmed that powerful and eulted Sage that, in his delight, he addtessed her, saying : "' O Lady of lovely limbs, I am well pleased with thine out standing virtues and will confer on thee a son lite unto myself who will perpetuate both our houses ; he will be known by the name of Poulastys and, as thou bast listened to me reciting the Veda, he will also be called Vishravas." " Thus, his heart filled with delight, did the ascetic speak to his divine consort and, in a short time, she gave birth to a son, Vishravas, who was filmed in the Three Worlds and full of glory and piety. Learned, looting on all with an equal eye, happy in the fulfilment of his duty,lite unto his sire inclined to asceticism, such was Vishravaa.

CHAPTER 3

Vishravas becomes the Protector of Wealth

the wort of the ascetic and, the curse of that great and pure souled Sage having been made clear to him, he, taking his daughter, went to where Poulastya was to be found and said to him: " ' O Blessed One, accept this daughter of mine in all her native perfection as alms spontaneously offered. O Great *Rishi*, assuredly she will ever be completely obedient to thee who art given to the ptaetice of asceticism and to the mortification of the senses.' " Hesring the words of the virtuous Rajarishi, that Twice born One, who was willing to accept the young girl, said :-' It is well I ' and, having given his daughter to that king of Sages, Trinabindu returned to his hermitage whilst tbe young wife remained with her consort, gratifYing him with her virtue. Her character and conduct so charmed that powerful and eulted Sage that, in his delight, he addtessed her, saying : "' O Lady of lovely limbs, I am well pleased with thine out standing virtues and will confer on thee a son lite unto myself who will perpetuate both our houses ; he will be known by the name of Poulastys and, as thou bast listened to me reciting the Veda, he will also be called Vishravas." " Thus, his heart filled with delight, did the ascetic speak to his divine consort and, in a short time, she gave birth to a son, Vishravas, who was filmed in the Three Worlds and full of glory and piety. Learned, looting on all with an equal eye, happy in the fulfilment of his duty,lite unto his sire inclined to asceticism, such was Vishravaa. “Hearing of the life he was leading, thegreatMuni Bhsradwaja gave his own daughter of radiant complexion to him and Vishravas accepted Bbaradwaja’s daughter with traditional rites and began to consider how he might perpetuate his line and happiness. In extreme delight, that foremoat of the asetics, conversant with his duty, begot with his wife a wonderful child full ofvigour, endowed with all the brahmic qualities. “At the birth of this child, his paternal grandfather was filled with joy, and Poulaatya, beholding him, bethought himself how he might make

him happy. ' He shall become the " Guardian of Wealth"," he said in his delight, which was shared by all the Sages, and he gave him a name, saying : " ' Since the child resembles Vishravas, he shall be known as Vaishravana ! ' " Thereafter Vaishravana, retiring to pastoral solitudes, grew up to resemble the mighty Anala, who is invoked at the time of sacrifice and, while he sojourned in that retrest, the thought came to that magnanimous one, ' I will pursue my supreme duty ; the path of duty is the highest path '. “For a thousand years he gave himself up to aseticism in the great forest and practising severe auaterities, performed heavy penances. At the end of a thousand years, he underwent the following discipline-drinking water, he fed on air alone or took no nourishment whatsoever. A thousand ages pasaed like a single yesr, whereupon the mighty **BRAHMA**, accompanied by the Hosts of the Gods and their leaders, came to the hermitage and ssid to him : " ' I am highly gratified with thine accomplishments, O Devoted Son, now choose a boon I May prosperity attend thee ; thou dost merit a favour, O Sage I ' " Then Vaishravana answered the Grandsire of the World, who stood near and said : " ' O Blessed One, I desire to be the saviour and protector of the world I’ " In the satisfaction of his soul, **BRAHMA**, who was accompanied by the Celestial Host, joyfully answered :-' So be it I It is my desire to creste four Guardians of the World. Now there shall be the region ofYama, the region oflndra, the region ofVaruna and the one sought by tbee. Go, O Virtuous Ascetic, and reign over tbe dominion of wealtb I Witb Shakra, **VARUNA**, tbe Lotd of the Waters, and Yams, tbou sbalt be the fuurtb. Receive as tby vehicle this chariot named Pusbpaka, which is as bright as the sun, and be equal to the Gods. Be happy, we shall now from whence we came, having accomplished that which we bad to do by conferring this double gift, O Dear Son!' " Witb tbesewords, Brabma withdrew to the region of tbe Gods and when the

Celestial Host, witb the Grandsire at their head, bad gone to tbe heavenly region, Vaishravana, having become the Lotd of Wealth, humbly addtessed his sire witb joined palms and said : "' O messed One, I have received a rare boon from the Grand sire of the World, but the divine Prajapati bas not assigned me a dwelling place ; do tbou tberefure counsel me, O messed One, O Lord, as to where an agreeable retreat may be found where no suffering comes to any living being.' " At tbeae words of his son, Vaisbravana, tbe foremost of tbe ascetics answered saying : " Hear, O Most Virtuous of Men I On the shores oftbe ocean, to the soutb tbere is a mountain named Trikuta. On its lofty summit, which is as great as the capital of tbe mighty **INDRA**, the ravishing Qty of Lanka was constructed by Visbvakarma fur the Rakabasas and it resembles Amaravati. Do tbou dwell in Lanka and be happy ! Do not hesitate I Witb its moats, golden walls, engines of war and the weapons witb which it is filled, witb its gold and emerald archways, that city is a marvell The Rakahasasleft it formerly in fear of **VISHNU** and it is deserted, all tbe demons having gone to the nethermost region. Now Lanka is empty and has no protector. Go and inhabit it, My Son, and be happy ! No harm will visit tbee tbere.' " Hearing the words of his aire, the virtuous Vaishravana went to dwell in Lanka on the summit of the mountain, and soon, under his rule, it was filled witb thousands of delighted Nairritas disporting themselves. " That righteous King of tbe Nairritas, the blessed Sage Vaishravana, dwelt in Lanka, tbat city surrounded by the sea and, from time to time, the saintly Lotd of Wealth, in tbe 381 Pushpab Chariot, went to visit his father and mother. Hymned by the Hosts of the Gods and Gandharvas and entertained by the dances of the Apsaras, thst Guardian of Weslth, radiating glory like unto the sun, went to visit his sire. "

CHAPTER 4

Origin of the Rakshasas and of the Boons they received

THIS discourse of Agastya filled Rsma with astonishment. " How was it that the *Rakshasas* formerly dwelt in Lanka ? ", such was the question thst **RAMA** put to the ascetic, shaking his head and casting wondering glances upon him from time to time. **HE** *said*:-" O Blessed One, the words ' Formerly Lanka belonged to the Eaters of Flesh ' from thy lips causes me extreme surprise. We have been told thst the *Rakshasas* were the offspring of Poulastya and now, thou aftirmest thst they owe their origin to a clliferent source. Were **RAVANA**, Kumbbakama, Prahasta, Vikata and Ravani stronger than they ? Who, O *Brahmin*, was their first king ? What was the name of thst one of terrific strength ? For what fault were they driven out by **VISHNU** ? Tell me all in detail, O Irreproachable Sage and, as the sun chases away the shade, so dispel my curiosity I " Hearing Raghava's fair and eloquent words, Agastya, amazed, answered: " Formerly Prajapsti created the waters, choosing that element as his source and, thereafter, in order to protect it, thst lotus-hom One generated all creatures. Then those beings, tormented by hunger and thirst, humbly presented themselves before their author and enquired saying : " ' What shall we do ? ' "Whereupon Prajapsti, smiling, gave this answer to them all: ' Protect the waters carefully, O Sons of Manu I ' Then some said :-' Rakshami ' (*we will protect*) and others 'Yak shami' (*we will sacrifice*). Thus addressed by those afilil;ted by hunger and thirst, the Creator asid : 382 " ' Those IUIIODg you who have said "Rabhami" shall be *Rakshasas* and those among you who have said

“Yakshami” shall be Yakshas.' " On this, two brothers sprang up, named Heti and Praheti, the equals of Madhu and Ksitabha, who were *Rakshasas*, oppressors of their foes ; and the righteous Praheti withdrew to the soli tudes to practice asceticism, but Heti did all in his power to find a wife and, immeasurably intelligent and of great wisdom, he espoused tbe sister of Kala, a young girl named Bhaya, who was exceedingly terrifYing ; and that foremost of those possessing sons begot a son by the name of Vidyutkesha. " The son of Heti, Vidyutkesha, was possessed of the splendour of the sun and grew like a lotus in a lake and that ranger of the night, having reached the bloom of youth, his sire resolved that he should wed. In the interests of his son he sought out the daughter of Sandhya, who was his equal in beauty, and Sandhya, refiecting ' a daughter must inevitably be given to some stranger gave her to Vidyutkesha in marriage, O Raghava. " Vidyutkesha, that of the night, having received the daughter of Sandhya, began to divert himself with her as Maghavat with the daughter of Paulomi. After a time, O **RAMA**, Salatsntaka was filled with child, as a cloud is charged with water from tbe ocean. " Repairing to the Mandara Mountain, tbe *Rakshasi* brought forth a child who was as beautifUl as a cloud, even as Ganga had been delivered of an infant by the God of Fire. Having given birth to that child, she again desired to disport herself with Vidyutkesha and, forsaking her son, she rejoined her consort. Then the infant who had just been bom and was as radiant as the autumnal sun, whose voice resembled the rumbling of a cloud, placing his fist in his mouth. cried for a long time, and **SHIVA**, who was following the Path of the Wind, mounted on his bull and accompanied by Parvati, heard the sound of weeping and with Uma beheld the son of the Rakahasi who was crying. Allowing himself to be moved by compassion by his consort, Bhava, the Destroyer of Tripura, made him equal to his mother

in age and bestowed immortality upon him. Thereafter the uncllanging and imperishable Mahadeva bestowed an aerial car upon him that traversed space, in order to gratify Parvati, and she, on her side, also conferred a boon on him, saying : " ' The Rskshasas shall conceive instantly and give birth as they conceive ; their children shall at once attain the age of their mothers.' " Thereafter the highly intelligent Sukesha, proud of the favours he had received, having obtained this great fortune from the Lord Hara, began to range everywhere, displaying himself in his aerial car and teSembling Purandara when he obtained heaven. CHAPTER S The Sttii'Y of the three Sons of Suk8sha "AGANDHARVA named Gramani, who was as effulgent as fire, had a daughter named Devavati in all the beauty of her youth, famed in the Three Worlds, equal to a second Shri, and that virtuous Gandharva, beholding Sukesha to be thus endowed, gave her to him as a second Shri of whom he was the guardian. "Approaching her beloved consort, who had attained a sovereign state by virtue of the boons he had received, as a mendicant on whom wealth has been conferred, Devavati was highly delighted. United to that woman, the ranger of the night appeared as majestic as a great elephant, the offspring of Aryama. In time Sukesha became a father, O Rsghava, and begot thtee sons, the equals of the Three Sacrificial Fires, Malyavan, Sumali and Mali, the foremost of hewes, rivals of the Three-eyed God ; such were the sons of the Sovereign of the Rskshasas. In repose, they teSembled the Three worlds, in action, they wete

CHAPTER 5

The Story of the three Sons of Sukesha

upon him that traversed space, in order to gratify Parvati, and she, on her side, also conferred a boon on him, saying : " ' The Rskshasas shall conceive instantly and give birth as they conceive ; their children shall at once attain the age of their mothers.' " Thereafter the highly intelligent Sukesha, proud of the favours he had received, having obtained this great fortune from the Lord Hara, began to range everywhere, displaying himself in his aerial car and teSembling Purandara when he obtained heaven. CHAPTER S The Sttii'Y of the three Sons of Suk8sha "AGANDHARVA named Gramani, who was as effulgent as fire, had a daughter named Devavati in all the beauty of her youth, famed in the Three Worlds, equal to a second Shri, and that virtuous Gandharva, beholding Sukesha to be thus endowed, gave her to him as a second Shri of whom he was the guardian. "Approaching her beloved consort, who had attained a sovereign state by virtue of the boons he had received, as a mendicant on whom wealth has been conferred, Devavati was highly delighted. United to that woman, the ranger of the night appeared as majestic as a great elephant, the offspring of Aryama. In time Sukesha became a father, O Rsghava, and begot thtee sons, the equals of the Three Sacrificial Fires, Malyavan, Sumali and Mali, the foremost of hewes, rivals of the Three-eyed God ; such were the sons of the Sovereign of the Rskshasas. In repose, they teSembled the Three worlds, in action, they wete diseases that have been neglected and, learning of the boons their sire had received, which had led him to increased sover eignty and which he owed to his asceticism, the three brothets repaired to Mount Meru in order to practice penance. "Adopting a rigid and formidable course of austerity, O Foremost of Monarchs, those *Rakshasas* gave themselves up to fearful mortifications, sowing terror among ail beings. On account of their penances, faith, virtue and equanimity, scarce to be witnessed on earth, they agitated the Three

Worlds with the Gods, *Asuras* and men. “Then the Four-faced Deity, in his marvellous chariot, came to pay homage to the sons of Sukesha and said : " ' It is I who am the conferrer of boons ! ' " Whereupon they, recognizing him to be **BRAHMA**, the Dispens er of Favours, who was accompanied by the Indras and their Hosts, with joined palms, shaking like trees, answered him, saying: " ' If our penance has found favour with thee, O Lord, then grant us the boons of remaining invincible, of destroying our enemies, of living long, of becoming powerful and of being devoted to one another.' '" Let it be so I ' " replied the God, who wasa loverofbrahmins, to the sons of Sukesha and he returned to Brahmaloka. There upon those rangers of the night, O **RAMA**, who had become supremely arrogant on account of the boons they had received, began to harass the Gods and *Asuras*, and the Celestials with the companies of *Rishis* and Cbaranas, being thus persecuted and having no proteCtor with whom they could take refUge, resembled beings in hell. " Meantime, O Prince of Rsghu, the three Rakahasas sought out the immortal VIShvakarms, the foremost of architeCtS and joyously said to him : " ' O Thou, who from thine own resources, crested the palaces of the great Gods, strong, dazzling and impreguable, do thou in thy transcendent intelligence construct a dwelling for us of our own choosing on the Himavat, Meru or Mandara Mountains. Build us a vast abode equal to that belonging to Maheshvara.' “Then the mighty-armed Vishvakarms spoke to the Rakahaaas UTT ARA *KANDA* " They wer-Prahasta, Akampana, Vikata, Kalikamukha, Dhumrabba, Danda, Suparshwa of great energy, Samhradi, Pragbasa, Bbasakarna, Rska, Pashpotkala, Kaikasi of gracious smiles and Kumbhanasi. These, we are told, were the off spring of Sumali. “Mali’s wife was the Gandharvi named Vasuda, who was supremely graceful, whose eyes resembled lotus petals and who rivalled the most ravishing of the Yakshis. Hear, O

Lord Raghava, and I will tell thee of the offspring the youngest brother begot with her ; they were Anala, Ani1a, Hara and Sampati ; these sons of Mali became the counsellors of Bibishana. " Meanwhile, those foremost of night-rangers surrounded by hundreds of their sons, in the intoxication of their extreme strength. harassed the Gods and their leaders with the *Rishis*, Nagas and Yaksbas. Ranging the earth, irresistible as the tempest, ruthless as death in combat, overweeniogly proud of their boons, they constantly impeded the sacrifices of the Sages.

CHAPTER 6

Vishnu goes to the defence of the Gods

" THus a1Hicted, the Gods and *Rishis*, those treasuries of asceti cism, terror-stricken, sought refuge with the God of Gods, Mahcshwara, He Who creates and destroys the universe, the Inner Ruler, Who is unmanifest, the substrstum of the worlds, the supreme Guru, adored by aU. And the Gods, coming to that enemy of Kama, the Destroyer of Tripura, addressed him in a voice shaking with fear, and said : "' O Bbagawat, the sons of Sukcsha, wrought up with pride on account of the boons they have received from the Grandsire of the World, those scourgers of their foea, are oppressing the ehildren of the Lord of Creatures. Onr dwellinga, which should be our refuge, no longer afford us shelter ; having driven out the Gods ftom heaven, they themselves assume the rle of Gods. “lam **VISHNU**", “lam.Rudra". “IamBrahma".” lam the King oftheGods", “lam.**YAMA** ", “lamVaruna ",” lamtheMoon", “Verily, I am the Sun", thus do Mali, Sumali and Malysvan speak, those R.skshasas, formidable in combat, who hsrass us as also those who

precede them. We are terrified, O Lord, deliver us from fear ; do thou assume a terrible form and subdue those thorns in the side of the Gods.' " On this prayer ftom the united Gods being addressed to Kapatdin,of reddish hue, he, in deference to Sukesha answered the Celestial Host, saying : "' Nay, I shall not destroy these *Rakshasas*; I am not able to slay them, O Ye Gods, but I shall unfold to you how you may rid yoursdves of them I This step having been taken, O Maharishis, go and seek refuge with the Lotd **VISHNU** who will himself destroy them I ' " Thereupon, offering obeisance to Maheshwara, with jubilant cries they presented themselves before **VISHNU**, though tilled with terror on account of those rangers of the night. " Bowing down to the God who bears the conch and discus, they paid him great homage and, in trembling tones, denounced the sons of Sukesha, saying : "' O Lord, by virtue of the boons they have received, the three sons of Sukesha, like unto three fires, penetrated into our abode and took possession of it. Lanka is the name of that inaccessible citadd built on the summit of the Mount Trikuta ; it is there that these rangers of the night, our persecutors, have established themsdves. Come to our aid and destroy them, O Slayer of Madhu I We take refuge in Thee, be our ddiverer, O Lotd of the Gods! Do Thnu offer up their lotus-like faces, severed by Thy discus, to **YAMA**. In time of peril, none but Thee canst give us shdter, O Lotd. As the sun dispds the mist, so do Thnu dispd our terror in regard to these R.skshasas, who, with their adherents take delight in warfare I ' " When the Gods had spoken thus, the Lord of Lorda, Janar dans, who strikes terror in the hearts of his foes, ro-aaaured them, aaying : " ' The *Rakshasa* Sukesha, who, on account of the boona received from lshana, is intoldcated with pride, is mown to me aud his also, the eldest of whom is Malyavan. Those Rabhasas, the vilest of aU, exceed all limits aud I shall eztermin are them in my wrath, O Ye Gods, have no fear I ' " Hearing the words

of the mighty Janardana, VlSbnu, each of the Gods returned to his abode, chanting His praises. " Learning of the intervention of the Gods, that ranger of the night Malyavan, said to his two valiant brothers : " ' The Immona1s and the *Rishis* have unitedly sought ont Shankara in order to bring about our destruction and addressed Him thus: " O Lord, the offspring of Sukesha, intoxicated with pride, by the power they received from those boons torment us without respire. Harassed by these *Rakshasas*, it is impossible fur us, O Prajapati, to remain in our retreats fur fear of those wicked ones ; do Thou defend us and subdue them, O Three-eyed God, and, with Thy word of power ' Hum , burn them up, O Supreme Consumer. '"Thus did the Gods speak and the Slayer of Andaka, shaking his head and hands, answered them saying : " ' It is impossible for me to destroy the celestial children of Sukesha in the open field but I will tell you the means whereby they may pe slain. Let the God who bears the Mace and Discus in His hands, who is clad in yellow, Janardana, Hari, Narayana, the Lord of Shri, be your refuge I ' " Having received this counsd from Hara and taken leave of that enemy of Kama, the Gods went to Narayana's abode aud rdated all to Him. Then Narayana said to the Gods, who had **INDRA** at their head : " I shall slay all your enemies, O Ye Gods, fear nor I ' " ' O Foremost of the Rakshaaas, Hari promised those Gods, who were filled with terror, that He would destroy us. There tore do what you think lit. Narayana has slain Hiranyakashipu aud other foes of the Gods ; Namuchi, Kalanemi, Samrhada that foremost of warriors, aud Radheya,Bahumayin, the virtuous Lokapala aud Yamala, Arjuna, Hardikya, Shumbha, Nishumbha, all those Aauraa aud Danavas, fWl of courage aud strength, said to be invincible in the field. who had oft"ered hundreds of sacrifices, were versed in magic aud skilled in the uae of weapons and who were all a source of terror to their foes. Knowing this, it bchoveth

us to unite in order to slay the wicked Narayana who wishes to exterminate us.' " Hearing Malyavan, their elder brother speak thus, Sumali and Mali answered him as the Twin Ashwins addteas Vasava, saying: "' We have studied the Veda, made charitable gifts, offered sacrifices, safe-guarded our sovereignty, obtained the boon of longevity and freedom from disease and have established righteousness. Plunging our weapons into the bottomless ocean of the Gods, we have explored it ; we have overcome our enemies though their valour was unequalled; nay, we have nothing to fear from Mrityu, Narayana, Rudra, Shakra and **YAMA**, all hesitate to oppose us I Since have come together, let us assist each other mutually and exterminate the Gods, whose perfidy has been revealed to us.' " Having taken counsel together thus, those huge-bodied and valiant Nairritas hurled themselves into the fray, like unto Jambha and Vritra of yore. " O Rams, thus resolved, summoning up all their strength, they set out to fight, mounted on their chariots, elephants and horses that resembled elephants, mules, bulls, buft'alo, porpoises, aerpents, whales, turtle, fish, and birds resembling **GARUDA**, also on lions, tigers, boats, deer and Yaks. " Intoxicated with pride, all those *Rakshasas* marched out of Lanka, and those enemies of the Gods determined to lay siege to Devaloka. Perceiving the destruction of Lanka to be at hand, all the beings who inhabited it, recognizing the peril in which they stood, became wholly dispirited, whilst the *Rakshasas*, borne in marvellous chariots hastened towards Devaloka in hundreds and thousands, but the Goda avoided the path they had taken. " Thereupon, at Kala's command, temble portents appeared on earth and in the skies, foretelling the death of the *Rakshasa* leaders. From the clouds a torrent of hot blood and bones fell, the seas over-passed their bornes and the mountains shook. jackals of formidable aspect howled lugubriously, emitting hoarse laughter that resembled the rumble of clouds. Groups of

phantoms passed by in sucxession, and flocb of vultures, . wmiting ftames, hovered like fate over the Chief of the Rak· shasas. Red-footed pigeons and crows fled in all directions, ravens croaked and two footed cats were seen. " Disregarding these omens, the RakshPas, proud of their strength, continued to advance without halting, caught in the noose of death. Malyavan, Sumali and Mali of immense power, preceded the *Rakshasas* like unto ftaming brazieta ; Malyavan, who resembled Mount Malyavan, wss escorted by all the rangeta of the night, as the Gods by Dhatsr. That army of the foremost of the *Rakshasas*, thundering like massed clouds, eager for victory, advanced towards Devaloka under Mali’s leadership “Then the Lord Narayana, learning thereof from a messenger of the Gods, resolved to enter into combat with them. Making ready His arms and quivers, He mounted Vainateya and, having put on His celestial armour which shone like a thousand suns, He strapped on two dazzling quivers full of arrows. Buckling on His stainless sword, that God, Whose eyes resembled lotuses, furnished with His conch, discus, mace, sword, excellent weapons and His bow,' fully equipped, mounted the son of Vinata,' who was as high as a hill, and thereafter the Lord set out in all haste to slay the *Rakshasas*. " On the back of Supama, the dark-hued Hari, clad in yeUow, resembled a cloud transpierced with lightning on the peak of a golden mountain. As He left, with His discus, sword, bow, spear and His conch in His hands, Siddhas, Devarishis, Great Serpents, Gandharvas and Yakshas hymned the praises of the renowned enemy of the *Asura* Host. " With the blast of His wings, Supama struck at the Host of the *Rakshasas*, bringing down their standards and dispetaing their weapons so that they reeled like the dark summit of a mountain whose crags are crumbling away. “With their excellent shafts however, soiled with flesh and blood, like unto the fires of doom at the end of the world cycle, which they loosed in thousands,

those rangers of the night covered and pierced Madhava.

CHAPTER 7

The Combat between Vishnu and the Rakshasas

" IN the midst of rumblings, the clouds in the form of *Rakshasas* poured down a shower of weapons on the Pesk Narayana, as with their torrents they sbtoud a mountain, and the dark and immaculate **VISHNU**, sunounded by those swarthy and powerful rangers of the night, resembled Mount Anjana undet rain. As locusts in a rice field or gnats in a flame, as llies in a pot of honey, as monsters in the deep, so did the arrows, keen as diamonds, swift as the wind or thought, which the *Rakshasas* loosed on Hari, piercing him, disappear as the worlds vanish at the time of universal destruction. " Warriors in chariOts or seated on the heads of elephants, soldiers on horseback, infantry stationed in the sky, leaden of the Raksbasas resembling mountains, with their shafts, spears, swotds and darts, caused Hari to bold His breath, like unto the Twice-bom when practising Pranayama.' " Like an oaan where fishes play, that invincible God, under the coundess blows of those rangers of the night, drew His bow and loosed His shafts on them ; then **VISHNU** with extreme force, like unto lightning, swift as thought, riddled them with His penetrating weapons and spears by hundreds and thousands. Having dispersed them under a load of arrows as the wind a downpour, the Supreme Purusba blew His great Conch Pan· cbajaya, and that king of conches, bom of the waters, into which Hari blew with all His strength, re-echoed in such fearful wise that it shook the Three Worlds as it were. The sound of that king of conches struck terror into the Raksbasas, as the King of Beasts in the forest terrorizes the elephants

intoxicated with ichor. At the sound of the conch, the horses were no longer able to stand erect, the frenzy of the elephants was subdued, wbilst the warriors fell from their cars bereft of strength. “Loosed from His bow, **VISHNU**’s arrows, possessed of plumed hafts, having rent the Rabhasas, penetrated into the earth. Pierced by those darts, which the hand of Narayana loosed in the fight, the Rabhasas fell on the earth like struck by lightning, their powerful limbs by **VISHNU**’s discus, the blood flowing in torreots, as from mountsins secreting gold. The sound of that king of conches, the twanging of the bow string and the voice of Visbnu stifled the cries of the *Rakshasas*. " Then Hari severed their trembling necks, their darts, banners, bows, chariOts, pennants and quiven. As the rays fall from the sun, as masses of water spout forth from the ses, as mighty tuskers rush down the mountain side, as torrents of rain fall from a cloud, so did the darts and arrows discharged by Nara ysna from His bow, fall in hundreds and thousands. As a lion before a Sharabha, as an elephant before a lion, as a tiger before an elephant, as a pantbet before a tiger, as a dog before a panther, as a cat before a dog, as a snake before a cat, as mice before a snake, so did the *Rakshasas* flee before the mighty Visbnu. Some escaped, others fell in their flight and the rest lay stretched on the earth. Whilst slaying his foes in their thousands, the Destroyer of M.adhu filled the conch with his breath, as **INDRA** the clouds with water. “Put to flight by Narayana’s shafts, terrified by the sound of the conch, the army of the *Rakshasas*, their ranb broken, fled in the direction of Lanka. " Seeing his troops routed, decimated by Narayana’s arrows, Sumali covered Hari with a hail of darts on the battlefield, as the fog obscures the sun, whereupon the valiant *Rakshasas* plucked up oourage. Then Sumali, proud of his strength, rallying his forces, hurled himself forward with a great shout. Shaking his earrings as an elephant his trunk, that night-ranger, in his joy, raised a great

clamour like unto a cloud pierced by lightning and. while Sumali cried out thus, Hari cut off the head of his charioteer with its dazzling eanings, and the steeds of that *Rakshasa* swerved, bearing away Sumali, the lesder of the Titans, as those otbet steeds, the senses, when uncontrolled, bear away man's judgment. "Thereafter while Sumali was being borne away by the hones of his chariot, Mali, alert, armed with his bow, rushed on the mighty **VISHNU** who, on his vehicle, had thrown himself into the 393 ftay ; and he let fty his arrows deoorated with gold from his bow, which fell on Hari piercing him, as birds penetrate into the Krauncba Mountain. Assailed by the shafts, which Mali loosed in their thousands in the fight, **VISHNU** remained as undisturbed as one in full conrrol of his senses in the filce of adversity. " Twanging His bow-stting, Bhagawat, the Author of all beings, still bearing his sword and mace, discharged a hail of arrows on Mali, like unto thunder and lightning, penetrating his body, and those shafts drank his blood as serpenlll a pleasing draught. " In the confusion into which he had thrown Mali, the God who bears the conch, discus and mace, struck oft' his disdem and brought down his banner, his bow and his steeds. Deprived of his chariot, that most powerful ranger of the night seized hold of his mace and, with this weapon in his hand, like a lion from a mountain height, hurled himself on the King of the Birds' as Antaka on Ishana, striking him on the forehead, as **INDRA** strikes a mountain with his thunderbolt. " On receiving that violent blow dealt by Mali, **GARUDA**, dis tracted with pain, carried the God away from the fight, and **VISHNU**, having turned away through this act of Mali's and **GARUDA**'s, a great clamour arose from the *Rakshasas* shouting in triumph. " Hearing the Raksbasas shout thus, the younger brother of Harihaya, the blessed Hari, was incensed with that King of Birds who served as his mount and, with the intention of slaying Mali, though his back was turned, He loosed His discus that

was as bright as the solar orb, whose radiance illumines the heavens. Like unto Kala’s wheel, the discus fell on Mali’s head and that terrible head of that leader of the *Rakshasas*, thus severed, rolled down amidst torrents of blood, as formerly that of Rahu. " At that instant, the Gods, transported with joy, emitted roara like unto lions, crying with all their strength, ' Victory to Thee, OLord!' “Beholding Mali slain, Sumali and Malyavan, in burning grief, took refuge in Lanka with their forces. Meanwhile **GARUDA** having recovered, retraced his steps and, in fury, dispersed the *Rakshasas* with the blast of his wings. Their lotus faces cut with the discus, their breasts by the mace, their necks severed by the ploughsbate, their foreheads split open by pilres, some pierced by the swotd, some slain by arrows, those *Rakshasas* began to fall from the skies into the waters of the sea. " Narayana, like unto a luminous cloud, with his excellent shafts loosed from His bow, as so many lightning strokes, exter minated those rangers of the night with their hair dishevelled and streaming in the wind. Their parasols broken, their rich apparel tom by the shafts, their entrails ripped open, their eyes wide with fear, those warriors, throwing away their arms, fell into a frenzy of terror. Resembling elephants attacked by a lion, those night-rangers with their mounts emitted cries whilst fleeing from that Primeval Lion,' who puraued them. “Overwhelmed by a rain of darts from Hari, they threw away their weapons, and those rangers of the night resembled sombre clouds which the wind drives before it. Their heads severed.by the discus, their limbs crushed with blows from the mace, cut in two by strokes of the swotd, those foremost of the night rangers, resembling sable clouds, crumbled like rocks and they stumbled and fell on the earth which they covered completely like dark mountains which have been shattered.

CHAPTER 8

The Combat between Vishnu and Malyavan

" WHEN the army that followed him was destroyed by Padmanabha, Malyavan halted in his flight, as the ocean when it reaches the shore. His eyes red withanger,his head trembling, that ranger of the night said to Padmanabha, the Supreme Purusba : " 'O Narayana, Thou art ignorant of the ancient tradition of warriors, since Tbou, as if a stranger to their caste, dost alay those who, in their terror, have retreated in the fight. That assassin who commits the sin of slaying a foe who has turned his hack on him, O Chief of the Gods, does not attain heaven, as do the virtuous on leaving this world. Assuredly if Thou dost desire to enter into combat, Thou Who art armed with conch, discus and mace, here I stsnd ! Manifest Thy prowess that I may witness it ! ' " Seeing Malyavan stsnding motionless, like unto the mountain of that name, the younger brother of the King of the Gods, in his valour, answered the foremost of the Rskshasas, saying : " ' I have vowed the Gods that I will deliver them from the terror thou hast inspired, by slaying thee, I shall honour that pledge. The welfare of the Gods is dearer to me than life itself; therefore I shall destroy you all ; now descend into the lowest hell ! ' " Thus did the Lord of Lords speak, He Whose eyes resembled crimson lotuses and, filled with fory, the Rskshasa, with his spear, cut open his breast. Wielded by Malyavan’s arm, that weapon emitting the sound of a bell, glittered in the bresst of Hari like lightoing athwart a cloud. Thereafter, He Who is dear to the God Who bears the Spear ' drawing out that lance, hurled it at Malyavan and, as formerly Skanda loosed it, that weapon, flying from the hand of Govinds, rushed on the Rskshasa like unto a grest meteor striking the Anjana Mountain, and it fell on his mighty

chest, that was adorned with innumer able diamonds, as lightning strikes a rocky summit. That blow cut his mail asunder and his eyes were veiled but, recovering consciousness, he stood erect once more, like unto an im moveable rock. Armed with an iron club with innumerable spikes, he struck the God violendy in the centre of the breast and, in his martial ardour, having wounded the younger brother ofVasava with his fist, that ranger of the night retreated a bow's length. At that moment, the cry ' acellent, acellent ' arose in the sky. " Thereafter the Rskshasa attacked **GARUDA**, and Vlinateya incensed, drove him off with the blut of his wings as a violent tempest disperses a heap of withered leaves. " Seeing his elder brother driven back by the blast of **GARUDA**'s wings, Sumali, overcome with confusion, with his fted in the direction of Lanka. And thrust back by the violence of the wind produced by those wings, Malysvan also, joined by his forces, lied to Lanka covered with shame. " O Lotus-eyed Prince, the Raksbasas having been repeatedly defeated in the battle by Hari and having lost the most valiant of their leaders, in their inability to withstand **VISHNU**, Who was destroying them, abandoned Lanka and went to dwell in Patala with their consorts. O Prince of the House of Ragbu, those *Rakshasas*, renowned for their strength and who were the issue of the Salakatankata Race, remained under the leadership of Sumali. It was Thou Who didst destroy those warriors of the family of Poulastya named Sumali, Malysvan, Mali and their companions, who were all excecdingly resourceful and more powerful than **RAVANA**. None other could have subdued the enemies of the Gods or have wecdcd out those thorns in the side of the Celestials, save Naraysna, the God Who bears the conch, discus and mace. Thou art that Four-armed God, Naraysna, eternal, invincible and immutable, Who came to exterminate the *Rakshasas*. Thou art the Father of all Beings, who, whenever righteousness declines and for love of those who take

refuge in Thee, dost appear to wipe out evil-doers. " O Lord of Men, I have related in detail all that concerns the origin of the Raksbasas. Learn further, O Prince of the Ragbus, of the immeasurable power of **RAVANA** and his sons. " For a long time, Sumali wandered about the nether reginns, tormented by the fear of **VISHNU**, whilst the mighty God of Wealth, surrounded by his sons and grandsons, sojourned in Lanka.

CHAPTER 9

The Birth of Dashagriva and His Brothers

" APTBR a time, that *Rakshasa*, named Sumali, emerged from the Dllther regions to range the world of men. With his earrings of pure gold, he, like unto a dark cloud, took with him a young wandered about the earth, he beheld the Lord of Wealth, who in his Chariot Pushpaka was going to visit his sire. Beholding that son of Poulastya, that lord who was as radiant as a God, advancing towards him like unto fire, he, amazed, returned to Rasatala from the world of men. " Thereafter that exceedingly intelligent *Rakshasa* refiected ' Which is the best way of increasing our power ? ' Thus did the foremost of the Raksbasas, who was like unto a dark cloud and was wearing golden earrings, refiect within himself and, having considered awhile, that extremely sagscinus *Rakshasa* said to his daughter Kaikasi, fur such was her name : "'My Daughter, it is time fur thee to wed ; thy youth is slipping away and, afraid of being refused, those who are in love with thee do not pay their suit. Striving to ful1il our duty, we seek only thine advantage. Assuredly, thou art endowed with every good attribute and resemblest Shri in person, O Dear Child I A young daughter is a source of anxiety to her mther who is concerned fur her honour, nor does he know whom

she will wed. O Beloved Child, the mother's family, the father's family and the one into which she is received are all three involved in this anxiety. Do thou therefure seek out that blessed ascetic, the furemost of Poulastya's offspring and choose Vish ravas, the descendant of Poulastya, O My Daughter. Assuredly thou wilt beget sons equal to that Lord of Wealth, who, in his splendour, rivals the sun.' " At these words, in filial obedience, that young girl went to seek out Vishravas where he was undergoing penance. At that time, O **RAMA**, that Twice-born, the issue of Poulastya was engaged in the Fire Sacrifice and himself appeared like unto a fuurth fire. Heedless of the late hour and, in obedience to her sire, she presented herself befure the ascetic and, halting there with her eyes cast down, fixed on her feet, she scratched the earth from time to time with her toe. " Beholding that lovely girl, whose mce resembled the full moon and who shone in her own radiance, that *Muni* of eDited lineage, enquired of her saying : "' O Fortunate One, whose daughter art thou? From whence dost thou come and fur what reason or with wbat motive ? Answer me truthfully, O Beautiful One? ' 398 " Thus questioned, the young girl with joined palms, answered: ' By thine own powers, O *Muni*, thou must be conversant with mine intentions I Learn only, O Btahmarishi, tbst it is by the command of my sire tbst I have come, and Kaikasi is my name. The rest must be known to thee.' Theresfter the *Muni*, reflecting awhile, uttered these words : " ' I know well, O Fortunate One, what brings thee hete, thou att desirous of having sons by me, thou whose gait is like unto an intoxicated elephant ! But, having presented thyself at this hour,' hear me, O Fortunate One, thou shalt bring forth off spring of a dark aspect delighting in the companionship of doers of evil deeds. O Lady of Lovely Form, thou shalt beget *Rakshasas* of cruel exploits.' "At these words, Kaikasi prostrated herself, saying : " ' O Blessed One who recitest the Veda, I do

not desire such son whose nature is depraved, from thee, be gracious unto me I’ " Thns besought by thst youthful maiden, Vishravas, foremost among *Munis*, like unto the moon in the presence of Robini, added: " ' O Lady of Lovely Face, the son thou shalt bring forth last will be like unto me, assuredly he will be virtuous.' " Thns did he speak to thst young girl, O **RAMA**, and after some time she gave birth to a hideous child with the face of a demon, exceedingly dark ; and he had ten necks and great teeth and resembled a heap of collyrium ; his lips were of the hue of copper, he had twenty arms and a vast mouth and his hair was fiery red. At his birth, jackals and other wild beasts with flaming jaws circled from left to right. The God Parjanya let loose a rain of blood whilst clouds emitted harsh sounds ; the sun ceased to shine, fierce winds blew and the unchanging ocean, Lord of the Rivers, was agitated. " When this great being was born, a rain of fiowers fell and, in the heavens, celestial gongs resounded whilst an aerial voice cried, ' Excellent ", .. Excellent '. “Thereafter Kumbhakama and Dasbagriva throve in that vaat forest and each was exceedingly powerfUl and they were scourgers of the worlds. The insensate Kumbhakama ranged the Three Worlds devouring the great *Rishis* who were fixed in their duty, and be remained unsatisfied. " As for the virtuous Bibiabana, ever vowed to righteousness, the study of the Veda being his chief nourishment, be lived as the subduer of his senses. " After a time Vaisbravana, the Lord of Wealth, went to visit his sire in his Chariot Pusbpaka and, seeing him 1laming with elfulgence, the Rsksbasi sought out Dashagriva and said to him: " My Son, behold Vaisbravana, thy brother, blazing with glory and behold thy stste, who art of the same tiunily, O Dasbagriva. Thou who art of immeasurable might, strive to be like Vaisbravana himself.' " Hearing his mother’s words, the arrogant Dasbagriva experi enced a wave of overpowering bitterness, whereupon

be formu lated this vow. " I swear to thee in truth that I shall become my brother's equal if not his superior in power ; banish any fesrs that may have entered thine heart ! ' " Thereafter, in his spleen, Dasbagriva, accompanied by his younger brother,' began to undertake an exceedingly dillicult task, undergoing a rigid penance. (*He thought*) I shall accomplish mine end by asceticism ' and having thus resolved, be went to the lovely bermiblge of Gokarna in order to purifY his soul. There that Raksbasa with his younger brother performed unsurpassed austerities. Such were his mortifications that be gratified the Lord, the Grandsire of the World, who, in his satiafaction, granted him those boons that would assure him of victory. "

CHAPTER 10

Concerning the Penances practised by Dashagriva and His Brothers

THEN **RAMA** enquired of the *Muni* :-" How did those highly powerful brothers practice penance, O Brahmana, and of what nature was it ? " Theo Agastya of tranquil mind answered **RAMA** and said : " Various were the pious observances of escb of them; Kumbhabma too, putting forth all his sttengtb, constantly pursued the path of duty. In the heat of summer he stood amidst five files and, in the rainy season, he took up the Vira posture,' whilst in the winter season he remained plunged in water. " Thus two thousand years passed during which he applied himself to piety and remained on the righteous path. " On his side, Bibishana, who was virtue itself, intent on duty and of pure soul, stood on one leg for five thousand years. This penance accomplished, troops of Apsaras dsnced and a rain of Bowers fell, whilst the Gods hymned his

praises. During another five thousand years, he stood filcing the sun, hia head and arms raised, his mind filed in contemplation of the Veds. In this wise, Bibishana, like an inhabitant of heaven in the Nandana Gardens, dwelt for ten thousand years. And Dashagtiva deprived himself of nourishment for the same period and every thousand years sacrificed one of his heads to the God of Fire. Thus nine thousand years passed and nine of his heads had beeA sacrificed to Fire; when ten thousand years had gone by, Dashagtiva prepared to sever his tenth head when the Grandsire of the World appeared, and He, with the Gods, highly gratified, presented Himself before **RAVANA** and said to him : " ' I am pleased with thee, what boon shall I confer on thee this day ? Thou shalt not have undergone these austerities in vain. O Thou who art conversant with *dharma*, speedily choose what boon wiU 11101t please thee ; thou hast found favour with me, O Dashagtiva I " Thereupon Dashagriva, delighted, bowing down to that God, answered in a voice uembling with joy : " ' O Bbagawat, for living beings there exists no fear like that of death ; there is no foe oomparable to Mrityu, therefore I choose immortality ! ' " Thus spoke Dashagriva and Brahms answered him saying : " ' It is not possible to grant thee immortality, choose some other boon ! " At these words of Brahms, the Creator of the World, O **RAMA**, Dashagriva replied with joined palms : "'May I not be slain by Suparnss, Nagas, Yakshas, Daityas Danavas, *Rakshasas* nor by the Gods, O Eternal One, O Lord of Beings. I do not fear other creatures, who, with men, I look upon as mere straws, O Thou who art adored by the Celestials.' " Thus spoketheRakshasa **DASARATHA**, and the Lord, the Grand sire of the Worlds, who was accompanied by the Gods, said to him: .. ' It shall be as thou desirest, O Foremost of the *Rakshasas* ! Then, having answered Dashagriva thus, O **RAMA**, the Grand sire added : " 'Hear what great favour I shall grant thee further in my satisfaction. The

beads that formerly were sacrificed by thee into the fire, O Irreproachable One, will now grow again as they were before and, O *Rakshasa*, I will finally confer another boon on thee that is hard to obtain, O My Friend, thou shalt be able to assume any form thou desirest at will. " As soon as the Grandsire had spoken thus, the heads of the *Rakshasa* Dashagriva, that had been ansumed by fire, grew again. " O **RAMA**, having spoken thus to Dashagriva, the Grandsire of the Worlds said to Bibishana :-" ' O My Dear Bibishana, thou whose intcllect is fixed on virtue, I am gratified with thee, choose a boon, O Righteous and Pious One.' " Then the pure-souled Bibishana, who radiated good qualities as the moon her beams, spoke with joined palms, saying : " ' O Bhagawat, I have endeavoured to do that which I ought to do. Thou art the Guru of the World; if, in thy satisfaction, thou dost accord me a boon, then hear me, O Blessed Lord. May my soul ever be fized in righteousness in the midst of the 402 greatest adversity. Without being instructed, may I be able to use tbe Brabma Weapon. May wbatever thoughts come to me, wherever or in whatever state I find myself, always conform to virtue and may I fulfil my duty I O Most Exalted of Beings, these are tbe boons I consider to be tbe most precious ; for those who follow dbarma notbing is impossible I ' “Tben Prajapati, full of joy, again addressed Bibisbana saying: "' O Most Virtuous and Dear Child, let it be as tbou sayest, though tbou wast born in the Raksbasa Race, O Slayer of Thy Foes, no evil ever enters thy heart ! I grant tbee immortality I ' " Having uttered these words, as Prajapati was preparing to accord a boon to Kumbbakarna, all the Gods, with joined palms, addressed him thus : "'As for Kumbbakarna, do not grant him any boons ! Thou knowest well how tbe Three Worlds fear this perverse wretch I In the Nandana Gardens, seven Apsaras and ten servants of Mahendra were devoured by him, O Brabma, as also *Rishis* and men. Such are tbe deeds

of this Raksbasa before receiving a boon ; if one is conferred on him, he may consume tbe Three Worlds I O Thou whose splendour is immeasurable, feigning to grant him a boon cause him to become bemused ; in this way, the worlds will live in peace and he will receive his just deserts.' " Thus did the Goda speak, and Brahms, born of the lotus, tbought on the Goddess, his consort, and, as soon as he called her to mind, Saraswati appeared at his side and, with joined palms said to him : " ' O Lord, I am here, wbat shall I do ? ' " Then Prajapati answered tbat Goddess, who bad come there, saying: " ' O Thou who art Speech, be thou in the mouth of tbat **INDRA** among tbe Raksbasas and utter tbat which tbe Goda desire.' "'So be it ! '" ahe answered and, baving entered his mouth, **KUMBBAKARNA** *said*: "'To Bleep for innumerable years, O Lord of Lords, this is my desire I' " ' May it be so I '" answered Brabma and, with the Gods, he departed. 403 "The Goddess Saraswati then left the Rabhasa, whUe Brahm, with the Gods ascended to the heavenly region. "When Saraswati had departed, Knmbhalwna came to himself' and that perverse wtetch, in his misfortune, rellected : " ' How can snch words have passed my lips? I must have been bemused by the Gods who came hither.' " Having received those various boons, the three brothers of 1lamiDg energy, returned to the Sleshmstska Forest where they dwelt happily. CHAPTER Dlumada cllks Lan/oa to Dtuhogrifla " SUMAU, having learnt of the boons that the rangers of the night had received, abandoning his fear, emerged from the nether regions, and the companions of that *Rakshasa*, Maricha, Prahasta, Virupabha and Mahodata rushed out also full of fury. " Thereafter Somali with his friends, sUIIOunded by the fore most of the *Rakshasas*, sought out Dashagriva and, embracing him, said: "' By the grace of heaven, O Dear Child, the desire of my heart has been fulfilled since thou haat received these ezcellent boons from the Lord of the Three Worlds. The great fear

that forced us to abandon Lanka in order to take refuge in Rasatala, into which we were precipitated by **VISHNU**, has now been dissipated I Many and many a time, under the threat of that terror, we abandoned our retreat but, being pursued, together we plunged into hell. Thy brother, that crafty Lord of Wealth, took possession of the City of Lanka, the abode of the *Rakshasas*. If it be possible by conciliation, gifts or force, to regain the posses sion of it, then do so, O Irreproachable Hero I Thou wilt then become the sovereign of Lanka and, by thy grace, the Rabhasa Race, that has been disestablished, will be reinstated; there after thou wilt reign over us all, O Lord.' " Then Dashagriva answered his maternal grandfather who ltOOd near and said :

CHAPTER 11

Dhanada cedes Lanka to Dashagriva

"The Goddess Saraswati then left the Rabhasa, whUe Brahm, with the Gods ascended to the heavenly region. "When Saraswati had departed, Knmbhalwna came to himself' and that perverse wtetch, in his misfortune, rellected : " ' How can snch words have passed my lips? I must have been bemused by the Gods who came hither.' " Having received those various boons, the three brothers of 1lamiDg energy, returned to the Sleshmstska Forest where they dwelt happily. CHAPTER Dlumada cllks Lan/oa to Dtuhogrifla " SUMAU, having learnt of the boons that the rangers of the night had received, abandoning his fear, emerged from the nether regions, and the companions of that *Rakshasa*, Maricha, Prahasta, Virupabha and Mahodata rushed out also full of fury. " Thereafter Somali with his friends, sUIIOunded by the fore most of the *Rakshasas*, sought out

Dashagriva and, embracing him, said: "' By the grace of heaven, O Dear Child, the desire of my heart has been fulfilled since thou haat received these ezcellent boons from the Lord of the Three Worlds. The great fear that forced us to abandon Lanka in order to take refuge in Rasatala, into which we were precipitated by **VISHNU**, has now been dissipated I Many and many a time, under the threat of that terror, we abandoned our retreat but, being pursued, together we plunged into hell. Thy brother, that crafty Lord of Wealth, took possession of the City of Lanka, the abode of the *Rakshasas*. If it be possible by conciliation, gifts or force, to regain the posses sion of it, then do so, O Irreproachable Hero I Thou wilt then become the sovereign of Lanka and, by thy grace, the Rabhasa Race, that has been disestablished, will be reinstated; there after thou wilt reign over us all, O Lord.' " Then Dashagriva answered his maternal grandfather who ltOOd near and said : UTT ARA *KANDA* "' The Lord of Wealth is mine elder brother; it is not fitting that thou shouldst speak thus.' " Quietly rebuked in this wise by thst **INDRA** of the *Rakshasas*, the most powerful of them aU, Sumali, being aware of his intentions, did not insist fUrther. " Some time later, as **RAVANA** continued to reside in thst place, Prabasta addressed these significant words to him : "' O Valiant Dasbagriva, such a speech is not worthy of thee ; brotherly love is not the concern of heroes I Hesr me I There were two sisters who loved each other and who were supremely filir ; they were wedded to thst Lord of Creatures, the Prajapati Kashyapa, and with him Aditi begot the Gods, those Lords of the Three Worlds, whilst Diti begot the Dsityas. To the Daityas, those virtuous heroes, the earth, with its mountains, surrounded by the ocean, formerly belonged. They wued exceedingly strong, nevcrthe1ess they were slain in war by the mighty **VISHNU**, who gave over the imperishable Triple World to the Gods. Thou art therefore not the only one to act in opposi tion to a brother,

which was done by the Gods and *Asuras*. Follow my counsel therefore I ' " Dashagriva, hearing these words was filled with joy and, having rellected a moment, he ssid, ' It is well ! ' and, in his delight, thst same day the valiant Dasbagriva with his rangers of the night repaired to the wood bordering on Lanka. Stationed on the Trikuta Mountain, thst ranger of the night sent out Prahasta, who was skilled in speech, as his ambassador, and aaid to him: .. ' Go speedily, O Prabasta, and speak to the foremost of the Nairritas, addressing him in conciliatory words, saying : " ' This Oty of Lanka, O King, belongs to the magnanimous *Rakshasas* I O My Friend, thou didat take possession of it ; it is not just, O Thou who art beyond reproach ! If thou dost restore it to as now, O Hero of unrivalled exploits, I shall be gratified and jastice will have been maintained. ' " Then Prahaata repaired to the Oty of Lanka, whose strong warriors, to come hither and my words are those of Dashanaua, O Lotd of Wealth I " ' This ravishiog city, O Large-eyed Hero, was formerly held by the Rskshssas of terrible exploits, whose chief was Somali. It is on this account, dear son of Vishravas, that Dasbagriva asb thee to restore it to them ; this request is made in all friendli· ness.' " Having heard Prahasta, Vaisbravana replied in words worthy of one who is skilled in speech and said : " ' Lanb was bestowed on me by my sire when it had been abandoned by the rangers of the night ; I have peopled it by inducements of gifts, honours and every kind of privilege. Now go and bring this answer to Dasbagriva-" The city and the kingdom under my dominion are thine also, O Long-armed Hero, enjoy this realm without restriction; share this dominion and its riches with me without division." ' " Having spoken thus, that Lotd of Wealth went to visit his sire and paying obeisance to him related the nature of **RAVANA**'s request, saying : " ' O My Father, Dasbagriva has sent a messenger to me, saying, " Give up the City of Lanb that was formerly occupied by

the Rabhasa Race.” What shall I do now, O Blessed One, tell me?' “On this enquiry, the Brahmarishi Visbravas, foremost of the ascetics, said to Dhanada who stood before him with joined palms: .. ' Hear me, O My Son, the long-armed Dasbagriva has spoken of this matter in my presence and I have often rebuked him ; he is exceedingly wicked and, in my wrath, I said to him " Thou wilt be destroyed ; it were better for thee to listen to my words which are fraught with reason and integrity ". He is perverse however, and the boons he has received have so intoxicated him that he can no longer discriminate between what is just and unjust. It is on account of my curse that he has fallen into this lamentable condition. Do thou therefore retire to Mount Kailasha, that support of the earth, O Long-armed Hero, and leave Lanb with thy followers at once. In that place the en chanting Mandakini, the most excellent of rivers llows, whose Kumuda, Utpala and other varieties of water-lilies of sweet fragrance. *Devas*, Gandharvas, Apsaras, Uragas and Kinneras sojourn there, constantly disporting themselves. It is not fitting, O Dbansds, thst thou shouldst enter into combat with thst Rskshasa, for thou art conversant with the special boons he has received.' " Heating this reply and obedient to the counsel ofhis venerable sire, Dbansds left Lanka with his conson, his sons, his ministers, his vehicles and bis wealth. “McantimcPrahasta had sought out the mighty Dashagrivaand, with a joyous heart, said to bim in the midst of his counsellors : " The City of Lanka is now free, Dhanada has abandoned it and has departed. Do thou establish thyself therein so thst. with us, thou canst fulfil thy duty.' " Thus did Prahasta speak, and the all-powerful Dashagriva invaded Lanka with his brothers, his army and his coun. As the Gods enter heaven, so did thst enemy of the Cclcstials enter thst city that Dbansds had just dcaertcd and wbich was divided by well-planned highways. Enthroned by the rangers of the night,

Dashanana installed bimsclf in thst city, wbich was filled with *Rakshasas* resembling dark clouds. " The Lord of Wealth, however, in reverence for bis father's words, built a city on Mount Kailasha wbich was immaculate as the moon, adorned with splendid palaces sumptuously decorated, as Purandara constructed Amaravati.

CHAPTER 12

The Marriages of the Rakshasas

" TRI! foremost of the *Rakshasas*, having been anointed king, with his brother began to consider giving his sister in marriage. He therefore gave thst *Rakshasi* to the King of the KaJakas and the Lord of the Danavas bimaclf presented Shurpanakha, his sister, to Vidyujjihva. "This being accomplished, thst night-ranger left for the chase and thereafter he beheld the son of Diti, Maya, O Rams. Seeing 407 him accompanied by a young girl, that Raksbasa, Dasbagriva said to him : " Who art thou wandering in the forest that is devoid of man or beast ? How is it that tbou art in the company of tbis youtbful maiden whose eyes resemble a doc's ? ' " "O Rams, to tbis question, put to him by that ranger of tbc night, Maya replied, saying : "'Hear me and I will tell thee the truth I There was a nymph named Hems of whom thou hast already heard. The Gods bestowed her on me, as Pauloma was given to Shatakratu. Full nf love for her, I passed centuries at her side when abc was taken from me by the Gods. Thirteen years passed and in the fourteenth, I built a golden city which I decorated with diamonds and emeralds by the aid nf my magic powers. There I dwelt, deprived of Hems, sad, dejected and extremely wretched. Thereafter, taking my daughter with me, I left that city in order to retire to the forest. This is

my child, O King, who was brought up in Hema's lap and here I am seeking a husband for her. A daughter is a grcst calamity, at least for all tbose who have regard to her honour. In truth, she is a source nf anxiety to the family of her father and that of her mother. " ' Two sons were also born to me by my wife ; the first was Mayavi, O Dear Friend, and Dundubhi followed immediately. I have told tbee the whole truth in accordance with thy wish ! And now, My Dear Son, I would know something of thee, who art tbou?' " At these words tbc Raksbasa answered respectfully : " I am nf Poulastya's race and my name is Dashagriva, my father was tbc Sage Vishravas, who was tbc third son nfBrshma.'" " On hearing these words of that lndra among the *Rakshasas*, O Rams, indicating that he was the son of a grcst Sage, Maya, the foremost nf the Danavas wished to give hia daughter to him. Taking her hand in hia, Maya addressed that King of the *Rakshasas*, saying : '" O King, this child, whose motberwas the nymph Hema, tbc youtbful **MANDODARI**, for s1,1ch is her name, do thou accept as thy COilSOl't.' " Let it be so I ' answered Dashagriva, whereupon igniting a fire there, he took her hand in his, O Rams. Maya was 408 conversant with the curse that Dashagriva's sire, that treasury of asceticism had pronounced, nevertheless he bestowed his daughter in marriage on him, knowing him to be the ofl'spring of the Grandsire of the World. At the ssme time, he gave him a marvellous spesr which he had obtained through his supreme It was with this weapon that **RAVANA** wounded Lakshmans. Then, having brought about this marriage, the Lord of Lanka returned to that city. " There, with their consent, he chose two wives for his two brothers ; the daughter of Virochsna, named Vajrsvals, was given by him to Kumbbakarna, and Bibishana received as wife the virtuous Sarsms, the daughter of the King of the Gand harvas, the magnanimous Shailusha, and she had been bom on the shores of the

Lake Manasa. " At that time in the rsiny season, the waters of the Manasa Lake were swollen and the mother of the girl cried out alfection ately, ' Do not overflow, O Lake ! Thereafter the girl was called Sarsms. " These alliances having been concluded, the *Rakshasas* gave themselves up to pleasure, each with his own collsort, as the Gandharvas in the Nandana Gardens. " And **MANDODARI** gave birth to a child with the voice of a thunder-cloud, he who is known to thee as Indrajita. Scarcely had he been bom than that son of **RAVANA** began to roar with a terrible voice, like unto thunder, and the city was deafened, O Raghava. His father therefore called him Meghanada ;' and he grew up in the magnificent private apartments, hidden in the lap of the foremost of women, as a tire is concealed under shavings ; and that son of **RAVANA** filled his mother and father with joy.

CHAPTER 13

Ravana's Crimes

Ssid to his brother, who was present : '" O King, sleep holds me in thrall, prepare a refuge fut me.t " Therefore the king selected some artisans, like unro Vish vabrma, who constructed a splendid dwelling fut Kumbbaltama, a league in expanse and two in length which was aceedingly sumptUous and secluded. On every side, it was decorated with oolumns of crystal encrusted with gold ; the stairways were made of cmcrald with rows of small bclls banging from the carved ivory galleries, the floors being of diamond and crystal. " All should have been oonstantly and wholly happy in that place, which was enchanting and luxurious in every way, and which was built by the *Rakshasas* and resembled a sscred cave in the Mcru Mountain. It was there, ovcroome

by slumber, that the mighty Kumbbaltama rested innumerable years without waking. “Whilst his brother, the mighty Kumbbaltama, overcome by Nidra, slept fur thousands of years without waking, Dashanana, of unbridled passions, harassed the *Devas*, *Rishis*, Yakshas and Gandharvas and overran their beautiful parks and groves like a madman, laying them waste ; and that *Rakshasa* churned up the rivers, like an clcphant disporting itself, agitating the trees like a violent tempest and striking the bills as if by lightning. “HcaringofDashagriva’sexploits,thevirtuousLordofWealth, reftccting that he was his own brother, fur the honour of his race and desirous of manifesting fraternal affection, sent a messenger to Lanks in Dashagriva’s interests. " Then the messenger, entering the city, approached Bihishana who received him with honour and enquired concerning his visit. After asking about the welfare of Dhanada and his kinsfolk, Bihishana brought him to Dashanana in the assembly hall where he was resting. " Bcbolding the king blazing in his own effulgence, the messenger said :-' Hail to thee, O King ' and having paid obeisance with these words, stood silent awhile. At that time Dashagriva was reclining on a sumptUous couch adorned with rich coverings whereupon the messenger addressed him saying : "' O King, I bring thee the words uttered by thy brother in their entirety-' Between us two, equality of conduct should exist as among others of our race. A uuce to these evil deeds ! From now on comport thyself in a seemly manner and, if possible, take righteousness as thy guide ! I have seen the Nandaua Gardens laid waste and, it is said, that the *Rishis* have been persCCilted ; the measures that the Gods arc taking agsinst thee arc known to me. I have been disrcgsrded by thee on countless occasinns, but even if a youthful person err, he should be protected by his relatives. " ' Having repaired to the Himavat Plateau to practice *dharma* and subjugate my

senses, I forced myself to undergo penance in order to gratify the Lord Mahadcva; there I beheld that divine God accompanied by Uma and a glance from my lcfr eye fcii on the Goddess I " Who is this woman ? " I asked myself, desiring this knowledge and for no other reason, for Rudrani had assumed an unparalleled form. Then the Goddess, by her celestial power, consumed my lcfr eye, which grew yciiow and the light became obscured as if by dust. " ' Thereupon I repaired to another vast mountain plateau and remained there eight hundred years observing silence. Having completed that penance, the God Maheahwara came to me and, highly gratified, said : " '" I am satisfied with thine austerities O Virtuous and Saintly Ascetic. This vow has been fulfilled by me and by thee, O Lord ofRishis ; none other could have observed a similar mortification. These practices arc emcmcly rigid and I myself formerly followed them alao. Grant me thy friendship therefore, O Sinless One, thou hast conquered me and thy penance has been fruitful. As the Goddess, whose form thou didat look upon, 411 burnt up thy left eye, turning it yellow, thou shalt be ll8llled J!kabbipingali.' " " ' Having thus conaacted a friendship with Shanbra, I took leave of him and, on my return, learnt of thine evil conduct. Abandon this impious coune that will bring dishonour on our race. The Gods with the hosts of *Rishis* are considering how they msy destroy thee.' " Hearing these words, Dashagriva, his eyes red with anger, clenching his fists and teeth, answered him thus : "' O Messenger, I knew what thou wast about to utter ! Neither art thou my brother nor is he who sent thee ; for the Lord of Wealth is not speaking in mine interests I That fool forces me to hear of his friendship with Msheshwara ! This speech of thine is intolerable. I have borne it till now, for he is mine elder brother and, as such, it is not fitting that I should slay him. Now, hesring thine address, this is my resolve-' By the strength of mine arms, I shall conquer the Three Worlds.

Solely on his account, I shall dispatch the Four Guardians of the World to the region of Yams ! ' " Having spoken thus, the Lord of Lanka, **RAVANA**, slew the messenger with a single stroke of his sword and gave him to the wicked Rabhasas to devour. Thereafter, ascending his chariot amidst acclamations, in his eagerness to subdue the Three Worlds, he set out to seck the Lord of Wealth.

CHAPTER 14

The Combat between Ravana and the Yakshas

and, knowing this, they approsched Dhaneshwara and, coming into his presence, they imparted his brother's intentions to him. Thereupon, with Dhanada's permission, they set out joyfully in order to give battle. " Tbe impact of those valiant troops of the King of the Nairritas was as violent as the ses ; and the mountains seemed to be riven asunder, whilst a furious struggle ensued amongst the followers of the Rahbasas and, seeing his army thrown into disorder, Dasbagriva, the ranger of the night, after many encouraging shouts, 1lew into a rage. Tben the companions of the King of the Rahbasas of redoubtable valour, esch took on a thousand Yakshas. Smitten with blows from maces, iron bars, swords, picks and darts, Dushane, scarcely able to bresthe, was over whelmed by a rain of wespons which fell thick and fast like hail from the clouds. Nevertheless he remained unmoved under the shafts of the Yahbas, as a mountain that the clouds ftood with innumerable showers. " Thereafter, that hero, brandishing his mace like unto Kala's sceptre, llung himself on the Yakshas whom he hurled into **YAMA**'s abode. Like unto fire, llaming up on account of the wind, consuming a hesp of grass or dried faggots which are scattered about, so did he destroy the army of

the Yahbas. " And his ministers, Mahodara, Shuka and the othets, only suffered a few of the Yakshas to escape, who resembled clouds dispersed by the wind. Overwhelmed with blows and broken, they fell in the fight, filled with fury, biting their Jipa with their sharp teeth. And some of the Yakshas, exhausted, clung to esch other, their wespons broken, and aank down on the battlefield as dykes give way before a surge of waters. With those who were slain ascending to hesven, those who fought rushing hither and thither and the companies of *Rishis* witnessing the scene, there was not a single space left anywhere. " Beholding the foremost of the Yahbas scattered despite their vslour, the mighty Lord of Weslth despatched other Yakshas and, at his call, O **RAMA**, a Yaksha named Samyodhaltantaka instantly rushed our at the hesd of a 1alge force. Struck by him 413 in the fight, as by a second **VISHNU** with his discus, Maricha fell to the earth like a star falling from the heights of Mount Kailasha, ts merits exhausted. “Thereafter, that Ranger of the Night, regaining consciouancss, gathered up his strength in a moment and entered into combat with the Yaksha, who having been defeated, fled. Meantime Dashagriva, his limbs loaded with ornaments of gold, silver and emerald, advanced to the very portals of the outer defences and, seeing that Ranger of the Night enter, the doorkeeper sought to prevent him ; but the Rakshaaa forced his way in, whereupon the Yaksha seized hold of him. Seeing himself checked, O **RAMA**, he was not discouraged and began to break down the door, whilst the Yaksha, overwhelmed by his blows, streaming with blood, looked like a mountain from which minerals are pouring. “Though struck by the Y aksha with the door-post, that hero was not slain on account of the rare gifts received from Swyam bhu, and in his turn, arming himself with the same post, he struck the Y aksha who, his body reduced to dust, disappeared, leaving no ttace. “Thereupon, witneasingthe strength of the

Rakshasas, a general stampede took place among the Yakshas, who, mad with terror, sought refuge in the rivers and the caves, throwing away their arms, exhausted, their features distorted. CHAPTER IS The Combat be”-n Rmlana and Dlumada. Rar1a11a seizes l’rllhpaka " Sm!ING the foremost of the Yakshas fleeing in their thousands, the Lord of Wealth said to the powerful Manibhadts : " ' O Prince of the Yakshas, slay that wicked **RAVANA** of evil ways and deliver the valiant and heroic Yakshas I ' “At this command, the long-armed and invincible Manibhadts set out to fight surrounded by four thousand Yakshas and they hurled themselves on the *Rakshasas*, whom they struck with

CHAPTER 15

The Combat between Ravana and Dhanada. Ravana seizes Pushpaka

in the fight, as by a second **VISHNU** with his discus, Maricha fell to the earth like a star falling from the heights of Mount Kailasha, ts merits exhausted. “Thereafter, that Ranger of the Night, regaining consciouancss, gathered up his strength in a moment and entered into combat with the Yaksha, who having been defeated, fled. Meantime Dashagriva, his limbs loaded with ornaments of gold, silver and emerald, advanced to the very portals of the outer defences and, seeing that Ranger of the Night enter, the doorkeeper sought to prevent him ; but the Rakshaaa forced his way in, whereupon the Yaksha seized hold of him. Seeing himself checked, O **RAMA**, he was not discouraged and began to break down the door, whilst the Yaksha, overwhelmed by his blows, streaming with blood, looked like a mountain from which minerals are pouring. “Though struck by the Y aksha with the door-post,

that hero was not slain on account of the rare gifts received from Swyam bhu, and in his turn, arming himself with the same post, he struck the Y aksha who, his body reduced to dust, disappeared, leaving no ttace. “Thereupon, witneasingthe strength of the *Rakshasas*, a general stampede took place among the Yakshas, who, mad with terror, sought refuge in the rivers and the caves, throwing away their arms, exhausted, their features distorted. CHAPTER IS The Combat be”-n Rmlana and Dlumada. Rar1a11a seizes l’rllhpaka " Sm!ING the foremost of the Yakshas fleeing in their thousands, the Lord of Wealth said to the powerful Manibhadts : " ' O Prince of the Yakshas, slay that wicked **RAVANA** of evil ways and deliver the valiant and heroic Yakshas I ' “At this command, the long-armed and invincible Manibhadts set out to fight surrounded by four thousand Yakshas and they hurled themselves on the *Rakshasas*, whom they struck with 414 blowl ftom maces, bars, javelins, lances, swords and clubs. And they entered into a violent struggle, fll1ling on the foe with the swiftness of birds of ptey, crying 'Advance I Advance I’ ' Yield ! ' ' Never I ' ' Fight ! ' “Beholding that formidable combat, the *Devas*, Gandharvas, Risbis and Chanters of the Veda were extremely astonished. A thousand of the Yakshas fell under Prahasta’s blows in the conllict and that irreproachable Hero Mahodara slew a further thousand, whilst, in his fury, O Prince, Maticha, thirsting fight, slew two thousand of the enemy in the twinkling of an eye. “On their side, the Yakshas fought valiantly but the *Rakshasas* called upon their powers of magic aod thus gained ascendancy in the combat, O Lion among Men. While wtesding with DhUDU’IIksha in the great struggle, Manibhadra received a violent blow in the chest from a pike but remained unmoved, and be, in his turn, struck the Titan Dhumraksha on the head whereupon he fell senseless. " Seeing Dbumraksha wounded aod covered with blood, Dashanaoa hurled himself on Manihhadra in the

thick of the fray and, while be was ruslting on him in fury, the foremost of the Yakshas, Manibhadra, pierced him with three darts. Wounded, Dashagriva struck a blow at Manihhadra's diadem which fell to one side aod, from that day, be was known as ' Parsb vamauli '. "Manibhadra, having been put to lligbt despite his valour, a great clamour arose on the mountain, O King. From afar, the Lord of Wealth, who was armed with a mace and surrounded by Sbukra, Prausthapada, Padma aod Shakha, beheld **RAVANA**, and, seeing his brother in the field, having !oat all dignity, deprived of his glory on account of the curse, the sagacious Kuvera addressed him in words worthy of the House of his Grandsire, saying : " ' Aa despite my warning, thou dost not deaist, O Perverse Wretch, thou shalt recognize the consequences in the future, when thou hast fallen into hell. He who through heedlessness drinb poiaon and when he realises it, in his delusion, doea not .refrain, will know the results of his act in its efl'ects. The Gods do not necessarily approve even dharmic actinns, how much less those that bring about such a oondition as tbinc ; 1t because of tbis that thou art reduced to tbis state and thou dost not appesr to be aware of it. He who does not honour his mothct, father, a btabmin or a preceptor, will reap the fruit of bis fault when he falls under the sway of the Lotd of Death. That fool who does not mortifY his body will suffer hereafter, when after death he enters the region that his deeds have merited. No wicked man sees his designs ful1illed as he would have wished ; as he sows so shall he reap. In tbis world, prosperity, beauty, power, sons, wealth and prowess arc all attained by pious acts. Given over to such iniquitous deeds, thou wilt go to hell. I will not parley with thee further ; thus ahould one act in of evil-doers I ' "At these words ofDhausda, wbich were addressed to Ravena's oounscllors led by Maricha, they being struck, turned and fted. Dashagriva, however, who had received a blow on the head from the

mace of that powerful Lord of the Yabhas, did not move. Thereafter Yabha and Rabhasa entered into a fierce and pro longed duel, experiencing no fatigue, and Dhausda loosed the Fire-weapon on the Lord of the Titans, who parried it with the **VARUNA** weapon. Then Ravena, having recourse to magic, natural to a Rabhasa, transformed bimself in a thousand ways io order to slay his adversary, and that Teo-necked One assumed the form of a tiger, a boar, a cloud, a mountaio, an ocean, a tree, a Yabha and a Daitya. Thus, though wearing many forma, bis own remained hidden. Thereafter seizing hold of a mighty weapon, Dashagriva, wbirliog it round, brought that enormous mace down on the head of Dhanada and the blow knocked the Lord of Wealth senseless, who fell covered with blood, like unto indestrucuble veb.ic1e of the Gods, a perpetual joy to the eyes and heart, that masterpiece created by Viabvakarma at **BRAHMA**'s command, with its countless ornaments, was indeed a marvel. All that could be desired was to be found therein and it was of a magnificence nothing could surpass ; neithet too hot nor too cold, it was pleasantly temperate at all seasons. " Ascending that chariot, which he had acquired by his prowess, coursing wheresoever he would, the King **RAVANA**, in his pride and wickedness, deemed himself to have overcome the Three Worlds. Having conquered Vaishravana, he descended from Mount Kailasha and, having by his prowess obtained this great victory, that Ranger of the Night, dazzling in his diadem and necklace of ftawleas pearls, in his marvellous chariot, blazed like fire.

CHAPTER 16

The Origin of Ravana's Name

" **O** having vanquiabed his brothet, the supreme Lord of the *Rakshasas* went to the great fen where Mahasena was bom ; and Dashagriva beheld that vast and golden expanse of reeds sending forth shafts of light like unto a second sun. Ascending the mountain which rose in the of that fen, O **RAMA**, he observed that the Chariot Pushpaka was suddenly deprived of motion. " Thereupon that King of the Rakshaass, surrounded by his attendants, rdlected :-' How is this, the chariot has halted ? Why is it not still moving since it was created to follow its master's will ? Wherefore does the Pushpaka Car not go wheresoever I desire? Is this not the doing of some inhabitant of the mountain'? " Then, O **RAMA**, the intclligent Maricha said to him : " ' It is not without reason, O King, that the Chariot Pushpaka moves no longer. Without doubt it is only able to serve Dhanada and, since it is separated from that Lord ofWealth, it has become motion1eas I ' " As he spoke thus, a fearful yellow and black-hued dwarf appeared, who was cmemcly stout and posseased a shaven head 417 and short arms ; it was Nandi. Approacbing that Inclra 8IIIOill the *Rakshasas*, that senant of Bhava, Nandi, fearlessly addtessed him, sayiog : " ' Begone, O Dasbagriva, the Lord Shankara is disporting himself on this mountain ; it is forbidden to birds, serpents, Yakshas, *Devas*, Gandharvas and *Rakshasas* to come hither I ' " Hearing Nandi's words, **RAVANA**, with his earrings trembling in his wrath, his eyes ted with fury, leapt down from the Push palra Chariot and approaching the foot of the peak, demanded : " ' Who is this Shankara ? ' "Then he beheld Nandi standing at the side of that God, supporting himself on his gleaming trident, blazing in his own elfulgence, like unto a second Shankara. " Beholding that monkey-faced One, the *Rakshasa*, in his contempt laughed derisively, roaring like a thunder-cloud. Highly provoked, the blessed Nandi, Shankara in another form, said to Dashagriva, who stood near : " ' Since thou hast derided me in my

monkey form, O Dasba nana, by bunting into loud laughter resembling thunder, monkeys, like unto myself in fortn, endowed with prodigious strength, shaJJ be botn to destroy thee and thy race. Armed with nails and teeth, O Barbarian, they will descend like an avalanche of rocks, and swift as thought, thitsting to fight and, proud of their strength, shaJJ crush thy great pride and thy high prowess with that of thine adherents and thy sons. I am well able to slay thee now, O Ranger of the Night, but it is no longer necessary to put thee to death since thy previous acts have alresdy overtaken thee.' “Hearing these prophetic utterances of that magnanimous God, the celestial gongs resounded and a rain of 1lowers fell from the sky. Disregarding Nandi’s words, the extremely powerful Dasbanana drew nearer to the mountain and said : "' As it is on thine account that the course of Pushpalra, in which I was travelling, has been arrested, I shaJJ uproot the mountain, O Cowherd I What is the nature of the power which Cllables Bhava to sport here continually like a king ? He is not aware of what should be known to him and that the znoment for him to tremble has come.' UTTAR.A *KANDA* and shook it violently so that the rocky mass vibrated. In consequence of the mountain quaking, the attendants nf the God were troubled and Parvati herself, terrified, clung ro the neck nf Maheahwara. " Then, O Rams, Mahadeva, the foremost of the Gods, as if in spon, pressed the mountain with his great roe and, at the same time, he crushed R.avana’s arms, that resembled pillars of granire, ro the great consternation of all the counsellors nf that Rakahasa. And he, in pain and fury, suddenly let fonh a terrible cry, causing the Three Worlds ro tremble, so that his ministers thought it ro be the crash of thunder at the dissolution nf the worlds ! Thereupon the Gods, with **INDRA** at their head, stumbled on their way ; the oceans became agitated, the mountains shook, and the Yakahas, Vidyadharss and Siddhas cried out :-' What is this ? Do thou pacify

Mahadeva, the Blue-throated One, the Lord nf Uma; apart from Him, there is no refuge in the world, O Daahanana ! By hymns and prostra tion seek refuge with Him, propitiated and gratified, Shankara will look on thee with favour.' " Hearing the words ofhis ministers, Daahanana, bowing before Him, worshipped the God Whose standard beats the bull, by the recitation of hymns and innumersble sacred texts. Thus did that titan lament for a thousand years. " Thereafter the Lord Mahadeva, propitiated,relessed the arms nf Dsshanana from under the mountain and addressed him saying: "' I am gratified with thy courage and endurance, O Dasha nana I When thou wast imprisoned under the rock, thou didst emit a terrible cry, striking rerror in the Three Worlds. For this resson, O King, from now on thy name ahall be R.avana, and Celestials, Men, Yakahas and other Beings in the universe ahall call thee “R.avana "-“He who causes the worlds ro cry Danavas, *Rakshasas*, Guhyakas or Nagas nor by any other great Beings, I do not take man into account deeming him to be too insignificant. I have been granted a long life by **BRAHMA**, O Destroyer ofTripura, but I desire a further lease oflifc; do thou oonfcr this upon me, as also a weapon.' " Thus spoke Ravena, and Shankara bestowed an exceedingly bright sword upon him, famed as Chanclrahasa. Thereafter the Lord of Creatures accorded him a further lease of life and, handing him the weapon, **SHAMBHU** *said*: " ' Never treat this weapon with oontempt, if thou dost dis regard it, it will assuredly return to me I ' " Having received his name from that great God Maheshwara, **RAVANA** paid obeisance to him and re-ascended his aerial Car Pushpaka. Thereafter, O Rams, he began to range the entire world subduing the foremost of warriors, irresistible in oombat and those who were filled with oourage and boiling with ardour, who dreamt only of war and who perished with their troops by refusing to submit to him. But those, who knew **RAVANA** to be invincible, showed themselves

to be more wary and said to that titan, proud of his strength,' We have been vanquished I’

CHAPTER 17

The Story of Vedavati

"'Whose daughter art thou, O Fortuaate One? From whence springs thy way of life ? Who is thy consort, O Youthful Lady of lovely loots ? He with whom thou art uDited is fortunate indeed ! I beg of thee to tell me all ; why these morlilicadoJIB ? ' " Being thus questioned by **RAVANA**, that young girl, radiant with beauty and rich in ascetic practices, having offered him the tradidol181 hospitality, replied: " My Sire is named Kushadwaja, a Brahmarishi of immeasur able renown, the illustrious son of Brihaspati, whom he equals in wisdom. I, his daughter was bom of the speech of that mag nanimous One, whose constant pursuit is the study of the Veda; my name is Vedavati. At that time, the *Devas*, Gandharvas, Yabhas, Rabhasas and Pannagas approached my sire to ask for my hand but my father did not wish to give me in marriage to them, O King of the Rabhasas, for the reason which I shaU now unfold to thee ; listen attentively, O Lion among Heroes ! " My Sire had chosen **VISHNU**, Chief of the Gods, Lord of the Three Worlds Himself, to be my conson and on this account he would not permit me to wed any other. Hesring this the King of the Daityas, Shumbhu, proud of his strength, was highly provoked and, during the Dight, while my father slept, he was slain by that wicked one. My unfonunate mother, who till then, had been so happy, embracing my father’s body, entered the fire. '" Now I desire to fulfil his will regarding Narayana; it is He to whom I have given my heart. With this intention I am under going a rigid penance. I

have told thee all, O King of the *Rakshasas* ; Narayana is my lord ; I desire no other than the Supreme Purusha. For the aake of Narayana, I have undergone these severe mortifications. Thou art known to me, O King, go hence, thou the offspring of Poulastya. By the grace of mine austerities I know all that has taken place in the Three Worlds.' " Thereupon **RAVANA**, dismounting from his chariot, overcome by the darts of the God of Love, once more addreased that young girl of severe penances, saying : " O Lady of Lovely Hips, thou art presumptuous in har bouring such an ambition ; it is to the aged that the accumula tion of merit accrues, O Thou whose eyes resemble a fawn's. Thou art posseased of the beauty of the Three Worlds, O Timid Lady, but thy youth is passing away ; I am the Lord of Lanka aa and am called Dashagriva I Become my consort and enjoy every delight accotding to thy whim. Who is tbis whom thou callest **VISHNU** ? In valour, asceticism, magnificence and strength, the one thou lovest cannot compare with us, O Fottunate and Youtbful Lady I ' "Aa he spoke thus, Vedavati cried out For shame I For shoure ! ' and thereafter addressed that Ranger of the Night further, saying : " Who, had he any wisdom, would fail to pay homage to the Supreme Lord of the Three Worlds, **VISHNU**, Who is universally revered, save thou, O **INDRA** among the *Rakshasas* ? ' "At these words of Vedavati, that Ranger of the Night seized bold of the hair of that young girl, whereupon Vedavati, in indignation, cut off her hair with her hand which had been transfnrmed into a sword. Burning with anger, she, as if she would consume that night-ranger, kindled a brazier and, in her eagerness to yield up her life, said to him : " ' Soiled by thy contact, O Vile *Rakshasa*, I do not desire to live and shall throw myself into the fire before thine eyes. Since thou hast affronted me in the forest, O Wretch, I shall be reborn for thy destruction. It is nor possible for a woman to slay an evil man and, if I

curse thee, my penances will be ren dered void ; if, however, I have ever given anything in charity or offered any sacrifice, may I be of immaculate birth and the noble daughter of a virtuous man.' " So speaking, she threw herself into the fire that she had ignited, and straightway a rain of 1lowers fell. " Vedavati is the daughter of **JANAKA**, her supposed father, O Strung-armed Lord, and thy consort, for thou art the eternal **VISHNU**. That woman, who, in anger, formerly curaed the enemy who resembled a mountain, destroyed him by appealing to thy supernatural power. Thus that goddess was reborn among men, springing up like a flame on the altar, from a field which was turned by the blade of a plough. First she was born as Vedavati in the Golden Age and subsequently, in the Silver Age, she was re-born in the amily of the magnanimous **JANAKA** in the race of Mithils, for the destruction of that *Rakshasa*." CHAPTI!K 18 The Gods a tlwuscmd Forms in fear of Rtwana having entered the fire, **RAVANA** remounted his chariot and began to range the earth once more. Having reacbed Ushirabija, he beheld the King Marutta performing a sacrifice io company with the Gods. "A Brahmarishi named Samvarta, the brother of Brihaspati himself, conversant with the tradition, was assisting amidst the Celestial Host. Perceiving the *Rakshasa*, rendered iovioable oo account of the boons he had received, the Gods, fearing an outrage oo his pan, assumed the shape of animals. "Iodra became a peacoclt, Dharmaraja a crow, Kuvera a cbameleoo and Varona a swan. The other Deities having escaped io a like maooer, O Slayer of Thy Foes, **RAVANA** penetrated into the place of sacrifice like an unclcao dog. "Approaching the king, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the *Rakshasas* said to him : .. ' Fight or submit ! ' " Then the mooarcb replied, ' Who art thou ? ' to whicb Ravaoa, with a sneering laugh, answered : " ' I am cbartoed with thy simplicity, seeing thou doat not flee before me, Ravaoa, the younger

brother of Dhaoada. Io the Three Worlda can there be any other who is ignorant of my strength, I who vanquished my brother and carried off his aerial car ? " Then the King Marutta aosweted Ravaoa, saying : " ' Forsooth thou art highly fortunate that thou hast triumphed over thine elder brother io combat. None io the Three Worlda can equal thee io glory, yet unrighteous deeds can never be commcoded. Having committed this foul act, thou dost preen thyself on having vanquished thy brother I Whar coune of uceticism didst thou fullow furmerly that has esroed thee this boon ? I have never hesrd aught equal to that wbicb thou hast related to me. Halt where thou ataodest ; never shalt thou

CHAPTER 18

The Gods assume a thousand Forms in fear of Ravana

CHAPTI!K 18 The Gods a tlwuscmd Forms in fear of Rtwana having entered the fire, **RAVANA** remounted his chariot and began to range the earth once more. Having reacbed Ushirabija, he beheld the King Marutta performing a sacrifice io company with the Gods. “A Brahmarishi named Samvarta, the brother of Brihaspati himself, conversant with the tradition, was assisting amidst the Celestial Host. Perceiving the *Rakshasa*, rendered iovioable oo account of the boons he had received, the Gods, fearing an outrage oo his pan, assumed the shape of animals. “Iodra became a peacoclt, Dharmaraja a crow, Kuvera a cbameleoo and Varona a swan. The other Deities having escaped io a like maooer, O Slayer of Thy Foes, **RAVANA** penetrated into the place of sacrifice like an unclcao dog. “Approaching the king, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the *Rakshasas* said to him : .. ' Fight or submit ! ' " Then the mooarcb

replied, ' Who art thou ? ' to whicb Ravaoa, with a sneering laugh, answered : " ' I am cbartoed with thy simplicity, seeing thou doat not flee before me, Ravaoa, the younger brother of Dhaoada. Io the Three Worlda can there be any other who is ignorant of my strength, I who vanquished my brother and carried off his aerial car ? " Then the King Marutta aosweted Ravaoa, saying : " ' Forsooth thou art highly fortunate that thou hast triumphed over thine elder brother io combat. None io the Three Worlda can equal thee io glory, yet unrighteous deeds can never be commcoded. Having committed this foul act, thou dost preen thyself on having vanquished thy brother I Whar coune of uceticism didst thou fullow furmerly that has esroed thee this boon ? I have never hesrd aught equal to that wbicb thou hast related to me. Halt where thou ataodest ; never shalt thou 423 approach me alive ! This very hour, with my sharp arrows, I shall send thee to the abode of death ! ' " Speaking thus, the king, armed with his bow and arrows, in the height of anger, rushed out, but Samvarta barred the way ; then the gteat *Rishi* said to Marutta : " ' Hear the words inspired by my attachment for thee I Thou shouldst not enter into combat. If this sacrifice in honour of Mabeshwara remain uncompleted, thy race will be destrOyed. How can one, who has undertaken a sacrifice, fight ? How can he show anger? Further, it is doubtful that thou wilt triumph; the *Rakshasa* is di11i.cult to overcome.' " Hearing the words of his Guru, Marutts, that Lord of the Barth, throwing away his bow and arrows, grew calm and gave himself wholly to the ceremony. " Then Shuka, deeming he had accepted defeat, proclaimed with shouts of triumph, ' **RAVANA** is the victor I ' " Having devoured the gteat *Rishis*, who were present at the sacrifice, **RAVANA**, gorged with their blood, began to range the earth once more. When he had departed, the Celestials with **INDRA** at their head terurned and spoke to those creatures whose forms they had borrowed. " In his delight,

INDRA said to the peacoclr, whose tail was dark blue: " ' I am pleased with thee, O Virtuous Bird, thou shalt have nothing to fear from serpents ; thou shalt bear a thousand eyes on thy tail and shalt manifest thy joy when it rains, as a testimony of my satisfaction." " Such was the boon conferred on the peacock by that gteat lord. O Monarch, the tails of peacocks, which were dark blue formerly, have become blilliandy hued on account of this boon. " O **RAMA**, Dharmaraja then said to the crow, who had perched on the sacrificial post : " ' O Bird, I am gratified with thee, listen to mine auspicious words. Thou shalt not be visited by the -ious diseases to which all beinga are subject, for thou hast gratified me, be assured thereof I Through the grace of the boon I shall confer on thee, O Bird, thou shalt have no need to fear death and shalt Jive long, tiD thou art slain by man. Those inhabiting my empire, who are tormellted by hwtger, shall be satisfied, as also their kinsfolk when thou hast fed.' " **VARUNA**, in his turn, said to the swan, the King of Winged Creatures, who was disporting itself in the waters of the Ganges : " ' Thou shalt appear in a ravishing and graceful form, radiant as the lunar orb, supremely beautiful, white as pure foam. In contact with mine element, thou wilt rejoice continually. Thon shalt taste a happiness that is unparalleled, which will be the mark of mine approval ! ' " O **RAMA**, formerly swans were not wholly white, their wings were dark at the tips and their breasts were the colour of emerald. " In his turn, Kuvera addressed the chameleon who was resting on a rock and said : " ' I confer on thee a golden hue on account of the pleasure thou hast given me. Thy head will be of an unalterable golden colour as a mark of my favour.' " Such were the boons conferred on those creatures after the sacrifice of the Gods, who, when the ceremony had been com pleted, returned with their king to their abode."

CHAPTER 19

Ravana fights with Anaranya who dies prophesying the Rakshasa's End

" HAVING triumphed over Marurta, the Lord of the *Rakshasas*, Daabanana, ranged the royal cities thirsty for combat and, approaching the mighty monarchs who were the equals of Mahendra and **VARUNA**, that Lord of the Titans said to them, ' Fight or submit ! Thus have I resolved, there is no escape for you I' " Thereupon, though not faint-hearted, those sagacious monarchs, fized in their duty, took counsel together and, despite their great streogth, recognizing the superior power of their foe, O Dear Child, all those princes, Dushkanta, Suratha, Gadhi, Gaya and the King Pururava, said to him :-' We are defeated l ' "Then **RAVANA**, the Lord of the *Rakshasas* approached Ayodhya, which was as strongly fortified by Anaranya as Amara vati by Sbakra. Presenting himself before that lion among men, a king who was equal to Purandara in valour, **RAVANA** *said*: " ' Enter into combat with us or admit defeat, such is our mandate!' "The King of Ayodhya, Anaranya, hearing that wicked Monarch of the *Rakshasas* speak thus, answered indignantly : " ' O Lord of the Titans, I accept thy challenge, stay and make thy preparations spccdily as I too shsll make mine.' " Thereafter, though already overcome by that which he had heard related and despite his great prowess, the king with his army set out, in an attempt to slay **RAVANA**, with his elephants numbering ten thousand, his horses a million, his chariots in their thousands and his infantry, which, O Prince, covered the whole earth. And that force rushed out to fight with its infantry and cavalry and a terrific and cxtraordinsry struggle

ensued between the King Anaranya and the Lord of the *Rakshasas*. " In the grip of **RAVANA**'s forces, the army of that monarch, having fought for a long time and manifested supreme courage, was entirely destroyed a libation poured into a fire is wholly consumed. Coming in contact with those ranks projecting ftamcs, the remaining battalions were completely annihilated like moths that enter a brazier. " Beholding his vast army obliterated as hundreds of streams disappear in the sea in which they empty thctnsclves, the king, transponed with fury, stretching his bow, thatrescmbled Sbakra'1, advanced in the height of anger towards **RAVANA** whereupon his followers, Maricha, Shub and Sarana, ded like deer. Then that descendant of Ikshvaku loosed eight hundred arrowa on the head of the Sovereign of the *Rakshasas* but, as showers loosed from the clouds on the summit of a mountain, those shafts fcll upon him without indicting a single wound. " Meantime the Lord of the *Rakshasas*, provoked, atrwk the ace of Anaranya, unscsting that king from his chariot so that the monarch, trembling convulsivcly,fcll to the canh helpless, as a Sa1a Tree struck down in the forest by a lightning Stroke. Then the Rakshua mockingly enquired of that dcsccndant of the Ibhvaku Race, ying :-" What hast thou gained by entering into combat with me ? In the Three Worlds, none can stand against me, O Chief of Men I I deem that thou art immersed in pleasure and hast not even heard of my prowess I ' " Thus spoke **RAVANA** and the king, scarcely breathing. answered: " What can I do now ? Assuredly fate is inexorable ! It is not thou who hast conquered me, O *Rakshasa*, despite thy bosst ings, it is Time that has overwhelmed me ; he is the trUe author of death ! What can I do, now that I have come to the end of my days ? Nay, O *Rakshasa*, I did not turn back in this fight with thee in which I am about to succumb but, on account of thy disregard for one of the magnanimous Ikshvakus, I tell thee this, O *Rakshasa*:—if I have ever given anything in

charity, if I have ever undertaken a sacrifice, if I have ever practiced a rigid penance, if I have protected my subjects, may my worda prove true-in the House oftbe magnanimous Ikshvakus will be born a warrior named **RAMA**, tbe son of **DASARATHA**, who will extinguish thy vital breaths I ' “As tbis curse was being pronounced, the sound of celestial gongs could be heard and, from the cloud-covered sky, a rain of ftowers fell. Thereafter the king, that **INDRA** among Monarchs, ascended to the region of Trivishtapa, and that sovereign having entered heaven, the *Rakshasa* went away.”

CHAPTER 20

Ravana's Meeting with the Sage Narada

“As the King of the *Rakshasas* was ranging the earth, sowing terror amongst its inhabitants, he beheld Narada, that foremost of Manis, riding on a cloud and, having paid obeisance to him and enquired as to bis welfare, Dashagriva questioned him concerning his presence there. Then Narada, the supremely illustrious and celestial *Rishi* of immeasurable elfulgence, stationed on the peak of a cloud, replied to **RAVANA** who stood in the aerial Car Pushpaka, saying : 427 " O King of the *Rakshasas*, O My Friend, stay a moment I O Son of Visbravas, Olfspring of a noble Race, I am gratified by thy valiant aploits. **VISHNU**, overcoming the Daityas, pleased me and thou also hast filled me with delight by harassing the Gand hatvas and Uragas and exterminating them. I will tell thee something that should be known to thee if thou art willing to hear it ! Pay attention to my words, My Dear Son l " Why destroy the world, O Dear Cbild, thou whom the Gods cannot slay ? This world passes away and is under the power of Mrityu ; it is not wotthy of

thee to harass the world of mortals, thou who may not be destroyed by Suras, Danavas, Dairyas, Yakshas, Gandharvas and *Rakshasas*. Who would slay creatures who are ever bewildered in respect to their welfare and a prey to great calamities ? Who would strike a world such as this which is overcome by age and disease ? What wise man would enjoy making war on this world of men amidst a perennial stream of every kind of afBiction that visits it on all sides ? How can one torment this world which is perishable, smitten by divine forces, hunger, thirst and old age and assailed by misfortune and disappointment ? " Sometimes, full of joy, men give themselves up to music and dancing, whilst others are crying out in distress, their faces streaming with rears that fall from their eyes. Through attach ment to mother, filther, children or in affection for their consorts, they rush into ills they know not, then why torment a world already brought low by nescience ? Assuredly thou hast heretofore subdued the world of men, O Dear One ! Thou shouldst undoubtedly descend to **YAMA**'s abode; it is **YAMA** Serpent Race and the Gods under my yoke, I shall churn up the ocean containing the Nectar of Immortality.' " Thereafter, the blessed Risbi Narada asked Dashagriva : " ' Why therefore dost thou remain here engaged in another path ? Assuredly the way that leads to the City of **YAMA**, the King of the Dead, is extremely hard, O Invincible Hero, O Scourge of thy Foes.' " Thereat, bursting into laughter, like unto the crash of thunder ill autumn, DashauaDa cried out: " ' Verily it is accomplished ! ' Then he added, ' Resolved to slay Vaivasvata, O Great *Brahmin*, I shall go to the southern region, where that king, born of **SURYA**, dwells. Truly, O Most mcsacd One, in mine anger and martial ardour, I swear I shall overcome the four Guardiaus of the World! Here am I, ready to march agaillst the city of the King of the Pitris. I shall compass the cud of Mrityu, he who plunges all beings into mourning.' " Having spokeD thus the *Muni* and taken

leave of bim, Dashagriva went away and entered the southern region accom panied by bis ministerS. " Narada however, filled with brahmanic ardour stood awbilc plunged in thought and, as he pondered, that IDdra among ascetics resembled a smokeless fire. " He re11ected :- How can death be overcome, he who afllicts the Three Worlds with their rulers and all animate and inanimate beings, visiting them with just retributinD at the terminatinn of their lives ? He, the wimcss of their olferinga and sacrifices, like unto a second Pavaka ; he, whose power energises the worlds when beinga attaining consciousness put furth their activity, and in fear of whom the Three Worlds are diaturbed. He befure whom the Three Worlds flee in terror, how dare that foremost of *Rakshasas* stand befurc bim ? He who is VJ.dhatar and Dhatar, the distributor of rewards and punishments in acxordsnce with men's deeds; he the con queror of the Three Worlds, how can **RAVANA** overcome bim? And if he doca subdue bim, what other order will he establish ? Curiosity urges me to dcaceud into **YAMA**'s abode in order to witucas the duel between **YAMA** and that Rabhasa in pcrsoo. "

CHAPTER 21

Ravana goes to the Nether Regions to challenge Yama

had taken place and there he found the God **YAMA** before a fire, desling out justice to every being according to his deserts. " Then **YAMA**, becoming aware of the presence of that great *Rishi* Narada, offering him a comfortable seat and the Arghya, according to tradition, said to him : " ' O Devarishi, is all well or is righteousness in jeopardy ? Wherefore hast thou come hither, thou who art revered by the Gods and

Gandharvas ? ' " Thereupon Narada, that blessed *Rishi*, answered him aaying: " ' Hear what I have to tell thee and do what thou considerest fitting ! That ranger of the night, named Dashagriva, is coming here to overthrow thee by the force of his will, though thou art invincible. It is on this account that I have come hither in all haste, fearing what would befall thee, O Lord Who bearest the Rod." “At that instant, they beheld the Rakshaaa’s chariot, bright as the sun, approaching in the distance ; and the mighty Dasha griva advancing in the dazzling Pushpaka Car dispelled the darkness of the region of death. " On all sides that long-armed hero beheld those who were eating the fruit of their good and evil acta and he observed the soldiers of **YAMA** and his attendants, ferocious beings of formid able and hideous aspect. He aaw those undergoing torment emitting loud cries, giving themselves up to bitter lamentations, devoured by worms and fierce dogs, uttering ahricb that rent the ears, filling all with terror ; and those who were croaaing the Vaitarani River, which flowed with blood, sinking at each step into the burning SDda which scorched them ; and ma1ectors being cut to pieces in the Asipatra Wood’ or pltmgcd in the Raurava region’ or the Ksharanadi’ or slashed with Kshurad haras’, crying out for water, tortured by huogcr and thint. emaciated, aftlictcd, pale, their hair in disarray, besmeared with mud and filth, saickcn and demented, running hither and thither. And **RAVANA** beheld them in hundreds and thousands on the way, and he saw others in palaces, where aonga and musical instruments could be heard, disporting themselves as the result of their good deeds. And milk was supplied to those who had given kine in charity and rice to those who had distribu ted rice, and dwcllings to those who had bestowed dwcllings on others ; each reaping the fruit of his own deeds. Others among the virtuous were surrounded by youthful women adorned with gold, precious gems and magnificent pearls,

resplendent in their own radiance ; all these appeared to the long-armed **RAVANA**, Lord of the *Rakshasas*. " Then those who were in torment as a punishment for their evil deeds, were audaciously liberated by the *Rakshasa* who was powerful and valiant. and those phantoms, suddenly receiving that unexpected clemency, set free by that mighty monarch, rushed upon him, and a great clamour arose, whereupon the soldiers belonging to Dharrnaraja, who were full of courage, ran to that spot. “Armed with arrows, iron bars, spears, maces, lances and picks in their hundreds and thousands, they attscked the Pushpaka Car bravely. Seats, upper galleries, lloors and arches were rapidly demolished by those warriors who fell upon it like a swarm of bees ; but the celestial aerial car, though broken, was indestructible and resumed its former shape through **BRAHMA**’s power. That great army of the magnanimous **YAMA** was not to be counted and the advance guard alone numbered a hundred thousand warriors. " Trees, rocks, missiles in their hundreds were thrown in profUsion with all their strength by those valiant followers of Dashanana and by the king bimaclf. Although their limbs were covered with blood and lacerated by every kind of missile, the ministers of the furemoat of the titans fought like giants and the foremost of warriors, the intrepid soldiers ofYama and **RAVANA**’s fullowers struck esch other with redoubled blows, O Prince. Thereafter, lesving their adversaries, **YAMA**’s furces rushed on Dashanana with their spears, and the King of the Rskshasas, his body streaming with blood, shone like an Ashoka Tree in llower. " Meantime, spean, maces, javelins, lances, darts, arrows, rocks and trees poured from the mighty bow of that courageous warrior. A formidable shower of trees, stones and wespons of all sorts fell on the furces of **YAMA** and theresfter on the esrth. " Having severed all those missiles and rcpclled that hail of projectiles, the soldiers of **YAMA** struck that redoubtable titan, who fuught single-handed against hundreds and

thousauds and they all surrounded him like a mass of clouds round a mountain and, with their Bhindipalas and their spears, they assailed him with such furce that he could scarcely bresthe. His coat of mail severed, cut to pieces midst rivers of blood llowing from his

CHAPTER 22

The Duel between Ravana and Yama: Brahma intervenes

"HBAaniG that great tumult, the Lord Vaivasvata realised bis enemy had triumphed and that bis army was destroyed. Knowing his forces were slain, bis eyes red with anger, he addtessed bis charioteer, saying: " ' Take my chariot there speedily I ' " Thereupon the driver brought the vaat celestial car of his most powerful master and that exceedingly energetic one ascen ded it. And MrityU, the destroyer of the Triple World of perpetual cbange, with a lance and mallet in bis band and Time as bis Rod, stood at **YAMA**'s side; and that divine weapon blazed like fire. "Beholding Kalahigbly enraged, inapiring terror in the wbole univerae, the Three Worlds were agitated and the inhabitants of beaven were seized with fear. Thereafter the charioteer urged on bis steeds that were the colour of blood, and drove bis thnndering cbanot to meet the Lord of the Raksbasas; and, in an inatant, bis horaes, the equals of tbose belonging to Hari, carried **YAMA** with the speed of thought to the scene of the combat. " Seeing that terrible chariot that MrityU accompanied, the followera of the foremost of the Raksbasas took to their heels, saying: " ' It is impossible for us to contend with him I ' In their cowardice, beside themselves with terror, they fled away, Daahagriva, however, in the presence of that chariot that spread terror in the

Univerae, remained unmoved and experieneed no fear. " Coming within range ofbis adveraary, **YAMA**, in fury, looaed arrows and darts piercing **RAVANA**'s vital parts bnt he, maater of himself, let fty a hall of shafts on **YAMA**'s chariot, u a cloud lets II its watera, and though the Raksbasa was unable to repel those great sbafts that fell in hundreds on his mighty breast, yet he experienced no ill effect ; nevertheless, after a fight lasting seven days, and all those missiles of various kinds that **YAMA**, the Scourge of his Foes, loosed upon him, **RAVANA**, averting his face, became distraught and a terrible struggle ensued between **YAMA** and the *Rakshasa*, each eager to uiumph and neither turning back in the fight. "At that time, *Devas*, Gandharvas, Siddhas and great *Rishis* with Prajapati at theit head, assembled on the field of battle, for the duel taking place between the Lord of the *Rakshasas* and the King of the Dead appeared like the dissolution of the worlds. "**RAVANA**, stretching his bow, like unto **INDRA**'s thunderbolt, 611ed the whole of space with his shafts and he struck Mrityu with four barbed arrows and his driver with seven, thereafter with his swift arrows piercing **YAMA** in his vital parts a hundred thousand times. " Then, from the mouth of the enraged **YAMA**, a circle of flame issued, accompanied by wind and smoke, verily a fire of wrath. Beholding that marvel in the presence of Gods and Danavas, both Mrityu and Kala were transported with rage and Mrityu, in a paroxysm of anger, said to Vaivasvata :- Suffer me to destrOy this wicked *Rakshasa* ! This very day, in accord with the natural Jaw, this *Rakshasa* shall cease to be ! Hiranya kashipu, the fortunate Namuchi, Sbambara, Nisbandi, Dhuma ketu, Bali, Virochans, the Giant Shambhu, mighty monarchs, Vritra and Bana, the Rajarishis veraed in the Shastras, Punnagas, Daityas, Y abbas and troops of Apsaras, with the earth and its mountains, rivers and trees and the great ocean, have all been destroyed by me at the end of the World cycle, O Great King. Those beings and

others in great numbers, who were powerfUl and invincible, have been annihUated by my glance, how much more easll) can I hting about the death of this ranger of the night? Let me go therefore, O Virtuous Lord, that I may destroy him I No creature, however powerful he may be, can survive if my glance falls upon him. This power is not mine own ; it is a natural Jaw that on whosoever I cast my glance, O Kala, he does not live even for an instant.' " Thus spoke Mrityu and the iUusuioua Lord of **JUATICE** *answered*: 434 " Calm thyself, I sbaiJ slay him!' Then the Lord Vaivas vata, his eyes red with anger, lifted up the Rod of Death that never misses its target, that Rod to the sides of which the snares of destruction are attached, and he seized hold of a hammer like unto a !lash of lightning, which, by its aspect alone, extinguishes the breath of living beings, how much more when it falls on them ! That weapon surrounded by !lames, that buge mace, that -.ned to consume the *Rakshasa*, emitted sparks when that mighty being took hold of it. Then, as the God prepared to smite **RAVANA**, the Grandsire of tbe World appeared suddenly and said: .. O Great-armed Vaivasvata, O Thou, whose courage is immeasurable, know that thou must not strike the ranger of the nigbt with thy Rod. I have bestowed a boon on him, O King of the Gods, thou must not render it void for I bave pledged my word I Verily he who makes me appear as a deceiver, whether he be God or a mere mortal, renders the Triple World guilty of deceit I That terrible weapon, if loosed in anger, will strike down all beings, irrespective if they are dear to me or no. Inevitable destruction and deatb to all follows on that Rod of Death of immeasurable splendour created by me ! Undoubtedly, O My Friend, thou shouldst not let it fall on **RAVANA**'s head, for once it falls, none will survive even for an instant. Should it fall on the Raksbasa Dasbagriva, whether he die or does not die, either way, deceit will have been practised ! Therefore turn aside

that uplifted Rod from the King of Lanka and confirm my good faith in deference to the worlds l ' “Thus addressed, the virtuous Lord of Death, Y ama answered: " I sbaiJ restrain the Rod as thou art our Master, but, as I may not slay mine adversary who is protected by thy boon, what sbaiJ I do now in the fight? I sbaiJ render myself invisible to the Rakshasal’ " So speaking, he vanished with his chariot and hones. " Thereafter, Dashagriva, master of the field, proclaimed his name and, re-mounting Pushpaks, emerged from **YAMA**’s abode. Vaivasvata, however, with the Gods, preceded by **BRAHMA**, joyfully returned to the Celestial Region, as did the great *Muni* Narada also.” 43S CHAPTER Z3 RIJfNl1lll.'s Struggk 'lllith the Sons of Varrma " HAVING overcome **YAMA** the foremost of the Gods, the Ten necked **RAVANA**, proud warrior, went to seek out his followers. Beholdiug him with his limbs covered with blood, riddled with wounds, they were amazed. With Maricha at their head, they offered felicitations to him on his victory and re-assured by him, they all took their places in the Pushpaka Chariot. Thereafter the *Rakshasa* descended into the watery region’ inhabited by Daityas and Uragas under the powerful protection of **VARUNA**. From there he went to the Capital Bhogavati, where Vasuki reigns, and, having subjugated the Nagas, he joyfully entered the city made of precious stones. There the Nivatakavachas’, Daityas protected by Brahms dwelt, and the *Rakshasa*, approach ing them, challenged them to fight. Instantly those intrepid Daityas, full of valour, armed with every weapon in their martial ardour, rushed out joyfully. " Then the *Rakshasas* and Danavas struck each other furiously with spears, tridents, Kalishas, harpoons, swords and Parash vadhas and, while they fought thus, a whole year passed away without either side being victorious or snlfering defeat. “At the end of that time, the Grandsire, Lord of the Three Worlds, the imperishable God, appeared in his marvellous chariot and, in order to

briog the bellicose activities of the Nivatakavachas to a close, that Ancient One made known to them the purpose of his intervention, saying : " ' **RAVANA** csnnot be overcome in hattie by the Gods or Asuru and you yourselves csnnot be destrOyed even by the Immortals and Danavas together. It would find favour with me, if the *Rakshasas* were joined with you in friendship ; undoubtedly all benefits are shared by friends.'

CHAPTER 23

Ravana's Struggle with the Sons of Varona

CHAPTER Z3 RIJfNl1lll.'s Struggk 'lllith the Sons of Varrma " HAVING overcome **YAMA** the foremost of the Gods, the Ten necked **RAVANA**, proud warrior, went to seek out his followers. Beholdiug him with his limbs covered with blood, riddled with wounds, they were amazed. With Maricha at their head, they offered felicitations to him on his victory and re-assured by him, they all took their places in the Pushpaka Chariot. Thereafter the *Rakshasa* descended into the watery region' inhabited by Daityas and Uragas under the powerful protection of **VARUNA**. From there he went to the Capital Bhogavati, where Vasuki reigns, and, having subjugated the Nagas, he joyfully entered the city made of precious stones. There the Nivatakavachas', Daityas protected by Brahms dwelt, and the *Rakshasa*, approach ing them, challenged them to fight. Instantly those intrepid Daityas, full of valour, armed with every weapon in their martial ardour, rushed out joyfully. " Then the *Rakshasas* and Danavas struck each other furiously with spears, tridents, Kalishas, harpoons, swords and Parash vadhas and, while they fought thus, a whole year passed away without either side being victorious or

snlfering defeat. “At the end of that time, the Grandsire, Lord of the Three Worlds, the imperishable God, appeared in his marvellous chariot and, in order to briog the bellicose activities of the Nivatakavachas to a close, that Ancient One made known to them the purpose of his intervention, saying : " ' **RAVANA** csnnot be overcome in hattie by the Gods or Asuru and you yourselves csnnot be destrOyed even by the Immortals and Danavas together. It would find favour with me, if the *Rakshasas* were joined with you in friendship ; undoubtedly all benefits are shared by friends.' " Thereupon, in the presence of fire, **RAVANA** concluded an alliance with the Nivatakavachas and became their friend. " Honoured by them according to tradition, he sojourned in that place for a year, where he passed his time exactly as in his own city. There, having studied a hundred forms of magic he became proficient in one, then he set out to explore Rasatala in order to discover the capital of the Lord of the Waters, Varona. Reaching the Oty of Ashma, he slew all the in habitants and, with his sword, pierced his powerful brother-in law, Vidyujjihva, the consort of Shurpanakha, who was proud of his strength and who, with his tongue, was licking a *Rakshasa*, preparatory to devouring him. Having slain him, **RAVANA** thereafter, in an instant, destroyed four hundred Daityas. It was then that the celestial abode of Varona, resembling a cloud, dazzling as Mount Kailasha, appeared to that monarch, and he beheld there the Cow, Surabha, from whom milk ever ftows which forms the Ocean Kshiroda. " **RAVANA** asw Vararani, Mother of cows and bulls alao, from whom is born Chandra of cooling rays, who ushers in the night, tsking refuge under whom, the great *Rishis* subsist on the froth of that milk from which the Nectar of Immortality, the food of the Gods sprang, as also Svadha, the food of the Piais. Having circumambulated that wonderful Cow, known to men as Surabha, **RAVANA** penetrated into a formidable region defended by

troops of every kind. It was then he beheld the splendid residence of Varona, abounding in hundreds of cataracts, ever wearing a delighttbl aspect and resembling an autumn cloud. " Having struck down the leaders of the army in battle, whom he riddled with blows, **RAVANA** asid to those warriors :-' Speedily inform the King that **RAVANA** has come hither seeking battle, asying “Accept this challenge if thou art not afraid, otherwise, paying obeisance to him declare, I am defeated I ' " ' " Meantime, the sons and grandsona of the 1118jp18Dimoua " Thereafter a terrible struggle ensued, causing the hair to stand on end, between the children of the Lord of the Waten and the crafty **RAVANA**. The brave companions of the *Rakshasa* Dashagriva, in an instant, destroyed **VARUNA**’s entire army. " Seeing their army sttuck down in the fight, the sons of **VARUNA**, overwhelmed by a hail of missiles, broke oft” the conllict and, as they were escaping underground, they beheld **RAVANA** in the Pushpaka Chariot and hurled themselves into the sky in their Beet cars. Having attained an equally advantageOus position, a desperate fight broke out afresh and a terrible conflict arose in the air like unto that between the Gods and the Danavas. With their shafts, like unto Pavaka’s, they put **RAVANA** to fiight and, in their joy, emitted coundess shouts of triumph. " Then Mahodara, provoked, on seeing **RAVANA** thus sore pressed, banished all fear of death and, in his martial ardour, casting infuriated glances round about, with his mace sttuck the chariots that were coursing at will with the speed of the wind, causing them to filii on the earth. Having slain the soldiers and destroyed the chariots of **VARUNA**’s sons, Mahodara, seeing them deprived of their cars, emitted a loud shout. The chariots with their steeds and their excellent drivers, destroyed by Mahodara, lay on the earth and, though bereft of their vehicles, the sons of the magnanimous **VARUNA**, by virtue of their natural prowess, remained courageously in the sky without being

perturbed. Stretching their bows, they pierced Mahodara and, gathering together, they surrounded **RAVANA** on the battle field and, with their formidable shafts, like unto thunderbolts loosed from their bows, they overwhelmed him in their rage, as clouds rain down on a great mountain. " On his side, the irascible Dashagriva, like unto the fire of dissolution, showered down a fearful hail of missiles on their vital parts with irresistible and uninterrupted force, and there .. ere maces of every kind, Bhallas in their hundreds, harpoons, lances and huge Shataghnis. Then **VARUNA**'s sons, reduced to walking on foot, saw themselves resaicted like unto sixty-year old elephants who have entered a great morass and, beholding the sons of **VARUNA** thus saicken and exhausted, the supremely powerful **RAVANA** emitted shouts of joy like unto an immense cloud, and letting forth those loud roars, he sttuck **VARUNA**'s 438 oftipring with shafts of every kind which he showend down upon them like a cloud. " Thereupon they turned back and fell headlong to the ground and their followers carried them hastily from the battlefield to their homes, whilst the *Rakshasa* cried out ' Carry the tidings to **VARUNA**!' "Thereafter one of **VARUNA**'s counsellors, named Ptahasta, answered him saying : " ' **VARUNA**, the Lotd of the Waters, that mighty monarch, whom thou art challenging to combat, has gone to Brahmaloka to hear the Gandharva music. Why exhaust thyself in vain, O Hero, since the King is not here ? ' " Then the Lotd of the *Rakshasas*, having heard this, pro claimed his name and emitted joyful cries; thereafter, issuing out of **VARUNA**'s abode and returning from whence he had come, **RAVANA** ascended into the sky and directed his course to Lanka." RilrHma' Meeting 'IIIith Bali " THIIREAPTl!R **RAVANA**'s war-intoxicated followers ranged the City of Ashma and Dashanana beheld there a great pslace, the archways Of which were set with emeralds and adorned with a network of pearls. Abounding in golden

pillars and sacred altars, the stxirways, made of gold, were studded with diamonds and hung with small bells and delightful scats placed here and there, so that it resembled the palace of Mahendra. " Beholding that beautiful dwelling, the supremely powerful **RAVANA** reflected within himself:-' Whose is this marvellous mansion like unto the peak of Mount Meru ? Go, O Ptahasta and ascertain speedily to whom this residence belongs! ' " Thereupon Ptahasta entered that czcellent abode and, finding no one in the first apartment, he went to another, 439 penetrating into seven rooms till at last he observed a fire burning, in the llames of which he beheld a man seated, laughing aloud; and, hearing that dreadful laughter, Prahaata's hair stood on end. The man thus seated as if unconscious in the fire, blinding to look upon as the sun and like unto **YAMA** himself, was wearing a golden chain. Beholding this, that night ranger speedily left the house and communicated all to **RAVANA**. " O **RAMA**, Dashagriva, resembling a piece of collyrium, alighting from Pushpaka, sought to enter that dwelling but a huge-bodied person, moon-crested, barred the door. His tongue resembled a flame, his eyes were ted, his teeth dazzling, his lips like the Bimba Fruit, his nose dreadful and he was handsome of form with a neck curved like a conch, marked with three lines, his jaws enormous, his beard thick, his bones well covered with ftesh, possessing large fangs, his whole aspect terrible, causing the hair to stand on end ; and he held a mace in his hand as he stood at the door; then as **RAVANA** beheld him, his hair rose on end, his heart beat furiously and his body trembled. " Perceiving these inauspicious omens, **RAVANA** began to ponder within himself and while he was reftecting thus, that Being addressed him, saying : " Of what art thou thinking, O *Rakshasa*? Tell me without fear I I shall confer the pleasure of combat on thee, O Hero, O Night-ranger ! ' " Thereafter be spoke again to **RAVANA**, saying : " Dost thou desire to enter into conflict

with Bali or hast thou some other intention ? ' " Hearing these words, **RAVANA** was overwhelmed with fear so that his hair stood on end but, recollecting himself, he answered: " ' O Thou, the foremost of those skilled in speech, who resideth in this mansion? I would enter into combat with him if thou counsellest me to do so I ' " Then that Being answered him, saying : " The Lord of the Dansvas Jives here ; he is supremely magnanimous, valiant, possessing truth for his prowess, endowed with many qualities, resplendent, like unto **YAMA** bearing a noose in his hand, bright as the rising sun, incapable of beiDa 440 defeated in oombat, impetuous, invincible, victorious, a veritable ocean ofacoomplishments, soft-spoken, the support of those who depend on llim, devoted to his preceptor and the *brahmin*, conversant with the proper time (*for executing actions*), gifted with great powers, truthful, handsome, skilful, heroic, ever engaged in the study of the Veda; though walking on foot, he moves like the wind, he shines like fire, radiating heat like the sun, he stands in awe of neither Gods, spirits, makes nor birds, fear is unknown to him. Dost thou wish to fight with Bali, O Lord of the R.skshasas, O Thou gifted with supreme energy ? Then enter this abode speedily and engage in the enoounter ! ' “Being thus addressed, the Ten-necked Titan went in to where Bali was, and that foremost of the Dana vas, who resembled a flame of fire and was as hard to gaze upon as tbe sun, beholding the Lord of Lanka, burst into laughter and, taking tbe R.skshasa by tbe hand placed him on his lap, saying : "' O Ten-necked Lord of the *Rakshasas*, O Long-armed One, what desire of thine shall I gratifY ? Say what has brought thee hither?' " Being thus addressed by Bali, **RAVANA** *answered*: " ' O Dlustrious One, I have heard that formerly thou wert imprisoned by **VISHNU**, verily I have the power to release thee from these bonds ! ' " Hearing these words of **RAVANA**, Bali laughed and said : " ' Hear and I will tell thee, O

RAVANA ! The Dark-hued One Who stands at the door, formerly subdued all the Danavas and other powerful Lords and I also was imprisoned by Him. He is as invinable as Death ; none in the world can delude Him. He, Who stands at the entrance, is the Destroyer, Creator and Preserver, Lord of the Three Worlds. Neither thou nor I know Him ; He is the Lord of the past, present and future, He is Time, He is the KaU *Yuga*, He overthrows all beings ; He is the Creator and Destroyer of the Tbree Worlds and of all animate and inanimate things ; that great God of all Gods creates and re-creates the universe again and agsin for ever. O Night· ranger, He is the Dispenser of the fruits of sacrifices, gifts and oblations, verily He is the Creator and Preserver of the entire Universe, there is none in the Three Worlds oomparable with Him in majesty and glory. O Scion of the Houae of Poulaatya. 441 He has the Danavas, our forbears, and thee, under His control, like beasts bound with ropes. " ' Vritra, Danu, Shuka, Sbambu, Nishumbha, Shumhha, Kalanemi, PrahJada and others, Kuta, Virochslla, Mridu, Yamala, Arjuna, Kansa, Ksitabha and Madhu all radiated hest like the sun and were as resplendent as its rays, all moved like the wind and showered down rain like unto **INDRA**, all celebrated sacrifices and underwent severe penances, aU were exalted of soul and fOllowers of the Path of *Yoga*, all acquired wealth and enjoyed many pleasures, all distributed gifts abundantly, studied the Veda and protected their subjects, all were defenders of their kinsfOlk and slayers of their roes , none could stand against them in the Three Worlds and they were powertW, thoroughly conversant with the Shastras and all branches of learning and were never known to retreat in hattie. " ' They ruled the kingdoms of the Gods, having overcome them a thousand times, and they were ever engaged in harassing them and protecting their own fOllowers. lntlated with pride and arrogance, given to attachment, they were as e1fulgent as the newly

risen sun, hut the glorious Hari, the Lord **VISHNU** knows how to bring about the desrruction of those who per peruaUy trouble the Gods. He creates them all and Himself constantly brings about their end ; existing by Himself at the time of dissolution. " ' These highly powerful and illustrious Danava Chiefs, able to assume any fOrm at will, were destroyed by thst glorious God, and further, aU those heroes, said to be invincible and irresistible in warfare, have been discomfited by the wondrous power of but, taking hold of it, he could not move it by any means and, being ashsmed, that highly powerful one again attempted it and barely taising it, that Rskshasa immediately fell to the earth unconscious, bathed in a pool of blood, like unto a Sals Tree that has been felled. “Meantime the counsellors of the Lord of the Rskshasas, who were in the Pushpaka Chariot, cried out loudly 'Alas I Alas I’ and thereafter, the *Rakshasa*, regaining his senses, rose up, his head bowed in shame and Bali said to him : " ' Draw near, O Foremost of the *Rakshasas*, and listen to my words, O Hero I This disc encrusted with gems, which thou didst seek to lift, was an ornament for the ear belonging to one of my forbears and has remained here where it fell, look upon it I O Thou, endowed with great strength, the other fell on the summit of a mountain and, besides these two, his crown also fell on the earth before an altar during the encounter. Formerly neither time, death nor disease could overcome mine ancestor Hiranyakashipu, nor could he be visited by death during the day, at dawn or dusk. O Foremost of the Rskshasas, neither a dry nor a wet object nor any weapon could encompass his end. "'It came about that he entered into a dreadful quarrel with Prahladaand antagonism having grown up between him and the defenceless and courageous Prahlada, the Lord appeared in the form of Nrsingha, he of dreadful aspect who was the cause of terror to all beings. O Foremost of the *Rakshasas*, that awful Being, casting glances

here and there, overwhelmed the Three Worlds and, taking up Hiranyakashipu in his arms, he tore his body open with his nails ; that same Being, the supreme and taintless Vasudeva stands at the door! I shall now tell thee of that supreme God, do thou hear me, if my words have any significance for thee. He who stands at the door has subdued thousands of Jndrss and hundreds and thousands of great Gods and *Rishis*.' " Hearing these words, **RAVANA** *said*: " ' I have beheld Kritanta, the Lord of Spirits and Death Himself I His hair is formed of serpents and scorpions, he bears a noose in his hand, his tongue is like unto a !lame of fire darting like lightning. his jaws dreadful, his eyes red; he is endowed with immense speed and is the terror of all beings, like unto the sun incapable of being looked upon. Unconquerable in combat, the chastiser of evil-doers, yet even he was overcome in conftict, nor did I experience the least fear ofhlm, O Lord of the Danavas. I do not know this person (*at the door*), it behoveth thee to tell me who he is.' " Hearing these words of **RAVANA**, Bali, the Son of Virochana, answered: " ' He is the Lord Hari, Narayana, the Protector of the Three Worlds. He is Ananta, Kapila, **VISHNU** and the highly effulgent Nrsingha ; He is K.ratudhama and Sudhama who bears the dreadful mace in his bands. He resembles the Twelve Adityas, He is the first Man, the primeval and excellent Purusha ; He is like unto a dark blue cloud and is the first Lord of the Gods. O Long-armed One, He is encircled by !lame ; He is the supreme Yogi, beloved of His devotees ; He projected the universe, preserves it and destroys it, assuming the form of Time endowed with great power. This Hari, bearing the discus in His hand, is the sacrifice and is worshipped in the sacrifice, He is the one great form of all the Gods, all beings, all worlds and all knowledge ; He is Baladeva, O Mighty-armed One, the Slayer of Warriors ; He has the eye of a hero and is the eternal Guru, the Father of the Three Worlds. All Sages, desirous

of liberation, meditate on Him. He who knows Him thus, is freed ftom sin ; he, who remembers, adores and worships Him, attains all.' " Hearing these words of Bali, the highly powerful **RAVANA**, his eyes red with anger, went out with uplifted wespons. “Beholding hlm thus inllamed with fury, the Lord Hari, Who bore a club in His hand, reflected, ' In deference to **BRAHMA**, I ISt “Al’Tmt reflecting awhile, the Lord of Lanka went to the Solar Region, passing the night on the enchanting summit of Mount Sumeru. Riding in the Pushpaka Chariot, which was endowed with the speed of the sun’s steeds, he, by various ways advanced, and beheld the glorious and resplendent Sun, the purifier of all, adorned with golden bracelets and crowned with a halo encrusted with gems. His lovely counteoance was graced with a pair of brilliant earrings, his person embellished with Keyuras, goldeo ornaments and garlands of crimson lotuses. His body was annointed with red sandalwood and he was blazing with a thousand rays. " Beholding the Sun, foremost of the Gods, Surys, that primeval Deity without end or middle, having Uchhaisravas as his steed, He the Witness of the World, Lord of the Earth, **RAVANA** was overwhelmed by His rays and said to Prahasta : " ' O Counsellor, do thou go at my behest and apprise the Sun of mine inteotion saying, ' **RAVANA** has come hither to challenge thee, do thou fight or admit defeat; do one or the other speedily !' " Hearing these words, that *Rakshasa* advanced towards the sun and beheld two door-keepers named Pingala and Dandi and, having communicated **RAVANA**’s resolutions to them, he stood silent, being overpowered by the sun’s rays. “Approaching the Sun, Dandi related the matter to him and, hearing of **RAVANA**’s inteotion, the sagacious Surys, that enemy of the night, said to him : " ' O Dandi, either subdue **RAVANA** or say to him " I have been defeated, do as thou deemest best I " “At this command, Dandi approached the higlt-souled **RAVANA** and

informed him of what the Sun had said. " Hearing Dandi's words, the Lord of the Rakahasas pro claimed his victory by a roll of drums and went away." IStSERII!S **RAVANA**'s Encounter with the King Mandhata passed the night on the enchanting summit of Mount Sumesu and deliberated for some time, the mighty Lord of Lanka went to the region of the moon. These he beheld one sprinkled with heavenly unguents, seated in his chariot attended by Apsaras and being embraced by them, proceeding on his way, worn out by the gratification of desire. Seeing such a pesson, his curiosity was asoused and, obsesving a *Rishi*, named Pasvata, these, he said to him : " ' Thou ast welcome, O Blessed Sage, verily thou hast come at a fitting moment ! Who is this shameless being proceeding in a cbasiot attended by Apsasas ? He appears to be unawase of his peril?' " Thus addressed by **RAVANA**, the *Rishi* Parvata, said to him : " ' O Child, O Thou gifted with high intelligence, hear me and I will tell thee the truth. By him aU these worlds have been subdued and **BRAHMA** propitiated, and he is on his way to a blissful place. As thou, by virtue of asceticism, hast conquered the worlds, O Lord of the *Rakshasas*, so has he ; and, having drunk the *Soma*-juice and performed many pious acts, he has set forth on his journey. O Foremost of the *Rakshasas*, thou valiant and hast truth for thy prowess ; the mighty are never offended by the virtuous ! ' " Then **RAVANA** beheld a large and excellent car, radiant and effulgent, from which the sound of music and singing issued and he said: " ' O Great *Rishi*, who is that pesson endowed with radiance who proceeds surrounded by cbasming singers, dancing girls and Kinneras?' " Hearing these words, Pasvata, the foremost of Sages, again replied: " ' He is a hero, a mighty wasrior, who has never retreated in battle. Having performed innumerable hemic feats in combat UTT ARA *KANDA* and slain many adversaries, he has received countless wounds and finally sacrificed his life for his master.

Having destroyed a myriad people in battle, he has at last been slain by his enemies. He is now to be a guest of lndra or, it may be that he is going to some other auspicious region. This foremost of men is being entertained by singing and dancing.' " Tben Rsvana enquired once more : " ' Who goeth yonder shining like the sun ? ' " Hearing Rsvana's words, **PARVATA** *said*: " That person, resembling the full moon, adorned with various ornaments and robes, O Mighty King, whom thou beholdest in a great chariot accompanied by troops of Apsaras, has distributed much gold, therefore he proceedeth in supreme elfulgence in a swiftly coursing car.' " Hearing Parvata's words, Rsvana said again : " ' O Foremost of *Rishis*, do thou tell me which of these kings proceeding here, if entreated, will grant me the pleasure of battle? Verily thou art my filther ; do thou point out to me such a one, O Tbou conversant with piety.' " Tbus addressed, Parvata, once more replied to Rsvana, saying: " ' O Great King, all these monarchs desire heaven not con11ict, but, O Mighty One, I shall indicate to thee one who will enter into combat with thee. " ' There is a supremely powerful king, the Lord of the Seven Islands, well known by the name of Mandhata, who will do battle with thee.' " Hearing these words of Parvata, **RSVANA** *said*: " ' Do thou tell me where this king doth dwell, O Tbou of great devotion, I shall go to where that foremost of men resides.' " Hearing Rsvana's words, the Sage said again : " ' Tbe son of Yuvaneshwa, having conquered the world consisting of the Seven Islands, from sea to sea, Mandhata, the foremost of kings is coming here.' " Thereupon the long-armed Rsvana, proud of the boon conferred upon him in the Three Worlds, beheld the heroic Mandhata, the Lord of Ayodhya and the foremost of monarchs. The Lord of the Seven Islands was proceeding in a gilded and decorated car resplendent as that of Mahendra, ndiant in hia 447 own beauty, sprinkled with celestial and the Ten· necked One said to him :-' Do thou give me

battle I ' " Being thus addressed, he, laughing, said to Dashanana : " ' If thy life is not dear to thee, then enter into combat with me, O *Rakshasa* ! ' " Hearing these wotds of Mandhata, **RAVANA** *said*: '" **RAVANA** has experienced no barm from **VARUNA**, Kuveta or **YAMA**, what should he fear from a mere man ? ' " Having spoken thus, the Lord of the Rabhasas issued orders to the titans who were invincible in battle, whereupon, in fury, the counsellors of the wicked-souled *Rakshasa*, well skilled in the art of warfare, began to discharge a hail of arrows. " Then the mighty monarch, Mandhata, with golden featheted shafts, assailed Prahasta, Shuka, Sarana, Mahodara, Virupaksha, Akampana and other generals, and Prahasta covered the king with arrows but, before they reached him, that foremost of men shattered them to pieces. As grass is consumed by fire so was that host of Rabhasas consumed by the King Mandhata by means of hundreds of Bushundis, Bhallas, Bhindipalas and Tomaras. As Kamikeya sundered Mount Ktauncha with his shafts, so did Mandhata, full of rage, pierce Prahasta with five Tomaraa endowed with supreme velocity and, brandishing his mace, resembling **YAMA**'s, again and again he struck **RAVANA**'s chariot violently and that club resembling lightning, feJJ with force so that **RAVANA** was thrown down like unto Shakra's banner. Thereafter the joy of King Mandhata was increased, as the waters of the salty ocean at the time of the full moon, but the entire Rabhasa Host, shrieking with tetror, stood round the unconscious Lord of the Rabhasas. Speedily regaining his senses, **RAVANA**, the terror of all beings, Lotd of Lanka, showeted missiles on the person of Mandhata and, beholding that king fiilling unconscious, the highly powerful rangers of the night were greatly delighted and emitted leonine roara. " Regaining his senses in a moment, the King of Ayodhya, beholding his adversary acclaimed by his followers and ministers, was enraged, and assuming a dazzling form like unto the sun or moon, instantly began to

slay the titans with a dreadfW hail of shafts ; and his arrows and the noise thereof overwhelmed the entire *Rakshasa* Host, that resembled a tempestuous ocean. " Thereupon a fearful con11ict arose between man and demon and those two heroic and high-souled leaders of men and R.akshasas, like persons possessed, taking up the attitude of warriors, entered the field with swords and bows and, highly enraged, began to assail each other with shafts, woUIIding each other in the attack. Then, setting the Raudra-weapon on his bow, **RAVANA** discharged it, but Mandhata turned it aside with the Fire-weapon. Thereafter Dashanana took up the Gand harva weapon and King Mandhata the **BRAHMA-**astra, a source of terror to all. And **RAVANA** took up the Celestial and dreadfUl Pashupata-weapon, the increaser of in the Three Worlds, obtained from Rudra, by virtue of his rigid penances. " Beholding this, all moveable and immoveable beings were stricken with terror and the Three Worlds, including all that was animate and inanimate, Gods and Serpents, together took refuge in theit abodes under the earth. " Meantime, by virtue of their meditation, the two foremost of ascetics, Poulastya and Galava, aware of the con11ict, remon strated with these two warriors in various ways and restrained the King and the Lord of the *Rakshasas*. Thereafter the man and the R.akshasa were reconciled and, highly delighted, returned from whence they had come." established. Thereafter, he proceeded to an excellent airy region where the high-souled Siddhas and Charanas ever abide, which is ten thousand leagues in extent. " O Slayer of thy Foes, be then passed to a fourth region, where the Bhutas and Vmayakas perpetually sojourn and thereafter, he went to the fifth aerial realm, which extends over ten thousand leagues, where Gunga, the foremost of rivers is to be found. and the elephants headed by Kumuda, from whose bodies, drops pour down constantly as they sport in the waters, spout forth the sacred

stream which they sprinkle in all directions. Here the waters fall down in rain and snow under the rays of the sun, purified by the wind, O Raghava. " Then that Rabhasa went to the sixth aerial region, O Thou endowed with great radiance, where **GARUDA** dwells, ever revered by his kinsfolk and friends, and, thereafter, ascended to the seventh aerial region, lying ten thousand leagues higher, where the Seven *Rishis* dwell.' And again proceeding ten thousand leagues higher he reached the eighth aerial region where Gunga, known as the Ganges of the sky, having strong currents, is found in the path of the sun and. who, upheld by air, sends forth a great roaring. " Now I shall describe the region yet higher than these, where the Moon-god dwells and the extent thereof is eighty thousand leagues. There the Moon encircled by stars and planets, from whom hundreds and thousands of rays stream forth, illumines the world, bringing happiness to all beings. " Thereupon, beholding Dashagriva, the Moon, blazing up as it were, consumed him with its cold fires and, stricken with fear of those rays, his counsellors were unable to withstand them and Prahasta, uttering the words ' Let victory be thine I ' there after ssid : " ' O King, we are being destroyed by the cold and must leave this place I O Foremost of Monarchs, the icy rays of the moon have the property of fire.' " Hearing the words of Prahasta, **RAVANA**, beside himself with wrath, lifted his bow, twanging it and began to asssil the Moon with Narachas, whereupon **BRAHMA** speedily went to that lmw: region and said :-" ' O Ten-necked One, O Mighty-armed One, O Son of Vishravas, O Gentle One, do thou go hence from here speedily ; do not oppress the Moon, for that bigbly effulgent King of the Twice-born desireth the well-being of all I will bestow a mystical formula on thee ! He who recollectS it at the hour of death, does not succumb ! ' " Thus addressed, the Ten-necked Raksbasa, with joined palms, said : " ' O God, if I have found favour with thee, then, O Lord of the Worlds, O

Thou of great penances, impart that sacred mantta to me, O Thou truly Pious One, reciting which, O Great One, I shall be liberated from fear of the Celestials. Verily, by Thy favour, O Lord of the Gods, I shall become invincible to all the *Asuras*, Danavas and Birds.' " Thus accosted, Brabma said to Dashanana : " ' O Lord of the Raksbasas, do not repeat this mantta daily but only when thy life is in danger. Holding a string of Rud raksha beads and repeating it, thou shalt become invincible ; but if thou dost not recite it, thou shalt not meet with success. Hear and I shall communicate this sacred formula to thee, O Foremost of the *Rakshasas*, reciting which thou shalt obtain victory in the encounter : " ' Salutations unto Thee, O God, O Lord of Lords, O Thou worshipped by the Celestials and *Asuras*. O Thou, the same in the past, present and future, O Great God, O Thou having tawny eyes, O Thou, a boy assuming the form of an aged Being, O Thou who wearest a tiger skin. O God, Thou art worthy to be worshipped and art the Lord of the Three Worlds. Thou art Isbwara, Hara, Haratanemi, the Fire at the end of the World Cycle, Yugantadahaka ; Thou art Baladeva, Thou art Ganesha, Lokashambu, and Lokapala, Thou art endowed with huge arms, Thou art blessed, the Bearer of the Trident ; Thou art possessed of dresdful teeth and jaws, the greatest of the Gods, Thou art Time, Thou art Power, Thou art the Blue-throated and posaessed of a huge belly, Thou art Devantaka, the foremost of the ascetics and the Lord of all creatures. Thou art the Leader, Protector, Hari-Hara, Destroyer and Preserver, Thou wearest = matted locks, art clean-shaven and wrapped in a loincloth, Thou art mighty and illustrious, Thou art the Lord of Spirits and Goblins, the Support of all, ProteCtor of all, Destroyer of all, the Creator and the Eternal Preceptor, Thou art the Bearer of the Kamandalu,' the Wielder of the Pinaka Bow and the Dhurjata. Thou art worthy of veneration, Thou art Awn, the highest of all, the First Chanter

of the Sama-Veda. Thou art Death and the nature of death, Pariyatra' and the Observer of great vows ; Thou art a brahmachari dwelling in a cave bearing a Vina, Panava and quiver in thine hands ; Thou art immortal, lovely to look upon as the newly risen sun ; Thou dwellest in the crematorium ; Thou art the illustrious Lord of Uma, trans cending all taint ; Thou didst pluck out the eyes of Bhagadeva and the teeth of Pusha. Thou art the overcomer of fever and bearest a noose in Thy hand, verily Thou art Dissolution and Time of the llaming mouth, fire being Thy symbol, Thou art highly effulgent and the Lord of men. Thou art demented and causest people to tremble ; Thou art the Fourth and deeply venerated of men, Thou art the Holy Dwarf, Vamanadeva, and the Dwarf who circumambulates the East. Thou wearest the semblance of a beggar with three locks, and art crafty by nature. Thou didst stay the hand oflndra and of the Vasus, Thou art the Seasons, the Creator of seasons ; Thou art Time, Honey and the One of honey eyes. Thou art the Lord of herbs, a lordly tree bearing fruit and ftowers ; Thy seat is made of arrows ; Thou art ever worshipped by people in all conditions ; Thou art the Creator and Proteetor of the Universe, the Eternal and true Purusba ; Thou art the Controller of Righteousness, Virupabha, the Three Dharmas, the ProteCtor of all beings. Thou art the Tbree-eyed One of many forms blazing like a million suns, Thou art the Lord of the Cclestials, the foremost of the Gods, bearing matted locks and the crescent moon, Thou art worthy of being approached and art one with created beings ; Thou art the Player of all musical inatruments, ever creating and binding all, and dost bring about the liberation of all beings. Thou art Pushpadanta, indivis.ible, the foremost of Thou hast tawny besrds, besrest a bow and art fesrfilland endowed with terrible might.' " ' Tbese hundred and eight ss.cred and czcelle,nt 11811les, utteted by me, desuoy all sins, bestow merit and give refuge to those who seek it. O

Dashanana, if thou dost recite them, thou shalt be able to cmrcome thy foes ! ' " Rtwana and the Malra-Purusha conferred that favour on RVIIDll, the Grandsire, sprung from the lotus, speedily went to his own region and Rs.vans., having obtained the boon, departed. “After a few days, that Scourge of the Worlds, the *Rakshasa* Rs.vans. with his counsellon reached the banks of the western ocean and, on an island, a person was seen .. ted there alone, bright as fire, 11811led Mahajambunada. His form was dread1W like unto the Fire of Dissolution and, beholding that highly powerfill Being resembling Mahendra, the Chief of the Gods among the Celestials, or the sun among the planets, a lion among the Sharabhas, Ainvata among elephants, Sumeru among mountains and Parijata among trees, **DASHAGRIVA** *said*: " Enter into combat with me I ' and his eyes llickered like a cluster of planets.' Gnashing his teeth, he made a sonnd like a grinding mill and the highly powerfill Dashanana amidst his counsellon, roared aloud. Thereafter with darts, Shatis, Rishtis and Pattikas, he assailed that highly effulgent Being of long anns, dread aspect, huge teeth, grim form, conch-like neck. broad chest, frog-like belly, leonine countenance, feet like unto the summit of Mount Kailasha, the palms of his hands and the aoles of his feet like unto red lotuses, endowed with the swiftness of thought and the wind, terrifying. bearing a quiver, adorned with bells and chowries, encircled by fla111es, cmitlina a sweet sound like a net-work of Kinkinis,weariDg a garland of golden flowers round his neck, noble, like unto the Rig-Veda and resembling the Anjana or Golden Mountain. “As a lion remains unmoved by the attack of a wolf or an elephant, or Mount Sumeru by the King of the Serpents, or the vast ocean by the current of a river, neither was that great Being perturbed, but addressing Dasbagriva, said : '" O Vicious-minded Nigbt-ranger, I sball soon rid thee of thy desire for combat.' " O **RAMA**, the migbt of that

Being was a thousand times greater than **RAVANA**'s, wbich was a source of terror to the worlds. Piety and asceticism, wbich are the roots of attainment of everything in the world, are in bis thighs, desire is in bis male organ, the Vishvadevas are at bis waist and the winds at the side of bis intestines; the eight Vasus dwell in bis middle, the oceans abide in bis belly, the quarters are bis bips, the Maruts bis joints, the Pittris are at bis back and the Gnndsire has taken refuge in bis heart. Charitable acts of making many gifts of kine, gold and land are the hair in bis armpits ; the Mountains, Himalaya, Hemakura, Mandara and Meru are bis bones, the thunderbolt is in bis palm, the sty in bis frame, the evening rain-clouds are on bis neck ; the Creator and Preserver and the Vidyadharas are bis arms; Ananta, Vasuki, Vishalaksha, ltavat, Kamvala, Asvatara, Karkotaka, Dbananjaya, the veno mous Takshaka and Urpatskshaka' have taken shelter under bis nails in order to vomit forth their poison. Fire is in bis mouth, the Rudras on bis shoulders ; the formighrs, months, years and seasons in bis jaws, the lunar fortnigbt and tbe dark half of the month are bis nostrils, the airy currents are the pores of his body, Saraswati with her Vina is in bis tbtoat, the Asvins are in bis ranger to ftight that great Purusha, like unto the Rig-Veda, resembling a mountain be-decked with lotus wreaths, entered the region under the esrth. " Then **RAVANA** addressed his counsellors thus : " O Prahasta, O Shuka, O Sarana and ye other ministers, where has that Purusha suddenly gone ? Do ye tell me ! ' " Hearing the words of **RAVANA**, the Night-rangers said : That Purusha, who crusheth the pride of *Devas* and Danavas, has entered into that place ! ' "As **GARUDA** swoops on a serpent so did that wicked-minded **RAVANA** speedily approach the entrance of that cave and entered it fearlessly. Penetrating there, he beheld three warriors, dark like unto collyrium, wearing Keyurss,adorned with red garlands, besmeared with sandalpaste,

bedecked with diverse golden ornaments set with gems ; and he saw three crores of csalted beings, fearless, pure, radiant as fire, intent on dancing. " Beholding them, Dashagriva was not in the least afraid but watched them gyrating whilst he stoOd at the entrance ; and they all resembled the Maha-Purusha, who had previously been seen by him, and all were of similar colour, dress, form and all equally endowed with energy. Then the hair of Dashagriva stood on end as he gazed upon them but, on account of the boon he had received from the Self-born, he issued out of that place alive. Theresfter he saw the Maha Purusha lying on a couch, and his dwelling, his seat and his bed were all white and costly and he slept there enveloped in flames. “And there, with a fan in her lotus-like hands sat the Goddess Lakshmi, most beautiful in all the Three Worlds and their decoration, as it were; chute, adorned with celestial garlands, sprinkled with excellent sandal-paste, bedecked with rich ornaments and clad in costly robes. And the wicked **RAVANA**, Lord of the *Rakshasas*, having entered there without a counsellor, beholding that chaste damsel of sweet smiles, seated on a royal throne, became filled with desite and wished to hold her by the hand, as one under the sway of death fondles a sleeping serpent. " Beholding that Lord of the *Rakshasas* with a loosened garment and knowing hitn desirous of taking hold of her, the huge-armed Deity, sleeping, enveloped in flames, laughed aloud and suddenly by his power began to consume Rsvana, the harasser of bis foes, who feU down on the esrth like an uprooted tree. Beholding that Rskshssa fallen, the Purusha addrased him saying: " ' Rise up, O Foremost of the R.akshasas, thou ahalt not meet with death to-day I Thou ahalt live protected by the Grandsire’s boon. Do thou therefore go hence without fear, O Rsvana, thy death is not yet decreed ! ' " Regaining consciousness after a while, Rsvana was seized with fear and being thus addressed, that enemy of the Gods rose up, bis hair

standing on end and said to that highly resplen dent Deity: " ' Who art thou endowed with grest energy and like unto the Fire of Dissolution ? Say who art thou, O God and from whence hast thou come hither ? ' " Being thus accosted by the wiclted-minded Rsvana, the God, smiling, replied in accents as deep as the muttering of clouds, saying: " ' What hast thou to do with me, O Dashagriva, thou ahalt be slain ere long I ' " Being thus addressed, the Ten-neclted Raksbasa, with joined palms, said : " ' On account of Brahms's boon, I shall not tread the path of death ; there is none born amongst men or Gods who am equal me or, in virtue of bis prowess, disregard the Grandsire's boon. His words may never prove vain nor am any, howsoever he exert himself, prove them to be false ; I do not see any in the Three Worlds who could render his boon to me void. O Great God, I am immortal, I do not fear Thee and even were I to meet with death, may it be through thee and none other, O Lord; death at Thy hands will bring me glory and renown I ' " Then Rsvana endowed with dreadtW prowess saw the Three Worlds with all the animate and inanimate aeanuea within the body of the Deity. The Adityas, the Muuts, the Sadhyas, the Vasus, the Twin Ashvins, the Rudras, the Pirtris, **YAMA**, Kuvera, the seas, mountains, rivers, all the branches of the other Gods, Yakshas, Daityas and *Rakshasas* were an seen in their subtle forms in the limbs of that Purusba lying there. " On this, the virtuous-souled **RAMA** said to Agastya, the fore most of *Munis* :-" O Lord, tell me who was that Msha Purusba on that island ? Who were those hundreds and thousands of beings ? Who is the Purusba who humbles the pride of Daityas and Danavas ? " Hearing **RAMA**'s words, **SHRI AGASTYA** *answered*: " O Thou existing eternally, O God of Gods, hearken and I will tell thee. That Purusba on the island was the illustrious Kspila and an those wbo were dancing are the Deities equalling that intelligent Kspila in energy and power. Aod that Rsk

sbasa, bent on sin, was not looked on by Him with a wrathful glance, thetefore he was not immediately reduced to ashes, but **RAVANA**, who resembled a mountain, with bis pierced, fell to the ground. As a crafty man penetrates a secret, so did that Purusba pierce **RAVANA**'s petson with bia arrow-like words. " Tberesfter that Rsksbasa of great prowess, having regained bia senses after a long time, returned to where bis counsellors were."

CHAPTER 24

Ravana carries off a number of Women and is cursed by them

Of Kings, *Rishis*, Gods and Danavas. Whenever he met a young maiden of remarkable beauty, he slew an her kinsfolk and friends and took her into bia chariot. Thus the daughters of Pannagas, Rsksbasas, *Asuras*, men and Yakahss were compelled to enter bia equipage and an these unfortunate beings, under the sway of their hips like unto the ules of a chariot, who resembled the consorts of the Gods with their elegant waists and their comple· ion like unto refined gold, were mad with fear and grief. The bresth of their sighing scorched the ear, lending the Pushpaka Chariot the appearance of a fire ceremony that is lit on all sides. " Fallen into the power of Dashagriva, those women were overcome with allliction and the aadness epressed in their looks and mieo caused them to resemble black antelopes that have become a prey to a lion. And one asked herself Is he not going to devour me ? ' whilst another, in the despair that overwhelmed her, thought He is about to slay me ! ' Recollecting their mothers, fathers, husbands and brothers, plunged in grief and allliction, those womeo, thus assemblecl began to

lament, saying: " 'Alas ! What will become of my son without me ? What will become of my mother ? ' And, submerged in an ocean of grief, they criecl What can I do now fat from my lord ? O Death, I call upon thee to bear me away for allliction is now my portion. Have I committed some misdeed formerly in another body?' " Theo all those wretchecl women, sunk in an ocean of despair exclaimed :-' We see no eod to our misery I Woe unto the world ! Assureclly none is more vile than the mighty **RAVANA**, aince under his blows our helpless consorts have perished, as starS disappear on the rising of the sun. Ah I That powerful Rakslwa takes delight in deviaing the means of our destruction I Alas I He gives himself up to evil without scruple, he is in di1fereot to every condemnation ; till now none has been able to put an eod to the eploits of this wickecl wretch, yet it is a great ain to lay hands on other meo's wives; this *Rakshasa* is the vilest of all aince he seeks enjoyment with them. Because of this, a woman will be the cause of the desth of this wickecl being!' " When those virtuous and noble women had uttered these words, celestial gongs sounded and a shower of blosaom fell. Cursed by his captives, Dashagriva seemed toloseallhis power and glory and, hearing those women, who were chaste and devoled to their consorts, lamenting in this wise, that bull among the Rakslwas became diatraaecl. " Thereafter he made his entry into the City of Lanka to the acclamations of the rangers of the night and, at that time, the fierce Raksbasi, who was able to change her form at will, the sister of **RAVANA**, suddenly sank down on the earth before him, and **RAVANA**, helping her to rise and comforting her, said : " ' O Desr One, what is this ? Why dost thou seek speech with me so urgendy ? ' " Thereupon, her eyes inflamed and suffused with tesrs, she said to him : " ' O King, I have been widowed through thy ruthless conduct ! O Lord, thy valour in combat bas cut down those Daityas called Kslakeyas to the number of

fourteen thousand and, in addition, my valiant lord who was dearer to me than life itself. He was slain by thee, his foe, a brother in name only and, by thee, I myself am slain, O Prince, thou my kinsman ! From now, I shall hesr the tide of widow through thy filult I Was it not for thee to spare a brother-in-law in the fight ? ' " Hearing those indignant words from his sister, Dashagriva, in order to appease her, spoke soothingly, saying : " ' Dry thy tesrs, my desr sister and fear nothing I I shall load thee with gifts, homage and filvours. In the heat of bstde, being carried away by a desire to triumph, I loosed my shafts without being able to distinguish mine own people from others and did not recognize my brother-in-law whom I struck in the height of the conftict. That is how thy consort fell under my blows in the fight. O My Sister, whatever presents itself at this time, I will do for thy pleasure. It is for thee to go and live near thy kinsman, Khara, who enjoys sovereignty. Fourteen thousand Raksbasas will be made subject to that powerful Prince in the expeditions and distribution of spoils. There, that son of the sister of thy mother, thy cousin Khara, the Ranger of the Night, will ever be obedient to thy commands. Let that warrior speedily go and guard the Dandaka Forest ; Dushana shall be his commander ; great is his valour. The courageous Khara shall ever obey thy will and be the leader of the titans able to change their form at pleasure.' " Having spoken thus, Dashagriva placed an army offourteen thousand Rakshasaa, fWI of valour, under Khan’s command. Surrounded by all those titans of redoubtable appearance. THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI Khara set out fearlessly at once to the Dandaka Forest. There he established his authority without hindrance and Shurpanaltha dwelt ncar him in the forest.”

CHAPTER 25

Dashagriva allies himself to Madhu

" DASHAGRIVA, having given over that redoubtable army to Khara and consoled his sister, became mastet of himself once more and was freed from anxiety. " Thereafter that powertW lndra among the 1lakshaaas penetrated into the marvellous Nikumbhila Grove whete he beheld hundreds of sacrificial posts and altars and, as if blazing in brilliance, a sacrifice was being performed. " There, clad in a black antelope skin, holding a coconut loshta and staff, he beheld his own son, Meghanada of dread aspect. Approaching him, the Lord of Lanka, clasping him in his arms, enquired of him : " ' What art thou doing hete, O Cbild, tell me truly I ' " Then that excellent Twice-bom of rigid penances, Ushanas, in ordet that the sacrifice should prove auspicious, answered llavana, saying : " ' I shall tell thee myself, O King, listen to all that has taken place. Seven sacrifices with countless preparatory rites have been undertaken by thy son, the Agnisthoma, Ashvamedha, Bahus varnab, llajasuya, Gomedha and the Vaishnava and, having cnpged in the Maheshvara sacrifice, difficult fot men to under take, thy son, on its completion, received gifts from the Lord of Creatures Himself: a stable and celestial chariot coursing at will in the sky, the power of illusion by which darknen is created on the field of battle so that even the Gods and Asaras can no looget lind their way, and, in ordet to exterminate the file in combat, O King, he has also been gtanted two inedlausu’ble . u—..... quivers, a bow that no weapon can shatter and a powerful arrow. Having received these gift>, thy son, O Dasbanaoa, wishes to meet with thee on the completion of the sacrifice and will soon present himself before thee.' " **THEN DASHAGRIVA** *said*: " This is not well done, since our

enemy, **INDRA**, bas been worshipped with these offerings. However, what is done is done and doubtless thou wilt acquire metit thereby, let us now return, My Friend, and enter our abode.' " Thereafter Dasbagriva with his son and Bibisbana returned to his dwelling and caused all the captives, who were crying and sobbing, to be brought down ; and the virtuous Bibisbana, being aware of his intention regarding those women, who were noble and veritable pearls, the offspring of the Gods, Daoavas and *Rakshasas*, said to his brother : "'It is practices sucb as these, whicb thou dost follow with deliberate intention despite thy knowledge of the causes of destruction of beings, that are ruinous to thy good name, thy family and fortune I After ill-treating their relatives, thou bast carried away these bigh-bom women, whilst Madhu alfronta thee by carrying oft" Kumbbinasi,' " **THEN RAVAOA** *answered*:-' I was not aware of this ; who is this Madhu of whom thou speakest ? ' and Bibishaoa replied to his brother indignaotly and said : " Learn the consequences of thine evU *karma* I The elder brother of our maternal grandfather, Sumali, that virtuous old mao named Malyavao, Ranger of the Night, the father of our mother, is the grandfather of Kumbhinasi, so that we are virtually her brothers. She bas been borne away by Madhu, a *Rakshasa* of superior power, wbile thy son was engaged in the sacrifice and I was bathing in the waters. Kumbbakama, on bia side, was still under the inlluence of sleep. Having slain the aged ministers, that foremost of night-rangers instantly carried away the princess most ruthlessly, though abe was in the precincts of the inner apartments. Though these ill-tidings were known to us, we did not slay the ravisher since it is impera tive that a young girl be provided with a consort by her brothers. This is the fruit of thy perverse and wicked conduct which, as thou aeest, thou art now reaping in this world itaelf.' 461 " Hearing these words of Bibishana's, thst Inclra of the Rstsbasas, Rsvana, wrought up through the wickedness

of his soul, like unto an ocean with surging waves, bis eyes red with anger, said : "'Let my chariot be harnessed speedily, let my warriors stand resdy with my brother Kumbbakarna and the foremost of the rangers of the night in their conveyances heaped with every wespon. To-day, having slain Madhu, who dares to defy Rsvans, I shall go to the region of the Gods, burning to fight, surrounded by my companions.' " Four thousand Aksbauhinis of the foremost of the titans, armed from head to foot with vsrious weapons, instantly rushed out, eager for band to band encounter, and Indrajita marched in the advance guard with his warriors. Rsvans occupied the centre and Kumbbakarna the rearguard. As for the virtuous Bibishana, he remained in Lanka, faithful to bis duty. All the other warriors advanced against Msdhu's city and they were mounted on mules, buffalo, fiery steeds, porpoises and great serpents, covering the sky and, beholding Rsvans on the march, hundreds ofDaityas, who were at emnity with the Gods, followed him. " Meanwhile Dashanana, having reached Madhupura, entered it, yet he did not find Madhu there but bis own sister, who, paying obeisance to him, with a deep bow cast herself at bis feet, for Kumbhinasi feared the Lord of the Rstsbaass. " Then he, raising her up, said to her : " ' Do not tremble I ' and the King of the Rstsbasas added ' What dost thou desire of me ? ' Then she replied :- O Long-armed Prince, if I find favour with thee, then, O Proud Hero, do not slay my lord ; it is not fitting to reduce women of nobility to such allliction. Of all ill-fortune, to become a widow is the greatest. Be true to thy word, O **INDRA** of Monarchs, and receive my supplicatinn with favour. Thou hast thyself said " Thou bast nothing to fear I " ' " Theu Rsvana, in cheerful tones, answered bis sister, who stood near him, saying :-' Where is thy husband, tell me quickly ! I shall go with him to conquer the reginn of the Gods. I shall not slay Madhu because of my tender alfcction for thee.' "At these words,

Kumbhinasi roused ber lmd, thst Ranaer of 462 the N"aght, who was sleeping profoundly and, in the height of joy, said to him : " ' My powerful btothet, Dashagriva, is here, who desires to vanquish the world of the Gods ; he has chosen thee as his ally, therefore go, O Titan, with thy kinsmen and lend him thy strong suppon. It is fitting that thou shouldst assist him in this on account of his magnanimity and the honour which he has paid thee.' " On hearing this, Madhu answered, ' So be it I ' and behold ing **RAVANA**, the Lord of the *Rakshasas*, he approached him according to tradition and paid him due tribute. " Thus honoured, Dashagriva passed a night in Madhu's abode and then started on his way. Having reached Kailasha, that mountain that served as Vaishravana's retreat, the Iodra among the *Rakshasas*, like unto Mahendra, caused his army to set up camp."

CHAPTER 26

Nalakuvara curses Ravana

" IT was on Kailasha, the sun having withdrawn behind the Astachala Range, that Dashagriva, full of vigour, chose to encamp the army. " When the immaculate moon rose over the mountain with a splendour equal to his, the vast host that composed the army, furnished with diverse weapons, Jay sleeping. " The mighty **RAVANA**, resting on the summit of the mountain, surveyed the splendour of the forests in the light of the moon, the llaming Kamikara Woods, the Kadambas and Vakulas, pools covered with lotuses in bloom, the waters of the Mands kini, the Cbampalta, Ashob, Pwmaga, Mandars, Cuta, Patala, Lodhra, Priyangs, Arjuna, Ketaka, Tagara, Narikela, Priysla, Panasa and other trees. Sweet-throated Kinneru, transported with love, 8IIDII melodies

that ravished the soul with delight ; there the Vidyadharas, intozicated, their eyes in8amed, diverted themselves with their consorts. Like unto a carillon of bells, singing in Dbanada's abode. Trees, shaken by the wind, covered the mountain with a shower of blossom, distilling the perfume of honey and mead, and a balmy breeze, laden with the enchanting aroma of nectar and pollen, blew, enhancing **RAVANA**'s voluptuous desire. The songs, the myriad flowers, the freshness of the breeze, the beauty of the mountain in the night, the moon at its zenith, thtew **RAVANA**, that mighty warrior, into a ferment of passion. " Meanwhile, Rambha, loveliest of nymphs adorned with celestial ornaments, was on her way to a sacred festival and her face was like unto the full moon, her limbs smeared with sandal· paste, her hair sown with Mandara flowers, and she was garlanded with celestial blooms. Her eyes were beautiful, her waist high, adorned with a jewelled belt, and her hips were shapely, the gift oflove as it were. She was enchanting with her countenance embellished with the marks of flowers' that bloom in the six seasons and, in her beauty, stateliness, radiance and splendour, she resembled Shri. Swathed in a dark blue cloth, like unto a rain cloud, her countenance bright as the moon, her eyebrows resplendent arches, her hips like the tapering trunks of elephants, her hands like two fresh buds, under **RAVANA**'s eyes she psssed through the ranks of the army. " Thereupon he, rising, pierced by the shafts of love, with his hand stayed the course of that nymph who was abashed and, smiling, enquired of her : " Where art thou going, O Lady of lovely hips ? What good fonune art thou pursuing ? For whom has this auspicious hour dawned ? Who is about to enjoy thee ? Who, this day, will quaff the elixir of thy lips ezhaling the perfume of the lotus that UTT ARA *KANDA* ezercise dominion over the Three Worlds, who with joined palms address this humble request to thee, I, Dashaoana, Lord of the Three Worlds and

their Ordainer, therefore grant my request.' " Hearing these worda, Rambha, trembling, with joined palms, replied :-' Look on me with favour, it is not fitting that thou shouldst address me thus, thou who art my superior I Rathet is it thy duty to protect me from others if I should be in danger of sull'ering violence at their hands, for apart from duty, I am virtually thy dsughter-in-law, I speak truth I' " Then Dashagriva answered Rambha, who had prostrated herself at his feet and whose hair stood on end merely on behold ing him, and said : " ' Hadst thou been my son's conson, thou wouldst in effect be my dsughter-in-law I ' Thereupon she answered : " ' Truly it is so, by law, I am the wife of thy son and dearer to him than his life's breath, O BuD amongst the *Rakshasas* ; he is the son of thy brother Vaishravana, who is renowned in the Three Worlds, and is named Nalakuvara, an ascetic in vinue, a warrior in respect of valour and, in wrath he resembles **AGNI** ; in forbesrance he is like unto the earth I I was going to meet that son of the Guardian of the Worlds ; it is for his sake that I am adorned with these ornaments so that he and no other should enjoy me. For these reasons, let me go hence, O King, O Subduer of thy Foes, for that vinuous prince awaits me im· patiendy. It is not for thee to thwart his desires, let me go I Do thou follow the path of the vinuous, O BuD among the Rak shasas I It is for me to pay thee homsge and for thee to protect mel' " Thus did she address Dashagriva, who answered her in amooth accents, saying : " Thou hast said thou art my dsughter-in-law I For those who have but one husband, this argument is valid but in Devaloka, the Gods have established a law that is said to be eternal, that Apsaras have no appointed consorts nor are the Gods monogamous I ' " Thus speaking, the *Rakshasa*, who had stationed himself on the mountain ridge, inftamed with desire, ravished Rambha and, when she was released from his embrace, her garlands and her 46S Ol'll8lllellts spoiled and torn

away, she resembled a river where a great elephant, disporting himself, muddying the waters, bas borne away tbe banks. Her bait in disorder, her handa clenched, lite unto a creeper with its ftowera shaken by the wind, trembling witb terror, she sought out Nalakuvara and, witb joined palms, fell at his feet. " Then he enquired of her saying : " ' What ia this, O messed One ? Why dost thou prostrate thyself at my feet ? ' “Thereupon she, sighing deeply, trembling, witb joined palms began to teD him everything and said : " ' O Lord, tbia night, Dashagriva scaled tbe Trivishtapa Peak while he was encamped on tbat mountain with his army and I was observed by him as I came to meet thee, O Conqueror of Thy Foes ! That *Rakshasa* seized hold of me and questioned me saying " To whom dost thou belong ? " Then I told him all, verily the whole truth, but he, intoXicated with desire, would not listen to me when I pleaded with him, saying " I am thy daughter-in-law ! " RefUsing to listen to mine entreaties, he assaulted me ruthlessly ! This ia mine only fault, O Thou of firm vows, thou shouldat therefore pardon me. O Friend, verily there ia no equality of strength between man and woman I ' " These worda filled tbe son of Vaiahravana with indignation and hearing of tbia supreme outrage, he entered into meditation and having ascertained the truth, tbe son of Vaishravana, his eyes in8amed with anger, instantly took water in his hand and sprinkled his whole person in accord witb tradition, after which he pronounced a terrible curse on tbat lndra of tbe *Rakshasas,* aaying : " ' Since, despite thy lack of love for him, he ravished thee thus brutally, O messed One, on tbia account he will never be able to approach another youthful woman unless she shares his love ; if, carried away by lust, he does violence to any woman who does not love him, his head will split into seven pieces.' " Having uttered tbia curse like unto a scorching flame, celestial gongs resounded and a shower of flowers fell from tbe sky. All tbe Gods witb the Grandaire at

their head were filled with joy, conversant as they were with the whole courae of tbe world and the future death of tbe Rskshasa. 466 " When Dashagriva learnt of the curse, however, his hair stOOd on end and he ceased to indulge in uniting himself with those who had no affection for him. Thereafter, among those who had been borne away by him and remained faithful to their conSOtt8, there was great rejoicing when they heard of the curse uttered by Nalakuvars, which was pleasing to their heart."

CHAPTER 27

The Fight between the Gods and the Rakshasas. The Death of Sumali

" **H**AVING crossed Mount Kailasha with his infimtry and cavalry, the extremely powerful Dashanana reached Indraloka and, like an ocean that ovcrflows, the tumult of the Rakahasa army, approaching on all sides, reverberated in Dcvaloka. " Hearing of **RAVANA**'s advent, Indrs trembled on his throne and addressed the assembled Gods, Adityas, Vasus, Rudrss, Sadhyas and Hosts of Maruts, saying : " Prepare to fight against the wicked-minded **RAVANA** l ' "At Shakra's command, the Gods, his equals in war, endowed with great valour, boldly armed themselvea for combat. Mahendra however, who feared **RAVANA** extremely, profoundly perturbed, sought out Vishou and spoke to him thus : " O Vishou, how shall I withatand the Rakahasa **RAVANA**, whose strength is formidable and who, alas, is advancing to attack me ? He owes his power to the boon he has received from **BRAHMA** and to nought else and the words uttered by that Lotus-hom God must be carried into effect ! Do Thou grant me such assistance again which Thou

didat accord me when I deatroyed Namuchi, Vritrs, Bali, Naraka and Shambara l O Lord, O God of Gods, Slayer of Madhu, there is no refuge save Thee in the Thtcc Worlds with all the animate and inanimate beings. Thou art the blessed Narayana, the etcrnallotus-bOtn One; Thou art the Sustsincr of the Worlds and of myself, Shakra, the King of the Gods ; Thou hast created the Thtcc Worlds with all the moving and unmoving objects and, at the end of the world cycle, all is withdrawn into Thee, O Bhagawat ; 467 therefore, O God of Gods, tell me truly if Thou wilt arm Thywelf with sword and discus in order to enter into combat with **RAVANA**?' " Thus spoke Sbakra, the King of the Gods, and that sovereign Lord, Narayana, answered him saying : " ' Fear not I Hear me I On account of the boon he has received which renders him invincible, this wicked wretch may not be overcome by the Gods and *Asuras* combined I IntoXica ted with his power, that Raksbasa, accompanied by his son, will certainly achieve a great feat. As for thy request, that I should enter into combat with him, I shall certainly not meet the Rak shasa **RAVANA** in fight, for **VISHNU** never leaves the battlefield without laying his adversary low ; it is nor possible to accomplish this to-day since **RAVANA** is protected by the boon, but I swear to thee, O King of the Gods, Shatakratu, that I myself will become the cause of that titan's death. The Gods shall rejoice when I make known to them that the hour has struck I I speak the truth, O Mighty Lord of the Gods, Conson of Sachi, therefore fight with the assistance of the Gods and banish all fear I ' " Then the Rudras with the Adityas, Vasus, Maruts and the two Ashvins, assembling, advanced to meet the *Rakshasa*. At that instant, the end of the night having come, a great clamour arose from **RAVANA**'s army as they took the field on all sides, and those valiant warriors, wrought up with eacitement, on seeing each other, eagerly rushed on the foe. Thereafter confUsion was sown

amongst the ranks of the Daivatas by the presence of that indomitable and vast army in the forefront of battle and a terrible struggle ensued between the Gods, Danavas and Raksbasas, amidst a fearful tumult and under a hail of missiles of every kind. " Then those valiant *Rakshasas* of grim aspect grouped themselves round **RAVANA** in the fight, and Maricha, Prahasta, Mahaparshwa, Mshodara, Akampana, Nikumbha, Shuka, Sarana Dhumaketu, Mahadamshtta, Ghatodara,]ambumalin, Maharada Virupaksha, Saptaghna, Yajnakopa, Durmukha, Dushana, Khara, Trishiras, Karaviraksha, Surysshastru, Mahakaya and Atiksya, Devantaka, Narantaka and the highly powerful Sumali, **RAVANA**'s maternal grand18ther, all those warriors, encircling their valiant leader, entered the battlefield. UTT ARA *KANDA* "Aad with whetted shafbl, emaged, he began to assail the Celestial Host, as a tempest scatters the clouds ; and the forces of the Gods were overthrown by the rangen of the night. O **RAMA**, and scattered in all clirections, like unto a herd of deer before lions. " Meantime the courageous Savitra, the eighth Vasu, entered the bsttlefield surrounded by soldiers, tiill of martial ardour, tumished with evecy kind of weapon and he began to sow terror in the enemy ranks when he appeared in the midst of the fight. Thereafter the two Adityas, tiill of valour and intrepidity, Twastar and Pushan, at the hesd of a division, entered the lists in their turn, whereupon a fearful struggle ensued between the *Rakshasas* and the Gods, who never retreated in bsttle and were jealous of their good name. Aad the Celestials there present fell in hundreds of thousands under the blows of the *Rakshasas*, who were formidable and armed with weapons of every kind. On their side, the Gods, redoubtable in their vigour and extreme valour, with the help of filultless arrows, despatched their foes to the region of **YAMA**. Thereupon O **RAMA**, the *Rakshasa* Sumali, tiilly armed, hurled himself on the foe in fury and scattered the entire

Celestial Host with his innumerable and penetrating missiles, as a violent hurricane, the clouds, and with formidable blows from spears and javelins, decimated them, so that the Gods were unsble to stand. " The Immortals haviog thus been put to ftight by Sumali, the eighth Vasu, Savitra, emaged, stood fast, and surrounded by his forces, tiill of energy and courage stayed the onrush of that Ranger of the Night, whereupon a fearful duel, causing the hair to stand on end, ensued between Sumali and the Vasu, both warriors who did not know what it was to retreat in battle. Under the powerful missiles of his adversary, the chariot of the *Rakshasa*, that was harnessed to serpents, suddenly fell to pieces ; and having shattered his chariot in the light with his countless darts, the Vasu seized hold of his mace with the intention of slaying him. Brandishing that weapon with its flaming point, resembling the Rod of Death, Savitra brought it down on Sumali'a head and the mace fell upon him with the llaah of a meteor, so that it appeared like a grest thunderbolt hurled by lndra on a mountain. Thereafter nothing of the *Rakshasa* THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI could be seen, neither bone nor hesd nor ftesh, for that mace, by overthrowing him on the battle field, hsd reduced him to dust. " Then the R.skshssu, beholding that Sumali hsd fallen in the fight, questioning esch other, all lied, routed by that Vasu who hsd overcome them." CHAPTBR 28 "SBBING Sumali overthrown and reduced to dust by Vasu and beholding his army in Bight harassed by the Gods, the valiant son ofR.avana, whose voice resembled the muttering of a thunder cloud, provoked, rallied the R.skshssu and, mounted on an excellent chariot that coursed wheresoere he willed, that grest warrior hurled himself on the Celestial Host. Like unto a fire that consumes the forests, he entered the field armed with every weapon, and when the Gods beheld him, a general stampede followed, none daring to face such a combatant. Then Shakra stayed all

those fugitives by admonishing them thus : " ' Neither should you tremble nor flee, return and fight, O Ye Gods I Behold my son, who is invincible, entering the lists I ' “At that moment the son of Sbskra, the illustrious God Jayanta, mounted on his chariot, that was marvellously construc ted, turned towards the battlefield. Thereafter the Gods, surrounding the son of Sachi, turned baclt to fight R.avani and a well-matched contest ensued between Gods and R.skshasas. Then R.avani loosed his golden shafts on Gomukha, the son of Matsli, Jayauta’s charioteer, whilst Sachi’a son, in his turn, in wrath bsraased R.avani’s driver on every side. His eyes dilated with the fury that possessed him, the mighty R.mmi covered his opponents with darts and thereafter, in his ire, he let 1ly innumerable extremely sharp weapons on the Celestial Host and Shataghnis, pikes, javelins, maces, swords, ues and huge crags were all discharged by him upon them. Then the worlda became agitated and while Indrajita decimated the enemy battalions the quarters were enveloped in darkness. “Meanwhile the army of the Gods deserted Jayanta and, in

CHAPTER 28

The Duel between Indra and Ravana

THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI could be seen, neither bone nor hesd nor ftesh, for that mace, by overthrowing him on the battle field, hsd reduced him to dust. " Then the R.skshssu, beholding that Sumali hsd fallen in the fight, questioning esch other, all lied, routed by that Vasu who hsd overcome them.” CHAPTBR 28 “SBBING Sumali overthrown and reduced to dust by Vasu and beholding his army in Bight harassed by the Gods, the valiant son ofR.avana, whose voice

resembled the muttering of a thunder cloud, provoked, rallied the R.skshssu and, mounted on an excellent chariot that coursed wheresoere he willed, that grest warrior hurled himself on the Celestial Host. Like unto a fire that consumes the forests, he entered the field armed with every weapon, and when the Gods beheld him, a general stampede followed, none daring to face such a combatant. Then Shakra stayed all those fugitives by admonishing them thus : " ' Neither should you tremble nor flee, return and fight, O Ye Gods I Behold my son, who is invincible, entering the lists I ' “At that moment the son of Sbskra, the illustrious God Jayanta, mounted on his chariot, that was marvellously construc ted, turned towards the battlefield. Thereafter the Gods, surrounding the son of Sachi, turned baclt to fight R.avani and a well-matched contest ensued between Gods and R.skshasas. Then R.avani loosed his golden shafts on Gomukha, the son of Matsli, Jayauta’s charioteer, whilst Sachi’a son, in his turn, in wrath bsraased R.avani’s driver on every side. His eyes dilated with the fury that possessed him, the mighty R.mmi covered his opponents with darts and thereafter, in his ire, he let 1ly innumerable extremely sharp weapons on the Celestial Host and Shataghnis, pikes, javelins, maces, swords, ues and huge crags were all discharged by him upon them. Then the worlda became agitated and while Indrajita decimated the enemy battalions the quarters were enveloped in darkness. “Meanwhile the army of the Gods deserted Jayanta and, in 470 CODfbsion broke their ranks, being overwhelmed by the shafts of their rival. " *Rakshasas* and Gods could not distinguish each othet and the forces thrown into disotder on every side, fled in all directions. " The Gods struck the Gods and the *Rakshasas* the Rsbhasas, bewildered by the dstkness that enveloped them, whilst others ran away. At that instant, a warrior, full of valour, named Puloman, the foremost of the Daityas, seized Jayanta and bore

him away. Taking hold of his daughter’s son, he dived into the sea for he was his maternal grandfather and Sachi’s sire. " Learning of Jayanta’s disappearance, the Gods, cast down and discouraged, dispersed. Then Ravani, enraged, emitting loud cries, surrounded by his forces rushed on the Gods. “Not beholding his son and observing the ftight of the Gods, the Lotd of the Celeatials said to Matali :-' Bring me my chariot I ' and Matali harnessed the divine, powerful and huge car, bringing it in all haste to his master. Thereupon, above the chariot and before him, clouds, riven by lightning, driven by the tempest emitted formidable murterings and the Gandharvas struck up every kind of musical instrument while troops of Apsaras danced at the departure of the King of the Gods, and Rudras, Vasus, Adityas, the two Ashvins, as also the Hosts of the Maruts, armed with every kind of weapon, formed the escort of the Lotd of the Thirty, as he started out. “As Shakra advanced, a bitter wind blew, the sun ceased to shine and a great meteOr fell. At the same time, the courageous Dashagriva, burning with atdour, himself ascended the divine Pushpab Car constructed by Vishvakarm.a and harnessed to huge serpents, who, as it were causing the hair to stand on end, consumed everything with the wind of their breath. " Daityas and titans surrounded the celeatisl car that was rolling towatds the field of battle, advancing to meet Mahendra, and Dashagriva, having dismissed his son, took his place himself, whilst Ravani left the field and remained a tranquil witness. " Then the struggle was resumed between the *Rakshasas* and the Gods, who like unto clouds, caused a ahow= of tnissilea to fall in the fight. And the wicked **KUMBHAKARNA**, brandisbing weapons of every kind, came there, O King, unaware with whom 471 the con11ict was taking place ; using his teeth, his feet, his bands, lances, picks, mallets or anything whatsoever in order to asssil the Gods in his fury. Having attacked the formidable Rudras, it went ill

with that Ranger of the Night, who, in an instant, was riddled with wounds ; and the army of the *Rakshasas*, hatd pressed by the Gods, assisted by the Hosts of Maruts and armed with every weapon, were mmpletely routed and, in the struggle, some fell on the earth mutilated and palpitating, whilst others remained clinging to their mounts. Some titanS twined their arms round their chariots, elephants, donkeys, butralo, serpents, horses, porpoise and boars with heads of gohlins, where they lay motionless, whereupon the Gods pierced them with their shafts and thus they died. The sight of all those *Rakshasas* lying here and there in the sleep of death on that vast battlefield looked passing strange and, at the forefront of the battle, a river flowed, blood being its waters, weapons its crocodiles, in which vultures and crows abounded. " Meantime Dashagriva, seething with anger on seeing his army entirely overthrown by the Gods, hurled himself with one bound into that sea of warriors, slaying the Cclestials in the figltt and challenging Shakra himself. “Thereupon Shakra stretched his great bow that gave forth a thunderous noise and, when he drew it, the twanging of that weapon caused the quarters to resound. Then Iudra, bending that great bow, let filii his flaming arrows like unto fire or the Ravaua’s head and, on his side, that powerful titan mvered his rival with a hail of arrows loosed from his bow and both showered down missiles on every side so that nothing muld be distinguished and the whole firmament was enveloped in darkness.” CHAPTBB %9 Rtman; taJw r,.a,,. captiw " IN the darltueas that had supervened, the Gods and the Rak shasas engaged in a terrible struggle, slaying each other in the intozicatiuu of their strength and, in the obscurity that enveloped

CHAPTER 29

Ravani takes Indra captive

the con11ict was taking place ; using his teeth, his feet, his bands, lances, picks, mallets or anything whatsoever in order to asssil the Gods in his fury. Having attacked the formidable Rudras, it went ill with that Ranger of the Night, who, in an instant, was riddled with wounds ; and the army of the *Rakshasas*, hatd pressed by the Gods, assisted by the Hosts of Maruts and armed with every weapon, were mmpletely routed and, in the struggle, some fell on the earth mutilated and palpitating, whilst others remained clinging to their mounts. Some titanS twined their arms round their chariots, elephants, donkeys, butralo, serpents, horses, porpoise and boars with heads of gohlins, where they lay motionless, whereupon the Gods pierced them with their shafts and thus they died. The sight of all those *Rakshasas* lying here and there in the sleep of death on that vast battlefield looked passing strange and, at the forefront of the battle, a river flowed, blood being its waters, weapons its crocodiles, in which vultures and crows abounded. " Meantime Dashagriva, seething with anger on seeing his army entirely overthrown by the Gods, hurled himself with one bound into that sea of warriors, slaying the Cclestials in the figltt and challenging Shakra himself. “Thereupon Shakra stretched his great bow that gave forth a thunderous noise and, when he drew it, the twanging of that weapon caused the quarters to resound. Then Iudra, bending that great bow, let filii his flaming arrows like unto fire or the Ravaua’s head and, on his side, that powerful titan mvered his rival with a hail of arrows loosed from his bow and both showered down missiles on every side so that nothing muld be distinguished and the whole firmament was enveloped in

darkness.” CHAPTBB %9 Rtman; taJw r,.a,,. captiw " IN the darltueas that had supervened, the Gods and the Rak shasas engaged in a terrible struggle, slaying each other in the intozicatiuu of their strength and, in the obscurity that enveloped UTT ARA *KANDA* them like a great veil, the supremely intrepid IDdra, **RAVANA** and Megbanada alone were not deluded. " Beholding tbat army wholly annihilated, **RAVANA** was suddenly seized with violent rage and emitted a great roar. In his fury tbat invincible warrior addtessed his driver, who stOOd near with the chariot, saying, ' Take me through the enemy ranks from one end to the other ! This very day, with mine innumerable and powerful wespons, all the Gods in my path will be despatched by me to the region of **YAMA**. I myself shall slay **INDRA**, Dbanada, Varona, **YAMA** and all the Gods and shall soon strike them down and trample them under my feet. Do not delay, drive the car on speedily, and again I say to thee, " Drive through the enemy ranks from end to end ! We are now in the Nandan Gardens therefore take me to the Udaya Mountain “At this command, the cbarioteer dtove his steeds, who were as swift as thought, through the enemy ranks. " Divining **RAVANA**’s intention, Shakra, standing in his cbariot on the battlefield, addtessed the Gods, whose sovereign he was, saying: '" O Ye Gods, hear me, this is what I consider expedient Dashagriva should without delay be captured alive. That extremely powerful Rabhasa will enter our ranks in his cbariot with the speed of the wind, like unto an ocean whose waves are overftowing on the day of higb tide. He may not be slain for a special boon protects him but seek to make him captive in the struggle I It was by taking Bali prisoner tbat I was able to enjoy the Three Worlda; for this reason let us do the same to this wicked wretch.. " Thus speaking, Shakra left **RAVANA** and went to another part of the field, sowing terror among the *Rakshasas* whom he assailed, O Great King. " While the indefatigable Dashagriva went to the

left, Shatakratu penetrated the right wing of his adversary's forces. Having advanced a hundred leagues, the King of the *Rakshasas* covered the entire Host of the Goda with a shower of arrows. " Seeing the carnage tbat waa being created in his army, the intrepid Shakra atayed Dashanana by encircling him, whereupon 473 the Danavu and Rabhasas beholding **RAVANA** overcome by Shakra, cried out ' Alas I We are lost I ' " Slllnding in his chariot, RaVIIIi, who was ttanspotted with rF. penetrated into the ranks of the redoubtable Celestial Host and routed the army by resotting to the power of illusion that had been eonferred on him by Pashupati. Then, leaving the Gods aside, he rushed on Shakra himself, and the highly energetic Mahendra did not observe the son of his adversary. The Gods, however, whose strength was immeasurable, severed Ravani's armour, even wounding him, but he remained unper turbed and with his excellent shafts pierced Matali who was advancing towards him, covering Mahendra afresh with a hail of missiles. " Thereupon Shakra descended from his chariot dismissing his charioteer, and mounting Airavata, he pursued RaVIIIi, who had made himself invisible through his magic power, but he, springing into the sky, assailed him with arrows. Seeing that **INDRA** was exhausted, Ravani bound him by his magic and led him to the side where his own army was. Beholding Mahendra borne away by force from the fight, all the Celestials enquired ' What has taken place ? One cannot discern the magician who has ttiumphed over Shakra, that victorious warrior, who, by the aid of magic, has carried **INDRA** away despite his skill.' Then all the divisions of the Gods, in their wrath, overwhelmed **RAVANA** with a hail of shafts and forced him to retreat, whilst he, worn out in the encounter with the Adityas and the Vasus was unable to continue the fight. " Beholding his sire hatassed and asssiled with sbafta in the encounter, RaVIIIi, remaining invisible in the struggle, said to him: " '

Come, O Dear Father, let us give up the light, know that victory has been obtained, therefore abandon thy feverish activity! The King of the Gods and of the Three Worlds has been taken captive I The Gods have seen the pride, which inspired their forces, humbled. Enjoy the Three Worlds at thy pleasure, having overcome the foe by thy valour, why fatigue thyself further with combat ? ' " Hearing Ravani's words, the battalions of the Gods and the Immortals deprived of Shakra, who had led them, pvc up the 474 fight. And the all-powerful enemy of the Gods, the illustrious Sovereign of the Rskshasas, thus entreated to ceaae from further fighting by his son, whose dear voice he recognized, answered him with deference, sayiog : " ' Thy valour is equal to the greatest ofheroes, thou iu whom my family and race find their iucrcase, O Prince, since this day thou hast overcome the one whose strength is immeasurable, he, the Sovereign of the Gods. Ascend Vasava's chariot and pro ceed towards the city with thiue army as an escort ; I, on my side, with my companions, will follow joyfully with all speed.' " On this the valiant Ravani, surrounded by his forces with the Chief of the Gods iu chaius, set out towards his abode, thereafter dismissiug the *Rakshasas* who had fought iu the campaign."

CHAPTER 30

Telling of the Curse pronounced by the Sage Gautama on Shakra

" **W**HEN the all-powerful Mahendra had been overcome by the son of Rsvana, the Gods with Prajapati at their head went to Lanka and, approachiug Dashagriva, who was surrounded by his brothers, Prajapati, from the sky where he was stationed, addressed him iu conciliatory

tones, saying : " ' My Dear Rsvana, I am pleased with thy son's beariug on the battlefield I Assuredly iu valour and heroism, he ia thiue equal if not thy superior I Thou hast overcome the Three Worlds by thy prowess and fu)fi))ed thy vow; I am gratified with thee and thy son. He, standiug there full of strength and energy, will become renowned iu the worlds under the name of " Thereupon the all-powerfill Prajapati replied to Megbanada, saying: " ' There is none immortal on earth, whether it be beast, bird or any othet mighty being.' " Hearing this irtevocable decree of the Grandsire, the Lord. **INDRA**'s vanquisher, the courageous Megbanada, said to him : " ' Then heat me , and may it come to pass in this wise on the release of Shatakratu ! This is my desire, I, who constantly worship Pavaka with oblations and mantras and who delight in fighting and overcoming my foes, let the chariot of Vibhabasu harnessed to steeds, be plaeed at my service and may death be unable to strike me down when I am mounted upon it I This is my request, but, should I engage in combat without having completed my prayers and offered my oblations to the God of Fire, then may I perisb ! All, O Lord. seek immortality by means of penances ; I wish to acquire immortality through valour I ' " ' Let it be so ' said the Blessed Grandsire and thereafter Sbakra was set free by lndrajita and the Gods returned to their own abode. " Meantime, O **RAMA**, the Wtetched **INDRA**, his glory dimmed, his heatt full of anxiety, was plunged in melancholy and, beholding him in that plight, the Grandsire enquired of him, saying : " ' O Shatakratu, didst thou not formerly commit some gteat sin ? O Chief of the Gods, O Lord, when in my wisdom I created men, they were all possessed of the same colour, shape, language and appeatance, there was no difference between them in form or aspect, nevertheless my mind was pre-occupied when I re1lected on those beings and, I created a woman u distinct from them, modifying each of the male characterisdca.

Thus I made a female, who on occount of the grace of her limbs became lmown u Ahalya ; " Hala " meaning ugly, from which " Halya " is derived, and she in whom " Halya " does nor appeat is named Ahalya; this was the name I called her. When I fashioned that woman, O Chief of the Gods, O Bull among the Cclestiala, I re1lected, " To whom shall she belong ? " This is how, O Lord Shakra, O Destroyer of Qties, thou didst come to know this woman and, in thine heatt, being the Lord of the Worlds, thou didst resolve " she shall be mine ".' " ' Meantime I plaeed her under the prorectioA of the 476 magnanimous Gautama and he, having taken care of her for many yean, gave her back to me, whereupon I, having tested the absolute self-control of that illustrious ascetic and recognizing the height of his austerity, gave her ro him in wedlock. That virtuous and renowned *Muni* was gratified with her company but the Gods were in despair because she bad been given ro Gautama and thou, enraged, thy heart filled with desire, went ro the hermitage of the Sage and beheld the woman who was as radiant as a Oame in a brazier, whereupon thou didst ravish her in the heat of thy passion. Thereafter thou wert obaerved by that high-born *Rishi* in the hermitage and, in his indignation, that extremely powerful ascetic cursed thee, due ro which, O King of the Gods, thou bast just suffered this change of circum stance. And that ascetic addressed thee, saying : " ' " Since thou hast wantonly ravished my spouse, O Vasava, thou shalt fall captive ro thine enemy on the field of battle I This vile passion that thou hast manifested, O Perverse Wretch, will undoubtedly spread among men and women and whosoever shall be guilty of it shall bear half the responsibility, whilst the other half shall be thine ; nor shall thy state be permanent, for the sovereignty of whoever the Gods choose as their King shall not endure ; this is the curse I pronounce on thee I " " ' Thus spoke Gautama and thereafter he reproached his spouse, and that exalted ascetic addtcssed

her, saying : " ' " O Shameless One, leave my hermitage ! Though young and lovely, since thou art inconstant, thy beauty shall no longer belong to thee alone in the world and shall assuredly be shared by all beings, since on thine account, this mischief bas been perpetrated by **INDRA** ! From now on, all beings shall partake of thy beauty I " " ' Then Ahalya sought ro propitiate the great Risbi Gautama, saying: .. ' " It was in ignorance that I suffered myself ro be seduced by **INDRA**, O Grest Ascetic, for he assumed thy fornt, nor was it by giving way ro desire, O *Rishi*, therefore forgive me, it is thy duty!" " 'At these words of Ahalya's, **GAUTAMA** *answered*: " ' " In the House of lbhvaku there will be born a mighty warrior named **RAMA**, renowned in the universe and he will 477 repair to the forest for the sake of the *brahmins*. That long armed hero will be none other than **VISHNU** in human form ; thou shalt behold him, O Blessed One, and, seeing him, thon shalt be purified, for it is he who can efface the sin thou hast committed. Having offered him the traditional hospitality, thou shalt return to me once again and we shall resume our common life, O Lady of fair countenance ! " " ' Having spoken thus, the *Rishi* re-entered his hermitage, while his consort gave herself up to rigid penances. It is on account of this Sage's curse that all this has taken place ; there fore, O Mighty Hero, call to mind the sin thou didst commit. This is why thou didst fall a victim to thy foes, O Vasava, and for no other cause, therefore, with thy senses fully controlled, speedily offer up a sacrifice to **VISHNU**. Purified by this pro pitiatoty rite, thou shalt return to the Celestial Region. Tby son, O Lord, did not perish in the fight but was borne away to the ocean by his maternal grandfather.' " Hearing Bralnna's words, Mahendra undertook a sacrifice in honour of **VISHNU** and thereafter the Lord of the Gods ascended to heaven, reigning there as king. " I have described to thee, how great was the power of Indrajita, who overcame the King of the

Gods, how much more therefore was he able to triumph over other beings ! " Hearing these words of Agastya, **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** as also the monkeys and titans, exclaimed " How wonderful! " and Bibishana, who stood at **RAMA**'s side, said : " I remember that remarkable feat now, I was formerly witness thereof., Then **RAMA** addressed Agastya saying :-"AU thou hast said is true 1" " This, O **RAMA**, is the narrative of the origin and progress of **RAVANA**, the thorn in the side of the worlds, who, like his son, bore away Shakra, the King of the Gods, in the fight." CHAPTER 3 Rtmana goes to the Banks of the Narmada Riwr Tall all-powerful **RAMA**, in his astonishment, bowed low to that excllent *Rishi* Agastya and again enquired of him, saying : " O Blessed One, O Best of the Twice-born, when that cruel *Rakshasa* began to range the earth, were the worlds bereft of warriors ? Was there no prince, no being, able to oppose him, since that Lord of the Titans mer with no resistance, or had the rulers of the worlds lost their power or were the many kings he overcame, without weapons ? " Having listened to the words of that son of Raghu, the blessed Sage answered him smiling, as the Gtandsire of the World addresses Rudra, and said : " It was destroying the rulers thus that **RAVANA** ranged the earth and, O **RAMA**, Lord of the Worlds, he came to the city of Mahishmati which rivalled that of the Gods, where the Deity of Fire dwelt perpctuslly. There a monarch reigned, named Arjuna, in effulgence like unto the fire which was kept there ever concealed in a pit covered by reeds.' " On that day, the powerful Sovereign of the Haihayas, Lord Arjuna went to the River Narmada to sport with his wives and at that time, **RAVANA** approached Mahishmati and that Indn among the *Rakshasas* enquired of the King's counsellors, saying: " Tell me quicldy, where is the Lord Arjuna, speak truly; I am **RAVANA** who have come to measure my strength with that most powerful of monarchs. Do you announce mine

arrival to him!' " Hearing **RAVANA**'s words, the sagacious ministers informed the King of the *Rakshasas* of the absence of their sovereign and the son of Vishravas learning from the people of the city that Arjuna had departed, went away in the direetion of the Vindhya RaDgc, which like unto a cloud floating in space, appeared to him to resemble Himavat and, springing ftom. the earth, it

CHAPTER 31

Ravana goes to the Banks of the Narmada River

Rtmana goes to the Banks of the Narmada Riwr Tall all-powerful **RAMA**, in his astonishment, bowed low to that excllent *Rishi* Agastya and again enquired of him, saying : " O Blessed One, O Best of the Twice-born, when that cruel *Rakshasa* began to range the earth, were the worlds bereft of warriors ? Was there no prince, no being, able to oppose him, since that Lord of the Titans mer with no resistance, or had the rulers of the worlds lost their power or were the many kings he overcame, without weapons ? " Having listened to the words of that son of Raghu, the blessed Sage answered him smiling, as the Gtandsire of the World addresses Rudra, and said : " It was destroying the rulers thus that **RAVANA** ranged the earth and, O **RAMA**, Lord of the Worlds, he came to the city of Mahishmati which rivalled that of the Gods, where the Deity of Fire dwelt perpctuslly. There a monarch reigned, named Arjuna, in effulgence like unto the fire which was kept there ever concealed in a pit covered by reeds.' " On that day, the powerful Sovereign of the Haihayas, Lord Arjuna went to the River Narmada to sport with his wives and at that time, **RAVANA** approached Mahishmati and that Indn among the *Rakshasas* enquired of the King's counsellors,

saying: " Tell me quicldy, where is the Lord Arjuna, speak truly; I am **RAVANA** who have come to measure my strength with that most powerful of monarchs. Do you announce mine arrival to him!' " Hearing **RAVANA**'s words, the sagacious ministers informed the King of the *Rakshasas* of the absence of their sovereign and the son of Vishravas learning from the people of the city that Arjuna had departed, went away in the direetion of the Vindhya RaDgc, which like unto a cloud floating in space, appeared to him to resemble Himavat and, springing ftom. the earth, it seemed to lick the skies and was possessed of a myriad peaks. Lions frequented its caverns whilst its crystalline cataracts, faDing over the cliffs, resounded like peals oflaughter, and Gods, Gandharvas as alao the Apsaras and Kinneras with their consorts, disporting themselves there, transformed it into a paradise. Its rivers 8owed in translucent waves and that Vindhya Range, like unto Himavat, with its peaks and caves resembled Shesha with his hoods, his tongues darting forth. "Gazing upon it, **RAVANA** reached the Narmada River, whose pure waters flowed over a bed of stOnes and which emptied itself into the western sea. Bu11'alo, Srimaras, lions, tigers, bears and elephants, tormented by hest and thirst, agitated the waters, whilst Cbakravabs, Kavandas, Hsmsas, Sarasas and other waterfuwl, with their impassioned warbling, abounded there. The flowering formed its diadem, the psirs of Cbakravab birds its breasts, the banks of sand its thighs, the flocks of swans its bright girdle ; the pollen of the flowers powdered its limbs, the foam of the waves was its immaculate robe ; sweet was its contact fur whoever entered it and it was lovely to look upon with its flowering lotuses. " Dismounting from the a.ariot Puahpaka, close to the Narmada, that most beautiful of streams, Dashanans, a bull among titans, accompanied by his ministers, went towards it as towards a lovely and attractive woman and seated himaelf on the enchanting sandy banks that

were frequented by Sages. " Beholding the Narmada, the ten-necked Ravans, transported with delight, exclaimed ' It is the Ganges herself! ' Thereafter he addressed his ministers Shuts and Sarana and others, saying: " ' **SURYA** of a thousand rays seems to have changed the world to gold and, in the sty, that orb of the day whose beams were just now intense, having observed me seated here, has grown as cool as the moon. Anila, who, refreshed by the waters of the Narmada, inspired by fear of me, blowa softly diftbsing a sweet pertiune, that marvellous stream, the Narmada, increaser of felicity, in whose waters crocodile, fiah and birds abound, appears like a timid girl. You who were wounded by the weapons of kings equal tn Shakra in combat and who were covered with blood like untn the aap of the Sandal Tree, now plunge intn the 4lo beautiful and hospitable Narmada as elephants inmicated with ichor and led by Sarvabbauma immerse themselves in the Ganges. Bathing in that great river will free you from all ills ! As for me, I shall presently oft'er up ftowers in tranquillity to Kapardin on this sandy bank that shines like the autumn moon.' " HeariDg these words of **RAVANA**, Prahasta, Shuka and Sarana with Mahodara and Dhumraksba dived into the Narmada River and, agitated by those titan lesders resembling elephants, the stream appeared like unto the Ganges when Vamana, Anjana, Padma and other great tuskers disport themselves therein. " Thereafter, emerging from the waten, those highly powerful Raksbasaa soon gathered heaps of ftowers that they placed on the sandy bank, whose enchanting radiance rivalled that of a dazzling cloud and, in a moment, those titans had heaped up a mountain of flowers, whereupon the King of the *Rakshasas* entered the river to bathe, like unto a great tusker entering the Ganges. " Having bathed and recited the most excellent of prayers according to tradition, **RAVANA** emerged from the waters and divested himself of his wet garments, clothing himself in a white robe.

Then the Raksbasaa followed their king, who advanced with joined palms, so that they appeared like moving hills. Wherever the Lord of the Raksbasaa went, a golden **SHIVA**-Linga was borne before him and he placed it on a sandy altar and worshipped it with flowers, perfumes and sandal paste. Having paid homage to that symbol that delivers all beings from their sufferings and which was large and exceedingly beautiful, adorned with a crescent moon, that Ranger of the Night, with uplifted arms, danced and sang before it." CHAPTBII 32 " NOT tar from where the dresd Lord of the Raksbasaa was making his o1l'ering offtowers on the sandy banks of the Narmada, Arjuna, the foremost of amquerors, supreme sovereign of Mahishmati, was sporting with his wives in the waters of that

CHAPTER 32

Arjuna captures Ravana

beautiful and hospitable Narmada as elephants inmicated with ichor and led by Sarvabbauma immerse themselves in the Ganges. Bathing in that great river will free you from all ills ! As for me, I shall presently oft'er up ftowers in tranquillity to Kapardin on this sandy bank that shines like the autumn moon.' " HeariDg these words of **RAVANA**, Prahasta, Shuka and Sarana with Mahodara and Dhumraksba dived into the Narmada River and, agitated by those titan lesders resembling elephants, the stream appeared like unto the Ganges when Vamana, Anjana, Padma and other great tuskers disport themselves therein. " Thereafter, emerging from the waten, those highly powerful Raksbasaa soon gathered heaps of ftowers that they placed on the sandy bank, whose enchanting radiance rivalled that of a dazzling cloud and, in a

moment, those titans had heaped up a mountain of flowers, whereupon the King of the *Rakshasas* entered the river to bathe, like unto a great tusker entering the Ganges. " Having bathed and recited the most excellent of prayers according to tradition, **RAVANA** emerged from the waters and divested himself of his wet garments, clothing himself in a white robe. Then the Raksbasaa followed their king, who advanced with joined palms, so that they appeared like moving hills. Wherever the Lord of the Raksbasaa went, a golden **SHIVA-**Linga was borne before him and he placed it on a sandy altar and worshipped it with flowers, perfumes and sandal paste. Having paid homage to that symbol that delivers all beings from their sufferings and which was large and exceedingly beautiful, adorned with a crescent moon, that Ranger of the Night, with uplifted arms, danced and sang before it." CHAPTBII 32 " NOT tar from where the dresd Lord of the Raksbasaa was making his o1l'ering offtowers on the sandy banks of the Narmada, Arjuna, the foremost of amquerors, supreme sovereign of Mahishmati, was sporting with his wives in the waters of that THI! river. In their midst, that moaarch looked lite a great tusker surrounded by innumerable female elephants. Then he, desiring to measure the great strength of his thoussnd arms, stayed the rapid oourse of the Narmsda and, the watets thus arrested by the myrisd arms of Kartavirya, fiowed towards its source bearing away its banks. With its fishes, croeodiles and sharks, its carpet of flowers and Kusha Grass, the current of the Narmsda grew turbulent, as in the rainy season, and, as if purposely released by Kartavirya, that flood bore away all **RAVANA**'s floral offerings, whereupon he, leaving the sacrifice only half performed, cast his glance on the river that appeared to him to resemble a cherished oonsort who is overwrought. " Having surveyed the rising like waves in the sea, rushing from the west to overwhelm the eastern shore, **RAVANA** observed that,

in a little while, the birds no longer shunned it and it had returned to its natural state, lite a woman who is paeified. " Pointing with the finger of his right hand, Dashagriva signalled to Shub and Sarana that they should seek out the cause of the rising current and, at this command from their king, the two brothers, Shub and Sarana rose into the air and turned westward. Having traversed two miles, those Night rangers observed a man in the river sporting with some women and he resembled a huge Sala Tree, his hair floating in the stream and the oorners of his eyes were in1lamed by the desire which agitated his heart. And that Soourge of his Foes blocked the river with his myriad arms, as a mountain the earth with its oountless slopes and foot-hills, and innumerable fair women surrounded him, as a tusker in rut is encircled by female elephants. " Beholding that prodigious sight, the two *Rakshasas*, Shub and Sarana returned tOgether to **RAVANA** and said to him : " O Prince of the *Rakshasas*, an unknown person, lite unto an enormous Sala Tree, in order to amuse his consorts, is staying the course of the Narmsda lite a dyke. Restrained by his myriad arms, the river is throwing up great waves lite unto the sea I' " Hearing these words from Shub and Sarana, **RAVANA** aald, It is Arjuna' and rushed away, eager to entet into combat with him. And, as **RAVANA**, the Lord of the *Rakshasas*, set forth to 482 meet Arjuna, a fierce dust storm arose accompanied by muttering clouds raining drops of blood aod that **INDRA** among the Rak shasas, escorted by Mahodara, Mahaparshwa, Dhumraksha, Shuka aod Saraoa, proceeded in the direction where Arjuna was. Soon that mighty *Rakshasa*, of the hue of aotimony, reached the waters of the Narmada aod there, surrounded by his wives, as a tusker by female elephants, the foremost of monarchs, Arjuna appeared before him. Then the Lord of the *Rakshasas*, who was intoxicated with power, his eyes red with anger, said to Arjuna's ministers in stentorian tones : " ' O Counsellors of the

Lord Haihaya, inform him speedily that he who is called Ravaoa has come to fight with him I ' “When they heard these words ofRavaoa, Arjuna’s ministers raised their weapons aod answered him saying : " ' O Ravaoa, thou hast indeed chosen ao excellent moment for combat I Wouldst thou fight a prince who is drunk and who is, further, amidst his consorts? Dost thou really desire to fight with our king whilst he is surrounded by his wives ? Possess thyself in patience to-day, O Dashagriva, aod when the night is over, if thou still wishest to do so, then challenge Arjuna, O Dear Friend. If, however, thou art bent on combat, O Thou sated with war, then overcome us here aod thereafter meet Arjuna aod fight with him.' " Then Ravaoa’s ministers slew some of Arjuna’s counsellors aod devoured them avidly, and a great uproar arose on the hanks of the Narmada, from the followers of Arjuna and Ravaoa’s ministers. The soldiers of the King of the Haihayas assailed Ravaoa aod his miniSters, on whom they hurled themselves with appalling fury with artows, dsrts, javelins aod tridents that pierced like lightning, aod they created a tumult like unto the sea with its crocodiles, fish and sharks. " Meanwhile the ministers of Ravaoa, Prahasta, Shuka and Saraoa, enraged aod full of valour, decimated the army of Kartavirya, aod Arjuna’s followers, mad with terror, informed him of the attack by Ravaoa and his ministers. " On these tidings, Arjuns addressed the concourse of women, aaying :-'Have no fear ', and rushed out of the water, like another Pavaka emitting terrible llames, so that he resembled the Fire of Dissolutioll at the end of the World Period. Adomed 483 with bracelets of refined gold, he at once seized hold of a mace and hurled himself on the *Rakshasas*, whom he dispersed as the sun the darkness. With his arms, Arjuna, having brandished the huge mace, let it fiill with the force of **GARUDA**’s ftight. " Then Prahasta, unshakeable, like unto a hill, mace in hand, stood barring his path, like

unto the Vindhya Range obstructing the sun, and he hurled that dreadfill weapon bound with copper, emitting a great shout like unto Antab. At the tip of the pike, loosed by Prahasta's hand, a brilliant 1lame appeared like the point of an Ashoka Tree that seemed to glow, but the son of Kritavirya, Arjuna, without being perturbed, skilfully deflected that mace that was fiilling upon him, with his own weapon. Then the supretne Lord of the Haihayas hurled himself on his adversary with his heavy weapon which he brandished in his five hundred arms. " Struck by that powerful blow of the mace, Prahasta, who had confronted him, fell like a mountain that has been riven by **INDRA**'s thunderbolt. " Seeing Prahasta lying there, Maricha, Shuka and Satana, as also Mahodara and Dhumraksha lied from the battlefield. " His ministers routed and Prahasta struck down, **RAVANA** threw himself on Arjuna, the foretnost of monatcha, and a formidable duel ensued between that king of a myriad arms and the twenty-armed **RAVANA** causing the hair to stand on end. Like unto two oceans that overftow, two mountains shaken to their foundations, two llaming suns, two blazing fires, two elephants intoxicated with their own strength, two bulls fighting for a heifer, two muttering clouds, two lions proud of their strength, like unto Rudra and Kala enraged, so did the Rakahasa and the King Arjuna, armed with maces, assail each other with fearful blows. Resembling mountains, able to withatand the dreadfilllightning strokes, so did man and Rakahasa endure the blows of the mace. As the noise of thunder creates reverbera tions, so the impact of those weapons resounded in every quartet. Arjuna's mace, fiilling on his opponent's breast, lent it the appearance of gold or a cloud illumined by lightning. In the same way, each time **RAVANA**'s mace fell on Arjuna's breast, it resembled a meteor fiilling on a high mountain. Neither Arjuna nor the Sovereign of the *Rakshasas* wearied in the strugJe. 48.4 UTTAR.A ltANDA which remained

undecided as formerly the duel between Bali and **INDRA**. AB two bulls struggle with their horus or two elepbants with their sharp tusks, so did those most valiant of men and R.akshasas fight. Finaiiy Arjuna, in fury, with an his strength struck the huge chest of R.avana with his mace, but, protected by the armour bestowed ou him by Brahms as a boon, that weapon was rendered impotent and fell cloven on the earth. Under the blow dealt by Arjuna, however, R.avana fell back a bow's length and sank down groaning. "Perceiving him to be overcome, Arjuna immediately rushed on Dashagriva and seized hold of him as **GARUDA** did a serpent. With his myriad arms, that mighty king took hold of Dashanana and bound him as Narayana had bound Bali. " R.avana, having beeu made captive, an the Siddhas, Char anas and Devatas cried out, ' Wen done I wen done I ' and showered flowers on Arjuna's head. AB a tiger who has captured a gazene or a lion an elepbant, so did the King of the Haihayas emit loud roars like unto a cloud. " Thereafter the night-ranger, Prahasta, having recovered consciousness, seeing Dasbanana bound, rushed on Arjuna in fury and the forces of the R.akshasas assailed him with extreme violence as, at the end of the hot season, the rain-clouds break over the ocean. " ' Release him I Release him I ' they cried unceasingly, attacking Arjuna with iron ban and spears but, entirely unmoved by the hail of weapons, ere they could reach him, the intrepid King of the Haihayas, Scourge of his Foes, speedily took hold of those projectiles hurled at him by the enemies of the Gods, and by means of many a dreadful and irresistible missile, he put them to flight as the wind disperses the clouds. " Having scattered the R.akshasas, Arjuna, the son of Krita virya, surrounded by his friends, besring R.avana, bound, returned to his city. Then the Twice-born and the people scattered flowers and rice upon him, as he made his entry into the capital, resembling the God of a Thousand Byes when he captured

Bali.”

CHAPTER 33

Arjuna releases Ravana at the request of Poulastya

“HlwuNG from the Gods in heaven of **RAVANA**’s capture, which resembled the binding of the wind, Poulastya, despite his self mastery, was moved by tender a1fection for his offspring and approached the Lord of Mshishmati. Entering the path of the wind, whom he equalled in velocity, that Twice-born One, with the swiftness of thought, reached the City of Mshishmati and, as Brahms enters **INDRA**’s capital, he penetrated into that city that resembled Amaravati and was full of prosperous and cheerful people. " Walking on foot, he advanced like unto the sun with such effulgence that the eye could scarcely rest upon him and, beholding him, the inhabitants hsstened to inform Arjuna. " ' It is Poulastya ', said that Sovereign of the Haihsyas on perceiving him, whereupon, with joined palms, he touched his forehead in salutation as he went forward to meet the ascetic. Like Brihsspati before Shakra so did the Purohita precede the king, bearing the Arghya and also the Madhuparka offerings. " Thereafter the *Rishi* drew near like unto the rising aun, and Arjuna, deeply moved on beholding him, paid obeisance to him as **INDRA** offers reverence to Brahms. Presenting him with the Madhuparka, a cow, and water wherewith to wash his feet, as also the Arghya, that **INDRA** among Monarchs addressed Poulas tya in a voice trembling with delight and said : " ' Since I behold thee, O Thou whose sight is hsrd to obtain, to-day Mahishmati has become the equal of Amaravati, O Foremost of the Twice-born I To-day I am hsppy, O Lord, to-day, my desires are consummated; to-day my birth is rendered

fruitful; to-day, my penance hss been blessed since I now embrace thy two feet that are worshipped by the Celestial Host. Here is my kingdom and here my sons and my consorts at thy service ; whst are thy commands ? ' " Then Poulastya, hsving enquired concerning his welfare, the discharge ofhis duty and the sacrificial fires and his offspring, said to the Sovereign of the Haihsyas : 486 " ' O Foremost of Kings, whoae eyes are as large as lotus petsls, whose face shines like the full moon, none is equal to thee in strength since thou hast conquered Dasbagriva, he, before whom, the ocean and the wind are stayed and remain motionless in fear, he, my grandson whom thou didst mske captive on the battlefield, who till now was invincible. Thou hast swsllowed his glory and reodered thy nsme illustrious. O Dear Friend, on my request, now release Dsshanana ! ' " Thereupon Arjuna, without uttering a word, having listened to Poulastya's appeal, cheerfully released the foremoat of the Rabhasas and, having set that enemy of the Gods free, Arjuna honoured him with jewels, garlanda and celestial raiment and contracted an allisnce with him in the presence of fire, then. prostrating himself at the feet of **BRAHMA**'s son, he returned to his abode. " Thereafter Poulastya himself dismissed the powerful Lord of the *Rakshasas* after embracing him and he, having received hospitality, departed, ashamed at his defeat, whilst Poulastya, the son of that Grandsire of the World, he the foremost of *Munis*, who had just delivered Dasbagriva, returned to **BRAHMA**-loka. " Thus, despite his immense strength, was **RAVANA**, who bad been defeated by Kartavirya, released at Poulastya's request. So are the mighty overcome by those who are still mightier than they, O Thou, who increaseth the felicity of the Raghavas! He who desires his own happiness should not despise his adversaries. " Meanwhile the Lord of those eaters of llesh, having con tracted a friendship with that thousand-armed monarch, began to range the earth full of arrogance,

overcoming its rulers.” CHAPTBR 34 Bali lurlw .Rat1ana hU Gird/8

CHAPTER 34

Bali hangs Ravana on his Girdle

" ' **O** Foremost of Kings, whoae eyes are as large as lotus petsls, whose face shines like the full moon, none is equal to thee in strength since thou hast conquered Dasbagriva, he, before whom, the ocean and the wind are stayed and remain motionless in fear, he, my grandson whom thou didst mske captive on the battlefield, who till now was invincible. Thou hast swsllowed his glory and reodered thy nsme illustrious. O Dear Friend, on my request, now release Dsshanana ! ' " Thereupon Arjuna, without uttering a word, having listened to Poulastya’s appeal, cheerfully released the foremoat of the Rabhasas and, having set that enemy of the Gods free, Arjuna honoured him with jewels, garlanda and celestial raiment and contracted an allisnce with him in the presence of fire, then. prostrating himself at the feet of **BRAHMA**’s son, he returned to his abode. " Thereafter Poulastya himself dismissed the powerful Lord of the *Rakshasas* after embracing him and he, having received hospitality, departed, ashamed at his defeat, whilst Poulastya, the son of that Grandsire of the World, he the foremost of *Munis*, who had just delivered Dasbagriva, returned to **BRAHMA**-loka. " Thus, despite his immense strength, was **RAVANA**, who bad been defeated by Kartavirya, released at Poulastya’s request. So are the mighty overcome by those who are still mightier than they, O Thou, who increaseth the felicity of the Raghavas! He who desires his own happiness should not despise his adversaries. " Meanwhile the Lord of those eaters of llesh, having con tracted a friendship with that thousand-armed monarch, began to range

the earth full of arrogance, overcoming its rulers.” CHAPTBR 34 Bali lurlw .Rat1ana hU Gird/8 in his arrogance he sought him out in order to provoke him to combat. " One day he came to the dty of Kishkindha and cballenged King Bali of the golden diadem. There he round the kinsfbllt of that monkey only, Tara, her father Suaheoa and the Lord **SUGRIVA**, who answered that belligerent one, who had just come, saying: " O King of the RakBbasas, Bali, who would have accepted thy cballenge, is not here, what other Plavamgama is able to meet thee in combat ? Bali has gone to the fuur oceans to per fOrm the Sandhya Ceremony, O **RAVANA**, he will soon return, have patience awhile ! That heap of bones, white as conch shells, belongs to those who desired to measure their strength in combat with the Lord of the *Vanaras*, O Prince. Even hadst thou sucked the nectar of immortality, O **RAVANA**, thy meeting with Bali would put an end to thine existence. O Son of Vish ravas, look upon this marvellous universe once more fur soon it will no longer be possible fur thee to do so. Since thou art in haste to die, however, go to the southern sea where thou wilt behold Bali who resembles the Deity of Fire.' " Thereupon, having inveighed agsinst Tara and the others, **RAVANA**, that **RAVANA** of the Worlds,' remounted his Chariot Pushpaka and drove towards the southern sea. There he beheld Bali, like unto a mountain of gold, absorbed in the perfOrmance ofSandhya. " Descending from the Pushpaka Car, **RAVANA** of the hue of collyrium, stole upon Bali silently in order to seize him, but by chance, he was observed by him who had no doubts as to his fell design, though Bali remained unmoved like a lion in the presence of a hare or **GARUDA** before a serpent, and he was in no wise perturbed by **RAVANA** of malevolent intent. " He rdlected, ' This is **RAVANA**, who with malice in hia soul, approaches in order to seize hold of me. I ahaU hang him on my girdle and go to the three other oceans, then all will behold mine

adversary, Dashagriva, hia arms and limbs and hia raiment daugling, hooked to my side like a anakc caught by **GARUDA**.' " Thinking thus, Bali remained there reciting hia Vedic Mantras in a low voice, like unto the King of the Mountains. ... UTT ARA *KANDA* Bach desiring to lay hold on the other, in the pride their strength inspired in them, the Sovereign of the Monkeys and the Lord of the Rskshasas sought to realise their design. " Perceiving by the sound of his footsteps thst **RAVANA** was about to place bis hands upon him, Bali, though his back was turned, caught hold of the titan as **GARUDA** a serpent and, having seized the Lord of the Rskahaass, hooked him to bis girdle, thereupon that monkey, with one bound, sprang into the air, and though la=ated and tom by his nails, Bali carried off **RAVANA** as a tempest propels a cloud. " Meantime the ministers ofDashanana, whom he was bearing away, fell upon Bali emitting loud cries in order to make him release him. Pursued by them, Bali, in his aerial course, shone like the sun that is followed by a drift of clouds in space. Those foremost of the Rskahasas, cxhausted by the wind thst caused their arms and thighs to shake, were stayed in their course, and the mountains themselves made way for Bali, bow much more those who, made of 1lesh and blood, sought to survive. With a speed impossible to flocks of birds, thst lndra among monkeys, in great haste, paid obeisance to all the oceans in turn and, at dusk, received the homage of all winged creatures on the way, he, the foremost among them ; thereafter with **RAVANA** be finally reached the Western Sea. There thst monkey performed the Sandhya Ceremony and, having bathed, still bearing Dashanana, went to the Northern Sea. Thereafter thst great monkey with his adversary traversed thousands of leagues, swift as the wind or thought. Having observed the Sandbya Ceremony at the Northern Sea, Bali, carrying Dashanana, went to the Eastern Sea. There, Vasavi, the Lord of the Monkeys, performed

bis evening devotions and, still bearing **RAVANA**, he returned to Kishkindha. Having performed the Sandhya at the four oceans, thst monkey, weary of supporting **RAVANA**, halted in a wood near Kishkindha and thst King of the Monkeys, unhooking **RAVANA** from bis girdle, with a mocking laugh, said :- Whence art thou?' " Greatly astonished, the King of the Rskahaass, whose eyes were half-closed with fatigue, addressed the Lord of the Monkeys thus: " O Foremost of Monkeys, O Thou who reaemblest Mahen dra. I am J;he Lord of the Rskahaass, **RAVANA**, who came in the 419 hope of entering into combat with thee and here I am, thy captive I What strength, what energy, what inner power has enabled thee to bind me thus without fatigue and with such speed, O Valiant Monkey? Assuredly there are only thtee beings who could have acted thus, the mind, the wind and Suparna. Having witnessed thy power, O Bull among Monkeys, in the pteSCilce of fire I wish to enter into an alliance of sincere and enduring friendship with thee I Consorts, sons, city, kingdom, pleasures, raiment and food will all be shared by us, O King, O Foremost of the Monkeys ! " Thereupon, Jigbting a fire, monkey and titan became brothers and embraced each other. Clasping haods, the monkey and the titan joyfully entered Kishkindha, like unto two lions into a rocky cavern. Resembling another **SUGRIVA**, **RAVANA** sojourned there for a month and thereafter bis ministers desirous of over coming the Three Worlds, led bim away. " Thus did **RAVANA** act with Bali formerly and, although humbled by bim, swore to be bis brother in the presence of fire. Bali's strength was unequalled, O **RAMA**, it was immeasurable ; yet thou didst consume bim as the fire a cricket." CHAPTBR 3S TM Story of Hammum's ChildluJod THIN **RAMA** made a fUrther enquiry of that Sage, whose hermi tage was in the southern region and, paying obeisance to bim in grest reverence, with joined palms addresaed bim in pregnant terms,

saying : “Assuredly the prowesa of Bali and **RAVANA** was incomparable, yet, to my mind at least, it was never equal to **HANUMAN**’s I Courage, skill, strength, tenacity of purpose, sagacity, experience, energy and prowesa are all to be found in **HANUMAN** I “When beholding the Ocean, the army of the monkeys was in despair, that long-armed hero consoled them, traveraing a hundred leagues and destroying the City of Lanka. Entering **RAVANA**’s inner apartments, he discovered **SITA** and encouraged

CHAPTER 35

The Story of Hanuman's Childhood

hope of entering into combat with thee and here I am, thy captive I What strength, what energy, what inner power has enabled thee to bind me thus without fatigue and with such speed, O Valiant Monkey? Assuredly there are only thtee beings who could have acted thus, the mind, the wind and Suparna. Having witnessed thy power, O Bull among Monkeys, in the pteSCilce of fire I wish to enter into an alliance of sincere and enduring friendship with thee I Consorts, sons, city, kingdom, pleasures, raiment and food will all be shared by us, O King, O Foremost of the Monkeys ! " Thereupon, Jigbting a fire, monkey and titan became brothers and embraced each other. Clasping haods, the monkey and the titan joyfully entered Kishkindha, like unto two lions into a rocky cavern. Resembling another **SUGRIVA**, **RAVANA** sojourned there for a month and thereafter bis ministers desirous of over coming the Three Worlds, led bim away. " Thus did **RAVANA** act with Bali formerly and, although humbled by bim, swore to be bis brother in the presence of fire. Bali’s strength was unequalled, O **RAMA**, it was

immeasurable ; yet thou didst consume bim as the fire a cricket." CHAPTBR 3S TM Story of Hammum's ChildluJod THIN **RAMA** made a fUrther enquiry of that Sage, whose hermi tage was in the southern region and, paying obeisance to bim in grest reverence, with joined palms addresaed bim in pregnant terms, saying : "Assuredly the prowesa of Bali and **RAVANA** was incomparable, yet, to my mind at least, it was never equal to **HANUMAN**'s I Courage, skill, strength, tenacity of purpose, sagacity, experience, energy and prowesa are all to be found in **HANUMAN** I "When beholding the Ocean, the army of the monkeys was in despair, that long-armed hero consoled them, traveraing a hundred leagues and destroying the City of Lanka. Entering **RAVANA**'s inner apartments, he discovered **SITA** and encouraged 490 her by his words. Single-handed, **HANUMAN** slew those who marched at the head of the enemy forces, the sons of **RAVANA**'s ministers, the Kinkaras, and thereafter, when he bad broken his fetters and admonished Dasbanana, he reduced Lanka to ashes as Pavaka the world. Such feats were never surpassed by **INDRA**, **VARUNA**, Vishou or Kuvera. By the might of his arms, I bave conquered Lanka and regained Sits, **LAKSHMANA**, my kingdom, friends and kinsfolk. Who but **HANUMAN**, the companion of the King of the *Vanaras*, would bave been capable of obtaining tidings of Janaki? But how comes it, tbat in his devotion to **SUGRIVA**, he did not consume Bali at the time of the quartel, as a fite a shrub ? It seems to me tbat **HANUMAN** was not yet aware of his powers when he witnessed the King of the Monkeys, whom he loved as his own being, set at nought ! Recount to me in detail and candidly everything concerning **HANUMAN**, O Blessed and IDustrious Ascetic, O Thou whom the Gods revere!" Hearing these sagacious words, the Sage, in **HANUMAN**'s presence, answered : " Wbat thou hast said regarding **HANUMAN** is true, O Prince of the Raghus ! I deem none is equal to him in strength or surpasses him

in swiftness and intelligence but formerly an irrevocable curse was pronounced on him by the Sages, on account of which, tbat hero was made unconscious of his great power, O Scourge of thy Foes. " In his childhood, O Mighty **RAMA**, he did something of which I cannot speak, so puerile was it, but if thou so desiteat, O Raghava, I will disclose it to thee. " There is a mountain named Sumeru tbat **SURYA** gilds as a boon ; there Kesbarin, the sire of **HANUMAN**, dwells. Vayu begot a wonderful child on his cherished and illustrious consort, Anjana, and she brought tbat son, whose colour was like unto an ear of com, into the world. Wishing to pluck some fruits, tbat lovely woman penetrated into a thicket, and the child, who in his J110ther's absence suffered greatly from hunger, began to emit pietciog cries, like unto Karttikcya in the Sbara Wood. "At tbat moment, he obaerved the sun rising like unto a bunch of Java flowers,' and, eager for food, he imagined it to be a fruit and rushed towards it. Turning to the rising sun, the child, himself like unto the dawn, wishing to lay hold of it, sprang into the sky. And **HANUMAN**'s bounds, he being but a child, greatly astonished the *Devas,* Danavas and Yakshas who reflected, 'Neithet Vayu, **GARUDA** nor even thought itself have the velocity of this son of the Wind who has lespt into the sky. If, whilst still a child, the speed of his flight is such, what will it not be when he attains his youthful strength.' "Now Vayu followed in his son's wake lest the sun should scorch him and protected him with his cooling bresth. Thus **HANUMAN**, rising in space, traversed thousands of lesgues and, on account of his sire's power and his own guilelessness, drew nesr to the sun. " ' That little One is not conscious of his error ' reflected **SURYA**, ' we must act accordingly ', and he refrained from consuming him. " Now on that very day that **HANUMAN** sprang into the sky to seize hold of the solar orb, Rahuhsd prepared to take hold of it himself and, coming in contact with that child in the sun's chariot,

Rahu sprang away in fesr, he, the scourge of the sun and moon. Provoked, that son of Simhika went to **INDRA**'s abode and, scowling, said to that God, who was surrounded by the Celestial Host : "' O Vasava, in ottler to satisfy my hunger, thou didst bestow the sun and moon on me, why hast thou made a present of them to anothet, O Slayer of Bali and Vritra? To-day, which is the time of the conjunction, I had gone to lay hold of the sun when another Rahu approached and seized it.' " Hesring these words of Rahu, Vasava, astonished, rose up from his throne and bearing his golden diadem, went out. Thereafter he mounted Airavata, foremost of elephants, who was as high as a hill or the peak of Mount Kailasha with his four tusks, running with mada jnice, enormous, ricbly caparisoned and whose golden bells rang merrily. " Then **INDRA** commanded Rahu to precede him and directed his course to where **SURYA** and **HANUMAN** were. Thereupon Rahu set out with all speed leaving Vasava far behind and the child, **HANUMAN**, beheld him as he drew nesr, whereupon he let go of the sun and, taking Rahu to be a fruit, once more bounded into the sky to seize Simhika's son. " Observing that Plavamgama loosing his hold on the sun in order to throw himself upon him, the offspring of Simhika, of whom the head alone remained visible, taking refuge under Indta's protection, in his terror, cried out' **INDRA**, Indta' with out cessing, and **INDRA**, recognizing the voice of Rahu ere he was able to discern him, answered his appeal, saying ' Have no fear, I am about to slay him I ' " Meantime, beholding Airavata, Maruti reftected ' O, the lovely fruit ! ' and threw himself on that Lord of Elephants and while he sought to take bold of Airavata, his form fearful to behold suddenly appeared over Indta and his followers. There after as he rushed on Sachi's consort, Indta, not unduly angered, with his finger loosed a thunderbolt that struck **HANUMAN** and, at the impact, the child feJJ on a mountain, in his faJJ breaking his left jaw. Seeing his son lying

inanimate under the stroke of the thunderbolt, Pavana was enraged against **INDRA**, and the God Maruta, who penetrates and infuses all beings, withdtew into a cave to which he bore his child. Thereafter, as Vasava restrains the fioods, he caused immense sufferings to all beings by preventing the passage of excreta and urine in them. “On account ofVayu’s wrath all creatures on every side were deprived of their breath so that their joints were dislocated and they became as blocks of wood. All sacred studies, the holy syllable 'Vashat ', religious ceremonies and duties being suspended by Vayu’s displeasure, the Three Worlds became a bell. " Then all creatures with the Gandharvas, *Devas*, *Asuras* and men, in their a111iction and the desire to become happy once more, hurried to Prajapati ; and the Gods, their bellies swollen, with joined palms, said to him : " ' Thou hast created four kinds of beings, O Blessed One, Thou art their protector. Thou hast given us Pavana as the Lord of our Jives, why nevertheless, has he who had become the Ruler of the Vital Breaths, now brought about this misfortune in the manner of a woman in the inner apartments ? ' " Hearing these words of all the beings, Prajapati, who was their protector, said to them, ' It is true I ' and added ' Learn 493 the reason which incited Vayu to anger and bas caused this impediment. O Beings, this I have probed fur myself. The Foremost of the Gods, this day, caused his son to fall at Rabu’s instigatinn, whereupon that God of the Wind became enraged and Vayu, though bodiless, circulates in every body. A body bereft of Vayu is like a piece of wood, Vayu is the vital breath, Vayu is felicity itself, Vayu is the universe; without Vayu, the wbole world cannot be happy ; now that the universe is bereft of Vayu it is deprived of life; all creatures without breath are as boards. For not having honoured the son of Aditi, we must seek out Marum, the author of our ills, lest we perish I ' " Thereupon, accompanied by aU beings, Prajapati with the *Devas*, Gandbarvas,

Serpents and Guyhakas approached Maruta in the place to which be bad borne his son, whom the King of the Gods bad struck down. “Meanwhile, perceiving the offspring of Sadagati,radisnt as the sun, fire or gold, in that dark cave where be bad been with drawn, the Four-faced God was moved with compassion as also the *Devas*, Gandbarvas, *Rishis*, Yaksbas and Raksbasas.”

CHAPTER 36

The Boons bestowed on the Child Hanuman and how he was cursed by the Ascetics

TM BDOn$ butorJJSd tm the Child tmd hl1fll he auu cursed by the Ascetia “As soon as be beheld the Grandsire of the World, Vayu, taking his young child, for whom be bad wept as one dead, rushed towards Dbatar. With his waving Joclts, his disdem and the garlands with which be was adorned, Vayu, having bowed three times, fcl1 at the feet of Brabma. “Tben be, who was conversant with the Veda, his arms decorated with dazzling braceletS, touched the child as if in play , thereupon, that God sprung from the lotus, merely by caressing the child, revived him as seed that is watered. " Beholding his restored, the Wind-god, blowing aus piciously, began to circulate in all beings as erstwhile aod, freed from the obstructions caused by Maruta, all creatures became happy, like lakes covered with lotuses over which an icy wind has ceased to blow. " Then **BRAHMA**, who possesses the three pairs of qualities,' who is Himself the esseoce of Trimurti, having his abode in the Three Worlds, He who is revered by the Gods, said to the Celestials, in his anxiety to propitiate Marum : " Know the truth, I will impart it to you for it is importaot ! Hear all of you, Mahendra, **AGNI**,

VARUNA, Maheshwara, Dhaoeshwara and others-this child will carry out all you have to accomplish, therefore graot him every boon in order to gratifY his sire.' " Thereupon the God of a Thousaod Eyes, delighted, his brow radisnt, took off his garland of lotuses aod spoke thus: " Since the thunderbolt escaped from my grasp aod ahattered his jaw, this child shall be called Haoumao. I shall bestow ao excellent boon upon him ; from to-day, he will be invulnerable to thunderbolts I ' " Then Martanda, in his turn, that blessed One who dispels the darkness, said : " I will bestow a hundredth part of mine elfulgence upon him aod when he is able to learn the Shastras, I will endow him with doquence ! ' " Thereafter **VARUNA** accorded him the following boon, saying: " Innumerable years shall pass, yet shall my noose aod my watera never be used against him I ' "After this, **YAMA** granted him the boon of invulnerability aod immunity to disesse aod said : " As a sign of my satisction, I shall grant him the fiJtther boon of never being slain in battle I ' " Then the red-eyed Dhaoada spoke thus : " This mace held by me shall protect him in combat I ' THE llAMAYANA OF VALMIKI " Thereafter the God Sbaobra, bestowing the foremost of favours upon him, said : " ' I shall restrain my shafts from wounding him I ' " Then Vishvakarma of the great Car, casting his eyes on the child, said : .. ' He will be invulnerable to the celestial weapons forged by me and his life shall endure I ' " Finally the magnanimous Brahms spoke thus : " 'None of my weapons shall be able to barm him I ' " Beholding the child enriched by the boons of the Gods, the Four-faced Lord, Guru of the Worlds, in his satisfaction addressed Vayu, saying: " ' Thy son, Maruti, will be the terror of his foes, the support of his friends and invincible I Able to change his form at will, he will accomplish all he desires and go wheresoever he pleases with unimaginable velocity. In order to destroy llavana and gratifY llama, he will perform such feats of arms that will

cause every being to tremble ! ' " These words pacified Vayu, as also the Immortals and, with the Grandsire at their head, they all departed to the place from whence they had come. " Vayu, the Bearer of Perfume, 1llking his son, returned home and, telling Anjana of the boons he had received, went away. " O llama, receiving these favours which filled him with power, and with the temerity natural to him, **HANUMAN** resembled the ocean that is overflowing. " In his intemperate ardour, that bull among monkeys shamelessly began to create trouble in the hermitages of the great Risbis. Scattering the spoons, jars, sacrificial fires, and heaps of bark used by those peace-loving Sages, overturning and shatter ing them, by auch ezploits, he, who had been rendered invulner able to all hrahmanic weapons by Shambhu, distinguished himself. " Knowing from whence his power was derived, the great *Rishis* bore with him, nevertheless, despite the warnings of his sire, Kesharin, the son of Anjana meeded all bounds, whereupon highly indignant, those mighty *Rishis*, born in the line of Bhrigu and Angiras, cursed him, O Prince of the llaghus, without, however, giving rein to their fUll anger and irritation. UTT ARA *KANDA* " **THEY** *said*:-'Since, in the knowledge of thy power, O Plavamgama, thou dost harass us, by the adverse efl'ect of our curse thou shalt become unaware of it for a long time, but, when it is remembered by thee, thou shalt be able to wield it effectively. , " Thereafter, the knowledge of his powers was taken from him in virtue of the great *Rishis*' words and, from that moment. **HANUMAN** ranged the solitudes in a placid mood. " At that time, Riksharajas, full of eftillgence, like unto the sun, the father of Bali and **SUGRIVA**, ruled over all the monkeys and after a prolonged reign, that Sovereign of the Monkeys succumbed to the natural law of time and, having died, the ministers, learned in the sacred formulas, installed Bali in his father's stead and **SUGRIVA** as heir-apparent. " **HANUMAN** and **SUGRIVA** were

as one and there was no difference between them ; they loved each other as do **AGNI** and Anila but when the quarrel between Bali and **SUGRIVA** arose, **HANUMAN**, on account of the *brahmins*' curse, was unaware of his powers, nor, in the terror in which Bali had thrown him, did **SUGRIVA** call them to mind, O Lord. The curse of the *brahmins* having robbed him of that knowledge, the foremost of Monkeys, supported **SUGRIVA** as an ally in the fight, who resembled a lion that a great elephant subdues. For valour, energy, intelligence, strength, amiability, sweetoess of disposition, knowledge of what is fitting and not fitting, steadfastness, skill, courage and audacity, who can surpass **HANUMAN** in the world ? " That lndra among monkeys, in order to acquire grammar took refUge with the Sun-god and, in his spirit of enquiry that was without equal, he travelled from the mountain where he rises to the one where he sets, with a large book, a vast encyclo pedia comprising the Sutras, their Commentaries, their meaning and the synthesis. " That Prince of Monkeys became an accomplished scholar and none equalled him in the Shastras nor in the interpretation of the Prosody. In all the sciences and in the rules of asceticism, he rivalled Brihaspati. By thy grace, he will become a very *brahmin* conversant with the meaning of the most recent grammatical systems. Like unto an ocean, eager to engulf the worlds, like unto Pavab desirous of consuming them at the 497 fiaal dissolution, who is able to challenge **HANUMAN**, tbat second Antab? " O **RAMA**, on thine account, the Gods created **HANUMAN** and the other foremost of monkeys, **SUGRIVA**, Maioda, Dvivids as also Nila, Tara, Tareya, Nata, Rambba, Gaja, Gavabba, Gavaya, Sudamabtra, Prabbojya, Atimukba and Nata as also the bears with those leading monkeys who were all created by the Gods, O **RAMA**. " I have answered thy question fully and have just told thee of **HANUMAN**'s ezploit accomplisbed in childhood." Agastya's tale greatly amazed **RAMA**,

Saumitri, the monkeys and the Raksbasas, and Agastya addressed **RAMA**, saying : " Thou bast learnt all that I have to tell ; now tbat we have beheld thee and received thine hospitality, we crave leave to depart I" Hearing the words of the supremely pious Agastya, Ragbava with joined palms, bowing to tbat great Risbi, said : " To-day the Gods, my parents, ancestors and my family have been blessed by thy holy sight, yea, sanctified for ever. In the joy of my return, this is what I have to ask of thee. It is for thee in thine affection to coocede it. " I, who came to establish the inhabitants of the city and the country in their personal duties, desire thy co-operation in the sacrifice that I now wish to perform, O Thou who bclongest to the virtuous. Wilt thou, whose asceticism eliminates allilwlts, not assist me in these ceremonies, for then shall I be welcomed by mine ancestors and my felicity be complete ? Do ye all assemble here I " On this request, Agastya and the other Risbis of rigid penances, answered, " Let it be oo I " and went to their hermitages. Having spoken thus, all those ascetics departed in the order in which they bad come. Ragbava, having re11ected on the utterances of the Sage, was greatly astonished, and the orb of the day having withdrawn behind the Asta Mountain, be dismissed the monkeys and the kings; thereafter tbat foremost of men, having performed his evening devotions and the night having come, retired to the inner apartments,

CHAPTER 37

Homage is paid to Shri Rama

THE insllllllation of Kakutstha, who was versed in the science of the Self, having taken place, the following night was spent by his subjects in rejoicing and when it had passed, at dawn, those who were charged with

waking the king assembled at the palace. Thereafter these sweet-voiced minstrels, like unto the learned Kinneras, chanted pleasandy to that valiant prince as to a cherished son : " O Gende Hero, awake I O Thou who increaseth the felicity of Kausbalya, when thou dost sleep the whole universe is wrapped in slumber, O Monarch ! Thine heroism is equal to **VISHNU**'s and thy beauty to the Asbvins. Thou, the rival of Brihaspati in wisdom, art a second Prajapati. Thy life's span is like the earth's, thy radiance like the sun's, thou art endowed with the swiftness of the wind and thy profundity is like the deep. Thou art unshakable like unto Sthanuand thy charm rivals the moon. No king was ever like unto thee in the past nor shall there ever be such a monarch in time to come, O Sovereign. O Lion among Men, since thou art invincible, firm in thy duty and ever seeketh the welfare of thy subjects, glory and prosperity will never desert thee. Humility and piety ever reside in thee, O Kakutstha I " These and similar praises were addressed to him by the harda as also the Sutas, who, with divine hymns, sought to rouse Raghava, and it was amidst these melodious chants that he woke from sleep and rose from his couch, that was covered with white stuffs, like unto **VISHNU** when be leaves the snake that has served as his bed. Then that magnanimoua hero stood up and coundess arten dants approached him, bowing with joined palms, olfering him beautiful ewers for washing and, having bathed and purified himself, he went at the appninted hour to kindle the sacrificial THB ltAMAYANA OP VALMIKI fire and thereafter with swift steps, he entered the sacred pavilion reserved for the Ibhvatus. There for along time Ramo paid homage to the Gods, his ancestors and the *brahmins*, according to tradition, theo, coming forth surrounded by his people, he went to the outer coun of the palace accompanied by his counsellors and also the family priests, who shone in their own effulgence, led by **VASISHTHA**.

Wealthy *Kshatriyas*, Lords of countless provinces walked at **RAMA**'s side, as the Celestials by Shakra. **BHARATA**, **LAKSHMANA** and **SHATRUGHNA**, of great reoown, joyfully formed an escort of honour round him, like unto the Three Vedas at the Adhvara Sacrifice. At his side walked innumerable atteodants with joined palms and radiant counten ance, named Muditas. Twenty monkeys full of eoergy and prowess led by **SUGRIVA** followed Rams, and Bibishana between four *Rakshasas* walked beside that hero, as Guhyakas by the Lord of Wealth. Elders, and merchants and those of noble families, bowing to the king, followed him with dignity, and that Sovereign, surrounded by the blessed and illustrious *Rishis*, mighty kings, monkeys and *Rakshasas*, like unto the Chief of the Gods, received continual homage from the ascetics ; and the countless prsises of those who entered Ramo's preseoce, and traditions, full of eloquence and piety, were constantly recited by the magnanimous *brahmins* versed in the Scriptures. UTT ARA *KANDA* " Once, when that highly virtuous ascetic was journeying through the world, he came to my retreat and I paid him due homage and made him welcome. When he was seated at his ease, b,;ng curious, I put this same question to him and he answered me, saying : " ' Hear me, O Great Ascetic, Foremost of the Pious, there is a mountain named Meru, which is all golden, enchanting and most beautiful. Its central peak is gready revered by the Gods and the marvellous assembly hall of **BRAHMA** is situated there, which extends over a hundred leagues. The Four-mouthed Deity, sprung from a lotua, ever resides there and, on a certain occasion while be was practising *Yoga*, a few tears fell from his eyes, whereupon the Patriarch, with his hand, brushed them away allowing them to fall on the earth and from them a monkey was born. " ' O Foremost of Men, as soon as that monkey appeared, the high-souled **BRAHMA** instructed him in sweet accents, saying : " ' " Do thou proceed

to that foremost of the mountains where the Gods perpetually dwell, O Chief of Monkeys, and subsist there on the various fruits and roots. On that enchanting mountain, thou shouldst live depending on me, O Foremost of Monkeys, living in this wise for some time, thou shalt attsin prosperity.” ' " O Ramo, that great monkey, offering salutations to the feet of **BRAHMA**, said to the Creator of the World : " ' O Lord, I shall execute thy behest and live depending on Theel’ " Thereafter that forest dweller immediately proceeded to the wood abounding in fruit and blossom, and there he lived on fruits, gatheriog honey and various blooms, returning to **BRAHMA** each evening with an offering of the most excellent frvit and llowers, which he placed at the feet of that God of Gods. In this way he spent a long time on that mountain. " O Ramo, once that great monkey, Riksharajas, was alBicted by thirst and went to the northern peak of Mount Meru where he beheld a lake ringing with the songs of a myriad birds. Shaking his neck in delight, he observed his re11ection in the waters and, beholding that image, the monkey chief lilled with anger and anziety asked himaelf, What arch enemy of mine sot dwells in these waters ? I sball destroy the czcellent abode of that vicious-souled one ! ' Thinking thus within himself, that monkey, in his impetuosity, piUDged into the lake and with a bound emerged once more, but as be rose from the waters, he found himself transformed into a woman, who was extremely charming, graceful and filir. " Her waist was wide, her eyebrows symmetrical, her hair black and curly, her countenance filir and smiling, her bosom high and her beauty matchless. On the banks of that lake, she appeared enchanting, illumining the four quarters, agitating the minds of all beings and, in the Three Worlds, she was as beauti ful as any. O **RAMA**, she resembled the simple creeper, Sastilata, or Lakshmi bereft of her lotus or the pure rays of the moon or Parvati. “At that time, Indta, the Lord of the Cclestials, having

worshipped the feet of **BRAHMA**, was returning by that way and the Sun-god also came thither. " Simultaneously beholding that lovely female form, they were overcome with desire, and, their minds being in a ferment, they were wholly swept away. " Thereupon **INDRA** begot a son on that woman, named Bali, so-called because his seed fell on the hair of that beauty, and the Solar Deity begot another son on her, named **SUGRIVA**, who sprang from her neck. " Those two powerful monkeys being born, **INDRA** conferred a lasting golden chain on Bali and returned to his own abode and, having engaged **HANUMAN**, the Wind-god's son, in the service of besides those who arc endowed with magic powers. Inaccessible and abounding in gems, those of the four cutes inhabit it, and it is pure and sacted. " 'At my command, Vishvakarma created that cel.estisl and enchanting Qry of Kishkindba, do thou find an abode for Riksharajas, the foremost of the Monkeys and his sons there, and, having called the leading Plavamgamas together and received them courteously, install him on the throne. On beholding this monkey chief, gifted with intelligence, they will all become subject to him.' " Brabma having spoken thus, the celeatisl messenger with Riksharajas proceeded to that most beautiful Qry of Kisbkiudha with the speed of the wind where, as commanded by **BRAHMA**, he installed Riksharajas as king. " Thereafter, having bathed and being adomed with a crown and varinus ornaments, Riksharajas, with a joyful heart began to rule over the monkeys, and all the *Vanaras* residing on the earth, comprising the Seven Islands and bounded by the sea, became subject to him. " Thus Riksharajas was both father and mother to Bali and **SUGRIVA** ; may prosperity attend thee ! The learned, who listen to and cause others to hear this narrative, enhancing their delight, obtain all their desires. " O Lord, I have duly described at length all that concerns the birth of the monkey kings and the *Rakshasas*." **RAMA**, having uttered these words,

AGASTYA *said*: " O Long-armed One, even thus was the birth of Bali and **SUGRIVA** brought about in days of yore. I shall now relate another ancient legend to thee, O **RAMA**, as to why **RAVANA** bore **SITA** away, hear me with attention I " In the Golden Age, **RAVANA** offered reverence to the Grand sire's offspring, that truthful *Rishi* Sanatkumara, who, shining in his own effulgence, was as resplendent as the sun and who was seated in his own retreat, and paying homage to him, **RAVANA** *said*: " ' O Lord, who is there now among the Goda, who is brave and powerful and by whose aid the Celestials can overcome their foes, one whom the Twice-born worship daily and upon whom devotees constantly meditate ? O Thou, whose wealth is thy piety and who art possessed of the sixfold riches, do thou gtaciously tell me in detail.' " Being conversant with **RAVANA**'s intentions, the glorious Sage Sanatkumars, having knowledge of all things through his meditations, said to him affectionately :-' Hear me, O My Son, the wise, in their sacrifices, duly pay homage to the Lord of the Universe, whose origin is unknown to us, who is daily worshipped by the Celestials and Asurss, He is the supremely powerful Narayana from whose navel, Brahms, the Creator of the World has sprung and from whom, all things animate and inanimate are born. Yogis meditate upon Him and offer sacrifices in His honour according to the Puranas, Vedas, Pancharattas and other rituals. In combat, He is ever victorious over the Daityas, Danavas, Ratshasas and other enemies of the Gods, all of whom ever worship Him.' " Hearing the words of the great Ascetic Sanatkumars, **RAVANA**, the Lord of the Ratshasas, making obeisance to him, answered: "' Being slain by Hari, to what state do the Daityas, Dana vas and Ratshasas attain and why does Hari desttoy them ? ' " **THEREUPON SANATKUMARS** *replied*:-' They who are slain by the Gods abide in Swargs but are born again on earth when their merit is exhausted. They are born and they die,

they suffer and enjoy according to the merits of their previoua births, but those who are slain by the Wielder of the Discus, the Lord of the 504 Three Worlds, Hari, atlllin to His region, since even His wrath is like unto a boon, O King ! ' " Hearing the words spoken by that mighty Ascetic Sanat kumara, that night-ranger, **RAVANA**, filled with delight and wonder, began to reflect on how he tnight enter into conflict with the Lord." "As the vicious-souled **RAVANA** was reflecting thus, the gt'CIIt Ascetic Sanatkumara said to him : " ' O Loog-armed Wanior, what thy mind has conceived will be accomplished in a gt'CIIt encounter ! Rejoice and wait awhile!' " Hearing these words, the long-armed **RAVANA** addressed the Sage and said : " ' O Foremost of the *Rishis*, do thou tell me in detail what are His distinguishing characteristics ? ' " Having listened to the Lord of the *Rakshasas*, the ascetic replied: " ' Listen and I will tell thee all :-0 Foremost of the Rak shasas, in the universe of animate and inanimate beings, that gt'CIIt God is all-pervading, subtle, eternal and omnipresent. He is present in the Celestial Region, on earth and in the region under the earth, on the mountains, in the furests and all stationary objects, rivers and cities ; He is "Awn", He is Truth, He is Savitri and the earth ; He is the supporter of the earth and the Serpent Ananta ; He is day and night, morning and evening, death, the moon, time, the wind, **BRAHMA**, Rudra, lndra and **VARUNA**. He causes the worlds to appear and shine furth; He creates them, destroys them, rules over them and sports therein. He is eternal, the Lord of Men, He is **VISHNU**, the Ancient Purusha and the only DestrOyer. What more is there to aay, O Dashanaoa? He pervades the Three Worlds, the moving and unmoving. Wearing yellow raitnent like unto the filaments of a lotus, Narayana resembles the Jighming ftashes. Bearing the 50S Sbrivatsa Mart on His breast, that cloud-coloured Lord, lite unto the moon, is pleasing to loot upon. Latshmi resides in His body

in the furm of warfare, as lightning in the clouds. Neither *Devas*, *Asuras* nor Nagas are able to loot on Him but the one, with whom He is pleased, alone beholds Him. O My Son, neither by the fruits of sacrifice, penance, self-control, gifts nor rituals nor by any other means can one behold that Supreme God. Those alone see Him who have surrendered their whole life and being to Him and who, by virtue of discrim inative knowledge, have burnt up all their sins. If thou desirest to behold Him, hesr me and I will tell thee all. " ' At the close of the Golden Age and the beginning of the Silver Age, the Lord Narayana will assume human furm for the sate of men and the Gods. A son, named **RAMA**, will be born to **DASARATHA** of the Ibhvatu Race, who will rule on esrth. **RAMA** will be highly eftWgeot, powerful and as forbearing as the esrth nor shall his enemies in combat be able to loot on him, as one is unable to gaze upon the sun. " ' His consort, the gracious Latshmi shall be renowned under the name of **SITA** and be born as the daughter of **JANAKA**, King of Mithi1a ; she will issue ftom the earth. In besuty, she will be unequalled in the world, endowed with auspicious marts she will ever follow **RAMA** lite a shadow, as the moon is accompanied by its besma; of virtuous conduct, she will be chaste and patient. **SITA** and **RAMA** will always appear together as the sun and its rays. O **RAVANA**, I have now related to thee all that concerns Narayana, the grest, eternal and incomprehensible *Brahman*.' " O Raghava, on hearing these words, the mighty Lord of the Ratshasas began to devise means whereby he might enter into combat with thee. Meditating again and again on the words of Sanatkumara, he began to wander here and there." Listening to this narrative, **RAMA**, his eyes wide with wonder, was gresdy astonished and, being delighted, he again addressed Agastys, the foremost of the wise, saying : " Do thou recount the ancient traditiona further, O Lord." THE illustrious Risbi Agastya, sprung from a vessel,' paying obeisance

to Rams, as Brahms pays homage to Sbiva, addressed tbat hero whose prowess was truth, saying : " Do thou hear me ! ,. Thereafter the highly effulgent Agastya began to relate the subsequent events in tbat legend, and the blessed Sage with a delighted bean described to Rams all he had heard narrated, saying: " O Illustrious and Long-armed Rams, it is on this account tbat the vicious-souled **RAVANA** stole **SITA**, the daughter of **JANAKA**, away. O Thou who an possessed oflong anns, O Great Warrior, O Thou wbo an invincible, Narada recounted this tale to me on the summit of the Meru Mountain. O Raghava, the highly effulgent One told me this story in the presence of the *Devas*, Gandharvas, Siddhas, Ascerics and other great Beings. O Lord of Monarchs, O Conferer of Honours, do thou hear this tale wbich removes great sins I Listening to it, O Thou oflong arms, the Risbia and the *Devas*, with delighted hearts, their eyes shining with the splendour of lotus ftowers, said to the Asceric Narada: " ' He, who listens to or relates this story with faith and devotion, shall be blessed with sons and grandsons and, after bis death, be honoured in the Celestial Region.' " Daityas, Danavas or Raltshasas who were powerful, he chaUenged them to fight. " O Lord of the Barth, having traversed the whole world, the Teo-necked *Rakshasa* beheld the Sage Narada returning from Brahmaloka to his own abode, like unto a second sun, passing through the clouds. Then **RAVANA**, with a cheerful heart, approached him and, with joined palms, addressed the Sage, saying: " ' O Thou gifted with the silt kinds of wealth, many times thou hast beheld all creation from **BRAHMA** down to an insect. Do thou tell me, O Great One, in which region the inhabitants are the most powerful, I wish to chaUeoge them to combat according to my whim.' " Thereupon, reflecting an instant, the divine Sage Narada answered him saying : " ' O King, there is a large island in the Milky Ocean, where all the inhabitants are endowed with grest strength and are of enormous

stature, as etru.lgeot as the moon's besms, possessing fair complexions, voices as deep as the muttering of clouds and who are extremely valiant. Their arms are long and like iron bars, O King of the *Asuras*, such are the people of that island, who are as powerful as thou wouldst wish to see on esrth.' " Hesring the words of Narada, **RAVANA** *said*: " ' O Divine Sage, why are the people of that island so strong and how did such mighty beings come to live in that place ? O Lord, do thou relate everything to me at length. The whole world is ever seen by thee like a fruit in tbe palm of the hand!' " Hearing the words of **RAVANA**, the blesaed **SAGE** *said*: " ' O Lord of the *Rakshasas*, the people of that island constantly worship Narayana with their whole being. Their hesrts and minds are ever set on Him and, having given their lives and soula to Narayana alone, they have been blessed with that abode and dwell on Sweta-dwipa. Those who die in battle at the hands of Shri Narayana, Besrer of the discus and Preserver of the World, go to the celestial region. O Friend, neither by sacrifice, penance, =eellent gifrs nor by any other pious act does one attain to that region full of bliss.' " Hearing these words of Narada, **RAVANA** was amazed and soB UTT ARA *KANDA* rdlecting awhile, said :-' I will enter into conftict with these people I' " Thereafter, taking leave of Narada, he proceeded to Sweta dwipa aod Narada, pondering for a loog time, curious to witoess thst encounter, speedily left for thst island, he being fond of mischief aod conftict. " O Prince, Ravaoa, with his *Rakshasas*, advanced on Sweta dwipa, rending the four quarters with his leonine aod Narada preceded him to thst island thst was di11icult of access even to the *Devas*. " There the Pushpaka Car of the mighty Ravaoa was assailed by adverse winds so thst it was unable to staod against them and was tossed about like a straw, nor could it remain stationary on account of the furious blasts. Then Ravaoa's counsellors said to him: .. ' O Lord, we are beside

ourselves aod overcome by fear ; it is not possible for us to remain here, how then shall we be able to fight?' " Speaking thus, the *Rakshasas* lied away in all directions ; then **RAVANA** sent away his aerial car decorated with gold with the *Rakshasas* and, assuming a terrible form, entered the island alone. " Thereafter, as he was approaching, he was observed by maoy women ofthst white island, who, drawing near, took hold of his hand aod amiling, said : " ' Why hast thou come hither ? Who art thou ? Who is thy aire ? Who has sent thee, tell us all caodidly ? ' " Than Ravaoa, enraged, aoswered : " ' I am the son of the Sage Vishravas and my name is **RAVANA** ! I have come hither in order to fight but I aee no warrior here I ' " When the wicked-minded *Rakshasa* had spoken thus, the maidens laughed gently, but one of them, incensed, suddenly took hold of Ravaoa as one would a child aod, as if in play, tossed him to and fro to her companions, saying : " ' See, I have caught an insect, how wonderful it is with ita ten hands, twenty arms and its colour reaemhling a heap of antimony I' " Thereafter, they paaaed him from hand to hand in play, each spinllillg him with her lingers and RaVIIIII, worn out by being handled thus, grew exceedingly angry and bit the hand of one of those 1ilir ones, who, being in pain, let him go, whereupon another, seizing the powerful Rabhasa, rose into the sky. Then **RAVANA**, in fury, tore her with his nails and being dropped by that damsel, the night-ranger, terrified, fell into the waters of the sea, as a mountain peak when shattered by a thunderbolt. " O **RAMA**, those youthtill women of Sweta-dwipa again caught hold of the Rabhasa and began to !ling him to and fro. At that moment, the illustrious Sage Narada, observing **RAVANA**'s plight, was astonished and, laughing loudly, began to dance with delight. " O Great King, desirous of receiving death at thy hand, the wicked **RAVANA** bore **SITA** away. Thou art Narayana, the Wielder of the Conch, discus and mace. Thou -dost bear the lotus, the thunderbolt

and the bow in thine honda. Thou art Hrishikesha and art adorned with the Shrivatsa Mark, Thou art the Maha Yogi, ever worshipped by the *Devas* and Thou dost confer fearlessness on Thy devotees. Thou hast assumed a human form in otder to slay **RAVANA**. Dost Thou know thy Self to be Narayana, O Blessed One, do not forget thy teal Self, recollect that Thou art the true Self; Btahma Himself has declated Thee to be the Mystery of all mysteries I " O Prince of the Raghus, Thou art the Thtee Gunas, the Thtee Vedas, The Thtee Regions, that of the Celestials, of men and the region under the earth, Thou dost sport in the thtee divisions of time, Thou art conversant with the scleoce of archery, music and medicine, Thou art the DestrOyer of the enemies of the Gods. In days of yore, Thou didat traverse the Thtee Worlds in thtee strides. Thou art born of Aditi and art the younger brother of **INDRA**, born to bind Bali. O Fore most of the Gods, the purpose of the *Devas* has been accom plished I The wicked **RAVANA** with his sons and kinsmen has been slain ; the *Rishis*, who have piety as their wealth, and all the Gods are gratified. O Chief of the Immortals, all this has been brought about by Thy grace I " **SITA** is the personification of Labhmi and arose from the earth ; fbr thy sake, she was born in the House of Janab. Brinaing her to Lanb, **RAVANA** pmtected her with care u his ,.o r mother. O **RAMA**, I have related tbe whole story to thee, tbe immortal Narada dcscribcd it to hsviDg hcsrd it from the *Rishi* Sanatkumsra; Dashsllana followed the instructions of Sanatkumsra faithfuDy. " Whoever listens to this narrative in faitb and knowledge at tbe time of sacrifice, his offerings of food, becoming imperish able, reach tbe ancestorS." Hcsring this divine theme, tbc lotus-eyed **RAMA**, witb his brothers, was grcady astonished and tbc monkeys, tbcit eyes wide witb delight, witb **SUGRIVA**, the *Rakshasas*, Bibishana, the kings, their counsellors and the asacmblcd Btahmins, Kshstriyas, Vaishyas aod Shudras gazed on **RAMA** witb joy.

Then tbe highly ci!Wgmt Agastya said to **RAMA** : " O **RAMA**, we have all looked on aod been honoured by tbcc and now beg leave to depart." Speaking tbus and hsviDg received due homage, tbcy returned whence tbcy had come. The sun hsving act, **RAMA**, the foremost of men, bade filrcwell to tbe monkeys aod tbcir Sovereign and duly performed the Sandhya Rites ; tbcrcaftcr night hsving gradually act in, he entered the inner apartments. CHAPTBR 38 Rams 141m l4aw of his Alliu

CHAPTER 38

Rama takes leave of His Allies

r mother. O **RAMA**, I have related tbe whole story to thee, tbe immortal Narada dcscribcd it to hsviDg hcsrd it from the *Rishi* Sanatkumsra; Dashsllana followed the instructions of Sanatkumsra faithfuDy. " Whoever listens to this narrative in faitb and knowledge at tbe time of sacrifice, his offerings of food, becoming imperish able, reach tbe ancestorS." Hcsring this divine theme, tbc lotus-eyed **RAMA**, witb his brothers, was grcady astonished and tbc monkeys, tbcit eyes wide witb delight, witb **SUGRIVA**, the *Rakshasas*, Bibishana, the kings, their counsellors and the asacmblcd Btahmins, Kshstriyas, Vaishyas aod Shudras gazed on **RAMA** witb joy. Then tbe highly ci!Wgmt Agastya said to **RAMA** : " O **RAMA**, we have all looked on aod been honoured by tbcc and now beg leave to depart." Speaking tbus and hsviDg received due homage, tbcy returned whence tbcy had come. The sun hsving act, **RAMA**, the foremost of men, bade filrcwell to tbe monkeys aod tbcir Sovereign and duly performed the Sandhya Rites ; tbcrcaftcr night hsving gradually act in, he entered the inner apartments. CHAPTBR 38 Rams 141m l4aw of his Alliu " I am pleased with thee and thy conduct ;

as for the gems that thou hast heaped upon me, I bequeath them all to my daughter, O Prince I " **JANAKA** having departed, Raghava, with joined palms, respect fully addressed the son of Kaiteyi, his maternal uncle, the Prince Yudajita, aaying : " This empire, I myself, **BHARATA** and **LAKSHMANA** alao, are at thy disposal, O Lion among Men. The King, thine aged sire may be grieving on thy behalf and thy return this day will delight him, O Lord. **LAKSHMANA** will follow thee as thine escort after thou hast accepted wealth and gems of every kind." Acquiescing to his request, Yudajita answered " It is well! As for the pearls and gold, do thou retain them forever ! " There after, the aon of Kaiteya paid obeisance to **RAMA**, keeping him on his right hand and after receiving homage, he departed, followed by **LAKSHMANA** as **VISHNU** by lndra at the time of the destrUction of Vritra. Having bade farewell to his maternal uncle, **RAMA** embraced his friend, Pratardana, the King of Kashi, and addressed him in these words : " Thou hast proved thy friendship and devotion to the full, O Prince, as wimessed by the campaign undertaken with **BHARATA**. Now return this day to the enchanting City of Bensres of which thou art the support and which is surrounded by great walls and magnificent gateways." Speaking thus, the virtuous Kakutstha, rising from his throne, held him in a close embrace for along time, thereafter permitting him to take his leave. Bidding farewell to the King of Kashi, Raghava, the increaser of **KAUSHALYA**'s joy, speedily returned to his own city in safety. Having dismissed Kasheya, Raghava smilingly addressed courteous words to the hundred monarchs present and said to them: " Your loyalty has been unshakable and your affection enduting ; through the grace of your devotion and the proweaa of magnanimous warriors such aa you are, that insenaate and perverse wretch, **RAVANA**, has been alain I It is your prowess that has destroyed him, I was merely the occasion of his

destruction in the fight with his forces, his sons, his ministers and his kins folk. Hearing that the daughter of King]anoka had been bome away in the forest, the great-hearted **BHARATA** summoned you all. Your devotion has been unanimous, O Princes of great soul, but your stay here has been prolonged and I now wish to assure myself of your safe return." Then the kings, greatly delighted, answered him aaying : " By the grace of heaven thou hast triumphed, O Ramo, and hast regained thy kingdom ! By divine grace, thou hast re covered **SITA** I By divine grace, thy foe is vanquished I To behold thee victorious and delivered from thine enemies, O **RAMA**, was our most ardent desire and is now our supreme aatisfaction ! The praises thou hast heaped upoo us are narural to thee, O Thou whose merits are such that we cannot match them with our tributes. We are about to take leave of thee but thou wilt ever remain in our thoughts I O Long-armed Warrior, we shall retum full of devotion to thee. Mayest thou, O Great Prioce, ever hold us in atrection." " Be it so ! " replied Ramo and the kings, highly delighted paid obeisance to Raghava with joined palms, eager to rerum home and, having been duly honoured by him, went to their own countries.

CHAPTER 39

Rama loads His Allies with Gifts

Prosperous, happy, abounding in silver and grain and over flowing with treasure. Reaching their capitsls safely, those monarchs, anxious to gtatify **RAMA**, paid him homage by sending him every kind of precious object : horses, carriages, jewels, elephants intoxicated with ichor, rare sandalwood, celestial ornaments, gems, pearls, coral, lovely slave girls, coverinp made of goats skin and a variety of chariots. The mighty

BHARATA, **LAKSHMANA** and **SHATRUGHNA**, having accepted tbose gifts, took their way back to the capital and, returning to the ravishing Oty of Ayodhya, those lions among men handed all those objects of gteat price to **RAMA**, who, receiving them, joyfnDy bestowed them on **SUGRIVA**, who had fulfilled his duty, and also on Bibishana and the othet Rakabasas and the monkeys, by whose aid he had attained victory, and those monkeys and titans decorated their heads and arms with the jewels tbat **RAMA** had given them. Thereaftet, the Sovereign of the Ikshvakus, tbat warrior of the gteat car, he whose eyea resembled the petals of the lotus, **RAMA**, seating **HANUMAN** and Anpda on his knees, said to **SUGRIVA** : " This Anpda, thine illustrious son, and the Son of the Wind, thy ministet, O **SUGRIVA**, both of whom are endowed with wiadom and devoted to our intetests, merit kind of honour and, on thine account also, O King of the Monkeys." With these words, the illustrious **RAMA** took off some extremely rare ornaments from his breast and decorated **ANGADA** and **HANUMAN** with them. Theteafter Raghava addreased the foremost of the monkey leadets-Nila, Nala, Kesharin, Kumuda, Gandhamadaua, Sushena, Panasa, the valiant Mainda and Dvivida, **JAMBAVAN**, Gavaksha, Vinata and Dhumra, Balimukha, and Prajangha, Samuada of gteat valour, Darimukba, Dadhimukba and Iudra-Uttering these words, that lion among men bestowed jewels upon them in accord with their desserts as also diamonds of great price and then embraced them aU. Thereafter they drank of fragrant honey and partook of choice viands, roots and fruits and, sojourning there for a month, such was their devotion to **RAMA**, that it seemed to them that but an hour had passed. **RAMA** too spent the time happily in the company of the monkeys, who were able to change their form at will, and the extremely powerful titans and bears of great energy. In this way the second month of autumn passed and the monkeys and titans savoured

delights of every kind in that city belonging to the Ikshvakus that was full of allurements and, during the time they were thus entertained, by the grace of Ramo’s affectionate regard, the hours flew by happily for them.

CHAPTER 40

Rama takes leave of the Bears, Monkeys and Titans

IN this way, the bears, monkeys and titans passed their time with **RAMA**, and theresfter the mighty Raghava said to **SUGRIVA** : " Return to Kishkindha, My Friend, which may not be conquered by the Gods or Asurss themsdves. With thy ministers, rule over thine empire without hindrance. O Mighty King, thou shouldst look on Angads with supreme affection as also **HANUMAN** and the great-hearted Nala, Sushena thy valiant father-in-law, and Tara the foremost of warriors, the invinable Kamuds and Nila who is full of strength, the energetic Shatabali, Mainda, Dvivida, Gaja, Gavaksha, Gavaya, the mighty Shanbha and the King of the Bean the indomitable Jamhavan. Look also with affection on Gandhamadsna, the agile Rishabha, the Plavamgamas Suptala, Kesharin, Shumbha and Shankashuda, aU these n1gnnimous ones, who in order to serve my cauae were ready to give up their lives ; look on them always with friendli· ness and never cause them pain.” Having spoken thus to **SUGRIVA**, whom he embraced again and again, **RAMA** said a1fectionatdy to Bibishana : .. Do thou rule Lanb wthfully ; thou art conversant with ss thy duty, this is my CODviction md also of those iD the capital, the R.skshasas aDd thy brother VaishraVBDS. Give no place iD thy soul to evil, O King I Just moll8fCbs are assuted of earthly

prosperity. ThiDk ever of me aDd Sugtiva, mine ally, O Prince, md iD perfect CODtentmeDt go hence without aDXicty I " HcariDg Rams's words, the bears, mcmkcys md *Rakshasas* cried, "Eacellent! Excellent! " praiaiDg Kakutstha again and again, saying : " Thy wisdom, O Long-<U:JDcd Hero, thy worulerful valout, thine extreme goodlless, O Rams, baa ever rcruiercd thee the equal of Swyambhu I " While the mcmkcys aDd the titaDS were spcakiDg thus, HBD1l111811, bowing to Rsghava, said : " I shall ever hold thee iD the gteatcSt affection, O Prince, my devotion is thine forevct, O Hero, nor shall I give mine aUegimce to my other object. As long as thy story is told iD the world, assuredly life will remain iD my body, O ValiaDt Rams. The Apsaras will recount thiDe history md all thy diviDe exploits to me, O Joy of the ltsghus, O Uon among Men, md, listening to them, O Great Hero, the nectar of thy deeds will dispel all mine aDXieties, as the wind chases away a tlock of clouds. " As HBD1l111811 was spcaltiDg, Rams rose from his marvellous throne md, embraciDg him tenderly, said to him : " Undoubtedly so will it be, O Best of Mcmkcys, as long as my story is current iD the world, so long will thy fame endute md life remain iD thy body. For every service thou hast rendered me, I would give up my life aDd still remain thy debtor, O Monkey. In mine heart, the memory of what thou hast done for me will ever abide, O HBD1l111811 ; it is iD times of misfortune that one baa recourse to those whom one baa benefited." Thereafter, taking from his neck a string of pearls from which ID emerald as bright as the mOOD hung, Rsghava placed it round Hmumm's md, with that rope of pearls fiilliDg on his breast, the monkey appeared as radiant as Mount Sumeru wbCD the moon passes over the summit of that golden peak. At a signal from Hmumm, those powerful monkeys, having placed theit heads at the feet of Rsghava, rising one after the other, went away. **SUGRIVA**, who held **RAMA** in a

firm embrace, and the virtuous Bibishana were shaking with sobs and all were waping, their eyes brimming with tears, beside themselves, distracted with grief as it were, on leaving Raghava. Overwhelmed with gifts by the maguanimous **RAMA**, each returned to his own country, as souls leave the body. Titans, bears and monkeys, after bowing to Rams, the Increaser of the glory of the Raghu Race, their eyes filled with tears, caused by that separation, took the road to their own countries.

CHAPTER 41

Rama dismisses the Pushpaka Chariot

HAVING said farewell to the bears, the monkeys and the titans, the long-armed **RAMA** began to live happily with his brothers. One day, at noon, that great Prince Raghava heard a melodious voice speaking from the sky, saying : " O My Friend **RAMA**, look on me and know, O Prince, that it is I, Pushpata, who come from Kuvera's abode. At his command I have returned from his palace ; it is he, O First of Men, who has told me to place myself at thy service, saying : " ' Thou hast been won by the magnanimous Prince Raghava in the fight when he struck down **RAVANA**, that invincible Monarch of the Titans. I experienced supreme felicity on the slaying of that wretch with his forces, sons and kinsfolk. Having been made captive in Lanka by **RAMA**, the Paramatman, do thou go and serve him as a vehicle, O Friend I It is I who command thee I It is my supreme desire that thou shoulclst carry that hero, the Joy of the Raghu Race, round the world ; go without anxiety I' " Obedient to the behests of the illustrious Dhanada, I have reached thee without dl11iculty and place myself at thy disposal. Inaccessible to s1l beings, at Dhanada's will, in obedience to thy commands I come to surrender my

power to thy service.” Hearing theae words, the valiant **RAMA** 8Diwered the Pushpab Car in the sky, that had returned to him. SBying : IL " O Most woudertUI of cbariotl, O Pushpeka, welcome to thee; Dbanada’s generosity must not find me wanting I " Thereafter the long-armed Raghava paid homage to Pushpab with roasted grain, Bowers and fragrant perfumes, saying : " Go now, O Pushpab, wherever thou desirest but come again whenever I call thee mind I Go by the path of the Siddhas, O Friend, and let no harm come to thee. Mayest thou not suffer any collision in thy fantastic journeyings in space, such is my will! " Ramo, having dismissed the aerial with due homage, Pushpab replying ' So be it,' went whcreaoever it desired and, when that chariot of pure soul had disappeared, **BHARATA**, with joined palms, addressed his elder brother, the Joy of the House of Raghu, saying : " O Hero, thou who hast the soul of a God, under thy rule one beholds beings who are not of the human race speaking frequently, nor is there any disease among men and their days are passed in peace ; even the aged do not die and women give birth without pain, whilst all enjoy good heslth. A real felicity is to be seen among the citizens and, in the rainy season, Parjanyalets loose the nectar of immortality; soft auspicious and balmy breezes blow and the people of town and country all exclaim ' May such a king reign over us long ', O Prince! " Hearing these gracious and flattering words spoken by **BHARATA**, Ramo, the foremost of monarchs, was supretnely ptified.

CHAPTER 42

The Felicity enjoyed by Rama and Sita

TM Fdicity mjo;yed by **RAMA** lltld Sits Mandara and Kadali Trees screened it with a web of thicket and creepers ; Priyangu, Kadamba, Bakula, Jambu, Dadima and Kovidara Trees embellished it on every side with their magnifi cent flowers, marvellous fruits of celestial fragrances, divine nectar, tender shoots and buds. Heavenly of graceful sbape, thick with heavy foliage and enchanting blossom were humming with intoxicated bees. Kokilas, Bhringarajas and other birds of varied plumage, their heads crowned with polleo from the Mango Trees, added to the besuty of those marvellous woods. Some of the trees had the brilliance of gold or resembled tongues of flame, others were as dark as collyrium and every where only flowers of sweet fragrance and wreaths of blossom of all kinds were to be found. Pools of various sbapes, filled with limpid water on which tufts of flowering lotus and water-lilies floated, were approached by steps made of rubies. Trees in full flower adorned the banks which re-echoed to the call of Datyubas and Shukas and the cries of geese and swans. Tbat grove was eocloaed by flat rocks of differing forms within which were many grassy glades of the sbeeo of emerald and pearl, and these were adorned by trees rivalling each other in the profusion of their blossom, the earth beoeath being heaped with flowers, resembling the sky full of stars, so tbat it appeared like the gardeo of **INDRA** or Chaitaratba crested by **BRAHMA**. Such was **RAMA**'s pastoral retreat with its arbours filled with countless seats and grassy couches inviting one to rest ; and the Increaser of Raghu's joy eotered tbat magnificeot Asboka Grove and seated himself on a throne of great splendour which was decorated with innumerable flowers and covered with a carpet of Kusba Grass. Taking **SITA** by the hand, Kakutstba gave her delicious wine made of distilled honey to drink, as formerly Purandara had offered to Sachi. Thereafter pure viands and fruirs of every kind were brought by servants, whilst lovely Apsaras, skilled in

the arts of singing and dancing, began to perform in the Prince's preseoce and troops of Nymphs and Uragas, surrounded by the Kinneris intoxicated with wine, danced before Kakutstha, and the virtuous **RAMA**, the most captivating of warriors, delig_hted those ravishing and charming womeo. $1P Seated by Vaidebi, he was radiant with sple:Ddour and resembled **VASISHTHA** at the aide of Arundhati. In this way, in the joy that possessed him, **RAMA**, like unto a God, each day prepared some new delight for **SITA**, the Princess of Videba, who was like unto the daughter of a Celestial Being. While **SITA** and Raghava sported thus for a long lime, the flowery season, that yields perpetual enjoymenr, passed away and, as those two tasted every kind of felicity, Spring appeared once more. One day, having fulfilled the functions of state, that virtuous Prince returned to his palace where he spent the rest of the day. On her side, **SITA**, having worshipped the Gods and performed her morning duties, offering her services to aU her mothers-in-law without distinction, thereafter adorned herself with marveUous jewels and re-joined Ramo, like unto Sachi when re-united with that God of a Thousand Eyes as he returns to his City Trivishtapa. Beholding his consort glowing with beauty, Raghava experi enced an unequalled delight and ezclaimed " It is weU ! " then he addressed the lovely **SITA**, who resembled a daughter of the Gods, and said : .. Now, O Vaidebi, that thou dost bear a child in thy womb, what dost thou desire, O Lady of lovely hips ? What pleasure can I prepare for thee ? " Smiling, Vaidehi answered Ramo, saying : " O Ragbava, I wish to visit the sacred retreats of the *Rishis* of rigid penances, who dweU on the banks of the Ganges where they subsist on fruit and roots, and there I wiU throw myself at their feet, O Lord. O Kakutstha, it is my supreme desire even to pass a night in the hermitage of these ascetics who live on fruit and roots." Then Ramo of imperishable exploits gave her

permiasinn to do so, saying : “Be at peace, O Vaidebi, to-morrow without fail, thou shalt go there I” Having answered Maithili, born of Janak, in this wise, Kakutstha went to the central court surrounded by his liienda.

CHAPTER 43

Rama informs Himself concerning current Rumours from His Friends

monkeys, bean and Rabbasas subject to him. Having slain **RAVANA** in the figbt and recovered **SITA**, Ragbava, having mastered his anger, bas taken his spouse into his house again. What pleasure can his heart experience in possessing **SITA**, whom **RAVANA** formerly held in his lap, having borne her away by force ? How is it that **RAMA** was not filled with aversion for her after she bad been taken to Lanlra and conducted to the Ashoka Grove, where she was left to the mercy of the titanS ? We shall now have to countenance the same state of affairs regarding our own wives, since what a king does, his subjects follow!' " These are the sayings current everywhere among the people of town and country, O King.” At these words, Ragbava, stricken with grief, aslted, " Is it thus that they speak of me ? " Then all, bowing to the ground in reverence, answered the unfortunate Ragbava and said : " It is ttue, O Lord of the Earth I "

CHAPTER 44

Rama summons His Brothers

by the Gods and Danavu together. With his root-soldiers and cavalry, he has destroyed the invincible **RAVANA** and has made the monkeys, bean and Rabbasas subject to him. Having slain **RAVANA** in the figbt and recovered **SITA**, Ragbava, having mastered his anger, bas taken his spouse into his house again. What pleasure can his heart experience in possessing **SITA**, whom **RAVANA** formerly held in his lap, having borne her away by force ? How is it that **RAMA** was not filled with aversion for her after she bad been taken to Lanlra and conducted to the Ashoka Grove, where she was left to the mercy of the titanS ? We shall now have to countenance the same state of affairs regarding our own wives, since what a king does, his subjects follow!' " These are the sayings current everywhere among the people of town and country, O King." At these words, Ragbava, stricken with grief, aslted, " Is it thus that they speak of me ? " Then all, bowing to the ground in reverence, answered the unfortunate Ragbava and said : " It is ttue, O Lord of the Earth I " " The King desires to see thee, do thou go to him without delay!" " It is well ! " answered Saumitri and, in obedience to Rag hava's command, he ascended a chariot and hasteoed to the palace. When he had departed, the doorkeeper approached **BHARATA** and, saluting him in a like manner, said : " The king respectfully requests thy presence I " Hearing these instructions issued by **RAMA**, **BHARATA**, rising swiftly from his seat, started out hurriedly on foot. Beholding the virtuous Bharsta going away, the messenger speedily approached **SHATRUGHNA**'s abode and, with joined palms, addressed him, saying : " Go quickly, O Prince of the Raghus, the king wishes to see thee ; **LAKSHMANA** has already preceded thee as a1ao the re nowned Bharsta." At these words, **SHATRUGHNA** desceoded from his throne and, bowing to the ground, weot to rejoin Raghava. Meantime the messeoger having returned, paid obeisance to **RAMA** and made it known to him thst his brothers had

come. Learning of the youthful princes' arrival, **RAMA**, who was deeply troubled, with a downcast mien, sad at heart, said to the door keeper: " Make haste and uaher them into my presence I Mine existence depends on them, they are my very life's breath I " At this command from thst **INDRA** of Men, the princes, attired in white, bowed with joined palma and entered respectfully. On behol.ding **RAMA**, who resembled the moon in eclipse or the sun thst the dusk robs of its splendour, whose eyes were filled with CHAPT!II 4S Rlmta commtmtls LD/ulmuzluJ to tak **SITA** to the Hermitage ALL having taken their places tiill of sadness, Kakutstha, his features stricken, said to them : " Hear me all of you, may good betide you ! Do not let your attention wander ! 'Ibis is what people are saying about me concerning **SITA** ! The inhabitants of the city as also those of the country censure me severely and their criticism pierces my heart ! I am born in the Race of the illustrious Ikshvalrus and **SITA** belongs to the family of the great-souled Jllllka. My Desr **LAKSHMANA**, thou knowest bow, in the lonely forest, **RAVANA** bore **SITA** away and that I destroyed him. It was then that the thought came to me regarding the daughter of **JANAKA**, ' How can I bring **SITA** baclt to Ayodhya from this place ? ' Thereupon, in order to re-assure me, **SITA** entered the fire in my presence and that of the Gods, O Saumitri I **AGNI**, the Bearer of sacrificial ofl'crings, witnessed to Maitbili's innocence and Vayu also, who was then joumeying through space, and Chandra and Aditya proclaimed it formerly before the Gods and all the Risbis, that the daughter of Jllllka was without fault. The Gods and Gandharvas testified to her pure conduct in Lanka, where Mahendra placed the proofs in my hand, further I knew from my own inner being that the illustrious **SITA** was innocent. It was then that I took her haclt and returned to Ayodhya. Since then a great sadness, on bearing the censure of the people of town and country, has filled my heart. Whoever it may

be, if his ill fame be current in the world, he alis to a lower state, so long as the defamatory rumours eziat. Dishonour is condemned by the Gods ; honour is revered in the world and, it is on account of fair repute, that great souls act. As for me, so greatly do I fear dishonour that I would renounce my life and you yourselves on ita account, O Bulla among Men. how much more therefore is it incumbent on me to separate myself UoJD the daughter of Jllllllka. See therefore in what an ocesn of grief I have alien I There is no misfortune greater than this I To-morrow, at dawn, ,34

CHAPTER 45

Rama commands Lakshmana to take Sita to the Hermitage

CHAPT!II 4S Rlmta commtmtls LD/ulmuzluJ to tak **SITA** to the Hermitage ALL having taken their places tiill of sadness, Kakutstha, his features stricken, said to them : " Hear me all of you, may good betide you ! Do not let your attention wander ! 'Ibis is what people are saying about me concerning **SITA** ! The inhabitants of the city as also those of the country censure me severely and their criticism pierces my heart ! I am born in the Race of the illustrious Ikshvalrus and **SITA** belongs to the family of the great-souled Jllllllka. My Desr **LAKSHMANA**, thou knowest bow, in the lonely forest, **RAVANA** bore **SITA** away and that I destroyed him. It was then that the thought came to me regarding the daughter of **JANAKA**, ' How can I bring **SITA** baclt to Ayodhya from this place ? ' Thereupon, in order to re-assure me, **SITA** entered the fire in my presence and that of the Gods, O Saumitri I **AGNI**, the Bearer of sacrificial ofl’crings, witnessed to Maitbili’s innocence and Vayu also,

who was then joumeying through space, and Chandra and Aditya proclaimed it formerly before the Gods and all the Risbis, that the daughter of Jllllllka was without fault. The Gods and Gandharvas testified to her pure conduct in Lanka, where Mahendra placed the proofs in my hand, further I knew from my own inner being that the illustrious **SITA** was innocent. It was then that I took her haclt and returned to Ayodhya. Since then a great sadness, on bearing the censure of the people of town and country, has filled my heart. Whoever it may be, if his ill fame be current in the world, he alis to a lower state, so long as the defamatory rumours eziat. Dishonour is condemned by the Gods ; honour is revered in the world and, it is on account of fair repute, that great souls act. As for me, so greatly do I fear dishonour that I would renounce my life and you yourselves on ita account, O Bulla among Men. how much more therefore is it incumbent on me to separate myself UoJD the daughter of Jllllllka. See therefore in what an ocesn of grief I have alien I There is no misfortune greater than this I To-morrow, at dawn, ,34 O Saumiai, take my chariot with Sumantta as thy charioteer and, causing **SITA** to asceod it, leave her beyond the confines of the kingdom. " On the further side of the Ganges, the magnanimous **VALMIKI** has bis hermitage of celestial aspect situated by the Tamaaa ; it is in a solitaty spot that thou shouldst leave her, O Thou who an the Joy of the House of Raghu. Go quickly, O Saumitri, and cany out my behest. Do not discuss it in any way ; go therefore, O Saumiai, it is not the time fur observa· tions. Any resistence on thy pan will cause me extreme dis plessure. Yea, I swear to thee by my two feet, by my life, that those who seek to make me alter my resolve in any way pr oppose my desire, I shall deem to be mine enemies. If you are subject to me and hold me in reverence, then obey me and take **SITA** away from here this very day. Formerly she appealed to me saying, ' I wish to visit the aacred

retreats of the bsnks of the Ganges ', let her wish be fulfilled I " Having spoken thus, the vinuous K.akutstha, his eyes filled with tears, re-entered bis apanments esconed by his brotbera, bis bean riven with grief, sighing like an elephant. CHAPTBR 46 La1uhmtma filMs **SITA** ....., WHBN the night had passed, Labhmana, with a aad bean and downcast mien, said to Sumantta : " O Charioteer, harness swift horses to the most escellent of can and, by the king's orders, prepare a comfunable and luxurious seat fur **SITA**, abe, in accord with the king's wish, under

CHAPTER 46

Lakshmana takes Sita away

O Saumiai, take my chariot with Sumantta as thy charioteer and, causing **SITA** to asceod it, leave her beyond the confines of the kingdom. " On the further side of the Ganges, the magnanimous **VALMIKI** has bis hermitage of celestial aspect situated by the Tamaaa ; it is in a solitaty spot that thou shouldst leave her, O Thou who an the Joy of the House of Raghu. Go quickly, O Saumitri, and cany out my behest. Do not discuss it in any way ; go therefore, O Saumiai, it is not the time fur observa· tions. Any resistence on thy pan will cause me extreme dis plessure. Yea, I swear to thee by my two feet, by my life, that those who seek to make me alter my resolve in any way pr oppose my desire, I shall deem to be mine enemies. If you are subject to me and hold me in reverence, then obey me and take **SITA** away from here this very day. Formerly she appealed to me saying, ' I wish to visit the aacred retreats of the bsnks of the Ganges ', let her wish be fulfilled I " Having spoken thus, the vinuous K.akutstha, his eyes filled with tears, re-entered bis apanments esconed by his brotbera, bis bean riven with grief, sighing like an

elephant. CHAPTBR 46 La1uhmtma filMs **SITA** ....., WHBN the night had passed, Labhmana, with a aad bean and downcast mien, said to Sumantta : " O Charioteer, harness swift horses to the most escellent of can and, by the king's orders, prepare a comfunable and luxurious seat fur **SITA**, abe, in accord with the king's wish, under At these words of Sumantra, Labhmana -=teled the King's palace and, having approached Sits, that Bull among Men addressed her thus : "According to the wish that thou didst express to him, that Lord of Men, the king, has charged me to take thee to the desired retreats. At the request of our sovereign, I will conduct thee without delay to those excellent solitudes of the Risbis on the banks of the Ganges, O Divine Vaidebi. I sball take thee to those hermitages inhabited by the Sages." At these words of the magnanimous **LAKSHMANA**, Vaidebi experienced supreme felicity, so grestly did the thought of the expedition please her and, having furnished herself with costly raiment and jewels of every kind, she prepared to depart, saying: " I sball give these jewels as also the eJ:cellent robes and various treasures to the wives of the ascetics." " It is well ", said Saumitri, causing Maithili to ascend the chariot and, recolleeting **RAMA**'s command, he went forward drawn by swift horses. Thereafter Sits said to **LAKSHMANA**, the increaser of prosperity : " I behold countless inauspicious omens, O Joy of the House of Raghu, observe how my left eye twitches and all my limbs tremble, further my mind is confused and I feel eztremely restless whilst all my courage has ebbed away, O Saumitri. The earth appears deserted, O Large-eyed Prince, can thy brother be happy, O Thou who art so devoted to him? May all be well with my mothers-in-law without distinction, O Hero ! May all beings in town and country be happy ! " Thus, with joined palms, Sits, the divine Maithili prayed, and **LAKSHMANA** listening, bent his head and, though his heart was contracted with grief, he cried in joyous aaents, " Mayest

thou too be happy I " Meantime they reached the hanks of the Ganmati and rested in a hermitage, and the following day, at dawn, Saumitri, rising, said to the charioteer : " Harness the car speedily I To-day, with great strength, I sball bear the waters of the Bhagirathi on my head, as did Tryambaka.'" 1bua commanded, the driver with joined palma, said to Vaidehi: " Mount I " and he gave rein to the honea yoked to the chariot, who were as swift as thought, whereupon she, hearing the voice of the charioteer, ascended that excellent car. There after the large-eyed Sits accompanied by Saumitri and Sumantra reached the Ganges, that destroys all sin and, arriving there at noon, beholding the waters of the Bhagirathi, the unfortunate **LAKSHMANA** began to weep openly in bis profound distress and the virtuous **SITA**, in her extreme solicitude, observing Laksh mana's misery, enquired of him, saying: " Wherefore art thou groaning? We have reached the banks of the Jabnavi. the object of my desires for a long time and, at the moment of rejoicing, why dost thou cause me pain in this wise, O **LAKSHMANA** ? O Bull among Men, is thy grief on account of these two days absence from **RAMA**, thou who art ever in attendance on bim ? **RAMA** is dearer to me than life, O Laksh mana, yet I do not distress myself; do not behave like a child ! Let us cross the Ganges and visit the Sages so that I may distribute the raiment and jewels. Having paid homage to the great Risbis, which we owe to them and, passing one dsy there, we shall return to the city. My heart is impatient to see

CHAPTER 47

Lakshmana tells Sita she has been repudiated

1bua commanded, the driver with joined palma, said to Vaidehi: " Mount I " and he gave rein to the honea yoked to the chariot, who were as swift as thought, whereupon she, hearing the voice of the charioteer, ascended that excellent car. There after the large-eyed Sits accompanied by Saumitri and Sumantra reached the Ganges, that destroys all sin and, arriving there at noon, beholding the waters of the Bhagirathi, the unfortunate **LAKSHMANA** began to weep openly in bis profound distress and the virtuous **SITA**, in her extreme solicitude, observing Laksh mana's misery, enquired of him, saying: " Wherefore art thou groaning? We have reached the banks of the Jabnavi. the object of my desires for a long time and, at the moment of rejoicing, why dost thou cause me pain in this wise, O **LAKSHMANA** ? O Bull among Men, is thy grief on account of these two days absence from **RAMA**, thou who art ever in attendance on bim ? **RAMA** is dearer to me than life, O Laksh mana, yet I do not distress myself; do not behave like a child ! Let us cross the Ganges and visit the Sages so that I may distribute the raiment and jewels. Having paid homage to the great Risbis, which we owe to them and, passing one dsy there, we shall return to the city. My heart is impatient to see Arriving at the artber bank at the Bhagirathi, Labbmana, with joined palms, his ace bathed in tears, said : "A stake has been driven into my heart by the noble and virtuous **RAMA**, which will bring universal censure upon me. Death were better for me this day, verily death would be preferable to the mission on which I am engaged, which the world will condemn. Forgive me and do not impute this offence to me, O Illustrious Princess." Thereafter, making obeisance, Labhmana threw himself on the earth. Seeing him weep, paying her homage and calling on death, Maithili, alarmed, said to Labhmana : " What is this ? I do not understand anything ; tell me the truth, O Labhmana, why att thou agitated ? Is the king well ? Tell me the cause at thy grief!" Thus

questioned by Vaidehi, Labhmana, his heart filled with anguish, with bowed head, choked with sobs, addressed her saying : " Having learnt in open council that he was the object of censure in the city and country on thine account, O Daughter of Janab, **RAMA**, his heart riven, returning home told me of it. I am unable to repeat the things spoken in confidence to me, O Queen. Although thou att blameless in mine eyes, the king has repudiated thee. Public condemnation has per turbed him; do not misunderstand the matter, O Goddess. I am to leave thee in the vicinity of the sacred hermitages. The king has commanded me to do so on the pretext of satisfying thy desire. The ascetics' retreats on the banks of the Jahnavi are sacred and enchanting, do not give way to grief, O Lovely One. The foremost of *Rishis*, the supretncly illustrious Sage Valmild was a great friend of thy sire, King **DASARATHA**. Taking refuge under the shadow at the feet of that magnanimous One and living in chastity, be happy, O Daughter at Janab. It is by remaining filithful to thy Lord and practising devotion to **RAMA** in thine heart that thou shalt, by thy conduct, acquire supreme felicity, O Goddess." CRAPTBR 48 Lalulmuuta kaws **SITA** "" the Banks t1{ the G1Jt181 Hl!AiuNG **LAKSHMANA**'s harsh words, the daughter of Janak, overcome with despair, fell to the ground but, regaining con sciousness after a time, her eyes bathed in tears, she addresaed bim in btoken accents, saying : "Assuredly this body of mine baa been created for misfortune and is its supporter froJ:n this time forward. What sin can I have committed in days gone by or whom did I separate from bet husband, that I, who am virtuous and chaste, should be caat off by the king? " Formerly I lived in the forest following in Ramo's footsteps and was content in the misfortune in which I found myself, O Prince, now, how can I, abandoned by all, live in solitude, O dear **LAKSHMANA** ? To whom shall I confide the allliction that has overwhelmed me ? What can I say

to the ascetics, O Lord ? For what sin, for what reason, am I repudiated by the magnani mous Ragbava ? I may not yield up my life in the of the Ganges, lest I bring the royal line to an end I Therefore do what thou haat been commanded, O Saumitri, leave me to my wretched plight I It is for thee to carry out the king's behests, yet hear me-do thou with joined palms pay homage to all my mothers-in-law and, having worshipped his feet, address the king. With bowed head, speak to them all, O **LAKSHMANA**, and do thou also say to the king, who is ever bed in his duty, O Ragbava, thou knowest I am truly pure and that I have been bound to thee in supreme love, yet thou hast renounced me in fear of dishonour, because thy subjects have reproached and censured thee, O Hero. Thou shouldst, however have spared me, since thou art my only refuge.' Further, thou shouldst aay to the king who is established in righteousness, 'As thou dost act in regard to thy brothers, so shouldst thou act in regard to thy subjects ; this is pre-eminently thy duty and will bring thee immeasurable renown ; by its observance thou wilt enjoy the fruits of the earth I As for me, I am not distressed on mine own

CHAPTER 48

Lakshmana leaves Sita on the Banks of the Ganges

CRAPTBR 48 Lalulmuuta kaws **SITA** "" the Banks t1{ the G1Jt181 Hl!AiuNG **LAKSHMANA**'s harsh words, the daughter of Janak, overcome with despair, fell to the ground but, regaining con sciousness after a time, her eyes bathed in tears, she addresaed bim in btoken accents, saying : "Assuredly this body of mine baa been created for misfortune and is its supporter froJ:n this time forward. What sin can I have committed in days gone by or whom did I separate from bet

husband, that I, who am virtuous and chaste, should be caat off by the king? " Formerly I lived in the forest following in Ramo's footsteps and was content in the misfortune in which I found myself, O Prince, now, how can I, abandoned by all, live in solitude, O dear **LAKSHMANA** ? To whom shall I confide the allliction that has overwhelmed me ? What can I say to the ascetics, O Lord ? For what sin, for what reason, am I repudiated by the magnani mous Ragbava ? I may not yield up my life in the of the Ganges, lest I bring the royal line to an end I Therefore do what thou haat been commanded, O Saumitri, leave me to my wretched plight I It is for thee to carry out the king's behests, yet hear me-do thou with joined palms pay homage to all my mothers-in-law and, having worshipped his feet, address the king. With bowed head, speak to them all, O **LAKSHMANA**, and do thou also say to the king, who is ever bed in his duty, O Ragbava, thou knowest I am truly pure and that I have been bound to thee in supreme love, yet thou hast renounced me in fear of dishonour, because thy subjects have reproached and censured thee, O Hero. Thou shouldst, however have spared me, since thou art my only refuge.' Further, thou shouldst aay to the king who is established in righteousness, 'As thou dost act in regard to thy brothers, so shouldst thou act in regard to thy subjects ; this is pre-eminently thy duty and will bring thee immeasurable renown ; by its observance thou wilt enjoy the fruits of the earth I As for me, I am not distressed on mine own acoount, O Prince of Raghu, it ia for thee to keep thy fair name untarnished ! The husband ia as a God to the woman, he ia her family, and her spiritual preceptor, therefore, even at the price of her life, she must seek to plesse her lord.' " Repeat these words to Rams, it is all I ask of thee. Having borne witness that I am tar sdvanced in pregnancy, do thou depart." So did **SITA** speak and **LAKSHMANA**, ssd at heart, bowed to the earth without being able to answer her. Thereafter he circum· ambulated her

sobbing aloud and, after reflecting awhile, said : " What hast thou said, O Beautiful Princess, I have never raised mine eyes to thy face and have ever but looked on thy feet, O Irreproachable One. How should I, in his absence, dare to gaze upon the one Rams has abandoned in the lonely forest ? " With these words, he paid obeisance to her and re-entered the boat. Boarding the skiff, he urged the ferryman on, saying : " Cross to the farther shore." Beside himself with grief, in deep allliction, he, having reached the other bank proceeded in his swiftly moving chariot, rurning round again and again to gaze on **SITA**, who, as if bereft of all support, was wandering about distraught on the farther aide of the Ganges. Her eyes fixed on the chariot and on **LAKSHMANA**, now tar distant, **SITA** was overcome with grief, and, crushed by the weight of her misfortune, the illustrious, noble and virtuous woman, seeing herself without a protector in the forest, that re-echoed to the cry of peacocks, a prey to despair, burst into loud sobs. CHAPTBR 4!1 V almiki """" **SITA** 1ril Protlttitm

CHAPTER 49

Valmiki offers Sita His Protection

acoount, O Prince of Raghu, it ia for thee to keep thy fair name untarnished ! The husband ia as a God to the woman, he ia her family, and her spiritual preceptor, therefore, even at the price of her life, she must seek to plesse her lord.' " Repeat these words to Rams, it is all I ask of thee. Having borne witness that I am tar sdvanced in pregnancy, do thou depart." So did **SITA** speak and **LAKSHMANA**, ssd at heart, bowed to the earth without being able to answer her. Thereafter he circum· ambulated her sobbing aloud and, after reflecting awhile, said : " What

hast thou said, O Beautiful Princess, I have never raised mine eyes to thy face and have ever but looked on thy feet, O Irreproachable One. How should I, in his absence, dare to gaze upon the one Rams has abandoned in the lonely forest ? " With these words, he paid obeisance to her and re-entered the boat. Boarding the skiff, he urged the ferryman on, saying : " Cross to the farther shore." Beside himself with grief, in deep allliction, he, having reached the other bank proceeded in his swiftly moving chariot, rurning round again and again to gaze on **SITA**, who, as if bereft of all support, was wandering about distraught on the farther aide of the Ganges. Her eyes fixed on the chariot and on **LAKSHMANA**, now tar distant, **SITA** was overcome with grief, and, crushed by the weight of her misfortune, the illustrious, noble and virtuous woman, seeing herself without a protector in the forest, that re-echoed to the cry of peacocks, a prey to despair, burst into loud sobs. CHAPTBR 4!1 V almiki """" **SITA** 1ril Protlttitm seen and who must be the consort of some great man, her features distorted, is lalllCDting in the vicinity of the hermitage I O Blessed One, thou wilt surely deem her to be a goddess fallen from heaven! Verily the most lovely of in deep distress, appeared before us on the bank of a river, shedding scalding tears, overcome by grief. In this misfortune that was assuredly not merited, she is alone and without a protector. We do not know the lady but do thou receive her with kindness for she is close to this retreat and bas come to refuge with thee." **VALMIKI**, that Prince of Sages, being aware of everything by virtue of his asceticism, ascertaining the truth of their words, with rapid steps went to where the Queen was weeping, and, as he strode forward, the disciples followed that illustrious *Muni*. Bearing the Arghya in his hands, proceeding on foot, the sagacious Valmilri reached the banks of the river and beheld Ragbava's beloved consort IBIDCDting like one bereft. Thereafter, having consoled her by virtue of

his holiness, the great ascetic addressed her in a sweet voice, saying : " O Virtuous Lady, thou art the daughter-in-law of King **DASARATHA**, Rams's beloved consort, the daughter of Janak I O Faithful One, by virtue of my meditations, the cause that brings thee here bas been revealed to me. O Auspicious One, I am fully aware of thy purity, for all that comes to pass in the Three Worlds is known to me. By my spiritual vision, I am convinced of thy chaste conduct, O Daughter of Janalta ; thou art under my protection, O Vaidelti, take comfort I Not filr from mine hermitage there are many female ascetics established in pious practices, they will care for thee as for their own daughter, O Hearing their words, **VALMIKI** *answered*: " This lady is **SITA**, the aJDSOrt of the virtuous **RAMA**, she is the daughter-in-law of King Da88laths, the chaste daughter of **JANAKA**. Though innocent, her husband has renounced her, we should all therefore protect her ; she is worthy of our affection I Such is my wish, who am your spiritnal preceptor ; at my behest, do ye pay her every honour." Having placed **SITA** in the charge of those female ascetics, the and illustrious Sage **VALMIKI**, followed by his disciples, returned to his hermitage. The foUMJJinl TraditiDMI V ma appear l#e in the llrigiMl text THus has this ancient tale been narrated in its entirety, may good betide you I May the might of **VISHNU** increase I Those who have installed **SHRI RAMA**, who is the colour of a blue lotus, in their heart, will achieve success, nor will they ever ezperience defeat ! May the rains come when they are needed ; may the earth bring forth a rich harvest of grain and may the land be free from disorders. May the brshmins be without anxiety and just. May prosperity reign in due time and the monsoons never faiL May Raghunath ever triumph and Shri ever reign. May the kings of the earth protect their subjecta in accord with justice. May the cows and the *brahmins* prosper. May all the worlds be happy. May good fortune attend the King of Koshala, who is an

ocean of virtue ; may good fortune attend on that monarch born of the Sovereisn of the World. UTT ARA *KANDA* are full of joy, who is, with his brothers and **SITA**, ever devoted to his sire. May good fortune attend on the One who is constant and noble, who dwelt in and abandoned Ssketa (*Ayodhya*) and wan dered about Chittrakuta worshipped by the self-controlled. May good fortune attend on my Guru, who, bearing the bow, the arrow and the sword, was ever worshipped with devotion by Janski and **LAKSHMANA**. May good fortune attend on that King of the Vultures who dwelt in the Dandaka Forest, who is the enemy of those who oppose the Gods, who is a great devotee and a granter of liberation. May good betide him who is exalted by Satrwa, who is ex tremely approachable, who is perfect in virtue and who deaired to partake of the roots and fruits offered to him in reverence by Shabari. May good fortune attend on the destroyer of Bali, he of supreme steadfastness, the fulfiller of the desire of the Monkey King, whose companion was **HANUMAN**. May good fortune attend him who is resolute in combat, the foremost of the conquerors of the *Rakshasas*, the blessed Hero of the Raghus, who passed over the ocean by a causeway. May good fortune attend on the Blessed **RAMA**, King of Kings and Princes, who returned to the celestial city and was installed there with **SITA**. May good fortune attend on him who was honoured by the foremost Acharyss and all the great Sages of old engaged in prayer, benediction and blessings. CHAPTBII SO HAVING seen the Princess of Mithila conducted to the hermitage,

CHAPTER 50

Sumantra seeks to console Lakshmana

UTT ARA *KANDA* are full of joy, who is, with his brothers and **SITA**, ever devoted to his sire. May good fortune attend on the One who is constant and noble, who dwelt in and abandoned Ssketa (*Ayodhya*) and wan dered about Chittrakuta worshipped by the self-controlled. May good fortune attend on my Guru, who, bearing the bow, the arrow and the sword, was ever worshipped with devotion by Janski and **LAKSHMANA**. May good fortune attend on that King of the Vultures who dwelt in the Dandaka Forest, who is the enemy of those who oppose the Gods, who is a great devotee and a granter of liberation. May good betide him who is exalted by Satrwa, who is ex tremely approachable, who is perfect in virtue and who deaired to partake of the roots and fruits offered to him in reverence by Shabari. May good fortune attend on the destroyer of Bali, he of supreme steadfastness, the fulfiller of the desire of the Monkey King, whose companion was **HANUMAN**. May good fortune attend him who is resolute in combat, the foremost of the conquerors of the *Rakshasas*, the blessed Hero of the Raghus, who passed over the ocean by a causeway. May good fortune attend on the Blessed **RAMA**, King of Kings and Princes, who returned to the celestial city and was installed there with **SITA**. May good fortune attend on him who was honoured by the foremost Acharyss and all the great Sages of old engaged in prayer, benediction and blessings. CHAPTBII SO HAVING seen the Princess of Mithila conducted to the hermitage, " See into what afBiction **SITA**'s plight has thrown **RAMA** I What could be saddet for Raghava than to have to renounce the daughtet of **JANAKA**, a chaste wU'e? It is evident to me that fate has sepatated Raghava from Vaidebi! O Charioteer, destiny is inexorable I Raghava, who, in his wmth, slew the Gods, Gandharvas, *Asuras* and *Rakshasas*, is under the sway of destiny. Formerly **RAMA**, at his father's command, dwelt in the vast and lonely Dandaka Forest for fourteen years, but more

painful and cruel to me seems the repudiation of **SITA** through listening to the calumny of the people. What justification was there, O Suta, for this dishonourable procedure consequent on the ill-considered reports regarding Maithili ? " Hearing these words utteted by **LAKSHMANA**, the loyal and sagacious **SUMANTRA** *answered*: " Do not grieve about Maithili, O Son of **SUMITRA**, O Laksh mana, it was formerly predicted by the *brahmins* thy Sire. Assuredly **RAMA** is destined to become extremely unhappy ; misfortune is his lot! Undoubtedly that long-armed hero will be sepatated from all those he loves. Under the sway of destiny, that great man will renounce thee, **SHATRUGHNA** and **BHARATA**. Do not repeat to **BHARATA** or **SHATRUGHNA** what Durvasa utteted in reply to the king who was questioning him. It was in the presence of a large assembly when I was present, O Bull among Men, that the *Rishi* utteted these words, **VASISHTHA** himself, with others, being there. " Hearing the words of the Riahi, the foremost of men, **DASARATHA**, then charged me saying, ' Do not repeat anything that thou hast heard to others '-1 have kept his command scrupulously and, as I see it, under no circumstances should I divulge the matter to any, yet, if I can ttust thy discretion, O Dear One, then hear me, O Joy of the Raghus. If I repeat the secret formerly confided to me by King **DASARATHA** then it is fate and inevitable. It is on account of fate that a similar misfortune, the source of thy present distress, took place. Do not speak of it before **BHARATA** or in **SHATRUGHNA**’s presence either.” When he heard those grave and portentous words of Suman tra’s, Saumitri said to the charioteer, " Tell me the whole truth I”

CHAPTER 51

Vishnu is cursed by Bhrigu

" **F**ormedy a great Sage, named Durvasa, tbe son of Atri, passed the rainy season in **VASISHTHA**'s hermitage. Thy supremely illustrious Sire went there himself, deairous of beholding the magnanimous family priest and he observed the great ascetic, Durvasa, bright as tbe sun, radiant in hia own effulgence, seated by tbe side of **VASISHTHA**. Those two Sages, the foremost of ascetics, saluted him with respect and bade him welcome, honouring him with a seat, fruit and roots, and water wherewith to wash hia feet. Thereafter he dwelt in their company and tbe illustrious Rishia there present, at noon, used to recount pleasing traditions, and once during their recital, the king, with joined palms, said to the magnanimous ascetic, tbe son of Atri: " ' O Blessed One, how long will my dynasty endure ? To what age will **RAMA** live ? And my other sons, how long will they survive ? How long will the sons of **RAMA** live ? Be so good as to tell me tbe destiny of my race, O Blessed Lord. " Hearing the words of King **DASARATHA**, the highly effulgent Durvasa began to speak thus : " ' Learn, O King, what happened formerly during the cooftict berween tbe *Devas* and *Asuras*. The Daityas, whom tbe Suras threatened, took refuge with the conson of Bhrigu and she, having given them a haven, they dwelt there in safety. Seeing them thus succoured, the Chief of the Gods, enraged, with his sharp-edged discus severed tbe head of Bhrigu's wife. "'Beholding tbe murder of hia consort, Bhrigu, in hia wrath, instantly curaed Viahnu, the destroyer of enemy hosts, saying : """Since in thine insensate fury, thou hast slain my spouse, who should never have died thus, thou shalt take hinh in the world of men, O Janardana, and there thou shalt live separated from thy conson for many yeara." 535 "'Having pronounced this curse, Bhrigu was overcome with remorse and his merits being exhausted by the malediction he hsd uttered, he began to propitiate thst God, psying homage to the One who delights in penance and protects his devotees.

Theresfter thst God spoke, saying, “For the good of the worlds, I will be subject to thy curse.” " ' This is how the illustrious **VISHNU** was cursed by Bhrigu in days of yore and descended on earth, becoming thy son, O Foremost of Monarchs. Renowned in the Three Worlds under the name of **RAMA**, he hss to undergo the dire consequences of Bhrigu’s curse. He will reign in Ayodhya for a long time. Those who follow him will be hsppy and prosperous and, hsving reigned for eleven thousand years, **RAMA** will go to Brahmaloka. Hsving performed many great sacrifices, distributing costly gifts, he, who may not be overcome by the most powerful beings, shsll establish many dynasties and he will beget two sons by **SITA**.' " Having related all concerning the psst and future of his race to King Dasaraths, Durvasa fell silent, whereupon the king paid obeisance to the two magnanimous ascetics and returned to the city. " This is whst I was formerly told by the *Rishi* and I hsve kepr it in my heart ; none of these things could hsve hsppened otherwise. **SITA**’s two sons will be installed in Ayodhya by Raghsva, the words of a Sage never fail to be fuiJilled. It being so, do not grieve either for **SITA** or for **RAMA**, O Son of Raghu. Take courage, O Prince." Hearing this remarkable speech of the charioteer’s, **LAKSHMANA** experienced unsurpsssed felicity and cried our, " Excellcnt I Excellent ! " Meantime while **LAKSHMANA** and the charioteer were thus conversing on the way, the sun let and they halted on the banka of the Keshini River.

CHAPTER 52

Lakshmana seeks out Rama

HAVING passed the night by the Keshini, **LAKSHMANA**, the Joy of the House of Rsghu, rose at dawn and continued on his way. At noon,

that Prince of the Great Car entered the opulent City of Ayodhya, crowded with happy people. The extremely sagacioua Saumitri, however, became exceeding)y apprehensive, re1lecting " On mine arrival, when I fall at **RAMA**'s feet, what ahall I say to him ? " As he was thua anxiously pondering, **RAMA**'s residence, bright as the moon, rose before him, and the prince, dismounting at the door of the palace, his heart con tracted, with bowed head entered without hindrance. Seeing his elder brother, **RAMA**, seated on his throne in deep distress, **LAKSHMANA**'s eyea were filled with rears and, seizing hold of his feet, his soul alllicted, with great reverence he offered obeisance to him and addressed him in plaintive accents, saying : " In accord with thy command, O Lord, I left the daughter of **JANAKA** on the banks of the Ganges near the splendid retreat of the Sage **VALMIKI**, fOllowing the counsel given to me. It is there at the entrance of the hermirsge that I abandoned the chaste **SITA** and have returned to serve thee. Do not grieve, O Foremost of Men, it has been decreed by destiny. Asauredly those like thee, who are intelligent and wise, do not give way to despair. All growth ends in decay, those who rise high, fall, and all meetings end in separation ; death is the end of life. TherefOre in regard to sons, wives, ltinsfollt and wealth, detachment should be practised, fur separation from them all is certain. Thou who art able to control the spirit by the spirit and the mind by the mind and all the worlds, O Kakutstha, bow much more art thou able to control grief. Nay, nay, in aimi1ar circumstances, the tore most of men, like thyself, do not distress themselves. Asauredly thou wilt be censured anew, O Rsghava, fur giving way to grief on account of calumny. Undoubtedly the people will condemn thee. O Best of Men, thou who art so well endowed with firmness of purpose, give up this filint-heartedness and ceaae to grieve.., S37 Hearing the wo,rds of the magnanimous Laksbmana, the oon of

Sumitta, Kskutsths, beloved of his frieods, answered him in cheerful tones, saying : " It shall be as thou sayest, O Best of Meo, O Valiant Laksh mana, I am gntified by the execution of my behests, O Hero. O Gentle Prince, my distress bas beeo assusged by thy felicitous words ; I shall be guided by them, O Saumitri." CHAPTBR 53 **RAMA** 11/ls I..Diu""-the Stury of Nriga HBAiuNG **LAKSHMANA**'s remarkable speech that filled him with amazement, **RAMS** *replied*: "Assuredly it would be dillicult in these times to find a relative like thee, O Dear Brother I O Thou who bearest auspicious marks, who art gifted with intelligeoce and art one with me in thought, now learn all that is passing in my heart and, knowing it, do what I command thee. " O Dear Saumitri, four days have gone by since I concerned myself with the intereats of my people and my son! is tormented ; now call together my subjects, the family priests and also the ministers with all those to whose affairs atteotion must be giveo ! Tbe king who does not fnlfil his duties in regard to his people each day, undoubtedly falls into the darkest bell. " It is related that formerly a monarch named Nriga reigned,

CHAPTER 53

Rama tells Lakshmana the Story of Nriga

Hearing the wo,rds of the magnanimous Laksbmana, the oon of Sumitta, Kskutsths, beloved of his frieods, answered him in cheerful tones, saying : " It shall be as thou sayest, O Best of Meo, O Valiant Laksh mana, I am gntified by the execution of my behests, O Hero. O Gentle Prince, my distress bas beeo assusged by thy felicitous words ; I shall be guided by them, O Saumitri." CHAPTBR 53 **RAMA** 11/ls I..Diu""-the Stury of Nriga HBAiuNG **LAKSHMANA**'s remarkable

speech that filled him with amazement, **RAMS** *replied*: “Assuredly it would be dillicult in these times to find a relative like thee, O Dear Brother I O Thou who bearest auspicious marks, who art gifted with intelligeoce and art one with me in thought, now learn all that is passing in my heart and, knowing it, do what I command thee. " O Dear Saumitri, four days have gone by since I concerned myself with the intereats of my people and my son! is tormented ; now call together my subjects, the family priests and also the ministers with all those to whose affairs atteotion must be giveo ! Tbe king who does not fnlfil his duties in regard to his people each day, undoubtedly falls into the darkest bell. " It is related that formerly a monarch named Nriga reigned, " Then the ascetic, in whose bouse the cow bad been retained, speedily pursued him and, reaching that Risbi, addtened him in harsh tones, saYing That cow belongs to me and was given me by the foremost of monarchs ; it was Nriga who bestowed bet on me as a gift.' " Thereupon a great quarrel ensued between those learned brabmins, and wrangling, they both approached the one who bad given away that cow, but though they waited thetea long time, they wete unable to gain admission to the palace. Having tarried thete many days and nights, they became greatly enraged and those illustrious ascetics, furious at not achieving their purpose, utteted the following dreadful malediction : " ' Since thou bast refused to grant us audience in ordet to settle our dispute, do thou become a lizard and remain invisible to all beings ; in that state thou shalt pass hundreds and thous ands of years in a ditch ; when **VISHNU**, in human form, descends to earth among the Yadus, whose glory be will enhance, thou shalt be liberated from the curse I He sball be named Vasudeva. When the Ka1i *Yuga* bas come, Nara and Narayana will descend on earth to relieve bet of bet burden.' " Having pronounced this curse on the king, the *brahmins* fell silent and they both agreed to

bestow the cow, who bad become old and weak, on anothet *brahmin*. " O Labbmana, King Nriga is still suffering undet that dreadfUl curse. The folly of not attending to the dispute between contestants is to be attributed to the king. Therefore let all those who have come for reasons of arbitration be usbeted into my presence , though a king does not seek the fruit of dnty fW.filled. Go now petsonally and see if anyone seeks audience with me,.,

CHAPTER 54

The End of the Story of Nriga

TM Btrd of tlu Story of Nriga HEARING the words of the supremely effulgent **RAMA**, the esceedlngly tagacloua I .obhmana, with joined palms, replied : THE ltAMAYANA OF VALMIKI curse like unto the 1tod of **YAMA**. O Foremost of Men, what did King Nriga reply to those enraged ascetics when they condemned him to such suft'cring ? " Thus questioned by Lskshmana, Raghava took up the tale agsin, saying : " O Gentle One, hear what that prince first did when he was struck down by the curse. Learning that the two Sages had departed, the king called together his ministers, citizens and chief priests and, in the presence of his subjects, said : " ' Hear me carefully ! Having pronounced a dreadful curse upon me, the *Rishis* Narada and Parvata have, with the speed of the wind, returned to the Region of **BRAHMA**. Let the youthful Prince Vasu, here present, be installed on the throne to-day. Let artisans construct three ditches, where I shall expiate the curse laid upon me by the *brahmins*, one proof against the rains, one against the cold and a third against the heat ; let this habitation be made comfortable and trees laden with fruit and hushea covered with Bowers be planted round

about, as also shrubs of every kind to lend shade. The precinctS of these ditches should he pleasant and I shall pass the time agreeably there till the termination of my suft'erings. Let Bowers with a sweet fragrance be sown frequently for half a league on all sides I' " Having made these arrangements, he installed Vasu on the throne and addresaed him, saying : " ' My Son, he ever fixed in thy duty and rule thy subjects in accord with the laws of the *Kshatriyas*. Keep before thine eyes the curse the two *brahmins* pronounced upon me. Do not grieve on my account, O Foremost of Men. Destiny is just, O My son, it is destiny' that has plunged me in this allliction. What must happen will happen ; what we must pursue will he pursued ; what is to he attained will he attained, whether good or ill, according to the acts of a previnus existence. Do not grieve, O My Son.' " Having spoken thus to his son, the highly illustrious King Nriga deacended into the constructed ditch in order to take up his abode there. Having entered that deep hole adorned with precious gems, the magnanim0111 Nriga suft'ered the curse that the two *brahmins* had pronounced on him in thelr anger." CHAPTER SS The Story D/ Nimi " I related the coning of Nriga in detail but, if tbou so desiretb, listen to tbe following story I " On this, **SAUMITRI** *said*: " I never tire of hearing tbese marvellous tales, O King ! " Thus spoke **LAKSHMANA**, and **RAMA**, tbe Joy of tbe Ikshvakus, began to recount many exceedingly instructive legends, aaying : " There was once a king named Nimi, the twelfth son of tbe magnanimous olfspring of tbe Ikshvakus and be was foU of courage and trutb. That highly valorous monsrch founded a besutiful city, resembling that of tbe Gods, in tbe vicinity of Gautama's hermitage, and the name of that city was Vaijanta I It served as tbe residence of the royal Sage Nimi and, while he dwelt in that vast capital, he reftccted ' I will perform a great aacrifice to gratify my aire I ' " Having invited his fatbet, Ikshvaku, tbe son of Manu, he lint

welcomed Vasishtba, tbe foremost of *Rishis* ; tbereaftet tbe Rajarishi Nimi, tbe Joy of Ikshvaku, invited Atri, Angira and also Bhrigu, that treasury of asceticism. “Mesnwhile **VASISHTHA** aaid to Nimi, tbe foremost of royal Sages :-' I am alresdy pledged to **INDRA**, tbetefore wait for me till his aacrifice is completed.' " Soon afterwards, tbe great ascetic Gautama undertook the aacrifi.ce1 whilst the mighty **VASISHTHA** was officiating at **INDRA**’s ceremony. " King Nimi, that foremost of men, having assembled the *brahmins*, cdebnted a aacrifice in the vicinity of his city on tbe aide of tbe Himavat Mountain, its term esceeding five thousand yean. “**INDRA**’a sacrifice beiDa completed, the blessed and irre proachable Sage **VASISHTHA** returned to the king and oft"eted himself as ofliciating priest. Observing that Gautama had, in the interval. filled that oflice, **VASISHTHA** was ttanapotted witb

CHAPTER 55

The Story of Nimi

CHAPTER SS The Story D/ Nimi " I related the coning of Nriga in detail but, if tbou so desiretb, listen to tbe following story I " On this, **SAUMITRI** *said*: " I never tire of hearing tbese marvellous tales, O King ! " Thus spoke **LAKSHMANA**, and **RAMA**, tbe Joy of tbe Ikshvakus, began to recount many exceedingly instructive legends, aaying : " There was once a king named Nimi, the twelfth son of tbe magnanimous olfspring of tbe Ikshvakus and be was foU of courage and trutb. That highly valorous monsrch founded a besutiful city, resembling that of tbe Gods, in tbe vicinity of Gautama’s hermitage, and the name of that city was Vaijanta I It served as tbe residence of the royal Sage Nimi and, while he dwelt in that vast capital, he reftccted ' I will perform a great

aacrifice to gratify my aire I ' " Having invited his fatbet, Ikshvaku, tbe son of Manu, he lint welcomed Vasishtba, tbe foremost of *Rishis* ; tbereaftet tbe Rajarishi Nimi, tbe Joy of Ikshvaku, invited Atri, Angira and also Bhrigu, that treasury of asceticism. “Mesnwhile **VASISHTHA** aaid to Nimi, tbe foremost of royal Sages :-' I am alresdy pledged to **INDRA**, tbetefore wait for me till his aacrifice is completed.' " Soon afterwards, tbe great ascetic Gautama undertook the aacrifi.ce1 whilst the mighty **VASISHTHA** was officiating at **INDRA**’s ceremony. " King Nimi, that foremost of men, having assembled the *brahmins*, cdebnted a aacrifice in the vicinity of his city on tbe aide of tbe Himavat Mountain, its term esceeding five thousand yean. “**INDRA**’a sacrifice beiDa completed, the blessed and irre proachable Sage **VASISHTHA** returned to the king and oft"eted himself as ofliciating priest. Observing that Gautama had, in the interval. filled that oflice, **VASISHTHA** was ttanapotted witb rage and, anxious to bebold the king, sought out the mcmarclt, but thst day he lay in a deep sleep and the fury of the magnani mous Vasishths burst forth anew, ao thst he began to curse the king, who was unaware of his ptesence thete, saying : " ' Since thou didst choose another and have failed to treat me with due respect, O King, thy body will be rendered lifeless ! ' " Thereupon the king awoke and, hearing the curse pro nounced against him, in a tranSport of rage, said to the aon of **BRAHMA**: " ' When I was unconscious and asleep, thou, beside thyself with anger, hast subjected me to the fire of thy wrath like unto the Rod of **YAMA** ! For this, be asaured thy body too, O Brahmarishi, sball be bereft of sensation for a long time.' " Thus both dominated by anger, the foremost of kings and the chief of the ascetics, mutually cursed one another and they, whose powers were equal to the Gods, wete both instantly deprived of their bodies.” CHAPTER $6 The c..,.mr, af 1M Nymp/1 Ul’fNIIhi beard this story, Labhmana, the Slayer of His Foes,

with joined palms, addressed the d!Uigeat **RAMA**, saying : " O Kakutsths, how did thst Twice-born One, worshipped by the Cclestials, and the king, having cast off their bodies, regsin them once more ? " Thus questioned by Labhmana, **RAMA**, having truth for his prowess, answered : " Following on their mutual cursing, those two virtuous Ones, that Sage among monarchs and the foremost of ascetics, having discarded their bodies, lived in their subtle forma. Thereafter, the great Riahi Vasiahths, desirous of regsining his physical ahape, sought ont his sire, and thst virtuous Sage in his subtle body, pald obeisance to the feer of that God of Gods, the Grandslre, and addressed him, saying : "' O Lord, through King Nimi'a curae, I am deprived of my physical body, O Lord of Lords, O MabadcvaI am merged in

CHAPTER 56

The Cursing of the Nymph Urvashi

rage and, anxious to bebold the king, sought out the mcmarclt, but thst day he lay in a deep sleep and the fury of the magnani mous Vasishths burst forth anew, ao thst he began to curse the king, who was unaware of his ptesence thete, saying : " ' Since thou didst choose another and have failed to treat me with due respect, O King, thy body will be rendered lifeless ! ' " Thereupon the king awoke and, hearing the curse pro nounced against him, in a tranSport of rage, said to the aon of **BRAHMA**: " ' When I was unconscious and asleep, thou, beside thyself with anger, hast subjected me to the fire of thy wrath like unto the Rod of **YAMA** ! For this, be asaured thy body too, O Brahmarishi, sball be bereft of sensation for a long time.' " Thus both dominated by anger, the foremost of kings and the chief of the ascetics, mutually cursed one another and

they, whose powers were equal to the Gods, wete both instantly deprived of their bodies.” CHAPTER $6 The c..,.mr, af 1M Nymp/1 Ul’fNIIhi beard this story, Labhmana, the Slayer of His Foes, with joined palms, addressed the d!Uigeat **RAMA**, saying : " O Kakutsths, how did thst Twice-born One, worshipped by the Cclestials, and the king, having cast off their bodies, regsin them once more ? " Thus questioned by Labhmana, **RAMA**, having truth for his prowess, answered : " Following on their mutual cursing, those two virtuous Ones, that Sage among monarchs and the foremost of ascetics, having discarded their bodies, lived in their subtle forma. Thereafter, the great Riahi Vasiahths, desirous of regsining his physical ahape, sought ont his sire, and thst virtuous Sage in his subtle body, pald obeisance to the feer of that God of Gods, the Grandslre, and addressed him, saying : '" O Lord, through King Nimi’a curae, I am deprived of my physical body, O Lord of Lords, O MabadcvaI am merged in air I Those deprived of a body sufl"er great misfortune ; many righteous deeds may not be performed without a body, O Lord, by thy favour grant me another form ! ' " Then Btahma Swyambhu, whose powers are immeasurable, said to him : .. ' Do thou enter the vital seed of Mitra and **VARUNA**, O Thou illustrious One ! Thou shalt then be born without a mother, O Foremost of the Twice-born, and, endowed with great virtue, shalt regain thy state.' “Thus spoke the divine Grandsire, and **VASISHTHA**, circum ambulating him, instantly left for **VARUNA**’s abode. At that time, Mitra, being worshipped by the foremost of the Celestials was reigning over **VARUNA**’s kingdom and the chief Apsara, Urvashi, came there by chance in company with bet friends. " Beholding the lovely Urvashi sporting in the waters, **VARUNA** was seized with extreme delight and desired to unite himself with that nymph, whose eyes are as large as lotus petals and whose face was as radiant as the moon, but she, with

joined palms, answered him saying : " ' Mitra has already invited me for this purpose, O Chief of the Gods!' “Then **VARUNA**, being stricken with desire, said:-' Since thou dost not wish to be united with me, I shaU loose my vital seed in the vessel created by **BRAHMA**, O Thou of lovely hips and beautiful complexion, thus shall my desire be satisfied.' " Hearing this amiable speech, Urvashi was highly gratified and said to him : .. ' Be it so, for my mind is fixed on thee, though my body belongs to Mitra, O Lord I ' “At these words of Urvashi, **VARUNA** discharged his powerful vital seed, that ahone like fire, into the vessel. Then the divine Urvasbi immediately sought out Mitra and he, in the heigbt of anger, said to her : " Why didst thou desert me, who first chose thee ? For what reasoo hast thou taken another, O Thou without moral aense ? For this misdeed, I condemn thee to live in the world of men for THE R.AMAYANA OF VALMIKI " 'I’hen Urvasbi, under the in11ucnce of that curse, went to Pratisthlma to Pururavu, the beloved son of Budha, and she bore him a lovely child, Ayn, who was full of valour and became the father ofNabusha, the equal of **INDRA** in glory, and wben the Lord of the Celestials Jooaed his thunderbolt on Vritra and suft"ered eclipse,' Nabuaba reigned in his stesd for thousands of years. " In consequence of this curse, Urvuhi, of charming teeth, beautiful eyes and grsccful brows, descended on esrth where she passed many years and, the period of the curse having expired, she returned to the Rqpon of **INDRA**.”

CHAPTER 57

The End of the Story of Vasishtha and Nimi

TM End 11/ tM Story 11/ V asishtha and Nimi HwuNG that wooderful and divine theme, Labhmana, highly delighted, said to R.aghava : " O Kakutstha, bow did that Twice-born One and the king, adored by the Gods, who had been deprived of their physical bodies regain them again ? " Thus questinned, R.ama, that true hero began to relate the history of the magnanimous Vasishtba, saying: " O Prince of the R.aghus, from that vessel in which the mighty Gods had emptied their vital seed, Sages were bom, who were the foremost of Riabis. First Agastya appesred, that blessed ascetic, and he said to Mitra, I am not thy son ' and went away. O I .akshman, the seed of Mitra formerly received by Urvasbi, was to be found in the same vessel as that ofVaruna'a "After a time Vasiabtha was born in his tum, he who is wonhipped by the Celestials, he is a God to the Dtabvakus and the mighty and highly effulgent Dtabvaku chose the irreproach able **VASISHTHA** as his family priest for the good of our race, O My Friend I I have thus described ID thee how the magnanimous **VASISHTHA**, who was previously bodiless, was re-born, now hear of the history of Nimi. "Beholding the king deprived of biB body, all the sagacioua *Rishis* assisted him by the celebration of a sacrifice and the foremost of the Twice-bam preserved the body of that first of monarcbs by means of unguents, cloths and herbs with the help of the citizens and servants. At the conclusion of the sacrifice, Bhrigu said to Nimi, ' I shall restore thee to life, O King, I am gratified with thee.' " Thereafter the Gods in their delight said to him :-' Chooae a boon, O Royal Sage, where shall thy consciousness be set ? ' " Thus spoke the Gods and Nimi's spirit answered : " ' I wish to live in the eyes of all beings, O Illustrious Gods ! ' " ' So be it ', said the Celestials, ' Thou shalt dwell in the eyes of all beings in the form of sit. By thy grace, O Lord of the Earth, their eyes shall close again and again for rest when thou dost move about in the form of air.' " Having spoken thus, the Gods returned to their own region

and the magnanimous *Rishis* bore away Nimi’s body to the sacrificial ground and began to rub it with great energy to the accompaniment of sacred formulas. And from the Arani,t thus violently agitated, a great and highly ascetic Being arose and, on account of him being born from an inanimate body, he was called Mithi, the King of Videha, and through this birth, he became the ancient Janak.' It was from that Being of severe penances, who was called Mithi, that the race of Mithila originated. O Friend, I have told thee all without omitting any thing concerning the curse and of the wonderful birth of that royal Sage and the foremost of kings.” CHAPTBR 58

CHAPTER 58

Shukra curses Yayati

“**B**eholding the king deprived of biB body, all the sagacioua *Rishis* assisted him by the celebration of a sacrifice and the foremost of the Twice-bam preserved the body of that first of monarcbs by means of unguents, cloths and herbs with the help of the citizens and servants. At the conclusion of the sacrifice, Bhrigu said to Nimi, ' I shall restore thee to life, O King, I am gratified with thee.' " Thereafter the Gods in their delight said to him :-' Chooae a boon, O Royal Sage, where shall thy consciousness be set ? ' " Thus spoke the Gods and Nimi’s spirit answered : " ' I wish to live in the eyes of all beings, O Illustrious Gods ! ' " ' So be it ', said the Celestials, ' Thou shalt dwell in the eyes of all beings in the form of sit. By thy grace, O Lord of the Earth, their eyes shall close again and again for rest when thou dost move about in the form of air.' " Having spoken thus, the Gods returned to their own region and the magnanimous *Rishis* bore away Nimi’s body to the sacrificial

ground and began to rub it with great energy to the accompaniment of sacred formulas. And from the Arani,t thus violently agitated, a great and highly ascetic Being arose and, on account of him being born from an inanimate body, he was called Mithi, the King of Videha, and through this birth, he became the ancient Janak.' It was from that Being of severe penances, who was called Mithi, that the race of Mithila originated. O Friend, I have told thee all without omitting any thing concerning the curse and of the wonderful birth of that royal Sage and the foremost of kings." CHAPTBR 58 of Videha and the Sage **VASISHTHA** is astonishing and wonderfUl, but why was King Nimi, a warrior full of valour, who bad re ceived initiation, unable to forgive the *Rishi* **VASISHTHA** ? " Thus questioned by Labhmana, who was conversant with the Shastras, **RAMA**, the foremost of warriors, answered his illus trious brother, saying: " O Valiant One, forgiveness is not always shown by men ! O Saumitri, hear with what resignation King Yayati bore the injuries done to him ! " King Yayati, the prosperity of his people, was the son of Nahusha-he had two wives, whose beauty was unequalled on earth. One was his favourite, Sharmishtha, bom of Diti and the Daitya Vrashparvan, the other consort ofYayati was the daughter of Shukacharya and called Devayani, who was not beloved ofher husband. " Two sons of great beauty and amiability were bom to them, Sharmishtha begot Puru and Devayani, Yadu. Puru was the favourite of his sire on acaunt of his good qualities and also because of his mother, whereupon Yadu, much distressed, said to Devayani : " ' Thou, who art bom in the family of the divine son of Bhrigu of imperishable exploits, art exposed to misery and contempt. It is intolerable, let us both enter the lire, O Queen, and let the King amuse himself for innumerable nights with the daughter of the Daitya. Or, if thou art able to endure it, then allow me to go my way. Do thou suffer this for I shaD not brook it and

have resolved to put an end to my life.' “At these words from her son, who was weeping, Devayani, overcome by grief, highly indignant, called her Sire to mind and being thought upon, Bhargava inatandy appeared before bis daughter and, beholding her perturbed and beside herself, he enquired of her saying : " ' O Child, what is the matter ? ' Then Bhargava, his heart wrung, questioned her again and again, whereupon Devayani, entaged, answered her father, aaying : " ' I shaD enter the fire or drink polson or cast mywlf in the me and traits me with disdain, therefore thou too art dill regarded 1’ “At these words, which filled him with fury, the descendant of Bhrigu began to curse the son of Nahusha, saying : "' O Nahusha, since in the wickedness of thy heart, thou hast looked upon me with contempt, old age shall come upon thee and thou shalt become senile.' “Having spoken thus and comfurted his daughter, the descendant of Bhrigu, that highly illustrious lllahmarishi retUrned to his own abode. " Having solaced his daughter, Dcvayani, and pronounced that cune on the king, the foremost of the Twice-born, Shukra, radiant as the sun, departed."

CHAPTER 59

Puru takes the place of His Father cursed by Shukra

" This response aom Puru filled Nahusha with ezceeding joy and, seeing himself freed from seoility, he experieoced an unequalled satisfactioo. Thereupoo, regaining his youth, he performed thousands of sacrifices and ruled the earth for innumerable years. After a long time, the king aaid to Puru : " ' Give me back mine old age, my Son, that I deposited with thee ! I placed this decrepitude upoo thee and that is why

I now reclaim it. Fear not, I am pleased with thy submission to my will and shall instsll thee as king in token of my satisfaction.' " Having spoken thus to his son, Puru, King Yayati, born of Nahusba, addtessed the son of Devayani harshly, saying : " ' Thou art an intractable *Rakshasa* bom to me as a warrior, O Thou who dost disregard my behests ! Thou shalt never be king ! Since thou hast set me at nought, who am thy sire and thy spiritual director, thou shalt beget terrible *Rakshasas* and Yatudhanas! Assuredly, O Thou of perverse soul, thy race shall not intermingle with the issue of the lunar race and will resemble thee in conduct.' " Having spoken thus for the good of his realm, that royal Sage invested Puru with the supreme dignity and himself withdrew to the forest. “After a long time, when the hour fixed had struck, he went to the Celestial Abode. Thereafter Puru ruled the empire with grest equity and glory in the Oty of Pratiahthaus in the kingdom ofKasbi. “Yadu however begot thousands of Yatudhanas in the in accessible Qty ofDurga. In this wise, Yayati endured Shukra’s curse in accord with the traditious of the Kahatriyas but Nimi never exercised forgiveness. " I have related everything to thee, let us follow the example of those who accept all, so that we do not fall like Nriga.” As **RAMA**, whose face resembled the moon, was speaking thua, the heaveus were apang1ed with stara and the east healme a roseate golden colour as if she had donned a robe covered with the pollen of flowers. 3rd IN the clear light of dawn, the lotus-eyed **RAMA** performed the morning rites and took his seat in the council chamber on the royal throne in the company of the *brahmins* and citizens engaged in affairs of state. And the Priest **VASISHTHA** with the Sage Kashyapa and others well versed in the rules of government, ministers conversant with the law, scriptures and ethics were of the assembly, which resembled **INDRA**’s Hall of Justice or **YAMA**’s or Kuvera’s. Then **RAMA** said to **LAKSHMANA**, who

was endowed with auspicious marks : " O Saumitri, O Long-armed Warrior, do thou go out to the city gate and summon those who have come here as petitioners." Thereupon, according to **RAMA**'s command, **LAKSHMANA**, endowed with auspicious marks, went to the gate and called upon those who had come as complainants, but no one presented himself, for, under the rule of **RAMACHANDRA**, there was neither poverty nor disease and the earth was filled with grain and herbs. Neither children nor the young nor those of middle age met with death, the kingdom was ruled with equity and there was no adversity. Thus during **RAMA**'s administration none was to be seen who was in need of juatice. Then **LAKSHMANA**, with joined palms, said to **RAMA** :-" None has come as complainant," whereupon **RAMA**, with a delighted heart, answered : " Do thou go once more, O Saumitri, and see if any presents himself I Under royal decree, unrighteousness must not prevail. Though laws inaugurated by me protect my subjects from harm, like the arrows I discharge, yet, O Long-armed One, do thou engage thyself in vigilance on their behalf." Thus addressed, **LAKSHMANA** went forth from the palace and observed a dog sitting at the gate. Fixing its gaze steadfastly upon him, that dog was howling unceasingly and the valiant **LAKSHMANA**, beholding it in that plight, said : aN S49 "O Fortunate One, what has brought thee hither, speak without fear ? " Hearing the words of Lskshmana, the dog replied : " I wish to communicate something to Rsma of imperishable exploits, who is the refuge of all beings and who confers fearless ness on a11." Hearing the dog's words, **LAKSHMANA** entered the beautiful palace to inform Rsma and, having reported the matter to Rsmachandra, he went out and said to the dog : " If thou hast anything true to say then come and inform the king!" Hearing the words of **LAKSHMANA**, the dog said : " Since we are vilely born, we may not enter the temple of a God, the palace of a king or the

abode of a *brahmin*, nor may we go where there is fire, **INDRA**, the sun or the wind ! The king is the personification of virtue ; Shri Rsmachandra is truthful, well versed in the science of warfare and is ever engaged in the welfare of all beings ; he is perfectly cogoisant of the time and place to exercise the six qualities, a master of ethics, omniscient, all-seeing and is the delight of his subjects. He is the moon, the sun, **AGNI**, **YAMA**, **INDRA**, Kuvera and **VARUNA**. O Saumitri, do thou go and communicate to the king, the protector of his subjectS, that without his permission I may not enter." Thereupon the highly etfulgent and noble-minded **LAKSHMANA** went into the palace and said to Rsma : " O Long-armed One, the enhancer ofKaushalya's joy, I have carried out thy behests and shall relate everything to thee, hear me ! As a petitioner, a dog is at the gate awaiting thy pleasure." Then **RAMA** answered, saying : " Whosoever it may be, speedily bring him in ! " " Come, communicate what thou hast to say without fear!, Thereupon the dog, whose skull was gashed, said: " The king is the protector of animals and their lord ! He is awake when others sleep ; by administering the law, the king protects *dharma* ; without bis support, his people perish. The king is the lord, the king is the father of all the world ! He is Kala,' He is *Yuga*,' He is the creation which comprises all animate and inanimate beings ; He is *dharma* because He suppons all, for it is *dharma* that sustains the worlds, by *dharma* the Three Worlds are upheld; it is *dharma* that restrains the wicked ; it is for this he is called Dharana ; dhanna is greater than aU and confers benefits after the death of the body ; nought is superior to *dharma* in the world. O King, charity, compassion, reverence for the wise and absence of guile are the chief virtues that constitute *dharma*. They who follow *dharma* are happy in this life and in the next. O Raghava, O Thou of firm vows, thou art the authority of authorities. Thou an well known for such conduct as is

followed by the pious. Thou art an ocean of good qualities and the abode of righteousness. O Foremost of Kings, if in mine ignorance I have said many things to thee, with bowed head I crave thy forgiveness ; be not angry with me." Hearing these words from the dog, that wete full of wisdom, **RAMA** *said*: " What shall I do for thee, speak without fear ! " Then the dog answered : " O King, it is by *dharma* that a king rules, it is by *dharma* that a king protects his subjects and becomes a refuge, delivering men from fear. Bearing this in mind, O **RAMA**, do thou hear me. There is a *brahmin* named Sarvatha-siddha who lives on alms and who has all his desires satisfied. Through no fault of mine he has inflicted a wound on my head." Hearing these words, **RAMA** sent forth a messenger who brought Sarvartha-siddha there, and he, beholding **RAMA** in the assembly of those effulgent and leading Sages, said :-" O Sinless King, for what purpose hast thou sent for me ? " Then the king answered, saying : " O *Brahmin*, thou hast injured this dog. What offence did it commit that thou didst strike it severely with thy staff? Anger is a mortal foe; anger is a sweet-spoken enemy in the garb of a friend ; anger is the first of passions and like unto a sharp sword ; anger bears away the essence of good ; it carries away all that is acquired by asceticism ; sacrifices, gifts and charity are all destroyed by anger, therefore it is proper to banish anger by every means. Passion runs wild on all sides like exceedingly wicked steeds. Satiated with all the objectS of enjoyment, it is better to govern these appetites with patience. By mind, speech and sight, a man should engage himself in the well-being of others. He should give up aversion and injure no one. The harm that an uncontrolled mind can accomplish is beyond the range of a sharp sword or a serpent that has been trodden underfoot or a foe who has been provoked. Even the nature of one who has learnt humility cannot always be trusted ; a study of the Scriptures docs not alter the innate

character of a man, he who conceals his nature, will reveal his true self at a given moment." **RAMA** of imperishable exploits, having spoken thus, Sarvatha siddha, the foremost of the Twice-born, said : " O King, wandering about the whole day in search of alms, I became angry and struck the dog. It was seated in the centre of a narrow street and I requested it to move away ; thereupon moving with reluctance, it stood by the roadside. O Descendant of Raghu, at that time I was overcome with hunger and struck it for its perverse conduct. I am guilty, O King, do thou punish me, O Lord of Monarchs, do thou administer correction and I shall be released from the fear of hell." Then **RAMA** enquired of all his ministers, saying : " What shall be done now ? What punishment should be inflicted on him ? By administrating justice in accord with the crime, our subjects are protected." Thereupon Bhrigu, Angiras, Kutsa, **VASISHTHA**, Kashyapa and the other *Rishis*, ministers, leading merchants and Sages conversant with the Shastras, who were present there, aaid, "A *brahmin* is exempt from punishment," and the Sages, conversant SS2 with the law, having spoken thus, those ascetics addressed **RAMA**, saying: " O Raghava, a king is the ruler of all and thou above all, for thou att the Chastiser of the Thtee Worlds, the Eternal **VISHNU**." They, having spoken thus, the dog said : " Thou didst solemnly enquire ' What shall I do for thee ? ' therefore if thou art pleased with me and dost wish to bestow a favour on me, do thou appoint this *brahmin* to be head of the holy assembly of the K.alanjava Monastery." Thereupon the king instantly sanctioned the appointment, and the *brahmin*, honoured and gratified, mounted on an elephant, proceeded to occupy his new and dignified status. At this **RAMA**'s counsellors were astonished and said : " O Thou of great effulgence, this *brahmin* has not been punished, rather hast thou favoured him with a boon ! " Hearing the words of the ministers, **RAMA** *said*:-"You do not

know the secret of the matter, the dog knows it well! " Thereafter, questioned by **RAMA**, the dog said : " O King, I was formerly the head of the assembly of Kalan java and after worshipping the Gods, feeding the *brahmins* and feasting the servants, male and female, I used to take my food. I duly administered all things and my mind was untouched by sin. I protected the articles belonging to the tutelary Deities carefully, cultivated virtue, followed *dharma* and engaged in the welfare of all beings. In spite of this, I have fallen into this wretched state. O Raghava, this *brahmin* is given to anger and impious, he injures others and is harsh and cruel, he will dis honour seven generations of his race. He will by no means be able to discharge the duties of the head of an assembly. " He who wishes to see his children, friends and beasts fall into hell, is made chief of the Gods, cows and *brahmins* I O Raghava, he perishes who deprives the *brahmins*, women or children of their legitimate possessions; one who misappro priates the offerings of the *brahmins* or the Gods, goes to the lowest hell."* Hearing the words of the dog, the eyes of **RAMA** opened wide in astonishment. Thereafter the dog departed from whence it had come. In its former birth it had been high-minded but was born in a degraded state in that existence. Repairing to the holy City of Kashi, that dog, desiring to leave its body in a sacred spot, thereafter undertook a waterless fast. 3rd FoR a long time a vulture and an owl dwelt near the City of Ayodhyn in a forest on a mountain, that was intersected by many streams, where cucltoos called and which abounded in lions, tigers and birds of every kind. One day, the wicked vulture alleging that the owl’s nest was his, began to quarrel with him, whereupon both said : " Ler us seek out the lotus-eyed **RAMA**, who is the king of the people and let him decide to whom the nest belongs.” Having thus agreed, the vulture and the owl, wrangling with one another, wrought up with ire, came before **RAMA** and touched his

feet. Beholding that Lord of Men, the vulture said: .. O Preserver of humanity, thou an the foremost of the Devos and *Asuras*, O Resplendent One, in hearing and intelligence thou an superior to Brihaspati and Shukracharyn. Thou an con versant with the good and evil *karma* of all creatures. In beauty thou resemblest the moon, in splendour the sun, in glory the Himalaya, in profundity the ocean, in prowess the Grandsire, in fOrbearance the earth, in speed the wind ; thou an the Spiritual Preceptor of aU animate and inanimate beings and art endowed with every kind of wealth ; thou an illustrious, forgiving, invincible, victorious and master of all the scriptures and laws. O Foremost of Men, hear my plea I O Lord of Raghu, I had built a nest for myself and rhis owl is now occupy ing it as his own, therefore, O King, do thou protect me I " The vulture, having said this, the owl spoke, saying : " True it is that in a king, there is to be found a portion of the SS4 moon, of **INDRA**, the sun, Kuvera and **YAMA** but there is also a measure of man in him. Thou, however, art the aU-pervasive Narayana Himself, Thou, impclled by thine own Self dost judge all creatures impartially, yet a certain gendeness is mani fest in thee and therefore people say thou art endowed with a portion of the moon. O Lord, by anger, punishment and re ward, thou dost remove the sins and dangers of thy subjects ; it is thine to give and withdraw, thou art the dispenser, destroyer and protector and art as **INDRA** to us. In energy thou art as fire, irresistible to all creatures and, since thou dost spread thy lustre on aU beings, thou art like the sun ! Thou resemblest the Lord of Wealth and art even superior to him, for prosperity resides in thee. Thou lookest on all creatures whether animate or inani mate with the same eye, O Raghava, and dost regard foe and friend alike, duly protecring thy subjects. O Raghava, those who have incurred thine anger are already slain, therefore thou art praised as **YAMA**. O Foremost of Kings, since, in human form, thou art merciful

and beneficent, people sing thy glory, thou who art intent on not harming men. The king is the strength of the weak and helpless, the eye of the blind and the refuge of those who seek shelter in him. Thou art also our Lord, therefore hear our plea! O King, entering into my nest, this vulture is oppressing me ; thou alone, O Foremost of Men, art the divine chastiser of creatures ! " Hearing these words, **RAMA** called for his ministers with those of King **DASARATHA**, Vrishti, Jayanta, Vijaya, Siddhartha, Rashtravarddhana, Ashoka, Dharmapala and the highly powerful Sumantra and others, who were well versed in the law, high minded and conversant with the Shastras, intelligent, nobly born and skilled in counsel. Thereafter summoning both, **RAMA**, descending from his throne, enquired of the vulture:-" How long has this nest been made ? Tell me if thou dost remember it ! " Then the vulture replied:-" From the time men were firat born on earth and spread over the four quartera of the globe, I have been living in this nest." Thereupon the owl said : "At the time when trees first covered the earth, this nest of mine was constructed." sss Hearing these words, **RAMA** said to his counsellors : " That assembly is not an assembly where there are no wise and elderly men, nor those who do not dwell on righteous topics. That religion is no religion where truth is not to be found and that truth is no truth where there is guile. Those counsellors are liars, who remain silent when they are well informed in any matter. He who does not speak either on account of passion, fear or anger, binds himself with a thousand nooses of **VARUNA** and, at the expiration of a full year, is only released from a single sin." Hearing these words, the ministers said to **RAMA** : "O Thou of great intellect, what the owl has said is true, the vulture bas spoken falsely. Thou art proof of this, O Great King, since the king is the final refuge of all, the root of the people and eternal *dharma* itself. Those punished by the king do not fall into a lower state, they are saved from

hell and expand in virtue.n Hearing these words of the ministers, **RAMA** *said*: " Hear what is related in the Puranas ! Formerly the sun, moon and firmament with its stars, the earth with its mountains and forests, the Three Worlds with all that moves and does not move were merged in the waters of the great ocean. “At that time, Narayana existed as a second Sumeru and, in his belly, lay the earth with Lakshmi. Having destroyed the creation and entered the waters, the highly e1fulgent **VISHNU**, identical with the souls of creatures, lay asleep there for many long years. Beholding **VISHNU** asleep after the destruction of the worlds and, knowing all the entries to be obstructed, the great **BRAHMA** entered his belly. Thereupon a golden lotus sprang from **VISHNU**’s navel, and that great Lord, the Creator, **BRAHMA**, rose therefrom and engaged in severe penances for the purpose of creating the earth, air, mountains, trees, men, reptiles and all other life-forms from the womb or egg. " Thereafter, from the wax in the ears of Narayana, two valiant and dreadful Daityas, Madhu and Kaitabha were born. Beholding the Grandaire, they were greatly enraged and rushed upon him, whereupon **BRAHMA**, the Self-born cried out loudly. “Awakened by that sound, Narayana engaged in combat with 556 Madhu and Kaitabha and slew them with his discus and the earth was drenched with their blood. Then, purifying it once more, **VISHNU**, the Preserver of the World covered it with trees and created medicinal herbs. Thus filled with the marrow of Madhu and Kaitabha, the earth called Medini. It is for this that I hold this abode does not belong to the vulture but to the owl, O Counsellors, the owl having maintained that he built the nest when trees were first created, that is, before men appeared. This vicious vulture should therefore be punished, for this evil minded one, having robbed another of its nest, is now oppressing him.” At that moment a voice was heard in the sky, saying : " O **RAMA**, do not slay the vulture for it has already

been reduced to ashes by the power of Gautama's asceticism. O Lord of Men, this vulture in a former birth was an heroic, truthful and pure king, by the name of Brahmadatta. One day a *brahmin* called Gautama, the very personification of Time, came to the house of Brahmadatta for food and said : " ' O King, I shall feed in thy house for more than a hundred years!' " Thereupon, with his own hands offering that effulgent *brahmin* water to wash his feet, the King Brahmadatta enter tained him with due hospitality. Once, accidentally, fiesh was mixed with the food of the high-souled Gautama and he, enraged, uttered a terrible curse, saying :-' O King, do thou become a vulture ! ' " The monarch thereupon replied :-' O Thou of great vows, do not curse me thus, be propitiated, it was in ignorance that this offence was offered by me, O Great One ! O Blameless One, do thou so act that this curse be rendered void ! ' " Recognizing that the offence had been unwittingly com mitted by the king, the ascetic said : " ' O King, a monarch shall be hom under the name of **RAMA** in the Race of Ikshvaku. O Foremost of Men, thou shalt be released from the curse when he touches thee.' " Hearing these words from the sky, **RAMA** touched Brahms dana and he, giving up his vulture's form, ISSilming a beautiful body sprinkled with celestial perfumes, worshipped **RAMA** and said: SS1 " O Thou conversant with piety, by thy grace I .bave been saved from a dreadful hell, thou hast verily brought the curse to an end for me f " The Ascetics seek out **RAMA** As **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** passed the time conversing thus, the temperate spring night dsew on and, when the stainless dawn broke, Kakutstha, having performed his morning worship, went to the audience chamber to attend to affairs of state. Then Sumantra approached him and said : " O King, there are some Sages who are waiting at the gate with Chyavana, the descendant of Bhrigu, at their head ; these illustrious *Rishis* seek audience with thee, O Great King, and, eager for thy sight,

those dwellers on the banks of the Yamuna have sent me to announce their arrival.” Heating these words, the virtuous **RAMA**, conversant with his duty, said :-" Let those blessed ascetics, whose leader is Bhargava, enter.” Thereupon, in deference to the king’s summons, the chamberlain, with joined palms, bowing low, ushered in those eminent ascetics, numbering over a hundred, who were blazing in their own effulgence. Thereafter those magnanimous Sages, entering the palace, with their loshtas filled with holy water drawn from sacred places, carried various kinds of fruit and roots as an offering to the king, which **RAMA** accepted with delight. Then that long-armed prince said to those illustrious Sages : " Do you occupy these seats according to your pleasure.” Thus invited by **RAMA**, those great *Rishis* took their places on the brilliant golden seats and, seeing them installed, **RAMA**, with joined palms, paying obeisance to them, enquired of them saying: " For what reason have you come ? In my devotion I would feign know what I may do for you ? I am at your command O IUustrinus Ones, and shall carry out all you desire with great delight. My whole kingdom and the life in my breast and all sss

CHAPTER 60

The Ascetics seek out Rama

" **O** Thou conversant with piety, by thy grace I .bave been saved from a dreadful hell, thou hast verily brought the curse to an end for me f " The Ascetics seek out **RAMA** As **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** passed the time conversing thus, the temperate spring night dsew on and, when the stainless dawn broke, Kakutstha, having performed his morning worship, went to the audience chamber to attend to affairs of state. Then

Sumantra approached him and said : " O King, there are some Sages who are waiting at the gate with Chyavana, the descendant of Bhrigu, at their head ; these illustrious *Rishis* seek audience with thee, O Great King, and, eager for thy sight, those dwellers on the banks of the Yamuna have sent me to announce their arrival." Heating these words, the virtuous **RAMA**, conversant with his duty, said :-" Let those blessed ascetics, whose leader is Bhargava, enter." Thereupon, in deference to the king's summons, the chamberlain, with joined palms, bowing low, ushered in those eminent ascetics, numbering over a hundred, who were blazing in their own effulgence. Thereafter those magnanimous Sages, entering the palace, with their loshtas filled with holy water drawn from sacred places, carried various kinds of fruit and roots as an offering to the king, which **RAMA** accepted with delight. Then that long-armed prince said to those illustrious Sages : " Do you occupy these seats according to your pleasure." Thus invited by **RAMA**, those great *Rishis* took their places on the brilliant golden seats and, seeing them installed, **RAMA**, with joined palms, paying obeisance to them, enquired of them saying: " For what reason have you come ? In my devotion I would feign know what I may do for you ? I am at your command O IUustrinus Ones, and shall carry out all you desire with great delight. My whole kingdom and the life in my breast and all sss that I am is at the service of the Twice-born ; this is the trUth that I speak ! " Hearing this opeech, the magoanimous *Rishis* of severe peoances, who dwelt on the banks of the Yamuna, cried out : Excellent I " and with extreme delight, they added : " O Thou, the best of Men, none other on this earth would speak as thou hast done. Many monarchs, though supremely courageous and powerful, dare not engage themselves in an undertaking when they consider the difficulties; thou, however, without eveo knowing in what the matter consists, in thy revereoce for the *brahmins*, dost pledge thy word which

thou wilt undoubtedly honour. It behoveth thee to deliver the Sages from a great peril, O Lord.” CHAPTER The Story of Madhu THEN Kakutstha enquired of those ascetics, who had spokeo thus, saying : " Say what shall I do, O *Munis*, in order to dispel this danger for you?” At these words from Kakutstha, **BHARGAVA** *replied*: " Learn the cause of our fears and from wheoce they spting, O Prince ! Formerly in the Krita-*yuga*, a highly intelligeot Daitya, the great *Asura* Madhu, the eldest son of Lola, who was well-disposed to the *brahmins* and protected all those who sought refuge in him, was united in an unequalled frieodship to the supremely illustrious Gods. And Madhu, who was eodowed with valour and ever fixed in his duty, received a marvellous weapon from Rudra, who held him in high esteem. Taking from his own trideot, another of great power and beauty, that magnanimous One, well pleased, conferred it upon him and said: " ' Thou hast fulfilled thy duty in a remarkable degree, which has evoked my grace ! In the supreme delight that I now cxperi eoce, I confer this cxcelleot weapon upon thee. As long as thou dost not artack the Gods or the *brahmins*, O Great *Asura*, this SS9

CHAPTER 61

The Story of Madhu

that I am is at the service of the Twice-born ; this is the trUth that I speak ! " Hearing this opeech, the magoanimous *Rishis* of severe peoances, who dwelt on the banks of the Yamuna, cried out : Excellent I " and with extreme delight, they added : " O Thou, the best of Men, none other on this earth would speak as thou hast done. Many monarchs, though supremely courageous and powerful, dare not engage themselves

in an undertaking when they consider the difficulties; thou, however, without eveo knowing in what the matter consists, in thy revereoce for the *brahmins*, dost pledge thy word which thou wilt undoubtedly honour. It behoveth thee to deliver the Sages from a great peril, O Lord." CHAPTER The Story of Madhu THEN Kakutstha enquired of those ascetics, who had spokeo thus, saying : " Say what shall I do, O *Munis*, in order to dispel this danger for you?" At these words from Kakutstha, **BHARGAVA** *replied*: " Learn the cause of our fears and from wheoce they spting, O Prince ! Formerly in the Krita-*yuga*, a highly intelligeot Daitya, the great *Asura* Madhu, the eldest son of Lola, who was well-disposed to the *brahmins* and protected all those who sought refuge in him, was united in an unequalled frieodship to the supremely illustrious Gods. And Madhu, who was eodowed with valour and ever fixed in his duty, received a marvellous weapon from Rudra, who held him in high esteem. Taking from his own trideot, another of great power and beauty, that magnanimous One, well pleased, conferred it upon him and said: " ' Thou hast fulfilled thy duty in a remarkable degree, which has evoked my grace ! In the supreme delight that I now cxperi eoce, I confer this cxcelleot weapon upon thee. As long as thou dost not artack the Gods or the *brahmins*, O Great *Asura*, this SS9 spear will remain with thee, otherwise it will vanish. Whoever rashly provokes thee to combat will be reduced to ashes by this weapon which, thereafter, will return to thine hand! ' " Having received this rare gift from Rudra, the great *Asura* prostrated himself before Mahadeva and said: " ' O Lord, Thou who art the Chief of the Gods, O Blessed One, may this weapnn ever remain in my family.' " Thus spoke Madhu, and the Lord of all beings, **SHIVA**, that great God, anwered him saying : "'Nay, that may not be, nevertheless since thy plea finds favour with me, it shall not have been uttered in vain ; thy son shall inherit this weapnn. As long as it is in

his hand, he will be invulnerable to all beings, but only if it remains there.' “Then Madhu, the foremost of the *Asuras*, having received that great and marvellous gift from the God, built himself a magnificent abode. He had a beloved wife, the fortunate and illustrious Kumbhinasi, who was born of Vishvasu by Anala, and she bore him a son full of vigour named Lavana. Cruel and perverse from infancy, he was ever engaged in harming others and, seeing the iniquitous conduct of his son, Madhu was incensed and grieved but he said nothing. After a time he left this world and entered **VARUNA**’s abode, having bequeathed the weapnn to Lavana and instructed him in the nature of the gift. " Now Lavana, due to the pnwer of that weapnn and his natural perversity, has become the scourge of the Three Worlds and particularly of the Sages, his might being equalled by the pnwer of that weapon. Thou hast heard all, now it is for thee to decide, O Kakutstha, for thou art our supreme refuge. " Many monarchs, O **RAMA**, have been solicited by the Sages to deliver them from fear, but, O Valiant Prince, we have not found a protector. Learning that thou hadst destroyed **RAVANA** with his infantry and cavalry, we have recognized thee as our saviour, O Dear Son. We know of no other king on earth capable of delivering us ; we entreat thee to free us from the terror wbich Lavana inspires in us. This, O **RAMA**, is the cause of our present fear ; thou art able to dispel it ; fWfil our desire, O Thou wbose valour is unconquerable.”

CHAPTER 62

Shatrughna asks permission to fight Lavana

" On what does he live ? How does he conduct himself? Where does he dwell ? " Raghava, having questioned them thus, all the ascetics

informed him as to how Lavana sustained himself and said : " His food consists of all creatures, particularly the ascetics, his manner of life is savage and he constantly roams in Madhu vana. Having slain thousands of lions, tigers, antelopes, birds and even men, his daily food is their flesh, and that monster, like unto Aotaka at the dissolution of the worlds, also devours all beings." Hearing these words, Raghava said to those great Sages : " I shall slay that demon, have no fear." Having given his word to the ascetics of great elfulgeoce, **RAMA**, the delight of Raghu said to his three brothers who were present : " Who is brave enough to slay this *Asura* ? On whom shall the choice fall, on the valiant **BHARATA** or the sagacious **SHATRUGHNA** ? " Listening to Raghava's words, **BHARATA** *answered*:-" It is I who will slay him ! Let the task be entrusted to me ! " Hearing **BHARATA**, full of energy and courage, speak thus, Shatrughoa, the younger brother of **LAKSHMANA**, rose from his golden seat and, bowing before that Lord of Men, said : " The long-armed **BHARATA** has already proved his fortitude ; let him remain amongst us, O Joy of the Raghus. When Ayodhya was previously deprived of thy noble person, **BHARATA**, concealing his sorrow in his heart, ruled the kingdom till the return of his lord. Undergoing innumerable hardships, O Prince, lying on a hard couch in Nandigrama, the supremely illustrious **BHARATA** lived on fruit and roots, his hair matted and clothed in bark. Having endured such a test, thar son of Raghu should not have to undergo further trials since I, thy servant, am here." Thus spoke **SHATRUGHNA** and **RAGHAVA** *said*: " Be it so, O Descendant ofKakutstha, carry out my commands and I will install thee as king in the splendid capitsl of Madhu. O Long-anned Warrior, let Bhatata stay here as thou wishest ; thou art brave and experienced and well able to establish a kingdom with its ftourishing provinces and a capital that is washed by the Yamuna, for he who, having destroyed a

dynasty, does not install a king, goes to hell. As for thee, when thou hast slain the son of Madhu, Lavana of perverse ways, do thou govern his kingdom righteously if thou desirest to carry out my wishes. Do not question what I have said, O Hero, the youn ger brother should undoubtedly obey the elder. O Descendant of Kakutstha, receive the consecration at my hands with the traditional blessings pronounced by **VASISHTHA** and the other *brahmins*."

CHAPTER 63

The Installation of ShatrUghna

THESE words of **RAMA** filled the valiant **SHATRUGHNA** with con fusion and he spoke with exceeding diffidence, saying : " O Lord of Men, these measures do not seem to me to be justified ! How may a younger brother be installed when his elders yet live ? Still it is imperative that I should submit to thy will, O Fortunate Prince, for it would be impossible for me to disregard any order of thine. I have heard from thy lips, O Hero, and the scriptures have taught me that one should never oppose the one in authority once he has spoken. My words were ill-advised when I said ' I will slay the redoubtable Lavana in the open field.' This unfortunate utterance places me in a serious dilemma, O Foremost of Men. One should not add anything when one's elders have spoken, for this is a moral taint and, in the next world, proves a cause of retribution. I shall not speak again, O Lord Kakutstha, for fear that a second observation draw punishment upon me. I shall do thy pleasure. O Foremost of Men, O Joy of Raghu, but do thou so order it that in mine interest this improper act be erased." s6a Thus spoke the brave and high-souled **SHATRUGHNA** and Ramo, greatly delighted, said to Bhatata

and Laksbmana : " Prepare everything for the installation with care. This very day I shall install that tiger among men, issue of the House of Raghu. At my command, summon the Purodhas, O Offspring of Kalrutstha, and the citizens, Ritvijs and ministers." Hearing the king's command, the great car-warriors, under the direction of the Purodhas, began the ceremony. Thereafter, the lords and *brahmins* entered the king's palace and the enthronement of the magnanimous **SHATRUGHNA** was solemnly performed, to the great delight of Raghava and the city. The fortunate **SHATRUGHNA**, son of Kakutstha, having received the divine anointing, resembled a second sun, as Skanda when he was formerly enthroned by the inhabitants of heaven led by **INDRA**. Meanwhile **SHATRUGHNA** being installed by **RAMA** of imperish able exploits, the inhabitants of the city were highly delighted as also the illustrious brabmins, and **KAUSHALYA**, **SUMITRA** and also **KAIKEYI**, who with the other queens, rejoiced in their royal residence. Thereafter the *Rishis*, who dwelt on the banks of the Yam una, on account of **SHATRUGHNA**'s enthronement, prophesied the death ofLavana. Clasping the newly crowned one to his heart, Raghava, in caressing tones, thus enhancing his courage, said to him : " Here is an infallible shaft that overthrows hostile citadels ; by means of this thou shalt destroy Lavana, O My Dear Brother, Joy of the House of Raghu. It was fashioned, O Descendant of Kakutstha, when Swyambhu, the divine Ajita reposed on the waters out of sight of the Gods and *Asuras*, invisible to all beings. That God fashioned this arrow, the fotemost of all, in order to slay those two perverse beings, Madhu and Kaitabha, for he was enraged against them, when he desired to create the Three Worlds despite all the *Rakshasas*. " Having destroyed Madhu and Kaitabha, for the good of all beings with this marvellous weapon, **BRAHMA** created the worlda. I did not loose this dart formerly on

RAVANA, whom I wished to alay, O **SHATRUGHNA**, for all aeatureS would have been greatly diminished thereby. “As for the superior weapon bestowed on Madhu by the magnanimous Tryambaka for the destruction of his foes, Lavana, while he is ranging the regions in search of his favourite nourishment, leaves it in his dwelling where he honours it in various ways ; but when the desire for combat rises in him or he is challenged, that demon lays hold of that weapon and reduces his foes to ashes. O Foremost of Men, ere he returns to the city and while he is without his weapon, place thyself at the entry furnished with thy powerful shaft. Before he regains his abode, challenge that demon to combat, O Long-armed Warrior, and thou shalt overcome him. If thou actest in any other way, thou canst not slay him ; whereas using these means, O Valiant One, thou wilt exterminate him. Thou knowest all and how to eschew that weapon of irresistible force belonging to the ancient Shitikanta.”

CHAPTER 64

Shatrughna sets out to meet Lavana

Of **RAGHU** *continued*: " Here are four thousand horses, thousand chariots, a hundred selected elephants and stalls furnished with every provision, also singers and dancers. O Foremost of Men, I give thee gold and silver coins; take with thee a quantity of gold and set out, having furnished thyself with supplies of weapons, food and conveyances. " By words and gifts, do thou satisfy that well-nourished army that is cheerful, contented and disciplined, O Valiant Prince. Where there are neither riches, women nor kinafolk, devoted servants will not be found, O **SHATRUGHNA**. Having marshalled thy great army composed of

people full of ardour, do thou go alone, bow in hand to the Madhu Wood. Act in such a manner that Lavana, the son of Madhu, is not a\VIII'e that thou art approaching, seeking to enter into combat with him, that he may be without suspicion ; there is no other means of slaying him. O Foremost of Men, he who approaches him with that purpose inevitably perishes under his blows. The summer having passed and the rainy season being at band, thou shalt destroy the wicked Lavana for the hour will have struck ! " With the great *Rishis* at their head, send the troops forward so that they profit by the summer for crossing the waters of the Jabnavi. There thou shouldst take care to encamp the whole army on the river and thou, who fleet of foot, shouldst go ahead with thy bow. Halt at the place indicated to you and establish the camps without obstruction so that no-one may have cause for complaint." Having thus issued his orders and marshaUed his army, Sharrughna circumambulated **RAMA**, bowing to him, with joined palms, and in great humility, paid obeisance to **BHARATA** and **LAKSHMANA** as also the family priest, Shri **VASISHTHA**. Having received permission from **RAMA** to depart, that hero, the Scourge of His Foes, circumambulated him and went away. Ordering his army, comprising innumerable elephants and weD bred steeds to advance, that descendant of Raghu took leave of the king and out on his mission.

CHAPTER 65

The Story of Saudasa who is cursed by Vasishtha

Thereupon, **SHATRUGHNA**, being honoured, accepted the fruits and roots for his repast and, being fed thereon till he was fully satisfied, then enquired of the great *Rishi*, saying : " Whose is this fertile area to the

east of the hermitage, that has been created by sacrifice ? '" To this enquiry, **VALMIKI** *replied*: " O ShatrUghna, hear to whom this region formerly belonged ! One of thine ancestors was the King Saudasa and, of that monarch was born Mitrasaha,' who was full of vignur and extremely virtuous. One day the valiant and righteous Saudasa, having followed the hunt, observed two *Rakshasas* wandering here and there, in the form of tigers, and those monsters were devouring thousands of antelopes in order to appease their insatiable appetites. Seeing those two *Rakshasas*, who had denuded the forest of deer, Saudasa was seized with violent anger and pierced one of them with a long dart. Having slain it, that foremost of men recovered his composure and, his anger dissipated, he gazed on the dead *Rakshasa*. Observing him contemplating his companion thus, the surviving demon, filled with a burning grief, said to him : " ' Thou hast slain my companion whn had done thee no harm, I shall revenge myself on thee one day, thou wretch ! ' " Speaking thus, the *Rakshasa* disappeared. " In the course of time, the son of Saudasa, Mitrasaha, came to the throne, and Saudasa undertook the Ashwamedha Sacrifice in the vicinity of this ashrams with **VASISHTHA** as the olliciating priest. This continued for many years and was of exceeding splendour so that it resembled one offered by the Gods. At the close of the riteS, the *Rakshasa*, calling to mind his past grievance, assumed the form ofVasishtha and said to the king: " ' Now the sacrifice has been completed, let flesh be brought speedily that I may eat without delay ! ' " Hearing that *Rakshasa*, transformed into a *brahmin*, speaking thus, the king addressed his cooks, who were skilled in their art and said :-" ' Speedily prepare Havis' and such savoury dishes of flesh that will please my Guru ! ' " This command of that monarch bewildered the cooks, whereupon the *Rakshasa*, assuming their form, prepared a dish of human flesh which he brought to the king, saying, Here is a savoury dish made

of flesh ! ' " O Foremost of Men, the king, with his consort, Madayanti, presented those dishes brought by the *Rakshasa*, that were composed of flesh, to the Sage **VASISHTHA**, and that ascetic, perceiving he had been offered human flesh, was transported with rage and began to pronounce a curse upon him, saying : " ' Since it has pleased thee, O King, to offer me a repast of this nature, it shall assuredly become thy food.' " Thereupon Saudasa, incensed, in his tum took water in his hand and was about to curse **VASISHTHA** when his wife restrained him, saying : "' O King, since the blessed Sage is our spiritual Preceptor, it is not proper for thee to pronounce a curse upon him, a priest is like unto a God.' " Then that virtuous monarch poured out that water charged with power and some fell on his feet, which became stained and, from that time the illustrious Saudasa became known as Kalmashapada.' Then that monarch, with his conson, having prostrated themselves before **VASISHTHA** again and again, in formed him of what the *Rakshasa*, under the shape of a *brahmin*, had done. " Hearing from that foremost of monarchs of the vile act of the *Rakshasa*, **VASISHTHA** addressed the king once more, saying : " ' The words that I have pronounced in anger may not be uttered in vain but I will grant thee a boon. Thou shalt be freed from the curse in twelve years and, by my favour, shall not remember what has passed, O Foremost of Men.' " Having suffered the consequences of that curse, Saudasa, the Slayer of His Foes, recovered his kingdom and rnled over his subjects. O Descendant of Raghu, this is the beautiful site of that sacrifice performed by Kalmashapada about which thou hast enquired." Having heard the dreadful story of that monarch, **SHATRUGHNA**, paying obeisance to that great *Rishi*, entered the leaf-thatched hut.

CHAPTER 66

The Birth of Kusha and Lava

the youthful ascetics brought the pleasant and auspicious tidings to **VALMIKI**, saying : " O Blessed One, Rams's consort has given birth to twin sons, do thou perform the rites that will preserve them from evil forces." Hearing these words, the great *Rishi* went to see those newly born Ones, who were as effulgent as the new moon and full of vignur, like unto twin offspring of the Gods. Coming to where **SITA** was, on beholding those two infants, his heart was filled with delight and he performed the *Rakshasa* Rite.' Taking a handful of Kusba Grass with its roots, that Twice-born One, **VALMIKI**, pronounced the formula of protection for the destruction of evil forces, saying : " Since they will rub the first born of the children with the Kusba Grass' blessed by the aid of Mantras, his name shall be Kusha and, as the last born will be carefully dried by the female ascetics with the roots of the grass, he shall be called Lava. Therefore those two shall be called Kusba and Lava and, by these names that I have given them, they will become renowned." Thereafter, the female ascetics purified themselves and reverently received the grass from the bands of the *Muni*, applying it to the two children. The rite having been performed in the night, Sbatrughna hearing the pleasant tidings, the names the children would bear, and Rams's praises, also that **SITA** bad undergone this double and fortunate birth, approached the leaf thatched hut where **SITA** lay and said : " O Mother, be thou happy!" Thus, for the magnanimous Sbatrughna. that night of the rainy season in the month of Shravana passed joyfully and rapidly and, the next day at dawn, that great hero, having offered up his morning devotions, with joined palms paid obeisance to the Sage and

resumed his journey. After a march of seven days, reaching the banks of the Yam una, he halted at the hermitage of *Rishis* of great renown, and that illustrious Prince listened to the pleasant and ancient legends of Chyavaoa of the line of Bhrigu and of other Sages. In this way, **SHATRUGHNA**, the son of that foremost of monarchs, King **DASARATHA**, in great delight, passed the night conversing with the ascetics, of whom Kancana was the leader, on various themes.

CHAPTER 67

The Story of Mandhata

THE night having come, **SHATRUGHNA** enquired of the son of Bhrigu, Chyavana, concerning the strength of Lavana, saying : " O *Brahmin*, how powerful is his weapon ? Who did Lavana formerly slay with that splendid shaft in combat ? " Thus questioned by him, the extremely virtuous Cbyavana answered the magnanimous **SHATRUGHNA**, the Joy of the Raghus, saying: " O Son of Raghu, innumerable are his exploits ! Hear what befell a descendant of Ikshvaku. Formerly there reigned in Ayodhya, the valiant son of Yavanashwa, Mandhata, who was renowned in the Three Worlds for his prowess. " Having placed the entire earth under his yoke, that monarch sought to conquer the Celestial Realm. Great was the fear of **INDRA** and the Gods on beholding Mandhata's preparations, who wished to conquer the region of the *Devas*. Learning of his intention to share **INDRA**'s throne and kingdom, the God, who chastised Paka, addressed Yuvaoashwa's son in propitiatory accents and said : " ' Thou dost not yet rule over the entire earth, not having wholly subjugated it, O King, yet thou aspirest to the celestial throne. When the whole earth is under thy dominion, then, s69 with thy servants, thine

army and thy chariots, do thou take possession of the kingdom of the Gods.' " Thus did **INDRA** speak, and Mandhata answered him, saying : " ' Who on the face of the earth has contested my domina tion? ' Then the God of a **THOUSAND EYES** *said*: "'The *Rakshasa* named Lavana, son of Madhu, who dwells in the forest, has not recognized thine authority, O Irreproach able Warrior!' “At these extremely unpleasing words uttered by **INDRA**, the king hung his head in shame, being unable to answer him. Thereafter, paying obeisance to the Thousand-eyed God, he departed with bowed head and retUrned to earth. “Then that Prince, the Slayer of His Foes, concealing his anger, placed himself at the head of his servants, infantry and cavalry and marched against the son of Madhu in order to con quer him. And that foremost of men sent a messenger to Lavana to challenge him to combat, who, coming before him, covered the son of Madhu with abuses and, while he was still speaking, the *Rakshasa* devoured him. “As his envoy failed to return, the king, enraged, assailed Lavana with a hail of arrows, whereupon the *Rakshasa*, taking up his trident, mockingly hurled it upon him in order to exter minate him and his followers, and the flaming trident, that formidable weapon, reduced the king, his servants, his infantry and cavalry to ashes and returned to the band of its master. " Thus did that grest monarch perish with his footsoldiers and chariots. O My Friend, it was through the power of that trident, which is unsurpassed ! To-morrow at dawn thou shalt without doubt slay Lavaoa ere he has taken up his weapon ; thy victory is assured ! The worlds will be freed as a result of thine exploit. O Foremost of Men, I have now told thee all concerning the wicked Lavaoa ; it is on this account that Mandhata succumbed in his undertaking. To-morrow at dawn, O Magnanimous One, thou shalt undoubtedly slay him ! He will have set out in search of food without his trident. Thy victory is therefore assured, O Foremost of

Men.”

CHAPTER 68

Shatrughna encounters Lavana

WHILST Chyavana was recounting this story and all were wishing him an overwhelming vicrory, the night speedily passed away for the magnanimous Shatrughoa. Meantime as the cloudless dawn broke, the bold *Rakshasa* ser out from the city eager to find food and, during this time the intrepid Shatroghna crossed the Yamuna and, bow in hand, took up his position at the gate of Madhupura. At noon, that *Rakshasa* of evil *karma* returned laden with countless living beings and, beholding Shatrughoa standing at the gate with his weapon, the demon enquired of him : “What wilt thou do with that weapon? In my wrath, O Least of Warriors, I have devoured thousands of men like thee with their weapons ; it is death that brings thee here. I am not yet fully fed, O Vilest of Men, why hast thou come to cast thyself into my mouth, thou fool ! " Thus did he speak, laughing loudly, and the courageous Shatrughoa shed tears of rage and, in his fury, sparks of fire issued from all his limbs. Thereafter, in a transport of anger, he said to that ranger of the uigbt : " I shall enter into single combat with thee ! I am the son of **DASARATHA**, the brother of the sagacious **RAMA**, my name is Shatrughoa, a veritable Shatroghna,' and it is my desire to slay thee that has brought me hither ! I wish to fight with thee, THE RAMA YANA OF VALMIKI sweep you all away like straws, both those who are already born and those still to be born. O Thou of vicious intellect, I accept thy challeoge ! Stay but a momeot till I fetch my weapoo, one suited to thy destruction ! " Thereupon **SHATRUGHNA** instantly

answered saying : " What, shalt thou escape me alive? He who has any wit does not allow a foe to go free who has come forth of his own accord. He, who, in his stupidity, suffers a foe to escape, perishes. Look long on the world, for, with my whetted shafts, I shall despatch thee to **YAMA**'s abode, thou the enemy of the Three Worlds and of Raghava."

CHAPTER 69

The Death of Lavana

AT these words from the mighty **SHATRUGHNA**, Lavana fell into a violeot rage and cried out :-" Stay ",striking his hands together and grinding his teeth, thereafter assailing that Lion of the Raghus with redoubled blo\\ s. Thereupon **SHATRUGHNA**, the Slayer of His Foes, answered Lavana of formidable aspect, who had addressed him thus, saying: " When others were slain by thee, I was not yet born, but to-day, pierced by my darts, do thou eoter the region of **YAMA** ! May the *Rishis* and learned *brahmins* this day be wimess of thy death in combat, O Wretch ! When my shafts have consumed thee in the fight, thou who art a ranger of the night, the city well-seasoned crescent-shaped arrows and, thereafter, he let a shower of darts fall on the valiant *Rakshasa* without causing him to retreat. With a mocking laugh, Lavana, btandishiug a tree, struck the head of that hero so that he fell insensible, and when that warrior fell, a great cry of "Ah ! Ah ! " arose from the *Rishis*, *Devas*, Gandharvas and also Apsaras. Thereupon the *Rakshasa,* thinking **SHATRUGHNA** to be slain, did not enter his house, though tbe opportunity presented itself and, seeing him lying on tbe earth, he did not go in search of his trident, but, reflecting, " He is dead," he began to collect his food. **SHATRUGHNA**, however, regaining his senses, in an

instant took hold of his weapon and went to his place at the city gate once more, amidst tbe acclamations of tbe *Rishis* ; and he selected a celestial, infallible and marvellous arrow that illumined the ten regions with its brilliance and resembled lightning in its velocity. That shaft, smeared with sandal paste of the colour of blood, wonderfully plumed, was greatly feared by the leaders of the Danavas, the mountains and also the *Asuras*, and, beholding that dreadful weapon, flaming like Time at tbe end of tbe world period, all beings were seized with terror. Then *Devas*, *Asuras*, Gandharvas and troops of Apsaras and tbe whole universe trembled and took refuge with the Grandsire of tbe worlds. Thereafter the Gods, beside themselves with fear, enquired of that Lord of Lords, the Bestower of Grace, tbe Grandsire of the Worlds, whether the universe were about to be destrOyed. Hearing them speak tbus, **BRAHMA**, the Grandsire, addressed them in soothiug accents, that restored their serenity, saying : " Hear me, O Ye Gods, it is in order to destrOy Lavana in combat that **SHATRUGHNA** is armed with that weapon. O Fore most nf tbe Gods, all are overwhelmed by the power of this eternal weapon forged by the primeval God, tbe Creator of tbe World. O My Children, that ctrulgent shaft which causes such terror was fashioned for tbe destruction of the demons, Madhu and Kaitabba, by tbe magnanimous God, **VISHNU**, who alone understands it. In reality, it is tbe primeval form of **VISHNU** Himself, therefore go and witness tbe death of the foremost of the Raksbasas, Lavana, under the blows of that valiant warrior, the younger brother of **RAMA**." 513 At these words of that God of Gods, the *Devas* went to the place where the combat berween **SHATRUGHNA** and Lavana was in progress and that weapon of celestial effulgence, which Shat rughna held in his hand, appeared to all beings like the Fire that blazes forth at the dissolution of the worlds ! Beholding the firmament filled with the Celestial Host, the descendant

ofRaghu emitted a leonine roar and, thereafter, looked on Lavana again and again. On this renewed provocation from his adversary, the *Rakshasa*, enraged, stretched his bow up to his ear and that most skilled of archers discharged his great arrow on the breast of the enemy, that piercing it, entered the lower regions. Having penetrated into Rasatala itself, the celestial weapon, honoured by the Gods, immediately returned to that hero, the Joy of the lkshvakus, and, pierced by Shat rughna's arrow, Lavana, that ranger of the night, fell like a mountain struck by lightning. Thereafter, Lavana being slain under the eyes of the Gods, the mighty celestial trident returned to Rudra. When, with a single shafi, that hero of the Raghus destroyed the terror of the Three Worlds with his bow and marvellous arrow, he resembled that orb of a thousand rays which dispels the darkness. Then the *Devas*, great *Rishis*, Pannagas and Apsaras cried out in chorus : " By good fortune, the son of **DASARATHA** has triumphed ; fear is banished and, like a great reptile, Lavana lies stretched on the earth."

CHAPTER 70

Shatrughna establishes Himself in the City of Madhu

humbly: " That I may enter into possession of this ravishing and picturesque city, constructed by the Gods, is my dearest wish ! " Then the Celestials answered with delight, " Be it so ! this eharming city shall assuredly become Shurashena ! " At these words the high-souled Celestials returned to their abode ; the valiant **SHATRUGHNA**, however, summoned his army that was encamped on the banks of the Yamuna and the troops immediately came to that place, having learned of his victory,

and he established himself there in the month of Shravana. The inhabitants of that region of celestial aspect lived there for twelve years in peace and happiness, and the fields abounded in grain. Under the aegis of **SHATRUGHNA**'s arms, **INDRA** sent rain in the proper season and the city was full of healthy and happy people. That capital had the brilliance of the crescent moon and rose in splendour on the banks of the Yam una ; and it was magnificent with its buildings and squares, markets and high ways and the inhabitants who belonged to the four castes. **SHATRUGHNA** had embellished the magnificent and vast edifices that Lavana had formerly constructed and painted in various colours. Parks and places of entertainment were to be found in all parts of that city, which was also adorned with works of art both human and divine. Of a celestial aspect, it was filled with different kinds of merchandise, and traders from every country came there. Looking on that opulent city, **SHATRUGHNA**, the younger brother of **BHARATA**, at the height of prosperity and happiness, experienced supreme satisfaction. After twelve years while he yet dwelt in that enchanting abode, the thought came to him, " I desire to behold **RAMA** again," thereupon, while residing in that city full of people of every condition, the prince resolved to look on the feet of the Chief of the Ragbus once more. CHAPTER 7I **SHATRUGHNA** seeks out the Sage V almiki Now in the twelfth year, Sbaxrughna, with a small escort of servants and soldiers, desired to return to Ayodhya where **RAMA** reigned. Having dissuaded his leading counsellors and chief warriors from accompanying him, be set out on his most excellent steed with a hundred chariots. That descendant of Raghu, having covered fifteen stages (*of the journey*) reached **VALMIKI**'s hermitage where be halted. Thereafter that fOremost of men paid obeisance to the ascetic, who, as host, with his own hands offered him water to wash his feet and the Arghya. Then the

Sage recounted the most agreeable and varied traditions to the magnanimous Shatrnghna and, speaking of the death of Lavana, he said : " Thou hast accomplished a difficult feat in slaying him ! O Valiant Youth, many mighty monarchs with their troops of infantry and cavalry succumbed in their struggle with Lavana. Thou hast slain him as it were in sport, O Foremost of Men! By thy valour, the fear of the worlds has been terminated. The death ofRavana was brought about with great difficulty by **RAMA**, but this marvellous feat of arms has been accomplished by thee without any trouble whatsoever ! At the faD of Lavana, great joy broke out amongst the Celestials and happiness now reigns amidst aU beings in the whole world, O Prince of the House of Raghu ! Being present in Vasava's assembly, I wimessed thy combat, and my heart too was filled with a keen felicity ; now by smelling the crown of thy head, I testify to the great affection I bear fur thee." With these words, the illustrious **VALMIKI** smelt the crown of **SHATRUGHNA**'s head and offered him and his followers the traditional hospitality. Having eaten, **SHATRUGHNA**, the foremost of men, listened to the sweetest chants which told the history of **RAMA** and how aU had tsken place. Stringed instruments accompanied the singing in the triple mode' which was expressive and melodic ; and he

CHAPTER 71

Shatrughna seeks out the Sage Valmiki

CHAPTER 7I **SHATRUGHNA** seeks out the Sage V almiki Now in the twelfth year, Sbaxrughna, with a small escort of servants and soldiers, desired to return to Ayodhya where **RAMA** reigned. Having dissuaded his leading counsellors and chief warriors from accompanying him, be

set out on his most excellent steed with a hundred chariots. That descendant of Raghu, having covered fifteen stages (*of the journey*) reached **VALMIKI**'s hermitage where be halted. Thereafter that fOremost of men paid obeisance to the ascetic, who, as host, with his own hands offered him water to wash his feet and the Arghya. Then the Sage recounted the most agreeable and varied traditions to the magnanimous Shatrnghna and, speaking of the death of Lavana, he said : " Thou hast accomplished a difficult feat in slaying him ! O Valiant Youth, many mighty monarchs with their troops of infantry and cavalry succumbed in their struggle with Lavana. Thou hast slain him as it were in sport, O Foremost of Men! By thy valour, the fear of the worlds has been terminated. The death ofRavana was brought about with great difficulty by **RAMA**, but this marvellous feat of arms has been accomplished by thee without any trouble whatsoever ! At the faD of Lavana, great joy broke out amongst the Celestials and happiness now reigns amidst aU beings in the whole world, O Prince of the House of Raghu ! Being present in Vasava's assembly, I wimessed thy combat, and my heart too was filled with a keen felicity ; now by smelling the crown of thy head, I testify to the great affection I bear fur thee." With these words, the illustrious **VALMIKI** smelt the crown of **SHATRUGHNA**'s head and offered him and his followers the traditional hospitality. Having eaten, **SHATRUGHNA**, the foremost of men, listened to the sweetest chants which told the history of **RAMA** and how aU had tsken place. Stringed instruments accompanied the singing in the triple mode' which was expressive and melodic ; and he heard the story of **RAMA** and what had formerly been achieved by him ; his imperishable exploits as they had taken place in time gone by, and that foremost of men, **SHATRUGHNA**, was transported, his eyes fuU of tears, and he remained absorbed, sighing again and again. It seemed to him that this

song made the past live once more, and **SHATRUGHNA**'s companions, overcome, listened to the enchanting symphonic poem with bowed heads. Thereafter, those warriors cried out, " Wonderful ! " and began to question each other, saying : " What is this ? Where are we ? Is it a vision or a dream ? Are we seeing that marvellous epic in a dream ? " In their extreme astonishment, they said to Shatrugbna : " O Prince, do thou interrogate **VALMIKI**, that foremost of Sages," for they were all struck with amazement, but Shat rughna answered them, saying : O Ye Soldiers, it is not fitting to intenogate such a person. Many miracles take place in this hermitage, nevertheless, it does not become us to question a great ascetic out of curiosity." Having spoken thus to his troops, the son of Raghu paid obeisance to that illustrious *Rishi* and entered his own quarters.

CHAPTER 72

Shatrughna returns to see Rama

Chariot and, in his eagerness to see **RAMA**, soon reached Ayodhya. Having entered that charming city, the long-armed and fortunate desceodant of the Iksbvakus sought out **RAMA** of great renown and beheld him seated amidst his counsellors, his countenance as radiant as the full moon, and be resembled the Thousand-eyed God surrounded by the Immortals. Paying obeisance to the resplendent and magnanimous **RAMA** with joined palms, be addressed that hero, whose prowess was truth, saying : " O Great King, all that thou hast commanded has been carried out by me ; the wicked Lavana is dead and his city is occupied. Now twelve years have been passed far from thee, O Joy of the Raghus, and I can no longer live separated from thee, O Prince. Be gracious to

me, O Kakutstha, thou whose valour is immeasurable ; do not ask me to remain there longer like a calf separated from its mother.” As he spoke thus, Kakutstha embraced him and said : " Do not give way to despondency, O Valiant One, such conduct is not worthy of a warrior. Kings do not withdraw to foreign lands, O Raghava, the duty of a king is the protection of his people. O Virtuous **SHATRUGHNA**, do thou visit me from time to time in Ayodhya, then thou must return to thy capital. I too cherish thee more than life itself yet it is essential to look to the security of thy kingdom. Meantime remain here with me for seven days, O Kakutstha, and thereafter return to Madhura with thine escort of servants and cavalty.” Heating **RAMA** 's words that were pleasing to the heart and in conformity with *dharma*, Shatrugbna answered sorrowfully,” So be it!, Thereafter, having passed a week in Ramo’s proximity, that skilful archer, **SHATRUGHNA**, in accord with his brother’s will, made preparations to depart. Paying obeisance to that true hero, the magnanimous Rams, and to **BHARATA** and **LAKSHMANA**, he ascended his chariot and, being accompanied for a great distance by **LAKSHMANA** and **BHARATA**, be hastened to regain his capital.

CHAPTER 73

The Death of a Brahmin's Son

Now some time after, an aged peasant, a *brahmin*, bearing his dead child in his arms came to the palace gate, weeping and crying out again and again : What sin did I commit in a previous existence ? " Overcome with paternal grief, he repeated unceasingly, “O My Son, My Son ! Ab ! Of what fault was I formerly guilty in another body that I should see mine only son meet with death ? This boy bad not yet reached

adolescence, his fourteenth year not having been completed! To my misfortune, before his time, this dear child has been sttuck down by death ! In a few days, I and thy mother too will die of grief, O Dear Child ! I do not recollect ever to have uttered a lie ; I do not remember ever inflicting an injury on any animal or doing harm to any person ! For what misdeed bas this child, born to me, gone to the abode of Vaivaswata this day, ere he bad performed a son's duties to his sire? Never before have I wimessed or heard of such a dreadful thing as, in **RAMA**'s reign, for people to die prematurely. **RAMA** must have committed a serious fault since in his kingdom, children succumb. Assuredly the young who inhabit other countries need not fear death I O King, give me back the life of my child, who has fallen under the sway of death I With my wife, I shall yield up my life at the gate of the king as if I were without a protector ! Thereafter, having been guilty of Brahmanicide, O **RAMA**, be happy ! Mayest thou live long with thy brothera ! O Mighty Monarch, under thy rule, after a period of prosperity in thine empire, misfonune has now overtaken us, placing us under death's dominion, O **RAMA** ! From now on we shall not enjoy the least felicity aince the empire of the magnanimous Iltshvakus no longer has a support. With **RAMA** as its protector, the death of children is certain. People perish under the unrighteous rule of an impious monarch. The S79 evil conduct of a king brings about the premature death of his subjects. When, in the cities and country, crimes are committed and no supervision is exercised, then death is to be feared ! Undoubtedly the king will be held to be at fault in city and countty, hence the death of this child." Such were the countless recriminations that the unfortunate father addressed to the king whilst he clasped his son to his breast.

CHAPTER 74

Narada's Discourse

THE piteous lamentations of that unfortunate *brahmin* reached the ears of the king and he, in the profound distress he experi enced, called together his ministers, **VASISHTHA** and Vamadeva, with his brothers and the elders of the city also. Then eight *brahmins* were ushered into the king's presence by **VASISHTHA**, who resembled a God, and they said: " May prosperity attend thee ! " Thereafter those foremost of the Twice-born, Markandeya, Maudgalya, Vamadeva, Kashyapa, Katyayana, Javali, Gautama and Narada took their seats, and those *Rishis* being assembled, **RAMA** paid obeisance to them with joined palms. Then the ministers and citizens received a cordial welcome, as was fitting, and all those highly effulgent persons being seated near him, Raghava informed them of the reproaches of that Twice-hom One. Hearing the words of the prince, who was filled with distress, Narada himself made this memorable reply in the assembly of the Sages: " Learn, O King, what has caused the untimely death of this child ! When thou art conversant therewith, do what thou considerest to be thy duty ! " O Prince, Joy of the Raghus, formerly in the Krita *Yuga*, *brahmins* were re-born enlightened and endowed with the gift of immonality. In that age, none died prematurely and all were wise. " The Treta *Yuga* followed when the sons of Manu were born, who practised austerities; these noble men were the rulers, and full of power and heroism. In that era, *Brahmins* and Ksbatriyas were equal in power nor could any distinction be fuund amongst them ; it was then that the four castes were established. " When that *Yuga*, which bad been free from nescience, was consumed in the Fire, unrighteousness placed one foot on the earth and,

on account of wrong-doing, glory waned and the span of life was diminished, O Best of Monarchs. Flesh that had been formerly eaten,' became impure food throughout the whole world and, in these conditions, men gave themselves up to good deeds, taking refuge in purity and justice to rid them selves of evil. " In the Treta *Yuga*, brahrnins and warriors practised asceticism and the rest were under the supreme obligation of obedience, proper ro the Vaishya and Shudra classes; the Shudras' duty being to serve the other three. "O Great King, in the Dwapara *Yuga*, untruth and evil increased, unrightousncss having placed a second foot on the earth, and then the Vaishyas began to practice penance, so that *dharma*, in the form of asceticism, was perfurmed by the three castes, but the Shudras were not permitted to undertake it during that time, O Foremost of Men. " O Prince, a man of the lowest caste may not give himself up to penance in the Dwapara *Yuga*; it is only in the Kali *Yuga* that the practice of asceticism is permitted to the Shudra caste. During the Dwapara *Yuga* it is a great crime fur one of Shudra birth to perfunn such practices. "At this time, in thine empire, a rigid penance is being under taken by a wretched Shudra, O Prince, and this is the cause of the death of that child. " The practice of unrighteouancss, be it in the city or the : :g: country, brings about misfortune and the monarch who doea not mete out an immediate punishment, goea to hell, of this there is no doubt. "An act of mortification that is prescribed is well done and a sixth of the merit goes to the king who rules with justice. But how should he, who does not protect his people, enjoy the sixth portion ? O Lion among Men, thou shouldst investigate the happenings in thy kingdom and put down evil wherever it is practised, so righteousness may fiourish, man's life be prolonged and the child be revived."

CHAPTER 75

Rama makes a Tour of Inspection of His Kingdom

HEARING the nectar-like words of Narada, Rams was delighted and said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O Dear Friend, thou who art faithful to thy vows, go and console that leading *brahmin* and cause the body of the child to be placed in a jar of oil with precious unguents and fragrant salves so that it is covered and does not suffer decomposition. Act in such a way that the body of the child does not dissolve or decay." Having issued this command to **LAKSHMANA**, who was endowed with auspicious marks, the highly illustrious Kakutstha thought of Pushpaka, and said " Come hither ! " Conscious of his inten tion, the golden chariot appeared before him in the same hour and bowing, said to him : " Behold, I am here at thy service, O Long-armed Prince I " Listening to the gracious words of Pushpaka, Rams paid obeisance to the gTCt *Rishis* and ascended the chariot. Armed with his bow, his two quivers and his glittering sword, Raghava left the city in the charge of his two brothers, Saumitri and **BHARATA**, and thereafter that monarch directed his course to the western region which he explored on every side ; then he went to the northern region bounded by the Himalayas, but found nn UTT ARA *KANDA* trace of evil-doing there ; later the eastern region was carefully searched by him and that long-armed Prince, from on high in his chariot, beheld people of pure morals there, as stainless as a mirror. Then he, who causes felicity to the great *Rishis*, ranged the southern region and, on the side of the Shaivala Mountain, a vast Jake appeared to him, on the banks of which the blessed Raghava beheld an ascetic practising an extremely rigorous penance, his head hanging downwards. On this that Prince born of Raghu approached the one who had given himself up to

rigorous practices and said : " Blessed art thou, O Ascetic, who art faithful to thy vows ! From what caste art thou sprung, O Thou who hast grown old in mortification and who an established in heroism. I am interested in this matter, I, **RAMA**, the son of **DASARATHA**. What purpose hast thou in view ? Is it heaven or some other object ? What boon dost thou seek by means of this hard penance ? I wish to know what thou desirest in perfonning these austerities, O Ascetic. May prosperity attend thee ! Art thou a *brahmin* ? Art thou an invincible *Kshatriya*? An thou a Vaishya, one of the third caste or an thou a Shudra ? Answer me truthfully ! " Then the ascetic, who was hanging head downwards, thus questioned by **RAMA**, revealed his origin to that Prince born of **DASARATHA**, the foremost of kings, and the reason why he was practising penance.

CHAPTER 76

Shambuka is slain by Rama

praise, and a rain of celestial flowers of divine fragrance fell on all sides, scattered by Vayu. In their supreme satisfaction, the Gods said to that hero, **RAMA** : " Thou hast protected the interests of the Gods, O Highly Intelligent Prince, now ask a boon, O Beloved Offspring of Raghu, Destroyer of Thy Foes. By thy grace, this Shudra will not be able to attain heaven!" Hearing the words of the Gods, that hero of the region of truth, with joined palms, addressed Purandara of a Thousand Eyes, saying : " Since the Gods are gratified with me, let the son of that *brahmin* be resuscitated ! Accord me this, the greatest of all favours ! It is on account of my negligence that this child, the only son of that *brahmin*, has died before his time. Give him back his life ! May

prosperity be yours ! I have promised that I would restore his son to this Twice-born, do not let my words prove false ! " Thus spoke Raghava and the foremost of the Celestials, full of joy, gave him this reply, enhancing his felicity : " O Kakutstha be happy ! This very day that child has received new life and has been restored to his parents. The child was resuscitated at the instant that the head of the Shudra fell. Be happy ! May prosperity attend thee ! Now let us go, O Raghava, O Foremost of Monarchs, we desire to visit Agastya's hermitage. The hour of consecration is at hand for that great *Rishi* ! O illustrious Prince, for twelve years, he has lived in the water. O Kakutstha, let us go together to offer felicitations to that ascetic. Do thou come and visit the foremost of *Rishis* also and be happy." " Be it so ! "said the enhancer of the Raghus' joy and ascended the gold-encrusted Chariot, Pushpalta. Meantime, the Gods had lefr in their vast chariots and **RAMA** followed them without delay to the hermitage of Kumbhayoni. Beholding those Gods come to meet him, the virtuous Agastya, that treasury of asceticism, paid obeisance to all without distinction and, having received his homage and offered aaluta tations to him, the Gods joyfully returned to their abode with their attendants. When they had departed, **RAMA** descended from the Pushpaka Plane and offered obeisance to that illustrious *Rishi*. Agastya, radiant in his own effulgence, returned the salutation of his magnanimous Sovereign, who, having received supreme hospitality, sested himself, whereupnn the illustrious Kumb hayoni of rigid penances said to him : " O Foremost of Men, be thou welcome ! O Raghava, it is my good fortune that brings thee here ! O **RAMA**, thou art worthy of the highest respect on account of thine outstanding and innumerable attributes, O Prince ! Thou art a guest worthy of honour and abidest in mine hesrt. The Gods tell me that thou hast come here after slaying the Shudra and, by this act of justice thou hast restored the

son of a *brahmin* to life ! Pass the night here with me, O Raghava, for thou art Narayana, the messed Lord and all is to be found in Thee ! Thou art the divine Purusha I To-morrow at dawn thou canst retutn to the city in the Pushpaka Chariot. " O My Friend, here is an ornament wrought by Vishvakarma, which is of divine origin and glows by its own light. Be pleased to accept it, O Kakutstha. To give again what one has received is said to be of the grestest profit. Thou art worthy of this ornament and also of the highest rewards since thou hast protected the Gods and their lesders. I have therefore a right to offer this to thee, do thou accept it, O Prince." as their ruler. To obtain a king, therefore, men approached Brabma, the God of Gods and said : " ' O Lord, thou bast made **INDRA** ruler over the Celestials, therefore do thou confer a sovereign upon us who shall be the foremost of men ; we cannot live without a king, this is our firm conviction ! ' " Then the Grandsire of the World sent for **INDRA** and the other Gods and said : " ' Do ye all sacrifice a portion of your welfare ! ' and the Celestials surrendered pan of their power and a king was born, whereupon **BRAHMA** named him Kshupa. In his person, **BRAHMA** placed an equal proportion of the powers of the Gods and appointed him as ruler of men. By virtue of the portion of **INDRA**'s energy, the King Kshupa brought the eanh under his control; by the portion of Varona's energy, he fostered health in his body ; by the power of **YAMA**, he ruled the people. O **RAMA**, by vinue of **INDRA**'s portion, thou art the Ruler of the earth, do thou accept this jewel and confer thy grace on me." Hearing the words of the Sage, **RAMA** accepted the brilliant and celestial gem sparkling like the rays of the sun and, having taken that excellent ornament, Dasarathi enquired of the great Sage Kumbhayoni, saying : " Whence bast thou obtained this divine ornament of celestial workmanship ? Who bas given it to thee , O *Brahmin*, I ask thee out of curiosity , Thou an an ocean of marvels ! " **THEN AGASTYA**

answered: " Hear, O **RAMA**, how I obtained this ornament in the Treta *Yuga*."

CHAPTER 77

The Story of Swargin

" In the centre was a lake some four miles in extent, abounding in swans and waterfowl, Chakravakra birds being its ornament. It was coveted with lotuses and waterlilies, no weed or moss grew there and its waters were deep, tranquil and sweet. Near that wonderfUl lake, I found a spacious hermitage which was of great antiquity and devoid of man or beast. It was there I spent a summer night, O Foremost of Men. At dawn, I rose to per form my morning devotions and directed my steps to the lake. There I beheld a dead body, plump and spotless, shining in splendour in the water. This sight caused me to reflect awhile, O Raghava, and I stood on the banks of the lake asking myself, ' What can this be ? ' " O Lord, a moment later a wonderfUl celestial chariot came into view, which was magnificent, and harnessed to swans that were as swift as thought. In that chariot I beheld a man of extraordinary beauty, O Joy of the House of Raghu, who was surrounded by thousands of Apsaras adorned with celestial ornaments. Some were singing enchantingly whilst others played on musical instruments such as Mridangas, Vinas and Panavas ; some were dancing and some, with the aid of Chan waras gleaming like the moon's rays, possessing ornate handles, were fanning the face of that lotus-eyed youth. Then he, who was as radiant as the peak of Mount Meru, leaving his seat, descended from the chariot and, under my gaze, devoured that corpae. Having satisfied his hunger with abundant flesh, he plunged into the waters and

after washing his hands and rinsing his mouth according to tradition, he re-ascended his chariot. " Beholding that heavenly being about to depart, I spoke to him thus, O Prince : " ' Who art thou who resemblest a God? Why hast thou partaken of this forbidden flesh, O My Friend ? Tell me how doea this loathsome nourishment benefit thee, O Thou who art the equal of the Celestials ? There is some mystery in this, O Friend, I wish to know what it is ; I cannot believe a corpae to be fitting food for thee.' "Thus, out of curiosity, in friendly accents, did I speak to that Nakin,' O Prince and having listened to me, he told me all."

CHAPTER 78

Shveta tells His Story

Joy of the House of Raghu. " ' Hesr, O *Brahmin*, of what happened to me formerly, bringing about my felicity and also my suffering. Lesm of the inexorable fate about which thou hast questioned me. " ' In times gone by, my illustrious Sire, the mighty Sudeva reigned over the Vidarbhas. He bad two sons by his two queens, O *Brahmin*, I was named Sbveta and my younger brother Suratha. My father having ascended to hesven, I was installed as king by the people, and accordingly applied myself to rule with equity. " 'A thousand yesrs passed whilst I governed the empire piously and protected my people according to *dharma*. Knowing by certain indications that I was ageing, O Foremost of the Twice-born, I reftected on the laws of time and went to the forest. There I penetrated into an inaccessible grove, where there were neither bessts nor birds, in order to practise penance on the banks of this besutifollake, having first placed my brother Suratha on the throne as lord of the empire. " ' Nesr this lake, I gave myself up to severe mortifications and

practised austerities for thousands ofyesrs in the gtest forest. This excessively rigid penance caused me to attain Btahmaloka, which nothing transcends. Having ascended to hesven, extreme hunger and thirst assailed me, O Foremost of the Twice-born, whereupon, my mind troubled, I approached the Lord of the Three Worlds, the Grandsire, and said to him : " ' " O Blessed One, in Btahmaloka one should not be subject to hunger and thirst ; from what act of mine does this desire to est and drink, spring ? What should be my food, tell me, O Divine Grandsire ? " " ' Then the Grandsire answered me, saying : " ' " O Son of Sudeva, thine own flesh shall be thy savoury nourishment and thou shalt feed on it daily. Thou didst ever nourish thy body well when thou wast performing an excellent 588 penance. That which is sowed ever ftourishes, O Virtuous Shveta. Without making any gifts, thou didst practise asceti cism ; it is on this account that thou art subject to hunger and thitst in heaven, which thou hast attained. Therefore, thine own body that has been well nourished shall be thy food in heaven, and it shall be converted into Amrita, but when the great and invincible *Rishi* Agastya comes to the forest, he will deliver thee from this bondage, O Shvcta ! My Friend, he can save the hosts of the Gods themselves, how much more is he able to save thee from the domination of hunger and thirst to which thou art subjected, O Long-armed Hero." " ' O Lord of the Twice-born, since the decree of Bhagawat, that Lord of Lords, I have been nourishing myself miserably on mine own body! For innumerable years I have fed upon it without it diminishing, O Brahmarishi, and my appetite is excessive. Do thou deliver me from this painful pass ; release will not come to me from any other than the Ascetic Kumb hayoni ! O Dear and Excellent Sage, do thou accept this gift, may good betide thee, accord me this favour ! I will bestow gold, possessions, raiment, savoury food and much else besides, as also ornaments on thee, O Foremost of

Sages, I offer thee all that is desirable and all felicity, as the price of my deliverance, O Grant me that grace ! ' " Hearing these words nf that unfortunate Celestial Being, I accepted the rate jewel in order to save him and, as soon as I received that magnificent gem, the mortal body of that Royai *Rishi* melted away. His body being thus dissolved, that Rajatishi cxpcticnccd supreme satisfiution and joyfully ascended to Swarga. This is why that Celestial Being, who resembled Shakra, gave that divine gem, wonderful to look upon, to me, O Kakutstha."

CHAPTER 79

The hundred Sons of Ikshvaku

uninhabited wood in order to give himself up to the performance of asceticism ; I wish to know all in detail ? " Hearing this question inspired by curiosity, that foremost of ascetics began to speak thus : " In ancient times in the golden age, O **RAMA**, the Lord Manu was the ruler of the earth. His son was Ikshvaku, the enhancer of the felicity of his race. Having placed his eldest son, the invincible Ikshvaku on the throne, **MANU** *said*: " ' Become the founder of royal dynasties in the world ! ' " O **RAMA**, Ikshvaku promised to follow his injunctions and Manu, greatly delighted, added : " ' I am pleased with thee, O Noble One, undoubtedly thou shalt found a dynasty but, whilst ruling thy subjects with firm ness, never punish any who is without fault ! A punishment meted out to the guilty according to the law is instrumental in conducting a monarch to heaven, therefore, O Long-armed Hero, O Dear Child, exercise extreme care in wielding the sceptre, this is thy supreme duty on earth.' " Having counselled his son repeatedly in this wise, Manu joyfully repaired to the eternal abode of Brahrna. " His Sire

having ascended to the Celestial Region, Ikshvaku of immeasurable glory refiected anxiously within himself as to how he should create progeny. Having performed many sacrifices and charitable deeds, he was blessed with a hundred sons like unto the offspring of the Gods. The youngest of all, O Descendant of Raghu, was stupid and ignorant nor would he listen to the advice of his elders. On account of his lack of virtue, the king named him Danda, thinking that the rod (*Danda*) would inevitably fall on him. “As the monarch was unable to find a province suitable for his son, O Raghava, Conqueror of Thy Foes, he carved out a territory for him between the Vindhya and Shaivala Mountains. Danda became king and there built an incomparably beautiful city on that charming site surrounded by mountains. He named that city Madhumanta, O Lord, and chose Shultra *Deva* of pious practices as his spiritual preceptor. Danda with his Guru ruled over that city inhabited by happy people as the King of the Gods in heaven. That monarch, the son of the foremost of men, with the help of Shukra *Deva* ruled as the great and magnanimous Shakra in heaven under the guidance of Brihaspati.”

CHAPTER 80

Danda insults Aruja

" **D**anda, O Kskutstha, fully self-controlled, continued to rule for innumerable years, overcoming all obstacles. One day, in the delicious month of Cbairra, the king went to the ravishing hermitage of Bhargava and he beheld the daughter of that ascetic, who was walking in the woodland glade, and she was unrivalled in beauty on earth so that he was seized with desire. Pierced by the darts of the God of Love, he approached that youthful maiden and enquired of her, saying : " ' From

whence art thou, O Lady of graceful hips ? Who is thy father, O Beautiful One? Being a111icted with passion, I make these enquiries of thee, O Fair Lady ? ' " Thus did he speak in his agitation and the daughter of the ascetic answered sweetly : " ' I am the eldest daughter of Shukraeharya of imperishable deeds, know that my name is Aruja, O Foremost of Kings, and I dwell in this hermitage. Do not force thine attentions upon me, O King, for I am a girl still under my father's authority. My Sire is thy Guru, O Great Prince, thou art the disciple of that magnanimous ascetic ; that great Sage will inftict a terrible punishment on thee in his wrath. It is for thee to act honestly regarding me, in accord with the law of *dharma*, O Prince. Do thou first approach my father and ask for my hand or fearful consequences will follow thine act. In his wrath, my father will consume the Three Worlds themselves, O Thou of faultless form; if, however, thou ask for my hand, he will bestow it on thee.' " Thus spoke Aruja, but Danda, who had fallen under the sway of desire, with joined palms, answered her in his frenzy, saying: S9I " ' Grant me thy favours, O Charming One, do not delay, on thine account my breath is being extinguished, O Thou of lovely countenance. Having united myself with thee, what care I if death or the most terrible retribution foUow ? Respond to my love, O Timid One, that love that overwhelms me.' " Speaking thus, he seized that youthful woman roughly in his powerful arms and sated his lust on bet. Having committed this monstrous outrage, Danda returned to the unrivaUed city of Madhumanta with aU speed. Aruja however, sobbing near the hermitage, terrified, awaited her father who resembled a God." CHAPTER The Destruction uf Dam/a's Kincdom heard what had taken place, the blessed and illustrious Riahi, surrounded by his disciples, rerurned to the hermitage, tormented with hunger. Like unto the moon that has been devoured by the planet Rahu at dawn and is deprived of its

radiance, he beheld the unfortunate Aruja besmeared with dust; and that *brahmin*, being already consumed with hunger, feU into a transport of rage, so that it seemed he wished to destroy the Three Worlds. Thereafter he addressed his disciples, saying: " ' Witness the terrible calamity born of my wrath, like unto fire, that will befaU that evil-doer, Danda! The time has come for the destruction of that wretched monarch and his court, he, who has dared to place his hand in the flame of the sacrificial fire, will soon reap the fruit of his evil act ! In seven nights, he will perish with his children, infantry and cavalry. Pakashana' will destroy the territory of that wretch with a rain of dust for a distance of a hundred leagues in extent. In the kingdom of Danda, in seven days, all things animate and inaniniate will perish utterly and everything that grows will vanish entirely under the rain of ashes I ' " Having spoken thus to the inhabitants of the hermitage, his eyes red with anger, he added :

CHAPTER 81

The destruction of Danda's Kingdom

" ' Grant me thy favours, O Charming One, do not delay, on thine account my breath is being extinguished, O Thou of lovely countenance. Having united myself with thee, what care I if death or the most terrible retribution foUow ? Respond to my love, O Timid One, that love that overwhelms me.' " Speaking thus, he seized that youthful woman roughly in his powerful arms and sated his lust on bet. Having committed this monstrous outrage, Danda returned to the unrivaUed city of Madhumanta with aU speed. Aruja however, sobbing near the hermitage, terrified, awaited her father who resembled a God."

CHAPTER The Destruction uf Dam/a's Kincdom heard what had taken place, the blessed and illustrious Riahi, surrounded by his disciples, rerurned to the hermitage, tormented with hunger. Like unto the moon that has been devoured by the planet Rahu at dawn and is deprived of its radiance, he beheld the unfortunate Aruja besmeared with dust; and that *brahmin*, being already consumed with hunger, feU into a transport of rage, so that it seemed he wished to destroy the Three Worlds. Thereafter he addressed his disciples, saying: " ' Witness the terrible calamity born of my wrath, like unto fire, that will befaU that evil-doer, Danda! The time has come for the destruction of that wretched monarch and his court, he, who has dared to place his hand in the flame of the sacrificial fire, will soon reap the fruit of his evil act ! In seven nights, he will perish with his children, infantry and cavalry. Pakashana' will destroy the territory of that wretch with a rain of dust for a distance of a hundred leagues in extent. In the kingdom of Danda, in seven days, all things animate and inaniniate will perish utterly and everything that grows will vanish entirely under the rain of ashes I ' " Having spoken thus to the inhabitants of the hermitage, his eyes red with anger, he added :-" ' Take up your abode beyond the routines of this regiou ! ' " Hearing the words of Sbukracharya, all those who dwelt in the hermitage, left that place to establish themselves elsewhere, aud Sbukracharya, having spoken thus to that company of Sages, addressed his daughter Aruja aud said : " ' Remain in this hermitage, O Foolish One, and give thyself up to meditation. O Aruja, awaiting the time of thy deliverance, eujoy carefree this lake of enchanting aspect four miles in extent ! Those creatures that take refuge with thee at that time will in no wise suffer from the rain of dust ! ' "At the command of the Brabmarisbi, her Sire, Aruja, who was overcome with grief, answered ; ' So be it ! ' " Having spoken thus, Shukracharya found a dwelling else where. "

Meantime the kingdom of that foremost of meu with his servants, his army and his chariots was reduced to ashes on the seventh day, as predicted by that interpreter of the Veda. O Prince, that empire situated between the Vindbya aud the Sbaivala Mountains, its sovereign having ceased to uphold *dharma*, thus cursed by the Brahmarisbi, bas since been known as the Desert of Dandaka, O Kakutstha, and the place where the ascetics dwelt became known as Janasthana. I have now replied fully to all that thou bast asked, O Ragbava. The hour for the evening devotions is passing, O Hero; from all directions, the great *Rishis* with their loshtas filled, baving bathed, O Prince, arc now worshipping the Sun-god. The sun bas withdrawn behind the Astacbala Mountains while these learned interpreters of the V cda were reading the Brahmauas together ; do thou also perform thine ablutions, O **RAMA**."

CHAPTER 82

Rama takes leave of Agastya

FOLLOWING the bebeat of the Risbi, **RAMA**, in order to perform his evening devotions, approached the sacred lake frequented by troops of Apsaras. Having completed his ablutions and the S93 evening rites, be returned to the hermitage of the magnanimous Kumbhayoni. Thereupon Agastya, for his repast, prepared many kinds of fruit> and root> with rice and pure ingredient>, and the foremost of men partook of that food resembling Amrita and passed the night there happily. At dawn, that Subduer of His Foes, the Prince of the Raghus, having performed the morning rituals, approached the Sage before his departure and, paying obeisance to that great ascetic, born from a jar, said to him : " Suffer me to return to this retreat, I beg of thee ! Happy am I to have received the

favour of looking on such a great ascetic whom I shall visit again for my sanctification ! " Listening to the words of Kakutstha, wonderful to bear, he, whose visinn was righteousness, in great delight, answered : " O **RAMA**, O Joy of the Raghus, thy speech, brilliantly expressed, is of great eloquence. Thou thyself art the sanctity of all beings ! O **RAMA**, whoever cast> a single glance of love on thee is purified ; he goes to paradise where he receives the homage of the Lords of the Third Heaven ; but those who look on thee with a malevolent eye are suddenly suuck down by the Rod of Death and fall into hell ! O Prince, Issue of the Raghu Race, thou art the salvation of all beings on earth and those who even speak of thee acquire perfection. Do thou go in peace l Govern thine empire with equity ; thou art the path of the world!" Thus did that *Muni* speak and the virtuous prince with joined palms, paid obeisance to that ascetic and, having offered saluta tions to that foremost of Sages and the other *Munis*, rranquilly ascended the golden Pushpaka Chariot. As he was leaving, the companies of Sages showered blessings of every kind upon him, he who was equal to Mahendra, as the *Devas* acclaim that God of a Thousand Eyes. Standing in space, **RAMA**, in his golden Chariot Pushpaka, resembled the moon encircled with clouds. Thereafter, at noon, Kakuttha entered Ayodhya amidst continuous acclamations and, having reached the cenrral court, he dismounted from the car. When the prince left Pushpaka, that magnificent chariot, which coursed wheresoever one willed, dismissing it, he said : " Go, may good betide thee ! " 594 Thereafter **RAMA** issued this command to the doorkeeper who was in the courtyard and said : " Go and announce mine arrival to **LAKSHMANA** and **BHARATA**, those two swift-footed heroes, and summon them here without delay."

CHAPTER 83

Bharata persuades Rama not to perform the Rajasuya Sacrifice

AT this command from **RAMA** of imperishable exploits, the guard summoned those two youthful princes and came back to inform his master. Then he, seeing **BHARATA** and **LAKSHMANA**, embraced them both and said to them : " I have filithfully carried out the task of the excellent Twice born, now I wish to perform the Rajasuya Sacrifice, which to my mind is indestructible and unchangeable, the support of the law and the destroyer of all evil. Accompanied by you both, who are parts of myself, I wish to prepare for this sacrifice based on eternal *dharma*, for it is an unwritten duty. It was after per forming the Rajasuya Sacrifice that Mitra, the Scourge of His Foes, obtained **VARUNA**-hood by means of this rich offering. Having celebrated that sacrifice according to the aadition which was well-known to him, *Soma* acquired an imperishable state and renown in the world. Do you therefore tell me what is now best, and considering the matter with me, say candidly what is of the greatest profit for the future." Thus spoke Raghava, and **BHARATA**, a skilful debator, with joined palms made answer, saying : " O Dear Brother, in thee the highest sense of duty is to be found I It is in thee that the world finds her support ; in thee, aU glory resides, and also immeasurable valour, O Long-armed Hero. All the kings of the earth, and we too, regard thee as the protector of the universe, as do the Gods and Prajapati. Children look on thee as their filther, O Valiant Prince, thou hast become the salvation of living beings also, O Raghava ; how shouldst thou perform a aacrifice of such a nature, O Lord, in which the

destruction of many royal Houses is involved ? Further O King, S9S it means the total annihilation of those warriors who have become the heroes of the earth, which will prove a cause of universal condemnation. O Lion among Warriors, O Thou whose virtues render thee unequalled in power, do not destroy the world that is wholly subject to thee." When **RAMA** heard **BHARATA** speak thus, in words sweet as nectar, he experienced an extreme delight and addressed this benign response to the enhancer of **KAIKEYI**'s joy, saying: "I am happy and delighted with what thou hast said, O Irreproachable Hero, this resolute discourse, in aocord with righteousness, that thou hast uttered, O Lion among Heroes, has preserved the earth ! The resolve I made to proceed with the grest Rajasuya Sacrifice, I now renounce on thine excellent counsel, O Virtuous **BHARATA**. The wise should never commit any act detrimental to the world. Conttariwise one should be willing to receive good advice even from a child, O Thou, the elder brother of **LAKSHMANA** ; I am pleased with thy counsel which is wise and considered, O Valiant Prince I "

CHAPTER 84

The Story of Vritra

THUs spoke **RAMA** to the great-souled **BHARATA**, and thereafter **LAKSHMANA** addressed this eloquent discourse to the One who enhanced the felicity of the Raghus, saying : " The great Sacrifice Ashwamedha removes all sins and is the infallible means of purification ; may it please thee to undertake it, O Joy of the Raghus! "It is said in the Puranas that the magnanimous Vasava, sullied by the sin of brahmanicide, was cleansed by performing the Horse-sacrifice. O

Long-armed Warrior, in former times when *Devas* and *Asuras* were united, there Jived a universally honoured Daitya named Vritra. The width of his body was an hundred leagues and he was three times as tall. In his loving kindness, he cast his beneficent glance in all directions on the Three Worlds. Loyal, grateful, highly intelligent, he ruled his fertile territory with care and integrity and, under his domininn, 596 the earth produced all that could be desited-llowers, roots and delicious fruits. Without being cultivated the earth was abun dantly fruitful and for many years that magnanimoua prince enjoyed a rich empire marvellous to behold. Then the thought came to him : ' I shall perform a rigid penance ; in truth, asceticism is a great joy, all other happiness is a mere illusion.' " Having established his eldest son over his people as King of Madhura, he gave himself up to a rigid penance that caused terror among the Gods. As Vritra was mortifYing himself thus, Vasava, in his extreme allliction, sought out Vishou and spoke to him as follows : " ' On account of his asceticism that long-armed hero, Vritra, has conquered the worlds ; he is powerful and virtuous ; I shall not be able to overcome him. If he continues with these austerities, O Chief of the Gods, we shall be subject to him as long as the worlds endure. Thou hast overlooked the extremely illustrious Vritra or he would not live an instant in the face of thy wrath, O Lord of the Gods. From the moment he succeeded in propitiating thee, O **VISHNU**, he has taken over the direction of the worlds. It is for thee in thy great solicitude to befriend the universe, then by thy favour, the worlds will live in peace, free from affliction. All the inhabitants of the celestial region have fixed their gaze on thee, O **VISHNU**. Slay Vritra and by this great feat deliver them ! Thou hast ever lent support to the magnanimous Gods which cannot be withstood by their adversaries ; be the refuge of those who have no other refuge ! ' "

CHAPTER 85

The Death of Vritra

" 'An ancient tie binds me to the magnanimous Vritta, there fote I am unsble to favout you by slaying that great Asuta; it is not possible for me to grant you that supreme felicity but I will indicate the means whenby the Thousand-eyed God may destroy him. I shall divide my natural essence into three pans, O Foremost of the Gods, and by these means, that God of a Thousand Eyes can undoubtedly slay Vritra. A third of my being will enter Vasava, a second part into the thunderbolt and a third will enter the bosom of the earth, thus Vritra will perish I ' " Thus spoke the Lord of the Gods, and the Deities answered him saying: " ' O Slayer of Daityas, assuredly what Thou hast uttered will come to pass ! May victory be Thine, shall now take our leave infused by Thy power in order to slay the Asuta Vritra, O Lord!. " Then all the magnanimous Gods with Sahasraksha at theit head went to the great Asuta Vritra's retreat. Then: they beheld the most powerful of Asutas, e1fulgent in his own radiance that seemed to consume the worlds and space itself. Beholding the foremost of the Asutas, the Gods wen: seized with and rellected, 'How shall we kill him? ' 'How may we avoid defeat I' "As they were thinking thus, Sahasraksha, the Destroyer of Qties, taking the thunderbolt in his hands, hurled it at Vritra, striking his head. Like unto the Fire of Time, formidable, blazing with its wreath of llame, that thunderbolt falling on Vritra's head caused terror to all the worlds. " Then the extremely illustrious King of the Gods, rdlecting on the iniquity he had perpetrated in slaying his enemy, fled in all haste to the ends of the Wotld ; and the sin of brahmanicide pursued him in his flight and entered into him, so that **INDRA** was subject to great aftlictinn. " The

enemy destroyed, but deprived of theit leader, the Gods with **AGNI** at theit head, lavished homage on **VISHNU**, Lord of the Three Worlds, saying : " ' Thou art the way, O Supreme Master, the First-bom, Father of the Universe I For the proteCtion of the world thou hast assumed the form of **VISHNU**. By thy favour, Vritra is s98 slain, but the sin of brahmanicide holds Vasava in bondage, do thou liberate him l ' " Then **VISHNU** answered the Gods who had spoken thus and said: " ' Let Shakra, he who bears the thunderbolt, perform a sacrifice in mine honour and I will cleanse him of his sin. Let him who destroyed Paka, offer up the sacred Horse-sacrifice and he will become King of the Gods once more, without having anything to fear.' " Having thus addressed the Gods in these words like unto Amrita, **VISHNU**, the Lord of the Celestials, while they were yet acclaiming him, returned to Trivishtapa."

CHAPTER 86

Indra is liberated by means of the Ashvamedha Sacrifice

HAVING thus described the slaying of Vritra at length, Laksh mana, the foremost of men, continued : " The extremely valiant Vritra, who inspired terror in the Gods, being destroyed, Shakra, his slayer, filled with the guilt of brshmanicide, failed to return to his senses and, having taken refuge at the end of the worlds, his mind confused, distracted, he remained there for some time, resembling a serpent that is casting its slough. And the Thousand-eyed God, having disappeared, the whole world was agitated and the earth seemed to be lost, bereft of its humidity, its forests dried up.' There were no running waters to feed the lakes and rivers and a great desolation seized all beings on account of

the lack of rain. " Then the Gods seeing the decay of the world, which filled them with distress, began to prepare for the sacrifice according to the words **VISHNU** had formerly uttered, and all the Hosts of the Gods accompanied by their spiritual preceptors and the *Rishis* sought out the terror-stricken **INDRA** in his retreat. " Beholding Sabasrakaba assailed by the guilt ofbrahmanicide, Men, thereafter the great Horse-sacrifice took place, which was offered by the magnanimous Mahendra in order to cleanse himself of the sin of btabmanicide, and the ceremony being completed, the spirit of brabmanicide issued out of **INDRA**'s body and approaching the Gods enquired of them saying:-' Tell me, where shall be my abode ? 'and the Gods in delight, answered : Divide thyself into four parts, O Evil One ! ' " Hearing the words of the mighty Gods, the spirit of brab manicide did so, varying his habitation, he with whom co habitation is a disaster, and said : "'Restraining egoity and following mine own whim with a quarter of myself I shall inhabit the rivers in flood in the rainy season. With another quarter undoubtedly I shall dwell perpetu ally in the earth as Ushara.' I speak the truth ! For the third portion I shall live for three nights each month with radiantly youthful women, whose pride I shall humble ; with my fourth portion I shall live in those who by false report cause the death of innocent *brahmins*, O Mighty Deities.' " Then the Gods answered, saying :-' O Thou, to live with whom is a calamity, do as thou sayest, accomplish thy design!' "Full of joy, the Gods then paid homage to Vasava of a Thousand Eyes, who was cleansed of his sin and delivered from his affiiction. And Sabasraksha, having been installed on the throne, peace came to the whole world and **INDRA** paid homage to that wonderful sacrifice. " Such is the pre-eminence of the Ashwamedha Ceremony, O Joy of the Raghus ! Do thou perform the Horse-sacrifice ! " Hearing these exalting words ofLakshmaoa, whose charm touched his heart, that magnanimous

sovereign, the equal of **INDRA** in strength and prowess, experienced supreme satisfaction.

CHAPTER 87

The Story of Ila

Kardama, the son of Prajapati, the extremely virtuous and blessed Ila, reigned over the province of Bahlika. That highly illustrious monarch, O Lion of Men, having made the entire earth subject to him, reigned over his subjects as his own sons. " The magnanimous Gods, the wealthy Daityas, the Nagas, *Rakshasas*, Gandharvas and Yakshas, inspired by fear, constantly worshipped him, O Dear Friend, O Joy of the Raghus, and the Three Worlds trembled before that irascible potentate. Such was that prince, the illustrious Sovereign of the Bahlikas, full of enetgy, highly intelligent and fixed in his duty. " During the lovely month of Chaitra, that long-armed warrior went hunting in the enchanting forest with his attendants, infantry and cavalry, and that magnanimous prince, in that wood, slew wild beasts in their hundreds and thousands, yet was not sated. Countless animals of all kinds had already perished when he reached the country where Karttikeya had been born. There the foremost of the Gods, the invincible Hara, was spotting with the daughter of the King of the Mountains, and, having trans formed himself into a woman, the Lord of Uma, whose emblem is the bull, sought to entettain the Goddess in the midst of the watetfalls. WheteVer there were male beings or trees in the forest, whatsoever there was, assumed a female form. King Ila, the son of Kardama penetrated into that place slaying innumer able beasts and he observed that they were all female, thereafter he became aware that he too was changed into a woman, as also his

followers. His distress was great on this metamorphosis and he recognized it to be the work of Uma's consort and was seized with terror. Thereupon that monarch, with his attendants, his army and his chariots, rook refuge with that mighty blue-throated God, Kapardin, and the magnanimous Maheshwara, laughing with that Goddess, the bestower of grace, said to the son of Prajapati: '" Rise, rise, O Royal *Rishi*, O Valiant son ofKardama, =cept manhood, ask what thou wilt ! ' The king was sorely disappoil\ ted by this reply of the magnanimous **SHIVA**. Transformed into a woman, he did not wish to accept any other boon from the foremost of the Gods and, in his profound distress, that prince, 6ol falling at the feet of the daughter of the King of the Mountains, Uma, with his whole heart entreated her, saying : " O Thou who distributest thy favours in all the worlds, O Lovely Goddess, whose sight is never fruitless, cast thy merciful glance upon me ! ' " Knowing what was passing in the heart of the Rajarishi, that Goddess, who stood before Hara, she, the consort of Rudra, made this reply : " ' Half the boon, that thou dost beg of us both, shall be granted by Mahadeva and the other half by me, therefore receive this half from man and woman according to thy desire ! ' " Hearing that remarkable and unparalleled boon bestowed by that Goddess, the king, overcome with joy, said : " ' If I have found favour with thee, O Goddess, whose beauty is unrivalled on earth, may I be a woman during one month and, in the second month, assume the form of a mao ! ' " Then that Goddess of gracious mien, understanding his desire, answered amicably : " ' It shall be so, O King, and when thou art a man, thou shalt not remember thou wast ever a woman and, in the succeeding month, having become a woman, thou shalt forget thou wast ever a man!' "That is how that king, bom of Katdama, being a mao for one month became a woman the following month under the name of lla, the most lovely female in the Three

Worlds.”

CHAPTER 88

Budha encounters lIa

THE story of Ila, related by **RAMA**, greatly astonished LRkahmaoa and **BHARATA**, and both, with joined palms, requested him to recount further details of that magnanimous King and his uaosformations, saying : " What did that wretched king do when he was transformed into a woman and how did he conduct himself when he became a man once more ? " Hearing these words inspired by curiosity, Kakutstha told them what had happened to that monarch, saying : " Having been transformed into a woman, he passed the tint month amidst his female attendants, his former courtiers, and that lady, the most beautiful on earth, whose eyes resembled lotus petals, entering a deep forest, wandering on foot amongst the copses, bushes and creepers, having given up all conveyances, spotted in the winding vale. Now in that wooded region, not far from the mountain, lay a charming lake frequented by birds of every kind ; there Ila beheld Budha,' the son of the Moon, who was as radiant as that orb on rising. " Budha, who remained inaccessible in the waters, had given himself up to a rigid penance, and that illustrious Sage was benevolent and extremely compassionate. In her astonishment, Da agitated the waters with her companions, and beholding her, Budha fell under the sway of the God of Love with his shafts and, no longer self-controlled, became restless, as he stood in the lake. Seeing Ila, whose beauty was unsurpassed in the Three Worlds, he reflected :-' Who is this lady, more lovely than the Cclestials ? I have never before beheld such radiance amongst the wives of Devos, Nagas, *Asuras* or Apsaras. If

she is not already wedded to another, she is worthy of me ! ' “As he delayed, thinking thus, the company left the water and Budha, pondering, emerged therefrom. Thereafter those women having been summoned by him went to his retrest and they paid obeisance to him, whereupon that virtuous ascetic enquired of them, saying : " ' To whom does this lady, the most lovely in all the world, belong? Why has she come here? Tell me all without hesitation.' " Hearing these fair words spoken in gentle tones, all those women answered with sweet voices, saying : " ' That lady is our mistress, she has no husband and wanders in the woods in our company.' " Hearing the reply of those women, that Twice-hom called to mind the science by which all may be perceived,' whereupon he became conversant with all that had passed regarding King Da, and that foremost of Sages said to those women :-" Here on the mownainous region you shall dwell as Kimpurushis !' Make your home on this mountain ; you shall feed on roots, leaves and fruits and shall have Kimpurushas as your consorts ! ' “At this command of the son of *Soma*, those women, who were men, having been transformed into Kimpurushis, took up their abode on the slopes of the mountain.”

CHAPTER 89

The Binh of Pururavas

ful!, Thereafter the illustrious and virtuous **RAMA** continued the story of Ila, the son of Prajapati, saying : " When he saw that all those troops of Kinnaris had departed, the foremost of the *Rishis* said to the beautiful Ila with a smile : " I am the beloved son of *Soma*, O Lady of gracious mien, do thou look on me with favour I ' “Thus did be speak in that lonely forest deserted by the others, and that gracious and beautiful

solitary One answered him, saying : " O Dear Son of *Soma*, I range where I will, I am at thy service, do whatsoever pleaseth thee I ' " Hearing this charming reply, the son of the moon was overjoyed and united himself with her in love. Thereafter the enamoured Budha passed the month of Madhu, that vanished like a moment, in dalliance with Ila, and, the month having expited, that moon-faced one awoke from her couch and beheld the son of *Soma* given over to the practice of penance in the waters, suppordess, his arms upstretched, and said to him : " ' O Blessed One, I came to this inaccessible mountain with my train of attendants, I do not sec them anywhere, where have they gone?' " Hearing the words of the Rajarishi, who had lost all knowledge of the past, Budha, in order to re-assure him, said in friendly tones : " 'A great hailstorm overwhelmed thy attendants whilst thou wast asleep, having taken refuge in the hermitage in fear of the wind and rain. Be happy, banish all anxiety and calm thyself! O Hero, live here in peace, nourishing thyself on fruitand roots.' " The King, comforted by these words, then made this noble reply, in the distress that the loss of his people caused him : " ' I cannot abandon my kingdom, though deprived of my servants ; I must not delay an instant, O illustrious Ascetic, permit me to depart. I have an elder son fixed in his duty and extremely illustrious, O *Brahmin*, his name is Shashabindu ; he shall succeed me. Nay, I cannot ahandon my consorts and my good servants, O lllustrious Ascetic, do not reproach me.' " Thus spoke that **INDRA** among monarchs and Budha, who first consoled him, then addressed these astonishing words to him, saying : " ' Be pleased to remain here ; do not grieve, O Mighty Kardameya ; at the end of tbe year I will grant thee a boon.' " Hearing these words of Budha of imperishable deeds, who was conversant with the Veda, Ila resolved to remain there. Tbe following month, becoming a woman, he spent in dalliance with Budha and,

thereafrcr, becoming a man once more, he passed the time in the exercise of duty. In the ninth month the lovely Ila gave birth to a son, the mighty Pururavas and, afier he was born, she gave the child into the paternal hands of Budha, whom be resembled.”

CHAPTER 90

Ila regains her natural state through the Performance of the Ashvamedha Sacrifice

“After Ila had passed a year with the son of the Moon-god, what did she do ? O Lotd of the Earth, tell us all ! " Thus questioned by his two brothers in affectionate tones, **RAMA** continued to relate the story of Ila, the son of Prajapati, and said: " That hero, having recovered his manhood, the extremely intelligent and illustrious Budha called together the Sages, the extremely noble Samvarta, Chyavana the son of Bhrigu, the Ascetic Arishtanemi, Pramodana, Modakara and the Hermit Durvasa. When they were all assembled, the eloquent Budha, able to discern the truth, said to those Sages, his friends, who were endowed with great power : " ' Learn what has happened to that long-armed king, the son of Katdama, so that his happiness may be re-established !' " While those Twice-born were conversing thus, Katdama came to that forest accompanied by Poulastya, Kratu, Vashat kara, and Omkara of great eft’ulgence. All those ascetics, happy to find themselves together and wishing to be of service to the Lotd of Bahli, each voiced their views about him ; Kardama, however, expressed himself with extreme \\isdom for the good of his son, and said : " ' O Twice-hom Ones, hear what I have to say for the happiness of the prince. I see no remedy apart from the God who has the hull as his emblem. There is no sacrifice

greater than the Ashwamedha, which is dear to the heart of the mighty Rudra. Let us therefore perform this mighty sacrifice.' " Thus spoke Katdama and all the foremost of Sages approved these means of propitiating Rudra. " Thereafter a Rajarishi, the disciple of Samvarta, the Conqueror of Hostile Citadels, whose name was Marutta, performed that great sacrifice which took place near Budha's hermitage, whereupon the glorious Rudra was extremely gratified and, the ceremony being accomplished, the consort of Uma, in an excess of joy, addressed all those Sages, iu Da's presence, saying : " ' I am pleased with your devotion in the Ashwamedha Sacrifice. O Dlustrious Biahmins, what shall I do for this King of the Bahlis ? ' Thus did the Lotd of the Gods speak, and the Sages, in deep recollection, caused the Lotd of the Gods to 6o6 look upon them with favour so thst Ila might regain his manhood. Then Mahadeva, gratified, gave him back his virility and having conferred thst favour on lla, the mighty God disappeared. " The Horse-sacrifice being complete and Hara having ren dered himself invisible, all those Twice-born, of penetrating gaze, returned whence they bad come. The king, however, renouncing his capital, founded the city of Pratisbthana in the central region, which was uosurpassed in splendour, whilst Sbasbabindu, that Rajarisbi, Conqueror of Hostile Cities, dwelt in Babli. From thst time Pratisbthana became the residence of King Ila, the valiant son of Prajapati, and, his time having come, be went to Brabma's abode. " The son of Ila, the King Pururavas succeeded him in Pratisbthana. Such is the merit of the Asbwamedba Sacrifice, O Bull among Men. Ila, who was formerly a woman, became a man again, which would have been impossible by any other means."

CHAPTER 91

Rama gives the command for the Ashvamedha Sacrifice to be performed

HAVING related this history to his two brothers, Kakutstha of immeasurable glory, addressed these pious words to Laksbmana, saying: “Assemble for couoscl, Vasisbths, Vamadeva, Javali, Kasbyapa and all the brabmins learned in the Asbwamedba Sacrifice. O Laksbmana, I shall loose the caparisoned steed in accord with tradition I” On this command being communicated to him, Laksbmana, of swift step, assembled all those Sages and ushered them into Ramo’s presence. When they beheld **RAMA**, who resembled a God, paying obeisance to their feet, they showered blessing upon him. Having performed the Pranjali,' Ragbava addressed those Sages on the Asbwamedba Sacrifice, in a speech inspired by *dharma*. Hearing the words of **RAMA** and having offered homage to the God, whose emblem is the Bull, all those Twice-born praised the Ashwamedha highly, and that eulogy greatly delighted Kakutstha, who seeing them ready to perform the ceremony, said to **LAKSHMANA** : " O Long-armed Hero, make known to the magnanimous **SUGRIVA** that he should come here with his great monkeys and the innumerable dwellers in the woods in order to enjoy this great festival and be happy. Let Bibisbana, he who bas no rival in valour, come surrounded by his host of Raksbasas, moving where they will, in order to assist me in the great Ashwamedba Sacrifice. Let wealthy monarchs, who wish to render me a service, come in all baste with their retinues to see the place of sacrifice and all the virtuous Twice-born, who have gone to foreign lands, summon them all to the

Ashwamedba Sacrifice, O **LAKSHMANA**. Invite all the *Rishis*, those long-armed warriors, mines of asceticism, who live in distant parts with their wives, as also the players on the cymbals, jugglers and dancers. " Let a vast structure be up near the Gaumati River in the Naimisba Wood, O Long-armed Warrior, it is pre-eminently a sacred spot. Let propitiatory rites be performed everywhere and hundreds of *brahmins*, conversant with the Jaw, assist in the Naimisba Wood at this great sacrifice, the highest of all and which is unsurpassed, O Joy of the Ragbus. Assemble all the people speedily, O Virtuous Prince, and do not let them depart ill-contented, unsatisfied or without having been loaded with favours according to tradition. O Hero, send out in advance a hundred thousand loads of rice in good condition and an ayuta of sesamum seed and beans as well as chick-peas, lentils, quantities of salt, oil of good quality and innumerable perfumes. " Ler **BHARATA** first carefully furnish a hundred kotis of gold and as much silver, and go before. In the centre, the merchants, all the jugglers, dancers, cooks and women should be ranged, let them be numerous and young in heart ; the troops, however, should go in advance with **BHARATA**. Shopkeepers, children, the aged, the Twice-born in profound meditation, the masons, carpenters, agents and also the mothers and women of the Princes apartments with the golden statue of my consorr for 6oS consecration, as also skilled sscrificcrs, should be first assembled by the illustrious **BHARATA**, who will precede them. " O Prince, he will cause pavilions to be set up worthy of the mighty kings and their suites. Food, drink aod raiment should be supplied for those brilliant escorts." Thereafter **BHARATA** went away followed by **SHATRUGHNA** and the magnanimous monkeys who surrounded **SUGRIVA**, accom panied by the leading priests. Bibishana, at the bead of the *Rakshasas* and women in great numbers, provided an escort for the *Rishis* of rigid penance.

CHAPTER 92

Description of the Ashvamedha Sacrifice

HAVING arranged everything in detail with dispatch, the elder brother of **BHARATA** loosed the horse marked with black spots, adorned with his own insignia. Placing **LAKSHMANA**, assisted by the priests, in charge of the steed, he himself went to the Naimisha Wood with his army. That long-armed prince, beholding the vast and beautiful sacrificial spot, was greatly delighted and exclaimed, “How wonderful!” During his sojourn in the Naimisha Wood, the kings brought all their gifts to **RAMA** and he, in his turn, provided for them abundantly with food, drink and provisions of every kind. **BHARATA** and **SHATRUGHNA** were in the service of the king ; the magnanimous monkeys, who accompanied **SUGRIVA**, attended on the priests with humility ; Bibishana with his innumerable titans became the most diligent servitors of those *Rishis* of rigid penaoce. Sumptuous pavilions set up for the powerful monarchs and their retinues were under the orders of that mostvaliaot prince. Such were the excellent arrangements devised for the Ashwa medha Sacrifice. Meantime **LAKSHMANA** carefully watched over the comings and goings of the horse. Thus did that magnanimous Lion among monarchs proceed with the utmost punctiliousness in this foremost of sacrifices, during which nothing was heard but ' Give lavishly of all that is sought,' and, in the Ashwamedha 6o9 Sacrifice, that liberal Prince furnished all that everyone required till they were fully satisfied. Sweet dishes of every kind, confections, till they were no longer in demand, were distributed by monkeys and titans, and no-one was seen in rags or affiicted or hungry, but, in that splendid royal feast, only those who were happy and satisfied could be observed. Amongst

the venerable Sages present, the oldest could not remember a sacrifice where such prodigious liberality had taken place. Those who desired gold received gold, those who preferred possessions received them, those who coveted jewels had jewels bestowed upon them ; and one beheld silver, gold, gems and raiment being distributed continually in great quantities. 'Neither Shakra, nor *Soma*, nor **YAMA**, nor **VARUNA** have ever achieved anything of such magnitude ' proclaimed the ascetics; and, on every side, monkeys and titans stood distributing raiment, silver and rice in profusion to those who sought them. This sacrifice of that foremost of monarchs was carried out in accord with every tradition and, at the end of a whole year, it still had not come to a close, nor was the treasury exhausted.

CHAPTER 93

Valmiki commands Kusha and Lava to recite the Ramayana

the Lord of the Earth, indicates that you should be heard by the assembled Sages, act accordingly. Each time you will have twenty Sargas' to sing, which you have previously learnt from me. Above all, do not entertain the least desire for reward ! Of what use is gold to ascetics who Jive on fruit and roots ? If Kakutstha questions you, saying ' Who is your Master ? ' answer the king in this wise, ' We are both the disciples of the great Sage **VALMIKI** ! ' Sing without fear to the accompaniment of these stringed instruments of a tone unknown heretofore, that you have tuned sweetly. Sing the poem from the beginning without showing any lack of respect to the king, who is the Father of all beings according to the law. "To-morrow therefore, at

dawn, with a cheerful heart and taking care to sing with sweet voices, accompany yourselves on these stringed instruments of harmonized intervals.” Having repeatedly issued these instructions, that ascetic born of Pracetas,' of noble birth, the illustrious Sage **VALMIKI**, became silenL On receiving the commands of that Sage, the two sons of Maithili humbly answered “We will act in accord with thy behests ! " and those Conquerors of Hostile Cities then took their leave. Those youthful boys allowed the excellent counsels of the *Rishi* to enter their heam, as the Ashwius receive the teachings of Bhargava and, eager to put them into practice, they whiled away that auspicious night.

CHAPTER 94

Kusha and Lava chant the Ramayana

WHEN the dawn appeared, those two youthful ascetics, having bathed and ignited the sacred fire, began to sing, as the *Rishi* had previously instructed them to do. Kakutstha listened to that poem, composed by the aged **VALMIKI**, unheard till then, set to music in multiple cadences, accompauied by sttiuged instruments, in measured rhythm, and, hearing those youthful musicians, Raghava was gtCBtly mystified. During an interval in the sacrifice, that foremost of monarchs called together the great Sages, Kings, Pundits, Naigamas,' aged Grammarians, venerable *brahmins* and those versed in music, the Twice-born, those learned in omens and the citizens specially instructed in aesthetics, those who had knowledge of metres, words and accents, those who knew the different rhythms and measures, those versed in astronomy, those skilled in the science of sacrifices and rituals and experienced liturgists, those versed in discerning cause and effect, philosophers, scholars, teachers of hymns

and legends and the Veda, those conversant with the Vrittas and Sutras, and also singers and dan=· Thereafter, having assembled them all, **RAMA** ushered in the two singers to that vast and murmuring throng of listeners for his own great pleasure. The two youthful disciples of the Sage began that recitation that unrolled melodiously, like unto the singing of the Gandharvas, nor could the company be sated with listening to so beautiful a song. In their delight, ascetics and gtCBt potentates, seemed to consume those musicians with their gaze, whom they looked upon again and again, and the whole assembly having centred its attention upon them, each said to his neighbour :-' Both resemble **RAMA**, like twin representa tions of the same planet. If they did not wear matted locks and bark robes, we should see no difference between the singers and Raghava!' As the people of town and country spoke thus, Kusha and Lava, having introduced the first part according to Narada's instructions, continued up to the twentieth Sarga' during the afternoon, then Raghava, having heard the twenty Sargas, said to his beloved brother, " Give these two musicians eighteen thousand gold pieces immediately with aught else that they may desire, O Kakutstha ! '" Thereupon Saumitri instantly offered this to those youthful boys, one after the other, but the great souled Kusha and Lava would not accept the gold that was presented to them, enquiring in astonishment, " What good is this ? Grain, fruit and roots suffice ascetics Uke ourselves, what should we do with gold or silver in the forest ? " These words amazed all Rams's assistants exrremely and, desiring to know the origin of the poem, that illustrious prince enquired of those two disciples of the ascetic, saying : " What is this poetical composition ? Where is the residence of the sublime author of this great epic ? Where is this bull among the ascetics ? , On this enquiry from Raghava, the two disciples of the Sage answered, saying : "The blessed **VALMIKI**, who is attending

the sacrifice, is the author of the poem in which thine whole life is told. Twenty four thousand verses and a hundred Upakhyanashave been used by that ascetic, the son of Bhtigu. Five hundred Sargas divided into six *Kandas*, together with the , O King, are the work of that magnanimous *Rishi*, our Guru. Thy conduct, thy circumstances, thine entire life is unrolled with its vicissitudes. If thou desirest it, O King, thou mayest hear it from us in the intervals of the sacrifice, in thy moments of leisure. Thereafter Ramo, accompanied by the Sages and magnanimous monarchs, having heard that melodious chant, returned to the sacrificial pavilion. That recitation accompanied by Talas and Layas, divided into Sargas in harmonious notes and tones, in which the scansion was stressed by the stringed instruments, was heard by the King from the lipa of Kusha and Lava.

CHAPTER 95

Rama sends for Sita

SURROUNDED by the ascetics, kings and monkeys, Ramo listened during many days to the sublime and wonderful epic, and while the two sons of **SITA**, Kusha and Lsva, were singing, he recog nized them. Having reflected deeply, he summoned messengers of vinuous conduct and in the assembly spoke them of that princess, saying : " Go and repest my wotds that Blessed One and say : " ' If she be irreproachable in her conduct and without sin, then, should she so desire it and has the approval of the *Rishi*, let her prove her good faith ! ' Do you then return and inform me concerning this matter. To-morrow at dawn, let Msithili, the daughter of **JANAKA** attest her purity on oath in my presence, before the assembly ! " At this extremely significant command from Raghava,

the messengers straightway went to seek out the foremost of the ascetics and, bowing to that Sage, who shone with infinite e11'ulgence, they, with humility, communicated Ramo's words him. Hesring them, the extremely illustrious ascetic, learning of Ramo's wish, said " Be it so I Msy prosperity attend you ! " Thereafter those royal messengers returned with the *Muni*'s answer and repested it faithfully Raghava and he, being informed of the decision of that magnanimous Sage, full of joy, addressed the *Rishis* and the assembled kings, saying : " O Blessed Ones, with your disciples, the kings and their attendants and whosoever may wish do so, bear witness the vow that **SITA** will make ! " These words of the magnanimous Raghava were praised by all the leading *Rishis* and those mighty kings who addressed the monarch saying : " Such conduct is only possible in Thee and is found nowhere else in the world, O Prince ! " Having resolved thus, Raghava, the Scourge of his Foes, said: " To-morrow this shall take place," whereupon he dismissed the assembly. The trial by oath being fixed for the following day, the

CHAPTER 96

Valmiki leads Sita before Rama

VASISHTHA, Vamadeva, Javali, Kashyapa, Vishvamitra, Dirghat mas and Durvasa of rigid penances, also Poulastya and Shakti, Bhatgava, Vamana, Markandeya, Dhirghayus and the highly renowned Maudgalya, Garga, Chyavana, the virtuous Shatan anda, the far-famed Bharadwaja, the illustrious Agniputra, Narada, Parvata and Gautama of great glory, all these ascetics and others of austere observances, in great numbers. Inspired by curiosity, they all assembled, as also the intrepid titans ; and the valisnt monkeys and kings, intrigued, gathered there in like manner,

with the warriors, merchants and thousands of the lower caste. Bralunins of rigid penances atrived from every region and all met together to be present at the taking of the oath by **SITA** ; and that immense multitude stood absolutely motionless, as if turned to stone. Knowing that all were come, the foremost of Sages immediately approached with **SITA** following him, her head bowed, her palms joined, choked with sobs, her mind absorbed in **RAMA**. Beholding **SITA** walking behind **VALMIKI**, like unto the holy Sbruti following in **BRAHMA**'s footsteps, there arose a great clamour with cries of " Halahala ! " from all those who were oppressed with ptofound sorrow on account of the unfortunate princess. And some cried " Hail, O **RAMA** I " and some " Hail, O **SITA** ! " while the rest acclaimed both. Thereafter, advancing amidst that multitude, the foremost of the ascetics, accompanied by **SITA**, addressed Raghava, saying : "I am **VALMIKI**, and here, O Dasarathi, is **SITA** of virtuous ways and conduct, who, on account of calumny, was abandoned near mine hermitage, the censure of the people having inspired thee with fear, O Virtuous One ! **SITA** will prove her innocence ; it is for thee to issue the command. These two sons of Janaki, twin brothers, invincible heroes, are thy sons also ; I speak the 615 truth to thee I I am the tenth son of Pracetas, O Joy of the Raghus, I do not recollect evet having utteted a lie ; truly these ate thy children. During countless yesrs I have practised asceticism, may I never reap the fruits thereof if Maithili he guilty ! I bave nothing wherewith to reproach myself regarding thought, word or deed ; if Maithili be guilty, may I never gather the fruits thereof! With my five senses and the mind as the sixth, meditating amidst the forest waterfalls, **SITA**'s innocence was revealed to me. That lady of irreproachable and pure conduct, to whom her lord is a God, will give proof of her good faith, O Thou who didst fear public condemnation ! O Foremost of Men, here is tbat lady whom I proclaim to be essentially

chaste, I whose vision is divinely illumined and who, though she was supremely dear to thee and her innocence well known, thou didst repudiate when thy spirit was troubled by the censure of the people ! "

CHAPTER 97

Sita descends into the Earth

I wish to be reconciled with the chaste Vaidehi in the presence of this assembly." The defence of Sits filled all who wimessed it with emotinn and, at that moment, Vayu, the foremost of the Gods, sent forth a pure and fragrant breeze to the great delight of the assembly, as formerly in the Golden Age, and, it appeared marvellous to all those people from many lands who eaperienced it ! Beholding that assembly, **SITA**, attired in a yellow robe, with joined palms, her head bowed, her eyes lowered, said : " If, in thought, I have never dwelt on any but Rsma, may the Goddess Madhavi' receive me ! " As Vaidehi was still speaking, a miracle took place and, from the earth rose a marvellous celestial throne supported on the heads of Nagas of immeasurable power, their bodies adorned with divine gems. The Goddess Dhsrani, bidding her welcome, took Maithili in her arms, causing her to be seated on that celestial seat and, while she occupied the throne, a shower of blossoms fell without ceasing from the sky. Then the Gods bunt into loud acelamations, crying " Excellent ! Excellent ! O Sits, thy virtue is supreme ! " From the heavens, the Gods, with delighted hearts, beholding Sits descend into the earth, praised her again and again, and at the place of sacrifice, where all were assembled, Sages, kings and the foremost of men were unable to recover from their astonish ment. In the sky, on earth and in the nether regions, all beings, animate and inanimate, Dana vas of vast stature and

the foremnst of the Pannagas cried out in delight, whilst others remained absorbed in their thoughts or gazed on Rsma and on **SITA** in ecstasy. The entire assembly wimessed **SITA**’s descent into the earth and, at that moment, a great tremor passed through the whole world.

CHAPTER 98

Rama's Anger and Grief, Brahma appeases Him The Death of the Queens

WHEN Vaidebi had descended into the earth, all the monkeys and Sages cried out in Ramo’s presence, " Excellent ! Excellent” but **RAMA**, deeply distressed, supporting himself on a staff employed in tbe sacrifice, his eyes veiled with tears, his head bowed, was overcome with grief. Sighing again and again, letting fall many tears, a prey to pain and wrath, he said: " Beholding **SITA**, the personification of Shri, vanish in my presence, my soul experiences an agony hitherto unknown. Formerly, when she was in Lanka, on the further side of the vast ocean, I brought her back, how much more easily shall I be able to wrest her from the bosom of the earth ! O Goddess Vasuda, give me back my **SITA**, whom thou retainest, or thou shalt witness my wrath ! Thou shouldst know me since thou art assuredly my mother-in-law and Maithili rose from thee when **JANAKA** was following the plough. Therefore let **SITA** go or open thyself to me that I may dwell with her in Patala or else in Nakaprishtha ! Bring back Maithili on whose account I am distraught ! If thou failest to return **SITA** to me in her original form, I shall plough thee up with thy mountains and forests and shall destroy thee so that nothing but water remains ! " Thus spoke Kakutstha, full of wrath and grief, and **BRAHMA**, accompanied by the Hosts of the Gods,

addressed the son of Raghu, saying : " O **RAMA**, virtuous **RAMA**, do not be incensed, recollect thy divine origin and nature, O Scourge of Thy Foes ! Assuredly, O Prince, I do not need to remind thee that no-one is superior to thee ! Now recall that thou art Vishou, O Invincible Hero I The chaste and virtuous **SITA**, who was wholly absorbed in thee formerly, has happily reached the region of the Nagao, by virtue of her ascetic practices. Thou wilt undoubtedly be re-united with her in tbe Celestial Realm. O Rams, hear, in the assembly, what I relate in this poem, tbe most bcautitill of epics, recited in thine honour, I will make all known to thee in detail, do not 6I8 doubt it. In this poem of **VALMIKI** all is included from the time of thy birth, O Hero, the good and evil that has visited thee and what will happen in the future. That great poet, O **RAMA**, is wholly devoted to thee, none othet is worthy of the honour bestowed by poets save Rsghava. Formerly, in oompany with the Gods, I heard the entire classic ; it is divine, marvellously beautiful, true, and the retnovet of nescience. O Foremost of Men, O Supremely Virtuous Kakutstha, listen to the oonclusion of the Ramayana and what ooneetns the future. Listen now with the *Rishis*, O Doughty and Illustrious Prince, to the end of this sublime poetn entitled 'Uttara'. Assuredly, O Kakutstha, this excellent epilogue may not be heard by any othet save thee, who art the supreme Sage, O Heto, O Joy of the House of Raghu." Having spoken thns, **BRAHMA**, the Lord of the Three Worlds, returned to his abode with his followetS, the Gods. Meantime the magnanimous and high-souled *Rishis*, whose abode was Brahmaloka, at **BRAHMA**'s command, remained, desirous of hearing ' ' and what should happen to Raghava. Having listened to the significant words of that God of Gods, the illustrious **RAMA** said to **VALMIKI** : " O Blessed One, the *Rishis* of Brahmaloka desire to listen to ' ' and all that shall happen to me; to-morrow let it be narrated by thee ! " Having resolved thus, **RAMA**

sought out Kusha and Lava and, dismissing the company, returned with thetn to the leaf-thatched hut of the *Rishi* **VALMIKI**, whete he passed the night lamenting for **SITA**.

CHAPTER 99

The Death of the Queen

WHEN night bad given way to dawn, **RAMA** called together the **SITA**, having re-entered the earth, thus proving her fidelity, and the saaifice being completed, **RAMA**, in the extremity of grief, not beholding Vaidehi, regarded the world as a desert, and he dismissed the kings, bears, monkeys and titans and the host of leading *brahmins*, having loaded them with treasure. Taking leave of them, the lotus-eyed **RAMA**, who was ever absorbed in the thought of **SITA**, returned to Ayodhya. The Joy of the House of Raghu never sought another consort but, in every saaifice, he set up a golden image of Janaki in her stead. For ten thousand years, **RAMA** performed the Vajamedha Sacrifice and the Vajapeys, ten times more, distributing quantities of gold, and that fortunate One also performed the Agoisthoma, Atiratra and Gosava Sacrifices, giving away abundant charity. For a long time, the magnanimous Raghava occupied the throne, his heart fixed in his duty ; bears, monkeys and titans were subject to his rule and monarchs came daily to pay him homage. Parjanya sent rains in the proper season and it was abundant, the skies were clear, the regions sinless, the city and country abounding in cheerful and satisfied penple. None died prematurely nor was there any disease, and in Rams's reign, none were destitute. After many years however, **RAMA**'s aged mother, surrounded by her sons and grandsons, passed away and she was foiiowed by

SUMITRA and the renowned **KAIKEYI**, who having performed many righteous acts went to the celestial region, where those happy Ones were re-united with **DASARATHA** and received the fruit of their merit in heaven. From time to time, in memory of his mother, Raghava distributed gifts to the *brahmins* vowed to asceticism, and the virtuous **RAMA** offered up obsequies accompanied by gifts of gems to the Sages and performed incomparable austerities in honour of his ancestors. Thus thousands of years passed happily during which, with the aid of sacrifices, that prince promoted the execution of duty in all its aspects. CHAPTER IOO **RAMA** sends **BHARATA** to CtmiJU4" the Gandlumlas ONE day, Yudhajita, the King of Kaikaya, sent his spiritual Preceptor, Gargya, the son of Angiras, a Brahmarishi of im measurable glory, to the magnanimous Raghava, with ten thousand horses as a token of his unsurpassed affection, and also carpets, gems, diverse splendid stuffs and brilliant ornaments ; such were the gifts bestowed on **RAMA** by that monarch. HeIing of the arrival of that great Riahi Gargya with those magnificent presents from Ashwapati, his maternal uncle, the virtuous Raghava went out with his suite to meet him to the distance of a mile, and he offered homage to hisn, as Shakra pays obeisance to Brihaspati. Having paid salutations to the *Rishi* and accepted the gifts, he enquired of him fully regarding the welfare of his mother's brother and family. Ushering the blessed *Rishi* into his palace, **RAMA** began to question him, saying : " What message has my uncle confided to thee in sending thee hither ? " Having come there, that great *Rishi*, hearing **RAMA**'s words, unfolded his mission in eloquent terms, saying : " This, O Long-armed Hero, is what thy maternal uncle, Yudhajita, in his affection for thee, requests thee to heI. There is a country of the Gandharvas, rich in fruit and roots, situated on the banks of the Sindhu River ; that country is extremely fertile. The Gandharvas, armed and skilful warriors, defend it.

When thou hast conquered them, O Virtuous Kakutstha and destroyed their magnificent citadels, take possession of their cities, which are well constructed. None other can achieve this ; the country is extremely beautiful ; do thou follow my counsel, it is to thine advantage." This speech of his uncle's, conveyed by the great Riahi, pleased Raghava who replied " So be it I " and he glanced at **BHARATA** ; thereafter, delighted, Raghava, with joined palms, spoke again to that Twice-born, saying : " These two youthtill princes will explore the country, O

CHAPTER 100

Rama sends Bharata to conquer the Gandharvas

CHAPTER IOO **RAMA** sends **BHARATA** to CtmiJU4" the Gandlumlas ONE day, Yudhajita, the King of Kaikaya, sent his spiritual Preceptor, Gargya, the son of Angiras, a Brahmarishi of im measurable glory, to the magnanimous Raghava, with ten thousand horses as a token of his unsurpassed affection, and also carpets, gems, diverse splendid stuffs and brilliant ornaments ; such were the gifts bestowed on **RAMA** by that monarch. HeIing of the arrival of that great Riahi Gargya with those magnificent presents from Ashwapati, his maternal uncle, the virtuous Raghava went out with his suite to meet him to the distance of a mile, and he offered homage to hisn, as Shakra pays obeisance to Brihaspati. Having paid salutations to the *Rishi* and accepted the gifts, he enquired of him fully regarding the welfare of his mother's brother and family. Ushering the blessed *Rishi* into his palace, **RAMA** began to question him, saying : " What message has my uncle confided to thee in sending thee hither ? " Having come there, that great *Rishi*, hearing **RAMA**'s words, unfolded his mission in eloquent terms, saying : " This, O Long-armed

Hero, is what thy maternal uncle, Yudhajita, in his affection for thee, requests thee to heI. There is a country of the Gandharvas, rich in fruit and roots, situated on the banks of the Sindhu River ; that country is extremely fertile. The Gandharvas, armed and skilful warriors, defend it. When thou hast conquered them, O Virtuous Kakutstha and destroyed their magnificent citadels, take possession of their cities, which are well constructed. None other can achieve this ; the country is extremely beautiful ; do thou follow my counsel, it is to thine advantage." This speech of his uncle's, conveyed by the great Riahi, pleased Raghava who replied " So be it I " and he glanced at **BHARATA** ; thereafter, delighted, Raghava, with joined palms, spoke again to that Twice-born, saying : " These two youthtill princes will explore the country, O Brahmarishi ! **BHARATA** is the father of these valiant youths, Taksha and Pusbkala. Under the protection of my uncle, they will show themselves to be devoted in the dischatge of theit duty. With **BHARATA** at theit head, those two youthful princes, accompaoied by theit troops, will slay the sons of the Gand harvas and take possession of the two cities. Having subdued those two great capitals and installed his two sons, my very virtuous brother will return once more., Thus did **RAMA** speak to that Brahmarishi, and thereafter issued orders to **BHARATA** to start out with his army, having first installed those youthful princes. Under the constellation Saumya,preceded by the son of Angiras, Bhatata set out with his troops and his two sons, and it seemed as if that army, leaving Ayodhya, followed to a great distance by Raghava, could not have been approached even by the Gods themselves. Then those beings who live on flesh, and titans of colossal stature, followed in **BHARATA**'s train, thirsting for blood, and the redoubtable Bhutagramas, in theit desire to devour the corpses of the Gandharvas, came in hundreds and thousands, and lions, tigers, boars and birds in countless numbers

preceded the troops. In a month and a half, that army composed of cheerful and healthy warriors reached the Kingdom of Kaikeya. CHAPTER IOI Ths slaying of the Gtmdlumas and ths conquest of tluir C01mtry HI!ARING of the arrival of **BHARATA** at the head of a vast army accompanied by Gargya, the King of the Kaikcyas, Yudhajita, experienced supreme joy and set out in all haste with a great compaoy against the Gandharvas. **BHARATA** and Yudhajita, having joined forces, approached the City of the Gandharvas with theit swift troops and followers, whereupon, learning of the invasion, the Gandharvas assembled, eager for combat, full of vigour and shouting on every side. Then a terrible battle of appalling violence ensued, lasting seven days, without victory being decisive for either army.

CHAPTER 101

The slaying of the Gandharvas and the conquest of Their Country

Brahmarishi ! **BHARATA** is the father of these valiant youths, Taksha and Pusbkala. Under the protection of my uncle, they will show themselves to be devoted in the dischatge of theit duty. With **BHARATA** at theit head, those two youthful princes, accompaoied by theit troops, will slay the sons of the Gand harvas and take possession of the two cities. Having subdued those two great capitals and installed his two sons, my very virtuous brother will return once more., Thus did **RAMA** speak to that Brahmarishi, and thereafter issued orders to **BHARATA** to start out with his army, having first installed those youthful princes. Under the constellation Saumya,preceded by the son of Angiras, Bhatata set out with his troops and his two sons, and it seemed as if that army,

leaving Ayodhya, followed to a great distance by Raghava, could not have been approached even by the Gods themselves. Then those beings who live on flesh, and titans of colossal stature, followed in **BHARATA**'s train, thirsting for blood, and the redoubtable Bhutagramas, in theit desire to devour the corpses of the Gandharvas, came in hundreds and thousands, and lions, tigers, boars and birds in countless numbers preceded the troops. In a month and a half, that army composed of cheerful and healthy warriors reached the Kingdom of Kaikeya. CHAPTER IOI Ths slaying of the Gtmdlumas and ths conquest of tluir C01mtry HI!ARING of the arrival of **BHARATA** at the head of a vast army accompanied by Gargya, the King of the Kaikcyas, Yudhajita, experienced supreme joy and set out in all haste with a great compaoy against the Gandharvas. **BHARATA** and Yudhajita, having joined forces, approached the City of the Gandharvas with theit swift troops and followers, whereupon, learning of the invasion, the Gandharvas assembled, eager for combat, full of vigour and shouting on every side. Then a terrible battle of appalling violence ensued, lasting seven days, without victory being decisive for either army. Rivers of blood, ftoating with corpses, streamed on every side, scimitars and spears being the crocodiles. Thereafter Bharara, the younger brother of **RAMA**, enraged, loosed a terrible shaft propelled by mantras, named Samvarta,' on the Gandhatvas. Caught in the noose of destruction, three hundted thousand Gandharvas were slain in an instant, cut to pieces by that hero. The inhabitants of the Celestial Region were unable to remember such a fearful conflict in which, in the twinkling of an eye, so vast a number of warriors perished. The Gandharvas all being slain, **BHARATA**, the son of **KAIKEYI** entered those two opulent and magnificent cities, and there, **BHARATA** established Taksha in Takshashila and Pushkala in Pusbkalavata, in the country of the Gandharvas, in the ravishing region

of Gandhara. Overflowing with treasure and precious gems, adorned with groves, they seemed to vie with each other in magnificence. For five years the long-armed **BHARATA**, son of Ksikeyi, occupied those capitals of supreme beauty, whose inhabitants were of irreproachable conduct, and thereafter be returned to Ayodhya. Those cities with their innumerable parks, filled with vehicles and well-stocked markets, enchanting beyond imagining, were embellished by fabulous buildings and countless palaces, resplendent with a multitude of magnificent temples and adorned with Tala, Tamala, Tilaka, and Bakula Trees. Then the fortunate **BHARATA** paid obeisance to the magnani mous Raghava, who was *Dharma* personified, as Vasava offers salutations to **BRAHMA**, and Raghava listened with satisfaction when **BHARATA** told him of the total extermination of the Gand harvas which had taken place and of the occupation of their territory.

CHAPTER 102

Rama bestows Kingdoms on Lakshmana's Sons

danger of treachery from hostile monarchs, where they may live at ease and where the ascetics' retreats are not despoiled! O Friend, seek out such a country without causing injury to any ! " Thus spoke **RAMA**, and **BHARATA** *answered*: " There is a charming and healthy region named Karupatta ; let two cities that are salubrious and beautiful be established there for the magnanimous **ANGADA** and Chandraketu which shaD be called Angadiya and Chandrakanta." These wotds of **BHARATA** were approved by Raghava, and he brought that country under his rule and established **ANGADA** therein. The City of Angadiya was built for **ANGADA** by **RAMA** of imperishable deeds and it was splendid and weD

fortified. As for Chandraketu, who was a giant, his uncle built Chandrakanta for him in the country of the Mallas,' and that capital was celestial and equal to Amaravati. Thereafter, greatly delighted, **RAMA**, Lakahmana and **BHARATA**, those invincible warriors, attended the installation of those two youthful princes who, having received the divine unction, fixed in their duty, divided the territory, and **ANGADA** had the western and Chandraketu the northern region. **ANGADA** was accompanied by **SUMITRA**'s son, whilst Lakahmana and **BHARATA** followed in Chandraketu's train. His sons being firmly established on the throne, **LAKSHMANA** took the road back to Ayodhya, having sojourned in Angadiya for a year. On his side, **BHARATA** remained with Chandraketu one year more, thereafter returning to Ayodhya to take up his place again at **RAMA**'s feet. Both Saumitri and **BHARATA**, in their love for him and their extreme piery, forgot that time was passing and thus teo thousand years went by while they devoted thetDSelves to affairs of state. Employing their days in this wiae, their hearts satisfied, sur rounded with splendour, dwelling together in that rigbtenus city, they resembled the Three Fires whose ftames are fed with abundant libations amidst grest solemnity.

CHAPTER 103

Death is sent to seek out Rama

APTER a long time, Death, in the form of an ascetic, presented himself at the gates of the great and virtuous **RAMA** and said : " I am a messenger from an all-powerful Maharishi and have come to see **RAMA** on a matter of great importance." Hearing these words, Saumitri hastened to announce the arrival of the ascetic to **RAMA**, saying : ..

Mayest thou extend thy dominion over both worlds, O Illustrious Prince ! A Messenger has come to see thee, who, by virtue of his penances, is as radiant as the sun." Hearing **LAKSHMANA**'s words, **RAMA** *said*: " Bring in that ascetic of great effulgence, who carries a message from his master, O Dear Brother ! " **THEN SAUMITRI** *answered*: Be it so ! " and ushered in that Sage, ftamiog in splendour, surrounded as it were with burning rays. Approaching the foremost of the Raghus, who shone in his own effulgence, the *Rishi*, in an harmonious voice, addressed Raghava, saying :-" May felicity be thine ! " Then the supremely illustrious **RAMA**, having paid him the traditional homage and offered him the Arghya, enquired of him concerning his state. Having informed **RAMA** of his well being, the most skilled of orators, that illustrious ascetic seated himself on a golden throne and thereafter **RAMA** said to him : " Be thou welcome, O Great Sage, what message hast thou for me, since thou dost come as an ambassador ? " On this enquiry from that Lion among Men, the Sage said to him: .. If thou dost revere the wishes of the Gods, this meeting must take place between us alone ; whoever shall overhear us should be put to death by thee ; the words of the Lord of the Ascetics are secret and should be revered by Thee." " Be it so I " replied **RAMA**, and having given this assurance, be issued the following command to Laksbmana : " Do thou stand at the door, O Long-ermed Warrior and 625 dismiss the door-keeper. It is for me to slay whoever hears the converse between this *Muni* and myself, for it must take place between us alone." Having sent **LAKSHMANA** to guard the door, Kakutstha, born of Raghu, said : " O Ascetic, thou canst now disclose that with which thou hast been charged, speak without fear, I shall treasure it in my heart !"

CHAPTER 104

Death delivers his Message

" LEAIIN, O Magnanintous Sovereign, that this is the purpose of my coming ! It is the blessed Grandsire who has sent me, O Mighty Prince. I was his son in a former existence, O Con queror of Hostile Citadels ! Born of Msya, O Hero, I am Death who destroys all ! The Grandsire, Lord of the Worlds, speaks thus to thee : " ' Thy task is accomplished, O Friend, O Protector of the Worlds! Having formerly destroyed all beings by the aid of Msya, lying amidst the waters of the vast ocean, thou didst give me birth. Thou hadst already created the Serpent of large coils, Ananta, as also two mighty Beings, Madhu and Kaitabha, whose crushed bones covered the earth which appeared at that time with its chain of mountains. From a celestial lotus, bright as the sun, that issued from thy navel, thou didst produce me and give me the task of creating the world. Since thou hast charged me with this burden, I lean on thee for support, O Lord of the Earth ! Do thou watch over all beings, for it is thou who art my strength. By virtue of thine invincible and eternal nature, thou shouldst afford protection to all creation, for thou haat assumed the form of **VISHNU** ! O Mighty Son of Aditi, thou didst enhance the power of thy brothers and when they sought to accomplish their tasks, thou didst come to their aid. When, O Prince, all creatures were being exterminated by **RAVANA**, thou, desiring to alay him, bethought thyself of men. Then thou didst resolve to dwell among them in person for eleven thousand years and 6%6 thereafter return to us. Thou, who art mind-born, hast com pleted thy stay amoog mortals; it is the hour, O Foremost of Men, to return to us ; if it is thy desire to prolong thy sojourn amoog creatures, O Great King, do so and be happy

I ' " Such are the words of the Grandsire :-' If thou preferest to enter into possession of the world of the Gods ooce more, O Raghava, they with their leaders will be freed from all anxiety, since **VISHNU** will be amoogst them.' " Having heard the words of the Grandsire, which Death communicated to him, Raghava, smiling, answered the Destroyer of the Worlds, saying : " These wholly admirable words of that God of Gods assuredly causes me supreme delight, as also thy coming hither. I came for the good of the worlds, this is the purpose of my being ; mayest thou be happy ! Thine advent here has moved my heart ; I shall leave without delay. The Grandsire has uttered what is true, I must attend to all that concerns the Gods under my dominion, O Destroyer of the Universe ! " CHAPTER IDS

CHAPTER 105

The Sage Durvasa comes to visit Rama

thereafter return to us. Thou, who art mind-born, hast com pleted thy stay amoog mortals; it is the hour, O Foremost of Men, to return to us ; if it is thy desire to prolong thy sojourn amoog creatures, O Great King, do so and be happy I ' " Such are the words of the Grandsire :-' If thou preferest to enter into possession of the world of the Gods ooce more, O Raghava, they with their leaders will be freed from all anxiety, since **VISHNU** will be amoogst them.' " Having heard the words of the Grandsire, which Death communicated to him, Raghava, smiling, answered the Destroyer of the Worlds, saying : " These wholly admirable words of that God of Gods assuredly causes me supreme delight, as also thy coming hither. I came for the good of the worlds, this is the purpose of my being ; mayest thou be happy ! Thine advent here

has moved my heart ; I shall leave without delay. The Grandsire has uttered what is true, I must attend to all that concerns the Gods under my dominion, O Destroyer of the Universe ! " CHAPTER IDS Saumitri, or I sball pronouoce a curse on the kingdom, on thee, the city, on Rsghava, **BHARATA** and on thy House ! O Saumitri, I can no longer contain mine indignation ! " Hoving heard the mighty ascetic's alarming words, Lsbhmana pondered awhile within himself concerning their significance, and reflected : " It were better that I should perish than all others be destroyed ! " On this, he made the arrival of the ascetic known to Raghava and, **RAMA** hearing the tidings, took leave of Death and, in all haste, sought out the son of Atri. Having paid obeisance with joined palms to that great Sage ftaming in effulgence, he enquired of him, saying : " What may I do for thee ? " On this enquiry from that King of Ascetics, the **SAGE DURVASA** *answered*: " O Virtuous **RAMA**, hear me, this day I have concluded a fast of a thousand years. O Irreproachable Raghava, now give me what thou hast ready to eat ! " At these words, the King Raghava, with a delighted heart, offered the foremost of Sages dishes, that had been made ready, and that ascetic, having partaken of that food like unto Amrita, addressed **RAMA**, saying : " It is well ! " and returned to his hermitage. Thereafter **RAMA** called to mind the words of Death at that portentous meeting and, with bowed head, his heart wrung with anguish, he was unable to speak. Reflecting again and again within himself, the illustrious Raghava thought, "All is lost ! " and fell silent.

CHAPTER 106

Rama banishes Lakshmana

SEEING **RAMA**, his head bowed, alllicted and like unto the moon in eclipse, Lsbhmana spoke to him in cheerful and af!'ectionare tones, saying : " Thou shouldst nor grieve on mine account, O Long-armed 628 Warrior; thus was it already ordained and has its roots in a past cause ! Slay me without hesitation, be faitbful to thy vow ! Those who do not honour their promise, go to hell ! If thou hast any affection for me, O Great King, and dost find any merit in me, then slay me and fulfil the law, O Raghava ! " Thus spoke **LAKSHMANA**, and **RAMA**, his mind ttoubled, called his ministers and priests together and told them what had taken place, of the arrival of Durvasa and the vow he had made to the Ascetic. When they had heard these things, the ministers and *brahmins* became silent, nevertheless the illustrious **VASISHTHA** spoke thus : " O Long-armed Prince, I perceive that the separation from **LAKSHMANA** is for thee a calamity, causing thy hair to stand on end O Illustrious Rams, do thou abandon him ; death is powerful, let not thy words prove false. When a promise is nor hononted and virtue is destroyed, undoubtedly the Thtee Worlds with aU animate and inanimate beings, with the hosts of the Goda and *Rishis*, perish ! Therefore, O Lion among Men, in order to save the Thtee Worlds and assure the continuance of the universe, banish Lakshtnana ! " Hearing these words, which were in accord with duty and righteousness, approved by aU, Rams, in the midst of the assem bly, said to Lakshtnana : " Lest righteousness should perish, I banish thee, O Saumirri, a sentence ofbanishment or death is the same to men of honour !" At this decree of Rams's, **LAKSHMANA**, weeping, his mind diStracted, departed in all haste without returning to his home. Having reached the banks of the Sarayu River, he performed his ablutions and, with joined palms, closing the doors of the senses, he began to meditate. As he was thus restraining his senses, he did not release his breath while given up to contem plation, and the Gods with

their leaders, the ttoops of Apsaras and companies of *Rishis* covered him with a rain of flowers. Becoming invisible to men, the mighty **LAKSHMANA** was borne away in the body by Shakra, who carried him to the Celestial Region. Beholding the fourth part of **VISHNU** entering heaven, the foremost of the Gods, delighted, joyfully and unitedly offered homage to that descendant of Raghu

CHAPTER 107

Rama installs Kusha and Lava on the Throne

HAVING banished **LAKSHMANA**, **RAMA**, a prey to grief and deso lation, said to his priests, ministers and citizens : " To-day I shall give the royal annointing to the valiant **BHARATA**, who is faithful to his duty, and make him Lord of Ayodhya; thereafter I shall go to the forest. Make all prepara tions, lose no time, for to-day I too shall follow the path that **LAKSHMANA** baa taken ! " Thus spoke Raghava and his subjectS bowed low as if deprived of all strength. On his side, **BHARATA**, beside himself on hearing his brother's speech, refused the crown and expressed himself thus: " I swear in truth, O King, without thee I do not wish to reign, even in Svarga, O Thou, the Joy of the Raghus ! Estab lish thy two sons, the valiant Kusha and Lava in the Southern Koshalas and the Northern Regions; send swift messengers to **SHATRUGHNA** to announce our departure, let there be no delay I " Hearing these words of **BHARATA** and also beholding the citizens who, their heads bowed, were overwhelmed with grief, **VASISHTHA** *spoke*: " O Beloved **RAMA**, see how these people are prostrating themselves, having learnt what they desire, fulfill it, do not grieve them l " Thus spoke **VASISHTHA** and Kskutatha, having caused them to rise, said to the people, " What is

asked of me ? " and they all ssidtohim: " If thou art leaving us, let us accompany thee wheresoever thou goest, O **RAMA** ; if thou dost love thy subjectS and that atfection is unsurpassed, let us, with our sons and wives, follow the righteous path with thee ; whether it be to an inaccessible retreat, river or ocean, thou shouldst not abandon us ; lead us all wherever thou wilt, O Thou our Master I This is our supreme desire, our most cherished wish ; it will always be the delight nf our hearts to accompany thee, O Prince l " 630 Recognizing his people's profound attachment, **RAMA** answered, " So be it ! " and occupied himself in carrying through what he had undertaken that day. He gave over the Southern Koshalas to the valiant Kusha and those of the north to Lava ; thereafter, placing those two princes on his lap, he enthroned them in Ayodhya and bestowed upon them thousands of chariots and numberless elephants with ten thousand horses. Having furnished them with jewels and treasure in abundance and given them cheerful and healthy people to attend upon them, he sent the two brothers, Kusha and Lava, each to his own capital. Those two heroes being installed in their respective cities, **RAMA** sent out an emissarv to the magnanimous ShatruJdma.

CHAPTER 108

Rama issues His last Commands

THE messengers, urged on by **RAMA**'s command, swiftly and promptly went to Madhura without halting on the way. After three nights they reached that city where they all informed Shattughna what had happened ; the banishing of **LAKSHMANA**, Raghava's vow, the installation of his two sons and the resolution of his subjects to follow

him ; how an enchanting city had been built for Kusha under the name of Kushavati on the high ridge of the Vindhya Mountains by the virtuous **RAMA**, and that Shravasti was the name of the ravishing and famous capital of Lava ; they told him also of the preparations made by Raghava and **BHARATA** to take all the people from Ayodhya and enter Svarga. Having related all these things to the magnanimous Shattugh na, the messengers became silent and thereafter added, " Make all haste, O King I " Heating these fearful tidings regarding the imminent destruc tion of his entire House, Shattughna, the Joy of Raghu, called his people together and summoned his family priest, Kanchana, in order to impart the ttuth to them of his immediate departUte with his brothers. Thereafter, that valiant prince installed his two sons, having distributed abundant wealth equally amongst them, and Subabu was established in Madhura and Shatrughatin in Vaidiaha. This being accomplished, that descendant of Raghu left for Ayodhya in a single chariot. There he beheld the magnanimous **RAMA** like unto a flaming brazier, clothed in a robe of fine wool, in the midst of the im perishable Sages. Paying obeisance to them with joined palms, his senses under control, he addressed hia virtuous brother, whose thought too was ever fixed on his ducy, and said : " I have enthroned my sons, O King, and have come hither ; know well that I am resolved to follow thee ! Do not oppose me, O Valiant One, for I would not that thy will should be disregarded by one like me." Seeing hia resolve was fixed, **RAMA** said to Shattughna, " So be it." Having ceased from speaking, the monkeys, who were able to change their form at wiU, with the companies of bears and titans came there from all directions with **SUGRIVA** at their head, all being united in their desire to behold **RAMA**, who stood with his face turned towards the sky. *Devas*, Rishia and Gandharvas with their offspring, hearing of **RAMA**'s intended departure, had all assembled, saying : " We have come

here to follow thee, O Prince ! To leave with out us, O **RAMA** is to strike us down with the Rod of Death." At that instant, the supremely powerful **SUGRIVA**, bowing before that hero in accord with tradition, addressed him with humilitY and said : " Having installed the virtuous **ANGADA**, O Prince, know that I have come hither with the intention of accompanying thee ! " At these words, the illustrious Kakutstha smiling, answered : " So be it ! " Thereafter be said to Bibiahana, the King of the *Rakshasas* : "As long as people exist, O Mighcy Lord of the *Rakshasas*, do thou remain in Lanka. As long as the moon and sun continue to shine on the eanh, as long as they speak of me in the world, so long shall thine empire endure ; this is the wiU of thy friend, do thou obey ! Govern thy people according to justice and do not question this further. One thing more I wish to say to thee, 63a O Mighty Monarch of the *Rakshasas*, do thou worship the Divinity of the House of Ikshvaku, the Guide of the Universe, Shri Jagannath, whom the *Devas* themselves with their leaders perpetually adore." " So shall it be," answered Bibishana, and Kakutstha thereafter addressed Hsnuman, saying : " Resign thyself to continuing to live, do not render my will void. As long as my story is told in the world, O Foremost of Monkeys, so long mayest thou be happy and remember my words!" Thereupon **HANUMAN**, acquieseing in Ramo's utterance, in his delight, said : "As long as thy purifying history is circulated in the world, so long O **RAMA**, shall I remain on earth submissive to thy will ! " Then Raghava issued the same command to **JAMBAVAN** and said: " Till the Kali *Yuga* begins, continue to dwell on earth ! " Thereafter, addressing all the other bears and monkeys, he said: If it be your desire, then follow me ! "

CHAPTER 109

Rama's Departure for the Mahaprasthana

Goddess Vyavasaya and, assuming human form, his innumerable arrows, marvellous bow and all the other weapons accompanied him. The Vedas, in the persons ofbrahmins, the Holy Gayatri, ProtectOr of the World, the sacred syUable “AUM” and the invocation " Vashat “followed in **RAMA**’s train as also the great souled *Rishis*, and all the Deities of the Earth accompanied that hero to the open gates of heaven. In his steps trod the women of the inner apartments with the aged, the children, servants, eunuchs and personal attendants. The faithful **BHARATA** with his wives accompanied by **SHATRUGHNA** followed in **RAMA**’s train, attended by the sacrificial fire. AU the magnanimous Sages with the ritualistic articles, having assembled there with their sons and wives, joined the procession of the virtuous Kakutstha. Ministers, groups of servants with their offspring, their kinsmen and their flocks joyfully followed in the footsteps of their master. AU the citizens, happy and healthy people, distinguished by their good qualities, joined Raghava’s departure and all the men and women with their birds, beasts and friends, purified of their sins, went forward cheerfully. Devoted to **RAMA**, the Monkeys, having bathed, delighted and satisfied, cried out exultantly with all their strength, " Kilakila ! " In that multitude, none was sad, downcast or unhappy, but a universal felicity filled all to the highest degree. In their desire to behold **RAMA** taking his departure, the people of the countty, through which he passed, on seeing him, took their places in his train. Bears, monkeys, titans, citizens, with deep devotion, followed him in the utmost serenity. Even the invisible Beings of the city joined Raghava’s procession when he went to heaven.

Beholding him, all creatures, animate and inanimate, lovingly accompanied him on that journey. Not a single being, not even the least of them, was to be seen in Ayodhya; even those born of animals followed in **RAMA**'s wake. CHAPTER 10 llama ascmds to Heaom rDith tlu other Beings WHEN he had proceeded about s.ix miles, the Pride of the Raghus beheld the sacred waterS of the Sarayu flowing westwards, eddying and rippliog in their course, and he went on further to the Goprataraka Gbata,his subjects thronging round him on all sides. AI that moment, as Kakutstha was pteparing to ascend to hesven, Brahms, the Grandsire of the World, surrounded by the Gods and the illustrious *Rishis* adorned with jewels, appeared seated in their aerial chariots, and the whole firmament glowed with a transcendent splendour, a marvellous radiance emanating from the lustre of those hesvenly beings of virtuous deeds. Pure, balmy and fragrant breezes blew, whilst shower upon shower of blossom was scattered by the Gods. Theresfrer to the sound of a myriad instruments and the singing of the Gandharvas and Apsaras, **RAMA** stepped into the waters, where: upon the Grandsire, from on high, uttered these words : " Hail O **VISHNU** ! Hail O Raghava ! With thy God-like brothers, now enter thine eternal abode I Return to thine own body if thou so desirest, O Long-armed Warrior I Occupy the realm of **VISHNU** or the shining ether, O Mighty God ! Thou art the support of the world, though there are some who do not recognize Thee without the large-eyed Maya, thine ancient Consort I Thou art the Inconceivable One, the Grest Being, the Indestructible, the Ageless One. Enter into thy real body if Thou so desirest." Hesring these wotds of the Grandsire, the supremely virtuous **RAMA** formed his resolution and entered **VISHNU**'s abode in his body with his younger brothers. Thereupon Immortals began to worship that God who had returned to His form as Viahnu, and the Sadhyas, the hosts of Mamts with **INDRA**

and **AGNI** at their hesd, the celestial companies of Rlahis, the Gandharvas and Apsaras, Suparnas, Nagas, Y8shas, Daityas, Danavas and *Rakshasas* and all the dwellera

CHAPTER 110

Rama ascends to Heaven with the other Beings

llama ascmds to Heaom rDith tlu other Beings WHEN he had proceeded about s.ix miles, the Pride of the Raghus beheld the sacred waterS of the Sarayu flowing westwards, eddying and rippliog in their course, and he went on further to the Goprataraka Gbata,his subjects thronging round him on all sides. AI that moment, as Kakutstha was pteparing to ascend to hesven, Brahms, the Grandsire of the World, surrounded by the Gods and the illustrious *Rishis* adorned with jewels, appeared seated in their aerial chariots, and the whole firmament glowed with a transcendent splendour, a marvellous radiance emanating from the lustre of those hesvenly beings of virtuous deeds. Pure, balmy and fragrant breezes blew, whilst shower upon shower of blossom was scattered by the Gods. Theresfrer to the sound of a myriad instruments and the singing of the Gandharvas and Apsaras, **RAMA** stepped into the waters, where: upon the Grandsire, from on high, uttered these words : " Hail O **VISHNU** ! Hail O Raghava ! With thy God-like brothers, now enter thine eternal abode I Return to thine own body if thou so desirest, O Long-armed Warrior I Occupy the realm of **VISHNU** or the shining ether, O Mighty God ! Thou art the support of the world, though there are some who do not recognize Thee without the large-eyed Maya, thine ancient Consort I Thou art the Inconceivable One, the Grest Being, the Indestructible, the Ageless One. Enter into thy real body if Thou so

desirest.” Hesring these wotds of the Grandsire, the supremely virtuous **RAMA** formed his resolution and entered **VISHNU**’s abode in his body with his younger brothers. Thereupon Immortals began to worship that God who had returned to His form as Viahnu, and the Sadhyas, the hosts of Mamts with **INDRA** and **AGNI** at their hesd, the celestial companies of Rlahis, the Gandharvas and Apsaras, Suparnas, Nagas, Y8shas, Daityas, Danavas and *Rakshasas* and all the dwellera in heaven felt a supreme delight, their desires fulfilled, their sins washed away, and they cried out " Hail I All Hail I " Then the all-resplendent **VISHNU** said to the Grandsire : " Grant to each of these my subjects a suitable abode. They are my devotees and truly deserving, having sacrificed their lives for me ! " Thus spoke **VISHNU**, and the God **BRAHMA**, Guru of the Worlds, answered saying : “All those who have assembled here shall go to the region called Santanakas ! Yea, even the beasrs who die meditating on Thy holy Feet shall live in the vicinity of Brahmaloka where I have united all pleasurable things. The monkeys and the beats, the manifestations of various Deities have already returned to the worlds of the Gods, from whence they came forth, and **SUGRIVA** has entered the disc of the sun ! " Even as the great God was spealting, the monkeys and the beats, having assumed their pristine furms, came to Goprataraka Ghata befure the eyes of the assembled Gods. At that time, whosoever entered the waters of the Sarayu River, yielded up their lives gladly, their eyes suffused with tears of ecstasy, and, having abandoned their bodies, took their places in a celestial chariot. As fur those in animal furm, who entered the waters of the Sarayu in hundreds, they ascended to the Third Heaven in divinely resplendent bodies and they appeared as e1fulgent as the Gods in their celestial lineamenrs. All beings, whether animate or inanimate, who entered those waters attained to the region of the Gods, and, in their tum, the bears, monkeys and titans, abandoning

their bodies in the river, also attained heaven. Having granted them all a place in paradise, the Grandsire of the World accompanied by the Gods, in the height of felicity, retumed to the Third Heaven, his supreme abode.

CHAPTER 111

The Supreme Virtue of the Ramayana

in heaven felt a supreme delight, their desires fulfilled, their sins washed away, and they cried out " Hail I All Hail I " Then the all-resplendent **VISHNU** said to the Grandsire : " Grant to each of these my subjects a suitable abode. They are my devotees and truly deserving, having sacrificed their lives for me ! " Thus spoke **VISHNU**, and the God **BRAHMA**, Guru of the Worlds, answered saying : “All those who have assembled here shall go to the region called Santanakas ! Yea, even the beasrs who die meditating on Thy holy Feet shall live in the vicinity of Brahmaloka where I have united all pleasurable things. The monkeys and the beats, the manifestations of various Deities have already returned to the worlds of the Gods, from whence they came forth, and **SUGRIVA** has entered the disc of the sun ! " Even as the great God was spealting, the monkeys and the beats, having assumed their pristine furms, came to Gopratarаka Ghata befure the eyes of the assembled Gods. At that time, whosoever entered the waters of the Sarayu River, yielded up their lives gladly, their eyes suffused with tears of ecstasy, and, having abandoned their bodies, took their places in a celestial chariot. As fur those in animal furm, who entered the waters of the Sarayu in hundreds, they ascended to the Third Heaven in divinely resplendent bodies and they appeared as e1fulgent as the Gods in their

celestial lineamenrs. All beings, whether animate or inanimate, who entered those waters attained to the region of the Gods, and, in their tum, the bears, monkeys and titans, abandoning their bodies in the river, also attained heaven. Having granted them all a place in paradise, the Grandsire of the World accompanied by the Gods, in the height of felicity, retumed to the Third Heaven, his supreme abode. The Lord **VISHNU** returned to Svargaloka as erstwhile, He Who pervades the Three Worlds and all they contain, both the moving and the fixed. Gods, Gandharvas, Siddhas and great *Rishis* in heaven, ever listen with ddight to the poem 'Ramayana'. This epic, which promotes long life, grants good fortune and destroys sin, is equal to the Veda and should be recited by the wise to men of faith. On hearing it, he who has no son will obtain a son, he who has no fortune will become wealthy ; to read but a foot of this poem will absolve him from all sin. He who commits sins daily will be wholly purified by reciting a single slob. The reciter of this narrative should be rewarded with raiment, cows and gold, for, if he is satisfied, all the Gods are satisfied. He who recites this epic 'Ramayana' that prolongs life, will be blessed with his sons and grandsons in this world and after his death, in the other world. He who, with devotion, recites the 'Ramayana' at the hour when the cows are loosed or at noon or at dusk, will never sulfer adversity. The enchanting City of Ayodhya, having remained deserted for countless years, will be re-peopled by a Prince named Rishabha. This narrative, that grants longevity, with the 'Bhavishya' and 'Uttara', whose author is the son ofPracetas, has the approval of Brahms Hintsdf. GLOSSARY (For Flowers, Trees and Weapons, see separate Glossaries) A ABIDJIT. A Constellation which denotes when the sun it. GLOSSARY pit or hole where the sacrificial lire the title Son of '. series of offerings to the God of Fire celebrated for five days during the Spring. The son of Sudarshana. feast similar to the

Harvest Festival. The wife of the *Rishi* Gautama, who was traasformed into a rock by him when he cursed her for dalliance with the God **INDRA** ; she was ultimately restored to her own form by **RAMA**. Maker of Day', a title of the Sun-god. See under Three Fires. The sacred elephant that transports the God lndra. One of the elephants supporting the four quarters of the earth. A king of the dynasty of Ibhvaku, the father of Dasarstha. A female titan. A class of hermits, sec under ' Ascetics '. ' Invincible ', a name given **VISHNU**. The titan who informed **RAVANA** of the destruction of Janasthana and who persuaded him to abduct **SITA**. He was slain by **HANUMAN**. minister in the Court of King **DASARATHA**. A son of **RAVANA** who was slain by **HANUMAN**. An army consisting of a number of cavalty, infantry, chariots and elephants. Kuvera's capital. ALAitSHITA. A forest where Narada dwelt. of Vishala Al.ARKA. A hero renowned for hia devotinn. lndra's capital which is also called Vitapavati. A king of Ayodhys story is told in Balabnda. AAIBITA. The ' Nectar of Immortality ' produced by the churning of the ocean by Gods and Demons. GLOSSARY A de-the son of the Sage Kashyapa and Diti, who was said to have a thousand arms and heads, and was slain by **SHIVA**. The kingdom ruled over by KiDg Lomapads, probably Bengal. A or limb ; an army is divided into angas which has been rranslated as divisions in this text. The son of a IDOilkey warrior, heit-apprODt to the kingdom of the IDOilkey race. The city ruled by of Labhmana's sons. city the monkeys sesrched for **SITA**. female demon. The Planet Mars. One of the immortal Sages, the father of Gargya. Amu. The God of the Wind. Ot1e of the s0t1s of Mali. salutation made with joined palms. Ascetics who drink from the hollow of theit hands. A nymph with whom the God of the Wind became enamouted and who subsequ...dy gave birth to **HANUMAN**. The of Asmanjas ; his stoty is told in . A t11me of **YAMA**, the God of Desth. A messure implying a great number. A

Madhya ten times. The son of Hiranya-kashipu, a and the father ofPrahlada whose story ill told in the **VISHNU** Purana. Anuhlada bore away Sachi, **INDRA**'s consort, and was slain by him. A range. A tide meaoing the ' Friend of Water'. A.Ps.utA. A water-sprite or nymph ; the word ' Ap ' meaning ' water ' and ' sara ' to ' emerge from '. The Apsaras were the wives of the Gandharvas. AaANI. The of the sacred fig-tree which is for kindling at sacrifices. GLOSSARY ABA. A monkey leader. GLOSSARY The son of Kashyapa. The Horse-sacrifice of Vedic times performed OJiiy by kings. See YudhsjiiS. The name of the foremost of the Serpent Race; iiS meaning is Swift,, ' Speedy'. The month that is of September and October. AsHVINs or Celestial Horsemen, precursors of the dswn, twin oft'spring of the sun and of medicine. The sons of the Ashvins. Ast. From 'Asi Pattrs Vans', a hell where the trees have leaves as sharp as swords. AsiTA. The father of Sagars q.v. See Patala. A name of the Sun meaning ' Hest '. A bird ' Falco Cheela '. The Fourth Veds. See Bala and Atibala. 'Huge-bodied', a name of a titan warrior. A great Car-warrior, one who can fight innumerable archers, thoogh less than thoosand. An optional of the Jyotishtima-sacrilice; also the commencement and conclusion of certain other sacrifices. musical instrument. ATRI. One of the aeven immortal Sages. One of the counsellon of King **DASARATHA**. or OM. The syUable said to be the first sound in creation ; its import can he studied in the Mandukya Upanishad. A great *Rishi,* the grandson of Bhrigu ; the name is derived from ' uru ' or ' thigh ' as he was said have been produced from his mother's thigh. His austerities alartned the Gods and his anger against the warrior class, who had slain his forbears, was unparalleled. Eventnally it was mitigated by the imervention of the Pitris and he cast it into the sea where this fire of his wrath became a being with a horse's head named Hayashira. GLOSSARY The son of Pururavas and Urvashi;

he was the father of Nahushs. A number to he counted, a myriad or sometimes said to he a thousand plus a hundred ; also sometimes deDotillg thousand. B A title similar to a knighthood. A country scoured by the monkeys iD search of **SITA**. Bactrians or People of the nonh and west of India. A titan. An *asura*. A sacrifice at which liberal distributions of gold are made. and The ' Sciellce of sacred formulas ', given to **RAMA** by the Sage Vishvamitra. The monkey king of Kishkindhs, brother of **SUGRIVA**. A monkey leader. A king who the son of Vikubhi and the father ol Anaranya. A titan leader. One of **RAMA**'s courtiers. A Deity mentioned iD the Vedas; it is the name of an Aditya presiding over love and marriage ; the appellation actually means ' Wealthy Master ' or ' Gracious Lord ' and Bcstower of Wealth'; this name is also used for the Moon. A descendant of King Sagara, who by his penances brought the River Ganges to eanh. GLOSSARY A name of **SHIVA**. One of the eighteen Puranas ; a revelation of future events by **BRAHMA**. 'Fear', the sister of Kala and consort of Praheti. A kettledrum. GLOSSARY BIIAHM....,m. A Constellation said by some to be ShraV8118 9.v. The name of a certain class of *Rishi*, higher than a Maharishi and of the order. Sometimes written **BRAHMA** *rishi*.} A titan warrior. BRAHMASmRAS. The Abode of the Deity presiding over the **BRAHMA** Weapon. who recites or expounds the Veda, or teaches the Spiritual Knowledge. BRIHASPATI or VRIHASPATI. The spiritual Preceptor of the Gods, also said to be the Regent of the Planet Jupiter which is called by the same name. BUDHA. The Planet Mercury. BULL. The white bull, called Nandi, which is said to be the God **SHIVA**'s vehicle and represents the Ssttwa-guna. (See under Gunas.) CAsns. There are four castes, the priesdy, warrior and merchant class and the one thst serves the other three. A Sage who entertained Shattughna in his hermitage. The King of the Gandhatvas. The Celestial

Gardens belonging to the God Kuvera. A tombstone, column, monument or sacrificial pile. Designation of a class of Beings ; the name means Moving in a circle '. A fish resembling a whei:J. A Brahmany Duck or Ruddy Goose. A Chowrie or fan made uf Yaks tails, an uf royality. GLOSSARY The mountain where **KUMBHAKARNA** slept. BIRD. ' Cuculus Melanoleucus ', a bird that according to legend lives only on tain-drops. An army consisting of foot soldiers, cavalry, elephants and chariots. The Planet Spica. The month Chitra or Chaitra which is of February and March. A sacred mountain where **RAMA** and **SITA** dwelt in exile and to this day considered a holy A Sage, the son of the *Rishi* Bhrigu. D A monkey who guarded a grove and ill-treated by **ANGADA**'s victorious troops. Giants, titans or demons. One of **BRAHMA**'s sons, whose daughter Uma became the consort of **SHIVA**. A female demon named Surasa also. Traditional offering made after a sacred ceremony. A titan warrior. A race of Giants who were enemies of the Gods. A staff or rod. The name of Somali's son whose story is told in ' ., 'Bearer of the Rod', a name of Death as Bearer of the Rod of Punishment. The name of a vast forest lying between Rivers Godavari and Natmada, the scene of **RAMA** and **SITA**'s exile. DANDI. One of Sun-god's doorkeepers. GLOSSARY Robbers. or A small Gallinule resembling a cuckoo. The Celestial Region or the Abode of the Gods. ' Slayer of the Gods ', the title of a titan warrior. See under *Rishi*. The Gods or Shining Ones. A mountain that was called the' Refuge of the Gods'. The daughter of the GandhaTva Gramani who became the consort of **SHIVA**. The wife of Nahusha. A tide given Parvati, the consort of **SHIVA**. A name of Kuvera meaning 'Granter of Wealth'. A tide meaning' Victorious in Battle', used for the Moon-god, Fire-god and others. 'Lord of Wealth', a tide given to Kuvera. The Veda of Archery. The mother of Atikaya. One of the wives of the Sage Kashyapa. The Goddess of the Earth personified

as the wife of Dhruva q.v. Righteousness or duty, the traditionally otdained course of conduct ; one of the four ends of life which are *Dharma*, Artha, and *Moksha*-duty, prosperity, legitimate pleasure and liberation. *Dharma* is personfied as one of the Prajapatis, the God of Moral Law and Spiritual Duty. A Sage whom **RAMA** encountered ncar the 'Lake of the Five Nymphs.' One of Rams's counsellors. A title of **YAMA** as God of Justice. or DHATRI. 'Creator', 'Author', 'Founder', a name given to **BRAHMA**, **VISHNU** and others. A Sage. DHRISHTI. One of the chief counsellors at the court of King **DASARATHA**. GLOSSARY DINDIMA. A musical instrument. A Sage. A Sage. Dm. The daughter of Daksha and wife of Kashyapa ; she became the mother of the Daityas. 'Bringer of Day , a tide of the Sun. A measure approximating ninety-two pounds. A sacred spot spoken of by the Lord of the Waters on which **RAMA** was told loose his destructive weapon. Woven silk or very fine cloth made of the inner bark of the plant of the same name. A Son of Maya, a giant who fought with Bali, the King of the Monkeys. A kettledrum. A title given to **RAVANA** meaning Dreadful ', ' Unapproachable ' or ' Unassailable city. A monkey warrior. A female titan. DUivASA. A Sage. DusuANTA. A General in Khara's army who was slain by **RAMA**. A king who yielded to **RAVANA** without fighting. A titan warrior. A monkey warrior. Prince of S'abra and father of Satyavanta. This includes the qualiry of accepting the truth and what is right, cherishing it, remembering it, propagating it and the knowledge of the ultimate essence. A female titan. GLOSSARY QuALITIES. Knowledge of time and place, endurance, empirical knowledge, skill, physical strength, power of concealing one's counsd, the honouring of obligations and promises, heroism, appreciation of the enemy's strength and one's own relation to it, gratitude and beneficence to one's dependents or suppliants, non-acceptance of insult, freedom from

uncontrolled movements (*poise*). The father of Jamhavan. GADHI. The father of the Sage Vishvamitra and the son of King Kushanabha, hence the patronymic ' K.aushika '. A king who yielded to **RAVANA** without fighting. A monkey leader. A Sage who prevented **RAVANA** and King Mandhata from using the dcsuuctive weapon reconciling them. A general in the monkey army who was wounded by Indrajita. A mountain of fragrant forests to the east of Mount Meru, sometimes called the Mountain of Intoxicating Fragrance '. A where the cities that were ruled over by the sons of **BHARATA** were established, now Afghanistan. Celestial musicians. or or The sacred river Ganges known under many other names such as : Bhagirathi-after the Sage Bhagiratha. Harasckhara-the Crest of **SHIVA**. Khapaga-Three-way ftowing. Mandakini-Gently-ftowing. Jabnavi after the Sage Jahnu and so on. The wife of Kashyapa and mother of horses. or A great Sage who is mentioned in the Upani shads. GLOSSARY The most sacred prayer of the Rig-veda which is personi as a Goddess and considered to be the consort of **BRAHMA** and mother of the four Vedas. A monkey leader. 'He from whom ftoweth the fruit of acts', or ' He from whom cometh showers ', a name given **INDRA**. A titan warrior. titan. A nymph, the wife of Kushanabha and mother of a hundred daughters. Go. A leader of **VARUNA**'s troops. A river close to Dandaka Forest. GoDHA. A piece of leather or metal worn on the Jell arm to protect Soft leather, possible cow or doc-skin. GoltARNA. A hermitage. black monkey that has a tail like a cow ; also called Gopuccha. A giant. The Cow-sacrifice. The son of Matali and the charioteer of Jayanta. 'A Ford for Cattle', a place of pilgrimage near the River Sarayu. The sacrifice of a cow lasting a day. An inauspicious planet such as Mars, Saturn, R.ahu and Ketu. A cluster or group of inauspicious planets. The leader of an army or of a village or community. A Gandharva who gave his daughter, Devavati, to Sukesha

in marriage. oF WoliLD. A title given to **BRAHMA**, the Creator. GamHBAS. Birds of prey. Ganu. One who, having completed his education, marries and GLOSSARY H A Gandharva. 'Ugliness' from which 'Halya' meaning 'Ugly' is derived. See the story of Ahalya. A swan, heron or flamingo. or monkey was and friend and a great devotee of **RAMA**. He was the son of Pavana, the Wind-god and the Nymph Anjana. The name actually means ' He of the fractured jaw '. A name of **SHIVA**. A son of Mali. A monkey warrior. HARA-HAlu:. The name of **SHIVA** and **VISHNU** conjoined. A name of the Sun-god and of lndra. An *Asura*. The name of the Lord **VISHNU** meaning ' Captivating ', 'Pleasing'. ' Having horses ', a title given to lndra. A female titan. monkey warrior. A Daitya. The people born of the Cow Shabala. The name of **GARUDA**. The abode of lndra. A star identified as Corvus. A titan. A city on the Ganges. HAVIs. A sacred draught or anything offered as an oblation with fire, clarified butter or ghee. The son of Vishvamitra. A particular offering to the Gods in an ancient Fire ceremony. 'Horse-necked', according to one **VISHNU** himself assumed this form to recover the Vedas which had been stolen by two Daityas, Madhu and Kaitabha. GLOSSARY The name of **BRAHMA** as having been born from the go!deo Egg, a manifestation of the Supreme Soul. HlllANYA-KAsHIPU. ' Clothed in Gold', a title given to a Daitya who obtained the sovereignty of the Three Worlds from **SHIVA** for a million years and who persecuted his son Prahlada who was a devotee of **VISHNU**. 'Having golden seed', a name of Agoi and the Sun. The *Homa* Sacrifice is the act of making an oblation the Gods by pouring butter into the fire to the accompaniment of prayers and invocations. It is regarded as one of the five great Sacrifices called *Deva-yajnas*. HRAOINI. A titan. A titan. The father of **JANAKA**. lbiSHIKBSHA. A name of **VISHNU** meaning ' Lord of the Organ. of Sense Hunu. A Gandharva. '

Eater of the Sacrificial Offerings ', a name given the God of Fire, Agoi. A river. The son of Manu, founder of the Solar Race of Kings who ruled over Ayodhya. ILA. The name of King Kardama when he had been transformed into a woman. A demon subdued by the Sage Agastya. The King of the Gods who is known under orher names such as: Mahendra-Great God. Shatakratu-He of a Hundred Sacrifices. Purandara-Destroyer of Cities. Vajrapani-He of the Thunderbolt Hand. Lord of Sachi, (*Sachi being his consort*). Maghavan-Possessor of Wealth, and other titles. GLOSSARY A title meaning ' Granter of Enjoyment or Refreshmelu '. The name of one of the great Serpents. IRAVAn. The mother of the elephant Airavata q.v. ' Ruler ', ' Master ', a name of **SHIVA**. Legend or tradition, history or traditional account of former events. or A *brahmin* at King **DASARATHA**'s court. GLOSSARY A tide meaning 'Victorious', 'Triumphant' given to **VISHNU**. The locks of a devotee. A monkey warrior. A sacred ceremony, really the *Soma* Ceremony with GLOSSARY A son of Mali. The wife of King Asit, mothet of Sagara. A river. of The name of Saudasa, whose story is told in Uttatakanda. A demon or goblin. of A Day, and Night of Btahma, a thousand *Yugas*. A tree of Patadise. KAMA. The Indian Cupid or God of Love, also called by other names. Artha. The wish-fulfilling cow which belonged to the Sage **VASISHTHA**. A titan. The city ruled over by Brahmadatta. A woollen cloth or upper garment. A kind of gold. mountain. A kind of gold. A Sage in the line of Bhrigu. **SHATRUGHNA**'s family priest. A monkey warrior. Anothet name of the God of Love. A *Rishi* who cursed a forest. A forbeat of Bali. A great *Rishi*, the son of Medhatithi, the fathet of Kandu. A Sage. 'Wearing a Kaparda ', a special knot of hair; a name A titan. A monkey. GLOSSARY The law governing the behaviour of matter in all its gross and subde forms in accord with the divine purpose. The Sun. A kind of

gold. A tide of Arjuna, the King of the Haihayas. KARnKA. October, when the sun enters Libra. The God of War who is called Skanda and Mahasena. He was the son of **SHIVA**. A people. The modern sacred city. The King of Kashi was A region explored by the monkeys for **SITA**. An ascetic. The great Vedic Sage, grandson of **BRAHMA**, who was the father of Vivasvata. A and Writer of great celebrity, the author of Dharmashastra. A cloth. **DASARATHA**'s chief queen and the mother of **RAMA**. A *Rishi*. A tide of Vishvamitra after his grandfather. The name of a devotee who went to hell for having pointed out a road to robbers by which they pursued and killed some persons who were fleeing from them. The sister of Vishvamitra who became a river. The celebtated jewel that churned from the ocean and later adorned the breast of **VISHNU**. Headless spirits or ghosts. A Sage. A river, the resort of Apsaras. A class of Celestial The father of **HANUMAN**, a monkey warrior. KEsmNI. A river. GLOSSARY KINNERAS. Celestial Beinp with hones heads who attend on the God Kuvera. KniATAS. A race of hunters. Knm. A celestial nymph personifying fame and glory. KlsHKINDHA. The country ruled over by Bali, poasibly Myaore ; this kingdom handed on to **SUGRIVA** by **RAMA**. KNoWER SELF. A knower of Truth or Reality-en illumined being. KoSHAIA. The kingdom ruled over by King **DASARATHA**. KOTI. Ten millions. A lapwing. A monkey warrior. KRAro. A great Sage, one of the seven immortal Sages, Regents of the stars of the constellation of the Plough. 'Protector of sacrifices', a title of **VISHNU**. KRAuNCHA. A species of heron, Ardea Jacolator. A mountain. A Sage. A forest. A KRAUNCHr. A daughter of Kashyapa and Tamra; she became the mother of owls and birds of prey. KaiKARA. A partridge. A KlusHNAVARTMAN. Father of Kratbana, a monkey leader. A river. Destiny, fate or death. The name means 'Bringer to an end'. KllrrAYUGA. The Golden Age. KRITtiKAS. The Pleiades,

nurses of the God of War, Karttikeya. One of the wives of Kashyapa. KansHA. A distance equal to the distance the voice carries. The Kshara River, said to be in hell, its are corrosive. GLOSSARY KuMBBAHANU. One of Prahasta's companions. The brother of **RAVANA**, a monster slain by **RAMA**. A name given tbe Sage Agastya referring his birth in a jar, The conson of Madhu. A monkey leader. One of tbe elephants of tbe four quarters. The fatber of Anjana and maternal grandfather of **HANUMAN**. The place where Vishvakarma constructed an abode for Agastya. An osprey. Kuaus. A tribe. A forest. KusHA. One of tbe sons of **RAMA** and **SITA**. The brotber of **JANAKA** and father of tbe wives of Shatrughns and **BHARATA**. The son of Kusha and grandson of **BRAHMA**. The son of Kusha and brotber of Kushambha ; his daughters married Brahmadatta. A monkey, the son of Vivasvata. The son of Sahadeva and fatber of Somadatta. The city built by **RAMA** for his son Kusha. The descendants of Kusha. KunKA. A river. A river. KUTSA. An ascetic. KAlKA. The sign of Cancer. The sign of Pisces. The twelve signs of the Zodiac are considered as rising above tbe horizon in the course of tbe day. The Lagns has the name of tbe sign, its duration is from the first rising of tbe sign till tbe whole is above tbe horizon. Lagns literally means tbe point where tbe horizon and tbe patb of tbe planet meet. GLOSSARY Time in regard to music, quick, moderate, slow. The Planet Mars. The Guardians of the four quarters who were Gods. 'Creator of Joy', 'Bringer of Happiness', a tide given to **BRAHMA** or **SHIVA**. LoLA. A Danava, the filther of Madhu. A king whose story is told in . A titan. The wife of the Sage Agastya. LoSHTA. A vessel of coconut or metal used for begging and cere monial purposes. M The temporal juices of an elephant in rut. The frenzy of intoxication. The God of Love, or Kandarpa. The wife of King Saudasa. or Spiritous liquor made of honey and molasses and the blossom of Bassia Latifolia.

A name of **VISHNU**. A name of the earth meauing ' Vernal Beauty ' or ' Drinker of *Soma* '. A demon, slain by Vishou Vishvamitra's son who was cursed by his father for disobedience. A city founded by Danda. A mixture of eurda, butter, honey and the milk of coconut, a traditional offering., The city of Madhu taken by **RAVANA**. GLOSSARY MA!wAYA, A titan warrior. 'Loud-throated\ the name of a titan warrior. One of the elephants supporting the four quarters. 'Mighty-flanked', a titan warrior. Death, the word means ' Setting out on the journey ' or ' Departure from life '. A titan warrior. A titan, the son of Khara. A son of Vishvamitm. Car-warriors, those who can take on ten thousand archers single-handed Great warriors. Great *Rishis*, also spelt Maharishis. A mountain. The God of War, Skanda or Karttikeya. or A mountain where the sun was said to rise. Cosmic Intellect. 'Of great energy or lustre', a title. 'Great soul', a tide given to a *Rishi* or Great forest. A name of Indrs. A mountain in the centre of the sea visited by **INDRA** at the time of the new moon. name of **SHIVA**. MAHI. The Earth Goddess. The city ruled over by King of the Haihayas. Great or powerful animal ', a name given to Dun dubhi, the bufl'alo slain by Bali. city ruled by God of The name of a son of V1Shvamitra. general in **RAVANA**'s army. The name means 'Huge bellied'. GLOSSARY MAKAaA. A kind of sea-monster, sometimes confounded with a shark, crocodile or dolphin. A country. A mountain on the summit of which Agastya dwelt. MALI. One of the sons of Sukesha. or **RAVANA**'s father-in-law, the brother of Sumali and father of **MANDODARI**. or A lake on Mt. Kailasha, said to he hollowed out of the mind of **BRAHMA**. The name means ' Lake of the Mind ' ; it is still considered a sacred place. A Chittrakuta. A treeless mountain where Kama practised austerities. A circle. A mountain used in the churning of the ocean by the Gods and *Asuras*. A Sage. **BHARATA**'s wife, the daughter of King Kushadwaja. Terrible demons that hung suspended

from rocks in **GARUDA**'s abode. or A king of the race of lkshvaku, the son of Yuvaneshwa. **RAVANA**'s consort and the mother of Indrajita. A monkey warrior. One of Kuvera's warriors who was slain by Prahasta. A Yaksha defeated by Dashagriva; see under Parshva-Mauli. MANKUKA. A musical instrument. A name of Kama, the Ged of Love. The hunch-hacked maid of **KAIKEYI**, who inspired her mistress to exact the fulfilment of the boons King **DASARATHA** had conferred on her. A sacred formula. A minister of **DASARATHA**'s court. GLOSSARY The place on which **RAMA** loosed an arrow on the request of the Ocean. Lords of the Tempest. A name of **HANUMAN** as son of Maruta, the Wind·god. A who encountered **RAVANA** while sacrificing the Gods. A Sage, disciple of Samvarta. Marutta officiated at the Ashvamedha Sacrifice for King lla. MAsHAS. A class of Sage or Hermit. A measure. lndra's charioteer. A Sage. A forest or wood. Elephants. An aerial Being mentioned in the Rig-Veda as bringing down fire to eanh. A sacred city. A titan warrior. A Sage. The deluding power of the Lord by which the universe has come into existence and appears as real. The son of Diti, a giant who created a magical cave for the Nymph Hema, his consort. Maya the artificer of the Gods. A giant by Bali. A name of the earth on account of it having been covered by the marrow of Madhu and Kaitabha aftet they had been slain by **VISHNU**. The Regent of tbe clouds. A of Indrajita meaning ' The Roar of a thunder cloud'. Musical instruments. One of the ' ragas ' or musical scales. An ornament wom round the GLOSSARY MluGI. The daughter of Krodavasha, the mother of elephants. See under and MluTYU. The God of Death, another name of **YAMA**, meaning ' Bringer of Death '. A class of servants. An instant, a moment, an hour according the conmu MUNDt. ' Shaven ' or ' bald '. MVNI. A holy Sage, a pious or learned person, a tide given to a holy man. A country. A tambourine. People cursed by Vishvamitra who

subsequently assumed the lowest caste. N The son of Yayati and father of Aja. Sea-serpents. Those of the Serpent Race. The father of King Yayati. Nahusha’s curious story is found in the Mahabharata and the Puranas. Interpreters of the Veda. WooD. A wood so-called because Gauri-mukha destroy ed the army of *Asuras* there in the ' twinkling of an eye ', ' nai-misha ' meaning ' twinkling '. It was in this wood that **RAMA** celebrated the Ashvamedha Sacrifice. The ruling star of the titans. A name given to the titaDs as offilpring of Nairtita. One dweJiing in the sky or 'Nab’, a divine being. GLOSSARY The son of Vaishravana who was wedded to Rambha and cursed **RAVANA** for his assault on her. A river. A demon slain by **INDRA** by meana of the foam on water. A Sage. The celestial Gardens of **INDRA**. NANDI. The sacred bull that is **SHIVA**’s vehicle and which symbo lizes the Sattwa-guna. The city from which **BHARATA** ruled in **RAMA**’s absence. A Sage who cursed **RAVANA**. A divine Sage who appeared to **VALMIKI** and told him the histoty of **RAMA**’s life. See . Hell, of which Manu enumerates twenty divisions, some being the abode of serpents or demons. The seven best knowo are : Atala, Vitala, Sutala, Rasatala, Talatala, Mahatala and Patala. The name of a demun slain by **INDRA**. A son of Kashyapa and Kalaka. ' Destroyer of man ', a son of **RAVANA**. The King of Kailasha who was vanquished by **RAVANA**. A name of **VISHNU**, so called because the waters (*Nara*) were his first place of motion. A river. A Gandbarvi, whose daughten married Sumali, Mali and Malyavan. Dancers, actors, bards, mummers or heralds. Dancen. or A small gallinule. Nmms. The penonified treasures of the God of Wealth. A titan, the son of Kumbhabrna. OM. See under Awn. GLOSSARY The sacred syllable ' OM’ or ' AuM '. OsliADHI-PRASTHA. The 'Place of medicinal herbs’, a in the Himalayas mentioned in the ' Kumara Sambhava ' a poem, on the God of War by Kalidasa. A measurement, a thousand billions. A

Yaksha. An elephant. A lotus. Woons. Woods sought **SITA**. The 'Lotus-navellcd One', a name of **VISHNU**. 'He the lotus', of Sun. 'The Lotus-forest', a celestial retreat. Warriors born of the sacred cow Shabala, for protection. A name possibly given to the Persians. P A demon slain by Indta. P The Punisher of Paka ', a title given to lndra. The moon. Winged clouds. A lake. The lake by which **RAMA** and **LAKSHMANA** rested in their exile. or A monkey leader. A titan who was one of Bibishana's counsellors. A Danava slain by **VISHNU**. **VISHNU**'s conch. GLOSSARY Bracelets. A spoon used in sacrifices. A funeral couch or pyre. One of the principal mountain ranges in India, said to rise from the sea. A Vedic Deity or Rain God. Sometimes used as a title for **INDRA**. GLOSSARY A name of the sun. A minister of **SUGRIVA**. A name of **VISHNU**. A monkey leader. ' The Fierce One ', a name of the sun. The eleventh Prajapati, Guardian of the West. The father of **VALMIKI**. A name given to **VARUNA** and **AGNI**. A salutation which consists of circumambulating a person keeping him on the right hand. A titan slain hy **HANUMAN**. One of **VARUNA**'s ministen. A titan, the father of Jambumalin and **RAVANA**'s coun sellor. He the conqueror of Manibhadra and was later slain by Nila. PaAmm. A Daitya, see Heti. A Daitya. A monkey warrior. Lord of Beings', a name given to **BRAHMA** and other Gods. The sons of Brabma. A city. A mountain. The time of dissolution of the world at the end of a world cycle. A titan. A monkey renowned for his courage. One of Bibishana's ministers. An ascetic. An ascetic. ViiBI air or breath. The Practice or Science of breath control. GLOSSARY A spotted deer or piebald horse. l'RITIUVI. The earth. PRITHU. The son of Aoaranya and the father of Trishanku. A monkey warrior. A ti-. A dappled deer. The twelfth Prajapati. The daughter of the Demon Vaishvanara who became the wife of Kashyapa. The seventh and considered the most auspicious Nakshatra q.v. A nymph. A A

nymph outraged by **RAVANA**. 'Well spoken of',' Famed', a tide of **VISHNU**. Legends and tales of ancient times in epic form ; there are eighteen main Puranas. ' Destroyer of Cities ', a title of lndra. See Purohita. PuRoHITA. A family priest. Puau. The son of Yayati. A king who yielded to **RAVANA** without fighting. The son of Budha and Ila. Pururavas married the Nymph Urvashi and their son was Ayus. PuRusHA. The Supreme Spirit, the Soul of the Universe, the otiginal man. A measurement, said to be twelve span. 'Appearing before creation', a title applied to ancestors. or The sun or' Newly-risen Sun' or' Maintainer', a Vedic Deity, brother of Sucya, personified as a herdsman in the heavens. **BHARATA**'s son. The City of the Gandharvas ruled over by **BHARATA**'s son. GLOSSARY R A titan warrior. RAIIHJtu. A Gandharva, one of the guardians of the sandalwood forest. A tide of those belonging to the House of Raghu to which King **DASARATHA** and forbeatS belonged. The son of Kakutstha and father of Pravriddha. RAHu. A mythical demon said to cause the eclipse of the sun or moon by assuming a meteor's shape. The city ruled by **BHARATA**'s maternal uncle, from which **BHARATA** brought home on the occasion of Ranta's exile. A royal swan or royal *Rishi*. See also under *Rishi*. See under Gunas. A great sacrifice performed in ancient times at the installation of a monarch. The 'Place of the Silver-navelled One', a mountain near Mount Kailasha. One of Suntali's sons. RITES. Rites to avert evil. Titans or demons. A female titan or demon. ' Of a red or crimson colour ', a name of the Sun. or The Incarnation of **VISHNU** who appeared as the eldest son of King **DASARATHA**. It is round this great figure that the Ramayana is written. The recitation of ' Ramayana ' which has been a tradition in India for thousands of years. A nymph who symbolized the perfection of beauty and who was often sent from **INDRA**'s realm to Sages from their pious practices. A monkey leader.

GLOSSARY RAvt. The Sun. The wife of Yamadagni and the mother of Parasurama. RJcmKA. An ascetic who gave his second son Shunashepha to be sacrificed. The son of Bhrigu whom **VISHNU** gave his bow. The husband of Satyavati. RIG or Rlo-VEDA. The original Veda, a collection of hymns. A The bears. A mountain. A monkey. A monkey leader. Rlsm. A great Sage or illumined Being of which there were four classes: Maharishi-A great *Rishi*. Rajarishi-A royal Rihi. Brabmarishi. A sacred *Rishi*. Devarishi. A divine *Rishi*. The mountain on which **SUGRIVA** took refuge and where he met **RAMA**. The' Deer-homed', the son of Sage Vibhandaka, who married the daughter of King Lomapada, Shanta, and later performed the Puttresti ceremony for King **DASARATHA**. A title of **VISHNU** meaning 'Of true and pure nature '. It also used for the thirteenth Manu. RITU. Any fixed time appointed for regular worship or sacrifice such as Vasanta, the Spring; Grishna the hot season; Sarad, the Autumn; Hemantashishshira, the cold and dewy season. The priests officiating at an installation ceremony. Roo See also Glossary. RoHt. A fish-Cypryous Rohita Ham. A deer. RoHINI. The Star Aldebaran. RoHITA. A species of deer. A Gandharva who guarded a sandalwood forest. RoHITAS. The name of the steeds of the Sun-god. The name of a Deity celebrated in the Atharva Veda probably a form of the Sun or Fire-god. GLOSSARY An island full of gold mines where the monkeys searched for **SITA**. RUllu. A deer. A of Yatudhanas. SACHI. lndra's conson who was said to be the daughter of the Oaitya Puloman. ' Ever-going ', a name of Vayu, the Wind-god. SADHYA. The daughter of DakshL The personified rites and prayers of the Vedas, who dwell between heaven and eanh and are classes as Deities. SADIN. A titan. A king whose history is recorded in . The discus ofVishnu that forged by Vishvaksnna. The' Thousand-eyed God , a tide of IndrL SAHASRAllCms. ' Thousand-rayed a title of the Sun. A A mountain

passed by the monkeys on their match to the sea. A wooden monar for cleaning rice. The daughter of Sandhya and the conson of the Titan Vidyukesha. A race of giants to which Malyavan, Mali and Sumali belonged. The mountains where the Monkey Sharabha lived. of sons. A titan warrior. SAMIDH The fuel, wood, logs or grass in a sacrificial offering. A monkey chief. Grandsire of the monkeys. GLOSSARY The Goddess of the dawn and dusk. Devotions undertaken at dawn and dusk. S.unru. A measure, a thousand Arbudas q.v. or A region near or the extension of Brahmsloka where the hears and monkeys went on leaving their bodies. A monkey warrior. A monkey warrior. The Sapindi Ceremony undertaken for the establish ing the connection with kindred through funeral offerings. One of the titan generals. The hennitage of the seven Sages. A titan warrior. The seven *Rishis* who are said to be the Regents of the Seven Stars of the Plough. SAPTA-SAPTI. ' He from whom proceed the seven senses ' or ' Who bas seven steeds ' , a title of the Sun-god. The daughter of the King of the Gandharvas Shailusha ; she was the conson of Bibishana. A bird or animal of variegated colour such as the peacock or spotted deer. A goose. The Goddess of speech and learning. A river. The sacred river, the Sarju. A chapter The elephant that carried Kuvera. One of the elephants of the four quarters. Consists of' Mura Valerian' and such drugs. mountain. A *brahmin* who ill-treated a dog, his story is told in . beings collectively. GLOSSARY SAUMJTIU. A name of **LAKSHMANA** as son of **SUMITRA**. The Planet Mercury. A divine potion ; the name means ' relating to the Sun '. A country where the monkeys searched for **SITA**. Socha! Salt or alkali. or The sun, the producer of heat and the spiritual faculties of heat. SENANJ. The leader of an army. A name for the God of Love. The sacred spot where **RAMA** threw the bridge over the sea to Lanka. The wish-fulfilling cow belonging to **VASISHTHA**. or SmBRI. A female

ascetic whom **RAMA** visited while in exile. A grassy spot. A mountain. A river. SHAILUSHA. A Gandharva, guardian of a sandalwood forest. The mountain where **RAMA** found the and slew him. A people. A name of **INDRA**, King of the Gods. A standard or flag set up in honour of **INDRA**. The abode of Shakra. A fabulous thorny rod of the cotton tree used for torturing the wicked in hell. A porcupine. See also WEAPONS The Demon of Drought represented in the Rig-veda as the enemy of **INDRA**. The place of Shamhara's bow. 'Bringer of Felicity', the name of a Vedic Deity, later associated with **SHIVA**. The ' Soul of the Universe ' in its cosmic form of the eleven Rudras. GLOSSARY ' Reed-bom ', a name of Kamikeya. A monkey warrior. A monkey leader. One of **RAVANA**'s spies. GLOSSARY SHRUTA-Knm. The consort of **SHATRUGHNA**. SHRUTI. The Vedas severally. ' The Firm', a name of **SHIVA**. Ooe of the lowest caste. One of **RAVANA**'s spies. A Gandharva. A Parrot. The Planer Venus. A great Ssge, Shuktschacys who was said to be the of Bhrigu aod whose patrionymic Bhargava. Shumbha and Nishumbha were two *Asuras* and brothers who against the Gods and were slain by the Goddess Durga A monkey warrior. The son of the Sage Richika. An Asurs. The second son of the Sage Richika who offered as a human sacrifice but saved by the Sage Vishvamitra. A Gandharva, guardian of a sandalwood forest. The region round Mathura. The word means ' Worthy of Heroes '. A city ruled over by **SHATRUGHNA**. of titan was mutilated by **RAMA** and Lakshmaoa. A name of the Wind-god. A name for the Demon of Drought. A mountain. The Planer Venus. The King of Vidarbha. A monkey warrior. A son of King Sudesa. The daughter of Kashyapa aod Tamrs, mother of birds of prey. GLOSSARY The God of War who was the son of **SHIVA**, also called Karttikeya. A kind of wood taken from the Cordia Myxa Trees. A forest. SMRITI. Literally 'What is remembered', tradition or laws given

by Manu and others. *SoMA*. The Moon·god, said to be a son of the Sage Atri. The juice that is fermented from Asclepias·adda ; it is used as a beverage or libation in sacred ceremonies. The daughter of Urmila and mother of Brahmadatta. A mountain. SouRA Countries east of Koshala. A marine monster. A species of deer. A Sage who was harassed by the Demon Kabandha. The stone on which Rudra sat to practice asceticism. A son of **SHATRUGHNA**, who was installed in the City of Madhava. A monkey warrior. A demon who disturbed the sacrifices of the Sage Vishva mitra. A sacred tree. A son of Varona. A monkey leader. One of King **JANAKA**'s ministers. A lake covered with silver lotuses. An island where the sun is said to rise. An elephant ridden in battle by Mahadeva. A king of the Vidarbhas. The name of one of the guardians of the four quarters. A name of **VISHNU**. A mountain. GLOSSARY The Sun appears under countless names such as :-Anshu man, Ahaskara, Bhanu, Bhaskar, Divakara, DiDakara, Gava sthana, Prabhakara, **SURYA**, Savita, Sura, Suvarnasdrisha, Twasta, Vyomanatha and others. Having a beautiful navel ', a name given to the Moun tain Mainaka. A name given to the son of **GARUDA**. The father of Maricha. SuNDARI. A name meaning ' Beautiful ' the consort of Malyavan. A name of **GARUDA**, King of the Birds. A son of the Vulture Sampati. A Titan warrior. A Goddess who created celestial weapons ; she a daughter of Dakaha. A monkey warrior. SuRA. The Sun. The daughter of Krodhavasha ; she became the consort of Kashyapa. One of **RAMA**'s courtiers. A titan general. A name of the Gods ; in the Veda it is applied to the offspring of the Sun. A female demon who sought to obstruct **HANUMAN** when he was traversing the ocean. The country round Mathura. One of King **DASARATHA**'s ministers. A king who yielded to **RAVANA** without fighting. A son of King Sudesa, King of the Vidarbhas. A monkey warrior. A monkey warrior. The place where the suns meet. The abode

of **SURYA**, the Sun-god. A titan. GLOSSARY SuvARNIMI!RU. One of the so-called ' Golden Mountains ' of which there were sixty thousand. A mountain. A mountain near Lanka where **RAMA** stationed His troops. One of King **DASARATHA**'s spiritual Directors. Ornaments worn in the ears. SvADHA. An oblation offered to the Pitris. The word means ' Inherent power or strength '. A sea out of which the Jarupashila Mountain rose. SvAHA. The consort of **AGNI**. A word of power used in invocation and sacrifices. The utterance of' Svaha' at ceremonies. SwAMPRABHA. The daughter of the Sage Merusavami. SWAllGA. The Celestial Region. SwAllGIN. An iohabitant of the celestial Region. The Self-existent', a name of the Creator. A ceremony where the bride chooses her own consort. A beoediction. A religious rite preparatory to a sacrifice. A Sage. A river. A mountain in the sea. TAITTIRYA. One of the Upanishads. TAKSHA. A son of **BHARATA**. A name of Vishvaltartna. A name of one of the Great Serpents. The city ruled by Taksha, **BHARATA**'s son, said be ideotilied with Taxila that was occupied by the Greeks and barbarians. TALA. A leather strap used by archers. A clapper used in music. GLOSSARY T A meteor. A monkey warrior. A monkey leader. T In ancient times considered the personification of the Sun in the form of a bird, later it became the name of **GARUDA**. The father of the monkeys. A Yakshini, the mother of Maricha. A lake. Lustre, energy or effulgence and spiritual power. The. This title 'Tlu-DASA' applies to the Gods; in round numbers thirty-three-twelve Adityas, eight Vasus, eleven Rudras and the Ashvins. TIME, The. Past, present and future. The. The Ahavaniya Fire in the east for offerings to the *Devas*, the Dakshina Fire in the south for offerings to the Pitris and the Gahapatya Fire in the west which is per petually maintained and passed on from father to son and from which the other sacrificial fires are lit. The. Wind, bile and phlegm. common or

ordinary, important and orgent. QuALmES. Renown and virility, majesty and beauty, knowledge and dispassion. AsoDES, or The Bhur, Bhuvah, Swab, the lower, middle and upper worlds, also called Tri loka and Tri-bhuvana, that is heaveo, eanh and the lower worlds. A A mark of auspiciousness placed on the forehead. TIME. See TiMI. A whale or large fish. The father of lndra and also of the Danavas and Shamhara. GLOSSARY A Sage whose daughter became the consort of the Sage Vishravas. 'Three-way-flowing', the 'Traverser of the Three Worlds ', a name of the Ganges. A demon slain by **SHIVA**. A city put to fire by the Gods. A king of the Solar Race whose story is told in Bala *kanda*. A constellation. Also called ' Trimurdhana ', a three-headed titan slain by RamR. TRivARSHA. Three consecutive showers favourable to crops. The City of **INDRA** also called Amaravati. ' Three-eyed', a name of **SHIVA**. This title can also meao ' Uttering the three Vedas or the three mystical Syllables ' A Gaodbarva cursed by the God Kuvera and hom as the Demon Viradha. or A name connected with the Sun, with one of the Adityas and also Vishvalalrma ; The meaoing is ' One who shines '. TWICE-BORN. Only a *brahmin* can strictly termed ' Twice hom ', but the tide came to be extended later to the warrior and the agricultural classes. u The white horse of lndra produced from the churning of the ocean by Gods and *Asuras*. It is said to be fed on ambrosia and be the foremost of steeds. A golden mountRin. One of the four officiating priests at a sacrifice. GLOSSARY A titan warrior. A Great Serpent. UPENDRA. A name of **VISHNU** and later of lndra. Great Serpents, those of the Naga Race. URMILA. The consort of Laksbmana. URVASHI. A nymph mentioned in the Rig-Veda. Many legends are told of her in the classics. Another name of Sbukra, the Guru of the *Asuras* and Daityas. This Sage assisted Indrajira in his sacrifices. Saline soil. (See , Ch. LXXXVI.) USHIRABIJA. The mounrain that is also called Mandara

where King Marotta performed his sacrifice. UsHIRAS. A hair-like grass growing on the golden trees of bell. See also and TREES Glossary. A river. *KANDA*. The seventh and supplementary book of' Rarnayana'. KURus. A race said to befriend spiritual persons. A constellation under which **SITA** was said to have been bom. The Mother of the Gods and Goddess of speech and learning. She is also called Saraswati. or 'Mare's Fire', the subterranean fire or the fire of the lower regions, fabled to emerge from a cavity called the ' Mare's mouth ' under the sea. 'Mare's mouth', the entrance to the nether region said to be found at the south pole where the submarine fire is found. One of the Adityas presiding over wealth. GLOSSARY A name of **GARUDA**. or A name of the Sun and Moon, meaning ' Illumining '. One descended from Virochana. A patronymic of Bali. The Son of Prahlada. Relating **VISHNU** or a sacrifice in his honour. The Vaishnavas are devotees of **VISHNU**. A name of Kuvera, **RAVANA**'s brother. The name of the daughter of the Sage Bbaradwaja. The Relating to all the Divinities or Vaishvas or Vishvas. The God of Fire, **AGNI**. The Zodiac. Those of the merchant or agricultural classes. A river in See Vivasvat. A name of the God of Death, **YAMA**. A sacrifice at which an acetous mixture of meal and water is offered to the Gods. GLOSSARY ' Dwellers in the forest ', a name given the monkey race. A special breed of elephants. Female monkeys. A mythical bird. A mountain. The mother of kine and bulls. V.UUNA. The Indian Neptune, Lord of the Waters. V.uUNI. ThedaughterofVaruna who was the personification of wine. Wine prepared from Hogsweed distilled with date or pslm juice. river. A name of lndrs. A name of Bali, as son of **INDRA** or Vasava. A word of power, a holy Syllable. The utterance of' Vashat' at ceremonies. A Sage. A great Sage, the spiritual Preceptor of King **DASARATHA** and **RAMA**'s own Guru. 'Abiding Lord', a tide. The son of King Nriga, whose story is

told in ' .' One of the Seven Immonal Sages. V ' One who grants wealth or treasure ' , a name of the earth. A Gandharvi who married Mali. A name of the Lord. Containing wealth ', a name of the earth. The Serpent King. A name of **AGNI**. The sons of Kashyapa and Aditi. The eight Vasus were originally personifications of natural phenomena, they were Apa, Dhruva, *Soma*, Dhara, Anila, Anala,Pratyusha and Prabhasa. Another name of Amaravati, the Qty of In drs. A name of Vayu, the Wind-god. A demon consumed by the Sage Agastya. GLOSSARY The son of the Ssge Kashyapa and the father of Rishyashringa. Celestial or Gods. See Bibishana. A Deity or Teacher of the spiritual truth. The Moon. A country, probably Birar, whose capital was Kundipura. A name of **BRAHMA**, the Creator. 'Magical-knowledge Holder', a particular class of or evil spirits attendant on the Gods. A A titan skilled in who created an illusoty head of **RAMA** and his how to deceive Sits. A monkey warrior. A monkey warrior. A titan A Daitya, the son of Heti. A titan. A pleasure garden or recreation ground, temple or sanctuary. Those who roam about at pleasure ', a name given to the monkeys. A minister at King **DASARATHA**'s court. A titan. A titan. A titan. A Sage. An lndisn lute. The mother of **GARUDA**. A monkey warrior. A class of Beings, sometimes malevolent. The hour that is auspicious for finding what has been lost. A ordered by Agastya not height. GLOSSARY The son of King Saudasa who became as Kalmashapada on account of a curse. VtsHAKA. A lunar asterism. A month in the flowering season. VISHALA. A titan. ' Having beautiful eyes ', a name of **SHIVA**, **GARUDA** and a Great Serpent. 'Lord of Men', a tide. The Lord in the aspect of' Maintainer of the Universe'. A great Sage born of Prajapati. The name comes from the root ' Sru to listen, his mother conceived when listening to the Veda being recited. He is said to be the son of Poulastya in 'Ramayana' and was the father of **RAVANA** and Kuvera.

VISHVA. The daughter of Daksha. A title meaning ' He who pervades all '. or All the Gods who are said to be the 'Preservers of Men ' and ' Bestowers of Rewards '. They are the sons of Vishva. The architect of the Gods. The 'Maker of Weapons'. Another name for Vishvakarma. 'Possessed of all desirable things' or 'Granting all boons ' or ' Adored or cherished by all ', a title. A great Sage whose story is told in . 'Lord of the Universe', a of **SHIVA**. A tide of **VISHNU** meaning ' Omnipresent ' or ' Wear ing all '. The God of the Wind. VITAPAVATI. The Ciry over which Kuvera ruled. A titan warrior. VITTAPA. A name of Kuvera. 'The Brilliant One', the Sun. Vivasvat was said. be the father of Manu. GLOSSARY w y YADu. The son of Yayati and Devayani. Yayati the founder of the Yadavas in which line Krishna waa born. *YAJNA*. A sactifice or penance. A titan wartior slain by **RAMA**. A titan warrior. The pan of the Veda that treats of rituals. Y A minister of **SUGRIVA**. Y Supernatural Beings, attendant on Kuvera. Female Yaksbas. The God of Death. An *Asura*, enemy of the Gods. Y Enemies of Krishna who in the form of trees he uprooted as a child. A Evil Spirits assume various forms. is also given to the Raksbasaa. An island searched by the monkeys for **SITA** and RavanL A *Rishi*. A people said to have been born of the sacted cow Shabala. One of **RAMA**'s ministers. The son of Nahusha, a forbear of King Daaaratba, his story appears in the ' Mahabharata ' and the ' **VISHNU** Purana '. 'Union': the methods (of meditation, mind-control, self discipline etc.) through which man came to realise the identity of his own essential being with God. 'The United', a title. FLOWERS AND TREES (Wherever possible Latin or English derivatives are given but in some cases no equivalent has been traced.) A A species of Fig. Agaru Amyris Agallochum, a species of Sandalwood. Semicarpus Anacardium Zeylanica, Plumbago. The Marking Nut Plant. Phyllanthus Emblica. A many-branched shrub resem bling Hemlock.

The fruit is known as Myrabolan and has healing properties; it is often seen in the hand of ' Menhla' the Buddha of Medicine, Mangifera Indica. A short-trunked tree covered with evergreen foliage which flowers from January to March; the blooms are partly white and partly greenish yellow with an orange stripe on each petal. This ttee is sacred to Hindus and Buddhists. The wood is used for funeral pyres and the flowers are dedicated to the Moon and the God of Love. or or Alangium Hexapetalum. small or medium sized, partially deciduous tree with branches armed with spines that grows throughout India in dry regions. The wood is olive brown, hard and close grained, the leaves oblong, glabrous and dark green. The flowers single or in clusters are white and scented; the fruit, a berry, is purplish red. Roors and fruit are used medicinally. Said to be a cure for snake and rat bite and also to alleviate colic and diseases of the blood. It is used as a substitute for Ipecacuanha. GLOSSARY AsaoKA. Saraca Indica. A small evergreen tree which produces a profusion of orange and scarlet clusters of blossom in January and February and has deep dark green shining foliage. Buddha is said to have been born under an Ashoka Tree and **SITA** was kept prisoner by **RAVANA** in an Ashoka Grove. Both Hindus and Buddhists regard it as sacred and it is said to flourish where a woman's foot has trod. The bark is astringent and bitter, cooling and refrigerant, useful in colic, emaciation and certain venom poisoning; it highly beneficial in vaginal disorders and effective in hremorrhages and ulcers. or Vatica Robusta, Sal large tree that grows in the eastern districts of central India. The wood, which ranks with teak is in general use in Bengal. The flowers are abundant and whitish or pale rose in colour. The Saul Tree. or The Fig Tree of which there are many varieties: Ficus Bengalensis-The Banian Tree. Ficus Religiosa-The Pipal or Peepal Tree. Ficus Glomerata-The Rumba! or Umbar Tree. Ficus Elastica-The India

Rubber Tree. AnMUKHA. Premna Spinoza. The wood of this tree is used for kindling. Dalbergia Oujeinensis. Grows in the hilly tractS of N. India twenty to thirty ft. high. The flowers are abundant and whitish or pale rose. Mountain Ebony. This tree is commonly known as Harimantha. B or Ziziphus Jujuba. The Jujube Tree, an attractive small or medium tree which flowers in April, its blossom forming pale green stars. The pulp of the fruit is eaten with sugar and the kernel raw. Sherbet is made from it and the Lac-insect feeds on this tree ; its secretions are used for dyes, lacquer, ink and polishes. GLOSSARY Pentapetes Phoenicia. A plant with a red which opeos at midday and withers away at sunrise. or V Hibiscus Murabilis. Changeable Rose. Blooms in September and October and possesses large heart shaped leaves ; the flowers are three or four inches across,. pure white in the morning, gradually changing to pale pink and red by evening. The name of various plants and also a tree. Mimosa Seressa, a lofty Fig Tree. Calosaothes Indica. This tree that grows to 40 ft. in height is found throughout India. The batk is thick, the leaves smooth, hairless and glabrous. Indian Laburnum. Monkeys are particularly partial to the sweet pulp of the pods in which the seeds lie ; it is also used for flavouring tobacco and as a purgative. The wood is good for fuel and charcoal. Dillenia Indica or Dillenia Elliptica Speciosa. A tree that grows to feet; it is an evergreen; the flowers are large and white with yellow antlers and appear at the end of the branches. This tree is found in dense forests and is much cultivated round teroples. The batk and leaves are medicinal and the juice from the acid fruit mixed with sugar makes a cooling drink. There is another small fruit allied to the Mango1ia Speciosa of this name. Trapa Bispinosa. A floating herb, that grows throughout India and Ceylon, the velvety flowers have four small white petals. BmmTAKA or or VmiiiDAitA. Terminalia Bellerica. The

Belleric Myrabolan, an important forest tree, though not considered useful for timber, beir.g subject to insect attack. Its fruit however, which appears as a grey velvet ball, is used for medicinal purposes as also for dyes and tanning. The kernels yield oil and, if taken in excess, are said to produce intoxication. A favourite food of monkeys, squirrels, deer and other animals. The flower sprays, in creamy tassels,. appear from March to June. The fruit is known as Myrabolan and this name is also used for the fruit of the Am1aka (*Phyllan thus Bmblica*) and Tenninalia Chebula, the three making a tonic called 'Trefala Churan '. GLOSSARY A species of Thorn-apple. One of the Magnolias that wild in the Eastern sub-Himalayan tract and lower hills, also in Assam, Burma and Southern India ; it is much cultivated. A tall, handsome, quick-growing tree that is evergreen, the flowers are deep yellow or orange and very fragrant. The bark, flowers and seeds are used for various purposes. The bark has stimu lant, expectorant and astringent qualities, the flowers yield a fragrant oil used in opthalmia and gout. The dried buds of this are the pungeot and aromatic clove. Sirium Folium. The sweet-scented Oleander Rosebay which grows in rocky stream-beds on the lower Himalayas. It has evergreen foliage and flowers throughout the year. The blooms are deep rose, pink and white in sprays and are offered to **SHIVA**. The poison, contained in the leaves, when made into a paste, is used for leprosy and skin diseases. A Mango Tree. D or Punica Grantum. The Pomegranate which grows throughout India and is indigenous to Persia and Mghani stan. A large shrub or sometimes small tree with numerous asceoding branches. The flowers are funnel-shaped and orange in colour. The fruit is bard globose and yellow, tinged with red when ripe. The root-bark is a vermicide. The juice is appetizing and tonic, useful in fever, dyspepsia, bilious ness and heartburn and has other curative properties. GRAss. Poa Cynosuroides, a grass used at

sacrifices. GLOSSARY Datura Fastuosa (*Solanaceae*). An annual poisonous shrub with a strong disagreeable smell that grows throughout India. The flowers, similar to the convolvulus in shape, are purplish white outside and white inside ; the fruit is a small prickly ball closely packed with smooth yellowish-brown seeds. The leaves, flowers and seeds are used medicinally and are narcotic and soporific. Fomentations of the leaves are said to relieve the pains and swellings of rheumatism and the dried flowers, when powdered, are inhaled for asthma and bronchitis and coughs. The shrub, Grislea Tomentosa, which is common throughout India, the searlet flowers on long spreading branehes appear in the hot season. One of the Acacia family. A small tree bearing white flowers, commonly known as Ghalaghasiya or Halaksiya. A plant from the stem of which very fine cloth is made. DuavA. Panicum Daerylon. Bent Grass. a kind of Arum. GLOSSARY colour appear from March to May. Vinegar is distilled from the juice of the fruit, a one-seeded berry, blackish purple when ripe. The bark, leaves and fruit have other medicinal pro perties. A kind of grape without pips. Prunus Padus L. Bird Cherry. China Rose or Shoe Plant, which has large single bell-shaped flowers of a rich chinese red. These are used for decoration at festivals. The crushed flowers are used for shoe polish. K or Musa Sapientum. The Plantain or Banana Palm, which has a soft perishable stem and is poetically a symbol of the frailty of human existence. Several plants such as Pistia Stritiotes and Bombay Hepthyllum. The Plant Nauclea Cadamba. A white water-lily. See A species of Sandal Tree. Various leguminous seeds, chiefly Phaseolus. Also some kinds of pulse and vetches. A fragrant Aloes-wood. The yellow Sandal Tree. A kind of Turmeric. The Plant Curcuma Xanthorrhiza. A species of Mimosa. Averrhoa Carambola. A small densely branched tree with variegated white and purple fiowers and one variety produces an edible

sweet yellow fruit. GLOSSARY Pongamia Glabra. The !lowers of this tree in white short sprays appear when the new leaves are developed. It is a medicinal tree from which an embrocation is made for skin diseases. The juice is applied to sores and used for cleaning teeth as it has antiseptic qualities. Another fragrant Oleander that common to many pam of India in the rocky stream beds of the lower Himalayas, fringing roads and rivers. The foliage evergreen throughout the year, but at its height during the rains; the fi.owers are deep rose and white, single and double. The sap is poisonous. Pterosptemum Acerfolium, also called Cassia Fistula. The common name of this is Kaniyar and it is one of the Indian Laburnums. Ficus Glomerata. In April, the new leaves of shining dark red, lend it a beautiful appearance ; its fruit much relished. This tree commonly known as Rumhal or Umhar. Gmelina Arborea. The Liquorice Plant. Reeds or Rushes. Bignonia Suavolens. The Yellow Elder. A Trumpet Flower, an extensive climber clear yellow Bowers of which there are several varieties. A tree with orange-coloured fragrant !lowers. Pandanus OdoTatissimus. Grows in the hottest parts of India. The leaves are drooping, green and glossy and the Bowers crowded as a catkin-like spadia of orange yellow. Acacia Catechu. The Areca or Berel-nut Palm which grows in damp coastal regions of Southern India and Ceylon. Betel-nut the fruit uuiversally chewed by Asian people. Pheonix Sylvestris. See Rintala. Arundo Karka. A reed or hollow bamboo or rattling cane. A tree of the same name. or Butea Frondosa. A tree with beautiful orange Bowers and a quantity of milky sticky juice. It is called the ' Flower of the Forest ' or ' Parrot Tree '. From GLOSSARY GLOSSARY MATULINGA. A Citron or Sweet Lime. MAuNJA. A kind of grass. The’ Reviver of the Dead,, a herb. Pterospemum Suberifolium, a white variety of Calottopis Gigantica, a Thorn-apple. MuCHULINDA. Probably connected with tbe ' Muchi Wood’ or 'Coral

Tree'. See N Mesua Ferres, a small tree. NAGAvaJKSHA. A mountain Shrub. or Caleduba Arborea or Dalbergia Arborea. NALJNA. Nelumbium Speciosum. A water-lily. NAICAL GRAss. Phragmites Karka Trin. A species of Reed. NAIIKELA. A rail unbranched tree with a terminal plume of pin nate leaves ; its flowers are yellowish and resemble stiff catkins. Tbe nut is edible and oil is obtained from it which is used for soap, shampoos and culinary purposes ; it is also useful for tbe manufacture of candles. NICHOLA. Barringronia Acutangola, commonly called Hijjal. An Ashoka with blue flowers. NIMBA. Azadirachta Indica. A tree with bitter fruit, tbe size of an olive ; the leaves are chewed at funerals and are said to ward off sickness and, when dried, keep off insects ; the timber is similar to mahogany. NIP A or NIP A species of Kadamba Tree. or Wild Rice. NY Ficus Indica. The Indian Fig Tree. OSHADJ. An annual plant that dies after opening. p GLOSSARY Like the Kapitha, this tree, Artocarpus Intergrifolia is also a Jack-fruit which bears the largest edible fruit in the world, weighing up to roo lbs, round and irregular; it is in great demand but less favoured than the Mango or Plaintain. This tree grows in the forest in the Western Ghats. Erythinia Fulgens. A Coral angular spikes of rich red blooms along its bare branches from January to March. A tropical climbing plant. or Bignonia Suavolens. A tree with sweet scented blossom, possibly the red Lohdra. Mesua Roxburghii. A medium-sized tree found in the mountains of East Bengal and the Eastern Himalayas. The leaves are dark green and glossy and the flowers composed of four pure white petals and large golden antlers. or The Pipal, a Fig Tree, Ficus Religiosa. or or A tree similar to the Madhuka. The common Oil Plant. A vine-like plant. Known as Saj and Maddi, a common forest tree that yields excellent hard timber. Fragrant seed, Italian Millet. Long Pepper. Saffron. Various plants. Rottleria Tinctoria. The ftowers of this tree

produce a yellow dye. A Cypress. Sacred Basil. Q R GLOSSARY s Shorea Robusta. The Sal Tree. Bignonia Indica. The Gum Tree. Deep blue llowers in clusters appear at the beginning of the hot season and fade later to pale silver when golden berries appear. A translucent green resin exudes from this tree, with a pleasant odour. Tbe wood, gum, bark and fruit all have medicinal value. The timber is known as Ligoum Vitae or Brazil Wood. A medicinal herb. ' That which produces a salve for wounds '. Stercula Foetida. Poon or Devil's Tree, a wild Almond. The black seeds of this tree are roasted and eaten like chestnuts but, taken raw, bring on nausea and vertigo. Seven-leafed Milk Plant. Alstonia or Echites Scholaris, the Seven-leafed Tree. Pinus Longifolia, a species of Pine. White Murdah. Saccharum Bengalense Retz (S. Roxb.). One of the sugar canes. A long winding creeper. Fresh green grass. Vallisneria Octandra or Bexica, an aquatic plant. Bombas Malaharicum or Gossampinus Malaharicum or Salmalis Malaharica, the Red Silk Cotton Tree. A tall, handsome tree found all over India except in the driest areas. The large llowers, appearing in January or February, are brilliant scarlet and pink ; they are much sought afrer by birds of evety kind, and people also consider them edible. In April, the fruit appears like green fingers which later be come brown and split open when a fluffy cotton is freed and lloats down to earth ; this is used for tinder and stuffing pillows. An astringent gum is also obtained from this tree. This is said to be a tree that grows in hell and the fabulous thorny rod from it is used for torturing the wicked. GLOSSARY A kind of grain belonging to the variety called Shashtika. Fig-tree at Prayaga. The sacred basil. A climbing plant, the Ichnocarpus or Echites Frutescens. SILLEA. Cephalostashum Capitatum Munro, a large bamboo. Datura Mete!, a Thorn-apple. Cassia Sianica. A Cassia with bright yellow flowers. Vitex Negundo, a small tree. Cordia Myxa. Scarlet Cordia or Aloe Wood. This

tree produces fragrant white flowers in March and April. The fruit is like a pale cherry, the nut is edible and the pulp makes bird lime ; it is also medicinal. Simplocos Racemosa, a tree bearing white flowers. Another Sal tree. A sacred herb 'That which heals the skin Astercantha Longifolia. Dalbergia Ougeninensis, a tree similar to the T The Shrub Tabaemoemontana Coronaria. The Moon beam or Waxfiower, which has dazzling white Bowers which women wear in their hair, The seeds of the three-ribbed fruit make a red dye; the roots mixed with lime juice are used as a cure for eye diseases ; a fragrant powder and perfume are prepared from the scented wood. Pinieta Acris. TALA. Borassus Flabelliformis. The Palmyra Palm, one of the most important of Indian trees. A kind of sugar is obtained from it and the intoxicating drink ' Arrack ' is made from the fermentation of this juice. Fans, mats, etc. are made from the leaves which are also used for thatching ; the hard outer wood of the tree is made into posts and other domestic objects and the hollowed out stems used for waterpipes. The jelly-like pulp of the fruit and the soft kernels of the young fruit are cooked and eaten as vegetables. Brushes come from the ribs of the leaves and the stalks are used for torches. GLOSSARY TIMIDA. Sesamum Indica, the Sesamum Plant which bears an oily seed used in cookery. TIMIIIA. An aquatic plant. or TINtsHA. A climbing plant with purple fiowers. A kind of Pumpkin or Water-melon. Diospyros Glutinosa or Diospyros Embryopteris, a kind of Ebony. A Persimmon. Rottleria Tinctoria. A Coconut. u or Paspalum Frumentaccum. ' Uddalaka pushpa-bhanjika’ or the 'Breaking of the Uddalaka Flowcn ', is a game played by the people of the eastern districts of India. Spikenard. A gnss, the small Saccharum. Andropogan Muricatus, a fragrant root. The blue Lotus. A water-lily. Costus Spcciosum, a plant. Bamboos. Memisa Sirissa. Calamus Rotang, a reed. Hibiscus Mutabilis. GLOSSARY w y z WEAPONS A The Fire

Weapon or Weapon of the Fire-god Agui. **INDRA**'s Weapon. Arrow. Part of a wheel, probably the hub. A Weapon the course of which cannot be followed. Arrows resembling bands with the palms hollowed as in a salutation. A Goad. A Weapon called the 'Web'. A Weapon producing moisture. ARHANI. The Thunderbolt. A kind of Arrow or Dart. A magic Weapon used by the *Asuras*. A Weapon with a bent or curved head. The Weapon of Defence, or Protection. A kind of Dart or Arrow. B Crescent-shaped Arrows. Short Darts or Arrows thrown by hand or shot through a tube. An iron Spear or Dart or a stone fastened a string. A Weapon that breaks through or pierces. The Rod of **BRAHMA**. GLOSSARY or A Weapon that tears or splits asunder. The Drying-up Weapon. The Ten-eyed Weapon. The Ten-headed Weapon. The Weapon that robs of The Weapon that brings The Weapon of Nemesis. The Sacred-navelled Weapon. The Weapon that has the power of entangling the foe. The of or The Active of Arrow. DHRITI. The Weapon of Forbearance. The Titanic Weapon. The of Navel. A form of the Danda Weapon. E F G The Weapon of the Gandharvas. H GLOSSARY Weapons in which evil spirits are said to reside. Really magical formulas said to exorcise weapons possessing evil spirits.]YOTISHTA. The Luminous Weapon. K The Noose of Death. K.u.AslwatA. The Discus of Death or Time as Death. KAI.ISHA. An Axe or Hatehet. KAMARucm. An Arrow or Dart, one that is bright and able to go where it will. KAMAiluPA. A Weapon able to assutne any fortn at will. KAMI!.u.A. A Harpoon. A Weapon exciting sex·desire, named after the God of Love Kandarpa. A Weapon protecting the side, possibly a of the armour. A Helmet. The Weapon of the Valiant Hand. Barbed Arrows with two sides resembling ears. A Whip. KAuMoDAIt. The Iron-headed Qub belonging to Shri **VISHNU**. The word actually means a small bell, hence the weapon may have had bells hung on it.

KouMADAKI. A Weapon that gives to the earth. KRoUNCHA or The Heron,s Beak. KsHAPANI. An Oar or Net; something that destroys the destroyer. KSHUIIA. An Arrow with a razor-like edge or a sharp blade attaeh ed to a shaft. GLOSSARY M Weapon of Kandarpa. The Great-armed or Great-handed Weapon. The Great Magical Illusion or the Lying Weapon. The Weapon **SHIVA**. MALI. The Weapon that holds or binds. A particular magical Weapon employed by the Gan dharvas. The Weapon of Manu. The essence of the nature of an Arrow. A Weapon that inflicts injury or suffering. MA The Great Deception. MoDAKI. One of two beautiful mythical Clubs. The Weapon of Inebriation. MoHA. The Weapon that causes loss of consciousness. MoHAN. The Weapon of Attraction. One of the of Kandarpa. N Magical Formulas pronounced on Weapons. An Iron Arrow or Dart and also a Pike or Javelin. The Joy-producing Weapon employed by the Vidya dharas. An Iron Arrow. A Water-weapon. The Discourager. The Peaceful. A Sword, Scimitar or Falchion more than thirty fingers in length. GLOSSARY The Moving Weapon. The Supreme Qearing Weapon. The Great Mouthed Weapon. Slayer of the Brave. An Iron Weapon. An An or Hatchet. An Iron Bludgeon or Iron-Studded Qub. A Rope. A Weapon sacred to **SHIVA**. A kind of Sword. The Weapon of the Pitris. The Chumer. A Bearded Dart. The Weapon of Destruction. A Weapon dealing with the vital airs. A Weapon causing sleep. Vayu's Weapon. That which neutralizes the effects of other weapons. PuaANG A Weapon that has its face averted. Q R The Desolator. The Titan-Astra which destroys the fortune, courage and life of one's foes. RAn. The Weapon of Enjoyment. RlsHTIS. Swords, Arrows or Speara, Weapons of the Maruts. GLOSSARY The Weapon of Existence. KIRTI. The Justly-famed. The Moon's Weapon. The Heroic Weapon. Iron Spears, Lances or Pikes. The Vulture-shaped Weapon. A Dart, Javelin or Spear

tipped with iron. A Weapon of **SHIVA**'s called the ' Cause of Welfare '. The Weapon with a flaming mouth. The Bow of **VISHNU**. A spiked Mace or a stone set round with iron spikes; it is named ' Slayer of Hundreds'. 'Having a hundred Feathers', probably an Arrow. The Hundred-mouthed Weapon. The Hundred-bellied Weapon. One of the two beautiful mythical Clubs. SHIUMUKHAS. Arrows resembling Heron's feathers. A sharp Arrow. A Weapon used to dry up water and counteract the Varshana Weapon. The Pure-handed Weapon. The Dry Weapon. A Weapon resembling Lion's Teeth. The Dew Weapon. The Fine-navelled Weapon. A Weapon named ' The Blasting of Enemies ' that steals away lustre and beauty. The Weapon of the Controlled Mind. A Weapon affeeting sleep. The Richly-navelled Weapon. T See Bhalla.